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First Canto

Preface

We must know the present need of human society. And what is that need? Human society is no longer bounded by geographical limits to particular countries or communities. Human society is broader than in the Middle Ages, and the world tendency is toward one state or one human society. The ideals of spiritual communism, according to *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, are based more or less on the oneness of the entire human society, nay, of the entire energy of living beings. The need is felt by great thinkers to make this a successful ideology. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* will fill this need in human society. It begins, therefore, with the aphorism of Vedānta philosophy *janmādy asya yataù* [SB 1.1.1] to establish the ideal of a common cause.

Human society, at the present moment, is not in the darkness of oblivion. It has made rapid progress in the field of material comforts, education and economic development throughout the entire world. But there is a pinprick somewhere in the social body at large, and therefore there are large-scale quarrels, even over less important issues. There is need of a clue as to how humanity can become one in peace, friendship and prosperity with a common cause. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* will fill this need, for it is a cultural presentation for the respiritualization of the entire human society.

Srimad-Bhagavatam should be introduced also in the schools and colleges, for it is recommended by the great student-devotee Prahlāda Mahārāja in order to change the demoniac face of society.

*kaumāra ācaret prājñodharmān bhāgavatān ihadurlabhaà mānuñāà
janmatad apy adhruvam arthadam (Bhāg. 7.6.1)*

Disparity in human society is due to lack of principles in a godless civilization. There is God, or the Almighty One, from whom everything emanates, by whom everything is maintained and in whom everything is merged to rest. Material science has tried to find the ultimate source of creation very insufficiently, but it is a fact that there is one ultimate source of everything that be. This ultimate source is explained rationally and authoritatively in the beautiful *Bhāgavatam*, or *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

Srimad-Bhagavatam is the transcendental science not only for knowing the ultimate source of everything but also for knowing our relation with Him and our duty toward perfection of the human society on the basis of this perfect knowledge. It is powerful reading matter in the Sanskrit language, and it is now rendered into English elaborately so that simply by a careful reading one will know God perfectly well, so much so that the reader will be sufficiently educated to defend himself from the onslaught of atheists. Over and above this, the reader will be able to convert others to accepting God as a concrete principle.

Srimad-Bhagavatam begins with the definition of the ultimate source. It is a bona fide commentary on the *Vedānta-sūtra* by the same author, Śrīla Vyāsadeva, and gradually it develops into nine cantos up to the highest state of God realization. The only qualification one needs to study this great book of transcendental knowledge is to proceed step by step cautiously and not jump forward haphazardly like with an ordinary book. It should be gone through chapter by chapter, one after another. The reading matter is so arranged with its original Sanskrit text, its English transliteration, synonyms, translation and purports so that one is sure to become a God-realized soul at the end of finishing the first nine cantos.

The Tenth Canto is distinct from the first nine cantos because it deals directly with the transcendental activities of the Personality of Godhead Śrī Kṛṣṇa. One will be unable to capture the effects of the Tenth Canto without going through the first nine cantos. The book is complete in twelve cantos, each independent, but it is good for all to read them in small installments one after another.

I must admit my frailties in presenting *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, but still I am

hopeful of its good reception by the thinkers and leaders of society on the strength of the following statement of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* (1.5.11):

*tad-väḡ-visargo janatägha-viplavo
yasmin prati-çlokaṃ abaddhavaty api
nämäny anantasya yaço 'ikitäni yac
chäëvanti gäyanti gäëanti sädhavaù*

“On the other hand, that literature which is full with descriptions of the transcendental glories of the name, fame, form and pastimes of the unlimited Supreme Lord is a transcendental creation meant to bring about a revolution in the impious life of a misdirected civilization. Such transcendental literatures, even though irregularly composed, are heard, sung and accepted by purified men who are thoroughly honest.”

Oà tat sat

A. C. Bhaktivedanta Swami

Dated at Delhi

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Introduction

The conception of God and the conception of Absolute Truth are not on the same level. The *Srimad-Bhagavatam* hits on the target of the Absolute Truth. The conception of God indicates the controller, whereas the conception of the Absolute Truth indicates the *summum bonum* or the ultimate source of all energies. There is no difference of opinion about the personal feature of God as the controller because a controller cannot be impersonal. Of course modern government, especially democratic government, is impersonal to some extent, but ultimately the chief executive head is a person, and the impersonal feature of government is subordinate to the personal feature. So without a doubt whenever we refer to control over others we must admit the existence of a personal feature. Because there are different controllers for different managerial positions, there may be many small gods. According to the *Bhagavad-gita* any controller who has some specific extraordinary power is called a *vibhūtimat sattva*, or controller empowered by the Lord. There are many *vibhūtimat*

sattvas, controllers or gods with various specific powers, but the Absolute Truth is one without a second. This *Srimad-Bhagavatam* designates the Absolute Truth or the *summum bonum* as the *paraà satyam*.

The author of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, Srila Vyāsadeva, first offers his respectful obeisances unto the *paraà satyam* (Absolute Truth), and because the *paraà satyam* is the ultimate source of all energies, the *paraà satyam* is the Supreme Person. The gods or the controllers are undoubtedly persons, but the *paraà satyam* from whom the gods derive powers of control is the Supreme Person. The Sanskrit word *éçvara* (controller) conveys the import of God, but the Supreme Person is called the *parameçvara*, or the supreme *éçvara*. The Supreme Person, or *parameçvara*, is the supreme conscious personality, and because He does not derive any power from any other source, He is supremely independent. In the Vedic literatures Brahmā is described as the supreme god or the head of all other gods like Indra, Candra and Varuëa, but the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* confirms that even Brahmā is not independent as far as his power and knowledge are concerned. He received knowledge in the form of the *Vedas* from the Supreme Person who resides within the heart of every living being. That Supreme Personality knows everything directly and indirectly. Individual infinitesimal persons, who are parts and parcels of the Supreme Personality, may know directly and indirectly everything about their bodies or external features, but the Supreme Personality knows everything about both His external and internal features.

The words *janmädy asya* [SB 1.1.1] suggest that the source of all production, maintenance or destruction is the same supreme conscious person. Even in our present experience we can know that nothing is generated from inert matter, but inert matter can be generated from the living entity. For instance, by contact with the living entity, the material body develops into a working machine. Men with a poor fund of knowledge mistake the bodily machinery to be the living being, but the fact is that the living being is the basis of the bodily machine. The bodily machine is useless as soon as the living spark is away from it. Similarly, the original source of all material energy is the Supreme Person. This fact is expressed in all the Vedic literatures, and all the exponents of spiritual science have accepted this truth. The living force is called Brahman, and one of the greatest

äcäryas (teachers), namely Sripäda Çaikaräcärya, has preached that Brahman is substance whereas the cosmic world is category. The original source of all energies is the living force, and He is logically accepted as the Supreme Person. He is therefore conscious of everything past, present and future, and also of each and every corner of His manifestations, both material and spiritual. An imperfect living being does not even know what is happening within his own personal body. He eats his food but does not know how this food is transformed into energy or how it sustains his body. When a living being is perfect, he is aware of everything that happens, and since the Supreme Person is all-perfect, it is quite natural that He knows everything in all detail. Consequently the perfect personality is addressed in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* as Väsudeva, or one who lives everywhere in full consciousness and in full possession of His complete energy. All of this is clearly explained in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and the reader has ample opportunity to study this critically.

In the modern age Lord Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu preached the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* by practical demonstration. It is easier to penetrate into the topics of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* through the medium of Sri Caitanya's causeless mercy. Therefore a short sketch of His life and precepts is inserted herein to help the reader understand the real merit of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

It is imperative that one learn the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from the person *Bhägavatam*. The person *Bhägavatam* is one whose very life is *Srimad-Bhagavatam* in practice. Since Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu is the Absolute Personality of Godhead, He is both Bhagavän and *Bhägavatam* in person and in sound. Therefore His process of approaching the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is practical for all people of the world. It was His wish that the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* be preached in every nook and corner of the world by those who happened to take their birth in India.

The *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the science of Kṛṣṇa, the Absolute Personality of Godhead of whom we have preliminary information from the text of the *Bhagavad-gita*. Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu has said that anyone, regardless of what he is, who is well versed in the science of Kṛṣṇa (*Srimad-Bhagavatam* and *Bhagavad-gita*) can become an authorized preacher or

preceptor in the science of Kṛṣṇa.

There is a need for the science of Kṛṣṇa in human society for the good of all suffering humanity of the world, and we simply request the leaders of all nations to pick up this science of Kṛṣṇa for their own good, for the good of society and for the good of all the world's people.

A short sketch of the life and teachings of Lord Caitanya, The Preacher of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*

Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the great apostle of love of God and the father of the congregational chanting of the holy name of the Lord, advented Himself at Sridhāma Māyāpura, a quarter in the city of Navadvépa in Bengal, on the Phālguné Pūrēimā evening in the year 1407 Çakābda (corresponding to February 1486 by the Christian calendar).

His father, Sri Jagannātha Miçra, a learned *brahmana* from the district of Sylhet, came to Navadvépa as a student because at that time Navadvépa was considered to be the center of education and culture. He domiciled on the banks of the Ganges after marrying Srimaté Çacédevé, a daughter of Srila Nélāmbara Cakravarti, the great learned scholar of Navadvépa.

Jagannātha Miçra had a number of daughters by his wife, Srimaté Çacédevé, and most of them expired at an early age. Two surviving sons, Sri Viçvarüpa and Viçvambhara, became at last the object of their paternal affection. The tenth and youngest son, who was named Viçvambhara, later became known as Nimāi Paëðita and then, after accepting the renounced order of life, Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu exhibited His transcendental activities for forty-eight years and then disappeared in the year 1455 Çakābda at Puré.

For His first twenty-four years He remained at Navadvépa as a student and householder. His first wife was Srimaté Lakñmēpriyā, who died at an early age when the Lord was away from home. When He returned from East Bengal He was requested by His mother to accept a second wife, and He agreed. His second wife was Srimaté Viṣṇupriyā Devé, who bore the

separation of the Lord throughout her life because the Lord took the order of *sannyāsa* at the age of twenty-four, when Srimatē Viṣṇupriyā was barely sixteen years old.

After taking *sannyāsa*, the Lord made His headquarters at Jagannātha Puré due to the request of His mother, Srimatē Čacédevé. The Lord remained for twenty-four years at Puré. For six years of this time He traveled continuously all over India (and especially throughout southern India) preaching the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

Lord Caitanya not only preached the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* but propagated the teachings of the *Bhagavad-gīta* as well in the most practical way. In the *Bhagavad-gīta* Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is depicted as the Absolute Personality of Godhead, and His last teachings in that great book of transcendental knowledge instruct that one should give up all the modes of religious activities and accept Him (Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa) as the *only* worshipable Lord. The Lord then assured that all His devotees would be protected from all sorts of sinful acts and that for them there would be no cause for anxiety.

Unfortunately, despite Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa's direct order and the teachings of the *Bhagavad-gīta*, less intelligent people misunderstand Him to be nothing but a great historical personality, and thus they cannot accept Him as the original Personality of Godhead. Such men with a poor fund of knowledge are misled by many nondevotees. Thus the teachings of the *Bhagavad-gīta* were misinterpreted even by great scholars. After the disappearance of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa there were hundreds of commentaries on the *Bhagavad-gīta* by many erudite scholars, and almost every one of them was motivated by self-interest.

Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu is the selfsame Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. This time, however, He appeared as a great devotee of the Lord in order to preach to the people in general, as well as to religionists and philosophers, about the transcendental position of Sri Kṛṣṇa, the primeval Lord and the cause of all causes. The essence of His preaching is that Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, who appeared at Vrajabhūmi (Vāndāvana) as the son of the King of Vraja (Nanda Mahārāja), is the Supreme Personality of Godhead and is therefore worshipable by all. Vāndāvana-dhāma is nondifferent from the Lord

because the name, fame, form and place where the Lord manifests Himself are all identical with the Lord as absolute knowledge. Therefore Våndävana-dhäma is as worshipable as the Lord. The highest form of transcendental worship of the Lord was exhibited by the damsels of Vrajabhümi in the form of pure affection for the Lord, and Lord Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu recommends this process as the most excellent mode of worship. He accepts the *Srimad-Bhägavata Purana* as the spotless literature for understanding the Lord, and He preaches that the ultimate goal of life for all human beings is to attain the stage of *premā*, or love of God.

Many devotees of Lord Caitanya like Srila Våndävana dāsa Öhäkura, Sri Locana dāsa Öhäkura, Srila Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvami, Sri Kavikarēapūra, Sri Prabodhānanda Sarasvaté, Sri Rūpa Gosvami, Sri Sanātana Gosvami, Sri Raghunātha Bhaööa Gosvami, Sri Jiva Gosvami, Sri Gopāla Bhaööa Gosvami, Sri Raghunātha dāsa Gosvami and in this latter age within two hundred years, Sri Visvanatha Cakravarti, Sri Baladeva Vidyäbhüñana, Sri Çyāmānanda Gosvami, Sri Narottama dāsa Öhäkura, Sri Bhaktivinoda Öhäkura and at last Sri Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvaté Öhäkura (our spiritual master) and many other great and renowned scholars and devotees of the Lord have prepared voluminous books and literatures on the life and precepts of the Lord. Such literatures are all based on the *sastras* like the *Vedas, Puranas, Upaniñads, Ramayana, Mahäbhārata* and other histories and authentic literatures approved by the recognized *äcāryas*. They are unique in composition and unrivaled in presentation, and they are full of transcendental knowledge. Unfortunately the people of the world are still ignorant of them, but when these literatures, which are mostly in Sanskrit and Bengali, come to light the world and when they are presented before thinking people, then India's glory and the message of love will overflow this morbid world, which is vainly searching after peace and prosperity by various illusory methods not approved by the *äcāryas* in the chain of disciplic succession.

The readers of this small description of the life and precepts of Lord Caitanya will profit much to go through the books of Srila Våndävana dāsa Öhäkura (*Sri Caitanya-bhägavata*) and Srila Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvami (*Sri Caitanya-caritāmāta*). The early life of the Lord is most fascinatingly

expressed by the author of *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, and as far as the teachings are concerned, they are more vividly explained in the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*. Now they are available to the English-speaking public in our *Teachings of Lord Caitanya*.

The Lord's early life was recorded by one of His chief devotees and contemporaries, namely Srila Murāri Gupta, a medical practitioner of that time, and the latter part of the life of Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu was recorded by His private secretary Sri Dāmodara Gosvami, or Srila Svarūpa Dāmodara, who was practically a constant companion of the Lord at Puré. These two devotees recorded practically all the incidents of the Lord's activities, and later on all the books dealing with the Lord, which are above mentioned, were composed on the basis of *kaḍācās* (notebooks) by Srila Dāmodara Gosvami and Murāri Gupta.

So the Lord advented Himself on the Phālguné Pūrëimā evening of 1407 Çakābda, and it was by the will of the Lord that there was a lunar eclipse on that evening. During the hours of eclipse it was the custom of the Hindu public to take bath in the Ganges or any other sacred river and chant the Vedic *mantras* for purification. When Lord Caitanya was born during the lunar eclipse, all India was roaring with the holy sound of Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare/ Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare. These sixteen names of the Lord are mentioned in many *Puranas* and *Upaniñads*, and they are described as the *Tāraka-brahma nāma* of this age. It is recommended in the *sastras* that offenseless chanting of these holy names of the Lord can deliver a fallen soul from material bondage. There are innumerable names of the Lord both in India and outside, and all of them are equally good because all of them indicate the Supreme Personality of Godhead. But because these sixteen are especially recommended for this age, people should take advantage of them and follow the path of the great *ācāryas* who attained success by practicing the rules of the *sastras* (revealed scriptures).

The simultaneous occurrence of the Lord's appearance and the lunar eclipse indicated the distinctive mission of the Lord. This mission was to preach the importance of chanting the holy names of the Lord in this age of Kali (quarrel). In this present age quarrels take place even over trifles, and

therefore the *sastras* have recommended for this age a common platform for realization, namely chanting the holy names of the Lord. People can hold meetings to glorify the Lord in their respective languages and with melodious songs, and if such performances are executed in an offenseless manner, it is certain that the participants will gradually attain spiritual perfection without having to undergo more rigorous methods. At such meetings everyone, the learned and the foolish, the rich and the poor, the Hindus and the Muslims, the Englishmen and the Indians, and the *caëòälas* and the *brahmanas*, can all hear the transcendental sounds and thus cleanse the dust of material association from the mirror of the heart. To confirm the Lord's mission, all the people of the world will accept the holy name of the Lord as the common platform for the universal religion of mankind. In other words, the advent of the holy name took place along with the advent of Lord Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu.

When the Lord was on the lap of His mother, He would at once stop crying as soon as the ladies surrounding Him chanted the holy names and clapped their hands. This peculiar incident was observed by the neighbors with awe and veneration. Sometimes the young girls took pleasure in making the Lord cry and then stopping Him by chanting the holy name. So from His very childhood the Lord began to preach the importance of the holy name. In His early age Lord Sri Caitanya was known as Nimäi. This name was given by His beloved mother because the Lord took His birth beneath a *nimba* tree in the courtyard of His paternal house.

When the Lord was offered solid food at the age of six months in the *anna-präçana* ceremony, the Lord indicated His future activities. At this time it was customary to offer the child both coins and books in order to get some indication of the future tendencies of the child. The Lord was offered on one side coins and on the other the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. The Lord accepted the *Bhägavatam* instead of the coins.

When He was a mere baby crawling in the yard, one day a snake appeared before Him, and the Lord began to play with it. All the members of the house were struck with fear and awe, but after a little while the snake went away, and the baby was taken away by His mother. Once He was stolen by a thief who intended to steal His ornaments, but the Lord took a pleasure

trip on the shoulder of the bewildered thief, who was searching for a solitary place in order to rob the baby. It so happened that the thief, wandering hither and thither, finally arrived just before the house of Jagannātha Miçra and, being afraid of being caught, dropped the baby at once. Of course the anxious parents and relatives were glad to see the lost child.

Once a pilgrim *brahmana* was received at the house of Jagannātha Miçra, and when he was offering food to the Godhead, the Lord appeared before him and partook of the prepared food. The eatables had to be rejected because the child touched them, and so the *brahmana* had to make another preparation. The next time the same thing happened, and when this happened repeatedly for the third time, the baby was finally put to bed. At about twelve at night when all the members of the house were fast asleep within their closed rooms, the pilgrim *brahmana* offered his specially prepared foods to the Deity, and, in the same way, the baby Lord appeared before the pilgrim and spoiled his offerings. The *brahmana* then began to cry, but since everyone was fast asleep, no one could hear him. At that time the baby Lord appeared before the fortunate *brahmana* and disclosed His identity as Kṛṣṇa Himself. The *brahmana* was forbidden to disclose this incident, and the baby returned to the lap of His mother.

There are many similar incidents in His childhood. As a naughty boy He sometimes used to tease the orthodox *brahmanas* who used to bathe in the Ganges. When the *brahmanas* complained to His father that He was splashing them with water instead of attending school, the Lord suddenly appeared before His father as though just coming from school with all His school clothes and books. At the bathing *ghāṛā* He also used to play jokes on the neighboring girls who engaged in worshiping Siva in hopes of getting good husbands. This is a common practice amongst unmarried girls in Hindu families. While they were engaged in such worship, the Lord naughtily appeared before them and said, “My dear sisters, please give Me all the offerings you have just brought for Lord Siva. Lord Siva is My devotee, and Pārvaté is My maidservant. If you worship Me, then Lord Siva and all the other demigods will be more satisfied.” Some of them refused to obey the naughty Lord, and He would curse them that due to their refusal they would be married to old men who had seven children by their

previous wives. Out of fear and sometimes out of love the girls would also offer Him various goods, and then the Lord would bless them and assure them that they would have very good young husbands and that they would be mothers of dozens of children. The blessings would enliven the girls, but they used often to complain of these incidents to their mothers.

In this way the Lord passed His early childhood. When He was just sixteen years old He started His own *catuñpāöhé* (village school conducted by a learned *brahmana*). In this school He would simply explain Kṛṣṇa, even in readings of grammar. Srila Jiva Gosvami, in order to please the Lord, later composed a grammar in Sanskrit, in which all the rules of grammar were explained with examples that used the holy names of the Lord. This grammar is still current. It is known as *Hari-nāmāmāta-vyākaraëa* and is prescribed in the syllabus of schools in Bengal.

During this time a great Kashmir scholar named Keçava Kāçméré came to Navadvépa to hold discussions on the *sastras*. The Kashmir *paëòita* was a champion scholar, and he had traveled to all places of learning in India. Finally he came to Navadvépa to contest the learned *paëòitas* there. The *paëòitas* of Navadvépa decided to match Nimäi Paëòita (Lord Caitanya) with the Kashmir *paëòita*, thinking that if Nimäi Paëòita were defeated, they would have another chance to debate with the scholar, for Nimäi Paëòita was only a boy. And if the Kashmir *paëòita* were defeated, then they would even be more glorified because people would proclaim that a mere boy of Navadvépa had defeated a champion scholar who was famous throughout India. It so happened that Nimäi Paëòita met Keçava Kāçméré while strolling on the banks of the Ganges. The Lord requested him to compose a Sanskrit verse in praise of the Ganges, and the *paëòita* within a short time composed a hundred *çlokas*, reciting the verses like a storm and showing the strength of his vast learning. Nimäi Paëòita at once memorized all the *çlokas* without an error. He quoted the sixty-fourth *çloka* and pointed out certain rhetorical and literary irregularities. He particularly questioned the *paëòita's* use of the word *bhaväné-bhartuù*. He pointed out that the use of this word was redundant. *Bhaväné* means the wife of Siva, and who else can be her *bhartä*, or husband? He also pointed out several other discrepancies, and the Kashmir *paëòita* was struck with wonder. He was astonished that a mere student of grammar could point out the literary

mistakes of an erudite scholar. Although this matter was ended prior to any public meeting, the news spread like wildfire all over Navadvépa. But finally Keçava Kāçméré was ordered in a dream by Sarasvaté, the goddess of learning, to submit to the Lord, and thus the Kashmir *paëðita* became a follower of the Lord.

The Lord was then married with great pomp and gaiety, and at this time He began to preach the congregational chanting of the holy name of, the Lord at Navadvépa. Some of the *brahmanas* became envious of His popularity, and they put many hindrances on His path. They were so jealous that they finally took the matter before the Muslim magistrate at Navadvépa. Bengal was then governed by Pathans, and the governor of the province was Nawab Hussain Shah. The Muslim magistrate of Navadvépa took up the complaints of the *brahmanas* seriously, and at first he warned the followers of Nimäi Paëðita not to chant loudly the name of Hari. But Lord Caitanya asked His followers to disobey the orders of the Kazi, and they went on with their *saikértana* (chanting) party as usual. The magistrate then sent constables who interrupted a *saikértana* and broke some of the *mādaigas* (drums). When Nimäi Paëðita heard of this incident He organized a party for civil disobedience. He is the pioneer of the civil disobedience movement in India for the right cause. He organized a procession of one hundred thousand men with thousands of *mādaigas* and *karatālas* (hand cymbals), and this procession passed over the roads of Navadvépa in defiance of the Kazi who had issued the order. Finally the procession reached the house of the Kazi, who went upstairs out of fear of the masses. The great crowds assembled at the Kazi's house displayed a violent temper, but the Lord asked them to be peaceful. At this time the Kazi came down and tried to pacify the Lord by addressing Him as his nephew. He pointed out that Nélāmbara Cakravarti referred to him as an uncle, and consequently, Srimaté Çacédevé, the mother of Nimäi Paëðita, was his sister. He asked the Lord whether his sister's son could be angry at His maternal uncle, and the Lord replied that since the Kazi was His maternal uncle he should receive his nephew well at his home. In this way the issue was mitigated, and the two learned scholars began a long discussion on the Koran and Hindu *sastras*. The Lord raised the question of cow-killing, and the Kazi properly answered Him by referring to the Koran. In turn the Kazi also questioned the Lord about cow sacrifice in the *Vedas*, and the Lord replied

that such sacrifice as mentioned in the *Vedas* is not actually cow-killing. In that sacrifice an old bull or cow was sacrificed for the sake of receiving a fresh younger life by the power of Vedic *mantras*. But in the Kali-yuga such cow sacrifices are forbidden because there are no qualified *brahmanas* capable of conducting such a sacrifice. In fact, in Kali-yuga all *yajñas* (sacrifices) are forbidden because they are useless attempts by foolish men. In Kali-yuga only the *saikértana yajña* is recommended for all practical purposes. Speaking in this way, the Lord finally convinced the Kazi, who became the Lord's follower. The Kazi thenceforth declared that no one should hinder the *saikértana* movement which was started by the Lord, and the Kazi left this order in his will for the sake of progeny. The Kazi's tomb still exists in the area of Navadvépa, and Hindu pilgrims go there to show their respects. The Kazi's descendants are residents, and they never objected to *saikértana*, even during the Hindu-Muslim riot days.

This incident shows clearly that the Lord was not a so-called timid Vaiñëava. A Vaiñëava is a fearless devotee of the Lord, and for the right cause he can take any step suitable for the purpose. Arjuna was also a Vaiñëava devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa, and he fought valiantly for the satisfaction of the Lord. Similarly, Vajrägajé, or Hanumän, was also a devotee of Lord Rāma, and he gave lessons to the nondevotee party of Ravana. The principles of Vaiñëavism are to satisfy the Lord by all means. A Vaiñëava is by nature a nonviolent, peaceful living being, and he has all the good qualities of God, but when the nondevotee blasphemes the Lord or His devotee, the Vaiñëava never tolerates such impudency.

After this incident the Lord began to preach and propagate His *Bhāgavata-dharma*, or *saikértana* movement, more vigorously, and whoever stood against this propagation of the *yuga-dharma*, or duty of the age, was properly punished by various types of chastisement. Two *brahmana* gentlemen named Cäpala and Gopäla, who also happened to be maternal uncles of the Lord, were inflicted with leprosy by way of chastisement, and later, when they were repentant, they were accepted by the Lord. In the course of His preaching work, He used to send daily all His followers, including Srila Nityänanda Prabhu and Öhäkura Haridäsa, two chief whips of His party, from door to door to preach the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. All of Navadvépa was surcharged with His *saikértana* movement, and His

headquarters were situated at the house of Srivāsa Öhäkura and Sri Advaita Prabhu, two of His chief householder disciples. These two learned heads of the *brahmana* community were the most ardent supporters of Lord Caitanya's movement. Sri Advaita Prabhu was the chief cause for the advent of the Lord. When Advaita Prabhu saw that the total human society was full of materialistic activities and devoid of devotional service, which alone could save mankind from the threefold miseries of material existence, He, out of His causeless compassion for the age-worn human society, prayed fervently for the incarnation of the Lord and continually worshiped the Lord with water of the Ganges and leaves of the holy *tulasé* tree. As far as preaching work in the *saikértana* movement was concerned, everyone was expected to do his daily share according to the order of the Lord.

Once Nityānanda Prabhu and Srila Haridāsa Öhäkura were walking down a main road, and on the way they saw a roaring crowd assembled. Upon inquiring from passers-by, they understood that two brothers, named Jagäi and Mädhäi, were creating a public disturbance in a drunken state. They also heard that these two brothers were born in a respectable *brahmana* family, but because of low association they had turned into debauchees of the worst type. They were not only drunkards but also meat-eaters, woman-hunters, dacoits and sinners of all description. Srila Nityānanda Prabhu heard all of these stories and decided that these two fallen souls must be the first to be delivered. If they were delivered from their sinful life, then the good name of Lord Caitanya would be even still more glorified. Thinking in this way, Nityānanda Prabhu and Haridāsa pushed their way through the crowd and asked the two brothers to chant the holy name of Lord Hari. The drunken brothers became enraged upon this request and attacked Nityānanda Prabhu with filthy language. Both brothers chased them a considerable distance. In the evening the report of the preaching work was submitted to the Lord, and He was glad to learn that Nityānanda and Haridāsa had attempted to deliver such a stupid pair of fellows.

The next day Nityānanda Prabhu went to see the brothers, and as soon as He approached them one of them threw a piece of earthen pot at Him. This struck Him on the forehead, and immediately blood began to flow. But

Nityānanda Prabhu was so kind that instead of protesting this heinous act, He said, “It does not matter that you have thrown this stone at Me. I still request you to chant the holy name of Lord Hari.”

One of the brothers, Jagāi, was astonished to see this behavior of Nityānanda Prabhu, and he at once fell down at His feet and asked Him to pardon his sinful brother. When Mādhāi again attempted to hurt Nityānanda Prabhu, Jagāi stopped him and implored him to fall down at His feet. In the meantime the news of Nityānanda’s injury reached the Lord, who at once hurried to the spot in a fiery and angry mood. The Lord immediately invoked His Sudarçana *cakra* (the Lord’s ultimate weapon, shaped like a wheel) to kill the sinners, but Nityānanda Prabhu reminded Him of His mission. The mission of the Lord was to deliver the hopelessly fallen souls of Kali-yuga, and the brothers Jagāi and Mādhāi were typical examples of these fallen souls. Ninety percent of the population of this age resembles these brothers, despite high birth and mundane respectability. According to the verdict of the revealed scriptures, the total population of the world in this age will be of the lowest *çüdra* quality, or even lower. It should be noted that Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu never acknowledged the stereotyped caste system by birthright; rather, He strictly followed the verdict of the *sastras* in the matter of one’s *svarüpa*, or real identity.

When the Lord was invoking His Sudarçana *cakra* and Srila Nityānanda Prabhu was imploring Him to forgive the two brothers, both the brothers fell down at the lotus feet of the Lord and begged His pardon for their gross behavior. The Lord was also asked by Nityānanda Prabhu to accept these repenting souls, and the Lord agreed to accept them on one condition, that they henceforward completely give up all their sinful activities and habits of debauchery. both the brothers agreed and promised to give up all their sinful habits, and the kind Lord accepted them and did not again refer to their past misdeeds.

This is the specific kindness of Lord Caitanya. In this age no one can say that he is free from sin. It is impossible for anyone to say this. But Lord Caitanya accepts all kinds of sinful persons on the one condition that they promise not to indulge in sinful habits after being spiritually initiated by the bona fide spiritual master.

There are a number of instructive points to be observed in this incident of the two brothers. In this Kali-yuga practically all people are of the quality of Jagäi and Mädhäi. If they want to be relieved from the reactions of their misdeeds, they must take shelter of Lord Caitanya Mahäprabhu and after spiritual initiation thus refrain from those things which are prohibited in the *sastras*. The prohibitory rules are dealt with in the Lord's teachings to Srila Rüpa Gosvami.

During His householder life, the Lord did not display many of the miracles which are generally expected from such personalities, but He did once perform a wonderful miracle in the house of Sriniväsa Öhäkura while *saikértana* was in full swing. He asked the devotees what they wanted to eat, and when He was informed that they wanted to eat mangoes, He asked for a seed of a mango, although this fruit was out of season. When the seed was brought to Him He sowed it in the yard of Sriniväsa, and at once a creeper began to grow out of the seed. Within no time this creeper became a full-grown mango tree heavy with more ripened fruits than the devotees could eat. The tree remained in Sriniväsa's yard, and from then on the devotees used to take as many mangoes from the tree as they wanted.

The Lord had a very high estimation of the affections of the damsels of Vrajabhümi (Vändävana) for Kṛṣṇa, and in appreciation of their unalloyed service to the Lord, once Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu chanted the holy names of the *gopés* (cowherd girls) instead of the names of the Lord. At this time some of His students, who were also disciples, came to see Him, and when they saw that the Lord was chanting the names of the *gopés*, they were astonished. Out of sheer foolishness they asked the Lord why He was chanting the names of the *gopés* and advised Him to chant the name of Kṛṣṇa. The Lord, who was in ecstasy, was thus disturbed by these foolish students. He chastised them and chased them away. The students were almost the same age as the Lord, and thus they wrongly thought of the Lord as one of their peers. They held a meeting and resolved that they would attack the Lord if He dared to punish them again in such a manner. This incident provoked some malicious talks about the Lord on the part of the general public.

When the Lord became aware of this, He began to consider the various

types of men found in society. He noted that especially the students, professors, fruitive workers, *yogés*, nondevotees, and different types of atheists were all opposed to the devotional service of the Lord. “My mission is to deliver all the fallen souls of this age,” He thought, “but if they commit offenses against Me, thinking Me to be an ordinary man, they will not benefit. If they are to begin their life of spiritual realization, they must some way or another offer obeisances unto Me.” Thus the Lord decided to accept the renounced order of life (*sannyāsa*) because people in general were inclined to offer respects to a *sannyāsé*.

Five hundred years ago the condition of society was not as degraded as it is today. At that time people would show respects to a *sannyāsé*, and the *sannyāsé* was rigid in following the rules and regulations of the renounced order of life. Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu was not very much in favor of the renounced order of life in this age of Kali, but that was only for the reason that very few *sannyāsés* in this age are able to observe the rules and regulations of *sannyāsa* life. Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu decided to accept the order and become an ideal *sannyāsé* so that the general populace would show Him respect. One is duty-bound to show respect to a *sannyāsé*, for a *sannyāsé* is considered to be the master of all *varēas* and *āçramas*.

While He was contemplating accepting the *sannyāsa* order, it so happened that Keçava Bhāraté, a *sannyāsé* of the Māyāvādé school and resident of Katwa (in Bengal), visited Navadvépa and was invited to dine with the Lord. When Keçava Bhāraté came to His house, the Lord asked him to award Him the *sannyāsa* order of life. This was a matter of formality. The *sannyāsa* order is to be accepted from another *sannyāsé*. Although the Lord was independent in all respects, still, to keep up the formalities of the *sastras*, He accepted the *sannyāsa* order from Keçava Bhāraté, although Keçava Bhāraté was not in the Vaiñëava-sampradāya (school).

After consulting with Keçava Bhāraté, the Lord left Navadvépa for Katwa to formally accept the *sannyāsa* order of life. He was accompanied by Srila Nityānanda Prabhu, Candraçekhara Ācārya, and Mukunda Datta. Those three assisted Him in the details of the ceremony. The incident of the Lord’s accepting the *sannyāsa* order is very elaborately described in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* by Srila Vāndāvana dāsa Ōhākura.

Thus at the end of His twenty-fourth year the Lord accepted the *sannyāsa* order of life in the month of Māgha. After accepting this order He became a full-fledged preacher of the *Bhāgavata-dharma*. Although He was doing the same preaching work in His householder life, when He experienced some obstacles to His preaching He sacrificed even the comfort of His home life for the sake of the fallen souls. In His householder life His chief assistants were Srila Advaita Prabhu and Srila Srivāsa Ōhākura, but after He accepted the *sannyāsa* order His chief assistants became Srila Nityānanda Prabhu, who was deputed to preach specifically in Bengal, and the six Gosvamis (Rūpa Gosvami, Sanātana Gosvami, Jiva Gosvami, Gopāla Bhaōōa Gosvami, Raghunātha dāsa Gosvami and Raghunātha Bhaōōa Gosvami), headed by Srila Rūpa and Sanātana, who were deputed to go to Vāndāvana to excavate the present places of pilgrimage. The present city of Vāndāvana and the importance of Vrajabhūmi were thus disclosed by the will of Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

The Lord, after accepting the *sannyāsa* order, at once wanted to start for Vāndāvana. For three continuous days He traveled in the Rāōha-deṇa (places where the Ganges does not flow). He was in full ecstasy over the idea of going to Vāndāvana. However, Srila Nityānanda diverted His path and brought Him instead to the house of Advaita Prabhu in Čāntipura. The Lord stayed at Sri Advaita Prabhu's house for a few days, and knowing well that the Lord was leaving His hearth and home for good, Sri Advaita Prabhu sent His men to Navadvēpa to bring mother Čacé to have a last meeting with her son. Some unscrupulous people say that Lord Caitanya met His wife also after taking *sannyāsa* and offered her His wooden slipper for worship, but the authentic sources give no information about such a meeting. His mother met Him at the house of Advaita Prabhu, and when she saw her son in *sannyāsa*, she lamented. By way of compromise, she requested her son to make His headquarters in Puré so that she would easily be able to get information about Him. The Lord granted this last desire of His beloved mother. After this incident the Lord started for Puré, leaving all the residents of Navadvēpa in an ocean of lamentation over His separation.

The Lord visited many important places on the way to Puré. He visited the temple of Gopēnāthajé, who had stolen condensed milk for His devotee

Srila Mādhavendra Puré. Since then Deity Gopénāthajé is well known as Kñéra-corā-gopénātha. The Lord relished this story with great pleasure. The propensity of stealing is there even in the absolute consciousness, but because this propensity is exhibited by the Absolute, it loses its perverted nature and thus becomes worshipable even by Lord Caitanya on the basis of the absolute consideration that the Lord and His stealing propensity are one and identical. This interesting story of Gopénāthajé is vividly explained in the *Caitanya-caritāmāta* by Kṛṣṇadāsa Kavirāja Gosvami.

After visiting the temple of Kñéra-corā-gopénātha of Remuëä at Balasore in Orissa, the Lord proceeded towards Puré and on the way visited the temple of Säkñi-gopāla, who appeared as a witness in the matter of two *brahmana* devotees' family quarrel. The Lord heard the story of Säkñi-gopāla with great pleasure because He wanted to impress upon the atheists that the worshipable Deities in the temples approved by the great *ācāryas* are not idols, as alleged by men with a poor fund of knowledge. The Deity in the temple is the *arcā* incarnation of the Personality of Godhead, and thus the Deity is identical with the Lord in all respects. He responds to the proportion of the devotee's affection for Him. In the story of Säkñi-gopāla, in which there was a family misunderstanding by two devotees of the Lord, the Lord, in order to mitigate the turmoil as well as to show specific favor to His servitors, traveled from Vāndāvana to Vidyānagara, a village in Orissa, in the form of His *arcā* incarnation. From there the Deity was brought to Cuttack, and thus the temple of Säkñi-gopāla is even today visited by thousands of pilgrims on the way to Jagannātha Puré. The Lord stayed overnight there and began to proceed toward Puré. On the way, His *sannyāsa* rod was broken by Nityānanda Prabhu. The Lord became apparently angry with Him about this and went alone to Puré, leaving His companions behind.

At Puré, when He entered the temple of Jagannātha, He became at once saturated with transcendental ecstasy and fell down on the floor of the temple unconscious. The custodians of the temple could not understand the transcendental feats of the Lord, but there was a great learned *paëðita* named Sarvabhauma Bhaööäcārya, who was present, and he could understand that the Lord's losing His consciousness upon entering the Jagannātha temple was not an ordinary thing. Sarvabhauma Bhaööäcārya,

who was the chief appointed *paëðita* in the court of the King of Orissa, Mahārāja Pratāparudra, was attracted by the youthful luster of Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu and could understand that such a transcendental trance was only rarely exhibited and only then by the topmost devotees who are already on the transcendental plane in complete forgetfulness of material existence. Only a liberated soul could show such a transcendental feat, and the Bhaööcārya, who was vastly learned, could understand this in the light of the transcendental literature with which he was familiar. He therefore asked the custodians of the temple not to disturb the unknown *sannyāsé*. He asked them to take the Lord to his home so He could be further observed in His unconscious state. The Lord was at once carried to the home of Sarvabhauma Bhaööcārya, who at that time had sufficient power of authority due to his being the *sabhā-paëðita*, or the state dean of faculty in Sanskrit literatures. The learned *paëðita* wanted to scrutinizingly test the transcendental feats of Lord Caitanya because often unscrupulous devotees imitate physical feats in order to flaunt transcendental achievements just to attract innocent people and take advantage of them. A learned scholar like the Bhaööcārya can detect such imposters, and when he finds them out he at once rejects them.

In the case of Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the Bhaööcārya tested all the symptoms in the light of the *sastras*. He tested as a scientist, not as a foolish sentimentalist. He observed the movement of the stomach, the beating of the heart and the breathing of the nostrils. He also felt the pulse of the Lord and saw that all His bodily activities were in complete suspension. When he put a small cotton swab before the nostrils, he found that there was a slight breathing as the fine fibers of cotton moved slightly. Thus he came to know that the Lord's unconscious trance was genuine, and he began to treat Him in the prescribed fashion. But Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu could only be treated in a special way. He would respond only to the resounding of the holy names of the Lord by His devotees. This special treatment was unknown to Sarvabhauma Bhaööcārya because the Lord was still unknown to him. When the Bhaööcārya saw Him for the first time in the temple, he simply took Him to be one of many pilgrims.

In the meantime the companions of the Lord, who reached the temple a little after Him, heard of the Lord's transcendental feats and of His being

carried away by the Bhaööäcärya. The pilgrims at the temple were still gossiping about the incident. But by chance, one of these pilgrims had met Gopénätha Äcärya, who was known to Gadädhara Paëòita, and from him it was learned that the Lord was lying in an unconscious state at the residence of Sarvabhauma Bhaööäcärya, who happened to be the brother-in-law of Gopénätha Äcärya. All the members of the party were introduced by Gadädhara Paëòita to Gopénätha Äcärya, who took them all to the house of Bhaööäcärya where the Lord was lying unconscious in a spiritual trance. All the members then chanted loudly the holy name of the Lord Hari as usual, and the Lord regained His consciousness. After this, Bhaööäcärya received all the members of the party, including Lord Nityānanda Prabhu, and asked them to become his guests of honor. The party, including the Lord, went for a bath in the sea, and the Bhaööäcärya arranged for their residence and meals at the house of Kāçé Miçra. Gopénätha Äcärya, his brother-in-law, also assisted. There were some friendly talks about the Lord's divinity between the two brothers-in-law, and in this argument Gopénätha Äcärya, who knew the Lord before, now tried to establish the Lord as the Personality of Godhead, and the Bhaööäcärya tried to establish Him as one of the great devotees. Both of them argued from the angle of vision of authentic *sastras* and not on the strength of sentimental *vox populi*. The incarnations of God are determined by authentic *sastras* and not by popular votes of foolish fanatics. Because Lord Caitanya was an incarnation of God in fact, foolish fanatics have proclaimed so many so-called incarnations of God in this age without referring to authentic scriptures. But Sarvabhauma Bhaööäcärya or Gopénätha Äcärya did not indulge in such foolish sentimentalism; on the contrary, both of them tried to establish or reject His divinity on the strength of authentic *sastras*.

Later it was disclosed that Bhaööäcärya also came from the Navadvépa area, and it was understood from him that Nélämbara Cakravarti, the maternal grandfather of Lord Caitanya, happened to be a class fellow of the father of Sarvabhauma Bhaööäcärya. In that sense, the young *sannyāsé* Lord Caitanya evoked paternal affection from Bhaööäcärya. Bhaööäcärya was the professor of many *sannyāsés* in the order of the Çaikaräcärya-sampradäya, and he himself also belonged to that cult. As such, the Bhaööäcärya desired that the young *sannyāsé* Lord Caitanya also hear from him about the teachings of Vedänta.

Those who are followers of the Çaikara cult are generally known as Vedāntists. This does not, however, mean that Vedānta is a monopoly study of the Çaikara-sampradāya. Vedānta is studied by all the bona fide *sampradāyas*, but they have their own interpretations. But those in the Çaikara-sampradāya are generally known to be ignorant of the knowledge of the Vedāntist Vaiñēavas. For this reason the Bhaktivedanta title was first offered to the author by the Vaiñēavas.

The Lord agreed to take lessons from Bhaööacārya on the Vedānta, and they sat together in the temple of Lord Jagannātha. The Bhaööacārya went on speaking continually for seven days, and the Lord heard him with all attention and did not interrupt. The Lord's silence raised some doubts in Bhaööacārya's heart, and he asked the Lord how it was that He did not ask anything or comment on his explanations of Vedānta.

The Lord posed Himself before the Bhaööacārya as a foolish student and pretended that He heard the Vedānta from him because the Bhaööacārya felt that this was the duty of a *sannyāsē*. But the Lord did not agree with his lectures. By this the Lord indicated that the so-called Vedāntists amongst the Çaikara-sampradāya, or any other *sampradāya* who do not follow the instructions of Srila Vyāsadeva, are mechanical students of the Vedānta. They are not fully aware of that great knowledge. The explanation of the *Vedānta-sūtra* is given by the author himself in the text of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. One who has no knowledge of the *Bhāgavatam* will hardly be able to know what the Vedānta says.

The Bhaööacārya, being a vastly learned man, could follow the Lord's sarcastic remarks on the popular Vedāntist. He therefore asked Him why He did not ask about any point which He could not follow. The Bhaööacārya could understand the purpose of His dead silence for the days He heard him. This showed clearly that the Lord had something else in mind; thus the Bhaööacārya requested Him to disclose His mind.

Upon this, the Lord spoke as follows: "My dear sir, I can understand the meaning of the *sūtras* like *janmādy asya yataù* [SB 1.1.1], *çāstra-yonitvāt*, and *athāto brahma jijñāsā* of the *Vedānta-sūtra*, but when you explain them in your own way it becomes difficult for Me to follow them. The purpose of

the *sūtras* is already explained in them, but your explanations are covering them with something else. You do not purposely take the direct meaning of the *sūtras* but indirectly give your own interpretations.”

The Lord thus attacked all Vedāntists who interpret the *Vedānta-sūtra* fashionably, according to their limited power of thinking, to serve their own purpose. Such indirect interpretations of the authentic literatures like the *Vedānta-sūtra* are hereby condemned by the Lord.

The Lord continued: “Srila Vyāsadeva has summarized the direct meanings of the *mantras* in the *Upaniñads* in the *Vedānta-sūtra*. Unfortunately you do not take their direct meaning. You indirectly interpret them in a different way.

“The authority of the *Vedas* is unchallengeable and stands without any question of doubt. And whatever is stated in the *Vedas* must be accepted completely, otherwise one challenges the authority of the *Vedas*.

“The conchshell and cow dung are bone and stool of two living beings. But because they have been recommended by the *Vedas* as pure, people accept them as such because of the authority of the *Vedas*.”

The idea is that one cannot set his imperfect reason above the authority of the *Vedas*. The orders of the *Vedas* must be obeyed as they stand, without any mundane reasoning. The so-called followers of the Vedic injunctions make their own interpretations of the Vedic injunctions, and thus they establish different parties and sects of the Vedic religion. Lord Buddha directly denied the authority of the *Vedas*, and he established his own religion. Only for this reason, the Buddhist religion was not accepted by the strict followers of the *Vedas*. But those who are so-called followers of the *Vedas* are more harmful than the Buddhists. The Buddhists have the courage to deny the *Vedas* directly, but the so-called followers of the *Vedas* have no courage to deny the *Vedas*, although indirectly they disobey all the injunctions of the *Vedas*. Lord Caitanya condemned this.

The examples given by the Lord of the conchshell and the cow dung are very much appropriate in this connection. If one argues that since cow dung

is pure, the stool of a learned *brahmana* is still more pure, his argument will not be accepted. Cow dung is accepted, and the stool of a highly posted *brahmana* is rejected. The Lord continued:

“The Vedic injunctions are self-authorized, and if some mundane creature adjusts the interpretations of the *Vedas*, he defies their authority. It is foolish to think of oneself as more intelligent than Srila Vyāsadeva. He has already expressed himself in his *sūtras*, and there is no need of help from personalities of lesser importance. His work, the *Vedānta-sūtra*, is as dazzling as the midday sun, and when someone tries to give his own interpretations on the self-effulgent sunlike *Vedānta-sūtra*, he attempts to cover this sun with the cloud of his imagination.

“The *Vedas* and *Puranas* are one and the same in purpose. They ascertain the Absolute Truth, which is greater than everything else. The Absolute Truth is ultimately realized as the Absolute Personality of Godhead with absolute controlling power. As such, the Absolute Personality of Godhead must be completely full of opulence, strength, fame, beauty, knowledge and renunciation. Yet the transcendental Personality of Godhead is astonishingly ascertained as impersonal.

“The impersonal description of the Absolute Truth in the *Vedas* is given to nullify the mundane conception of the absolute whole. Personal features of the Lord are completely different from all kinds of mundane features. The living entities are all individual persons, and they are all parts and parcels of the supreme whole. If the parts and parcels are individual persons, the source of their emanation must not be impersonal. He is the Supreme Person amongst all the relative persons.

“The *Vedas* inform us that from Him [Brahman] everything emanates, and on Him everything rests. And after annihilation, everything merges in Him only. Therefore, He is the ultimate dative, causative and accommodating cause of all causes. And these causes cannot be attributed to an impersonal object.

“The *Vedas* inform us that He alone became many, and when He so desires He glances over material nature. Before He glanced over material nature

there was no material cosmic creation. Therefore, His glance is not material. Material mind or senses were unborn when the Lord glanced over material nature. Thus evidence in the *Vedas* proves that beyond a doubt the Lord has transcendental eyes and a transcendental mind. They are not material. His impersonality therefore is a negation of His materiality, but not a denial of His transcendental personality.

“Brahman ultimately refers to the Personality of Godhead. Impersonal Brahman realization is just the negative conception of the mundane creations. Paramātmā is the localized aspect of Brahman within all kinds of material bodies. Ultimately the Supreme Brahman realization is the realization of the Personality of Godhead according to all evidence of the revealed scriptures. He is the ultimate source of *viṣṇu-tattvas*.

“The *Puranas* are also supplementary to the *Vedas*. The Vedic *mantras* are too difficult for an ordinary man. Women, *sudras* and the so-called twice-born higher castes are unable to penetrate into the sense of the *Vedas*. And thus the *Mahābhārata* as well as the *Puranas* are made easy to explain the truths of the *Vedas*. In his prayers before the boy Sri Kṛṣṇa, Brahmā said that there is no limit to the fortune of the residents of Vrajabhūmi headed by Sri Nanda Mahārāja and Yaçodāmayé because the eternal Absolute Truth has become their intimate relative.

“The Vedic *mantra* maintains that the Absolute Truth has no legs and no hands and yet goes faster than all and accepts everything that is offered to Him in devotion. The latter statements definitely suggest the personal features of the Lord, although His hands and legs are distinguished from mundane hands and legs or other senses.

“Brahman, therefore, is never impersonal, but when such *mantras* are indirectly interpreted, it is wrongly thought that the Absolute Truth is impersonal. The Absolute Truth Personality of Godhead is full of all opulences, and therefore He has a transcendental form of full existence, knowledge and bliss. How then can one establish that the Absolute Truth is impersonal?

“Brahman, being full of opulences, is understood to have manifold

energies, and all these energies are classified under three headings under the authority of *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* [6.7.60], which says that the transcendental energies of Lord Viṣṇu are primarily three. His spiritual energy and the energy of the living entities are classified as superior energy, whereas the material energy is an inferior one which is sprouted out of ignorance.

“The energy of the living entities is technically called *kñetrajña* energy. This *kñetrajña-çakti*, although equal in quality with the Lord, becomes overpowered by material energy out of ignorance and thus suffers all sorts of material miseries. In other words, the living entities are located in the marginal energy between the superior (spiritual) and inferior (material) energies, and in proportion to the living being’s contact with either the material or spiritual energies, the living entity is situated in proportionately higher and lower levels of existence.

“The Lord is beyond the inferior and marginal energies as above mentioned, and His spiritual energy is manifested in three different phases: as eternal existence, eternal bliss and eternal knowledge. As far as eternal existence is concerned, it is conducted by the *sandhiné* potency; similarly, bliss and knowledge are conducted by the *hlādhiné* and *saàvit* potencies respectively. As the supreme energetic Lord, He is the supreme controller of the spiritual, marginal and material energies. And all these different types of energies are connected with the Lord in eternal devotional service.

“The Supreme Personality of Godhead is thus enjoying in His transcendental eternal form. Is it not astounding that one dares to call the Supreme Lord nonenergetic? The Lord is the controller of all energies, and the living entities are parts and parcels of one of the energies. Therefore there is a gulf of difference between the Lord and the living entities. How then can one say that the Lord and the living entities are one and the same? In the *Bhagavad-gītā* also the living entities are described as belonging to the superior energy of the Lord. According to the principles of intimate correlation between the energy and the energetic, both of them are nondifferent also. Therefore, the Lord and the living entities are nondifferent as the energy and the energetic.

“Earth, water, fire, air, ether, mind, intelligence and ego are all inferior

energies of the Lord, but the living entities are different from all as superior energy. This is the version of *Bhagavad-gita* [7.4].

“The transcendental form of the Lord is eternally existent and full of transcendental bliss. How then can such a form be a product of the material mode of goodness? Anyone, therefore, who does not believe in the form of the Lord is certainly a faithless demon and as such is untouchable, a not to be seen *persona non grata* fit to be punished by the Plutonic king.

“The Buddhists are called atheists because they have no respect for the *Vedas*, but those who defy the Vedic conclusions, as above mentioned, under the pretense of being followers of the *Vedas*, are verily more dangerous than the Buddhists.

“Sri Vyāsadeva very kindly compiled the Vedic knowledge in his *Vedānta-sūtra*, but if one hears the commentation of the Māyāvāda school (as represented by the Çaikara-sampradāya) certainly he will be misled on the path of spiritual realization.

“The theory of emanations is the beginning subject of the *Vedānta-sūtra*. All the cosmic manifestations are emanations from the Absolute Personality of Godhead by His inconceivable different energies. The example of the touchstone is applicable to the theory of emanation. The touchstone can convert an unlimited quantity of iron into gold, and still the touchstone remains as it is. Similarly, the Supreme Lord can produce all manifested worlds by His inconceivable energies, and yet He is full and unchanged. He is *pūrēa* [complete], and although an unlimited number of *pūrēas* emanate from Him, He is still *pūrēa*.

“The theory of illusion of the Māyāvāda school is advocated on the ground that the theory of emanation will cause a transformation of the Absolute Truth. If that is the case, Vyāsadeva is wrong. To avoid this, they have skillfully brought in the theory of illusion. But the world or the cosmic creation is not false, as maintained by the Māyāvāda school. It simply has no permanent existence. A nonpermanent thing cannot be called false altogether. But the conception that the material body is the self is certainly

wrong.

“*Praëava* [oà], or the *oàkära* in the *Vedas*, is the primeval hymn. This transcendental sound is identical with the form of the Lord. All the Vedic hymns are based on this *praëava oàkära*. *Tat tvam asi* is but a side word in the Vedic literatures, and therefore this word cannot be the primeval hymn of the *Vedas*. Sripäda Çaikaräcärya has given more stress on the side word *tat tvam asi* than on the primeval principle *oàkära*.”

The Lord thus spoke on the *Vedänta-sütra* and defied all the propaganda of the Mäyäväda school.^{i*} The Bhaööcärya tried to defend himself and his Mäyäväda school by jugglery of logic and grammar, but the Lord defeated him by His forceful arguments. He affirmed that we are all related with the Personality of Godhead eternally and that devotional service is our eternal function in exchanging the dealings of our relations. The result of such exchanges is to attain *premā*, or love of Godhead. When love of Godhead is attained, love for all other beings automatically follows because the Lord is the sum total of all living beings.

The Lord said that but for these three items—namely, eternal relation with God, exchange of dealings with Him and the attainment of love for Him—all that is instructed in the *Vedas* is superfluous and concocted.

The Lord further added that the Mäyäväda philosophy taught by Sripäda Çaikaräcärya is an imaginary explanation of the *Vedas*, but it had to be taught by him (Çaikaräcärya) because he was ordered to teach it by the Personality of Godhead. In the *Padma Purana* it is stated that the Personality of Godhead ordered His Lordship Siva to deviate the human race from Him (the Personality of Godhead). The Personality of Godhead was to be so covered so that people would be encouraged to generate more and more population. His Lordship Siva said to Devé: “In the Kali-yuga, I shall preach the Mäyäväda philosophy, which is nothing but clouded Buddhism, in the garb of a *brahmana*.”

After hearing all these speeches of the Lord Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu, the Bhaööcärya was struck with wonder and awe and regarded Him in dead silence. The Lord then encouraged him with assurance that there was no

cause to wonder. “I say that *devotional service unto the Personality of Godhead is the highest goal of human life.*” He then quoted a *çloka* from the *Bhāgavatam* and assured him that even the liberated souls who are absorbed in the spirit and spiritual realization also take to the devotional service of the Lord Hari because the Personality of Godhead has such transcendental qualities that He attracts the heart of the liberated soul too.

Then the Bhaööcārya desired to listen to the explanation of the “*ātmārāma*” *çloka* from the *Bhāgavatam* (1.7.10). The Lord first of all asked Bhaööcārya to explain it, and after that He would explain it. The Bhaööcārya then explained the *çloka* in a scholarly way with special reference to logic. He explained the *çloka* in nine different ways chiefly based on logic because he was the most renowned scholar of logic of the time.

The Lord, after hearing the Bhaööcārya, thanked him for the scholarly presentation of the *çloka*, and then, at the request of the Bhaööcārya, the Lord explained the *çloka* in sixty-four different ways without touching the nine explanations given by the Bhaööcārya.

Thus after hearing the explanation of the *ātmārāma çloka* from the Lord, the Bhaööcārya was convinced that such a scholarly presentation is impossible for an earthly creature.^{ii*} Before this, Sri Gopénātha Ācārya had tried to convince him of the divinity of the Lord, but at the time he could not so accept Him. But the Bhaööcārya was astounded by the Lord’s exposition of the *Vedānta-sūtra* and explanations of the *ātmārāma çloka*, and thus he began to think that he had committed a great offense at the lotus feet of the Lord by not recognizing Him to be Kṛṣṇa Himself. He then surrendered unto Him, repenting for his past dealings with Him, and the Lord was kind enough to accept the Bhaööcārya. Out of His causeless mercy, the Lord manifested before him first as four-handed Nārāyaṇa and then again as two-handed Lord Kṛṣṇa with a flute in His hand.

The Bhaööcārya at once fell down at the lotus feet of the Lord and composed many suitable *çlokas* in praise of the Lord by His grace. He composed almost one hundred *çlokas* in praise of the Lord. The Lord then embraced him, and out of transcendental ecstasy the Bhaööcārya lost

consciousness of the physical state of life. Tears, trembling, throbbing of the heart, perspiration, emotional waves, dancing, singing, crying and all the eight symptoms of trance were manifested in the body of the Bhaööcärya. Sri Gopénätha Äcärya became very glad and astonished by this marvelous conversion of his brother-in-law by the grace of the Lord.

Out of the hundred celebrated *çloka*s composed by the Bhaööcärya in praise of the Lord, the following two are most important, and these two *çloka*s explain the mission of the Lord in gist.

1. Let me surrender unto the Personality of Godhead who has appeared now as Lord Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu. He is the ocean of all mercy and has now come down to teach us material detachment, learning and devotional service to Himself.
2. Since pure devotional service of the Lord has been lost in the oblivion of time, the Lord has appeared to renovate the principles, and therefore I offer my obeisances unto His lotus feet.

The Lord explained the word *mukti* to be equivalent to the word Viṣṇu, or the Personality of Godhead. To attain *mukti*, or liberation from the bondage of material existence, is to attain to the service of the Lord.

The Lord then proceeded towards South India for some time and converted all He met on the way to become devotees of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. Such devotees also converted many others to the cult of devotional service, or to the *Bhägavata-dharma* of the Lord, and thus He reached the bank of the Godävaré, where He met Srila Rämänanda Räya, the governor of Madras on behalf of Mahäräja Pratäparudra, the King of Orissa. His talks with Rämänanda Räya are very important for higher realization of transcendental knowledge, and the conversation itself forms a small booklet. We shall, however, give herewith a summary of the conversation.

Sri Rämänanda Räya was a self-realized soul, although outwardly he belonged to a caste lower than the *brahmana* in social status. He was not in the renounced order of life, and besides that he was a high government servant in the state. Still, Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu accepted him as a

liberated soul on the strength of the high order of his realization of transcendental knowledge. Similarly, the Lord accepted Srila Haridāsa Ōhākura, a veteran devotee of the Lord coming from a Mohammedan family. And there are many other great devotees of the Lord who came from different communities, sects and castes. The Lord's only criterion was the standard of devotional service of the particular person. He was not concerned with the outward dress of a man; He was concerned only with the inner soul and its activities. Therefore all the missionary activities of the Lord are to be understood to be on the spiritual plane, and as such the cult of Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu, or the cult of *Bhāgavata-dharma*, has nothing to do with mundane affairs, sociology, politics, economic development or any such sphere of life. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the purely transcendental urge of the soul.

When He met Sri Rāmānanda Rāya on the bank of the Godāvarī, the *varēācrama-dharma* followed by the Hindus was mentioned by the Lord. Srila Rāmānanda Rāya said that by following the principles of *varēācrama-dharma*, the system of four castes and four orders of human life, everyone could realize Transcendence. In the opinion of the Lord, the system of *varēācrama-dharma* is superficial only, and it has very little to do with the highest realization of spiritual values. The highest perfection of life is to get detached from the material attachment and proportionately realize the transcendental loving service of the Lord. The Personality of Godhead recognizes a living being who is progressing in that line. Devotional service, therefore, is the culmination of the culture of all knowledge. When Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, appeared for the deliverance of all fallen souls, He advised the deliverance of all living entities as follows. The Supreme Absolute Personality of Godhead, from whom all living entities have emanated, must be worshiped by all their respective engagements, because everything that we see is also the expansion of His energy. That is the way of real perfection, and it is approved by all bona fide *ācāryas* past and present. The system of *varēācrama* is more or less based on moral and ethical principles. There is very little realization of the Transcendence as such, and Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu rejected it as superficial and asked Rāmānanda Rāya to go further into the matter.

Sri Rāmānanda Rāya then suggested renunciation of fruitive actions unto

the Lord. The *Bhagavad-gita* (9.27) advises in this connection: “Whatever you do, whatever you eat and whatever you give, as well as whatever you perform in penance, offer to Me alone.” This dedication on the part of the worker suggests that the Personality of Godhead is a step higher than the impersonal conception of the *varëäçrama* system, but still the relation of the living being and the Lord is not distinct in that way. The Lord therefore rejected this proposition and asked Rämänanda Räya to go further.

Räya then suggested renunciation of the *varëäçrama-dharma* and acceptance of devotional service. The Lord did not approve of this suggestion also for the reason that all of a sudden one should not renounce his position, for that may not bring in the desired result.

It was further suggested by Räya that attainment of spiritual realization freed from the material conception of life is the topmost achievement for a living being. The Lord rejected this suggestion also because on the plea of such spiritual realization much havoc has been wrought by unscrupulous persons; therefore all of a sudden this is not possible. The Räya then suggested sincere association of self-realized souls and hearing submissively the transcendental message of the pastimes of the Personality of Godhead. This suggestion was welcomed by the Lord. This suggestion was made following in the footsteps of Brahmäjé, who said that the Personality of Godhead is known as *ajita*, or the one who cannot be conquered or approached by anyone. But such *ajita* also becomes *jita* (conquered) by one method, which is very simple and easy. The simple method is that one has to give up the arrogant attitude of declaring oneself to be God Himself. One must be very meek and submissive and try to live peacefully by lending the ear to the speeches of the transcendently self-realized soul who speaks on the message of *Bhägavata-dharma*, or the religion of glorifying the Supreme Lord and His devotees. To glorify a great man is a natural instinct for living beings, but they have not learned to glorify the Lord. Perfection of life is attained simply by glorifying the Lord in association with a self-realized devotee of the Lord.ⁱⁱⁱ* The self-realized devotee is he who surrenders unto the Lord fully and who does not have attachment for material prosperity. Material prosperity and sense enjoyment and their advancement are all activities of ignorance in human society. Peace and friendship are impossible for a society detached from

the association of God and His devotees. It is imperative, therefore, that one sincerely seek the association of pure devotees and hear them patiently and submissively from any position of life. The position of a person in the higher or lower status of life does not hamper one in the path of self-realization. The only thing one has to do is to hear from a self-realized soul with a routine program. The teacher may also deliver lectures from the Vedic literatures, following in the footsteps of the bygone *ācāryas* who realized the Absolute Truth. Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu recommended this simple method of self-realization generally known as *Bhāgavata-dharma*. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the perfect guide for this purpose.

Above these topics discussed by the Lord and Sri Rāmānanda Rāya, there were still more elevated spiritual talks between the two great personalities, and we purposely withhold those topics for the present because one has to come to the spiritual plane before further talks with Rāmānanda Rāya can be heard. We have presented further talks of Srila Rāmānanda Rāya with the Lord in another book (*Teachings of Lord Caitanya*).

At the conclusion of this meeting, Sri Rāmānanda Rāya was advised by the Lord to retire from service and come to Puré so that they could live together and relish a transcendental relationship. Some time later, Sri Rāmānanda Rāya retired from the government service and took a pension from the King. He returned to his residence in Puré, where he was one of the most confidential devotees of the Lord. There was another gentleman at Puré of the name Çikhi Māhiti, who was also a confidant like Rāmānanda Rāya. The Lord used to hold confidential talks on spiritual values with three or four companions at Puré, and He passed eighteen years in that way in spiritual trance. His talks were recorded by His private secretary Sri Dāmodara Gosvami, one of the four most intimate devotees.

The Lord extensively traveled all over the southern part of India. The great saint of Mahārāṣṭra known as Saint Tukārāma was also initiated by the Lord. Saint Tukārāma, after initiation by the Lord, overflowed the whole of the Mahārāṣṭra Province with the *saikértana* movement, and the transcendental flow is still rolling on in the southwestern part of the great Indian peninsula.

The Lord excavated from South India two very important old literatures, namely the ^{iv}Brahmā-saàhitā and *Kṛṣṇa-karēāmāta*, and these two valuable books are authorized studies for the person in the devotional line. The Lord then returned to Puré after His South Indian tour.

On His return to Puré, all the anxious devotees of the Lord got back their life, and the Lord remained there with continued pastimes of His transcendental realizations. The most important incident during that time was His granting audience to King Pratāparudra. King Pratāparudra was a great devotee of the Lord, and he considered himself to be one of the servants of the Lord entrusted with sweeping the temple. This submissive attitude of the King was very much appreciated by Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The King requested both Bhaööcārya and Rāya to arrange his meeting with the Lord. When, however, the Lord was petitioned by His two stalwart devotees, He flatly refused to grant the request, even though it was put forward by personal associates like Rāmānanda Rāya and Sarvabhauma Bhaööcārya. The Lord maintained that it is dangerous for a *sannyāsé* to be in intimate touch with worldly money-conscious men and with women. The Lord was an ideal *sannyāsé*. No woman could approach the Lord even to offer respects. Women's seats were accommodated far away from the Lord. As an ideal teacher and *ācārya*, He was very strict in the routine work of a *sannyāsé*. Apart from being a divine incarnation, the Lord was an ideal character as a human being. His behavior with other persons was also above suspicion. In His dealing as *ācārya*, He was harder than the thunderbolt and softer than the rose. One of His associates, Junior Haridāsa, committed a great mistake by lustfully glancing at a young woman. The Lord as Supersoul could detect this lust in the mind of Junior Haridāsa, who was at once banished from the Lord's association and was never accepted again, even though the Lord was implored to excuse Haridāsa for the mistake. Junior Haridāsa afterwards committed suicide due to being disassociated from the company of the Lord, and the news of suicide was duly related to the Lord. Even at that time the Lord was not forgetful of the offense, and He said that Haridāsa had rightly met with the proper punishment.

On the principles of the renounced order of life and discipline, the Lord knew no compromise, and therefore even though He knew that the King

was a great devotee, He refused to see the King, only because the King was a dollar-and-cent man. By this example the Lord wanted to emphasize the proper behavior for a transcendentalist. A transcendentalist has nothing to do with women and money. He must always refrain from such intimate relations. The King was, however, favored by the Lord by the expert arrangement of the devotees. This means that the beloved devotee of the Lord can favor a neophyte more liberally than the Lord. Pure devotees, therefore, never commit an offense at the feet of another pure devotee. An offense at the lotus feet of the Lord is sometimes excused by the merciful Lord, but an offense at the feet of a devotee is very dangerous for one who actually wants to make progress in devotional service.

As long as the Lord remained at Puré, thousands of His devotees used to come to see Him during the Ratha-yātrā car festival of Lord Jagannātha. And during the car festival, the washing of the Guëdicā temple under the direct supervision of the Lord was an important function. The Lord's congregational *saikértana* movement at Puré was a unique exhibition for the mass of people. That is the way to turn the mass mind towards spiritual realization. The Lord inaugurated this system of mass *saikértana*, and leaders of all countries can take advantage of this spiritual movement in order to keep the mass of people in a pure state of peace and friendship with one another. This is now the demand of the present human society all over the world.

After some time the Lord again started on His tour towards northern India, and He decided to visit Våndāvana and its neighboring places. He passed through the jungles of Jharikhaëòa (Madhya Bhārata), and all the wild animals also joined His *saikértana* movement. The wild tigers, elephants, bears and deer all together accompanied the Lord, and the Lord accompanied them in *saikértana*. By this He proved that by the propagation of the *saikértana* movement (congregational chanting and glorifying of the name of the Lord) even the wild animals can live in peace and friendship, and what to speak of men who are supposed to be civilized. No man in the world will refuse to join the *saikértana* movement. Nor is the Lord's *saikértana* movement restricted to any caste, creed, color or species. Here is direct evidence of His great mission: He allowed even the wild animals to partake in His great movement.

On His way back from Våndävana He first came to Prayäga, where He met Rüpa Gosvami along with his younger brother, Anupama. Then He came down to Benares. For two months, He instructed Sri Sanätana Gosvami in the transcendental science. The instruction to Sanätana Gosvami is in itself a long narration, and full presentation of the instruction will not be possible here. The main ideas are given as follows.

Sanätana Gosvami (formerly known as Säkara Mallika) was in the cabinet service of the Bengal government under the regime of Nawab Hussain Shah. He decided to join with the Lord and thus retired from the service. On His way back from Våndävana, when He reached Väräëasé, the Lord became the guest of Sri Tapana Miçra and Candraçekhara, assisted by a Mahäräñöra *brahmana*. At that time Väräëasé was headed by a great *sannyäsé* of the Mäyäväda school named Sripäda Prakäçänanda Sarasvaté. When the Lord was at Väräëasé, the people in general became more attracted to Lord Caitanya Mahäprabhu on account of His mass *saikértana* movement. Wherever He visited, especially the Visvanatha temple, thousands of pilgrims would follow Him. Some were attracted by His bodily features, and others were attracted by His melodious songs glorifying the Lord.

The Mäyävädé *sannyäsés* designate themselves as Nārāyaṇa. Väräëasé is still overflowed with many Mäyävädé *sannyäsés*. Some people who saw the Lord in His *saikértana* party considered Him to be actually Nārāyaṇa, and this report reached the camp of the great *sannyäsé* Prakäçänanda.

In India there is always a kind of spiritual rivalry between the Mäyäväda and *Bhägavata* schools, and thus when the news of the Lord reached Prakäçänanda he knew that the Lord was a Vaiñëava *sannyäsé*, and therefore he minimized the value of the Lord before those who brought him the news. He deprecated the activities of the Lord because of His preaching the *saikértana* movement, which was in his opinion nothing but religious sentiment. Prakäçänanda was a profound student of the Vedänta, and he advised his followers to give attention to the Vedänta and not to indulge in *saikértana*.

One devotee *brahmana*, who became a devotee of the Lord, did not like

the criticism of Prakāṇanda, and he went to the Lord to express his regrets. He told the Lord that when he uttered the Lord's name before the *sannyāsé* Prakāṇanda, the latter strongly criticized the Lord, although the *brahmana* heard Prakāṇanda uttering several times the name Caitanya. The *brahmana* was astonished to see that the *sannyāsé* Prakāṇanda could not vibrate the sound Kṛṣṇa even once, although he uttered the name Caitanya several times.

The Lord smilingly explained to the devotee *brahmana* why the Māyāvādé cannot utter the holy name of Kṛṣṇa. "The Māyāvādés are offenders at the lotus feet of Kṛṣṇa, although they utter always *brahma*, *ātmā*, or *caitanya*, etc. And because they are offenders at the lotus feet of Kṛṣṇa, they are actually unable to utter the holy name of Kṛṣṇa. The name Kṛṣṇa and the Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa are identical. There is no difference in the absolute realm between the name, form or person of the Absolute Truth because in the absolute realm everything is transcendental bliss. There is no difference between the body and the soul for the Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa. Thus He is different from the living entity who is always different from his outward body. Because of Kṛṣṇa's transcendental position, it is very difficult for a layman to actually know the Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa, His holy name and fame, etc. His name, fame, form and pastimes all are one and the same transcendental identity, and they are not knowable by the exercise of the material senses.

"The transcendental relationship of the pastimes of the Lord is the source of still more bliss than one can experience by realization of Brahman or by becoming one with the Supreme. Had it not been so, then those who are already situated in the transcendental bliss of Brahman would not have been attracted by the transcendental bliss of the pastimes of the Lord."

After this, a great meeting was arranged by the devotees of the Lord in which all the *sannyāsés* were invited, including the Lord and Prakāṇanda Sarasvaté. In this meeting both the scholars (the Lord and Prakāṇanda) had a long discourse on the spiritual values of the *saikértana* movement, and a summary is given below.

The great Māyāvādé *sannyāsé* Prakāṇanda inquired from the Lord as to

the reason for His preferring the *saikértana* movement to the study of the *Vedānta-sūtra*. Prakāṣānanda said that it is the duty of a *sannyāsé* to read the *Vedānta-sūtra*. What caused the Lord to indulge in *saikértana*?

After this inquiry, the Lord submissively replied: “I have taken to the *saikértana* movement instead of the study of Vedānta because I am a great fool.” The Lord thus represented Himself as one of the numberless fools of this age who are absolutely incapable of studying the Vedānta philosophy. The fools’ indulgence in the study of Vedānta has caused so much havoc in society. The Lord thus continued: “And because I am a great fool, My spiritual master forbade Me to play with Vedānta philosophy. He said that it is better that I chant the holy name of the Lord, for that would deliver Me from material bondage.

“In this age of Kali there is no other religion but the glorification of the Lord by utterance of His holy name, and that is the injunction of all the revealed scriptures. And My spiritual master has taught Me one *ṣloka* [from the *Bāhan-nāradéya Purana*]:

harer nāma harer nāma harer nāmaiva kevalam kalau nāsty eva nāsty eva nāsty eva gatiḥ anyathā. [Adi 17.21]

“So on the order of My spiritual master, I chant the holy name of Hari, and I am now mad after this holy name. Whenever I utter the holy name I forget Myself completely, and sometimes I laugh, cry and dance like a madman. I thought that I had actually gone mad by this process of chanting, and therefore I asked My spiritual master about it. He informed Me that this was the real effect of chanting the holy name, which produces a transcendental emotion that is a rare manifestation. It is the sign of love of God, which is the ultimate end of life. Love of God is transcendental to liberation [*mukti*], and thus it is called the fifth stage of spiritual realization, above the stage of liberation. By chanting the holy name of Kṛṣṇa one attains the stage of love of God, and it was good that fortunately I was favored with the blessing.”

On hearing this statement from the Lord, the Māyāvādé *sannyāsé* asked the Lord what was the harm in studying the Vedānta along with chanting

the holy name. Prakāṣānanda Sarasvaté knew well that the Lord was formerly known as Nimāi Paëòita, a very learned scholar of Navadvépa, and His posing as a great fool was certainly to some purpose. Hearing this inquiry by the *sannyāsé*, the Lord smiled and said, “My dear sir, if you do not mind, I will answer your inquiry.”

All the *sannyāsés* there were very much pleased with the Lord for His honest dealings, and they unanimously replied that they would not be offended by whatever He replied. The Lord then spoke as follows:

“*Vedānta-sūtra* consists of transcendental words or sounds uttered by the transcendental Personality of Godhead. As such, in the Vedānta there cannot be any human deficiencies like mistake, illusion, cheating or inefficiency. The message of the *Upaniñads* is expressed in the *Vedānta-sūtra*, and what is said there directly is certainly glorified. Whatever interpretations have been given by Çaikarācārya have no direct bearing on the *sūtra*, and therefore such commentation spoils everything.

“The word Brahman indicates the greatest of all, which is full with transcendental opulences, superior to all. Brahman is ultimately the Personality of Godhead, and He is covered by indirect interpretations and established as impersonal. Everything that is in the spiritual world is full of transcendental bliss, including the form, body, place and paraphernalia of the Lord. All are eternally cognizant and blissful. It is not the fault of the Ācārya Çaikara that he has so interpreted Vedānta, but if someone accepts it, then certainly he is doomed. Anyone who accepts the transcendental body of the Personality of Godhead as something mundane certainly commits the greatest blasphemy.”

The Lord thus spoke to the *sannyāsé* almost in the same way that He spoke to the Bhaööacārya of Puré, and by forceful arguments He nullified the Mäyāvāda interpretations of the *Vedānta-sūtra*. All the *sannyāsés* there claimed that the Lord was the personified *Vedas* and the Personality of Godhead. All the *sannyāsés* were converted to the cult of *bhakti*, all of them accepted the holy name of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and they dined together with the Lord in the midst of them. After this conversion of the *sannyāsés*, the popularity of the Lord increased at Vāräëasé, and thousands

of people assembled to see the Lord in person. The Lord thus established the primary importance of *Srimad-Bhāgavata-dharma*, and He defeated all other systems of spiritual realization. After that everyone at Vārāṇasī was overwhelmed with the transcendental *saikērtana* movement.

While the Lord was camping at Vārāṇasī, Sanātana Gosvami also arrived after retiring from office. He was formerly one of the state ministers in the government of Bengal, then under the regime of Nawab Hussain Shah. He had some difficulty in getting relief from the state service, for the Nawab was reluctant to let him leave. Nonetheless he came to Vārāṇasī, and the Lord taught him the principles of devotional service. He taught him about the constitutional position of the living being, the cause of his bondage under material conditions, his eternal relation with the Personality of Godhead, the transcendental position of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, His expansions in different plenary portions of incarnations, His control of different parts of the universe, the nature of His transcendental abode, devotional activities, their different stages of development, the rules and regulations for achieving the gradual stages of spiritual perfection, the symptoms of different incarnations in different ages, and how to detect them with reference to the context of revealed scriptures.

The Lord's teachings to Sanātana Gosvami form a big chapter in the text of *Sri Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, and to explain the whole teachings in minute details will require a volume in itself. These are treated in detail in our book *Teachings of Lord Caitanya*.

At Mathurā, the Lord visited all the important places; then He reached Vāṇḍāvana. Lord Caitanya appeared in the family of a high-caste *brahmana*, and over and above that as *sannyāsī* He was the preceptor for all the *varēas* and *ācramas*. But He used to accept meals from all classes of Vaiṇēavas. At Mathurā the Sanoḍiyā *brahmanas* are considered to be in the lower status of society, but the Lord accepted meals in the family of such a *brahmana* also because His host happened to be a disciple of the Mādhavendra Purī family.

At Vāṇḍāvana the Lord took bath in twenty-four important bathing places and ghāḥas. He traveled to all the twelve important *vanas* (forests). In

these forests all the cows and birds welcomed Him, as if He were their very old friend. The Lord also began to embrace all the trees of those forests, and by doing so He felt the symptoms of transcendental ecstasy. Sometimes He fell unconscious, but He was made to regain consciousness by the chanting of the holy name of Kṛṣṇa. The transcendental symptoms that were visible on the body of the Lord during His travel within the forest of Våndāvana were all unique and inexplicable, and we have just given a synopsis only.

Some of the important places that were visited by the Lord in Våndāvana were Kāmyavana, Ādēçvara, Pāvana-sarovara, Khadiravana, Çeñaçäyé, Khela-tértha, Bhäëòéravana, Bhadravana, Srivana, Lauhavana, Mahāvana, Gokula, Kāliya-hrada, Dvādaçāditya, Keçé-tértha, etc. When He saw the place where the *rāsa* dance took place, He at once fell down in trance. As long as He remained at Våndāvana, He made His headquarters at Akrūra-ghäöa.

From Våndāvana His personal servitor Kṛṣṇadāsa Vipra induced Him to go back to Prayāga to take bath during the Māgha-melā. The Lord acceded to this proposal, and they started for Prayāga. On the way they met with some Pathans, amongst whom there was a learned Moulana. The Lord had some talks with the Moulana and his companions, and the Lord convinced the Moulana that in the Koran also there are descriptions of *Bhāgavata-dharma* and Kṛṣṇa. All the Pathans were converted to His cult of devotional service.

When He returned to Prayāga, Srila Rūpa Gosvami and his youngest brother met Him near Bindu-mādhava temple. This time the Lord was welcomed by the people of Prayāga more respectfully. Vallabha Bhaööa, who resided on the other bank of Prayāga in the village of Äöäila, was to receive Him at his place. but while going there the Lord jumped in the River Yamunä. With great difficulty He was picked up in an unconscious state. Finally He visited the headquarters of Vallabha Bhaööa. This Vallabha Bhaööa was one of His chief admirers, but later on he inaugurated his own party, the Vallabha-sampradāya.

On the bank of the Daçaçvamedha-ghäöa at Prayāga for ten days

continually the Lord instructed Rūpa Gosvami in the science of devotional service to the Lord. He taught the Gosvami the divisions of the living creatures in the 8,400,000 species of life. Then He taught him about the human species. Out of them He discussed the followers of the Vedic principles, out of them the fruitive workers, out of them the empiric philosophers, and out of them the liberated souls. He said that there are only a few who are actually pure devotees of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa.

Srila Rūpa Gosvami was the younger brother of Sanātana Gosvami, and when he retired from service he brought with him two boat fulls of gold coins. This means that he brought with him some hundreds of thousands of rupees accumulated by the labor of his service. And before leaving home for Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu, he divided the wealth as follows: fifty percent for the service of the Lord and His devotees, twenty-five percent for relatives and twenty-five percent for his personal needs in case of emergency. In that way he set an example for all householders.

The Lord taught the Gosvami about devotional service, comparing it to a creeper, and advised him to protect the *bhakti* creeper most carefully against the mad elephant offense against the pure devotees. In addition, the creeper has to be protected from the desires of sense enjoyment, monistic liberation and perfection of the *hāḍha-yoga* system. They are all detrimental on the path of devotional service. Similarly, violence against living beings, and desire for worldly gain, worldly reception and worldly fame are all detrimental to the progress of *bhakti*, or *Bhāgavata-dharma*.

Pure devotional service must be freed from all desires for sense gratification, fruitive aspirations and culture of monistic knowledge. One must be freed from all kinds of designations, and when one is thus converted to transcendental purity, one can then serve the Lord by purified senses.

As long as there is the desire to enjoy sensually or to become one with the Supreme or to possess the mystic powers, there is no question of attaining the stage of pure devotional service.

Devotional service is conducted under two categories, namely primary

practice and spontaneous emotion. When one can rise to the platform of spontaneous emotion, he can make further progress by spiritual attachment, feeling, love, and many higher stages of devotional life for which there are no English words. We have tried to explain the science of devotional service in our book *The Nectar of Devotion*, based on the authority of *Bhakti-rasāmāta-sindhu* by Srila Rūpa Gosvami.

Transcendental devotional service has five stages of reciprocation:

1. The self-realization stage just after liberation from material bondage is called the *çānta*, or neutral stage.
2. After that, when there is development of transcendental knowledge of the Lord's internal opulences, the devotee engages himself in the *dāsya* stage.
3. By further development of the *dāsya* stage, a respectful fraternity with the Lord develops, and above that a feeling of friendship on equal terms becomes manifest. Both these stages are called *sākhya* stage, or devotional service in friendship.
4. Above this is the stage of paternal affection toward the Lord, and this is called the *vātsalya* stage.
5. And above this is the stage of conjugal love, and this stage is called the highest stage of love of God, although there is no difference in quality in any of the above stages. The last stage of conjugal love of God is called the *mādhurya* stage.

Thus He instructed Rūpa Gosvami in devotional science and deputed him to Våndāvana to excavate the lost sites of the transcendental pastimes of the Lord. After this, the Lord returned to Vārāṇasī and delivered the *sannyāsés* and instructed the elder brother of Rūpa Gosvami. We have already discussed this.

The Lord left only eight *çloka*s of His instructions in writing, and they are known as the *Çikṇāṇṇaka*. All other literatures of His divine cult were

extensively written by the Lord's principal followers, the six Gosvamis of Våndävana, and their followers. The cult of Caitanya philosophy is richer than any other, and it is admitted to be the living religion of the day with the potency for spreading as *viçva-dharma*, or universal religion. We are glad that the matter has been taken up by some enthusiastic sages like Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvaté Gosvami Mahäräja and his disciples. We shall eagerly wait for the happy days of *Bhägavata-dharma*, or *prema-dharma*, inaugurated by the Lord Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu.

The eight *çloka*s completed by the Lord are:

1

Glory to the Sri Kṛṣṇa saikértana, which cleanses the heart of all the dust accumulated for years and extinguishes the fire of conditional life, of repeated birth and death. This saikértana movement is the prime benediction for humanity at large because it spreads the rays of the benediction moon. It is the life of all transcendental knowledge. It increases the ocean of transcendental bliss, and it enables us to fully taste the nectar for which we are always anxious.

2

O my Lord, Your holy name alone can render all benediction to living beings, and thus You have hundreds and millions of names like Kṛṣṇa and Govinda. In these transcendental names You have invested all Your transcendental energies. There are not even hard and fast rules for chanting these names. O my Lord, out of kindness You enable us to easily approach You by chanting Your holy names, but I am so unfortunate that I have no attraction for them.

3

One should chant the holy name of the Lord in a humble state of mind, thinking oneself lower than the straw in the street; one should be more tolerant than a tree, devoid of all sense of false prestige, and ready to offer all respect to others. In such a state of mind one can chant the holy name of

the Lord constantly.

4

O almighty Lord, I have no desire to accumulate wealth, nor do I desire beautiful women, nor do I want any number of followers. I only want Your causeless devotional service birth after birth.

5

O son of Mahārāja Nanda [Kṛṣṇa], I am Your eternal servitor, yet somehow or other I have fallen into the ocean of birth and death. please pick me up from this ocean of death and place me as one of the atoms of Your lotus feet.

6

O my Lord, when will my eyes be decorated with tears of love flowing constantly when I chant Your holy name? When will my voice choke up, and when will the hairs of my body stand on end at the recitation of Your name?

7

O Govinda! Feeling Your separation, I am considering a moment to be like twelve years or more. Tears are flowing from my eyes like torrents of rain, and I am feeling all vacant in the world in Your absence.

8

I know no one but Kṛṣṇa as my Lord, and He shall remain so even if He handles me roughly in His embrace or makes me brokenhearted by not being present before me. He is completely free to do anything and everything, for He is always my worshipful Lord unconditionally.

Chapter One

Questions by the Sages

TEXT 1

p NaMaae >aGavTae vaSaudevaYa
JaNMaaÛSYa YaTaae_NvYaaïdTarTaêaQaeRZvi>aj" Svra\$(
TaeNae b]ø ôda Ya Aaidk-vYae MauùiNTa YaTSaUrYa")
TaeJaaevairMa*da& YaQaa iviNaMaYaae Ya}a i}aSaGaaeR_Ma*za
DaaMana SveNa Sada iNarSTaku-hk&- SaTYa& Par& DaqMaih)) 1))

oà namo bhagavate vāsudevāya

janmādy asya yato 'nvayād itarataç cārtheñv abhijjāu svarāö

tene brahma hādā ya ādi-kavaye muhyanti yat sūrayaù

tejo-vāri-mādā yathā vinimayo yatra tri-sargo 'māñā

dhāmnā svena sadā nirasta-kuhakaà satyaà paraà dhémahi

SYNONYMS

om—O my Lord; *namaù*—offering my obeisances; *bhagavate*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *vāsudevāya*—unto Vāsudeva (the son of Vasudeva), or Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the primeval Lord; *janma-ādi*—creation, sustenance and destruction; *asya*—of the manifested universes; *yataù*—from whom; *anvayāt*—directly; *itarataù*—indirectly; *ca*—and; *artheñu*—purposes; *abhijjāu*—fully cognizant; *sva-rāö*—fully independent; *tene*—imparted; *brahma*—the Vedic knowledge; *hādā*—consciousness of the heart; *yaù*—one who; *ādi-kavaye*—unto the original created being; *muhyanti*—are illusioned; *yat*—about whom; *sūrayaù*—great sages and demigods; *tejaù*—fire; *vāri*—water; *mādām*—earth; *yathā*—as much as; *vinimayaù*—action and reaction; *yatra*—whereupon; *tri-sargaù*—three modes of creation, creative faculties; *amāñā*—almost factual; *dhāmnā*—along with all transcendental paraphernalia; *svena*—self-sufficiently; *sadā*—always; *nirasta*—negation by absence; *kuhakam*—illusion; *satyam*—truth; *param*—absolute; *dhémahi*—I do meditate upon.

TRANSLATION

O my Lord, Sri Kṛṣṇa, son of Vasudeva, O all-pervading Personality of Godhead, I offer my respectful obeisances unto You. I meditate upon Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa because He is the Absolute Truth and the primeval cause of all causes of the creation, sustenance and destruction of the manifested universes. He is directly and indirectly conscious of all manifestations, and He is independent because there is no other cause beyond Him. It is He only who first imparted the Vedic knowledge unto the heart of Brahmājé, the original living being. By Him even the great sages and demigods are placed into illusion, as one is bewildered by the illusory representations of water seen in fire, or land seen on water. Only because of Him do the material universes, temporarily manifested by the reactions of the three modes of nature, appear factual, although they are unreal. I therefore meditate upon Him, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, who is eternally existent in the transcendental abode, which is forever free from the illusory representations of the material world. I meditate upon Him, for He is the Absolute Truth.

PURPORT

Obeisances unto the Personality of Godhead, Vāsudeva, directly indicate Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, who is the divine son of Vasudeva and Devaké. This fact will be more explicitly explained in the text of this work. Sri Vyāsadeva asserts herein that Sri Kṛṣṇa is the original Personality of Godhead, and all others are His direct or indirect plenary portions or portions of the portion. Srila Jiva Gosvami has even more explicitly explained the subject matter in his *Kṛṣṇa-sandarbha*. And Brahmä, the original living being, has explained the subject of Sri Kṛṣṇa substantially in his treatise named *Brahma-saṁhitā*. In the *Sāma-veda Upaniṣad*, it is also stated that Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the divine son of Devaké. Therefore, in this prayer, the first proposition holds that Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the primeval Lord, and if any transcendental nomenclature is to be understood as belonging to the Absolute Personality of Godhead, it must be the name indicated by the word Kṛṣṇa, which means the all-attractive. In *Bhagavad-gita*, in many places, the Lord asserts Himself to be the original Personality of Godhead, and this is confirmed by Arjuna, and also by great sages like Nārada, Vyāsa, and many others. In the *Padma*

Purana, it is also stated that out of the innumerable names of the Lord, the name of Kṛṣṇa is the principal one. Vāsudeva indicates the plenary portion of the Personality of Godhead, and all the different forms of the Lord, being identical with Vāsudeva, are indicated in this text. The name Vāsudeva particularly indicates the divine son of Vasudeva and Devaké. Sri Kṛṣṇa is always meditated upon by the *paramahamsas*, who are the perfected ones among those in the renounced order of life.

Vāsudeva, or Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, is the cause of all causes. Everything that exists emanates from the Lord. How this is so is explained in later chapters of this work. This work is described by Mahāprabhu Sri Caitanya as the spotless *Purana* because it contains the transcendental narration of the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa. The history of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is also very glorious. It was compiled by Sri Vyāsadeva after he had attained maturity in transcendental knowledge. He wrote this under the instructions of Sri Nārada-jé, his spiritual master. Vyāsadeva compiled all Vedic literatures, containing the four divisions of the *Vedas*, the *Vedānta-sūtras* (or the *Brahma-sūtras*), the *Puranas*, the *Mahābhārata*, and so on. But nevertheless he was not satisfied. His dissatisfaction was observed by his spiritual master, and thus Nārada advised him to write on the transcendental activities of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. These transcendental activities are described specifically in the Tenth Canto of this work. But, in order to reach to the very substance, one must proceed gradually by developing knowledge of the categories.

It is natural that a philosophical mind wants to know about the origin of the creation. At night he sees the stars in the sky, and he naturally speculates about their inhabitants. Such inquiries are natural for man because man has a developed consciousness which is higher than that of the animals. The author of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* gives a direct answer to such inquiries. He says that the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the origin of all creations. He is not only the creator of the universe, but the destroyer as well. The manifested cosmic nature is created at a certain period by the will of the Lord. It is maintained for some time, and then it is annihilated by His will. Therefore, the supreme will is behind all cosmic activities. Of course, there are atheists of various categories who do not believe in a creator, but that is due to a poor fund of knowledge. The modern scientist, for example, has created space satellites,

and by some arrangement or other, these satellites are thrown into outer space to fly for some time at the control of the scientist who is far away. Similarly, all the universes with innumerable stars and planets are controlled by the intelligence of the Personality of Godhead.

In Vedic literatures, it is said that the Absolute Truth, Personality of Godhead, is the chief amongst all living personalities. All living beings, beginning from the first created being, Brahmā, down to the smallest ant, are individual living beings. And above Brahmā, there are even other living beings with individual capacities, and the Personality of Godhead is also a similar living being. And He is an individual as are the other living beings. But the Supreme Lord, or the supreme living being, has the greatest intelligence, and He possesses supermost inconceivable energies of all different varieties. If a man's brain can produce a space satellite, one can very easily imagine how brains higher than man can produce similarly wonderful things which are far superior. The reasonable person will easily accept this argument, but there are stubborn atheists who would never agree. Srila Vyāsadeva, however, at once accepts the supreme intelligence as the *parameṣvara*. He offers his respectful obeisances unto the supreme intelligence addressed as the *para* or the *parameṣvara* or the Supreme Personality of Godhead. And that *parameṣvara* is Sri Kṛṣṇa, as admitted in *Bhagavad-gita* and other scriptures delivered by Sri Vyāsadeva and specifically in this *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. In *Bhagavad-gita*, the Lord says that there is no other *para-tattva* (*summum bonum*) than Himself. Therefore, Sri Vyāsadeva at once worships the *para-tattva*, Sri Kṛṣṇa, whose transcendental activities are described in the Tenth Canto.

Unscrupulous persons go immediately to the Tenth Canto and especially to the five chapters which describe the Lord's *rāsa* dance. This portion of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the most confidential part of this great literature. Unless one is thoroughly accomplished in the transcendental knowledge of the Lord, one is sure to misunderstand the Lord's worshipable transcendental pastimes called *rāsa* dance and His love affairs with the *gopés*. This subject matter is highly spiritual, and only the liberated persons who have gradually attained to the stage of *paramahansa* can transcendently relish this *rāsa* dance. Srila Vyāsadeva therefore gives the reader the chance to gradually develop spiritual realization before actually

relishing the essence of the pastimes of the Lord. Therefore, he purposely invokes a Gäyatré *mantra*, *dhémahi*. This Gäyatré *mantra* is meant for spiritually advanced people. When one is successful in chanting the Gäyatré *mantra*, he can enter into the transcendental position of the Lord. One must therefore acquire brahminical qualities or be perfectly situated in the quality of goodness in order to chant the Gäyatré *mantra* successfully and then attain to the stage of transcendently realizing the Lord, His name, His fame, His qualities and so on.

Srimad-Bhagavatam is the narration of the *svarüpa* of the Lord manifested by His internal potency, and this potency is distinguished from the external potency which has manifested the cosmic world, which is within our experience. Srila Vyäsadeva makes a clear distinction between the two in this *çloka*. Sri Vyäsadeva says herein that the manifested internal potency is real, whereas the external manifested energy in the form of material existence is only temporary and illusory like the mirage in the desert. In the desert mirage there is no actual water. There is only the appearance of water. Real water is somewhere else. The manifested cosmic creation appears as reality. But reality, of which this is but a shadow, is in the spiritual world. Absolute Truth is in the spiritual sky, not the material sky. In the material sky everything is relative truth. That is to say, one truth depends on something else. This cosmic creation results from interaction of the three modes of nature, and the temporary manifestations are so created as to present an illusion of reality to the bewildered mind of the conditioned soul, who appears in so many species of life, including the higher demigods, like Brahmä, Indra, Candra, and so on. In actuality, there is no reality in the manifested world. There appears to be reality, however, because of the true reality which exists in the spiritual world, where the Personality of Godhead eternally exists with His transcendental paraphernalia.

The chief engineer of a complicated construction does not personally take part in the construction, but he knows every nook and corner because everything is done under his direction. He knows everything about the construction, both directly and indirectly. Similarly, the Personality of Godhead, who is the supreme engineer of this cosmic creation, knows every nook and corner, although affairs are being carried out by demigods.

Beginning from Brahmā down to the insignificant ant, no one is independent in the material creation. The hand of the Lord is seen everywhere. All material elements as well as all spiritual sparks emanate from Him only. And whatever is created in this material world is but the interaction of two energies, the material and the spiritual, which emanate from the Absolute Truth, the Personality of Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa. A chemist can manufacture water in the chemical laboratory by mixing hydrogen and oxygen. But, in reality, the living entity works in the laboratory under the direction of the Supreme Lord. And the materials with which he works are also supplied by the Lord. The Lord knows everything directly and indirectly, and He is cognizant of all minute details, and He is fully independent. He is compared to a mine of gold, and the cosmic creations in so many different forms are compared to objects made from the gold, such as gold rings, necklaces and so on. The gold ring and the gold necklace are qualitatively one with the gold in the mine, but quantitatively the gold in the mine is different. Therefore, the Absolute Truth is simultaneously one and different. Nothing is absolutely equal with the Absolute Truth, but at the same time, nothing is independent of the Absolute Truth.

Conditioned souls, beginning from Brahmā, who engineers the entire universe, down to the insignificant ant, are all creating, but none of them are independent of the Supreme Lord. The materialist wrongly thinks that there is no creator other than his own self. This is called *māyā*, or illusion. Because of his poor fund of knowledge, the materialist cannot see beyond the purview of his imperfect senses, and thus he thinks that matter automatically takes its own shape without the aid of a superior intelligence. This is refuted in this *śloka* by Srila Vyāsadeva: “Since the complete whole or the Absolute Truth is the source of everything, nothing can be independent of the body of the Absolute Truth.” Whatever happens to the body quickly becomes known to the embodied. Similarly, the creation is the body of the absolute whole. Therefore, the Absolute knows everything directly and indirectly that happens in the creation.

In the *śruti-mantra*, it is also stated that the absolute whole or Brahman is the ultimate source of everything. Everything emanates from Him, and everything is maintained by Him. And at the end, everything enters into Him. That is the law of nature. In the *smṛti-mantra*, the same is confirmed.

It is said that the source from which everything emanates at the beginning of Brahmā's millennium and the reservoir to which everything ultimately enters, is the Absolute Truth or Brahman. Material scientists take it for granted that the ultimate source of the planetary system is the sun, but they are unable to explain the source of the sun. Herein, the ultimate source is explained. According to the Vedic literatures, Brahmā, who may be compared to the sun, is not the ultimate creator. It is stated in this *çloka* that Brahmā was taught Vedic knowledge by the Personality of Godhead. One may argue that Brahmā, being the original living being, could not be inspired because there was no other being living at that time. Herein it is stated that the Supreme Lord inspired the secondary creator, Brahmā, in order that Brahmā could carry out his creative functions. So, the supreme intelligence behind all creations is the Absolute Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa. In *Bhagavad-gita*, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa states that it is He only who superintends the creative energy, *prakāṣi*, which constitutes the totality of matter. Therefore, Sri Vyāsadeva does not worship Brahmā, but the Supreme Lord, who guides Brahmā in his creative activities. In this *çloka*, the particular words *abhijñā* and *svarā* are significant. These two words distinguish the Supreme Lord from all the other living entities. No other living entity is either *abhijñā* or *svarā*. That is, no one is either fully cognizant or fully independent. Even Brahmā has to meditate upon the Supreme Lord in order to create. Then what to speak of great scientists like Einstein! The brains of such a scientist are certainly not the products of any human being. Scientists cannot manufacture such a brain, and what to speak of foolish atheists who defy the authority of the Lord? Even Māyāvādī impersonalists who flatter themselves that they can become one with the Lord are neither *abhijñā* or *svarā*. Such impersonalists undergo severe austerities to acquire knowledge to become one with the Lord. But ultimately they become dependent on some rich disciple who supplies them with money to build monasteries and temples. Atheists like Ravana or Hiranyakaśipu had to undergo severe penances before they could flout the authority of the Lord. But ultimately, they were rendered helpless and could not save themselves when the Lord appeared before them as cruel death. This is also the case with the modern atheists who also dare to flout the authority of the Lord. Such atheists will be dealt with similarly, for history repeats itself. Whenever men neglect the authority of the Lord, nature and her laws are there to penalize them. This is confirmed in *Bhagavad-gita* in the well-

known verse *yadä yadä hi dharmasya gläniù*. “Whenever there is a decline of *dharm*a and a rise of *adharm*a, O Arjuna, then I incarnate Myself.” (Bg. 4.7)

That the Supreme Lord is all-perfect is confirmed in all *śruti-mantras*. It is said in the *śruti-mantras* that the all-perfect Lord threw a glance over matter and thus created all living beings. The living beings are parts and parcels of the Lord, and He impregnates the vast material creation with seeds of spiritual sparks, and thus the creative energies are set in motion to enact so many wonderful creations. An atheist may argue that God is no more expert than a watchmaker, but of course God is greater because He can create machines in duplicate male and female forms. The male and female forms of different types of machineries go on producing innumerable similar machines without God’s further attention. If a man could manufacture such a set of machines that could produce other machines without his attention, then he could approach the intelligence of God. But that is not possible, for each machine has to be handled individually. Therefore, no one can create as well as God. Another name for God is *asamaurdhva*, which means that no one is equal to or greater than Him. *Paraà satyam*, or the Supreme Truth, is He who has no equal or superior. This is confirmed in the *śruti-mantras*. It is said that before the creation of the material universe there existed the Lord only, who is master of everyone. That Lord instructed Brahmā in Vedic knowledge. That Lord has to be obeyed in all respects. Anyone who wants to get rid of the material entanglement must surrender unto Him. This is also confirmed in *Bhagavad-gita*.

Unless one surrenders unto the lotus feet of the Supreme Lord, it is certain that he will be bewildered. When an intelligent man surrenders unto the lotus feet of Kṛṣṇa and knows completely that Kṛṣṇa is the cause of all causes, as confirmed in *Bhagavad-gita*, then only can such an intelligent man become a *mahātmā*, or great soul. But such a great soul is rarely seen. Only the *mahātmās* can understand that the Supreme Lord is the primeval cause of all creations. He is *parama* or ultimate truth because all other truths are relative to Him. He is omniscient. For Him, there is no illusion.

Some Mäyävädé scholars argue that *Srimad-Bhagavatam* was not compiled

by Sri Vyāsadeva. And some of them suggest that this book is a modern creation written by someone named Vopadeva. In order to refute such meaningless arguments, Sri Sridhara Svāmé points out that there is reference to the *Bhāgavatam* in many of the oldest *Puranas*. This first *çloka* of the *Bhāgavatam* begins with the Gāyatrī *mantra*. There is reference to this in the *Matsya Purana*, which is the oldest *Purana*. In that *Purana*, it is said with reference to the Gāyatrī *mantra* in the *Bhāgavatam* that there are many narrations of spiritual instructions beginning with the Gāyatrī *mantra*. And there is the history of Vātrāsura. Anyone who makes a gift of this great work on a full moon day attains to the highest perfection of life by returning to Godhead. There is reference to the *Bhāgavatam* in other *Puranas* also, where it is clearly stated that this work was finished in twelve cantos, which include eighteen thousand *çlokas*. In the *Padma Purana* also there is reference to the *Bhāgavatam* in a conversation between Gautama and Mahārāja Ambaréṇa. The king was advised therein to read regularly *Srimad-Bhagavatam* if he desired liberation from material bondage. Under the circumstances, there is no doubt about the authority of the *Bhāgavatam*. Within the past five hundred years, many erudite scholars and *ācāryas* like Jiva Gosvami, Sanātana Gosvami, Visvanatha Cakravarti, Vallabhācārya, and many other distinguished scholars even after the time of Lord Caitanya made elaborate commentaries on the *Bhāgavatam*. And the serious student would do well to attempt to go through them to better relish the transcendental messages.

Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Öhākura specifically deals with the original and pure sex psychology (*ādi-rasa*), devoid of all mundane inebriety. *The whole material creation is moving under the principle of sex life*. In modern civilization, sex life is the focal point for all activities. Wherever one turns his face, he sees sex life predominant. Therefore, sex life is not unreal. Its reality is experienced in the spiritual world. The material sex life is but a perverted reflection of the original fact. The original fact is in the Absolute Truth, and thus the Absolute Truth cannot be impersonal. It is not possible to be impersonal and contain pure sex life. Consequently, the impersonalist philosophers have given indirect impetus to the abominable mundane sex life because they have overstressed the impersonality of the ultimate truth. Consequently, man without information of the actual spiritual form of sex has accepted perverted material sex life as the all in all. There is a

distinction between sex life in the diseased material condition and spiritual sex life.

This *Srimad-Bhagavatam* will gradually elevate the unbiased reader to the highest perfectional stage of transcendence. It will enable him to transcend the three modes of material activities: fruitive actions, speculative philosophy, and worship of functional deities as inculcated in Vedic verses.

TEXT 2

DaMaR" Pa[aeiJ#Take-Tavae_]a ParMaae iNaMaRTSara<aa& SaTaa&
veÛ& vaSTavMa}a vSTau iXavd& TaaPa}aYaaeNMaUI/NaMa()
é[qMaÛaGavTae MahaMauINak*-Tae ik&- va ParErqir"
SaÛae ôÛvâDYaTae_]a k*-iTai>a" éué[Uzui>aSTaT+a<aaTa()) 2))

dharmaù projjhita-kaitavo 'tra paramo nirmatsaräëää satää

vedyaà västavam atra vastu çivadaà täpa-trayonmülanam

çrémad-bhägavate mahä-muni-kâte kiä vä parair éçvaraù

sadyo hâdy avarudhyate 'tra kâtibhiù çuçrũñubhis tat-kñäëät

SYNONYMS

dharmaù—religiosity; *projjhita*—completely rejected; *kaitavaù*—covered by fruitive intention; *atra*—herein; *paramaù*—the highest; *nirmatsaräëäm*—of the one-hundred-percent pure in heart; *satäm*—devotees; *vedyam*—understandable; *västavam*—factual; *atra*—herein; *vastu*—substance; *çivadam*—well-being; *täpa-traya*—threefold miseries; *unmülanam*—causing uprooting of; *çrémat*—beautiful; *bhägavate*—the *Bhägavata Purana*; *mahä-muni*—the great sage (Vyäsadeva); *kâte*—having compiled; *kim*—what is; *vä*—the need; *paraiù*—others; *éçvaraù*—the Supreme Lord; *sadyaù*—at once; *hâdi*—within the heart; *avarudhyate*—become compact; *atra*—herein; *kâtibhiù*—by the pious men; *çuçrũñubhiù*—by culture; *tat-kñäëät*—without delay.

TRANSLATION

Completely rejecting all religious activities which are materially motivated, this Bhāgavata Purana propounds the highest truth, which is understandable by those devotees who are fully pure in heart. The highest truth is reality distinguished from illusion for the welfare of all. Such truth uproots the threefold miseries. This beautiful Bhāgavatam, compiled by the great sage Vyāsadeva [in his maturity], is sufficient in itself for God realization. What is the need of any other scripture? As soon as one attentively and submissively hears the message of Bhāgavatam, by this culture of knowledge the Supreme Lord is established within his heart.

PURPORT

Religion includes four primary subjects, namely pious activities, economic development, satisfaction of the senses, and finally liberation from material bondage. Irreligious life is a barbarous condition. Indeed, human life begins when religion begins. Eating, sleeping, fearing, and mating are the four principles of animal life. These are common both to animals and to human beings. But religion is the extra function of the human being. Without religion, human life is no better than animal life. Therefore, in human societies there is some form of religion which aims at self-realization and which makes reference to man's eternal relationship with God.

In the lower stages of human civilization, there is always competition to lord it over the material nature or, in other words, there is a continuous rivalry to satisfy the senses. Driven by such consciousness, man turns to religion. He thus performs pious activities or religious functions in order to gain something material. But if such material gains are obtainable in other ways, then so-called religion is neglected. This is the situation in modern civilization. Man is thriving economically, so at present he is not very interested in religion. Churches, mosques or temples are now practically vacant. Men are more interested in factories, shops, and cinemas than in religious places which were erected by their forefathers. This practically proves that religion is performed for some economic gains. Economic gains are needed for sense gratification. Often when one is baffled in the pursuit

of sense gratification, he takes to salvation and tries to become one with the Supreme Lord. Consequently, all these states are simply different types of sense gratification.

In the *Vedas*, the above-mentioned four activities are prescribed in the regulative way so that there will not be any undue competition for sense gratification. But *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is transcendental to all these sense gratificatory activities. It is purely transcendental literature which can be understood only by the pure devotees of the Lord who are transcendental to competitive sense gratification. In the material world there is keen competition between animal and animal, man and man, community and community, nation and nation. But the devotees of the Lord rise above such competitions. They do not compete with the materialist because they are on the path back to Godhead where life is eternal and blissful. Such transcendentalists are nonenvious and pure in heart. In the material world, everyone is envious of everyone else, and therefore there is competition. But the transcendental devotees of the Lord are not only free from material envy, but are well-wishers to everyone, and they strive to establish a competitionless society with God in the center. The contemporary socialist's conception of a competitionless society is artificial because in the socialist state there is competition for the post of dictator. From the point of view of the *Vedas* or from the point of view of common human activities, sense gratification is the basis of material life. There are three paths mentioned in the *Vedas*. One involves fruitive activities to gain promotion to better planets. Another involves worshiping different demigods for promotion to the planets of the demigods, and another involves realizing the Absolute Truth and His impersonal feature and becoming one with Him.

The impersonal aspect of the Absolute Truth is not the highest. Above the impersonal feature is the Paramātmā feature, and above this is the personal feature of the Absolute Truth, or Bhagavān. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* gives information about the Absolute Truth in His personal feature. It is higher than impersonalist literatures and higher than the *jñāna-kāṇḍa* division of the *Vedas*. It is even higher than the *karma-kāṇḍa* division, and even higher than the *upāśanā-kāṇḍa* division, because it recommends the worship of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. In the *karma-kāṇḍa*, there is competition to reach heavenly planets for better

sense gratification, and there is similar competition in the *jñāna-kāñḍā* and the *upāsanā-kāñḍā*. The *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is superior to all of these because it aims at the Supreme Truth which is the substance or the root of all categories. From *Srimad-Bhagavatam* one can come to know the substance as well as the categories. The substance is the Absolute Truth, the Supreme Lord, and all emanations are relative forms of energy.

Nothing is apart from the substance, but at the same time the energies are different from the substance. This conception is not contradictory. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* explicitly promulgates this simultaneously-one-and-different philosophy of the *Vedānta-sūtra*, which begins with the “*janmādy asya*” [SB 1.1.1] *sūtra*.

This knowledge that the energy of the Lord is simultaneously one with and different from the Lord is an answer to the mental speculators’ attempt to establish the energy as the Absolute. When this knowledge is factually understood, one sees the conceptions of monism and dualism to be imperfect. Development of this transcendental consciousness grounded in the conception of simultaneously-one-and-different leads one immediately to the stage of freedom from the threefold miseries. The threefold miseries are (1) those miseries which arise from the mind and body, (2) those miseries inflicted by other living beings, and (3) those miseries arising from natural catastrophes over which one has no control. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* begins with the surrender of the devotee unto the Absolute Person. The devotee is fully aware that he is one with the Absolute and at the same time in the eternal position of servant to the Absolute. In the material conception, one falsely thinks himself the lord of all he surveys, and therefore he is always troubled by the threefold miseries of life. But as soon as one comes to know his real position as transcendental servant, he at once becomes free from all miseries. As long as the living entity is trying to master material nature, there is no possibility of his becoming servant of the Supreme. Service to the Lord is rendered in pure consciousness of one’s spiritual identity; by service one is immediately freed from material encumbrances.

Over and above this, *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is a personal commentation on the *Vedānta-sūtra* by Sri Vyāsadeva. It was written in the maturity of his

spiritual life through the mercy of Nārada. Sri Vyāsadeva is the authorized incarnation of Nārāyaṇa, the Personality of Godhead. Therefore, there is no question as to his authority. He is the author of all other Vedic literatures, yet he recommends the study of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* above all others. In other *Puranas* there are different methods set forth by which one can worship the demigods. But in the *Bhāgavatam* only the Supreme Lord is mentioned. The Supreme Lord is the total body, and the demigods are the different parts of that body. Consequently, by worshiping the Supreme Lord, one does not need to worship the demigods. The Supreme Lord becomes fixed in the heart of the devotee immediately. Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu has recommended the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* as the spotless *Purana* and distinguishes it from all other *Puranas*.

The proper method for receiving this transcendental message is to hear it submissively. A challenging attitude cannot help one realize this transcendental message. One particular word is used herein for proper guidance. This word is *ṣuṣṛñu*. One must be anxious to hear this transcendental message. The desire to sincerely hear is the first qualification.

Less fortunate persons are not at all interested in hearing this *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. The process is simple, but the application is difficult. Unfortunate people find enough time to hear idle social and political conversations, but when invited to attend a meeting of devotees to hear *Srimad-Bhagavatam* they suddenly become reluctant. Sometimes professional readers of the *Bhāgavatam* immediately plunge into the confidential topics of the pastimes of the Supreme Lord, which they seemingly interpret as sex literature. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is meant to be heard from the beginning. Those who are fit to assimilate this work are mentioned in this *śloka*: “One becomes qualified to hear *Srimad-Bhagavatam* after many pious deeds.” The intelligent person, with thoughtful discretion, can be assured by the great sage Vyāsadeva that he can realize the Supreme Personality directly by hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Without undergoing the different stages of realization set forth in the *Vedas*, one can be lifted immediately to the position of *paramahansa* simply by agreeing to receive this message.

TEXT 3

iNaGaMak-LPaTaraeGaRil/Ta& f-l&/
éuk-Mau%adMa*Tad]vSa&YauTaMa()
iPabTa >aaGavTa& rSaMaal/Ya&
Mauhurhae riSak-a >auiv >aavuk-a")) 3))

nigama-kalpa-taror galitaà phalaà

çuka-mukhäd amâta-drava-saàyutam

pibata bhägavataà rasam älayaà

muhur aho rasikä bhuvi bhävukäù

SYNONYMS

nigama—the Vedic literatures; *kalpa-taroù*—the desire tree; *galitam*—fully matured; *phalam*—fruit; *çuka*—Srila Çukadeva Gosvami, the original speaker of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*; *mukhäd*—from the lips of; *amâta*—nectar; *drava*—semisolid and soft and therefore easily swallowable; *saàyutam*—perfect in all respects; *pibata*—do relish it; *bhägavatam*—the book dealing in the science of the eternal relation with the Lord; *rasam*—juice (that which is relishable); *älayam*—until liberation, or even in a liberated condition; *muhuù*—always; *aho*—O; *rasikäù*—those who are full in the knowledge of mellows; *bhuvi*—on the earth; *bhävukäù*—expert and thoughtful.

TRANSLATION

O expert and thoughtful men, relish Srimad-Bhagavatam, the mature fruit of the desire tree of Vedic literatures. It emanated from the lips of Sri Çukadeva Gosvami. Therefore this fruit has become even more tasteful, although its nectarean juice was already relishable for all, including liberated souls.

PURPORT

In the two previous *çlokas* it has been definitely proved that the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the sublime literature which surpasses all other Vedic scriptures due to its transcendental qualities. It is transcendental to all mundane activities and mundane knowledge. In this *çloka* it is stated that *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is not only a superior literature but is the ripened fruit of all Vedic literatures. In other words, it is the cream of all Vedic knowledge. Considering all this, patient and submissive hearing is definitely essential. With great respect and attention, one should receive the message and lessons imparted by the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

The *Vedas* are compared to the desire tree because they contain all things knowable by man. They deal with mundane necessities as well as spiritual realization. The *Vedas* contain regulated principles of knowledge covering social, political, religious, economic, military, medicinal, chemical, physical and metaphysical subject matter and all that may be necessary to keep the body and soul together. Above and beyond all this are specific directions for spiritual realization. Regulated knowledge involves a gradual raising of the living entity to the spiritual platform, and the highest spiritual realization is knowledge that the Personality of Godhead is the reservoir of all spiritual tastes, or *rasas*.

Every living entity, beginning from Brahmä, the first-born living being within the material world, down to the insignificant ant, desires to relish some sort of taste derived from sense perceptions. These sensual pleasures are technically called *rasas*. Such *rasas* are of different varieties. In the revealed scriptures the following twelve varieties of *rasas* are enumerated: (1) *raudra* (anger), (2) *adbhuta* (wonder), (3) *çaiḡāra* (conjugal love), (4) *hāsya* (comedy), (5) *vēra* (chivalry), (6) *dayā* (mercy), (7) *dāsya* (servitorship), (8) *sakhya* (fraternity), (9) *bhayānaka* (horror), (10) *bēbhatsa* (shock), (11) *çānta* (neutrality), (12) *vātsalya* (parenthood).

The sum total of all these *rasas* is called affection or love. Primarily, such signs of love are manifested in adoration, service, friendship, paternal affection, and conjugal love. And when these five are absent, love is present indirectly in anger, wonder, comedy, chivalry, fear, shock and so on. For example, when a man is in love with a woman, the *rasa* is called conjugal love. But when such love affairs are disturbed there may be

wonder, anger, shock, or even horror. Sometimes love affairs between two persons culminate in ghastly murder scenes. Such *rasas* are displayed between man and man and between animal and animal. There is no possibility of an exchange or *rasa* between a man and an animal or between a man and any other species of living beings within the material world. The *rasas* are exchanged between members of the same species. But as far as the spirit souls are concerned, they are one qualitatively with the Supreme Lord. Therefore, the *rasas* were originally exchanged between the spiritual living being and the spiritual whole, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The spiritual exchange or *rasa* is fully exhibited in spiritual existence between living beings and the Supreme Lord.

The Supreme Personality of Godhead is therefore described in the *śruti-mantras*, Vedic hymns, as “the fountainhead of all *rasas*.” When one associates with the Supreme Lord and exchanges one’s constitutional *rasa* with the Lord, then the living being is actually happy.

These *śruti-mantras* indicate that every living being has its constitutional position, which is endowed with a particular type of *rasa* to be exchanged with the Personality of Godhead. In the liberated condition only, this primary *rasa* is experienced in full. In the material existence, the *rasa* is experienced in the perverted form, which is temporary. And thus the *rasas* of the material world are exhibited in the material form of *raudra* (anger) and so on.

Therefore, one who attains full knowledge of these different *rasas*, which are the basic principles of activities, can understand the false representations of the original *rasas* which are reflected in the material world. The learned scholar seeks to relish the real *rasa* in the spiritual form. In the beginning he desires to become one with the Supreme. Thus, less intelligent transcendentalists cannot go beyond this conception of becoming one with the spirit whole, without knowing of the different *rasas*.

In this *çloka*, it is definitely stated that spiritual *rasa*, which is relished even in the liberated stage, can be experienced in the literature of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* due to its being the ripened fruit of all Vedic knowledge. By submissively hearing this transcendental literature, one can attain the full

pleasure of his heart's desire. But one must be very careful to hear the message from the right source. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is exactly received from the right source. It was brought by Nārada Muni from the spiritual world and given to his disciple Sri Vyāsadeva. The latter in turn delivered the message to his son Srila Çukadeva Gosvami, and Srila Çukadeva Gosvami delivered the message to Mahārāja Parékñit just seven days before the King's death. Srila Çukadeva Gosvami was a liberated soul from his very birth. He was liberated even in the womb of his mother, and he did not undergo any sort of spiritual training after his birth. At birth no one is qualified, neither in the mundane nor in the spiritual sense. But Sri Çukadeva Gosvami, due to his being a perfectly liberated soul, did not have to undergo an evolutionary process for spiritual realization. Yet despite his being a completely liberated person situated in the transcendental position above the three material modes, he was attracted to this transcendental *rasa* of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is adored by liberated souls who sing Vedic hymns. The Supreme Lord's pastimes are more attractive to liberated souls than to mundane people. He is of necessity not impersonal because it is only possible to carry on transcendental *rasa* with a person.

In the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* the transcendental pastimes of the Lord are narrated, and the narration is systematically depicted by Srila Çukadeva Gosvami. Thus the subject matter is appealing to all classes of persons, including those who seek liberation and those who seek to become one with the supreme whole.

In Sanskrit the parrot is also known as *çuka*. When a ripened fruit is cut by the red beaks of such birds, its sweet flavor is enhanced. The Vedic fruit which is mature and ripe in knowledge is spoken through the lips of Srila Çukadeva Gosvami, who is compared to the parrot not for his ability to recite the *Bhāgavatam* exactly as he heard it from his learned father, but for his ability to present the work in a manner that would appeal to all classes of men.

The subject matter is so presented through the lips of Srila Çukadeva Gosvami that any sincere listener that hears submissively can at once relish transcendental tastes which are distinct from the perverted tastes of the

material world. The ripened fruit is not dropped all of a sudden from the highest planet of Kṛṣṇaloka. Rather, it has come down carefully through the chain of disciplic succession without change or disturbance. Foolish people who are not in the transcendental disciplic succession commit great blunders by trying to understand the highest transcendental *rāsa* known as the *rāsa* dance without following in the footsteps of Çukadeva Gosvami, who presents this fruit very carefully by stages of transcendental realization. One should be intelligent enough to know the position of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* by considering personalities like Çukadeva Gosvami, who deals with the subject so carefully. This process of disciplic succession of the *Bhāgavata* school suggests that in the future also *Srimad-Bhagavatam* has to be understood from a person who is factually a representative of Srila Çukadeva Gosvami. A professional man who makes a business out of reciting the *Bhāgavatam* illegally is certainly not a representative of Çukadeva Gosvami. Such a man's business is only to earn his livelihood. Therefore one should refrain from hearing the lectures of such professional men. Such men usually go to the most confidential part of the literature without undergoing the gradual process of understanding this grave subject. They usually plunge into the subject matter of the *rāsa* dance, which is misunderstood by the foolish class of men. Some of them take this to be immoral, while others try to cover it up by their own stupid interpretations. They have no desire to follow in the footsteps of Srila Çukadeva Gosvami.

One should conclude, therefore, that the serious student of the *rāsa* should receive the message of *Bhāgavatam* in the chain of disciplic succession from Srila Çukadeva Gosvami, who describes the *Bhāgavatam* from its very beginning and not whimsically to satisfy the mundaner who has very little knowledge in transcendental science. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is so carefully presented that a sincere and serious person can at once enjoy the ripened fruit of Vedic knowledge simply by drinking the nectarean juice through the mouth of Çukadeva Gosvami or his bona fide representative.

TEXT 4

NaEiMaze_iNaiMaz+ae}ae %oZYa" XaaENak-adYa")
 Sa}a& SvGaaRYal/aek-aYa SahóSaMaMaaSaTa)) 4))

naimiñe 'nimiña-kñetre

añayaù çaunakādayaù

satraà svargāya lokāya

sahasra-samam āsata

SYNONYMS

naimiñe—in the forest known as Naimiñāraëya; *animiña-kñetre*—the spot which is especially a favorite of Viṣṇu (who does not close His eyelids); *añayaù*—sages; *çaunaka-ādayaù*—headed by the sage Çaunaka; *satram*—sacrifice; *svargāya*—the Lord who is glorified in heaven; *lokāya*—and for the devotees who are always in touch with the Lord; *sahasra*—one thousand; *samam*—years; *āsata*—performed.

TRANSLATION

Once, in a holy place in the forest of Naimiñāraëya, great sages headed by the sage Çaunaka assembled to perform a great thousand-year sacrifice for the satisfaction of the Lord and His devotees.

PURPORT

The prelude of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* was spoken in the previous three *çlokas*. Now the main topic of this great literature is being presented. *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, after its first recitation by Srila Çukadeva Gosvami, was repeated for the second time at Naimiñāraëya.

In the *Vāyavéya Tantra*, it is said that Brahmā, the engineer of this particular universe, contemplated a great wheel which could enclose the universe. The hub of this great circle was fixed at a particular place known as Naimiñāraëya. Similarly, there is another reference to the forest of Naimiñāraëya in the *Varāha Purana*, where it is stated that by performance of sacrifice at this place, the strength of demoniac people is curtailed. Thus *brahmanas* prefer Naimiñāraëya for such sacrificial performances.

The devotees of Lord Viṣṇu offer all kinds of sacrifices for His pleasure. The devotees are always attached to the service of the Lord, whereas fallen souls are attached to the pleasures of material existence. In *Bhagavad-gita*, it is said that anything performed in the material world for any reason other than for the pleasure of Lord Viṣṇu causes further bondage for the performer. It is enjoined therefore that all acts must be performed sacrificially for the satisfaction of Viṣṇu and His devotees. This will bring everyone peace and prosperity.

The great sages are always anxious to do good to the people in general, and as such the sages headed by Ṣaunaka and others assembled at this holy place of Naimiṣāraēya with a program of performing a great and continuous chain of sacrificial ceremonies. Forgetful men do not know the right path for peace and prosperity. However, the sages know it well, and therefore for the good of all men they are always anxious to perform acts which may bring about peace in the world. They are sincere friends to all living entities, and at the risk of great personal inconvenience they are always engaged in the service of the Lord for the good of all people. Lord Viṣṇu is just like a great tree, and all others, including the demigods, men, Siddhas, Cāraēas, Vidyādhara and other living entities, are like branches, twigs and leaves of that tree. By pouring water on the root of the tree, all the parts of the tree are automatically nourished. Only those branches and leaves which are detached cannot be so satisfied. Detached branches and leaves dry up gradually despite all watering attempts. Similarly, human society, when it is detached from the Personality of Godhead like detached branches and leaves, is not capable of being watered, and one attempting to do so is simply wasting his energy and resources.

The modern materialistic society is detached from its relation to the Supreme Lord. And all its plans which are being made by atheistic leaders are sure to be baffled at every step. Yet they do not wake up to this.

In this age, the congregational chanting of the holy names of the Lord is the prescribed method for waking up. The ways and means are most scientifically presented by Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and intelligent persons may take advantage of His teachings in order to bring about real peace and prosperity. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is also presented for the same

purpose, and this will be explained more specifically later in the text.

TEXT 5

**Ta Wk-da Tau MauNaYa" Pa[aTahuRTahuTaaGanYa")
SaTk*-Ta& SaUTaMaaSaqNa& PaPa[C^uirdMaadraTa()) 5))**

ta ekadä tu munayaù

prätar huta-hutägnayaù

sat-kåtaà sūtam äsénaà

papracchur idam ädarät

SYNONYMS

te—the sages; *ekadä*—one day; *tu*—but; *munayaù*—sages; *prätaù*—morning; *huta*—burning; *huta-agnayaù*—the sacrificial fire; *sat-kåtam*—due respects; *sūtam*—Sri Sūta Gosvami; *äsénam*—seated on; *papracchuù*—made inquiries; *idam*—on this (as follows); *ädarät*—with due regards.

TRANSLATION

One day, after finishing their morning duties by burning a sacrificial fire and offering a seat of esteem to Srila Sūta Gosvami, the great sages made inquiries, with great respect, about the following matters.

PURPORT

Morning is the best time to hold spiritual services. The great sages offered the speaker of the *Bhāgavatam* an elevated seat of respect called the *vyāsāsana*, or the seat of Sri Vyāsadeva. Sri Vyāsadeva is the original spiritual preceptor for all men. And all other preceptors are considered to be his representatives. A representative is one who can exactly present the viewpoint of Sri Vyāsadeva. Sri Vyāsadeva impregnated the message of *Bhāgavatam* unto Srila Çukadeva Gosvami, and Sri Sūta Gosvami heard it

Those who listen to the *Bhāgavatam* may put questions to the speaker in order to elicit the clear meaning, but this should not be done in a challenging spirit. One must submit questions with a great regard for the speaker and the subject matter. This is also the way recommended in *Bhagavad-gītā*. One must learn the transcendental subject by submissive aural reception from the right sources. Therefore these sages addressed the speaker Sūta Gosvami with great respect.

%oZYa Ocu"

añaya ücuù

setihäsäni cänagha

dharma-çästräëi yäny uta

āñayaù—the sages; *ücuù*—said; *tvayä*—by you; *khalu*—undoubtedly; *purëäni*—the supplements to the *Vedas* with illustrative narrations; *saitihäsäni*—along with the histories; *ca*—and; *anagha*—freed from all vices;

ākhyātāni—explained; *api*—although; *adhétāni*—well read; *dharma-çāstrāëi*—scriptures giving right directions to progressive life; *yāni*—all these; *uta*—said.

TRANSLATION

The sages said: Respected Sūta Gosvami, you are completely free from all vice. You are well versed in all the scriptures famous for religious life, and in the Puranas and the histories as well, for you have gone through them under proper guidance and have also explained them.

PURPORT

A *gosvāmé*, or the bona fide representative of Sri Vyāsadeva, must be free from all kinds of vices. The four major vices of Kali-yuga are (1) illicit connection with women, (2) animal slaughter, (3) intoxication, (4) speculative gambling of all sorts. A *gosvāmé* must be free from all these vices before he can dare sit on the *vyāsāsana*. No one should be allowed to sit on the *vyāsāsana* who is not spotless in character and who is not freed from the above-mentioned vices. He not only should be freed from all such vices, but must also be well versed in all revealed scriptures or in the *Vedas*. The *Puranas* are also parts of the *Vedas*. And histories like the *Mahābhārata* or *Ramayana* are also parts of the *Vedas*. The *ācārya* or the *gosvāmé* must be well acquainted with all these literatures. To hear and explain them is more important than reading them. One can assimilate the knowledge of the revealed scriptures only by hearing and explaining. Hearing is called *çravaëa*, and explaining is called *kértana*. The two processes of *çravaëa* and *kértana* are of primary importance to progressive spiritual life. Only one who has properly grasped the transcendental knowledge from the right source by submissive hearing can properly explain the subject.

TEXT 7

**YaaiNa vedivda& é[eïae >aGavaNa(badraYa<a")
ANYae c MauNaYa" SaUTa Paravrivdae ivdu")) 7))**

yäni veda-vidäà çreñöho

bhagavän bädaräyaëaù

anye ca munayaù süta

parävara-vido viduù

SYNONYMS

yäni—all that; *veda-vidäm*—scholars of the *Vedas*; *çreñöhaù*—seniormost; *bhagavän*—incarnation of Godhead; *bädaräyaëaù*—Vyäsadeva; *anye*—others; *ca*—and; *munayaù*—the sages; *süta*—O Süta Gosvami; *parävara-vidaù*—amongst the learned scholars, one who is conversant with physical and metaphysical knowledge; *viduù*—one who knows.

TRANSLATION

Being the eldest learned Vedântist, O Süta Gosvami, you are acquainted with the knowledge of Vyäsadeva, who is the incarnation of Godhead, and you also know other sages who are fully versed in all kinds of physical and metaphysical knowledge.

PURPORT

Srimad-Bhagavatam is a natural commentation on the *Brahma-sütra*, or the *Bädaräyaëi Vedänta-sütras*. It is called natural because Vyäsadeva is author of both the *Vedänta-sütras* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, or the essence of all Vedic literatures. Besides Vyäsadeva, there are other sages who are the authors of six different philosophical systems, namely Gautama, Kaëäda, Kapila, Patañjali, Jaimini and Añöävakra. Theism is explained completely in the *Vedänta-sütra*, whereas in other systems of philosophical speculations, practically no mention is given to the ultimate cause of all causes. One can sit on the *vyäsäsana* only after being conversant in all systems of philosophy so that one can present fully the theistic views of the *Bhägavatam* in defiance of all other systems. Srila Süta Gosvami was the proper teacher, and therefore the sages at Naimiñäraëya elevated him to

the *vyäsäsana*. Srila Vyäsadeva is designated herein as the Personality of Godhead because he is the authorized empowered incarnation.

TEXT 8

**veTQa Tv& SaaEMYa TaTSav| TatvTaSTadNauGa]haTa()
b]UYau" iòGDaSYa iXaZYaSYa Gaurvae GauùMaPYauTa)) 8))**

vettha tvaà saumya tat sarvaà

tattvatas tad-anugrahät

brüyuù snigdhasya çïñyasya

guravo guhyam apy uta

SYNONYMS

vettha—you are well conversant; *tvam*—Your Honor; *saumya*—one who is pure and simple; *tat*—those; *sarvam*—all; *tattvataù*—in fact; *tat*—their; *anugrahät*—by the favor of; *brüyuù*—will tell; *snigdhasya*—of the one who is submissive; *çïñyasya*—of the disciple; *guravaù*—the spiritual masters; *guhyam*—secret; *api uta*—endowed with.

TRANSLATION

And because you are submissive, your spiritual masters have endowed you with all the favors bestowed upon a gentle disciple. Therefore you can tell us all that you have scientifically learned from them.

PURPORT

The secret of success in spiritual life is in satisfying the spiritual master and thereby getting his sincere blessings. Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Öhäkura has sung in his famous eight stanzas on the spiritual master as follows: “I offer my respectful obeisances unto the lotus feet of my spiritual master. Only by his satisfaction can one please the Personality of Godhead, and

when he is dissatisfied there is only havoc on the path of spiritual realization.” It is essential, therefore, that a disciple be very much obedient and submissive to the bona fide spiritual master. Srila Sūta Gosvami fulfilled all these qualifications as a disciple, and therefore he was endowed with all favors by his learned and self-realized spiritual masters such as Srila Vyāsadeva and others. The sages of Naimiñāraëya were confident that Srila Sūta Gosvami was bona fide. Therefore they were anxious to hear from him.

TEXT 9

Ta}a Ta}aaÅSaaYauZMaNa(>avTaa YaiÜiNaiêTaMa()
Pau&SaaMaek-aNTaTa" é[eYaSTaà" Xa&iSaTauMahRiSa)) 9))

tatra taträïjasäyuhnman

bhavatä yad viniçcitam

puàsäm ekäntataù çreyas

tan naù çaàsitum arhasi

SYNONYMS

tatra—thereof; *tatra*—thereof; *aïjasä*—made easy; *äyuhnman*—blessed with a long duration of life; *bhavatä*—by your good self; *yat*—whatever; *viniçcitam*—ascertained; *puàsäm*—for the people in general; *ekäntataù*—absolutely; *çreyaù*—ultimate good; *tat*—that; *naù*—to us; *çaàsitum*—to explain; *arhasi*—deserve.

TRANSLATION

Please, therefore, being blessed with many years, explain to us, in an easily understandable way, what you have ascertained to be the absolute and ultimate good for the people in general.

PURPORT

In *Bhagavad-gita*, worship of the *ācārya* is recommended. The *ācāryas* and *gosvāmés* are always absorbed in thought of the well-being of the general public, especially their spiritual well-being. Spiritual wellbeing is automatically followed by material well-being. The *ācāryas* therefore give directions in spiritual well-being for people in general. Foreseeing the incompetencies of the people in this age of Kali, or the iron age of quarrel, the sages requested that Sūta Gosvami give a summary of all revealed scriptures because the people of this age are condemned in every respect. The sages, therefore, inquired of the absolute good, which is the ultimate good for the people. The condemned state of affairs of the people of this age is described as follows.

TEXT 10

**Pa[aYae<aaLPaaYauz" Sa>Ya k-l/aviSMaNa(YauGae JaNaa")
MaNda" SauMaNdMaTaYaae MaNd>aaGYaa ùuPad]uTaa")) 10))**

prāyeëälpāyuhnāu sabhya

kalāv asmin yuge janāu

mandāu sumanda-matayo

manda-bhāgyā hy upadrutāu

SYNONYMS

prāyeëa—almost always; *alpa*—meager; *āyuhnāu*—duration of life; *sabhya*—member of a learned society; *kalau*—in this age of Kali (quarrel); *asmin*—herein; *yuge*—age; *janāu*—the public; *mandāu*—lazy; *sumanda-mataya*—misguided; *manda-bhāgyāu*—unlucky; *hi*—and above all; *upadrutāu*—disturbed.

TRANSLATION

O learned one, in this iron age of Kali men have but short lives. They are quarrelsome, lazy, misguided, unlucky and, above all, always disturbed.

PURPORT

The devotees of the Lord are always anxious for the spiritual improvement of the general public. When the sages of Naimiñāraëya analyzed the state of affairs of the people in this age of Kali, they foresaw that men would live short lives. In Kali-yuga, the duration of life is shortened not so much because of insufficient food but because of irregular habits. By keeping regular habits and eating simple food, any man can maintain his health. Overeating, over-sense gratification, overdependence on another's mercy, and artificial standards of living sap the very vitality of human energy. Therefore the duration of life is shortened.

The people of this age are also very lazy, not only materially but in the matter of self-realization. The human life is especially meant for self-realization. That is to say, man should come to know what he is, what the world is, and what the supreme truth is. Human life is a means by which the living entity can end all the miseries of the hard struggle for life in material existence and by which he can return to Godhead, his eternal home. But, due to a bad system of education, men have no desire for self-realization. Even if they come to know about it, they unfortunately become victims of misguided teachers.

In this age, men are victims not only of different political creeds and parties, but also of many different types of sense-gratificatory diversions, such as cinemas, sports, gambling, clubs, mundane libraries, bad association, smoking, drinking, cheating, pilfering, bickerings, and so on. Their minds are always disturbed and full of anxieties due to so many different engagements. In this age, many unscrupulous men manufacture their own religious faiths which are not based on any revealed scriptures, and very often people who are addicted to sense gratification are attracted by such institutions. Consequently, in the name of religion so many sinful acts are being carried on that the people in general have neither peace of mind nor health of body. The student (*brahmacāré*) communities are no longer being maintained, and householders do not observe the rules and regulations of the *gāhastha-āçrama*. Consequently, the so-called *vānaprasthas* and *sannyāsés* who come out of such *gāhastha-āçramas* are easily deviated from the rigid path. In the Kali-yuga the whole atmosphere

is surcharged with faithlessness. Men are no longer interested in spiritual values. Material sense gratification is now the standard of civilization. For the maintenance of such material civilizations, man has formed complex nations and communities, and there is a constant strain of hot and cold wars between these different groups. It has become very difficult, therefore, to raise the spiritual standard due to the present distorted values of human society. The sages of Naimiñāraëya are anxious to disentangle all fallen souls, and here they are seeking the remedy from Srila Sūta Gosvami.

TEXT 11

>aUrqi<a >aUirk-MaaRi<a é[aeTaVYaaNa iv>aaGaXa")
ATa" SaaDaae_]a YaTSaar& SaMaud(Da*TYa MaNaqzYaa)
b]Uih >ad]aYa>aUTaaNaa& YaeNaaTMaa SauPa[SaqdiTa)) 11))

bhüréëi bhüri-karmäëi

çrotavyäni vibhāgaçaù

ataù sādho 'tra yat sārāà

samuddhātya manéñayä

brühi bhadråya bhütänäà

yenātmä suprasédati

SYNONYMS

bhüréëi—multifarious; *bhüri*—many; *karmäëi*—duties; *çrotavyäni*—to be learned; *vibhāgaçaù*—by divisions of subject matter; *ataù*—therefore; *sādho*—O sage; *atra*—herein; *yat*—whatever; *sāram*—essence; *samuddhātya*—by selection; *manéñayä*—best to your knowledge; *brühi*—please tell us; *bhadråya*—for the good of; *bhütänäm*—the living beings; *yena*—by which; *ātmä*—the self; *suprasédati*—becomes fully satisfied.

TRANSLATION

There are many varieties of scriptures, and in all of them there are many prescribed duties, which can be learned only after many years of study in their various divisions. Therefore, O sage, please select the essence of all these scriptures and explain it for the good of all living beings, that by such instruction their hearts may be fully satisfied.

PURPORT

Ātmā, or self, is distinguished from matter and material elements. It is spiritual in constitution, and thus it is never satisfied by any amount of material planning. All scriptures and spiritual instructions are meant for the satisfaction of this self, or *ātmā*. There are many varieties of approaches which are recommended for different types of living beings in different times and at different places. Consequently, the numbers of revealed scriptures are innumerable. There are different methods and prescribed duties recommended in these various scriptures. Taking into consideration the fallen condition of the people in general in this age of Kali, the sages of Naimiñāraēya suggested that Sri Sūta Gosvami relate the essence of all such scriptures because in this age it is not possible for the fallen souls to understand and undergo all the lessons of all these various scriptures in a *varēa* and *āçrama* system.

The *varēa* and *āçrama* society was considered to be the best institution for lifting the human being to the spiritual platform, but due to Kali-yuga it is not possible to execute the rules and regulations of these institutions. Nor is it possible for the people in general to completely sever relations with their families as the *varēāçrama* institution prescribes. The whole atmosphere is surcharged with opposition. And considering this, one can see that spiritual emancipation for the common man in this age is very difficult. The reason the sages presented this matter to Sri Sūta Gosvami is explained in the following verses.

TEXT 12

SaUTa JaaNaaiSa >ad]& Tae >aGavaNa(SaaTvTaa& PaiTa")

devKYaa& vSaudevSYa JaaTaae YaSYa ick-IzRYaa)) 12))

süta jänäsi bhadraà te

bhagavän sätvatää patiù

devakyää vasudevasya

jäto yasya cikérñayä

SYNONYMS

süta—O Süta Gosvami; *jänäsi*—you know; *bhadram te*—all blessings upon you; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *sätvatäm*—of the pure devotees; *patiù*—the protector; *devakyäm*—in the womb of Devaké; *vasudevasya*—by Vasudeva; *jätaù*—born of; *yasya*—for the purpose of; *cikérñayä*—executing.

TRANSLATION

All blessings upon you, O Süta Gosvami. You know for what purpose the Personality of Godhead appeared in the womb of Devaké as the son of Vasudeva.

PURPORT

Bhagavän means the Almighty God who is the controller of all opulences, power, fame, beauty, knowledge and renunciation. He is the protector of His pure devotees. Although God is equally disposed to everyone, He is especially inclined to His devotees. *Sat* means the Absolute Truth. And persons who are servitors of the Absolute Truth are called *sätvatas*. And the Personality of Godhead who protects such pure devotees is known as the protector of the *sätvatas*. *Bhadraà te*, or “blessings upon you,” indicates the sages’ anxiety to know the Absolute Truth from the speaker. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, appeared to Devaké, the wife of Vasudeva. Vasudeva is the symbol of the transcendental position wherein the appearance of the Supreme Lord takes place.

TEXT 13

Taà" éué[UzMaa<aaNaaMahRSYa®aNauvi<aRTauMa()
YaSYaavTaarae >aUTaaNaa& +aeMaaYa c >avaYa c)) 13))

tan naù çuçrũñamäëänäm

arhasy aìgänuvarëitum

yasyävatäro bhütänäm

kñemäya ca bhaväya ca

SYNONYMS

tat—those; *naù*—unto us; *çuçrũñamäëänäm*—those who are endeavoring for; *arhasi*—ought to do it; *aìga*—O Sùta Gosvami; *anuvarëitum*—to explain by following in the footsteps of previous *äcäryas*; *yasya*—whose; *avatäraù*—incarnation; *bhütänäm*—of the living beings; *kñemäya*—for good; *ca*—and; *bhaväya*—upliftment; *ca*—and.

TRANSLATION

O Sùta Gosvami, we are eager to learn about the Personality of Godhead and His incarnations. Please explain to us those teachings imparted by previous masters [äcäryas], for one is uplifted both by speaking them and by hearing them.

PURPORT

The conditions for hearing the transcendental message of the Absolute Truth are set forth herein. The first condition is that the audience must be very sincere and eager to hear. And the speaker must be in the line of disciplic succession from the recognized *äcärya*. The transcendental message of the Absolute is not understandable by those who are materially absorbed. Under the direction of a bona fide spiritual master, one becomes gradually purified. Therefore, one must be in the chain of disciplic

succession and learn the spiritual art of submissive hearing. In the case of Sūta Gosvami and the sages of Naimiñāraëya, all these conditions are fulfilled because Srila Sūta Gosvami is in the line of Srila Vyāsadeva, and the sages of Naimiñāraëya are all sincere souls who are anxious to learn the truth. Thus the transcendental topics of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa’s superhuman activities, His incarnation, His birth, appearance or disappearance, His forms, His names and so on are all easily understandable because all requirements are fulfilled. Such discourses help all men on the path of spiritual realization.

TEXT 14

AaPaà" Sa&Sa*iTa& gaaera& YaàaMa ivvXaae Ga*<aNa()
TaTa" SaÛae ivMauCYaeTa YaiØ>aeiTa SvYa& >aYaMa()) 14))

äpannaù saàsâtia̐ ghoräà

yan-näma vivaço gâëan

tataù sadyo vimucyeta

yad bibheti svayaà bhayam

SYNONYMS

äpannaù—being entangled; *saàsâtim*—in the hurdle of birth and death; *ghoräm*—too complicated; *yat*—what; *näma*—the absolute name; *vivaçaù*—unconsciously; *gâëan*—chanting; *tataù*—from that; *sadyaù*—at once; *vimucyeta*—gets freedom; *yat*—that which; *bibheti*—fears; *svayam*—personally; *bhayam*—fear itself.

TRANSLATION

Living beings who are entangled in the complicated meshes of birth and death can be freed immediately by even unconsciously chanting the holy name of Kṛṣṇa, which is feared by fear personified.

PURPORT

Väsudeva, or Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Absolute Personality of Godhead, is the supreme controller of everything. There is no one in creation who is not afraid of the rage of the Almighty. Great *asuras* like Ravana, Hiraṇyakaśipu, Kaàsa, and others who were very powerful living entities were all killed by the Personality of Godhead. And the almighty Väsudeva has empowered His name with the powers of His personal Self. Everything is related to Him, and everything has its identity in Him. It is stated herein that the name of Kṛṣṇa is feared even by fear personified. This indicates that the name of Kṛṣṇa is nondifferent from Kṛṣṇa. Therefore, the name of Kṛṣṇa is as powerful as Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself. There is no difference at all. Anyone, therefore, can take advantage of the holy names of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa even in the midst of greatest dangers. The transcendental name of Kṛṣṇa, even though uttered unconsciously or by force of circumstances, can help one obtain freedom from the hurdle of birth and death.

TEXT 15

YaTPaadSa&é[Yaa" SaUTa MauNaYa" Pa[XaMaaYaNa")
SaÛ" PauNaNTYauPaSPa*ía" SvDauRNYaaPaae_NauSaevYaa)) 15))

yat-pāda-saàçrayäù sūta

munayaù praçamäyanäù

sadyaù punanty upaspãñöäù

svardhun-äpo 'nusevayä

SYNONYMS

yat—whose; *pāda*—lotus feet; *saàçrayäù*—those who have taken shelter of; *sūta*—O Sūta Gosvami; *munayaù*—great sages; *praçamäyanäù*—absorbed in devotion to the Supreme; *sadyaù*—at once; *punanti*—sanctify; *upaspãñöäù*—simply by association; *svardhuné*—of the sacred Ganges; *äpaù*—water; *anusevayä*—bringing into use.

TRANSLATION

O Sūta, those great sages who have completely taken shelter of the lotus feet of the Lord can at once sanctify those who come in touch with them, whereas the waters of the Ganges can sanctify only after prolonged use.

PURPORT

Pure devotees of the Lord are more powerful than the waters of the sacred river Ganges. One can derive spiritual benefit out of prolonged use of the Ganges waters. But one can be sanctified at once by the mercy of a pure devotee of the Lord. In *Bhagavad-gītā* it is said that any person, regardless of birth as *çūdra*, woman, or merchant, can take shelter of the lotus feet of the Lord and by so doing can return to Godhead. To take shelter of the lotus feet of the Lord means to take shelter of the pure devotees. The pure devotees whose only business is serving are honored by the names Prabhupāda and Viṣṇupāda, which indicate such devotees to be representatives of the lotus feet of the Lord. Anyone, therefore, who takes shelter of the lotus feet of a pure devotee by accepting the pure devotee as his spiritual master can be at once purified. Such devotees of the Lord are honored equally with the Lord because they are engaged in the most confidential service of the Lord, for they deliver out of the material world the fallen souls whom the Lord wants to return home, back to Godhead. Such pure devotees are better known as vicelords according to revealed scriptures. The sincere disciple of the pure devotee considers the spiritual master equal to the Lord, but always considers himself to be a humble servant of the servant of the Lord. This is the pure devotional path.

TEXT 16

**k-ae va >aGavTaSTaSYa Pau<Yaëaeke-@yk-MaR<a")
éuiÖk-aMaae Na é*<auYaaÛXa" k-il/Mal/aPahMa()) 16))**

ko vā bhagavatas tasya

puëya-çlokeòya-karmaëaù

çuddhi-kämo na çäëuyäd

yaçaù kali-maläpaham

SYNONYMS

kaù—who; *vä*—rather; *bhagavataù*—of the Lord; *tasya*—His; *puëya*—virtuous; *çloka-éòya*—worshipable by prayers; *karmaëaù*—deeds; *çuddhi-kämaù*—desiring deliverance from all sins; *na*—not; *çäëuyät*—does hear; *yaçaù*—glories; *kali*—of the age of quarrel; *mala-apaham*—the agent for sanctification.

TRANSLATION

Who is there, desiring deliverance from the vices of the age of quarrel, who is not willing to hear the virtuous glories of the Lord?

PURPORT

The age of Kali is the most condemned age due to its quarrelsome features. Kali-yuga is so saturated with vicious habits that there is a great fight at the slightest misunderstanding. Those who are engaged in the pure devotional service of the Lord, who are without any desire for self-aggrandizement and who are freed from the effects of fruitive actions and dry philosophical speculations are capable of getting out of the estrangements of this complicated age. The leaders of the people are very much anxious to live in peace and friendship, but they have no information of the simple method of hearing the glories of the Lord. On the contrary, such leaders are opposed to the propagation of the glories of the Lord. In other words, the foolish leaders want to completely deny the existence of the Lord. In the name of secular state, such leaders are enacting various plans every year. But by the insurmountable intricacies of the material nature of the Lord, all these plans for progress are being constantly frustrated. They have no eyes to see that their attempts at peace and friendship are failing. But here is the hint to get over the hurdle. If we want actual peace, we must open the road to understanding of the Supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa and glorify Him for His virtuous activities as they are depicted in the pages of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 17

TaSYa k-MaaR<Yaudarai<a PairGaqTaaiNa SaUiri>a")
b]Uih Na" é[ÖDaaNaaNaa& I/II/Yaa dDaTa" k-I/a")) 17))

tasya karmäëy udäräëi

parigétäni süribhiù

brühi naù çraddadhänänäà

lélayä dadhataù kaläù

SYNONYMS

tasya—His; *karmäëi*—transcendental acts; *udäräëi*—magnanimous;
parigétäni—broadcast; *süribhiù*—by the great souls; *brühi*—please speak;
naù—unto us; *çraddadhänänäm*—ready to receive with respect; *lélayä*—
pastimes; *dadhataù*—advented; *kaläù*—incarnations.

TRANSLATION

His transcendental acts are magnificent and gracious, and great learned sages like Nārada sing of them. Please, therefore, speak to us, who are eager to hear about the adventures He performs in His various incarnations.

PURPORT

The Personality of Godhead is never inactive as some less intelligent persons suggest. His works are magnificent and magnanimous. His creations both material and spiritual are all wonderful and contain all variegatedness. They are described nicely by such liberated souls as Srila Nārada, Vyāsa, Vālméki, Devala, Asita, Madhva, Sri Caitanya, Rāmānuja, Viṣṇusvāmé, Nimbārka, Sridhara, Visvanatha, Baladeva, Bhaktivinoda, Siddhānta Sarasvaté and many other learned and self-realized souls. These creations, both material and spiritual, are full of opulence, beauty and

knowledge, but the spiritual realm is more magnificent due to its being full of knowledge, bliss and eternity. The material creations are manifested for some time as perverted shadows of the spiritual kingdom and can be likened to cinemas. They attract people of less intelligent caliber who are attracted by false things. Such foolish men have no information of the reality, and they take it for granted that the false material manifestation is the all in all. But more intelligent men guided by sages like Vyāsa and Nārada know that the eternal kingdom of God is more delightful, larger, and eternally full of bliss and knowledge. Those who are not conversant with the activities of the Lord and His transcendental realm are sometimes favored by the Lord in His adventures as incarnations wherein He displays the eternal bliss of His association in the transcendental realm. By such activities He attracts the conditioned souls of the material world. Some of these conditioned souls are engaged in the false enjoyment of material senses and others in simply negating their real life in the spiritual world. These less intelligent persons are known as *karmés*, or fruitive workers, and *jñānés*, or dry mental speculators. But above these two classes of men is the transcendentalist known as *sātvata*, or the devotee, who is busy neither with rampant material activity nor with material speculation. He is engaged in the positive service of the Lord, and thereby he derives the highest spiritual benefit unknown to the *karmés* and *jñānés*.

As the supreme controller of both the material and spiritual worlds, the Lord has different incarnations of unlimited categories. Incarnations like Brahmā, Rudra, Manu, Pāthu and Vyāsa are His material qualitative incarnations, but His incarnations like Rāma, Narasiṅha, Varāha and Vāmana are His transcendental incarnations. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the fountainhead of all incarnations, and He is therefore the cause of all causes.

TEXT 18

AQaa:Yaaih hreDasMaàvTaark-Qaa" éu>aa")
I/Il/a ivdDaTa" SvErMaqirSYaaTMaMaaYaYaa)) 18))

athākhyāhi harer dhémann

avatāra-kathāù çubhāù

lila vidadhataù svairam

éçvarasyätma-mäyayä

SYNONYMS

atha—therefore; *äkhyähi*—describe; *hareù*—of the Lord; *dhéman*—O sagacious one; *avatära*—incarnations; *kathäù*—narratives; *çubhäù*—auspicious; *lila*—adventures; *vidadhataù*—performed; *svairam*—pastimes; *éçvarasya*—of the supreme controller; *ätma*—personal; *mäyayä*—energies.

TRANSLATION

O wise Sūta, please narrate to us the transcendental pastimes of the Supreme Godhead’s multi-incarnations. Such auspicious adventures and pastimes of the Lord, the supreme controller, are performed by His internal powers.

PURPORT

For the creation, maintenance and destruction of the material worlds, the Supreme Lord Personality of Godhead Himself appears in many thousands of forms of incarnations, and the specific adventures found in those transcendental forms are all auspicious. Both those who are present during such activities and those who hear the transcendental narrations of such activities are benefited.

TEXT 19

**vYa& Tau Na ivTa*PYaaMa otaMaëaek-iv§-Mae)
YaC^*<vTaa& rSajaNaa& Svadu Svadu Pade Pade)) 19))**

vayaà tu na vitåpyäma

uttama-çloka-vikrame

yac-chåëvatäà rasa-jjännäà

svädu svädu pade pade

SYNONYMS

vayam—we; *tu*—but; *na*—not; *vitāpyāmau*—shall be at rest; *uttama-çloka*—the Personality of Godhead, who is glorified by transcendental prayers; *vikrame*—adventures; *yat*—which; *çāëvatām*—by continuous hearing; *rasa*—humor; *jñānam*—those who are conversant with; *svädu*—relishing; *svädu*—palatable; *pade pade*—at every step.

TRANSLATION

We never tire of hearing the transcendental pastimes of the Personality of Godhead, who is glorified by hymns and prayers. Those who have developed a taste for transcendental relationships with Him relish hearing of His pastimes at every moment.

PURPORT

There is a great difference between mundane stories, fiction, or history and the transcendental pastimes of the Lord. The histories of the whole universe contain references to the pastimes of the incarnations of the Lord. The *Ramayana*, the *Mahābhārata*, and the *Puranas* are histories of bygone ages recorded in connection with the pastimes of the incarnations of the Lord and therefore remain fresh even after repeated readings. For example, anyone may read *Bhagavad-gita* or the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* repeatedly throughout his whole life and yet find in them new light of information. Mundane news is static whereas transcendental news is dynamic, inasmuch as the spirit is dynamic and matter is static. Those who have developed a taste for understanding the transcendental subject matter are never tired of hearing such narrations. One is quickly satiated by mundane activities, but no one is satiated by transcendental or devotional activities. *Uttama-çloka* indicates that literature which is not meant for nescience. Mundane literature is in the mode of darkness or ignorance, whereas transcendental literature is quite different. Transcendental literature is above the mode of darkness, and its light becomes more luminous with progressive reading and realization of the transcendental subject matter. The so-called

liberated persons are never satisfied by the repetition of the words *ahaà brahmäsmi*. Such artificial realization of Brahman becomes hackneyed, and so to relish real pleasure they turn to the narrations of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Those who are not so fortunate turn to altruism and worldly philanthropy. This means the Mäyävāda philosophy is mundane, whereas the philosophy of *Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is transcendental.

TEXT 20

k*-TavaNa(ik-I/ k-MaaRi<a Sah raMae<a ke-Xav")
AiTaMaTYaaRiNa >aGavaNa(GaU!" k-Pa\$=MaaNauz")) 20))

kātavān kila karmāēi

saha rāmeēa keçavaù

atimartyāni bhagavān

güòhaù kapaöa-mānuñhaù

SYNONYMS

kātavān—done by; *kila*—what; *karmāēi*—acts; *saha*—along with; *rāmeēa*—Balarāma; *keçavaù*—Sri Kṛṣṇa; *atimartyāni*—superhuman; *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *güòhaù*—masked as; *kapaöa*—apparently; *mānuñhaù*—human being.

TRANSLATION

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, along with Balarāma, played like a human being, and so masked He performed many superhuman acts.

PURPORT

The doctrines of anthropomorphism and zoomorphism are never applicable to Sri Kṛṣṇa, or the Personality of Godhead. The theory that a man becomes

God by dint of penance and austerities is very much rampant nowadays, especially in India. Since Lord Rāma, Lord Kṛṣṇa and Lord Caitanya Mahāprabhu were detected by the sages and saints to be the Personality of Godhead as indicated in revealed scriptures, many unscrupulous men have created their own incarnations. This process of concocting an incarnation of God has become an ordinary business, especially in Bengal. Any popular personality with a few traits of mystic powers will display some feat of jugglery and easily become an incarnation of Godhead by popular vote. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa was not that type of incarnation. He was actually the Personality of Godhead from the very beginning of His appearance. He appeared before His so-called mother as four-armed Viṣṇu. Then, at the request of the mother, He became like a human child and at once left her for another devotee at Gokula, where He was accepted as the son of Nanda Mahārāja and Yaçodā Mātā. Similarly, Sri Baladeva, the counterpart of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, was also considered a human child born of another wife of Sri Vasudeva. In *Bhagavad-gītā*, the Lord says that His birth and deeds are transcendental and that anyone who is so fortunate as to know the transcendental nature of His birth and deeds will at once become liberated and eligible to return to the kingdom of God. So knowledge of the transcendental nature of the birth and deeds of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is sufficient for liberation. In the *Bhāgavatam*, the transcendental nature of the Lord is described in nine cantos, and in the Tenth Canto His specific pastimes are taken up. All this becomes known as one's reading of this literature progresses. It is important to note here, however, that the Lord exhibited His divinity even from the lap of His mother, that His deeds are all superhuman (He lifted Govardhana Hill at the age of seven), and that all these acts definitely prove Him to be actually the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Yet, due to His mystic covering, He was always accepted as an ordinary human child by His so-called father and mother and other relatives. Whenever some herculean task was performed by Him, the father and mother took it otherwise. And they remained satisfied with unflinching filial love for their son. As such, the sages of Naimiñāraëya describe Him as apparently resembling a human being, but actually He is the supreme almighty Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 21

k-il/MaaGaTaMaajaYa +ae}ae_iSMaNa(vEZ<ave vYaMa()
AaSaqNaa dqgaRSa}ae<a k-QaaYaa& Sa+a<aa hre")) 21))

kalim ägatam äjïäya

kñetre 'smin vaiñëave vayam

äsénä dérga-satreëa

kathäyää sakñäëä hareù

SYNONYMS

kalim—the age of Kali (iron age of quarrel); *ägatam*—having arrived;
äjïäya—knowing this; *kñetre*—in this tract of land; *asmin*—in this;
vaiñëave—specially meant for the devotee of the Lord; *vayam*—we;
äsénäù—seated; *dérga*—prolonged; *satreëa*—for performance of
sacrifices; *kathäyäm*—in the words of; *sa-kñäëäù*—with time at our
disposal; *hareù*—of the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

Knowing well that the age of Kali has already begun, we are assembled here in this holy place to hear at great length the transcendental message of Godhead and in this way perform sacrifice.

PURPORT

This age of Kali is not at all suitable for self-realization as was Satya-yuga, the golden age, or Tretä- or Dvāpara-yugas, the silver and copper ages. For self-realization, the people in Satya-yuga, living a lifetime of a hundred thousand years, were able to perform prolonged meditation. And in Tretä-yuga, when the duration of life was ten thousand years, self-realization was attained by performance of great sacrifice. And in the Dvāpara-yuga, when the duration of life was one thousand years, self-realization was attained by worship of the Lord. But in the Kali-yuga, the maximum duration of life being one hundred years only and that combined with various difficulties,

the recommended process of self-realization is that of hearing and chanting of the holy name, fame, and pastimes of the Lord. The sages of Naimiñāraëya began this process in a place meant specifically for the devotees of the Lord. They prepared themselves to hear the pastimes of the Lord over a period of one thousand years. By the example of these sages one should learn that regular hearing and recitation of the *Bhāgavatam* is the only way for self-realization. Other attempts are simply a waste of time, for they do not give any tangible results. Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu preached this system of *Bhāgavata-dharma*, and He recommended that all those who were born in India should take the responsibility of broadcasting the messages of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, primarily the message of *Bhagavad-gita*. And when one is well established in the teachings of *Bhagavad-gita*, he can take up the study of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* for further enlightenment in self-realization.

TEXT 22

**Tv& Na" SaNdiXaRTaae Daa}aa duSTar& iNaiSTaTaqzRTaaMa()
k-il&/ Satvhr& Pau&Saa& k-<aRDaar wva<aRvMa()) 22))**

tvaà naù sandarçito dhäträ

dustaraà nistitérñatäm

kalià sattva-haraà puàsäà

karëa-dhära ivärëavam

SYNONYMS

tvam—Your Goodness; *naù*—unto us; *sandarçitaù*—meeting; *dhäträ*—by providence; *dustaram*—insurmountable; *nistitérñatäm*—for those desiring to cross over; *kalim*—the age of Kali; *sattva-haram*—that which deteriorates the good qualities; *puàsäm*—of a man; *karëa-dhäraù*—captain; *iva*—as; *arëavam*—the ocean.

TRANSLATION

We think that we have met Your Goodness by the will of providence, just so that we may accept you as captain of the ship for those who desire to cross the difficult ocean of Kali, which deteriorates all the good qualities of a human being.

PURPORT

The age of Kali is very dangerous for the human being. Human life is simply meant for self-realization, but due to this dangerous age, men have completely forgotten the aim of life. In this age, the life span will gradually decrease. People will gradually lose their memory, finer sentiments, strength, and better qualities. A list of the anomalies for this age is given in the Twelfth Canto of this work. And so this age is very difficult for those who want to utilize this life for self-realization. The people are so busy with sense gratification that they completely forget about self-realization. Out of madness they frankly say that there is no need for self-realization because they do not realize that this brief life is but a moment on our great journey towards self-realization. The whole system of education is geared to sense gratification, and if a learned man thinks it over, he sees that the children of this age are being intentionally sent to the slaughterhouses of so-called education. Learned men, therefore, must be cautious of this age, and if they at all want to cross over the dangerous ocean of Kali, they must follow the footsteps of the sages of Naimiñāraëya and accept Sri Sūta Gosvami or his bona fide representative as the captain of the ship. The ship is the message of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa in the shape of *Bhagavad-gita* or the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 23

**b]Uih YaaeGaeire k*-Z<ae b]ø<Yae DaMaRvMaRi<a)
Sva& k-aïaMaDauNaaePaeTae DaMaR" k&- Xar<a& GaTa")) 23))**

brühi yogeçvare kãñëe

brahmaëye dharma-varmaëi

sväà kãñöhäm adhunopete

dharmaù kaà çaraëaà gataù

SYNONYMS

brühi—please tell; *yoga-éçvare*—the Lord of all mystic powers; *kãñëe*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *brahmaëye*—the Absolute Truth; *dharma*—religion; *varmaëi*—protector; *sväm*—own; *kãñöhäm*—abode; *adhunä*—nowadays; *upete*—having gone away; *dharmaù*—religion; *kam*—unto whom; *çaraëam*—shelter; *gataù*—gone.

TRANSLATION

Since Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Absolute Truth, the master of all mystic powers, has departed for His own abode, please tell us to whom the religious principles have now gone for shelter.

PURPORT

Essentially religion is the prescribed codes enunciated by the Personality of Godhead Himself. Whenever there is gross misuse or neglect of the principles of religion, the Supreme Lord appears Himself to restore religious principles. This is stated in *Bhagavad-gita*. Here the sages of Naimiñäraëya are inquiring about these principles. The reply to this question is given later. The *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the transcendental sound representation of the Personality of Godhead, and thus it is the full representation of transcendental knowledge and religious principles.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, First Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled “Questions by the Sages.”

Chapter Two

Divinity and Divine Service

TEXT 1

VYaaSa ovac
wiTā SaMPa[énSa&ôíae ivPa[a<aa& raEMahzRi<a")
Pa[iTaPaUJYa vcSTaeza& Pa[v̥cu-MauPacṣ-Mae)) 1))

vyāsa uvāca

iti sampraçna-saàhāñöo

vipräää raumaharñaeiù

pratipūjya vacas teñäà

pravaktum upacakrame

SYNONYMS

vyāsaù uvāca—Vyāsa said; *iti*—thus; *sampraçna*—perfect inquiries; *saàhāñöaù*—perfectly satisfied; *viprääm*—of the sages there; *raumaharñaeiù*—the son of Romaharñaeä, namely Ugraçravä; *pratipūjya*—after thanking them; *vacaù*—words; *teñäm*—their; *pravaktum*—to reply to them; *upacakrame*—attempted.

TRANSLATION

Ugraçravä [Süta Gosvami], the son of Romaharñaeä, being fully satisfied by the perfect questions of the brahmanas, thanked them and thus attempted to reply.

PURPORT

The sages of Naimiñäraëya asked Süta Gosvami six questions, and so he is answering them one by one.

TEXT 2

SaUTa ovac
Ya& Pa[v]JaNTaMaNauPaeTaMaPaeTak*-TYa&

ÜEPaaYaNaae ivrhk-aTar AaJauhav)
Pau}aeiTa TaNMaYaTaYaa Tarvae_i>aNaedu,
STa& SavR>aUTaôdYa& MauiNaMaaNaTaae_iSMa)) 2))

süta uväca

yaà pravrajantam anupetam apeta-kåtyaà

dvaipäyano viraha-kåtara äjuhäva

putreti tan-mayatayä taravo 'bhinedus

taà sarva-bhüta-hådayaà munim änato 'smi

SYNONYMS

sütaù—Süta Gosvami; *uväca*—said; *yam*—whom; *pravrajantam*—while going away for the renounced order of life; *anupetam*—without being reformed by the sacred thread; *apeta*—not undergoing ceremonies; *kåtyam*—prescribed duties; *dvaipäyanaù*—Vyāsadeva; *viraha*—separation; *kåtaraù*—being afraid of; *äjuhäva*—exclaimed; *putra iti*—O my son; *tat-mayatayä*—being absorbed in that way; *taravaù*—all the trees; *abhineduù*—responded; *tam*—unto him; *sarva*—all; *bhüta*—living entities; *hådayam*—heart; *munim*—sage; *änataù asmi*—offer obeisances.

TRANSLATION

Srila Süta Gosvami said: Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto that great sage [Çukadeva Gosvami] who can enter the hearts of all. When he went away to take up the renounced order of life [sannyäsa], leaving home without undergoing reformation by the sacred thread or the ceremonies observed by the higher castes, his father, Vyāsadeva, fearing separation from him, cried out, “O my son!” Indeed, only the trees, which were absorbed in the same feelings of separation, echoed in response to the begrieved father.

PURPORT

The institution of *varëa* and *äçrama* prescribes many regulative duties to be observed by its followers. Such duties enjoin that a candidate willing to study the *Vedas* must approach a bona fide spiritual master and request acceptance as his disciple. The sacred thread is the sign of those who are competent to study the *Vedas* from the *äcärya*, or the bona fide spiritual master. Sri Çukadeva Gosvami did not undergo such purificatory ceremonies because he was a liberated soul from his very birth.

Generally, a man is born as an ordinary being, and by the purificatory processes he is born for the second time. When he sees a new light and seeks direction for spiritual progress, he approaches a spiritual master for instruction in the *Vedas*. The spiritual master accepts only the sincere inquirer as his disciple and gives him the sacred thread. In this way a man becomes twice-born, or a *dvija*. After qualifying as a *dvija* one may study the *Vedas*, and after becoming well versed in the *Vedas* one becomes a *vipra*. A *vipra*, or a qualified *brahmana*, thus realizes the Absolute and makes further progress in spiritual life until he reaches the Vaiñëava stage. The Vaiñëava stage is the postgraduate status of a *brahmana*. A progressive *brahmana* must necessarily become a Vaiñëava, for a Vaiñëava is a self-realized, learned *brahmana*.

Srila Çukadeva Gosvami was a Vaiñëava from the beginning; therefore, there was no need for him to undergo all the processes of the *varëäçrama* institution. Ultimately the aim of *varëäçrama-dharma* is to turn a crude man into a pure devotee of the Lord, or a Vaiñëava. Anyone, therefore, who becomes a Vaiñëava accepted by the first-class Vaiñëava, or *uttama-adhikäre* Vaiñëava, is already considered a *brahmana*, regardless of his birth or past deeds. Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu accepted this principle and recognized Srila Haridäsa Öhäkura as the *äcärya* of the holy name, although Öhäkura Haridäsa appeared in a Mohammedan family. In conclusion, Srila Çukadeva Gosvami was born a Vaiñëava, and, therefore, brahminism was included in him. He did not have to undergo any ceremonies. Any lowborn person—be he a Kiräta, Hüëa, Ändhra, Pulinda, Pulkaça, Äbhëra, Çumbha, Yavana, Khasa or even lower—can be delivered to the highest transcendental position by the mercy of Vaiñëavas. Srila Çukadeva Gosvami was the spiritual master of Sri Söta Gosvami, who therefore offers his respectful obeisances unto Srila Çukadeva Gosvami before he begins his

answers to the questions of the sages at Naimiñāraëya.

TEXT 3

Ya" SvaNau>aavMai%l/é[uiTaSaarMaek-,
MaDYaaTMadqPaMaiTaiTaTaQzRTaa& TaMaae_NDaMa()
Sa&Saaair<aa& k-å<aYaah Paura<aGauù&
Ta& VYaaSaSaUNauMauPaYaaiMa Gauå& MauNaqNaaMa()) 3))

yaù svānubhāvam akhila-śruti-sāram ekam

adhyātma-dēpam atititērñatāà tamo 'ndham

saàsāriëää karuëayāha puräëa-guhyāà

taà vyāsa-sūnum upayāmi guruà munénām

SYNONYMS

yaù—he who; *sva-anubhāvam*—self-assimilated (experienced); *akhila*—all around; *śruti*—the *Vedas*; *sāram*—cream; *ekam*—the only one; *adhyātma*—transcendental; *dēpam*—torchlight; *atititērñatām*—desiring to overcome; *tamaù andham*—deeply dark material existence; *saàsāriëām*—of the materialistic men; *karuëayā*—out of causeless mercy; *āha*—said; *puräëa*—supplement to the *Vedas*; *guhyam*—very confidential; *tam*—unto him; *vyāsa-sūnum*—the son of Vyāsadeva; *upayāmi*—let me offer my obeisances; *gurum*—the spiritual master; *munénām*—of the great sages.

TRANSLATION

Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto him [Çuka], the spiritual master of all sages, the son of Vyāsadeva, who, out of his great compassion for those gross materialists who struggle to cross over the darkest regions of material existence, spoke this most confidential supplement to the cream of Vedic knowledge, after having personally assimilated it by experience.

PURPORT

In this prayer, Srila Sūta Gosvami practically summarizes the complete introduction of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the natural supplementary commentary on the *Vedānta-sūtras*. The *Vedānta-sūtras*, or the *Brahma-sūtras*, were compiled by Vyāsadeva with a view to presenting just the cream of Vedic knowledge. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the natural commentary on this cream. Srila Çukadeva Gosvami was a thoroughly realized master on the *Vedānta-sūtra*, and consequently he also personally realized the commentary, *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. And just to show his boundless mercy upon bewildered materialistic men who want to cross completely over nescience, he recited for the first time this confidential knowledge.

There is no point in arguing that a materialistic man can be happy. No materialistic creature—be he the great Brahmā or an insignificant ant—can be happy. Everyone tries to make a permanent plan for happiness, but everyone is baffled by the laws of material nature. Therefore the materialistic world is called the darkest region of God’s creation. Yet the unhappy materialists can get out of it simply by desiring to get out. Unfortunately they are so foolish that they do not want to escape. Therefore they are compared to the camel who relishes thorny twigs because he likes the taste of the twigs mixed with blood. He does not realize that it is his own blood and that his tongue is being cut by the thorns. Similarly, to the materialist his own blood is as sweet as honey, and although he is always harassed by his own material creations, he does not wish to escape. Such materialists are called *karmés*. Out of hundreds of thousands of *karmés*, only a few may feel tired of material engagement and desire to get out of the labyrinth. Such intelligent persons are called *jñānés*. The *Vedānta-sūtra* is directed to such *jñānés*. But Srila Vyāsadeva, being the incarnation of the Supreme Lord, could foresee the misuse of the *Vedānta-sūtra* by unscrupulous men, and, therefore, he personally supplemented the *Vedānta-sūtra* with the *Bhāgavata Purana*. It is clearly said that this *Bhāgavatam* is the original commentary on the *Brahma-sūtras*. Srila Vyāsadeva also instructed the *Bhāgavatam* to his own son, Srila Çukadeva Gosvami, who was already at the liberated stage of transcendence. Srila Çukadeva realized it personally and then explained it. By the mercy of Srila

Çukadeva, the *Bhāgavata-vedānta-sūtra* is available for all those sincere souls who want to get out of material existence.

Srimad-Bhagavatam is the one unrivaled commentary on *Vedānta-sūtra*. Sripāda Çaikarācārya intentionally did not touch it because he knew that the natural commentary would be difficult for him to surpass. He wrote his *Çāréraka-bhāñya*, and his so-called followers deprecated the *Bhāgavatam* as some “new” presentation. One should not be misled by such propaganda directed against the *Bhāgavatam* by the Māyāvāda school. From this introductory *çloka*, the beginning student should know that *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the only transcendental literature meant for those who are *paramahamsas* and completely freed from the material disease called malice. The Māyāvādés are envious of the Personality of Godhead despite Sripāda Çaikarācārya’s admission that Nārāyaṇa, the Personality of Godhead, is above the material creation. The envious Māyāvādé cannot have access to the *Bhāgavatam*, but those who are really anxious to get out of this material existence may take shelter of this *Bhāgavatam* because it is uttered by the liberated Srila Çukadeva Gosvami. It is the transcendental torchlight by which one can see perfectly the transcendental Absolute Truth realized as Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān.

TEXT 4

NaaraYa<a& NaMaSk*-TYa Nar& cEv NaraetaMaMa()
devq& SarSvTaq& VYaaSa& TaTaae JaYaMaudqrYaeTa()) 4))

nārāyaëà namaskātya

naraà caiva narottamam

devéà sarasvatéà vyäsaà

tato jayam udérayet

SYNONYMS

nārāyaëam—the Personality of Godhead; *namaù-kātya*—after offering

respectful obeisances; *naram ca eva*—and Nārāyaṇa Rsi; *nara-uttamam*—the supermost human being; *devém*—the goddess; *sarasvatém*—the mistress of learning; *vyāsam*—Vyāsadeva; *tataù*—thereafter; *jayam*—all that is meant for conquering; *udérayet*—be announced.

TRANSLATION

Before reciting this Srimad-Bhagavatam, which is the very means of conquest, one should offer respectful obeisances unto the Personality of Godhead, Nārāyaṇa, unto Nara-nārāyaëa Rsi, the supermost human being, unto mother Sarasvaté, the goddess of learning, and unto Srila Vyāsadeva, the author.

PURPORT

All the Vedic literatures and the *Puranas* are meant for conquering the darkest region of material existence. The living being is in the state of forgetfulness of his relation with God due to his being overly attracted to material sense gratification from time immemorial. His struggle for existence in the material world is perpetual, and it is not possible for him to get out of it by making plans. If he at all wants to conquer this perpetual struggle for existence, he must reestablish his eternal relation with God. And one who wants to adopt such remedial measures must take shelter of literatures such as the *Vedas* and the *Puranas*. Foolish people say that the *Puranas* have no connection with the *Vedas*. However, the *Puranas* are supplementary explanations of the *Vedas* intended for different types of men. All men are not equal. There are men who are conducted by the mode of goodness, others who are under the mode of passion and others who are under the mode of ignorance. The *Puranas* are so divided that any class of men can take advantage of them and gradually regain their lost position and get out of the hard struggle for existence. Srila Sūta Gosvami shows the way of chanting the *Puranas*. This may be followed by persons who aspire to be preachers of the Vedic literatures and the *Puranas*. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the spotless *Purana*, and it is especially meant for those who desire to get out of the material entanglement permanently.

TEXT 5

MauNaYa" SaaDau Pa*fae_h& >aviÜl/aeRk-Ma®l/Ma()
YaTk*-Ta" k*-Z<aSaMPa[énae YaeNaaTMaa SauPa[SaqdiTa)) 5))

munayaù sädhu pãñöo 'haà

bhavadbhir loka-maìgalam

yat kãtaù kãñëa-sampraçno

yenätmä suprasédati

SYNONYMS

munayaù—O sages; *sädhu*—this is relevant; *pãñöaù*—questioned; *aham*—myself; *bhavadbhiù*—by all of you; *loka*—the world; *maìgalam*—welfare; *yat*—because; *kãtaù*—made; *kãñëa*—the Personality of Godhead; *sampraçnaù*—relevant question; *yena*—by which; *ätmä*—self; *suprasédati*—completely pleased.

TRANSLATION

O sages, I have been justly questioned by you. Your questions are worthy because they relate to Lord Kṛṣṇa and so are of relevance to the world's welfare. Only questions of this sort are capable of completely satisfying the self.

PURPORT

Since it has been stated hereinbefore that in the *Bhāgavatam* the Absolute Truth is to be known, the questions of the sages of Naimiñāraëya are proper and just, because they pertain to Kṛṣṇa, who is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the Absolute Truth. In *Bhagavad-gita* (15.15) the Personality of Godhead says that in all the *Vedas* there is nothing but the urge for searching after Him, Lord Kṛṣṇa. Thus the questions that pertain to Kṛṣṇa are the sum and substance of all the Vedic inquiries.

The whole world is full of questions and answers. The birds, beasts and

men are all busy in the matter of perpetual questions and answers. In the morning the birds in the nest become busy with questions and answers, and in the evening also the same birds come back and again become busy with questions and answers. The human being, unless he is fast asleep at night, is busy with questions and answers. The businessmen in the market are busy with questions and answers, and so also the lawyers in the court and the students in the schools and colleges. The legislators in the parliament are also busy with questions and answers, and the politicians and the press representatives are all busy with questions and answers. Although they go on making such questions and answers for their whole lives, they are not at all satisfied. Satisfaction of the soul can only be obtained by questions and answers on the subject of Kṛṣṇa.

Kṛṣṇa is our most intimate master, friend, father or son and object of conjugal love. Forgetting Kṛṣṇa, we have created so many objects of questions and answers, but none of them are able to give us complete satisfaction. All things—but Kṛṣṇa—give temporary satisfaction only, so if we are to have complete satisfaction we must take to the questions and answers about Kṛṣṇa. We cannot live for a moment without being questioned or without giving answers. Because the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* deals with questions and answers that are related to Kṛṣṇa, we can derive the highest satisfaction only by reading and hearing this transcendental literature. One should learn the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* and make an all-around solution to all problems pertaining to social, political or religious matters. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* and Kṛṣṇa are the sum total of all things.

TEXT 6

**Sa vE Pau&Saa& Parae DaMaaE YaTaaE >aiÇ-rDaaE+aJae)
AhETauKYaPa[iTahTaa YaYaaTMaa SauPa[SaqdiTa)) 6))**

sa vai puàsäà paro dharmo

yato bhaktir adhokñaje

ahaituky apratihata

yayātmā suprasēdati

SYNONYMS

saù—that; *vai*—certainly; *puàsām*—for mankind; *paraù*—sublime; *dharmaù*—occupation; *yataù*—by which; *bhaktiù*—devotional service; *adhokñaje*—unto the Transcendence; *ahaituké*—causeless; *apratihatā*—unbroken; *yayā*—by which; *ātmā*—the self; *suprasēdati*—completely satisfied.

TRANSLATION

The supreme occupation [dharma] for all humanity is that by which men can attain to loving devotional service unto the transcendent Lord. Such devotional service must be unmotivated and uninterrupted to completely satisfy the self.

PURPORT

In this statement, Sri Sūta Gosvami answers the first question of the sages of Naimiñāraëya. The sages asked him to summarize the whole range of revealed scriptures and present the most essential part so that fallen people or the people in general might easily take it up. The *Vedas* prescribe two different types of occupation for the human being. One is called the *pravātti-mārga*, or the path of sense enjoyment, and the other is called the *nivātti-mārga*, or the path of renunciation. The path of enjoyment is inferior, and the path of sacrifice for the supreme cause is superior. The material existence of the living being is a diseased condition of actual life. Actual life is spiritual existence, or *brahma-bhūta* existence, where life is eternal, blissful and full of knowledge. Material existence is temporary, illusory and full of miseries. There is no happiness at all. There is just the futile attempt to get rid of the miseries, and temporary cessation of misery is falsely called happiness. Therefore, the path of progressive material enjoyment, which is temporary, miserable and illusory, is inferior. But devotional service to the Supreme Lord, which leads one to eternal, blissful and all-cognizant life, is called the superior quality of occupation. This is sometimes polluted when mixed with the inferior quality. For example,

adoption of devotional service for material gain is certainly an obstruction to the progressive path of renunciation. Renunciation or abnegation for ultimate good is certainly a better occupation than enjoyment in the diseased condition of life. Such enjoyment only aggravates the symptoms of disease and increases its duration. Therefore devotional service to the Lord must be pure in quality, i.e., without the least desire for material enjoyment. One should, therefore, accept the superior quality of occupation in the form of the devotional service of the Lord without any tinge of unnecessary desire, fruitive action and philosophical speculation. This alone can lead one to perpetual solace in His service.

We have purposely denoted *dharma* as occupation because the root meaning of the word *dharma* is “that which sustains one’s existence.” A living being’s sustenance of existence is to coordinate his activities with his eternal relation with the Supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa. Kṛṣṇa is the central pivot of living beings, and He is the all-attractive living entity or eternal form amongst all other living beings or eternal forms. Each and every living being has his eternal form in the spiritual existence, and Kṛṣṇa is the eternal attraction for all of them. Kṛṣṇa is the complete whole, and everything else is His part and parcel. The relation is one of the servant and the served. It is transcendental and is completely distinct from our experience in material existence. This relation of servant and the served is the most congenial form of intimacy. One can realize it as devotional service progresses. Everyone should engage himself in that transcendental loving service of the Lord, even in the present conditional state of material existence. That will gradually give one the clue to actual life and please him to complete satisfaction.

TEXT 7

**vaSaudeve >aGaviTa >aiÇ-YaaeGa" Pa[YaaeiJaTa")
JaNaYaTYaaéu vEraGYa& jaNa& c YadhETauk-Ma()) 7))**

väsudeve bhagavati

bhakti-yogaù prayojitaù

janayaty äçu vairägyaà

jïänaà ca yad ahaitukam

SYNONYMS

väsudeve—unto Kṛṣṇa; *bhagavati*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *bhakti-yogaù*—contact of devotional service; *prayojitaù*—being applied; *janayati*—does produce; *äçu*—very soon; *vairägyam*—detachment; *jïänam*—knowledge; *ca*—and; *yat*—that which; *ahaitukam*—causeless.

TRANSLATION

By rendering devotional service unto the Personality of Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa, one immediately acquires causeless knowledge and detachment from the world.

PURPORT

Those who consider devotional service to the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa to be something like material emotional affairs may argue that in the revealed scriptures, sacrifice, charity, austerity, knowledge, mystic powers and similar other processes of transcendental realization are recommended. According to them, *bhakti*, or the devotional service of the Lord, is meant for those who cannot perform the high-grade activities. Generally it is said that the *bhakti* cult is meant for the *sudras*, *vaisyas* and the less intelligent woman class. But that is not the actual fact. The *bhakti* cult is the topmost of all transcendental activities, and therefore it is simultaneously sublime and easy. It is sublime for the pure devotees who are serious about getting in contact with the Supreme Lord, and it is easy for the neophytes who are just on the threshold of the house of *bhakti*. To achieve the contact of the Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa is a great science, and it is open for all living beings, including the *sudras*, *vaisyas*, women and even those lower than the lowborn *sudras*, so what to speak of the high-class men like the qualified *brahmanas* and the great self-realized kings. The other high-grade activities designated as sacrifice, charity, austerity, etc., are all corollary factors following the pure and scientific *bhakti* cult.

The principles of knowledge and detachment are two important factors on the path of transcendental realization. The whole spiritual process leads to perfect knowledge of everything material and spiritual, and the results of such perfect knowledge are that one becomes detached from material affection and becomes attached to spiritual activities. Becoming detached from material things does not mean becoming inert altogether, as men with a poor fund of knowledge think. *Naiñkarma* means not undertaking activities that will produce good or bad effects. Negation does not mean negation of the positive. Negation of the nonessentials does not mean negation of the essential. Similarly, detachment from material forms does not mean nullifying the positive form. The *bhakti* cult is meant for realization of the positive form. When the positive form is realized, the negative forms are automatically eliminated. Therefore, with the development of the *bhakti* cult, with the application of positive service to the positive form, one naturally becomes detached from inferior things, and he becomes attached to superior things. Similarly, the *bhakti* cult, being the supermost occupation of the living being, leads him out of material sense enjoyment. That is the sign of a pure devotee. He is not a fool, nor is he engaged in the inferior energies, nor does he have material values. This is not possible by dry reasoning. It actually happens by the grace of the Almighty. In conclusion, one who is a pure devotee has all other good qualities, namely knowledge, detachment, etc., but one who has only knowledge or detachment is not necessarily well acquainted with the principles of the *bhakti* cult. *Bhakti* is the supermost occupation of the human being.

TEXT 8

**DaMaR" SvNauïïTa" Pau&Saa& ivZvKSaeNak-QaaSau Ya")
NaaeTPaadYaeÛid riTa& é[Ma Wv ih ke-vl/Ma()) 8))**

dharmaù svanuñöhitaù puàsäà

viñvaksena-kathäsu yaù

notpādayed yadi ratià

çrama eva hi kevalam

SYNONYMS

dharmau—occupation; *svanuññöhita*—executed in terms of one's own position; *puàsäm*—of humankind; *viñvaksena*—the Personality of Godhead (plenary portion); *kathäsu*—in the message of; *ya*—what is; *na*—not; *utpādayet*—does produce; *yadi*—if; *ratim*—attraction; *çrama*—useless labor; *eva*—only; *hi*—certainly; *kevalam*—entirely.

TRANSLATION

The occupational activities a man performs according to his own position are only so much useless labor if they do not provoke attraction for the message of the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

There are different occupational activities in terms of man's different conceptions of life. To the gross materialist who cannot see anything beyond the gross material body, there is nothing beyond the senses. Therefore his occupational activities are limited to concentrated and extended selfishness. Concentrated selfishness centers around the personal body—this is generally seen amongst the lower animals. Extended selfishness is manifested in human society and centers around the family, society, community, nation and world with a view to gross bodily comfort. Above these gross materialists are the mental speculators who hover aloft in the mental spheres, and their occupational duties involve making poetry and philosophy or propagating some *ism* with the same aim of selfishness limited to the body and the mind. But above the body and mind is the dormant spirit soul whose absence from the body makes the whole range of bodily and mental selfishness completely null and void. But less intelligent people have no information of the needs of the spirit soul.

Because foolish people have no information of the soul and how it is beyond the purview of the body and mind, they are not satisfied in the performance of their occupational duties. The question of the satisfaction

of the self is raised herein. The self is beyond the gross body and subtle mind. He is the potent active principle of the body and mind. Without knowing the need of the dormant soul, one cannot be happy simply with emolument of the body and mind. The body and the mind are but superfluous outer coverings of the spirit soul. The spirit soul's needs must be fulfilled. Simply by cleansing the cage of the bird, one does not satisfy the bird. One must actually know the needs of the bird himself.

The need of the spirit soul is that he wants to get out of the limited sphere of material bondage and fulfill his desire for complete freedom. He wants to get out of the covered walls of the greater universe. He wants to see the free light and the spirit. That complete freedom is achieved when he meets the complete spirit, the Personality of Godhead. There is a dormant affection for God within everyone; spiritual existence is manifested through the gross body and mind in the form of perverted affection for gross and subtle matter. Therefore we have to engage ourselves in occupational engagements that will evoke our divine consciousness. This is possible only by hearing and chanting the divine activities of the Supreme Lord, and any occupational activity which does not help one to achieve attachment for hearing and chanting the transcendental message of Godhead is said herein to be simply a waste of time. This is because other occupational duties (whatever *ism* they may belong to) cannot give liberation to the soul. Even the activities of the salvationists are considered to be useless because of their failure to pick up the fountainhead of all liberties. The gross materialist can practically see that his material gain is limited only to time and space, either in this world or in the other. Even if he goes up to the Svargaloka, he will find no permanent abode for his hankering soul. The hankering soul must be satisfied by the perfect scientific process of perfect devotional service.

TEXT 9

**DaMaRSYa ùaPavGYaRSYa NaaQaaeR_QaaRYaaePak-LPaTae)
NaaQaRSYa DaMaCEk-aNTaSYa k-aMaae l/a>aaYa ih SMa*Ta")) 9))**

dharmasya hy āpavargyasya

nārtho 'rthäyopakalpate

nārthasya dharmaikāntasya

kāmo läbhäya hi smātaù

SYNONYMS

dharmasya—occupational engagement; *hi*—certainly; *äpavargyasya*—ultimate liberation; *na*—not; *arthaù*—end; *arthäya*—for material gain; *upakalpate*—is meant for; *na*—neither; *arthasya*—of material gain; *dharmā-eka-antasya*—for one who is engaged in the ultimate occupational service; *kāmaù*—sense gratification; *läbhäya*—attainment of; *hi*—exactly; *smātaù*—is described by the great sages.

TRANSLATION

All occupational engagements are certainly meant for ultimate liberation. They should never be performed for material gain. Furthermore, according to sages, one who is engaged in the ultimate occupational service should never use material gain to cultivate sense gratification.

PURPORT

We have already discussed that pure devotional service to the Lord is automatically followed by perfect knowledge and detachment from material existence. But there are others who consider that all kinds of different occupational engagements, including those of religion, are meant for material gain. The general tendency of any ordinary man in any part of the world is to gain some material profit in exchange for religious or any other occupational service. Even in the Vedic literatures, for all sorts of religious performances an allurements of material gain is offered, and most people are attracted by such allurements or blessings of religiosity. Why are such so-called men of religion allured by material gain? Because material gain can enable one to fulfill desires, which in turn satisfy sense gratification. This cycle of occupational engagements includes so-called religiosity followed by material gain and material gain followed by

fulfillment of desires. Sense gratification is the general way for all sorts of fully occupied men. But in the statement of Sūta Gosvami, as per the verdict of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, this is nullified by the present *çloka*.

One should not engage himself in any sort of occupational service for material gain only. Nor should material gain be utilized for sense gratification. How material gain should be utilized is described as follows.

TEXT 10

**k-aMaSYa NaeiNd]YaPa[qiTal/aR>aae JaqveTa YaavTaa)
JaqvSYa TatviJajaSaa NaaQaaeR Yaêeh k-MaRi>a")) 10))**

kāmasya nendriya-prétir

lābho jéveta yāvatā

jivasya tattva-jijñāsā

nārtho yaç ceha karmabhiù

SYNONYMS

kāmasya—of desires; *na*—not; *indriya*—senses; *prétiù*—satisfaction; *lābhaù*—gain; *jéveta*—self-preservation; *yāvatā*—so much so; *jivasya*—of the living being; *tattva*—the Absolute Truth; *jijñāsā*—inquiries; *na*—not; *arthaù*—end; *yaù ca iha*—whatsoever else; *karmabhiù*—by occupational activities.

TRANSLATION

Life’s desires should never be directed toward sense gratification. One should desire only a healthy life, or self-preservation, since a human being is meant for inquiry about the Absolute Truth. Nothing else should be the goal of one’s works.

PURPORT

The completely bewildered material civilization is wrongly directed towards the fulfillment of desires in sense gratification. In such civilization, in all spheres of life, the ultimate end is sense gratification. In politics, social service, altruism, philanthropy and ultimately in religion or even in salvation, the very same tint of sense gratification is ever-increasingly predominant. In the political field the leaders of men fight with one another to fulfill their personal sense gratification. The voters adore the so-called leaders only when they promise sense gratification. As soon as the voters are dissatisfied in their own sense satisfaction, they dethrone the leaders, The leaders must always disappoint the voters by not satisfying their senses. The same is applicable in all other fields; no one is serious about the problems of life. Even those who are on the path of salvation desire to become one with the Absolute Truth and desire to commit spiritual suicide for sense gratification. But the *Bhāgavatam* says that one should not live for sense gratification. One should satisfy the senses only inasmuch as required for self-preservation, and not for sense gratification. Because the body is made of senses, which also require a certain amount of satisfaction, there are regulative directions for satisfaction of such senses. But the senses are not meant for unrestricted enjoyment. For example, marriage or the combination of a man with a woman is necessary for progeny, but it is not meant for sense enjoyment. In the absence of voluntary restraint, there is propaganda for family planning, but foolish men do not know that family planning is automatically executed as soon as there is search after the Absolute Truth. Seekers of the Absolute Truth are never allured by unnecessary engagements in sense gratification because the serious students seeking the Absolute Truth are always overwhelmed with the work of researching the Truth. In every sphere of life, therefore, the ultimate end must be seeking after the Absolute Truth, and that sort of engagement will make one happy because he will be less engaged in varieties of sense gratification. And what that Absolute Truth is is explained as follows.

TEXT 11

**vdiNTa TatativdStatv& YaJJaNaMaÜYaMa()
b]øeiTa ParMaaTMaeiTa >aGavaiNaiTa XaBÛTae)) 11))**

vadanti tat tattva-vidas

tattvaà yaj jñanam advayam

brahmeti paramātmēti

bhagavān iti çabdyate

SYNONYMS

vadanti—they say; *tat*—that; *tattva-vidas*—the learned souls; *tattvam*—the Absolute Truth; *yaj*—which; *jñanam*—knowledge; *advayam*—nondual; *brahma iti*—known as Brahman; *paramātmā iti*—known as Paramātmā; *bhagavān iti*—known as Bhagavān; *çabdyate*—it so sounded.

TRANSLATION

Learned transcendentalists who know the Absolute Truth call this nondual substance Brahman, Paramātmā or Bhagavān.

PURPORT

The Absolute Truth is both subject and object, and there is no qualitative difference there. Therefore, Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān are qualitatively one and the same. The same substance is realized as impersonal Brahman by the students of the *Upaniñads*, as localized Paramātmā by the Hiraëyagarbhas or the *yogés*, and as Bhagavān by the devotees. In other words, Bhagavān, or the Personality of Godhead, is the last word of the Absolute Truth. Paramātmā is the partial representation of the Personality of Godhead, and impersonal Brahman is the glowing effulgence of the Personality of Godhead, as the sun rays are to the sun-god. Less intelligent students of either of the above schools sometimes argue in favor of their own respective realization, but those who are perfect seers of the Absolute Truth know well that the above three features of the one Absolute Truth are different perspective views seen from different angles of vision.

As it is explained in the first *çloka* of the First Chapter of the *Bhägavatam*, the Supreme Truth is self-sufficient, cognizant and free from the illusion of relativity. In the relative world the knower is different from the known, but in the Absolute Truth both the knower and the known are one and the same thing. In the relative world the knower is the living spirit or superior energy, whereas the known is inert matter or inferior energy. Therefore, there is a duality of inferior and superior energy, whereas in the absolute realm both the knower and the known are of the same superior energy. There are three kinds of energies of the supreme energetic. There is no difference between the energy and energetic, but there is a difference of quality of energies. The absolute realm and the living entities are of the same superior energy, but the material world is inferior energy. The living being in contact with the inferior energy is illusioned, thinking he belongs to the inferior energy. Therefore there is the sense of relativity in the material world. In the Absolute there is no such sense of difference between the knower and the known, and therefore everything there is absolute.

TEXT 12

TaC^{\tilde{O}DaaNaa MauNaYaae jaNavEraGYaYauç-Yaa)
PaXYaNtYaaTMaiNa caTMaaNa& >aç-ya é[uTaGa*hqTaYaa)) 12))

tac chraddadhänä munayo

jïäna-vairägya-yuktayä

paçyanty ätmani cätmänaà

bhaktyä çruta-gâhétayä

SYNONYMS

tat—that; *çraddadhänä*—seriously inquisitive; *munaya*—sages; *jïäna*—knowledge; *vairägya*—detachment; *yuktayä*—well equipped with; *paçyanti*—see; *ätmani*—within himself; *ca*—and; *ätmänam*—the Paramätmä; *bhaktyä*—in devotional service; *çruta*—the *Vedas*; *gâhétayä*—

well received.

TRANSLATION

The seriously inquisitive student or sage, well equipped with knowledge and detachment, realizes that Absolute Truth by rendering devotional service in terms of what he has heard from the Vedānta-śruti.

PURPORT

The Absolute Truth is realized in full by the process of devotional service to the Lord, Vāsudeva, or the Personality of Godhead, who is the full-fledged Absolute Truth. Brahman is His transcendental bodily effulgence, and Paramātmā is His partial representation. As such, Brahman or Paramātmā realization of the Absolute Truth is but a partial realization. There are four different types of human beings—the *karmés*, the *jñānés*, the *yogés* and the devotees. The *karmés* are materialistic, whereas the other three are transcendental. The first-class transcendentalists are the devotees who have realized the Supreme Person. The second-class transcendentalists are those who have partially realized the plenary portion of the absolute person. And the third-class transcendentalists are those who have barely realized the spiritual focus of the absolute person. As stated in the *Bhagavad-gita* and other Vedic literatures, the Supreme Person is realized by devotional service, which is backed by full knowledge and detachment from material association. We have already discussed the point that devotional service is followed by knowledge and detachment from material association. As Brahman and Paramātmā realization are imperfect realizations of the Absolute Truth, so the means of realizing Brahman and Paramātmā, i.e., the paths of *jñāna* and *yoga*, are also imperfect means of realizing the Absolute Truth. Devotional service, which is based on the foreground of full knowledge combined with detachment from material association and which is fixed by the aural reception of the *Vedānta-śruti*, is the only perfect method by which the seriously inquisitive student can realize the Absolute Truth. Devotional service is not, therefore, meant for the less intelligent class of transcendentalist. There are three classes of devotees, namely first, second, and third class. The third-class devotees, or the neophytes, who have no knowledge and are not detached from

material association, but who are simply attracted by the preliminary process of worshipping the Deity in the temple, are called material devotees. Material devotees are more attached to material benefit than transcendental profit. Therefore, one has to make definite progress from the position of material devotional service to the second-class devotional position. In the second-class position, the devotee can see four principles in the devotional line, namely the Personality of Godhead, His devotees, the ignorant and the envious. One has to raise himself at least to the stage of a second-class devotee and thus become eligible to know the Absolute Truth.

A third-class devotee, therefore, has to receive the instructions of devotional service from the authoritative sources of *Bhāgavata*. The number one *Bhāgavata* is the established personality of devotee, and the other *Bhāgavatam* is the message of Godhead. The third-class devotee therefore has to go to the personality of devotee in order to learn the instructions of devotional service. Such a personality of devotee is not a professional man who earns his livelihood by the business of *Bhāgavatam*. Such a devotee must be a representative of Çukadeva Gosvami, like Sūta Gosvami, and must preach the cult of devotional service for the all-around benefit of all people. A neophyte devotee has very little taste for hearing from the authorities. Such a neophyte devotee makes a show of hearing from the professional man to satisfy his senses. This sort of hearing and chanting has spoiled the whole thing, so one should be very careful about the faulty process. The holy messages of Godhead, as inculcated in the *Bhagavad-gita* or in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, are undoubtedly transcendental subjects, but even though they are so, such transcendental matters are not to be received from the professional man, who spoils them as the serpent spoils milk simply by the touch of his tongue.

A sincere devotee must, therefore, be prepared to hear the Vedic literature like the *Upaniṣads*, *Vedānta* and other literatures left by the previous authorities or Gosvamis, for the benefit of his progress. Without hearing such literatures, one cannot make actual progress. And without hearing and following the instructions, the show of devotional service becomes worthless and therefore a sort of disturbance in the path of devotional service. Unless, therefore, devotional service is established on the principles of *śruti*, *smṛti*, *purāṇa* or *pañcarātra* authorities, the make-show

of devotional service should at once be rejected. An unauthorized devotee should never be recognized as a pure devotee. By assimilation of such messages from the Vedic literatures, one can see the all-pervading localized aspect of the Personality of Godhead within his own self constantly. This is called *samādhī*.

TEXT 13

ATa" PauIM>aiÜRJaé[eïa v<aaRé[Maiv>aaGaXa")
SvNauüTaSYa DaMaRSYa Sa&iSaiÖhRiTaez<aMa()) 13))

ataù pumbhir dvija-çreñöhä

varëäçrama-vibhāgaçaù

svanuñöhitasya dharmasya

saàsiddhir hari-toñaëam

SYNONYMS

ataù—so; *pumbhiù*—by the human being; *dvija-çreñöhäù*—O best among the twice-born; *varëa-äçrama*—the institution of four castes and four orders of life; *vibhāgaçaù*—by the division of; *svanuñöhitasya*—of one's own prescribed duties; *dharmasya*—occupational; *saàsiddhiù*—the highest perfection; *hari*—the Personality of Godhead; *toñaëam*—pleasing.

TRANSLATION

O best among the twice-born, it is therefore concluded that the highest perfection one can achieve by discharging the duties prescribed for one's own occupation according to caste divisions and orders of life is to please the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

Human society all over the world is divided into four castes and four orders

of life. The four castes are the intelligent caste, the martial caste, the productive caste and the laborer caste. These castes are classified in terms of one's work and qualification and not by birth. Then again there are four orders of life, namely the student life, the householder's life, the retired and the devotional life. In the best interest of human society there must be such divisions of life, otherwise no social institution can grow in a healthy state. And in each and every one of the abovementioned divisions of life, *the aim must be to please the supreme authority of the Personality of Godhead*. This institutional function of human society is known as the system of *varëäçrama-dharma*, which is quite natural for the civilized life. The *varëäçrama* institution is constructed to enable one to realize the Absolute Truth. It is not for artificial domination of one division over another. When the aim of life, i.e., realization of the Absolute Truth, is missed by too much attachment for *indriya-préti*, or sense gratification, as already discussed hereinbefore, the institution of the *varëäçrama* is utilized by selfish men to pose an artificial predominance over the weaker section. In the Kali-yuga, or in the age of quarrel, this artificial predominance is already current, but the saner section of the people know it well that the divisions of castes and orders of life are meant for smooth social intercourse and high-thinking self-realization and not for any other purpose.

Herein the statement of *Bhägavatam* is that the highest aim of life or the highest perfection of the institution of the *varëäçrama-dharma* is to cooperate jointly for the satisfaction of the Supreme Lord. This is also confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita* (4.13).

TEXT 14

**TaSMaadeke-Na MaNaSaa >aGavaNa(SaaTvTaa& PaiTa")
é[aeTaVYa" k-liTaRTaVYaê DYaeYa" PaUJYaê iNaTYada)) 14))**

tasmäd ekena manasä

bhagavän sätvatää patiù

çrotavyaù kértitavyaç ca

dhyeyaù pūjyaç ca nityadä

SYNONYMS

tasmät—therefore; *ekena*—by one; *manasä*—attention of the mind; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *sätvatäm*—of the devotees; *patiù*—protector; *çrotavyaù*—is to be heard; *kértitavyaù*—to be glorified; *ca*—and; *dhyeyaù*—to be remembered; *pūjyaù*—to be worshiped; *ca*—and; *nityadä*—constantly.

TRANSLATION

Therefore, with one-pointed attention, one should constantly hear about, glorify, remember and worship the Personality of Godhead, who is the protector of the devotees.

PURPORT

If realization of the Absolute Truth is the ultimate aim of life, it must be carried out by all means. In any one of the above-mentioned castes and orders of life, the four processes, namely glorifying, hearing, remembering and worshiping, are general occupations. Without these principles of life, no one can exist. Activities of the living being involve engagements in these four different principles of life. Especially in modern society, all activities are more or less dependent on hearing and glorifying. Any man from any social status becomes a well-known man in human society within a very short time if he is simply glorified truly or falsely in the daily newspapers. Sometimes political leaders of a particular party are also advertised by newspaper propaganda, and by such a method of glorification an insignificant man becomes an important man—within no time. But such propaganda by false glorification of an unqualified person cannot bring about any good, either for the particular man or for the society. There may be some temporary reactions to such propaganda, but there are no permanent effects. Therefore such activities are a waste of time. The actual object of glorification is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who has created everything manifested before us. We have broadly discussed this fact from the beginning of the “*janmädya asya*” [SB 1.1.1] *çloka* of this

Bhāgavatam. The tendency to glorify others or hear others must be turned to the real object of glorification—the Supreme Being. And that will bring happiness.

TEXT 15

**YadNauDYaaiSaNaā Yauṣ-a" k-MaRGa]iNQaiNabNDaNaMa()
i^NDiNTa k-aeivdaSTaSYa k-ae Na ku-YaaRTk-QaariTaMa()) 15))**

yad-anudhyāsinā yuktāu

karma-granthi-nibandhanam

chindanti kovidās tasya

ko na kuryāt kathā-ratim

SYNONYMS

yat—which; *anudhyā*—remembrance; *asinā*—sword; *yuktāu*—being equipped with; *karma*—reactionary work; *granthi*—knot; *nibandhanam*—interknit; *chindanti*—cut; *kovidāu*—intelligent; *tasya*—His; *kaù*—who; *na*—not; *kuryāt*—shall do; *kathā*—messages; *ratim*—attention.

TRANSLATION

With sword in hand, intelligent men cut through the binding knots of reactionary work [karma] by remembering the Personality of Godhead. Therefore, who will not pay attention to His message?

PURPORT

The contact of the spiritual spark with material elements creates a knot which must be cut if one wants to be liberated from the actions and reactions of fruitive work. Liberation means freedom from the cycle of reactionary work. This liberation automatically follows for one who constantly remembers the transcendental pastimes of the Personality of

Godhead. This is because all the activities of the Supreme Lord (His *lila*) are transcendental to the modes of the material energy. They are all-attractive spiritual activities, and therefore constant association with the spiritual activities of the Supreme Lord gradually spiritualizes the conditioned soul and ultimately severs the knot of material bondage.

Liberation from material bondage is, therefore, a by-product of devotional service. Attainment of spiritual knowledge is not sufficient to insure liberation. Such knowledge must be overcoated with devotional service so that ultimately the devotional service alone predominates. Then liberation is made possible. Even the reactionary work of the fruitive workers can lead one to liberation when it is overcoated with devotional service. *Karma* overcoated with devotional service is called *karma-yoga*. Similarly, empirical knowledge overcoated with devotional service is called *jñāna-yoga*. But pure *bhakti-yoga* is independent of such *karma* and *jñāna* because it alone can not only endow one with liberation from conditional life but also award one the transcendental loving service of the Lord.

Therefore, any sensible man who is above the average man with a poor fund of knowledge must constantly remember the Personality of Godhead by hearing about Him, by glorifying Him, by remembering Him and by worshiping Him always, without cessation. That is the perfect way of devotional service. The Gosvamis of Våndāvana, who were authorized by Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu to preach the *bhakti* cult, rigidly followed this rule and made immense literatures of transcendental science for our benefit. They have chalked out ways for all classes of men in terms of the different castes and orders of life in pursuance of the teachings of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* and similar other authoritative scriptures.

TEXT 16

éué[Uzae" é[ÖDaaNaSYa vaSaudevk-Qaaâic")
SYaaNMahTSaevYaa ivPa[a" Pau<YaTaqQaRiNazev<aaTa()) 16))

çuçrũñoù çraddadhānasya

vāsudeva-kathā-ruciù

syän mahat-sevayä vipräu

puëya-tértha-niñevaëät

SYNONYMS

çuçrũñoù—one who is engaged in hearing; *çraddadhänasya*—with care and attention; *väsudeva*—in respect to Väsudeva; *kathä*—the message; *ruciù*—affinity; *syät*—is made possible; *mahat-sevayä*—by service rendered to pure devotees; *vipräu*—O twice-born; *puëya-tértha*—those who are cleansed of all vice; *niñevaëät*—by service.

TRANSLATION

O twice-born sages, by serving those devotees who are completely freed from all vice, great service is done. By such service, one gains affinity for hearing the messages of Väsudeva.

PURPORT

The conditioned life of a living being is caused by his revolting against the Lord. There are men called *deva*, or godly living beings, and there are men called *asuras*, or demons, who are against the authority of the Supreme Lord. In the *Bhagavad-gita* (Sixteenth Chapter) a vivid description of the *asuras* is given in which it is said that the *asuras* are put into lower and lower states of ignorance life after life and so sink to the lower animal forms and have no information of the Absolute Truth, the Personality of Godhead. These *asuras* are gradually rectified to God consciousness by the mercy of the Lord's liberated servitors in different countries according to the supreme will. Such devotees of God are very confidential associates of the Lord, and when they come to save human society from the dangers of godlessness, they are known as the powerful incarnations of the Lord, as sons of the Lord, as servants of the Lord or as associates of the Lord. But none of them falsely claim to be God themselves. This is a blasphemy declared by the *asuras*, and the demoniac followers of such *asuras* also accept pretenders as God or His incarnation. In the revealed scriptures there is definite information of the incarnation of God. No one should be

accepted as God or an incarnation of God unless he is confirmed by the revealed scriptures.

The servants of God are to be respected as God by the devotees who actually want to go back to Godhead. Such servants of God are called *mahātmās*, or *térthas*, and they preach according to particular time and place. The servants of God urge people to become devotees of the Lord. They never tolerate being called God. Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu was God Himself according to the indication of the revealed scriptures, but He played the part of a devotee. People who knew Him to be God addressed Him as God, but He used to block His ears with His hands and chant the name of Lord Viṣṇu. He strongly protested against being called God, although undoubtedly He was God Himself. The Lord behaves so to warn us against unscrupulous men who take pleasure in being addressed as God.

The servants of God come to propagate God consciousness, and intelligent people should cooperate with them in every respect. By serving the servant of God, one can please God more than by directly serving the Lord. The Lord is more pleased when He sees that His servants are properly respected because such servants risk everything for the service of the Lord and so are very dear to the Lord. The Lord declares in the *Bhagavad-gita* (18.69) that no one is dearer to Him than one who risks everything to preach His glory. By serving the servants of the Lord, one gradually gets the quality of such servants, and thus one becomes qualified to hear the glories of God. The eagerness to hear about God is the first qualification of a devotee eligible for entering the kingdom of God.

TEXT 17

é*<vTaa& Svk-Qaa" k*-Z<a" Pau<Yaé[v<ak-ITaRNa")
ôÛNTa" SQaae ù>ad]ai<a ivDauNaaeiTa SauôTSaTaaMa()) 17))

çäëvatää sva-kathäù kãñëaù

puëya-çravaëa-kértanaù

hådy antaù stho hy abhadräëi

vidhunoti suhāt satām

SYNONYMS

çāëvatām—those who have developed the urge to hear the message of; *sva-kathäù*—His own words; *kāñëaù*—the Personality of Godhead; *puëya*—virtues; *çravaëa*—hearing; *kértanaù*—chanting; *hådi antaù sthaù*—within one’s heart; *hi*—certainly; *abhadräëi*—desire to enjoy matter; *vidhunoti*—cleanses; *suhāt*—benefactor; *satām*—of the truthful.

TRANSLATION

Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, who is the Paramātmä [Supersoul] in everyone’s heart and the benefactor of the truthful devotee, cleanses desire for material enjoyment from the heart of the devotee who has developed the urge to hear His messages, which are in themselves virtuous when properly heard and chanted.

PURPORT

Messages of the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa are nondifferent from Him. Whenever, therefore, offenseless hearing and glorification of God are undertaken, it is to be understood that Lord Kṛṣṇa is present there in the form of transcendental sound, which is as powerful as the Lord personally. Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu, in His *Çikñäññöaka*, declares clearly that the holy name of the Lord has all the potencies of the Lord and that He has endowed His innumerable names with the same potency. There is no rigid fixture of time, and anyone can chant the holy name with attention and reverence at his convenience. The Lord is so kind to us that He can be present before us personally in the form of transcendental sound, but unfortunately we have no taste for hearing and glorifying the Lord’s name and activities. We have already discussed developing a taste for hearing and chanting the holy sound. It is done through the medium of service to the pure devotee of the Lord.

The Lord is reciprocally respondent to His devotees. When He sees that a devotee is completely sincere in getting admittance to the transcendental

service of the Lord and has thus become eager to hear about Him, the Lord acts from within the devotee in such a way that the devotee may easily go back to Him. The Lord is more anxious to take us back into His kingdom than we can desire. Most of us do not desire at all to go back to Godhead. Only a very few men want to go back to Godhead. But anyone who desires to go back to Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa helps in all respects.

One cannot enter into the kingdom of God unless one is perfectly cleared of all sins. The material sins are products of our desires to lord it over material nature. It is very difficult to get rid of such desires. Women and wealth are very difficult problems for the devotee making progress on the path back to Godhead. Many stalwarts in the devotional line fell victim to these allurements and thus retreated from the path of liberation. But when one is helped by the Lord Himself, the whole process becomes as easy as anything by the divine grace of the Lord.

To become restless in the contact of women and wealth is not an astonishment, because every living being is associated with such things from remote time, practically immemorial, and it takes time to recover from this foreign nature. But if one is engaged in hearing the glories of the Lord, gradually he realizes his real position. By the grace of God such a devotee gets sufficient strength to defend himself from the state of disturbances, and gradually all disturbing elements are eliminated from his mind.

TEXT 18

**NaíPa[aYaeZv>ad]ezu iNaTYa& >aaGavTaSaevYaa)
>aGavTYautaMaëaeke- >aiç->aRviTa NaEïik-I)) 18))**

nañöa-präyeñv abhadreñu

nityaà bhägavata-sevayä

bhagavaty uttama-çloke

bhaktir bhavati naiñöhiké

SYNONYMS

nañöa—destroyed; *präyeñu*—almost to nil; *abhadreñu*—all that is inauspicious; *nityam*—regularly; *bhägavata*—*Srimad-Bhagavatam*, or the pure devotee; *sewayä*—by serving; *bhagavati*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *uttama*—transcendental; *çloke*—prayers; *bhaktiù*—loving service; *bhavati*—comes into being; *naiñöhiké*—irrevocable.

TRANSLATION

By regular attendance in classes on the Bhägavatam and by rendering of service to the pure devotee, all that is troublesome to the heart is almost completely destroyed, and loving service unto the Personality of Godhead, who is praised with transcendental songs, is established as an irrevocable fact.

PURPORT

Here is the remedy for eliminating all inauspicious things within the heart which are considered to be obstacles in the path of self-realization. The remedy is the association of the *Bhägavatas*. There are two types of *Bhägavatas*, namely the book *Bhägavata* and the devotee *Bhägavata*. Both the *Bhägavatas* are competent remedies, and both of them or either of them can be good enough to eliminate the obstacles. A devotee *Bhägavata* is as good as the book *Bhägavata* because the devotee *Bhägavata* leads his life in terms of the book *Bhägavata* and the book *Bhägavata* is full of information about the Personality of Godhead and His pure devotees, who are also *Bhägavatas*. *Bhägavata* book and person are identical.

The devotee *Bhägavata* is a direct representative of Bhagavän, the Personality of Godhead. So by pleasing the devotee *Bhägavata* one can receive the benefit of the book *Bhägavata*. Human reason fails to understand how by serving the devotee *Bhägavata* or the book *Bhägavata* one gets gradual promotion on the path of devotion. But actually these are facts explained by Srila Nārādadeva, who happened to be a maidservant's son in his previous life. The maidservant was engaged in the menial service of the sages, and thus he also came into contact with them. And simply by

associating with them and accepting the remnants of foodstuff left by the sages, the son of the maidservant got the chance to become the great devotee and personality Srila Nārādadeva. These are the miraculous effects of the association of *Bhāgavatas*. And to understand these effects practically, it should be noted that by such sincere association of the *Bhāgavatas* one is sure to receive transcendental knowledge very easily, with the result that he becomes fixed in the devotional service of the Lord. The more progress is made in devotional service under the guidance of the *Bhāgavatas*, the more one becomes fixed in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. The messages of the book *Bhāgavata*, therefore, have to be received from the devotee *Bhāgavata*, and the combination of these two *Bhāgavatas* will help the neophyte devotee to make progress on and on.

TEXT 19

**Tada rJaSTaMaae>aava" k-aMal/ae>aadYaê Yae)
ceTa WTaErNaaivÖ& iSQaTa& Satve Pa[SaqdiTa)) 19))**

tadä rajas-tamo-bhäväù

käma-lobhädayaç ca ye

ceta etair anäviddhaà

sthitaà sattve prasédati

SYNONYMS

tadä—at that time; *rajaù*—in the mode of passion; *tamaù*—the mode of ignorance; *bhäväù*—the situation; *käma*—lust and desire; *lobha*—hankering; *ädayaù*—others; *ca*—and; *ye*—whatever they are; *cetaù*—the mind; *etaiù*—by these; *anäviddham*—without being affected; *sthitam*—being fixed; *sattve*—in the mode of goodness; *prasédati*—thus becomes fully satisfied.

TRANSLATION

As soon as irrevocable loving service is established in the heart, the effects of nature's modes of passion and ignorance, such as lust, desire and hankering, disappear from the heart. Then the devotee is established in goodness, and he becomes completely happy.

PURPORT

A living being in his normal constitutional position is fully satisfied in spiritual bliss. This state of existence is called *brahma-bhūta* or *ātmā-nandé*, or the state of self-satisfaction. This self-satisfaction is not like the satisfaction of the inactive fool. The inactive fool is in the state of foolish ignorance, whereas the self-satisfied *ātmānandé* is transcendental to the material state of existence. This stage of perfection is attained as soon as one is fixed in irrevocable devotional service. Devotional service is not inactivity, but the unalloyed activity of the soul.

The soul's activity becomes adulterated in contact with matter, and as such the diseased activities are expressed in the form of lust, desire, hankering, inactivity, foolishness and sleep. The effect of devotional service becomes manifest by complete elimination of these effects of passion and ignorance. The devotee is fixed at once in the mode of goodness, and he makes further progress to rise to the position of Vāsudeva, or the state of unmixed *sattva*, or *suddha-sattva*. Only in this *suddha-sattva* state can one always see Kṛṣṇa eye to eye by dint of pure affection for the Lord.

A devotee is always in the mode of unalloyed goodness; therefore he harms no one. But the nondevotee, however educated he may be, is always harmful. A devotee is neither foolish nor passionate. The harmful, foolish and passionate cannot be devotees of the Lord, however they may advertise themselves as devotees by outward dress. A devotee is always qualified with all the good qualities of God. Quantitatively such qualifications may be different, but qualitatively both the Lord and His devotee are one and the same.

TEXT 20

Wv& Pa[SaàMaNaSaae >aGavÙiç-YaaeGaTa")

>aGavtatvivjaNa& Mauç-Sa®SYa JaaYaTae)) 20))

evaà prasanna-manaso

bhagavad-bhakti-yogataù

bhagavat-tattva-vijñānaà

mukta-saigasya jâyate

SYNONYMS

evam—thus; *prasanna*—enlivened; *manasaù*—of the mind; *bhagavat-bhakti*—the devotional service of the Lord; *yogataù*—by contact of; *bhagavat*—regarding the Personality of Godhead; *tattva*—knowledge; *vijñānam*—scientific; *mukta*—liberated; *saigasya*—of the association; *jâyate*—becomes effective.

TRANSLATION

Thus established in the mode of unalloyed goodness, the man whose mind has been enlivened by contact with devotional service to the Lord gains positive scientific knowledge of the Personality of Godhead in the stage of liberation from all material association.

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gita* (7.3) it is said that out of many thousands of ordinary men, one fortunate man endeavors for perfection in life. Mostly men are conducted by the modes of passion and ignorance, and thus they are engaged always in lust, desire, hankerings, ignorance and sleep. Out of many such manlike animals, there is actually a man who knows the responsibility of human life and thus tries to make life perfect by following the prescribed duties. And out of many thousands of such persons who have thus attained success in human life, one may know scientifically about the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa. In the same *Bhagavad-gita* (18.55) it is also said that scientific knowledge of Sri Kṛṣṇa is understood only by the

process of devotional service (*bhakti-yoga*).

The very same thing is confirmed herein in the above words. No ordinary man, or even one who has attained success in human life, can know scientifically or perfectly the Personality of Godhead. Perfection of human life is attained when one can understand that he is not the product of matter but is in fact spirit. And as soon as one understands that he has nothing to do with matter, he at once ceases his material hankerings and becomes enlivened as a spiritual being. This attainment of success is possible when one is above the modes of passion and ignorance, or, in other words, when one is actually a *brahmana* by qualification. A *brahmana* is the symbol of *sattva-guṇa*, or the mode of goodness. And others, who are not in the mode of goodness, are either *kṣatriyas*, *vaisyas*, *sudras* or less than the *sudras*. The brahminical stage is the highest stage of human life because of its good qualities. So one cannot be a devotee unless one at least qualifies as a *brahmana*. The devotee is already a *brahmana* by action. But that is not the end of it. As referred to above, such a *brahmana* has to become a Vaiṣṇava in fact to be actually in the transcendental stage. A pure Vaiṣṇava is a liberated soul and is transcendental even to the position of a *brahmana*. In the material stage even a *brahmana* is also a conditioned soul because although in the brahminical stage the conception of Brahman or transcendence is realized, scientific knowledge of the Supreme Lord is lacking. One has to surpass the brahminical stage and reach the *vasudeva* stage to understand the Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa. The science of the Personality of Godhead is the subject matter for study by the postgraduate students in the spiritual line. Foolish men, or men with a poor fund of knowledge, do not understand the Supreme Lord, and they interpret Kṛṣṇa according to their respective whims. The fact is, however, that one cannot understand the science of the Personality of Godhead unless one is freed from the contamination of the material modes, even up to the stage of a *brahmana*. When a qualified *brahmana* factually becomes a Vaiṣṇava, in the enlivened state of liberation he can know what is actually the Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 21

i>aŪTae ôdYaGaJiNQaiX^ŪNTae SavRSa&XaYaa")

+aqYaNTae caSYa k-MaaRi<a d*í WvaTMaNaqìre)) 21))

bhidyate hādaya-granthiḥ

chidyante sarva-saḍḍayāù

kñéyante cāsya karmāëi

dāñña evātmanéçvare

SYNONYMS

bhidyate—pierced; *hādaya*—heart; *granthiḥ*—knots; *chidyante*—cut to pieces; *sarva*—all; *saḍḍayāù*—misgivings; *kñéyante*—terminated; *ca*—and; *asya*—his; *karmāëi*—chain of fruitive actions; *dāñña*—having seen; *eva*—certainly; *ātmani*—unto the self; *éçvare*—dominating.

TRANSLATION

Thus the knot in the heart is pierced, and all misgivings are cut to pieces. The chain of fruitive actions is terminated when one sees the self as master.

PURPORT

Attaining scientific knowledge of the Personality of Godhead means seeing one's own self simultaneously. As far as the identity of the living being as spirit self is concerned, there are a number of speculations and misgivings. The materialist does not believe in the existence of the spirit self, and empiric philosophers believe in the impersonal feature of the whole spirit without individuality of the living beings. But the transcendentalists affirm that the soul and the Supersoul are two different identities, qualitatively one but quantitatively different. There are many other theories, but all these different speculations are at once cleared off as soon as Sri Kṛṣṇa is realized in truth by the process of *bhakti-yoga*. Sri Kṛṣṇa is like the sun, and the materialistic speculations about the Absolute Truth are like the darkest midnight. As soon as the Kṛṣṇa sun is arisen within one's heart, the

darkness of materialistic speculations about the Absolute Truth and the living beings is at once cleared off. In the presence of the sun, the darkness cannot stand, and the relative truths that were hidden within the dense darkness of ignorance become clearly manifested by the mercy of Kṛṣṇa, who is residing in everyone's heart as the Supersoul.

In the *Bhagavad-gita* (10.11) the Lord says that in order to show special favor to His pure devotees, He personally eradicates the dense darkness of all misgivings by switching on the light of pure knowledge within the heart of a devotee. Therefore, because of the Personality of Godhead's taking charge of illuminating the heart of His devotee, certainly a devotee, engaged in His service in transcendental love, cannot remain in darkness. He comes to know everything of the absolute and the relative truths. The devotee cannot remain in darkness, and because a devotee is enlightened by the Personality of Godhead, his knowledge is certainly perfect. This is not the case for those who speculate on the Absolute Truth by dint of their own limited power of approach. Perfect knowledge is called *paramparā*, or deductive knowledge coming down from the authority to the submissive aural receiver who is bona fide by service and surrender. One cannot challenge the authority of the Supreme and know Him also at the same time. He reserves the right of not being exposed to such a challenging spirit of an insignificant spark of the whole, a spark subjected to the control of illusory energy. The devotees are submissive, and therefore the transcendental knowledge descends from the Personality of Godhead to Brahmā and from Brahmā to his sons and disciples in succession. This process is helped by the Supersoul within such devotees. That is the perfect way of learning transcendental knowledge.

This enlightenment perfectly enables the devotee to distinguish spirit from matter because the knot of spirit and matter is untied by the Lord. This knot is called *ahaikāra*, and it falsely obliges a living being to become identified with matter. As soon as this knot is loosened, therefore, all the clouds of doubt are at once cleared off. One sees his master and fully engages himself in the transcendental loving service of the Lord, making a full termination of the chain of fruitive action. In material existence, a living being creates his own chain of fruitive work and enjoys the good and bad effects of those actions life after life. But as soon as he engages himself in

the loving service of the Lord, he at once becomes free from the chain of *karma*. His actions no longer create any reaction.

TEXT 22

**ATaae vE k-vYaae iNaTYa& >aiÇ&- ParMaYaa Mauda)
vaSaudeve >aGaviTa ku-vRNTYaaTMaPa[SaadNaqMa()) 22))**

ato vai kavayo nityaà

bhaktià paramayä mudä

väsudeve bhagavati

kurvanty ätma-prasādaném

SYNONYMS

ataù—therefore; *vai*—certainly; *kavayaù*—all transcendentalists; *nityam*—from time immemorial; *bhaktim*—service unto the Lord; *paramayä*—supreme; *mudä*—with great delight; *väsudeve*—Sri Kṛṣṇa; *bhagavati*—the Personality of Godhead; *kurvanti*—do render; *ätma*—self; *prasādaném*—that which enlivens.

TRANSLATION

Certainly, therefore, since time immemorial, all transcendentalists have been rendering devotional service to Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, with great delight, because such devotional service is enlivening to the self.

PURPORT

The speciality of devotional service unto the Personality of Godhead Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is specifically mentioned herein. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the *svayaà-rüpa* Personality of Godhead, and all other forms of Godhead, beginning from Sri Baladeva, Saṅkarṣṇa, Väsudeva, Aniruddha, Pradyumna and Nārāyaṇa and

extending to the *puruṣa-avatāras*, *guḍa-avatāras*, *līla-avatāras*, *yuga-avatāras* and many other thousands of manifestations of the Personality of Godhead, are Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa's plenary portions and integrated parts. The living entities are separated parts and parcels of the Personality of Godhead. Therefore Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the original form of Godhead, and He is the last word in the Transcendence. Thus He is more attractive to the higher transcendentalists who participate in the eternal pastimes of the Lord. In forms of the Personality of Godhead other than Sri Kṛṣṇa and Baladeva, there is no facility for intimate personal contact as in the transcendental pastimes of the Lord at Vrajabhūmi. The transcendental pastimes of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa are not newly accepted, as argued by some less intelligent persons; His pastimes are eternal and are manifested in due course once in a day of Brahmājé, as the sun rises on the eastern horizon at the end of every twenty-four hours.

TEXT 23

Satv& rJaSTaMa wiTa Pa[k*-TaeGauR<aaSTaE,
 YauRç-" Par" Pauâz Wk- whaSYa Datae)
 iSQaTYaadYae hiriviriÄhreiTa Sa&ja"
 é[eYaa&iSa Ta}a %lu/ SatvTaNaæNa*R<aa& SYau")) 23))

sattvaà rajas tama iti prakâter guëäs tair

yuktaù paraù puruṣa eka ihäsya dhatte

sthity-ädaye hari-viriïci-hareti saðjïäù

çreyäàsi tatra khalu sattva-tanor nâëäà syuù

SYNONYMS

sattvam—goodness; *rajaù*—passion; *tamaù*—the darkness of ignorance; *iti*—thus; *prakâteù*—of the material nature; *guëäù*—qualities; *taiù*—by them; *yuktaù*—associated with; *paraù*—transcendental; *puruṣaù*—the personality; *ekaù*—one; *iha asya*—of this material world; *dhatte*—accepts; *sthiti-ädaye*—for the matter of creation, maintenance and destruction, etc.;

hari—Viṣṇu, the Personality of Godhead; *virīci*—Brahmā; *hara*—Lord Siva; *iti*—thus; *sañjāu*—different features; *çreyāsi*—ultimate benefit; *tatra*—therein; *khalu*—of course; *sattva*—goodness; *tanoù*—form; *nāñm*—of the human being; *syuù*—derived.

TRANSLATION

The transcendental Personality of Godhead is indirectly associated with the three modes of material nature, namely passion, goodness and ignorance, and just for the material world’s creation, maintenance and destruction He accepts the three qualitative forms of Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Siva. Of these three, all human beings can derive ultimate benefit from Viṣṇu, the form of the quality of goodness.

PURPORT

That Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, by His plenary parts, should be rendered devotional service, as explained above, is confirmed by this statement. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and all His plenary parts are *viṣṇu-tattva*, or the Lordship of Godhead. From Sri Kṛṣṇa, the next manifestation is Baladeva. From Baladeva is Saṅkarṣṇa, from Saṅkarṣṇa is Nārāyaṇa, from Nārāyaṇa there is the second Saṅkarṣṇa, and from this Saṅkarṣṇa the Viṣṇu *puruṣa-avatāras*. The Viṣṇu or the Deity of the quality of goodness in the material world is the *puruṣa-avatāra* known as Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu or Paramātmā. Brahmā is the deity of *rajas* (passion), and Siva of ignorance. They are the three departmental heads of the three qualities of this material world. Creation is made possible by the goodness of Viṣṇu, and when it requires to be destroyed, Lord Siva does it by the *tāñavanātya*. The materialists and the foolish human beings worship Brahmā and Siva respectively. But the pure transcendentalists worship the form of goodness, Viṣṇu, in His various forms. Viṣṇu is manifested by His millions and billions of integrated forms and separated forms. The integrated forms are called Godhead, and the separated forms are called the living entities or the *jivas*. Both the *jivas* and Godhead have their original spiritual forms. *Jivas* are sometimes subjected to the control of material energy, but the Viṣṇu forms are always controllers of this energy. When Viṣṇu, the Personality of Godhead, appears in the material world, He comes to deliver the conditioned living beings who are under the

material energy. Such living beings appear in the material world with intentions of being lords, and thus they become entrapped by the three modes of nature. As such, the living entities have to change their material coverings for undergoing different terms of imprisonment. The prison house of the material world is created by Brahmā under instruction of the Personality of Godhead, and at the conclusion of a *kalpa* the whole thing is destroyed by Siva. But as far as maintenance of the prison house is concerned, it is done by Viṣṇu, as much as the state prison house is maintained by the state. Anyone, therefore, who wishes to get out of this prison house of material existence, which is full of miseries like repetition of birth, death, disease and old age, must please Lord Viṣṇu for such liberation. Lord Viṣṇu is worshiped by devotional service only, and if anyone has to continue prison life in the material world, he may ask for relative facilities for temporary relief from the different demigods like Siva, Brahmā, Indra and Varuṇa. No demigod, however, can release the imprisoned living being from the conditioned life of material existence. This can be done only by Viṣṇu. Therefore, the ultimate benefit may be derived from Viṣṇu, the Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 24

**PaaIQaRvaŌaā<aae DaUMaSTaSMaadiGanñYaqMaYa")
TaMaSaSTau rJaSTaSMaaTSatv& Yad(b]ødXaRNaMa()) 24))**

pārthivād dāruëo dhūmas

tasmād agnis trayémayaù

tamasas tu rajas tasmāt

sattvaà yad brahma-darçanam

SYNONYMS

pārthivāt—from earth; *dāruëaù*—firewood; *dhūmaù*—smoke; *tasmāt*—from that; *agniù*—fire; *trayé*—Vedic sacrifices; *mayaù*—made of; *tamasaù*—in the mode of ignorance; *tu*—but; *rajaù*—the mode of passion;

tasmät—from that; *sattvam*—the mode of goodness; *yat*—which; *brahma*—the Absolute Truth; *darṣanam*—realization.

TRANSLATION

Firewood is a transformation of earth, but smoke is better than the raw wood. And fire is still better, for by fire we can derive the benefits of superior knowledge [through Vedic sacrifices]. Similarly, passion [rajas] is better than ignorance [tamas], but goodness [sattva] is best because by goodness one can come to realize the Absolute Truth.

PURPORT

As explained above, one can get release from the conditioned life of material existence by devotional service to the Personality of Godhead. It is further comprehended herein that one has to rise to the platform of the mode of goodness (*sattva*) so that one can be eligible for the devotional service of the Lord. But if there are impediments on the progressive path, anyone, even from the platform of *tamas*, can gradually rise to the *sattva* platform by the expert direction of the spiritual master. Sincere candidates must, therefore, approach an expert spiritual master for such a progressive march, and the bona fide, expert spiritual master is competent to direct a disciple from any stage of life: *tamas*, *rajas* or *sattva*.

It is a mistake, therefore, to consider that worship of any quality or any form of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is equally beneficial. Except Viṣṇu, all separated forms are manifested under the conditions of material energy, and therefore the forms of material energy cannot help anyone to rise to the platform of *sattva*, which alone can liberate a person from material bondage.

The uncivilized state of life, or the life of the lower animals, is controlled by the mode of *tamas*. The civilized life of man, with a passion for various types of material benefits, is the stage of *rajas*. The *rajas* stage of life gives a slight clue to the realization of the Absolute Truth in the forms of fine sentiments in philosophy, art and culture with moral and ethical principles, but the mode of *sattva* is a still higher stage of material quality, which

actually helps one in realizing the Absolute Truth. In other words, there is a qualitative difference between the different kinds of worshiping methods as well as the respective results derived from the predominating deities, namely Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Hara.

TEXT 25

>aeiJare MauNaYaae_QaaGa]e >aGavNTaMaDaae+aJaMa()
Satv& ivéuÖ& +aeMaaYa k-LPaNTae Yae_Nau TaaiNah)) 25))

bhejire munayo 'thägre

bhagavantam adhokñajam

sattvaà viçuddhaà kñemäya

kalpante ye 'nu tän iha

SYNONYMS

bhejire—rendered service unto; *munayaù*—the sages; *atha*—thus; *agre*—previously; *bhagavantam*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *adhokñajam*—the Transcendence; *sattvam*—existence; *viçuddham*—above the three modes of nature; *kñemäya*—to derive the ultimate benefit; *kalpante*—deserve; *ye*—those; *anu*—follow; *tän*—those; *iha*—in this material world.

TRANSLATION

Previously all the great sages rendered service unto the Personality of Godhead due to His existence above the three modes of material nature. They worshiped Him to become free from material conditions and thus derive the ultimate benefit. Whoever follows such great authorities is also eligible for liberation from the material world.

PURPORT

The purpose of performing religion is neither to profit by material gain nor to get the simple knowledge of discerning matter from spirit. The ultimate aim of religious performances is to release oneself from material bondage and regain the life of freedom in the transcendental world, where the Personality of Godhead is the Supreme Person. Laws of religion, therefore, are directly enacted by the Personality of Godhead, and except for the *mahājanas*, or the authorized agents of the Lord, no one knows the purpose of religion. There are twelve particular agents of the Lord who know the purpose of religion, and all of them render transcendental service unto Him. Persons who desire their own good may follow these *mahājanas* and thus attain the supreme benefit.

TEXT 26

**MauMau+avae gaaeræPaaNa(ihTva >aUTaPaTaqNaQa)
NaaraYa<ak-l/a" XaaNTaa >aJaiNTa ùNaSaUYav")) 26))**

mumukñavo ghora-rüpän

hitvä bhüta-patén atha

näräyaëa-kaläù çäntä

bhajanti hy anasüyavaù

SYNONYMS

mumukñavaù—persons desiring liberation; *ghora*—horrible, ghastly; *rüpän*—forms like that; *hitvä*—rejecting; *bhüta-patén*—demigods; *atha*—for this reason; *näräyaëa*—the Personality of Godhead; *kaläù*—plenary portions; *çäntäù*—all-blissful; *bhajanti*—do worship; *hi*—certainly; *anasüyavaù*—nonenvious.

TRANSLATION

Those who are serious about liberation are certainly nonenvious, and they respect all. Yet they reject the horrible and ghastly forms of the

demigods and worship only the all-blissful forms of Lord Viṣṇu and His plenary portions.

PURPORT

The Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa, who is the original person of the Viṣṇu categories, expands Himself in two different categories, namely integrated plenary portions and separated parts and parcels. The separated parts and parcels are the servitors, and the integrated plenary portions of *viṣṇu-tattvas* are the worshipful objects of service.

All demigods who are empowered by the Supreme Lord are also separated parts and parcels. They do not belong to the categories of *viṣṇu-tattva*. The *viṣṇu-tattvas* are living beings equally as powerful as the original form of the Personality of Godhead, and They display different categories of power in consideration of different times and circumstances. The separated parts and parcels are powerful by limitation. They do not have unlimited power like the *viṣṇu-tattvas*. Therefore, one should never classify the *viṣṇu-tattvas*, or the plenary portions of Nārāyaṇa, the Personality of Godhead, in the same categories with the parts and parcels. If anyone does so he becomes at once an offender by the name *pāñāḍé*. In the age of Kali many foolish persons commit such unlawful offenses and equalize the two categories.

The separated parts and parcels have different positions in the estimation of material powers, and some of them are like Kāla-bhairava, Śmaśāna-bhairava, Śani, Mahākālī and Caṇḍikā. These demigods are worshiped mostly by those who are in the lowest categories of the mode of darkness or ignorance. Other demigods, like Brahmā, Siva, Sūrya, Gaëṇa and many similar deities, are worshiped by men in the mode of passion, urged on by the desire for material enjoyment. But those who are actually situated in the mode of goodness (*sattva-guṇa*) of material nature worship only *viṣṇu-tattvas*. *Viṣṇu-tattvas* are represented by various names and forms, such as Nārāyaṇa, Dāmodara, Vāmana, Govinda and Adhokṣaja.

The qualified *brahmanas* worship the *viṣṇu-tattvas* represented by the *çālagrāma-çilā*, and some of the higher castes like the *kṣatriyas* and *vaisyas*

also generally worship the *viṣṇu-tattvas*.

Highly qualified *brahmanas* situated in the mode of goodness have no grudges against the mode of worship of others. They have all respect for other demigods, even though they may look ghastly, like Kāla-bhairava or Mahākālī. They know very well that those horrible features of the Supreme Lord are all different servitors of the Lord under different conditions, yet they reject the worship of both horrible and attractive features of the demigods, and they concentrate only on the forms of Viṣṇu because they are serious about liberation from the material conditions. The demigods, even to the stage of Brahmā, the supreme of all the demigods, cannot offer liberation to anyone. Hiraṇyakaśipu underwent a severe type of penance to become eternal in life, but his worshipful deity, Brahmā, could not satisfy him with such blessings. Therefore Viṣṇu, and none else, is called *mukti-pāda*, or the Personality of Godhead who can bestow upon us *mukti*, liberation. The demigods, being like other living entities in the material world, are all liquidated at the time of the annihilation of the material structure. They are themselves unable to get liberation, and what to speak of giving liberation to their devotees. The demigods can award the worshipers some temporary benefit only, and not the ultimate one.

It is for this reason only that candidates for liberation deliberately reject the worship of the demigods, although they have no disrespect for any one of them.

TEXT 27

**rJaSTaMa"Pa[k*-TaYa" SaMaXaql/a >aJaiNTa vE)
iPaTa*>aUTaPa[JaeXaadqNa(ié[YaEiYaRPa[JaePSav")) 27))**

rajas-tamaù-prakātayaù

sama-çélä bhajanti vai

pitā-bhūta-prajeçädén

çriyaiçvarya-prajepsavaù

SYNONYMS

rajaù—the mode of passion; *tamaù*—the mode of ignorance; *prakātayaù*—of that mentality; *sama-çéläù*—of the same categories; *bhajanti*—do worship; *vai*—actually; *pitā*—the forefathers; *bhūta*—other living beings; *prajeça-ädén*—controllers of cosmic administration; *çriyā*—enrichment; *aīçvarya*—wealth and power; *prajā*—progeny; *épsavaù*—so desiring.

TRANSLATION

Those who are in the modes of passion and ignorance worship the forefathers, other living beings and the demigods who are in charge of cosmic activities, for they are urged by a desire to be materially benefited with women, wealth, power and progeny.

PURPORT

There is no need to worship demigods of whatsoever category if one is serious about going back to Godhead. In the *Bhagavad-gita* (7.20,23) it is clearly said that those who are mad after material enjoyment approach the different demigods for temporary benefits, which are meant for men with a poor fund of knowledge. We should never desire to increase the depth of material enjoyment. Material enjoyment should be accepted only up to the point of the bare necessities of life and not more or less than that. To accept more material enjoyment means to bind oneself more and more to the miseries of material existence. More wealth, more women and false aristocracy are some of the demands of the materially disposed man because he has no information of the benefit derived from Viṣṇu worship. By Viṣṇu worship one can derive benefit in this life as well as in life after death. Forgetting these principles, foolish people who are after more wealth, more wives and more children worship various demigods. The aim of life is to end the miseries of life and not to increase them.

For material enjoyment there is no need to approach the demigods. The demigods are but servants of the Lord. As such, they are duty-bound to supply necessities of life in the form of water, light, air, etc. *One should work hard and worship the Supreme Lord by the fruits of one's hard labor*

for existence, and that should be the motto of life. One should be careful to execute occupational service with faith in God in the proper way, and that will lead one gradually on the progressive march back to Godhead.

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, when He was personally present at Vrajadhāma, stopped the worship of the demigod Indra and advised the residents of Vraja to worship by their business and to have faith in God. Worshiping the multidemigods for material gain is practically a perversity of religion. This sort of religious activity has been condemned in the very beginning of the *Bhāgavatam* as *kaitava-dharma*. There is only one religion in the world to be followed by one and all, and that is the *Bhāgavata-dharma*, or the religion which teaches one to worship the Supreme Personality of Godhead and no one else.

TEXTS 28–29

**vaSaudevPara veda vaSaudevPara Ma%a")
vaSaudevPara YaaeGaa vaSaudevPara" iṣ-Yaa")) 28))
vaSaudevPar& jaNa& vaSaudevPar& TaPa")
vaSaudevParae DaMaaeR vaSaudevPara GaiTa")) 29))**

vāsudeva-parā vedā

vāsudeva-parā makhāu

vāsudeva-parā yogā

vāsudeva-parāu kriyāu

vāsudeva-paraà jñānaà

vāsudeva-paraà tapaù

vāsudeva-paro dharmo

vāsudeva-parā gatiù

SYNONYMS

vāsudeva—the Personality of Godhead; *parāu*—the ultimate goal; *vedāu*—revealed scriptures; *vāsudeva*—the Personality of Godhead; *parāu*—for worshiping; *makhāu*—sacrifices; *vāsudeva*—the Personality of Godhead; *parāu*—the means of attaining; *yogāu*—mystic paraphernalia; *vāsudeva*—the Personality of Godhead; *parāu*—under His control; *kriyāu*—fruitive activities; *vāsudeva*—the Personality of Godhead; *param*—the supreme; *jñānam*—knowledge; *vāsudeva*—the Personality of Godhead; *param*—best; *tapaū*—austerity; *vāsudeva*—the Personality of Godhead; *paraū*—superior quality; *dharmaū*—religion; *vāsudeva*—the Personality of Godhead; *parāu*—ultimate; *gatiū*—goal of life.

TRANSLATION

In the revealed scriptures, the ultimate object of knowledge is Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead. The purpose of performing sacrifice is to please Him. Yoga is for realizing Him. All fruitive activities are ultimately rewarded by Him only. He is supreme knowledge, and all severe austerities are performed to know Him. Religion [dharma] is rendering loving service unto Him. He is the supreme goal of life.

PURPORT

That Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, is the only object of worship is confirmed in these two *śloka*s. In the Vedic literature there is the same objective: establishing one's relationship and ultimately reviving our lost loving service unto Him. That is the sum and substance of the *Vedas*. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* the same theory is confirmed by the Lord in His own words: the ultimate purpose of the *Vedas* is to know Him only. All the revealed scriptures are prepared by the Lord through His incarnation in the body of Śrīla Vyāsadeva just to remind the fallen souls, conditioned by material nature, of Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead. No demigod can award freedom from material bondage. That is the verdict of all the Vedic literatures. Impersonalists who have no information of the Personality of Godhead minimize the omnipotency of the Supreme Lord and put Him on equal footing with all other living beings, and for this act such

impersonalists get freedom from material bondage only with great difficulty. They can surrender unto Him only after many, many births in the culture of transcendental knowledge.

One may argue that the Vedic activities are based on sacrificial ceremonies. That is true. But all such sacrifices are also meant for realizing the truth about Vāsudeva. Another name of Vāsudeva is Yajna (sacrifice), and in the *Bhagavad-gita* it is clearly stated that all sacrifices and all activities are to be conducted for the satisfaction of Yajna, or Viṣṇu, the Personality of Godhead. This is the case also with the *yoga* systems. *Yoga* means to get into touch with the Supreme Lord. The process, however, includes several bodily features such as *āsana*, *dhyāna*, *prāëyāma* and meditation, and all of them are meant for concentrating upon the localized aspect of Vāsudeva represented as Paramātmā. Paramātmā realization is but partial realization of Vāsudeva, and if one is successful in that attempt, one realizes Vāsudeva in full. But by ill luck most *yogés* are stranded by the powers of mysticism achieved through the bodily process. Ill-fated *yogés* are given a chance in the next birth by being placed in the families of good learned *brahmanas* or in the families of rich merchants in order to execute the unfinished task of Vāsudeva realization. If such fortunate *brahmanas* and sons of rich men properly utilize the chance, they can easily realize Vāsudeva by good association with saintly persons. Unfortunately, such preferred persons are captivated again by material wealth and honor, and thus they practically forget the aim of life.

This is also so for the culture of knowledge. According to *Bhagavad-gita* there are eighteen items in culturing knowledge. By such culture of knowledge one becomes gradually prideless, devoid of vanity, nonviolent, forbearing, simple, devoted to the great spiritual master, and self-controlled. By culture of knowledge one becomes unattached to hearth and home and becomes conscious of the miseries due to death, birth, old age and disease. And all culture of knowledge culminates in devotional service to the Personality of Godhead, Vāsudeva. Therefore, Vāsudeva is the ultimate aim in culturing all different branches of knowledge. Culture of knowledge leading one to the transcendental plane of meeting Vāsudeva is real knowledge. physical knowledge in its various branches is condemned in the *Bhagavad-gita* as *ajñāna*, or the opposite of real knowledge. The

ultimate aim of physical knowledge is to satisfy the senses, which means prolongation of the term of material existence and thereby continuance of the threefold miseries. So prolonging the miserable life of material existence is nescience. But the same physical knowledge leading to the way of spiritual understanding helps one to end the miserable life of physical existence and to begin the life of spiritual existence on the plane of Vāsudeva.

The same applies to all kinds of austerities. *Tapasya* means voluntary acceptance of bodily pains to achieve some higher end of life. Ravana and Hiranyakaśipu underwent a severe type of bodily torture to achieve the end of sense gratification. Sometimes modern politicians also undergo severe types of austerities to achieve some political end. This is not actually *tapasya*. One should accept voluntary bodily inconvenience for the sake of knowing Vāsudeva because that is the way of real austerities. Otherwise all forms of austerities are classified as modes of passion and ignorance. passion and ignorance cannot end the miseries of life. Only the mode of goodness can mitigate the threefold miseries of life. Vasudeva and Devaké, the so-called father and mother of Lord Kṛṣṇa, underwent penances to get Vāsudeva as their son. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the father of all living beings (Bg. 14.4). Therefore He is the original living being of all other living beings. He is the original eternal enjoyer amongst all other enjoyers. Therefore no one can be His begetting father, as the ignorant may think. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa agreed to become the son of Vasudeva and Devaké upon being pleased with their severe austerities. Therefore if any austerities have to be done, they must be done to achieve the end of knowledge, Vāsudeva.

Vāsudeva is the original Personality of Godhead Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. As explained before, the original Personality of Godhead expands Himself by innumerable forms. Such expansion of forms is made possible by His various energies. His energies are also multifarious, and His internal energies are superior and external energies inferior in quality. They are explained in the *Bhagavad-gita* (7.4–6) as the *parā* and the *aparā prakāśis*. So His expansions of various forms which take place via the internal energies are superior forms, whereas the expansions which take place via the external energies are inferior forms. The living entities are also His expansions. The living entities who are expanded by His internal potency

are eternally liberated persons, whereas those who are expanded in terms of the material energies are eternally conditioned souls. Therefore, all culture of knowledge, austerities, sacrifice and activities should be aimed at changing the quality of the influence that is acting upon us. For the present, we are all being controlled by the external energy of the Lord, and just to change the quality of the influence, we must endeavor to cultivate spiritual energy. In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is said that those who are *mahātmās*, or those whose minds have been so broadened as to be engaged in the service of Lord Kṛṣṇa, are under the influence of the internal potency, and the effect is that such broadminded living beings are constantly engaged in the service of the Lord without deviation. That should be the aim of life. And that is the verdict of all the Vedic literatures. No one should bother himself with fruitive activities or dry speculation about transcendental knowledge. Everyone should at once engage himself in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. Nor should one worship different demigods who work as different hands of the Lord for creation, maintenance or destruction of the material world. There are innumerable powerful demigods who look over the external management of the material world. They are all different assisting hands of Lord Vāsudeva. Even Lord Siva and Lord Brahmā are included in the list of demigods, but Lord Viṣṇu, or Vāsudeva, is always transcendently situated. Even though He accepts the quality of goodness of the material world, He is still transcendental to all the material modes. The following example will clear that matter more explicitly. In the prison house there are the prisoners and the managers of the prison house. Both the managers and the prisoners are bound by the laws of the king. But even though the king sometimes comes in the prison, he is not bound by the laws of the prison house. The king is therefore always transcendental to the laws of the prison house, as the Lord is always transcendental to the laws of the material world.

TEXT 30

**Sa Wved& SaSaJaaRGa]e >aGavaNaaTMaMaaYaYaa)
SadSad]UPaYaa caSaaE Gau<aMaYaaGau<aae iv>au")) 30))**

sa evedaà sasarjāgre

bhagavän ätma-mäyayä

sad-asad-rüpayä cäsau

guëamayäguëo vibhuù

SYNONYMS

saù—that; *eva*—certainly; *idam*—this; *sasarja*—created; *agre*—before; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *ätma-mäyayä*—by His personal potency; *sat*—the cause; *asat*—the effect; *rüpayä*—by forms; *ca*—and; *asau*—the same Lord; *guëa-maya*—in the modes of material nature; *aguëaù*—transcendental; *vibhuù*—the Absolute.

TRANSLATION

In the beginning of the material creation, that Absolute Personality of Godhead [Väsudeva], in His transcendental position, created the energies of cause and effect by His own internal energy.

PURPORT

The position of the Lord is always transcendental because the causal and effectual energies required for the creation of the material world were also created by Him. He is unaffected, therefore, by the qualities of the material modes. His existence, form, activities and paraphernalia all existed before the material creation.^{v*} *He is all-spiritual* and has nothing to do with the qualities of the material world, which are qualitatively distinct from the spiritual qualities of the Lord.

TEXT 31

**TaYaa ivl/iSaTaeZvezu Gau<aezu Gau<avaiNav)
ANTa"Pa[iví Aa>aaiTa ivjaNaeNa ivJa*iM>aTa")) 31))**

tayä vilasiteñv eñu

guëeñu guëavän iva

antaù-praviñöa äbhäti

vijjānena vijāmbhitaù

SYNONYMS

tayä—by them; *vilasiteñu*—although in the function; *eñu*—these; *guëeñu*—the modes of material nature; *guëavän*—affected by the modes; *iva*—as if; *antaù*—within; *praviñöaù*—entered into; *äbhäti*—appears to be; *vijjānena*—by transcendental consciousness; *vijāmbhitaù*—fully enlightened.

TRANSLATION

After creating the material substance, the Lord [Väsudeva] expands Himself and enters into it. And although He is within the material modes of nature and appears to be; one of the created beings, He is always fully enlightened in His transcendental position.

PURPORT

The living entities are separated parts and parcels of the Lord, and the conditioned living entities, who are unfit for the spiritual kingdom, are strewn within the material world to enjoy matter to the fullest extent. As Paramātmā and eternal friend of the living entities, the Lord, by one of His plenary portions, accompanies the living entities to guide them in their material enjoyment and to become witness to all activities. While the living entities enjoy the material conditions, the Lord maintains His transcendental position without being affected by the material atmosphere. In the Vedic literatures (*śruti*) it is said that there are two birds in one tree.^{vi*} One of them is eating the fruit of the tree, while the other is witnessing the actions. The witness is the Lord, and the fruit-eater is the living entity. The fruit-eater (living entity) has forgotten his real identity and is overwhelmed in the fruitive activities of the material conditions, but the Lord (Paramātmā) is always full in transcendental knowledge. That is the

difference between the Supersoul and the conditioned soul. The conditioned soul, the living entity, is controlled by the laws of nature, while the Paramātmā, or the Supersoul, is the controller of the material energy.

TEXT 32

YaQaa ùvihTaae viödaRåZvek-" SvYaaeiNazu)
NaaNaev >aaiTa iviaTMaa >aUTaezu c TaQaa PauMaaNa()) 32))

yathā hy avahito vahnir

dāruṇv ekaṁ sva-yoniṇu

nāneva bhāti viçvātmā

bhūteṇu ca tathā pumān

SYNONYMS

yathā—as much as; *hi*—exactly like; *avahitaṁ*—surcharged with; *vahniṁ*—fire; *dāruṇu*—in wood; *ekaṁ*—one; *sva-yoniṇu*—the source of manifestation; *nānā iva*—like different entities; *bhāti*—illuminates; *viçvātmā*—the Lord as Paramātmā; *bhūteṇu*—in the living entities; *ca*—and; *tathā*—in the same way; *pumān*—the Absolute Person.

TRANSLATION

The Lord, as Supersoul, pervades all things, just as fire permeates wood, and so He appears to be of many varieties, though He is the absolute one without a second.

PURPORT

Lord Vāsudeva, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, by one of His plenary parts expands Himself all over the material world, and His existence can be perceived even within the atomic energy. Matter, antimatter, proton, neutron, etc., are all different effects of the Paramātmā feature of the Lord.

As from wood, fire can be manifested, or as butter can be churned out of milk, so also the presence of the Lord as Paramātmā can be felt by the process of legitimate hearing and chanting of the transcendental subjects which are especially treated in the Vedic literatures like the *Upaniñads* and *Vedānta*. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the bona fide explanation of these Vedic literatures. The Lord can be realized through the aural reception of the transcendental message, and that is the only way to experience the transcendental subject. As fire is kindled from wood by another fire, the divine consciousness of man can similarly be kindled by another divine grace. His Divine Grace the spiritual master can kindle the spiritual fire from the woodlike living entity by imparting proper spiritual messages injected through the receptive ear. Therefore one is required to approach the proper spiritual master with receptive ears only, and thus divine existence is gradually realized. The difference between animality and humanity lies in this process only. A human being can hear properly, whereas an animal cannot.

TEXT 33

**ASaaE Gau<aMaYaE>aaRvE>aURTaSaU+MaeiNd]YaaTMai>a")
SviNaiMaRTaezu iNaivRíae >au»e >aUTaezu Tad(Gau<aaNa()) 33))**

asau guëamayair bhävair

bhüta-sükñmendriyätmabhiù

sva-nirmiteñu nirviñöo

bhuikte bhüteñu tad-guëän

SYNONYMS

asau—that Paramātmā; *guëa-mayaiù*—influenced by the modes of nature; *bhävaiù*—naturally; *bhüta*—created; *sükñma*—subtle; *indriya*—senses; *ätmabhiù*—by the living beings; *sva-nirmiteñu*—in His own creation; *nirviñöaù*—entering; *bhuikte*—causes to enjoy; *bhüteñu*—in the living entities; *tad-guëän*—those modes of nature.

TRANSLATION

The Supersoul enters into the bodies of the created beings who are influenced by the modes of material nature and causes them to enjoy the effects of these modes by the subtle mind.

PURPORT

There are 8,400,000 species of living beings beginning from the highest intellectual being, Brahmā, down to the insignificant ant, and all of them are enjoying the material world according to the desires of the subtle mind and gross material body. The gross material body is based on the conditions of the subtle mind, and the senses are created according to the desire of the living being. The Lord as Paramātmā helps the living being to get material happiness because the living being is helpless in all respects in obtaining what he desires. He proposes, and the Lord disposes. In another sense, the living beings are parts and parcels of the Lord. They are therefore one with the Lord. In the *Bhagavad-gita* the living beings in all varieties of bodies have been claimed by the Lord as His sons. The sufferings and enjoyments of the sons are indirectly the sufferings and enjoyments of the father. Still the father is not in any way affected directly by the suffering and enjoyment of the sons. He is so kind that He constantly remains with the living being as Paramātmā and always tries to convert the living being towards the real happiness.

TEXT 34

**>aavYaTYaez SatveNa I/aek-aNa(vE I/aek->aavNa")
I/Il/avTaaraNaurTaae deviTaYaRx(Naraidzu)) 34))**

bhāvayaty eṇa sattvena

lokān vai loka-bhāvanau

līlavatārānurato

deva-tiryāṇ-narāḍiṇu

SYNONYMS

bhāvayati—maintains; *eñau*—all these; *sattvena*—in the mode of goodness; *lokān*—all over the universe; *vai*—generally; *loka-bhāvanau*—the master of all the universes; *līla*—pastimes; *avatāra*—incarnation; *anuratau*—assuming the role; *deva*—the demigods; *tiryak*—lower animals; *nara-ādiñu*—in the midst of human beings.

TRANSLATION

Thus the Lord of the universes maintains all planets inhabited by demigods, men and lower animals. Assuming the roles of incarnations, He performs pastimes to reclaim those in the mode of pure goodness.

PURPORT

There are innumerable material universes, and in each and every universe there are innumerable planets inhabited by different grades of living entities in different modes of nature. The Lord (Viṣṇu) incarnates Himself in each and every one of them and in each and every type of living society. He manifests His transcendental pastimes amongst them just to create the desire to go back to Godhead. The Lord does not change His original transcendental position, but He appears to be differently manifested according to the particular time, circumstances and society.

Sometimes He incarnates Himself or empowers a suitable living being to act for Him, but in either case the purpose is the same: the Lord wants the suffering living being to go back home, back to Godhead. The happiness which the living beings are hankering for is not to be found within any corner of the innumerable universes and material planets. The eternal happiness which the living being wants is obtainable in the kingdom of God, but the forgetful living beings under the influence of the material modes have no information of the kingdom of God. The Lord, therefore, comes to propagate the message of the kingdom of God, either personally as an incarnation or through His bona fide representative as the good son of God. Such incarnations or sons of God are not making propaganda for going back to Godhead only within the human society. Their work is also going on in all

types of societies, amongst demigods and those other than human beings.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Second Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled “Divinity and Divine Service.”

Chapter Three

Kṛṣṇa Is the Source of All Incarnations

TEXT 1

SaUTa ovac

JaGa*he PaaEāz& æPa& >aGavaNMahdaidi>a")

SaM>aUTa& zae@Xak-I/MaadaE I/aek-iSaSa*+aYaa)) 1))

sūta uvāca

jagāhe pauruṇāṁ rūpāṁ

bhagavān mahad-ādibhiḥ

sambhūtaṁ ṇoḍaṣa-kalam

ādau loka-sisāṅṇayā

SYNONYMS

sūtaḥ uvāca—Sūta said; *jagāhe*—accepted; *pauruṇām*—plenary portion as the *puruṣa* incarnation; *rūpam*—form; *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *mahat-ādibhiḥ*—with the ingredients of the material world; *sambhūtam*—thus there was the creation of; *ṇoḍaṣa-kalam*—sixteen primary principles; *ādau*—in the beginning; *loka*—the universes; *sisāṅṇayā*—on the intention of creating.

TRANSLATION

Süta said: In the beginning of the creation, the Lord first expanded Himself in the universal form of the *puruṣa* incarnation and manifested all the ingredients for the material creation. And thus at first there was the creation of the sixteen principles of material action. This was for the purpose of creating the material universe.

PURPORT

The *Bhagavad-gita* states that the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa maintains these material universes by extending His plenary expansions. So this *puruṣa* form is the confirmation of the same principle. The original Personality of Godhead Vāsudeva, or Lord Kṛṣṇa, who is famous as the son of King Vasudeva or King Nanda, is full with all opulences, all potencies, all fame, all beauty, all knowledge and all renunciation. Part of His opulences are manifested as impersonal Brahman, and part of His opulences are manifested as Paramātmā. This *puruṣa* feature of the same Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa is the original Paramātmā manifestation of the Lord. There are three *puruṣa* features in the material creation, and this form, who is known as the Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, is the first of the three. The others are known as the Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu and the Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, which we shall know one after another. The innumerable universes are generated from the skin holes of this Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, and in each one of the universes the Lord enters as Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu.

In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is also mentioned that the material world is created at certain intervals and then again destroyed. This creation and destruction is done by the supreme will because of the conditioned souls, or the *nitya-baddha* living beings. The *nitya-baddha*, or the eternally conditioned souls, have the sense of individuality or *ahaikāra*, which dictates them sense enjoyment, which they are unable to have constitutionally. The Lord is the only enjoyer, and all others are enjoyed. The living beings are predominated enjoyers. But the eternally conditioned souls, forgetful of this constitutional position, have strong aspirations to enjoy. The chance to enjoy matter is given to the conditioned souls in the material world, and side by side they are given the chance to understand their real constitutional position. Those fortunate living entities who catch the truth and surrender unto the lotus feet of Vāsudeva after many, many births in

the material world join the eternally liberated souls and thus are allowed to enter into the kingdom of Godhead. After this, such fortunate living entities need not come again within the occasional material creation. But those who cannot catch the constitutional truth are again merged into the *mahat-tattva* at the time of the annihilation of the material creation. When the creation is again set up, this *mahat-tattva* is again let loose. This *mahat-tattva* contains all the ingredients of the material manifestations, including the conditioned souls. Primarily this *mahat-tattva* is divided into sixteen parts, namely the five gross material elements and the eleven working instruments or senses. It is like the cloud in the clear sky. In the spiritual sky, the effulgence of Brahman is spread all around, and the whole system is dazzling in spiritual light. The *mahat-tattva* is assembled in some corner of the vast, unlimited spiritual sky, and the part which is thus covered by the *mahat-tattva* is called the material sky. This part of the spiritual sky, called the *mahat-tattva*, is only an insignificant portion of the whole spiritual sky, and within this *mahat-tattva* there are innumerable universes. All these universes are collectively produced by the Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, called also the Mahā-Viṣṇu, who simply throws His glance to impregnate the material sky.

TEXT 2

YaSYaaM>aiSa XaYaaNaSYa YaaeGaiNad]a& ivTaNvTa")
Naai>ahṛdaMbuJaadaSaqd(b]øa iviSa*Jaa& PaiTa")) 2))

yasyāmbhasi çayānasya

yoga-nidrāà vitanvataù

nābhi-hradāmbujād āséd

brahmā viçva-sājjāà patiù

SYNONYMS

yasya—whose; *ambhasi*—in the water; *çayānasya*—lying down; *yoga-nidrām*—sleeping in meditation; *vitānvataù*—ministering; *nābhi*—navel;

hrada—out of the lake; *ambujät*—from the lotus; *äsét*—was manifested; *brahmä*—the grandfather of the living beings; *viçva*—the universe; *såjäm*—the engineers; *patiù*—master.

TRANSLATION

A part of the *puruṣa* lies down within the water of the universe, from the navel lake of His body sprouts a lotus stem, and from the lotus flower atop this stem, *Brahmā*, the master of all engineers in the universe, becomes manifest.

PURPORT

The first *puruṣa* is the Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. From His skin holes innumerable universes have sprung up. In each and every universe, the *puruṣa* enters as the Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. He is lying within the half of the universe which is full with the water of His body. And from the navel of Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu has sprung the stem of the lotus flower, the birthplace of *Brahmā*, who is the father of all living beings and the master of all the demigod engineers engaged in the perfect design and working of the universal order. Within the stem of the lotus there are fourteen divisions of planetary systems, and the earthly planets are situated in the middle. Upwards there are other, better planetary systems, and the topmost system is called *Brahmaloka* or *Satyaloka*. Downwards from the earthly planetary system there are seven lower planetary systems inhabited by the *asuras* and similar other materialistic living beings.

From Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu there is expansion of the Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, who is the collective *Paramātmā* of all living beings. He is called *Hari*, and from Him all incarnations within the universe are expanded.

Therefore, the conclusion is that the *puruṣa-avatāra* is manifested in three features — first the Kāraṇodakaśāyī who creates aggregate material ingredients in the *mahat-tattva*, second the Garbhodakaśāyī who enters in each and every universe, and third the Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu who is the *Paramātmā* of every material object, organic or inorganic. One who knows these plenary features of the Personality of Godhead knows Godhead

properly, and thus the knower becomes freed from the material conditions of birth, death, old age and disease, as it is confirmed in *Bhagavad-gita*. In this *çloka* the subject matter of Mahä-Viṣṇu is summarized. The Mahä-Viṣṇu lies down in some part of the spiritual sky by His own free will. Thus He lies on the ocean of *kāraëa*, from where He glances over His material nature, and the *mahat-tattva* is at once created. Thus electrified by the power of the Lord, the material nature at once creates innumerable universes, just as in due course a tree decorates itself with innumerable grown fruits. The seed of the tree is sown by the cultivator, and the tree or creeper in due course becomes manifested with so many fruits. Nothing can take place without a cause. The Kāraṇa Ocean is therefore called the Causal Ocean. *Kāraṇa* means “causal.” We should not foolishly accept the atheistic theory of creation. The description of the atheists is given in the *Bhagavad-gita*. The atheist does not believe in the creator, but he cannot give a good theory to explain the creation. Material nature has no power to create without the power of the *puruṣa*, just as a *prakāti*, or woman, cannot produce a child without the connection of a *puruṣa*, or man. The *puruṣa* impregnates, and the *prakāti* delivers. We should not expect milk from the fleshy bags on the neck of a goat, although they look like breastly nipples. Similarly, we should not expect any creative power from the material ingredients; we must believe in the power of the *puruṣa*, who impregnates *prakāti*, or nature. Because the Lord wished to lie down in meditation, the material energy created innumerable universes at once, in each of them the Lord lay down, and thus all the planets and the different paraphernalia were created at once by the will of the Lord. The Lord has unlimited potencies, and thus He can act as He likes by perfect planning, although personally He has nothing to do. No one is greater than or equal to Him. That is the verdict of the *Vedas*.

TEXT 3

YaSYaavYavSa&SQaaNaE" k-iLPaTaae I/aek-ivSTar")
TaÜE >aGavTaae æPa& ivéuÖ& SatvMaUiJaRTaMa()) 3))

yasyävayava-saàsthänaiù

kalpito loka-vistaraù

tad vai bhagavato rūpā

viçuddhā sattvam ūrjitam

SYNONYMS

yasya—whose; *avayava*—bodily expansion; *saàsthānaiù*—situated in; *kalpitaù*—is imagined; *loka*—planets of inhabitants; *vistaraù*—various; *tat vai*—but that is; *bhagavataù*—of the Personality of Godhead; *rūpam*—form; *viçuddham*—purely; *sattvam*—existence; *ūrjitam*—excellence.

TRANSLATION

It is believed that all the universal planetary systems are situated on the extensive body of the puruṣa, but He has nothing to do with the created material ingredients. His body is eternally in spiritual existence par excellence.

PURPORT

The conception of the *virāṭ-rūpa* or *viçva-rūpa* of the Supreme Absolute Truth is especially meant for the neophyte who can hardly think of the transcendental form of the Personality of Godhead. To him a form means something of this material world, and therefore an opposite conception of the Absolute is necessary in the beginning to concentrate the mind on the power extension of the Lord. As stated above, the Lord extends His potency in the form of the *mahat-tattva*, which includes all material ingredients. The extension of power by the Lord and the Lord Himself personally are one in one sense, but at the same time the *mahat-tattva* is different from the Lord. Therefore the potency of the Lord and the Lord are simultaneously different and nondifferent. The conception of the *virāṭ-rūpa*, especially for the impersonalist, is thus nondifferent from the eternal form of the Lord. This eternal form of the Lord exists prior to the creation of the *mahat-tattva*, and it is stressed here that the eternal form of the Lord is par excellence spiritual or transcendental to the modes of material nature. The very same transcendental form of the Lord is manifested by His internal potency, and the formation of His multifarious manifestations of

incarnations is always of the same transcendental quality, without any touch of the *mahat-tattva*.

TEXT 4

PaXYaNTYadae æPaMad>a]c+auza
SahóPaadaeå>auJaaNaNaad(>auTaMa()
SahóMaUDaRé[v<aai+aNaaiSak&-
SahóMaaELYaMbrku-<@I/aeçSaTa()) 4))

paçyanty ado rüpaṁ adabhra-cakñuñä

sahasra-pädoru-bhujānanādbhutam

sahasra-mürdha-çravaëäkñi-näsikaà

sahasra-mauly-ambara-kuëòalollasat

SYNONYMS

paçyanti—see; *adaù*—the form of the *puruṣa*; *rüpaṁ*—form; *adabhra*—perfect; *cakñuñä*—by the eyes; *sahasra-päda*—thousands of legs; *üru*—thighs; *bhuja-änana*—hands and faces; *adbhutam*—wonderful; *sahasra*—thousands of; *mürdha*—heads; *çravaëa*—ears; *akñi*—eyes; *näsikam*—noses; *sahasra*—thousands; *mauli*—garlands; *ambara*—dresses; *kuëòala*—earrings; *ullasat*—all glowing.

TRANSLATION

The devotees, with their perfect eyes, see the transcendental form of the *puruṣa* who has thousands of legs, thighs, arms and faces—all extraordinary. In that body there are thousands of heads, ears, eyes and noses. They are decorated with thousands of helmets and glowing earrings and are adorned with garlands.

PURPORT

With our present materialized senses we cannot perceive anything of the transcendental Lord. Our present senses are to be rectified by the process of devotional service, and then the Lord Himself becomes revealed to us. In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is confirmed that the transcendental Lord can be perceived only by pure devotional service. So it is confirmed in the *Vedas* that only devotional service can lead one to the side of the Lord and that only devotional service can reveal Him. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā* also it is said that the Lord is always visible to the devotees whose eyes have been anointed with the tinge of devotional service. So we have to take information of the transcendental form of the Lord from persons who have actually seen Him with perfect eyes smeared with devotional service. In the material world also we do not always see things with our own eyes; we sometimes see through the experience of those who have actually seen or done things. If that is the process for experiencing a mundane object, it is more perfectly applicable in matters transcendental. So only with patience and perseverance can we realize the transcendental subject matter regarding the Absolute Truth and His different forms. He is formless to the neophytes, but He is in transcendental form to the expert servitor.

TEXT 5

**WTaàaNaavTaara<aa& iNaDaaNa& bqJaMaVYaYaMa()
YaSYaa&Xaa&XaeNa Sa*JYaNTae deviTaYaRx(NaradYa")) 5))**

etan nānavatārēā

nidhānaà bējam avyayam

yasyāàçāçena sājyante

deva-tīryaì-narādayaù

SYNONYMS

etat—this (form); *nānā*—multifarious; *avatārēām*—of the incarnations; *nidhānam*—source; *bējam*—seed; *avyayam*—indestructible; *yasya*—whose; *aàça*—plenary portion; *aàçena*—part of the plenary portion;

sājyante—create; *deva*—demigods; *tiryak*—animals; *nara-ādayaù*—human beings and others.

TRANSLATION

This form [the second manifestation of the *puruṣa*] is the source and indestructible seed of multifarious incarnations within the universe. From the particles and portions of this form, different living entities, like demigods, men and others, are created.

PURPORT

The *puruṣa*, after creating innumerable universes in the *mahat-tattva*, entered in each of them as the second *puruṣa*, Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. When He saw that within the universe there was only darkness and space, without a resting place, He filled half of the universe with water from His own perspiration and laid Himself down on the same water. This water is called Garbhodaka. Then from His navel the stem of the lotus flower sprouted, and on the flower petals the birth of Brahmā, or the master engineer of the universal plan, took place. Brahmā became the engineer of the universe, and the Lord Himself took charge of the maintenance of the universe as Viṣṇu. Brahmā was generated from *rajo-guna* of *prakāṭi*, or the mode of passion in nature, and Viṣṇu became the Lord of the mode of goodness. Viṣṇu, being transcendental to all the modes, is always aloof from materialistic affection. This has already been explained. From Brahmā there is Rudra (Siva), who is in charge of the mode of ignorance or darkness. He destroys the whole creation by the will of the Lord. Therefore all three, namely Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Siva, are incarnations of the Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. From Brahmā the other demigods like Dakṣa, Marīci, Manu and many others become incarnated to generate living entities within the universe. This Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu is glorified in the *Vedas* in the hymns of *Garbha-stuti*, which begin with the description of the Lord as having thousands of heads, etc. The Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu is the Lord of the universe, and although He appears to be lying within the universe, He is always transcendental. This also has already been explained. The Viṣṇu who is the plenary portion of the Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu is the Supersoul of the universal life, and He is known as the maintainer of the

universe or Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. So the three features of the original *puruṣa* are thus understood. And all the incarnations within the universe are emanations from this Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu.

In different millennia there are different incarnations, and they are innumerable, although some of them are very prominent, such as Matsya, Kūrma, Varāha, Rāma, Nṛsiṃha, Vāmana and many others. These incarnations are called *līla* incarnations. Then there are qualitative incarnations such as Brahmā, Viṣṇu, and Siva (or Rudra) who take charge of the different modes of material nature.

Lord Viṣṇu is nondifferent from the Personality of Godhead. Lord Siva is in the marginal position between the Personality of Godhead and the living entities, or *jīvas*. Brahmā is always a *jīva-tattva*. The highest pious living being, or the greatest devotee of the Lord, is empowered with the potency of the Lord for creation, and he is called Brahmā. His power is like the power of the sun reflected in valuable stones and jewels. When there is no such living being to take charge of the post of Brahmā, the Lord Himself becomes a Brahmā and takes charge of the post.

Lord Siva is not an ordinary living being. He is the plenary portion of the Lord, but because Lord Siva is in direct touch with material nature, he is not exactly in the same transcendental position as Lord Viṣṇu. The difference is like that between milk and curd. Curd is nothing but milk, and yet it cannot be used in place of milk.

The next incarnations are the Manus. Within one day's duration of the life of Brahmā (which is calculated by our solar year as 4,300,000 x 1,000 years) there are fourteen Manus. Therefore there are 420 Manus in one month of Brahmā and 5,040 Manus in one year of Brahmā. Brahmā lives for one hundred years of his age, and therefore there are 5,040 x 100 or 504,000 Manus in the duration of Brahmā's life. There are innumerable universes, with one Brahmā in each of them, and all of them are created and annihilated during the breathing time of the *puruṣa*. Therefore one can simply imagine how many millions of Manus there are during one breath of the *puruṣa*.

The Manus who are prominent within this universe are as follows: Yajna as Svayambhuva Manu, Vibhu as Svarocisa Manu, Satyasena as Uttama Manu, Hari as Tamasa Manu, Vaikuntha as Raivata Manu, Ajita as Caksusa Manu, Vāmana as Vaivasvata Manu (the present age is under the Vaivasvata Manu), Sarvabhauma as Savarni Manu, Rsabha as Daksasavarni Manu, Visvaksena as Brahma-savarni Manu, Dharmasetu as Dharma-savarni Manu, Sudhama as Rudra-savarni Manu, Yogesvara as Deva-savarni Manu, and Brhadbhanu as Indra-savarni Manu. These are the names of one set of fourteen Manus covering 4,300,000,000 solar years as described above.

Then there are the *yugāvatāras*, or the incarnations of the millennia. The *yugas* are known as Satya-yuga, Tretā-yuga, Dvāpara-yuga and Kali-yuga. The incarnations of each *yuga* are of different color. The colors are white, red, black and yellow. In the Dvāpara-yuga, Lord Kṛṣṇa in black color appeared, and in the Kali-yuga Lord Caitanya in yellow color appeared.

So all the incarnations of the Lord are mentioned in the revealed scriptures. There is no scope for an imposter to become an incarnation, for an incarnation must be mentioned in the *sastras*. An incarnation does not declare Himself to be an incarnation of the Lord, but great sages agree by the symptoms mentioned in the revealed scriptures. The features of the incarnation and the particular type of mission which He has to execute are mentioned in the revealed scriptures.

Apart from the direct incarnations, there are innumerable empowered incarnations. They are also mentioned in the revealed scriptures. Such incarnations are directly as well as indirectly empowered. When they are directly empowered they are called incarnations, but when they are indirectly empowered they are called *vibhūtis*. Directly empowered incarnations are the Kumāras, Nārada, Pāthu, Çeña, Ananta, etc. As far as *vibhūtis* are concerned, they are very explicitly described in the *Bhagavad-gita* in the *Vibhūti-yoga* chapter. And for all these different types of incarnations, the fountainhead is the Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu.

TEXT 6

Sa Wv Pa[QaMa& dev" k-aEMaar& SaGaRMaaié[Ta")

ccar duêr& b]øa b]øcYaRMa%i<@TaMa()) 6))

sa eva prathamaà devaù

kaumäraà sargam äçritaù

cacära duçcaraà brahmä

brahmacaryam akhaëòitam

SYNONYMS

saù—that; *eva*—certainly; *prathamam*—first; *devaù*—Supreme Lord; *kaumäram*—named the Kumäras (unmarried); *sargam*—creation; *äçritaù*—under; *cacära*—performed; *duçcaram*—very difficult to do; *brahmä*—in the order of Brahman; *brahmacaryam*—under discipline to realize the Absolute (Brahman); *akhaëòitam*—unbroken.

TRANSLATION

First of all, in the beginning of creation, there were the four unmarried sons of Brahmä [the Kumäras], who, being situated in a vow of celibacy, underwent severe austerities for realization of the Absolute Truth.

PURPORT

The creation of the material world is effected, maintained and then again annihilated at certain intervals. So there are different names of the creations in terms of the particular types of Brahmä, the father of the living beings in the creation. The Kumäras, as above mentioned, appeared in the Kaumära creation of the material world, and to teach us the process of Brahman realization, they underwent a severe type of disciplinary action as bachelors. These Kumäras are empowered incarnations. And before executing the severe type of disciplinary actions, all of them became qualified *brahmanas*. This example suggests that one must first acquire the qualifications of a *brahmana*, not simply by birth but also by quality, and then one can undergo the process of Brahman realization.

TEXT 7

iÜTaqYa& Tau >avaYaaSYa rSaaTal/GaTaa& MahqMa()
oÖirZYaàuPaadta YajeXa" SaaEk-r& vPau")) 7))

dvitéyaà tu bhaväyäsya

rasātala-gatäà mahém

uddhariñyann upädatta

yajñeçaù saukaraà vapuù

SYNONYMS

dvitéyam—the second; *tu*—but; *bhaväya*—for the welfare; *asya*—of this earth; *rasātala*—of the lowest region; *gatäm*—having gone; *mahém*—the earth; *uddhariñyan*—lifting; *upädatta*—established; *yajñeçaù*—the proprietor or the supreme enjoyer; *saukaram*—hoggish; *vapuù*—incarnation.

TRANSLATION

The supreme enjoyer of all sacrifices accepted the incarnation of a boar [the second incarnation], and for the welfare of the earth He lifted the earth from the nether regions of the universe.

PURPORT

The indication is that for each and every incarnation of the Personality of Godhead, the particular function executed is also mentioned. There cannot be any incarnation without a particular function, and such functions are always extraordinary. They are impossible for any living being to perform. The incarnation of the boar was to take the earth out of Pluto's region of filthy matter. Picking up something from a filthy place is done by a boar, and the all-powerful Personality of Godhead displayed this wonder to the *asuras*, who had hidden the earth in such a filthy place. There is nothing

impossible for the Personality of Godhead, and although He played the part of a boar, by the devotees He is worshiped, staying always in transcendence.

TEXT 8

**Ta*TaQYaMa*izSaGa| vE devizRTvMauPaeTYa Sa")
TaN}a& SaaTvTaMaací NaEZk-MYa| k-MaR<aa& YaTa")) 8))**

tâtéyam āñi-sargaà vai

devarñitvam upetya saù

tantraà sätvatam äcañöa

naiñkarmyaà karmaëää yataù

SYNONYMS

tâtéyam—the third one; *āñi-sargam*—the millennium of the *āñis*; *vai*—certainly; *devarñitvam*—incarnation of the *āñi* amongst the demigods; *upetya*—having accepted; *saù*—he; *tantram*—exposition of the *Vedas*; *sätvatam*—which is especially meant for devotional service; *äcañöa*—collected; *naiñkarmyam*—nonfruitive; *karmaëäm*—of work; *yataù*—from which.

TRANSLATION

In the millennium of the āñis, the Personality of Godhead accepted the third empowered incarnation in the form of Devarñi Nārada, who is a great sage among the demigods. He collected expositions of the Vedas which deal with devotional service and which inspire nonfruitive action.

PURPORT

The great Rsi Nārada, who is an empowered incarnation of the Personality of Godhead, propagates devotional service all over the universe. All great

devotees of the Lord all over the universe and in different planets and species of life are his disciples. Srila Vyāsadeva, the compiler of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, is also one of his disciples. Nārada is the author of *Nārada-pāicarātra*, which is the exposition of the *Vedas* particularly for the devotional service of the Lord. This *Nārada-pāicarātra* trains the *karmés*, or the fruitive workers, to achieve liberation from the bondage of fruitive work. The conditioned souls are mostly attracted by fruitive work because they want to enjoy life by the sweat of their own brows. The whole universe is full of fruitive workers in all species of life. The fruitive works include all kinds of economic development plans. But the law of nature provides that every action has its resultant reaction, and the performer of the work is bound up by such reactions, good or bad. The reaction of good work is comparative material prosperity, whereas the reaction of bad work is comparative material distress. But material conditions, either in so-called happiness or in so-called distress, are all meant ultimately for distress only. Foolish materialists have no information of how to obtain eternal happiness in the unconditional state. Sri Nārada informs these foolish fruitive workers how to realize the reality of happiness. He gives direction to the diseased men of the world how one's present engagement can lead one to the path of spiritual emancipation. The physician directs the patient to take treated milk in the form of curd for his sufferings from indigestion due to his taking another milk preparation. So the cause of the disease and the remedy of the disease may be the same, but it must be treated by an expert physician like Nārada. The *Bhagavad-gita* also gives the same solution of serving the Lord by the fruits of one's labor. That will lead one to the path of *naiñkarmya*, or liberation.

TEXT 9

**TauYaeR DaMaRk-I/aSaGaeR NarNaaraYa<aav*zq)
>aUTvaTMaaePaXaMaaePaeTaMak-raed(duêr& TaPa")) 9))**

turye dharma-kalā-sarge

nara-nārāyaëv āñé

bhūtvātmopāçamopetam

akarod duṣcaraà tapaù

SYNONYMS

turye—in the fourth of the line; *dharma-kalā*—wife of Dharmarāja; *sarge*—being born of; *nara-nārāyaëau*—named Nara and Nārāyaṇa; *āñé*—sages; *bhütvä*—becoming; *ätma-upaçama*—controlling the senses; *upetam*—for achievement of; *akarot*—undertook; *duṣcaram*—very strenuous; *tapaù*—penance.

TRANSLATION

In the fourth incarnation, the Lord became Nara and Nārāyaṇa, the twin sons of the wife of King Dharma. Thus He undertook severe and exemplary penances to control the senses.

PURPORT

As King Rsabha advised His sons, *tapasya*, or voluntary acceptance of penance for realization of the Transcendence, is the only duty of the human being; it was so done by the Lord Himself in an exemplary manner to teach us. The Lord is very kind to the forgetful souls. He therefore comes Himself and leaves behind necessary instructions and also sends His good sons as representatives to call all the conditioned souls back to Godhead. Recently, within the memory of everyone, Lord Caitanya also appeared for the same purpose: to show special favor to fallen souls of this age of iron industry. The incarnation of Nārāyaṇa is worshiped still at Badaré-nārāyaëa, on the range of the Himalayas.

TEXT 10

**PaÄMa" k-iPal/ae NaaMa iSaÖeXa" k-al/ivPlu/TaMa()
Pa[aevacasaurYae Saa&:Ya& TatvGa]aMaiviNa<aRYaMa()) 10))**

païcamaù kapilo nāma

siddheçaù käla-viplutam

proväcäsuraḥ saïkhyā

tattva-grāma-vinirāyam

SYNONYMS

pañcama—the fifth one; *kapila*—Kapila; *nāma*—of the name; *siddheṣa*—the foremost amongst the perfect; *kāla*—time; *vipluta*—lost; *provāca*—said; *āsura*—unto the *brahmana* named Āsuri; *saïkhyam*—metaphysics; *tattva-grāma*—the sum total of the creative elements; *vinirāyam*—exposition.

TRANSLATION

The fifth incarnation, named Lord Kapila, is foremost among perfected beings. He gave an exposition of the creative elements and metaphysics to Āsuri Brāhmaṇa, for in course of time this knowledge had been lost.

PURPORT

The sum total of the creative elements is twenty-four in all. Each and every one of them is explicitly explained in the system of Sāïkhya philosophy. Sāïkhya philosophy is generally called metaphysics by the European scholars. The etymological meaning of *saïkhyā* is “that which explains very lucidly by analysis of the material elements.” This was done for the first time by Lord Kapila, who is said herein to be the fifth in the line of incarnations.

TEXT 11

ziMa(A}aerPaTYaTv& v*Ta" Pa[aáae_NaSaUYaYaa)
AaNvqi+ak-IMaI/k-aRYa Pa[úadaid>Ya OicvaNa()) 11)

ñāñöham atrer apatyatva

vātaḥ prāpto 'nasūyayā

änvékñikém alarkäya

prahlädädibhya ücivän

SYNONYMS

ñañöham—the sixth one; *atreu*—of Atri; *apatyatvam*—sonship; *våtau*—being prayed for; *pråpta*—obtained; *anasüyayä*—by Anasuya; *änvékñikém*—on the subject of transcendence; *alarkäya*—unto Alarka; *prahläda-ädibhya*—unto Prahläda and others; *ücivän*—spoke.

TRANSLATION

The sixth incarnation of the puruṣa was the son of the sage Atri. He was born from the womb of Anasuya, who prayed for an incarnation. He spoke on the subject of transcendence to Alarka, Prahlāda and others [Yadu, Haihaya, etc.].

PURPORT

The Lord incarnated Himself as Dattatreya, the son of Rsi Atri and Anasuya. The history of the birth of Dattatreya as an incarnation of the Lord is mentioned in the *Brahmāṇḍa Purāṇa* in connection with the story of the devoted wife. It is said there that Anasuya, the wife of Rsi Atri, prayed before the Lords Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Śiva as follows: “My lords, if you are pleased with me, and if you desire me to ask from you some sort of blessings, then I pray that you combine together to become my son.” This was accepted by the lords, and as Dattatreya the Lord expounded the philosophy of the spirit soul and especially instructed Alarka, Prahlāda, Yadu, Haihaya, etc.

TEXT 12

**TaTa" SaáMa AakU-TYaa& áceYaRjae_>YaJaaYaTa)
Sa YaaMaaÛE" SaurGa<aErPaaTSvaYaM>auvaNTarMa()) 12))**

tatau saptama äkütyäa

rucer yajio 'bhyajāyata

sa yāmadyaì sura-gaëair

apät svāyambhuvāntaram

SYNONYMS

tataù—after that; *saptame*—the seventh in the line; *ākūtyām*—in the womb of Ākūti; *ruceù*—by Prajāpati Ruci; *yajiaù*—the Lord's incarnation as Yajna; *abhyajāyata*—advented; *saù*—He; *yāma-ādyaiù*—with Yāma and others; *sura-gaëaiù*—with demigods; *apät*—ruled; *svāyambhuva-antaram*—the change of the period of Svayambhuva Manu.

TRANSLATION

The seventh incarnation was Yajna, the son of Prajāpati Ruci and his wife Ākūti. He controlled the period during the change of the Svayambhuva Manu and was assisted by demigods such as His son Yama.

PURPORT

The administrative posts occupied by the demigods for maintaining the regulations of the material world are offered to the highly elevated pious living beings. When there is a scarcity of such pious living beings, the Lord incarnates Himself as Brahmā, Prajāpati, Indra, etc., and takes up the charge. During the period of Svayambhuva Manu (the present period is of Vaivasvata Manu) there was no suitable living being who could occupy the post of Indra, the King of the Indraloka (heaven) planet. The Lord Himself at that time became Indra. Assisted by His own sons like Yama and other demigods, Lord Yajna ruled the administration of the universal affairs.

TEXT 13

**AíMae MaeãdeVYaa& Tau Naa>aeJaaRTa oăŖ-Ma")
dXaRYaNa(vTMaR Daqra<aa& SavaRé[MaNaMaSk*-TaMa()) 13))**

añöame merudevyäà tu

näbher jäta urukramaù

darçayan vartma dhéräëäà

sarväçrama-namaskâtam

SYNONYMS

añöame—the eighth of the incarnations; *merudevyäm tu*—in the womb of Merudevé, the wife of; *näbheù*—King Nábhi; *jätaù*—took birth; *urukramaù*—the all-powerful Lord; *darçayan*—by showing; *vartma*—the way; *dhéräëäm*—of the perfect beings; *sarva*—all; *äçrama*—orders of life; *namaskâtam*—honored by.

TRANSLATION

The eighth incarnation was King Rsabha, son of King Nábhi and his wife Merudevé. In this incarnation the Lord showed the path of perfection, which is followed by those who have fully controlled their senses and who are honored by all orders of life.

PURPORT

The society of human being is naturally divided into eight by orders and statuses of life—the four divisions of occupation and four divisions of cultural advancement. The intelligent class, the administrative class, the productive class and the laborer class are the four divisions of occupation. And the student life, the householder’s life, retired life and renounced life are the four statuses of cultural advancement towards the path of spiritual realization. Out of these, the renounced order of life, or the order of *sannyäsa*, is considered the highest of all, and a *sannyäse* is constitutionally the spiritual master for all the orders and divisions. In the *sannyäsa* order also there are four stages of upliftment toward perfection. These stages are called *kuticaka*, *bahudaka*, *parivrajakacarya*, and *paramahamsa*. The *paramahamsa* stage of life is the highest stage of perfection. This order of

life is respected by all others. Mahārāja Rsabha, the son of King Nābhi and Merudevé, was an incarnation of the Lord, and He instructed His sons to follow the path of perfection by *tapasya*, which sanctifies one's existence and enables one to attain the stage of spiritual happiness which is eternal and ever increasing. Every living being is searching after happiness, but no one knows where eternal and unlimited happiness is obtainable. Foolish men seek after material sense pleasure as a substitute for real happiness, but such foolish men forget that temporary so-called happiness derived from sense pleasures is also enjoyed by the dogs and hogs. No animal, bird or beast is bereft of this sense pleasure. In every species of life, including the human form of life, such happiness is immensely obtainable. The human form of life, however, is not meant for such cheap happiness. The human life is meant for attaining eternal and unlimited happiness by spiritual realization. This spiritual realization is obtained by *tapasya*, or undergoing voluntarily the path of penance and abstinence from material pleasure. Those who have been trained for abstinence in material pleasures are called *dhéra*, or men undisturbed by the senses. Only these *dhéras* can accept the orders of *sannyāsa*, and they can gradually rise to the status of the *paramahamsa*, which is adored by all members of society. King Rsabha propagated this mission, and at the last stage He became completely aloof from the material bodily needs, which is a rare stage not to be imitated by foolish men, but to be worshiped by all.

TEXT 14

%izi>aYaaRicTaae >aeJae NavMa& PaaiQaRv& vPau")
duGDaeMaaMaezDaqivRPa[aSTaeNaaYa& Sa oXataMa")) 14))

āñibhir yācito bheje

navamaà pārthivaà vapuù

dugdhemām oñadhér vipräs

tenāyaà sa uçattamaù

SYNONYMS

añibhiù—by the sages; *yācitaù*—being prayed for; *bheje*—accepted; *navamam*—the ninth one; *pārthivam*—the ruler of the earth; *vapuù*—body; *dugdha*—milking; *imäm*—all these; *oñadhéù*—products of the earth; *vipräù*—O *brahmanas*; *tena*—by; *ayam*—this; *saù*—he; *uçattamaù*—beautifully attractive.

TRANSLATION

O brahmanas, in the ninth incarnation, the Lord, prayed for by sages, accepted the body of a king [Pāthu] who cultivated the land to yield various produces, and for that reason the earth was beautiful and attractive.

PURPORT

Before the advent of King Pāthu, there was great havoc of maladministration due to the vicious life of the previous king, the father of Mahārāja Pāthu. The intelligent class of men (namely the sages and the *brahmanas*) not only prayed for the Lord to come down, but also dethroned the previous king. It is the duty of the king to be pious and thus look after the all-around welfare of the citizens. Whenever there is some negligence on the part of the king in discharging his duty, the intelligent class of men must dethrone him. The intelligent class of men, however, do not occupy the royal throne, because they have much more important duties for the welfare of the public. Instead of occupying the royal throne, they prayed for the incarnation of the Lord, and the Lord came as Mahārāja Pāthu. Real intelligent men, or qualified *brahmanas*, never aspire for political posts. Mahārāja Pāthu excavated many produces from the earth, and thus not only did the citizens become happy to have such a good king, but the complete sight of the earth also became beautiful and attractive.

TEXT 15

**æPa& Sa JaGa*he MaaTSYa& ca+auzaediDaSaMâve)
NaaVYaaraePYa MahqMaYYaaMaPaaÜEvSvTa& MaNauMa()) 15))**

rüpaà sa jagåhe mätsyaa

cäkñuñodadhi-samplave

nävy äropyā mahé-mayyäm

apäd vaivasvataà manum

SYNONYMS

rüpam—form; *saù*—He; *jagâhe*—accepted; *mätsyam*—of a fish; *cäkñuñä*—Caksusa; *udadhi*—water; *samplave*—inundation; *nävi*—on the boat; *äropyā*—keeping on; *mahé*—the earth; *mayyäm*—drowned in; *apät*—protected; *vaivasvatam*—Vaivasvata; *manum*—Manu, the father of man.

TRANSLATION

When there was a complete inundation after the period of the Caksusa Manu and the whole world was deep within water, the Lord accepted the form of a fish and protected Vaivasvata Manu, keeping him up on a boat.

PURPORT

According to Sripäda Sridhara Svämé, the original commentator on the *Bhägavatam*, there is not always a devastation after the change of every Manu. And yet this inundation after the period of Caksusa Manu took place in order to show some wonders to Satyavrata. But Sri Jiva Gosvami has given definite proofs from authoritative scriptures (like *Viṣṇu-dharmottara*, *Markandeya Purana*, *Harivamsa*, etc.) that there is always a devastation after the end of each and every Manu. Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti has also supported Srila Jiva Gosvami, and he (Sri Cakravarti) has also quoted from *Bhagavatamṛta* about this inundation after each Manu. Apart from this, the Lord, in order to show special favor to Satyavrata, a devotee of the Lord, in this particular period, incarnated Himself.

TEXT 16

**SauraSaura<aaMaudiDa& MaQNaTaa& MaNdracl/Ma()
dDa]e k-Ma#=#æPae<a Pa*i Wk-adXae iv>au")) 16))**

suräsuraëäm udadhia

mathnatäà mandarācalam

dadhre kamaöha-rüpeëa

pãñöha ekādaçe vibhuù

SYNONYMS

sura—the theists; *asuraëäm*—of the atheists; *udadhim*—in the ocean; *mathnatäm*—churning; *mandarācalam*—the Mandaracala Hill; *dadhre*—sustained; *kamaöha*—tortoise; *rüpeëa*—in the form of; *pãñöhe*—shell; *ekādaçe*—the eleventh in the line; *vibhuù*—the great.

TRANSLATION

The eleventh incarnation of the Lord took the form of a tortoise whose shell served as a pivot for the Mandaracala Hill, which was being used as a churning rod by the theists and atheists of the universe.

PURPORT

Once both the atheists and the theists were engaged in producing nectar from the sea so that all of them could become deathless by drinking it. At that time the Mandaracala Hill was used as the churning rod, and the shell of Lord Tortoise, the incarnation of Godhead, became the resting place (pivot) of the hill in the seawater.

TEXT 17

**DaaNvNTar& ÜadXaMa& }aYaaedXaMaMaev c)
APaaYaYaTSauraNaNYaaNMaaeihNYaa MaaehYaNa(iñYaa)) 17))**

dhānvantaraà dvādaçamaà

trayodaçamam eva ca

apāyayat surān anyān

mohinyā mohayan striyā

SYNONYMS

dhānvantaram—the incarnation of Godhead named Dhanvantari;
dvādaçamam—the twelfth in the line; *trayodaçamam*—the thirteenth in the line; *eva*—certainly; *ca*—and; *apāyayat*—gave to drink; *surān*—the demigods; *anyān*—others; *mohinyā*—by charming beauty; *mohayan*—alluring; *striyā*—in the form of a woman.

TRANSLATION

In the twelfth incarnation, the Lord appeared as Dhanvantari, and in the thirteenth He allured the atheists by the charming beauty of a woman and gave nectar to the demigods to drink.

TEXT 18

**cTaudRXa& NaariSa&h& ib>a]ÕETYaeNd]MaUiJaRTaMa()
ddar k-rJaEæraverk-a& k-Ş=k*-ÛQaa)) 18))**

caturdaçaà nārasiàhaà

bibhrad daityendram ūrjitam

dadāra karajair ūrāv

erakāà kaōa-kād yathā

SYNONYMS

caturdaçam—the fourteenth in the line; *nāra-siàham*—the incarnation of the Lord as half-man and half-lion; *bibhrat*—advented; *daitya-indram*—the king of the atheists; *ūrjitam*—strongly built; *dadāra*—bifurcated; *karajaiù*—by the nails; *ūrau*—on the lap; *erakām*—canes; *kaōa-kāt*—carpenter;

yathā—just like.

TRANSLATION

In the fourteenth incarnation, the Lord appeared as Nṛsiṃha and bifurcated the strong body of the atheist Hiraṇyakaśipu with His nails, just as a carpenter pierces cane.

TEXT 19

PaÄdXa& vaMaNak&- k*-TvaGaadßr& ble/")
Pad}aYa& YaacMaaNa" Pa[TYaaidTSauĩĩPaíPaMa()) 19))

pañcadaçaà vämanakaà

kåtvägäd adhvaraà baleù

pada-trayaà yäcamänaù

pratyäditsus tri-piñöapam

SYNONYMS

pañcadaçaṁ—the fifteenth in the line; *vämanakam*—the dwarf *brahmana*; *kåtvä*—by assumption of; *agät*—went; *adhvaram*—arena of sacrifice; *baleù*—of King Bali; *pada-trayam*—three steps only; *yäcamänaù*—begging; *pratyäditsuù*—willing at heart to return; *tri-piñöapam*—the kingdom of the three planetary systems.

TRANSLATION

In the fifteenth incarnation, the Lord assumed the form of a dwarf-*brahmana* [Vämana] and visited the arena of sacrifice arranged by Mahäräja Bali. Although at heart He was willing to regain the kingdom of the three planetary systems, He simply asked for a donation of three steps of land.

PURPORT

The Almighty God can bestow upon anyone the kingdom of the universe from a very small beginning, and similarly, He can take away the kingdom of the universe on the plea of begging a small piece of land.

TEXT 20

**AvTaare zae@XaMae PaXYaNa(b]ød]uhae Na*PaaNa()
i}a"Saák*-Tv" ku-iPaTaae iNa"+a}aaMak-raeNMahqMa()) 20))**

avatäre ñoðaçame

paçyan brahma-druho nâpän

triù-sapta-kâtvaù kupito

niù-kñaträm akaron mahém

SYNONYMS

avatäre—in the incarnation of the Lord; *ñoðaçame*—the sixteenth; *paçyan*—seeing; *brahma-druhaù*—disobedient to the orders of the *brahmanas*; *nâpän*—the kingly order; *triù-sapta*—thrice seven times; *kâtvaù*—had done; *kupitaù*—being engaged; *niù*—negation; *kñaträm*—the administrative class; *akarot*—did perform; *mahém*—the earth.

TRANSLATION

In the sixteenth incarnation of the Godhead, the Lord [as Bhågupati] annihilated the administrative class [kṣatriyas] twenty-one times, being angry with them because of their rebellion against the brahmanas [the intelligent class].

PURPORT

The *kṣatriyas*, or the administrative class of men, are expected to rule the

planet by the direction of the intelligent class of men, who give direction to the rulers in terms of the standard *sastras*, or the books of revealed knowledge. The rulers carry on the administration according to that direction. Whenever there is disobedience on the part of the *kṣatriyas*, or the administrative class, against the orders of the learned and intelligent *brahmanas*, the administrators are removed by force from the posts, and arrangement is made for better administration.

TEXT 21

TaTa" SaádXae JaaTa" SaTYavTYaa& ParaXaraTa()
cŞe- vedTarae" Xaa%a d*îa Pau&Saae_LPaMaeDaSa")) 21))

tataù saptadaçe jâtaù

satyavatyäà parāçarät

cakre veda-taroù çäkhä

dâñövä puàso 'lpa-medhasaù

SYNONYMS

tataù—thereafter; *saptadaçe*—in the seventeenth incarnation; *jâtaù*—advented; *satyavatyäm*—in the womb of Satyavati; *parāçarät*—by Parāçara Muni; *cakre*—prepared; *veda-taroù*—of the desire tree of the *Vedas*; *çäkhäù*—branches; *dâñövä*—be seeing; *puàsaù*—the people in general; *alpa-medhasaù*—less intelligent.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, in the seventeenth incarnation of Godhead, Sri Vyāsadeva appeared in the womb of Satyavati through Parāçara Muni, and he divided the one Veda into several branches and subbranches, seeing that the people in general were less intelligent.

PURPORT

Originally the *Veda* is one. But Srila Vyāsadeva divided the original *Veda* into four, namely *Sāma*, *Yajur*, *Āg*, *Atharva*, and then again they were explained in different branches like the *Puranas* and the *Mahābhārata*. Vedic language and the subject matter are very difficult for ordinary men. They are understood by the highly intelligent and self-realized *brahmanas*. But the present age of Kali is full of ignorant men. Even those who are born by a *brahmana* father are, in the present age, no better than the *sudras* or the women. The twice-born men, namely the *brahmanas*, *kṣatriyas* and *vaishyas*, are expected to undergo a cultural purificatory process known as *saṅskāras*, but because of the bad influence of the present age the so-called members of the *brahmana* and other high-order families are no longer highly cultured. They are called the *dvija-bandhus*, or the friends and family members of the twice-born. But these *dvija-bandhus* are classified amongst the *sudras* and the women. Srila Vyāsadeva divided the *Vedas* into various branches and subbranches for the sake of the less intelligent classes like the *dvija-bandhus*, *sudras* and women.

TEXT 22

NardevTvMaaPaà" Saurk-aYaRick-lzRYaa)
SaMaud]iNaGa]hadqiNa cŞe- vqYaaR<YaTa" ParMa()) 22))

nara-devatvam āpannaù

sura-kārya-cikérñayä

samudra-nigrahädéni

cakre véryäëy ataù param

SYNONYMS

nara—human being; *devatvam*—divinity; *āpannaù*—having assumed the form of; *sura*—the demigods; *kārya*—activities; *cikérñayä*—for the purpose of performing; *samudra*—the Indian Ocean; *nigraha-ädéni*—controlling, etc.; *cakre*—did perform; *véryäëi*—superhuman prowess; *ataù param*—thereafter.

TRANSLATION

In the eighteenth incarnation, the Lord appeared as King Rāma. In order to perform some pleasing work for the demigods, He exhibited superhuman powers by controlling the Indian Ocean and then killing the atheist King Ravana, who was on the other side of the sea.

PURPORT

The Personality of Godhead Sri Rāma assumed the form of a human being and appeared on the earth for the purpose of doing some pleasing work for the demigods or the administrative personalities to maintain the order of the universe. Sometimes great demons and atheists like Ravana and Hiraṇyakaśipu and many others become very famous due to advancing material civilization by the help of material science and other activities with a spirit of challenging the established order of the Lord. For example, the attempt to fly to other planets by material means is a challenge to the established order. The conditions of each and every planet are different, and different classes of human beings are accommodated there for particular purposes mentioned in the codes of the Lord. But, puffed up by tiny success in material advancement, sometimes the godless materialists challenge the existence of God. Ravana was one of them, and he wanted to deport ordinary men to the planet of Indra (heaven) by material means without consideration of the necessary qualifications. He wanted a staircase to be built up directly reaching the heavenly planet so that people might not be required to undergo the routine of pious work necessary to enter that planet. He also wanted to perform other acts against the established rule of the Lord. He even challenged the authority of Sri Rāma, the Personality of Godhead, and kidnapped His wife, Sita. Of course Lord Rāma came to chastise this atheist, answering the prayer and desire of the demigods. He therefore took up the challenge of Ravana, and the complete activity is the subject matter of the *Ramayana*. Because Lord Rāmacandra was the Personality of Godhead, He exhibited superhuman activities which no human being, including the materially advanced Ravana, could perform. Lord Rāmacandra prepared a royal road on the Indian Ocean with stones that floated on the water. The modern scientists have done research in the area of weightlessness, but it is not possible to bring in weightlessness

anywhere and everywhere. But because weightlessness is the creation of the Lord by which He can make the gigantic planets fly and float in the air, He made the stones even within this earth to be weightless and prepared a stone bridge on the sea without any supporting pillar. That is the display of the power of God.

TEXT 23

**Wk-aeNaiv&Xae iv&XaiTaMae v*iZ<azu Pa[aPYa JaNMaNaq)
raMak*-Z<aaiviTa >auvae >aGavaNahrÛrMa()) 23))**

ekonaviàçe viàçatime

vãñëiñu prāpya janmané

rāma-kāñëäv iti bhuvo

bhagavān aharad bharam

SYNONYMS

ekonaviàçe—in the nineteenth; *viàçatime*—in the twentieth also;
vãñëiñu—in the Vãñëi dynasty; *prāpya*—having obtained; *janmané*—births;
rāma—Balarāma; *kāñëäu*—Sri Kṛṣṇa; *iti*—thus; *bhuvaù*—of the world;
bhagavān—the Personality of Godhead; *aharat*—removed; *bharam*—burden.

TRANSLATION

In the nineteenth and twentieth incarnations, the Lord advented Himself as Lord Balarāma and Lord Kṛṣṇa in the family of Vãñëi [the Yadu dynasty], and by so doing He removed the burden of the world.

PURPORT

The specific mention of the word *bhagavān* in this text indicates that Balarāma and Kṛṣṇa are original forms of the Lord. This will be further

explained later. Lord Kṛṣṇa is not an incarnation of the *puruṣa*, as we learned from the beginning of this chapter. He is directly the original Personality of Godhead, and Balarāma is the first plenary manifestation of the Lord. From Baladeva the first phalanx of plenary expansions, Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣṇa, Aniruddha and Pradyumna, expands. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is Vāsudeva, and Baladeva is Saṅkarṣṇa.

TEXT 24

**TaTa" k-l/aE SaMPa[v*tæ SaMMaaehaYa SauriÜzaMa()
buÖae NaaManaÅNaSauTa" k-lk-Şe=zu >aivZYaiTa)) 24))**

tataù kalau sampravåtte

sammohäya sura-dviñäm

buddho nämnäijana-sutaù

kékaöeñu bhaviñyati

SYNONYMS

tataù—thereafter; *kalau*—the age of Kali; *sampravåtte*—having ensued; *sammohäya*—for the purpose of deluding; *sura*—the theists; *dviñäm*—those who are envious; *buddhaù*—Lord Buddha; *nämnä*—of the name; *aijana-sutaù*—whose mother was Aijanä; *kékaöeñu*—in the province of Gayä (Bihar); *bhaviñyati*—will take place.

TRANSLATION

Then, in the beginning of Kali-yuga, the Lord will appear as Lord Buddha, the son of Aijanä, in the province of Gayä, just for the purpose of deluding those who are envious of the faithful theist.

PURPORT

Lord Buddha, a powerful incarnation of the Personality of Godhead,

appeared in the province of Gayā (Bihar) as the son of Aijānā, and he preached his own conception of nonviolence and deprecated even the animal sacrifices sanctioned in the *Vedas*. At the time when Lord Buddha appeared, the people in general were atheistic and preferred animal flesh to anything else. On the plea of Vedic sacrifice, every place was practically turned into a slaughterhouse, and animal-killing was indulged in unrestrictedly. Lord Buddha preached nonviolence, taking pity on the poor animals. He preached that he did not believe in the tenets of the *Vedas* and stressed the adverse psychological effects incurred by animal-killing. Less intelligent men of the age of Kali, who had no faith in God, followed his principle, and for the time being they were trained in moral discipline and nonviolence, the preliminary steps for proceeding further on the path of God realization. He deluded the atheists because such atheists who followed his principles did not believe in God, but they kept their absolute faith in Lord Buddha, who himself was the incarnation of God. Thus the faithless people were made to believe in God in the form of Lord Buddha. That was the mercy of Lord Buddha: he made the faithless faithful to him.

Killing of animals before the advent of Lord Buddha was the most prominent feature of the society. People claimed that these were Vedic sacrifices. When the *Vedas* are not accepted through the authoritative disciplic succession, the casual readers of the *Vedas* are misled by the flowery language of that system of knowledge. In the *Bhagavad-gita* a comment has been made on such foolish scholars (*avipaścitaù*). The foolish scholars of Vedic literature who do not care to receive the transcendental message through the transcendental realized sources of disciplic succession are sure to be bewildered. To them, the ritualistic ceremonies are considered to be all in all. They have no depth of knowledge. According to the *Bhagavad-gita* (15.15), *vedaḥ ca sarvair aham eva vedyàù*: the whole system of the *Vedas* is to lead one gradually to the path of the Supreme Lord. The whole theme of Vedic literature is to know the Supreme Lord, the individual soul, the cosmic situation and the relation between all these items. When the relation is known, the relative function begins, and as a result of such a function the ultimate goal of life or going back to Godhead takes place in the easiest manner. Unfortunately, unauthorized scholars of the *Vedas* become captivated by the purificatory ceremonies only, and natural progress is thereby checked.

To such bewildered persons of atheistic propensity, Lord Buddha is the emblem of theism. He therefore first of all wanted to check the habit of animal-killing. The animal-killers are dangerous elements on the path going back to Godhead. There are two types of animal-killers. The soul is also sometimes called the “animal” or the living being. Therefore, both the slaughterer of animals and those who have lost their identity of soul are animal-killers.

Mahārāja Parékñit said that only the animal-killer cannot relish the transcendental message of the Supreme Lord. Therefore if people are to be educated to the path of Godhead, they must be taught first and foremost to *stop the process of animal-killing* as above mentioned. *It is nonsensical to say that animal-killing has nothing to do with spiritual realization.* By this dangerous theory many so-called *sannyāsés* have sprung up by the grace of Kali-yuga who preach animal-killing under the garb of the *Vedas*. The subject matter has already been discussed in the conversation between Lord Caitanya and Maulana Chand Kazi Shaheb. The animal sacrifice as stated in the *Vedas* is different from the unrestricted animal-killing in the slaughterhouse. Because the *asuras* or the so-called scholars of Vedic literatures put forward the evidence of animal-killing in the *Vedas*, Lord Buddha superficially denied the authority of the *Vedas*. This rejection of the *Vedas* by Lord Buddha was adopted in order to save people from the vice of animal-killing as well as to save the poor animals from the slaughtering process of their big brothers who clamor for universal brotherhood, peace, justice and equity. There is no justice when there is animal-killing. Lord Buddha wanted to stop it completely, and therefore his cult of *ahiāsā* was propagated not only in India but also outside the country.

Technically Lord Buddha’s philosophy is called atheistic because there is no acceptance of the Supreme Lord and because that system of philosophy denied the authority of the *Vedas*. But that is an act of camouflage by the Lord. Lord Buddha is the incarnation of Godhead. As such, he is the original propounder of Vedic knowledge. He therefore cannot reject Vedic philosophy. But he rejected it outwardly because the *sura-dviñā*, or the demons who are always envious of the devotees of Godhead, try to support cow-killing or animal-killing from the pages of the *Vedas*, and this is now being done by the modernized *sannyāsés*. Lord Buddha had to reject the

authority of the *Vedas* altogether. This is simply technical, and had it not been so he would not have been so accepted as the incarnation of Godhead. Nor would he have been worshiped in the transcendental songs of the poet Jayadeva, who is a *Vaiñëava äcärya*. Lord Buddha preached the preliminary principles of the *Vedas* in a manner suitable for the time being (and so also did Çaikaräcärya) to establish the authority of the *Vedas*. Therefore both Lord Buddha and Äcärya Çaikara paved the path of theism, and *Vaiñëava äcäryas*, specifically Lord Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu, led the people on the path towards a realization of going back to Godhead.

We are glad that people are taking interest in the nonviolent movement of Lord Buddha. But will they take the matter very seriously and close the animal slaughterhouses altogether? If not, there is no meaning to the *ahiäsä* cult.

Srimad-Bhagavatam was composed just prior to the beginning of the age of Kali (about five thousand years ago), and Lord Buddha appeared about twenty-six hundred years ago. Therefore in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* Lord Buddha is foretold. Such is the authority of this clear scripture. There are many such prophecies, and they are being fulfilled one after another. They will indicate the positive standing of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, which is without *trace of mistake, illusion, cheating and imperfection*, which are the four flaws of all conditioned souls. The liberated souls are above these flaws; therefore they can see and foretell things which are to take place on distant future dates.

TEXT 25

**AQaaSaaE YauGaSaNDYaaYaa& dSYauPa[aYaezu raJaSau)
JaiNaTaa ivZ<auYaXaSaae NaaMana k-iLk-JaRGaTPaiTa")) 25))**

athäsau yuga-sandhyäyää

dasyu-präyeñu räjasu

janitä viṣṇu-yaçaso

nāmnä kalkir jagat-patiù

SYNONYMS

atha—thereafter; *asau*—the same Lord; *yuga-sandhyäyäm*—at the conjunction of the *yugas*; *dasyu*—plunderers; *präyeñu*—almost all; *räjasu*—the governing personalities; *janitä*—will take His birth; *viṣṇu*—named Viṣṇu; *yaçasaù*—surnamed Yaçä; *nāmnä*—in the name of; *kalkiù*—the incarnation of the Lord; *jagat-patiù*—the Lord of the creation.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, at the conjunction of two yugas, the Lord of the creation will take His birth as the Kalki incarnation and become the son of Viṣṇu Yaçä. At this time the rulers of the earth will have degenerated into plunderers.

PURPORT

Here is another foretelling of the advent of Lord Kalki, the incarnation of Godhead. He is to appear at the conjunction of the two *yugas*, namely at the end of Kali-yuga and the beginning of Satya-yuga. The cycle of the four *yugas*, namely Satya, Tretä, Dväpara and Kali, rotates like the calendar months. The present Kali-yuga lasts 432,000 years, out of which we have passed only 5,000 years after the Battle of Kurukñetra and the end of the regime of King Parékñit. So there are 427,000 years balance yet to be finished. Therefore at the end of this period, the incarnation of Kalki will take place, as foretold in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. The name of His father, Viṣṇu Yaçä, a learned *brahmana*, and the village Çambhala are also mentioned. As above mentioned, all these foretellings will prove to be factual in chronological order. That is the authority of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 26

**AvTaara ùSa&:YaeYaa hre" SatviNaDaeiÜRJaa")
YaQaaivdaiSaNa" ku-LYaa" SarSa" SYau" SahóXa")) 26))**

avatärä hy asaìkhyeyä

hareù sattva-nidher dvijäù

yathävidäsinaù kulyäù

sarasaù syuù sahasraçaù

SYNONYMS

avatäräù—incarnations; *hi*—certainly; *asaikhyeyäù*—innumerable; *hareù*—of Hari, the Lord; *sattva-nidheù*—of the ocean of goodness; *dvijäù*—the *brahmanas*; *yathä*—as it is; *avidäsinaù*—inexhaustible; *kulyäù*—rivulets; *sarasaù*—of vast lakes; *syuù*—are; *sahasraçaù*—thousands of.

TRANSLATION

O brahmanas, the incarnations of the Lord are innumerable, like rivulets flowing from inexhaustible sources of water.

PURPORT

The list of incarnations of the Personality of Godhead given herein is not complete. It is only a partial view of all the incarnations. There are many others, such as Sri Hayagräva, Hari, Haäsa, Påñigarbha, Vibhu, Satyasena, Vaikuntha, Sarvabhauma, Visvaksena, Dharmasetu, Sudhama, Yogesvara, Brhadbhanu and others of the bygone ages. Sri Prahläda Mahäräja said in his prayer, “My Lord, You manifest as many incarnations as there are species of life, namely the aquatics, the vegetables, the reptiles, the birds, the beasts, the men, the demigods, etc., just for the maintenance of the faithful and the annihilation of the unfaithful. You advent Yourself in this way in accordance with the necessity of the different *yugas*. In the Kali-yuga You have incarnated garbed as a devotee.” This incarnation of the Lord in the Kali-yuga is Lord Caitanya Mahäprabhu. There are many other places, both in the *Bhägavatam* and in other scriptures, in which the incarnation of the Lord as Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu is explicitly mentioned. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā* also it is said indirectly that although there are many incarnations of the Lord, such as Rāma, Nṛsiṁha, Varāha, Matsya, Kūrma and many others, the Lord Himself sometimes incarnates in person.

Lord Kṛṣṇa and Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu are not, therefore, incarnations, but the original source of all other incarnations. This will be clearly explained in the next *çloka*. So the Lord is the inexhaustible source for innumerable incarnations which are not always mentioned. But such incarnations are distinguished by specific extraordinary feats which are impossible to be performed by any living being. That is the general test to identify an incarnation of the Lord, directly and indirectly empowered. Some incarnations mentioned above are almost plenary portions. For instance, the Kumāras are empowered with transcendental knowledge. Sri Nārada is empowered with devotional service. Mahārāja Pāthu is an empowered incarnation with executive function. The Matsya incarnation is directly a plenary portion. So the innumerable incarnations of the Lord are manifested all over the universes constantly, without cessation, as water flows constantly from waterfalls.

TEXT 27

%zYaae MaNavae deva MaNauPau}aa MahaEJaSa")
k-l/a" SaveR hrerev SaPa[JaaPaTaYa" SMa*Taa")) 27))

āñayo manavo devā

manu-putrā mahaujasaù

kaläù sarve harer eva

saprajāpatayaù smätäù

SYNONYMS

āñayaù—all the sages; *manavaù*—all the Manus; *deväù*—all the demigods; *manu-puträù*—all the descendants of Manu; *mahä-ojasaù*—very powerful; *kaläù*—portion of the plenary portion; *sarve*—all collectively; *hareù*—of the Lord; *eva*—certainly; *sa-prajāpatayaù*—along with the Prajāpatīs; *smätäù*—are known.

TRANSLATION

All the āñis, Manus, demigods and descendants of Manu, who are especially powerful, are plenary portions or portions of the plenary portions of the Lord. This also includes the Prajāpatis.

PURPORT

Those who are comparatively less powerful are called *vibhūti*, and those who are comparatively more powerful are called *āveṣa* incarnations.

TEXT 28

WTae ca&Xak-I/a" Pau&Sa" k*-Z<aSTau >aGavaNa(SvYaMa()
wNd]airVYaaku-l&/ I/aek&- Ma*@YaiNTa YauGae YauGae)) 28))

ete cāṇṇa-kalāu puṇṇa

kāñṇas tu bhagavān svayam

indrāri-vyākulaḥ lokaḥ

mādayanti yuge yuge

SYNONYMS

ete—all these; *ca*—and; *aṇṇa*—plenary portions; *kalāu*—portions of the plenary portions; *puṇṇa*—of the Supreme; *kāñṇa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *tu*—but; *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *svayam*—in person; *indra-ari*—the enemies of Indra; *vyākulam*—disturbed; *lokam*—all the planets; *mādayanti*—gives protection; *yuge yuge*—in different ages.

TRANSLATION

All of the above-mentioned incarnations are either plenary portions or portions of the plenary portions of the Lord, but Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the original Personality of Godhead. All of them appear on planets whenever there is a disturbance created by the atheists. The Lord incarnates to protect the theists.

PURPORT

In this particular stanza Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, is distinguished from other incarnations. He is counted amongst the *avatāras* (incarnations) because out of His causeless mercy the Lord descends from His transcendental abode. *Avatāra* means “one who descends.” All the incarnations of the Lord, including the Lord Himself, descend on the different planets of the material world as also in different species of life to fulfill particular missions. Sometimes He comes Himself, and sometimes His different plenary portions or parts of the plenary portions, or His differentiated portions directly or indirectly empowered by Him, descend on this material world to execute certain specific functions. Originally the Lord is full of all opulences, all prowess, all fame, all beauty, all knowledge and all renunciation. When they are partly manifested through the plenary portions or parts of the plenary portions, it should be noted that certain manifestations of His different powers are required for those particular functions. When in the room small electric bulbs are displayed, it does not mean that the electric powerhouse is limited by the small bulbs. The same powerhouse can supply power to operate large-scale industrial dynamos with greater volts. Similarly, the incarnations of the Lord display limited powers because so much power is needed at that particular time.

For example, Lord Paraçurāma and Lord Nṛsiṃha displayed unusual opulence by killing the disobedient *kṣatriyas* twenty-one times and killing the greatly powerful atheist Hiraṇyakaśipu. Hiraṇyakaśipu was so powerful that even the demigods in other planets would tremble simply by the unfavorable raising of his eyebrow. The demigods in the higher level of material existence many, many times excel the most well-to-do human beings, in duration of life, beauty, wealth, paraphernalia, and in all other respects. Still they were afraid of Hiraṇyakaśipu. Thus we can simply imagine how powerful Hiraṇyakaśipu was in this material world. But even Hiraṇyakaśipu was cut into small pieces by the nails of Lord Nṛsiṃha. This means that anyone materially powerful cannot stand the strength of the Lord’s nails. Similarly, Jāmadagnya displayed the Lord’s power to kill all the disobedient kings powerfully situated in their respective states. The Lord’s empowered incarnation Nārada and plenary incarnation Varāha, as well as indirectly empowered Lord Buddha, created faith in the mass of people.

The incarnations of Rāma and Dhanvantari displayed His fame, and Balarāma, Mohiné and Vāmana exhibited His beauty. Dattatreya, Matsya, Kumāra and Kapila exhibited His transcendental knowledge. Nara and Nārāyaṇa Rsis exhibited His renunciation. So all the different incarnations of the Lord indirectly or directly manifested different features, but Lord Kṛṣṇa, the primeval Lord, exhibited the complete features of Godhead, and thus it is confirmed that He is the source of all other incarnations. And the most extraordinary feature exhibited by Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa was His internal energetic manifestation of His pastimes with the cowherd girls. His pastimes with the *gopés* are all displays of transcendental existence, bliss and knowledge, although these are manifested apparently as sex love. The specific attraction of His pastimes with the *gopés* should never be misunderstood. The *Bhāgavatam* relates these transcendental pastimes in the Tenth Canto. And in order to reach the position to understand the transcendental nature of Lord Kṛṣṇa's pastimes with the *gopés*, the *Bhāgavatam* promotes the student gradually in nine other cantos.

According to Srila Jiva Gosvami's statement, in accordance with authoritative sources, Lord Kṛṣṇa is the source of all other incarnations. It is not that Lord Kṛṣṇa has any source of incarnation. All the symptoms of the Supreme Truth in full are present in the person of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and in the *Bhagavad-gītā* the Lord emphatically declares that there is no truth greater than or equal to Himself. In this stanza the word *svayam* is particularly mentioned to confirm that Lord Kṛṣṇa has no other source than Himself. Although in other places the incarnations are described as *bhagavān* because of their specific functions, nowhere are they declared to be the Supreme Personality. In this stanza the word *svayam* signifies the supremacy as the *summum bonum*.

The *summum bonum* Kṛṣṇa is one without a second. He Himself has expanded Himself in various parts, portions and particles as *svayaṁ-rūpa*, *svayam-prakāṣa*, *tad-ekātmā*, *prābhava*, *vaibhava*, *vilāsa*, *avatāra*, *āveṣa*, and *jivas*, all provided with innumerable energies just suitable to the respective persons and personalities. Learned scholars in transcendental subjects have carefully analyzed the *summum bonum* Kṛṣṇa to have sixty-four principal attributes. All the expansions or categories of the Lord possess only some percentages of these attributes. But Sri Kṛṣṇa is the

possessor of the attributes cent percent. And His personal expansions such as *svayam-prakāṣa*, *tad-ekātmā* up to the categories of the *avatāras* who are all *viṣṇu-tattva*, possess up to ninety-three percent of these transcendental attributes. Lord Siva, who is neither *avatāra* nor *āveṣa* nor in between them, possesses almost eighty-four percent of the attributes. But the *jivas*, or the individual living beings in different statuses of life, possess up to the limit of seventy-eight percent of the attributes. In the conditioned state of material existence, the living being possesses these attributes in very minute quantity, varying in terms of the pious life of the living being. The most perfect of living beings is Brahmā, the supreme administrator of one universe. He possesses seventy-eight percent of the attributes in full. All other demigods have the same attributes in less quantity, whereas human beings possess the attributes in very minute quantity. The standard of perfection for a human being is to develop the attributes up to seventy-eight percent in full. The living being can never possess attributes like Siva, Viṣṇu or Lord Kṛṣṇa. A living being can become godly by developing the seventy-eight-percent transcendental attributes in fullness, but he can never become a God like Siva, Viṣṇu or Kṛṣṇa. He can become a Brahmā in due course. The godly living beings who are all residents of the planets in the spiritual sky are eternal associates of God in different spiritual planets called Hari-dhāma and Maheṣa-dhāma. The abode of Lord Kṛṣṇa above all spiritual planets is called Kṛṣṇaloka or Goloka Vāndāvana, and the perfected living being, by developing seventy-eight percent of the above attributes in fullness, can enter the planet of Kṛṣṇaloka after leaving the present material body.

TEXT 29

**JaNMā Gauṇ& >aGavTaaē Ya WTaTPa[YaTaaē Nar")
SaaYa& Pa[aTaGa*R<aNa(>aḥ-ya du"%Ga]aMaaiÜMauCYaTae)) 29))**

janma guhyaà bhagavato

ya etat prayato naraù

sāyaà prātar gāēan bhaktyä

duùkha-grämäd vimucyate

SYNONYMS

janma—birth; *guhyam*—mysterious; *bhagavataù*—of the Lord; *yaù*—one; *etat*—all these; *prayataù*—carefully; *naraù*—man; *säyam*—evening; *prätaù*—morning; *gãëan*—recites; *bhaktyä*—with devotion; *duùkha-grämät*—from all miseries; *vimucyate*—gets relief from.

TRANSLATION

Whoever carefully recites the mysterious appearances of the Lord, with devotion in the morning and in the evening, gets relief from all miseries of life.

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gita* the Personality of Godhead has declared that anyone who knows the principles of the transcendental birth and activities of the Lord will go back to Godhead after being relieved from this material tabernacle. So simply knowing factually the mysterious way of the Lord's incarnation in this material world can liberate one from material bondage. Therefore the birth and activities of the Lord, as manifested by Him for the welfare of the people in general, are not ordinary. They are mysterious, and only by those who carefully try to go deep into the matter by spiritual devotion is the mystery discovered. Thus one gets liberation from material bondage. It is advised therefore that one who simply recites this chapter of *Bhägavatam*, describing the appearance of the Lord in different incarnations, in sincerity and devotion, can have insight into the birth and activities of the Lord. The very word *vimukti*, or liberation, indicates that the Lord's birth and activities are all transcendental; otherwise simply by reciting them one could not attain liberation. They are therefore mysterious, and those who do not follow the prescribed regulations of devotional service are not entitled to enter into the mysteries of His births and activities.

TEXT 30

WTad]UPa& >aGavTaae ùæPaSYa icdaTMaNa")
MaaYaaGau<aEivRricTa& Mahdaidi>araTMaiNa)) 30))

etat rūpaà bhagavato

hy arūpasya cid-ātmanaù

māyā-guëair viracitaà

mahadādibhir ātmani

SYNONYMS

etat—all these; *rūpa*—forms; *bhagavataù*—of the Lord; *hi*—certainly; *arūpasya*—of one who has no material form; *cit-ātmanaù*—of the Transcendence; *māyā*—material energy; *guëaiù*—by the qualities; *viracitam*—manufactured; *mahat-ādibhiù*—with the ingredients of matter; *ātmani*—in the self.

TRANSLATION

The conception of the viräo universal form of the Lord, as appearing in the material world, is imaginary. It is to enable the less intelligent [and neophytes] to adjust to the idea of the Lord's having form. But factually the Lord has no material form.

PURPORT

The conception of the Lord known as the *viçva-rūpa* or the *virāt-rūpa* is particularly not mentioned along with the various incarnations of the Lord because all the incarnations of the Lord mentioned above are transcendental and there is not a tinge of materialism in their bodies. There is no difference between the body and self as there is in the conditioned soul. The *virāt-rūpa* is conceived for those who are just neophyte worshipers. For them the material *virāt-rūpa* is presented, and it will be explained in the Second Canto. In the *virāt-rūpa* the material manifestations of different planets have been conceived as His legs, hands,

etc. Actually all such descriptions are for the neophytes. The neophytes cannot conceive of anything beyond matter. The material conception of the Lord is not counted in the list of His factual forms. As Paramātmā, or Supersoul, the Lord is within each and every material form, even within the atoms, but the outward material form is but an imagination, both for the Lord and for the living being. The present forms of the conditioned souls are also not factual. The conclusion is that the material conception of the body of the Lord as *virāḍ* is imaginary. Both the Lord and the living beings are living spirits and have original spiritual bodies.

TEXT 31

YaQaa Na>aiSa MaegaaEgaae re<auvaR PaaiQaRvae_iNale/)
Wv& d]iir d*XYaTvMaaraeiPaTaMabuiÖi>a")) 31))

yathä nabhasi meghaugho

reëur vä pärvhivo 'nile

evaà drañöari dāçyatvam

äropitam abuddhibhiù

SYNONYMS

yathä—as it is; *nabhasi*—in the sky; *megha-oghaù*—a mass of clouds; *reëuù*—dust; *vä*—as well as; *pärvhivaù*—muddiness; *anile*—in the air; *evam*—thus; *drañöari*—to the seer; *dāçyatvam*—for the purpose of seeing; *äropitam*—is implied; *abuddhibhiù*—by the less intelligent persons.

TRANSLATION

Clouds and dust are carried by the air, but less intelligent persons say that the sky is cloudy and the air is dirty. Similarly, they also implant material bodily conceptions on the spirit self.

PURPORT

It is further confirmed herein that with our material eyes and senses we cannot see the Lord, who is all spirit. We cannot even detect the spiritual spark which exists within the material body of the living being. We look to the outward covering of the body or subtle mind of the living being, but we cannot see the spiritual spark within the body. So we have to accept the living being's presence by the presence of his gross body. Similarly, those who want to see the Lord with their present material eyes or with the material senses are advised to meditate on the gigantic external feature called the *virāṭ-rūpa*. For instance, when a particular gentleman goes in his car, which can be seen very easily, we identify the car with the man within the car. When the President goes out in his particular car, we say, "There is the President." For the time being we identify the car with the President. Similarly, less intelligent men who want to see God immediately without necessary qualification are shown first the gigantic material cosmos as the form of the Lord, although the Lord is within and without. The clouds in the sky and the blue of the sky are better appreciated in this connection. Although the bluish tint of the sky and the sky itself are different, we conceive of the color of the sky as blue. But that is a general conception for the laymen only.

TEXT 32

**ATa" Par& YadVYaç-MaVYaU!Gau<ab*&ihTaMa()
Ad*íaé[uTavSTauTvaTSa Jaqvae YaTPauNa>aRv")) 32))**

ataù paraà yad avyaktam

avyüòha-guëa-båàhitam

adåñöäçruta-vastutvāt

sa jévo yat punar-bhavaù

SYNONYMS

ataù—this; *param*—beyond; *yat*—which; *avyaktam*—unmanifested; *avyüòha*—without formal shape; *guëa-båàhitam*—affected by the

qualities; *adāñña*—unseen; *açruta*—unheard; *vastutvāt*—being like that; *saù*—that; *jévaù*—living being; *yat*—that which; *punaù-bhavaù*—takes birth repeatedly.

TRANSLATION

Beyond this gross conception of form is another, subtle conception of form which is without formal shape and is unseen, unheard and unmanifest. The living being has his form beyond this subtlety, otherwise he could not have repeated births.

PURPORT

As the gross cosmic manifestation is conceived as the gigantic body of the Lord, so also there is the conception of His subtle form, which is simply realized without being seen, heard or manifested. But in fact all these gross or subtle conceptions of the body are in relation with the living beings. The living being has his spiritual form beyond this gross material or subtle psychic existence. The gross body and psychic functions cease to act as soon as the living being leaves the visible gross body. In fact, we say that the living being has gone away because he is unseen and unheard. Even when the gross body is not acting when the living being is in sound sleep, we know that he is within the body by his breathing. So the living being's passing away from the body does not mean that there is no existence of the living soul. It is there, otherwise how can he repeat his births again and again?

The conclusion is that the Lord is eternally existent in His transcendental form, which is neither gross nor subtle like that of the living being; His body is never to be compared to the gross and subtle bodies of the living being. All such conceptions of God's body are imaginary. The living being has his eternal spiritual form, which is conditioned only by his material contamination.

TEXT 33

Ya}aeMae SadSad]UPae Pa[iTaizÖe SvSa&ivda)

AivÔYaaTMaiNa k*-Tae wiTa Tad(b]ødXaRNaMa()) 33))

yatrema sad-asad-rüpe

pratiñiddhe sva-saàvidä

avidyayätmani kâte

iti tad brahma-darçanam

SYNONYMS

yatra—whenever; *ime*—in all these; *sat-asat*—gross and subtle; *rüpe*—in the forms of; *pratiñiddhe*—on being nullified; *sva-saàvidä*—by self-realization; *avidyayä*—by ignorance; *ätmani*—in the self; *kâte*—having been imposed; *iti*—thus; *tat*—that is; *brahma-darçanam*—the process of seeing the Absolute.

TRANSLATION

Whenever a person experiences, by self-realization, that both the gross and subtle bodies have nothing to do with the pure self, at that time he sees himself as well as the Lord.

PURPORT

The difference between self-realization and material illusion is to know that the temporary or illusory impositions of material energy in the shape of gross and subtle bodies are superficial coverings of the self. The coverings take place due to ignorance. Such coverings are never effective in the person of the Personality of Godhead. Knowing this convincingly is called liberation, or seeing the Absolute. This means that perfect self-realization is made possible by adoption of godly or spiritual life. Self-realization means becoming indifferent to the needs of the gross and subtle bodies and becoming serious about the activities of the self. The impetus for activities is generated from the self, but such activities become illusory due to ignorance of the real position of the self. By ignorance, self-interest is

calculated in terms of the gross and subtle bodies, and therefore a whole set of activities is spoiled, life after life. When, however, one meets the self by proper culture, the activities of the self begin. Therefore a man who is engaged in the activities of the self is called *jévan-mukta*, or a liberated person even in the conditional existence.

This perfect stage of self-realization is attained not by artificial means, but under the lotus feet of the Lord, who is always transcendental. In the *Bhagavad-gita* the Lord says that He is present in everyone's heart, and from Him only all knowledge, remembrance or forgetfulness take place. When the living being desires to be an enjoyer of material energy (illusory phenomena), the Lord covers the living being in the mystery of forgetfulness, and thus the living being misinterprets the gross body and subtle mind to be his own self. And by culture of transcendental knowledge, when the living being prays to the Lord for deliverance from the clutches of forgetfulness, the Lord, by His causeless mercy, removes the living being's illusory curtain, and thus he realizes his own self. He then engages himself in the service of the Lord in his eternal constitutional position, becoming liberated from the conditioned life. All this is executed by the Lord either through His external potency or directly by the internal potency.

TEXT 34

**YaÛezaeParTaa devq MaaYaa vEXaardq MaiTa")
SaMPaà WveiTa ivduMaRihiMan Sve MahqYaTae)) 34))**

yady eñoparatä devé

mäyā vaiçäradé matiù

sampanna eveti vidur

mahimni sve mahéyate

SYNONYMS

yadi—if, however; *eñä*—they; *uparatä*—subsided; *devé mäyä*—illusory energy; *vaiçäradé*—full of knowledge; *matiù*—enlightenment; *sampannaù*—enriched with; *eva*—certainly; *iti*—thus; *viduù*—being cognizant of; *mahimni*—in the glories; *sve*—of the self; *mahéyate*—being situated in.

TRANSLATION

If the illusory energy subsides and the living entity becomes fully enriched with knowledge by the grace of the Lord, then he becomes at once enlightened with self-realization and thus becomes situated in his own glory.

PURPORT

Because the Lord is the absolute Transcendence, all of His forms, names, pastimes, attributes, associates and energies are identical with Him. His transcendental energy acts according to His omnipotency. The same energy acts as His external, internal and marginal energies, and by His omnipotency He can perform anything and everything through the agency of any of the above energies. He can turn the external energy into internal by His will. Therefore by His grace the external energy, which is employed in illusioning those living beings who want to have it, subsides by the will of the Lord in terms of repentance and penance for the conditioned soul. And the very same energy then acts to help the purified living being make progress on the path of self-realization. The example of electrical energy is very appropriate in this connection. The expert electrician can utilize the electrical energy for both heating and cooling by adjustment only. Similarly, the external energy, which now bewilders the living being into continuation of birth and death, is turned into internal potency by the will of the Lord to lead the living being to eternal life. When a living being is thus graced by the Lord, he is placed in his proper constitutional position to enjoy eternal spiritual life.

TEXT 35

Wv& JaNMaaiNa k-MaaRi<a ùk-TauRrJaNaSYa c)

v<aRYaiNTa SMa k-vYaae vedGauùaiNa ôTPaTae")) 35))

evaà janmäni karmäi

hy akartur ajanasya ca

varëayanti sma kavayo

veda-guhyäni hât-pateù

SYNONYMS

evam—thus; *janmäni*—birth; *karmäi*—activities; *hi*—certainly; *akartuù*—of the inactive; *ajanasya*—of the unborn; *ca*—and; *varëayanti*—describe; *sma*—in the past; *kavayaù*—the learned; *veda-guhyäni*—undiscoverable by the *Vedas*; *hât-pateù*—of the Lord of the heart.

TRANSLATION

Thus learned men describe the births and activities of the unborn and inactive, which is undiscoverable even in the Vedic literatures. He is the Lord of the heart.

PURPORT

Both the Lord and the living entities are essentially all spiritual. Therefore both of them are eternal, and neither of them has birth and death. The difference is that the so-called births and disappearances of the Lord are unlike those of the living beings. The living beings who take birth and then again accept death are bound by the laws of material nature. But the so-called appearance and disappearance of the Lord are not actions of material nature, but are demonstrations of the internal potency of the Lord. They are described by the great sages for the purpose of self-realization. It is stated in the *Bhagavad-gita* by the Lord that His so-called birth in the material world and His activities are all transcendental. And simply by meditation on such activities one can attain realization of Brahman and thus become liberated from material bondage. In the *śrutis* it

is said that the birthless appears to take birth. The Supreme has nothing to do, but because He is omnipotent, everything is performed by Him naturally, as if done automatically. As a matter of fact, the appearance and disappearance of the Supreme Personality of Godhead and His different activities are all confidential, even to the Vedic literatures. Yet they are displayed by the Lord to bestow mercy upon the conditioned souls. We should always take advantage of the narrations of the activities of the Lord, which are meditations on Brahman in the most convenient and palatable form.

TEXT 36

Sa va wd& iviMaMaaegal/Il/"
Sa*JaTYavTYaita Na SaÂTae_iSMaNa()
>aUTaezu caNTaihRTa AaTMaTaN}a"
zaÍiGaRk&- iJaga]iTa z@(Gau<aeXa")) 36))

sa vä idaà viçvam amogha-lélaù

sâjaty avaty atti na sajjate 'smin

bhüteñu cântarhita âtma-tantraù

ñäö-vargikaà jighrati ñaö-guëëçaù

SYNONYMS

saù—the Supreme Lord; *vä*—alternately; *idam*—this; *viçvam*—manifested universes; *amogha-lélaù*—one whose activities are spotless; *sâjati*—creates; *avati atti*—maintains and annihilates; *na*—not; *sajjate*—is affected by; *asmin*—in them; *bhüteñu*—in all living beings; *ca*—also; *antarhitaù*—living within; *âtma-tantraù*—self-independent; *ñäö-vargikam*—endowed with all the potencies of His opulences; *jighrati*—superficially attached, like smelling the fragrance; *ñaö-guëa-éçaù*—master of the six senses.

TRANSLATION

The Lord, whose activities are always spotless, is the master of the six senses and is fully omnipotent with six opulences. He creates the manifested universes, maintains them and annihilates them without being in the least affected. He is within every living being and is always independent.

PURPORT

The prime difference between the Lord and the living entities is that the Lord is the creator and the living entities are the created. Here He is called the *amogha-lélaù*, which indicates that there is nothing lamentable in His creation. Those who create disturbance in His creation are themselves disturbed. He is transcendental to all material afflictions because He is full with all six opulences, namely wealth, power, fame, beauty, knowledge and renunciation, and thus He is the master of the senses. He creates these manifested universes in order to reclaim the living beings who are within them suffering threefold miseries, maintains them, and in due course annihilates them without being the least affected by such actions. He is connected with this material creation very superficially, as one smells odor without being connected with the odorous article. Nongodly elements, therefore, can never approach Him, despite all endeavors.

TEXT 37

**Na caSYa k-iêiàPau<aeNa DaaTau,
rvEiTa JaNTau" ku-MaNaz OTaq")
NaaMaaiNa æPai<a MaNaaevcaei>a"
SaNTaNvTaa Na\$=cYaaRiMavaj")) 37))**

na cäsya kaçcin nipuëena dhätur

avaiti jantuù kumanéña ütèù

nämäni rüpäëi mano-vacobhiù

santanvato naöa-caryäm iväjiàù

SYNONYMS

na—not; *ca*—and; *asya*—of Him; *kaçcit*—anyone; *nipuëena*—by dexterity; *dhātuu*—of the creator; *avaiti*—can know; *jantuù*—the living being; *kumanéññaù*—with a poor fund of knowledge; *ütéù*—activities of the Lord; *nāmāni*—His names; *rüpäëi*—His forms; *manaù-vacobhiù*—by dint of mental speculation or deliverance of speeches; *santanvataù*—displaying; *naöa-caryäm*—a dramatic action; *iva*—like; *ajjaù*—the foolish.

TRANSLATION

The foolish with a poor fund of knowledge cannot know the transcendental nature of the forms, names and activities of the Lord, who is playing like an actor in a drama. Nor can they express such things, neither in their speculations nor in their words.

PURPORT

No one can properly describe the transcendental nature of the Absolute Truth. Therefore it is said that He is beyond the expression of mind and speech. And yet there are some men, with a poor fund of knowledge, who desire to understand the Absolute Truth by imperfect mental speculation and faulty description of His activities. To the layman His activities, appearance and disappearance, His names, His forms, His paraphernalia, His personalities and all things in relation with Him are mysterious. There are two classes of materialists, namely the fruitive workers and the empiric philosophers. The fruitive workers have practically no information of the Absolute Truth, and the mental speculators, after being frustrated in fruitive activities, turn their faces towards the Absolute Truth and try to know Him by mental speculation. And for all these men, the Absolute Truth is a mystery, as the jugglery of the magician is a mystery to children. Being deceived by the jugglery of the Supreme Being, the nondevotees, who may be very dexterous in fruitive work and mental speculation, are always in ignorance. With such limited knowledge, they are unable to penetrate into the mysterious region of transcendence. The mental speculators are a little more progressive than the gross materialists or the fruitive workers, but because they are also within the grip of illusion, they take it for granted

that anything which has form, a name and activities is but a product of material energy. For them the Supreme Spirit is formless, nameless and inactive. And because such mental speculators equalize the transcendental name and form of the Lord with mundane names and form, they are in fact in ignorance. With such a poor fund of knowledge, there is no access to the real nature of the Supreme Being. As stated in *Bhagavad-gita*, the Lord is always in a transcendental position, even when He is within the material world. But ignorant men consider the Lord one of the great personalities of the world, and thus they are misled by the illusory energy.

TEXT 38

Sa ved DaaTau" Padvq& ParSYa
durNTavqYaRSYa rQaa®Paa<ae")
Yaae_MaaYaYaa SaNTaTaYaaNauv*tYaa
>aJaeTa TaTPaadSaraeJaGaNDaMa()) 38))

sa veda dhātuù padavèà parasya

duranta-véryasya rathàiga-päëeù

yo 'mäyayä santatayänuvåttyä

bhajeta tat-päda-saroja-gandham

SYNONYMS

saù—He alone; *veda*—can know; *dhātuù*—of the creator; *padavém*—glories; *parasya*—of the transcendence; *duranta-véryasya*—of the greatly powerful; *ratha-aiga-päëeù*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa, who bears in His hand the wheel of a chariot; *yaù*—one who; *amäyayä*—without reservation; *santatayä*—without any gap; *anuvåttyä*—favorably; *bhajeta*—renders service; *tat-päda*—of His feet; *saroja-gandham*—fragrance of the lotus.

TRANSLATION

Only those who render unreserved, uninterrupted, favorable service unto

the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa, who carries the wheel of the chariot in His hand, can know the creator of the universe in His full glory, power and transcendence.

PURPORT

Only the pure devotees can know the transcendental name, form and activities of Lord Kṛṣṇa due to their being completely freed from the reactions of fruitive work and mental speculation. The pure devotees have nothing to derive as personal profit from their unalloyed service to the Lord. They render incessant service to the Lord spontaneously, without any reservation. Everyone within the creation of the Lord is rendering service to the Lord indirectly or directly. No one is an exception to this law of the Lord. Those who are rendering service indirectly, being forced by the illusory agent of the Lord, are rendering service unto Him unfavorably. But those who are rendering service unto Him directly under the direction of His beloved agent are rendering service unto Him favorably. Such favorable servitors are devotees of the Lord, and by the grace of the Lord they can enter into the mysterious region of transcendence by the mercy of the Lord. But the mental speculators remain in darkness all the time. As stated in *Bhagavad-gītā*, the Lord Himself guides the pure devotees toward the path of realization due to their constant engagement in the loving service of the Lord in spontaneous affection. That is the secret of entering into the kingdom of God. Fruitive activities and speculation are no qualifications for entering.

TEXT 39

AQaeh DaNYaa >aGavNTa wTQa&
YaÜaSaudeve_i%l/I/aek-NaaQae)
ku-vRiNTa SavaRTMak-MaaTMa>aav&
Na Ya}a >aUYa" PairvTaR oGa]")) 39))

atheha dhanyä bhagavanta itthaà

yad vāsudeve ’khila-loka-nāthe

kurvanti sarvātmakam ātma-bhāvaà

na yatra bhūyaù parivarta ugraù

SYNONYMS

atha—thus; *iha*—in this world; *dhanyäù*—successful; *bhagavantaù*—perfectly cognizant; *ittham*—such; *yat*—what; *vāsudeve*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *akhila*—all-embracing; *loka-nāthe*—unto the proprietor of all the universes; *kurvanti*—inspires; *sarva-ātmakam*—one hundred percent; *ātma*—spirit; *bhāvam*—ecstasy; *na*—never; *yatra*—wherein; *bhūyaù*—again; *parivartaù*—repetition; *ugraù*—dreadful.

TRANSLATION

Only by making such inquiries in this world can one be successful and perfectly cognizant, for such inquiries invoke transcendental ecstatic love unto the Personality of Godhead, who is the proprietor of all the universes, and guarantee cent-percent immunity from the dreadful repetition of birth and death.

PURPORT

The inquiries of the sages headed by Çaunaka are herewith praised by Sūta Gosvami on the merit of their transcendental nature. As already concluded, only the devotees of the Lord can know Him to a considerable extent, and no one else can know Him at all, so the devotees are perfectly cognizant of all spiritual knowledge. The Personality of Godhead is the last word in Absolute Truth. Impersonal Brahman and localized Paramātmā (Supersoul) are included in the knowledge of the Personality of Godhead. So one who knows the Personality of Godhead can automatically know all about Him, His multipotencies and His expansions. So the devotees are congratulated as being all-successful. A cent-percent devotee of the Lord is immune to the dreadful material miseries of repeated birth and death.

TEXT 40

wd& >aaGavTa& NaaMa Paura<a& b]øSaiMMaTaMa()
otaMaëaek-cirTa& ck-ar >aGavaNa*iz")
iNa"é[eYaSaaYa l/aek-SYa DaNYa& SvSTYaYaNa& MahTa()) 40))

idaà bhāgavataà nāma

puräëaà brahma-sammitam

uttama-çloka-caritaà

cakāra bhagavān āñiù

niùçreyasäya lokasya

dhanyaà svasty-ayanaà mahat

SYNONYMS

idam—this; *bhāgavatam*—book containing the narration of the Personality of Godhead and His pure devotees; *nāma*—of the name; *puräëam*—supplementary to the *Vedas*; *brahma-sammitam*—incarnation of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *uttama-çloka*—of the Personality of Godhead; *caritam*—activities; *cakāra*—compiled; *bhagavān*—incarnation of the Personality of Godhead; *āñiù*—Sri Vyāsadeva; *niùçreyasäya*—for the ultimate good; *lokasya*—of all people; *dhanyam*—fully successful; *svasti-ayanam*—all-blissful; *mahat*—all-perfect.

TRANSLATION

This Srimad-Bhagavatam is the literary incarnation of God, and it is compiled by Srila Vyāsadeva, the incarnation of God. It is meant for the ultimate good of all people, and it is all-successful, all-blissful and all-perfect.

PURPORT

Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu declared that *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the

spotless sound representation of all Vedic knowledge and history. There are selected histories of great devotees who are in direct contact with the Personality of Godhead. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the literary incarnation of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and is therefore nondifferent from Him. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* should be worshiped as respectfully as we worship the Lord. Thereby we can derive the ultimate blessings of the Lord through its careful and patient study. As God is all light, all bliss and all perfection, so also is *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. We can have all the transcendental light of the Supreme Brahman, Sri Kṛṣṇa, from the recitation of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, provided it is received through the medium of the transparent spiritual master. Lord Caitanya's private secretary Srila Svarūpa Dāmodara Gosvami advised all intending visitors who came to see the Lord at Puré to make a study of the *Bhāgavatam* from the person *Bhāgavatam* Person *Bhāgavatam* is the self-realized bona fide spiritual master, and through him only can one understand the lessons of *Bhāgavatam* in order to receive the desired result. One can derive from the study of the *Bhāgavatam* all benefits that are possible to be derived from the personal presence of the Lord. It carries with it all the transcendental blessings of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa that we can expect from His personal contact.

TEXT 41

**Taidd& Ga]ahYaaMaaSa SauTaMaaTMavTaa& vrMa()
SavRvedeiTahaSaaNaa& Saar& Saar& SaMaud(Da*TaMa()) 41))**

tad idaà grāhayām āsa

sutam ātmavatāà varam

sarva-vedetihāsānāà

sāraà sāraà samuddhātām

SYNONYMS

tat—that; *idam*—this; *grāhayām āsa*—made to accept; *sutam*—unto his son; *ātmavatām*—of the self-realized; *varam*—most respectful; *sarva*—all;

veda—Vedic literatures (books of knowledge); *itihāsānām*—of all the histories; *sāram*—cream; *sāram*—cream; *samuddhātām*—taken out.

TRANSLATION

Sri Vyāsadeva delivered it to his son, who is the most respected among the self-realized, after extracting the cream of all Vedic literatures and histories of the universe.

PURPORT

Men with a poor fund of knowledge only accept the history of the world from the time of Buddha, or since 600 B.C., and prior to this period all histories mentioned in the scriptures are calculated by them to be only imaginary stories. That is not a fact. All the stories mentioned in the *Puranas* and *Mahābhārata*, etc., are actual histories, not only of this planet but also of millions of other planets within the universe. Sometimes the history of planets beyond this world appear to such men to be unbelievable. But they do not know that different planets are not equal in all respects and that therefore some of the historical facts derived from other planets do not correspond with the experience of this planet. Considering the different situation of different planets and also time and circumstances, there is nothing wonderful in the stories of the *Puranas*, nor are they imaginary. We should always remember the maxim that one man's food is another man's poison. We should not, therefore, reject the stories and histories of the *Puranas* as imaginary. The great *āñis* like Vyāsa had no business putting some imaginary stories in their literatures.

In the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* historical facts selected from the histories of different planets have been depicted. It is therefore accepted by all the spiritual authorities as the *Mahā-Purana*. The special significance of these histories is that they are all connected with activities of the Lord in a different time and atmosphere. Srila Çukadeva Gosvami is the topmost personality of all the self-realized souls, and he accepted this as the subject of studies from his father, Vyāsadeva. Srila Vyāsadeva is the great authority, and the subject matter of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* being so important, he delivered the message first to his great son Srila Çukadeva Gosvami. It is

compared to the cream of the milk. Vedic literature is like the milk ocean of knowledge. Cream or butter is the most palatable essence of milk, and so also is *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, for it contains all palatable, instructive and authentic versions of different activities of the Lord and His devotees. There is no gain, however, in accepting the message of *Bhägavatam* from the unbelievers, atheists and professional reciters who make a trade of *Bhägavatam* for the laymen. It was delivered to Srila Çukadeva Gosvami, and he had nothing to do with the *Bhägavata* business. He did not have to maintain family expenses by such trade. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* should therefore be received from the representative of Çukadeva, who must be in the renounced order of life without family encumbrance. Milk is undoubtedly very good and nourishing, but when it is touched by the mouth of a snake it is no longer nourishing; rather, it becomes a source of death. Similarly, those who are not strictly in the Vaiñëava discipline should not make a business of this *Bhägavatam* and become a cause of spiritual death for so many hearers. In the *Bhagavad-gita* the Lord says that the purpose of all the *Vedas* is to know Him (Lord Kṛṣṇa), and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa Himself in the form of recorded knowledge. Therefore, it is the cream of all the *Vedas*, and it contains all historical facts of all times in relation with Sri Kṛṣṇa. It is factually the essence of all histories.

TEXT 42

**Sa Tau Sa&é[avYaaMaaSa MaharaJa& Parqi+aTaMa()
Pa[aYaaePaiví& Ga®aYaa& ParqTa& ParMaizRi>a")) 42))**

sa tu saàçrāvayām äsa

mahäräjaà parékñitam

präyopaviñöaà gaigäyää

parétaà paramarñibhiù

SYNONYMS

saù—the son of Vyāsadeva; *tu*—again; *saàçrāvayäm äsa*—make them audible; *mahä-räjam*—unto the emperor; *parékñitam*—of the name Parékñit; *präya-upaviñöam*—who sat until death without food or drink; *gaigäyäm*—on the bank of the Ganges; *parétam*—being surrounded; *parama-āñibhiù*—by great sages.

TRANSLATION

Çukadeva Gosvami, the son of Vyāsadeva, in his turn delivered the Bhāgavatam to the great Emperor Parékñit, who sat surrounded by sages on the bank of the Ganges, awaiting death without taking food or drink.

PURPORT

All transcendental messages are received properly in the chain of disciplic succession. This disciplic succession is called *paramparä*. Unless therefore *Bhāgavatam* or any other Vedic literatures are received through the *paramparä* system, the reception of knowledge is not bona fide. Vyāsadeva delivered the message to Çukadeva Gosvami, and from Çukadeva Gosvami, Sūta Gosvami received the message. One should therefore receive the message of *Bhāgavatam* from Sūta Gosvami or from his representative and not from any irrelevant interpreter.

Emperor Parékñit received the information of his death in time, and he at once left his kingdom and family and sat down on the bank of the Ganges to fast till death. All great sages, *āñis*, philosophers, mystics, etc., went there due to his imperial position. They offered many suggestions about his immediate duty, and at last it was settled that he would hear from Çukadeva Gosvami about Lord Kṛṣṇa. Thus the *Bhāgavatam* was spoken to him.

Sripāda Çaikarācārya, who preached Māyāvāda philosophy and stressed the impersonal feature of the Absolute, also recommended that one must take shelter at the lotus feet of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, for there is no hope of gain from debating. Indirectly Sripāda Çaikarācārya admitted that what he had preached in the flowery grammatical interpretations of the *Vedānta-sūtra* cannot help one at the time of death. At the critical hour of death one must

recite the name of Govinda. This is the recommendation of all great transcendentalists. Çukadeva Gosvami had long ago stated the same truth, that at the end one must remember Nārāyaṇa. That is the essence of all spiritual activities. In pursuance of this eternal truth, *Srimad-Bhagavatam* was heard by Emperor Parékñit, and it was recited by the able Çukadeva Gosvami. And both the speaker and the receiver of the messages of *Bhägavatam* were duly delivered by the same medium.

TEXT 43

k*-Z<ae SvDaaMaaePaGaTae DaMaRjaNaaidi>a" Sah)
k-l/aE Naíd*XaaMaez Paura<aak-aeR_DauNaaeidTa")) 43))

kāñēe sva-dhāmopagate

dharma-jñānadibhiù saha

kalau nañöa-dâçäm eña

puräëärko 'dhunoditaù

SYNONYMS

kāñēe—in Kṛṣṇa's; *sva-dhāma*—own abode; *upagate*—having returned; *dharma*—religion; *jñāna*—knowledge; *ādibhiù*—combined together; *saha*—along with; *kalau*—in the Kali-yuga; *nañöa-dâçäm*—of persons who have lost their sight; *eñaù*—all these; *puräëa-arkaù*—the *Purana* which is brilliant like the sun; *adhunä*—just now; *uditaù*—has arisen.

TRANSLATION

This Bhägavata Purana is as brilliant as the sun, and it has arisen just after the departure of Lord Kṛṣṇa to His own abode, accompanied by religion, knowledge, etc. Persons who have lost their vision due to the dense darkness of ignorance in the age of Kali shall get light from this Purana.

PURPORT

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa has His eternal *dhāma*, or abode, where He eternally enjoys Himself with His eternal associates and paraphernalia. And His eternal abode is a manifestation of His internal energy, whereas the material world is a manifestation of His external energy. When He descends on the material world, He displays Himself with all paraphernalia in His internal potency, which is called *ātma-māyā*. In the *Bhagavad-gita* the Lord says that He descends by His own potency (*ātma-māyā*). His form, name, fame, paraphernalia, abode, etc., are not, therefore, creations of matter. He descends to reclaim the fallen souls and to reestablish codes of religion which are directly enacted by Him. Except for God, no one can establish the principles of religion. Either He or a suitable person empowered by Him can dictate the codes of religion. Real religion means to know God, our relation with Him and our duties in relation with Him and to know ultimately our destination after leaving this material body. The conditioned souls, who are entrapped by the material energy, hardly know all these principles of life. Most of them are like animals engaged in eating, sleeping, fearing and mating. They are mostly engaged in sense enjoyment under the pretension of religiosity, knowledge or salvation. They are still more blind in the present age of quarrel, or Kali-yuga. In the Kali-yuga the population is just a royal edition of the animals. They have nothing to do with spiritual knowledge or godly religious life. They are so blind that they cannot see anything beyond the jurisdiction of the subtle mind, intelligence or ego, but they are very much proud of their advancement in knowledge, science and material prosperity. They can risk their lives to become a dog or hog just after leaving the present body, for they have completely lost sight of the ultimate aim of life. The Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa appeared before us just a little prior to the beginning of Kali-yuga, and He returned to His eternal home practically at the commencement of Kali-yuga. While He was present, He exhibited everything by His different activities. He spoke the *Bhagavad-gita* specifically and eradicated all pretentious principles of religiosity. And prior to His departure from this material world, He empowered Sri Vyāsadeva through Nārada to compile the messages of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and thus both the *Bhagavad-gita* and the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* are like torchbearers for the blind people of this age. In other words, if men in this age of Kali want to see the real light of life, they must take to these two books only, and their aim of life will be fulfilled. *Bhagavad-gita* is the preliminary study of the *Bhāgavatam*. And *Srimad-*

Bhagavatam is the *summum bonum* of life, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa personified. We must therefore accept *Srimad-Bhagavatam* as the direct representation of Lord Kṛṣṇa. One who can see *Srimad-Bhagavatam* can see also Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa in person. They are identical.

TEXT 44

Ta}a k-ITaRYaTaae ivPa[a ivPa[zeR>aURirTaeJaSa")
Ah& caDYaGaMa& Ta}a iNaivíSTadNauGa]haTa()
Saae_h& v" é[aviYaZYaaiMa YaQaaDaqTa& YaQaaMaiTa)) 44))

tatra kértayato viprä

viprarñer bhüri-tejasaù

ahaà cädhyagamaà tatra

niviñöas tad-anugrahät

so 'haà vaù çrävayiñyämi

yathädhétaà yathä-mati

SYNONYMS

tatra—there; *kértayataù*—while reciting; *vipräù*—O *brahmanas*; *vipra-
añeù*—from the great *brahmana-*añi**; *bhüri*—greatly; *tejasaù*—powerful;
aham—I; *ca*—also; *adhyagamam*—could understand; *tatra*—in that
meeting; *niviñöaù*—being perfectly attentive; *tad-anugrahät*—by his mercy;
saù—that very thing; *aham*—I; *vaù*—unto you; *çrävayiñyämi*—shall let you
hear; *yathä-adhétam yathä-mati*—as far as my realization.

TRANSLATION

O learned brahmanas, when Çukadeva Gosvami recited Bhāgavatam there [in the presence of Emperor Parékñit], I heard him with rapt attention, and thus, by his mercy, I learned the Bhāgavatam from that

great and powerful sage. Now I shall try to make you hear the very same thing as I learned it from him and as I have realized it.

PURPORT

One can certainly see directly the presence of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa in the pages of *Bhāgavatam* if one has heard it from a self-realized great soul like Çukadeva Gosvami. One cannot, however, learn *Bhāgavatam* from a bogus hired reciter whose aim of life is to earn some money out of such recitation and employ the earning in sex indulgence. No one can learn *Srimad-Bhagavatam* who is associated with persons engaged in sex life. That is the secret of learning *Bhāgavatam* Nor can one learn *Bhāgavatam* from one who interprets the text by his mundane scholarship. One has to learn *Bhāgavatam* from the representative of Çukadeva Gosvami, and no one else, if one at all wants to see Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa in the pages. That is the process, and there is no alternative. Sūta Gosvami is a bona fide representative of Çukadeva Gosvami because he wants to present the message which he received from the great learned *brahmana*. Çukadeva Gosvami presented *Bhāgavatam* as he heard it from his great father, and so also Sūta Gosvami is presenting *Bhāgavatam* as he had heard it from Çukadeva Gosvami. Simple hearing is not all; one must realize the text with proper attention. The word *nivīṇōa* means that Sūta Gosvami drank the juice of *Bhāgavatam* through his ears. That is the real process of receiving *Bhāgavatam*. One should hear with rapt attention from the real person, and then he can at once realize the presence of Lord Kṛṣṇa in every page. The secret of knowing *Bhāgavatam* is mentioned here. No one can give rapt attention who is not pure in mind. No one can be pure in mind who is not pure in action. No one can be pure in action who is not pure in eating, sleeping, fearing and mating. But somehow or other if someone hears with rapt attention from the right person, at the very beginning one can assuredly see Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa in person in the pages of *Bhāgavatam*.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Third Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "Kṛṣṇa Is the Source of All Incarnations."

Chapter Four

The Appearance of Sri Nārada

TEXT 1

VYaaSa ovac

wiTa b]uva<a& Sa&STaUYa MauNaqNaa& dqgaRSai}a<aaMa()
v*Ö" ku-l/PaiTa" SaUTa& bû*c" XaaENak-ae_b]vqTa()) 1))

vyāsa uvāca

iti bruvāēaà saàstüya

munénäà dérgha-satriëäm

vāddhaù kula-patiù sūtaà

bahvācaù çaunako 'bravét

SYNONYMS

vyāsaù—Vyāsadeva; *uvāca*—said; *iti*—thus; *bruvāēam*—speaking; *saàstüya*—congratulating; *munénäm*—of the great sages; *dérgha*—prolonged; *satriëäm*—of those engaged in the performance of sacrifice; *vāddhaù*—elderly; *kula-patiù*—head of the assembly; *sūtam*—unto Sūta Gosvami; *bahu-ācaù*—learned; *çaunakaù*—of the name Çaunaka; *abravét*—addressed.

TRANSLATION

On hearing Sūta Gosvami speak thus, Çaunaka Muni, who was the elderly, learned leader of all the āñis engaged in that prolonged sacrificial ceremony, congratulated Sūta Gosvami by addressing him as follows.

PURPORT

In a meeting of learned men, when there are congratulations or addresses

for the speaker, the qualifications of the congratulator should be as follows. He must be the leader of the house and an elderly man. He must be vastly learned also. Sri Çaunaka Rsi had all these qualifications, and thus he stood up to congratulate Sri Sūta Gosvami when he expressed his desire to present *Srimad-Bhagavatam* exactly as he heard it from Çukadeva Gosvami and also realized it personally. Personal realization does not mean that one should, out of vanity, attempt to show one's own learning by trying to surpass the previous *ācārya*. He must have full confidence in the previous *ācārya*, and at the same time he must realize the subject matter so nicely that he can present the matter for the particular circumstances in a suitable manner. *The original purpose of the text must be maintained.* No obscure meaning should be screwed out of it, yet it should be presented in an interesting manner for the understanding of the audience. This is called realization. The leader of the assembly, Çaunaka, could estimate the value of the speaker, Sri Sūta Gosvami, simply by his uttering *yathādhétam* and *yathā-mati*, and therefore he was very glad to congratulate him in ecstasy. No learned man should be willing to hear a person who does not represent the original *ācārya*. So the speaker and the audience were bona fide in this meeting where *Bhāgavatam* was being recited for the second time. That should be the standard of recitation of *Bhāgavatam*, so that the real purpose can be served without difficulty. Unless this situation is created, *Bhāgavatam* recitation for extraneous purposes is useless labor both for the speaker and for the audience.

TEXT 2

XaaENak- ovac

**SaUTa SaUTa Maha>aaGa vd Naae vdTaa& vr)
k-Qaa& >aaGavTaq& Pau<Yaa& Yadah >aGavaH^uk-")) 2))**

çaunaka uvāca

sūta sūta mahā-bhāga

vada no vadatāà vara

kathāà bhāgavatēà puēyāà

yad äha bhagaväi chukaù

SYNONYMS

çaunakaù—Çaunaka; *uväca*—said; *süta süta*—O Süta Gosvami; *mahä-bhāga*—the most fortunate; *vada*—please speak; *naù*—unto us; *vadatām*—of those who can speak; *vara*—respected; *kathām*—message; *bhāgavatém*—of the *Bhāgavatam*; *puëyām*—pious; *yat*—which; *äha*—said; *bhagavän*—greatly powerful; *çukaù*—Sri Çukadeva Gosvami.

TRANSLATION

Çaunaka said: O Süta Gosvami, you are the most fortunate and respected of all those who can speak and recite. Please relate the pious message of Srimad-Bhagavatam, which was spoken by the great and powerful sage Çukadeva Gosvami.

PURPORT

Süta Gosvami is twice addressed herein by Çaunaka Gosvami out of great joy because he and the members of the assembly were eager to hear the text of *Bhāgavatam* uttered by Çukadeva Gosvami. They were not interested in hearing it from a bogus person who would interpret in his own way to suit his own purpose. Generally the so-called *Bhāgavatam* reciters are either professional readers or so-called learned impersonalists who cannot enter into the transcendental personal activities of the Supreme Person. Such impersonalists twist some meanings out of *Bhāgavatam* to suit and support impersonalist views, and the professional readers at once go to the Tenth Canto to misexplain the most confidential part of the Lord’s pastimes. Neither of these reciters are bona fide persons to recite *Bhāgavatam*. Only one who is prepared to present *Bhāgavatam* in the light of Çukadeva Gosvami and only those who are prepared to hear Çukadeva Gosvami and his representative are bona fide participants in the transcendental discussion of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 3

k-iSMaNa(YauGae Pa[v*taeYa& SQaaNae va ke-Na heTauNaa)
ku-Ta" SaÄaeidTa" k*-Z<a" k*-TavaNa(Sa&ihTaa& MauiNa")) 3))

kasmin yuge pravâtteyaà

sthâne vä kena hetunä

kutaù saïcoditaù kãñëaù

kâtavän saàhitäà muniù

SYNONYMS

kasmin—in which; *yuge*—period; *pravâttä*—was begun; *iyam*—this; *sthâne*—in the place; *vä*—or; *kena*—on what; *hetunä*—ground; *kutaù*—wherefrom; *saïcoditaù*—inspired by; *kãñëaù*—Kṛṣṇa-dvaipäyana Vyäsa; *kâtavän*—compiled; *saàhitäm*—Vedic literature; *muniù*—the learned.

TRANSLATION

In what period and at what place was this first begun, and why was this taken up? From where did Kṛṣṇa-dvaipäyana Vyäsa, the great sage, get the inspiration to compile this literature?

PURPORT

Because *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the special contribution of Srila Vyäsadeva, there are so many inquiries by the learned Çaunaka Muni. It was known to them that Srila Vyäsadeva had already explained the text of the *Vedas* in various ways up to the *Mahäbhärata* for the understanding of less intelligent women, *sudras* and fallen members of the family of twice-born men. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is transcendental to all of them because it has nothing to do with anything mundane. So the inquiries are very intelligent and relevant.

TEXT 4

TaSYa Pau}aae MahaYaaeGaq SaMad*x(iNaivRk-LPak-")
Wk-aNTaMaiTaãìd]ae GaU!ae MaU! wveYaTae)) 4))

tasya putro mahä-yogé

sama-dâi nirvikalpakaù

ekänta-matir unnidro

güòho müòha iveyate

SYNONYMS

tasya—his; *putraù*—son; *mahä-yogé*—a great devotee; *sama-dâk*—equibalanced; *nirvikalpakaù*—absolute monist; *ekänta-matiù*—fixed in monism or oneness of mind; *unnidraù*—surpassed nescience; *güòhaù*—not exposed; *müòhaù*—stunted; *iva*—like; *iyate*—appears like.

TRANSLATION

His [Vyäsadeva's] son was a great devotee, an equibalanced monist, whose mind was always concentrated in monism. He was transcendental to mundane activities, but being unexposed, he appeared like an ignorant person.

PURPORT

Srila Çukadeva Gosvami was a liberated soul, and thus he remained always alert not to be trapped by the illusory energy. In the *Bhagavad-gita* this alertness is very lucidly explained. The liberated soul and the conditioned soul have different engagements. The liberated soul is always engaged in the progressive path of spiritual attainment, which is something like a dream for the conditioned soul. The conditioned soul cannot imagine the actual engagements of the liberated soul. While the conditioned soul thus dreams about spiritual engagements, the liberated soul is awake. Similarly, the engagement of a conditioned soul appears to be a dream for the liberated soul. A conditioned soul and a liberated soul may apparently be

on the same platform, but factually they are differently engaged, and their attention is always alert, either in sense enjoyment or in self-realization. The conditioned soul is absorbed in matter, whereas the liberated soul is completely indifferent to matter. This indifference is explained as follows.

TEXT 5

**d*îaNauYaaNTaMa*izMaaTMaJaMaPYaNaGan&
deVYaae ihYaa PaïrdDauNaR SauTaSYa ic}aMa()
TaÜq+Ya Pa*C^iTa MauNaaE JaGaduSTavaiSTa
ñqPauIM>ada Na Tau SauTaSYa ivivç-d*îe")) 5))**

dāñövänuyantam āñim ātmajam apy anagnā

devyo hriyā paridadhur na sutasya citram

tad vékñya pācchati munau jagadus tavāsti

stré-pum-bhidā na tu sutasya vivikta-dāñöe

SYNONYMS

dāñövä—by seeing; *anuyāntam*—following; *āñim*—the sage; *ātmajam*—his son; *api*—in spite of; *anagnam*—not naked; *devya*—beautiful damsels; *hriyā*—out of shyness; *paridadhu*—covered the body; *na*—not; *sutasya*—of the son; *citram*—astonishing; *tad vékñya*—by seeing that; *pācchati*—asking; *munau*—unto the *muni* (Vyāsa); *jagadu*—replied; *tava*—your; *asti*—there are; *stré-pum*—male and female; *bhidā*—differences; *na*—not; *tu*—but; *sutasya*—of the son; *vivikta*—purified; *dāñöe*—of one who looks.

TRANSLATION

While Sri Vyāsadeva was following his son, beautiful young damsels who were bathing naked covered their bodies with cloth, although Sri Vyāsadeva himself was not naked. But they had not done so when his son had passed. The sage inquired about this, and the young ladies replied that his son was purified and when looking at them made no distinction

between male and female. But the sage made such distinctions.

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gita* (5.18) it is said that a learned sage looks equally on a learned and gentle *brahmana*, a *caëðäla* (dog-eater), a dog or a cow due to his spiritual vision. Srila Çukadeva Gosvami attained that stage. Thus he did not see a male or female; he saw all living entities in different dress. The ladies who were bathing could understand the mind of a man simply by studying his demeanor, just as by looking at a child one can understand how innocent he is. Çukadeva Gosvami was a young boy sixteen years old, and therefore all the parts of his body were developed. He was naked also, and so were the ladies. But because Çukadeva Gosvami was transcendental to sex relations, he appeared very innocent. The ladies, by their special qualifications, could sense this at once, and therefore they were not very concerned about him. But when his father passed, the ladies quickly dressed. The ladies were exactly like his children or grandchildren, yet they reacted to the presence of Vyāsadeva according to the social custom because Srila Vyāsadeva played the part of a householder. A householder has to distinguish between a male and female, otherwise he cannot be a householder. One should, therefore, attempt to know the distinction between spirit soul without any attachment for male and female. As long as such distinction is there, one should not try to become a *sannyäse* like Çukadeva Gosvami. At least theoretically one must be convinced that a living entity is neither male nor female. The outward dress is made of matter by material nature to attract the opposite sex and thus keep one entangled in material existence. A liberated soul is above this perverted distinction. He does not distinguish between one living being and another. For him they are all one and the same spirit. The perfection of this spiritual vision is the liberated stage, and Srila Çukadeva Gosvami attained that stage. Srila Vyāsadeva was also in the transcendental stage, but because he was in the householder's life, he did not pretend to be a liberated soul, as a matter of custom.

TEXT 6

k-QaMaal/i+aTa" PaaErE" SaMPa[aa" ku-åJaa®I/aNa()

oNMataMaUk-Ja@viÜcrNa(GaJaSaaûYae)) 6))

katham älakñitaù pauraiù

sampräptaù kuru-jäìgalän

unmatta-müka-jaòavad

vicaran gaja-sähvaye

SYNONYMS

katham—how; *älakñitaù*—recognized; *pauraiù*—by the citizens;
sampräptaù—reaching; *kuru-jäìgalän*—the Kuru-jäìgala provinces;
unmatta—mad; *müka*—dumb; *jaòavat*—stunted; *vicaran*—wandering;
gaja-sähvaye—Hastinäpura.

TRANSLATION

How was he [Srila Çukadeva, the son of Vyäsa] recognized by the citizens when he entered the city of Hastinäpura [now Delhi], after wandering in the provinces of Kuru and Jäìgala, appearing like a madman, dumb and retarded?

PURPORT

The present city of Delhi was formerly known as Hastinäpura because it was first established by King Hasté. Gosvami Çukadeva, after leaving his paternal home, was roaming like a madman, and therefore it was very difficult for the citizens to recognize him in his exalted position. A sage is not, therefore, recognized by sight, but by hearing. One should approach a *sädhu* or great sage not to see but to hear him. If one is not prepared to hear the words of a *sädhu*, there is no profit. Çukadeva Gosvami was a *sädhu* who could speak on the transcendental activities of the Lord. He did not satisfy the whims of ordinary citizens. He was recognized when he spoke on the subject of *Bhägavatam*, and he never attempted jugglery like a magician. Outwardly he appeared to be a retarded, dumb madman, but in

fact he was the most elevated transcendental personality.

TEXT 7

k-Qa& va Paa<@veYaSYa raJazeRMauRiNaNaa Sah)
Sa&vad" SaMa>aUtaaTa Ya}aEza SaaTvTaq é[uiTa")) 7))

kathaà vä päëðaveyasya

räjarñer muninä saha

saàvädaù samabhüt täta

yatraiñä sätvaté śrutiù

SYNONYMS

katham—how is it; *vä*—also; *päëðaveyasya*—of the descendant of Päëðu (Parékñit); *räjarñeù*—of the king who was a sage; *muninä*—with the *muni*; *saha*—with; *saàvädaù*—discussion; *samabhüt*—took place; *täta*—O darling; *yatra*—whereupon; *eñä*—like this; *sätvaté*—transcendental; *śrutiù*—essence of the *Vedas*.

TRANSLATION

How did it so happen that King Parékñit met this great sage, making it possible for this great transcendental essence of the Vedas [Bhāgavatam] to be sung to him?

PURPORT

Srimad-Bhagavatam is stated here as the essence of the *Vedas*. It is not an imaginary story as it is sometimes considered by unauthorized men. It is also called *Çuka-saàhitä*, or the Vedic hymn spoken by Sri Çukadeva Gosvami, the great liberated sage.

TEXT 8

Sa GaaedaehNaMaa}a& ih Ga*hezu Ga*hMaeiDaNaaMa()
Ave+aTae Maha>aaGaSTaqQasku-v|STadaé[MaMa()) 8))

sa go-dohana-mātraà hi

gāheñu gāha-medhinām

avekñate mahā-bhāgas

térthé-kurvaàs tad āçramam

SYNONYMS

saù—he (Çukadeva Gosvami); *go-dohana-mātram*—only for the time of milking the cow; *hi*—certainly; *gāheñu*—in the house; *gāha-medhinām*—of the householders; *avekñate*—waits; *mahā-bhāgaù*—the most fortunate; *térthé*—pilgrimage; *kurvan*—transforming; *tat āçramam*—the residence.

TRANSLATION

He [Çukadeva Gosvami] was accustomed to stay at the door of a householder only long enough for a cow to be milked. And he did this just to sanctify the residence.

PURPORT

Çukadeva Gosvami met Emperor Parékñit and explained the text of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. He was not accustomed to stay at any householder's residence for more than half an hour (at the time of milking the cow), and he would just take alms from the fortunate householder. That was to sanctify the residence by his auspicious presence. Therefore Çukadeva Gosvami is an ideal preacher established in the transcendental position. From his activities, those who are in the renounced order of life and dedicated to the mission of preaching the message of Godhead should learn that they have no business with householders save and except to enlighten them in transcendental knowledge. Such asking for alms from the householder should be for the purpose of sanctifying his home. One who is

in the renounced order of life should not be allured by the glamor of the householder's worldly possessions and thus become subservient to worldly men. For one who is in the renounced order of life, this is much more dangerous than drinking poison and committing suicide.

TEXT 9

**Ai>aMaNYauSauTa& SaUTa Pa[ahu>aaRGavTaaetaMaMa()
TaSYa JaNMa MahaêYa | k-MaaRi<a c Ga*<aqih Na")) 9))**

abhimanyu-sutaà sūta

prāhur bhāgavatottamam

tasya janma mahāçcaryaà

karmäëi ca gāëëhi naù

SYNONYMS

abhimanyu-sutam—the son of Abhimanyu; *sūta*—O Sūta; *prāhu*—is said to be; *bhāgavata-uttamam*—the first-class devotee of the Lord; *tasya*—his; *janma*—birth; *mahā-çcaryam*—very wonderful; *karmäëi*—activities; *ca*—and; *gāëëhi*—please speak to; *naù*—us.

TRANSLATION

It is said that Mahārāja Parékñit is a great first-class devotee of the Lord and that his birth and activities are all wonderful. Please tell us about him.

PURPORT

The birth of Mahārāja Parékñit is wonderful because in the womb of his mother he was protected by the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa. His activities are also wonderful because he chastised Kali, who was attempting to kill a cow. To kill cows means to end human civilization. He wanted to

protect the cow from being killed by the great representative of sin. His death is also wonderful because he got previous notice of his death, which is wonderful for any mortal being, and thus he prepared himself for passing away by sitting down on the bank of the Ganges and hearing the transcendental activities of the Lord. During all the days he heard *Bhāgavatam*, he did not take food or drink, nor did he sleep a moment. So everything about him is wonderful, and his activities are worth hearing attentively. Desire is expressed herein to hear about him in detail.

TEXT 10

**Sa SaMa]a\$(k-SYa va heTaa" Paa<@UNaa& MaaNavDaRNa")
Pa[aYaaePaivíae Ga®aYaaMaNaad*TYaaiDara\$(=ié[YaMa()) 10))**

sa samrāō kasya vā hetou

pāēōünāà māna-varḍhanaù

prāyopaviñōo gaigāyām

anādātyādhirāō-ṣriyam

SYNONYMS

saù—he; *samrāō*—the Emperor; *kasya*—for what; *vā*—or; *hetou*—reason; *pāēōünām*—of the sons of Pāēōu; *māna-varḍhanaù*—one who enriches the family; *prāya-upaviñōaù*—sitting and fasting; *gaigāyām*—on the bank of the Ganges; *anādātya*—neglecting; *adhirāō*—acquired kingdom; *ṣriyam*—opulences.

TRANSLATION

He was a great emperor and possessed all the opulences of his acquired kingdom. He was so exalted that he was increasing the prestige of the Pāēōu dynasty. Why did he give up everything to sit down on the bank of the Ganges and fast until death?

PURPORT

Mahārāja Parékñit was the Emperor of the world and all the seas and oceans, and he did not have to take the trouble to acquire such a kingdom by his own effort. He inherited it from his grandfathers Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira and brothers. Besides that, he was doing well in the administration and was worthy of the good names of his forefathers. Consequently there was nothing undesirable in his opulence and administration. Then why should he give up all these favorable circumstances and sit down on the bank of the Ganges, fasting till death? This is astonishing, and therefore all were eager to know the cause.

TEXT 11

**NaMaiNTa YaTPaadiNake-TaMaaTMaNa"
iXavaYa haNaqYa DaNaaiNa Xa}av")
k-Qa& Sa vqr" ié[YaMa® duSTYaJaa&
YauvEzTaaeTóíuMahae SahaSaui>a")) 11))**

namanti yat-pāda-niketam ātmanaù

çivāya hānéya dhanāni çatravaù

kathaà sa véraù çriyam aiga dustyajäà

yuvaiñatotsrañöum aho sahāsubhiù

SYNONYMS

namanti—bow down; *yat-pāda*—whose feet; *niketam*—under; *ātmanaù*—own; *çivāya*—welfare; *hānéya*—used to bring about; *dhanāni*—wealth; *çatravaù*—enemies; *katham*—for what reason; *saù*—he; *véraù*—the chivalrous; *çriyam*—opulences; *aiga*—O; *dustyajäm*—insuperable; *yuvä*—in full youth; *aiñata*—desired; *utsrañöum*—to give up; *aho*—exclamation; *saha*—with; *asubhiù*—life.

TRANSLATION

He was such a great emperor that all his enemies would come and bow down at his feet and surrender all their wealth for their own benefit. He was full of youth and strength, and he possessed insuperable kingly opulences. Why did he want to give up everything, including his life?

PURPORT

There was nothing undesirable in his life. He was quite a young man and could enjoy life with power and opulence. So there was no question of retiring from active life. There was no difficulty in collecting the state taxes because he was so powerful and chivalrous that even his enemies would come to him and bow down at his feet and surrender all wealth for their own benefit. Mahārāja Parékñit was a pious king. He conquered his enemies, and therefore the kingdom was full of prosperity. There was enough milk, grains and metals, and all the rivers and mountains were full of potency. So materially everything was satisfactory. Therefore, there was no question of untimely giving up his kingdom and life. The sages were eager to hear about all this.

TEXT 12

iXavaYa I/aek-SYa >avaYa >aUTaYae
Ya otaMaëaek-ParaYa<aa JaNaa")
JaqviNTa NaaTMaaQaRMaSaaE Paraé[Ya&
MauMaaec iNaivRÛ ku-Ta" k-le/vrMa()) 12))

çiväya lokasya bhaväya bhütaye

ya uttama-çloka-paräyaëä janäù

jévanti nātmārtham asau parāçrayaà

mumoca nirvidya kutaù kalevaram

SYNONYMS

çiväya—welfare; *lokasya*—of all living beings; *bhaväya*—for flourishing;

bhütaye—for economic development; *ye*—one who is; *uttama-çloka-paräyaëù*—devoted to the cause of the Personality of Godhead; *janäù*—men; *jévanti*—do live; *na*—but not; *ätma-artham*—selfish interest; *asau*—that; *para-äçrayam*—shelter for others; *mumoca*—gave up; *nirvidya*—being freed from all attachment; *kutaù*—for what reason; *kalevaram*—mortal body.

TRANSLATION

Those who are devoted to the cause of the Personality of Godhead live only for the welfare, development and happiness of others. They do not live for any selfish interest. So even though the Emperor [Parékñit] was free from all attachment to worldly possessions, how could he give up his mortal body, which was shelter for others?

PURPORT

Parékñit Mahäräja was an ideal king and householder because he was a devotee of the Personality of Godhead. A devotee of the Lord automatically has all good qualifications. And the Emperor was a typical example of this. Personally he had no attachment for all the worldly opulences in his possession. But since he was king for the all-around welfare of his citizens, he was always busy in the welfare work of the public, not only for this life, but also for the next. He would not allow slaughterhouses or killing of cows. He was not a foolish and partial administrator who would arrange for the protection of one living being and allow another to be killed. Because he was a devotee of the Lord, he knew perfectly well how to conduct his administration for everyone's happiness—men, animals, plants and all living creatures. He was not selfishly interested. Selfishness is either self-centered or self-extended. He was neither. His interest was to please the Supreme Truth, Personality of Godhead. The king is the representative of the Supreme Lord, and therefore the king's interest must be identical with that of the Supreme Lord. The Supreme Lord wants all living beings to be obedient to Him and thereby become happy. Therefore the king's interest is to guide all subjects back to the kingdom of God. Hence the activities of the citizens should be so coordinated that they can at the end go back home, back to Godhead. Under the administration of a representative king,

the kingdom is full of opulence. At that time, human beings need not eat animals. There are ample food grains, milk, fruit and vegetables so that the human beings as well as the animals can eat sumptuously and to their heart's content. If all living beings are satisfied with food and shelter and obey the prescribed rules, there cannot be any disturbance between one living being and another. Emperor Parékñit was a worthy king, and therefore all were happy during his reign.

TEXT 13

**TaTSav| Na" SaMaac+v Pa*íae Yaidh ik-ÄNa)
MaNYae Tva& ivzYae vaca& òaTaMaNYa}a ^aNdSaaTa()) 13))**

tat sarvaà naù samācakñva

pāñño yad iha kīcana

manyē tvāà viñaye vācāà

snātam anyatra chāndasāt

SYNONYMS

tat—that; *sarvam*—all; *naù*—unto us; *samācakñva*—clearly explain; *pāññoaù*—questioned; *yad iha*—herein; *kīcana*—all that; *manyē*—we think; *tvām*—you; *viñaye*—in all subjects; *vācām*—meanings of words; *snātam*—fully acquainted; *anyatra*—except; *chāndasāt*—portion of the *Vedas*.

TRANSLATION

We know that you are expert in the meaning of all subjects, except some portions of the Vedas, and thus you can clearly explain the answers to all the questions we have just put to you.

PURPORT

The difference between the *Vedas* and the *Puranas* is like that between the

brahmanas and the *parivräjakas*. The *brahmanas* are meant to administer some fruitive sacrifices mentioned in the *Vedas*, but the *parivrajakacaryas*, or learned preachers, are meant to disseminate transcendental knowledge to one and all. As such, the *parivrajakacaryas* are not always expert in pronouncing the Vedic *mantras*, which are practiced systematically by accent and meter by the *brahmanas* who are meant for administering Vedic rites. Yet it should not be considered that the *brahmanas* are more important than the itinerant preachers. They are one and different simultaneously because they are meant for the same end, in different ways.

There is no difference also between the Vedic *mantras* and what is explained in the *Puranas* and *Itihāsa*. According to Srila Jiva Gosvami, it is mentioned in the *Mādhyandina-śruti* that all the *Vedas*, namely the *Sāma*, *Atharva*, *Āg*, *Yajur*, *Puranas*, *Itihāsas*, *Upaniṣads*, etc., are emanations from the breathing of the Supreme Being. The only difference is that the Vedic *mantras* are mostly begun with *praëava oākāra*, and it requires some training to practice the metric pronunciation of the Vedic *mantras*. But that does not mean that *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is of less importance than the Vedic *mantras*. On the contrary, it is the ripened fruit of all the *Vedas*, as stated before. Besides that, the most perfectly liberated soul, Srila Çukadeva Gosvami, is absorbed in the studies of the *Bhāgavatam*, although he is already self-realized. Srila Sūta Gosvami is following his footsteps, and therefore his position is not the least less important because he was not expert in chanting Vedic *mantras* with metric pronunciation, which depends more on practice than actual realization. Realization is more important than parrotlike chanting.

TEXT 14

SaUTa ovac

ÜaPare SaMaNauPa[aée Ta*TaQYae YauGaPaYaRYae)
JaaTa" ParaXaraÜaeGaQ vaSaVYaa& k-l/Yaa hre")) 14))

sūta uvāca

dvāpare samanuprāpte

tâtéye yuga-paryaye

jātaù parāçaräd yogé

väsavyäà kalayä hareù

SYNONYMS

sūtaù—Sūta Gosvami; *uvāca*—said; *dvāpare*—in the second millennium; *samanuprāpte*—on the advent of; *tâtéye*—third; *yuga*—millennium; *paryaye*—in the place of; *jātaù*—was begotten; *parāçarät*—by Parāçara; *yogé*—the great sage; *väsavyäm*—in the womb of the daughter of Vasu; *kalayä*—in the plenary portion; *hareù*—of the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

Sūta Gosvami said: When the second millennium overlapped the third, the great sage [Vyāsadeva] was born to Parāçara in the womb of Satyavati, the daughter of Vasu.

PURPORT

There is a chronological order of the four millenniums, namely Satya, Dvāpara, Tretā and Kali. But sometimes there is overlapping. During the regime of Vaivasvata Manu, there was an overlapping of the twenty-eighth round of the four millenniums, and the third millennium appeared prior to the second. In that particular millennium, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa also descends, and because of this there was some particular alteration. The mother of the great sage was Satyavati the daughter of the Vasu (fisherman), and the father was the great Parāçara Muni. That is the history of Vyāsadeva's birth. Every millennium is divided into three periods, and each period is called a *sandhyä*. Vyāsadeva appeared in the third *sandhyä* of that particular age.

TEXT 15

**Sa k-daicTSarSvTYaa oPaSPa*XYa Jal&/ éuic")
ivivç- Wk- AaSaqNa oidTae rivMa<@le/)) 15))**

sa kadäcit sarasvatyâ

upaspâçya jalaà çuciù

vivikta eka äséna

udite ravi-maëðale

SYNONYMS

saù—he; *kadäcit*—once; *sarasvatyâù*—on the bank of the Sarasvaté;
upaspâçya—after finishing morning ablutions; *jalam*—water; *çuciù*—being purified; *vivikte*—concentration; *ekaù*—alone; *äsénaù*—being thus seated;
udite—on the rise; *ravi-maëðale*—of the sun disc.

TRANSLATION

**Once upon a time he [Vyäsadeva], as the sun rose, took his morning
ablution in the waters of the Sarasvaté and sat alone to concentrate.**

PURPORT

The River Sarasvaté is flowing in the Badarikäçrama area of the Himalayas.
So the place indicated here is Çamyäpräsa in Badarikäçrama, where Sri
Vyäsadeva is residing.

TEXT 16

**Paravrj" Sa %oiz" k-ale/NaaVYaç-r&hSaa)
YauGaDaMaRVYaiTak-r& Pa[aá& >auiv YauGae YauGae)) 16))**

parävara-jïaù sa äñiù

kälenävyakta-raàhasä

yuga-dharma-vyatikaraà

prāptaà bhuvi yuge yuge

SYNONYMS

para-avara—past and future; *jīaù*—one who knows; *saù*—he; *āñiù*—Vyāsadeva; *kālena*—in the course of time; *avyakta*—unmanifested; *raàhasä*—by great force; *yuga-dharma*—acts in terms of the millennium; *vyatikaram*—anomalies; *prāptam*—having accrued; *bhuvi*—on the earth; *yuge yuge*—different ages.

TRANSLATION

The great sage Vyāsadeva saw anomalies in the duties of the millennium. This happens on the earth in different ages, due to unseen forces in the course of time.

PURPORT

The great sages like Vyāsadeva are liberated souls, and therefore they can see clearly past and future. Thus he could see the future anomalies in the Kali age, and accordingly he made arrangement for the people in general so that they can execute a progressive life in this age, which is full of darkness. The people in general in this age of Kali are too much interested in matter, which is temporary. Because of ignorance they are unable to evaluate the assets of life and be enlightened in spiritual knowledge.

TEXTS 17–18

>aaEiTak-aNaa& c >aavaNaa& Xaiç-hṛīaSa& c TaTk*-TaMa()
Aé[ÖDaaNaaia"SatvaNduMaeRDaaNa(hṛīiSaTaaYauz")) 17))
du>aRGaa&ê JaNaaNa(vq+Ya MauiNaidRVYaeNa c+auza)
SavRv<aaRé[Maa<aa& YaÖDYaaE ihTaMaMaaegad*k(-)) 18))

bhautikānāà ca bhävānāà

çakti-hräsāà ca tat-kātam

açraddadhänän niùsattvän

durmedhän hrasitäyuñau

durbhagäaç ca janän vékñya

munir divyena cakñuñä

sarva-varëäçramäëää yad

dadhyau hitam amogha-dåk

SYNONYMS

bhautikänäm ca—also of everything that is made of matter; *bhävänäm*—actions; *çakti-hräsam ca*—and deterioration of natural power; *tat-kåtam*—rendered by that; *açraddadhänän*—of the faithless; *niùsattvän*—impatient due to want of the mode of goodness; *durmedhän*—dull-witted; *hrasita*—reduced; *äyuñau*—of duration of life; *durbhagän ca*—also the unlucky; *janän*—people in general; *vékñya*—by seeing; *muniù*—the *muni*; *divyena*—by transcendental; *cakñuñä*—vision; *sarva*—all; *varëa-äçramäëäm*—of all the statuses and orders of life; *yat*—what; *dadhyau*—contemplated; *hitam*—welfare; *amogha-dåk*—one who is fully equipped in knowledge.

TRANSLATION

The great sage, who was fully equipped in knowledge, could see, through his transcendental vision, the deterioration of everything material, due to the influence of the age. He could also see that the faithless people in general would be reduced in duration of life and would be impatient due to lack of goodness. Thus he contemplated for the welfare of men in all statuses and orders of life.

PURPORT

The unmanifested forces of time are so powerful that they reduce all matter to oblivion in due course. In Kali-yuga, the last millennium of a

round of four millenniums, the power of all material objects deteriorates by the influence of time. In this age the duration of the material body of the people in general is much reduced, and so is the memory. The action of matter has also not so much incentive. The land does not produce food grains in the same proportions as it did in other ages. The cow does not give as much milk as it used to give formerly. The production of vegetables and fruits is less than before. As such, all living beings, both men and animals, do not have sumptuous, nourishing food. Due to want of so many necessities of life, naturally the duration of life is reduced, the memory is short, intelligence is meager, mutual dealings are full of hypocrisy and so on.

The great sage Vyāsadeva could see this by his transcendental vision. As an astrologer can see the future fate of a man, or an astronomer can foretell the solar and lunar eclipses, those liberated souls who can see through the scriptures can foretell the future of all mankind. They can see this due to their sharp vision of spiritual attainment.

And all such transcendentalists, who are naturally devotees of the Lord, are always eager to render welfare service to the people in general. They are the real friends of the people in general, not the so-called public leaders who are unable to see what is going to happen five minutes ahead. In this age the people in general as well as their so-called leaders are all unlucky fellows, faithless in spiritual knowledge and influenced by the age of Kali. They are always disturbed by various diseases. For example, in the present age there are so many TB patients and TB hospitals, but formerly this was not so because the time was not so unfavorable. The unfortunate men of this age are always reluctant to give a reception to the transcendentalists who are representatives of Śrīla Vyāsadeva and selfless workers always busy in planning something which may help everyone in all statuses and orders of life. The greatest philanthropists are those transcendentalists who represent the mission of Vyāsa, Nārada, Madhva, Caitanya, Rūpa, Sarasvatī, etc. They are all one and the same. The personalities may be different, but the aim of the mission is one and the same, namely, to deliver the fallen souls back home, back to Godhead.

TEXT 19

caTauhaeR}a& k-MaR éuÖ& Pa[JaaNaa& vq+Ya vEidk-Ma()
VYadDaaÛjSaNTaTYaE vedMaek&- cTauivRDaMa()) 19))

cätur-hotraà karma çuddhaà

prajänäà vékñya vaidikam

vyadadhäd yajña-santatyai

vedam ekaà catur-vidham

SYNONYMS

cätuè—four; *hotram*—sacrificial fires; *karma çuddham*—purification of work; *prajänäm*—of the people in general; *vékñya*—after seeing; *vaidikam*—according to Vedic rites; *vyadadhät*—made into; *yajña*—sacrifice; *santatyai*—to expand; *vedam ekam*—only one *Veda*; *cätuè-vidham*—in four divisions.

TRANSLATION

He saw that the sacrifices mentioned in the Vedas were means by which the people's occupations could be purified. And to simplify the process he divided the one Veda into four, in order to expand them among men.

PURPORT

Formerly there was only the *Veda* of the name *Yajur*, and the four divisions of sacrifices were there specifically mentioned. But to make them more easily performable, the *Veda* was divided into four divisions of sacrifice, just to purify the occupational service of the four orders. Above the four *Vedas*, namely *Åg*, *Yajur*, *Säma*, and *Atharva*, there are the *Puranas*, the *Mahäbhärata*, *Saàhitäs*, etc., which are known as the fifth *Veda*. Sri Vyäsadeva and his many disciples were all historical personalities, and they were very kind and sympathetic toward the fallen souls of this age of Kali. As such, the *Puranas* and *Mahäbhärata* were made from related historical facts which explained the teaching of the four *Vedas*. There is no point in

doubting the authority of the *Puranas* and *Mahābhārata* as parts and parcels of the *Vedas*. In the *Chāndogya Upaniṣad* (7.1.4), the *Puranas* and *Mahābhārata*, generally known as histories, are mentioned as the fifth *Veda*. According to Srila Jiva Gosvami, that is the way of ascertaining the respective values of the revealed scriptures.

TEXT 20

%GYaJau"SaaMaaQavaR:Yaa vedaêTvar od(Da*Taa")
wiTahaSaPaura<a& c PaÄMaae ved oCYaTae)) 20))

āg-yajuù-sämätharväkhyä

vedäç catvära uddhâtäù

itihäsa-puräëaà ca

pañcama veda ucyate

SYNONYMS

āg-yajuù-säma-atharva-äkhyäù—the names of the four *Vedas*; *vedäù*—the *Vedas*; *catväraù*—four; *uddhâtäù*—made into separate parts; *itihäsa*—historical records (*Mahābhārata*); *puräëam ca*—and the *Puranas*; *pañcamaù*—the fifth; *vedaù*—the original source of knowledge; *ucyate*—is said to be.

TRANSLATION

The four divisions of the original sources of knowledge [the *Vedas*] were made separately. But the historical facts and authentic stories mentioned in the *Puranas* are called the fifth *Veda*.

TEXT 21

Ta}aGveRdDar" PaEI/" SaaMaGaae JaEiMaiNa" k-iv")
vEXaMPaaYaNa WvEk-ae iNaZ<aaTaae YaJauzaMauTa)) 21))

tatrarg-veda-dharaù pailaù

sāmago jaiminiù kaviù

vaiçampäyana evaiko

niñëäto yajuñäm uta

SYNONYMS

tatra—thereupon; *åg-veda-dharaù*—the professor of the *Åg Veda*; *pailaù*—the *åñi* named Paila; *sāma-gaù*—that of the *Sāma Veda*; *jaiminiù*—the *åñi* named Jaimini; *kaviù*—highly qualified; *vaiçampäyanaù*—the *åñi* named Vaiçampäyana; *eva*—only; *ekaù*—alone; *niñëätaù*—well versed; *yajuñäm*—of the *Yajur Veda*; *uta*—glorified.

TRANSLATION

After the Vedas were divided into four divisions, Paila Rsi became the professor of the Åg Veda, Jaimini the professor of the Sāma Veda, and Vaiçampäyana alone became glorified by the Yajur Veda.

PURPORT

The different *Vedas* were entrusted to different learned scholars for development in various ways.

TEXT 22

**AQavaRi®rSaaMaaSaqTSauMaNTaudaRå<aae MauiNa")
wiTahaSaPaura<aaNaa& iPaTaa Mae raeMahzR<a")) 22))**

atharvågirasäm äsét

sumantur dāruëo muniù

itihāsa-puräëänäà

pitä me romaharñäëaù

SYNONYMS

atharva—the *Atharva Veda*; *aìgirasäm*—unto the *añi Aìgirä*; *äsét*—was entrusted; *sumantuù*—also known as Sumantu Muni; *däruëaù*—seriously devoted to the *Atharva Veda*; *muniù*—the sage; *itihäsa-puräëänäm*—of the historical records and the *Puranas*; *pitä*—father; *me*—mine; *romaharñäëaù*—the *añi Romaharñäëa*.

TRANSLATION

The Sumantu Muni Aìgirä, who was very devotedly engaged, was entrusted with the Atharva Veda. And my father, Romaharñäëa, was entrusted with the Puranas and historical record

PURPORT

In the *śruti-mantras* also it is stated that Aìgirä Muni, who strictly followed the rigid principles of the *Atharva Vedas*, was the leader of the followers of the *Atharva Vedas*.

TEXT 23

Ta WTa %ozYaae ved& Sv& Sv& VYaSYaàNaek-Daa)
iXaZYaE" Pa[iXaZYaESTaiC^ZYaEveRdaSTae Xaai%Naae_>avNa()) 23))

ta eta añayo vedaà

svaà svaà vyasyann anekadhä

çiñyaiù praçiñyais tac-chiñyair

vedäs te çäkhino 'bhavan

SYNONYMS

te—they; *ete*—all these; *āñayaù*—learned scholars; *vedam*—the respective *Vedas*; *svam svam*—in their own entrusted matters; *vyasyan*—rendered; *anekadhä*—many; *çïñyaiù*—disciples; *praçïñyaiù*—grand-disciples; *tat-çïñyaiù*—great grand-disciples; *vedäù te*—followers of the respective *Vedas*; *çäkhinaù*—different branches; *abhavan*—thus became.

TRANSLATION

All these learned scholars, in their turn, rendered their entrusted Vedas unto their many disciples, grand-disciples and great grand-disciples, and thus the respective branches of the followers of the Vedas came into being.

PURPORT

The original source of knowledge is the *Vedas*. There are no branches of knowledge, either mundane or transcendental, which do not belong to the original text of the *Vedas*. They have simply been developed into different branches. They were originally rendered by great, respectable and learned professors. In other words, the Vedic knowledge, broken into different branches by different disciplic successions, has been distributed all over the world. No one, therefore, can claim independent knowledge beyond the *Vedas*.

TEXT 24

**Ta Wv veda duMaeRDaEDaaRYaRNTae PauâzEYaRQaa)
Wv& ck-ar >aGavaNa(VYaaSa" k*-Pa<avTSaI/")) 24))**

ta eva vedä durmedhair

dhäryante puruṣair yathä

evaà cakära bhagavän

vyäsaù kâpaëa-vatsalaù

SYNONYMS

te—that; *eva*—certainly; *vedäù*—the book of knowledge; *durmedhaiù*—by the less intellectual; *dhäryante*—can assimilate; *puruṣaiù*—by the man; *yathä*—as much as; *evam*—thus; *cakära*—edited; *bhagavän*—the powerful; *vyäsaù*—the great sage of Vyäsa; *käpaëa-vatsalaù*—very kind to the ignorant mass.

TRANSLATION

Thus the great sage Vyäsadeva, who is very kind to the ignorant masses, edited the Vedas so they might be assimilated by less intellectual men.

PURPORT

The *Veda* is one, and the reasons for its divisions in many parts are explained herewith. The seed of all knowledge, or the *Veda*, is not a subject matter which can easily be understood by any ordinary man. There is a stricture that no one should try to learn the *Vedas* who is not a qualified *brahmana*. This stricture has been wrongly interpreted in so many ways. A class of men, who claim brahminical qualification simply by their birthright in the family of a *brahmana*, claim that the study of the *Vedas* is a monopoly of the *brahmana* caste only. Another section of the people take this as an injustice to members of other castes, who do not happen to take birth in a *brahmana* family. But both of them are misguided. The *Vedas* are subjects which had to be explained even to Brahmäjé by the Supreme Lord. Therefore the subject matter is understood by persons with exceptional qualities of goodness. Persons who are in the modes of passion and ignorance are unable to understand the subject matter of the *Vedas*. The ultimate goal of Vedic knowledge is Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead. This Personality is very rarely understood by those who are in the modes of passion and ignorance. In the Satya-yuga everyone was situated in the mode of goodness. Gradually the mode of goodness declined during the Tretä and Dväpara-yugas, and the general mass of people became corrupt. In the present age the mode of goodness is almost nil, and so for the general mass of people, the kindhearted, powerful sage Srila Vyäsadeva divided the *Vedas* in various ways so that they may be practically followed

by less intelligent persons in the modes of passion and ignorance. It is explained in the next *çloka* as follows.

TEXT 25

ñqéUd]iÜJabNDaUNaa& }aYaq Na é[uiTaGaaecra)
k-MaRé[eYaiSa MaU!aNaa& é[eYa Wv& >aveidh)
wiTa >aarTaMaa:YaaNa& k*-PaYaa MauiNaNaa k*-TaMa()) 25))

stré-çüdra-dvijabandhünää

trayé na śruti-gocarä

karma-çreyasi müðhänää

çreya evaà bhaved iha

iti bhāratam ākhyānā

kāpayā muninā kātam

SYNONYMS

stré—the woman class; *çüdra*—the laboring class; *dvija-bandhünäm*—of the friends of the twice-born; *trayé*—three; *na*—not; *śruti-gocarä*—for understanding; *karma*—in activities; *çreyasi*—in welfare; *müðhänäm*—of the fools; *çreyaù*—supreme benefit; *evam*—thus; *bhaved*—achieved; *iha*—by this; *iti*—thus thinking; *bhāratam*—the great *Mahābhārata*; *ākhyānam*—historical facts; *kāpayā*—out of great mercy; *muninā*—by the *muni*; *kātam*—is completed.

TRANSLATION

Out of compassion, the great sage thought it wise that this would enable men to achieve the ultimate goal of life. Thus he compiled the great historical narration called the Mahābhārata for women, laborers and friends of the twice-born.

PURPORT

The friends of the twice-born families are those who are born in the families of *brahmanas*, *kṣatriyas* and *vaiśyas*, or the spiritually cultured families, but who themselves are not equal to their forefathers. Such descendants are not recognized as such, for want of purificatory achievements. The purificatory activities begin even before the birth of a child, and the seed-giving reformatory process is called *Garbhādhāna-saṅskāra*. One who has not undergone such *Garbhādhāna-saṅskāra*, or spiritual family planning, is not accepted as being of an actual twice-born family. The *Garbhādhāna-saṅskāra* is followed by other purificatory processes, out of which the sacred thread ceremony is one. This is performed at the time of spiritual initiation. After this particular *saṅskāra*, one is rightly called twice-born. One birth is calculated during the seed-giving *saṅskāra*, and the second birth is calculated at the time of spiritual initiation. One who has been able to undergo such important *saṅskāras* can be called a bona fide twice-born.

If the father and the mother do not undertake the process of spiritual family planning and simply beget children out of passion only, their children are called *dvija-bandhus*. These *dvija-bandhus* are certainly not as intelligent as the children of the regular twice-born families. The *dvija-bandhus* are classified with the *sudras* and the woman class, who are by nature less intelligent. The *sudras* and the woman class do not have to undergo any *saṅskāra* save and except the ceremony of marriage.

The less intelligent classes of men, namely women, *sudras* and unqualified sons of the higher castes, are devoid of necessary qualifications to understand the purpose of the transcendental *Vedas*. For them the *Mahābhārata* was prepared. The purpose of the *Mahābhārata* is to administer the purpose of the *Vedas*, and therefore within this *Mahābhārata* the summary *Veda* of *Bhagavad-gītā* is placed. The less intelligent are more interested in stories than in philosophy, and therefore the philosophy of the *Vedas* in the form of the *Bhagavad-gītā* is spoken by the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. Vyāsadeva and Lord Kṛṣṇa are both on the transcendental plane, and therefore they collaborated in doing good to the fallen souls of this age. The *Bhagavad-gītā* is the essence of all Vedic

knowledge. It is the first book of spiritual values, as the *Upaniñads* are. The Vedānta philosophy is the subject matter for study by the spiritual graduates. Only the post-graduate spiritual student can enter into the spiritual or devotional service of the Lord. It is a great science, and the great professor is the Lord Himself in the form of Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu. And persons who are empowered by Him can initiate others in the transcendental loving service of the Lord.

TEXT 26

Wv& Pa[v*taSYa Sada >aUTaaNaa& é[eYaiSa iÜJaa")
SavaRTMake-NaaiPa Yada NaaTauZYad(Da*dYa& TaTa")) 26))

evaà pravåttasya sadä

bhütänää çreyasi dvijäù

sarvātmakenäpi yadä

nātuñyat dhādayaà tataù

SYNONYMS

evam—thus; *pravåttasya*—one who is engaged in; *sadä*—always;
bhütänäm—of the living beings; *çreyasi*—in the ultimate good; *dvijäù*—O twice-born; *sarvātmakena api*—by all means; *yadä*—when; *na*—not;
atuñyat—become satisfied; *dhādayam*—mind; *tataù*—at that.

TRANSLATION

O twice-born brahmanas, still his mind was not satisfied, although he engaged himself in working for the total welfare of all people.

PURPORT

Sri Vyāsadeva was not satisfied with himself, although he had prepared literatures of Vedic value for the all-around welfare of the general mass of

people. It was expected that he would be satisfied by all such activities, but ultimately he was not satisfied.

TEXT 27

**NaaiTaPa[Saqdd(Da*dYa" SarSvTYaaSTa\$e= éucaE)
ivTakR-YaNa(ivivç-SQa wd& caevac DaMaRivTa()) 27))**

nätiprasédad dhādayaù

sarasvatyäs taöe çucau

vitarkayan vivikta-stha

idaà coväca dharma-vit

SYNONYMS

na—not; *atiprasédat*—very much satisfied; *hādayaù*—at heart; *sarasvatyāù*—of the River Sarasvaté; *taöe*—on the bank of; *çucau*—being purified; *vitarkayan*—having considered; *vivikta-sthaù*—situated in a lonely place; *idam ca*—also this; *uväca*—said; *dharma-vit*—one who knows what religion is.

TRANSLATION

**Thus the sage, being dissatisfied at heart, at once began to reflect,
because he knew the essence of religion, and he said within himself:**

PURPORT

The sage began to search out the cause of not being satisfied at heart. Perfection is never attained until one is satisfied at heart. This satisfaction of heart has to be searched out beyond matter.

TEXTS 28–29

Da*Tav]TaeNa ih MaYaa ^Nda&iSa Gaurvae_GanYa")
MaaNaTaa iNaVYaRl/Ike-Na Ga*hqTa& caNauXaaSaNaMa()) 28))
>aarTaVYaPadeXaeNa àaManaYaaQaRê Pa[diXaRTa")
d*XYaTae Ya}a DaMaaRid ñqéUd]aidi>arPYauTa)) 29))

dhâta-vratena hi mayä

chandäàsi guravo 'gnayaù

mānitä nirvyalékena

gāhétaà cānuçäsanam

bhārata-vyapadeçena

hy ämnäyārthaç ca pradarçitaù

dāçyate yatra dharmädi

stré-çüdrädibhir apy uta

SYNONYMS

dhâta-vratena—under a strict disciplinary vow; *hi*—certainly; *mayä*—by me; *chandäàsi*—the Vedic hymns; *guravaù*—the spiritual masters; *agnayaù*—the sacrificial fire; *mānitäù*—properly worshiped; *nirvyalékena*—without pretense; *gāhétam ca*—also accepted; *anuçäsanam*—traditional discipline; *bhārata*—the *Mahābhārata*; *vyapadeçena*—by compilation of; *hi*—certainly; *ämnäya-arthaù*—import of disciplic succession; *ca*—and; *pradarçitaù*—properly explained; *dāçyate*—by what is necessary; *yatra*—where; *dharma-ädiù*—the path of religion; *stré-çüdra-ädibhiù api*—even by women, *sudras*, etc.; *uta*—spoken.

TRANSLATION

I have, under strict disciplinary vows, unpretentiously worshiped the Vedas, the spiritual master and the altar of sacrifice. I have also abided by

the rulings and have shown the import of disciplic succession through the explanation of the *Mahābhārata*, by which even women, sudras and others [friends of the twice-born] can see the path of religion.

PURPORT

No one can understand the import of the *Vedas* without having undergone a strict disciplinary vow and disciplic succession. The *Vedas*, spiritual masters and sacrificial fire must be worshiped by the desiring candidate. All these intricacies of Vedic knowledge are systematically presented in the *Mahābhārata* for the understanding of the woman class, the laborer class and the unqualified members of *brahmana*, *kñatriya* or *vaiçya* families. In this age, the *Mahābhārata* is more essential than the original *Vedas*.

TEXT 30

TaQaaIPa bTa Mae dEùae àaTMaa cEvaTMaNaa iv>au")
ASaMPaà wva>aaiTa b]øvcRSYaSataMa")) 30))

tathäpi bata me daihyo

hy ätmä caivätmanä vibhuù

asampanna iväbhäti

brahma-varcasya sattamaù

SYNONYMS

tathäpi—although; *bata*—defect; *me*—mine; *daihyaù*—situated in the body; *hi*—certainly; *ätmä*—living being; *ca*—and; *eva*—even; *ätmanä*—myself; *vibhuù*—sufficient; *asampannaù*—wanting in; *iva äbhäti*—it appears to be; *brahma-varcasya*—of the Vedäntists; *sattamaù*—the supreme.

TRANSLATION

I am feeling incomplete, though I myself am fully equipped with everything required by the Vedas.

PURPORT

Undoubtedly Srila Vyāsadeva was complete in all the details of Vedic achievements. Purification of the living being submerged in matter is made possible by the prescribed activities in the *Vedas*, but the ultimate achievement is different. Unless it is attained, the living being, even though fully equipped, cannot be situated in the transcendently normal stage. Srila Vyāsadeva appeared to have lost the clue and therefore felt dissatisfaction.

TEXT 31

**ik&- va >aaGavTaa DaMaaR Na Pa[aYae<a iNaæiPaTaa")
iPa[Yaa" ParMah&SaaNaa& Ta Wv ùCYauTaiPa[Yaa")) 31))**

kià vā bhāgavatā dharmā

na prāyeëa nirūpitāu

priyāu paramahaàsānāu

ta eva hy acyuta-priyāu

SYNONYMS

kim vā—or; *bhāgavatāu dharmāu*—devotional activities of the living beings; *na*—not; *prāyeëa*—almost; *nirūpitāu*—directed; *priyāu*—dear; *paramahaàsānām*—of the perfect beings; *te eva*—that also; *hi*—certainly; *acyuta*—the infallible; *priyāu*—attractive.

TRANSLATION

This may be because I did not specifically point out the devotional service of the Lord, which is dear both to perfect beings and to the infallible Lord.

PURPORT

The dissatisfaction which was being felt by Srila Vyāsadeva is expressed herein in his own words. This was felt for the normal condition of the living being in the devotional service of the Lord. Unless one is fixed in the normal condition of service, neither the Lord nor the living being can become fully satisfied. This defect was felt by him when Nārada Muni, his spiritual master, reached him. It is described as follows.

TEXT 32

TaSYaEv& i%I/MaaTMaaNa& MaNYaMaaNaSYa i%ŪTa")
k*-Z<aSYa Naardae_>YaaGaadaé[Ma& Pa[aGaudaôTaMa()) 32))

tasyaivaà khilam ātmānaà

manyamānasya khidyataù

kāñēasya nāradao 'bhyāgād

āçramaà präg udāhātam

SYNONYMS

tasya—his; *evam*—thus; *khilam*—inferior; *ātmānam*—soul;
manyamānasya—thinking within the mind; *khidyataù*—regretting;
kāñēasya—of Kṛṣṇa-dvaipāyana Vyāsa; *nāradaù abhyāgāt*—Nārada came there; *āçramam*—the cottage; *prāk*—before; *udāhātam*—said.

TRANSLATION

As mentioned before, Nārada reached the cottage of Kṛṣṇa-dvaipāyana Vyāsa on the banks of the Sarasvaté just as Vyāsadeva was regretting his defects.

PURPORT

The vacuum felt by Vyāsadeva was not due to his lack of knowledge. *Bhāgavata-dharma* is purely devotional service of the Lord to which the monist has no access. The monist is not counted amongst the *paramahamsas* (the most perfect of the renounced order of life). *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is full of narrations of the transcendental activities of the Personality of Godhead. Although Vyāsadeva was an empowered divinity, he still felt dissatisfaction because in none of his works were the transcendental activities of the Lord properly explained. The inspiration was infused by Sri Kṛṣṇa directly in the heart of Vyāsadeva, and thus he felt the vacuum as explained above. It is definitely expressed herewith that without the transcendental loving service of the Lord, everything is void; but in the transcendental service of the Lord, everything is tangible without any separate attempt at fruitive work or empiric philosophical speculation.

TEXT 33

**TaMai>ajaYa SahSaa Pa[TYauTQaaYaaGaTa& MauiNa")
PaUJaYaaMaaSa iviDavàard& SaurPaUiJaTaMa()) 33))**

tam abhijjāya sahasā

pratyutthāyāgataṁ muniṁ

pūjayām āsa vidhivan

nāradaṁ sura-pūjitam

SYNONYMS

tam abhijjāya—seeing the good fortune of his (Nārada’s) arrival; *sahasā*—all of a sudden; *pratyutthāya*—getting up; *āgatam*—arrived at; *muniṁ*—Vyāsadeva; *pūjayām āsa*—worship; *vidhi-vat*—with the same respect as offered to Vidhi (Brahmā); *nāradaṁ*—to Nārada; *sura-pūjitam*—worshiped by the demigods.

TRANSLATION

At the auspicious arrival of Sri Nārada, Sri Vyāsadeva got up respectfully and worshiped him, giving him veneration equal to that given to Brahmājé, the creator.

PURPORT

Vidhi means Brahmā, the first created living being. He is the original student as well as professor of the *Vedas*. He learned it from Sri Kṛṣṇa and taught Nārada first. So Nārada is the second *ācārya* in the line of spiritual disciplic succession. He is the representative of Brahmā, and therefore he is respected exactly like Brahmā, the father of all *vidhis* (regulations); similarly all other successive disciples in the chain are also equally respected as representatives of the original spiritual master.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Fourth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "The Appearance of Sri Nārada."

Chapter Five

Nārada's Instructions on Srimad-Bhagavatam for Vyāsadeva

TEXT 1

SaUTa ovac

**AQa Ta& Sau%MaaSaqNa oPaaSaqNa& b*hC^\va")
devizR" Pa[ah ivPa[iz| vq<aaPaai<a" SMaYaiàv)) 1))**

sūta uvāca

atha taà sukham āsēna

upāsēnaà bāhac-chravāu

devarñiù prāha viprarñià

véëä-päëiù smayann iva

SYNONYMS

sütaù—Süta; *uväca*—said; *atha*—therefore; *tam*—him; *sukham äsénaù*—comfortably seated; *upäsénam*—unto one sitting nearby; *båhat-çraväù*—greatly respected; *devarñiù*—the great *åñi* among the gods; *pråha*—said; *viprarñim*—unto the *åñi* among the *brahmanas*; *véëä-päëiù*—one who carries a *véëä* in his hand; *smayan iva*—apparently smiling.

TRANSLATION

Süta Gosvami said: Thus the sage amongst the gods [Nārada], comfortably seated and apparently smiling, addressed the åñi amongst the brahmanas [Vedavyāsa].

PURPORT

Nārada was smiling because he well knew the great sage Vedavyāsa and the cause of his disappointment. As he will explain gradually, Vyāsadeva’s disappointment was due to insufficiency in presenting the science of devotional service. Nārada knew the defect, and it was confirmed by the position of Vyāsa.

TEXT 2

Naard ovac

**PaaraXaYaR Maha>aaGa >avTa" k-iÀdaTMaNaa)
PairTauZYaiTa Xaarqr AaTMaa MaaNaSa Wv va)) 2))**

nārada uvāca

pārāçarya mahā-bhāga

bhavataù kaccid ātmanā

parituñyati çārera

ātmā mānasa eva vā

SYNONYMS

nārada—Nārada; *uvāca*—said; *pārāçarya*—O son of Parāçara; *mahā-bhāga*—the greatly fortunate; *bhavata*—your; *kaccit*—if it is; *ātmanā*—by the self-realization of; *parituñyati*—does it satisfy; *çäréra*—identifying the body; *ātmā*—self; *mānasa*—identifying the mind; *eva*—certainly; *vā*—and.

TRANSLATION

Addressing Vyāsadeva, the son of Parāçara, Nārada inquired: Are you satisfied by identifying with the body or the mind as objects of self-realization?

PURPORT

This was a hint by Nārada to Vyāsadeva regarding the cause of his despondency. Vyāsadeva, as the descendant of Parāçara, a greatly powerful sage, had the privilege of having a great parentage which should not have given Vyāsadeva cause for despondency. Being a great son of a great father, he should not have identified the self with the body or the mind. Ordinary men with a poor fund of knowledge can identify the body as self or the mind as self, but Vyāsadeva should not have done so. One cannot be cheerful by nature unless one is factually seated in self-realization, which is transcendental to the material body and mind.

TEXT 3

**iJajaiSaTa& SauSaMPaàMaiPa Tae Mahdd(>auTaMa()
k*-TavaNa(>aarTa& YaSTv& SavaRQaRPairb*&ihTaMa()) 3))**

jijñāsitaḥ susaṁpannam

api te mahad-adbhutam

kātavān bhārataà yas tvaà

sarvārtha-paribāhitam

SYNONYMS

jijñāsitam—fully inquired; *susampannam*—well versed; *api*—in spite of; *te*—your; *mahat-adbhutam*—great and wonderful; *kātavān*—prepared; *bhāratam*—the *Mahābhārata*; *yaù tvam*—what you have done; *sarva-ārtha*—including all sequences; *paribāhitam*—elaborately explained.

TRANSLATION

Your inquiries were full and your studies were also well fulfilled, and there is no doubt that you have prepared a great and wonderful work, the Mahābhārata, which is full of all kinds of Vedic sequences elaborately explained.

PURPORT

The despondency of Vyāsadeva was certainly not due to his lack of sufficient knowledge because as a student he had fully inquired about the Vedic literatures, as a result of which the *Mahābhārata* is compiled with full explanation of the *Vedas*.

TEXT 4

**ijajaiSaTaMaDaqTa& c b]øYataTa(SaNaaTaNaMa()
TaQaaIPa XaaecSYaaTMaaNaMak*-TaaQaR wv Pa[>aae)) 4))**

jijñāsitam adhétaà ca

brahma yat tat sanātanam

tathāpi çocasy ātmānam

akātārtha iva prabho

SYNONYMS

jijñāsita—deliberated fully well; *adhéta*—the knowledge obtained; *ca*—and; *brahma*—the Absolute; *yat*—what; *tat*—that; *sanātanam*—eternal; *tathāpi*—in spite of that; *çocasi*—lamenting; *ātmānam*—unto the self; *akāta-artha*—undone; *iva*—like; *prabho*—my dear sir.

TRANSLATION

You have fully delineated the subject of impersonal Brahman as well as the knowledge derived therefrom. Why should you be despondent in spite of all this, thinking that you are undone, my dear prabhu?

PURPORT

The *Vedānta-sūtra*, or *Brahma-sūtra*, compiled by Sri Vyāsadeva is the full deliberation of the impersonal absolute feature, and it is accepted as the most exalted philosophical exposition in the world. It covers the subject of eternity, and the methods are scholarly. So there cannot be any doubt about the transcendental scholarship of Vyāsadeva. So why should he lament?

TEXT 5

VYaaSa ovac
ASTYaeV Mae SavRiMad& TvYaaeç&-
TaQaaIPa NaaTMaa PairTauZYaTae Mae)
TaNMauI/MaVYaç-MaGaaDabaeDa&
Pa*C^aMahe TvaTMa>avaTMa>aUTaMa()) 5))

vyāsa uvāca

asty eva me sarvam idaṁ tvayoktaṁ

tathāpi nātmā parituṅyate me

tan-mūlam avyaktam agādha-bodhaṁ

pācchāmahe tvātma-bhavātma-bhūtam

SYNONYMS

vyāsaù—Vyāsa; *uvāca*—said; *asti*—there is; *eva*—certainly; *me*—mine; *sarvam*—all; *idam*—this; *tvayā*—by you; *uktam*—uttered; *tathāpi*—and yet; *na*—not; *ātmā*—self; *parituñyate*—does pacify; *me*—unto me; *tat*—of which; *mūlam*—root; *avyaktam*—undetected; *agādha-bodham*—the man of unlimited knowledge; *pācchāmahe*—do inquire; *tvā*—unto you; *ātma-bhava*—self-born; *ātma-bhūtam*—offspring.

TRANSLATION

Sri Vyāsadeva said: All you have said about me is perfectly correct. Despite all this, I am not pacified. I therefore question you about the root cause of my dissatisfaction, for you are a man of unlimited knowledge due to your being the offspring of one [Brahmā] who is self-born [without mundane father and mother].

PURPORT

In the material world everyone is engrossed with the idea of identifying the body or the mind with the self. As such, all knowledge disseminated in the material world is related either with the body or with the mind, and that is the root cause of all despondencies. This is not always detected, even though one may be the greatest erudite scholar in materialistic knowledge. It is good, therefore, to approach a personality like Nārada to solve the root cause of all despondencies. Why Nārada should be approached is explained below.

TEXT 6

**Sa vE >avaNa(ved SaMaSTaGauù,
MauPaaiSaTaae YaTPauâz" Paura<a")
ParavreXaae MaNaSaEv ivi&
Sa*JaTYavTYaita Gau<aErSa®")) 6))**

sa vai bhavän veda samasta-guhyam

upäsito yat puruṣaù puräëaù

parävareṣo manasaiva viçvaà

såjaty avaty atti guëair asaigaù

SYNONYMS

saù—thus; *vai*—certainly; *bhavän*—yourself; *veda*—know; *samasta*—all-inclusive; *guhyam*—confidential; *upäsitaù*—devotee of; *yat*—because; *puruṣaù*—the Personality of Godhead; *puräëaù*—the oldest; *parävareṣaù*—the controller of the material and spiritual worlds; *manasä*—mind; *eva*—only; *viçvam*—the universe; *såjati*—creates; *avati atti*—annihilates; *guëaiù*—by the qualitative matter; *asaigaù*—unattached.

TRANSLATION

My lord! Everything that is mysterious is known to you because you worship the creator and destroyer of the material world and the maintainer of the spiritual world, the original Personality of Godhead, who is transcendental to the three modes of material nature.

PURPORT

A person who is cent-percent engaged in the service of the Lord is the emblem of all knowledge. Such a devotee of the Lord in full perfection of devotional service is also perfect by the qualification of the Personality of Godhead. As such, the eightfold perfections of mystic power (*añña-siddhi*) constitute very little of his godly opulence. A devotee like Nārada can act wonderfully by his spiritual perfection, which every individual is trying to attain. Srila Nārada is a cent-percent perfect living being, although not equal to the Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 7

Tv& PaYaR\$=àkR- wv i}al/aek-I,
MaNTaêrae vaYauirvaTMaSaa+aq)
Paravre b]øi<a DaMaRTaae v]TaE"
òTaSYa Mae NYaUNaMal&/ ivc+v)) 7))

tvaà paryaöann arka iva tri-lokém

antaç-carò väyur ivätma-säkñé

parävare brahmaëi dharmato vrataiù

snätasya me nyünam alaà vicakñva

SYNONYMS

tvam—Your Goodness; *paryaöan*—traveling; *arka*—the sun; *iva*—like; *tri-lokém*—the three worlds; *anta-carò*—can penetrate into everyone’s heart; *väyur iva*—as good as the all-pervading air; *ätma*—self-realized; *säkñé*—witness; *parävare*—in the matter of cause and effect; *brahmaëi*—in the Absolute; *dharmataù*—under disciplinary regulations; *vrataiù*—in vow; *snätasya*—having been absorbed in; *me*—mine; *nyünam*—deficiency; *alam*—clearly; *vicakñva*—search out.

TRANSLATION

Like the sun, Your Goodness can travel everywhere in the three worlds, and like the air you can penetrate the internal region of everyone. As such, you are as good as the all-pervasive Supersoul. Please, therefore, find out the deficiency in me, despite my being absorbed in transcendence under disciplinary regulations and vows.

PURPORT

Transcendental realization, pious activities, worshiping the Deities, charity, mercifulness, nonviolence and studying the scriptures under strict disciplinary regulations are always helpful.

TEXT 8

é[qNaard ovac

>avTaaNauIdTaPa[aYa& YaXaae >aGavTaae_Mal/Ma()
YaeNaEvaSaaE Na TauZYaeTa MaNYae TaÕXaRNa& i%l/Ma()) 8))

çré-nārada uvāca

bhavatānūdita-prāyaà

yaço bhagavato 'malam

yenaivāsau na tuñyeta

manye tad darçanaà khilam

SYNONYMS

çré-nārada—Sri Nārada; *uvāca*—said; *bhavatā*—by you; *anūdita-prāyam*—almost not praised; *yaça*—glories; *bhagavata*—of the Personality of Godhead; *amalam*—spotless; *yena*—by which; *eva*—certainly; *asau*—He (the Personality of Godhead); *na*—does not; *tuñyeta*—be pleased; *manye*—I think; *tad*—that; *darçanam*—philosophy; *khilam*—inferior.

TRANSLATION

Sri Nārada said: You have not actually broadcast the sublime and spotless glories of the Personality of Godhead. That philosophy which does not satisfy the transcendental senses of the Lord is considered worthless.

PURPORT

The eternal relation of an individual soul with the Supreme Soul Personality of Godhead is constitutionally one of being the eternal servitor of the eternal master. The Lord has expanded Himself as living beings in order to accept loving service from them, and this alone can satisfy both the Lord

and the living beings. Such a scholar as Vyāsadeva has completed many expansions of the Vedic literatures, ending with the Vedānta philosophy, but none of them have been written directly glorifying the Personality of Godhead. Dry philosophical speculations even on the transcendental subject of the Absolute have very little attraction without directly dealing with the glorification of the Lord. The Personality of Godhead is the last word in transcendental realization. The Absolute realized as impersonal Brahman or localized Supersoul, Paramātmā, is less productive of transcendental bliss than the supreme personal realization of His glories.

The compiler of the *Vedānta-darçana* is Vyāsadeva himself. Yet he is troubled, although he is the author. So what sort of transcendental bliss can be derived by the readers and listeners of Vedānta which is not explained directly by Vyāsadeva, the author? Herein arises the necessity of explaining *Vedānta-sūtra* in the form of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* by the self-same author.

TEXT 9

**YaQaa DaMaaRdYaêaQaaR MauiNavYaaRNauk-liTaRTaa")
Na TaQaa vaSaudevSYa MaihMaa ùNauvi<aRTa")) 9))**

yathā dharmādayaḥ cārthā

muni-varyānukértitāu

na tathā vāsudevasya

mahimā hy anuvarēitaù

SYNONYMS

yathā—as much as; *dharmā-ādayaù*—all four principles of religious behavior; *ca*—and; *arthāù*—purposes; *muni-varya*—by yourself, the great sage; *anukértitāù*—repeatedly described; *na*—not; *tathā*—in that way; *vāsudevasya*—of the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa; *mahimā*—glories; *hi*—certainly; *anuvarēitaù*—so constantly described.

TRANSLATION

Although, great sage, you have very broadly described the four principles beginning with religious performances, you have not described the glories of the Supreme Personality, Vāsudeva.

PURPORT

The prompt diagnosis of Sri Nārada is at once declared. The root cause of the despondency of Vyāsadeva was his deliberate avoidance of glorifying the Lord in his various editions of the *Puranas*. He has certainly, as a matter of course, given descriptions of the glories of the Lord (Sri Kṛṣṇa) but not as many as given to religiosity, economic development, sense gratification and salvation. These four items are by far inferior to engagement in the devotional service of the Lord. Sri Vyāsadeva, as the authorized scholar, knew very well this difference. And still instead of giving more importance to the better type of engagement, namely, devotional service to the Lord, he had more or less improperly used his valuable time, and thus he was despondent. From this it is clearly indicated that no one can be pleased substantially without being engaged in the devotional service of the Lord. In the *Bhagavad-gita* this fact is clearly mentioned.

After liberation, which is the last item in the line of performing religiosity, etc., one is engaged in pure devotional service. This is called the stage of self-realization, or the *brahma-bhūta* stage. After attainment of this *brahma-bhūta* stage, one is satisfied. But satisfaction is the beginning of transcendental bliss. One should progress by attaining neutrality and equality in the relative world. And passing this stage of equanimity, one is fixed in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. This is the instruction of the Personality of Godhead in the *Bhagavad-gita*. The conclusion is that in order to maintain the status quo of the *brahma-bhūta* stage, as also to increase the degree of transcendental realization, Nārada recommended to Vyāsadeva that he (Vyāsadeva) should now eagerly and repeatedly describe the path of devotional service. This would cure him from gross despondency.

TEXT 10

Na YaÜciê}aPad& hreYaRXaae
JaGaTPaiv}a& Pa[Ga*<aqTa k-ihRicTa()
TaÜaYaSa& TaqQaRMauXaiNTa MaaNaSaa
Na Ya}a h&Saa iNarMaNTYauixak+aYaa")) 10))

na yad vacaṣ citra-padaà harer yaṣo

jagat-pavitraà pragâëéta karhicit

tad vāyasaà tértham uṣanti mānasä

na yatra haàsä niramanty uṣik-kñayäù

SYNONYMS

na—not; *yat*—that; *vacaù*—vocabulary; *citra-padam*—decorative; *hareù*—of the Lord; *yaṣaù*—glories; *jagat*—universe; *pavitrām*—sanctified; *pragâëéta*—described; *karhicit*—hardly; *tat*—that; *vāyasam*—crows; *tértham*—place of pilgrimage; *uṣanti*—think; *mānasäù*—saintly persons; *na*—not; *yatra*—where; *haàsäù*—all-perfect beings; *niramanti*—take pleasure; *uṣik-kñayäù*—those who reside in the transcendental abode.

TRANSLATION

Those words which do not describe the glories of the Lord, who alone can sanctify the atmosphere of the whole universe, are considered by saintly persons to be like unto a place of pilgrimage for crows. Since the all-perfect persons are inhabitants of the transcendental abode, they do not derive any pleasure there.

PURPORT

Crows and swans are not birds of the same feather because of their different mental attitudes. The fruitive workers or passionate men are compared to the crows, whereas the all-perfect saintly persons are compared to the swans. The crows take pleasure in a place where garbage is thrown out, just as the passionate fruitive workers take pleasure in wine

and woman and places for gross sense pleasure. The swans do not take pleasure in the places where crows are assembled for conferences and meetings. They are instead seen in the atmosphere of natural scenic beauty where there are transparent reservoirs of water nicely decorated with stems of lotus flowers in variegated colors of natural beauty. That is the difference between the two classes of birds.

Nature has influenced different species of life with different mentalities, and it is not possible to bring them up into the same rank and file.

Similarly, there are different kinds of literature for different types of men of different mentality. Mostly the market literatures which attract men of the crow's categories are literatures containing refused remnants of sensuous topics. They are generally known as mundane talks in relation with the gross body and subtle mind. They are full of subject matter described in decorative language full of mundane similes and metaphorical arrangements. Yet with all that, they do not glorify the Lord. Such poetry and prose, on any subject matter, is considered decoration of a dead body. Spiritually advanced men who are compared to the swans do not take pleasure in such dead literatures, which are sources of pleasure for men who are spiritually dead. These literatures in the modes of passion and ignorance are distributed under different labels, but they can hardly help the spiritual urge of the human being, and thus the swanlike spiritually advanced men have nothing to do with them. Such spiritually advanced men are called also *mānasa* because they always keep up the standard of transcendental voluntary service to the Lord on the spiritual plane. This completely forbids fruitive activities for gross bodily sense satisfaction or subtle speculation of the material egoistic mind.

Social literary men, scientists, mundane poets, theoretical philosophers and politicians who are completely absorbed in the material advancement of sense pleasure are all dolls of the material energy. They take pleasure in a place where rejected subject matters are thrown. According to Svāmé Sridhara, this is the pleasure of the prostitute-hunters.

But literatures which describe the glories of the Lord are enjoyed by the *paramahamsas* who have grasped the essence of human activities.

TEXT 11

TaÜaiGvSaGaaeR JaNaTaagaivâvae
YaiSMaNa(Pa[iTaëaek-MabÖvTYaiPa)
NaaMaaNYaNaNTaSYa YaXaae_iªTaaiNa YaTa(
é*<viNTa GaaYaiNTa Ga*<aiNTa SaaDav")) 11))

tad-väg-visargo janatägha-viplavo

yasmin prati-çlokaṁ abaddhavaty api

nāmāṇy anantasya yaço 'ikitāṇi yat

çāḍvanti gāyanti gāḍanti sādhaṇaṁ

SYNONYMS

tat—that; *vāk*—vocabulary; *visargaṁ*—creation; *janatā*—the people in general; *agha*—sins; *viplavaṁ*—revolutionary; *yasmin*—in which; *prati-çlokaṁ*—each and every stanza; *abaddhavaty*—irregularly composed; *api*—in spite of; *nāmāṇi*—transcendental names, etc.; *anantasya*—of the unlimited Lord; *yaçau*—glories; *aikitāṇi*—depicted; *yat*—what; *çāḍvanti*—do hear; *gāyanti*—do sing; *gāḍanti*—do accept; *sādhaṇaṁ*—the purified men who are honest.

TRANSLATION

On the other hand, that literature which is full of descriptions of the transcendental glories of the name, fame, forms, pastimes, etc., of the unlimited Supreme Lord is a different creation, full of transcendental words directed toward bringing about a revolution in the impious lives of this world's misdirected civilization. Such transcendental literatures, even though imperfectly composed, are heard, sung and accepted by purified men who are thoroughly honest.

PURPORT

It is a qualification of the great thinkers to pick up the best even from the worst. It is said that the intelligent man should pick up nectar from a stock of poison, should accept gold even from a filthy place, should accept a good and qualified wife even from an obscure family and should accept a good lesson even from a man or from a teacher who comes from the untouchables. These are some of the ethical instructions for everyone in every place without exception. But a saint is far above the level of an ordinary man. He is always absorbed in glorifying the Supreme Lord because by broadcasting the holy name and fame of the Supreme Lord, the polluted atmosphere of the world will change, and as a result of propagating the transcendental literatures like *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, people will become sane in their transactions. While preparing this commentation on this particular stanza of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* we have a crisis before us. Our neighboring friend China has attacked the border of India with a militaristic spirit. We have practically no business in the political field, yet we see that previously there were both China and India, and they both lived peacefully for centuries without ill feeling. The reason is that they lived those days in an atmosphere of God consciousness, and every country, over the surface of the world, was God-fearing, pure-hearted and simple, and there was no question of political diplomacy. There is no cause of quarrel between the two countries China and India over land which is not very suitable for habitation, and certainly there is no cause for fighting on this issue. But due to the age of quarrel, Kali, which we have discussed, there is always a chance of quarrel on slight provocation. This is due not to the issue in question, but to the polluted atmosphere of this age: systematically there is propaganda by a section of people *to stop glorification of the name and fame of the Supreme Lord*. Therefore, there is a great need for disseminating the message of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* all over the world. It is the duty of every responsible Indian to broadcast the transcendental message of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* throughout the world to do all the supermost good as well as to bring about the desired peace in the world. Because India has failed in her duty by neglecting this responsible work, there is so much quarrel and trouble all over the world. We are confident that if the transcendental message of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is received only by the leading men of the world, certainly there will be a change of heart, and naturally the people in general will follow them. The mass of people in general are tools in the hands of the modern politicians and leaders of the

people. If there is a change of heart of the leaders only, certainly there will be a radical change in the atmosphere of the world. We know that our honest attempt to present this great literature conveying transcendental messages for reviving the God consciousness of the people in general and respiritualizing the world atmosphere is fraught with many difficulties. Our presenting this matter in adequate language, especially a foreign language, will certainly fail, and there will be so many literary discrepancies despite our honest attempt to present it in the proper way. But we are sure that with all our faults in this connection the seriousness of the subject matter will be taken into consideration, and the leaders of society will still accept this due to its being an honest attempt to glorify the Almighty God. When there is fire in a house, the inmates of the house go out to get help from the neighbors who may be foreigners, and yet without knowing the language the victims of the fire express themselves, and the neighbors understand the need, even though not expressed in the same language. The same spirit of cooperation is needed to broadcast this transcendental message of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* throughout the polluted atmosphere of the world. After all, it is a technical science of spiritual values, and thus we are concerned with the techniques and not with the language. If the techniques of this great literature are understood by the people of the world, there will be success.

When there are too many materialistic activities by the people in general all over the world, there is no wonder that a person or a nation attacks another person or nation on slight provocation. That is the rule of this age of Kali or quarrel. The atmosphere is already polluted with corruption of all description, and everyone knows it well. There are so many unwanted literatures full of materialistic ideas of sense gratification. In many countries there are bodies appointed by the state to detect and censor obscene literature. This means that neither the government nor the responsible leaders of the public want such literature, yet it is in the marketplace because the people want it for sense gratification. The people in general want to read (that is a natural instinct), but because their minds are polluted they want such literatures. Under the circumstances, transcendental literature like *Srimad-Bhagavatam* will not only diminish the activities of the corrupt mind of the people in general, but also it will supply food for their hankering after reading some interesting literature. In the

beginning they may not like it because one suffering from jaundice is reluctant to take sugar candy, but we should know that sugar candy is the only remedy for jaundice. Similarly, let there be systematic propaganda for popularizing reading of the *Bhagavad-gita* and the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, which will act like sugar candy for the jaundicelike condition of sense gratification. When men have a taste for this literature, the other literatures, which are catering poison to society, will then automatically cease.

We are sure, therefore, that everyone in human society will welcome *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, even though it is now presented with so many faults, for it is recommended by Sri Nārada, who has very kindly appeared in this chapter.

TEXT 12

NaEZk-MYaRMaPYaCYauTa>aavviJaRTa&
 Na Xaae>aTae jaNaMal&/ iNarĀNaMa()
 ku-Ta" PauNa" Xaīd>ad]Maqire
 Na caiPaRTa& k-MaR YadPYak-ar<aMa()) 12))

naiñkarmyam apy acyuta-bhāva-varjitaà

na çobhate jñānam alaà niraijanam

kutaù punaù çaçvad abhadram éçvare

na cārpitaà karma yad apy akāraëam

SYNONYMS

naiñkarmyam—self-realization, being freed from the reactions of fruitive work; *api*—in spite of; *acyuta*—the infallible Lord; *bhāva*—conception; *varjitam*—devoid of; *na*—does not; *çobhate*—look well; *jñānam*—transcendental knowledge; *alam*—by and by; *niraijanam*—free from designations; *kutaù*—where is; *punaù*—again; *çaçvat*—always; *abhadram*—uncongenial; *éçvare*—unto the Lord; *na*—not; *ca*—and; *arpitam*—offered;

karma—fruitive work; *yat api*—what is; *akāraëam*—not fruitive.

TRANSLATION

Knowledge of self-realization, even though free from all material affinity, does not look well if devoid of a conception of the Infallible [God]. What, then, is the use of fruitive activities, which are naturally painful from the very beginning and transient by nature, if they are not utilized for the devotional service of the Lord?

PURPORT

As referred to above, not only ordinary literatures devoid of the transcendental glorification of the Lord are condemned, but also Vedic literatures and speculation on the subject of impersonal Brahman when they are devoid of devotional service. When speculation on the impersonal Brahman is condemned on the above ground, then what to speak of ordinary fruitive work, which is not meant to fulfill the aim of devotional service. Such speculative knowledge and fruitive work cannot lead one to the goal of perfection. Fruitive work, in which almost all people in general are engaged, is always painful either in the beginning or at the end. It can be fruitful only when made subservient to the devotional service of the Lord. In the *Bhagavad-gita* also it is confirmed that the result of such fruitive work may be offered for the service of the Lord, otherwise it leads to material bondage. The bona fide enjoyer of the fruitive work is the Personality of Godhead, and thus when it is engaged for the sense gratification of the living beings, it becomes an acute source of trouble.

TEXT 13

**AQaae Maha>aaGa >avaNaMaaegad*k(-
éuicé[va" SaTYarTaae Da*Tav]Ta")
oå§-MaSYaai%l/bNDaMauç-Yae
SaMaaiDaNaaNauSMar TaiÜceiíTaMa()) 13))**

atho mahä-bhāga bhavān amogha-dāk

çuci-çraväù satya-rato dhâta-vrataù

urukramasyäkhila-bandha-muktaye

samädhinānusmara tad-viceññōitam

SYNONYMS

atho—therefore; *mahā-bhāga*—highly fortunate; *bhavān*—yourself; *amogha-dāk*—the perfect seer; *çuci*—spotless; *çraväù*—famous; *satya-rataù*—having taken the vow of truthfulness; *dhâta-vrataù*—fixed in spiritual qualities; *urukramasya*—of the one who performs supernatural activities (God); *akhila*—universal; *bandha*—bondage; *muktaye*—for liberation from; *samädhinā*—by trance; *anusmara*—think repeatedly and then describe them; *tat-viceññōitam*—various pastimes of the Lord.

TRANSLATION

O Vyāsadeva, your vision is completely perfect. Your good fame is spotless. You are firm in vow and situated in truthfulness. And thus you can think of the pastimes of the Lord in trance for the liberation of the people in general from all material bondage.

PURPORT

People in general have a taste for literatures by instinct. They want to hear and read from the authorities something about the unknown, but their taste is exploited by unfortunate literatures which are full of subject matter for satisfaction of the material senses. Such literatures contain different kinds of mundane poems and philosophical speculations, more or less under the influence of *māyā*, ending in sense gratification. These literatures, although worthless in the true sense of the term, are variously decorated to attract the attention of the less intelligent men. Thus the attracted living entities are more and more entangled in material bondage without hope of liberation for thousands and thousands of generations. Sri Nārada Rsi, being the best amongst the Vaiññēavas, is compassionate toward such unfortunate victims of worthless literatures, and thus he

advises Sri Vyāsadeva to compose transcendental literature which is not only attractive but can also actually bring liberation from all kinds of bondage. Srila Vyāsadeva or his representatives are qualified because they are rightly trained to see things in true perspective. Srila Vyāsadeva and his representatives are pure in thought due to their spiritual enlightenment, fixed in their vows due to their devotional service, and determined to deliver the fallen souls rotting in material activities. The fallen souls are very eager to receive novel informations every day, and the transcendentalists like Vyāsadeva or Nārada can supply such eager people in general with unlimited news from the spiritual world. In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is said that the material world is only a part of the whole creation and that this earth is only a fragment of the whole material world.

There are thousands and thousands of literary men all over the world, and they have created many, many thousands of literary works for the information of the people in general for thousands and thousands of years. Unfortunately none of them have brought peace and tranquillity on the earth. This is due to a spiritual vacuum in those literatures; therefore the Vedic literatures, especially the *Bhagavad-gita* and the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, are specifically recommended to suffering humanity to bring about the desired effect of liberation from the pangs of material civilization, which is eating the vital part of human energy. The *Bhagavad-gita* is the spoken message of the Lord Himself recorded by Vyāsadeva, and the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the transcendental narration of the activities of the same Lord Kṛṣṇa, which alone can satisfy the hankering desires of the living being for eternal peace and liberation from miseries. *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, therefore, is meant for all the living beings all over the universe for total liberation from all kinds of material bondage. Such transcendental narrations of the pastimes of the Lord can be described only by liberated souls like Vyāsadeva and his bona fide representatives who are completely merged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. Only to such devotees do the pastimes of the Lord and their transcendental nature become automatically manifest by dint of devotional service. No one else can either know or describe the acts of the Lord, even if they speculate on the subject for many, many years. The descriptions of the *Bhāgavatam* are so precise and accurate that whatever has been predicted in this great literature about five thousand years ago is now exactly happening.

Therefore, the vision of the author comprehends past, present and future. Such liberated persons as Vyāsadeva are perfect not only by the power of vision and wisdom, but also in aural reception, in thinking, feeling and all other sense activities. A liberated person possesses perfect senses, and with perfect senses only can one serve the sense proprietor, Hãñékeça, Sri Kṛṣṇa the Personality of Godhead. *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, therefore, is the perfect description of the all-perfect Personality of Godhead by the all-perfect personality Srila Vyāsadeva, the compiler of the *Vedas*.

TEXT 14

TaTaae_NYaQaa ik-ÄNa YaiÜv+aTa"
Pa*QaGd*XaSTaTk*-TaæPaNaaMai>a")
Na k-ihRicTKvaiPa c du"iSQaTaa MaiTa,
IR/>æTa vaTaahTaNaaiEirvaSPadMa()) 14))

tato 'nyathä kiïcana yad vivakñataù

pāthag dāças tat-kāta-rūpa-nāmabhiù

na karhicit kväpi ca duùsthitä matir

labheta vätähata-naur iväspadam

SYNONYMS

tataù—from that; *anyathä*—apart; *kiïcana*—something; *yat*—whatsoever; *vivakñataù*—desiring to describe; *pāthak*—separately; *dāçaù*—vision; *tat-kāta*—reactionary to that; *rūpa*—form; *nāmabhiù*—by names; *na karhicit*—never; *kväpi*—any; *ca*—and; *duùsthitä matiù*—oscillating mind; *labheta*—gains; *väta-ähata*—troubled by the wind; *nauù*—boat; *iva*—like; *äspadam*—place.

TRANSLATION

Whatever you desire to describe that is separate in vision from the Lord simply reacts, with different forms, names and results, to agitate the mind

as the wind agitates a boat which has no resting place.

PURPORT

Sri Vyāsadeva is the editor of all descriptions of the Vedic literatures, and thus he has described transcendental realization in different ways, namely by fruitive activities, speculative knowledge, mystic power and devotional service. Besides that, in his various *Puranas* he has recommended the worship of so many demigods in different forms and names. The result is that people in general are puzzled how to fix their minds in the service of the Lord; they are always disturbed about finding the real path of self-realization. Srila Nārādadeva is stressing this particular defect in the Vedic literatures compiled by Vyāsadeva, and thus he is trying to emphasize describing everything in relation with the Supreme Lord, and no one else. In fact, there is nothing existent except the Lord. The Lord is manifested in different expansions. He is the root of the complete tree. He is the stomach of the complete body. pouring water on the root is the right process to water the tree, as much as feeding the stomach supplies energy to all parts of the body. Therefore, Srila Vyāsadeva should not have compiled any *Puranas* other than the *Bhāgavata Purana* because a slight deviation from that may create havoc for self-realization. If a slight deviation can create such havoc, then what to speak of deliberate expansion of the ideas separate from the Absolute Truth Personality of Godhead. The most defective part of worshiping demigods is that it creates a definite conception of pantheism, ending disastrously in many religious sects detrimental to the progress of the principles of the *Bhāgavatam*, which alone can give the accurate direction for self-realization in eternal relation with the Personality of Godhead by devotional service in transcendental love. The example of the boat disturbed by whirling wind is suitable in this respect. The diverted mind of the pantheist can never reach the perfection of self-realization, due to the disturbed condition of the selection of object.

TEXT 15

**JauGauiPSaTa& DaMaRk*-Tae_NauXaaSaTa"
Sv>aavrç-SYa MahaNa(VYaiTa§-Ma")
YaÜaKYaTaae DaMaR wTaqTar" iSQaTaae**

Na MaNYaTae TaSYa iNavar<a& JaNa")) 15))

jugupsitaà dharma-kâte 'nuçäsataù

svabhäva-raktasya mahän vyatikramaù

yad-väkyato dharma itétaraù sthito

na manyate tasya niväraëaà janaù

SYNONYMS

jugupsitam—verily condemned; *dharma-kâte*—for the matter of religion; *anuçäsataù*—instruction; *svabhäva-raktasya*—naturally inclined; *mahän*—great; *vyatikramaù*—unreasonable; *yad-väkyataù*—under whose instruction; *dharmaù*—religion; *iti*—it is thus; *itaraù*—the people in general; *sthitaù*—fixed; *na*—do not; *manyate*—think; *tasya*—of that; *niväraëam*—prohibition; *janaù*—they.

TRANSLATION

The people in general are naturally inclined to enjoy, and you have encouraged them in that way in the name of religion. This is verily condemned and is quite unreasonable. Because they are guided under your instructions, they will accept such activities in the name of religion and will hardly care for prohibitions.

PURPORT

Srila Vyāsadeva’s compilation of different Vedic literatures on the basis of regulated performances of fruitive activities as depicted in the *Mahābhārata* and other literature is condemned herewith by Srila Nārada. The human beings, by long material association, life after life, have a natural inclination, by practice, to endeavor to lord it over material energy. They have no sense of the responsibility of human life. This human form of life is a chance to get out of the clutches of illusory matter. The *Vedas* are meant for going back to Godhead, going back home. To revolve in the cycle

of transmigration in a series of lives numbering 8,400,000 is an imprisoned life for the condemned conditioned souls. The human form of life is a chance to get out of this imprisoned life, and as such the only occupation of the human being is to reestablish his lost relationship with God. Under the circumstances, one should never be encouraged in making a plan for sense enjoyment in the name of religious functions. Such diversion of the human energy results in a misguided civilization. Srila Vyāsadeva is the authority in Vedic explanations in the *Mahābhārata*, etc., and his encouragement in sense enjoyment in some form or other is a great barrier for spiritual advancement because the people in general will not agree to renounce material activities which held them in material bondage. At a certain stage of human civilization when such material activities in the name of religion (as sacrificing animals in the name of *yajña*) were too much rampant, the Lord incarnated Himself as Buddha and decried the authority of the *Vedas* in order to stop animal sacrifice in the name of religion. This was foreseen by Nārada, and therefore he condemned such literatures. The flesh-eaters still continue to perform animal sacrifice before some demigod or goddess in the name of religion because in some of the Vedic literatures such regulated sacrifices are recommended. They are so recommended to discourage flesh-eating, but gradually the purpose of such religious activities is forgotten, and the slaughterhouse becomes prominent. This is because foolish materialistic men do not care to listen to others who are actually in a position to explain the Vedic rites.

In the *Vedas* it is distinctly said that the perfection of life is never to be attained either by voluminous work, or by accumulation of wealth or even by increasing the population. But it is so attained only by renunciation. The materialistic men do not care to listen to such injunctions. According to them, the so-called renounced order of life is meant for those who are unable to earn their livelihood because of some corporeal defects, or for persons who have failed to achieve prosperity in family life.

In histories like the *Mahābhārata*, of course, there are topics on transcendental subjects along with material topics. The *Bhagavad-gītā* is there in the *Mahābhārata*. The whole idea of the *Mahābhārata* culminates in the ultimate instructions of the *Bhagavad-gītā*, that one should relinquish all other engagements and should engage oneself solely and fully

in surrendering unto the lotus feet of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. But men with materialistic tendencies are more attracted to the politics, economics and philanthropic activities mentioned in the *Mahābhārata* than to the principal topic, namely the *Bhagavad-gītā*. This compromising spirit of Vyāsadeva is directly condemned by Nārada, who advises him to directly proclaim that the prime necessity of human life is to realize one's eternal relation with the Lord and thus surrender unto Him without delay.

A patient suffering from a particular type of malady is almost always inclined to accept eatables which are forbidden for him. The expert physician does not make any compromise with the patient by allowing him to take partially what he should not at all take. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* it is also said that a man attached to fruitive work should not be discouraged from his occupation, for gradually he may be elevated to the position of self-realization. This is sometimes applicable for those who are only dry empiric philosophers without spiritual realization. But those who are in the devotional line need not be always so advised.

TEXT 16

ivc+a<aae_SYaahRiTā veidTau& iv>aae,
rNaNTaPaarSYa iNav*itaTa" Sau%Ma()
Pa[vTaRMaaNaSYa Gau<aErNaaTMaNa,
STaTaae >avaNdXaRYa ceiíTa& iv>aae")) 16))

vicakñāēo 'syārhati vedituà vibhor

ananta-pārasya nivāttitaù sukham

pravartamānasya guëair anātmanas

tato bhavān darçaya ceñöitaà vibhou

SYNONYMS

vicakñāēaù—very expert; *asya*—of him; *arhati*—deserves; *veditum*—to understand; *vibhou*—of the Lord; *ananta-pārasya*—of the unlimited;

nivāttitaù—retired from; *sukham*—material happiness; *pravartamānasya*—those who are attached to; *guëaiù*—by the material qualities; *anātmanaù*—devoid of knowledge in spiritual value; *tataù*—therefore; *bhavān*—Your Goodness; *darçaya*—show the ways; *ceñöitam*—activities; *vibhoù*—of the Lord.

TRANSLATION

The Supreme Lord is unlimited. Only a very expert personality, retired from the activities of material happiness, deserves to understand this knowledge of spiritual values. Therefore those who are not so well situated, due to material attachment, should be shown the ways of transcendental realization, by Your Goodness, through descriptions of the transcendental activities of the Supreme Lord.

PURPORT

Theological science is a difficult subject, especially when it deals with the transcendental nature of God. It is not a subject matter to be understood by persons who are too much attached to material activities. Only the very expert, who have almost retired from materialistic activities by culture of spiritual knowledge, can be admitted to the study of this great science. In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is clearly stated that out of many hundreds and thousands of men only one person deserves to enter into transcendental realization. And out of many thousands of such transcendently realized persons, only a few can understand the theological science specifically dealing with God as a person. Sri Vyāsadeva is therefore advised by Nārada to describe the science of God directly by relating His transcendental activities. Vyāsadeva is himself a personality expert in this science, and he is unattached to material enjoyment. Therefore he is the right person to describe it, and Çukadeva Gosvami, the son of Vyāsadeva, is the right person to receive it.

Srimad-Bhagavatam is the topmost theological science, and therefore it can react on the laymen as medicinal doses. Because it contains the transcendental activities of the Lord, there is no difference between the Lord and the literature. The literature is the factual literary incarnation of

the Lord. So the laymen can hear the narration of the activities of the Lord. Thereby they are able to associate with the Lord and thus gradually become purified from material diseases. The expert devotees also can discover novel ways and means to convert the nondevotees in terms of particular time and circumstance. Devotional service is dynamic activity, and the expert devotees can find out competent means to inject it into the dull brains of the materialistic population. Such transcendental activities of the devotees for the service of the Lord can bring a new order of life to the foolish society of materialistic men. Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu and His subsequent followers exhibited expert dexterity in this connection. By following the same method, one can bring the materialistic men of this age of quarrel into order for peaceful life and transcendental realization.

TEXT 17

**TYaṁ-a SvDaMa | cr<aaMbuJa& hre,
>aRJaàPaKvae_Qa PaTaetaTaae Yaid)
Ya}a Kv va>ad]Ma>aUdMauZYa ik&-
k-ae vaQaR Aaáae_>aJaTaa& SvDaMaRTa")) 17))**

tyaktvä sva-dharmaà caraëämbujaà harer

bhajann apakvo 'tha patet tato yadi

yatra kva väbhadram abhüd amuñya kià

ko värtha äpto 'bhajatäà sva-dharmataù

SYNONYMS

tyaktvä—having forsaken; *sva-dharmam*—one's own occupational engagement; *caraëa-ambujam*—the lotus feet; *hareù*—of Hari (the Lord); *bhajan*—in the course of devotional service; *apakvaù*—immature; *atha*—for the matter of; *patet*—falls down; *tataù*—from that place; *yadi*—if; *yatra*—whereupon; *kva*—what sort of; *vä*—or (used sarcastically); *abhadram*—unfavorable; *abhüt*—shall happen; *amuñya*—of him; *kim*—nothing; *kaù vä arthaù*—what interest; *äptaù*—obtained; *abhajatäm*—of

the nondevotee; *sva-dharmataù*—being engaged in occupational service.

TRANSLATION

One who has forsaken his material occupations to engage in the devotional service of the Lord may sometimes fall down while in an immature stage, yet there is no danger of his being unsuccessful. On the other hand, a nondevotee, though fully engaged in occupational duties, does not gain anything.

PURPORT

As far as the duties of mankind are concerned, there are innumerable duties. Every man is duty-bound not only to his parents, family members, society, country, humanity, other living beings, the demigods, etc., but also to the great philosophers, poets, scientists, etc. It is enjoined in the scriptures that one can relinquish all such duties and surrender unto the service of the Lord. So if one does so and becomes successful in the discharge of his devotional service unto the Lord, it is well and good. But it so happens sometimes that one surrenders himself unto the service of the Lord by some temporary sentiment, and in the long run, due to so many other reasons, he falls down from the path of service by undesirable association. There are so many instances of this in the histories. Bharata Mahārāja was obliged to take his birth as a stag due to his intimate attachment to a stag. He thought of this stag when he died. As such, in the next birth he became a stag, although he did not forget the incident of his previous birth. Similarly, Citraketu also fell down due to his offenses at the feet of Siva. But in spite of all this, the stress is given here to surrendering unto the lotus feet of the Lord, even if there is a chance of falling down, because even though one falls down from the prescribed duties of devotional service, he will never forget the lotus feet of the Lord. Once engaged in the devotional service of the Lord, one will continue the service in all circumstances. In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is said that even a small quantity of devotional service can save one from the most dangerous position. There are many instances of such examples in history. Ajāmila is one of them. Ajāmila in his early life was a devotee, but in his youth he fell down. Still he was saved by the Lord at the end.

TEXT 18

TaSYaEv heTaa" Pa[YaTaeTa k-aeivdae
Na I/>YaTae Yad(>a]MaTaaMauPaYaRDa")
Taç>YaTae du"%vdNYaTa" Sau%&
k-ale/Na SavR}a Ga>aqrr&hSaa)) 18))

tasyaiva hetoû prayateta kovido

na labhyate yad bhramatäm upary adhaù

tal labhyate duùkhavad anyataù sukhaà

kälena sarvatra gabhéra-raàhasä

SYNONYMS

tasya—for that purpose; *eva*—only; *hetoû*—reason; *prayateta*—should endeavor; *kovidaù*—one who is philosophically inclined; *na*—not; *labhyate*—is not obtained; *yat*—what; *bhramatäm*—wandering; *upari adhaù*—from top to bottom; *tat*—that; *labhyate*—can be obtained; *duùkhavat*—like the miseries; *anyataù*—as a result of previous work; *sukham*—sense enjoyment; *kälena*—in course of time; *sarvatra*—everywhere; *gabhéra*—subtle; *raàhasä*—progress.

TRANSLATION

Persons who are actually intelligent and philosophically inclined should endeavor only for that purposeful end which is not obtainable even by wandering from the topmost planet [Brahmaloka] down to the lowest planet [Pätäla]. As far as happiness derived from sense enjoyment is concerned, it can be obtained automatically in course of time, just as in course of time we obtain miseries even though we do not desire them.

PURPORT

Every man everywhere is trying to obtain the greatest amount of sense

enjoyment by various endeavors. Some men are busy engaged in trade, industry, economic development, political supremacy, etc., and some of them are engaged in fruitive work to become happy in the next life by attaining higher planets. It is said that on the moon the inhabitants are fit for greater sense enjoyment by drinking *soma-rasa*, and the Pitåloka is obtained by good charitable work. So there are various programs for sense enjoyment, either during this life or in the life after death. Some are trying to reach the moon or other planets by some mechanical arrangement, for they are very anxious to get into such planets without doing good work. But it is not to happen. By the law of the Supreme, different places are meant for different grades of living beings according to the work they have performed. By good work only, as prescribed in the scriptures, can one obtain birth in a good family, opulence, good education and good bodily features. We see also that even in this life one obtains a good education or money by good work. Similarly, in our next birth we get such desirable positions only by good work. Otherwise, it would not so happen that two persons born in the same place at the same time are seen differently placed according to previous work. But all such material positions are impermanent. The positions in the topmost Brahmaloka and in the lowest Pātåla are also changeable according to our own work. The philosophically inclined person must not be tempted by such changeable positions. He should try to get into the permanent life of bliss and knowledge where he will not be forced to come back again to the miserable material world, either in this or that planet. Miseries and mixed happiness are two features of material life, and they are obtained in Brahmaloka and in other *lokas* also. They are obtained in the life of the demigods and also in the life of the dogs and hogs. The miseries and mixed happiness of all living beings are only of different degree and quality, but no one is free from the miseries of birth, death, old age and disease. Similarly, everyone has his destined happiness also. No one can get more or less of these things simply by personal endeavors. Even if they are obtained, they can be lost again. One should not, therefore, waste time with these flimsy things; one should only endeavor to go back to Godhead. That should be the mission of everyone's life.

TEXT 19

Na vE JaNaae JaaTau k-QaÄNaav]Jae,
NMauku-NdSaeVYaNYavd® Sa&Sa*iTaMa()
SMarNMauku-Ndax(ga]yuPaGaUhNa& PauNa,
ivRhaTauMaC^eà rSaGa]hae JaNa")) 19))

na vai jano jätu kathaïcanävrajen

mukunda-sevy anyavad aïga saàsätim

smaran mukundäïghry-upagühanaà punar

vihätum icchen na rasa-graho janaù

SYNONYMS

na—never; *vai*—certainly; *janaù*—a person; *jätu*—at any time; *kathaïcana*—somehow or other; *ävrajet*—does not undergo; *mukunda-sevé*—the devotee of the Lord; *anyavat*—like others; *aïga*—O my dear; *saàsätim*—material existence; *smaran*—remembering; *mukunda-aïghri*—the lotus feet of the Lord; *upagühanam*—embracing; *punaù*—again; *vihätum*—willing to give up; *icchet*—desire; *na*—never; *rasa-grahaù*—one who has relished the mellow; *janaù*—person.

TRANSLATION

My dear Vyäsa, even though a devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa sometimes falls down somehow or other, he certainly does not undergo material existence like others [fruitive workers, etc.] because a person who has once relished the taste of the lotus feet of the Lord can do nothing but remember that ecstasy again and again.

PURPORT

A devotee of the Lord automatically becomes uninterested in the enchantment of material existence because he is *rasa-graha*, or one who has tasted the sweetness of the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa. There are certainly many instances where devotees of the Lord have fallen down due to

uncongenial association, just like fruitive workers, who are always prone to degradation. But even though he falls down, a devotee is never to be considered the same as a fallen *karmé*. A *karmé* suffers the result of his own fruitive reactions, whereas a devotee is reformed by chastisement directed by the Lord Himself. The sufferings of an orphan and the sufferings of a beloved child of a king are not one and the same. An orphan is really poor because he has no one to take care of him, but a beloved son of a rich man, although he appears to be on the same level as the orphan, is always under the vigilance of his capable father. A devotee of the Lord, due to wrong association, sometimes imitates the fruitive workers. The fruitive workers want to lord it over the material world. Similarly, a neophyte devotee foolishly thinks of accumulating some material power in exchange for devotional service. Such foolish devotees are sometimes put into difficulty by the Lord Himself. As a special favor, He may remove all material paraphernalia. By such action, the bewildered devotee is forsaken by all friends and relatives, and so he comes to his senses again by the mercy of the Lord and is set right to execute his devotional service.

In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is also said that such fallen devotees are given a chance to take birth in a family of highly qualified *brahmanas* or in a rich mercantile family. A devotee in such a position is not as fortunate as one who is chastised by the Lord and put into a position seemingly of helplessness. The devotee who becomes helpless by the will of the Lord is more fortunate than those who are born in good families. The fallen devotees born in a good family may forget the lotus feet of the Lord because they are less fortunate, but the devotee who is put into a forlorn condition is more fortunate because he swiftly returns to the lotus feet of the Lord, thinking himself helpless all around.

Pure devotional service is so spiritually relishable that a devotee becomes automatically uninterested in material enjoyment. That is the sign of perfection in progressive devotional service. A pure devotee continuously remembers the lotus feet of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and does not forget Him even for a moment, not even in exchange for all the opulence of the three worlds.

TEXT 20

wd& ih ivi& >aGavaiNaveTarae
YaTaae JaGaTSQaaNaiNaraeDaSaM>ava")
TaiÖ SvYa& ved >ava&STaQaaIPa Tae
Pa[adeXaMaa}a& >avTa" Pa[diXaRTaMa()) 20))

idaà hi viçvaà bhagavän ivetaro

yato jagat-sthäna-nirodha-sambhaväù

tad dhi svayaà veda bhaväàs tathäpi te

prädeça-mätraà bhavataù pradarçitam

SYNONYMS

idam—this; *hi*—all; *viçvam*—cosmos; *bhagavän*—the Supreme Lord; *iva*—almost the same; *itaraù*—different from; *yataù*—from whom; *jagat*—the worlds; *sthäna*—exist; *nirodha*—annihilation; *sambhaväù*—creation; *tat* *hi*—all about; *svayam*—personally; *veda*—know; *bhavän*—your good self; *tathä api*—still; *te*—unto you; *prädeça-mätram*—a synopsis only; *bhavataù*—unto you; *pradarçitam*—explained.

TRANSLATION

The Supreme Lord Personality of Godhead is Himself this cosmos, and still He is aloof from it. From Him only has this cosmic manifestation emanated, in Him it rests, and unto Him it enters after annihilation. Your good self knows all about this. I have given only a synopsis.

PURPORT

For a pure devotee, the conception of Mukunda, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, is both personal and impersonal. The impersonal cosmic situation is also Mukunda because it is the emanation of the energy of Mukunda. For example, a tree is a complete unit, whereas the leaves and the branches of the tree are emanated parts and parcels of the tree. The leaves and branches of the tree are also the tree, but the tree itself is neither the leaves nor the

branches. The Vedic version that the whole cosmic creation is nothing but Brahman means that since everything is emanating from the Supreme Brahman, nothing is apart from Him. Similarly, the part-and-parcel hands and legs are called the body, but the body as the whole unit is neither the hands nor the legs. The Lord is the transcendental form of eternity, cognition and beauty. And thus the creation of the energy of the Lord appears to be partially eternal, full of knowledge and beautiful also. The captivated conditioned souls under the influence of the external energy, *māyā*, are therefore entrapped in the network of the material nature. They accept this as all in all, for they have no information of the Lord who is the primeval cause. Nor have they information that the parts and parcels of the body, being detached from the whole body, are no longer the same hand or leg as when attached to the body. Similarly, a godless civilization detached from the transcendental loving service of the Supreme Personality of Godhead is just like a detached hand or leg. Such parts and parcels may appear like hands and legs, but they have no efficiency. The devotee of the Lord, Srila Vyāsadeva, knows this very well. He is further advised by Srila Nārada to expand the idea so that the entrapped conditioned souls may take lessons from him to understand the Supreme Lord as the primeval cause.

According to the Vedic version, the Lord is naturally fully powerful, and thus His supreme energies are always perfect and identical with Him. Both the spiritual and the material skies and their paraphernalia are emanations of the internal and external energies of the Lord. External energy is comparatively inferior, whereas the internal potency is superior. The superior energy is living force, and therefore she is completely identical, but the external energy, being inert, is partially identical. But both the energies are neither equal to nor greater than the Lord, who is the generator of all energies; such energies are always under His control, exactly as electrical energy, however powerful it may be, is always under the control of the engineer.

The human being and all other living beings are products of His internal energies. Thus the living being is also identical with the Lord. But he is never equal or superior to the Personality of Godhead. The Lord and living beings are all individual persons. With the help of the material energies the

living beings are also creating something, but none of their creations are equal or superior to the creations of the Lord. The human being may create a small playful sputnik and may throw it into outer space, but that does not mean that he can create a planet like the earth or moon and float it in the air as the Lord does. Men with a poor fund of knowledge claim to be equal to the Lord. They are never equal to the Lord. This is never to be. The human being, after attaining complete perfection, may achieve a large percentage of the qualities of the Lord (say up to seventy-eight percent), but it is never possible to surpass the Lord or to become equal with Him. In a diseased condition only, the foolish being claims to be one with the Lord and thus becomes misled by the illusory energy. The misguided living beings, therefore, must accept the supremacy of the Lord and agree to render loving service to Him. For this they have been created. Without this, there cannot be any peace or tranquillity in the world. Srila Vyāsadeva is advised by Srila Nārada to expand this idea in the *Bhāgavatam*. In the *Bhagavad-gītā* also the same idea is explained: surrender fully unto the lotus feet of the Lord. That is the only business of the perfect human being.

TEXT 21

**TvMaaTMaNaaTMaaNaMaveùMaaegad*k(-
ParSYa Pau&Sa" ParMaaTMaNa" k-l/aMa()
AJa& Pa[JaaTa& JaGaTa" iXavaYa Ta,
NMahaNau>aava>YaudYaae_iDaGa<YaTaaMa()) 21))**

tvam ātmanātmānam avehy amogha-dāk

parasya puàsaù paramātmānaù kalām

ajaà prajātaà jagataù çivāya tan

mahānubhāvābhyudayo 'dhigaëyatām

SYNONYMS

tvam—yourself; *ātmanā*—by your own self; *ātmānam*—the Supersoul; *avehi*—search out; *amogha-dāk*—one who has perfect vision; *parasya*—of

the Transcendence; *puàsaù*—the Personality of Godhead; *paramätmanaù*—of the Supreme Lord; *kaläm*—plenary part; *ajam*—birthless; *prajätam*—have taken birth; *jagataù*—of the world; *çiväya*—for the well-being; *tat*—that; *mahä-anubháva*—of the Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa; *abhyudayaù*—pastimes; *adhigaëya-täm*—describe most vividly.

TRANSLATION

Your Goodness has perfect vision. You yourself can know the Supersoul Personality of Godhead because you are present as the plenary portion of the Lord. Although you are birthless, you have appeared on this earth for the well-being of all people. Please, therefore, describe the transcendental pastimes of the Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa more vividly.

PURPORT

Srila Vyäsadeva is the empowered plenary portion incarnation of the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa. He descended by his causeless mercy to deliver the fallen souls in the material world. The fallen and forgotten souls are detached from the transcendental loving service of the Lord. The living entities are parts and parcels of the Lord, and they are eternally servitors of the Lord. All the Vedic literatures, therefore, are put into systematic order for the benefit of the fallen souls, and it is the duty of the fallen souls to take advantage of such literatures and be freed from the bondage of material existence. Although formally Srila Nārada Rsi is his spiritual master, Srila Vyäsadeva is not at all dependent on a spiritual master because in essence he is the spiritual master of everyone else. But because he is doing the work of an *äcärya*, he has taught us by his own conduct that one must have a spiritual master, even though he be God Himself. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, Lord Sri Rāma and Lord Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu, all incarnations of Godhead, accepted formal spiritual masters, although by Their transcendental nature They were cognizant of all knowledge. In order to direct people in general to the lotus feet of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, He Himself in the incarnation of Vyäsadeva is delineating the transcendental pastimes of the Lord.

TEXT 22

wd& ih Pau&SaSTaPaSa" é[uTaSYa va
iSvíSYa SaUç-SYa c buiÖdtaYaae")
AivCYauTaae_QaR" k-ivi>aiNaRæiPaTaae
YadutaMaëaek-Gau<aaNauv<aRNaMa()) 22))

idaà hi puàsas tapasaù çrutasya vā

sviñöasya süktasya ca buddhi-dattayoù

avicyuto 'rthaù kavibhir nirüpito

yad-uttamaçloka-guëänuvarëanam

SYNONYMS

idam—this; *hi*—certainly; *puàsaù*—of everyone; *tapasaù*—by dint of austerities; *çrutasya*—by dint of study of the *Vedas*; *vā*—or; *sviñöasya*—sacrifice; *süktasya*—spiritual education; *ca*—and; *buddhi*—culture of knowledge; *dattayoù*—charity; *avicyutaù*—infallible; *arthaù*—interest; *kavibhiù*—by the recognized learned person; *nirüpitaù*—concluded; *yat*—what; *uttamaçloka*—the Lord, who is described by choice poetry; *guëa-anuvarëanam*—description of the transcendental qualities of.

TRANSLATION

Learned circles have positively concluded that the infallible purpose of the advancement of knowledge, namely austerities, study of the Vedas, sacrifice, chanting of hymns and charity, culminates in the transcendental descriptions of the Lord, who is defined in choice poetry.

PURPORT

Human intellect is developed for advancement of learning in art, science, philosophy, physics, chemistry, psychology, economics, politics, etc. By culture of such knowledge the human society can attain perfection of life.

This perfection of life culminates in the realization of the Supreme Being, Viṣṇu. The *śruti* therefore directs that those who are actually advanced in learning should aspire for the service of Lord Viṣṇu. Unfortunately persons who are enamored by the external beauty of *viṣṇu-māyā* do not understand that culmination of perfection or self-realization depends on Viṣṇu. *Viṣṇu-māyā* means sense enjoyment, which is transient and miserable. Those who are entrapped by *viṣṇu-māyā* utilize advancement of knowledge for sense enjoyment. Sri Nārada Muni has explained that all paraphernalia of the cosmic universe is but an emanation from the Lord out of His different energies because the Lord has set in motion, by His inconceivable energy, the actions and reactions of the created manifestation. They have come to be out of His energy, they rest on His energy, and after annihilation they merge into Him. Nothing is, therefore, different from Him, but at the same time the Lord is always different from them.

When advancement of knowledge is applied in the service of the Lord, the whole process becomes absolute. The Personality of Godhead and His transcendental name, fame, glory, etc., are all nondifferent from Him. Therefore, all the sages and devotees of the Lord have recommended that the subject matter of art, science, philosophy, physics, chemistry, psychology and all other branches of knowledge should be wholly and solely applied in the service of the Lord. Art, literature, poetry, painting, etc., may be used in glorifying the Lord. The fiction writers, poets and celebrated litterateurs are generally engaged in writing of sensuous subjects, but if they turn towards the service of the Lord they can describe the transcendental pastimes of the Lord. Vālméki was a great poet, and similarly Vyāsadeva is a great writer, and both of them have absolutely engaged themselves in delineating the transcendental activities of the Lord and by doing so have become immortal. Similarly, science and philosophy also should be applied in the service of the Lord. There is no use presenting dry speculative theories for sense gratification. philosophy and science should be engaged to establish the glory of the Lord. Advanced people are eager to understand the Absolute Truth through the medium of science, and therefore a great scientist should endeavor to prove the existence of the Lord on a scientific basis. Similarly, philosophical speculations should be utilized to establish the Supreme Truth as sentient and all-powerful.

Similarly, all other branches of knowledge should always be engaged in the service of the Lord. In the *Bhagavad-gita* also the same is affirmed. All “knowledge” not engaged in the service of the Lord is but nescience. Real utilization of advanced knowledge is to establish the glories of the Lord, and that is the real import. Scientific knowledge engaged in the service of the Lord and all similar activities are all factually *hari-kértana*, or glorification of the Lord.

TEXT 23

Ah& PauraTaqTa>ave_>av& MauNae
daSYaaSTau k-SYaaêNa vedvaidNaaMa()
iNaæiPaTaae bal/k- Wv YaaeiGaNa&
éué[Uz<ae Pa[av*iz iNaivRiv+aTaaMa()) 23))

ahaà purâtéta-bhave 'bhavaà mune

däsyäs tu kasyäçcana veda-vädinäm

nirüpito bälaka eva yoginäà

çuçrüñaëe prävãñi nirvivikñatäm

SYNONYMS

aham—I; *purä*—formerly; *atéta-bhave*—in the previous millennium; *abhavam*—became; *mune*—O muni; *däsyäù*—of the maidservant; *tu*—but; *kasyäçcana*—certain; *veda-vädinäm*—of the followers of Vedänta; *nirüpitaù*—engaged; *bälakaù*—boy servant; *eva*—only; *yoginäam*—of the devotees; *çuçrüñaëe*—in the service of; *prävãñi*—during the four months of the rainy season; *nirvivikñatäm*—living together.

TRANSLATION

O muni, in the last millennium I was born as the son of a certain maidservant engaged in the service of brahmanas who were following the principles of Vedänta. When they were living together during the four

months of the rainy season, I was engaged in their personal service.

PURPORT

The wonder of an atmosphere surcharged with devotional service to the Lord is briefly described herein by Sri Nārada Muni. He was the son of the most insignificant parentage. He was not properly educated. Still, because his complete energy was engaged in the service of the Lord, he became an immortal sage. Such is the powerful action of devotional service. The living entities are the marginal energy of the Lord, and therefore they are meant for being properly utilized in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. When this is not done, one's situation is called *māyā*. Therefore the illusion of *māyā* is at once dissipated as soon as one's full energy is converted in the service of the Lord instead of in sense enjoyment. From the personal example of Sri Nārada Muni in his previous birth, it is clear that the service of the Lord begins with the service of the Lord's bona fide servants. The Lord says that the service of His servants is greater than His personal service. Service of the devotee is more valuable than the service of the Lord. One should therefore choose a bona fide servant of the Lord constantly engaged in His service, accept such a servant as the spiritual master and engage himself in his (the spiritual master's) service. Such a spiritual master is the transparent medium by which to visualize the Lord, who is beyond the conception of the material senses. By service of the bona fide spiritual master, the Lord consents to reveal Himself in proportion to the service rendered. Utilization of the human energy in the service of the Lord is the progressive path of salvation. The whole cosmic creation becomes at once identical with the Lord as soon as service in relation with the Lord is rendered under the guidance of a bona fide spiritual master. The expert spiritual master knows the art of utilizing everything to glorify the Lord, and therefore under his guidance the whole world can be turned into the spiritual abode by the divine grace of the Lord's servant.

TEXT 24

**Tae MaYYaPaeTaai%/caPale/_>aRke-
daNTae_Da*Ta\$-l@Nake-_NauviTaRiNa)**

cṣu-" k*-Paa& YaÛiPa TauLYadXaRNaa"
éué[UzMaa<ae MauNaYaae_LPa>aaizi<a)) 24))

te mayy apetākhila-cāpale 'rbhake

dānte 'dhāta-kréòanake 'nuvartini

cakruù kâpâà yadyapi tulya-darṣanāu

ṣuṣṛũñamāëe munayo 'lpa-bhāñiëi

SYNONYMS

te—they; *mayi*—unto me; *apeta*—not having undergone; *akhila*—all kinds of; *cāpale*—proclivities; *arbhake*—unto a boy; *dānte*—having controlled the senses; *adhāta-kréòanake*—without being accustomed to sporting habits; *anuvartini*—obedient; *cakruù*—did bestow; *kâpām*—causeless mercy; *yadyapi*—although; *tulya-darṣanāu*—impartial by nature; *ṣuṣṛũñamāëe*—unto the faithful; *munayaù*—the *muni* followers of the Vedānta; *alpa-bhāñiëi*—one who does not speak more than required.

TRANSLATION

Although they were impartial by nature, those followers of the Vedānta blessed me with their causeless mercy. As far as I was concerned, I was self-controlled and had no attachment for sports, even though I was a boy. In addition, I was not naughty, and I did not speak more than required.

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gita* the Lord says, “All the *Vedas* are searching after Me.” Lord Sri Caitanya says that in the *Vedas* the subject matters are only three, namely to establish the relation of the living entities with the Personality of Godhead, perform the relative duties in devotional service and thus achieve the ultimate goal, back to Godhead. As such, *vedānta-vādés*, or the followers of the Vedānta, indicate the pure devotees of the Personality of

Godhead. Such *vedānta-vādés*, or the *bhakti-vedāntas*, are impartial in distributing the transcendental knowledge of devotional service. To them no one is enemy or friend; no one is educated or uneducated. No one is especially favorable, and no one is unfavorable. The *bhakti-vedāntas* see that the people in general are wasting time in false sensuous things. Their business is to get the ignorant mass of people to reestablish their lost relationship with the Personality of Godhead. By such endeavor, even the most forgotten soul is roused up to the sense of spiritual life, and thus being initiated by the *bhakti-vedāntas*, the people in general gradually progress on the path of transcendental realization. So the *vedānta-vādés* initiated the boy even before he became self-controlled and was detached from childish sporting, etc. But before the initiation, he (the boy) became more and more advanced in discipline, which is very essential for one who wishes to make progress in the line. In the system of *varëäçrama-dharma*, which is the beginning of actual human life, small boys after five years of age are sent to become *brahmacäré* at the *guru's äçrama*, where these things are systematically taught to boys, be they king's sons or sons of ordinary citizens. The training was compulsory not only to create good citizens of the state, but also to prepare the boy's future life for spiritual realization. The irresponsible life of sense enjoyment was unknown to the children of the followers of the *varëäçrama* system. The boy was even injected with spiritual acumen before being placed by the father in the womb of the mother. Both the father and the mother were responsible for the boy's success in being liberated from the material bondage. That is the process of successful family planning. It is to beget children for complete perfection. Without being self-controlled, without being disciplined and without being fully obedient, no one can become successful in following the instructions of the spiritual master, and without doing so, no one is able to go back to Godhead.

TEXT 25

oiC^íle/PaaNaNauMaaeidTaae iÜJaE"
 Sak*-TSMa >auÅe TadPaaSTaik-iLbz")
 Wv& Pa[v*taSYa ivéuÖceTaSa,
 STaÖMaR WvaTMaãic" Pa[JaaYaTae)) 25))

ucchiñöa-lepän anumodito dvijaiù

sakât sma bhuije tad-apästa-kilbiñaù

evaà pravåttasya viçuddha-cetasas

tad-dharma evätma-ruciù prajäyate

SYNONYMS

ucchiñöa-lepän—the remnants of foodstuff; *anumoditaù*—being permitted; *dvijaiù*—by the Vedântist *brahmanas*; *sakât*—once upon a time; *sma*—in the past; *bhuije*—took; *tad*—by that action; *apästa*—eliminated; *kilbiñaù*—all sins; *evam*—thus; *pravåttasya*—being engaged; *viçuddha-cetasaù*—of one whose mind is purified; *tat*—that particular; *dharmaù*—nature; *eva*—certainly; *ätma-ruciù*—transcendental attraction; *prajäyate*—was manifested.

TRANSLATION

Once only, by their permission, I took the remnants of their food, and by so doing all my sins were at once eradicated. Thus being engaged, I became purified in heart, and at that time the very nature of the transcendentalist became attractive to me.

PURPORT

Pure devotion is as much infectious, in a good sense, as infectious diseases. A pure devotee is cleared from all kinds of sins. The Personality of Godhead is the purest entity, and unless one is equally pure from the infection of material qualities, one cannot become a pure devotee of the Lord. The *bhakti-vedäntas* as above mentioned were pure devotees, and the boy became infected with their qualities of purity by their association and by eating once the remnants of the foodstuff taken by them. Such remnants may be taken even without permission of the pure devotees. There are sometimes pseudodevotees, and one should be very much cautious about them. There are many things which hinder one from entering devotional

service. But by the association of pure devotees all these obstacles are removed. The neophyte devotee becomes practically enriched with the transcendental qualities of the pure devotee, which means attraction for the Personality of Godhead's name, fame, quality, pastimes, etc. Infection of the qualities of the pure devotee means to imbibe the taste of pure devotion always in the transcendental activities of the Personality of Godhead. This transcendental taste at once makes all material things distasteful. Therefore a pure devotee is not at all attracted by material activities. After the elimination of all sins or obstacles on the path of devotional service, one can become attracted, one can have steadiness, one can have perfect taste, one can have transcendental emotions, and at last one can be situated on the plane of loving service of the Lord. All these stages develop by the association of pure devotees, and that is the purport of this stanza.

TEXT 26

Ta}aaNvh& k*-Z<ak-Qaa" Pa[GaaYaTaa,
MaNauGa]he<aaé*<av& MaNaaehra")
Taa" é[ÖYaa Mae_NauPad& ivé*<vTa"
iPa[Yaé[vSYa® MaMaa>avd]uic")) 26))

tatrānvahāḥ kâñḥa-kathāu pragāyatām

anugraheḥāṣṭāvaḥ manoharāu

tāu ṣṛaddhayā me 'nupadaḥ viṣṭāvatāu

priyaṣṛavasy aiga mamābhavad ruciḥ

SYNONYMS

tatra—thereupon; *anu*—every day; *aham*—I; *kâñḥa-kathāu*—narration of Lord Kṛṣṇa's activities; *pragāyatām*—describing; *anugraheḥa*—by causeless mercy; *aṣṭāvam*—giving aural reception; *manāu-harāu*—attractive; *tāu*—those; *ṣṛaddhayā*—respectfully; *me*—unto me; *anupadam*—every step; *viṣṭāvatāu*—hearing attentively; *priyaṣṛavasi*—of the Personality of

Godhead; *aiga*—O Vyāsadeva; *mama*—mine; *abhavat*—it so became; *ruciù*—taste.

TRANSLATION

O Vyāsadeva, in that association and by the mercy of those great Vedāntists, I could hear them describe the attractive activities of Lord Kṛṣṇa And thus listening attentively, my taste for hearing of the Personality of Godhead increased at every step.

PURPORT

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Absolute Personality of Godhead, is attractive not only in His personal features, but also in His transcendental activities. It is so because the Absolute is absolute by His name, fame, form, pastimes, entourage, paraphernalia, etc. The Lord descends on this material world out of His causeless mercy and displays His various transcendental pastimes as a human being so that human beings attracted towards Him become able to go back to Godhead. Men are naturally apt to hear histories and narrations of various personalities performing mundane activities, without knowing that by such association one simply wastes valuable time and also becomes addicted to the three qualities of mundane nature. Instead of wasting time, one can get spiritual success by turning his attention to the transcendental pastimes of the Lord. By hearing the narration of the pastimes of the Lord, one contacts directly the Personality of Godhead, and, as explained before, by hearing about the Personality of Godhead, from within, all accumulated sins of the mundane creature are cleared. Thus being cleared of all sins, the hearer gradually becomes liberated from mundane association and becomes attracted to the features of the Lord. Nārada Muni has just explained this by his personal experience. The whole idea is that simply by hearing about the Lord's pastimes one can become one of the associates of the Lord. Nārada Muni has eternal life, unlimited knowledge and unfathomed bliss, and he can travel all over the material and spiritual worlds without restriction. One can attain to the highest perfection of life simply by attentive hearing of the transcendental pastimes of the Lord from the right sources, as Sri Nārada heard them from the pure devotees (*bhakti-vedāntas*) in his previous life. This process of

hearing in the association of the devotees is especially recommended in this age of quarrel (Kali).

TEXT 27

TaiS Ma&STada I/BDaãceMaRhaMaTae
iPa[Yaé[vSYaS%il/Taa MaiTaMaRMa)
YaYaahMaeTaTSadSaTSvMaaYaYaa
PaXYae MaiYa b]øi<a k-iLPaTa& Pare)) 27))

tasmiàs tadä labdha-rucer mahä-mate

priyaçravasy askhalitā matir mama

yayāham etat sad-asat sva-māyayā

paçye mayi brahmaëi kalpitaà pare

SYNONYMS

tasmin—it being so; *tadä*—at that time; *labdha*—achieved; *ruceù*—taste; *mahä-mate*—O great sage; *priyaçravasi*—upon the Lord; *askhalitā matiù*—uninterrupted attention; *mama*—mine; *yayä*—by which; *aham*—I; *etat*—all these; *sat-asat*—gross and subtle; *sva-māyayä*—one’s own ignorance; *paçye*—see; *mayi*—in me; *brahmaëi*—the Supreme; *kalpitam*—is accepted; *pare*—in the Transcendence.

TRANSLATION

O great sage, as soon as I got a taste for the Personality of Godhead, my attention to hear of the Lord was unflinching. And as my taste developed, I could realize that it was only in my ignorance that I had accepted gross and subtle coverings, for both the Lord and I are transcendental.

PURPORT

Ignorance in material existence is compared to darkness, and in all Vedic

literatures the Personality of Godhead is compared to the sun. Wherever there is light there cannot be darkness. Hearing of the Lord's pastimes is itself transcendental association with the Lord because there is no difference between the Lord and His transcendental pastimes. To become associated with the supreme light is to dissipate all ignorance. By ignorance only, the conditioned soul wrongly thinks that both he and the Lord are products of material nature. But in fact the Personality of Godhead and the living beings are transcendental, and they have nothing to do with the material nature. When ignorance is removed and it is perfectly realized that there is nothing existing without the Personality of Godhead, then nescience is removed. Since the gross and subtle bodies are emanations from the Personality of Godhead, the knowledge of light permits one to engage both of them in the service of the Lord. The gross body should be engaged in acts of rendering service to the Lord (as in bringing water, cleansing the temple or making obeisances, etc.). The path of *arcanā*, or worshiping the Lord in the temple, involves engaging one's gross body in the service of the Lord. Similarly, the subtle mind should be engaged in hearing the transcendental pastimes of the Lord, thinking about them, chanting His name, etc. All such activities are transcendental. None of the gross or subtle senses should otherwise be engaged. Such realization of transcendental activities is made possible by many, many years of apprenticeship in the devotional service, but simply attraction of love for the Personality of Godhead, as it was developed in Nārada Muni, by hearing, is highly effective.

TEXT 28

**wTQa& XarTPa[av*izk-av*TaU hre,
ivRé*<vTaae Mae_NauSav& YaXaae_Mal/Ma()
Sa²qTYaRMaaNa& MauiNai>aMaRhaTMai>a,
>aRiç-" Pa[v*taaTMarJaSTaMaaePaha)) 28))**

itthaà çarat-prāvāñikāv ātū harer

viçāëvato me 'nusavaà yaço 'malam

saikértyamānaà munibhir mahātmabhir

bhaktiù pravåttåtma-rajās-tamopahā

SYNONYMS

ittham—thus; *çarat*—autumn; *prävåññikau*—rainy season; *åtü*—two seasons; *hareù*—of the Lord; *viçåëvataù*—continuously hearing; *me*—myself; *anusavam*—constantly; *yaçaù amalam*—unadulterated glories; *saikértyamānam*—chanted by; *munibhiù*—the great sages; *mahā-ātmabhiù*—great souls; *bhaktiù*—devotional service; *pravåttā*—began to flow; *ātma*—living being; *rajaù*—mode of passion; *tama*—mode of ignorance; *upahā*—vanishing.

TRANSLATION

Thus during two seasons—the rainy season and autumn—I had the opportunity to hear these great-souled sages constantly chant the unadulterated glories of the Lord Hari. As the flow of my devotional service began, the coverings of the modes of passion and ignorance vanished.

PURPORT

Transcendental loving service for the Supreme Lord is the natural inclination of every living being. The instinct is dormant in everyone, but due to the association of material nature the modes of passion and ignorance cover this from time immemorial. If, by the grace of the Lord and the great-souled devotees of the Lord, a living being becomes fortunate enough to associate with the unadulterated devotees of the Lord and gets a chance to hear the unadulterated glories of the Lord, certainly the flow of devotional service takes place like the flow of a river. As the river flows on till she reaches the sea, similarly pure devotional service flows by the association of pure devotees till it reaches the ultimate goal, namely, transcendental love of God. Such a flow of devotional service cannot stop. On the contrary, it increases more and more without limitation. The flow of devotional service is so potent that any onlooker also becomes liberated from the influence of the modes of passion and ignorance. These two qualities of nature are thus removed, and the living being is liberated, being

situated in his original position.

TEXT 29

**TaSYaEv& Mae_Naurç-SYa Pa[ié[TaSYa hTaENaSa")
é[ÖDaaNaSYa bal/SYa daNTaSYaaNaucrSYa c)) 29))**

tasyaivaà me 'nuraktasya

praçritasya hatainasau

çraddadhānasya bālasya

dāntasyānucarasya ca

SYNONYMS

tasya—his; *evam*—thus; *me*—mine; *anuraktasya*—attached to them;
praçritasya—obediently; *hata*—freed from; *enasaù*—sins;
çraddadhānasya—of the faithful; *bālasya*—of the boy; *dāntasya*—
subjugated; *anucarasya*—strictly following the instructions; *ca*—and.

TRANSLATION

I was very much attached to those sages. I was gentle in behavior, and all my sins were eradicated in their service. In my heart I had strong faith in them. I had subjugated the senses, and I was strictly following them with body and mind.

PURPORT

These are the necessary qualifications of a prospective candidate who can expect to be elevated to the position of a pure unadulterated devotee. Such a candidate must always seek the association of pure devotees. One should not be misled by a pseudodevotee. He himself must be plain and gentle to receive the instructions of such a pure devotee. A pure devotee is a completely surrendered soul unto the Personality of Godhead. He knows

the Personality of Godhead as the supreme proprietor and all others as His servitors. And by the association of pure devotees only, one can get rid of all sins accumulated by mundane association. A neophyte devotee must faithfully serve the pure devotee, and he should be very much obedient and strictly follow the instructions. These are the signs of a devotee who is determined to achieve success even in the existing duration of life.

TEXT 30

**jaNa& GauùTaMa& YataTSaa+aaÙGavTaaeidTaMa()
ANvvaecNa(GaiMaZYaNTa" k*-PaYaa dqNavTSal/a")) 30))**

jïānaà guhyatamaà yat tat

sākñād bhagavatoditam

anvavocan gamiñyantaù

kāpayā déna-vatsaläù

SYNONYMS

jïānam—knowledge; *guhyatamam*—most confidential; *yat*—what is; *tat*—that; *sākñāt*—directly; *bhagavatā uditam*—propounded by the Lord Himself; *anvavocan*—gave instruction; *gamiñyantaù*—while departing from; *kāpayā*—by causeless mercy; *déna-vatsaläù*—those who are very kind to the poor and meek.

TRANSLATION

As they were leaving, those bhakti-vedāntas, who are very kind to poor-hearted souls, instructed me in that most confidential subject which is instructed by the Personality of Godhead Himself.

PURPORT

A pure Vedāntist, or a *bhakti-vedānta*, instructs followers exactly according

to the instructions of the Lord Himself. The Personality of Godhead, both in the *Bhagavad-gita* and in all other scriptures, has definitely instructed men to follow the Lord only. The Lord is the creator, maintainer and annihilator of everything. The whole manifested creation is existing by His will, and by His will when the whole show is finished He will remain in His eternal abode with all His paraphernalia. Before the creation He was there in the eternal abode, and after the annihilation He will continue to remain. He is not, therefore, one of the created beings. He is transcendental. In the *Bhagavad-gita* the Lord says that long, long before the instruction was imparted to Arjuna, the same was instructed to the sun-god, and in course of time, the same instruction, being wrongly handled and being broken, was again instructed to Arjuna because he was His perfect devotee and friend. Therefore, the instruction of the Lord can be understood by the devotees only and no one else. The impersonalist, who has no idea of the transcendental form of the Lord, cannot understand this most confidential message of the Lord. The expression “most confidential” is significant here because knowledge of devotional service is far, far above knowledge of impersonal Brahman. *Jñānam* means ordinary knowledge or any branch of knowledge. This knowledge develops up to the knowledge of impersonal Brahman. Above this, when it is partially mixed with devotion, such knowledge develops to knowledge of Paramātmā, or the all-pervading Godhead. This is more confidential. But when such knowledge is turned into pure devotional service and the confidential part of transcendental knowledge is attained, it is called the most confidential knowledge. This most confidential knowledge was imparted by the Lord to Brahmā, Arjuna, Uddhava, etc.

TEXT 31

**YaeNaEvah& >aGavTaae vaSaudevSYa veDaSa")
MaaYaaNau>aavMaivd& YaeNa GaC^iNTa TaTPadMa()) 31))**

yenaivāhaà bhagavato

vāsudevasya vedhasaù

mäyānubhävam avidaà

yena gacchanti tat-padam

SYNONYMS

yena—by which; *eva*—certainly; *aham*—I; *bhagavata*—of the Personality of Godhead; *vāsudevasya*—of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *vedhasa*—of the supreme creator; *māyā*—energy; *anubhavam*—influence; *avidam*—easily understood; *yena*—by which; *gacchanti*—they go; *tat-padam*—at the lotus feet of the Lord.

TRANSLATION

By that confidential knowledge, I could understand clearly the influence of the energy of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the creator, maintainer and annihilator of everything. By knowing that, one can return to Him and personally meet Him.

PURPORT

By devotional service or by the most confidential knowledge, one can understand very easily how the different energies of the Lord are working. One part of energy is manifesting the material world; the other (superior) part of His energy is manifesting the spiritual world. And the via medium energy is manifesting the living entities who are serving either of the above-mentioned energies. The living entities serving material energy are struggling hard for existence and happiness, which is presented to them as illusion. But those in the spiritual energy are placed under the direct service of the Lord in eternal life, complete knowledge and perpetual bliss. The Lord desires, as He has directly said in the *Bhagavad-gita*, that all conditioned souls, rotting in the kingdom of material energy, come back to Him by giving up all engagements in the material world. This is the most confidential part of knowledge. But this can be understood only by the pure devotees, and only such devotees enter the kingdom of God to see Him personally and serve Him personally. The concrete example is Nārada Himself, who attained this stage of eternal knowledge and eternal bliss. And the ways and means are open to all, provided one agrees to follow in the footsteps of Sri Nārada Muni. According to *śruti*, the Supreme Lord has

unlimited energies (without effort by Him), and these are described under three principal headings, as above mentioned.

TEXT 32

WTaTSa&SaUicTa& b]ø&STaaPa}aYaicik-iTSaTaMa()
Yadqìre >aGaviTa k-MaR b]øi<a >aaivTaMa()) 32))

etat saàsücitaà brahmaàs

täpa-traya-cikitsitam

yad éçvare bhagavati

karma brahmaëi bhävitam

SYNONYMS

etat—this much; *saàsücitam*—decided by the learned; *brahman*—O *brahmana* Vyäsa; *täpa-traya*—three kinds of miseries; *cikitsitam*—remedial measures; *yat*—what; *éçvare*—the supreme controller; *bhagavati*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *karma*—one’s prescribed activities; *brahmaëi*—unto the great; *bhävitam*—dedicated.

TRANSLATION

O Brähmaëa Vyäsadeva, it is decided by the learned that the best remedial measure for removing all troubles and miseries is to dedicate one’s activities to the service of the Supreme Lord Personality of Godhead [Sri Kṛṣṇa].

PURPORT

Sri Nārada Muni personally experienced that the most feasible and practical way to open the path of salvation or get relief from all miseries of life is to hear submissively the transcendental activities of the Lord from the right and bona fide sources. This is the only remedial process. The entire

material existence is full of miseries. Foolish people have manufactured, out of their tiny brains, many remedial measures for removing the threefold miseries pertaining to the body and mind, pertaining to the natural disturbances and in relation with other living beings. The whole world is struggling very hard to exist out of these miseries, but men do not know that without the sanction of the Lord no plan or no remedial measure can actually bring about the desired peace and tranquillity. The remedial measure to cure a patient by medical treatment is useless if it is not sanctioned by the Lord. To cross the river or the ocean by a suitable boat is no remedial measure if it is not sanctioned by the Lord. We should know for certain that the Lord is the ultimate sanctioning officer, and we must therefore dedicate our attempts to the mercy of the Lord for ultimate success or to get rid of the obstacles on the path of success. The Lord is all-pervading, all-powerful, omniscient and omnipresent. He is the ultimate sanctioning agent of all good or bad effects. We should, therefore, learn to dedicate our activities unto the mercy of the Lord and accept Him either as impersonal Brahman, localized Paramātmā or the Supreme Personality of Godhead. It does not matter what one is. One must dedicate everything in the service of the Lord. If one is a learned scholar, scientist, philosopher, poet, etc., then he should employ his learning to establish the supremacy of the Lord. Try to study the energy of the Lord in every sphere of life. Do not decry Him and try to become like Him or take His position simply by fragmental accumulation of knowledge. If one is an administrator, statesman, warrior, politician, etc., then one should try to establish the Lord's supremacy in statesmanship. Fight for the cause of the Lord as Sri Arjuna did. In the beginning, Sri Arjuna, the great fighter, declined to fight, but when he was convinced by the Lord that the fighting was necessary, Sri Arjuna changed his decision and fought for His cause. Similarly, if one is a businessman, an industrialist, an agriculturist, etc., then one should spend his hard-earned money for the cause of the Lord. Think always that the money which is accumulated is the wealth of the Lord. Wealth is considered to be the goddess of fortune (Lakṣmī), and the Lord is Nārāyaṇa, or the husband of Lakṣmī. Try to engage Lakṣmī in the service of Lord Nārāyaṇa and be happy. That is the way to realize the Lord in every sphere of life. The best thing is, after all, to get relief from all material activities and engage oneself completely in hearing the transcendental pastimes of the Lord. But in case of the absence of such an opportunity,

one should try to engage in the service of the Lord everything for which one has specific attraction, and that is the way of peace and prosperity. The word *saàsücitam* in this stanza is also significant. One should not think for a moment that the realization of Nārada was childish imagination only. It is not like that. It is so realized by the expert and erudite scholars, and that is the real import of the word *saàsücitam*.

TEXT 33

AaMaYaae Yaê >aUTaaNaa& JaaYaTae YaeNa Sauv]Ta)
Tadev àaMaYa& d]VYa& Na PauNaaiTa icik-iTSaTaMa()) 33))

āmaya yaç ca bhütānā

jāyate yena suvrata

tad eva hy āmayā dravyā

na punāti cikitsitam

SYNONYMS

āmaya—diseases; *yaç ca*—whatever; *bhütānām*—of the living being; *jāyate*—become possible; *yena*—by the agency; *suvrata*—O good soul; *tat*—that; *eva*—very; *hi*—certainly; *āmayam*—disease; *dravyam*—thing; *na*—does it not; *punāti*—cure; *cikitsitam*—treated with.

TRANSLATION

O good soul, does not a thing, applied therapeutically, cure a disease which was caused by that very same thing?

PURPORT

An expert physician treats his patient with a therapeutic diet. For example, milk preparations sometimes cause disorder of the bowels, but the very same milk converted into curd and mixed with some other remedial

ingredients cures such disorders. Similarly, the threefold miseries of material existence cannot be mitigated simply by material activities. Such activities have to be spiritualized, just as by fire iron is made red-hot, and thereby the action of fire begins. Similarly, the material conception of a thing is at once changed as soon as it is put into the service of the Lord. That is the secret of spiritual success. We should not try to lord it over the material nature, nor should we reject material things. The best way to make the best use of a bad bargain is to use everything in relation with the supreme spiritual being. Everything is an emanation from the Supreme Spirit, and by His inconceivable power He can convert spirit into matter and matter into spirit. Therefore a material thing (so-called) is at once turned into a spiritual force by the great will of the Lord. The necessary condition for such a change is to employ so-called matter in the service of the spirit. That is the way to treat our material diseases and elevate ourselves to the spiritual plane where there is no misery, no lamentation and no fear. When everything is thus employed in the service of the Lord, we can experience that there is nothing except the Supreme Brahman. The Vedic *mantra* that “everything is Brahman” is thus realized by us.

TEXT 34

**Wv& Na*<aa& iṣ-YaaYaaeGaa" SaveR Sa&Sa*iTaheTav")
Ta WvaTMaivNaaXaaYa k-LPaNTae k-iLPaTaa" Pare)) 34))**

evaà nâëää kriyā-yogäù

sarve saàsâti-hetavaù

ta evätma-vinäçäya

kalpante kalpitäù pare

SYNONYMS

evam—thus; *nâëäm*—of the human being; *kriyā-yogäù*—all activities; *sarve*—everything; *saàsâti*—material existence; *hetavaù*—causes; *te*—that; *eva*—certainly; *ätma*—the tree of work; *vinäçäya*—killing; *kalpante*—

become competent; *kalpitäù*—dedicated; *pare*—unto the Transcendence.

TRANSLATION

Thus when all a man's activities are dedicated to the service of the Lord, those very activities which caused his perpetual bondage become the destroyer of the tree of work.

PURPORT

Fruitive work which has perpetually engaged the living being is compared to the banyan tree in the *Bhagavad-gita*, for it is certainly very deeply rooted. As long as the propensity for enjoying the fruit of work is there, one has to continue the transmigration of the soul from one body or place to another, according to one's nature of work. The propensity for enjoyment may be turned into the desire for serving the mission of the Lord, By doing so, one's activity is changed into *karma-yoga*, or the way by which one can attain spiritual perfection while engaging in the work for which he has a natural tendency. Here the word *ätmä* indicates the categories of all fruitive work. The conclusion is that when the result of all fruitive and other work is dovetailed with the service of the Lord, it will cease to generate further *karma* and will gradually develop into transcendental devotional service, which will not only cut off completely the root of the banyan tree of work but will also carry the performer to the lotus feet of the Lord.

The summary is that one has to, first of all, seek the association of pure devotees who not only are learned in the Vedänta but are self-realized souls and unalloyed devotees of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead. In that association, the neophyte devotees must render loving service physically and mentally without reservation. This service attitude will induce the great souls to be more favorable in bestowing their mercy, which injects the neophyte with all the transcendental qualities of the pure devotees. Gradually this is developed into a strong attachment to hearing the transcendental pastimes of the Lord, which makes him able to catch up the constitutional position of the gross and subtle bodies and beyond them the knowledge of pure soul and his eternal relation with the Supreme Soul, the Personality of Godhead. After the relation is ascertained by

establishment of the eternal relation, pure devotional service to the Lord begins gradually developing into perfect knowledge of the Personality of Godhead beyond the purview of impersonal Brahman and localized Paramātmā. By such *puruñottama-yoga*, as it is stated in the *Bhagavad-gita*, one is made perfect even during the present corporeal existence, and one exhibits all the good qualities of the Lord to the highest percentage. Such is the gradual development by association of pure devotees.

TEXT 35

Yad}a iṣ-YaTae k-MaR >aGavTPairTaaez<aMa()
jaNa& YatadDaqNa& ih >aiç-YaaeGaSaMaiNvTaMa()) 35))

yad atra kriyate karma

bhagavat-paritoñāëam

jñānaà yat tad adhēnaà hi

bhakti-yoga-samanvitam

SYNONYMS

yat—whatever; *atra*—in this life or world; *kriyate*—does perform; *karma*—work; *bhagavat*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *paritoñāëam*—satisfaction of; *jñānam*—knowledge; *yat tat*—what is so called; *adhēnam*—dependent; *hi*—certainly; *bhakti-yoga*—devotional; *samanvitam*—dovetailed with *bhakti-yoga*.

TRANSLATION

Whatever work is done here in this life for the satisfaction of the mission of the Lord is called bhakti-yoga, or transcendental loving service to the Lord, and what is called knowledge becomes a concomitant factor.

PURPORT

The general and popular notion is that by discharging fruitive work in terms of the direction of the scriptures one becomes perfectly able to acquire transcendental knowledge for spiritual realization. *Bhakti-yoga* is considered by some to be another form of *karma*. But factually *bhakti-yoga* is above both *karma* and *jñāna*. *Bhakti-yoga* is independent of *jñāna* or *karma*; on the other hand, *jñāna* and *karma* are dependent on *bhakti-yoga*. This *kriyā-yoga* or *karma-yoga*, as recommended by Sri Nārada to Vyāsa, is specifically recommended because the principle is to satisfy the Lord. The Lord does not want His sons, the living beings, to suffer the threefold miseries of life. He desires that all of them come to Him and live with Him, but going back to Godhead means that one must purify himself from material infections. When work is performed, therefore, to satisfy the Lord, the performer becomes gradually purified from the material affection. This purification means attainment of spiritual knowledge. Therefore knowledge is dependent on *karma*, or work, done on behalf of the Lord. Other knowledge, being devoid of *bhakti-yoga* or satisfaction of the Lord, cannot lead one back to the kingdom of God, which means that it cannot even offer salvation, as already explained in connection with the stanza *naiñkarmyam apy acyuta-bhāva-varjitam* (***Srimad-Bhagavatam*** 1.5.12). The conclusion is that a devotee engaged in the unalloyed service of the Lord, specifically in hearing and chanting of His transcendental glories, becomes simultaneously spiritually enlightened by the divine grace, as confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita*.

TEXT 36

ku-vaR<aa Ya}a k-MaaRi<a >aGaviC^+aYaaSak*-Ta()
Ga*<aiNTa Gau<aNaaMaaiNa k*-Z<aSYaaNauSMariNTa c)) 36))

kurväëä yatra karmäëi

bhagavac-chikñayäsakât

gäëanti guëa-nämäni

käñëasyänusmaranti ca

SYNONYMS

kurväëäù—while performing; *yatra*—thereupon; *karmäëi*—duties; *bhagavat*—the Personality of Godhead; *çikñayä*—by the will of; *asakât*—constantly; *gäëanti*—takes on; *guëa*—qualities; *nämäni*—names; *kãñëasya*—of Kṛṣṇa; *anusmaranti*—constantly remembers; *ca*—and.

TRANSLATION

While performing duties according to the order of Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, one constantly remembers Him, His names and His qualities.

PURPORT

An expert devotee of the Lord can mold his life in such a way that while performing all kinds of duties either for this or the next life, he can constantly remember the Lord's name, fame, qualities, etc. The order of the Lord is distinctly there in the *Bhagavad-gita*: one should work only for the Lord in all spheres of life. In every sphere of life the Lord should be situated as the proprietor. According to the Vedic rites, even in the worship of some demigods like Indra, Brahmä, Sarasvaté and Gaëëça, the system is that in all circumstances the representation of Viṣṇu must be there as *yajñeçvara*, or the controlling power of such sacrifices. It is recommended that a particular demigod be worshiped for a particular purpose, but still the presence of Viṣṇu is compulsory in order to make the function proper.

Apart from such Vedic duties, even in our ordinary dealings (for example, in our household affairs or in our business or profession) we must consider that the result of all activities must be given over to the supreme enjoyer, Lord Kṛṣṇa. In the *Bhagavad-gita* the Lord has declared Himself to be the supreme enjoyer of everything, the supreme proprietor of every planet and the supreme friend of all beings. No one else but Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa can claim to be the proprietor of everything within His creation. A pure devotee remembers this constantly, and in doing so he repeats the transcendental name, fame and qualities of the Lord, which means that he is constantly in touch with the Lord. The Lord is identical with His name, fame, etc., and

therefore to be associated with His name, fame, etc., constantly, means actually to associate with the Lord.

The major portion of our monetary income, not less than fifty percent, must be spent to carry out the order of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Not only should we give the profit of our earning to this cause, but we must also arrange to preach this cult of devotion to others because that is also one of the orders of the Lord. The Lord definitely says that no one is more dear to Him than one who is always engaged in the preaching work of the Lord's name and fame all over the world. The scientific discoveries of the material world can also be equally engaged in carrying out His order. He wants the message of the *Bhagavad-gita* to be preached amongst His devotees. It may not be so done amongst those who have no credit of austerities, charity, education, etc. Therefore, the attempt must go on to convert unwilling men to become His devotees. Lord Caitanya has taught a very simple method in this connection. He has taught the lesson for preaching the transcendental message through singing, dancing and refreshment. As such, fifty percent of our income may be spent for this purpose. In this fallen age of quarrel and dissension, if only the leading and wealthy persons of society agree to spend fifty percent of their income in the service of the Lord, as it is taught by Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu, there is absolute certainty of converting this hell of pandemonium to the transcendental abode of the Lord. No one will disagree to partake in a function where good singing, dancing and refreshment are administered. Everyone will attend such a function, and everyone is sure to feel individually the transcendental presence of the Lord. This alone will help the attendant associate with the Lord and thereby purify himself in spiritual realization. The only condition for successfully executing such spiritual activities is that they must be conducted under the guidance of a pure devotee who is completely free from all mundane desires, fruitive activities and dry speculations about the nature of the Lord. No one has to discover the nature of the Lord. It is already spoken by the Lord Himself in the *Bhagavad-gita* especially and in all other Vedic literatures generally. We have simply to accept them *in toto* and abide by the orders of the Lord. That will guide us to the path of perfection. One can remain in his own position. No one has to change his position, especially in this age of variegated difficulties. The only condition is that one must give up the habit of dry speculation aimed at becoming one with the Lord. And

after giving up such lofty puffed-up vanities, one may very submissively receive the orders of the Lord in the *Bhagavad-gita* or *Bhāgavatam* from the lips of a bona fide devotee whose qualification is mentioned above. That will make everything successful, without a doubt.

TEXT 37

p NaMaae >aGavTae Tau>Ya& vaSaudevaYa DaqMaih)
Pa[ŪuManaYaaiNaāÖaYa NaMa" Sa²zR<aaYa c)) 37))

oà namo bhagavate tubhyaà

vāsudevāya dhémahi

pradyumnāyaniruddhāya

namaù saikarñāëäya ca

SYNONYMS

oà—the sign of chanting the transcendental glory of the Lord; *namaù*—offering obeisances unto the Lord; *bhagavate*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *tubhyam*—unto You; *vāsudevāya*—unto the Lord, the son of Vasudeva; *dhémahi*—let us chant; *pradyumnāya*, *aniruddhāya* and *saikarñāëäya*—all plenary expansions of Vāsudeva; *namaù*—respectful obeisances; *ca*—and.

TRANSLATION

Let us all chant the glories of Vāsudeva along with His plenary expansions Pradyumna, Aniruddha and Sañkarṣṇa.

PURPORT

According to *Pañcarātra*, Nārāyaṇa is the primeval cause of all expansions of Godhead. These are Vāsudeva, Sañkarṣṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha. Vāsudeva and Sañkarṣṇa are on the middle left and right, Pradyumna is on

the right of Saṅkarṣṇa, and Aniruddha is on the left of Vāsudeva, and thus the four Deities are situated. They are known as the four aides-de-camp of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa.

This is a Vedic hymn or *mantra* beginning with *oākāra praëava*, and thus the *mantra* is established by the transcendental chanting process, namely, *oà namo dhémahi*, etc.

The purport is that any transaction, either in the field of fruitive work or in empiric philosophy, which is not ultimately aimed at transcendental realization of the Supreme Lord, is considered to be useless. Nārada-jé has therefore explained the nature of unalloyed devotional service by his personal experience in the development of intimacy between the Lord and the living entity by a gradual process of progressive devotional activities. Such a progressive march of transcendental devotion for the Lord culminates in the attainment of loving service of the Lord, which is called *premā* in different transcendental variegatedness called *rasas* (tastes). Such devotional service is also executed in mixed forms, namely mixed with fruitive work or empiric philosophical speculations.

Now the question which was raised by the great *āñis* headed by Çaunaka regarding the confidential part of Sūta's achievement through the spiritual master is explained herein by the chanting of this hymn consisting of thirty-three letters. And this *mantra* is addressed to the four Deities, or the Lord with His plenary expansions. The central figure is Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa because the plenary portions are His aides-de-camp. The most confidential part of the instruction is that one should always chant and remember the glories of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, along with His different plenary portions expanded as Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha. Those expansions are the original Deities for all other truths, namely either *viṣṇu-tattva* or *çakti-tattvas*.

TEXT 38

**wiTa MaUTYaRi>aDaaNaeNa MaN}aMaUiTaRMaMaUiTaRk-Ma()
YaJaTae YajPauâz& Sa SaMYaGdXaRNa" PauMaaNa()) 38))**

iti mürty-abhidhānena

mantra-mūrtim amūrtikam

yajate yajña-puruṣaà

sa samyag darṣanaù pumän

SYNONYMS

iti—thus; *mūrti*—representation; *abhidhānena*—in sound; *mantra-mūrtim*—form representation of transcendental sound; *amūrtikam*—the Lord, who has no material form; *yajate*—worship; *yajña*—Viṣṇu; *puruṣam*—the Personality of Godhead; *saù*—he alone; *samyak*—perfectly; *darṣanaù*—one who has seen; *pumän*—person.

TRANSLATION

Thus he is the actual seer who worships, in the form of transcendental sound representation, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Viṣṇu, who has no material form.

PURPORT

Our present senses are all made of material elements, and therefore they are imperfect in realizing the transcendental form of Lord Viṣṇu. He is therefore worshiped by sound representation via the transcendental method of chanting. Anything which is beyond the scope of experience by our imperfect senses can be realized fully by the sound representation. A person transmitting sound from a far distant place can be factually experienced. If this is materially possible, why not spiritually? This experience is not a vague impersonal experience. It is actually an experience of the transcendental Personality of Godhead, who possesses the pure form of eternity, bliss and knowledge.

In the *Amarakoṣa* Sanskrit dictionary the word *mūrti* carries import in twofold meanings, namely, form and difficulty. Therefore *amūrtikam* is

explained by Ācārya Sri Visvanatha Cakravarti Öhäkura as meaning “without difficulty.” The transcendental form of eternal bliss and knowledge can be experienced by our original spiritual senses, which can be revived by chanting of the holy *mantras*, or transcendental sound representations. Such sound should be received from the transparent agency of the bona fide spiritual master, and the chanting may be practiced by the direction of the spiritual master. That will gradually lead us nearer to the Lord. This method of worship is recommended in the *päicarätrika* system, which is both recognized and authorized. The *päicarätrika* system has the most authorized codes for transcendental devotional service. Without the help of such codes, one cannot approach the Lord, certainly not by dry philosophical speculation. The *päicarätrika* system is both practical and suitable for this age of quarrel. The *Paicarättra* is more important than the *Vedänta* for this modern age.

TEXT 39

wMa& SviNaGaMa& b]øàveTYa MadNauïTaMa()
AdaNMae jaNaMaEiYa| SviSMaNa(>aav& c ke-Xav")) 39))

imaà sva-nigamaà brahmann

avetya mad-anuñöhitam

adän me jïänam aiçvaryaà

svasmin bhävaà ca keçavaù

SYNONYMS

imam—thus; *sva-nigamam*—confidential knowledge of the *Vedas* in respect to the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *brahman*—O *brahmana* (Vyäsadeva); *avetya*—knowing it well; *mat*—by me; *anuñöhitam*—executed; *adät*—bestowed upon me; *me*—me; *jïänam*—transcendental knowledge; *aiçvaryam*—opulence; *svasmin*—personal; *bhävam*—intimate affection and love; *ca*—and; *keçavaù*—Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

O brahmana, thus by the Supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa I was endowed first with the transcendental knowledge of the Lord as inculcated in the confidential parts of the Vedas, then with the spiritual opulences, and then with His intimate loving service.

PURPORT

Communion with the Lord by transmission of the transcendental sound is nondifferent from the whole spirit Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. It is a completely perfect method for approaching the Lord. By such pure contact with the Lord, without offense of material conceptions (numbering ten), the devotee can rise above the material plane to understand the inner meaning of the Vedic literatures, including the Lord's existence in the transcendental realm. The Lord reveals His identity gradually to one who has unflinching faith, both in the spiritual master and in the Lord. After this, the devotee is endowed with mystic opulences, which are eight in number. And above all, the devotee is accepted in the confidential entourage of the Lord and is entrusted with specific service of the Lord through the agency of the spiritual master. A pure devotee is more interested in serving the Lord than in showing an exhibition of the mystic powers dormant in him. Sri Nārada has explained all these from his personal experience, and one can obtain all the facilities which Sri Nārada obtained by perfecting the chanting process of the sound representation of the Lord. There is no bar for chanting this transcendental sound by anyone, provided it is received through Nārada's representative, coming down by the chain of disciplic succession, or the *paramparā* system.

TEXT 40

**TvMaPYad>a]é[uTa ivé[uTa& iv>aae"
SaMaaPYaTae YaeNa ivda& bu>auTSaTaMa()
Pa[a:Yaaih du"%EMauRhuridRTaaTMaNaa&
Sa&©e-XaiNavaR<aMauXaiNTa NaaNYaQaa)) 40))**

tvam apy adabhra-çruta viçrutaà vibhoù

samäpyate yena vidäa bubhutsitam

prakhyähi duùkhaiṛ muhur arditätmanäa

saikleça-nirväëam uçanti nänyathä

SYNONYMS

tvam—your good soul; *api*—also; *adabhra*—vast; *çruta*—Vedic literatures; *viçrutam*—have heard also; *vibhoù*—of the Almighty; *samäpyate*—satisfied; *yena*—by which; *vidäm*—of the learned; *bubhutsitam*—who always desire to learn transcendental knowledge; *prakhyähi*—describe; *duùkhaiù*—by miseries; *muhuù*—always; *ardita-ätmanäm*—suffering mass of people; *saikleça*—sufferings; *nirväëam*—mitigation; *uçanti na*—do not get out of; *anyathä*—by other means.

TRANSLATION

Please, therefore, describe the Almighty Lord’s activities which you have learned by your vast knowledge of the Vedas, for that will satisfy the hankerings of great learned men and at the same time mitigate the miseries of the masses of common people who are always suffering from material pangs. Indeed, there is no other way to get out of such miseries.

PURPORT

Sri Nārada Muni from practical experience definitely asserts that the prime solution of all problems of material work is to broadcast very widely the transcendental glories of the Supreme Lord. There are four classes of good men, and there are four classes of bad men also. The four classes of good men acknowledge the authority of the Almighty God, and therefore such good men (1) when they are in difficulty, (2) when they are in need of money, (3) when they are advanced in knowledge and (4) when they are inquisitive to know more and more about God, intuitively take shelter of the Lord. As such, Nārada-jé advises Vyāsadeva to broadcast the transcendental knowledge of God in terms of the vast Vedic knowledge which he had already attained.

As far as the bad men are concerned, they are also four in number: (1) those who are simply addicted to the mode of progressive fruitive work and thus are subjected to the accompanying miseries, (2) those who are simply addicted to vicious work for sense satisfaction and so suffer the consequence, (3) those who are materially very much advanced in knowledge, but who suffer because they do not have the sense to acknowledge the authority of the Almighty Lord, and (4) the class of men who are known as atheists and who therefore purposely hate the very name of God, although they are always in difficulty.

Sri Nāradaḥ advised Vyāsadeva to describe the glories of the Lord just to do good to all eight classes of men, both good and bad. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is therefore not meant for any particular class of men or sect. It is for the sincere soul who actually wants his own welfare and peace of mind.

Thus end the Bhaktivedānta purports of the First Canto, Fifth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "Nārada's Instructions on Srimad-Bhagavatam for Vyāsadeva."

Chapter Six

Conversation Between Nārada and Vyāsadeva

TEXT 1

SaUTa ovac

Wv& iNaXaMYa >aGavaNdevzeRJaRNMa k-MaR c)
>aUYa" PaPa[C^ Ta& b]øNa(VYaaSa" SaTYavTaqSauTa")) 1))

sūta uvāca

evaà niṣāmya bhagavān

devarñer janma karma ca

bhüyaù papraccha taà brahman

vyäsaù satyavaté-sutaù

SYNONYMS

sütaù uväca—Süta said; *evam*—thus; *niçamyä*—hearing; *bhagavän*—the powerful incarnation of God; *devarñeù*—of the great sage among the gods; *janma*—birth; *karma*—work; *ca*—and; *bhüyaù*—again; *papraccha*—asked; *tam*—him; *brahman*—O *brahmanas*; *vyäsaù*—Vyäsadeva; *satyavaté-sutaù*—the son of Satyavati.

TRANSLATION

Süta said: O brahmanas, thus hearing all about Sri Närada’s birth and activities, Vyäsadeva, the incarnation of God and son of Satyavati, inquired as follows.

PURPORT

Vyäsadeva was further inquisitive to know about the perfection of Näradajé, and therefore he wanted to know about him more and more. In this chapter Näradajé will describe how he was able to have a brief audience with the Lord while he was absorbed in the transcendental thought of separation from the Lord and when it was very painful for him.

TEXT 2

VYaaSa ovac

**i>a+au>aivRPa[viSaTae ivjaNaadeí*i>aSTav)
vTaRMaaNaae vYaSYaaÛe TaTa" ik-Mak-raeÛvaNa()) 2))**

vyäsa uväca

bhikñubhir vipravasite

vijñänädeñöåbhis tava

vartamāno vayasy ädye

tataù kim akarod bhavän

SYNONYMS

vyāsaù uvāca—Sri Vyāsadeva said; *bhikṣubhiù*—by the great mendicants; *vipravasite*—having departed for other places; *vijñāna*—scientific knowledge in transcendence; *ādeñöåbhiù*—those who had instructed; *tava*—of your; *vartamānaù*—present; *vayasi*—of the duration of life; *ädye*—before the beginning of; *tataù*—after that; *kim*—what; *akarot*—did; *bhavän*—your good self.

TRANSLATION

Sri Vyāsadeva said: What did you [Nārada] do after the departure of the great sages who had instructed you in scientific transcendental knowledge before the beginning of your present birth?

PURPORT

Vyāsadeva himself was the disciple of Nārada, and therefore it was natural to be anxious to hear what Nārada did after initiation from the spiritual masters. He wanted to follow in Nārada's footsteps in order to attain to the same perfect stage of life. This desire to inquire from the spiritual master is an essential factor to the progressive path. This process is technically known as *sad-dharma-pācchā*.

TEXT 3

**SvaYaM>auv k-Yaa v*tYaa viTaRTa& Tae Par& vYa")
k-Qa& cedMaudóá+aq" k-ale/ Pa[aáe k-le/vrMa()) 3))**

svâyambhuva kayä vättyä

vartitaà te paraà vayaù

kathaà cedam udasrākñéù

käle prāpte kalevaram

SYNONYMS

svâyambhuva—O son of Brahmä; *kayä*—under what condition; *vāṭṭyā*—occupation; *vartitam*—was spent; *te*—you; *param*—after the initiation; *vayaù*—duration of life; *katham*—how; *ca*—and; *idam*—this; *udasrākñéù*—did you quit; *käle*—in due course; *prāpte*—having attained; *kalevaram*—body.

TRANSLATION

O son of Brahmä, how did you pass your life after initiation, and how did you attain this body, having quit your old one in due course?

PURPORT

Sri Nārada Muni in his previous life was just an ordinary maidservant's son, so how he became so perfectly transformed into the spiritual body of eternal life, bliss and knowledge is certainly important. Sri Vyāsadeva desired him to disclose the facts for everyone's satisfaction.

TEXT 4

**Pa[aḥ-LPaivzYaaMaeTaa& Sma*iTa& Tae MauiNaSataMa)
Na ùez VYavDaaTk-al/ Wz SavRiNarak*-iTā")) 4))**

prāk-kalpa-viñayām etāà

smātià te muni-sattama

na hy eña vyavadhāt kāla

eña sarva-nirākātiù

SYNONYMS

prāk—prior; *kalpa*—the duration of Brahmā's day; *viñayām*—subject matter; *etām*—all these; *smātim*—remembrance; *te*—your; *muni-sattama*—O great sage; *na*—not; *hi*—certainly; *eñāu*—all these; *vyavadhāt*—made any difference; *kālaù*—course of time; *eñāu*—all these; *sarva*—all; *nirākātiù*—annihilation.

TRANSLATION

O great sage, time annihilates everything in due course, so how is it that this subject matter, which happened prior to this day of Brahmā, is still fresh in your memory, undisturbed by time?

PURPORT

As spirit is not annihilated even after the annihilation of the material body, so also spiritual consciousness is not annihilated. Sri Nārada developed this spiritual consciousness even when he had his material body in the previous *kalpa*. Consciousness of the material body means spiritual consciousness expressed through the medium of a material body. This consciousness is inferior, destructible and perverted. But superconsciousness of the supramind in the spiritual plane is as good as the spirit soul and is never annihilated.

TEXT 5

Naard ovac

i>a+auī>aivRPa[viSaTae ivjaNaadeī*i>aMaRMa)
vTaRMaaNaae vYaSYaaŪe TaTa WTadk-arzMa()) 5))

nārada uvāca

bhikñubhir vipravasite

vijñānadeñöābhir mama

vartamāno vayasy ädye

tata etad akārañam

SYNONYMS

nāradaù uvāca—Sri Nārada said; *bhikñubhiù*—by the great sages; *vipravasite*—having departed for other places; *vijñāna*—scientific spiritual knowledge; *ādeññābhiù*—those who imparted unto me; *mama*—mine; *vartamānaù*—present; *vayasi ädye*—before this life; *tataù*—thereafter; *etat*—this much; *akārañam*—performed.

TRANSLATION

Sri Nārada said: The great sages, who had imparted scientific knowledge of transcendence to me, departed for other places, and I had to pass my life in this way.

PURPORT

In his previous life, when Nārada^{jé} was impregnated with spiritual knowledge by the grace of the great sages, there was a tangible change in his life, although he was only a boy of five years. That is an important symptom visible after initiation by the bona fide spiritual master. Actual association of devotees brings about a quick change in life for spiritual realization. How it so acted upon the previous life of Sri Nārada Muni is described by and by in this chapter.

TEXT 6

**Wk-aTMaJaa Mae JaNaNaq YaaeizNMaU!a c ik-^arq)
MaYYaaTMaJae_NaNYaGaTaaE cñe- òehaNaubNDaNaMa()) 6))**

ekātmajā me janané

yoñin müòhā ca kīlkaré

mayy ätmaje 'nanya-gatau

cakre snehänubandhanam

SYNONYMS

eka-ätmajä—having only one son; *me*—my; *janané*—mother; *yoñit*—woman by class; *müðhä*—foolish; *ca*—and; *kikaré*—maidservant; *mayi*—unto me; *ätmaje*—being her offspring; *ananya-gatau*—one who has no alternative for protection; *cakre*—did it; *sneha-anubandhanam*—tied by affectionate bondage.

TRANSLATION

I was the only son of my mother, who was not only a simple woman but a maidservant as well. Since I was her only offspring, she had no other alternative for protection: she bound me with the tie of affection.

TEXT 7

**SaaSvTaN}aa Na k-LPaaSaqÛaeGa+aeMa& MaMaeC^Taq)
wRXaSYa ih vXae I/aek-ae Yaaeza daåMaYaq YaQaa)) 7))**

säsvatanträ na kalpäśéd

yoga-kñemaà mamecchaté

éçasya hi vaçe loko

yoñä dārumayé yathä

SYNONYMS

sä—she; *asvatanträ*—was dependent; *na*—not; *kalpä*—able; *äśét*—was; *yoga-kñemam*—maintenance; *mama*—my; *icchaté*—although desirous; *éçasya*—of providence; *hi*—for; *vaçe*—under the control of; *lokaù*—everyone; *yoñä*—doll; *dāru-mayé*—made of wood; *yathä*—as much as.

TRANSLATION

She wanted to look after my maintenance properly, but because she was not independent, she was not able to do anything for me. The world is under the full control of the Supreme Lord; therefore everyone is like a wooden doll in the hands of a puppet master.

TEXT 8

Ah& c Tad(b]øku-le/ Oizva&STaduPae+aYaa)
idGdeXak-al/aVYauTPaàae bal/k-" PaÄhaYaNa")) 8))

ahaà ca tad-brahma-kule

üñivääs tad-upekñayä

dig-deça-kälavyutpanno

bälakaù païca-häyanaù

SYNONYMS

aham—I; *ca*—also; *tat*—that; *brahma-kule*—in the school of the *brahmanas*; *üñivän*—lived; *tat*—her; *upekñayä*—being dependent on; *dik-deça*—direction and country; *käla*—time; *avyutpannaù*—having no experience; *bälakaù*—a mere child; *païca*—five; *häyanaù*—years old.

TRANSLATION

When I was a mere child of five years, I lived in a brahmana school. I was dependent on my mother's affection and had no experience of different lands.

TEXT 9

Wk-da iNaGaRTaa& GaehaÖuhNTaq& iNaiXa Gaa& PaiQa)
SaPaaeR_dXaTPada SPa*í" k*-Pa<aa& k-al/caeidTa")) 9))

ekadä nirgatäà gehäd

duhantéà niçi gäà pathi

sarpo 'daçat padä spãñöaù

kåpaëäà käla-coditaù

SYNONYMS

ekadä—once upon a time; *nirgatäm*—having gone away; *gehät*—from home; *duhantém*—for milking; *niçi*—at night; *gäm*—the cow; *pathi*—on the path; *sarpaù*—snake; *adaçat*—bitten; *padä*—on the leg; *spãñöaù*—thus struck; *kåpaëäm*—the poor woman; *käla-coditaù*—influenced by supreme time.

TRANSLATION

Once upon a time, my poor mother, when going out one night to milk a cow, was bitten on the leg by a serpent, influenced by supreme time.

PURPORT

That is the way of dragging a sincere soul nearer to God. The poor boy was being looked after only by his affectionate mother, and yet the mother was taken from the world by the supreme will in order to put him completely at the mercy of the Lord.

TEXT 10

**Tada TadhMaqXaSYa >aç-aNaa& XaMa>aqPSaTa")
ANauGa]h& MaNYaMaaNa" Pa[aiTai& idXaMautaraMa()) 10))**

tadä tad aham éçasya

bhaktänäà çam abhépsataù

anugrahaà manyamānaù

prātiñōhaà diçam uttarām

SYNONYMS

tadä—at that time; *tat*—that; *aham*—I; *éçasya*—of the Lord; *bhaktänām*—of the devotees; *çam*—mercy; *abhépsataù*—desiring; *anugraham*—special benediction; *manyamānaù*—thinking in that way; *prātiñōham*—departed; *diçam uttarām*—in the northern direction.

TRANSLATION

I took this as the special mercy of the Lord, who always desires benediction for His devotees, and so thinking, I started for the north.

PURPORT

Confidential devotees of the Lord see in every step a benedictory direction of the Lord. What is considered to be an odd or difficult moment in the mundane sense is accepted as special mercy of the Lord. Mundane prosperity is a kind of material fever, and by the grace of the Lord the temperature of this material fever is gradually diminished, and spiritual health is obtained step by step. Mundane people misunderstand it.

TEXT 11

**Sf-ITaaĀNaPada&STa}a PaurGa]aMav]Jaak-raNa()
%e\$=%vR\$=va\$q=ê vNaaNyauPavNaaiNa c)) 11))**

sphétäi janapadäàs tatra

pura-grāma-vrajākarān

kheöa-kharvaöa-väöéc ca

vanāny upavanāni ca

SYNONYMS

sphétän—very flourishing; *jana-padän*—metropolises; *tatra*—there; *pura*—towns; *gräma*—villages; *vraja*—big farms; *äkarän*—mineral fields (mines); *kheöa*—agricultural lands; *kharvaöa*—valleys; *väöéù*—flower gardens; *ca*—and; *vanäni*—forests; *upavanäni*—nursery gardens; *ca*—and.

TRANSLATION

After my departure, I passed through many flourishing metropolises, towns, villages, animal farms, mines, agricultural lands, valleys, flower gardens, nursery gardens and natural forests.

PURPORT

Man's activities in agriculture, mining, farming, industries, gardening, etc., were all on the same scale as they are now, even previous to the present creation, and the same activities will remain as they are, even in the next creation. After many hundreds of millions of years, one creation is started by the law of nature, and the history of the universe repeats itself practically in the same way. The mundane wranglers waste time with archaeological excavations without searching into the vital necessities of life. After getting an impetus in spiritual life, Sri Nārada Muni, even though a mere child, did not waste time for a single moment with economic development, although he passed towns and villages, mines and industries. He continually went on to progressive spiritual emancipation. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the repetition of history which happened some hundreds of millions of years ago. As it is said herein, only the most important factors of history are picked up to be recorded in this transcendental literature.

TEXT 12

ic}aDaaTauivic}aad]qiNa>a>aGan>auJad]uMaaNa()
Jal/aXaYaaiH^vJal/aàil/Naq" SaurSaeivTaa")
ic}aSvNaE" Pa}arQaEivR>a]Mad(>a]Marié[Ya")) 12))

citra-dhātu-vicitrādrén

ibha-bhagna-bhuja-drumän

jaläçayäi chiva-jalän

nalinéù sura-sevitäù

citra-svanaiù patra-rathair

vibhramad bhramara-çriyaù

SYNONYMS

citra-dhätu—valuable minerals like gold, silver and copper; *vicitra*—full of variegatedness; *adrén*—hills and mountains; *ibha-bhagna*—broken by the giant elephants; *bhuja*—branches; *drumän*—trees; *jaläçayän çiva*—health-giving; *jalän*—reservoirs of water; *nalinéù*—lotus flowers; *sura-sevitäù*—aspired to by the denizens of heaven; *citra-svanaiù*—pleasing to the heart; *patra-rathaiù*—by the birds; *vibhramat*—bewildering; *bhramara-çriyaù*—decorated by drones.

TRANSLATION

I passed through hills and mountains full of reservoirs of various minerals like gold, silver and copper, and through tracts of land with reservoirs of water filled with beautiful lotus flowers, fit for the denizens of heaven, decorated with bewildered bees and singing birds.

TEXT 13

**Nal/ve<auXarSTaNbku-Xak-Ick-GaûrMa()
Wk- WvaiTaYaaTaae_hMad]a+a& iviPaNa& MahTa()
gaaer& Pa[iTa>aYaak-ar& VYaal/aelU/k-iXavaiJarMa()) 13))**

nala-veëu-çaras-tanba-

kuça-kécaka-gahvaram

eka evätiyäto 'ham

adräkñaa vipinaa mahat

ghoraà pratibhayäkäraa

vyälolüka-çiväjiram

SYNONYMS

nala—pipes; *veëu*—bamboo; *çaraù*—pens; *tanba*—full of; *kuça*—sharp grass; *kécaka*—weeds; *gahvaram*—caves; *ekaù*—alone; *eva*—only; *atiyätaù*—difficult to go through; *aham*—I; *adräkñam*—visited; *vipinam*—deep forests; *mahat*—great; *ghoram*—fearful; *pratibhaya-äkäram*—dangerously; *vyäla*—snakes; *ulüka*—owls; *çiva*—jackals; *ajiram*—playgrounds.

TRANSLATION

I then passed alone through many forests of rushes, bamboo, reeds, sharp grass, weeds and caves, which were very difficult to go through alone. I visited deep, dark and dangerously fearful forests, which were the play yards of snakes, owls and jackals.

PURPORT

It is the duty of a mendicant (*parivrajakacarya*) to experience all varieties of God's creation by traveling alone through all forests, hills, towns, villages, etc., to gain faith in God and strength of mind as well as to enlighten the inhabitants with the message of God. A *sannyäse* is duty-bound to take all these risks without fear, and the most typical *sannyäse* of the present age is Lord Caitanya, who traveled in the same manner through the central Indian jungles, enlightening even the tigers, bears, snakes, deer, elephants and many other jungle animals. In this age of Kali, *sannyäsa* is forbidden for ordinary men. One who changes his dress to make propaganda is a different man from the original ideal *sannyäse*. One should, however, take the vow to stop social intercourse completely and devote life exclusively to

the service of the Lord. The change of dress is only a formality. Lord Caitanya did not accept the name of a *sannyāsé*, and in this age of Kali the so-called *sannyāsés* should not change their former names, following in the footsteps of Lord Caitanya. In this age, devotional service of hearing and repeating the holy glories of the Lord is strongly recommended, and one who takes the vow of renunciation of family life need not imitate the *parivrajakacarya* like Nārada or Lord Caitanya, but may sit down at some holy place and devote his whole time and energy to hear and repeatedly chant the holy scriptures left by the great *ācāryas* like the six Gosvamis of Våndāvana.

TEXT 14

**Pairé[aNTaeiNd]YaaTMaah& Ta*\$(ParqTaae bu>auí+aTa")
òaTva PaqTva hṛde NaŪa oPaSPa*íae GaTaé[Ma")) 14))**

pariçrāntendriyātmahā

tāḍ-paréta bubhukñitaù

snātvā pétvā hrade nadyā

upaspāñña gata-çramaù

SYNONYMS

pariçrānta—being tired; *indriya*—bodily; *ātmā*—mentally; *aham*—I; *tāḍ-parétaù*—being thirsty; *bubhukñitaù*—and hungry; *snātvā*—taking a bath; *pétvā*—and drinking water also; *hrade*—in the lake; *nadyāù*—of a river; *upaspāññaù*—being in contact with; *gata*—got relief from; *çramaù*—tiredness.

TRANSLATION

Thus traveling, I felt tired, both bodily and mentally, and I was both thirsty and hungry. So I took a bath in a river lake and also drank water. By contacting water, I got relief from my exhaustion.

PURPORT

A traveling mendicant can meet the needs of body, namely thirst and hunger, by the gifts of nature without being a beggar at the doors of the householders. The mendicant therefore does not go to the house of a householder to beg but to enlighten him spiritually.

TEXT 15

TaiSMaiàMaRNauJae_r<Yae iPaPPal/aePaSQa Aaié[Ta")
AaTMaNaaTMaaNaMaaTMaSQa& YaQaaé[uTaMaicNTaYaMa()) 15))

tasmin nirmanuje 'raëye

pippalopastha äçritaù

ätmanätmänam ätmasthaà

yathä-çrutam acintayam

SYNONYMS

tasmin—in that; *nirmanuje*—without human habitation; *araëye*—in the forest; *pippala*—banyan tree; *upasthe*—sitting under it; *äçritaù*—taking shelter of; *ätmanä*—by intelligence; *ätmänam*—the Supersoul; *ätma-stham*—situated within myself; *yathä-çrutam*—as I had heard it from the liberated souls; *acintayam*—thought over.

TRANSLATION

After that, under the shadow of a banyan tree in an uninhabited forest I began to meditate upon the Supersoul situated within, using my intelligence, as I had learned from liberated souls.

PURPORT

One should not meditate according to one's personal whims. One should

know perfectly well from the authoritative sources of scriptures through the transparent medium of a bona fide spiritual master and by proper use of one's trained intelligence for meditating upon the Supersoul dwelling within every living being. This consciousness is firmly developed by a devotee who has rendered loving service unto the Lord by carrying out the orders of the spiritual master. Sri Nāradaḡe contacted bona fide spiritual masters, served them sincerely and got enlightenment rightly. Thus he began to meditate.

TEXT 16

DYaaYaTaêr<aaM>aaeJa& >aaviNaiJaRTaceTaSaa)
AaETk-<#yaé[uk-l/a+aSYa ôÛaSaQNMae XaNaEhRir")) 16))

dhyäyataç caraëambhojaà

bhäva-nirjita-cetasä

autkaëöhyäçru-kaläkñasya

hådy äsén me çanair hariù

SYNONYMS

dhyäyataù—thus meditating upon; *caraëa-ambhojam*—the lotus feet of the localized Personality of Godhead; *bhäva-nirjita*—mind transformed in transcendental love for the Lord; *cetasä*—all mental activities (thinking, feeling and willing); *autkaëöhya*—eagerness; *açru-kala*—tears rolled down; *akñasya*—of the eyes; *hådi*—within my heart; *äsét*—appeared; *me*—my; *çanaiù*—without delay; *hariù*—the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

As soon as I began to meditate upon the lotus feet of the Personality of Godhead with my mind transformed in transcendental love, tears rolled down my eyes, and without delay the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa appeared on the lotus of my heart.

PURPORT

The word *bhāva* is significant here. This *bhāva* stage is attained after one has transcendental affection for the Lord. The first initial stage is called *çraddhā*, or a liking for the Supreme Lord, and in order to increase that liking one has to associate with pure devotees of the Lord. The third stage is to practice the prescribed rules and regulations of devotional service. This will dissipate all sorts of misgivings and remove all personal deficiencies that hamper progress in devotional service.

When all misgivings and personal deficiencies are removed, there is a standard faith in transcendental matter, and the taste for it increases in greater proportion. This stage leads to attraction, and after this there is *bhāva*, or the prior stage of unalloyed love for God. All the above different stages are but different stages of development of transcendental love. Being so surcharged with transcendental love, there comes a strong feeling of separation which leads to eight different kinds of ecstasies. Tears from the eyes of a devotee is an automatic reaction, and because Sri Nārada Muni in his previous birth attained that stage very quickly after his departure from home, it was quite possible for him to perceive the actual presence of the Lord, which he tangibly experienced by his developed spiritual senses without material tinge.

TEXT 17

Pa[eMaaiTa>ariNai>aRàPaul/k-a®ae_iTaiNav*RTa")
AaNaNdSaMâve l/I Naee NaaPaXYaMau>aYa& MauNae)) 17))

premätibhara-nirbhinna-

pulakäigo 'tinirvâtaù

änanda-samplave léno

näpaçyam ubhayaà mune

SYNONYMS

premā—love; *atibhara*—excessive; *nirbhinna*—especially distinguished; *pulaka*—feelings of happiness; *aìgaù*—different bodily parts; *ati-nirvātaù*—being fully overwhelmed; *ānanda*—ecstasy; *samplave*—in the ocean of; *lénaù*—absorbed in; *na*—not; *apaçyam*—could see; *ubhayam*—both; *mune*—O Vyāsadeva.

TRANSLATION

O Vyāsadeva, at that time, being exceedingly overpowered by feelings of happiness, every part of my body became separately enlivened. Being absorbed in an ocean of ecstasy, I could not see both myself and the Lord.

PURPORT

Spiritual feelings of happiness and intense ecstasies have no mundane comparison. Therefore it is very difficult to give expression to such feelings. We can just have a glimpse of such ecstasy in the words of Sri Nārada Muni. Each and every part of the body or senses has its particular function. After seeing the Lord, all the senses become fully awakened to render service unto the Lord because in the liberated state the senses are fully efficient in serving the Lord. As such, in that transcendental ecstasy it so happened that the senses became separately enlivened to serve the Lord. This being so, Nārada Muni lost himself in seeing both himself and the Lord simultaneously.

TEXT 18

æPa& >aGavTaae YataNMaNa"k-aNTa& éucaPahMa()
APaXYaNa(SahSaaetaSQae vE©-VYaad(duMaRNaa wv)) 18))

rūpaà bhagavato yat tan

manaù-kāntaà çucāpaham

apaçyan sahasottasthe

vaiklavyäd durmanä iva

SYNONYMS

rüpam—form; *bhagavataù*—of the Personality of Godhead; *yat*—as it is; *tat*—that; *manaù*—of the mind; *käntam*—as it desires; *çuca-apaham*—vanishing all disparity; *apaçyan*—without seeing; *sahasä*—all of a sudden; *uttasthe*—got up; *vaiklavyät*—being perturbed; *durmanäù*—having lost the desirable; *iva*—as it were.

TRANSLATION

The transcendental form of the Lord, as it is, satisfies the mind's desire and at once erases all mental incongruities. Upon losing that form, I suddenly got up, being perturbed, as is usual when one loses that which is desirable.

PURPORT

That the Lord is not formless is experienced by Nārada Muni. But His form is completely different from all forms of our material experience. For the whole duration of our life we go see different forms in the material world, but none of them is just apt to satisfy the mind, nor can any one of them vanish all perturbation of the mind. These are the special features of the transcendental form of the Lord, and one who has once seen that form is not satisfied with anything else; no form in the material world can any longer satisfy the seer. That the Lord is formless or impersonal means that He has nothing like a material form and is not like any material personality.

As spiritual beings, having eternal relations with that transcendental form of the Lord, we are, life after life, searching after that form of the Lord, and we are not satisfied by any other form of material appeasement. Nārada Muni got a glimpse of this, but having not seen it again he became perturbed and stood up all of a sudden to search it out. What we desire life after life was obtained by Nārada Muni, and losing sight of Him again was certainly a great shock for him.

TEXT 19

idd*+auSTadh& >aUYa" Pa[i<aDaaYa MaNaae ôid)
vq+aMaa<aae_iPa NaaPaXYaMaivTa*á wvaTaur")) 19))

didâkñus tad ahaà bhüyaù

praëidhâya mano hâdi

vékñamäëo 'pi näpaçyam

avitâpta iväturaù

SYNONYMS

didâkñuù—desiring to see; *tat*—that; *aham*—I; *bhüyaù*—again;
praëidhâya—having concentrated the mind; *manaù*—mind; *hâdi*—upon
the heart; *vékñamäëaù*—waiting to see; *api*—in spite of; *na*—never;
apaçyam—saw Him; *avitâptaù*—without being satisfied; *iva*—like; *äturaù*—
aggrieved.

TRANSLATION

I desired to see again that transcendental form of the Lord, but despite my attempts to concentrate upon the heart with eagerness to view the form again, I could not see Him any more, and thus dissatisfied, I was very much aggrieved.

PURPORT

There is no mechanical process to see the form of the Lord. It completely depends on the causeless mercy of the Lord. We cannot demand the Lord to be present before our vision, just as we cannot demand the sun to rise whenever we like. The sun rises out of his own accord; so also the Lord is pleased to be present out of His causeless mercy. One should simply await the opportune moment and go on discharging his prescribed duty in devotional service of the Lord. Nārada Muni thought that the Lord could be seen again by the same mechanical process which was successful in the first attempt, but in spite of his utmost endeavor he could not make the second

attempt successful. The Lord is completely independent of all obligations. He can simply be bound up by the tie of unalloyed devotion. Nor is He visible or perceivable by our material senses. When He pleases, being satisfied with the sincere attempt of devotional service depending completely on the mercy of the Lord, then He may be seen out of His own accord.

TEXT 20

**Wv& YaTaNTa& ivJaNae MaaMaahaGaaecrae iGaraMa()
GaM>aqrë+<aYaa vaca éuc" Pa[XaMaYaiàv)) 20))**

evaà yatantaà vijane

mām āhāgocarō girām

gambhéra-çlakñëayä vācā

çucaù praçamayann iva

SYNONYMS

evam—thus; *yatantam*—one who is engaged in attempting; *vijane*—in that lonely place; *mām*—unto me; *āha*—said; *agocaraù*—beyond the range of physical sound; *girām*—utterances; *gambhéra*—grave; *çlakñëayä*—pleasing to hear; *vācā*—words; *çucaù*—grief; *praçamayann*—mitigating; *iva*—like.

TRANSLATION

Seeing my attempts in that lonely place, the Personality of Godhead, who is transcendental to all mundane description, spoke to me with gravity and pleasing words, just to mitigate my grief.

PURPORT

In the *Vedas* it is said that God is beyond the approach of mundane words and intelligence. And yet by His causeless mercy one can have suitable

senses to hear Him or to speak to Him. This is the Lord's inconceivable energy. One upon whom His mercy is bestowed can hear Him. The Lord was much pleased with Nārada Muni, and therefore the necessary strength was invested in him so that he could hear the Lord. It is not, however, possible for others to perceive directly the touch of the Lord during the probationary stage of regulative devotional service. It was a special gift for Nārada. When he heard the pleasing words of the Lord, the feelings of separation were to some extent mitigated. A devotee in love with God feels always the pangs of separation and is therefore always enwrapped in transcendental ecstasy.

TEXT 21

hNTaaiSMaĀNMaiNa >avaNMAa Maa& d]íuiMahahRiTa)
AivPaKvk-zaYaa<aa& dudRXaaeR_h& ku-YaaeiGaNaMa()) 21))

hantāsmī janmani bhavān

mā māḍ draṇṇōum ihārhati

avipakva-kañyāḍḍā

durdaṛṇo 'haḍ kuyoginām

SYNONYMS

hanta—O Nārada; *asmin*—this; *janmani*—duration of life; *bhavān*—yourself; *mā*—not; *mām*—Me; *draṇṇōum*—to see; *iha*—here; *arhati*—deserve; *avipakva*—immature; *kañyāḍḍām*—material dirt; *durdaṛṇa*—difficult to be seen; *aham*—I; *kuyoginām*—incomplete in service.

TRANSLATION

O Nārada [the Lord spoke], I regret that during this lifetime you will not be able to see Me anymore. Those who are incomplete in service and who are not completely free from all material taints can hardly see Me.

PURPORT

The Personality of Godhead is described in the *Bhagavad-gita* as the most pure, the Supreme and the Absolute Truth. There is no trace of a tinge of materiality in His person, and thus one who has the slightest tinge of material affection cannot approach Him. The beginning of devotional service starts from the point when one is freed from at least two forms of material modes, namely the mode of passion and the mode of ignorance. The result is exhibited by the signs of being freed from *kāma* (lust) and *lobha* (covetousness). That is to say, one must be freed from the desires for sense satisfaction and avarice for sense gratification. The balanced mode of nature is goodness. And to be completely freed from all material tinges is to become free from the mode of goodness also. To search the audience of God in a lonely forest is considered to be in the mode of goodness. One can go out into the forest to attain spiritual perfection, but that does not mean that one can see the Lord personally there. One must be completely freed from all material attachment and be situated on the plane of transcendence, which alone will help the devotee get in personal touch with the Personality of Godhead. The best method is that one should live at a place where the transcendental form of the Lord is worshiped. The temple of the Lord is a transcendental place, whereas the forest is a materially good habitation. A neophyte devotee is always recommended to worship the Deity of the Lord (*arcanā*) rather than go into the forest to search out the Lord. Devotional service begins from the process of *arcanā*, which is better than going out in the forest. In his present life, which is completely freed from all material hankerings, Sri Nārada Muni does not go into the forest, although he can turn every place into Vaikuntha by his presence only. He travels from one planet to another to convert men, gods, Kinnaras, Gandharvas, *āñis*, *munis* and all others to become devotees of the Lord. By his activities he has engaged many devotees like Prahlāda Mahārāja, Dhruva Mahārāja and many others in the transcendental service of the Lord. A pure devotee of the Lord, therefore, follows in the footsteps of the great devotees like Nārada and Prahlāda and engages his whole time in glorifying the Lord by the process of *kértana*. Such a preaching process is transcendental to all material qualities.

TEXT 22

Sak*-Ôd(diXaRTa& æPaMaeTaTk-aMaaYa Tae_Naga)
MaTk-aMa" XaNakE-" SaaDau SavaRNMauÄiTa ôC^YaaNa()) 22))

sakâd yad darçitaà rüpaṁ

etat kāmāya te 'nagha

mat-kāmaù çanakaiù sādhu

sarvān muīcati hāt-chayān

SYNONYMS

sakât—once only; *yat*—that; *darçitam*—shown; *rüpaṁ*—form; *etat*—this is; *kāmāya*—for hankerings; *te*—your; *anagha*—O virtuous one; *mat*—Mine; *kāmaù*—desire; *çanakaiù*—by increasing; *sādhuù*—devotee; *sarvān*—all; *muīcati*—gives away; *hāt-çayān*—material desires.

TRANSLATION

O virtuous one, you have only once seen My person, and this is just to increase your desire for Me, because the more you hanker for Me, the more you will be freed from all material desires.

PURPORT

A living being cannot be vacant of desires. He is not a dead stone. He must be working, thinking, feeling and willing. But when he thinks, feels and wills materially, he becomes entangled, and conversely when he thinks, feels and wills for the service of the Lord, he becomes gradually freed from all entanglement. The more a person is engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord, the more he acquires a hankering for it. That is the transcendental nature of godly service. Material service has satiation, whereas spiritual service of the Lord has neither satiation nor end. One can go on increasing his hankerings for the loving transcendental service of the Lord, and yet he will not find satiation or end. By intense service of the Lord, one can experience the presence of the Lord transcendently.

Therefore seeing the Lord means being engaged in His service because His service and His person are identical. The sincere devotee should go on with sincere service of the Lord. The Lord will give proper direction as to how and where it has to be done. There was no material desire in Nārada, and yet just to increase his intense desire for the Lord, he was so advised.

TEXT 23

**SaTSaevYaadqgaRYaaiPa JaaTaa MaiYa d*!a MaiTa")
ihTvavŪiMaMa& I/aek&- GaNTaa MaÂNaTaaMaiSa)) 23))**

sat-sevayädérghayäpi

jätä mayi dāòhä matiù

hitvävadyam imaà lokaà

gantä maj-janatäm asi

SYNONYMS

sat-sevayä—by service of the Absolute Truth; *adérghayä*—for some days; *api*—even; *jätä*—having attained; *mayi*—unto Me; *dāòhä*—firm; *matiù*—intelligence; *hitvä*—having given up; *avadyam*—deplorable; *imam*—this; *lokam*—material worlds; *gantä*—going to; *mat-janatäm*—My associates; *asi*—become.

TRANSLATION

By service of the Absolute Truth, even for a few days, a devotee attains firm and fixed intelligence in Me. Consequently he goes on to become My associate in the transcendental world after giving up the present deplorable material worlds.

PURPORT

Serving the Absolute Truth means rendering service unto the Absolute

Personality of Godhead under the direction of the bona fide spiritual master, who is a transparent via medium between the Lord and the neophyte devotee. The neophyte devotee has no ability to approach the Absolute Personality of Godhead by the strength of his present imperfect material senses, and therefore under the direction of the spiritual master he is trained in transcendental service of the Lord. And by such training, even for some days, the neophyte devotee gets intelligence in such transcendental service, which leads him ultimately to get free from perpetual inhabitation in the material worlds and to be promoted to the transcendental world to become one of the liberated associates of the Lord in the kingdom of God.

TEXT 24

**MaiTaMaRiYa iNabÖeYa& Na ivPaÛeTa k-ihRicTa()
Pa[JaaSaGaRiNaraeDae_iPa SMa*iTaê MadNauGa]haTa()) 24))**

matir mayi nibaddheyaà

na vipadyeta karhicit

prajā-sarga-nirodhe 'pi

smātiṣ ca mad-anugrahāt

SYNONYMS

matiù—intelligence; *mayi*—devoted to Me; *nibaddhä*—engaged; *iyam*—this; *na*—never; *vipadyeta*—separate; *karhicit*—at any time; *prajā*—living beings; *sarga*—at the time of creation; *nirodhe*—also at the time of annihilation; *api*—even; *smātiù*—remembrance; *ca*—and; *mat*—Mine; *anugrahāt*—by the mercy of.

TRANSLATION

**Intelligence engaged in My devotion cannot be thwarted at any time.
Even at the time of creation, as well as at the time of annihilation, your**

remembrance will continue by My mercy.

PURPORT

Devotional service rendered to the Personality of Godhead never goes in vain. Since the Personality of Godhead is eternal, intelligence applied in His service or anything done in His relation is also permanent. In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is said that such transcendental service rendered unto the Personality of Godhead accumulates birth after birth, and when the devotee is fully matured, the total service counted together makes him eligible to enter into the association of the Personality of Godhead. Such accumulation of God's service is never vanquished, but increases till fully matured.

TEXT 25

WTaavduṣ-aeParraMa TaNMahd(
>aUTa& Na>aaeil/®Mail/®MaqirMa()
Ah& c TaSMaE MahTaa& MahqYaSae
XaqZ<aaRvNaaMa& ivdDae_Nauk-iMPaTa")) 25))

etävat uktvopararäma tan mahad

bhütaà nabho-liṅgam aliṅgam éçvaram

ahaà ca tasmai mahatäà mahéyase

çérñëävanämaà vidadhe 'nukampitaù

SYNONYMS

etävat—thus; *uktvä*—spoken; *upararäma*—stopped; *tat*—that; *mahat*—great; *bhütam*—wonderful; *nabhaù-liṅgam*—personified by sound; *aliṅgam*—unseen by the eyes; *éçvaram*—the supreme authority; *aham*—I; *ca*—also; *tasmai*—unto Him; *mahatäm*—the great; *mahéyase*—unto the glorified; *çérñëä*—by the head; *avanämam*—obeisances; *vidadhe*—executed; *anukampitaù*—being favored by Him.

TRANSLATION

Then that supreme authority, personified by sound and unseen by eyes, but most wonderful, stopped speaking. Feeling a sense of gratitude, I offered my obeisances unto Him, bowing my head.

PURPORT

That the Personality of Godhead was not seen but only heard does not make any difference. The Personality of Godhead produced the four *Vedas* by His breathing, and He is seen and realized through the transcendental sound of the *Vedas*. Similarly, the *Bhagavad-gita* is the sound representation of the Lord, and there is no difference in identity. The conclusion is that the Lord can be seen and heard by persistent chanting of the transcendental sound.

TEXT 26

NaaMaanYaNanTaSYa hTa}aPa" Pa#=Na(
GauùaiNa >ad]ai<a k*-TaaNa c SMarNa()
Gaa& PaYaR\$&=STauíMaNaa GaTaSPa*h"
k-al&/ Pa[Taq+aNa(ivMadae ivMaTSar")) 26))

nāmāny anantasya hata-trapaù paöhan

guhyāni bhadräëi kâtāni ca smaran

gäà paryaöaàs tuñöa-manä gata-spähaù

kälaà pratékñan vimado vimatsaraù

SYNONYMS

nāmāni—the holy name, fame, etc.; *anantasya*—of the unlimited; *hata-trapaù*—being freed from all formalities of the material world; *paöhan*—by recitation, repeated reading, etc.; *guhyāni*—mysterious; *bhadräëi*—all benedictory; *kâtāni*—activities; *ca*—and; *smaran*—constantly

remembering; *gām*—on the earth; *paryaöan*—traveling all through; *tuñöa-manäù*—fully satisfied; *gata-spåhaù*—completely freed from all material desires; *kālam*—time; *pratékñan*—awaiting; *vimadaù*—without being proud; *vimatsaraù*—without being envious.

TRANSLATION

Thus I began chanting the holy name and fame of the Lord by repeated recitation, ignoring all the formalities of the material world. Such chanting and remembering of the transcendental pastimes of the Lord are benedictory. So doing, I traveled all over the earth, fully satisfied, humble and unenvious.

PURPORT

The life of a sincere devotee of the Lord is thus explained in a nutshell by Nārada Muni by his personal example. Such a devotee, after his initiation by the Lord or His bona fide representative, takes very seriously chanting of the glories of the Lord and traveling all over the world so that others may also hear the glories of the Lord. Such devotees have no desire for material gain. They are conducted by one single desire: to go back to Godhead. This awaits them in due course on quitting the material body. Because they have the highest aim of life, going back to Godhead, they are never envious of anyone, nor are they proud of being eligible to go back to Godhead. Their only business is to chant and remember the holy name, fame and pastimes of the Lord and, according to personal capacity, to distribute the message for others' welfare without motive of material gain.

TEXT 27

**Wv& k*-Z<aMaTaeb]RøàaSaç-SYaaMal/aTMaNa")
k-al/" Pa[adur>aUTk-ale/ Tai@TSaaEdaMaNaq YaQaa)) 27))**

evaà kãñëa-mater brahman

näsaktasyämalätmanaù

kālaù prädurabhüt käle

taòit saudāmané yathä

SYNONYMS

evam—thus; *kāñëa-mateù*—one who is fully absorbed in thinking of Kṛṣṇa; *brahman*—O Vyāsadeva; *na*—not; *äsaktasya*—of one who is attached; *amala-ätmanaù*—of one who is completely free from all material dirt; *kālaù*—death; *prädurabhüt*—become visible; *käle*—in the course of time; *taòit*—lightning; *saudāmané*—illuminating; *yathä*—as it is.

TRANSLATION

And so, O Brähmaëa Vyäsadeva, in due course of time I, who was fully absorbed in thinking of Kṛṣṇa and who therefore had no attachments, being completely freed from all material taints, met with death, as lightning and illumination occur simultaneously.

PURPORT

To be fully absorbed in the thought of Kṛṣṇa means clearance of material dirt or hankerings. As a very rich man has no hankerings for small petty things, so also a devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa, who is guaranteed to pass on to the kingdom of God, where life is eternal, fully cognizant and blissful, naturally has no hankerings for petty material things, which are like dolls or shadows of the reality and are without permanent value. That is the sign of spiritually enriched persons. And in due course of time, when a pure devotee is completely prepared, all of a sudden the change of body occurs which is commonly called death. And for the pure devotee such a change takes place exactly like lightning, and illumination follows simultaneously. That is to say a devotee simultaneously changes his material body and develops a spiritual body by the will of the Supreme. Even before death, a pure devotee has no material affection, due to his body's being spiritualized like a red-hot iron in contact with fire.

TEXT 28

Pa[YauJYaMaaNae MaiYa Taa& éuÖa& >aaGavTaq& TaNauMa()
AarBDak-MaRiNavaR<aae NYaPaTaTa(PaaÄ>aaEiTak-")) 28))

prayujyamäne mayi tää

çuddhää bhägavatéà tanum

ärabdha-karma-nirvääo

nyapatat päïca-bhautikaù

SYNONYMS

prayujyamäne—having been awarded; *mayi*—on me; *täm*—that;
çuddhäm—transcendental; *bhägavatém*—fit for associating with the
Personality of Godhead; *tanum*—body; *ärabdha*—acquired; *karma*—
fruitive work; *nirvääù*—prohibitive; *nyapatat*—quit; *päïca-bhautikaù*—
body made of five material elements.

TRANSLATION

**Having been awarded a transcendental body befitting an associate of the
Personality of Godhead, I quit the body made of five material elements,
and thus all acquired fruitive results of work [karma] stopped.**

PURPORT

Informed by the Personality of Godhead that he would be awarded a transcendental body befitting the Lord's association, Nārada got his spiritual body as soon as he quitted his material body. This transcendental body is free from material affinity and invested with three primary transcendental qualities, namely eternity, freedom from material modes, and freedom from reactions of fruitive activities. The material body is always afflicted with the lack of these three qualities. A devotee's body becomes at once surcharged with the transcendental qualities as soon as he is engaged in the devotional service of the Lord. It acts like the magnetic influence of a touchstone upon iron. The influence of transcendental

devotional service is like that. Therefore change of the body means stoppage of the reaction of three qualitative modes of material nature upon the pure devotee. There are many instances of this in the revealed scriptures. Dhruva Mahārāja and Prahlāda Mahārāja and many other devotees were able to see the Personality of Godhead face to face apparently in the same body. This means that the quality of a devotee's body changes from material to transcendence. That is the opinion of the authorized Gosvamis via the authentic scriptures. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā* it is said that beginning from the *indra-gopa* germ up to the great Indra, King of heaven, all living beings are subjected to the law of *karma* and are bound to suffer and enjoy the fruitive results of their own work. Only the devotee is exempt from such reactions, by the causeless mercy of the supreme authority, the Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 29

k-LPaaNTa wdMaadaYa XaYaaNae_M>aSYaudNvTa")
iXaXaiYazaerNauPa[a<a& ivivXae_NTarh& iv>aae")) 29))

kalpānta idam ādāya

çayāne 'mbhasy udanvataù

çiçayiñor anuprāëaà

viviçe 'ntar ahaà vibhoù

SYNONYMS

kalpa-ante—at the end of Brahmā's day; *idam*—this; *ādāya*—taking together; *çayāne*—having gone to lie down; *ambhasi*—in the causal water; *udanvataù*—devastation; *çiçayiñor*—lying of the Personality of Godhead (Nārāyaṇa); *anuprāëam*—breathing; *viviçe*—entered into; *antaù*—within; *aham*—I; *vibhoù*—of Lord Brahmā.

TRANSLATION

At the end of the millennium, when the Personality of Godhead Lord Nārāyaṇa lay down within the water of devastation, Brahmā began to enter into Him along with all creative elements, and I also entered through His breathing.

PURPORT

Nārada is known as the son of Brahmā, as Lord Kṛṣṇa is known as the son of Vasudeva. The Personality of Godhead and His liberated devotees like Nārada appear in the material world by the same process. As it is said in the *Bhagavad-gita*, the birth and activities of the Lord are all transcendental. Therefore, according to authorized opinion, the birth of Nārada as the son of Brahmā is also a transcendental pastime. His appearance and disappearance are practically on the same level as that of the Lord. The Lord and His devotees are therefore simultaneously one and different as spiritual entities. They belong to the same category of transcendence.

TEXT 30

SahóYauGaPaYaRNTae oTQaaYaed& iSaSa*+aTa")
MarqiciMaé[a %ozYa" Pa[a<ae>Yaae_h& c Jaijre)) 30))

sahasra-yuga-paryante

utthāyedaà sisākñataù

maréci-miçrā āñayaù

prāëebhyo 'haà ca jajjire

SYNONYMS

sahasra—one thousand; *yuga*—4,300,000 years; *paryante*—at the end of the duration; *utthāya*—having expired; *idam*—this; *sisākñataù*—desired to create again; *maréci-miçrāù*—āñis like Maréci; *āñayaù*—all the āñis; *prāëebhyaù*—out of His senses; *aham*—I; *ca*—also; *jajjire*—appeared.

TRANSLATION

After 4,300,000,000 solar years, when Brahmä awoke to create again by the will of the Lord, all the *āñis* like Maréci, Aìgirä, Atri and so on were created from the transcendental body of the Lord, and I also appeared along with them.

PURPORT

The duration of a day in the life of Brahmä is 4,320,000,000 solar years. This is stated also in the *Bhagavad-gita*. So for this period Brahmäjé rests in *yoga-nidrä* within the body of the Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, the generator of Brahmä. Thus after the sleeping period of Brahmä, when there is again creation by the will of the Lord through the agency of Brahmä, all the great *āñis* again appear from different parts of the transcendental body, and Nārada also appears. This means that Nārada appears in the same transcendental body, just as a man awakes from sleep in the same body. Sri Nārada is eternally free to move in all parts of the transcendental and material creations of the Almighty. He appears and disappears in his own transcendental body, which is without distinction of body and soul, unlike conditioned beings.

TEXT 31

ANTabRihê I/aek-a&ñqNa(PaYaeRMYaSk-iNdTav]Ta")
ANauGa]haNMahaivZ<aaerivgaaTaGaiTa" KvicTa() 31))

antar bahiç ca lokäàs trén

paryemy askandita-vrataù

anugrahän mahä-viñëor

avighäta-gatiù kvacit

SYNONYMS

antaù—in the transcendental world; *bahiù*—in the material world; *ca*—and; *lokän*—planets; *trén*—three (divisions); *paryemi*—travel; *askandita*—unbroken; *vrataù*—vow; *anugrahät*—by the causeless mercy; *mahä-viñëoù*—of the Mahä-Viṣṇu (Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu); *avighäta*—without restriction; *gatiù*—entrance; *kvacit*—at any time.

TRANSLATION

Since then, by the grace of the almighty Viṣṇu, I travel everywhere without restriction both in the transcendental world and in the three divisions of the material world. This is because I am fixed in unbroken devotional service of the Lord.

PURPORT

As stated in the *Bhagavad-gita*, there are three divisions of the material spheres, namely the *ürdhva-loka* (topmost planets), *madhya-loka* (midway planets) and *adho-loka* (downward planets). Beyond the *ürdhva-loka* planets, that is to say above the Brahmaloḳa, are the material coverings of the universes, and above that is the spiritual sky, which is unlimited in expansion, containing unlimited self-illuminated Vaikuntha planets inhabited by God Himself along with His associates, who are all eternally liberated living entities. Sri Nārada Muni could enter all these planets in both the material and spiritual spheres without restriction, as much as the almighty Lord is free to move personally in any part of His creation. In the material world the living beings are influenced by the three material modes of nature, namely goodness, passion and ignorance. But Sri Nārada Muni is transcendental to all these material modes, and thus he can travel everywhere unrestricted. He is a liberated spaceman. The causeless mercy of Lord Viṣṇu is unparalleled, and such mercy is perceived by the devotees only by the grace of the Lord. Therefore, the devotees never fall down, but the materialists, i.e., the fruitive workers and the speculative philosophers, do fall down, being forced by their respective modes of nature. The *añis*, as above mentioned, cannot enter into the transcendental world like Nārada. This fact is disclosed in the *Narasiñha Purana*. *Rsis* like Maréci are authorities in fruitive work, and *añis* like Sanaka and Sanātana are authorities in philosophical speculations. But Sri Nārada Muni is the prime

authority for transcendental devotional service of the Lord. All the great authorities in the devotional service of the Lord follow in the footsteps of Nārada Muni in the order of the *Nārada-bhakti-sūtra*, and therefore all the devotees of the Lord are unhesitatingly qualified to enter into the kingdom of God, Vaikuntha.

TEXT 32

**devdtaaiMaMaa& vq<aa& Svr]øiv>aUizTaaMa()
MaUC^RiYaTva hirk-Qaa& GaaYaMaaNaêraMYahMa()) 32))**

deva-dattām imāà véëää

svara-brahma-vibhūñitām

mürcchayitvā hari-kathāà

gāyamānaç carāmy aham

SYNONYMS

deva—the Supreme Personality of Godhead (Sri Kṛṣṇa); *dattām*—gifted by; *imām*—this; *véëäm*—a musical stringed instrument; *svara*—singing meter; *brahma*—transcendental; *vibhūñitām*—decorated with; *mürcchayitvā*—vibrating; *hari-kathām*—transcendental message; *gāyamāna*—singing constantly; *carāmi*—do move; *aham*—I.

TRANSLATION

And thus I travel, constantly singing the transcendental message of the glories of the Lord, vibrating this instrument called a véëä, which is charged with transcendental sound and which was given to me by Lord Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

The musical stringed instrument called the véëä, which was handed to

Nārada by Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, is described in the *Līlga Purana*, and this is confirmed by Srila Jiva Gosvami. This transcendental instrument is identical with Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and Nārada because all of them are of the same transcendental category. Sound vibrated by the instrument cannot be material, and therefore the glories and pastimes which are broadcast by the instrument of Nārada are also transcendental, without a tinge of material inebriety. The seven singing meters, namely *ñā* (*ñāḍja*), *ā* (*āñabha*), *gä* (*gāndhāra*), *ma* (*madhyama*), *pa* (*paicama*), *dha* (*dhaivata*) and *ni* (*niñāda*), are also transcendental and specifically meant for transcendental songs. As a pure devotee of the Lord, Sri Nārada-deva is always fulfilling his obligation to the Lord for His gift of the instrument, and thus he is always engaged in singing His transcendental glories and is therefore infallible in his exalted position. Following in the footsteps of Srila Nārada Muni, a self-realized soul in the material world should also properly use the sound meters, namely *ñā*, *ā*, *gä*, *mä*, etc., in the service of the Lord by constantly singing the glories of the Lord, as confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita*.

TEXT 33

Pa[GaaYaTa" SvvaqYaaRi<a TaqQaRPaad" iPa[Yaé[va")
AahUTa wv Mae Xaqa]& dXaRNa& YaaITa ceTaiSa)) 33))

pragäyataù sva-véryäëi

tértha-pädaù priya-çraväù

ähüta iva me céghraà

darçanaà yäti cetasi

SYNONYMS

pragäyataù—thus singing; *sva-véryäëi*—own activities; *tértha-pädaù*—the Lord, whose lotus feet are the source of all virtues or holiness; *priya-çraväù*—pleasing to hear; *ähütaù*—called for; *iva*—just like; *me*—to me; *céghram*—very soon; *darçanam*—sight; *yäti*—appears; *cetasi*—on the seat

of the heart.

TRANSLATION

The Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, whose glories and activities are pleasing to hear, at once appears on the seat of my heart, as if called for, as soon as I begin to chant His holy activities.

PURPORT

The Absolute Personality of Godhead is not different from His transcendental name, form, pastimes and the sound vibrations thereof. As soon as a pure devotee engages himself in the pure devotional service of hearing, chanting and remembering the name, fame and activities of the Lord, at once He becomes visible to the transcendental eyes of the pure devotee by reflecting Himself on the mirror of the heart by spiritual television. Therefore a pure devotee who is related with the Lord in loving transcendental service can experience the presence of the Lord at every moment. It is a natural psychology in every individual case that a person likes to hear and enjoy his personal glories enumerated by others. That is a natural instinct, and the Lord, being also an individual personality like others, is not an exception to this psychology because psychological characteristics visible in the individual souls are but reflections of the same psychology in the Absolute Lord. The only difference is that the Lord is the greatest personality of all and absolute in all His affairs. If, therefore, the Lord is attracted by the pure devotee's chanting of His glories, there is nothing astonishing. Since He is absolute, He can appear Himself in the picture of His glorification, the two things being identical. Śrīla Nārada chants the glorification of the Lord not for his personal benefit but because the glorifications are identical with the Lord. Nārada Muni penetrates into the presence of the Lord by the transcendental chanting.

TEXT 34

**WTaÖyaTaurictaaNaa& Maa}aaSPaXaeRC^Yaa Mauhu")
>aviSaNDauâvae d*íae hircYaaRNauv<aRNaMa()) 34))**

etat dhy ätura-cittänää

mätrā-sparṣecchayā muhuù

bhava-sindhu-plavo dāñöö

hari-caryānuvarëanam

SYNONYMS

etat—this; *hi*—certainly; *ätura-cittänäm*—of those whose minds are always full of cares and anxieties; *mätrā*—objects of sense enjoyment; *sparṣa*—senses; *icchayā*—by desires; *muhuù*—always; *bhava-sindhu*—the ocean of nescience; *plavaù*—boat; *dāñööaù*—experienced; *hari-carya*—activities of Hari, the Personality of Godhead; *anuvarëanam*—constant recitation.

TRANSLATION

It is personally experienced by me that those who are always full of cares and anxieties due to desiring contact of the senses with their objects can cross the ocean of nescience on a most suitable boat—the constant chanting of the transcendental activities of the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

The symptom of a living being is that he cannot remain silent even for some time. He must be doing something, thinking of something or talking about something. Generally the materialistic men think and discuss about subjects which satisfy their senses. But as these things are exercised under the influence of the external, illusory energy, such sensual activities do not actually give them any satisfaction. On the contrary, they become full with cares and anxieties. This is called *mäyā*, or what is not. That which cannot give them satisfaction is accepted as an object for satisfaction. So Nārada Muni, by his personal experience, says that satisfaction for such frustrated beings engaged in sense gratification is to chant always the activities of the Lord. The point is that the subject matter only should be changed. No one can check the thinking activities of a living being, nor the feeling, willing or

working processes. But if one wants actual happiness, one must change the subject matter only. Instead of talking of the politics of a dying man, one might discuss the politics administered by the Lord Himself. Instead of relishing activities of the cinema artists, one can turn his attention to the activities of the Lord with His eternal associates like the *gopés* and *Lakñmés*. The almighty Personality of Godhead, by His causeless mercy, descends on the earth and manifests activities almost on the line of the worldly men, but at the same time extraordinarily, because He is almighty. He does so for the benefit of all conditioned souls so that they can turn their attention to transcendence. By doing so, the conditioned soul will gradually be promoted to the transcendental position and easily cross the ocean of nescience, the source of all miseries. This is stated from personal experience by such an authority as Sri Nārada Muni. And we can have the same experience also if we begin to follow in the footsteps of the great sage, the dearmost devotee of the Lord.

TEXT 35

**YaMaaidi>aYaaeRGaPaQaE" k-aMal/ae>ahTaae Mauhu")
Mauku-NdSaevYaa YaÜtaQaaTMaaÖa Na XaaMYaiTa)) 35))**

yamädibhir yoga-pathaiù

käma-lobha-hato muhuù

mukunda-sevayä yadvat

tathätmäddhä na çämyati

SYNONYMS

yama-ädibhiù—by the process of practicing self-restraint; *yoga-pathaiù*—by the system of *yoga* (mystic bodily power to attain the godly stage); *käma*—desires for sense satisfaction; *lobha*—lust for satisfaction of the senses; *hataù*—curbed; *muhuù*—always; *mukunda*—the Personality of Godhead; *sevayä*—by the service of; *yadvat*—as it is; *tathä*—like that; *ätmä*—the soul; *addhä*—for all practical purposes; *na*—does not;

çämyati—be satisfied.

TRANSLATION

It is true that by practicing restraint of the senses by the yoga system one can get relief from the disturbances of desire and lust, but this is not sufficient to give satisfaction to the soul, for this [satisfaction] is derived from devotional service to the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

Yoga aims at controlling the senses. By practice of the mystic process of bodily exercise in sitting, thinking, feeling, willing, concentrating, meditating and at last being merged into transcendence, one can control the senses. The senses are considered like venomous serpents, and the *yoga* system is just to control them. On the other hand, Nārada Muni recommends another method for controlling the senses in the transcendental loving service of Mukunda, the Personality of Godhead. By his experience he says that devotional service to the Lord is more effective and practical than the system of artificially controlling the senses. In the service of the Lord Mukunda, the senses are transcendently engaged. Thus there is no chance of their being engaged in sense satisfaction. The senses want some engagement. To check them artificially is no check at all because as soon as there is some opportunity for enjoyment, the serpentlike senses will certainly take advantage of it. There are many such instances in history, just like Viçvämītra Muni's falling a victim to the beauty of Menakā. But Ōhākura Haridāsa was allured at midnight by the well-dressed Māyā, and still she could not induce that great devotee into her trap.

The whole idea is that without devotional service of the Lord, neither the *yoga* system nor dry philosophical speculation can ever become successful. Pure devotional service of the Lord, without being tinged with fruitive work, mystic *yoga* or speculative philosophy, is the foremost procedure to attain self-realization. Such pure devotional service is transcendental in nature, and the systems of *yoga* and *jñāna* are subordinate to such a process. When the transcendental devotional service is mixed with a subordinate process,

it is no longer transcendental but is called mixed devotional service. Srila Vyāsadeva, the author of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, will gradually develop all these different systems of transcendental realization in the text.

TEXT 36

Sav| TaiddMaa:YaaTa& YaTPa*íae_h& TvYaaNaga)
JaNMak-MaRrhSYa& Mae >avTaêaTMaTaaez<aMa()) 36))

sarvaà tad idam äkhyätaà

yat pãñöo 'haà tvayänagha

janma-karma-rahasyaà me

bhavataç cätma-toñaëam

SYNONYMS

sarvam—all; *tat*—that; *idam*—this; *äkhyätam*—described; *yat*—whatever; *pãñöaù*—asked by; *aham*—me; *tvayä*—by you; *anagha*—without any sins; *janma*—birth; *karma*—activities; *rahasyam*—mysteries; *me*—mine; *bhavataù*—your; *ca*—and; *ätma*—self; *toñaëam*—satisfaction.

TRANSLATION

O Vyāsadeva, you are freed from all sins. Thus I have explained my birth and activities for self-realization, as you asked. All this will be conducive for your personal satisfaction also.

PURPORT

The process of devotional activities from the beginning to the stage of transcendence is all duly explained to satisfy the inquiries of Vyāsadeva. He has explained how the seeds of devotional service were sown by transcendental association and how they gradually developed by hearing the sages. The result of such hearing is detachment from worldliness, so

much so that even a small boy could receive the death news of his mother, who was his only caretaker, as the blessing of God. And at once he took the opportunity to search out the Lord. A sincere urge for having an interview with the Lord was also granted to him, although it is not possible for anyone to see the Lord with mundane eyes. He also explained how by execution of pure transcendental service one can get rid of the fruitive action of accumulated work and how he transformed his material body into a spiritual one. The spiritual body is alone able to enter into the spiritual realm of the Lord, and no one but a pure devotee is eligible to enter into the kingdom of God. All the mysteries of transcendental realization are duly experienced by Nārada Muni himself, and therefore by hearing such an authority one can have some idea of the results of devotional life, which are hardly delineated even in the original texts of the *Vedas*. In the *Vedas* and *Upaniñads* there are only indirect hints to all this. Nothing is directly explained there, and therefore *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the mature fruit of all the Vedic trees of literatures.

TEXT 37

SaUTa ovac

Wv& SaM>aaZYa >aGavaàardae vaSavqSauTaMa()
AaMaN}Ya vq<aa& r<aYaNa(YaYaaE Yaad*iC^k-ae MauiNa")) 37))

sūta uvāca

evaà sambhāñya bhagavān

nārado vāsavé-sutam

āmantrya véëää raëayan

yayau yādācchiko muniù

SYNONYMS

sūtaù—Sūta Gosvami; *uvāca*—said; *evam*—thus; *sambhāñya*—addressing; *bhagavān*—transcendentally powerful; *nāradaù*—Nārada Muni; *vāsavé*—

named Väsavé (Satyavati); *sutam*—son; *āmantrya*—inviting; *véëäm*—instrument; *raëāyan*—vibrating; *yayau*—went; *yädācchikaù*—wherever willing; *muniù*—the sage.

TRANSLATION

Süta Gosvami said: Thus addressing Vyāsadeva, Srila Nārada Muni took leave of him, and vibrating on his véëä instrument, he left to wander at his free will.

PURPORT

Every living being is anxious for full freedom because that is his transcendental nature. And this freedom is obtained only through the transcendental service of the Lord. Illusioned by the external energy, everyone thinks that he is free, but actually he is bound up by the laws of nature. A conditioned soul cannot freely move from one place to another even on this earth, and what to speak of one planet to another. But a full-fledged free soul like Nārada, always engaged in chanting the Lord's glory, is free to move not only on earth but also in any part of the universe, as well as in any part of the spiritual sky. We can just imagine the extent and unlimitedness of his freedom, which is as good as that of the Supreme Lord. There is no reason or obligation for his traveling, and no one can stop him from his free movement. Similarly, the transcendental system of devotional service is also free. It may or may not develop in a particular person even after he undergoes all the detailed formulas. Similarly, the association of the devotee is also free. One may be fortunate to have it, or one may not have it even after thousands of endeavors. Therefore, in all spheres of devotional service, freedom is the main pivot. Without freedom there is no execution of devotional service. The freedom surrendered to the Lord does not mean that the devotee becomes dependent in every respect. To surrender unto the Lord through the transparent medium of the spiritual master is to attain complete freedom of life.

TEXT 38

Ahae devizRDaRNYaae_Ya& YaTk-liTa| Xaa®RDaNvNa")

GaaYaNMaaÛiàd& TaN}Yaa rMaYaTYaaTaur& JaGaTa()) 38))

aho devarñir dhanyo 'yaà

yat-kértià çärìgadhanvanaù

gäyan mädyann idaà tantryä

ramayaty äturaà jagat

SYNONYMS

aho—all glory to; *devarñiù*—the sage of the gods; *dhanyaù*—all success; *ayam yat*—one who; *kértim*—glories; *çärìga-dhanvanaù*—of the Personality of Godhead; *gäyan*—singing; *mädyan*—taking pleasure in; *idam*—this; *tantryä*—by means of the instrument; *ramayati*—enlivens; *äturam*—distressed; *jagat*—world.

TRANSLATION

All glory and success to Srila Nārada Muni because he glorifies the activities of the Personality of Godhead, and so doing he himself takes pleasure and also enlivens all the distressed souls of the universe.

PURPORT

Sri Nārada Muni plays on his instrument to glorify the transcendental activities of the Lord and to give relief to all miserable living entities of the universe. No one is happy here within the universe, and what is felt as happiness is *mäyā's* illusion. The illusory energy of the Lord is so strong that even the hog who lives on filthy stool feels happy. No one can be truly happy within the material world. Srila Nārada Muni, in order to enlighten the miserable inhabitants, wanders everywhere. His mission is to get them back home, back to Godhead. That is the mission of all genuine devotees of the Lord following the footsteps of that great sage.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Sixth Chapter, of

the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled “Conversation Between Nārada and Vyāsa.”

Chapter Seven

The Son of Droëa Punished

TEXT 1

XaaENak- ovac
iNaGaRTae Naarde SaUTa >aGavaNa(badraYa<a")
é[uTava&STadi>aPa[eTa& TaTa" ik-Mak-raeiÜ>au")) 1))

çaunaka uvāca

nirgate nārade sūta

bhagavān bādarāyaēaù

çrutavāàs tad-abhipretaà

tataù kim akarod vibhuù

SYNONYMS

çaunakaù—Sri Çaunaka; *uvāca*—said; *nirgate*—having gone; *nārade*—Nārada Muni; *sūta*—O Sūta; *bhagavān*—the transcendently powerful; *bādarāyaēaù*—Vedavyāsa; *çrutavān*—who heard; *tat*—his; *abhipretam*—desire of the mind; *tataù*—thereafter; *kim*—what; *akarot*—did he do; *vibhuù*—the great.

TRANSLATION

Rsi Çaunaka asked: O Sūta, the great and transcendently powerful Vyāsadeva heard everything from Sri Nārada Muni. So after Nārada’s departure, what did Vyāsadeva do?

PURPORT

In this chapter the clue for describing *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is picked up as Mahārāja Parékñit is miraculously saved in the womb of his mother. This was caused by Drauëi (Açvatthämä), Ācārya Droëa's son, who killed the five sons of Draupadé while they were asleep, for which he was punished by Arjuna. Before commencing the great epic *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, Sri Vyāsadeva realized the whole truth by trance in devotion.

TEXT 2

SaUTa ovac

b]øNaÛa& SarSvTYaaMaaé[Ma" PaiêMae Ta\$e=)
XaMYaaPa[aSa wiTa Pa[aeç- %ºzq<aa& Sa}avDaRNa")) 2))

sūta uvāca

brahma-nadyäà sarasvatyäm

äçramaù paçcime taöe

çamyäpräsa iti prokta

åñéëää satra-varohanaù

SYNONYMS

sūtaù—Sri Sūta; *uvāca*—said; *brahma-nadyäm*—on the bank of the river intimately related with *Vedas*, *brahmanas*, saints, and the Lord; *sarasvatyäm*—Sarasvaté; *äçramaù*—cottage for meditation; *paçcime*—on the west; *taöe*—bank; *çamyäpräsaù*—the place named Çamyäpräsa; *iti*—thus; *proktaù*—said to be; *åñéëäm*—of the sages; *satra-varohanaù*—that which enlivens activities.

TRANSLATION

Sri Sūta said: On the western bank of the River Sarasvaté, which is

intimately related with the Vedas, there is a cottage for meditation at Çamyäpräsa which enlivens the transcendental activities of the sages.

PURPORT

For spiritual advancement of knowledge a suitable place and atmosphere are definitely required. The place on the western bank of the Sarasvaté is especially suitable for this purpose. And there is the *āçrama* of Vyāsadeva at Çamyäpräsa. Srila Vyāsadeva was a householder, yet his residential place is called an *āçrama*. An *āçrama* is a place where spiritual culture is always foremost. It does not matter whether the place belongs to a householder or a mendicant. The whole *varëāçrama* system is so designed that each and every status of life is called an *āçrama*. This means that spiritual culture is the common factor for all. The *brahmacärés*, the *gāhasthas*, the *vānaprasthas* and the *sannyäsés* all belong to the same mission of life, namely, realization of the Supreme. Therefore none of them are less important as far as spiritual culture is concerned. The difference is a matter of formality on the strength of renunciation. The *sannyäsés* are held in high estimation on the strength of practical renunciation.

TEXT 3

TaiSMaNa(Sv Aaé[Mae VYaaSaae bdrqz<@Mai<@Tae)
AaSaqNaae_Pa oPaSPa*XYa Pa[i<adDYaaE MaNa" SvYaMa()) 3))

tasmin sva āçrame vyāso

badaré-ñāëða-maëðite

äséno 'pa upaspāçya

praëidadhyaù manaù svayam

SYNONYMS

tasmin—in that (*āçrama*); *sve*—own; *āçrame*—in the cottage; *vyāsaù*—Vyāsadeva; *badaré*—berry; *ñāëða*—trees; *maëðite*—surrounded by;

äsénaù—sitting; *apaù upaspāçya*—touching water; *praëidadhyau*—concentrated; *manaù*—the mind; *svayam*—himself.

TRANSLATION

In that place, Srila Vyāsadeva, in his own āçrama, which was surrounded by berry trees, sat down to meditate after touching water for purification.

PURPORT

Under instructions of his spiritual master Srila Nārada Muni, Vyāsadeva concentrated his mind in that transcendental place of meditation.

TEXT 4

>aiç-YaaeGaeNa MaNaiSa SaMYak(- Pa[i<aihTae_Male/)
APaXYaTPauâz& PaU<a| MaaYaa& c TadPaaé[YaMa()) 4))

bhakti-yogena manasi

samyak praëihite ’male

apaçyat puruṣaà pürëaà

mäyää ca tad-apäçrayam

SYNONYMS

bhakti—devotional service; *yogena*—by the process of linking up; *manasi*—upon the mind; *samyak*—perfectly; *praëihite*—engaged in and fixed upon; *amale*—without any matter; *apaçyat*—saw; *puruṣam*—the Personality of Godhead; *pürëam*—absolute; *mäyäm*—energy; *ca*—also; *tat*—His; *apäçrayam*—under full control.

TRANSLATION

Thus he fixed his mind, perfectly engaging it by linking it in devotional

service [bhakti-yoga] without any tinge of materialism, and thus he saw the Absolute Personality of Godhead along with His external energy, which was under full control.

PURPORT

Perfect vision of the Absolute Truth is possible only by the linking process of devotional service. This is also confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita*. One can perfectly realize the Absolute Truth Personality of Godhead only by the process of devotional service, and one can enter into the kingdom of God by such perfect knowledge. Imperfect realization of the Absolute by the partial approach of the impersonal Brahman or localized Paramātmā does not permit anyone to enter into the kingdom of God. Sri Nārada advised Srila Vyāsadeva to become absorbed in transcendental meditation on the Personality of Godhead and His activities. Srila Vyāsadeva did not take notice of the effulgence of Brahman because that is not absolute vision. The absolute vision is the Personality of Godhead, as it is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita* (7.19): *vāsudevaù sarvam iti*. In the *Upaniñads* also it is confirmed that Vāsudeva, the Personality of Godhead, is covered by the golden glowing *hiraëmayena pätreëa* veil of impersonal Brahman, and when that curtain is removed by the mercy of the Lord the real face of the Absolute is seen. The Absolute is mentioned here as the *puruṣa*, or person. The Absolute Personality of Godhead is mentioned in so many Vedic literatures, and in the *Bhagavad-gita*, the *puruṣa* is confirmed as the eternal and original person. The Absolute Personality of Godhead is the perfect person. The Supreme Person has manifold energies, out of which the internal, external and marginal energies are specifically important. The energy mentioned here is the external energy, as will be clear from the statements of her activities. The internal energy is there along with the Absolute Person as the moonlight is there with the moon. The external energy is compared to darkness because it keeps the living entities in the darkness of ignorance. The word *apāçrayam* suggests that this energy of the Lord is under full control. The internal potency or superior energy is also called *māyā*, but it is spiritual *māyā*, or energy exhibited in the absolute realm. When one is under the shelter of this internal potency, the darkness of material ignorance is at once dissipated. And even those who are *ätmäräma*, or fixed in trance, take shelter of this *māyā*, or internal

energy. Devotional service, or *bhakti-yoga*, is the function of the internal energy; thus there is no place for the inferior energy, or material energy, just as there is no place for darkness in the effulgence of spiritual light. Such internal energy is even superior to the spiritual bliss attainable in the conception of impersonal Brahman. It is stated in the *Bhagavad-gita* that the impersonal Brahman effulgence is also an emanation from the Absolute Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa. The *parama-puruṣa* cannot be anyone except Sri Kṛṣṇa Himself, as will be explained in the later *śloka*s.

TEXT 5

YaYaa SaMMaaehTaae Jaqv AaTMaaNa& i}aGau<aaTMak-Ma()
Parae_iPa MaNauTae_NaQa| TaTk*-Ta& cai>aPaÛTae)) 5))

yayā sammohito jēva

ātmānaà tri-guëätmakam

paro 'pi manute 'narthaa

tat-kātaà cābhipadyate

SYNONYMS

yayā—by whom; *sammohita*—illusioned; *jēva*—the living entities; *ātmānam*—self; *tri-guëa-ātmakam*—conditioned by the three modes of nature, or a product of matter; *para*—transcendental; *api*—in spite of; *manute*—takes it for granted; *anartham*—things not wanted; *tat*—by that; *kātam ca*—reaction; *abhipadyate*—undergoes thereof.

TRANSLATION

Due to this external energy, the living entity, although transcendental to the three modes of material nature, thinks of himself as a material product and thus undergoes the reactions of material miseries.

PURPORT

The root cause of suffering by the materialistic living beings is pointed out with remedial measures which are to be undertaken and also the ultimate perfection to be gained. All this is mentioned in this particular verse. The living being is by constitution transcendental to material encagement, but he is now imprisoned by the external energy, and therefore he thinks himself one of the material products. And due to this unholy contact, the pure spiritual entity suffers material miseries under the modes of material nature. The living entity misunderstands himself to be a material product. This means that the present perverted way of thinking, feeling and willing, under material conditions, is not natural for him. But he has his normal way of thinking, feeling and willing. The living being in his original state is not without thinking, willing and feeling power. It is also confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita* that the actual knowledge of the conditioned soul is now covered by nescience. Thus the theory that a living being is absolute impersonal Brahman is refuted herein. This cannot be, because the living entity has his own way of thinking in his original unconditional state also. The present conditional state is due to the influence of the external energy, which means that the illusory energy takes the initiative while the Supreme Lord is aloof. The Lord does not desire that a living being be illusioned by external energy. The external energy is aware of this fact, but still she accepts a thankless task of keeping the forgotten soul under illusion by her bewildering influence. The Lord does not interfere with the task of the illusory energy because such performances of the illusory energy are also necessary for reformation of the conditioned soul. An affectionate father does not like his children to be chastised by another agent, yet he puts his disobedient children under the custody of a severe man just to bring them to order. But the all-affectionate Almighty Father at the same time desires relief for the conditioned soul, relief from the clutches of the illusory energy. The king puts the disobedient citizens within the walls of the jail, but sometimes the king, desiring the prisoners' relief, personally goes there and pleads for reformation, and on his doing so the prisoners are set free. Similarly, the Supreme Lord descends from His kingdom upon the kingdom of illusory energy and personally gives relief in the form of the *Bhagavad-gita*, wherein He personally suggests that although the ways of illusory energy are very stiff to overcome, one who surrenders unto the lotus feet of the Lord is set free by the order of the Supreme. This surrendering process is the remedial measure for getting relief from the bewildering

ways of the illusory energy. The surrendering process is completed by the influence of association. The Lord has suggested, therefore, that by the influence of the speeches of saintly persons who have actually realized the Supreme, men are engaged in His transcendental loving service. The conditioned soul gets a taste for hearing about the Lord, and by such hearing only he is gradually elevated to the platform of respect, devotion and attachment for the Lord. The whole thing is completed by the surrendering process. Herein also the same suggestion is made by the Lord in His incarnation of Vyāsadeva. This means that the conditioned souls are being reclaimed by the Lord both ways, namely by the process of punishment by the external energy of the Lord, and by Himself as the spiritual master within and without. Within the heart of every living being the Lord Himself as the Supersoul (Paramātmā) becomes the spiritual master, and from without He becomes the spiritual master in the shape of scriptures, saints and the initiator spiritual master. This is still more explicitly explained in the next *çloka*.

Personal superintendence of the illusory energy is confirmed in the *Vedas* (the *Kena Upaniṣad*) in relation to the demigods' controlling power. Herein also it is clearly stated that the living entity is controlled by the external energy in a personal capacity. The living being thus subject to the control of external energy is differently situated. It is clear, however, from the present statement of *Bhāgavatam* that the same external energy is situated in the inferior position before the Personality of Godhead, or the perfect being. The perfect being, or the Lord, cannot be approached even by the illusory energy, who can only work on the living entities. Therefore it is sheer imagination that the Supreme Lord is illusioned by the illusory energy and thus becomes a living being. If the living being and the Lord were in the same category, then it would have been quite possible for Vyāsadeva to see it, and there would have been no question of material distress on the part of the illusioned being, for the Supreme Being is fully cognizant. So there are so many unscrupulous imaginations on the part of the monists to endeavor to put both the Lord and the living being in the same category. Had the Lord and the living beings been the same, then Śrīla Çukadeva Gosvami would not have taken the trouble to describe the transcendental pastimes of the Lord, for they would all be manifestations of illusory energy.

Srimad-Bhagavatam is the *summum bonum* remedy for suffering humanity in the clutches of *māyā*. Srila Vyāsadeva therefore first of all diagnosed the actual disease of the conditioned souls, i.e., their being illusioned by the external energy. He also saw the perfect Supreme Being, from whom illusory energy is far removed, though He saw both the diseased conditioned souls and also the cause of the disease. And the remedial measures are suggested in the next verse. Both the Supreme Personality of Godhead and the living beings are undoubtedly qualitatively one, but the Lord is the controller of the illusory energy, whereas the living entity is controlled by the illusory energy. Thus the Lord and the living beings are simultaneously one and different. Another point is distinct herein: that eternal relation between the Lord and the living being is transcendental, otherwise the Lord would not have taken the trouble to reclaim the conditioned souls from the clutches of *māyā*. In the same way, the living entity is also required to revive his natural love and affection for the Lord, and that is the highest perfection of the living entity. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* treats the conditioned soul with an aim to that goal of life.

TEXT 6

**ANaQaaeRPaXaMa& Saa+aaÜiç-YaaeGaMaDaae+aJae)
I/aek-SYaaJaaNaTaae ivÜa&êşe- SaaTvTaSa&ihTaaMa()) 6))**

anarthopaçamaà säkñäd

bhakti-yogam adhokñaje

lokasyäjänato vidvääç

cakre sätvata-saàhitäm

SYNONYMS

anartha—things which are superfluous; *upaçamam*—mitigation; *säkñät*—directly; *bhakti-yogam*—the linking process of devotional service; *adhokñaje*—unto the Transcendence; *lokasya*—of the general mass of men; *ajänataù*—those who are unaware of; *vidvân*—the supremely learned;

cakre—compiled; *sātvata*—in relation with the Supreme Truth; *saàhitām*—Vedic literature.

TRANSLATION

The material miseries of the living entity, which are superfluous to him, can be directly mitigated by the linking process of devotional service. But the mass of people do not know this, and therefore the learned Vyāsadeva compiled this Vedic literature, which is in relation to the Supreme Truth.

PURPORT

Srila Vyāsadeva saw the all-perfect Personality of Godhead. This statement suggests that the complete unit of the Personality of Godhead includes His parts and parcels also. He saw, therefore, His different energies, namely the internal energy, the marginal energy and the external energy. He also saw His different plenary portions and parts of the plenary portions, namely His different incarnations also, and he specifically observed the unwanted miseries of the conditioned souls, who are bewildered by the external energy. And at last he saw the remedial measure for the conditioned souls, namely, the process of devotional service. It is a great transcendental science and begins with the process of hearing and chanting the name, fame, glory, etc., of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Revival of the dormant affection or love of Godhead does not depend on the mechanical system of hearing and chanting, but it solely and wholly depends on the causeless mercy of the Lord. When the Lord is fully satisfied with the sincere efforts of the devotee, He may endow him with His loving transcendental service. But even with the prescribed forms of hearing and chanting, there is at once mitigation of the superfluous and unwanted miseries of material existence. Such mitigation of material affection does not wait for development of transcendental knowledge. Rather, knowledge is dependent on devotional service for the ultimate realization of the Supreme Truth.

TEXT 7

YaSYaa& vE é[UYaMaa<aaYaa& k*-Z<ae ParMaPaUåze)
>aiç-âTPaÛTae Pau&Sa" Xaaek-Maaeh>aYaaPaha)) 7))

yasyää vai çrüyamäëäyää

kãñëe parama-püruñe

bhaktir utpadyate puàsaù

çoka-moha-bhayäpahä

SYNONYMS

yasyäm—this Vedic literature; *vai*—certainly; *çrüyamäëäyäm*—simply by giving aural reception; *kãñëe*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; *parama*—supreme; *püruñe*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *bhaktiù*—feelings of devotional service; *utpadyate*—sprout up; *puàsaù*—of the living being; *çoka*—lamentation; *moha*—illusion; *bhaya*—fearfulness; *apahä*—that which extinguishes.

TRANSLATION

Simply by giving aural reception to this Vedic literature, the feeling for loving devotional service to Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, sprouts up at once to extinguish the fire of lamentation, illusion and fearfulness.

PURPORT

There are various senses, of which the ear is the most effective. This sense works even when a man is deep asleep. One can protect himself from the hands of an enemy while awake, but while asleep one is protected by the ear only. The importance of hearing is mentioned here in connection with attaining the highest perfection of life, namely, getting free from three material pangs. Everyone is full of lamentation at every moment, he is after the mirage of illusory things, and he is always afraid of his supposed enemy. These are the primary symptoms of material disease. And it is definitely

suggested herein that simply by hearing the message of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* one gets attachment for the Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa, and as soon as this is effected the symptoms of the material diseases disappear. Srila Vyāsadeva saw the all-perfect Personality of Godhead, and in this statement the all-perfect Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa is clearly confirmed.

The ultimate result of devotional service is to develop genuine love for the Supreme Personality. Love is a word which is often used in relation with man and woman. And love is the only word that can be properly used to indicate the relation between Lord Kṛṣṇa and the living entities. The living entities are mentioned as *prakāṭi* in the *Bhagavad-gītā*, and in Sanskrit *prakāṭi* is a feminine object. The Lord is always described as the *parama-puruṣa*, or the supreme male personality. Thus the affection between the Lord and the living entities is something like that between the male and the female. Therefore the term love of Godhead is quite appropriate.

Loving devotional service to the Lord begins with hearing about the Lord. There is no difference between the Lord and the subject matter heard about Him. The Lord is absolute in all respects, and thus there is no difference between Him and the subject matter heard about Him. Therefore, hearing about Him means immediate contact with Him by the process of vibration of the transcendental sound. And the transcendental sound is so effective that it acts at once by removing all material affections mentioned above. As mentioned before, a living entity develops a sort of complexity by material association, and the illusory encagement of the material body is accepted as an actual fact. Under such false complexity, the living beings under different categories of life become illusioned in different ways. Even in the most developed stage of human life, the same illusion prevails in the form of many *isms* and divides the loving relation with the Lord and thereby divides the loving relation between man and man. By hearing the subject matter of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* this false complexity of materialism is removed, and real peace in society begins, which politicians aspire for so eagerly in so many political situations. The politicians want a peaceful situation between man and man, and nation and nation, but at the same time, because of too much attachment for material domination, there is illusion and fearfulness. Therefore the

politicians' peace conferences cannot bring about peace in society. It can only be done by hearing the subject matter described in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* about the Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa. The foolish politicians may go on holding peace and summit conferences for hundreds of years, but they will fail to achieve success. Until we reach the stage of reestablishing our lost relation with Kṛṣṇa, the illusion of accepting the body as the self will prevail, and thus fearfulness will also prevail. As for the validity of Sri Kṛṣṇa as the Supreme Personality of Godhead, there are hundreds and thousands of evidences from revealed scriptures, and there are hundreds and thousands of evidences from personal experiences of devotees in various places like Våndāvana, Navadvépa and Puré. Even in the *Kaumudé* dictionary the synonyms of Kṛṣṇa are given as the son of Yaçodä and the Supreme Personality of Godhead Parabrahman. The conclusion is that simply by hearing the Vedic literature *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, one can have direct connection with the Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa, and thereby one can attain the highest perfection of life by transcending worldly miseries, illusion and fearfulness. These are practical tests for one who has actually given a submissive hearing to the readings of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 8

Sa Sa&ihTaa& >aaGavTaq& k*-TvaNau\$-MYa caTMaJaMa()
 éuk-MaDYaaPaYaaMaaSa iNav*itaiNarTa& MauiNa")) 8))

sa saàhitäà bhägavatéà

kåtvänukramya cätma-jam

çukam adhyäpayäm äsa

nivåtti-nirataà muniù

SYNONYMS

saù—that; *saàhitäm*—Vedic literature; *bhägavatém*—in relation with the Personality of Godhead; *kåtvä*—having done; *anukramya*—by correction

and repetition; *ca*—and; *ätma-jam*—his own son; *çukam*—Çukadeva Gosvami; *adhyäpayäm äsa*—taught; *nivåtti*—path of self realization; *niratam*—engaged; *muniù*—the sage.

TRANSLATION

The great sage Vyäsadeva, after compiling the Srimad-Bhagavatam and revising it, taught it to his own son, Sri Çukadeva Gosvami, who was already engaged in self-realization.

PURPORT

Srimad-Bhagavatam is the natural commentation on the *Brahma-sütras* compiled by the same author. This *Brahma-sütra*, or *Vedänta-sütra*, is meant for those who are already engaged in self-realization. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is so made that one becomes at once engaged in the path of self-realization simply by hearing the topics. Although it is especially meant for the *paramahamsas*, or those who are totally engaged in self-realization, it works into the depths of the hearts of those who may be worldly men. Worldly men are all engaged in sense gratification. But even such men will find in this Vedic literature a remedial measure for their material diseases. Çukadeva Gosvami was a liberated soul from the very beginning of his birth, and his father taught him *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Amongst mundane scholars, there is some diversity of opinion as to the date of compilation of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. It is, however, certain from the text of the *Bhägavatam* that it was compiled before the disappearance of King Parékñit and after the departure of Lord Kṛṣṇa. When Mahārāja Parékñit was ruling the world as the King of Bhārata-varña, he chastised the personality of Kali. According to revealed scriptures and astrological calculation, the age of Kali is in its five thousandth year. Therefore, *Srimad-Bhagavatam* was compiled not less than five thousand years ago. *Mahābhārata* was compiled before *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and the *Puranas* were compiled before *Mahābhārata*. That is an estimation of the date of compilation of the different Vedic literatures. The synopsis of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* was given before the detailed description under instruction of Nārada. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the science for following the path of *nivåtti-mārga*. The path of *pravåtti-mārga* was condemned by Nārada. That path is

the natural inclination for all conditioned souls. The theme of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the cure of the materialistic disease of the human being, or stopping completely the pangs of material existence.

TEXT 9

XaaENak- ovac

**Sa vE iNav*itaiNarTa" SavR}aaePae+ak-ae MauiNa")
k-SYa va b*hTaqMaeTaaMaaTMaaraMa" SaMa>YaSaTa()) 9))**

çaunaka uväca

sa vai nivåtti-niratau

sarvatropekñako muniu

kasya vä bāhatém etäm

ätmäramaù samabhyasat

SYNONYMS

çaunakaù uväca—Sri Çaunaka asked; *saù*—he; *vai*—of course; *nivåtti*—on the path of self-realization; *niratau*—always engaged; *sarvatra*—in every respect; *upekñakaù*—indifferent; *muniu*—sage; *kasya*—for what reason; *vä*—or; *bāhatém*—vast; *etäm*—this; *ätma-ärämaù*—one who is pleased in himself; *samabhyasat*—undergo the studies.

TRANSLATION

Sri Çaunaka asked Sūta Gosvami: Sri Çukadeva Gosvami was already on the path of self-realization, and thus he was pleased with his own self. So why did he take the trouble to undergo the study of such a vast literature?

PURPORT

For the people in general the highest perfection of life is to cease from material activities and be fixed on the path of self-realization. Those who take pleasure in sense enjoyment, or those who are fixed in material bodily welfare work, are called *karmés*. Out of thousands and millions of such *karmés*, one may become an *ātmārāma* by self-realization. *Ātmā* means self, and *ārāma* means to take pleasure. Everyone is searching after the highest pleasure, but the standard of pleasure of one may be different from the standard of another. Therefore, the standard of pleasure enjoyed by the *karmés* is different from that of the *ātmārāmas*. The *ātmārāmas* are completely indifferent to material enjoyment in every respect. Srila Çukadeva Gosvami had already attained that stage, and still he was attracted to undergo the trouble of studying the great *Bhāgavatam* literature. This means that *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is a postgraduate study even for the *ātmārāmas*, who have surpassed all the studies of Vedic knowledge.

TEXT 10

SaUTa ovac

AaTMaaraMaaê MauNaYaae iNaGa]RNQaa APYauâš-Mae)
ku-vRNTYahETauk-I& >aiç-iMaTQaM>aUTaGau<aae hir")) 10))

sūta uvāca

ātmārāmāṇ ca munayo

nirgranthā apy urukrame

kurvanty ahaitukéà bhaktim

ittham-bhūta-guëo hariù

SYNONYMS

sūtaù uvāca—Sūta Gosvami said; *ātmārāmāù*—those who take pleasure in *ātmā* (generally, spirit self); *ca*—also; *munayaù*—sages; *nirgranthāù*—freed from all bondage; *api*—in spite of; *urukrame*—unto the great adventurer;

kurvanti—do; *ahaitukém*—unalloyed; *bhaktim*—devotional service; *ittham-bhüta*—such wonderful; *guëaù*—qualities; *hariù*—of the Lord.

TRANSLATION

All different varieties of ätmärāmas [those who take pleasure in ätmä, or spirit self], especially those established on the path of self-realization, though freed from all kinds of material bondage, desire to render unalloyed devotional service unto the Personality of Godhead. This means that the Lord possesses transcendental qualities and therefore can attract everyone, including liberated souls.

PURPORT

Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu explained this *ätmärāma çloka* very vividly before His chief devotee Srila Sanātana Gosvami. He points out eleven factors in the *çloka*, namely (1) *ätmärāma*, (2) *munayaù*, (3) *nirgrantha*, (4) *api*, (5) *ca*, (6) *urukrama*, (7) *kurvanti*, (8) *ahaitukém*, (9) *bhaktim*, (10) *ittham-bhüta-guëaù* and (11) *hariù*. According to the *Viçva-prakāça* Sanskrit dictionary, there are seven synonyms for the word *ätmärāma*, which are as follows: (1) Brahman (the Absolute Truth), (2) body, (3) mind, (4) endeavor, (5) endurance, (6) intelligence and (7) personal habits.

The word *munayaù* refers to (1) those who are thoughtful, (2) those who are grave and silent, (3) ascetics, (4) the persistent, (5) mendicants, (6) sages and (7) saints.

The word *nirgrantha* conveys these ideas: (1) one who is liberated from nescience, (2) one who has no connection with scriptural injunction, i.e., who is freed from the obligation of the rules and regulations mentioned in the revealed scriptures like ethics, *Vedas*, philosophy, psychology and metaphysics (in other words the fools, illiterate, urchins, etc., who have no connection with regulative principles), (3) a capitalist, and also (4) one who is penniless.

According to the *Çabda-koça* dictionary, the affix *ni* is used in the sense of (1) certainty, (2) counting, (3) building, and (4) forbiddance, and the word

grantha is used in the sense of wealth, thesis, vocabulary, etc.

The word *urukrama* means “the one whose activities are glorious.” *Krama* means “step.” This word *urukrama* specifically indicates the Lord’s incarnation as Vāmana, who covered the whole universe by immeasurable steps. Lord Viṣṇu is powerful, and His activities are so glorious that He has created the spiritual world by His internal potency and the material world by His external potency. By His all-pervading features He is everywhere present as the Supreme Truth, and in His personal feature He is always present in His transcendental abode of Goloka Vāndāvana, where He displays His transcendental pastimes in all variegatedness. His activities cannot be compared to anyone else’s, and therefore the word *urukrama* is just applicable to Him only.

According to Sanskrit verbal arrangement, *kurvanti* refers to doing things for someone else. Therefore, it means that the *ātmārāmas* render devotional service unto the Lord not for personal interest but for the pleasure of the Lord, Urukrama.

Hetu means “causal.” There are many causes for one’s sense satisfaction, and they can be chiefly classified as material enjoyment, mystic powers and liberation, which are generally desired by progressive persons. As far as material enjoyments are concerned, they are innumerable, and the materialists are eager to increase them more and more because they are under the illusory energy. There is no end to the list of material enjoyments, nor can anyone in the material universe have all of them. As far as the mystic powers are concerned, they are eight in all (such as to become the minutest in form, to become weightless, to have anything one desires, to lord it over the material nature, to control other living beings, to throw earthly globes in outer space, etc.). These mystic powers are mentioned in the *Bhāgavatam*. The forms of liberation are five in number.

Therefore, unalloyed devotion means service to the Lord without desire for the above-mentioned personal benefits. And the powerful Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa can be fully satisfied by such unalloyed devotees free from all sorts of desires for personal benefit.

Unalloyed devotional service of the Lord progresses in different stages. Practice of devotional service in the material field is of eighty-one different qualities, and above such activities is the transcendental practice of devotional service, which is one and is called *sādhana-bhakti*. When unalloyed practice of *sādhana-bhakti* is matured into transcendental love for the Lord, the transcendental loving service of the Lord begins gradually developing into nine progressive stages of loving service under the headings of attachment, love, affection, feelings, affinity, adherence, following, ecstasy, and intense feelings of separation.

The attachment of an inactive devotee develops up to the stage of transcendental love of God. Attachment of an active servitor develops up to the stage of adherence, and that for a friendly devotee develops up to the stage of following, and the same is also the case for the paternal devotees. Devotees in conjugal love develop ecstasy up to the stage of intense feelings of separation. These are some of the features of unalloyed devotional service of the Lord.

According to *Hari-bhakti-sudhodaya*, the import of the word *ittham-bhūta* is “complete bliss.” Transcendental bliss in the realization of impersonal Brahman becomes comparable to the scanty water contained in the pit made by a cow’s hoof. It is nothing compared with the ocean of bliss of the vision of the Personality of Godhead. The personal form of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is so attractive that it comprehends all attraction, all bliss and all tastes (*rasas*). These attractions are so strong that *no one wants to exchange them for material enjoyment, mystic powers and liberation*. There is no need of logical arguments in support of this statement, but out of one’s own nature one becomes attracted by the qualities of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. We must know for certain that the qualities of the Lord have nothing to do with mundane qualities. All of them are full of bliss, knowledge and eternity. There are innumerable qualities of the Lord, and one is attracted by one quality while another is attracted by another.

Great sages, such as the four bachelor-devotees Sanaka, Sanātana, Sananda and Sanat-kumāra, were attracted by the fragrance of flowers and *tulasé* leaves anointed with the pulp of sandalwood offered at the lotus feet of the Lord. Similarly, Çukadeva Gosvami was attracted by the transcendental

pastimes of the Lord. Çukadeva Gosvami was already situated in the liberated stage, yet he was attracted by the pastimes of the Lord. This proves that the quality of His pastimes has nothing to do with material affinity. Similarly, the young cowherd damsels were attracted by the bodily features of the Lord, and Rukmiñī was attracted by hearing about the glories of the Lord. Lord Kṛṣṇa attracts even the mind of the goddess of fortune. He attracts, in special cases, the minds of all young girls. He attracts the minds of the elderly ladies by paternal affection. He attracts the mind of the male in the humors of servitude and friendship.

The word *hari* conveys various meanings, but the chief import of the word is that He (the Lord) vanquishes everything inauspicious and takes away the mind of the devotee by awarding pure transcendental love. By remembering the Lord in acute distress one can be free from all varieties of miseries and anxieties. Gradually the Lord vanquishes all obstacles on the path of devotional service of a pure devotee, and the result of nine devotional activities, such as hearing and chanting, becomes manifested.

By His personal features and transcendental attributes, the Lord attracts all psychological activities of a pure devotee. Such is the attractive power of Lord Kṛṣṇa. The attraction is so powerful that a pure devotee never hankers for any one of the four principles of religion. These are the attractive features of the transcendental attributes of the Lord. And adding to this the words *api* and *ca*, one can increase the imports unlimitedly. According to Sanskrit grammar there are seven synonyms for the word *api*.

So by interpreting each and every word of this *çloka*, one can see unlimited numbers of transcendental qualities of Lord Kṛṣṇa that attract the mind of a pure devotee.

TEXT 11

**hreGauR<aai+aáMaiTa>aRGavaNa(badraYai<a")
ADYaGaaNMahda:YaaNa& iNaTYa& ivZ<auJaNaiPa[Ya")) 11))**

harer guëäkñipta-matir

bhagavän bādarāyaēiù

adhyagän mahad äkhyānaà

nityaà viṣṇu-jana-priyaù

SYNONYMS

hareù—of Hari, the Personality of Godhead; *guëa*—transcendental attribute; *äkñipta*—being absorbed in; *matiù*—mind; *bhagavän*—powerful; *bādarāyaēiù*—the son of Vyāsadeva; *adhyagät*—underwent studies; *mahat*—great; *äkhyānam*—narration; *nityam*—regularly; *viṣṇu-jana*—devotees of the Lord; *priyaù*—beloved.

TRANSLATION

Srila Çukadeva Gosvami, son of Srila Vyāsadeva, was not only transcendently powerful. He was also very dear to the devotees of the Lord. Thus he underwent the study of this great narration [Srimad-Bhagavatam].

PURPORT

According to *Brahma-vaivarta Purana*, Srila Çukadeva Gosvami was a liberated soul even within the womb of his mother. Srila Vyāsadeva knew that the child, after his birth, would not stay at home. Therefore he (Vyāsadeva) impressed upon him the synopsis of the *Bhāgavatam* so that the child could be made attached to the transcendental activities of the Lord. After his birth, the child was still more educated in the subject of the *Bhāgavatam* by recitation of the actual poems.

The idea is that generally the liberated souls are attached to the feature of impersonal Brahman with a monistic view of becoming one with the supreme whole. But by the association of pure devotees like Vyāsadeva, even the liberated soul becomes attracted to the transcendental qualities of the Lord. By the mercy of Sri Nārada, Srila Vyāsadeva was able to narrate the great epic of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, and by the mercy of Vyāsadeva, Srila

Çukadeva Gosvami was able to grasp the import. The transcendental qualities of the Lord are so attractive that Srila Çukadeva Gosvami became detached from being completely absorbed in impersonal Brahman and positively took up the personal activity of the Lord.

Practically he was thrown from the impersonal conception of the Absolute, thinking within himself that he had simply wasted so much time in devoting himself to the impersonal feature of the Supreme, or in other words, he realized more transcendental bliss with the personal feature than the impersonal. And from that time, not only did he himself become very dear to the *viṣṇu-janas*, or the devotees of the Lord, but also the *viṣṇu-janas* became very dear to him. The devotees of the Lord, who do not wish to kill the individuality of the living entities and who desire to become personal servitors of the Lord, do not very much like the impersonalists, and similarly the impersonalists, who desire to become one with the Supreme, are unable to evaluate the devotees of the Lord. Thus from time immemorial these two transcendental pilgrims have sometimes been competitors. In other words, each of them likes to keep separate from the other because of the ultimate personal and impersonal realizations. Therefore it appears that Srila Çukadeva Gosvami also had no liking for the devotees. But since he himself became a saturated devotee, he desired always the transcendental association of the *viṣṇu-janas*, and the *viṣṇu-janas* also liked his association, since he became a personal *Bhāgavata*. Thus both the son and the father were completely cognizant of transcendental knowledge in Brahman, and afterwards both of them became absorbed in the personal features of the Supreme Lord. The question as to how Çukadeva Gosvami was attracted by the narration of the *Bhāgavatam* is thus completely answered by this *çloka*.

TEXT 12

Parqi+aTaae_Qa raJazeRJaRNMak-MaRivl/aPaNaMa()
Sa&SQaa& c Paa<@uPau}jaa<aa& v+Yae k*-Z<ak-QaaedYaMa()) 12))

parékñito 'tha räjarñer

janma-karma-vilāpanam

saàsthää ca päëòu-puträëää

vakñye kãñëa-kathodayam

SYNONYMS

parékñitaù—of King Parékñit; *atha*—thus; *räjarñeù*—of the King who was the *ãñi* among the kings; *janma*—birth; *karma*—activities; *viläpanam*—deliverance; *saàsthäm*—renunciation of the world; *ca*—and; *päëòu-puträëäm*—of the sons of Päëòu; *vakñye*—I shall speak; *kãñëa-kathä-udayam*—that which gives rise to the transcendental narration of Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

Süta Gosvami thus addressed the ãñis headed by Çaunaka: Now I shall begin the transcendental narration of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and topics of the birth, activities and deliverance of King Parékñit, the sage amongst kings, as well as topics of the renunciation of the worldly order by the sons of Päëòu.

PURPORT

Lord Kṛṣṇa is so kind to the fallen souls that He personally incarnates Himself amongst the different kinds of living entities and takes part with them in daily activities. Any historical fact old or new which has a connection with the activities of the Lord is to be understood as a transcendental narration of the Lord. Without Kṛṣṇa, all the supplementary literatures like the *Puranas* and *Mahäbhärata* are simply stories or historical facts. But with Kṛṣṇa they become transcendental, and when we hear of them we at once become transcendently related with the Lord. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is also a *Purana*, but the special significance of this *Purana* is that the activities of the Lord are central and not just supplementary historical facts. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is thus recommended by Lord Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu as the spotless *Purana*. There is a class of less intelligent devotees of the *Bhägavata Purana* who desire to relish at once the activities of the Lord narrated in the Tenth Canto without first

understanding the primary cantos. They are under the false impression that the other cantos are not concerned with Kṛṣṇa, and thus more foolishly than intelligently they take to the reading of the Tenth Canto. These readers are specifically told herein that the other cantos of the *Bhāgavatam* are as important as the Tenth Canto. No one should try to go into the matters of the Tenth Canto without having thoroughly understood the purport of the other nine cantos. Kṛṣṇa and His pure devotees like the Pāñḍavas are on the same plane. Kṛṣṇa is not without His devotees of all the *rasas*, and the pure devotees like the Pāñḍavas are not without Kṛṣṇa. The devotees and the Lord are interlinked, and they cannot be separated. Therefore talks about them are all *kāñḍā-kathā*, or topics of the Lord.

TEXTS 13–14

Yada Ma*Dae k-aErvSa*ÅYaaNaa&
vqreZvQaae vqrGaiTa& GaTaezu)
v*k-aedraivÖGadai>aMaXaR,
>aGanaeåd<@e Da*Taraí\{Pau}ae)) 13))
>aTauR" iPa[Ya& d]aEi<airiTa SMa PaXYaNa(
k*-Z<aaSauTaaNaa& SvPaTaa& iXara&iSa)
oPaahriÜiPa[YaMaev TaSYa
JauGauIPSaTa& k-MaR ivGahRYaiNTa)) 14))

yadä mādhe kaurava-sāijayänäà

véreñv atho véra-gatià gateñu

våkodaräviddha-gadābhimarça-

bhagnoru-daëòe dhâtaräñöra-putre

bhartuù priyaà drauëir iti sma paçyan

kāñḍā-sutänäà svapatäà çiräàsi

upāharad vipriyam eva tasya

jugupsitaà karma vigarhayanti

SYNONYMS

yadä—when; *mådhe*—in the battlefield; *kaurava*—the party of Dhåtaråñöra; *såijayånäm*—of the party of the Pääòavas; *véreñu*—of the warriors; *atho*—thus; *véra-gatim*—the destination deserved by the warriors; *gateñu*—being obtained; *våkodara*—Bhéma (the second Pääòava); *äviddha*—beaten; *gadä*—by the club; *abhimarça*—lamenting; *bhagna*—broken; *uru-daëòe*—spinal cord; *dhåtaråñöra-putre*—the son of King Dhåtaråñöra; *bhartuù*—of the master; *priyam*—pleasing; *drauëiù*—the son of Droëäcårya; *iti*—thus; *sma*—shall be; *paçyan*—seeing; *kåñëä*—Draupadé; *sutånäm*—of the sons; *svapatäm*—while sleeping; *çiråasi*—heads; *upåharat*—delivered as a prize; *vipriyam*—pleasing; *eva*—like; *tasya*—his; *jugupsitam*—most heinous; *karma*—act; *vigarhayanti*—disapproving.

TRANSLATION

When the respective warriors of both camps, namely the Kauravas and the Pääòavas, were killed on the Battlefield of Kurukñetra and the dead warriors obtained their deserved destinations, and when the son of Dhåtaråñöra fell down lamenting, his spine broken, being beaten by the club of Bhémasena, the son of Droëäcårya [Açvatthämä] beheaded the five sleeping sons of Draupadé and delivered them as a prize to his master, foolishly thinking that he would be pleased. Duryodhana, however, disapproved of the heinous act, and he was not pleased in the least.

PURPORT

Transcendental topics of the activities of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* begin from the end of the battle at Kurukñetra, where the Lord Himself spoke about Himself in the *Bhagavad-gita*. Therefore, both the *Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam* are transcendental topics of Lord Kṛṣṇa. The *Gétä* is *kåñëa-kathä*, or topics of Kṛṣṇa, because it is spoken by the Lord, and the *Bhägavatam* is also *kåñëa-kathä* because it is spoken

about the Lord. Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu wanted everyone to be informed of both *kāñḍā-kathās* by His order. Lord Kṛṣṇa Caitanya is Kṛṣṇa Himself in the garb of a devotee of Kṛṣṇa, and therefore the versions of both Lord Kṛṣṇa and Sri Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Mahāprabhu are identical. *Lord Caitanya desired that all who are born in India seriously understand such kāñḍā-kathās* and then after full realization preach the transcendental message to everyone in all parts of the world. That will bring about the desired peace and prosperity of the stricken world.

TEXT 15

**MaaTaa iXaéUNaa& iNaDaNa& SauTaaNaa&
iNaXaMYa gaaer& PairTaPYaMaaNaa)
TadaâdÜaZPak-I/aku-I/a+aq
Taa& SaaNTvYaàah ik-rq\$=Maal/I)) 15))**

mätä çiçünäà nidhanaà sutänäà

niçamyā ghoraà paritapyamänä

tadärudad väñpa-kaläkuläkñé

täà säntvayann äha kiréöamälé

SYNONYMS

mätä—the mother; *çiçünäm*—of the children; *nidhanam*—massacre; *sutänäm*—of the sons; *niçamyā*—after hearing; *ghoram*—ghastly; *paritapyamänä*—lamenting; *tadä*—at that time; *arudat*—began to cry; *väñpa-kala-äkula-akñé*—with tears in the eyes; *täm*—her; *säntvayan*—pacifying; *äha*—said; *kiréöamälé*—Arjuna.

TRANSLATION

Draupadé, the mother of the five children of the Pāñḍavas, after hearing of the massacre of her sons, began to cry in distress with eyes full of tears. Trying to pacify her in her great loss, Arjuna spoke to her thus:

TEXT 16

Tada éucSTae Pa[Ma*JaaiMa >ad]e
Yad(b]øbNDaae" iXar AaTaTaaiYaNa")
Gaa<@qvMauçE-ivRiXa%EåPaahre
Tva§-MYa YaTòaSYaiSa dGDaPau}aa)) 16))

tadä çucas te pramâjâmi bhadre

yad brahma-bandhoù çira âtatâyinaù

gäëòéva-muktair viçikhair upähare

tväkramya yat snäsyasi dagdha-puträ

SYNONYMS

tadä—at that time only; *çucaù*—tears in grief; *te*—your; *pramâjâmi*—shall wipe away; *bhadre*—O gentle lady; *yat*—when; *brahma-bandhoù*—of a degraded *brahmana*; *çiraù*—head; *âtatâyinaù*—of the aggressor; *gäëòéva-muktaiù*—shot by the bow named Gäëòéva; *viçikhaiù*—by the arrows; *upähare*—shall present to you; *tvä*—yourself; *äkramya*—riding on it; *yat*—which; *snäsyasi*—take your bath; *dagdha-puträ*—after burning the sons.

TRANSLATION

O gentle lady, when I present you with the head of that brahmana, after beheading him with arrows from my Gäëòéva bow, I shall then wipe the tears from your eyes and pacify you. Then, after burning your sons' bodies, you can take your bath standing on his head.

PURPORT

An enemy who sets fire to the house, administers poison, attacks all of a sudden with deadly weapons, plunders wealth or usurps agricultural fields, or entices one's wife is called an aggressor. Such an aggressor, though he be a *brahmana* or a so-called son of a *brahmana*, has to be punished in all

circumstances. When Arjuna promised to behead the aggressor named Aṣvatthāmā, he knew well that Aṣvatthāmā was the son of a *brahmana*, but because the so-called *brahmana* acted like a butcher, he was taken as such, and there was no question of sin in killing such a *brahmana*'s son who proved to be a villain.

TEXT 17

wiTa iPa[Yaa& vLGauivic}aJaLPaE"
Sa SaaNTviYaTvaCYauTaiMa}aSaUTa")
ANvad]vÕ&iXaTa oGa]DaNva
k-iPaßJaae GauåPau}a& rQaeNa)) 17))

iti priyāà valgu-vicitra-jalpaiù

sa sāntvayitvācyuta-mitra-sūtaù

anvādravat daàçita ugra-dhanvā

kapi-dhvaja guru-putraà rathena

SYNONYMS

iti—thus; *priyām*—unto the dear; *valgu*—sweet; *vicitra*—variegated; *jalpaiù*—by statements; *saù*—he; *sāntvayitvā*—satisfying; *acyuta-mitra-sūtaù*—Arjuna, who is guided by the infallible Lord as a friend and driver; *anvādravat*—followed; *daàçitaù*—being protected by *kavaca*; *ugra-dhanvā*—equipped with furious weapons; *kapi-dhvajaù*—Arjuna; *guru-putram*—the son of the martial teacher; *rathena*—getting on the chariot.

TRANSLATION

Arjuna, who is guided by the infallible Lord as friend and driver, thus satisfied the dear lady by such statements. Then he dressed in armor and armed himself with furious weapons, and getting into his chariot, he set out to follow Aṣvatthāmā, the son of his martial teacher.

TEXT 18

TaMaaPaTaNTa& Sa ivl/+Ya dUraTa(
ku-MaarhaeiÜGanMaNaa rQaeNa)
Parad]vTPa[a<aParqPSauåVYaa |
YaavÓMa& åd]>aYaaÛQaak-")) 18))

tam äpatantaà sa vilakñya dūrāt

kumāra-hodvigna-manā rathena

parādravat prāëa-parépsur urvyāà

yāvad-gamaà rudra-bhayād yathā kaù

SYNONYMS

tam—him; *äpatantam*—coming over furiously; *saù*—he; *vilakñya*—seeing; *dūrāt*—from a distance; *kumāra-hā*—the murderer of the princes; *udvigna-manāù*—disturbed in mind; *rathena*—on the chariot; *parādravat*—fled; *prāëa*—life; *parépsuù*—for protecting; *urvyām*—with great speed; *yāvat-gamam*—as he fled; *rudra-bhayāt*—by fear of Siva; *yathā*—as; *kaù*—Brahmā (or *arkaù*—Sūrya).

TRANSLATION

Açvatthāmā, the murderer of the princes, seeing from a great distance Arjuna coming at him with great speed, fled in his chariot, panic stricken, just to save his life, as Brahmā fled in fear from Siva.

PURPORT

According to the reading matter, either *kaù* or *arkaù*, there are two references in the *Puranas*. *Kaù* means Brahmā, who once became allured by his daughter and began to follow her, which infuriated Siva, who attacked Brahmā with his trident. Brahmājé fled in fear of his life. As far as *arkaù* is concerned, there is a reference in the *Vāmana Purana*. There was a

demon by the name Vidyunmälé who was gifted with a glowing golden airplane which traveled to the back of the sun, and night disappeared because of the glowing effulgence of this plane. Thus the sun-god became angry, and with his virulent rays he melted the plane. This enraged Lord Siva. Lord Siva then attacked the sun-god, who fled away and at last fell down at Kācé (Vārāēasé), and the place became famous as Lolārka.

TEXT 19

YadaXar<aMaaTMaaNaMaE+aTa é[aNTavaiJaNaMa()
Añ& b]øiXarae MaeNae AaTMa}aa<a& iÜJaaTMaJa")) 19))

yadāçaraëam ätmānam

aikñata çrānta-vājinam

astrāà brahma-çiro mene

ätma-träëaà dvijätmajau

SYNONYMS

yadä—when; *açaraëam*—without being alternatively protected;
ätmānam—his own self; *aikñata*—saw; *çrānta-vājinam*—the horses being tired; *astram*—weapon; *brahma-çiraù*—the topmost or ultimate (nuclear);
mene—applied; *ätma-träëam*—just to save himself; *dvija-ätma-jau*—the son of a *brahmana*.

TRANSLATION

When the son of the brahmana [Açvatthämä] saw that his horses were tired, he considered that there was no alternative for protection outside of his using the ultimate weapon, the brahmästra [nuclear weapon].

PURPORT

In the ultimate issue only, when there is no alternative, the nuclear weapon

called the *brahmāstra* is applied. The word *dvijātmaja* is significant here because Aṣvatthāmā, although the son of Droṇācārya, was not exactly a qualified *brahmana*. The most intelligent man is called a *brahmana*, and it is not a hereditary title. Aṣvatthāmā was also formerly called the *brahma-bandhu*, or the friend of a *brahmana*. Being a friend of a *brahmana* does not mean that one is a *brahmana* by qualification. A friend or son of a *brahmana*, when fully qualified, can be called a *brahmana* and not otherwise. Since Aṣvatthāmā's decision is immature, he is purposely called herein the son of a *brahmana*.

TEXT 20

AQaaePaSPa*XYa Sail/I&/ SaNdDae TaTSaMaaihTa")
 AJaaNaàiPaSa&har& Pa[a<ak*-C^\\ oPaiSQaTae)) 20))

athopaspāṣya salilā

sandadhe tat samāhita

ajānann api saḥāra

prāḥa-kācchra upasthite

SYNONYMS

atha—thus; *upaspāṣya*—touching in sanctity; *salilam*—water; *sandadhe*—chanted the hymns; *tat*—that; *samāhita*—being in concentration; *ajānann*—without knowing; *api*—although; *saḥāram*—withdrawal; *prāḥa-kācchre*—life being put in danger; *upasthite*—being placed in such a position.

TRANSLATION

Since his life was in danger, he touched water in sanctity and concentrated upon the chanting of the hymns for throwing nuclear weapons, although he did not know how to withdraw such weapons.

PURPORT

The subtle forms of material activities are finer than grosser methods of material manipulation. Such subtle forms of material activities are effected through purification of sound. The same method is adopted here by chanting hymns to act as nuclear weapons.

TEXT 21

TaTa" Pa[aduZk*-Ta& TaeJa" Pa[c<@& SavRTaaeidXaMa()
Pa[a<aaPadMai>aPa[e+Ya ivZ<au& iJaZ<auâvac h)) 21))

tataù prāduñkātaà tejaù

pracaëòà sarvato diçam

präëäpadam abhiprekñya

viṣṇuà jiñëur uvāca ha

SYNONYMS

tataù—thereafter; *prāduñkātam*—disseminated; *tejaù*—glare;
pracaëòam—fierce; *sarvataù*—all around; *diçam*—directions; *präëa-
äpadam*—affecting life; *abhiprekñya*—having observed it; *viṣṇum*—unto
the Lord; *jiñëu*—Arjuna; *uvāca*—said; *ha*—in the past.

TRANSLATION

Thereupon a glaring light spread in all directions. It was so fierce that Arjuna thought his own life in danger, and so he began to address Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 22

AJauRNa ovac

k*-Z<a k*-Z<a Mahabahae >aç-aNaaMa>aYa^ar)

TvMaek-ae dùMaaNaaNaaMaPavGaaeR_iSa Sa&Sa*Tae")) 22))

arjuna uvāca

kāñḥa kāñḥa mahā-bāho

bhaktānām abhayaīkara

tvam eko dahyamānānām

apavargo 'si saṁsāte

SYNONYMS

arjuna—Arjuna said; *kāñḥa*—O Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kāñḥa*—O Lord Kṛṣṇa; *mahā-bāho*—He who is the Almighty; *bhaktānām*—of the devotees; *abhayaīkara*—eradicating the fears of; *tvam*—You; *eka*—alone; *dahyamānānām*—those who are suffering from; *apavarga*—the path of liberation; *asi*—are; *saṁsāte*—in the midst of material miseries.

TRANSLATION

Arjuna said: O my Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, You are the almighty Personality of Godhead. There is no limit to Your different energies. Therefore only You are competent to instill fearlessness in the hearts of Your devotees. Everyone in the flames of material miseries can find the path of liberation in You only.

PURPORT

Arjuna was aware of the transcendental qualities of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, as he had already experienced them during the Kurukṣetra War, in which both of them were present. Therefore, Arjuna's version of Lord Kṛṣṇa is authoritative. Kṛṣṇa is almighty and is especially the cause of fearlessness for the devotees. A devotee of the Lord is always fearless because of the protection given by the Lord. Material existence is something like a blazing fire in the forest, which can be extinguished by the mercy of the Lord Sri

Kṛṣṇa. The spiritual master is the mercy representative of the Lord. Therefore, a person burning in the flames of material existence may receive the rains of mercy of the Lord through the transparent medium of the self-realized spiritual master. The spiritual master, by his words, can penetrate into the heart of the suffering person and inject knowledge transcendental, which alone can extinguish the fire of material existence.

TEXT 23

**TvMaaÛ" Pauâz" Saa+aadqir" Pa[k*-Tae" Par")
MaaYaa& VYaudSYa icC^ç-ya kE-vLYae iSQaTa AaTMaiNa)) 23))**

tvam ädyaù puruṣaù sākñād

éçvaraù prakāteù paraù

māyāà vyudasya cic-chaktyä

kaivalye sthita ātmani

SYNONYMS

tvam ädyaù—You are the original; *puruṣaù*—the enjoying personality; *sākñāt*—directly; *éçvaraù*—the controller; *prakāteù*—of material nature; *paraù*—transcendental; *māyām*—the material energy; *vyudasya*—one who has thrown aside; *cit-çaktyä*—by dint of internal potency; *kaivalye*—in pure eternal knowledge and bliss; *sthitaù*—placed; *ātmani*—own self.

TRANSLATION

You are the original Personality of Godhead who expands Himself all over the creations and is transcendental to material energy. You have cast away the effects of the material energy by dint of Your spiritual potency. You are always situated in eternal bliss and transcendental knowledge.

PURPORT

The Lord states in the *Bhagavad-gita* that one who surrenders unto the lotus feet of the Lord can get release from the clutches of nescience. Kṛṣṇa is just like the sun, and *māyā* or material existence is just like darkness. Wherever there is the light of the sun, darkness or ignorance at once vanishes. The best means to get out of the world of ignorance is suggested here. The Lord is addressed herein as the original Personality of Godhead. From Him all other Personalities of Godhead expand. The all-pervasive Lord Viṣṇu is Lord Kṛṣṇa's plenary portion or expansion. The Lord expands Himself in innumerable forms of Godhead and living beings, along with His different energies. But Sri Kṛṣṇa is the original primeval Lord from whom everything emanates. The all-pervasive feature of the Lord experienced within the manifested world is also a partial representation of the Lord. Paramātmā, therefore, is included within Him. He is the Absolute Personality of Godhead. He has nothing to do with the actions and reactions of the material manifestation because He is far above the material creation. Darkness is a perverse representation of the sun, and therefore the existence of darkness depends on the existence of the sun, but in the sun proper there is no trace of darkness. As the sun is full of light only, similarly the Absolute Personality of Godhead, beyond the material existence, is full of bliss. He is not only full of bliss, but also full of transcendental variegatedness. Transcendence is not at all static, but full of dynamic variegatedness. He is distinct from the material nature, which is complicated by the three modes of material nature. He is *parama*, or the chief. Therefore He is absolute. He has manifold energies, and through His diverse energies He creates, manifests, maintains and destroys the material world. In His own abode, however, everything is eternal and absolute. The world is not conducted by the energies or powerful agents by themselves, but by the potent all-powerful with all energies.

TEXT 24

**Sa Wv Jaqvl/aek-SYa MaaYaaMaaeihTaceTaSa")
ivDaTSae SveNa vqYaeR<a é[eYaae DaMaaRidl/+a<aMa()) 24))**

sa eva jéva-lokasya

māyā-mohita-cetasaù

vidhatse svena véryeëa

çreyo dharmädi-lakñäëam

SYNONYMS

saù—that Transcendence; *eva*—certainly; *jéva-lokasya*—of the conditioned living beings; *mäyā-mohita*—captivated by the illusory energy; *cetasaù*—by the heart; *vidhatse*—execute; *svena*—by Your own; *véryeëa*—influence; *çreyaù*—ultimate good; *dharma-ädi*—four principles of liberation; *lakñäëam*—characterized by.

TRANSLATION

And yet, though You are beyond the purview of the material energy, You execute the four principles of liberation characterized by religion and so on for the ultimate good of the conditioned souls.

PURPORT

The Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa, out of His causeless mercy, descends on the manifested world without being influenced by the material modes of nature. He is eternally beyond the material manifestations. He descends out of His causeless mercy only to reclaim the fallen souls who are captivated by the illusory energy. They are attacked by the material energy, and they want to enjoy her under false pretexts, although in essence the living entity is unable to enjoy. One is eternally the servitor of the Lord, and when he forgets this position he thinks of enjoying the material world, but factually he is in illusion. The Lord descends to eradicate this false sense of enjoyment and thus reclaim conditioned souls back to Godhead. That is the all-merciful nature of the Lord for the fallen souls.

TEXT 25

**TaQaaYa& cavTaarSTae >auvae >aariJahqzRYaa)
SvaNaa& caNaNYa>aavaNaaMaNauDYaaNaaYa caSak*-Ta()) 25))**

tathäyaà cävatäras te

bhuvo bhära-jihérñayä

svänää cänanya-bhävänäm

anudhyänäya cäsakåt

SYNONYMS

tathä—thus; *ayam*—this; *ca*—and; *avatärau*—incarnation; *te*—Your; *bhuvaù*—of the material world; *bhära*—burden; *jihérñayä*—for removing; *svänäm*—of the friends; *ca ananya-bhävänäm*—and of the exclusive devotees; *anudhyänäya*—for remembering repeatedly; *ca*—and; *asakåt*—fully satisfied.

TRANSLATION

Thus You descend as an incarnation to remove the burden of the world and to benefit Your friends, especially those who are Your exclusive devotees and are rapt in meditation upon You.

PURPORT

It appears that the Lord is partial to His devotees. Everyone is related with the Lord. He is equal to everyone, and yet He is more inclined to His own men and devotees. The Lord is everyone's father. No one can be His father, and yet no one can be His son. His devotees are His kinsmen, and His devotees are His relations. This is His transcendental pastime. It has nothing to do with mundane ideas of relations, fatherhood or anything like that. As mentioned above, the Lord is above the modes of material nature, and thus there is nothing mundane about His kinsmen and relations in devotional service.

TEXT 26

ik-iMad& iSvTku-Taae veiTa devdev Na veÚyhMa()

SavRTaaeMau%MaaYaaiTa TaeJa" ParMadaå<aMa()) 26))

kim idaà svit kuto veti

deva-deva na vedmy aham

sarvato mukham äyāti

tejaù parama-däruëam

SYNONYMS

kim—what is; *idam*—this; *svit*—does it come; *kutaù*—wherefrom; *vä iti*—be either; *deva-deva*—O Lord of lords; *na*—not; *vedmi*—do I know; *aham*—I; *sarvataù*—all around; *mukham*—directions; *äyāti*—coming from; *tejaù*—effulgence; *parama*—very much; *däruëam*—dangerous.

TRANSLATION

O Lord of lords, how is it that this dangerous effulgence is spreading all around? Where does it come from? I do not understand it.

PURPORT

Anything that is presented before the Personality of Godhead should be so done after due presentation of respectful prayers. That is the standard procedure, and Sri Arjuna, although an intimate friend of the Lord, is observing this method for general information.

TEXT 27

é[q>aGavaNauvac
veTQaed& d]ae<aPau}aSYa b]aøMañ& Pa[diXaRTaMa()
NaEvaSaaE ved Sa&har& Pa[a<abaDa oPaiSQaTae)) 27))

çré-bhagavän uväca

vetthedaà droëa-putrasya

brāhmam astraà pradarçitam

naivāsau veda saàhāraà

prāëa-bādha upasthite

SYNONYMS

çré-bhagavān—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *uvāca*—said; *vettha*—just know from Me; *idam*—this; *droëa-putrasya*—of the son of Droëa; *brāhmam astraam*—hymns of the *brāhma* (nuclear) weapon; *pradarçitam*—exhibited; *na*—not; *eva*—even; *asau*—he; *veda*—know it; *saàhāram*—retraction; *prāëa-bādhe*—extinction of life; *upasthite*—being imminent.

TRANSLATION

The Supreme Personality of Godhead said: Know from Me that this is the act of the son of Droëa. He has thrown the hymns of nuclear energy [brahmāstra], and he does not know how to retract the glare. He has helplessly done this, being afraid of imminent death.

PURPORT

The *brahmāstra* is similar to the modern nuclear weapon manipulated by atomic energy. The atomic energy works wholly on total combustibility, and so the *brahmāstra* also acts. It creates an intolerable heat similar to atomic radiation, but the difference is that the atomic bomb is a gross type of nuclear weapon, whereas the *brahmāstra* is a subtle type of weapon produced by chanting hymns. It is a different science, and in the days gone by such science was cultivated in the land of Bhārata-varña. The subtle *science of chanting hymns* is also *material*, but it has yet to be known by the modern material scientists. Subtle material science *is not spiritual*, but it has a direct relationship with the spiritual method, which is still subtler. A chanter of hymns knew how to apply the weapon as well as how to retract

it. That was perfect knowledge. But the son of Droëäcärya, who made use of this subtle science, did not know how to retract. He applied it, being afraid of his imminent death, and thus the practice was not only improper but also irreligious. As the son of a *brahmana*, he should not have made so many mistakes, and for such gross negligence of duty he was to be punished by the Lord Himself.

TEXT 28

Na ùSYaaNYaTaMa& ik-iÄdñ& Pa[TYavk-XaRNaMa()
JaùñTaeJa oàÖMañjae ùñTaeJaSaa)) 28))

na hy asyänyatamaà kiïcid

astraà pratyavakarçanam

jahy astra-teja unnaddham

astra-jïo hy astra-tejasä

SYNONYMS

na—not; *hi*—certainly; *asya*—of it; *anyatamam*—other; *kiïcit*—anything; *astram*—weapon; *prati*—counter; *avakarçanam*—reactionary; *jahi*—subdue it; *astra-tejaù*—the glare of this weapon; *unnaddham*—very powerful; *astra-jïaù*—expert in military science; *hi*—as a matter of fact; *astra-tejasä*—by the influence of your weapon.

TRANSLATION

O Arjuna, only another brahmästra can counteract this weapon. Since you are expert in the military science, subdue this weapon's glare with the power of your own weapon.

PURPORT

For the atomic bombs there is no counterweapon to neutralize the effects.

But by subtle science the action of a *brahmästra* can be counteracted, and those who were expert in the military science in those days could counteract the *brahmästra*. The son of Droëcärya did not know the art of counteracting the weapon, and therefore Arjuna was asked to counteract it by the power of his own weapon.

TEXT 29

SaUTa ovac

é[uTva >aGavTaa Pa[aeç&- f-aLGauNa" Parvqrha)
SPa*îaPaSTa& Pairç-MYa b]aø& b]aøañ& SaNdDae)) 29))

süta uväca

çrutvä bhagavatä proktaà

phälgunaù para-véra-hä

spåñöväpas taà parikramya

brähmaà brähmästraà sandadhe

SYNONYMS

sütaù—Süta Gosvami; *uväca*—said; *çrutvä*—after hearing; *bhagavatä*—by the Personality of Godhead; *proktam*—what was said; *phälgunaù*—another name of Sri Arjuna; *para-véra-hä*—the killer of the opposing warrior; *spåñövä*—after touching; *äpaù*—water; *tam*—Him; *parikramya*—circumambulating; *brähmam*—the Supreme Lord; *brähma-astram*—the supreme weapon; *sandadhe*—acted on.

TRANSLATION

Sri Süta Gosvami said: Hearing this from the Personality of Godhead, Arjuna touched water for purification, and after circumambulating Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, he cast his brahmästra weapon to counteract the other one.

TEXT 30

Sa&hTYaaNYaaeNYaMau>aYaaeSTaeJaSaq XarSa&v*Tae)
Aav*TYa raedSaq %& c vv*DaaTae_kR-viövTa()) 30))

saàhatyānyonyam ubhayos

tejasé çara-saàvâte

ävåtya rodasé khaà ca

vavâdhâte 'rka-vahnivat

SYNONYMS

saàhatya—by combination of; *anyonyam*—one another; *ubhayo*—of both; *tejasé*—the glares; *çara*—weapons; *saàvâte*—covering; *ävåtya*—covering; *rodasé*—the complete firmament; *kham ca*—outer space also; *vavâdhâte*—increasing; *arka*—the sun globe; *vahni-vat*—like fire.

TRANSLATION

When the rays of the two brahmāstras combined, a great circle of fire, like the disc of the sun, covered all outer space and the whole firmament of planets.

PURPORT

The heat created by the flash of a *brahmāstra* resembles the fire exhibited in the sun globe at the time of cosmic annihilation. The radiation of atomic energy is very insignificant in comparison to the heat produced by a *brahmāstra*. The atomic bomb explosion can at utmost blow up one globe, but the heat produced by the *brahmāstra* can destroy the whole cosmic situation. The comparison is therefore made to the heat at the time of annihilation.

TEXT 31

d*îañTaeJaSTau TaYaaeñqcaek-aNa(Pa[dhNMahTa()
dùMaaNaa" Pa[Jaa" SavaR" Saa&vTaRk-MaMa&SaTa)) 31))

dãñövästra-tejas tu tayos

trél lokän pradahan mahat

dahyamänäù prajäù sarväù

säàvartakam amaàsata

SYNONYMS

dãñövä—thus seeing; *astra*—weapon; *tejaù*—heat; *tu*—but; *tayòù*—of both; *trén*—three; *lokän*—planets; *pradahat*—blazing; *mahat*—severely; *dahyamänäù*—burning; *prajäù*—population; *sarväù*—all over; *säàvartakam*—the name of the fire which devastates during the annihilation of the universe; *amaàsata*—began to think.

TRANSLATION

All the population of the three worlds was scorched by the combined heat of the weapons. Everyone was reminded of the säàvartaka fire which takes place at the time of annihilation.

PURPORT

The three worlds are the upper, lower and intermediate planets of the universe. Although the *brahmästra* was released on this earth, the heat produced by the combination of both weapons covered all the universe, and all the populations on all the different planets began to feel the heat excessively and compared it to that of the *säàvartaka* fire. No planet, therefore, is without living beings, as less intelligent materialistic men think.

TEXT 32

Pa[JaaePad]vMaal/+Ya l/aek-VYaiTak-r& c TaMa()
MaTa& c vaSaudevSYa SaÅharaJauRNaae ÜYaMa()) 32))

prajopadravam ālakñya

loka-vyatikaraà ca tam

mataà ca vāsudevasya

saïjahārärjuno dvayam

SYNONYMS

prajā—the people in general; *upadravam*—disturbance; *ālakñya*—having seen it; *loka*—the planets; *vyatikaram*—destruction; *ca*—also; *tam*—that; *matam ca*—and the opinion; *vāsudevasya*—of Vāsudeva, Sri Kṛṣṇa; *saïjahāra*—retracted; *arjuna*—Arjuna; *dvayam*—both the weapons.

TRANSLATION

Thus seeing the disturbance of the general populace and the imminent destruction of the planets, Arjuna at once retracted both brahmāstra weapons, as Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa desired.

PURPORT

The theory that the modern atomic bomb explosions can annihilate the world is childish imagination. First of all, the atomic energy is not powerful enough to destroy the world. And secondly, ultimately it all rests on the supreme will of the Supreme Lord because without His will or sanction nothing can be built up or destroyed. It is foolish also to think that natural laws are ultimately powerful. Material nature's law works under the direction of the Lord, as confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita*. The Lord says there that natural laws work under His supervision. The world can be destroyed only by the will of the Lord and not by the whims of tiny politicians. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa desired that the weapons released by both Drauëi and Arjuna be withdrawn, and it was carried out by Arjuna at once.

Similarly, there are many agents of the all-powerful Lord, and by His will only can one execute what He desires.

TEXT 33

**TaTa AaSaaŪ TarSaa daā<a& GaaETaMaqSauTaMa()
bbNDaaMazRTaaMa]a+a" Paéu& rXaNaaYaa YaQaa)) 33))**

tata āsādya tarasā

dāruëaà gautamé-sutam

babandhāmarña-tāmrākñāu

paçuà raçanayä yathä

SYNONYMS

tatau—thereupon; *āsādya*—arrested; *tarasā*—dexterously; *dāruëam*—dangerous; *gautamé-sutam*—the son of Gautamé; *babandha*—bound up; *amarña*—angry; *tāmra-akñāu*—with copper-red eyes; *paçum*—animal; *raçanayä*—by ropes; *yathä*—as it were.

TRANSLATION

Arjuna, his eyes blazing in anger like two red balls of copper, dexterously arrested the son of Gautamé and bound him with ropes like an animal.

PURPORT

Açvatthāmā's mother, Kâpé, was born in the family of Gautama. The significant point in this *çloka* is that Açvatthāmā was caught and bound up with ropes like an animal. According to Sridhara Svämé, Arjuna was obliged to catch this son of a *brahmana* like an animal as a part of his duty (*dharma*). This suggestion by Sridhara Svämé is also confirmed in the later statement of Sri Kṛṣṇa. Açvatthāmā was a bona fide son of Droëäcārya and Kâpé, but because he had degraded himself to a lower status of life, it was

proper to treat him as an animal and not as a *brahmana*.

TEXT 34

iXaibraYa iNaNaqzNTa& rJJvabd(ßairPau& bl/aTa()
Pa[ahaJauRNa& Pa[ku-iPaTaae >aGavaNaMbuJae+a<a")) 34))

çibiräya ninéñantaà

rajvā baddhvā ripuà balät

prähärjunaà prakupito

bhagavän ambujekñäëaù

SYNONYMS

çibiräya—on the way to the military camp; *ninéñantam*—while bringing him; *rajvā*—by the ropes; *baddhvā*—bound up; *ripum*—the enemy; *balät*—by force; *präha*—said; *arjunam*—unto Arjuna; *prakupitaù*—in an angry mood; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *ambuja-ékñäëaù*—who looks with His lotus eyes.

TRANSLATION

After binding Açvatthämä, Arjuna wanted to take him to the military camp. The Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa, looking on with His lotus eyes, spoke to angry Arjuna.

PURPORT

Both Arjuna and Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa are described here in an angry mood, but Arjuna's eyes were like balls of red copper whereas the eyes of the Lord were like lotuses. This means that the angry mood of Arjuna and that of the Lord are not on the same level. The Lord is Transcendence, and thus He is absolute in any stage. His anger is not like the anger of a conditioned living being within the modes of qualitative material nature. Because He is

absolute, both His anger and pleasure are the same. His anger is not exhibited in the three modes of material nature. It is only a sign of His bent of mind towards the cause of His devotee because that is His transcendental nature. Therefore, even if He is angry, the object of anger is blessed. He is unchanged in all circumstances.

TEXT 35

**MaENa& PaaQaaRhRiSa }aaTau& b]øbNDauiMaMa& Jaih)
Yaae_SaavNaaGaSa" SauáaNavDaqiàìXa bal/k-aNa()) 35))**

mainaà pārthārhasi trätua

brahma-bandhum imaà jahi

yo 'säv anägasau suptän

avadhén niçi bälakän

SYNONYMS

mä enam—never unto him; *pārtha*—O Arjuna; *arhasi*—ought to; *trätum*—give release; *brahma-bandhum*—a relative of a *brahmana*; *imam*—him; *jahi*—kill; *yaù*—he (who has); *asau*—those; *anägasau*—faultless; *suptän*—while sleeping; *avadhét*—killed; *niçi*—at night; *bälakän*—the boys.

TRANSLATION

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa said: O Arjuna, you should not show mercy by releasing this relative of a brahmana [brahma-bandhu], for he has killed innocent boys in their sleep.

PURPORT

The word *brahma-bandhu* is significant. A person who happens to take birth in the family of a *brahmana* but is not qualified to be called a *brahmana* is addressed as the relative of a *brahmana*, and not as a

brahmana. The son of a high court judge is not virtually a high court judge, but there is no harm in addressing a high court judge's son as a relative of the Honorable Justice. Therefore, as by birth only one does not become a high court judge, so also one does not become a *brahmana* simply by birthright but by acquiring the necessary qualifications of a *brahmana*. As the high court judgeship is a post for the qualified man, so also the post of a *brahmana* is attainable by qualification only. The *çästra* enjoins that even if good qualifications are seen in a person born in a family other than that of a *brahmana*, the qualified man has to be accepted as a *brahmana*, and similarly if a person born in the family of a *brahmana* is void of brahminical qualification, then he must be treated as a non-*brahmana* or, in better terms, a relative of a *brahmana*. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the supreme authority of all religious principles, the *Vedas*, has personally pointed out these differences, and He is about to explain the reason for this in the following *çlokas*.

TEXT 36

Mata& Pa[MataMauNMata& Sauá& bal&/ iñYa& Ja@Ma()
Pa[Paà& ivrQa& >aqTa& Na irPau& hiNTa DaMaRivTa()) 36))

mattaà pramattam unmattaà

suptaà bālaà striyaà jaòam

prapannaà virathaà bhétaà

na ripuà hanti dharma-vit

SYNONYMS

mattam—careless; *pramattam*—intoxicated; *unmattam*—insane; *suptam*—asleep; *bālam*—boy; *striyam*—woman; *jaòam*—foolish; *prapannam*—surrendered; *viratham*—one who has lost his chariot; *bhétam*—afraid; *na*—not; *ripum*—enemy; *hanti*—kill; *dharma-vit*—one who knows the principles of religion.

TRANSLATION

A person who knows the principles of religion does not kill an enemy who is careless, intoxicated, insane, asleep, afraid or devoid of his chariot. Nor does he kill a boy, a woman, a foolish creature or a surrendered soul.

PURPORT

An enemy who does not resist is never killed by a warrior who knows the principles of religion. Formerly battles were fought on the *principles of religion* and not for the sake of sense gratification. If the enemy happened to be intoxicated, asleep, etc., as above mentioned, he was never to be killed. These are some of the codes of religious war. Formerly war was never declared by the whims of selfish political leaders; it was carried out on religious principles free from all vices. Violence carried out on religious principles is far superior to so-called nonviolence.

TEXT 37

SvPa[a<aaNa(Ya" ParPa[a<aE" Pa[PauZ<aaTYaga*<a" %l/")
TaÜDaSTaSYa ih é[eYaae YaÕæzaÛaTYaDa" PauMaaNa()) 37))

sva-präëän yaù para-präëaiù

prapuñëäty aghåëaù khalaù

tad-vadhas tasya hi çreyo

yad-doñäd yäty adhaù pumän

SYNONYMS

sva-präëän—one's own life; *yaù*—one who; *para-präëaiù*—at the cost of others' lives; *prapuñëäti*—maintains properly; *aghåëaù*—shameless; *khalaù*—wretched; *tad-vadhaù*—killing of him; *tasya*—his; *hi*—certainly; *çreyaù*—well-being; *yat*—by which; *doñät*—by the fault; *yäti*—goes; *adhaù*—downwards; *pumän*—a person.

TRANSLATION

A cruel and wretched person who maintains his existence at the cost of others' lives deserves to be killed for his own well-being, otherwise he will go down by his own actions.

PURPORT

A life for a life is just punishment for a person who cruelly and shamelessly lives at the cost of another's life. Political morality is to punish a person by a death sentence in order to save a cruel person from going to hell. That a murderer is condemned to a death sentence by the state is good for the culprit because in his next life he will not have to suffer for his act of murder. Such a death sentence for the murderer is the lowest possible punishment offered to him, and it is said in the *sm̐ti-sastras* that men who are punished by the king on the principle of a life for a life are purified of all their sins, so much so that they may be eligible for being promoted to the planets of heaven. According to Manu, the great author of civic codes and religious principles, even the killer of an animal is to be considered a murderer because animal food is never meant for the civilized man, whose prime duty is to prepare himself for going back to Godhead. He says that in the act of killing an animal, there is a regular conspiracy by the party of sinners, and all of them are liable to be punished as murderers exactly like a party of conspirators who kill a human being combinedly. *He who gives permission, he who kills the animal, he who sells the slaughtered animal, he who cooks the animal, he who administers distribution of the foodstuff, and at last he who eats such cooked animal food are all murderers, and all of them are liable to be punished by the laws of nature.* No one can create a living being despite all advancement of material science, and therefore no one has the right to kill a living being by one's independent whims. For the animal-eaters, the scriptures have sanctioned restricted animal sacrifices only, and such sanctions are there just to restrict the opening of slaughterhouses and not to encourage animal-killing. The procedure under which animal sacrifice is allowed in the scriptures is good both for the animal sacrificed and the animal-eaters. It is good for the animal in the sense that the sacrificed animal is at once promoted to the human form of life after being sacrificed at the altar, and the animal-eater is saved from

grosser types of sins (eating meats supplied by organized slaughterhouses which are ghastly places for breeding all kinds of material afflictions to society, country and the people in general). The material world is itself a place always full of anxieties, and by encouraging animal slaughter the whole atmosphere becomes polluted more and more by war, pestilence, famine and many other unwanted calamities.

TEXT 38

**Pa[iTaé[uTa& c >avTaa PaaÄaLYaE é*<vTaae MaMa)
AahirZYae iXarSTaSYa YaSTae MaaiNaiNa Pau}aha)) 38))**

pratiçrutaà ca bhavatä

päicälyai çåëvato mama

ähariñye çiras tasya

yas te mänini putra-hä

SYNONYMS

pratiçrutam—it is promised; *ca*—and; *bhavatä*—by you; *päicälyai*—unto the daughter of the King of Päicäla (Draupadé); *çåëvataù*—which was heard; *mama*—by Me personally; *ähariñye*—must I bring; *çiraù*—the head; *tasya*—of him; *yaù*—whom; *te*—your; *mänini*—consider; *putra-hä*—the killer of your sons.

TRANSLATION

Furthermore, I have personally heard you promise Draupadé that you would bring forth the head of the killer of her sons.

TEXT 39

**TadSaaE vDYaTaa& PaaPa AaTaTaaYYaaTMabNDauha)
>aTauRê iviPa[Ya& vqr k*-TavaNa(ku-l/Paa&SaNa")) 39))**

tad asau vadhyatää päpa

ätatäyy ätma-bandhu-hä

bhartuç ca vipriyaà véra

kåtavän kula-pääsanaù

SYNONYMS

tat—therefore; *asau*—this man; *vadhyatäm*—will be killed; *päpaù*—the sinner; *ätatäyé*—assaulter; *ätma*—own; *bandhu-hä*—killer of sons; *bhartuù*—of the master; *ca*—also; *vipriyam*—having not satisfied; *véra*—O warrior; *kåtavän*—one who has done it; *kula-pääsanaù*—the burnt remnants of the family.

TRANSLATION

This man is an assassin and murderer of your own family members. Not only that, but he has also dissatisfied his master. He is but the burnt remnants of his family. Kill him immediately.

PURPORT

The son of Droëäcärya is condemned here as the burnt remnants of his family. The good name of Droëäcärya was very much respected. Although he joined the enemy camp, the Pääòavas held him always in respect, and Arjuna saluted him before beginning the fight. There was nothing wrong in that way. But the son of Droëäcärya degraded himself by committing acts which are never done by the *dvijas*, or the twice-born higher castes. Açvatthämä, the son of Droëäcärya, committed murder by killing the five sleeping sons of Draupadé, by which he dissatisfied his master Duryodhana, who never approved of the heinous act of killing the five sleeping sons of the Pääòavas. This means that Açvatthämä became an assaulter of Arjuna's own family members, and thus he was liable to be punished by him. In the *sastras*, he who attacks without notice or kills from behind or sets fire to another's house or kidnaps one's wife is condemned to death. Kṛṣṇa

reminded Arjuna of these facts so that he might take notice of them and do the needful.

TEXT 40

SaUTa ovac

Wv& Parq+aTaa DaMa| PaaQaR" k*-Z<aeNa caeidTa")
NaEC^ÖNTau& GauåSauTa& YaÛPYaaTMahNa& MahaNa() 40)

süta uväca

evaà parékñatä dharmaà

pärthaù kãñëena coditaù

naicchad dhantuà guru-sutaà

yadyapy ätma-hanaà mahän

SYNONYMS

sütaù—Süta Gosvami; *uväca*—said; *evam*—this; *parékñatä*—being examined; *dharmam*—in the matter of duty; *pärthaù*—Sri Arjuna; *kãñëena*—by Lord Kṛṣṇa; *coditaù*—being encouraged; *na aicchat*—did not like; *hantum*—to kill; *guru-sutam*—the son of his teacher; *yadyapi*—although; *ätma-hanam*—murderer of sons; *mahän*—very great.

TRANSLATION

Süta Gosvami said: Although Kṛṣṇa, who was examining Arjuna in religion, encouraged Arjuna to kill the son of Droëäcärya, Arjuna, a great soul, did not like the idea of killing him, although Açvatthämä was a heinous murderer of Arjuna's family members.

PURPORT

Arjuna was a great soul undoubtedly, which is proved here also. He is

encouraged herein personally by the Lord to kill the son of Droëa, but Arjuna considers that the son of his great teacher should be spared, for he happens to be the son of Droëäcärya, even though he is an unworthy son, having done all sorts of heinous acts whimsically for no one's benefit.

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa encouraged Arjuna outwardly just to test Arjuna's sense of duty. It is not that Arjuna was incomplete in the sense of his duty, nor was Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa unaware of Arjuna's sense of duty. But Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa put to test many of His pure devotees just to magnify the sense of duty. The *gopés* were put to such tests as well. Prahlāda Mahārāja also was put to such a test. All pure devotees come out successful in the respective tests by the Lord.

TEXT 41

**AQaaePaeTYa SviXaibr& GaaeivNdiPa[YaSaariQa")
NYavedYata& iPa[YaaYaE XaaecNTYaa AaTMaJaaNa(hTaaNa()) 41))**

athopetya sva-çibiraà

govinda-priya-särathiù

nyavedayat taà priyâyai

çocantyä ätma-jän hatän

SYNONYMS

atha—thereafter; *upetya*—having reached; *sva*—own; *çibiram*—camp; *govinda*—one who enlivens the senses (Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa); *priya*—dear; *särathiù*—the charioteer; *nyavedayat*—entrusted to; *tam*—him; *priyâyai*—unto the dear; *çocantyai*—lamenting for; *ätma-jän*—own sons; *hatän*—murdered.

TRANSLATION

After reaching his own camp, Arjuna, along with his dear friend and

charioteer [Sri Kṛṣṇa], entrusted the murderer unto his dear wife, who was lamenting for her murdered sons.

PURPORT

The transcendental relation of Arjuna with Kṛṣṇa is of the dearmost friendship. In the *Bhagavad-gita* the Lord Himself has claimed Arjuna as His dearmost friend. Every living being is thus related with the Supreme Lord by some sort of affectionate relation, either as servant or as friend or as parent or as an object of conjugal love. Everyone thus can enjoy the company of the Lord in the spiritual realm if he at all desires and sincerely tries for it by the process of *bhakti-yoga*.

TEXT 42

TaQaaôTa& PaéuvTa(PaaXabÖ,
Mavax(Mau%& k-MaRJauGauIPSaTaeNa)
iNarq+Ya k*-Z<aaPak*-Ta& Gaurae" SauTa&
vaMaSv>aava k*-PaYaa NaNaaMa c)) 42))

tathâhâtaà paçuvat päça-baddham

aväi-mukhaà karma-jugupsitena

nirékñya kãñëäpakâtaà guroù sutaà

vâma-svabhävâ kâpayä nanâma ca

SYNONYMS

tathä—thus; *âhâtam*—brought in; *paçu-vat*—like an animal; *päça-baddham*—tied with ropes; *aväk-mukham*—without a word in his mouth; *karma*—activities; *jugupsitena*—being heinous; *nirékñya*—by seeing; *kãñëä*—Draupadé; *apakâtam*—the doer of the degrading; *guroù*—the teacher; *sutam*—son; *vâma*—beautiful; *svabhävâ*—nature; *kâpayä*—out of compassion; *nanâma*—offered obeisances; *ca*—and.

TRANSLATION

Sri Sūta Gosvami said: Draupadé then saw Aṣvatthämä, who was bound with ropes like an animal and silent for having enacted the most inglorious murder. Due to her female nature, and due to her being naturally good and well-behaved, she showed him due respects as a *brahmana*.

PURPORT

Aṣvatthämä was condemned by the Lord Himself, and he was treated by Arjuna just like a culprit, not like the son of a *brahmana* or teacher. But when he was brought before Srimaté Draupadé, she, although begrieved for the murder of her sons, and although the murderer was present before her, could not withdraw the due respect generally offered to a *brahmana* or to the son of a *brahmana*. This is due to her mild nature as a woman. Women as a class are no better than boys, and therefore they have no discriminatory power like that of a man. Aṣvatthämä proved himself to be an unworthy son of Droëäcärya or of a *brahmana*, and for this reason he was condemned by the greatest authority, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and yet a mild woman could not withdraw her natural courtesy for a *brahmana*.

Even to date, in a Hindu family a woman shows proper respect to the *brahmana* caste, however fallen and heinous a *brahma-bandhu* may be. But the men have begun to protest against *brahma-bandhus* who are born in families of good *brahmanas* but by action are less than *sudras*.

The specific words used in this *çloka* are *vāma-svabhävā*, “mild and gentle by nature.” A good man or woman accepts anything very easily, but a man of average intelligence does not do so. But, anyway, we should not give up our reason and discriminatory power just to be gentle. One must have good discriminatory power to judge a thing on its merit. We should not follow the mild nature of a woman and thereby accept that which is not genuine. Aṣvatthämä may be respected by a good-natured woman, but that does not mean that he is as good as a genuine *brahmana*.

TEXT 43

ovac caSahNTYasYa bNDaNaaNaYaNa& SaTaq)
MauCYaTaa& MauCYaTaaMaez b]aø<aae iNaTara& Gauå")) 43))

uvāca cāsahanty asya

bandhanānayanāṇ saté

mucyatāṇ mucyatām eṇa

brāhmaṇo nitarāṇ guruṇ

SYNONYMS

uvāca—said; *ca*—and; *asahanté*—being unbearable for her; *asya*—his; *bandhana*—being bound; *ānayanam*—bringing him; *saté*—the devoted; *mucyatām mucyatām*—just get him released; *eṇaṇ*—this; *brahmanaṇ*—a *brahmana*; *nitarām*—our; *guruṇ*—teacher.

TRANSLATION

She could not tolerate Aṣvatthāmā’s being bound by ropes, and being a devoted lady, she said: Release him, for he is a brahmana, our spiritual master.

PURPORT

As soon as Aṣvatthāmā was brought before Draupadé, she thought it intolerable that a *brahmana* should be arrested like a culprit and brought before her in that condition, especially when the *brahmana* happened to be a teacher’s son.

Arjuna arrested Aṣvatthāmā knowing perfectly well that he was the son of Droṇācārya. Kṛṣṇa also knew him to be so, but both of them condemned the murderer without consideration of his being the son of a *brahmana*. According to revealed scriptures, a teacher or spiritual master is liable to be rejected if he proves himself unworthy of the position of a *guru* or spiritual master. A *guru* is called also an *ācārya*, or a person who has personally

assimilated all the essence of *sastras* and has helped his disciples to adopt the ways. Aṣvatthāmā failed to discharge the duties of a *brahmana* or teacher, and therefore he was liable to be rejected from the exalted position of a *brahmana*. On this consideration, both Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and Arjuna were right in condemning Aṣvatthāmā. But to a good lady like Draupadé, the matter was considered not from the angle of *ṣāstric* vision, but as a matter of custom. By custom, Aṣvatthāmā was offered the same respect as offered to his father. It was so because generally the people accept the son of a *brahmana* as a real *brahmana*, by sentiment only. Factually the matter is different. A *brahmana* is accepted on the merit of qualification and not on the merit of simply being the son of a *brahmana*.

But in spite of all this, Draupadé desired that Aṣvatthāmā be at once released, and it was all the same a good sentiment for her. This means that a devotee of the Lord can tolerate all sorts of tribulation personally, but still such devotees are never unkind to others, even to the enemy. These are the characteristics of one who is a pure devotee of the Lord.

TEXT 44

**SarhSYaae DaNauveRd" SaivSaGaaeRPaSa&YaMa")
AñGa]aMaê >avTaa iXai+aTaae YadNauGa]haTa()) 44))**

sarahasyo dhanur-vedaù

savisargopasaàyamaù

astra-grāmaç ca bhavatä

çikñito yad-anugrahät

SYNONYMS

sa-rahasyaù—confidential; *dhanuù-vedaù*—knowledge in the art of manipulating bows and arrows; *sa-visarga*—releasing; *upasaàyamaù*—controlling; *astra*—weapons; *grāmaù*—all kinds of; *ca*—and; *bhavatä*—by yourself; *çikñitaù*—learned; *yad*—by whose; *anugrahät*—mercy of.

TRANSLATION

It was by Droëäcärya's mercy that you learned the military art of throwing arrows and the confidential art of controlling weapons.

PURPORT

Dhanur-veda, or military science, was taught by Droëäcärya with all its confidential secrets of throwing and controlling by Vedic hymns. Gross military science is dependent on material weapons, but finer than that is the art of throwing the arrows saturated with Vedic hymns, which act more effectively than gross material weapons like machine guns or atomic bombs. The control is by Vedic *mantras*, or the transcendental science of sound. It is said in the *Ramayana* that Mahārāja Daçaratha, the father of Lord Sri Rāma, used to control arrows by sound only. He could pierce his target with his arrow by only hearing the sound, without seeing the object. So this is a finer military science than that of the gross material military weapons used nowadays. Arjuna was taught all this, and therefore Draupadé wished that Arjuna feel obliged to Äcärya Droëa for all these benefits. And in the absence of Droëäcärya, his son was his representative. That was the opinion of the good lady Draupadé. It may be argued why Droëäcärya, a rigid *brahmana*, should be a teacher in military science. But the reply is that a *brahmana* should become a teacher, regardless of what his department of knowledge is. A learned *brahmana* should become a teacher, a priest and a recipient of charity. A bona fide *brahmana* is authorized to accept such professions.

TEXT 45

**Sa Wz >aGavaNa(d]ae<a" Pa[JaaæPae<a vTaRTae)
TaSYaaTMaNaae_Da| PaTNYaaSTae NaaNvGaaÜqrSaU" k*-Paq)) 45))**

sa eña bhagavän droëau

prajā-rüpeëa vartate

tasyätmano 'rdhaà patny äste

nānvagād vérasüù kâpé

SYNONYMS

saù—he; *eñau*—certainly; *bhagavān*—lord; *droëau*—Droëäcärya; *prajā-rüpeëa*—in the form of his son Açvatthämä; *vartate*—is existing; *tasya*—his; *ātmanaù*—of the body; *ardham*—half; *patné*—wife; *äste*—living; *na*—not; *anvagāt*—undertook; *vérasüù*—having the son present; *kâpé*—the sister of Kâpäcärya.

TRANSLATION

He [Droëäcärya] is certainly still existing, being represented by his son. His wife Kâpé did not undergo a saté with him because she had a son.

PURPORT

The wife of Droëäcärya, Kâpé, is the sister of Kâpäcärya. A devoted wife, who is according to revealed scripture the better half of her husband, is justified in embracing voluntary death along with her husband if she is without issue. But in the case of the wife of Droëäcärya, she did not undergo such a trial because she had her son, the representative of her husband. A widow is a widow only in name if there is a son of her husband existing. So in either case Açvatthämä was the representative of Droëäcärya, and therefore killing Açvatthämä would be like killing Droëäcärya. That was the argument of Draupadé against the killing of Açvatthämä.

TEXT 46

**Tad(DaMaRj Maha>aaGa >aviÜGaaÇerv& ku-l/Ma()
v*iJaNa& NaahRiTā Pa[aáu& PaUJYa& vNÛMa>aq+<aXa")) 46))**

tad dharmajīa mahā-bhāga

bhavadbhir gauravaà kulam

våjinaà nārhati prāptuà

pūjyaà vandyam abhékñëaçaù

SYNONYMS

tat—therefore; *dharma-jīa*—one who is aware of the principles of religion; *mahā-bhāga*—the most fortunate; *bhavadbhiù*—by your good self; *gauravam*—glorified; *kulam*—the family; *våjinam*—that which is painful; *na*—not; *arhati*—does deserve; *prāptum*—for obtaining; *pūjyam*—the worshipable; *vandyam*—respectable; *abhékñëaçaù*—constantly.

TRANSLATION

O most fortunate one who knows the principles of religion, it is not good for you to cause grief to glorious family members who are always respectable and worshipful.

PURPORT

A slight insult for a respectable family is sufficient to invoke grief. Therefore, a cultured man should always be careful in dealing with worshipful family members.

TEXT 47

**Maa raedqdSYa JaNaNaq GaaETaMaq PaiTadevTaa)
YaQaah& Ma*TavTSaaTaaR raeidMYaé[uMau%q Mauhu")) 47))**

mā rodéd asya janané

gautamé pati-devatā

yathāhaà mātā-vatsärtā

rodimy açru-mukhé muhuù

SYNONYMS

mä—do not; *rodét*—make cry; *asya*—his; *janané*—mother; *gautamé*—the wife of Droëa; *pati-devatä*—chaste; *yathä*—as has; *aham*—myself; *mâta-vatsä*—one whose child is dead; *ärtä*—distressed; *rodimi*—crying; *açru-mukhé*—tears in the eyes; *muheu*—constantly.

TRANSLATION

My lord, do not make the wife of Droëäcärya cry like me. I am aggrieved for the death of my sons. She need not cry constantly like me.

PURPORT

Sympathetic good lady as she was, Srimaté Draupadé did not want to put the wife of Droëäcärya in the same position of childlessness, both from the point of motherly feelings and from the respectable position held by the wife of Droëäcärya.

TEXT 48

YaE" k-aeiPaTa& b]øku-l&/ raJaNYaEriJaTaaTMai>a")
TaTa(ku-l&/ Pa[dhTYaaéu SaaNaubNDa& éucaipaRTaMa()) 48))

yaiù kopitaà brahma-kulaà

räjanyair ajitätmabhiù

tat kulaà pradahaty äçu

sänubandhaà çucärpitam

SYNONYMS

yaiù—by those; *kopitam*—enraged; *brahma-kulam*—the order of the *brahmanas*; *räjanyaiù*—by the administrative order; *ajita*—unrestricted; *ätmabhiù*—by oneself; *tat*—that; *kulam*—family; *pradahati*—is burnt up;

äçu—within no time; *sa-anubandham*—together with family members; *çucä-arpitam*—being put into grief.

TRANSLATION

If the kingly administrative order, being unrestricted in sense control, offends the brahmana order and enrages them, then the fire of that rage burns up the whole body of the royal family and brings grief upon all.

PURPORT

The *brahmana* order of society, or the spiritually advanced caste or community, and the members of such highly elevated families, were always held in great esteem by the other, subordinate castes, namely the administrative kingly order, the mercantile order and the laborers.

TEXT 49

SaUTa ovac

**DaMYa | NYaaYYa& Sak-å<a& iNaVYaRI/lk&- SaMa& MahTa()
raJaa DaMaRSauTaae ra€Yaa" Pa[TYaNaNdÜcae iÜJaa")) 49))**

süta uväca

dharmyaà nyäyyaà sakaruëaà

nirvyalékaà samaà mahat

räjä dharma-suto räjiyäu

pratyanandad vaco dvijäu

SYNONYMS

sütaù uväca—Süta Gosvami said; *dharmyam*—in accordance with the principles of religion; *nyäyyam*—justice; *sa-karuëam*—full of mercy; *nirvyalékam*—without duplicity in *dharma*; *samam*—equity; *mahat*—

glorious; *räjä*—the King; *dharma-sutaù*—son; *räjiyäu*—by the Queen; *pratyānandat*—supported; *vacaù*—statements; *dvijäu*—O *brahmanas*.

TRANSLATION

Süta Gosvami said: O brahmanas, King Yudhiñöhira fully supported the statements of the Queen, which were in accordance with the principles of religion and were justified, glorious, full of mercy and equity, and without duplicity.

PURPORT

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, who was the son of Dharmarāja, or Yamarāja, fully supported the words of Queen Draupadé in asking Arjuna to release Açvatthāmā. One should not tolerate the humiliation of a member of a great family. Arjuna and his family were indebted to the family of Droëäcārya because of Arjuna’s learning the military science from him. If ingratitude were shown to such a benevolent family, it would not be at all justified from the moral standpoint. The wife of Droëäcārya, who was the half body of the great soul, must be treated with compassion, and she should not be put into grief because of her son’s death. That is compassion. Such statements by Draupadé are without duplicity because actions should be taken with full knowledge. The feeling of equality was there because Draupadé spoke out of her personal experience. A barren woman cannot understand the grief of a mother. Draupadé was herself a mother, and therefore her calculation of the depth of Kāpé’s grief was quite to the point. And it was glorious because she wanted to show proper respect to a great family.

TEXT 50

**Naku-I/" Sahdevê YauYauDaaNaae DaNaÅYa")
>aGavaNa(devk-IPau}aae Yae caNYae Yaaê YaaizTa")) 50))**

nakulaù sahadevaç ca

yuyudhäno dhanaijjayaù

bhagavän devaké-putro

ye cänye yäç ca yoñitaù

SYNONYMS

nakulaù—Nakula; *sahadevaù*—Sahadeva; *ca*—and; *yuyudhänaù*—Sätyaki; *dhanaijayaù*—Arjuna; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *devaké-putraù*—the son of Devaké, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *ye*—those; *ca*—and; *anye*—others; *yäù*—those; *ca*—and; *yoñitaù*—ladies.

TRANSLATION

Nakula and Sahadeva [the younger brothers of the King] and also Sätyaki, Arjuna, the Personality of Godhead Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, son of Devaké, and the ladies and others all unanimously agreed with the King.

TEXT 51

**Ta}aahaMaizRTaae >aqMaSTaSYa é[eYaaNa(vDa" SMa*Ta")
Na >aTauRNaaRTMaNaêaQaeR Yaae_hNa(SauáaNa(iXaéUNa(v*Qaa))
51))**

taträhämarñito bhémas

tasya çreyän vadhaù smâtaù

na bhartur nātmanaç cārthe

yo 'han suptän çiçün vāthä

SYNONYMS

tatra—thereupon; *äha*—said; *amarñitaù*—in an angry mood; *bhémaù*—Bhéma; *tasya*—his; *çreyän*—ultimate good; *vadhaù*—killing; *smâtaù*—recorded; *na*—not; *bhartuù*—of the master; *na*—nor; *ätmanaù*—of his own self; *ca*—and; *arthe*—for the sake of; *yaù*—one who; *ahan*—killed;

suptän—sleeping; *çiçün*—children; *vāthä*—without purpose.

TRANSLATION

Bhéma, however, disagreed with them and recommended killing this culprit who, in an angry mood, had murdered sleeping children for no purpose and for neither his nor his master's interest.

TEXT 52

iNaXaMYa >aqMaGaidTa& d]aEPaÛaê cTau>auRJa")
Aal/aeKYa vdNa& Sa:YauirdMaah hSaiàv)) 52))

niçamyā bhéma-gaditaà

draupadyäç ca catur-bhujaù

älokyā vādānā sakhyur

idam äha hasann iva

SYNONYMS

niçamyā—just after hearing; *bhéma*—Bhéma; *gaditam*—spoken by;
draupadyäù—of Draupadé; *ca*—and; *catuù-bhujaù*—the four-handed
(Personality of Godhead); *älokyā*—having seen; *vādanam*—the face;
sakhyuù—of His friend; *idam*—this; *äha*—said; *hasan*—smiling; *iva*—as it.

TRANSLATION

Caturbhuja [the four-armed one], or the Personality of Godhead, after hearing the words of Bhéma, Draupadé and others, saw the face of His dear friend Arjuna, and He began to speak as if smiling.

PURPORT

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa had two arms, and why He is designated as four-armed is

explained by Sridhara Svämé. Both Bhéma and Draupadé held opposite views about killing Aṣvatthämä. Bhéma wanted him to be immediately killed, whereas Draupadé wanted to save him. We can imagine Bhéma ready to kill while Draupadé is obstructing him. And in order to prevent both of them, the Lord discovered another two arms. Originally, the primeval Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa displays only two arms, but in His Nārāyaṇa feature He exhibits four. In His Nārāyaṇa feature He resides with His devotees in the Vaikuntha planets, while in His original Sri Kṛṣṇa feature He resides in the Kṛṣṇaloka planet far, far above the Vaikuntha planets in the spiritual sky. Therefore, if Sri Kṛṣṇa is called *caturbhuja*, there is no contradiction. If need be He can display hundreds of arms, as He exhibited in His *viṣva-rūpa* shown to Arjuna. Therefore, one who can display hundreds and thousands of arms can also manifest four whenever needed.

When Arjuna was perplexed about what to do with Aṣvatthämä, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, as the very dear friend of Arjuna, voluntarily took up the matter just to make a solution. And He was smiling also.

TEXTS 53–54

é[q>aGavaNauvac
b]øbNDauNaR hNTaVYa AaTaTaaYaq vDaahR<a")
MaYaEvae>aYaMaaManaTa& PairPaaùNauXaaSaNaMa()) 53))
ku-å Pa[iTaé[uTa& SaTYa& YataTSaaNTvYaTaa iPa[YaaMa()
iPa[Ya& c >aqMaSaeNaSYa PaaÄaLYaa MaùMaev c)) 54))

çré-bhagavän uväca

brahma-bandhur na hantavya

ätatäyé vadhärhaëaù

mayaivobhayam ämnätaà

paripähy anuçäsanam

kuru pratiçrutaà satyaà

yat tat säntvayatä priyäm

priyaà ca bhémasenasya

päicälyä mahyam eva ca

SYNONYMS

çré-bhagavän—the Personality of Godhead; *uväca*—said; *brahma-bandhu*—the relative of a *brahmana*; *na*—not; *hantavya*—to be killed; *ätatäyë*—the aggressor; *vadha-arhaëa*—is due to be killed; *mayä*—by Me; *eva*—certainly; *ubhayam*—both; *ämnätam*—described according to rulings of the authority; *paripähi*—carry out; *anuçäsanam*—rulings; *kuru*—abide by; *pratiçrutam*—as promised by; *satyam*—truth; *yat tat*—that which; *säntvayatä*—while pacifying; *priyäm*—dear wife; *priyam*—satisfaction; *ca*—also; *bhémasenasya*—of Sri Bhémasena; *päicälyä*—of Draupadé; *mahyam*—unto Me also; *eva*—certainly; *ca*—and.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa said: A friend of a brahmana is not to be killed, but if he is an aggressor he must be killed. All these rulings are in the scriptures, and you should act accordingly. You have to fulfill your promise to your wife, and you must also act to the satisfaction of Bhémasena and Me.

PURPORT

Arjuna was perplexed because Açvatthämä was to be killed as well as spared according to different scriptures cited by different persons. As a *brahma-bandhu*, or a worthless son of a *brahmana*, Açvatthämä was not to be killed, but he was at the same time an aggressor also. And according to the rulings of Manu, an aggressor, even though he be a *brahmana* (and what to speak of an unworthy son of a *brahmana*), is to be killed. Droëäcärya was certainly a *brahmana* in the true sense of the term, but because he stood in the battlefield he was killed. But although Açvatthämä was an aggressor, he stood without any fighting weapons. The ruling is that

an aggressor, when he is without weapon or chariot, cannot be killed. All these were certainly perplexities. Besides that, Arjuna had to keep the promise he had made before Draupadé just to pacify her. And he also had to satisfy both Bhéma and Kṛṣṇa, who advised killing him. This dilemma was present before Arjuna, and the solution was awarded by Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 55

SaUTa ovac

**AJauRNA" SahSaajaYa hrehaRdRMaQaaSaNa)
Mai<a& Jahar MaUDaRNYa& iÜJaSYa SahMaUDaRJaMa()) 55))**

sūta uvāca

arjunaù sahasäjäya

harer hārdam athāsinā

maëià jahāra mürdhanyaà

dvijasya saha-mürdhajam

SYNONYMS

sūtaù—Sūta Gosvami; *uvāca*—said; *arjunaù*—Arjuna; *sahasä*—just at that time; *äjäya*—knowing it; *hareù*—of the Lord; *hārdam*—motive; *atha*—thus; *asinā*—by the sword; *maëim*—the jewel; *jahāra*—separated; *mürdhanyam*—on the head; *dvijasya*—of the twice-born; *saha*—with; *mürdhajam*—hairs.

TRANSLATION

Just then Arjuna could understand the motive of the Lord by His equivocal orders, and thus with his sword he severed both hair and jewel from the head of Açvatthāmā.

PURPORT

Contradictory orders of different persons are impossible to carry out. Therefore a compromise was selected by Arjuna by his sharp intelligence, and he separated the jewel from the head of Aṣvatthāmā. This was as good as cutting off his head, and yet his life was saved for all practical purposes. Here Aṣvatthāmā is indicated as twice-born. Certainly he was twice-born, but he fell down from his position, and therefore he was properly punished.

TEXT 56

ivMauCYa rXaNaa bÖ& bal/hTYaahTaPa[>aMa()
TaeJaSaa Mai<aNaa hqNa& iXaibraiàrYaaPaYaTa()) 56))

vimucya raṣanā-baddhaà

bāla-hatyā-hata-prabham

tejasā maëinā hénàà

ṣibirān nirayāpayat

SYNONYMS

vimucya—after releasing him; *raṣanā-baddham*—from the bondage of ropes; *bāla-hatyā*—infanticide; *hata-prabham*—loss of bodily luster; *tejasā*—of the strength of; *maëinā*—by the jewel; *hénam*—being deprived of; *ṣibirāt*—from the camp; *nirayāpayat*—drove him out.

TRANSLATION

He [Aṣvatthāmā] had already lost his bodily luster due to infanticide, and now, moreover, having lost the jewel from his head, he lost even more strength. Thus he was unbound and driven out of the camp.

PURPORT

Thus being insulted, the humiliated Aṣvatthāmā was simultaneously killed and not killed by the intelligence of Lord Kṛṣṇa and Arjuna.

TEXT 57

vPaNa& d]iv<aadaNa& SQaaNaaiàYaaRPa<a& TaQaa)
Wz ih b]øbNDaUNaa& vDaae NaaNYaae_iSTa dEihk-")) 57))

vapanaà draviëädänaà

sthänän niryäpaëaà tathä

eña hi brahma-bandhünäà

vadho nänyo 'sti daihikaù

SYNONYMS

vapanam—cleaving the hairs from the head; *draviëa*—wealth; *adänam*—forfeiting; *sthänät*—from the residence; *niryäpaëam*—driving away; *tathä*—also; *eñaù*—all these; *hi*—certainly; *brahma-bandhünäm*—of the relatives of a *brahmana*; *vadhaù*—killing; *na*—not; *anyaù*—any other method; *asti*—there is; *daihikaù*—in the matter of the body.

TRANSLATION

Cutting the hair from his head, depriving him of his wealth and driving him from his residence are the prescribed punishments for the relative of a brahmana. There is no injunction for killing the body.

TEXT 58

Pau}aXaaek-aTaura" SaveR Paa<@va" Sah k*-Z<aYaa)
SvaNaa& Ma*TaaNaa& YaTk*-TYa& cçu-iNaRhRr<aaidk-Ma()) 58))

putra-çokäturäù sarve

päëòaväù saha kãñëayä

svänäà mätänäà yat kâtyaà

cakrur nirharaëädikam

SYNONYMS

putra—son; *çoka*—bereavement; *äturäù*—overwhelmed with; *sarve*—all of them; *päëòaväù*—the sons of Pääòu; *saha*—along with; *kãñëayä*—with Draupadé; *svänäm*—of the kinsmen; *mâtänäm*—of the dead; *yat*—what; *kåtyam*—ought to be done; *cakruù*—did perform; *nirharaëa-ädikam*—undertakable.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, the sons of Pääòu and Draupadé, overwhelmed with grief, performed the proper rituals for the dead bodies of their relatives.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Seventh Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled “The Son of Droëa Punished.”

Chapter Eight

Prayers by Queen Kunté and Parékñit Saved

TEXT 1

SaUTa ovac

AQa Tae SaMPareTaaNaa& SvaNaaMaudk-iMaC^TaaMa()
daTau& Sak*-Z<aa Ga®aYaa& PaurSk*-TYa YaYau" iñYa")) 1))

süta uväca

atha te samparetänää

svänäm udakam icchatäm

dätua sakãñëä gaigäyää

puraskātya yayuù striyaù

SYNONYMS

sūtaù uvāca—Sūta said; *atha*—thus; *te*—the Pāëòavas; *samparetānām*—of the dead; *svānām*—of the relatives; *udakam*—water; *icchatām*—willing to have; *dātum*—to deliver; *sa-kāññēu*—along with Draupadé; *gaigāyām*—on the Ganges; *puraskātya*—putting in the front; *yayuù*—went; *striyaù*—the women.

TRANSLATION

Sūta Gosvami said: Thereafter the Pāëòavas, desiring to deliver water to the dead relatives who had desired it, went to the Ganges with Draupadé. The ladies walked in front.

PURPORT

To date it is the custom in Hindu society to go to the Ganges or any other sacred river to take bath when death occurs in the family. Each of the family members pours out a potful of the Ganges water for the departed soul and walks in a procession, with the ladies in the front. The Pāëòavas also followed the rules more than five thousand years ago. Lord Kṛṣṇa, being a cousin of the Pāëòavas, was also amongst the family members.

TEXT 2

**Tae iNaNaqYaaedk&- SaveR ivl/PY a c >a*Xa& PauNa")
AaPl/uTaa hirPaadaBJarJa"PaUTaSairÂle/)) 2))**

te ninéyodakaà sarve

vilapya ca bhāṣaà punaù

äplutä hari-pädäbja-

rajaù-püta-sarij-jale

SYNONYMS

te—all of them; *ninéya*—having offered; *udakam*—water; *sarve*—every one of them; *vilapya*—having lamented; *ca*—and; *bhācam*—sufficiently; *punaù*—again; *äplutäù*—took bath; *hari-pädäbja*—the lotus feet of the Lord; *rajaù*—dust; *püta*—purified; *sarit*—of the Ganges; *jale*—in the water.

TRANSLATION

Having lamented over them and sufficiently offered Ganges water, they bathed in the Ganges, whose water is sanctified due to being mixed with the dust of the lotus feet of the Lord.

TEXT 3

**Ta}aaSaqNa& ku-âPaiTa& Da*Taraí\& SahaNauJaMa()
GaaN Daarq& Pau}aXaaek-aTaa| Pa*Qaa& k*-Z<aa& c MaaDav")) 3))**

taträsénaà kuru-patià

dhâtaräñöraà sahānujam

gāndhäréà putra-çokärtää

pāthää kãñëää ca mādhabaù

SYNONYMS

tatra—there; *äsénam*—sitting; *kuru-patim*—the King of the Kurus; *dhâtaräñöram*—Dhâtaräñöra; *saha-anujam*—with his younger brothers; *gāndhärém*—Gāndhäré; *putra*—son; *çoka-artäm*—overtaken by bereavement; *pāthäm*—Kunté; *kãñëäm*—Draupadé; *ca*—also; *mādhabaù*—Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa.

TRANSLATION

There sat the King of the Kurus, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, along with his

younger brothers and Dhâtarañöra, Gändhäre, Kunté and Draupadé, all overwhelmed with grief. Lord Kṛṣṇa was also there.

PURPORT

The Battle of Kurukñetra was fought between family members, and thus all affected persons were also family members like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira and brothers, Kunté, Draupadé, Subhadrä, Dhâtarañöra, Gändhäre and her daughters-in-law, etc. All the principal dead bodies were in some way or other related with each other, and therefore the family grief was combined. Lord Kṛṣṇa was also one of them as a cousin of the Pääòavas and nephew of Kunté, as well as brother of Subhadrä, etc. The Lord, therefore, was equally sympathetic toward all of them, and therefore he began to pacify them befittingly.

TEXT 4

SaaNTvYaaMaaSa MauiNai>ahRTabNDaUHa(éucaiparTaaNa()
>aUTaezu k-al/SYa GaiTa& dXaRYaàPa[iTai§-YaaMa()) 4))

säntvayäm äsa munibhir

hata-bandhüi çucärpitän

bhüteñu kälasya gatià

darçayan na pratikriyäm

SYNONYMS

säntvayäm äsa—pacified; *munibhiù*—along with the *munis* present there; *hata-bandhün*—those who lost their friends and relatives; *çucärpitän*—all shocked and affected; *bhüteñu*—unto the living beings; *kälasya*—of the supreme law of the Almighty; *gati*—reactions; *darçayan*—demonstrated; *na*—no; *pratikriyäm*—remedial measures.

TRANSLATION

Citing the stringent laws of the Almighty and their reactions upon living beings, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and the munis began to pacify those who were shocked and affected.

PURPORT

The stringent laws of nature, under the order of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, cannot be altered by any living entity. The living entities are eternally under the subjugation of the almighty Lord. The Lord makes all the laws and orders, and these laws and orders are generally called *dharma* or religion. No one can create any religious formula. Bona fide religion is to abide by the orders of the Lord. The Lord's orders are clearly declared in the *Bhagavad-gita*. Everyone should follow Him only or His orders, and that will make all happy, both materially and spiritually. As long as we are in the material world, our duty is to follow the orders of the Lord, and if by the grace of the Lord we are liberated from the clutches of the material world, then in our liberated stage also we can render transcendental loving service unto the Lord. In our material stage we can see neither ourselves nor the Lord for want of spiritual vision. But when we are liberated from material affection and are situated in our original spiritual form we can see both ourselves and the Lord face to face. *Mukti* means to be reinstated in one's original spiritual status after giving up the material conception of life. Therefore, human life is specifically meant for qualifying ourselves for this spiritual liberty. Unfortunately, under the influence of illusory material energy, we accept this spot-life of only a few years as our permanent existence and thus become illusioned by possessing so-called country, home, land, children, wife, community, wealth, etc., which are false representations created by *māyā* (illusion). And under the dictation of *māyā*, we fight with one another to protect these false possessions. By cultivating spiritual knowledge, we can realize that we have nothing to do with all this material paraphernalia. Then at once we become free from material attachment. This clearance of the misgivings of material existence at once takes place by association with the Lord's devotees, who are able to inject the transcendental sound into the depths of the bewildered heart and thus make one practically liberated from all lamentation and illusion. That is a summary of the pacifying measures for those affected by the reaction of stringent material laws, exhibited in the forms of birth, death,

old age and disease, which are insoluble factors of material existence. The victims of war, namely, the family members of the Kurus, were lamenting the problems of death, and the Lord pacified them on the basis of knowledge.

TEXT 5

**SaaDaiYaTvaJaaTaXa}aae" Sv& raJYa& ik-TavEôRTaMa()
gaaTaiYaTvaSaTaae raj" k-cSPaXaR+aTaaYauz")) 5))**

sādhayitvājāta-çatroù

svaà rājyaà kitavair hātam

ghātayitvāsato rājīaù

kaca-sparça-kñatāyuhnà

SYNONYMS

sādhayitvā—having executed; *ājāta-çatroù*—of one who has no enemy; *svam rājyam*—own kingdom; *kitavaiù*—by the clever (Duryodhana and party); *hātam*—usurped; *ghātayitvā*—having killed; *asataù*—the unscrupulous; *rājīaù*—of the queen's; *kaca*—bunch of hair; *sparça*—roughly handled; *kñata*—decreased; *āyuhnà*—by the duration of life.

TRANSLATION

The clever Duryodhana and his party cunningly usurped the kingdom of Yudhiñöhira, who had no enemy. By the grace of the Lord, the recovery was executed, and the unscrupulous kings who joined with Duryodhana were killed by Him. Others also died, their duration of life having decreased for their rough handling of the hair of Queen Draupadé.

PURPORT

In the glorious days, or before the advent of the age of Kali, the *brahmanas*,

the cows, the women, the children and the old men were properly given protection.

1. The protection of the *brahmanas* maintains the institution of *varëa* and *äçrama*, the most scientific culture for attainment of spiritual life.
2. The protection of cows maintains the most miraculous form of food, i.e., milk for maintaining the finer tissues of the brain for understanding higher aims of life.
3. The protection of women maintains the chastity of society, by which we can get a good generation for peace, tranquillity and progress of life.
4. The protection of children gives the human form of life its best chance to prepare the way of liberty from material bondage. Such protection of children begins from the very day of begetting a child by the purificatory process of *garbhädhäna-saàskära*, the beginning of pure life.
5. The protection of the old men gives them a chance to prepare themselves for better life after death.

This complete outlook is based on factors leading to successful humanity as against the civilization of polished cats and dogs. The killing of the above-mentioned innocent creatures is totally forbidden because even by insulting them one loses one's duration of life. In the age of Kali they are not properly protected, and therefore the duration of life of the present generation has shortened considerably. In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is stated that when the women become unchaste for want of proper protection, there are unwanted children called *varëa-saìkara*. To insult a chaste woman means to bring about disaster in the duration of life. Duùçäsana, a brother of Duryodhana, insulted Draupadé, an ideal chaste lady, and therefore the miscreants died untimely. These are some of the stringent laws of the Lord mentioned above.

TEXT 6

YaaJaiYaTvaiMaeDaESTa& i}jai>aâtaMak-LPakE-")

TaŪXa" PaavNa& id+au XaTaMaNYaaeirvaTaNaeeTa()) 6))

yājayitvāçvamedhais taà

tribhir uttama-kalpakaiù

tad-yaçaù pāvanaà dikñu

çata-manyor ivātanot

SYNONYMS

yājayitvā—by performing; *açvamedhaiù*—*yajña* in which a horse is sacrificed; *tam*—him (King Yudhiñöhira); *tribhiù*—three; *uttama*—best; *kalpakaiù*—supplied with proper ingredients and performed by able priests; *tat*—that; *yaçaù*—fame; *pāvanam*—virtuous; *dikñu*—all directions; *çata-manyoù*—Indra, who performed one hundred such sacrifices; *iva*—like; *atanot*—spread.

TRANSLATION

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa caused three well-performed Açvamedha-yajñas [horse sacrifices] to be conducted by Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira and thus caused his virtuous fame to be glorified in all directions, like that of Indra, who had performed one hundred such sacrifices.

PURPORT

This is something like the preface to the performances of Açvamedha-yajña by Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. The comparison of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira to the King of heaven is significant. The King of heaven is thousands and thousands of times greater than Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira in opulence, yet the fame of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was not less. The reason is that Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was a pure devotee of the Lord, and by His grace only was King Yudhiñöhira on the level of the King of heaven, even though he performed only three *yajñas* whereas the King of heaven performed hundreds. That is the prerogative of the devotee of the Lord. The Lord is equal to everyone,

but a devotee of the Lord is more glorified because he is always in touch with the all-great. The sun rays are equally distributed, but still there are some places which are always dark. This is not due to the sun but to the receptive power. Similarly, those who are cent percent devotees of the Lord get the full-fledged mercy of the Lord, which is always equally distributed everywhere.

TEXT 7

AaMaN}Ya Paa<@uPau}aa&ê XaENaeYaaeÖvSa&YauTa")
ÜEPaaYaNaaidi>aivRPa[E" PaUiJaTaE" Pa[iTaPaUiJaTa")) 7))

ämantrya päëòu-puträàç ca

çaineyoddhava-saàyutaù

dvaipäyanädibhir vipraiù

püjitaù pratipüjitaù

SYNONYMS

ämantrya—inviting; *päëòu-putrân*—all the sons of Päëòu; *ca*—also; *çaineya*—Sätyaki; *uddhava*—Uddhava; *saàyutaù*—accompanied; *dvaipäyana-ädibhiù*—by the *āñis* like Vedavyāsa; *vipraiù*—by the *brahmanas*; *püjitaù*—being worshiped; *pratipüjitaù*—the Lord also reciprocated equally.

TRANSLATION

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa then prepared for His departure. He invited the sons of Päëòu, after having been worshiped by the brahmanas, headed by Srila Vyāsadeva. The Lord also reciprocated greetings.

PURPORT

Apparently Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa was a *kñātriya* and was not worshipable by the

brahmanas. But the *brahmanas* present there, headed by Srila Vyāsadeva, all knew Him to be the Personality of Godhead, and therefore they worshiped Him. The Lord reciprocated the greetings just to honor the social order that a *kñātriya* is obedient to the orders of the *brahmanas*. Although Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa was always offered the respects due the Supreme Lord from all responsible quarters, the Lord never deviated from the customary usages between the four orders of society. The Lord purposely observed all these social customs so that others would follow Him in the future.

TEXT 8

GaNTau& k*-TaMaiTab]RøNa(Üark-a& rQaMaaiSQaTa")
oPale/>ae_i>aDaavNTaqMautara& >aYaivûl/aMa()) 8))

gantua kâtamatir brahman

dvärakää ratham ästhitaù

upalebhe 'bhidhävantém

uttarää bhaya-vihvaläm

SYNONYMS

gantum—just desiring to start; *kâtamatiù*—having decided; *brahman*—O *brahman*; *dvärakäm*—towards Dvärakä; *ratham*—on the chariot; *ästhitaù*—seated; *upalebhe*—saw; *abhidhävantém*—coming hurriedly; *uttaräm*—Uttarä; *bhaya-vihvaläm*—being afraid.

TRANSLATION

As soon as He seated Himself on the chariot to start for Dvärakä, He saw Uttarä hurrying toward Him in fear.

PURPORT

All the members of the family of the Pääòavas were completely dependent

on the protection of the Lord, and therefore the Lord protected all of them in all circumstances. The Lord protects everyone, but one who depends completely upon Him is especially looked after by the Lord. The father is more attentive to the little son who is exclusively dependent on the father.

TEXT 9

otaraevac

**Paaiah Paaiah MahaYaaeiGaNdevdev JaGaTPaTae)
NaaNYa& Tvd>aYa& PaXYae Ya}a Ma*TYau" ParSParMa()) 9))**

uttaroväca

pähi pähi mahä-yogin

deva-deva jagat-pate

nänyaà tvad abhayaà paçye

yatra mätüuà parasparam

SYNONYMS

uttarä uväca—Uttarä said; *pähi pähi*—protect, protect; *mahä-yogin*—the greatest mystic; *deva-deva*—the worshipable of the worshiped; *jagat-pate*—O Lord of the universe; *na*—not; *anyam*—anyone else; *tvat*—than You; *abhayam*—fearlessness; *paçye*—do I see; *yatra*—where there is; *mätüuà*—death; *parasparam*—in the world of duality.

TRANSLATION

Uttarä said: O Lord of lords, Lord of the universe! You are the greatest of mystics. Please protect me, for there is no one else who can save me from the clutches of death in this world of duality.

PURPORT

This material world is the world of duality, in contrast with the oneness of the absolute realm. The world of duality is composed of matter and spirit, whereas the absolute world is complete spirit without any tinge of the material qualities. In the dual world everyone is falsely trying to become the master of the world, whereas in the absolute world the Lord is the absolute Lord, and all others are His absolute servitors. In the world of duality everyone is *envious* of all others, and death is inevitable due to the dual existence of matter and spirit. The Lord is the only shelter of fearlessness for the surrendered soul. One cannot save himself from the cruel hands of death in the material world without having surrendered himself at the lotus feet of the Lord.

TEXT 10

Ai>ad]viTa MaaMaqXa XarSTaáaYaSaae iv>aae)
k-aMa& dhTau Maa& NaaQa Maa Mae Ga>aaeR iNaPaaTYaTaaMa()) 10
)

abhidravati mām éça

çaras taptäyaso vibho

kāmaà dahatu mää nātha

mā me garbho nipätyatām

SYNONYMS

abhidravati—coming towards; *mām*—me; *éça*—O Lord; *çaraù*—the arrow; *tapta*—fiery; *ayasaù*—iron; *vibho*—O great one; *kāmam*—desire; *dahatu*—let it burn; *mām*—me; *nātha*—O protector; *mā*—not; *me*—my; *garbhaù*—embryo; *nipätyatām*—be aborted.

TRANSLATION

O my Lord, You are all-powerful. A fiery iron arrow is coming towards me fast. My Lord, let it burn me personally, if You so desire, but please do not

let it burn and abort my embryo. Please do me this favor, my Lord.

PURPORT

This incident took place after the death of Abhimanyu, the husband of Uttarä. Abhimanyu's widow, Uttarä, should have followed the path of her husband, but because she was pregnant, and Mahäräja Parékñit, a great devotee of the Lord, was lying in embryo, she was responsible for his protection. The mother of a child has a great responsibility in giving all protection to the child, and therefore Uttarä was not ashamed to express this frankly before Lord Kṛṣṇa. Uttarä was the daughter of a great king, the wife of a great hero, and student of a great devotee, and later she was the mother of a good king also. She was fortunate in every respect.

TEXT 11

SaUTa ovac

oPaDaaYaR vcSTaSYaa >aGavaNa(>aç-vTSal/")
APaa<@viMad& k-Tau| d]aE<aerñMabuDYaTa)) 11))

süta uväca

upadhärya vacas tasyä

bhagavän bhakta-vatsalaù

apäëòavam idaà kartuà

drauëer agram abudhyata

SYNONYMS

sütaù uväca—Süta Gosvami said; *upadhärya*—by hearing her patiently; *vacaù*—words; *tasyäù*—her; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *bhakta-vatsalaù*—He who is very much affectionate towards His devotees; *apäëòavam*—without the existence of the Päëòavas' descendants; *idam*—this; *kartum*—to do it; *drauëeù*—of the son of Droëäcärya; *agram*—

weapon; *abudhyata*—understood.

TRANSLATION

Süta Gosvami said: Having patiently heard her words, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, who is always very affectionate to His devotees, could at once understand that Aṣvatthāmā, the son of Droëäcārya, had thrown the brahmāstra to finish the last life in the Pääòava family.

PURPORT

The Lord is impartial in every respect, but still He is inclined towards His devotees because there is a great necessity of this for everyone's wellbeing. The Pääòava family was a family of devotees, and therefore the Lord wanted them to rule the world. That was the reason He vanquished the rule of the company of Duryodhana and established the rule of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. Therefore, He also wanted to protect Mahārāja Parékñit, who was lying in embryo. He did not like the idea that the world should be without the Pääòavas, the ideal family of devotees.

TEXT 12

**TaùeRvaQa MauiNaé[eï Paa<@va" PaÄ SaaYak-aNa()
AaTMaNaae_i>aMau%aNdqáaNaal/+Yaaña<YauPaaddu")) 12))**

tarhy evätha muni-çreñöha

pääòaväù païca säyakän

ätmano 'bhimukhän déptän

älakñyästräëy upädaduù

SYNONYMS

tarhi—then; *eva*—also; *atha*—therefore; *muni-çreñöha*—O chief amongst the *munis*; *pääòaväù*—all the sons of Pääòu; *païca*—five; *säyakän*—

weapons; *ätmanaù*—own selves; *abhimukhän*—towards; *déptän*—glaring; *älakñya*—seeing it; *asträëi*—weapons; *upädaduù*—took up.

TRANSLATION

O foremost among the great thinkers [munis] [Çaunaka], seeing the glaring brahmästra proceeding towards them, the Pääòavas took up their five respective weapons.

PURPORT

The *brahmästras* are finer than the nuclear weapons. Açvatthämä discharged the *brahmästra* simply to kill the Pääòavas, namely the five brothers headed by Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira and their only grandson, who was lying within the womb of Uttarä. Therefore the *brahmästra*, more effective and finer than the atomic weapons, was not as blind as the atomic bombs. When the atomic bombs are discharged they do not discriminate between the target and others. Mainly the atomic bombs do harm to the innocent because there is no control. The *brahmästra* is not like that. It marks out the target and proceeds accordingly without harming the innocent.

TEXT 13

**VYaSaNa& vq+Ya TataezaMaNaNYaivzYaaTMaNaaMa()
SaudXaRNaeNa Svañe<a SvaNaa& r+aa& VYaDaaiÜ>au")) 13))**

vyasanaà vékñya tat teñäm

ananya-viñayätmanäm

sudarçanena svästreëa

svänää rakñää vyadhäd vibhuù

SYNONYMS

vyasanam—great danger; *vékñya*—having observed; *tat*—that; *teñām*—their; *ananya*—no other; *viñaya*—means; *ātmanām*—thus inclined; *sudarçanena*—by the wheel of Sri Kṛṣṇa; *sva-astreëa*—by the weapon; *svānām*—of His own devotees; *rakñām*—protection; *vyadhāt*—did it; *vibhuù*—the Almighty.

TRANSLATION

The almighty Personality of Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa, having observed that a great danger was befalling His unalloyed devotees, who were fully surrendered souls, at once took up His Sudarçana disc to protect them.

PURPORT

The *brahmāstra*, the supreme weapon released by Açvatthāmā, was something similar to the nuclear weapon but with more radiation and heat. This *brahmāstra* is the product of a more subtle science, being the product of a finer sound, a *mantra* recorded in the *Vedas*. Another advantage of this weapon is that it is not blind like the nuclear weapon because it can be directed only to the target and nothing else. Açvatthāmā released the weapon just to finish all the male members of Pāṇḍu's family; therefore in one sense it was more dangerous than the atomic bombs because it could penetrate even the most protected place and would never miss the target. Knowing all this, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa at once took up His personal weapon to protect His devotees, who did not know anyone other than Kṛṣṇa. In the *Bhagavad-gita* the Lord has clearly promised that His devotees are never to be vanquished. And He behaves according to the quality or degree of the devotional service rendered by the devotees. Here the word *ananya-viñayātmanām* is significant. The Pāṇḍavas were cent percent dependent on the protection of the Lord, although they were all great warriors themselves. But the Lord neglects even the greatest warriors and also vanquishes them in no time. When the Lord saw that there was no time for the Pāṇḍavas to counteract the *brahmāstra* of Açvatthāmā, He took up His weapon even at the risk of breaking His own vow. Although the Battle of Kurukñetra was almost finished, still, according to His vow, He should not have taken up His own weapon. But the emergency was more important than the vow. He is better known as the *bhakta-vatsala*, or the lover of His

devotee, and thus He preferred to continue as *bhakta-vatsala* than to be a worldly moralist who never breaks his solemn vow.

TEXT 14

**ANTa"SQa" SavR>aUTaaNaaMaaTMaa YaaeGaeìrae hir")
SvMaaYaYaav*<aaeÓ>a| vEra\$ya" ku-âTaNTave)) 14))**

antaùsthaù sarva-bhütänäm

ätmä yogeçvaro hariù

sva-mäyayävåëod garbhaà

vairäöyäu kuru-tantave

SYNONYMS

antaùsthaù—being within; *sarva*—all; *bhütänäm*—of the living beings; *ätmä*—soul; *yoga-éçvaraù*—the Lord of all mysticism; *hariù*—the Supreme Lord; *sva-mäyayä*—by the personal energy; *ävåëot*—covered; *garbham*—embryo; *vairäöyäu*—of Uttarä; *kuru-tantave*—for the progeny of Mahäräja Kuru.

TRANSLATION

The Lord of supreme mysticism, Sri Kṛṣṇa, resides within everyone’s heart as the Paramätmä. As such, just to protect the progeny of the Kuru dynasty, He covered the embryo of Uttarä by His personal energy.

PURPORT

The Lord of supreme mysticism can simultaneously reside within everyone’s heart, or even within the atoms, by His Paramätmä feature, His plenary portion. Therefore, from within the body of Uttarä He covered the embryo to save Mahäräja Parékñit and protect the progeny of Mahäräja Kuru, of whom King Päëòu was also a descendant. Both the sons of

Dhåtaråñöra and those of Pääòu belonged to the same dynasty of Mahārāja Kuru; therefore both of them were generally known as Kurus. But when there were differences between the two families, the sons of Dhåtaråñöra were known as Kurus whereas the sons of Pääòu were known as Pääòavas. Since the sons and grandsons of Dhåtaråñöra were all killed in the Battle of Kurukñetra, the last son of the dynasty is designated as the son of the Kurus.

TEXT 15

YaÛPYañ& b]øiXarSTvMaaega& caPa[iTai§-YaMa()
vEZ<av& TaeJa AaSaaÛ SaMaXaaMYad(>a*GaUÛh)) 15))

yadyapy astraà brahma-çiras

tv amoghaà cāpratikriyam

vaiñëavaà teja äsädyä

samaçämyad bhågüdvaha

SYNONYMS

yadyapi—although; *astram*—weapon; *brahma-çiraù*—supreme; *tu*—but; *amogham*—without check; *ca*—and; *apratikriyam*—not to be counteracted; *vaiñëavam*—in relation with Viṣṇu; *tejaù*—strength; *äsädyä*—being confronted with; *samaçämyat*—was neutralized; *bhågu-udvaha*—O glory of the family of Bhågu.

TRANSLATION

O Çaunaka, although the supreme brahmåstra weapon released by Açvatthämä was irresistible and without check or counteraction, it was neutralized and foiled when confronted by the strength of Viṣṇu [Lord Kṛṣṇa].

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is said that the *brahmajyoti*, or the glowing transcendental effulgence, is resting on Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. In other words, the glowing effulgence known as *brahma-tejas* is nothing but the rays of the Lord, just as the sun rays are rays of the sun disc. So this Brahma weapon also, although materially irresistible, could not surpass the supreme strength of the Lord. The weapon called *brahmāstra*, released by Aṣvatthāmā, was neutralized and foiled by Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa by His own energy; that is to say, He did not wait for any other's help because He is absolute.

TEXT 16

Maa Ma&SQaa ùeTadaêYa| SavaRêYaRMaYae_CYauTae)
Ya wd& MaaYaYaa deVYaa Sa*JaTYaviTa hNTYaJa")) 16))

mā maàsthā hy etad ācāryaà

sarvācāryamaye 'cyute

ya idaà māyayā devyā

sājatya avati hanti ajaù

SYNONYMS

mā—do not; *maàsthāù*—think; *hi*—certainly; *etat*—all these; *ācāryam*—wonderful; *sarva*—all; *ācārya-maye*—in the all-mysterious; *acyute*—the infallible; *yaù*—one who; *idam*—this (creation); *māyayā*—by His energy; *devyā*—transcendental; *sājati*—creates; *avati*—maintains; *hanti*—annihilates; *ajaù*—unborn.

TRANSLATION

O brahmanas, do not think this to be especially wonderful in the activities of the mysterious and infallible Personality of Godhead. By His own transcendental energy, He maintains and annihilates all material things, although He Himself is unborn.

PURPORT

The activities of the Lord are always inconceivable to the tiny brain of the living entities. Nothing is impossible for the Supreme Lord, but all His actions are wonderful for us, and thus He is always beyond the range of our conceivable limits. The Lord is the all-powerful, all-perfect Personality of Godhead. The Lord is cent percent perfect, whereas others, namely Nārāyaṇa, Brahmā, Siva, the demigods and all other living beings, possess only different percentages of such perfection. No one is equal to or greater than Him. He is unrivaled.

TEXT 17

b]øTaeJaaeiviNaMauRçE-raTMaJaE" Sah k*-Z<aYaa)
Pa[Yaa<aai>aMau%& k*-Z<aiMadMaah Pa*Qaa SaTaq)) 17))

brahma-tejo-vinirmuktair

ätmajaiù saha kãñëayä

prayäëäbhimukhaà kãñëam

idam äha pãthä saté

SYNONYMS

brahma-tejaù—the radiation of the *brahmästra*; *vinirmuktaiù*—being saved from; *ätma-jaiù*—along with her sons; *saha*—with; *kãñëayä*—Draupadé; *prayäëä*—outgoing; *abhimukham*—towards; *kãñëam*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; *idam*—this; *äha*—said; *pãthä*—Kunté; *saté*—chaste, devoted to the Lord.

TRANSLATION

Thus saved from the radiation of the *brahmästra*, Kunté, the chaste devotee of the Lord, and her five sons and Draupadé addressed Lord Kṛṣṇa as He started for home.

PURPORT

Kunté is described herein as *saté*, or chaste, due to her unalloyed devotion to Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. Her mind will now be expressed in the following prayers for Lord Kṛṣṇa. A chaste devotee of the Lord does not look to others, namely any other living being or demigod, even for deliverance from danger. That was all along the characteristic of the whole family of the Pāṇḍavas. They knew nothing except Kṛṣṇa, and therefore the Lord was also always ready to help them in all respects and in all circumstances. That is the transcendental nature of the Lord. He reciprocates the dependence of the devotee. One should not, therefore, look for help from imperfect living beings or demigods, but one should look for all help from Lord Kṛṣṇa, who is competent to save His devotees. Such a chaste devotee also never asks the Lord for help, but the Lord, out of His own accord, is always anxious to render it.

TEXT 18

ku-NTYauvac

NaMaSYae Pauāz& TvaŪMaqir& Pa[k*-Tae" ParMa()
Al/+Ya& SavR>aUTaaNaaMaNTabRihrvīSQaTaMa()) 18))

kuntṃ uvāca

namasye puruṣaṁ tvādyam

éçvaraṁ prakāteṁ param

alakṣyaṁ sarva-bhūtānāṁ

antar bahir avasthitam

SYNONYMS

kunté uvāca—Srimaté Kunté said; *namasye*—let me bow down; *puruṣam*—the Supreme Person; *tvā*—You; *ādyam*—the original; *éçvaram*—the controller; *prakāteṁ*—of the material cosmos; *param*—beyond;

alakñyam—the invisible; *sarva*—all; *bhütänäm*—of living beings; *antaù*—within; *bahiù*—without; *avasthitam*—existing.

TRANSLATION

Srimaté Kunté said: O Kṛṣṇa, I offer my obeisances unto You because You are the original personality and are unaffected by the qualities of the material world. You are existing both within and without everything, yet You are invisible to all.

PURPORT

Srimaté Kuntédevé was quite aware that Kṛṣṇa is the original Personality of Godhead, although He was playing the part of her nephew. Such an enlightened lady could not commit a mistake by offering obeisances unto her nephew. Therefore, she addressed Him as the original *puruṣa* beyond the material cosmos. Although all living entities are also transcendental, they are neither original nor infallible. The living entities are apt to fall down under the clutches of material nature, but the Lord is never like that. In the *Vedas*, therefore, He is described as the chief among all living entities (*nityo nityänää cetanaç cetanänäm*). Then again He is addressed as *éçvara*, or the controller. The living entities or the demigods like Candra and Sūrya are also to some extent *éçvara*, but none of them is the supreme *éçvara*, or the ultimate controller. He is the *parameçvara*, or the Supersoul. He is both within and without. Although He was present before Srimaté Kunté as her nephew, He was also within her and everyone else. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (15.15) the Lord says, “I am situated in everyone’s heart, and only due to Me one remembers, forgets and is cognizant, etc. Through all the *Vedas* I am to be known because I am the compiler of the *Vedas*, and I am the teacher of the *Vedānta*.” Queen Kunté affirms that the Lord, although both within and without all living beings, is still invisible. The Lord is, so to speak, a puzzle for the common man. Queen Kunté experienced personally that Lord Kṛṣṇa was present before her, yet He entered within the womb of Uttarā to save her embryo from the attack of Açvatthämä’s *brahmāstra*. Kunté herself was puzzled about whether Sri Kṛṣṇa is all-pervasive or localized. In fact, He is both, but He reserves the right of not being exposed to persons who are not surrendered souls. This checking curtain is called

the *mäyā* energy of the Supreme Lord, and it controls the limited vision of the rebellious soul. It is explained as follows.

TEXT 19

**MaaYaaJaviNak-aC^àMajaDaae+aJaMaVYaYaMa()
Na I/+YaSae MaU!d*Xaa Na\$=ae Naa\$yDarae YaQaa)) 19))**

mäyā-javanikācchannam

ajīādhokñajam avyayam

na lakñyase müòha-dāçä

naöo näöyadharo yathä

SYNONYMS

mäyā—deluding; *javanikā*—curtain; *ācchannam*—covered by; *ajīā*—ignorant; *adhokñajam*—beyond the range of material conception (transcendental); *avyayam*—irreproachable; *na*—not; *lakñyase*—observed; *müòha-dāçä*—by the foolish observer; *naöaù*—artist; *näöya-dharaù*—dressed as a player; *yathä*—as.

TRANSLATION

Being beyond the range of limited sense perception, You are the eternally irreproachable factor covered by the curtain of deluding energy. You are invisible to the foolish observer, exactly as an actor dressed as a player is not recognized.

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gita* Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa affirms that less intelligent persons mistake Him to be an ordinary man like us, and thus they deride Him. The same is confirmed herein by Queen Kunté. The less intelligent persons are those who rebel against the authority of the Lord. Such persons are known

as *asuras*. The *asuras* cannot recognize the Lord's authority. When the Lord Himself appears amongst us, as Rāma, Nṛsiṃha, Varāha or in His original form as Kṛṣṇa, He performs many wonderful acts which are humanly impossible. As we shall find in the Tenth Canto of this great literature, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa exhibited His humanly impossible activities even from the days of His lying on the lap of His mother. He killed the Pūtanā witch, although she smeared her breast with poison just to kill the Lord. The Lord sucked her breast like a natural baby, and He sucked out her very life also. Similarly, He lifted the Govardhana Hill, just as a boy picks up a frog's umbrella, and stood several days continuously just to give protection to the residents of Vāndāvana. These are some of the superhuman activities of the Lord described in the authoritative Vedic literatures like the *Puranas*, *Itihāsas* (histories) and *Upaniṣads*. He has delivered wonderful instructions in the shape of the *Bhagavad-gita*. He has shown marvelous capacities as a hero, as a householder, as a teacher and as a renouncer. He is accepted as the Supreme Personality of Godhead by such authoritative personalities as Vyāsa, Devala, Asita, Nārada, Madhva, Čaikara, Rāmānuja, Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu, Jiva Gosvami, Visvanatha Cakravarti, Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvaté and all other authorities of the line. He Himself has declared as much in many places of the authentic literatures. And yet there is a class of men with demoniac mentality who are always reluctant to accept the Lord as the Supreme Absolute Truth. This is partially due to their poor fund of knowledge and partially due to their stubborn obstinacy, which results from various misdeeds in the past and present. Such persons could not recognize Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa even when He was present before them. Another difficulty is that those who depend more on their imperfect senses cannot realize Him as the Supreme Lord. Such persons are like the modern scientist. They want to know everything by their experimental knowledge. But it is not possible to know the Supreme Person by imperfect experimental knowledge. He is described herein as *adhokṣaja*, or beyond the range of experimental knowledge. All our senses are imperfect. We claim to observe everything and anything, but we must admit that we can observe things under certain material conditions only, which are also beyond our control. The Lord is beyond the observation of sense perception. Queen Kunté accepts this deficiency of the conditioned soul, especially of the woman class, who are less intelligent. For less intelligent men there must be such things as temples, mosques or churches so that they may begin to recognize the

authority of the Lord and hear about Him from authorities in such holy places. For less intelligent men, this beginning of spiritual life is essential, and only foolish men decry the establishment of such places of worship, which are required to raise the standard of spiritual attributes for the mass of people. For less intelligent persons, bowing down before the authority of the Lord, as generally done in the temples, mosques or churches, is as beneficial as it is for the advanced devotees to meditate upon Him by active service.

TEXT 20

TaQaa ParMah&SaaNaa& MauNaqNaaMaMal/aTMaNaaMa()
>aiÇ-YaaeGaivDaaNaaQa| k-Qa& PaXYaeMa ih iñYa")) 20))

tathä paramahaàsänää

munénäm amalätmanäm

bhakti-yoga-vidhänärthaà

kathaà paçyema hi striyaù

SYNONYMS

tathä—besides that; *paramahaàsänäm*—of the advanced transcendentalists; *munénäm*—of the great philosophers or mental speculators; *amala-ätmanäm*—those whose minds are competent to discern between spirit and matter; *bhakti-yoga*—the science of devotional service; *vidhāna-artham*—for executing; *katham*—how; *paçyema*—can observe; *hi*—certainly; *striyaù*—women.

TRANSLATION

You Yourself descend to propagate the transcendental science of devotional service unto the hearts of the advanced transcendentalists and mental speculators, who are purified by being able to discriminate between matter and spirit. How, then, can we women know You

perfectly?

PURPORT

Even the greatest philosophical speculators cannot have access to the region of the Lord. It is said in the *Upaniñads* that the Supreme Truth, the Absolute Personality of Godhead, is beyond the range of the thinking power of the greatest philosopher. He is unknowable by great learning or by the greatest brain. He is knowable only by one who has His mercy. Others may go on thinking about Him for years together, yet He is unknowable. This very fact is corroborated by the Queen, who is playing the part of an innocent woman. Women in general are unable to speculate like philosophers, but they are blessed by the Lord because they believe at once in the superiority and almightiness of the Lord, and thus they offer obeisances without reservation. The Lord is so kind that He does not show special favor only to one who is a great philosopher. He knows the sincerity of purpose. For this reason only, women generally assemble in great number in any sort of religious function. In every country and in every sect of religion it appears that the women are more interested than the men. This simplicity of acceptance of the Lord's authority is more effective than showy insincere religious fervor.

TEXT 21

**k*-Z<aaYa vaSaudevaYa devk-INaNdNaaYa c)
NaNdGaaePaku-MaaraYa GaaeivNdaYa NaMaae NaMa")) 21))**

kāññäya väsudeväya

devaké-nandanäya ca

nanda-gopa-kumäräya

govindäya namo namaù

SYNONYMS

kāñḥäya—the Supreme Lord; *väsudeväya*—unto the son of Vasudeva; *devaké-nandanäya*—unto the son of Devaké; *ca*—and; *nanda-gopa*—Nanda and the cowherd men; *kumäräya*—unto their son; *govindäya*—unto the Personality of Godhead, who enlivens the cows and the senses; *namaù*—respectful obeisances; *namaù*—obeisances.

TRANSLATION

Let me therefore offer my respectful obeisances unto the Lord, who has become the son of Vasudeva, the pleasure of Devaké, the boy of Nanda and the other cowherd men of Våndävana, and the enlivener of the cows and the senses.

PURPORT

The Lord, being thus unapproachable by any material assets, out of unbounded and causeless mercy descends on the earth as He is in order to show His special mercy upon His unalloyed devotees and to diminish the upsurges of the demoniac persons. Queen Kunté specifically adores the incarnation or descent of Lord Kṛṣṇa above all other incarnations because in this particular incarnation He is more approachable. In the Rāma incarnation He remained a king's son from His very childhood, but in the incarnation of Kṛṣṇa, although He was the son of a king, He at once left the shelter of His real father and mother (King Vasudeva and Queen Devaké) just after His appearance and went to the lap of Yaçodämâyé to play the part of an ordinary cowherd boy in the blessed Vrajabhümi, which is very sanctified because of His childhood pastimes. Therefore Lord Kṛṣṇa is more merciful than Lord Rāma. He was undoubtedly very kind to Kunté's brother Vasudeva and the family. Had He not become the son of Vasudeva and Devaké, Queen Kunté could not claim Him to be her nephew and thus address Kṛṣṇa in parental affection. But Nanda and Yaçodä are more fortunate because they could relish the Lord's childhood pastimes, which are more attractive than all other pastimes. There is no parallel to His childhood pastimes as exhibited at Vrajabhümi, which are the prototypes of His eternal affairs in the original Kṛṣṇaloka described as the *cintāmaëi-dhāma* in the *Brahma-saṃhitā*. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa descended Himself at Vrajabhümi with all His transcendental entourage and paraphernalia. Sri

Caitanya Mahāprabhu therefore confirmed that no one is as fortunate as the residents of Vrajabhūmi, and specifically the cowherd girls, who dedicated their everything for the satisfaction of the Lord. His pastimes with Nanda and Yaçodā and His pastimes with the cowherd men and especially with the cowherd boys and the cows have caused Him to be known as Govinda. Lord Kṛṣṇa as Govinda is more inclined to the *brahmanas* and the cows, indicating thereby that human prosperity depends more on these two items, namely brahminical culture and cow protection. Lord Kṛṣṇa is never satisfied where these are lacking.

TEXT 22

**NaMa" Pa^aJaNaa>aaYa NaMa" Pa^aJaMaail/Nae)
NaMa" Pa^aJaNae}aaYa NaMaSTae Pa^aJaax(ga]Yae)) 22))**

namaù paikaja-nābhāya

namaù paikaja-māline

namaù paikaja-netrāya

namas te paikajāighraye

SYNONYMS

namaù—all respectful obeisances; *paikaja-nābhāya*—unto the Lord who has a specific depression resembling a lotus flower in the center of His abdomen; *namaù*—obeisances; *paikaja-māline*—one who is always decorated with a garland of lotus flowers; *namaù*—obeisances; *paikaja-netrāya*—one whose glance is as cooling as a lotus flower; *namaù te*—respectful obeisances unto You; *paikaja-aiighraye*—unto You, the soles of whose feet are engraved with lotus flowers (and who are therefore said to possess lotus feet).

TRANSLATION

My respectful obeisances are unto You, O Lord, whose abdomen is

marked with a depression like a lotus flower, who are always decorated with garlands of lotus flowers, whose glance is as cool as the lotus and whose feet are engraved with lotuses.

PURPORT

Here are some of the specific symbolical marks on the spiritual body of the Personality of Godhead which distinguish His body from the bodies of all others. They are all special features of the body of the Lord. The Lord may appear as one of us, but He is always distinct by His specific bodily features. Srimaté Kunté claims herself unfit to see the Lord because of her being a woman. This is claimed because women, *sudras* (the laborer class) and the *dvija-bandhus*, or the wretched descendants of the higher three classes, are unfit by intelligence to understand transcendental subject matter concerning the spiritual name, fame, attributes, forms, etc., of the Supreme Absolute Truth. Such persons, although they are unfit to enter into the spiritual affairs of the Lord, can see Him as the *arcä-vigraha*, who descends on the material world just to distribute favors to the fallen souls, including the above-mentioned women, *sudras* and *dvija-bandhus*. Because such fallen souls cannot see anything beyond matter, the Lord condescends to enter into each and every one of the innumerable universes as the Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, who grows a lotus stem from the lotuslike depression in the center of His transcendental abdomen, and thus Brahmä, the first living being in the universe, is born. Therefore, the Lord is known as the Paikajanäbhi. The Paikajanäbhi Lord accepts the *arcä-vigraha* (His transcendental form) in different elements, namely a form within the mind, a form made of wood, a form made of earth, a form made of metal, a form made of jewel, a form made of paint, a form drawn on sand, etc. All such forms of the Lord are always decorated with garlands of lotus flowers, and there should be a soothing atmosphere in the temple of worship to attract the burning attention of the nondevotees always engaged in material wranglings. The meditators worship a form within the mind. Therefore, the Lord is merciful even to the women, *sudras* and *dvija-bandhus*, provided they agree to visit the temple of worship in different forms made for them. Such temple visitors are not idolaters, as alleged by some men with a poor fund of knowledge. All the great *äcäryas* established such temples of worship in all places just to favor the less intelligent, and one should not

pose himself as transcending the stage of temple worship while one is actually in the category of the *sudras* and the women or less. One should begin to see the Lord from His lotus feet, gradually rising to the thighs, waist, chest and face. One should not try to look at the face of the Lord without being accustomed to seeing the lotus feet of the Lord. Srimaté Kunté, because of her being the aunt of the Lord, did not begin to see the Lord from the lotus feet because the Lord might feel ashamed, and thus Kuntédevé, just to save a painful situation for the Lord, began to see the Lord just above His lotus feet, i.e., from the waist of the Lord, gradually rising to the face, and then down to the lotus feet. In the round, everything there is in order.

TEXT 23

YaQaa ôzqke-Xa %le/Na devk-I
 k&-SaeNa âÖaiTaicr& éucaiparTaa)
 ivMaaeicTaah& c SahaTMaJaa iv>aae
 TvYaEv NaaQaeNa MauhuivRPaÓ<aaTa()) 23))

yathä hãñékeça khalena devaké

kaàsena ruddhäticiraà çucärpitä

vimocitähä ca sahätmajä vibho

tvayaiva näthena muhur vipad-gaëät

SYNONYMS

yathä—as it were; *hãñékeça*—the master of the senses; *khalena*—by the envious; *devaké*—Devaké (the mother of Sri Kṛṣṇa); *kaàsena*—by King Kaàsa; *ruddhä*—imprisoned; *ati-ciram*—for a long time; *çuca-arpitä*—distressed; *vimocitä*—released; *aham ca*—also myself; *saha-ätma-jä*—along with my children; *vibho*—O great one; *tvayä eva*—by Your Lordship; *näthena*—as the protector; *muheu*—constantly; *vipat-gaëät*—from a series of dangers.

TRANSLATION

O Hãñékeça, master of the senses and Lord of lords, You have released Your mother, Devaké, who was long imprisoned and distressed by the envious King Kaàsa, and me and my children from a series of constant dangers.

PURPORT

Devaké, the mother of Kṛṣṇa and sister of King Kaàsa, was put into prison along with her husband, Vasudeva, because the envious King was afraid of being killed by Devaké's eighth son (Kṛṣṇa). He killed all the sons of Devaké who were born before Kṛṣṇa, but Kṛṣṇa escaped the danger of child-slaughter because He was transferred to the house of Nanda Mahārāja, Lord Kṛṣṇa's foster father. Kuntédevé, along with her children, was also saved from a series of dangers. But Kuntédevé was shown far more favor because Lord Kṛṣṇa did not save the other children of Devaké, whereas He saved the children of Kuntédevé. This was done because Devaké's husband, Vasudeva, was living, whereas Kuntédevé was a widow, and there was none to help her except Kṛṣṇa. The conclusion is that Kṛṣṇa endows more favor to a devotee who is in greater dangers. Sometimes He puts His pure devotees in such dangers because in that condition of helplessness the devotee becomes more attached to the Lord. The more the attachment is there for the Lord, the more success is there for the devotee.

TEXT 24

**ivzaNMahaGane" PauåzaddXaRNaa,
dSaTSa>aaYaa vNavaSak*-C^\Ta")
Ma*Dae Ma*Dae_Naek-MaharQaañTaae
d]aE<YañTaêaSMA hre_i>ari+aTaa")) 24))**

viñān mahāgneu puruñāda-darṇanād

asat-sabhäyā vana-vāsa-kācchratau

mādhe mādhe 'neka-mahārathāstrato

drauëy-astrataç cäsma hare 'bhirakñitäu

SYNONYMS

viñät—from poison; *mahä-agneù*—from the great fire; *puruṣa-ada*—the man-eaters; *darçanät*—by combating; *asat*—vicious; *sabhäyäu*—assembly; *vana-väsa*—exiled to the forest; *käcchrataù*—sufferings; *mådhe mådhe*—again and again in battle; *aneka*—many; *mahä-ratha*—great generals; *astrataù*—weapons; *drauëi*—the son of Droëäcärya; *astrataù*—from the weapon of; *ca*—and; *äsma*—indicating past tense; *hare*—O my Lord; *abhirakñitäu*—protected completely.

TRANSLATION

My dear Kṛṣṇa, Your Lordship has protected us from a poisoned cake, from a great fire, from cannibals, from the vicious assembly, from sufferings during our exile in the forest and from the battle where great generals fought. And now You have saved us from the weapon of Açvatthämä.

PURPORT

The list of dangerous encounters is submitted herein. Devaké was once put into difficulty by her envious brother, otherwise she was well. But Kuntédevé and her sons were put into one difficulty after another for years and years together. They were put into trouble by Duryodhana and his party due to the kingdom, and each and every time the sons of Kunté were saved by the Lord. Once Bhéma was administered poison in a cake, once they were put into the house made of shellac and set afire, and once Draupadé was dragged out, and attempts were made to insult her by stripping her naked in the vicious assembly of the Kurus. The Lord saved Draupadé by supplying an immeasurable length of cloth, and Duryodhana's party failed to see her naked. Similarly, when they were exiled in the forest, Bhéma had to fight with the man-eater demon Hiòimbä Räkñasa, but the Lord saved him. So it was not finished there. After all these tribulations, there was the great Battle of Kurukñetra, and Arjuna had to meet such great generals as Droëa, Bhéñma and Karëa, all powerful fighters. And at

last, even when everything was done away with, there was the *brahmāstra* released by the son of Droëäcārya to kill the child within the womb of Uttarä, and so the Lord saved the only surviving descendant of the Kurus, Mahārāja Parékñit.

TEXT 25

ivPad" SaNTau Taa" Xaita}a Ta}a JaGad(Gaurae)
>avTaae dXaRNa& YaTSYaadPauNa>aRvdXaRNaMa()) 25))

vipadaù santu täù çaçvat

tatra tatra jagad-guro

bhavato darçanaà yat syäd

apunar bhava-darçanam

SYNONYMS

vipadaù—calamities; *santu*—let there be; *täù*—all; *çaçvat*—again and again; *tatra*—there; *tatra*—and there; *jagat-guro*—O Lord of the universe; *bhavataù*—Your; *darçanam*—meeting; *yat*—that which; *syät*—is; *apunaù*—not again; *bhava-darçanam*—seeing repetition of birth and death.

TRANSLATION

I wish that all those calamities would happen again and again so that we could see You again and again, for seeing You means that we will no longer see repeated births and deaths.

PURPORT

Generally the distressed, the needy, the intelligent and the inquisitive, who have performed some pious activities, worship or begin to worship the Lord. Others, who are thriving on misdeeds only, regardless of status, cannot approach the Supreme due to being misled by the illusory energy.

Therefore, for a pious person, if there is some calamity there is no other alternative than to take shelter of the lotus feet of the Lord. Constantly remembering the lotus feet of the Lord means preparing for liberation from birth and death. Therefore, even though there are so-called calamities, they are welcome because they give us an opportunity to remember the Lord, which means liberation.

One who has taken shelter of the lotus feet of the Lord, which are accepted as the most suitable boat for crossing the ocean of nescience, can achieve liberation as easily as one leaps over the holes made by the hoofs of a calf. Such persons are meant to reside in the abode of the Lord, and they have nothing to do with a place where there is danger in every step.

This material world is certified by the Lord in the *Bhagavad-gita* as a dangerous place full of calamities. Less intelligent persons prepare plans to adjust to those calamities without knowing that the nature of this place is itself full of calamities. They have no information of the abode of the Lord, which is full of bliss and without trace of calamity. The duty of the sane person, therefore, is to be undisturbed by worldly calamities, which are sure to happen in all circumstances. Suffering all sorts of unavoidable misfortunes, one should make progress in spiritual realization because that is the mission of human life. The spirit soul is transcendental to all material calamities; therefore, the so-called calamities are called false. A man may see a tiger swallowing him in a dream, and he may cry for this calamity. Actually there is no tiger and there is no suffering; it is simply a case of dreams. In the same way, all calamities of life are said to be dreams. If someone is lucky enough to get in contact with the Lord by devotional service, it is all gain. Contact with the Lord by any one of the nine devotional services is always a forward step on the path going back to Godhead.

TEXT 26

**JaNMaEiYaRé[uTaé[qi>areDaMaaNaMad" PauMaaNa()
NaEvahRTYai>aDaaTau& vE TvaMaik-ÄNaGaaecrMa()) 26))**

janmaiçvarya-çruta-çrébhir

edhamāna-madaù pumän

naivärhaty abhidhätuà vai

tväm akiïcana-gocaram

SYNONYMS

janma—birth; *aiçvarya*—opulence; *çruta*—education; *çrébhiù*—by the possession of beauty; *edhamāna*—progressively increasing; *madaù*—intoxication; *pumän*—the human being; *na*—never; *eva*—ever; *arhati*—deserves; *abhidhätum*—to address in feeling; *vai*—certainly; *tväm*—You; *akiïcana-gocaram*—one who is approached easily by the materially exhausted man.

TRANSLATION

My Lord, Your Lordship can easily be approached, but only by those who are materially exhausted. One who is on the path of [material] progress, trying to improve himself with respectable parentage, great opulence, high education and bodily beauty, cannot approach You with sincere feeling.

PURPORT

Being materially advanced means taking birth in an aristocratic family and possessing great wealth, an education and attractive personal beauty. All materialistic men are mad after possessing all these material opulences, and this is known as the advancement of material civilization. But the result is that by possessing all these material assets one becomes artificially puffed up, intoxicated by such temporary possessions. Consequently, such materially puffed up persons are incapable of uttering the holy name of the Lord by addressing Him feelingly, “O Govinda, O Kṛṣṇa.” It is said in the *sastras* that by once uttering the holy name of the Lord, the sinner gets rid of a quantity of sins that he is unable to commit. Such is the power of uttering the holy name of the Lord. There is not the least exaggeration in this statement. Actually the Lord’s holy name has such powerful potency.

But there is a quality to such utterances also. It depends on the quality of feeling. A helpless man can feelingly utter the holy name of the Lord, whereas a man who utters the same holy name in great material satisfaction cannot be so sincere. A materially puffed up person may utter the holy name of the Lord occasionally, but he is incapable of uttering the name in quality. Therefore, the four principles of material advancement, namely (1) high parentage, (2) good wealth, (3) high education and (4) attractive beauty, are, so to speak, disqualifications for progress on the path of spiritual advancement. The material covering of the pure spirit soul is an external feature, as much as fever is an external feature of the unhealthy body. The general process is to decrease the degree of the fever and not to aggravate it by maltreatment. Sometimes it is seen that spiritually advanced persons become materially impoverished. This is no discouragement. On the other hand, such impoverishment is a good sign as much as the falling of temperature is a good sign. The principle of life should be to decrease the degree of material intoxication which leads one to be more and more illusioned about the aim of life. Grossly illusioned persons are quite unfit for entrance into the kingdom of God.

TEXT 27

**NaMaae_ik-ÄNaivtaaYa iNav*taGau<av*taYae)
AaTMaaraMaaYa XaaNTaaYa kE-vLYaPaTaYae NaMa")) 27))**

namo 'kiicana-vittäya

nivatta-guëa-vättaye

ätmärämäya çäntäya

kaivalya-pataye namaù

SYNONYMS

namaù—all obeisances unto You; *akiicana-vittäya*—unto the property of the materially impoverished; *nivatta*—completely transcendental to the actions of the material modes; *guëa*—material modes; *vättaye*—affection;

ätma-ärämäya—one who is self-satisfied; *çäntäya*—the most gentle; *kaivalya-pataye*—unto the master of the monists; *namaù*—bowing down.

TRANSLATION

My obeisances are unto You, who are the property of the materially impoverished. You have nothing to do with the actions and reactions of the material modes of nature. You are self-satisfied, and therefore You are the most gentle and are master of the monists.

PURPORT

A living being is finished as soon as there is nothing to possess. Therefore a living being cannot be, in the real sense of the term, a renouncer. A living being renounces something for gaining something more valuable. A student sacrifices his childish proclivities to gain better education. A servant gives up his job for a better job. Similarly, a devotee renounces the material world not for nothing but for something tangible in spiritual value. Srila Rüpa Gosvami, Sanätana Gosvami and Srila Raghunätha dāsa Gosvami and others gave up their worldly pomp and prosperity for the sake of the service of the Lord. They were big men in the worldly sense. The Gosvamis were ministers in the government service of Bengal, and Srila Raghunätha dāsa Gosvami was the son of a big *zamindar* of his time. But they left everything to gain something superior to what they previously possessed. The devotees are generally without material prosperity, but they have a very secret treasure-house in the lotus feet of the Lord. There is a nice story about Srila Sanätana Gosvami. He had a touchstone with him, and this stone was left in a pile of refuse. A needy man took it, but later on wondered why the valuable stone was kept in such a neglected place. He therefore asked him for the most valuable thing, and then he was given the holy name of the Lord. *Akiïcana* means one who has nothing to give materially. A factual devotee, or *mahätmä*, does not give anything material to anyone because he has already left all material assets. He can, however, deliver the supreme asset, namely the Personality of Godhead, because He is the only property of a factual devotee. The touchstone of Sanätana Gosvami, which was thrown in the rubbish, was not the property of the Gosvami, otherwise it would not have been kept in such a place. This

specific example is given for the neophyte devotees just to convince them that material hankerings and spiritual advancement go ill together. Unless one is able to see everything as spiritual in relation with the Supreme Lord, one must always distinguish between spirit and matter. A spiritual master like Srila Sanātana Gosvami, although personally able to see everything as spiritual, set this example for us only because we have no such spiritual vision.

Advancement of material vision or material civilization is a great stumbling block for spiritual advancement. Such material advancement entangles the living being in the bondage of a material body followed by all sorts of material miseries. Such material advancement is called *anartha*, or things not wanted. Actually this is so. In the present context of material advancement one uses lipstick at a cost of fifty cents, and there are so many unwanted things which are all products of the material conception of life. By diverting attention to so many unwanted things, human energy is spoiled without achievement of spiritual realization, the prime necessity of human life. The attempt to reach the moon is another example of spoiling energy because even if the moon is reached, the problems of life will not be solved. The devotees of the Lord are called *akiīcanas* because they have practically no material assets. Such material assets are all products of the three modes of material nature. They foil spiritual energy, and thus the less we possess such products of material nature, the more we have a good chance for spiritual progress.

The Supreme Personality of Godhead has no direct connection with material activities. All His acts and deeds, which are exhibited even in this material world, are spiritual and without affection for the modes of material nature. In the *Bhagavad-gita* the Lord says that all His acts, even His appearance and disappearance in and out of the material world, are transcendental, and one who knows this perfectly shall not take his birth again in this material world, but will go back to Godhead.

The material disease is due to hankering after and lording it over material nature. This hankering is due to an interaction of the three modes of nature, and neither the Lord nor the devotees have attachment for such false enjoyment. Therefore, the Lord and the devotees are called *nivāṭṭa-*

guëa-våtti. The perfect *nivåtta-guëa-våtti* is the Supreme Lord because He never becomes attracted by the modes of material nature, whereas the living beings have such a tendency. Some of them are entrapped by the illusory attraction of material nature.

Because the Lord is the property of the devotees, and the devotees are the property of the Lord reciprocally, the devotees are certainly transcendental to the modes of material nature. That is a natural conclusion. Such unalloyed devotees are distinct from the mixed devotees who approach the Lord for mitigation of miseries and poverty or because of inquisitiveness and speculation. The unalloyed devotees and the Lord are transcendently attached to one another. For others, the Lord has nothing to reciprocate, and therefore He is called *åtmäråma*, self-satisfied. Self-satisfied as He is, He is the master of all monists who seek to merge into the existence of the Lord. Such monists merge within the personal effulgence of the Lord called the *brahmajyoti*, but the devotees enter into the transcendental pastimes of the Lord, which are never to be misunderstood as material.

TEXT 28

**MaNYae Tva& k-al/MaqXaaNaMaNaaidiNaDaNa& iv>auMa()
SaMa& crNTa& SavR}a >aUTaaNaa& YaiNMaQa" k-il/")) 28))**

manyè tvää kålam éçånam

anådi-nidhanaà vibhum

samaà carantaà sarvatra

bhütånää yan mithaù kaliù

SYNONYMS

manyè—I consider; *tväm*—Your Lordship; *kålam*—the eternal time; *éçånam*—the Supreme Lord; *anådi-nidhanam*—without beginning and end; *vibhum*—all-pervading; *samam*—equally merciful; *carantam*—distributing; *sarvatra*—everywhere; *bhütånäm*—of the living beings; *yat mithaù*—by

intercourse; *kaliù*—dissension.

TRANSLATION

My Lord, I consider Your Lordship to be eternal time, the supreme controller, without beginning and end, the all-pervasive one. In distributing Your mercy, You are equal to everyone. The dissensions between living beings are due to social intercourse.

PURPORT

Kuntédevé knew that Kṛṣṇa was neither her nephew nor an ordinary family member of her paternal house. She knew perfectly well that Kṛṣṇa is the primeval Lord who lives in everyone's heart as the Supersoul, Paramātmā. Another name of the Paramātmā feature of the Lord is *kāla*, or eternal time. Eternal time is the witness of all our actions, good and bad, and thus resultant reactions are destined by Him. It is no use saying that we do not know why and for what we are suffering. We may forget the misdeed for which we may suffer at this present moment, but we must remember that Paramātmā is our constant companion, and therefore He knows everything, past, present and future. And because the Paramātmā feature of Lord Kṛṣṇa destines all actions and reactions, He is the supreme controller also.

Without His sanction not a blade of grass can move. The living beings are given as much freedom as they deserve, and misuse of that freedom is the cause of suffering. The devotees of the Lord do not misuse their freedom, and therefore they are the good sons of the Lord. Others, who misuse freedom, are put into miseries destined by the eternal *kāla*. The *kāla* offers the conditioned souls both happiness and miseries. It is all predestined by eternal time. As we have miseries uncalled-for, so we may have happiness also without being asked, for they are all predestined by *kāla*. No one is therefore either an enemy or friend of the Lord. Everyone is suffering and enjoying the result of his own destiny. This destiny is made by the living beings in course of social intercourse. Everyone here wants to lord it over the material nature, and thus everyone creates his own destiny under the supervision of the Supreme Lord. He is all-pervading and therefore He can see everyone's activities. And because the Lord has no beginning or end, He is known also as the eternal time, *kāla*.

TEXT 29

Na ved k-iêÙGav&iêk-lizRTa&
TavehMaaNaSYa Na*<aa& iv@MbNaMa()
Na YaSYa k-iêÕiYaTaae_iSTa k-ihRicd(
ÜeZYaê YaiSMaNa(ivzMaa MaiTaNa*R<aaMa()) 29))

na veda kaçcid bhagavaàç cikérñitaà

tavehamānasya nãëää viòambanam

na yasya kaçcid dayito 'sti karhacid

dveñyaç ca yasmin viñamä matir nãëäm

SYNONYMS

na—does not; *veda*—know; *kaçcit*—anyone; *bhagavan*—O Lord; *cikérñitam*—pastimes; *tava*—Your; *éhamānasya*—like the worldly men; *nãëäm*—of the people in general; *viòambanam*—misleading; *na*—never; *yasya*—His; *kaçcit*—anyone; *dayitaù*—object of specific favor; *asti*—there is; *karhicit*—anywhere; *dveñyaù*—object of envy; *ca*—and; *yasmin*—unto Him; *viñamä*—partiality; *matiù*—conception; *nãëäm*—of the people.

TRANSLATION

O Lord, no one can understand Your transcendental pastimes, which appear to be human and are so misleading. You have no specific object of favor, nor do You have any object of envy. People only imagine that You are partial.

PURPORT

The Lord's mercy upon the fallen souls is equally distributed. He has no one as the specific object of hostility. The very conception of the Personality of Godhead as a human being is misleading. His pastimes *appear* to be exactly like a human being's, but actually they are transcendental and without any

tinge of material contamination. He is undoubtedly known as partial to His pure devotees, but in fact He is never partial, as much as the sun is never partial to anyone. By utilizing the sun rays, sometimes even the stones become valuable, whereas a blind man cannot see the sun, although there are enough sun rays before him. Darkness and light are two opposite conceptions, but this does not mean that the sun is partial in distributing its rays. The sun rays are open to everyone, but the capacities of the receptacles differ. Foolish people think that devotional service is flattering the Lord to get special mercy. Factually the pure devotees who are engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord are not a mercantile community. A mercantile house renders service to someone in exchange for values. The pure devotee does not render service unto the Lord for such exchange, and therefore the full mercy of the Lord is open for him. Suffering and needy men, inquisitive persons or philosophers make temporary connections with the Lord to serve a particular purpose. When the purpose is served, there is no more relation with the Lord. A suffering man, if he is pious at all, prays to the Lord for his recovery. But as soon as the recovery is over, in most cases the suffering man no longer cares to keep any connection with the Lord. The mercy of the Lord is open for him, but he is reluctant to receive it. That is the difference between a pure devotee and a mixed devotee. Those who are completely against the service of the Lord are considered to be in abject darkness, those who ask for the Lord's favor only at the time of necessity are partial recipients of the mercy of the Lord, and those who are cent percent engaged in the service of the Lord are full recipients of the mercy of the Lord. Such partiality in receiving the Lord's mercy is relative to the recipient, and it is not due to the partiality of the all-merciful Lord.

When the Lord descends on this material world by His all-merciful energy, He plays like a human being, and therefore it appears that the Lord is partial to His devotees only, but that is not a fact. Despite such apparent manifestation of partiality, His mercy is equally distributed. In the Battlefield of Kurukñetra all persons who died in the fight before the presence of the Lord got salvation without the necessary qualifications because death before the presence of the Lord purifies the passing soul from the effects of all sins, and therefore the dying man gets a place somewhere in the transcendental abode. Somehow or other if someone

puts himself open in the sun rays, he is sure to get the requisite benefit both by heat and by ultraviolet rays. Therefore, the conclusion is that the Lord is never partial. It is wrong for the people in general to think of Him as partial.

TEXT 30

**JaNMa k-MaR c ivàTMaàJaSYaak-TauRraTMaNa")
iTaYaRx(Naṽizzu Yaad"Sau TadTYaNTaiv@MbNaMa()) 30))**

janma karma ca viçvätman

ajasyäkartur ätmanaù

tiryai-nèñiñu yädausu

tad atyanta-viòambanam

SYNONYMS

janma—birth; *karma*—activity; *ca*—and; *viçva-ätman*—O soul of the universe; *ajasya*—of the unborn; *akartuù*—of the inactive; *ätmanaù*—of the vital energy; *tiryak*—animal; *nā*—human being; *āñiñu*—in the sages; *yädausu*—in the water; *tat*—that; *atyanta*—veritable; *viòambanam*—bewildering.

TRANSLATION

Of course it is bewildering, O soul of the universe, that You work, though You are inactive, and that You take birth, though You are the vital force and the unborn. You Yourself descend amongst animals, men, sages and aquatics. Verily, this is bewildering.

PURPORT

The transcendental pastimes of the Lord are not only bewildering but also apparently contradictory. In other words, they are all inconceivable to the

limited thinking power of the human being. The Lord is the all-prevailing Supersoul of all existence, and yet He appears in the form of a boar amongst the animals, in the form of a human being as Rāma, Kṛṣṇa, etc., in the form of a *āñi* like Nārāyaṇa, and in the form of an aquatic like a fish. Yet it is said that He is unborn, and He has nothing to do. In the *śruti mantra* it is said that the Supreme Brahman has nothing to do. No one is equal to or greater than Him. He has manifold energies, and everything is performed by Him perfectly by automatic knowledge, strength and activity. All these statements prove without any question that the Lord's activities, forms and deeds are all inconceivable to our limited thinking power, and because He is inconceivably powerful, everything is possible in Him. Therefore no one can calculate Him exactly; every action of the Lord is bewildering to the common man. He cannot be understood by the Vedic knowledge, but He can be easily understood by the pure devotees because they are intimately related with Him. The devotees therefore know that although He appears amongst the animals, He is not an animal, nor a man, nor a *āñi*, nor a fish. He is eternally the Supreme Lord, in all circumstances.

TEXT 31

GaaePYaadde TviYa k*-TaaGaiSa daMa Taavd(
Yaa Tae dXaaé[uk-il/I/aĀNaSaM>a]Maa+aMa()
v£&- iNaNaqYa >aYa>aavNaYaa iSQaTaSYa
Saa Maa& ivMaaehYaiTa >aqriPa YaiØ>aeiTa)) 31))

gopy ādade tvayi kātāgasi dāma tāvad

yā te daṣṭācru-kalilāijana-sambhramākñam

vaktraà ninéya bhaya-bhāvanayā sthitasya

sā mää vimohayati bhér api yad bibheti

SYNONYMS

gopé—the cowherd lady (Yaçodā); *ādade*—took up; *tvayi*—on Your;
kātāgasi—creating disturbances (by breaking the butter pot); *dāma*—rope;

tävat—at that time; *yä*—that which; *te*—Your; *daçä*—situation; *açru-kalila*—overflowed with tears; *añjana*—ointment; *sambhrama*—perturbed; *akñam*—eyes; *vaktram*—face; *ninéya*—downwards; *bhaya-bhāvanayä*—by thoughts of fear; *sthitasya*—of the situation; *sä*—that; *mām*—me; *vimohayati*—bewilders; *bhéu api*—even fear personified; *yat*—whom; *bibheti*—is afraid.

TRANSLATION

My dear Kṛṣṇa, Yaçodä took up a rope to bind You when You committed an offense, and Your perturbed eyes overflowed with tears, which washed the mascara from Your eyes. And You were afraid, though fear personified is afraid of You. This sight is bewildering to me.

PURPORT

Here is another explanation of the bewilderment created by the pastimes of the Supreme Lord. The Supreme Lord is the Supreme in all circumstances, as already explained. Here is a specific example of the Lord's being the Supreme and at the same time a plaything in the presence of His pure devotee. The Lord's pure devotee renders service unto the Lord out of unalloyed love only, and while discharging such devotional service the pure devotee forgets the position of the Supreme Lord. The Supreme Lord also accepts the loving service of His devotees more relishably when the service is rendered spontaneously out of pure affection, without anything of reverential admiration. Generally the Lord is worshiped by the devotees in a reverential attitude, but the Lord is meticulously pleased when the devotee, out of pure affection and love, considers the Lord to be less important than himself. The Lord's pastimes in the original abode of Goloka Våndävana are exchanged in that spirit. The friends of Kṛṣṇa consider Him one of them. They do not consider Him to be of reverential importance. The parents of the Lord (who are all pure devotees) consider Him a child only. The Lord accepts the chastisements of the parents more cheerfully than the prayers of the Vedic hymns. Similarly, He accepts the reproaches of His fiancées more palatably than the Vedic hymns. When Lord Kṛṣṇa was present in this material world to manifest His eternal pastimes of the transcendental realm of Goloka Våndävana as an attraction for the people

in general, He displayed a unique picture of subordination before His foster mother, Yaçodä. The Lord, in His naturally childish playful activities, used to spoil the stocked butter of mother Yaçodä by breaking the pots and distributing the contents to His friends and playmates, including the celebrated monkeys of Våndävana, who took advantage of the Lord's munificence. Mother Yaçodä saw this, and out of her pure love she wanted to make a show of punishment for her transcendental child. She took a rope and threatened the Lord that she would tie Him up, as is generally done in the ordinary household. Seeing the rope in the hands of mother Yaçodä, the Lord bowed down His head and began to weep just like a child, and tears rolled down His cheeks, washing off the black ointment smeared about His beautiful eyes. This picture of the Lord is adored by Kuntédevé because she is conscious of the Lord's supreme position. He is feared often by fear personified, yet He is afraid of His mother, who wanted to punish Him just in an ordinary manner. Kunté was conscious of the exalted position of Kṛṣṇa, whereas Yaçodä was not. Therefore Yaçodä's position was more exalted than Kunté's. Mother Yaçodä got the Lord as her child, and the Lord made her forget altogether that her child was the Lord Himself. If mother Yaçodä had been conscious of the exalted position of the Lord, she would certainly have hesitated to punish the Lord. But she was made to forget this situation because the Lord wanted to make a complete gesture of childishness before the affectionate Yaçodä. This exchange of love between the mother and the son was performed in a natural way, and Kunté, remembering the scene, was bewildered, and she could do nothing but praise the transcendental filial love. Indirectly mother Yaçodä is praised for her unique position of love, for she could control even the all-powerful Lord as her beloved child.

TEXT 32

**ke-icdahurJa& JaaTa& Pau<Yaëaek-SYa k-ITaRYae)
Yadae" iPa[YaSYaaNvvaYae Mal/YaSYaev cNdNaMa()) 32))**

kecid ähur ajaà jätà

puëya-çlokasya kértaye

yadoù priyasyānvaväye

malayasyeva candanam

SYNONYMS

kecit—someone; *āhuù*—says; *ajam*—the unborn; *jätam*—being born; *puëya-çlokasya*—of the great pious king; *kértaye*—for glorifying; *yadoù*—of King Yadu; *priyasya*—of the dear; *anvaväye*—in the family of; *malayasya*—Malaya hills; *iva*—as; *candanam*—sandalwood.

TRANSLATION

Some say that the Unborn is born for the glorification of pious kings, and others say that He is born to please King Yadu, one of Your dearest devotees. You appear in his family as sandalwood appears in the Malaya hills.

PURPORT

Because the Lord's appearance in this material world is bewildering, there are different opinions about the birth of the Unborn. In the *Bhagavad-gita* the Lord says that He takes His birth in the material world, although He is the Lord of all creations and He is unborn. So there cannot be any denial of the birth of the Unborn because He Himself establishes the truth. But still there are different opinions as to why He takes His birth. That is also declared in the *Bhagavad-gita*. He appears by His own internal potency to reestablish the principles of religion and to protect the pious and to annihilate the impious. That is the mission of the appearance of the Unborn. Still, it is said that the Lord is there to glorify the pious King Yudhiñöhira. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa certainly wanted to establish the kingdom of the Pääòavas for the good of all in the world. When there is a pious king ruling over the world, the people are happy. When the ruler is impious, the people are unhappy. In the age of Kali in most cases the rulers are impious, and therefore the citizens are also continuously unhappy. But in the case of democracy, the impious citizens themselves elect their representative to rule over them, and therefore they cannot blame anyone for their

unhappiness. Mahārāja Nala was also celebrated as a great pious king, but he had no connection with Lord Kṛṣṇa. Therefore Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira is meant here to be glorified by Lord Kṛṣṇa. He had also glorified King Yadu, having taken His birth in the family. He is known as Yādava, Yaduvéra, Yadunandana, etc., although the Lord is always independent of such obligation. He is just like the sandalwood that grows in the Malaya hills. Trees can grow anywhere and everywhere, yet because the sandalwood trees grow mostly in the area of the Malaya hills, the name sandalwood and the Malaya hills are interrelated. Therefore, the conclusion is that the Lord is ever unborn like the sun, and yet He appears as the sun rises on the eastern horizon. As the sun is never the sun of the eastern horizon, so the Lord is no one's son, but He is the father of everything that be.

TEXT 33

**APare vSaudevSYa devKYaa& YaaicTaae_>YaGaaTa()
AJaSTvMaSYa +aeMaaYa vDaaYa c SauriÜzaMa()) 33))**

apare vasudevasya

devakyäà yäcito 'bhyagät

ajas tvam asya kñemäya

vadhäya ca sura-dviñäm

SYNONYMS

apare—others; *vasudevasya*—of Vasudeva; *devakyäm*—of Devaké; *yäcitaù*—being prayed for; *abhyagät*—took birth; *ajaù*—unborn; *tvam*—You are; *asya*—of him; *kñemäya*—for the good; *vadhäya*—for the purpose of killing; *ca*—and; *sura-dviñäm*—of those who are envious of the demigods.

TRANSLATION

Others say that since both Vasudeva and Devaké prayed for You, You

have taken Your birth as their son. Undoubtedly You are unborn, yet You take Your birth for their welfare and to kill those who are envious of the demigods.

PURPORT

It is also said that Vasudeva and Devaké, in their previous birth as Sutapā and Pāṇi, underwent a severe type of penance to get the Lord as their son, and as a result of such austerities the Lord appeared as their son. It is already declared in the *Bhagavad-gītā* that the Lord appears for the welfare of all people of the world and to vanquish the *asuras*, or the materialistic atheists.

TEXT 34

>aaravTaar<aaYaaNYae >auvae Naav wvaedDaaE)
SaqdNTYaa >aUir>aare<a JaaTaae àaTMa>auvaiQaRTa")) 34))

bhāravatāraēāyānye

bhuvo nāva ivodadhau

sédantyā bhūri-bhäreëa

jāto hy ātma-bhuvārthitaù

SYNONYMS

bhāra-avatāraēāya—just to reduce the burden to the world; *anye*—others; *bhuvaù*—of the world; *nāvaù*—boat; *iva*—like; *udadhau*—on the sea; *sédantyäù*—aggrieved; *bhūri*—extremely; *bhäreëa*—by the burden; *jātaù*—You were born; *hi*—certainly; *ātma-bhuvä*—by Brahmä; *arthitaù*—being prayed for.

TRANSLATION

Others say that the world, being overburdened like a boat at sea, is much

aggrieved, and that Brahmā, who is Your son, prayed for You, and so You have appeared to diminish the trouble.

PURPORT

Brahmā, or the first living being born just after the creation, is the direct son of Nārāyaṇa. Nārāyaṇa, as Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, first of all entered the material universe. Without spiritual contact, matter cannot create. This principle was followed from the very beginning of the creation. The Supreme Spirit entered the universe, and the first living being, Brahmā, was born on a lotus flower grown out of the transcendental abdomen of Viṣṇu. Viṣṇu is therefore known as Padmanābha. Brahmā is known as *ātma-bhū* because he was begotten directly from the father without any contact of mother Lakṣmījé. Lakṣmījé was present near Nārāyaṇa, engaged in the service of the Lord, and still, without contact with Lakṣmījé, Nārāyaṇa begot Brahmā. That is the omnipotency of the Lord. One who foolishly considers Nārāyaṇa like other living beings should take a lesson from this. Nārāyaṇa is not an ordinary living being. He is the Personality of Godhead Himself, and He has all the potencies of all the senses in all parts of His transcendental body. An ordinary living being begets a child by sexual intercourse, and he has no other means to beget a child other than the one designed for him. But Nārāyaṇa, being omnipotent, is not bound to any condition of energy. He is complete and independent to do anything and everything by His various potencies, very easily and perfectly. Brahmā is therefore directly the son of the father and was not put into the womb of a mother. Therefore he is known as *ātma-bhū*. This Brahmā is in charge of further creations in the universe, secondarily reflected by the potency of the Omnipotent. Within the halo of the universe there is a transcendental planet known as Çvetadvépa, which is the abode of the Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, the Paramātmā feature of the Supreme Lord. Whenever there is trouble in the universe that cannot be solved by the administrative demigods, they approach Brahmājé for a solution, and if it is not to be solved even by Brahmājé, then Brahmājé consults and prays to the Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu for an incarnation and solution to the problems. Such a problem arose when Kaàsa and others were ruling over the earth and the earth became too much overburdened by the misdeeds of the *asuras*. Brahmājé, along with other demigods, prayed at the shore of the

Kñérodaka Ocean, and they were advised of the descent of Kṛṣṇa as the son of Vasudeva and Devaké. So some people say that the Lord appeared because of the prayers of Brahmäjé.

TEXT 35

>ave_iSMaNa(i©-XYaMaaNaaNaaMaivŪak-aMak-MaRi>a")
é[v<aSMar<aahaRi<a k-irZYaiàiTā ke-cNa)) 35))

bhave 'smin kliṣyamānānām

avidyā-kāma-karmabhiù

ṣravaëa-smaraëärhëi

kariñyann iti kecana

SYNONYMS

bhave—in the material creation; *asmin*—this; *kliṣyamānānām*—of those who are suffering from; *avidyā*—nescience; *kāma*—desire; *karmabhiù*—by execution of fruitive work; *ṣravaëa*—hearing; *smaraëa*—remembering; *arhëi*—worshiping; *kariñyan*—may perform; *iti*—thus; *kecana*—others.

TRANSLATION

And yet others say that You appeared to rejuvenate the devotional service of hearing, remembering, worshiping and so on in order that the conditioned souls suffering from material pangs might take advantage and gain liberation.

PURPORT

In the *Srimad Bhagavad-gita* the Lord asserts that He appears in every millennium just to reestablish the way of religion. The way of religion is made by the Supreme Lord. No one can manufacture a new path of religion, as is the fashion for certain ambitious persons. The factual way of

religion is to accept the Lord as the supreme authority and thus render service unto Him in spontaneous love. A living being cannot help but render service because he is constitutionally made for that purpose. The only function of the living being is to render service to the Lord. The Lord is great, and living beings are subordinate to Him. Therefore, the duty of the living being is just to serve Him only. Unfortunately the illusioned living beings, out of misunderstanding only, become servants of the senses by material desire. This desire is called *avidyā*, or nescience. And out of such desire the living being makes different plans for material enjoyment centered about a perverted sex life. He therefore becomes entangled in the chain of birth and death by transmigrating into different bodies on different planets under the direction of the Supreme Lord. Unless, therefore, one is beyond the boundary of this nescience, one cannot get free from the threefold miseries of material life. That is the law of nature.

The Lord, however, out of His causeless mercy, because He is more merciful to the suffering living beings than they can expect, appears before them and renovates the principles of devotional service comprised of hearing, chanting, remembering, serving, worshiping, praying, cooperating and surrendering unto Him. Adoption of all the above-mentioned items, or any one of them, can help a conditioned soul get out of the tangle of nescience and thus become liberated from all material sufferings created by the living being illusioned by the external energy. This particular type of mercy is bestowed upon the living being by the Lord in the form of Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 36

é*<viNTa GaaYaiNTa Ga*<aNTYa>aq+<aXa"
 SMariNTa NaNdiNTa TaveihTa& JaNaa")
 Ta Wv PaXYaNTYaicre<a Taavk&-
 >avPa[vahaeParMa& PadaMbuJaMa()) 36))

çäëvanti gäyanti gâëanty abhékñëaçau

smaranti nandanti tavehitaà janäù

ta eva paçyanty acireëa tävakaà

bhava-pravāhoparamaà padāmbujam

SYNONYMS

çāëvanti—hear; *gäyanti*—chant; *gāëanti*—take; *abhékñëaçau*—continuously; *smaranti*—remember; *nandanti*—take pleasure; *tava*—Your; *éhitam*—activities; *janäù*—people in general; *te*—they; *eva*—certainly; *paçyanti*—can see; *acireëa*—very soon; *täväkam*—Your; *bhava-pravāha*—the current of rebirth; *uparamam*—cessation; *pada-ambujam*—lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

O Kṛṣṇa, those who continuously hear, chant and repeat Your transcendental activities, or take pleasure in others' doing so, certainly see Your lotus feet, which alone can stop the repetition of birth and death.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa cannot be seen by our present conditional vision. In order to see Him, one has to change his present vision by developing a different condition of life full of spontaneous love of Godhead. When Sri Kṛṣṇa was personally present on the face of the globe, not everyone could see Him as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Materialists like Ravana, Hiraṇyakaśipu, Kaàsa, Jarāsandha and Çiçupāla, were highly qualified personalities by acquisition of material assets, but they were unable to appreciate the presence of the Lord. Therefore, even though the Lord may be present before our eyes, it is not possible to see Him unless we have the necessary vision. This necessary qualification is developed by the process of devotional service only, beginning with hearing about the Lord from the right sources. The *Bhagavad-gita* is one of the popular literatures which are generally heard, chanted, repeated, etc., by the people in general, but in spite of such hearing, etc., sometimes it is experienced that the performer of such devotional service does not see the Lord eye to eye. The reason is that the first item, *çravaëa*, is very important.

If hearing is from the right sources, it acts very quickly. Generally people hear from unauthorized persons. Such unauthorized persons may be very learned by academic qualifications, but because they do not follow the principles of devotional service, hearing from them becomes a sheer waste of time. Sometimes the texts are interpreted fashionably to suit their own purposes. Therefore, first one should select a competent and bona fide speaker and then hear from him. When the hearing process is perfect and complete, the other processes become automatically perfect in their own way.

There are different transcendental activities of the Lord, and each and every one of them is competent to bestow the desired result, provided the hearing process is perfect. In the *Bhāgavatam* the activities of the Lord begin from His dealings with the Pāṇḍavas. There are many other pastimes of the Lord in connection with His dealings with the *asuras* and others. And in the Tenth Canto the sublime dealings with His conjugal associates, the *gopés*, as well as with His married wives at Dvārakā are mentioned. Since the Lord is absolute, there is no difference in the transcendental nature of each and every dealing of the Lord. But sometimes people, in an unauthorized hearing process, take more interest in hearing about His dealings with the *gopés*. Such an inclination indicates the lusty feelings of the hearer, so a bona fide speaker of the dealings of the Lord never indulges in such hearings. One must hear about the Lord from the very beginning, as in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* or any other scriptures, and that will help the hearer attain perfection by progressive development. One should not, therefore, consider that His dealings with the Pāṇḍavas are less important than His dealings with the *gopés*. We must always remember that the Lord is always transcendental to all mundane attachment. In all the above-mentioned dealings of the Lord, He is the hero in all circumstances, and hearing about Him or about His devotees or combatants is conducive to spiritual life. It is said that the *Vedas* and *Puranas*, etc., are all made to revive our lost relation with Him. Hearing of all these scriptures is essential.

TEXT 37

**APYāŪ NaSTv& SvK*-TaeihTa Pa[>aae
iJahaSaiSa iSvTSauôdae_NauJaqivNa")**

**Yaeza& Na caNYaÜvTa" PadaMbuJaaTa(
ParaYa<a& raJaSau YaaeiJaTaa&hSaaMa()) 37))**

apy adya nas tvaà sva-kâteḥita prabho

jihāsasi svit suhādo ’nujévinau

yeñäà na cānyad bhavatau padāmbujāt

parāyaëaà rājasu yojitāahasām

SYNONYMS

api—if; *adya*—today; *nau*—us; *tvam*—You; *sva-kāta*—self-executed; *éḥita*—all duties; *prabho*—O my Lord; *jihāsasi*—giving up; *svit*—possibly; *suhāda*—intimate friends; *anujévinau*—living at the mercy of; *yeñām*—of whom; *na*—nor; *ca*—and; *anyat*—anyone else; *bhavatau*—Your; *pada-ambujāt*—from the lotus feet; *parāyaëam*—dependent; *rājasu*—unto the kings; *yojita*—engaged in; *aahasām*—enmity.

TRANSLATION

O my Lord, You have executed all duties Yourself. Are you leaving us today, though we are completely dependent on Your mercy and have no one else to protect us, now when all kings are at enmity with us?

PURPORT

The Pāëòavas are most fortunate because with all good luck they were entirely dependent on the mercy of the Lord. In the material world, to be dependent on the mercy of someone else is the utmost sign of misfortune, but in the case of our transcendental relation with the Lord, it is the most fortunate case when we can live completely dependent on Him. The material disease is due to thinking of becoming independent of everything. But the cruel material nature does not allow us to become independent. The false attempt to become independent of the stringent laws of nature is known as material advancement of experimental knowledge. The whole

material world is moving on this false attempt of becoming independent of the laws of nature. Beginning from Ravana, who wanted to prepare a direct staircase to the planets of heaven, down to the present age, they are trying to overcome the laws of nature. They are trying now to approach distant planetary systems by electronic mechanical power. But the highest goal of human civilization is to work hard under the guidance of the Lord and become completely dependent on Him. The highest achievement of perfect civilization is to work with valor but at the same time depend completely on the Lord. The Pāṇḍavas were the ideal executors of this standard of civilization. Undoubtedly they were completely dependent on the good will of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, but they were not idle parasites of the Lord. They were all highly qualified both by personal character and by physical activities. Still they always looked for the mercy of the Lord because they knew that every living being is dependent by constitutional position. The perfection of life is, therefore, to become dependent on the will of the Lord, instead of becoming falsely independent in the material world. Those who try to become falsely independent of the Lord are called *anātha*, or without any guardian, whereas those who are completely dependent on the will of the Lord are called *sanātha*, or those having someone to protect them. Therefore we must try to be *sanātha* so that we can always be protected from the unfavorable condition of material existence. By the deluding power of the external material nature we forget that the material condition of life is the most undesirable perplexity. The *Bhagavad-gita* therefore directs us (7.19) that after many, many births one fortunate person becomes aware of the fact that Vāsudeva is all in all and that the best way of leading one's life is to surrender unto Him completely. That is the sign of a *mahātmā*. All the members of the Pāṇḍava family were *mahātmās* in household life. Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira was the head of these *mahātmās*, and Queen Kuntédevé was the mother. The lessons of the *Bhagavad-gita* and all the *Puranas*, specifically the *Bhāgavata Purana*, are therefore inevitably connected with the history of the Pāṇḍava *mahātmās*. For them, separation from the Lord was just like the separation of a fish from water. Srimaté Kuntédevé, therefore, felt such separation like a thunderbolt, and the whole prayer of the Queen is to try to persuade the Lord to stay with them. After the Battle of Kurukṣetra, although the inimical kings were killed, their sons and grandsons were still there to deal with the Pāṇḍavas. It is not only the Pāṇḍavas who were put into the condition of enmity, but

all of us are always in such a condition, and the best way of living is to become completely dependent on the will of the Lord and thereby overcome all difficulties of material existence.

TEXT 38

ke- vYa& NaaMaæPaa>Yaa& Yadui>a" Sah Paa<@va")
>avTaae_dXaRNa& YaihR ôzqk-a<aaiMaveiXaTau")) 38))

ke vayaà nāma-rüpābhyāà

yadubhiù saha päëòaväù

bhavato 'darçanaà yarhi

hãñékäëäm iveçituù

SYNONYMS

ke—who are; *vayam*—we; *nāma-rüpābhyām*—without fame and ability; *yadubhiù*—with the Yadus; *saha*—along with; *päëòaväù*—and the Pääòavas; *bhavataù*—Your; *adarçanam*—absence; *yarhi*—as if; *hãñékäëäm*—of the senses; *iva*—like; *éçituù*—of the living being.

TRANSLATION

As the name and fame of a particular body is finished with the disappearance of the living spirit, similarly if You do not look upon us, all our fame and activities, along with the Pääòavas and Yadus, will end at once.

PURPORT

Kuntédevé is quite aware that the existence of the Pääòavas is due to Sri Kṛṣṇa only. The Pääòavas are undoubtedly well established in name and fame and are guided by the great King Yudhiñöhira, who is morality personified, and the Yadus are undoubtedly great allies, but without the

guidance of Lord Kṛṣṇa all of them are nonentities, as much as the senses of the body are useless without the guidance of consciousness. No one should be proud of his prestige, power and fame without being guided by the favor of the Supreme Lord. The living beings are always dependent, and the ultimate dependable object is the Lord Himself. We may, therefore, invent by our advancement of material knowledge all sorts of counteracting material resources, but without being guided by the Lord all such inventions end in fiasco, however strong and stout the reactionary elements may be.

TEXT 39

**NaeYa& Xaaei>aZYaTae Ta}a YaQaedaNaq& GadaDar)
TvTPadEriªTaa >aaiTa Svl/+a<aivl/i+aTaE")) 39))**

neyaà çobhiñyate tatra

yathedänéà gadādhara

tvat-padair aikitā bhāti

sva-lakñāëa-vilakñitaiù

SYNONYMS

na—not; *iyam*—this land of our kingdom; *çobhiñyate*—will appear beautiful; *tatra*—then; *yathā*—as it is now; *idäném*—how; *gadādhara*—O Kṛṣṇa; *tvat*—Your; *padaiù*—by the feet; *aikitā*—marked; *bhāti*—is dazzling; *sva-lakñāëa*—Your own marks; *vilakñitaiù*—by the impressions.

TRANSLATION

O Gadādhara [Kṛṣṇa], our kingdom is now being marked by the impressions of Your feet, and therefore it appears beautiful. But when You leave, it will no longer be so.

PURPORT

There are certain particular marks on the feet of the Lord which distinguish the Lord from others. The marks of a flag, thunderbolt, and instrument to drive an elephant, umbrella, lotus, disc, etc., are on the bottom of the Lord's feet. These marks are impressed upon the soft dust of the land where the Lord traverses. The land of Hastināpura was thus marked while Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa was there with the Pāṇḍavas, and the kingdom of the Pāṇḍavas thus flourished by such auspicious signs. Kuntédevé pointed out these distinguished features and was afraid of ill luck in the absence of the Lord.

TEXT 40

wMae JaNaPada" Sv*Öa" SauPaKvaEziDavqãDa")
vNaaid]NaÛudNvNTaae ùeDaNTae Tav vqi+aTaE")) 40))

ime jana-padäù svāddhäu

supakvauñadhi-vérudhaù

vanādri-nady-udanvanto

hy edhante tava vékñitaiù

SYNONYMS

ime—all these; *jana-padäù*—cities and towns; *svāddhäu*—flourished; *supakva*—nature; *auñadhi*—herbs; *vérudhaù*—vegetables; *vana*—forests; *adri*—hills; *nadé*—rivers; *udanvantaù*—seas; *hi*—certainly; *edhante*—increasing; *tava*—by You; *vékñitaiù*—seen.

TRANSLATION

All these cities and villages are flourishing in all respects because the herbs and grains are in abundance, the trees are full of fruits, the rivers are flowing, the hills are full of minerals and the oceans full of wealth. And this is all due to Your glancing over them.

PURPORT

Human prosperity flourishes by natural gifts and not by gigantic industrial enterprises. The gigantic industrial enterprises are products of a godless civilization, and they cause the destruction of the noble aims of human life. The more we go on increasing such troublesome industries to squeeze out the vital energy of the human being, the more there will be unrest and dissatisfaction of the people in general, although a few only can live lavishly by exploitation. The natural gifts such as grains and vegetables, fruits, rivers, the hills of jewels and minerals, and the seas full of pearls are supplied by the order of the Supreme, and as He desires, material nature produces them in abundance or restricts them at times. The natural law is that the human being may take advantage of these godly gifts by nature and satisfactorily flourish on them without being captivated by the exploitative motive of lording it over material nature. The more we attempt to exploit material nature according to our whims of enjoyment, the more we shall become entrapped by the reaction of such exploitative attempts. If we have sufficient grains, fruits, vegetables and herbs, then what is the necessity of running a slaughterhouse and killing poor animals? A man need not kill an animal if he has sufficient grains and vegetables to eat. The flow of river waters fertilizes the fields, and there is more than what we need. Minerals are produced in the hills, and the jewels in the ocean. If the human civilization has sufficient grains, minerals, jewels, water, milk, etc., then why should it hanker after terrible industrial enterprises at the cost of the labor of some unfortunate men? But all these natural gifts are dependent on the mercy of the Lord. What we need, therefore, is to be obedient to the laws of the Lord and achieve the perfection of human life by devotional service. The indications by Kuntédevé are just to the point. She desires that God's mercy be bestowed upon them so that natural prosperity be maintained by His grace.

TEXT 41

**AQa ivìeXa ivìaTMaNa(ivìMaUTaeR Svke-zu Mae)
òehPaaXaiMaMa& i^iNDa d*!& Paa<@uzu v*iZ<azu)) 41))**

atha viçveça viçvātman

viçva-mūrte svakeñu me

sneha-pāçam imaà chindhi

dāòhaà päëduñu vāñëiñu

SYNONYMS

atha—therefore; *viçva-éça*—O Lord of the universe; *viçva-ātman*—O soul of the universe; *viçva-mūrte*—O personality of the universal form; *svakeñu*—unto my own kinsmen; *me*—my; *sneha-pāçam*—tie of affection; *imam*—this; *chindhi*—cut off; *dāòham*—deep; *päëduñu*—for the Päëòavas; *vāñëiñu*—for the Vāñëis also.

TRANSLATION

O Lord of the universe, soul of the universe, O personality of the form of the universe, please, therefore, sever my tie of affection for my kinsmen, the Päëòavas and the Vāñëis.

PURPORT

A pure devotee of the Lord is ashamed to ask anything in self-interest from the Lord. But the householders are sometimes obliged to ask favors from the Lord, being bound by the tie of family affection. Srimaté Kuntédevé was conscious of this fact, and therefore she prayed to the Lord to cut off the affectionate tie from her own kinsmen, the Päëòavas and the Vāñëis. The Päëòavas are her own sons, and the Vāñëis are the members of her paternal family. Kṛṣṇa was equally related to both the families. Both the families required the Lord's help because both were dependent devotees of the Lord. Srimaté Kuntédevé wished Sri Kṛṣṇa to remain with her sons the Päëòavas, but by His doing so her paternal house would be bereft of the benefit. All these partialities troubled the mind of Kunté, and therefore she desired to cut off the affectionate tie.

A pure devotee cuts off the limited ties of affection for his family and widens his activities of devotional service for all forgotten souls. The typical

example is the band of six Gosvamis, who followed the path of Lord Caitanya. All of them belonged to the most enlightened and cultured rich families of the higher castes, but for the benefit of the mass of population they left their comfortable homes and became mendicants. To cut off all family affection means to broaden the field of activities. Without doing this, no one can be qualified as a *brahmana*, a king, a public leader or a devotee of the Lord. The Personality of Godhead, as an ideal king, showed this by example. Sri Rāmacandra cut off the tie of affection for His beloved wife to manifest the qualities of an ideal king.

Such personalities as a *brahmana*, a devotee, a king or a public leader must be very broadminded in discharging their respective duties. Srimatē Kuntédevé was conscious of this fact, and being weak she prayed to be free from such bondage of family affection. The Lord is addressed as the Lord of the universe, or the Lord of the universal mind, indicating His all-powerful ability to cut the hard knot of family affection. Therefore, it is sometimes experienced that the Lord, out of His special affinity towards a weak devotee, breaks the family affection by force of circumstances arranged by His all-powerful energy. By doing so He causes the devotee to become completely dependent on Him and thus clears the path for his going back to Godhead.

TEXT 42

**TviYa Mae_NaNYaivzYaa MaiTaMaRDauPaTae_Sak*-Ta()
riTaMauÜhTaadÖa Ga®evaEgaMaudNviTa)) 42))**

tvayi me 'nanya-viñayä

matir madhu-pate 'sakât

ratim udvahatäd addhä

gaìgevaugham udanvati

SYNONYMS

tvayi—unto You; *me*—my; *ananya-viñayā*—unalloyed; *matiù*—attention; *madhu-pate*—O Lord of Madhu; *asakāt*—continuously; *ratim*—attraction; *udvahatāt*—may overflow; *addhā*—directly; *gaigā*—the Ganges; *iva*—like; *ogham*—flows; *udanvati*—down to the sea.

TRANSLATION

O Lord of Madhu, as the Ganges forever flows to the sea without hindrance, let my attraction be constantly drawn unto You without being diverted to anyone else.

PURPORT

Perfection of pure devotional service is attained when all attention is diverted towards the transcendental loving service of the Lord. To cut off the tie of all other affections does not mean complete negation of the finer elements, like affection for someone else. This is not possible. A living being, whoever he may be, must have this feeling of affection for others because this is a symptom of life. The symptoms of life, such as desire, anger, hankerings, feelings of attraction, etc., cannot be annihilated. Only the objective has to be changed. Desire cannot be negated, but in devotional service the desire is changed only for the service of the Lord in place of desire for sense gratification. The so-called affection for family, society, country, etc., consists of different phases of sense gratification. When this desire is changed for the satisfaction of the Lord, it is called devotional service.

In the *Bhagavad-gita* we can see that Arjuna desired not to fight with his brothers and relations just to satisfy his own personal desires. But when he heard the message of the Lord, *Srimad Bhagavad-gita*, he changed his decision and served the Lord. And for his doing so, he became a famous devotee of the Lord, for it is declared in all the scriptures that Arjuna attained spiritual perfection by devotional service to the Lord in friendship. The fighting was there, the friendship was there, Arjuna was there, and Kṛṣṇa was there, but Arjuna became a different person by devotional service. Therefore, the prayers of Kunté also indicate the same categorical changes in activities. Srimaté Kunté wanted to serve the Lord without

diversion, and that was her prayer. This unalloyed devotion is the ultimate goal of life. Our attention is usually diverted to the service of something which is nongodly or not in the program of the Lord. When the program is changed into the service of the Lord, that is to say when the senses are purified in relation with the service of the Lord, it is called pure unalloyed devotional service. Srimatê Kuntêdevê wanted that perfection and prayed for it from the Lord.

Her affection for the Pãëòavas and the Vãñëis is not out of the range of devotional service because the service of the Lord and the service of the devotees are identical. Sometimes service to the devotee is more valuable than service to the Lord. But here the affection of Kuntêdevê for the Pãëòavas and the Vãñëis was due to family relation. This tie of affection in terms of material relation is the relation of *mâyä* because the relations of the body or the mind are due to the influence of the external energy. Relations of the soul, established in relation with the Supreme Soul, are factual relations. When Kuntêdevê wanted to cut off the family relation, she meant to cut off the relation of the skin. The skin relation is the cause of material bondage, but the relation of the soul is the cause of freedom. This relation of the soul to the soul can be established by the via medium of the relation with the Supersoul. Seeing in the darkness is not seeing. But seeing by the light of the sun means to see the sun and everything else which was unseen in the darkness. That is the way of devotional service.

TEXT 43

é[qk*-Z<a k*-Z<aSa% v*Z<Ya*z>aaviNaDa]uGa(
 raJaNYav&XadhNaaNaPavGaRvqYaR)
 GaaeivNd GaaeiÜJaSauraiTaRhravTaar
 YaaeGaeìrai%/Gaurae >aGavàMaSTae)) 43))

çré-kãñëa kãñëa-sakha vãñëy-ãñabhävani-dhrug-

räjanya-vaàça-dahanänapavarga-vérya

govinda go-dvija-surärti-harävatära

yogeçvarākhila-guro bhagavan namas te

SYNONYMS

çré-kāñëa—O Sri Kṛṣṇa; *kāñëa-sakha*—O friend of Arjuna; *vāñëi*—of descendants of Vāñëi; *āñabha*—O chief; *avani*—the earth; *dhruk*—rebellious; *rājanya-vaàça*—dynasties of the kings; *dahana*—O annihilator; *anapavarga*—without deterioration of; *vérya*—prowess; *govinda*—O proprietor of Golokadhäma; *go*—of the cows; *dvija*—the *brahmanas*; *sura*—the demigods; *arti-hara*—to relieve distress; *avatära*—O Lord who descends; *yoga-éçvara*—O master of all mystic powers; *akhila*—universal; *guro*—O preceptor; *bhagavan*—O possessor of all opulences; *namaù te*—respectful obeisances unto You.

TRANSLATION

O Kṛṣṇa, O friend of Arjuna, O chief amongst the descendants of Vāñëi, You are the destroyer of those political parties which are disturbing elements on this earth. Your prowess never deteriorates. You are the proprietor of the transcendental abode, and You descend to relieve the distresses of the cows, the brahmanas and the devotees. You possess all mystic powers, and You are the preceptor of the entire universe. You are the almighty God, and I offer You my respectful obeisances.

PURPORT

A summary of the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is made herein by Srimaté Kuntédevé. The almighty Lord has His eternal transcendental abode where He is engaged in keeping *surabhi* cows. He is served by hundreds and thousands of goddesses of fortune. He descends on the material world to reclaim His devotees and to annihilate the disturbing elements in groups of political parties and kings who are supposed to be in charge of administration work. He creates, maintains and annihilates by His unlimited energies, and still He is always full with prowess and does not deteriorate in potency. The cows, the *brahmanas* and the devotees of the Lord are all objects of His special attention because they are very important factors for the general welfare of living beings.

TEXT 44

SaUTa ovac

Pa*QaYaeTQa& k-l/PadE" Pair<aUTaai%/aedYa")
MaNd& JahaSa vEku-<#=ae MaaehYaiàv MaaYaYaa)) 44))

süta uväca

pāthayetthaà kala-padaiù

pariëütäkhilodayaù

mandaà jahäsa vaikuëöho

mohayann iva mäyayä

SYNONYMS

sütaù uväca—Süta said; *pāthayä*—by Pāthā (Kunté); *ittham*—this; *kala-padaiù*—by chosen words; *pariëüta*—being worshiped; *akhila*—universal; *udayaù*—glories; *mandam*—mildly; *jahäsa*—smiled; *vaikuëöhaù*—the Lord; *mohayan*—captivating; *iva*—like; *mäyayä*—His mystic power.

TRANSLATION

Süta Gosvami said: The Lord, thus hearing the prayers of Kuntédevé, composed in choice words for His glorification, mildly smiled. That smile was as enchanting as His mystic power.

PURPORT

Anything that is enchanting in the world is said to be a representation of the Lord. The conditioned souls, who are engaged in trying to lord it over the material world, are also enchanted by His mystic powers, but His devotees are enchanted in a different way by the glories of the Lord, and His merciful blessings are upon them. His energy is displayed in different ways, as electrical energy works in manifold capacities. Srimaté Kuntédevé

has prayed to the Lord just to enunciate a fragment of His glories. All His devotees worship Him in that way, by chosen words, and therefore the Lord is known as Uttamaçloka. No amount of chosen words is sufficient to enumerate the Lord's glory, and yet He is satisfied by such prayers as the father is satisfied even by the broken linguistic attempts of the growing child. The word *mäyā* is used both in the sense of delusion and mercy. Herein the word *mäyā* is used in the sense of the Lord's mercy upon Kuntédevé.

TEXT 45

**Taa& ba!iMaTYauPaaMaN}Ya Pa[ivXYa GaJaSaaûYaMa()
iñYaê SvPaur& YaaSYaNa(Pa[eM<aa raja iNavairTa")) 45))**

tāà bāòham ity upāmantrya

praviçya gajasāhvayam

striyaç ca sva-puraà yāsyān

premëä räjäā nivāritaù

SYNONYMS

tām—all those; *bāòham*—accepted; *iti*—thus; *upāmantrya*—subsequently informed; *praviçya*—entering; *gajasāhvayam*—the palace of Hastināpura; *striyaù ca*—other ladies; *sva-puram*—own residence; *yāsyān*—while starting for; *premëä*—with love; *räjäā*—by the King; *nivāritaù*—stopped.

TRANSLATION

Thus accepting the prayers of Srimaté Kuntédevé, the Lord subsequently informed other ladies of His departure by entering the palace of Hastināpura. But upon preparing to leave, He was stopped by King Yudhiñöhira, who implored Him lovingly.

PURPORT

No one could make Lord Kṛṣṇa stay at Hastināpura when He decided to start for Dvārakā, but the simple request of King Yudhiṣṭhira that the Lord remain there for a few days more was immediately effective. This signifies that the power of King Yudhiṣṭhira was loving affection, which the Lord could not deny. The almighty God is thus conquered only by loving service and nothing else. He is fully independent in all His dealings, but He voluntarily accepts obligations by the loving affection of His pure devotees.

TEXT 46

VYaaSaaŪErqìrehajE" k*-Z<aeNaad(>auTak-MaR<aa)
Pa[baeiDaTaae_PaqiTahaSaENaaRbuDYaTa éucaipaRTa")) 46))

vyäsadyair éçvarehājīaiù

kāñēenādbhuta-karmaëä

prabodhito 'pétihäsair

nābudhyata çucārpitaù

SYNONYMS

vyāsa-ādyaiù—by great sages headed by Vyāsa; *éçvara*—the almighty God; *éhä*—by the will of; *jīaiù*—by the learned; *kāñēena*—by Kṛṣṇa Himself; *adbhuta-karmaëä*—by one who performs all superhuman work; *prabodhitaù*—being solaced; *api*—although; *itihāsaiù*—by evidences from the histories; *na*—not; *abudhyata*—satisfied; *çucā arpitaù*—distressed.

TRANSLATION

King Yudhiṣṭhira, who was much aggrieved, could not be convinced, despite instructions by great sages headed by Vyāsa and the Lord Kṛṣṇa Himself, the performer of superhuman feats, and despite all historical evidence.

PURPORT

The pious King Yudhiñöhira was mortified because of the mass massacre of human beings in the Battle of Kurukñetra, especially on his account. Duryodhana was there on the throne, and he was doing well in his administration, and in one sense there was no need of fighting. But on the principle of justice Yudhiñöhira was to replace him. The whole clique of politics centered around this point, and all the kings and residents of the whole world became involved in this fight between the rival brothers. Lord Kṛṣṇa was also there on the side of King Yudhiñöhira. It is said in the *Mahābhārata, Ādi-parva* (20) that 640,000,000 men were killed in the eighteen days of the Battle of Kurukñetra, and some hundreds of thousands were missing. Practically this was the greatest battle in the world within five thousand years.

This mass killing simply to enthrone Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was too mortifying, so he tried to be convinced with evidences from histories by great sages like Vyāsa and the Lord Himself that the fight was just because the cause was just. But Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira would not be satisfied, even though he was instructed by the greatest personalities of the time. Kṛṣṇa is designated herein as the performer of superhuman actions, but in this particular instance neither He nor Vyāsa could convince King Yudhiñöhira. Does it mean that He failed to be a superhuman actor? No, certainly not. The interpretation is that the Lord as *éçvara*, or the Supersoul in the hearts of both King Yudhiñöhira and Vyāsa, performed still more superhuman action because the Lord desired it. As Supersoul of King Yudhiñöhira, He did not allow the King to be convinced by the words of Vyāsa and others, including Himself, because He desired that the King hear instructions from the dying Bhéñmadeva, who was another great devotee of the Lord. The Lord wanted that at the last stage of his material existence the great warrior Bhéñmadeva see Him personally and see his beloved grandchildren, King Yudhiñöhira, etc., now situated on the throne, and thus pass away very peacefully. Bhéñmadeva was not at all satisfied to fight against the Pāëðavas, who were his beloved fatherless grandchildren. But the *kṣatriyas* are also very stern people, and therefore he was obliged to take the side of Duryodhana because he was maintained at the expense of Duryodhana. Besides this, the Lord also desired that King Yudhiñöhira be pacified by the words of Bhéñmadeva so that the world could see that Bhéñmadeva excelled all in knowledge, including the Lord Himself.

TEXT 47

Aah raJaa DaMaRSauTaiêNTaYaNa(Sauôda& vDaMa()
Pa[ak*-TaeNaaTMaNaa ivPa[a" òehMaaehvXa& GaTa")) 47))

äha rājā dharma-sutaç

cintayan suhådäà vadham

präkåtenätmanä vipräù

sneha-moha-vaçaà gataù

SYNONYMS

äha—said; *rājā*—King Yudhiñöhira; *dharma-sutaù*—the son of Dharma (Yamarāja); *cintayan*—thinking of; *suhådäm*—of the friends; *vadham*—killing; *präkåtena*—by material conception only; *ätmanä*—by the self; *vipräù*—O *brahmana*; *sneha*—affection; *moha*—delusion; *vaçam*—being carried away by; *gataù*—having gone.

TRANSLATION

King Yudhiñöhira, son of Dharma, overwhelmed by the death of his friends, was aggrieved just like a common, materialistic man. O sages, thus deluded by affection, he began to speak.

PURPORT

King Yudhiñöhira, though he was not expected to become aggrieved like a common man, became deluded by worldly affection by the will of the Lord (just as Arjuna was apparently deluded). A man who sees knows well that the living entity is neither the body nor the mind, but is transcendental to the material conception of life. The common man thinks of violence and nonviolence in terms of the body, but that is a kind of delusion. Everyone is duty-bound according to one's occupational duties. A *kñātriya* is bound to fight for the right cause, regardless of the opposite party. In such discharge

of duty, one should not be disturbed by annihilation of the material body, which is only an external dress of the living soul. All this was perfectly known to Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, but by the will of the Lord he became just like a common man because there was another great idea behind this delusion: the King would be instructed by Bhéñma as Arjuna was instructed by the Lord Himself.

TEXT 48

**Ahae Mae PaXYaTaajaNa& ôid æ!& duraTMaNa")
PaarKYaSYaEv dehSYa bûyae Mae_+aaEih<aqhRTaa")) 48))**

aho me paçyatäjäñnaà

hådi rüðhaà durätmanaù

pärakyasyaiva dehasya

bahvyo me 'kñauhiëér hatäù

SYNONYMS

aho—O; *me*—my; *paçyata*—just see; *ajñanam*—ignorance; *hådi*—in the heart; *rüðham*—situated in; *durätmanaù*—of the sinful; *pärakyasya*—meant for others; *eva*—certainly; *dehasya*—of the body; *bahvyaù*—many, many; *me*—by me; *akñauhiëéù*—combination of military phalanxes; *hatäù*—killed.

TRANSLATION

King Yudhiñöhira said: O my lot! I am the most sinful man! Just see my heart, which is full of ignorance! This body, which is ultimately meant for others, has killed many, many phalanxes of men.

PURPORT

A solid phalanx of 21,870 chariots, 21,870 elephants, 109,650 infantry and

65,600 cavalry is called an *akñauhiëé*. And many *akñauhiëés* were killed on the Battlefield of Kurukñetra. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, as the most pious king of the world, takes for himself the responsibility for killing such a huge number of living beings because the battle was fought to reinstate him on the throne. This body is, after all, meant for others. While there is life in the body, it is meant for the service of others, and when it is dead it is meant to be eaten by dogs and jackals or maggots. He is sorry because for such a temporary body such a huge massacre was committed.

TEXT 49

**bal/iÜJaSauôinMa}aiPaTa*>a]aTa*Gauåd]uh")
Na Mae SYaaiàrYaaNMaae+aae ùiPa vzaRYauTaaYauTaE")) 49))**

bäla-dvija-suhân-mitra-

pitâ-bhrâtâ-guru-druhaù

na me syän nirayän mokñô

hy api varñäyutäyutaiù

SYNONYMS

bäla—boys; *dvi-ja*—the twice-born; *suhât*—well-wishers; *mitra*—friends; *pitâ*—parents; *bhrâtâ*—brothers; *guru*—preceptors; *druhaù*—one who has killed; *na*—never; *me*—my; *syât*—there shall be; *nirayât*—from hell; *mokñau*—liberation; *hi*—certainly; *api*—although; *varña*—years; *ayuta*—millions; *äyutaiù*—being added.

TRANSLATION

I have killed many boys, brahmanas, well-wishers, friends, parents, preceptors and brothers. Though I live millions of years, I will not be relieved from the hell that awaits me for all these sins.

PURPORT

Whenever there is a war, there is certainly a massacre of many innocent living beings, such as boys, *brahmanas* and women, whose killing is considered to be the greatest of sins. They are all innocent creatures, and in all circumstances killing of them is forbidden in the scriptures. Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira was aware of these mass killings. Similarly, there were friends, parents and preceptors also on both sides, and all of them were killed. It was simply horrible for him to think of such killing, and therefore he was thinking of residing in hell for millions and billions of years.

TEXT 50

NaENaae raj" Pa[Jaa>aTauRDaRMaRYauÖe vDaae iÜzaMa()
wiTa Mae Na Tau baeDaaYa k-LPaTae XaaSaNa& vc")) 50))

naino räjäaù prajā-bhartur

dharma-yuddhe vadho dviñām

iti me na tu bodhāya

kalpate çāsanaà vacaù

SYNONYMS

na—never; *enaù*—sins; *räjäaù*—of the king; *prajā-bhartuù*—of one who is engaged in the maintenance of the citizens; *dharma*—for the right cause; *yuddhe*—in the fight; *vadhaù*—killing; *dviñām*—of the enemies; *iti*—all these; *me*—for me; *na*—never; *tu*—but; *bodhāya*—for satisfaction; *kalpate*—they are meant for administration; *çāsanam*—injunction; *vacaù*—words of.

TRANSLATION

There is no sin for a king who kills for the right cause, who is engaged in maintaining his citizens. But this injunction is not applicable to me.

PURPORT

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira thought that although he was not actually involved in the administration of the kingdom, which was being carried on well by Duryodhana without harm to the citizens, he caused the killing of so many living beings only for his personal gain of the kingdom from the hands of Duryodhana. The killing was committed not in the course of administration but for the sake of self-aggrandizement, and as such he thought himself responsible for all the sins.

TEXT 51

ñq<aa& MaÖTabNDaUNaa& d]aehae Yaae_SaaivhaeiTQaTa")
k-MaRi>aGa*RhMaeDaqYaENaaRh& k-LPaae VYaPaaeihTauMa()) 51))

stréëää mad-dhata-bandhünää

droho yo 'säv ihotthitaù

karmabhir gâhamedhéyair

nähaà kalpo vyapohitum

SYNONYMS

stréëäm—of the women; *mat*—by me; *hata-bandhünäm*—of the friends who are killed; *drohaù*—enmity; *yaù*—that; *asau*—all those; *iha*—herewith; *utthitaù*—has accrued; *karmabhiù*—by dint of work; *gâhamedhéyaiù*—by persons engaged in material welfare; *na*—never; *aham*—I; *kalpaù*—can expect; *vyapohitum*—undoing the same.

TRANSLATION

I have killed many friends of women, and I have thus caused enmity to such an extent that it is not possible to undo it by material welfare work.

PURPORT

The *gâhamedhés* are those whose only business is to perform welfare work

for the sake of material prosperity. Such material prosperity is sometimes hampered by sinful activities, for the materialist is sure to commit sins, even unintentionally, in the course of discharging material duties. To get relief from such sinful reactions, the *Vedas* prescribe several kinds of sacrifices. It is said in the *Vedas* that by performing the Aṣvamedha-yajña (horse sacrifice) one can get relief from even *brahma-hatyā* (killing of a *brahmana*).

Yudhiñöhira Mahārāja performed this Aṣvamedha-yajña, but he thinks that even by performing such *yajñas* it is not possible to get relief from the great sins committed. In war either the husband or the brother or even the father or sons go to fight. And when they are killed, a fresh enmity is created, and thus a chain of actions and reactions increases which is not possible to be counteracted even by thousands of Aṣvamedha-yajñas.

The way of work (*karma*) is like that. It creates one action and another reaction simultaneously and thus increases the chain of material activities, binding the performer in material bondage. In the *Bhagavad-gita* (Bg. 9.27–28) the remedy is suggested that such actions and reactions of the path of work can be checked only when work is done on behalf of the Supreme Lord. The Battle of Kurukñetra was actually fought by the will of the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, as it is evident from His version, and only by His will was Yudhiñöhira placed on the throne of Hastināpura. Therefore, factually no sin whatsoever touched the Pāṇḍavas, who were only the order carriers of the Lord. For others, who declare war out of personal interest, the whole responsibility lies on them.

TEXT 52

YaQaa Pa³eNa Pa³aM>a" SaurYaa va Saurak*-TaMa()
>aUTahTYaa& TaQaEvEk-a& Na YajEMaaRíuRMahRiTa)) 52))

yathä paikena paikāmbhaù

surayä vä suräkåtam

bhüta-hatyäà tathaivaikää

na yajñair mārñöum arhati

SYNONYMS

yathä—as much as; *paikenä*—by the mud; *paika-ambhaù*—water mixed with mud; *surayä*—by wine; *vä*—either; *suräkâtam*—impurity caused by the slight touch of wine; *bhüta-hatyäm*—killing of animals; *tathä*—like that; *eva*—certainly; *ekäm*—one; *na*—never; *yajñaiù*—by the prescribed sacrifices; *mārñöum*—to counteract; *arhati*—is worthwhile.

TRANSLATION

As it is not possible to filter muddy water through mud, or purify a wine-stained pot with wine, it is not possible to counteract the killing of men by sacrificing animals.

PURPORT

Açvamedha-yajñas or *Gomedha-yajñas*, sacrifices in which a horse or a bull is sacrificed, were not, of course, for the purpose of killing the animals. Lord Caitanya said that such animals sacrificed on the altar of *yajña* were rejuvenated and a new life was given to them. It was just to prove the efficacy of the hymns of the *Vedas*. By recitation of the hymns of the *Vedas* in the proper way, certainly the performer gets relief from the reactions of sins, but in case of such sacrifices improperly done under inexpert management, surely one has to become responsible for animal sacrifice. In this age of quarrel and hypocrisy there is no possibility of performing the *yajñas* perfectly for want of expert *brahmanas* who are able to conduct such *yajñas*. Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira therefore gives a hint to performing sacrifices in the age of Kali. In the Kali-yuga the only sacrifice recommended is the performance of *hari-näma-yajña* inaugurated by Lord Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu. But one should not indulge in animal killing and counteract it by performing the *hari-näma yajña*. Those who are devotees of the Lord never kill an animal for self-interest, and (as the Lord ordered Arjuna) they do not refrain from performing the duty of a *kñätirya*. The whole purpose, therefore, is served when everything is done for the will of the Lord. This is possible only for the devotees.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Eighth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled “Prayers by Queen Kunté and Parékñit Saved.”

Chapter Nine

The Passing Away of Bhéñmadeva in the Presence of Lord Kṛṣṇa

TEXT 1

SaUTa ovac

wiTā >aqTā" Pa[Jaad]aehaTSavRDaMaRivivTSaYaa)
TaTaae ivNaXaNa& Pa[aGaad(Ya}a devv]Taae_PaTaTa()) 1))

sūta uvāca

iti bhétau prajā-drohāt

sarva-dharma-vivitsayā

tato vinaṣanaà prägäd

yatra deva-vrato 'patat

SYNONYMS

sūtaù uvāca—Sri Sūta Gosvami said; *iti*—thus; *bhétau*—being afraid of; *prajā-drohāt*—because of killing the subjects; *sarva*—all; *dharma*—acts of religion; *vivitsayā*—for understanding; *tatau*—thereafter; *vinaṣanam*—the place where the fight was held; *prägät*—he went; *yatra*—where; *deva-vratau*—Bhéñmadeva; *apatat*—lay down for passing away.

TRANSLATION

Sūta Gosvami said: Being afraid for having killed so many subjects on the

Battlefield of Kurukñetra, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira went to the scene of the massacre. There, Bhéñmadeva was lying on a bed of arrows, about to pass away.

PURPORT

In this Ninth Chapter, as it is willed by Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, Bhéñmadeva will impart instructions to King Yudhiñöhira on the subject of occupational duties. Bhéñmadeva will also offer his last prayer to the Lord on the verge of passing away from this mortal world and thus become liberated from the bondage of further material engagements. Bhéñmadeva was endowed with the power of leaving his material body at will, and his lying down on the bed of arrows was his own choice. This passing away of the great warrior attracted the attention of all the contemporary elites, and all of them assembled there to show their feelings of love, respect and affection for the great soul.

TEXT 2

**Tada Tae >a]aTar" SaveR SadìE" Sv<aR>aUizTaE")
ANvGaC^Na(rQaEivRPa[a VYaaSaDaaEMYaadYaSTaQaa)) 2))**

tadä te bhrätaraù sarve

sadaçvaiù svarëa-bhüñitaiù

anvagacchan rathair viprä

vyäsa-dhaumyädayas tathä

SYNONYMS

tadä—at that time; *te*—all of them; *bhrätaraù*—the brothers; *sarve*—all together; *sat-açvaiù*—drawn by first-class horses; *svarëa*—gold; *bhüñitaiù*—being decorated with; *anvagacchan*—followed one after another; *rathaiù*—on the chariots; *vipräù*—O *brahmanas*; *vyäsa*—the sage Vyäsa; *dhaumya*—Dhaumya; *ädayaù*—and others; *tathä*—also.

TRANSLATION

At that time all his brothers followed him on beautiful chariots drawn by first-class horses decorated with gold ornaments. With them were Vyāsa and āñis like Dhaumya [the learned priest of the Pāṇḍavas] and others.

TEXT 3

>aGavaNaiPa ivPa[zeR rQaeNa SaDaNaĀYa")
Sa TaEVYaRraecTa Na*Pa" ku-ver wv GauùkE-")) 3))

bhagavān api viprarñe

rathena sa-dhanaiījayaù

sa tair vyarocata nāpaù

kuvera iva guhyakaiù

SYNONYMS

bhagavān—the Personality of Godhead (Sri Kṛṣṇa); *api*—also; *vipra-āñe*—O sage among the *brahmanas*; *rathena*—on the chariot; *sa-dhanaiījayaù*—with Dhanaiījaya (Arjuna); *saù*—He; *taiù*—by them; *vyarocata*—appeared to be highly aristocratic; *nāpaù*—the King (Yudhiñöhira); *kuvera*—Kuvera, the treasurer of the demigods; *iva*—as; *guhyakaiù*—companions known as Guhyakas.

TRANSLATION

O sage amongst the brahmanas, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, also followed, seated on a chariot with Arjuna. Thus King Yudhiñöhira appeared very aristocratic, like Kuvera surrounded by his companions [the Guhyakas].

PURPORT

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa wanted the Pāṇḍavas to be present before Bhīṣmadeva in the most aristocratic order so that he might be pleased to see them happy at the time of his death. Kuvera is the richest of all the demigods, and herein King Yudhiṣṭhira appeared like him (Kuvera), for the procession along with Sri Kṛṣṇa was quite appropriate to the royalty of King Yudhiṣṭhira.

TEXT 4

d*îa iNaPaiTaTa& >aUMaaE idvXCYauTaiMavaMarMa()
Pa[<aeMau" Paa<@va >aqZMa& SaaNauGaa" Sah ciṣ-<aa)) 4))

dāñövä nipatitaà bhūmau

divaṣ cyutam ivāmaram

praëemuù päëòavä bhéñmaà

sānugäù saha cakriëä

SYNONYMS

dāñövä—thus seeing; *nipatitam*—lying down; *bhūmau*—on the ground; *divaù*—from the sky; *cyutam*—fallen; *iva*—like; *amaram*—demigod; *praëemuù*—bowed down; *päëòaväù*—the sons of Pāṇḍu; *bhéñmam*—unto Bhīṣma; *sa-anugäù*—with the younger brothers; *saha*—also with; *cakriëä*—the Lord (carrying the disc).

TRANSLATION

Seeing him [Bhīṣma] lying on the ground, like a demigod fallen from the sky, the Pāṇḍava King Yudhiṣṭhira, along with his younger brothers and Lord Kṛṣṇa, bowed down before him.

PURPORT

Lord Kṛṣṇa was also a younger cousin of Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira as well as

the intimate friend of Arjuna. But all the family members of the Pāṇḍavas knew Lord Kṛṣṇa as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The Lord, although conscious of His supreme position, always behaved in a humanly custom, and so He also bowed down before the dying Bhīṣmadeva as if He were one of the younger brothers of King Yudhiṣṭhira.

TEXT 5

**Ta}a b]øzRYa" SaveR devzRYaê SataMa)
raJazRYaê Ta}aaSaNa(d]íu& >arTaPau®vMa()) 5))**

tatra brahmarñayaù sarve

devarñayaç ca sattama

räjarñayaç ca taträsan

drañöuà bharata-puigavam

SYNONYMS

tatra—there; *brahma-āñayaù*—*āñis* among the *brahmanas*; *sarve*—all; *deva-āñayaù*—*āñis* among the demigods; *ca*—and; *sattama*—situated in the quality of goodness; *räja-āñayaù*—*āñis* among the kings; *ca*—and; *tatra*—in that place; *äsan*—were present; *drañöum*—just to see; *bharata*—the descendants of King Bharata; *puigavam*—the chief of.

TRANSLATION

Just to see the chief of the descendants of King Bharata [Bhīṣma], all the great souls in the universe, namely the āñis amongst the demigods, brahmanas and kings, all situated in the quality of goodness, were assembled there.

PURPORT

The *āñis* are those who have attained perfection by spiritual achievements.

Such spiritual achievements can be earned by all, whether one is a king or a mendicant. Bhéñmadeva himself was also one of the *brahmarñis* and the chief of the descendants of King Bharata. All *añis* are situated in the quality of goodness. All of them assembled there on hearing the news of the great warrior's impending death.

TEXTS 6–7

PavRTaae Naardae DaaEMYaae >aGavaNa(badraYa<a")
b*hdìae >arÜaJa" SaiXaZYaae re<auk-aSauTa")) 6))
viSai wNd]Pa[MadiñTaae Ga*TSaMadae_iSaTa")
k-+aqvaNa(GaaETaMaae_i}aê k-aEiXak-ae_Qa SaudXaRNa")) 7))

parvato nārado dhaumyo

bhagavān bādarāyaēaù

bāhadaçvo bharadvājaù

saçiñyo reëukä-sutaù

vasiñöha indrapramadas

trito gātsamado 'sitaù

kakñévān gautamo 'triç ca

kauçiko 'tha sudarçanaù

SYNONYMS

parvataù—Parvata Muni; *nāradaù*—Nārada Muni; *dhaumyaù*—Dhaumya;
bhagavān—incarnation of Godhead; *bādarāyaēaù*—Vyāsadeva;
bāhadaçvaù—Bāhadaçva; *bharadvājaù*—Bharadvāja; *sa-çiñyaù*—along
with disciples; *reëukä-sutaù*—Paraçurāma; *vasiñöhaù*—Vasiñöha;
indrapramadaù—Indrapramada; *tritaù*—Trita; *gātsamadaù*—Gātsamada;
asitaù—Asita; *kakñévān*—Kakñévān; *gautamaù*—Gautama; *atriù*—Atri;

ca—and; *kauçika*—Kauçika; *atha*—as well as; *sudarçana*—Sudarçana.

TRANSLATION

All the sages like Parvata Muni, Nārada, Dhaumya, Vyāsa the incarnation of God, Bāhadaçva, Bharadvāja and Paraçurāma and disciples, Vasiñöha, Indrapramada, Trita, Gātsamada, Asita, Kakñévän, Gautama, Atri, Kauçika and Sudarçana were present.

PURPORT

Parvata Muni: is considered to be one of the oldest sages. He is almost always a constant companion of Nārada Muni. They are also spacemen competent to travel in the air without the help of any material vehicle. Parvata Muni is also a *devarñi*, or a great sage amongst the demigods, like Nārada. He was present along with Nārada at the sacrificial ceremony of Mahārāja Janamejaya, son of Mahārāja Parékñit. In this sacrifice all the snakes of the world were to be killed. Parvata Muni and Nārada Muni are called Gandharvas also because they can travel in the air singing the glories of the Lord. Since they can travel in the air, they observed Draupadé’s *svayaàvara* ceremony (selecting of her own husband) from the air. Like Nārada Muni, Parvata Muni also used to visit the royal assembly in the heaven of King Indra. As a Gandharva, sometimes he visited the royal assembly of Kuvera, one of the important demigods. Both Nārada and Parvata were once in trouble with the daughter of Mahārāja Sāijaya. Mahārāja Sāijaya got the benediction of a son by Parvata Muni.

Nārada Muni: is inevitably associated with the narrations of the *Puranas*. He is described in the *Bhāgavatam*. In his previous life he was the son of a maidservant, but by good association with pure devotees he became enlightened in devotional service, and in the next life he became a perfect man comparable with himself only. In the *Mahābhārata* his name is mentioned in many places. He is the principle *devarñi*, or the chief sage amongst the demigods. He is the son and disciple of Brahmājé, and from him the disciplic succession in the line of Brahmā has been spread. He initiated Prahlāda Mahārāja, Dhruva Mahārāja and many celebrated devotees of the Lord. He initiated even Vyāsadeva, the author of the Vedic

literatures, and from Vyāsadeva, Madhvācārya was initiated, and thus the Madhva-sampradāya, in which the Gauḍeya-sampradāya is also included, has spread all over the universe. Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu belonged to this Madhva-sampradāya; therefore, Brahmājé, Nārada, Vyāsa, down to Madhva, Caitanya and the Gosvamis all belonged to the same line of disciplic succession. Nārada-jé has instructed many kings from time immemorial. In the *Bhāgavatam* we can see that he instructed Prahlaḍa Mahārāja while he was in the womb of his mother, and he instructed Vasudeva, father of Kṛṣṇa, as well as Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira.

Dhaumya: A great sage who practiced severe penances at Utkocaka Tērtha and was appointed royal priest of the Pāṇḍava kings. He acted as the priest in many religious functions of the Pāṇḍavas (*saṁskāra*), and also each of the Pāṇḍavas was attended by him at the betrothal of Draupadé. He was present even during the exile of the Pāṇḍavas and used to advise them in circumstances when they were perplexed. He instructed them how to live incognito for one year, and his instructions were strictly followed by the Pāṇḍavas during that time. His name is mentioned also when the general funeral ceremony was performed after the Battle of Kurukṣetra. In the *Anuśāśana-parva* of *Mahābhārata* (127.15–16), he gave religious instructions very elaborately to Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira. He was actually the right type of priest of a householder, for he could guide the Pāṇḍavas on the right path of religion. A priest is meant for guiding the householder progressively in the right path of *ācrama-dharma*, or the occupational duty of a particular caste. There is practically no difference between the family priest and the spiritual master. The sages, saints and *brahmanas* were especially meant for such functions.

Bādarāyaṇa (*Vyāsadeva*): He is known as Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa-dvaipāyana, Dvaipāyana, Satyavati-suta, Pārāçarya, Pārāçarātmaja, Bādarāyaṇa, Vedavyāsa, etc. He was the son of Mahāmuni Pārāçara in the womb of Satyavati prior to her betrothal with Mahārāja Çantanu, the father of the great general Grandfather Bhīṣmadeva. He is a powerful incarnation of Nārāyaṇa, and he broadcasts the Vedic wisdom to the world. As such, Vyāsadeva is offered respects before one chants the Vedic literature, especially the *Puranas*. Çukadeva Gosvami was his son, and *āñis* like Vaiçampāyana were his disciples for different branches of the *Vedas*. He is

the author of the great epic *Mahābhārata* and the great transcendental literature *Bhāgavatam*. The *Brahma-sūtras*—the *Vedānta-sūtras*, or *Bādarāyaṇa-sūtras*—were compiled by him. Amongst sages he is the most respected author by dint of severe penances. When he wanted to record the great epic *Mahābhārata* for the welfare of all people in the age of Kali, he was feeling the necessity of a powerful writer who could take up his dictation. By the order of Brahmājé, Sri Gaëeçajé took up the charge of noting down the dictation on the condition that Vyāsadeva would not stop dictation for a moment. The *Mahābhārata* was thus compiled by the joint endeavor of Vyāsa and Gaëeça.

By the order of his mother, Satyavati, who was later married to Mahārāja Çantanu, and by the request of Bhéñmadeva, the eldest son of Mahārāja Çantanu by his first wife, the Ganges, he begot three brilliant sons, whose names are Dhātarañöra, Pääòu and Vidura. The *Mahābhārata* was compiled by Vyāsadeva after the Battle of Kurukñetra and after the death of all the heroes of *Mahābhārata*. It was first spoken in the royal assembly of Mahārāja Janamejaya, the son of Mahārāja Parékñit.

Bāhadaçva: An ancient sage who used to meet Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira now and then. First of all he met Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira at Kāmyavana. This sage narrated the history of Mahārāja Nala. There is another Bāhadaçva, who is the son of the Ikñväku dynasty (*Mahābhārata*, *Vana-parva* 209.4–5)

Bharadvāja: He is one of the seven great *āñis* and was present at the time of the birth ceremony of Arjuna. The powerful *āñi* sometimes undertook severe penances on the shore of the Ganges, and his *āçrama* is still celebrated at Prayāgadhāma. It is learned that this *āñi*, while taking bath in the Ganges, happened to meet Ghātacé, one of the beautiful society girls of heaven, and thus he discharged semen, which was kept and preserved in an earthen pot and from which Droëa was born. So Droëäcārya is the son of Bharadvāja Muni. Others say that Bharadvāja the father of Droëa is a different person from Maharñi Bharadvāja. He was a great devotee of Brahmä. Once he approached Droëäcārya and requested him to stop the Battle of Kurukñetra.

Paraçurāma, or *Reëukäsuta*: He is the son of Maharñi Jamadagni and

Srīmaté Reëukā. Thus he is also known as Reëukāsuta. He is one of the powerful incarnations of God, and he killed the *kñātriya* community as a whole twenty-one times. With the blood of the *kṣatriyas* he pleased the souls of his forefathers. Later on he underwent severe penances at the Mahendra Parvata. After taking the whole earth from the *kṣatriyas*, he gave it in charity to Kaçyapa Muni. Paraçurāma instructed the *Dhanur-veda*, or the science of fighting, to Droëäcārya because he happened to be a *brahmana*. He was present during the coronation of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, and he celebrated the function along with other great *āñis*.

Paraçurāma is so old that he met both Rāma and Kṛṣṇa at different times. He fought with Rāma, but he accepted Kṛṣṇa as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. He also praised Arjuna when he saw him with Kṛṣṇa. When Bhéñma refused to marry Ambā, who wanted him to become her husband, Ambā met Paraçurāma, and by her request only, he asked Bhéñmadeva to accept her as his wife. Bhéñma refused to obey his order, although he was one of the spiritual masters of Bhéñmadeva. Paraçurāma fought with Bhéñmadeva when Bhéñma neglected his warning. Both of them fought very severely, and at last Paraçurāma was pleased with Bhéñma and gave him the benediction of becoming the greatest fighter in the world.

Vasiñöhha: The great celebrated sage among the *brahmanas*, well known as the Brahmarñi Vasiñöhadeva. He is a prominent figure in both the *Ramayana* and *Mahābhārata* periods. He celebrated the coronation ceremony of the Personality of Godhead Sri Rāma. He was present also on the Battlefield of Kurukñetra. He could approach all the higher and lower planets, and his name is also connected with the history of Hiraṇyakaśipu. There was a great tension between him and Viçvämitra, who wanted his *kāmadhenu*, wish-fulfilling cow. Vasiñöhha Muni refused to spare his *kāmadhenu*, and for this Viçvämitra killed his one hundred sons. As a perfect *brahmana* he tolerated all the taunts of Viçvämitra. Once he tried to commit suicide on account of Viçvämitra's torture, but all his attempts were unsuccessful. He jumped from a hill, but the stones on which he fell became a stack of cotton, and thus he was saved. He jumped into the ocean, but the waves washed him ashore. He jumped into the river, but the river also washed him ashore. Thus all his suicide attempts were unsuccessful. He is also one of the seven *āñis* and husband of Arundhaté,

the famous star.

Indrapramada: Another celebrated *āñi*.

Trita: One of the three sons of Prajāpati Gautama. He was the third son, and his other two brothers were known as Ekāt and Dvīta. All the brothers were great sages and strict followers of the principles of religion. By dint of severe penances they were promoted to Brahmaloka (the planet where Brahmājē lives). Once Trita Muni fell into a well. He was an organizing worker of many sacrifices, and as one of the great sages he also came to show respect to Bhēñmajē at his deathbed. He was one of the seven sages in the Varuēaloka. He hailed from the Western countries of the world. As such, most probably he belonged to the European countries. At that time the whole world was under one Vedic culture.

Gātsamada: One of the sages of the heavenly kingdom. He was a close friend of Indra, the King of heaven, and was as great as Bāhaspati. He used to visit the royal assembly of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, and he also visited the place where Bhēñmadeva breathed his last. Sometimes he explained the glories of Lord Siva before Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. He was the son of Vitahavya, and he resembled in features the body of Indra. Sometimes the enemies of Indra mistook him to be Indra and arrested him. He was a great scholar of the *Āg-veda*, and thus he was highly respected by the *brahmana* community. He lived a life of celibacy and was powerful in every respect.

Asita: There was a king of the same name, but herein the Asita mentioned is the Asita Devala Rsi, a great powerful sage of the time. He explained to his father 1,500,000 verses from the *Mahābhārata*. He was one of the members in the snake sacrifice of Mahārāja Janamejaya. He was also present during the coronation ceremony of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira along with other great *āñis*. He also gave Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira instructions while he was on the Aijana Hill. He was also one of the devotees of Lord Siva.

Kakñévān: One of the sons of Gautama Muni and the father of the great sage Candakausika. He was one of the members of Parliament of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira.

Atri: Atri Muni was a great *brahmana* sage and was one of the mental sons of Brahmäjé. Brahmäjé is so powerful that simply by thinking of a son he can have it. These sons are known as *mānasa-putras*. Out of seven *mānasa-putras* of Brahmäjé and out of the seven great *brahmana* sages, Atri was one. In his family the great Pracetās were also born. Atri Muni had two *kñatriya* sons who became kings. King Arthama is one of them. He is counted as one of the twenty-one *prajāpatīs*. His wife's name was Anasuya, and he helped Mahārāja Parékñit in his great sacrifices.

Kauçika: One of the permanent *āñi* members in the royal assembly of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. He sometimes met Lord Kṛṣṇa. There are several other sages of the same name.

Sudarçana: This wheel which is accepted by the Personality of Godhead (Viṣṇu or Kṛṣṇa) as His personal weapon is the most powerful weapon, greater than the *brahmāstras* or similar other disastrous weapons. In some of the Vedic literatures it is said that Agnideva, the fire-god, presented this weapon to Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, but factually this weapon is eternally carried by the Lord. Agnideva presented this weapon to Kṛṣṇa in the same way that Rukmiëé was given by Mahārāja Rukma to the Lord. The Lord accepts such presentations from His devotees, even though such presentations are eternally His property. There is an elaborate description of this weapon in the *Ādi-parva* of the *Mahābhārata*. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa used this weapon to kill Çiçupāla, a rival of the Lord. He also killed Çālva by this weapon, and sometimes He wanted His friend Arjuna to use it to kill his enemies (*Mahābhārata*, *Virāöa-parva* 56.3).

TEXT 8

ANYae c MauNaYaae b]øNa(b]øraTaadYaae_Mal/a")
iXaZYaEåPaeTaa AaJaGMau" k-XYaPaai®rSaadYa")) 8))

anye ca munayo brahman

brahmarätädayo 'maläù

çiñyair upetä äjagmuù

kaçyapàìgirasādayaù

SYNONYMS

anye—many others; *ca*—also; *munayaù*—sages; *brahman*—O *brahmanas*; *brahmarāta*—Çukadeva Gosvami; *ādayaù*—and such others; *amalāù*—completely purified; *çiñyaiù*—by the disciples; *upetāù*—accompanied; *ājagmuù*—arrived; *kaçyapa*—Kaçyapa; *äìgirasa*—Äìgirasa; *ādayaù*—others.

TRANSLATION

And many others like Çukadeva Gosvami and other purified souls, Kaçyapa and Äìgirasa and others, all accompanied by their respective disciples, arrived there.

PURPORT

Çukadeva Gosvami (Brahmarāta): The famous son and disciple of Sri Vyāsadeva, who taught him first the *Mahābhārata* and then *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Çukadeva Gosvami recited 1,400,000 verses of the *Mahābhārata* in the councils of the Gandharvas, Yakñas and Rākñasas, and he recited *Srimad-Bhagavatam* for the first time in the presence of Mahārāja Parékñit. He thoroughly studied all the Vedic literatures from his great father. Thus he was a completely purified soul by dint of his extensive knowledge in the principles of religion. From *Mahābhārata, Sabhā-parva* (4.11) it is understood that he was also present in the royal assembly of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira and at the fasting of Mahārāja Parékñit. As a bona fide disciple of Sri Vyāsadeva, he inquired from his father very extensively about religious principles and spiritual values, and his great father also satisfied him by teaching him the *yoga* system by which one can attain the spiritual kingdom, the difference between fruitive work and empiric knowledge, the ways and means of attaining spiritual realization, the four *āçramas* (namely the student life, the householder’s life, the retired life and the renounced life), the sublime position of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, the process of seeing Him eye to eye, the bona fide candidate for receiving knowledge, the consideration of the five elements, the unique position of intelligence, the consciousness of the material nature and the

living entity, the symptoms of the self-realized soul, the working principles of the material body, the symptoms of the influential modes of nature, the tree of perpetual desire, and psychic activities. Sometimes he went to the sun planet with the permission of his father and Nārada-jé. Descriptions of his travel in space are given in the *Çānti-parva* of the *Mahābhārata* (332). At last he attained the transcendental realm. He is known by different names like Araëeya, Aruëisuta, Vaiyäsaki and Vyäsätmaja.

Kaçyapa: One of the *prajāpatis*, the son of Maréci and one of the sons-in-law of Prajāpati Dakña. He is the father of the gigantic bird Garuòà, who was given elephants and tortoises as eatables. He married thirteen daughters of Prajāpati Dakña, and their names are Aditi, Diti, Danu, Kāñöhä, Ariñöä, Surasä, Ilä, Muni, Krodhavaçä, Tämrä, Surabhi, Saramä and Timi. He begot many children, both demigods and demons, by those wives. From his first wife, Aditi, all the twelve Ädityas were born; one of them is Vāmana, the incarnation of Godhead. This great sage, Kaçyapa, was also present at the time of Arjuna's birth. He received a presentation of the whole world from Paraçuräma, and later on he asked Paraçuräma to go out of the world. His other name is Ariñöanemi. He lives on the northern side of the universe.

Äigirasa: He is the son of Maharñi Äigirä and is known as Båhaspati, the priest of the demigods. It is said that Droëäcärya was his partial incarnation. Çukräcärya was the spiritual master of the demons, and Båhaspati challenged him. His son is Kaca, and he delivered the fire weapon first to Bharadväja Muni. He begot six sons (like the fire-god) by his wife Candramäsé, one of the reputed stars. He could travel in space, and therefore he could present himself even in the planets of Brahmaloaka and Indraloaka. He advised the King of heaven, Indra, about conquering the demons. Once he cursed Indra, who thus had to become a hog on the earth and was unwilling to return to heaven. Such is the power of the attraction of the illusory energy. Even a hog does not wish to part with its earthly possessions in exchange for a heavenly kingdom. He was the religious preceptor of the natives of different planets.

TEXT 9

TaaNa(SaMaeTaaNa(Maha>aaGaaNauPal/>Ya vSaUtaMa")

PaUJaYaaMaaSa DaMaRjae deXak-al/iv>aaGaivTa()) 9))

tän sametän mahä-bhägän

upalabhya vasüttamaù

püjayäm äsa dharma-jïo

deça-käla-vibhägavit

SYNONYMS

tän—all of them; *sametän*—assembled together; *mahä-bhägän*—all greatly powerful; *upalabhya*—having received; *vasu-uttamaù*—the best among the Vasus (Bhéñmadeva); *püjayäm äsa*—welcomed; *dharma-jïaù*—one who knows religious principles; *deça*—place; *käla*—time; *vibhäga-vit*—one who knows the adjustment of place and time.

TRANSLATION

Bhéñmadeva, who was the best amongst the eight Vasus, received and welcomed all the great and powerful āñis who were assembled there, for he knew perfectly all the religious principles according to time and place.

PURPORT

Expert religionists know perfectly well how to adjust religious principles in terms of time and place. All the great *ācāryas* or religious preachers or reformers of the world executed their mission by adjustment of religious principles in terms of time and place. There are different climates and situations in different parts of the world, and if one has to discharge his duties to preach the message of the Lord, he must be expert in adjusting things in terms of the time and place. Bhéñmadeva was one of the twelve great authorities in preaching this cult of devotional service, and therefore he could receive and welcome all the powerful sages assembled there at his deathbed from all parts of the universe. He was certainly unable at that time to welcome and receive them physically because he was neither at his

home nor in a normal healthy condition. But he was quite fit by the activities of his sound mind, and therefore he could utter sweet words with hearty expressions, and all of them were well received. One can perform one's duty by physical work, by mind and by words. And he knew well how to utilize them in the proper place, and therefore there was no difficulty for him to receive them, although physically unfit.

TEXT 10

k*-Z<a& c TaTPa[>aavj AaSaqNa& JaGadqirMa()
ôidSQa& PaUJaYaaMaaSa MaaYaYaaePaataivGa]hMa()) 10))

kâñëaà ca tat-prabhäva-jïa

äsënaà jagat-éçvaram

hâdi-sthaà püjayäm äsa

mäyayopätta-vigraham

SYNONYMS

kâñëam—unto Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *ca*—also; *tat*—of Him; *prabhäva-jïa*—the knower of the glories (Bhéñma); *äsënam*—sitting; *jagat-éçvaram*—the Lord of the universe; *hâdi-stham*—situated in the heart; *püjayäm äsa*—worshiped; *mäyayä*—by internal potency; *upätta*—manifested; *vigraham*—a form.

TRANSLATION

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is situated in everyone's heart, yet He manifests His transcendental form by His internal potency. This very Lord was sitting before Bhéñmadeva, and since Bhéñmadeva knew of His glories, he worshiped Him duly.

PURPORT

The Lord's omnipotency is displayed by His simultaneous presence in every place. He is present always in His eternal abode Goloka Våndävana, and still He is present in everyone's heart and even within every invisible atom. When He manifests His eternal transcendental form in the material world, He does so by His internal potency. The external potency, or the material energy, has nothing to do with His eternal form. All these truths were known to Sri Bhéñmadeva, who worshiped Him accordingly.

TEXT 11

Paa<@uPau}aaNauPaaSaqNaaNa(Pa[é[YaPa[eMaSa®TaaNa()
A>YaaciaNauraGaaé[ErNDaq>aUTaeNa c+auza)) 11))

päëòu-putrân upäsénân

praçraya-prema-saìgatân

abhyäcañöänurägäçrair

andhébhütena cakñuñä

SYNONYMS

päëòu—the late father of Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira and his brothers; *putrân*—the sons of; *upäsénân*—sitting silently nearby; *praçraya*—being overtaken; *prema*—in feelings of love; *saìgatân*—having gathered; *abhyäcañöä*—congratulated; *anuräga*—feelingly; *açraiù*—by tears of ecstasy; *andhébhütena*—overwhelmed; *cakñuñä*—with his eyes.

TRANSLATION

The sons of Mahäräja Päëòu were sitting silently nearby, overtaken with affection for their dying grandfather. Seeing this, Bhéñmadeva congratulated them with feeling. There were tears of ecstasy in his eyes, for he was overwhelmed by love and affection.

PURPORT

When Mahārāja Pāṇḍu died, his sons were all small children, and naturally they were brought up under the affection of elderly members of the royal family, specifically by Bhīṣmadeva. Later on, when the Pāṇḍavas were grown up, they were cheated by cunning Duryodhana and company, and Bhīṣmadeva, although he knew that the Pāṇḍavas were innocent and were unnecessarily put into trouble, could not take the side of the Pāṇḍavas for political reasons. At the last stage of his life, when Bhīṣmadeva saw his most exalted grandsons, headed by Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira, sitting very gently at his side, the great warrior-grandfather could not check his loving tears, which were automatically flowing from his eyes. He remembered the great tribulations suffered by his most pious grandsons. Certainly he was the most satisfied man because of Yudhiṣṭhira's being enthroned in place of Duryodhana, and thus he began to congratulate them.

TEXT 12

**Ahae k-íMahae_NYaaYYa& YaŪUYa& DaMaRNaNdNaa")
JaivTau& NaahRQa i©-í& ivPa[DaMaaRCYauTaaé[Yaa")) 12))**

aho kaññāṁ aho 'nyāyāṁ

yad yūyāṁ dharma-nandanāṁ

jévituaṁ nārhaṭha kliññāṁ

vipra-dharmācyutāçrayāṁ

SYNONYMS

aho—oh; *kaññāṁ*—what terrible sufferings; *aho*—oh; *anyāyāṁ*—what terrible injustice; *yad*—because; *yūyāṁ*—all of you good souls; *dharma-nandanāṁ*—sons of religion personified; *jévitum*—to remain alive; *na*—never; *arhaṭha*—deserve; *kliññāṁ*—suffering; *vipra*—*brahmanas*; *dharma*—piety; *acyuta*—God; *āçrayāṁ*—being protected by.

TRANSLATION

Bhéñmadeva said: Oh, what terrible sufferings and what terrible injustices you good souls suffer for being the sons of religion personified. You did not deserve to remain alive under those tribulations, yet you were protected by the brahmanas, God and religion.

PURPORT

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was disturbed due to the great massacre in the Battle of Kurukñetra. Bhéñmadeva could understand this, and therefore he spoke first of the terrible sufferings of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. He was put into difficulty by injustice only, and the Battle of Kurukñetra was fought just to counteract this injustice. Therefore, he should not regret the great massacre. He wanted to point out particularly that they were always protected by the *brahmanas*, the Lord and religious principles. As long as they were protected by these three important items, there was no cause of disappointment. Thus Bhéñmadeva encouraged Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira to dissipate his despondency. As long as a person is fully in cooperation with the wishes of the Lord, guided by the bona fide *brahmanas* and Vaiñëavas and strictly following religious principles, one has no cause for despondency, however trying the circumstances of life. Bhéñmadeva, as one of the authorities in the line, wanted to impress this point upon the Pääëavas.

TEXT 13

**Sa&iSQaTae_iTarQae Paa<@aE Pa*Qaa bal/Pa[Jaa vDaU")
YauZMaTk*-Tae bhUNa(©e-XaaNa(Pa[aáa Taaek-vTaq Mauhu")) 13))**

saàsthite 'tirathe päëòau

pãthä bãla-prajä vadhüù

yuñmat-kâte bahün kleçän

präptä tokavaté muhuù

SYNONYMS

saàsthite—after the demise; *ati-rathe*—of the great general; *päëòau*—Päëòu; *pâthä*—Kunté; *bäla-prajä*—having young children; *vadhüù*—my daughter-in-law; *yuñmat-kâte*—on your account; *bahün*—multifarious; *kleçän*—afflictions; *präptä*—underwent; *toka-vaté*—in spite of having grown-up boys; *muhuù*—constantly.

TRANSLATION

As far as my daughter-in-law Kunté is concerned, upon the great General Päëòu's death, she became a widow with many children, and therefore she suffered greatly. And when you were grown up she suffered a great deal also because of your actions.

PURPORT

The sufferings of Kuntédevé are doubly lamented. She suffered greatly because of early widowhood and to get her minor children brought up in the royal family. And when her children were grown up, she continued to suffer because of her sons' actions. So her sufferings continued. This means that she was destined to suffer by providence, and this one has to tolerate without being disturbed.

TEXT 14

Sav| k-al/k*-Ta& MaNYae >avTaa& c YadiPa[YaMa()
SaPaal/ae YaÜXae I/aek-ae vaYaaeirv gaNaavil/")) 14))

sarvaà käla-kâtaà manye

bhavatäà ca yad-apriyam

sapälo yad-vaçe loko

väyor iva ghanävaliù

SYNONYMS

sarvam—all this; *kāla-kātam*—done by inevitable time; *manye*—I think; *bhavatām ca*—for you also; *yat*—whatever; *apriyam*—detestable; *sa-pālaù*—with the rulers; *yat-vaçe*—under the control of that time; *lokaù*—everyone in every planet; *vāyoù*—the wind carries; *iva*—as; *ghana-āvaliù*—a line of clouds.

TRANSLATION

In my opinion, this is all due to inevitable time, under whose control everyone in every planet is carried, just as the clouds are carried by the wind.

PURPORT

There is control by time all over the space within the universe, as there is control by time all over the planets. All the big gigantic planets, including the sun, are being controlled by the force of air, as the clouds are carried by the force of air. Similarly, the inevitable *kāla*, or time, controls even the action of the air and other elements. Everything, therefore, is controlled by the supreme *kāla*, a forceful representative of the Lord within the material world. Thus Yudhiñöhira should not be sorry for the inconceivable action of time. Everyone has to bear the actions and reactions of time as long as one is within the conditions of the material world. Yudhiñöhira should not think that he had committed sins in his previous birth and is suffering the consequence. Even the most pious has to suffer the condition of material nature. But a pious man is faithful to the Lord, for he is guided by the bona fide *brahmana* and Vaiñëava following the religious principles. These three guiding principles should be the aim of life. One should not be disturbed by the tricks of eternal time. Even the great controller of the universe, Brahmäjé, is also under the control of that time; therefore, one should not grudge being thus controlled by time despite being a true follower of religious principles.

TEXT 15

**Ya}a DaMaRSauTaae raJaa GadaPaai<av*Rk-aedr")
k*-Z<aae_ñq Gaai<@v& caPa& SauôTk*-Z<aSTaTaae ivPaTa()) 15))**

yatra dharma-suto räjä

gadä-päëir våkodaraù

kãñëo 'stré gäëòivaà cäpaà

suhât kãñëas tato vipat

SYNONYMS

yatra—where there is; *dharma-sutaù*—the son of Dharmaräja; *räjä*—the King; *gadä-päëiù*—with his mighty club in hand; *våkodaraù*—Bhéma; *kãñëaù*—Arjuna; *astré*—carrier of the weapon; *gäëòivam*—Gäëòéva; *cäpam*—bow; *suhât*—well-wisher; *kãñëaù*—Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead; *tataù*—thereof; *vipat*—reverse.

TRANSLATION

O how wonderful is the influence of inevitable time. It is irreversible—otherwise, how can there be reverses in the presence of King Yudhiñöhira, the son of the demigod controlling religion; Bhéma, the great fighter with a club; the great bowman Arjuna with his mighty weapon Gäëòéva; and above all, the Lord, the direct well-wisher of the Pääòavas?

PURPORT

As far as the material or spiritual resources were required, there was no scarcity in the case of the Pääòavas. Materially they were well equipped because two great warriors, namely Bhéma and Arjuna, were there. Spiritually the King himself was the symbol of religion, and above all of them the Personality of Godhead, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, was personally concerned with their affairs as the well-wisher. And yet there were so many reverses on the side of the Pääòavas. Despite the power of pious acts, the power of personalities, the power of expert management and the power of weapons under the direct supervision of Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Pääòavas suffered so many practical reverses, which can only be explained as due to the influence of

kāla, inevitable time. *Kāla* is identical with the Lord Himself, and therefore the influence of *kāla* indicates the inexplicable wish of the Lord Himself. There is nothing to be lamented when a matter is beyond the control of any human being.

TEXT 16

**Na ùSYa k-ihRicd]aJaNa(PauMaaNa(ved iviDaiTSaTaMa()
YaiÜiJajaSaYaa YauÇ-a MauùINTa k-vYaae_iPa ih)) 16))**

na hy asya karhicit räjan

pumän veda vidhitsitam

yad vijijäsayä yuktä

muhyanti kavayo 'pi hi

SYNONYMS

na—never; *hi*—certainly; *asya*—His; *karhicit*—whatsoever; *räjan*—O King; *pumän*—anyone; *veda*—knows; *vidhitsitam*—plan; *yad*—which; *vijijäsayä*—with exhaustive inquiries; *yuktä*—being engaged; *muhyanti*—bewildered; *kavaya*—great philosophers; *api*—even; *hi*—certainly.

TRANSLATION

O King, no one can know the plan of the Lord [Sri Kṛṣṇa]. Even though great philosophers inquire exhaustively, they are bewildered.

PURPORT

The bewilderment of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira over his past sinful acts and the resultant sufferings, etc., is completely negated by the great authority Bhéñma (one of the twelve authorized persons). Bhéñma wanted to impress upon Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira that since time immemorial no one, including such demigods as Siva and Brahmä, could ascertain the real plan

of the Lord. So what can we understand about it? It is useless also to inquire about it. Even the exhaustive philosophical inquiries of sages cannot ascertain the plan of the Lord. The best policy is simply to abide by the orders of the Lord without argument. The sufferings of the Pāṇḍavas were never due to their past deeds. The Lord had to execute the plan of establishing the kingdom of virtue, and therefore His own devotees suffered temporarily in order to establish the conquest of virtue. Bhīṣmadeva was certainly satisfied by seeing the triumph of virtue, and he was glad to see King Yudhiṣṭhira on the throne, although he himself fought against him. Even a great fighter like Bhīṣma could not win the Battle of Kurukṣetra because the Lord wanted to show that vice cannot conquer virtue, regardless of who tries to execute it. Bhīṣmadeva was a great devotee of the Lord, but he chose to fight against the Pāṇḍavas by the will of the Lord because the Lord wanted to show that a fighter like Bhīṣma cannot win on the wrong side.

TEXT 17

TaSMaidd& dEvTaN}a& VYavSYa >arTazR>a)
TaSYaaNauivihTaae_NaaQaa NaaQa Paaih Pa[Jaa" Pa[>aae)) 17))

tasmād idaṁ daiva-tantraṁ

vyavasya bharatarñabha

tasyānuvihito 'nāthā

nātha pāhi prajāuṁ prabho

SYNONYMS

tasmāt—therefore; *idaṁ*—this; *daiva-tantram*—enchantment of providence only; *vyavasya*—ascertaining; *bharata-āñabha*—O best among the descendants of Bharata; *tasya*—by Him; *anuvihitaṁ*—as desired; *anāthāṁ*—helpless; *nātha*—O master; *pāhi*—just take care of; *prajāuṁ*—of the subjects; *prabho*—O Lord.

TRANSLATION

O best among the descendants of Bharata [Yudhiñöhira], I maintain, therefore, that all this is within the plan of the Lord. Accepting the inconceivable plan of the Lord, you must follow it. You are now the appointed administrative head, and, my lord, you should now take care of those subjects who are now rendered helpless.

PURPORT

The popular saying is that a housewife teaches the daughter-in-law by teaching the daughter. Similarly, the Lord teaches the world by teaching the devotee. The devotee does not have to learn anything new from the Lord because the Lord teaches the sincere devotee always from within. Whenever, therefore, a show is made to teach the devotee, as in the case of the teachings of *Bhagavad-gita*, it is for teaching the less intelligent men. A devotee's duty, therefore, is to ungrudgingly accept tribulations from the Lord as a benediction. The Pääòavas were advised by Bhéñmadeva to accept the responsibility of administration without hesitation. The poor subjects were without protection due to the Battle of Kurukñetra, and they were awaiting the assumption of power by Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. A pure devotee of the Lord accepts tribulations as favors from the Lord. Since the Lord is absolute, there is no mundane difference between the two.

TEXT 18

Wz vE >aGavaNa(Saa+aadaŪae NaaraYa<a" PauMaaNa()
MaaehYaNMaaYaYaa l/aek&- GaU!êriTa v*iZ<azu)) 18))

eña vai bhagavān sākñād

ädya nārāyaëaù pumān

mohayan mäyayā lokaà

güòhaç carati vñëiñu

SYNONYMS

eñau—this; *vai*—positively; *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *sākñāt*—original; *ādyaù*—the first; *nārāyaëau*—the Supreme Lord (who lies down on the water); *pumān*—the supreme enjoyer; *mohayan*—bewildering; *māyayā*—by His self-created energy; *lokam*—the planets; *güòhaù*—who is inconceivable; *carati*—moves; *vāñëiñu*—among the Vāñëi family.

TRANSLATION

This Sri Kṛṣṇa is no other than the inconceivable, original Personality of Godhead. He is the first Nārāyaṇa, the supreme enjoyer. But He is moving amongst the descendants of King Vāñëi just like one of us and He is bewildering us with His self-created energy.

PURPORT

The Vedic system of acquiring knowledge is the deductive process. The Vedic knowledge is received perfectly by disciplic succession from authorities. Such knowledge is never dogmatic, as ill conceived by less intelligent persons. The mother is the authority to verify the identity of the father. She is the authority for such confidential knowledge. Therefore, authority is not dogmatic. In the *Bhagavad-gita* this truth is confirmed in the Fourth Chapter (Bg. 4.2), and the perfect system of learning is to receive it from authority. The very same system is accepted universally as truth, but only the false arguer speaks against it. For example, modern spacecraft fly in the sky, and when scientists say that they travel to the other side of the moon, men believe these stories blindly because they have accepted the modern scientists as authorities. The authorities speak, and the people in general believe them. But in the case of Vedic truths, they have been taught not to believe. Even if they accept them they give a different interpretation. Each and every man wants a direct perception of Vedic knowledge, but foolishly they deny it. This means that the misguided man can believe one authority, the scientist, but will reject the authority of the *Vedas*. The result is that people have degenerated.

Here is an authority speaking about Sri Kṛṣṇa as the original Personality of Godhead and the first Nārāyaṇa. Even such an impersonalist as Ācārya Čaikara has said in the beginning of his commentation on the *Bhagavad-gīta* that Nārāyaṇa, the Personality of Godhead, is beyond the material creation. The universe is one of the material creations, but Nārāyaṇa is transcendental to such material paraphernalia.

Bhéñmadeva is one of the twelve *mahājanas* who know the principles of transcendental knowledge. His confirmation of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa's being the original Personality of Godhead is also corroborated by the impersonalist Čaikara. All other *ācāryas* have also confirmed this statement, and thus there is no chance of not accepting Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa as the original Personality of Godhead. Bhéñmadeva says that He is the first Nārāyaṇa. This is also confirmed by Brahmājé in the *Bhāgavatam* (10.14.14). Kṛṣṇa is the first Nārāyaṇa. In the spiritual world (Vaikuntha) there are unlimited numbers of Nārāyaṇas, who are all the same Personality of Godhead and are considered to be the plenary expansions of the original Personality of Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa. The first form of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa first expands Himself as the form of Baladeva, and Baladeva expands in so many other forms, such as Saṅkarṣṇa, Pradyumna, Aniruddha, Vāsudeva, Nārāyaṇa, Puruṇa, Rāma and Nṛsiṃha. All these expansions are one and the same *viṣṇu-tattva*, and Sri Kṛṣṇa is the original source of all the plenary expansions. He is therefore the direct Personality of Godhead. He is the creator of the material world, and He is the predominating Deity known as Nārāyaṇa in all the Vaikuntha planets. Therefore, His movements amongst human beings is another sort of bewilderment. The Lord therefore says in the *Bhagavad-gīta* that foolish persons consider Him to be one of the human beings without knowing the intricacies of His movements.

The bewilderment regarding Sri Kṛṣṇa is due to the action of His twofold internal and external energies upon the third one, called marginal energy. The living entities are expansions of His marginal energy, and thus they are sometimes bewildered by the internal energy and sometimes by the external energy. By internal energetic bewilderment, Sri Kṛṣṇa expands Himself into unlimited numbers of Nārāyaṇas and exchanges or accepts transcendental loving service from the living entities in the transcendental world. And by His external energetic expansions, He incarnates Himself in

the material world amongst the men, animals or demigods to reestablish His forgotten relation with the living entities in different species of life. Great authorities like Bhéñma, however, escape His bewilderment by the mercy of the Lord.

TEXT 19

**ASYaaNau>aav& >aGavaNa(ved GauùTaMa& iXav")
devizRNaaRrd" Saa+aaÜGavaNa(k-iPal/ae Na*Pa)) 19))**

asyänubhävaaà bhagavän

veda guhyatamaà çivaù

devarñir nāradaù sākñäd

bhagavän kapilo nāpa

SYNONYMS

asya—of Him; *anubhävam*—glories; *bhagavän*—the most powerful; *veda*—knows; *guhya-tamam*—very confidentially; *çivaù*—Lord Siva; *deva-āñiù*—the great sage among the demigods; *nāradaù*—Nārada; *sākñät*—directly; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *kapilaù*—Kapila; *nāpa*—O King.

TRANSLATION

O King, Lord Siva, Nārada the sage amongst the demigods, and Kapila, the incarnation of Godhead, all know very confidentially about His glories through direct contact.

PURPORT

Pure devotees of the Lord are all *bhāvas*, or persons who know the glories of the Lord in different transcendental loving services. As the Lord has innumerable expansions of His plenary form, there are innumerable pure devotees of the Lord, who are engaged in the exchange of service of

different humors. Ordinarily there are twelve great devotees of the Lord, namely Brahmā, Nārada, Siva, Kumāra, Kapila, Manu, Prahlāda, Bhéñma, Janaka, Çukadeva Gosvami, Bali Mahārāja and Yamarāja. Bhéñmadeva, although one of them, has mentioned only three important names of the twelve who know the glories of the Lord. Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Öhäkura, one of the great *äcäryas* in the modern age, explains that *anubhāva*, or the glory of the Lord, is first appreciated by the devotee in ecstasy manifesting the symptoms of perspiring, trembling, weeping, bodily eruptions, etc., which are further enhanced by steady understanding of the glories of the Lord. Such different understandings of *bhāvas* are exchanged between Yaçodā and the Lord (binding the Lord by ropes) and in the chariot driving by the Lord in the exchange of love with Arjuna. These glories of the Lord are exhibited in His being subordinated before His devotees, and that is another feature of the glories of the Lord. Çukadeva Gosvami and the Kumāras, although situated in the transcendental position, became converted by another feature of *bhāva* and turned into pure devotees of the Lord. Tribulations imposed upon the devotees by the Lord constitute another exchange of transcendental *bhāva* between the Lord and the devotees. The Lord says “I put My devotee into difficulty, and thus the devotee becomes more purified in exchanging transcendental *bhāva* with Me.” Placing the devotee into material troubles necessitates delivering him from the illusory material relations. The material relations are based on reciprocation of material enjoyment, which depends mainly on material resources. Therefore, when material resources are withdrawn by the Lord, the devotee is cent percent attracted toward the transcendental loving service of the Lord. Thus the Lord snatches the fallen soul from the mire of material existence. Tribulations offered by the Lord to His devotee are different from the tribulations resulting from vicious action. All these glories of the Lord are especially known to the great *mahājanas* like Brahmā, Siva, Nārada, Kapila, Kumāra and Bhéñma, as mentioned above, and one is able to grasp it by their grace.

TEXT 20

**Ya& MaNYaSae MaaTaule/Ya& iPa[Ya& iMa}a& SauôtaMaMa()
Ak-rae" Saicv& dUTa& SaaEôdadQa SaariQaMa()) 20))**

yaà manyase mätuleyaà

priyaà mitraà suhåttamam

akaroù sacivaà dütaà

sauhådäd atha särathim

SYNONYMS

yam—the person; *manyase*—you think; *mätuleyam*—maternal cousin; *priyam*—very dear; *mitram*—friend; *suhåt-tamam*—ardent well-wisher; *akaroù*—executed; *sacivam*—counsel; *dütam*—messenger; *sauhådät*—by good will; *atha*—thereupon; *särathim*—charioteer.

TRANSLATION

O King, that personality whom, out of ignorance only, you thought to be your maternal cousin, your very dear friend, well-wisher, counselor, messenger, benefactor, etc., is that very Personality of Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, although acting as the cousin, brother, friend, well-wisher, counselor, messenger, benefactor, etc., of the Pāñḍavas, was still the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Out of His causeless mercy and favor upon His unalloyed devotees, He performs all kinds of service, but that does not mean that He has changed His position as the Absolute Person. To think of Him as an ordinary man is the grossest type of ignorance.

TEXT 21

**SavaRTMaNa" SaMad*Xaae ùÜYaSYaaNahx(k*-Tae")
TaTk*-Ta& MaiTavEzMYa& iNarvÛSYa Na KvicTa()) 21))**

sarvātmanaù sama-dāṇo

hy advayasyānahaikāteu

tat-kātaà mati-vaiñamyāà

niravadyasya na kvacit

SYNONYMS

sarva-ātmanaù—of one who is present in everyone’s heart; *sama-dāṣaù*—of one who is equally kind to one and all; *hi*—certainly; *advayasya*—of the Absolute; *anahaikāteu*—free from all material identity of false ego; *tat-kātam*—everything done by Him; *mati*—consciousness; *vaiñamyam*—differentiation; *niravadyasya*—freed from all attachment; *na*—never; *kvacit*—at any stage.

TRANSLATION

Being the Absolute Personality of Godhead, He is present in everyone’s heart. He is equally kind to everyone, and He is free from the false ego of differentiation. Therefore whatever He does is free from material inebriety. He is equibalanced.

PURPORT

Because He is absolute, there is nothing different from Him. He is *kaivalya*; there is nothing except Himself. Everything and everyone is the manifestation of His energy, and thus He is present everywhere by His energy, being nondifferent from it. The sun is identified with every inch of the sun rays and every molecular particle of the rays. Similarly, the Lord is distributed by His different energies. He is Paramātmā, or the Supersoul, present in everyone as the supreme guidance, and therefore He is already the chariot driver and counsel of all living beings. When He, therefore, exhibits Himself as chariot driver of Arjuna, there is no change in His exalted position. It is the power of devotional service only that demonstrates Him as the chariot driver or the messenger. Since He has nothing to do with the material conception of life because He is absolute spiritual identity, there is for Him no superior or inferior action. Being the

Absolute Personality of Godhead, He has no false ego, and so He does not identify Himself with anything different from Him. The material conception of ego is equibalanced in Him. He does not feel, therefore, inferior by becoming the chariot driver of His pure devotee. It is the glory of the pure devotee that only he can bring about service from the affectionate Lord.

TEXT 22

**TaQaaPYaek-aNTa>açe-zu PaXYa >aUPaaNauk-iMPaTaMa()
YaNMae_SaU&STYaJaTa" Saa+aaTk*-Z<aae dXaRNaMaaGaTa")) 22))**

tathäpy ekänta-bhakteñu

paçya bhüpanukampitam

yan me 'süàs tyajataù säkñät

kãñëo darçanam ägataù

SYNONYMS

tathäpi—still; *ekänta*—unflinching; *bhakteñu*—unto the devotees; *paçya*—see here; *bhü-pa*—O King; *anukampitam*—how sympathetic; *yat*—for which; *me*—my; *asün*—life; *tyajataù*—ending; *säkñät*—directly; *kãñëaù*—the Personality of Godhead; *darçanam*—in my view; *ägataù*—has kindly come.

TRANSLATION

Yet, despite His being equally kind to everyone, He has graciously come before me while I am ending my life, for I am His unflinching servitor.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord, the Absolute Personality of Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa, although equal to everyone, is still more inclined to His unflinching devotee who is completely surrendered and knows no one else as his protector and

master. Having unflinching faith in the Supreme Lord as one's protector, friend and master is the natural condition of eternal life. A living entity is so made by the will of the Almighty that he is most happy when placing himself in a condition of absolute dependence.

The opposite tendency is the cause of falldown. The living entity has this tendency of falling down by dint of misidentifying himself as fully independent to lord it over the material world. The root cause of all troubles is there in false egotism. One must draw towards the Lord in all circumstances.

The appearance of Lord Kṛṣṇa at the deathbed of Bhéñmajé is due to his being an unflinching devotee of the Lord. Arjuna had some bodily relation with Kṛṣṇa because the Lord happened to be his maternal cousin. But Bhéñma had no such bodily relation. Therefore the cause of attraction was due to the intimate relation of the soul. Yet because the relation of the body is very pleasing and natural, the Lord is more pleased when He is addressed as the son of Mahārāja Nanda, the son of Yaçodä, the lover of Rādhäräëé. This affinity by bodily relation with the Lord is another feature of reciprocating loving service with the Lord. Bhéñmadeva is conscious of this sweetness of transcendental humor, and therefore he likes to address the Lord as Vijaya-Sakhe, Pārtha-Sakhe, etc., exactly like Nanda-nandana or Yaçodä-nandana. The best way to establish our relation in transcendental sweetness is to approach Him through His recognized devotees. One should not try to establish the relation directly; there must be a via medium which is transparent and competent to lead us to the right path.

TEXT 23

>aç-yaveXYa MaNaæe YaiSMaNa(vaca YaàaMa k-ITaRYaNa()
TYaJaNa(k-le/vr& YaaæGaq MauCYaTae k-aMak-MaRi>a")) 23))

bhaktyäveçya mano yasmin

väcä yan-näma kértayan

tyajan kalevaraà yogé

mucyate käma-karmabhiù

SYNONYMS

bhaktyä—with devout attention; *äveçya*—meditating; *manaù*—mind; *yasmin*—in whose; *väcä*—by words; *yat*—Kṛṣṇa; *näma*—holy name; *kértayan*—by chanting; *tyajan*—quitting; *kalevaram*—this material body; *yogé*—the devotee; *mucyate*—gets release; *käma-karmabhiù*—from fruitive activities.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead, who appears in the mind of the devotee by attentive devotion and meditation and by chanting of the holy name, releases the devotee from the bondage of fruitive activities at the time of his quitting the material body.

PURPORT

Yoga means concentration of the mind detached from all other subject matter. And actually such concentration is *samädhi*, or cent percent engagement in the service of the Lord. And one who concentrates his attention in that manner is called a *yogé*. Such a *yogé* devotee of the Lord engages himself twenty-four hours daily in the service of the Lord so that his whole attention is engrossed with the thoughts of the Lord in ninefold devotional service, namely hearing, chanting, remembering, worshiping, praying, becoming a voluntary servant, carrying out orders, establishing a friendly relationship, or offering all that one may possess, in the service of the Lord. By such practice of *yoga*, or linking up in the service of the Lord, one is recognized by the Lord Himself, as it is explained in the *Bhagavad-gita* concerning the highest perfectional stage of *samädhi*. The Lord calls such a rare devotee the best amongst all the *yogés*. Such a perfect *yogé* is enabled by the divine grace of the Lord to concentrate his mind upon the Lord with a perfect sense of consciousness, and thus by chanting His holy name before quitting the body the *yogé* is at once transferred by the internal energy of the Lord to one of the eternal planets where there is no question of material life and its concomitant factors. In material existence a

living being has to endure the material conditions of threefold miseries, life after life, according to his fruitive work. Such material life is produced by material desires only. Devotional service to the Lord does not kill the natural desires of the living being, but they are applied in the right cause of devotional service. This qualifies the desire to be transferred to the spiritual sky. General Bhéñmadeva is referring to a particular type of *yoga* called *bhakti-yoga*, and he was fortunate enough to have the Lord directly in his presence before he quitted his material body. He therefore desired that the Lord stay before his view in the following verses.

TEXT 24

Sa devdevae >aGavaNa(Pa[Taq+aTaa&
k-le/vr& Yaavidd& ihNaaeMYahMa()
Pa[SaàhaSaaâ<al/aecNaaeçSa,
NMau%aMbuJaae DYaaNaPaQaêTau>auRJa")) 24))

sa deva-devo bhagavän pratékñatää

kalevaraà yävad idaà hinomy aham

prasanna-häsäruëa-locanollasan-

mukhämbujo dhyäna-pathaç catur-bhujaù

SYNONYMS

saù—He; *deva-devaù*—the Supreme Lord of the lords; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *pratékñatäm*—may kindly wait; *kalevaram*—body; *yävat*—as long as; *idam*—this (material body); *hinomi*—may quit; *aham*—I; *prasanna*—cheerful; *häsa*—smiling; *aruëa-locana*—eyes red like the morning sun; *ullasat*—beautifully decorated; *mukha-ambujaù*—the lotus flower of His face; *dhyäna-pathaù*—in the path of my meditation; *catur-bhujaù*—the four-handed form of Nārāyaṇa (the worshipable Deity of Bhéñmadeva).

TRANSLATION

May my Lord, who is four-handed and whose beautifully decorated lotus face, with eyes as red as the rising sun, is smiling, kindly await me at that moment when I quit this material body.

PURPORT

Bhéñmadeva knew well that Lord Kṛṣṇa is the original Nārāyaṇa. His worshipable Deity was four-handed Nārāyaṇa, but he knew that four-handed Nārāyaṇa is a plenary expansion of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Indirectly he desired Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa to manifest Himself in His four-handed feature of Nārāyaṇa. A Vaiñëava is always humble in his behavior. Although it was cent percent certain that Bhéñmadeva was approaching *Vaikuntha-dhāma* just after leaving his material body, still as a humble Vaiñëava he desired to see the beautiful face of the Lord, for after quitting the present body he might not be in a position to see the Lord any more. A Vaiñëava is not puffed up, although the Lord guarantees His pure devotee entrance into His abode. Here Bhéñmadeva says, “as long as I do not quit this body.” This means that the great General would quit the body by his own will; he was not being forced by the laws of nature. He was so powerful that he could stay in his body as long as he desired. He got this benediction from his father. He desired that the Lord stay before him in His four-handed Nārāyaṇa feature so that he might concentrate upon Him and thus be in trance in that meditation. Then his mind might be sanctified with thinking of the Lord. Thus he did not mind wherever he might go. A pure devotee is never very anxious to go back to the kingdom of God. He entirely depends on the good will of the Lord. He is equally satisfied even if the Lord desires him to go to hell. The only desire that a pure devotee entertains is that he may always be in rapt attention with thinking of the lotus feet of the Lord, regardless. Bhéñmadeva wanted this much only: that his mind be absorbed in thinking of the Lord and that he pass away thus. That is the highest ambition of a pure devotee.

TEXT 25

SaUTa ovac

YauidaiïrSTadak-<YaR XaYaaNa& XarPaÅre)

APa*C^iÜivDaaNDaMaarNa*zq<aa& caNaué*<vTaaMa()) 25))

sūta uvāca

yudhiñöhiraś tad ākarēya

ṣayānāḥ ṣara-paijare

apācchat vividhān dharmān

āñēēāḥ cānuṣāēvatām

SYNONYMS

sūtaḥ uvāca—Sri Sūta Gosvami said; *yudhiñöhiraḥ*—King Yudhiñöhira; *tat*—that; *ākarēya*—hearing; *ṣayānam*—lying down; *ṣara-paijare*—on the bed of arrows; *apācchat*—asked; *vividhān*—multifarious; *dharmān*—duties; *āñēēām*—of the *āñis*; *ca*—and; *anuṣāēvatām*—hearing after.

TRANSLATION

Sūta Gosvami said: Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, after hearing Bhéñmadeva speak in that appealing tone, asked him, in the presence of all the great āñis, about the essential principles of various religious duties.

PURPORT

Bhéñmadeva, speaking in that appealing tone, convinced Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira that he was very soon passing away. And Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was inspired by Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa to ask him of the principles of religion. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa inspired Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira to ask Bhéñmadeva in the presence of many great sages, indicating thereby that the Lord’s devotee like Bhéñmadeva, although apparently living as a worldly man, is far superior to many great sages, even Vyāsadeva. Another point is that Bhéñmadeva at that time was not only lying on a deathbed of arrows, but was greatly aggrieved because of that state. One should not have asked him any question at that time, but Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa wanted to prove that His pure devotees are always sound in body and mind by dint of spiritual enlightenment, and thus in any circumstances a devotee of the Lord is in

perfect order to speak of the right way of life. Yudhiñöhira also preferred to solve his problematic questions by asking Bhéñmadeva rather than ask anyone else present there who was seemingly more learned than Bhéñmadeva. This is all due to the arrangement of the great wheel-carrier Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, who establishes the glories of His devotee. The father likes to see the son become more famous than himself. The Lord declares very emphatically that worship of His devotee is more valuable than the worship of the Lord Himself.

TEXT 26

PauāzSv>aavivihTaaNa(YaQaav<a| YaQaaé[MaMa()
vEraGYaraGaaePaaiDa>YaaMaaManaTaae>aYal/+a<aaNa()) 26))

puruṣa-sva-bhāva-vihitān

yathā-varēaà yathāçramam

vairāgya-rāgopādhibhyām

āmnāto bhaya-lakñāēn

SYNONYMS

puruṣa—the human being; *sva-bhāva*—by his own acquired qualities; *vihitān*—prescribed; *yathā*—according to; *varēam*—classification of castes; *yathā*—according to; *āçramam*—orders of life; *vairāgya*—detachment; *rāga*—attachment; *upādhibhyām*—out of such designations; *āmnāta*—systematically; *ubhaya*—both; *lakñāēn*—symptoms.

TRANSLATION

At Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira’s inquiry, Bhéñmadeva first defined all the classifications of castes and orders of life in terms of the individual’s qualifications. Then he systematically, in twofold divisions, described counteraction by detachment and interaction by attachment.

PURPORT

The conception of four castes and four orders of life, as planned by the Lord Himself (Bg. 4.13), is to accelerate transcendental qualities of the individual person so that he may gradually realize his spiritual identity and thus act accordingly to get free from material bondage, or conditional life. In almost all the *Puranas* the subject matter is described in the same spirit, and so also in the *Mahābhārata* it is more elaborately described by Bhéñmadeva in the *Çānti-parva*, beginning from the sixtieth chapter.

The *varëāçrama-dharma* is prescribed for the civilized human being just to train him to successfully terminate human life. Self-realization is distinguished from the life of the lower animals engaged in eating, sleeping, fearing and mating. Bhéñmadeva advised for all human beings nine qualifications: (1) not to become angry, (2) not to lie, (3) to equally distribute wealth, (4) to forgive, (5) to beget children only by one's legitimate wife, (6) to be pure in mind and hygienic in body, (7) not to be inimical toward anyone, (8) to be simple, and (9) to support servants or subordinates. One cannot be called a civilized person without acquiring the above-mentioned preliminary qualities. Besides these, the *brahmanas* (the intelligent men), the administrative men, the mercantile community and the laborer class must acquire special qualities in terms of occupational duties mentioned in all the Vedic scriptures. For the intelligent men, controlling the senses is the most essential qualification. It is the basis of morality. Sex indulgence even with a legitimate wife must also be controlled, and thereby family control will automatically follow. An intelligent man abuses his great qualifications if he does not follow the Vedic way of life. This means he must seriously make a study of the Vedic literatures, especially of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* and the *Bhagavad-gita*. For learning Vedic knowledge, one must approach a person who is cent percent engaged in devotional service. He must not do things which are forbidden in the *sastras*. A person cannot be a teacher if he drinks or smokes. In the modern system of education the teacher's academic qualification is taken into consideration without evaluation of his moral life. Therefore, the result of education is misuse of high intelligence in so many ways.

The *kñatriya*, the member of the administrative class, is especially advised to give charity *and not to accept charity in any circumstances*. Modern administrators raise subscriptions for some political functions, but never give charity to the citizens in any state function. It is just the reverse in the injunctions of the *sastras*. The administrative class must be well versed in the *sastras*, but must not take to the profession of teachers. *The administrators should never pretend to become nonviolent* and thereby go to hell. When Arjuna wanted to become a nonviolent coward on the Battlefield of Kurukñetra, he was severely chastised by Lord Kṛṣṇa. The Lord degraded Arjuna at that time to the status of an uncivilized man for his avowed acceptance of the cult of nonviolence. The administrative class must be personally trained in military education. Cowards should not be elevated to the presidential throne by dint of numerical votes only. The monarchs were all chivalrous personalities, and therefore monarchy should be maintained provided the monarch is regularly trained in the occupational duties of a king. *In fighting, the king or the president should never return home without being hurt by the enemy*. The so-called king of today never visits the warfield. He is very much expert in artificially encouraging the fighting strength in the hope of false national prestige. As soon as the administrative class is turned into a gang of mercantile and laborer men, the whole machinery of government becomes polluted.

The *vaisyas*, the members of the mercantile communities, are especially advised to protect the cows. Cow protection means increasing the milk productions, namely curd and butter. Agriculture and distribution of the foodstuff are the primary duties of the mercantile community backed by education in Vedic knowledge and trained to give in charity. As the *kṣatriyas* were given charge of the protection of the citizens, *vaisyas* were given the charge of the protection of animals. Animals are never meant to be killed. Killing of animals is a symptom of barbarian society. For a human being, agricultural produce, fruits and milk are sufficient and compatible foodstuffs. The human society should give more attention to animal protection. The productive energy of the laborer is misused when he is occupied by industrial enterprises. Industry of various types cannot produce the essential needs of man, namely rice, wheat, grains, milk, fruits and vegetables. The production of machines and machine tools increases the artificial living fashion of a class of vested interests and keeps

thousands of men in starvation and unrest. This should not be the standard of civilization.

The *çüdra* class is less intelligent and should have no independence. They are meant for rendering sincere service to the three higher sections of the society. The *çüdra* class can attain all comforts of life simply by rendering service to the higher classes. It is especially enjoined that a *çüdra* should never bank money. As soon as the *sudras* accumulate wealth, it will be misused for sinful activities in wine, women and gambling. *Wine, women and gambling indicate that the population is degraded to less than çüdra quality.* The higher castes should always look after the maintenance of the *sudras*, and they should provide them with old and used garments. A *çüdra* should not leave his master when the master is old and invalid, and the master should keep the servants satisfied in all respects. The *sudras* must first of all be satisfied by sumptuous food and clothing before any sacrifice is performed. In this age so many functions are held by spending millions, *but the poor laborer is not sumptuously fed or given charity, clothing, etc.* The laborers are thus dissatisfied, and so they make agitation.

The *varëas* are, so to speak, classifications of different occupations, and *äçrama-dharma* is gradual progress on the path of self-realization. Both are interrelated, and one is dependent on the other. The main purpose of *äçrama-dharma* is to awaken knowledge and detachment. The *brahmacäre äçrama* is the training ground for the prospective candidates. In this *äçrama* it is instructed that this material world is not actually the home of the living being. The conditioned souls under material bondage are prisoners of matter, and therefore self-realization is the ultimate aim of life. The whole system of *äçrama-dharma* is a means to detachment. One who fails to assimilate this spirit of detachment is allowed to enter into family life with the same spirit of detachment. Therefore, one who attains detachment may at once adopt the fourth order, namely, renounced, and thus live on charity only, not to accumulate wealth, but just to keep body and soul together for ultimate realization. Household life is for *one who is attached*, and the *vänaprastha* and *sannyäsa* orders of life are for *those who are detached* from material life. The *brahmacäre-äçrama* is especially meant for training both the attached and detached.

TEXT 27

daNaDaMaaRNa(raJaDaMaaRNa(Maae+aDaMaaRNa(iv>aaGaXa")
ñqDaMaaRNa(>aGavÖMaaRNa(SaMaaSaVYaaSaYaaeGaTa")) 27))

dāna-dharmān rāja-dharmān

mokṣa-dharmān vibhāgaçau

stré-dharmān bhagavad-dharmān

samāsa-vyāsa-yogataù

SYNONYMS

dāna-dharmān—the acts of charity; *rāja-dharmān*—pragmatic activities of the kings; *mokṣa-dharmān*—the acts for salvation; *vibhāgaçau*—by divisions; *stré-dharmān*—duties of women; *bhagavat-dharmān*—the acts of the devotees; *samāsa*—generally; *vyāsa*—explicitly; *yogataù*—by means of.

TRANSLATION

He then explained, by divisions, acts of charity, the pragmatic activities of a king and activities for salvation. Then he described the duties of women and devotees, both briefly and extensively.

PURPORT

To give charity is one of the householder's main functions, and he should be prepared to give in charity at least fifty percent of his hard-earned money. A *brahmacāré*, or student, should perform sacrifices, a householder should give charity, and a person in the retired life or in the renounced order should practice penances and austerities. Those are the general functions of all the *āçramas*, or orders of life on the path of self-realization. In the *brahmacāré* life the training is sufficiently imparted so that one may understand that the world as property belongs to the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead. No one, therefore, can claim to be the proprietor

of anything in the world. Therefore, in the life of a householder, which is a sort of license for sex enjoyment, one must give in charity for the service of the Lord. Everyone's energy is generated or borrowed from the reservoir of energy of the Lord; therefore, the resultant actions of such energy must be given to the Lord in the shape of transcendental loving service for Him. As the rivers draw water from the sea through the clouds and again go down to the sea, similarly our energy is borrowed from the supreme source, the Lord's energy, and it must return to the Lord. That is the perfection of our energy. The Lord, therefore, in the *Bhagavad-gita* (9.27) says that whatever we do, whatever we undergo as penance, whatever we sacrifice, whatever we eat or whatever we give in charity must be offered to Him (the Lord). That is the way of utilizing our borrowed energy. When our energy is utilized in that way, our energy is purified from the contamination of material inebrieties, and thus we become fit for our original natural life of service to the Lord.

Rāja-dharma is a great science, unlike modern diplomacy for political supremacy. The kings were trained systematically to become munificent and not merely be tax collectors. They were trained to perform different sacrifices only for the prosperity of the subjects. To lead the *prajā*s to the attainment of salvation was a great duty of the king. The father, the spiritual master and the king are not to become irresponsible in the matter of leading their subjects to the path of ultimate liberation from birth, death, diseases and old age. When these primary duties are properly discharged, there is no need of government of the people, by the people. In modern days the people in general occupy the administration by the strength of manipulated votes, but they are never trained in the primary duties of the king, and that is also not possible for everyone. Under the circumstances the untrained administrators play havoc to make the subjects happy in all respects. On the other hand, these untrained administrators gradually become rogues and thieves and increase the taxation to finance a top-heavy administration that is useless for all purposes. Actually the qualified *brahmanas* are meant to give direction to the kings for proper administration in terms of the scriptures like the *Manu-saṁhitā* and *Dharma-sastras* of Parāçara. A typical king is the ideal of the people in general, and if the king is pious, religious, chivalrous and munificent, the citizens generally follow him. Such a king is not a lazy sensuous person

living at the cost of the subjects, but alert always to kill thieves and dacoits. The pious kings were not merciful to dacoits and thieves in the name of nonsensical *ahisā* (nonviolence). The thieves and dacoits were punished in an exemplary way so that in the future no one would dare commit such nuisances in an organized form. Such thieves and dacoits were never meant for administration as they are now.

The taxation law was simple. There was no force, no encroachment. The king had a right to take one fourth of the production made by the subject. The king had a right to claim a fourth of one's allotted wealth. One would never grudge parting with it because due to the pious king and religious harmony there was enough natural wealth, namely grains, fruits, flowers, silk, cotton, milk, jewels, minerals, etc., and therefore no one was materially unhappy. The citizens were rich in agriculture and animal husbandry, and therefore they had enough grains, fruits and milk without any artificial needs of soaps and toilets, cinemas and bars.

The king had to see that the reserved energy of humanity was properly utilized. Human energy is meant not exactly for fulfilling animal propensities, but for self-realization. The whole government was specifically designed to fulfill this particular purpose. As such, the king had to select properly the cabinet ministers, but not on the strength of voting background. The ministers, the military commanders and even the ordinary soldiers were all selected by personal qualification, and the king had to supervise them properly before they were appointed to their respective posts. The king was especially vigilant to see that the *tapasvīs*, or persons who sacrificed everything for disseminating spiritual knowledge, were never disregarded. *The king knew well that the Supreme Personality of Godhead never tolerates any insult to His unalloyed devotees.* Such *tapasvīs* were trusted leaders even of the rogues and thieves, who would never disobey the orders of *tapasvīs*. The king would give special protection to illiterates, the helpless and widows of the state. Defense measures were arranged previous to any attack by the enemies. The taxing process was easy, and it was not meant for squandering, but was for strengthening the reserve fund. The soldiers were recruited from all parts of the world, and they were trained for special duties.

As far as salvation is concerned, one has to conquer the principles of lust, anger, unlawful desires, avarice and bewilderment. To get freedom from anger, one should learn how to forgive. To be free from unlawful desires one should not make plans. By spiritual culture one is able to conquer sleep. By tolerance only can one conquer desires and avarice. Disturbances from various diseases can be avoided by regulated diets. By self-control one can be free from false hopes, and money can be saved by avoiding undesirable association. By practice of *yoga* one can control hunger, and worldliness can be avoided by culturing the knowledge of impermanence. Dizziness can be conquered by rising up, and false arguments can be conquered by factual ascertainment. Talkativeness can be avoided by gravity and silence, and by prowess one can avoid fearfulness. Perfect knowledge can be obtained by self-cultivation. One must be free from lust, avarice, anger, dreaming, etc., to actually attain the path of salvation.

As far as the women class are concerned, they are accepted as a power of inspiration for men. As such, women are more powerful than men. Mighty Julius Caesar was controlled by a Cleopatra. Such powerful women are controlled by shyness. Therefore, shyness is important for women. Once this control valve is loosened, women can create havoc in society by adultery. Adultery means production of unwanted children known as *varëa-saïkara*, who disturb the world.

The last item taught by Bhéñmadeva was the process of pleasing the Lord. We are all eternal servants of the Lord, and when we forget this essential part of our nature we are put into material conditions of life. The simple process of pleasing the Lord (for the householders especially) is to install the Deity of the Lord at home. By concentrating on the Deity, one may progressively go on with the daily routine work. Worshiping the Deity at home, serving the devotee, hearing the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, residing in a holy place and chanting the holy name of the Lord are all inexpensive items by which one can please the Lord. Thus the subject matter was explained by the grandfather to his grandchildren.

TEXT 28

DaMaaRQaRk-aMaMaae+aa&ê SahaePaaYaaNa(YaQaa MauNae)

NaaNaa:YaaNaeiTahaSaezu v<aRYaaMaaSa TatvivTa()) 28))

dharmārtha-kāma-mokṣāḥ ca

sahopāyān yathā mune

nānākhyānetihāseṇu

varēyām āsa tattvavit

SYNONYMS

dharma—occupational duties; *artha*—economic development; *kāma*—fulfillment of desires; *mokṣān*—ultimate salvation; *ca*—and; *saha*—along with; *upāyān*—means; *yathā*—as it is; *mune*—O sage; *nānā*—various; *ākhyāna*—by recitation of historical narrations; *itihāseṇu*—in the histories; *varēyām āsa*—described; *tattva-vit*—one who knows the truth.

TRANSLATION

Then he described the occupational duties of different orders and statuses of life, citing instances from history, for he was himself well acquainted with the truth.

PURPORT

Incidents mentioned in the Vedic literatures, such as the *Puranas*, *Mahābhārata* and *Ramayana* are factual historical narrations that took place sometime in the past, although not in any chronological order. Such historical facts, being instructive for ordinary men, were assorted without chronological reference. Besides that, they happen on different planets, nay, in different universes, and thus the description of the narrations is sometimes measured by three dimensions. We are simply concerned with the instructive lessons of such incidents, even though they are not in order by our limited range of understanding. Bhéṇmadeva described such narrations before Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira in reply to his different questions.

TEXT 29

DaMa| Pa[vdTaSTaSYa Sa k-al/" Pa[TYauPaiSQaTa")
Yaae YaaeiGaNaX^NdMa*TYaaevaRiH^TaSTaUtaraYa<a")) 29))

dharmāḥ pravadataḥ tasya

sa kālāḥ pratyupasthitaḥ

yo yoginaḥ chanda-mātyor

vāichitas tūttarāyaḥ

SYNONYMS

dharmam—occupational duties; *pravadataḥ*—while describing; *tasya*—his; *saḥ*—that; *kālāḥ*—time; *pratyupasthitaḥ*—exactly appeared; *yaḥ*—that is; *yoginaḥ*—for the mystics; *chanda-mātyor*—of one who dies according to one's own selection of time; *vāichitaḥ*—is desired by; *tu*—but; *uttarāyaḥ*—the period when the sun runs on the northern horizon.

TRANSLATION

While Bhéṇmadeva was describing occupational duties, the sun's course ran into the northern hemisphere. This period is desired by mystics who die at their will.

PURPORT

The perfect *yogés* or mystics can leave the material body at their own sweet will at a suitable time and go to a suitable planet desired by them. In the *Bhagavad-gita* (8.24) it is said that self-realized souls who have exactly identified themselves with the interest of the Supreme Lord can generally leave the material body during the time of the fire-god's effulgence and when the sun is in the northern horizon, and thus achieve the transcendental sky. In the *Vedas* these times are considered auspicious for quitting the body, and they are taken advantage of by the expert mystics

who have perfected the system. Perfection of *yoga* means attainment of such supermental states as to be able to leave the material body as desired. *Yogés* can also reach any planet within no time without a material vehicle. The *yogés* can reach the highest planetary system within a very short time, and this is impossible for the materialist. Even attempting to reach the highest planet will take millions of years at a speed of millions of miles per hour. This is a different science, and Bhéñmadeva knew well how to utilize it. He was just waiting for the suitable moment to quit his material body, and the golden opportunity arrived when he was instructing his noble grandsons, the Pääòavas. He thus prepared himself to quit his body before the exalted Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the pious Pääòavas and the great sages headed by Bhagavān Vyāsa, etc., all great souls.

TEXT 30

**TadaePaSa&ôTYa iGar" Sahó<aq,
ivRMauć-Sa® & MaNa AaidPaUåze)
k*-Z<ae I/SaTPaqTaPaŞe= cTau>auRJae
Paur" iSQaTae_Maqil/Tad*GVYaDaarYaTa()) 30))**

tadopasaàhâtya giraù sahasraëér

vimukta-saigaà mana ädi-püruñe

kãñëe lasat-péta-paöe catur-bhuje

puraù sthite 'mélita-dåg vyadhärayat

SYNONYMS

tadä—at that time; *upasaàhâtya*—withdrawing; *giraù*—speech; *sahasraëéù*—Bhéñmadeva (who was expert in thousands of sciences and arts); *vimukta-saigam*—completely freed from everything else; *manaù*—mind; *ädi-püruñe*—unto the original Personality of Godhead; *kãñëe*—unto Kṛṣṇa; *lasat-péta-paöe*—decorated with yellow garments; *catur-bhuje*—unto the four-handed original Nārāyaṇa; *puraù*—just before; *sthite*—standing; *amélita*—widespread; *dåk*—vision; *vyadhärayat*—fixed.

TRANSLATION

Thereupon that man who spoke on different subjects with thousands of meanings and who fought on thousands of battlefields and protected thousands of men, stopped speaking and, being completely freed from all bondage, withdrew his mind from everything else and fixed his wide-open eyes upon the original Personality of Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa, who stood before him, four-handed, dressed in yellow garments that glittered and shined.

PURPORT

In the momentous hour of leaving his material body, Bhéñmadeva set the glorious example concerning the important function of the human form of life. *The subject matter which attracts the dying man becomes the beginning of his next life.* Therefore, if one is absorbed in thoughts of the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, he is sure to go back to Godhead without any doubt. This is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita* (8.5–15):

5: And whoever, at the time of death, quits his body remembering Me alone, at once attains My nature. Of this there is no doubt.

6: Whatever state of being one remembers when he quits his body, that state he will attain without fail.

7: Therefore, Arjuna, you should always think of Me in the form of Kṛṣṇa and at the same time carry out your prescribed duty of fighting. With your activities dedicated to Me and your mind and intelligence fixed on Me, you will attain Me without doubt.

8: He who meditates on the Supreme Personality of Godhead, his mind constantly engaged in remembering Me, undeviated from the path, he, O Pārtha [Arjuna], is sure to reach Me.

9: One should meditate upon the Supreme Person as the one who knows everything, as He who is the oldest, who is the controller, who is smaller than the smallest, who is the maintainer of everything, who is beyond all

material conception, who is inconceivable, and who is always a person. He is luminous like the sun and, being transcendental, is beyond this material nature.

10: One who, at the time of death, fixes his life air between the eyebrows and in full devotion engages himself in remembering the Supreme Lord will certainly attain to the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

11: Persons learned in the *Vedas*, who utter *oàkàra* and who are great sages in the renounced order, enter into Brahman. Desiring such perfection, one practices celibacy. I shall now explain to you this process by which one may attain salvation.

12: The yogic situation is that of detachment from all sensual engagements. Closing all the doors of the senses and fixing the mind on the heart and the life air at the top of the head, one establishes himself in *yoga*.

13: After being situated in this *yoga* practice and vibrating the sacred syllable *oà*, the supreme combination of letters, if one thinks of the Supreme Personality of Godhead and quits his body, he will certainly reach the spiritual planets.

14: For one who remembers Me without deviation, I am easy to obtain, O son of Pàthà, because of his constant engagement in devotional service.

15: After attaining Me, the great souls, who are *yogés* in devotion, never return to this temporary world, which is full of miseries, because they have attained the highest perfection.

Sri Bhéñmadeva attained the perfection of quitting his body at will and was fortunate enough to have Lord Kṛṣṇa, the object of his attention, personally present at the time of death. He therefore fixed his open eyes upon Him. He wanted to see Sri Kṛṣṇa for a long time out of his spontaneous love for Him. Because he was a pure devotee, he had very little to do with the detailed performance of yogic principles. Simple *bhakti-yoga* is enough to bring about perfection. Therefore, the ardent desire of Bhéñmadeva was to see the *person* of Lord Kṛṣṇa, the most lovable object, and by the grace of

the Lord, Sri Bhéñmadeva had this opportunity at the last stage of his breathing.

TEXT 31

ivéuÖYaa Daar<aYaa hTaaéu>a,
STadq+aYaEvaéu GaTaaYauDaé[Ma")
iNav*taSaveRiNd]Yav*itaiv>a]Ma,
STauíav JaNYa& ivSa*JaÅNaadRNaMa()) 31))

viçuddhayä dhäraëayä hatäçubhas

tad-ékñayaiväçu gatä-yudha-çramaù

nivåtta-sarvendriya-våtti-vibhramas

tuñöäva janyaà visåjaï janärdanam

SYNONYMS

viçuddhayä—by purified; *dhäraëayä*—meditation; *hata-açubhaù*—one who has minimized the inauspicious qualities of material existence; *tat*—Him; *ékñayä*—by looking on; *eva*—simply; *äçu*—immediately; *gatä*—having gone away; *yudha*—from the arrows; *çramaù*—fatigue; *nivåtta*—being stopped; *sarva*—all; *indriya*—senses; *våtti*—activities; *vibhramaù*—being widely engaged; *tuñöäva*—he prayed; *janyam*—the material tabernacle; *visåjan*—while quitting; *janärdanam*—to the controller of the living beings.

TRANSLATION

By pure meditation, looking at Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, he at once was freed from all material inauspiciousness and was relieved of all bodily pains caused by the arrow wounds. Thus all the external activities of his senses at once stopped, and he prayed transcendently to the controller of all living beings while quitting his material body.

PURPORT

The material body is a gift of the material energy, technically called illusion. Identification with the material body is due to forgetfulness of our eternal relationship with the Lord. For a pure devotee of the Lord like Bhéñmadeva, this illusion was at once removed as soon as the Lord arrived. Lord Kṛṣṇa is like the sun, and the illusory, external material energy is like darkness. In the presence of the sun there is no possibility that darkness can stand. Therefore, just on the arrival of Lord Kṛṣṇa, all material contamination was completely removed, and Bhéñmadeva was thus able to be transcendently situated by stopping the activities of the impure senses in collaboration with matter. The soul is originally pure and so also the senses. By material contamination the senses assume the role of imperfection and impurity. By revival of contact with the Supreme Pure, Lord Kṛṣṇa, the senses again become freed from material contaminations. Bhéñmadeva attained all these transcendental conditions prior to his leaving the material body because of presence of the Lord. The Lord is the controller and benefactor of all living beings. That is the verdict of all *Vedas*. He is the supreme eternity and living entity amongst all the eternal living beings.^{vii*} And He alone provides all necessities for all kinds of living beings. Thus He provided all facilities to fulfill the transcendental desires of His great devotee Sri Bhéñmadeva, who began to pray as follows.

TEXT 32

é[q>aqZMa ovac
wiTa MaiTaåPak-iLPaTaa ivTa*Z<aa
>aGaviTa SaaTvTaPau®ve iv>aUiMan)
SvSau%MauPaGaTae KviciÜhTau|
Pa[k*-iTauMauPaeYauiz YaÜvPa[vah")) 32))

çré-bhéñma uväca

iti matir upakalpita vitāñä

bhagavati sätvata-puigave vibhümni

sva-sukham upagate kvacid vihartuà

prakātim upeyūñi yad-bhava-pravāhaù

SYNONYMS

çré-bhéñmaù uvāca—Sri Bhéñmadeva said; *iti*—thus; *matiù*—thinking, feeling and willing; *upakalpità*—invested; *vitāñëä*—freed from all sense desires; *bhagavati*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *sātvata-puigave*—unto the leader of the devotees; *vibhūmni*—unto the great; *sva-sukham*—self-satisfaction; *upagate*—unto He who has attained it; *kvacit*—sometimes; *vihartum*—out of transcendental pleasure; *prakātim*—in the material world; *upeyūñi*—do accept it; *yat-bhava*—from whom the creation; *pravāhaù*—is made and annihilated.

TRANSLATION

Bhéñmadeva said: Let me now invest my thinking, feeling and willing, which were so long engaged in different subjects and occupational duties, in the all-powerful Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. He is always self-satisfied, but sometimes, being the leader of the devotees, He enjoys transcendental pleasure by descending on the material world, although from Him only the material world is created.

PURPORT

Because Bhéñmadeva was a statesman, the head of the Kuru dynasty, a great general and a leader of *kṣatriyas*, his mind was strewn over so many subjects, and his thinking, feeling and willing were engaged in different matters. Now, in order to achieve pure devotional service, he wanted to invest all powers of thinking, feeling and willing entirely in the Supreme Being, Lord Kṛṣṇa. He is described herein as the leader of the devotees and all-powerful. Although Lord Kṛṣṇa is the original Personality of Godhead, He Himself descends on earth to bestow upon His pure devotees the boon of devotional service. He descends sometimes as Lord Kṛṣṇa as He is, and sometimes as Lord Caitanya. Both are leaders of the pure devotees. Pure devotees of the Lord have no desire other than the service of the Lord, and therefore they are called *sātvata*. The Lord is the chief amongst such *sātvatas*. Bhéñmadeva, therefore, had no other desires. Unless one is

purified from all sorts of material desires, the Lord does not become one's leader. Desires cannot be wiped out, but they have only to be purified. It is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita* by the Lord Himself that He gives His instruction from within the heart of a pure devotee who is constantly engaged in the service of the Lord. Such instruction is given not for any material purpose but only for going back home, back to Godhead (Bg. 10.10). For the ordinary man who wants to lord it over material nature, the Lord not only sanctions and becomes a witness of activities, but He never gives the nondevotee instructions for going back to Godhead. That is the difference in dealings by the Lord with different living beings, both the devotee and the nondevotee. He is leader of all the living beings, as the king of the state rules both the prisoners and the free citizens. But His dealings are different in terms of devotee and nondevotee. Nondevotees never care to take any instruction from the Lord, and therefore the Lord is silent in their case, although He witnesses all their activities and awards them the necessary results, good or bad. The devotees are above this material goodness and badness. They are progressive on the path of transcendence, and therefore they have no desire for anything material. The devotee also knows Sri Kṛṣṇa as the original Nārāyaṇa because Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, by His plenary portion, appears as the Kāraṇodakaśāyī Viṣṇu, the original source of all material creation. The Lord also desires the association of His pure devotees, and for them only the Lord descends on the earth and enlivens them. The Lord appears out of His own will. He is not forced by the conditions of material nature. He is therefore described here as the *vibhu*, or the almighty, for He is never conditioned by the laws of material nature.

TEXT 33

i}a>auvNak-MaN& TaMaal/v<a |
 rivk-rGaaErvraMbr& dDaaNae)
 vPaurI/k-ku-I/av*TaaNaNaBJa&
 ivJaYaSa%e riTarSTau Mae_NavŪa)) 33))

tri-bhuvana-kamanaà tamāla-varēaà

ravi-kara-gaura-varāmbaraà dadhāne

vapur alaka-kulävâtānanābjaà

vijaya-sakhe ratir astu me 'navadyä

SYNONYMS

tri-bhuvana—three statuses of planetary systems; *kamanam*—the most desirable; *tamāla-varëam*—bluish like the *tamāla* tree; *ravi-kara*—sun rays; *gaura*—golden color; *varāmbaram*—glittering dress; *dadhāne*—one who wears; *vapuù*—body; *alaka-kula-ävāta*—covered with paintings of sandalwood pulp; *anana-abjam*—face like a lotus; *vijaya-sakhe*—unto the friend of Arjuna; *ratìù astu*—may attraction be reposed upon Him; *me*—my; *anavadyä*—without desire for fruitive results.

TRANSLATION

Sri Kṛṣṇa is the intimate friend of Arjuna. He has appeared on this earth in His transcendental body, which resembles the bluish color of the tamāla tree. His body attracts everyone in the three planetary systems [upper, middle and lower]. May His glittering yellow dress and His lotus face, covered with paintings of sandalwood pulp, be the object of my attraction, and may I not desire fruitive results.

PURPORT

When Sri Kṛṣṇa by His own internal pleasure appears on earth, He does so by the agency of His internal potency. The attractive features of His transcendental body are desired in all the three worlds, namely the upper, middle and lower planetary systems. Nowhere in the universe are there such beautiful bodily features as those of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Therefore His transcendental body has nothing to do with anything materially created. Arjuna is described here as the conqueror, and Kṛṣṇa is described as his intimate friend. Bhéñmadeva, on his bed of arrows after the Battle of Kurukñetra, is remembering the particular dress of Lord Kṛṣṇa which He put on as the driver of Arjuna's chariot. While fighting was going on between Arjuna and Bhéñma, Bhéñma's attraction was drawn by the glittering dress of Kṛṣṇa, and indirectly he admired his so-called enemy Arjuna for

possessing the Lord as his friend. Arjuna was always a conqueror because the Lord was his friend. Bhéñmadeva takes this opportunity to address the Lord as *vijaya-sakhe* (friend of Arjuna) because the Lord is pleased when He is addressed conjointly with His devotees, who are related with Him in different transcendental humors. While Kṛṣṇa was the charioteer of Arjuna, sun rays glittered on the dress of the Lord, and the beautiful hue created by the reflection of such rays was never forgotten by Bhéñmadeva. As a great fighter he was relishing the relation of Kṛṣṇa in the chivalrous humor. Transcendental relation with the Lord in any one of the different *rasas* (humors) is relishable by the respective devotees in the highest ecstasy. Less intelligent mundaners who want to make a show of being transcendently related with the Lord artificially jump at once to the relation of conjugal love, imitating the damsels of Vrajadhäma. Such a cheap relation with the Lord exhibits only the base mentality of the mundaner because one who has relished conjugal humor with the Lord cannot be attached to worldly conjugal *rasa*, which is condemned even by mundane ethics. The eternal relation of a particular soul with the Lord is evolved. A genuine relation of the living being with the Supreme Lord can take any form out of the five principal *rasas*, and it does not make any difference in transcendental degree to the genuine devotee. Bhéñmadeva is a concrete example of this, and it should be carefully observed how the great general is transcendently related with the Lord.

TEXT 34

**YauIDa TaurGarJaaivDaUMa]ivZvk(-,
k-clu/il/Taé[MavaYaRI/x(k*-TaaSYae)
MaMa iNaiXaTaXarEivRi>aÛMaaNa,
Tvic ivl/SaTk-vce_STau k*-Z<a AaTMaa)) 34))**

yudhi turaga-rajo-vidhümra-viñvak-

kaca-lulita-çramaväry-alaikâtäsye

mama niçita-çarair vibhidyamäna-

tvaci vilasat-kavace 'stu kãñëa ätmä

SYNONYMS

yudhi—on the battlefield; *turaga*—horses; *rajaù*—dust; *vidhümra*—turned an ashen color; *viñvak*—waving; *kaca*—hair; *lulita*—scattered; *çramaväri*—perspiration; *alaikâta*—decorated with; *äsye*—unto the face; *mama*—my; *niçita*—sharp; *çaraiù*—by the arrows; *vibhidyamäna*—pierced by; *tvaci*—in the skin; *vilasat*—enjoying pleasure; *kavace*—protecting armor; *astu*—let there be; *kåñëe*—unto Sri Kṛṣṇa; *ätmä*—mind.

TRANSLATION

On the battlefield [where Sri Kṛṣṇa attended Arjuna out of friendship], the flowing hair of Lord Kṛṣṇa turned ashen due to the dust raised by the hoofs of the horses. And because of His labor, beads of sweat wetted His face. All these decorations, intensified by the wounds dealt by my sharp arrows, were enjoyed by Him. Let my mind thus go unto Sri Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

The Lord is the absolute form of eternity, bliss and knowledge. As such, transcendental loving service to the Lord in one of the five principal relations, namely *çänta*, *däsyä*, *sakhyä*, *vätsalyä* and *mädhuryä*, i.e., neutrality, servitorship, fraternity, filial affection and conjugal love, is graciously accepted by the Lord when offered to the Lord in genuine love and affection. Sri Bhéñmadeva is a great devotee of the Lord in the relation of servitorship. Thus his throwing of sharp arrows at the transcendental body of the Lord is as good as the worship of another devotee who throws soft roses upon Him.

It appears that Bhéñmadeva is repenting the actions he committed against the person of the Lord. But factually the Lord's body was not at all pained, due to His transcendental existence. His body is not matter. Both He Himself and His body are complete spiritual identity. Spirit is never pierced, burnt, dried, moistened, etc. This is vividly explained in the *Bhagavad-gita*. So also it is stated in the *Skanda Purana*. It is said there that spirit is always uncontaminated and indestructible. It cannot be distressed, nor can it be dried up. When Lord Viṣṇu in His incarnation appears before us, He seems

to be like one of the conditioned souls, materially encaged, just to bewilder the *asuras*, or the nonbelievers, who are always alert to kill the Lord, even from the very beginning of His appearance. Kaàsa wanted to kill Kṛṣṇa, and Ravana wanted to kill Rāma, because foolishly they were unaware of the fact that the Lord is never killed, for the spirit is never annihilated.

Therefore Bhéñmadeva's piercing of the body of Lord Kṛṣṇa is a sort of bewildering problem for the nondevotee atheist, but those who are devotees, or liberated souls, are not bewildered.

Bhéñmadeva appreciated the all-merciful attitude of the Lord because He did not leave Arjuna alone, although He was disturbed by the sharpened arrows of Bhéñmadeva, nor was He reluctant to come before Bhéñma's deathbed, even though He was ill-treated by him on the battlefield. Bhéñma's repentance and the Lord's merciful attitude are both unique in this picture.

Sri Visvanatha Cakravarti Öhäkura, a great *äcärya* and devotee in the humor of conjugal love with the Lord, remarks very saliently in this regard. He says that the wounds created on the body of the Lord by the sharpened arrows of Bhéñmadeva were as pleasing to the Lord as the biting of a fiancée who bites the body of the Lord directed by a strong sense of sex desire. Such biting by the opposite sex is never taken as a sign of enmity, even if there is a wound on the body. Therefore, the fighting as an exchange of transcendental pleasure between the Lord and His pure devotee, Sri Bhéñmadeva, was not at all mundane. Besides that, since the Lord's body and the Lord are identical, there was no possibility of wounds in the absolute body. The apparent wounds caused by the sharpened arrows are misleading to the common man, but one who has a little absolute knowledge can understand the transcendental exchange in the chivalrous relation. The Lord was perfectly happy with the wounds caused by the sharpened arrows of Bhéñmadeva. The word *vibhidyamäna* is significant because the Lord's skin is not different from the Lord. Because our skin is different from our soul, in our case the word *vibhidyamäna*, or being bruised and cut, would have been quite suitable. Transcendental bliss is of different varieties, and the variety of activities in the mundane world is but a perverted reflection of transcendental bliss. Because everything in the

mundane world is qualitatively mundane, it is full of inebrieties, whereas in the absolute realm, because everything is of the same absolute nature, there are varieties of enjoyment without inebriety. The Lord enjoyed the wounds created by His great devotee Bhéñmadeva, and because Bhéñmadeva is a devotee in the chivalrous relation, he fixes up his mind on Kṛṣṇa in that wounded condition.

TEXT 35

**SaPaid Sai%vcae iNaXaMYa MaDYae
iNaJaParYaaebRI/Yaae rQa& iNaveXYa)
iSQaTaviTa ParSaEiNak-aYaur+<aa
ôTaviTa PaaQaRSa%e riTaMaRMaaSTau)) 35))**

sapadi sakhi-vaco niçamyā madhye

nija-parayor balayo rathā niveçya

sthitavati para-sainikāyur akñëä

hātavati pārtha-sakhe ratir mamāstu

SYNONYMS

sapadi—on the battlefield; *sakhi-vaca*—command of the friend; *niçamyā*—after hearing; *madhye*—in the midst; *nija*—His own; *parayo*—and the opposite party; *balayo*—strength; *ratham*—chariot; *niveçya*—having entered; *sthitavati*—while staying there; *para-sainika*—of the soldiers on the opposite side; *äyuru*—duration of life; *akñëä*—by looking over; *hātavati*—act of diminishing; *pārtha*—of Arjuna, son of Pāthā (Kunté); *sakhe*—unto the friend; *ratir*—intimate relation; *mama*—my; *astu*—let there be.

TRANSLATION

In obedience to the command of His friend, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa entered the arena of the Battlefield of Kurukñetra between the soldiers of Arjuna and

Duryodhana, and while there He shortened the life spans of the opposite party by His merciful glance. This was done simply by His looking at the enemy. Let my mind be fixed upon that Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gita* (1.21–25) Arjuna ordered the infallible Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa to place his chariot between the phalanxes of the soldiers. He asked Him to stay there until he had finished observing the enemies he had to face in the battle. When the Lord was so asked, He at once did so, just like an order carrier. And the Lord pointed out all the important men on the opposite side, saying, “Here is Bhéñma, here is Droëa,” and so on. The Lord, being the supreme living being, is never the order supplier or order carrier of anyone, whoever he may be. But out of His causeless mercy and affection for His pure devotees, sometimes He carries out the order of the devotee like an awaiting servant. By executing the order of a devotee, the Lord becomes pleased, as a father is pleased to carry out the order of his small child. This is possible only out of pure transcendental love between the Lord and His devotees, and Bhéñmadeva was quite aware of this fact. He therefore addressed the Lord as the friend of Arjuna.

The Lord diminished the duration of life of the opposite party by His merciful glance. It is said that all the fighters who assembled on the Battlefield of Kurukñetra attained salvation by personally seeing the Lord at the time of death. Therefore, His diminishing the duration of life of Arjuna’s enemy does not mean that He was partial to the cause of Arjuna. Factually He was merciful to the opposite party because they would not have attained salvation by dying at home in the ordinary course of life. Here was a chance to see the Lord at the time of death and thus attain salvation from material life. Therefore, the Lord is all good, and whatever He does is for everyone’s good. Apparently it was for the victory of Arjuna, His intimate friend, but factually it was for the good of Arjuna’s enemies. Such are the transcendental activities of the Lord, and whoever understands this also gets salvation after quitting this material body. The Lord does no wrong in any circumstance because He is absolute, all good at all times.

TEXT 36

VYavihTaPa*TaNaamau%& iNarq+Ya
SvJaNavDaaiÜMau%SYa daezbuÖya)
ku-MaiTaMahrdaTMaivÛYaa Ya,
Xcr<ariTa" ParMaSYa TaSYa Mae_STau)) 36))

vyavahita-pātanā-mukhaà nirékñya

sva-jana-vadhād vimukhasya doña-buddhyä

kumatim aharad ātma-vidyayä yaç

caraëa-ratiù paramasya tasya me 'stu

SYNONYMS

vyavahita—standing at a distance; *pātanā*—soldiers; *mukham*—faces; *nirékñya*—by looking upon; *sva-jana*—kinsmen; *vadhāt*—from the act of killing; *vimukhasya*—one who is reluctant; *doña-buddhyä*—by polluted intelligence; *kumatim*—poor fund of knowledge; *aharat*—eradicated; *ātma-vidyayä*—by transcendental knowledge; *yaù*—He who; *caraëa*—to the feet; *ratiù*—attraction; *paramasya*—of the Supreme; *tasya*—for Him; *me*—my; *astu*—let there be.

TRANSLATION

When Arjuna was seemingly polluted by ignorance upon observing the soldiers and commanders before him on the battlefield, the Lord eradicated his ignorance by delivering transcendental knowledge. May His lotus feet always remain the object of my attraction.

PURPORT

The kings and the commanders were to stand in the front of the fighting soldiers. That was the system of actual fighting. The kings and commanders were not so-called presidents or ministers of defense as they are today. They would not stay home while the poor soldiers or mercenaries were fighting face to face. This may be the regulation of modern democracy, but

when actual monarchy was prevailing, the monarchs were not cowards elected without consideration of qualification. As it was evident from the Battlefield of Kurukñetra, all the executive heads of both parties, like Droëa, Bhéñma, Arjuna and Duryodhana, were not sleeping; all of them were actual participants in the fighting, which was selected to be executed at a place away from the civil residential quarters. This means that the innocent citizens were immune from all effects of fighting between the rival royal parties. The citizens had no business in seeing what was going to happen during such fighting. They were to pay one fourth of their income to the ruler, whether he be Arjuna or Duryodhana. All the commanders of the parties on the Battlefield of Kurukñetra were standing face to face, and Arjuna saw them with great compassion and lamented that he was to kill his kinsmen on the battlefield for the sake of the empire. He was not at all afraid of the giant military phalanx presented by Duryodhana, but as a merciful devotee of the Lord, renunciation of worldly things was natural for him, and thus he decided not to fight for worldly possessions. But this was due to a poor fund of knowledge, and therefore it is said here that his intelligence became polluted. His intelligence could not be polluted at any time because he was a devotee and constant companion of the Lord, as is clear in the Fourth Chapter of the *Bhagavad-gita*. Apparently Arjuna's intelligence became polluted because otherwise there would not have been a chance to deliver the teachings of *Bhagavad-gita* for the good of all polluted conditioned souls engaged in material bondage by the conception of the false material body. The *Bhagavad-gita* was delivered to the conditioned souls of the world to deliver them from the wrong conception of identifying the body with the soul and to reestablish the soul's eternal relation with the Supreme Lord. *Ātma-vidyā*, or transcendental knowledge of Himself, was primarily spoken by the Lord for the benefit of all concerned in all parts of the universe.

TEXT 37

**SviNaGaMaMaPahaYa MaTPa[iTaja,
Ma*TaMaiDak-TauRMavPlu/Taae rQaSQa")
Da*TarQacr<aae_>YaYaaÀl/d(Gau,
hRirirv hNTauMa>a& GaTaaetarqYa")) 37))**

sva-nigamam apahäya mat-pratijiäm

åtam adhikartum avapluta rathasthaù

dhâta-ratha-caraëo 'bhyayäc caladgur

harir iva hantum ibhaà gatottaréyaù

SYNONYMS

sva-nigamam—own truthfulness; *apahäya*—for nullifying; *mat-pratijiäm*—my own promise; *åtam*—factual; *adhi*—more; *kartum*—for doing it; *avaplutaù*—getting down; *ratha-sthaù*—from the chariot; *dhâta*—taking up; *ratha*—chariot; *caraëaù*—wheel; *abhyayät*—went hurriedly; *caladguà*—trampling the earth; *hariù*—lion; *iva*—like; *hantum*—to kill; *ibham*—elephant; *gata*—leaving aside; *uttaréyaù*—covering cloth.

TRANSLATION

Fulfilling my desire and sacrificing His own promise, He got down from the chariot, took up its wheel, and ran towards me hurriedly, just as a lion goes to kill an elephant. He even dropped His outer garment on the way.

PURPORT

The Battle of Kurukñetra was fought on military principles but at the same time in a sporting spirit, like a friend's fight with another friend. Duryodhana criticized Bhéñmadeva, alleging that he was reluctant to kill Arjuna because of paternal affection. A *kñatriya* cannot tolerate insults on the principle of fighting. Bhéñmadeva therefore promised that the next day he would kill all five Pääòavas with special weapons made for the purpose. Duryodhana was satisfied, and he kept the arrows with him to be delivered the next day during the fight. By tricks Arjuna took the arrows from Duryodhana, and Bhéñmadeva could understand that this was the trick of Lord Kṛṣṇa. So he took a vow that the next day Kṛṣṇa would have to take up weapons Himself, otherwise His friend Arjuna would die. In the next day's fighting Bhéñmadeva fought so violently that both Arjuna and Kṛṣṇa were

in trouble. Arjuna was almost defeated; the situation was so tense that he was about to be killed by Bhéñmadeva the very next moment. At that time Lord Kṛṣṇa wanted to please His devotee, Bhéñma, by keeping Bhéñma's promise, which was more important than His own. Seemingly He broke His own promise. He promised before the beginning of the Battle of Kurukñetra that He would remain without weapons and would not use His strength for either of the parties. But to protect Arjuna He got down from the chariot, took up the wheel of the chariot and hurriedly rushed at Bhéñmadeva in an angry mood, as a lion goes to kill an elephant. He dropped His covering cloth on the way, and out of great anger He did not know that He had dropped it. Bhéñmadeva at once gave up his weapons and stood to be killed by Kṛṣṇa, his beloved Lord. The fighting of the day was thus ended at that very moment, and Arjuna was saved. Of course there was no possibility of Arjuna's death because the Lord Himself was on the chariot, but because Bhéñmadeva wanted to see Lord Kṛṣṇa take up some weapon to save His friend, the Lord created this situation, making Arjuna's death imminent. He stood before Bhéñmadeva to show him that his promise was fulfilled and that He had taken up the wheel.

TEXT 38

iXaTaiviXa%hTaae ivXaq<aRd&Xa"
 +aTaJaPairPlu/Ta AaTaTaaiYaNaee Mae)
 Pa[Sa>aMai>aSaSaar MaÜDaaQa |
 Sa >avTau Mae >aGavaNa(GaiTaMauRku-Nd")) 38))

çita-viçikha-hato viçérëa-daàçaù

kñataja-paripluta ätatäyino me

prasabham abhisasära mad-vadhärthaà

sa bhavatu me bhagavän gatir mukundaù

SYNONYMS

çita—sharp; *viçikha*—arrows; *hataù*—wounded by; *viçérëa-daàçaù*—

scattered shield; *kñataja*—by wounds; *paripluta*—smeared with blood; *ätatäyina*—the great aggressor; *me*—my; *prasabham*—in an angry mood; *abhisasära*—began to move on; *mat-vadha-artham*—for the purpose of killing me; *sa*—He; *bhavatu*—may become; *me*—my; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *gati*—destination; *mukunda*—who awards salvation.

TRANSLATION

May He, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, who awards salvation, be my ultimate destination. On the battlefield He charged me, as if angry because of the wounds dealt by my sharp arrows. His shield was scattered, and His body was smeared with blood due to the wounds.

PURPORT

The dealings of Lord Kṛṣṇa and Bhéñmadeva on the Battlefield of Kurukñetra are interesting because the activities of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa appeared to be partial to Arjuna and at enmity with Bhéñmadeva; but factually all this was especially meant to show special favor to Bhéñmadeva, a great devotee of the Lord. *The astounding feature of such dealings is that a devotee can please the Lord by playing the part of an enemy.* The Lord, being absolute, can accept service from His pure devotee even in the garb of an enemy. The Supreme Lord cannot have any enemy, nor can a so-called enemy harm Him because He is *ajita*, or unconquerable. But still He takes pleasure when His pure devotee beats Him like an enemy or rebukes Him from a superior position, although no one can be superior to the Lord. These are some of the transcendental reciprocatory dealings of the devotee with the Lord. And those who have no information of pure devotional service cannot penetrate into the mystery of such dealings. Bhéñmadeva played the part of a valiant warrior, and he purposely pierced the body of the Lord so that to the common eyes it appeared that the Lord was wounded, but factually all this was to bewilder the nondevotees. The all-spiritual body cannot be wounded, and a devotee cannot become the enemy of the Lord. Had it been so, Bhéñmadeva would not have desired to have the very same Lord as the ultimate destination of his life. Had Bhéñmadeva been an enemy of the Lord, Lord Kṛṣṇa could have annihilated

him without even moving. There was no need to come before Bhéñmadeva with blood and wounds. But He did so because the warrior devotee wanted to see the transcendental beauty of the Lord decorated with wounds created by a pure devotee. This is the way of exchanging transcendental *rasa*, or relations between the Lord and the servitor. By such dealings both the Lord and the devotee become glorified in their respective positions. The Lord was so angry that Arjuna checked Him when He was moving towards Bhéñmadeva, but in spite of Arjuna's checking, He proceeded towards Bhéñmadeva as a lover goes to a lover, without caring for hindrances. Apparently His determination was to kill Bhéñmadeva, but factually it was to please him as a great devotee of the Lord. The Lord is undoubtedly the deliverer of all conditioned souls. The impersonalists desire salvation from Him, and He always awards them according to their aspiration, but here Bhéñmadeva aspires to see the Lord in His personal feature. All pure devotees aspire for this.

TEXT 39

ivJaYarQaku-ṣu=Mb AataTaae}ae
 Da*TahYariXMaïNa TaiC^\Yae+a<aqYae)
 >aGaviTa riTarSTau Mae MauMaUzaeR,
 YaRiMah iNarq+Ya hTaa GaTaa" SvæPaMa()) 39))

vijaya-ratha-kuöumba ätta-totre

dhâta-haya-raçmini tac-chriyekñäëéye

bhagavati ratir astu me mumürñor

yam iha nirékñya hatä gatäù sva-rüpam

SYNONYMS

vijaya—Arjuna; *ratha*—chariot; *kuöumbe*—the object of protection at all risk; *ätta-totre*—with a whip in the right hand; *dhâta-haya*—controlling the horses; *raçmini*—ropes; *tat-çriyâ*—beautifully standing; *ékñäëéye*—to look at; *bhagavati*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *ratiù astu*—let my

attraction be; *me*—my; *mumürñoṁ*—one who is about to die; *yam*—upon whom; *iha*—in this world; *nirékñya*—by looking; *hatäṁ*—those who died; *gatäṁ*—attained; *sva-rüpam*—original form.

TRANSLATION

At the moment of death, let my ultimate attraction be to Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead. I concentrate my mind upon the chariot driver of Arjuna who stood with a whip in His right hand and a bridle rope in His left, who was very careful to give protection to Arjuna's chariot by all means. Those who saw Him on the Battlefield of Kurukñetra attained their original forms after death.

PURPORT

A pure devotee of the Lord constantly sees the presence of the Lord within himself because of being transcendently related by loving service. Such a pure devotee cannot forget the Lord for a moment. This is called trance. The mystic (*yogé*) tries to concentrate upon the Supersoul by controlling the senses from all other engagements, and thus he ultimately attains *samädhī*. A devotee more easily attains *samädhī*, or trance, by constantly remembering the Lord's personal feature along with His holy name, fame, pastimes, etc. Therefore, the concentration of the mystic *yogé* and that of the devotee are not on the same level. The concentration of the mystic is mechanical, whereas that of the pure devotee is natural in pure love and spontaneous affection. Bhéñmadeva was a pure devotee, and as a military marshal he constantly remembered the battlefield feature of the Lord as Pärtha-särathi, the chariot driver of Arjuna. Therefore, the Lord's pastime as Pärtha-särathi is also eternal. The pastimes of the Lord, beginning from His birth at the prison house of Kaàsa up to the *mausala-līla* at the end, all move one after another in all the universes, just as the clock hand moves from one point to another. And in such pastimes His associates like the Pääòavas and Bhéñma are constant eternal companions. So Bhéñmadeva never forgot the beautiful feature of the Lord as Pärtha-särathi, which even Arjuna could not see. Arjuna was behind the beautiful Pärtha-särathi while Bhéñmadeva was just in front of the Lord. As far as the military feature of the Lord is concerned, Bhéñmadeva observed this with more relish than

Arjuna.

All the soldiers and persons on the Battlefield of Kurukñetra attained their original spiritual form like the Lord after their death because by the causeless mercy of the Lord they were able to see Him face to face on that occasion. The conditioned souls rotating in the evolutionary cycle from the aquatics up to the form of Brahmā are all in the form of *māyā*, or the form obtained by one's own actions and awarded by material nature. The material forms of the conditioned souls are all foreign dresses, and when the conditioned soul becomes liberated from the clutches of material energy, he attains his original form. The impersonalist wants to attain the impersonal Brahman effulgence of the Lord, but that is not at all congenial to the living sparks, parts and parcels of the Lord. Therefore, the impersonalists again fall down and get material forms, which are all false to the spirit soul. A spiritual form like the Lord's, either two-handed or four-handed, is attained by the devotees of the Lord either in the Vaikunthas or in the Goloka planet, according to the original nature of the soul. This form, which is cent percent spiritual, is the *svarūpa* of the living being, and all the living beings who participated on the Battlefield of Kurukñetra, on both sides, attained their *svarūpa*, as confirmed by Bhéñmadeva. So Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa was not merciful only to the Pāëðavas; He was also merciful to the other parties because all of them attained the same result. Bhéñmadeva wanted the same facility also, and that was his prayer to the Lord, although his position as an associate of the Lord is assured in all circumstances. The conclusion is that whoever dies looking on the Personality of Godhead within or without attains his *svarūpa*, which is the highest perfection of life.

TEXT 40

I/il/TaGaiTaivl/aSavLGauhaSa,
Pa[<aYaiNarq+a<ak-iLPaTaaeåMaaNaa")
k*-TaMaNauk*-TavTYa oNMadaNDaa"
Pa[k*-iTaMaGaNa(ik-I/ YaSYa GaaePavß")) 40))

lalita-gati-vilāsa-valguhāsa-

praëaya-nirékñāëa-kalpitorumänäù

kāta-manu-kāta-vatya unmadāndhāu

prakātim agan kila yasya gopa-vadhvau

SYNONYMS

lalita—attractive; *gati*—movements; *vilāsa*—fascinating acts; *valguhāsa*—sweet smiling; *praēaya*—loving; *nirékñāēa*—looking upon; *kalpita*—mentality; *urumānāu*—highly glorified; *kāta-manu-kāta-vatya*—in the act of copying the movements; *unmada-andhāu*—gone mad in ecstasy; *prakātim*—characteristics; *agan*—underwent; *kila*—certainly; *yasya*—whose; *gopa-vadhvau*—the cowherd damsels.

TRANSLATION

Let my mind be fixed upon Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, whose motions and smiles of love attracted the damsels of Vrajabhāma [the gopés]. The damsels imitated the characteristic movements of the Lord [after His disappearance from the rāsa dance].

PURPORT

By intense ecstasy in loving service, the damsels of Vrajabhūmi attained qualitative oneness with the Lord by dancing with Him on an equal level, embracing Him in nuptial love, smiling at Him in joke, and looking at Him with a loving attitude. The relation of the Lord with Arjuna is undoubtedly praiseworthy for devotees like Bhéñmadeva, but the relation of the *gopés* with the Lord is still more praiseworthy because of their still more purified loving service. By the grace of the Lord, Arjuna was fortunate enough to have the fraternal service of the Lord as chariot driver, but the Lord did not award Arjuna with equal strength. The *gopés*, however, practically became one with the Lord by attainment of equal footing with the Lord. Bhéñma's aspiration to remember the *gopés* is a prayer to have their mercy also at the last stage of his life. The Lord is satisfied more when His pure devotees are glorified, and therefore Bhéñmadeva has not only glorified the acts of Arjuna, his immediate object of attraction, but has also remembered the *gopés*, who were endowed with unrivalled opportunities by rendering

loving service to the Lord. The *gopés'* equality with the Lord should never be misunderstood to be like the *sāyujya* liberation of the impersonalist. The equality is one of perfect ecstasy where the differential conception is completely eradicated, for the interests of the lover and the beloved become identical.

TEXT 41

**MauiNaGa<aNa*PavYaRSa&ku-le/_NTa",
SadiSa YauidaïirraJaSaUYa WzaMa()
AhR<aMauPaPaed wR+a<aqYaee
MaMa d*iXaGaaecr Wz AaivraTMaa)) 41))**

muni-gaëa-nāpa-varya-saïkule 'ntaù-

sadasi yudhiñöhira-rājasüya eñām

arhaëam upapeda ékñäëéyo

mama dāçi-gocara eña ävir ätmä

SYNONYMS

muni-gaëa—the great learned sages; *nāpa-varya*—the great ruling kings; *saïkule*—in the great assembly of; *antaù-sadasi*—conference; *yudhiñöhira*—of Emperor Yudhiñöhira; *rāja-süye*—a royal performance of sacrifice; *eñām*—of all the great elites; *arhaëam*—respectful worship; *upapeda*—received; *ékñäëéyaù*—the object of attraction; *mama*—my; *dāçi*—sight; *gocaraù*—within the view of; *eñaù äviù*—personally present; *ätmä*—the soul.

TRANSLATION

At the Rājasüya-yajña [sacrifice] performed by Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, there was the greatest assembly of all the elite men of the world, the royal and learned orders, and in that great assembly Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa was worshiped by one and all as the most exalted Personality of Godhead.

This happened during my presence, and I remembered the incident in order to keep my mind upon the Lord.

PURPORT

After gaining victory in the Battle of Kurukñetra, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, the Emperor of the world, performed the Rājasūya sacrificial ceremony. The emperor, in those days, upon his ascendance to the throne, would send a challenge horse all over the world to declare his supremacy, and any ruling prince or king was at liberty to accept the challenge and express his tacit willingness either to obey or to disobey the supremacy of the particular emperor. One who accepted the challenge had to fight with the emperor and establish his own supremacy by victory. The defeated challenger would have to sacrifice his life, making a place for another king or ruler. So Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira also dispatched such challenging horses all over the world, and every ruling prince and king all over the world accepted Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira's leadership as the Emperor of the world. After this, all rulers of the world under the regime of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira were invited to participate in the great sacrificial ceremony of Rājasūya. Such performances required hundreds of millions of dollars, and it was not an easy job for a petty king. Such a sacrificial ceremony, being too expensive and also difficult to perform under present circumstances, is now impossible in this age of Kali. Nor can anyone secure the required expert priesthood to take charge of the ceremony.

So, after being invited, all the kings and great learned sages of the world assembled in the capital of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. The learned society, including the great philosophers, religionists, physicians, scientists and all great sages, was invited. That is to say, the *brahmanas* and the *kṣatriyas* were the topmost leading men in society, and they were all invited to participate in the assembly. The *vaisyas* and *sudras* were unimportant elements in society, and they are not mentioned herein. Due to the change of social activities in the modern age, the importance of men has also changed in terms of occupational positions.

So in that great assembly, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa was the cynosure of neighboring eyes. Everyone wanted to see Lord Kṛṣṇa, and everyone wanted to pay his

humble respects to the Lord. Bhéñmadeva remembered all this and was glad that his worshipful Lord, the Personality of Godhead, was present before him in His actual formal presence. So to meditate on the Supreme Lord is to meditate on the activities, form, pastimes, name and fame of the Lord. That is easier than what is imagined as meditation on the impersonal feature of the Supreme. In the *Bhagavad-gita* (12.5) it is clearly stated that to meditate upon the impersonal feature of the Supreme is very difficult. It is practically no meditation or simply a waste of time because very seldom is the desired result obtained. The devotees, however, meditate upon the Lord's factual form and pastimes, and therefore the Lord is easily approachable by the devotees. This is also stated in the *Bhagavad-gita* (12.9). The Lord is nondifferent from His transcendental activities. It is indicated also in this *çloka* that Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, while actually present before human society, especially in connection with the Battle of Kurukñetra, was accepted as the greatest personality of the time, although He might not have been recognized as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The propaganda that a very great man is worshiped as God after his death is misleading because a man after his death cannot be made into God. Nor can the Personality of Godhead be a human being, even when He is personally present. Both ideas are misconceptions. The idea of anthropomorphism cannot be applicable in the case of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 42

**TaiMaMaMahMaJa& Xarqr>aaJaa&
ôid ôid iDaiïTaMaaTMak-iLPaTaaNaaMa()
Pa[iTad*XaiMav NaEk-DaakR-Maek&-
SaMaiDaGaTaae_iSMa ivDaUTa>aedMaaeh")) 42))**

tam imam aham ajaà çaréra-bhäjää

hådi hådi dhiñöhitam ätma-kalpitänäm

pratidåçam iva naikadhärkam ekaà

samadhi-gato 'smi vidhüta-bheda-mohaù

SYNONYMS

tam—that Personality of Godhead; *imam*—now present before me; *aham*—I; *ajam*—the unborn; *çaréra-bhäjäm*—of the conditioned soul; *hådi*—in the heart; *hådi*—in the heart; *dhiñöhita*—situated; *ätma*—the Supersoul; *kalpitänäm*—of the speculators; *pratidâçam*—in every direction; *iva*—like; *na ekadhä*—not one; *arkam*—the sun; *ekam*—one only; *samadhigataù asmi*—I have undergone trance in meditation; *vidhüta*—being freed from; *bheda-mohaù*—misconception of duality.

TRANSLATION

Now I can meditate with full concentration upon that one Lord, Sri Kṛṣṇa, now present before me because now I have transcended the misconceptions of duality in regard to His presence in everyone's heart, even in the hearts of the mental speculators. He is in everyone's heart. The sun may be perceived differently, but the sun is one.

PURPORT

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the one Absolute Supreme Personality of Godhead, but He has expanded Himself into His multiplenary portions by His inconceivable energy. The conception of duality is due to ignorance of His inconceivable energy. In the *Bhagavad-gita* (9.11) the Lord says that only the foolish take Him to be a mere human being. Such foolish men are not aware of His inconceivable energies. By His inconceivable energy He is present in everyone's heart, as the sun is present before everyone all over the world. The Paramätmä feature of the Lord is an expansion of His plenary portions. He expands Himself as Paramätmä in everyone's heart by His inconceivable energy, and He also expands Himself as the glowing effulgence of *brahmajyoti* by expansion of His personal glow. It is stated in the *Brahma-saṃhitä* that the *brahmajyoti* is His personal glow. Therefore, there is no difference between Him and His personal glow, *brahmajyoti*, or His plenary portions as Paramätmä. Less intelligent persons who are not aware of this fact consider *brahmajyoti* and Paramätmä to be different from Sri Kṛṣṇa. This misconception of duality is completely removed from the mind of Bhéñmadeva, and he is now satisfied that it is Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa only who is all

in all in everything. This enlightenment is attained by the great *mahātmās* or devotees, as it is stated in *Bhagavad-gita* (7.19) that Vāsudeva is all in all in everything and that there is no existence of anything without Vāsudeva. Vāsudeva, or Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, is the original Supreme Person, as now confirmed by a *mahājana*, and therefore both the neophytes and the pure devotees must try to follow in his footsteps. That is the way of the devotional line.

The worshipable object of Bhéñmadeva is Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa as Pārtha-sārathi, and that of the *gopés* is the same Kṛṣṇa in Våndāvana as the most attractive Çyāmasundara. Sometimes less intelligent scholars make a mistake and think that the Kṛṣṇa of Våndāvana and that of the Battle of Kurukñetra are different personalities. But for Bhéñmadeva this misconception is completely removed. Even the impersonalist's object of destination is Kṛṣṇa as the impersonal *jyoti*, and the *yogé's* destination of Paramātmā is also Kṛṣṇa. Kṛṣṇa is both *brahmajyoti* and localized Paramātmā, but in *brahmajyoti* or Paramātmā there is no Kṛṣṇa or sweet relations with Kṛṣṇa. In His personal feature Kṛṣṇa is both Pārtha-sārathi and Çyāmasundara of Våndāvana, but in His impersonal feature He is neither in the *brahmajyoti* nor in the Paramātmā. Great *mahātmās* like Bhéñmadeva realize all these different features of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and therefore they worship Lord Kṛṣṇa, knowing Him as the origin of all features.

TEXT 43

SaUTa ovac

k*-Z<a Wv& >aGaviTa MaNaaevaGd*iív*itai>a")
AaTMaNYaaTMaaNaMaaveXYa Saae_NTa"iaSa oPaarMaTa()) 43))

sūta uvāca

kāñēa evaà bhagavati

mano-vāg-dāñōi-vāttibhiù

ätmany ätmānam äveçya

so 'ntaùçvāsa upāramat

SYNONYMS

sūtaù uvāca—Sūta Gosvami said; *kāñḍee*—Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *evam*—only; *bhagavati*—unto Him; *manaù*—with mind; *vāk*—speech; *dāñḍi*—sight; *vāttibhiù*—activities; *ātmani*—unto the Supersoul; *ātmānam*—the living being; *āveçya*—having merged in; *saù*—he; *antaù-çvāsaù*—inhaling; *upāramat*—became silent.

TRANSLATION

Sūta Gosvami said: Thus Bhéñmadeva merged himself in the Supersoul, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, with his mind, speech, sight and actions, and thus he became silent, and his breathing stopped.

PURPORT

The stage attained by Bhéñmadeva while quitting his material body is called *nirvikalpa-samādhi* because he merged his self into thinking of the Lord and his mind into remembering His different activities. He chanted the glories of the Lord, and by his sight he began to see the Lord personally present before him, and thus all his activities became concentrated upon the Lord without deviation. This is the highest stage of perfection, and it is possible for everyone to attain this stage by practice of devotional service. The devotional service of the Lord consists of nine principles of service activities, and they are (1) hearing, (2) chanting, (3) remembering, (4) serving the lotus feet, (5) worshiping, (6) praying, (7) executing the orders, (8) fraternizing, and (9) fully surrendering. Any one of them or all of them are equally competent to award the desired result, but they require to be practiced persistently under the guidance of an expert devotee of the Lord. The first item, hearing, is the most important item of all, and therefore hearing of the *Bhagavad-gita* and, later on, *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is essential for the serious candidate who wants to attain the stage of Bhéñmadeva at the end. The unique situation at Bhéñmadeva's time of death can be attained, even though Lord Kṛṣṇa may not be personally present. His words

of the *Bhagavad-gita* or those of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* are identical with the Lord. They are sound incarnations of the Lord, and one can fully utilize them to be entitled to attain the stage of Sri Bhéñmadeva, who was one of the eight Vasus. Every man or animal must die at a certain stage of life, but one who dies like Bhéñmadeva attains perfection, and one who dies forced by the laws of nature dies like an animal. That is the difference between a man and an animal. The human form of life is especially meant for dying like Bhéñmadeva.

TEXT 44

SaMPaûMaaNaMaajaYa >aqZMa& b]øi<a iNaZk-le/)
SaveR b>aUvuSTae TaUZ<aq& vYaa&Saqv idNaaTYaYae)) 44))

sampadyamānam ājīāya

bhéñmaà brahmaëi niñkale

sarve babhūvus te tūñëéà

vayäàséva dinätyaye

SYNONYMS

sampadyamānam—having merged into; *ājīāya*—after knowing this;
bhéñmam—about Sri Bhéñmadeva; *brahmaëi*—into the Supreme Absolute;
niñkale—unlimited; *sarve*—all present; *babhūvuù te*—all of them became;
tūñëém—silent; *vayäàsi iva*—like birds; *dina-atyaye*—at the end of the day.

TRANSLATION

Knowing that Bhéñmadeva had merged into the unlimited eternity of the Supreme Absolute, all present there became silent like birds at the end of the day.

PURPORT

To enter into or to become merged into the unlimited eternity of the Supreme Absolute means to enter the original home of the living being. The living beings are all component parts and parcels of the Absolute Personality of Godhead, and therefore they are eternally related with Him as the servitor and the served. The Lord is served by all His parts and parcels, as the complete machine is served by its parts and parcels. Any part of the machine removed from the whole is no longer important. Similarly, any part and parcel of the Absolute detached from the service of the Lord is useless. The living beings who are in the material world are all disintegrated parts and parcels of the supreme whole, and they are no longer as important as the original parts and parcels. There are, however, more integrated living beings who are eternally liberated. The material energy of the Lord, called Durgā-çakti, or the superintendent of the prison house, takes charge of the disintegrated parts and parcels, and thus they undergo a conditioned life under the laws of material nature. When the living being becomes conscious of this fact, he tries to go back home, back to Godhead, and thus the spiritual urge of the living being begins. This spiritual urge is called *brahma-jijñāsā*, or inquiry about Brahman. Principally this *brahma-jijñāsā* is successful by knowledge, renunciation and devotional service to the Lord. *Jñāna*, or knowledge, means knowledge of everything of Brahman, the Supreme; renunciation means detachment of material affection, and devotional service is the revival by practice of the original position of the living being. The successful living beings who are eligible to enter into the realm of the Absolute are called the *jñānés*, the *yogés* and the *bhaktas*. The *jñānés* and *yogés* enter into the impersonal rays of the Supreme, but the *bhaktas* enter into the spiritual planets known as the Vaikunthas. In these spiritual planets the Supreme Lord as Nārāyaṇa predominates, and the healthy, unconditioned living beings live there by rendering loving service to the Lord in the capacity of servant, friend, parents and fiancée. There the unconditioned living beings enjoy life in full freedom with the Lord, whereas the impersonalist *jñānés* and *yogés* enter into the impersonal glowing effulgence of the Vaikuntha planets. The Vaikuntha planets are all self-illuminating like the sun, and the rays of the Vaikuntha planets are called the *brahmajyoti*. The *brahmajyoti* is spread unlimitedly, and the material world is but a covered portion of an insignificant part of the same *brahmajyoti*. This covering is temporary, and therefore it is a sort of illusion.

Bhéñmadeva, as a pure devotee of the Lord, entered the spiritual realm in one of the Vaikuntha planets where the Lord in His eternal form of *Pārtha-sārathi* predominates over the unconditioned living beings who are constantly engaged in the service of the Lord. The love and affection which bind the Lord and devotee are exhibited in the case of Bhéñmadeva. Bhéñmadeva never forgot the Lord in His transcendental feature as the *Pārtha-sārathi*, and the Lord was present personally before Bhéñmadeva while he was passing to the transcendental world. That is the highest perfection of life.

TEXT 45

Ta}a duNdu>aYaae NaedudeRvMaaNavvaidTaa")
XaXa&Sau" SaaDavae raja& %aTPaeTau" PauZPav*íYa")) 45))

tatra dundubhayo nedur

deva-mānava-vāditāu

çaçaàsuù sādhave rājīāà

khät petuù puñpa-vañöayaù

SYNONYMS

tatra—thereafter; *dundubhayaù*—drums; *neduù*—were sounded; *deva*—the demigods from other planets; *mānava*—men from all countries; *vāditāù*—beaten by; *ṣaṣaṣuù*—praised; *sādhavaù*—honest; *rājīām*—by the royal order; *khāt*—from the sky; *petuù*—began to fall; *puñpa-vāñōayaù*—showers of flowers.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, both men and demigods sounded drums in honor, and the honest royal order commenced demonstrations of honor and respect. And from the sky fell showers of flowers.

PURPORT

Bhéñmadeva was respected both by the human beings and by the demigods. The human beings live on earth and similar other planets in the Bhūr and Bhuvar group of planets, but the demigods live in the Svar, or heavenly planets, and all of them knew Bhéñmadeva as a great warrior and devotee of the Lord. As a *mahājana* (or authority) he was on the level of Brahmā, Nārada and Siva, although he was a human being. Qualification on a par with the great demigods is possible only on attainment of spiritual perfection. Thus Bhéñmadeva was known all over the universes, and during his time interplanetary travel was effected by finer methods than the futile endeavors of mechanical spacecraft. When the distant planets were informed of the passing away of Bhéñmadeva, all the inhabitants of the upper planets as well as of the earth dropped showers of flowers to show due respect to the departed great personality. This showering of flowers from heaven is a sign of recognition by great demigods, and it should never be compared to the decoration of a dead body. The body of Bhéñmadeva lost its material effects due to being surcharged with spiritual realization, and thus the body was spiritualized as when iron becomes red-hot when in contact with fire. The body of a fully self-realized soul is not, therefore, accepted as material. Special ceremonies are observed for such spiritual bodies. The respect and recognition of Bhéñmadeva are never to be imitated by artificial means, as it has become a fashion to observe the so-called *jayanté* ceremony for any and every common man. According to authorized *sastras*, such a *jayanté* ceremony for an ordinary man, however exalted he may be materially, is an offense to the Lord because *jayanté* is reserved for the day when the Lord appears on the earth. Bhéñmadeva was unique in his activities, and his passing away to the kingdom of God is also unique.

TEXT 46

TaSYa iNahRr<aadqiNa SaMPareTaSYa >aaGaRv)
YauIDaiĩr" k-ariYaTva MauhUTa| du"i%Taae_>avTa()) 46))

tasya nirharaëädéni

samparetasya bhārgava

yudhiñöhiraù kārāyivā

muhūrtaà duùkhito 'bhavat

SYNONYMS

tasya—his; *nirharaëa-ädëni*—funeral ceremony; *samparetasya*—of the dead body; *bhārgava*—O descendant of Bhāgu; *yudhiñöhiraù*—Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira; *kārāyivā*—having performed it; *muhūrtam*—for a moment; *duùkhitaù*—sorry; *abhavat*—became.

TRANSLATION

O descendant of Bhāgu [Çaunaka], after performing funeral rituals for the dead body of Bhéñmadeva, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was momentarily overtaken with grief.

PURPORT

Bhéñmadeva was not only a great family head of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, but also he was a great philosopher and friend to him, his brothers and his mother. Since Mahārāja Pääòu, the father of the five brothers headed by Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, had died, Bhéñmadeva was the most affectionate grandfather of the Pääòavas and caretaker of the widow daughter-in-law Kuntédevé. Although Mahārāja Dhātarāñöra, the elder uncle of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, was there to look after them, his affection was more on the side of his hundred sons, headed by Duryodhana. Ultimately a colossal clique was fabricated to deprive the five fatherless brothers of the rightful claim of the kingdom of Hastināpura. There was great intrigue, common in imperial palaces, and the five brothers were exiled to the wilderness. But Bhéñmadeva was always a sincerely sympathetic well-wisher, grandfather, friend and philosopher to Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, even up to the last moment of his life. He died very happily by seeing Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira to the throne, otherwise he would have long ago quitted his material body, instead of suffering agony over the undue sufferings of the Pääòavas. He

was simply waiting for the opportune moment because he was sure and certain that the sons of Pääòu would come out victorious in the Battlefield of Kurukñetra, as His Lordship Sri Kṛṣṇa was their protector. As a devotee of the Lord, he knew that the Lord's devotee cannot be vanquished at any time. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was quite aware of all these good wishes of Bhéñmadeva, and therefore he must have been feeling the great separation. He was sorry for the separation of a great soul, and not for the material body which Bhéñmadeva relinquished. The funeral ceremony was a necessary duty, although Bhéñmadeva was a liberated soul. Since Bhéñmadeva was without issue, the eldest grandson, namely Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, was the rightful person to perform this ceremony. It was a great boon to Bhéñmadeva that an equally great son of the family undertook the last rites of a great man.

TEXT 47

**TauíuvuMauRNaYaae ôía" k*-Z<a& Tad(GauùNaaMai>a")
TaTaSTae k*-Z<aôdYaa" Svaé[MaaNa(Pa[YaYau" PauNa")) 47))**

tuñöuvur munayo hññöü

kññëà tad-guhya-nāmabhiù

tatas te kññëa-hādayäù

svāçramān prayayyuù punaù

SYNONYMS

tuñöuvuù—satisfied; *munayaù*—the great sages, headed by Vyāsadeva, etc.; *hññöü*—all in a happy mood; *kññëam*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead; *tat*—His; *guhya*—confidential; *nāmabhiù*—by His holy name, etc.; *tataù*—thereafter; *te*—they; *kññëa-hādayäù*—persons who always bear Lord Kṛṣṇa in their hearts; *sva-āçramān*—to their respective hermitages; *prayayyuù*—returned; *punaù*—again.

TRANSLATION

All the great sages then glorified Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, who was present there, by confidential Vedic hymns. Then all of them returned to their respective hermitages, bearing always Lord Kṛṣṇa within their hearts.

PURPORT

The devotees of the Lord are always in the heart of the Lord, and the Lord is always in the hearts of the devotees. That is the sweet relation between the Lord and His devotees. Due to unalloyed love and devotion for the Lord, the devotees always see Him within themselves, and the Lord also, although He has nothing to do and nothing to aspire to, is always busy in attending to the welfare of His devotees. For the ordinary living beings the law of nature is there for all actions and reactions, but He is always anxious to put His devotees on the right path. The devotees, therefore, are under the direct care of the Lord. And the Lord also voluntarily puts Himself under the care of His devotees only. So all the sages, headed by Vyāsadeva, were devotees of the Lord, and therefore they chanted the Vedic hymns after the funeral ceremony just to please the Lord, who was present there personally. All the Vedic hymns are chanted to please Lord Kṛṣṇa. This is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gītā* (15.15). All the *Vedas*, *Upaniṣads*, *Vedānta*, etc., are seeking Him only, and all hymns are for glorifying Him only. The sages, therefore, performed the exact acts suitable for the purpose, and they happily departed for their respective hermitages.

TEXT 48

**TaTaae YauīDaiīrae GaTva Sahk*-Z<aae GaJaaûYaMa()
iPaTar& SaaNTvYaaMaaSa GaaNDAarq& c TaPaiSvNaqMa()) 48))**

tato yudhiñöhīro gatvā

saha-kāñēo gajāhvayam

pitaraà sāntvayām āsa

gāndhārēà ca tapasviném

SYNONYMS

tatau—thereafter; *yudhiñöhira*—Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira; *gatvā*—going there; *saha*—with; *kāñēa*—the Lord; *gajāhvayam*—in the capital named Gajāhvaya Hastināpura; *pitaram*—unto his uncle (Dhātārāñōra); *sāntvayām āsa*—consoled; *gāndhārém*—the wife of Dhātārāñōra; *ca*—and; *tapasviném*—an ascetic lady.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira at once went to his capital, Hastināpura, accompanied by Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and there he consoled his uncle and aunt Gāndhārē, who was an ascetic.

PURPORT

Dhātārāñōra and Gāndhārē, the father and the mother of Duryodhana and his brothers, were the elder uncle and aunt of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. After the Battle of Kurukñetra, the celebrated couple, having lost all their sons and grandsons, were under the care of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. They were passing their days in great agony over such a heavy loss of life and were practically living the life of ascetics. The death news of Bhéñmadeva, uncle of Dhātārāñōra, was another great shock for the King and the Queen, and therefore they required solace from Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was conscious of his duty, and he at once hurried to the spot with Lord Kṛṣṇa and satisfied the bereaved Dhātārāñōra with kind words, from both himself and the Lord also.

Gāndhārē was a powerful ascetic, although she was living the life of a faithful wife and a kind mother. It is said that Gāndhārē also voluntarily closed her eyes because of the blindness of her husband. A wife's duty is to follow the husband cent percent. And Gāndhārē was so true to her husband that she followed him even in his perpetual blindness. Therefore in her actions she was a great ascetic. Besides that, the shock she suffered because of the wholesale killing of her one hundred sons and her grandsons also was certainly too much for a woman. But she suffered all this just like an ascetic. Gāndhārē, although a woman, is no less than Bhéñmadeva in

character. They are both remarkable personalities in the *Mahābhārata*.

TEXT 49

iPa}aa caNauMaTaae raJaa vaSaudevaNauMaaeidTa")
ck-ar raJYa& DaMaeR<a iPaTa*PaETaaMah& iv>au")) 49))

pitṛā cānumato rājā

vāsudeva-numoditaù

cakāra rājyaà dharmeëa

pitā-paitāmahaà vibhuù

SYNONYMS

pitṛā—by his uncle, Dhātarañña; *ca*—and; *anumataù*—with his approval; *rājā*—King Yudhiñöhira; *vāsudeva-anumoditaù*—confirmed by Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *cakāra*—executed; *rājyam*—the kingdom; *dharmeëa*—in compliance with the codes of royal principles; *pitā*—father; *paitāmaha*—forefather; *vibhuù*—as great as.

TRANSLATION

After this, the great religious King, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, executed the royal power in the kingdom strictly according to the codes and royal principles approved by his uncle and confirmed by Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was not a mere tax collector. He was always conscious of his duty as a king, which is no less than that of a father or spiritual master. The king is to see to the welfare of the citizens from all angles of social, political, economic and spiritual upliftment. The king must know that human life is meant for liberating the encaged soul from the bondage of material conditions, and therefore his duty is to see that the

citizens are properly looked after to attain this highest stage of perfection.

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira followed these principles strictly, as will be seen from the next chapter. Not only did he follow the principles, but he also got approval from his old uncle, who was experienced in political affairs, and that was also confirmed by Lord Kṛṣṇa, the speaker of the philosophy of *Bhagavad-gita*.

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira is the ideal monarch, and monarchy under a trained king like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira is by far the most superior form of government, superior to modern republics or governments of the people, by the people. The mass of people, especially in this age of Kali, are all born *sudras*, basically lowborn, ill-trained, unfortunate and badly associated. They themselves do not know the highest perfectional aim of life. Therefore, votes cast by them actually have no value, and thus persons elected by such irresponsible votes cannot be responsible representatives like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Ninth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "The passing Away of Bhéñmadeva in the presence of Lord Kṛṣṇa."

Chapter Ten

Departure of Lord Kṛṣṇa for Dvārakā

TEXT 1

XaaENak- ovac
hTva SvirKQaSPa*Da AaTaTaaiYaNaee
Yauidaiïrae DaMaR>a*Taa& viri")
SahaNauJaE" Pa[TYavåÖ>aaeJaNa"
k-Qa& Pa[v*ta" ik-Mak-arzqtaTa")) 1))

çaunaka uvāca

hatvā svariktha-spādha ātatāyino

yudhiñōhiro dharma-bhātāà variñōhaù

sahānujaiù pratyavaruddha-bhojanaù

kathaà pravāttaù kim akārañét tataù

SYNONYMS

ṣaunakaù uvāca—Ṣaunaka inquired; *hatvā*—after killing; *svariktha*—the legal inheritance; *spādhaù*—desiring to usurp; *ātatāyinaù*—the aggressor; *yudhiñōhiraù*—King Yudhiñōhira; *dharma-bhātām*—of those who strictly follow religious principles; *variñōhaù*—greatest; *saha-anujaiù*—with his younger brothers; *pratyavaruddha*—restricted; *bhojanaù*—acceptance of necessities; *katham*—how; *pravāttaù*—engaged; *kim*—what; *akārañét*—executed; *tataù*—thereafter.

TRANSLATION

Ṣaunaka Muni asked: After killing his enemies who desired to usurp his rightful inheritance, how did the greatest of all religious men, Mahārāja Yudhiñōhira, assisted by his brothers, rule his subjects? Surely he could not freely enjoy his kingdom with unrestricted consciousness.

PURPORT

Mahārāja Yudhiñōhira was the greatest of all men of religion. Thus he was not at all inclined to fight with his cousins for the sake of enjoying the kingdom: he fought for the right cause because the kingdom of Hastināpura was his rightful inheritance and his cousins wanted to usurp it for themselves. He fought, therefore, for the right cause under the guidance of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, but he could not enjoy the results of his victory because his cousins were all killed in the fight. He therefore ruled over the kingdom as a matter of duty, assisted by his younger brothers. The inquiry was important for Ṣaunaka Rsi, who wanted to know about the behavior of Mahārāja Yudhiñōhira when he was at ease to enjoy the kingdom.

TEXT 2

SaUTa ovaç
v&Xa& ku-raev | XadvaiGaniNaôRTa&
Sa&raehiYaTva >av>aavNaae hir")
iNaveXaiYaTva iNaJaraJYa wRîrae
Yauidaiïr& Pa[qTaMaNaa b>aUv h)) 2))

sûta uvāca

vaàçaà kuror vaàça-davāgni-nirhātaà

saàrohayitvā bhava-bhāvano hariù

niveçayitvā nija-rājya éçvaro

yudhiñöhiraà préta-manā babhüva ha

SYNONYMS

sûtaù uvāca—Sûta Gosvami replied; *vaàçam*—dynasty; *kuroù*—of King Kuru; *vaàça-dava-agni*—a forest fire set by the bamboos; *nirhātam*—exhausted; *saàrohayitvā*—seedling of the dynasty; *bhava-bhāvanaù*—the maintainer of creation; *hariù*—the Personality of Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa; *niveçayitvā*—having reestablished; *nija-rājye*—in his own kingdom; *éçvaraù*—the Supreme Lord; *yudhiñöhiraam*—unto Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira; *préta-manäù*—pleased in His mind; *babhüva ha*—became.

TRANSLATION

Sûta Gosvami said: Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who is the maintainer of the world, became pleased after reestablishing Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira in his own kingdom and after restoring the Kuru dynasty, which had been exhausted by the bamboo fire of anger.

PURPORT

This world is compared to a forest fire caused by the cohesion of bamboo bushes. Such a forest fire takes place automatically, for bamboo cohesion occurs without external cause. Similarly, in the material world the wrath of those who want to lord it over material nature interacts, and the fire of war takes place, exhausting the unwanted population. Such fires or wars take place, and the Lord has nothing to do with them. But because He wants to maintain the creation, He desires the mass of people to follow the right path of self-realization, which enables the living beings to enter into the kingdom of God. The Lord wants the suffering human beings to come back home, back to Him, and cease to suffer the threefold material pangs. The whole plan of creation is made in that way, and one who does not come to his senses suffers in the material world by pangs inflicted by the illusory energy of the Lord. The Lord therefore wants His bona fide representative to rule the world. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa descended to establish this sort of regime and to kill the unwanted persons who have nothing to do with His plan. The Battle of Kurukṣetra was fought according to the plan of the Lord so that undesirable persons could get out of the world and a peaceful kingdom under His devotee could be established. The Lord was therefore fully satisfied when King Yudhiṣṭhira was on the throne and the seedling of the dynasty of Kuru, in the person of Mahārāja Parīkṣit, was saved.

TEXT 3

iNaXaMYa >aqZMaaeÇ-MaQaaCYauTaaeÇ&-
Pa[v*taivjaNaivDaUTaiv>a]Ma")
XaXaaSa GaaiMaNd] wvaiJaTaaé[Ya"
PairDYauPaaNTaaMaNauJaaNauviTaRTa")) 3))

niṣāmya bhéñmoktam athācyutoktā

pravāṭṭa-vijīāna-vidhūta-vibhramaù

ṣaṣāsa gām indra ivājitāçrayaù

paridhyupāntām anujānuvartitaù

SYNONYMS

niṣāmya—after listening; *bhéñma-uktam*—what was spoken by Bhéñmadeva; *atha*—as also; *acyuta-uktam*—what was spoken by the infallible Lord Kṛṣṇa; *pravāṭta*—being engaged in; *vijñāna*—perfect knowledge; *vidhūta*—completely washed; *vibhramaṇ*—all misgivings; *çaçāsa*—ruled over; *gām*—the earth; *indra*—the king of the heavenly planet; *iva*—like; *ajita-āçrayaṇ*—protected by the invincible Lord; *paridhi-upāntām*—including the seas; *anuja*—the younger brothers; *anuvartitaṇ*—being followed by them.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, after being enlightened by what was spoken by Bhéñmadeva and Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the infallible, engaged himself in matters of perfect knowledge because all his misgivings were eradicated. Thus he ruled over the earth and seas and was followed by his younger brothers.

PURPORT

The modern English law of primogeniture, or the law of inheritance by the firstborn, was also prevalent in those days when Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira ruled the earth and seas. In those days the King of Hastināpura (now part of New Delhi) was the emperor of the world, including the seas, up to the time of Mahārāja Parékñit, the grandson of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira's younger brothers were acting as his ministers and commanders of state, and there was full cooperation between the perfectly religious brothers of the King. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was the ideal king or representative of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa to rule over the kingdom of earth and was comparable to King Indra, the representative ruler of the heavenly planets. The demigods like Indra, Candra, Sūrya, Varuṇa and Vāyu are representative kings of different planets of the universe, and similarly Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was also one of them, ruling over the kingdom of the earth. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was not a typically unenlightened political leader of modern democracy. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was instructed by Bhéñmadeva and the infallible Lord also, and therefore he had full knowledge of everything in perfection.

The modern elected executive head of a state is just like a puppet because

he has no kingly power. Even if he is enlightened like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, he cannot do anything out of his own good will due to his constitutional position. Therefore, there are so many states over the earth quarreling because of ideological differences or other selfish motives. But a king like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira had no ideology of his own. He had but to follow the instructions of the infallible Lord and the Lord's representative and the authorized agent, Bhéñmadeva. It is instructed in the *sastras* that one should follow the great authority and the infallible Lord without any personal motive and manufactured ideology. Therefore, it was possible for Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira to rule the whole world, including the seas, because the principles were infallible and universally applicable to everyone. The conception of one world state can only be fulfilled if we can follow the infallible authority. An imperfect human being cannot create an ideology acceptable to everyone. Only the perfect and the infallible can create a program which is applicable at every place and can be followed by all in the world. It is the person who rules, and not the impersonal government. If the person is perfect, the government is perfect. If the person is a fool, the government is a fool's paradise. That is the law of nature. There are so many stories of imperfect kings or executive heads. Therefore, the executive head must be a trained person like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, and he must have the full autocratic power to rule over the world. The conception of a world state can take shape only under the regime of a perfect king like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. The world was happy in those days because there were kings like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira to rule over the world.

TEXT 4

**k-aMa& vvzR PaJaRNYa" SavRk-aMadugaa Mahq)
iSaizcu" SMa v]JaaNa(Gaav" PaYaSaaeDaSvTaqMauRda)) 4))**

kämaà vavarña parjanyaù

sarva-käma-dughä mahé

siñicuù sma vrajän gävaù

payasodhasvatér mudä

SYNONYMS

kāmam—everything needed; *vavarña*—was showered; *parjanyaù*—rains; *sarva*—everything; *kāma*—necessities; *dughā*—producer; *mahé*—the land; *siñicuù sma*—moisten; *vrajān*—pasturing grounds; *gāvaù*—the cow; *payasā udhasvatéù*—due to swollen milk bags; *mudā*—because of a joyful attitude.

TRANSLATION

During the reign of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, the clouds showered all the water that people needed, and the earth produced all the necessities of man in profusion. Due to its fatty milk bag and cheerful attitude, the cow used to moisten the grazing ground with milk.

PURPORT

The basic principle of economic development is centered on *land* and *cows*. The necessities of human society are food grains, fruits, milk, minerals, clothing, wood, etc. One requires all these items to fulfill the material needs of the body. Certainly one does not require flesh and fish or iron tools and machinery. During the regime of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, all over the world there were regulated rainfalls. Rainfalls are not in the control of the human being. The heavenly King Indradeva is the controller of rains, and he is the servant of the Lord. When the Lord is obeyed by the king and the people under the king's administration, there are regulated rains from the horizon, and these rains are the causes of all varieties of production on the land. Not only do regulated rains help ample production of grains and fruits, but when they combine with astronomical influences there is ample production of valuable stones and pearls. Grains and vegetables can sumptuously feed a man and animals, and a fatty cow delivers enough milk to supply a man sumptuously with vigor and vitality. If there is enough milk, enough grains, enough fruit, enough cotton, enough silk and enough jewels, then why do the people need cinemas, houses of prostitution, slaughterhouses, etc.? What is the need of an artificial luxurious life of cinema, cars, radio, flesh and hotels? Has this civilization produced anything but quarreling individually and nationally? Has this civilization enhanced the cause of equality and fraternity by sending thousands of men

into a hellish factory and the war fields at the whims of a particular man?

It is said here that the cows used to moisten the pasturing land with milk because their milk bags were fatty and the animals were joyful. Do they not require, therefore, proper protection for a joyful life by being fed with a sufficient quantity of grass in the field? Why should men kill cows for their selfish purposes? Why should man not be satisfied with grains, fruits and milk, which, combined together, can produce hundreds and thousands of palatable dishes. Why are there slaughterhouses all over the world to kill innocent animals? Mahārāja Parékñit, grandson of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, while touring his vast kingdom, saw a black man attempting to kill a cow. The King at once arrested the butcher and chastised him sufficiently. Should not a king or executive head protect the lives of the poor animals who are unable to defend themselves? Is this humanity? Are not the animals of a country citizens also? Then why are they allowed to be butchered in organized slaughterhouses? Are these the signs of equality, fraternity and nonviolence?

Therefore, in contrast with the modern, advanced, civilized form of government, an autocracy like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira's is by far superior to a so-called democracy in which animals are killed and a man less than an animal is allowed to cast votes for another less-than-animal man.

We are all creatures of material nature. In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is said that the Lord Himself is the seed-giving father and material nature is the mother of *all living beings in all shapes*. Thus mother material nature has enough foodstuff both for animals and for men, by the grace of the Father Almighty, Sri Kṛṣṇa. The human being is the elder brother of all other living beings. He is endowed with intelligence more powerful than animals for realizing the course of nature and the indications of the Almighty Father. Human civilizations should depend on the production of material nature without artificially attempting economic development to turn the world into a chaos of artificial greed and power only for the purpose of artificial luxuries and sense gratification. This is but the life of dogs and hogs.

TEXT 5

NaŪ" SaMaud]a iGarYa" SavNaSPaiTavqāDa")
f-l/NTYaaezDaYa" SavaR" k-aMaMaNv*Tau TaSYa vE)) 5))

nadyaù samudrā girayaù

savanaspati-vérudhaù

phalanty oñadhayaù sarvāù

kāmam anvātu tasya vai

SYNONYMS

nadyaù—rivers; *samudrāù*—oceans; *girayaù*—hills and mountains;
savanaspati—vegetables; *vérudhaù*—creepers; *phalanti*—active;
oñadhayaù—drugs; *sarvāù*—all; *kāmam*—necessities; *anvātu*—seasonal;
tasya—for the King; *vai*—certainly.

TRANSLATION

The rivers, oceans, hills, mountains, forests, creepers and active drugs, in every season, paid their tax quota to the King in profusion.

PURPORT

Since Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was under the protection of the *ajita*, the infallible Lord, as above mentioned, the properties of the Lord, namely the rivers, oceans, hills, forests, etc., were all pleased, and they used to supply their respective quota of taxes to the King. The secret to success *is to take refuge under the protection of the Supreme Lord*. Without His sanction, nothing can be possible. To make economic development by our own endeavors on the strength of tools and machinery is not all. The sanction of the Supreme Lord must be there, otherwise despite all instrumental arrangements everything will be unsuccessful. The ultimate cause of success is the *daiva*, the Supreme. Kings like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira knew perfectly well that the king is the agent of the Supreme Lord to look after the welfare of the mass of people. Actually the state belongs to the

Supreme Lord. The rivers, oceans, forests, hills, drugs, etc., are not creations of man. They are all creations of the Supreme Lord, and the living being is allowed to make use of the property of the Lord for the service of the Lord. Today's slogan is that everything is for the people, and therefore the government is for the people and by the people. But to produce a new species of humanity at the present moment on the basis of God consciousness and perfection of human life, the ideology of godly communism, the world has to again follow in the footsteps of kings like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira or Parékñit. There is enough of everything by the will of the Lord, and we can make proper use of things to live comfortably without enmity between men, or animal and man or nature. The control of the Lord is everywhere, and if the Lord is pleased, every part of nature will be pleased. The river will flow profusely to fertilize the land; the oceans will supply sufficient quantities of minerals, pearls and jewels; the forest will supply sufficient wood, drugs and vegetables, and the seasonal changes will effectively help produce fruits and flowers in profuse quantity. The artificial way of living depending on factories and tools can render so-called happiness only to a limited number at the cost of millions. Since the energy of the mass of people is engaged in factory production, the natural products are being hampered, and for this the mass is unhappy. Without being educated properly, the mass of people are following in the footsteps of the vested interests by exploiting natural reserves, and therefore there is acute competition between individual and individual and nation and nation. There is no control by the trained agent of the Lord. We must look into the defects of modern civilization by comparison here, and should follow in the footsteps of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira to cleanse man and wipe out anachronisms.

TEXT 6

**NaaDaYaae VYaaDaYa" @e-Xaa dEv>aUTaaTMaheTav")
AJaaTaXa}aav>avNa(JaNTaUNaa& raij k-ihRicTa()) 6))**

nādhayo vyādhayaù kleçä

daiva-bhütätma-hetavaù

ajāta-çatrāv abhavan

jantünää räjjī karhicit

SYNONYMS

na—never; *ādhayaù*—anxieties; *vyādhayaù*—diseases; *kleçäù*—trouble due to excessive heat and cold; *daiva-bhūta-ātma*—all due to the body, supernatural power and other living beings; *hetavaù*—due to the cause of; *ajāta-çatrau*—unto one who has no enemy; *abhavan*—happened; *jantünäm*—of the living beings; *räjjī*—unto the King; *karhicit*—at any time.

TRANSLATION

Because of the King's having no enemy, the living beings were not at any time disturbed by mental agonies, diseases, or excessive heat or cold.

PURPORT

To be nonviolent to human beings and to be a killer or enemy of the poor animals is Satan's philosophy. In this age there is enmity toward poor animals, and therefore the poor creatures are always anxious. The reaction of the poor animals is being forced on human society, and therefore there is always the strain of cold or hot war between men, individually, collectively or nationally. At the time of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, there were no different nations, although there were different subordinate states. The whole world was united, and the supreme head, being a trained king like Yudhiñöhira, kept all the inhabitants free from anxiety, diseases and excessive heat and cold. They were not only economically well-to-do, but also physically fit and undisturbed by supernatural power, by enmity from other living beings and by disturbance of bodily and mental agonies. There is a proverb in Bengali that a bad king spoils the kingdom and a bad housewife spoils the family. This truth is applicable here also. Because the King was pious and obedient to the Lord and sages, because he was no one's enemy and because he was a recognized agent of the Lord and therefore protected by Him, all the citizens under the King's protection were, so to speak, directly protected by the Lord and His authorized agents.

Unless one is pious and recognized by the Lord, he cannot make others happy who are under his care. There is full cooperation between man and God and man and nature, and this conscious cooperation between man and God and man and nature, as exemplified by King Yudhiñöhira, can bring about happiness, peace and prosperity in the world. The attitude of exploiting one another, the custom of the day, will only bring misery.

TEXT 7

**oizTva haiSTaNaPaure MaaSaaNa(k-iTaPaYaaNa(hir")
Sauôda& c ivXaaek-aYa SvSauê iPa[Yak-aMYaYaa)) 7))**

uñitvä hästinapure

mäsän katipayän hariù

suhådäà ca viçokäya

svasuç ca priya-kämyayä

SYNONYMS

uñitvä—staying; *hästinapure*—in the city of Hastinäpura; *mäsän*—months; *katipayän*—a few; *hariù*—Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *suhådäm*—relatives; *ca*—also; *viçokäya*—for pacifying them; *svasuù*—the sister; *ca*—and; *priya-kämyayä*—for pleasing.

TRANSLATION

Sri Hari, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, resided at Hastinäpura for a few months to pacify His relatives and please His own sister [Subhadrä].

PURPORT

Kṛṣṇa was to start for Dvārakä, His own kingdom, after the Battle of Kurukñetra and Yudhiñöhira's being enthroned, but to oblige the request of Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira and to show special mercy to Bhéñmadeva, Lord

Kṛṣṇa stopped at Hastināpura, the capital of the Pāṇḍavas. The Lord decided to stay especially to pacify the aggrieved King as well as to please Subhadrā, sister of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. Subhadrā was especially to be pacified because she lost her only son, Abhimanyu, who was just married. The boy left his wife, Uttarā, mother of Mahārāja Parīkṣit. The Lord is always pleased to satisfy His devotees in any capacity. Only His devotees can play the parts of His relatives. The Lord is absolute.

TEXT 8

AaMaN}Ya ca>YaNaujaTa" PairZvJYaai>avaŪ TaMa()
Aaāraeh rQa& kE-iêTPairZvç-ae_i>avaidTa")) 8))

āmantrya cābhyanujiātaù

pariñvajyābhivādyā tam

āruroha rathāḥ kaiçcit

pariñvaktāḥ bhivāditaù

SYNONYMS

āmantrya—taking permission; *ca*—and; *abhyanujiātaù*—being permitted; *pariñvajya*—embracing; *abhivādyā*—bowing down at the feet; *tam*—unto Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira; *āruroha*—ascended; *ratham*—the chariot; *kaiçcit*—by someone; *pariñvaktāḥ*—being embraced; *abhivāditaù*—being offered obeisances.

TRANSLATION

Afterwards, when the Lord asked permission to depart and the King gave it, the Lord offered His respects to Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira by bowing down at his feet, and the King embraced Him. After this the Lord, being embraced by others and receiving their obeisances, got into His chariot.

PURPORT

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was the elder cousin of Lord Kṛṣṇa, and therefore while departing from him the Lord bowed down at the King's feet. The King embraced Him as a younger brother, although the King knew perfectly well that Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The Lord takes pleasure when some of His devotees accept Him as less important in terms of love. No one is greater than or equal to the Lord, but He takes pleasure in being treated as younger than His devotees. These are all transcendental pastimes of the Lord. The impersonalist cannot enter into the supernatural roles played by the devotee of the Lord. Thereafter Bhéma and Arjuna embraced the Lord because they were of the same age, but Nakula and Sahadeva bowed down before the Lord because they were younger than He.

TEXTS 9–10

**Sau>ad]a d]aEPadq ku-NTaq ivra\$=TaNaYaa TaQaa)
 GaaN Daarq Da*Taraí\ê YauYauTSauGaaÇTaMaaE)) 9))
 v*k-aedrê DaaEMYaê iñYaae MaTSYaSauTaadYa")
 Na Saeihre ivMauùNTaae ivrh& Xaa®RDaNvNa")) 10))**

subhadrā draupadé kunté

viräöa-tanayä tathä

gāndhäré dhātarāñöraç ca

yuyutsur gautamo yamau

våkodaraç ca dhaumyaç ca

striyo matsya-sutādayaù

na sehire vimuhyanto

virahaà çärìga-dhanvanaù

SYNONYMS

subhadrä—the sister of Kṛṣṇa; *draupadé*—the wife of the Pääòavas; *kunté*—the mother of the Pääòavas; *viräöa-tanayä*—the daughter of Viräöa (Uttarä); *tathä*—also; *gändhäre*—the mother of Duryodhana; *dhåtaräñörau*—the father of Duryodhana; *ca*—and; *yuyutsu*—the son of Dhåtaräñöra by his *vaiçya* wife; *gautama*—Kåpücärya; *yama*—the twin brothers Nakula and Sahadeva; *våkodara*—Bhéma; *ca*—and; *dhaumya*—Dhaumya; *ca*—and; *striya*—also other ladies of the palace; *matsya-sutä-ädaya*—the daughter of a fisherman (Satyavati, Bhéñma's stepmother); *na*—could not; *sehira*—tolerate; *vimuhyanta*—almost fainting; *viraham*—separation; *çäriga-dhanvana*—of Sri Kṛṣṇa, who bears a conch in His hand.

TRANSLATION

At that time Subhadrä, Draupadé, Kunté, Uttarä, Gändhäre, Dhåtaräñöra, Yuyutsu, Kåpücärya, Nakula, Sahadeva, Bhémasena, Dhaumya and Satyavati all nearly fainted because it was impossible for them to bear separation from Lord Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is so attractive for the living beings, especially for the devotees, that it is impossible for them to tolerate separation. The conditioned soul under the spell of illusory energy forgets the Lord, otherwise he cannot. The feeling of such separation cannot be described, but it can simply be imagined by devotees only. After His separation from Våndävana and the innocent rural cowherd boys, girls, ladies and others, they all felt shock throughout their lives, and the separation of Rådhäräëé, the most beloved cowherd girl, is beyond expression. Once they met at Kurukñetra during a solar eclipse, and the feeling which was expressed by them is heartrending. There is, of course, a difference in the qualities of the transcendental devotees of the Lord, but none of them who have ever contacted the Lord by direct communion or otherwise can leave Him for a moment. That is the attitude of the pure devotee.

TEXTS 11–12

SaTSa®aN Mauç-du"Sa®ae haTau& NaaeTSahTae buDa")

k-ITYaRMaaNa& YaXaae YaSYa Sak*-dak-<YaR raecNaMa()) 11))
TaiSMaNNYaSTaiDaYa" PaaQaaR" SaherNa(ivrh& k-QaMa()
dXaRNaSPaXaRSa&I/aPaXaYaNaSaNa>aaeJaNaE")) 12))

sat-saigän mukta-duùsaigo

hätuà notsahate budhaù

kértyamānaà yaço yasya

sakâd äkarëya rocanam

tasmin nyasta-dhiyaù pärthäù

saheran virahaà katham

darçana-sparça-saàläpa-

çayanäsana-bhojanaiù

SYNONYMS

sat-saigät—by the association of pure devotees; *mukta-duùsaigaù*—freed from bad materialistic association; *hätum*—to give up; *na utsahate*—never attempts; *budhaù*—one who has understood the Lord; *kértyamānam*—glorifying; *yaçaù*—fame; *yasya*—whose; *sakât*—once only; *äkarëya*—hearing only; *rocanam*—pleasing; *tasmin*—unto Him; *nyasta-dhiyaù*—one who has given his mind unto Him; *pärthäù*—the sons of Pâthä; *saheran*—can tolerate; *viraham*—separation; *katham*—how; *darçana*—seeing face to face; *sparça*—touching; *saàläpa*—conversing; *çayana*—sleeping; *äsana*—sitting; *bhojanaiù*—dining together.

TRANSLATION

The intelligent, who have understood the Supreme Lord in association with pure devotees and have become freed from bad materialistic association, can never avoid hearing the glories of the Lord, even though

they have heard them only once. How, then, could the Pääòavas tolerate His separation, for they had been intimately associated with His person, seeing Him face to face, touching Him, conversing with Him, and sleeping, sitting and dining with Him?

PURPORT

The living being's constitutional position is one of serving a superior. He is obliged to serve by force the dictates of illusory material energy in different phases of sense gratification. And in serving the senses he is never tired. Even though he may be tired, the illusory energy perpetually forces him to do so without being satisfied. There is no end to such sense gratificatory business, and the conditioned soul becomes entangled in such servitude without hope of release. The release is only effected by association with pure devotees. By such association one is gradually promoted to his transcendental consciousness. Thus he can know that his eternal position is to render service unto the Lord and not to the perverted senses in the capacity of lust, anger, desire to lord it over, etc. Material society, friendship and love are all different phases of lust. Home, country, family, society, wealth and all sorts of corollaries are all causes of bondage in the material world, where the threefold miseries of life are concomitant factors. By associating with pure devotees and by hearing them submissively, attachment for material enjoyment becomes slackened, and attraction for hearing about the transcendental activities of the Lord becomes prominent. Once they are, they will go on progressively without stoppage, like fire in gunpowder. It is said that Hari, the Personality of Godhead, is so transcendently attractive that even those who are self-satisfied by self-realization and are factually liberated from all material bondage also become devotees of the Lord. Under the circumstances it is easily understood what must have been the position of the Pääòavas, who were constant companions of the Lord. They could not even think of separation from Sri Kṛṣṇa, since the attraction was more intense for them because of continuous personal contact. His remembrance by His form, quality, name, fame, pastimes, etc., is also attractive for the pure devotee, so much so that he forgets all forms, quality, name, fame and activities of the mundane world, and due to his mature association with pure devotees he is not out of contact with the Lord for a moment.

TEXT 13

SaveR Tae_iNaiMazEr+aESTaMaNaud]uTaceTaSa")
vq+aNTa" òehSaMbÖa ivcelu/STa}a Ta}a h)) 13))

sarve te 'nimiñair akñais

tam anu druta-cetasaù

vékñantaù sneha-sambaddhä

vicelus tatra tatra ha

SYNONYMS

sarve—all; *te*—they; *animiñaiù*—without twinkling of the eyes; *akñaiù*—by the eye; *tam anu*—after Him; *druta-cetasaù*—melted heart; *vékñantaù*—looking upon Him; *sneha-sambaddhä*—bound by pure affection; *vicelu*—began to move; *tatra tatra*—here and there; *ha*—so they did.

TRANSLATION

All their hearts were melting for Him on the pot of attraction. They looked at Him without blinking their eyes, and they moved hither and thither in perplexity.

PURPORT

Kṛṣṇa is naturally attractive for all living beings because He is the chief eternal amongst all eternals. He alone is the maintainer of the many eternals. This is stated in the *Kaõha Upaniñad*, and thus one can obtain permanent peace and prosperity by revival of one's eternal relation with Him, now forgotten under the spell of *mäyã*, the illusory energy of the Lord. Once this relation is slightly revived, the conditioned soul at once becomes freed from the illusion of material energy and becomes mad after the association of the Lord. This association is made possible not only by personal contact with the Lord, but also by association with His name,

fame, form and quality. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* trains the conditioned soul to this stage of perfection by submissive hearing from the pure devotee.

TEXT 14

NYaåNDaàuÓI/ØaZPaMaaETk-<#yaÕevk-ISauTae)
iNaYaaRTYaGaaraàae_>ad]iMaiTa SYaaØaNDaviñYa")) 14))

nyarundhann udgalad bāñpam

autkaëöhyäd devaké-sute

niryäty agärän no 'bhadram

iti syäd bāndhava-striyaù

SYNONYMS

nyarundhan—checking with great difficulty; *udgalat*—overflowing; *bāñpam*—tears; *autkaëöhyät*—because of great anxiety; *devaké-sute*—unto the son of Devaké; *niryäti*—having come out; *agärät*—from the palace; *naù*—not; *abhadram*—inauspiciousness; *iti*—thus; *syät*—may happen; *bāndhava*—relative; *striyaù*—ladies.

TRANSLATION

The female relatives, whose eyes were flooded with tears out of anxiety for Kṛṣṇa, came out of the palace. They could stop their tears only with great difficulty. They feared that tears would cause misfortune at the time of departure.

PURPORT

There were hundreds of ladies in the palace of Hastināpura. All of them were affectionate to Kṛṣṇa. All of them were relatives also. When they saw that Kṛṣṇa was going away from the palace for His native place, they were very anxious for Him, and as usual tears began to roll down their cheeks.

They thought, at the same time, that tears at that moment might be a cause of misfortune for Kṛṣṇa; therefore they wanted to check them. This was very difficult for them because the tears could not be checked. Therefore, they smeared their tears in their eyes, and their hearts throbbed. Therefore ladies who were the wives and daughters-in-law of those who died in the battlefield never came in direct contact with Kṛṣṇa. But all of them heard of Him and His great activities, and thus they thought of Him, talked of Him, His name, fame, etc., and became affectionate also, like those who were in direct contact. Therefore directly or indirectly anyone who thinks of Kṛṣṇa, talks of Kṛṣṇa or worships Kṛṣṇa becomes attached to Him. Because Kṛṣṇa is absolute, there is no difference between His name, form, quality, etc. Our intimate relation with Kṛṣṇa can be confidentially revived by our talking of, hearing of, or remembering Him. It is so done due to spiritual potency.

TEXT 15

**Ma*d®Xa«>aeYaRê vq<aaPa<avGaaeMau%a")
DauNDauYaaRNak-ga<\$=aÛa NaeduduRNdu>aYaSTaQaa)) 15))**

mādaiga-ṣaikhā-bheryaṣ ca

véëä-paëava-gomukhäu

dhundhury-änaka-ghaëöädyä

nedur dundubhayas tathä

SYNONYMS

mādaiga—sweet sounding drum; *ṣaikhā*—conchshell; *bheryaṣ*—brass band; *ca*—and; *véëä*—string band; *paëava*—a kind of flute; *gomukhäu*—another flute; *dhundhuré*—another drum; *änaka*—kettle; *ghaëöä*—bell; *ädyäu*—others; *nedu*—sounded; *dundubhaya*—other different types of drums; *tathä*—at that time.

TRANSLATION

While the Lord was departing from the palace of Hastināpura, different types of drums —like the mādāiga, dhola, nagra, dhundhuré and dundubhi—and flutes of different types, the véëä, gomukha and bheré, all sounded together to show Him honor.

TEXT 16

Pa[aSaadiXa%raæ!a" ku-âNaaYaaeR idd*+aYaa)
vv*zu" ku-SauMaE" k*-Z<a& Pa[eMav]q@aiSMaTae+a<aa")) 16))

präsāda-çikharärüòhäu

kuru-näryo didākñayä

vavāñuù kusumaiù kãñëaà

prema-vréòä-smitekñäëäù

SYNONYMS

präsāda—palace; *çikhara*—the roof; *ärüòhäu*—ascending; *kuru-näryaù*—the ladies of the Kuru royalty; *didākñayä*—seeing; *vavāñuù*—showered; *kusumaiù*—by flowers; *kãñëam*—upon Lord Kṛṣṇa; *prema*—out of affection and love; *vréòä-smita-ékñäëäù*—glancing with shy smiles.

TRANSLATION

Out of a loving desire to see the Lord, the royal ladies of the Kurus got up on top of the palace, and smiling with affection and shyness, they showered flowers upon the Lord.

PURPORT

Shyness is a particular extra-natural beauty of the fair sex, and it commands respect from the opposite sex. This custom was observed even during the days of the *Mahābhārata*, i.e., more than five thousand years ago. It is only the less intelligent persons not well versed in the history of the world who

say that observance of separation of female from male is an introduction of the Mohammedan period in India. This incident from the *Mahābhārata* period proves definitely that the ladies of the palace observed strict *pardā* (restricted association with men), and instead of coming down in the open air where Lord Kṛṣṇa and others were assembled, the ladies of the palace went up on the top of the palace and from there paid their respects to Lord Kṛṣṇa by showers of flowers. It is definitely stated here that the ladies were smiling there on the top of the palace, checked by shyness. This shyness is a gift of nature to the fair sex, and it enhances their beauty and prestige, even if they are of a less important family or even if they are less attractive. We have practical experience of this fact. A sweeper woman commanded the respect of many respectable gentlemen simply by manifesting a lady's shyness. Half-naked ladies in the street do not command any respect, but a shy sweeper's wife commands respect from all.

Human civilization, as conceived of by the sages of India, is to help one free himself from the clutches of illusion. The material beauty of a woman is an illusion because actually the body is made of earth, water, fire, air, etc. But because there is the association of the living spark with matter, it appears to be beautiful. No one is attracted by an earthen doll, even if it is most perfectly prepared to attract the attention of others. The dead body has no beauty because no one will accept the dead body of a so-called beautiful woman. Therefore, the conclusion is that the spirit spark is beautiful, and because of the soul's beauty one is attracted by the beauty of the outward body. The Vedic wisdom, therefore, forbids us to be attracted by false beauty. But because we are now in the darkness of ignorance, the Vedic civilization allows very restricted mixing of woman and man. They say that the woman is considered to be the fire, and the man is considered to be the butter. The butter must melt in association with fire, and therefore they may be brought together only when it is necessary. And shyness is a check to the unrestricted mixing. It is nature's gift, and it must be utilized.

TEXT 17

iSaTaaTaPa}a& JaGa]ah Mauç-adaMaiv>aUizTaMa()
rÒd<@& Gau@ake-Xa" iPa[Ya" iPa[YaTaMaSYa h)) 17))

sitātapatraà jagrāha

muktādāma-vibhūñitam

ratna-daëòàà guòäkeçaù

priyaù priyatamasya ha

SYNONYMS

sita-ātapatram—soothing umbrella; *jagrāha*—took up; *muktā-dāma*—decorated with laces and pearls; *vibhūñitam*—embroidered; *ratna-daëòam*—with a handle of jewels; *guòäkeçaù*—Arjuna, the expert warrior, or one who has conquered sleep; *priyaù*—most beloved; *priyatamasya*—of the most beloved; *ha*—so he did.

TRANSLATION

At that time Arjuna, the great warrior and conqueror of sleep, who is the intimate friend of the most beloved Supreme Lord, took up an umbrella which had a handle of jewels and was embroidered with lace and pearls.

PURPORT

Gold, jewels, pearls and valuable stones were used in the luxurious royal ceremonies. They are all nature's gifts and are produced by the hills, oceans, etc., by the order of the Lord, when man does not waste his valuable time in producing unwanted things in the name of necessities. By so-called development of industrial enterprises, they are now using pots of gutta-percha instead of metals like gold, silver, brass and copper. They are using margarine instead of purified butter, and one fourth of the city population has no shelter.

TEXT 18

**oÖv" SaaTYaik-êEv VYaJaNae ParMaad(>auTae)
ivk-IYaRMaa<a" ku-SauMaE reJae MaDauPaiTa" PaiQa)) 18))**

uddhavaù sätyakiç caiva

vyajane paramädbhute

vikéryamäëaù kusumai

reje madhu-patiù pathi

SYNONYMS

uddhavaù—a cousin-brother of Kṛṣṇa's; *sätyakiù*—His driver; *ca*—and; *eva*—certainly; *vyajane*—engaged in fanning; *parama-adbhute*—decorative; *vikéryamäëaù*—seated on scattered; *kusumaiù*—flowers all around; *reje*—commanded; *madhu-patiù*—the master of Madhu (Kṛṣṇa); *pathi*—on the road.

TRANSLATION

Uddhava and Sätyaki began to fan the Lord with decorated fans, and the Lord, as the master of Madhu, seated on scattered flowers, commanded them along the road.

TEXT 19

Aé[UYaNTaaiXaz" SaTYaaSTa}a Ta}a iÜJaeirTaa")
NaaNauæPaaNauæPaaê iNaGauR<aSYa Gau<aaTMaNa")) 19))

açrüyantäçiññaù satyäs

tatra tatra dvijeritäù

nänurüpänurüpäç ca

nirguëasya guëätmanaù

SYNONYMS

açrüyanta—being heard; *äçĩñau*—benediction; *satyäu*—all truths; *tatra*—here; *tatra*—there; *dvija-éritäu*—sounded by learned *brahmanas*; *na*—not; *anurüpa*—befitting; *anurüpäu*—fitting; *ca*—also; *nirguëasya*—of the Absolute; *guëa-ätmanaù*—playing the role of a human being.

TRANSLATION

It was being heard here and there that the benedictions being paid to Kṛṣṇa were neither befitting nor unbefitting because they were all for the Absolute, who was now playing the part of a human being.

PURPORT

At places there were sounds of Vedic benediction aiming at the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa. The benedictions were fitting in the sense that the Lord was playing the part of a human being, as if a cousin of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, but they were also unfitting because the Lord is absolute and has nothing to do with any kind of material relativities. He is *nirguëa*, or there are no material qualities in Him, but He is full of transcendental qualities. In the transcendental world there is nothing contradictory, whereas in the relative world everything has its opposite. In the relative world white is the opposite conception of black, but in the transcendental world there is no distinction between white and black. Therefore the sounds of benedictions uttered by the learned *brahmanas* here and there appear to be contradictory in relation with the Absolute Person, but when they are applied to the Absolute Person they lose all contradiction and become transcendental. One example may clear this idea. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is sometimes described as a thief. He is very famous amongst His pure devotees as the Mākhana-cora. He used to steal butter from the houses of neighbors at Våndāvana in His early age. Since then He is famous as a thief. But in spite of His being famous as a thief, He is worshiped as a thief, whereas in the mundane world a thief is punished and is never praised. Since He is the Absolute Personality of Godhead, everything is applicable to Him, and still in spite of all contradictions He is the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 20

ANYaaeNYaMaaSaqTSaĀLPa otaMaëaek-ceTaSaaMa()
k-aErveNd]Paurñq<aa& SavRé[uiTaMaNaaehr")) 20))

anyonyam äsét saiĳalpa

uttama-çloka-cetasäm

kauravendra-pura-stréëää

sarva-śruti-mano-haraù

SYNONYMS

anyonyam—among each other; *äsét*—there was; *saiĳalpaù*—talking; *uttama-çloka*—the Supreme, who is praised by selected poetry; *cetasäm*—of those whose hearts are absorbed in that way; *kaurava-indra*—the king of the Kurus; *pura*—capital; *stréëäm*—all the ladies; *sarva*—all; *śruti*—the *Vedas*; *manaù-haraù*—attractive to the mind.

TRANSLATION

Absorbed in the thought of the transcendental qualities of the Lord, who is glorified in select poetry, the ladies on the roofs of all the houses of Hastināpura began to talk of Him. This talk was more attractive than the hymns of the Vedas.

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is said that in all the Vedic literatures the goal is the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa. Factually the glories of the Lord are depicted in such literature as the *Vedas*, *Ramayana* and *Mahābhārata*. And in the *Bhāgavatam* they are specifically mentioned in respect to the Supreme Lord. Therefore, while the ladies on the tops of the houses in the capital of the kings of the Kuru dynasty were talking about the Lord, their talk was more pleasing than the Vedic hymns. Anything sung in the praise of the Lord is *Çruti-mantra*. There are songs of Ōhākura Narottama dāsa, one of the *ācāryas* in the Gauḍeya-sampradāya, composed in simple

Bengali language. But Öhäkura Visvanatha Cakravarti, another very learned *äcärya* of the same *sampradäya*, has approved the songs by Öhäkura Narottama dāsa to be as good as Vedic *mantras*. And this is so because of the subject matter. The language is immaterial, but the subject matter is important. The ladies, who were all absorbed in the thought and actions of the Lord, developed the consciousness of Vedic wisdom by the grace of the Lord. And therefore although such ladies might not have been very learned scholars in Sanskrit or otherwise, still whatever they spoke was more attractive than the Vedic hymns. The Vedic hymns in the *Upaniñads* are sometimes indirectly directed to the Supreme Lord. But the talks of the ladies were directly spoken of the Lord, and thus they were more pleasing to the heart. The ladies' talks appeared to be more valuable than the learned *brahmanas'* benedictions.

TEXT 21

Sa vE ik-I/aYa& Pauāz" PauraTaNaae
 Ya Wk- AaSaqdivXaez AaTMaiNa)
 AGa]e Gau<ae>Yaae JaGadaTMaNaqìre
 iNaMaqil/TaaTMaiàìXa SauáXaiç-zu)) 21))

sa vai kiläyaà puruṣaù purätano

ya eka äséd aviṣeña ätmani

agre guëebhyo jagad-ätmanéçvare

nimélitätman niçi supta-çaktiñu

SYNONYMS

saù—He (Kṛṣṇa); *vai*—as I remember; *kila*—definitely; *ayam*—this; *puruṣaù*—Personality of Godhead; *purätanaù*—the original; *yaù*—who; *ekaù*—only one; *äsét*—existed; *aviṣeñaù*—materially unmanifested; *ätmani*—own self; *agre*—before creation; *guëebhyaù*—of the modes of nature; *jagat-ätmani*—unto the Supersoul; *éçvare*—unto the Supreme Lord; *nimélita*—merged into; *ätman*—the living entity; *niçi supta*—inactive

at night; *çaktiñu*—of the energies.

TRANSLATION

They said: Here He is, the original Personality of Godhead as we definitely remember Him. He alone existed before the manifested creation of the modes of nature, and in Him only, because He is the Supreme Lord, all living beings merge, as if sleeping at night, their energy suspended.

PURPORT

There are two types of dissolution of the manifested cosmos. At the end of every 4,320,000,000 solar years, when Brahmā, the lord of one particular universe, goes to sleep, there is one annihilation. And at the end of Lord Brahmā's life, which takes place at the end of Brahmā's one hundred years of age, in our calculation at the end of 8,640,000,000 x 30 x 12 x 100 solar years, there is complete annihilation of the entire universe, and in both the periods both the material energy called the *mahat-tattva* and the marginal energy called *jiva-tattva* merge in the person of the Supreme Lord. The living beings remain asleep within the body of the Lord until there is another creation of the material world, and that is the way of the creation, maintenance and annihilation of the material manifestation.

The material creation is effected by the interaction of the three modes of material nature set in action by the Lord, and therefore it is said here that the Lord existed before the modes of material nature were set in motion. In the *Çruti-mantra* it is said that only Viṣṇu, the Supreme Lord, existed before the creation, and there was no Brahmā, Siva or other demigods. Viṣṇu means the Mahā-Viṣṇu, who is lying on the Causal Ocean. By His breathing only all the universes are generated in seeds and gradually develop into gigantic forms with innumerable planets within each and every universe. The seeds of universes develop into gigantic forms in the way seeds of a banyan tree develop into numberless banyan trees.

This Mahā-Viṣṇu is the plenary portion of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, who is mentioned in the *Brahma-saṃhitā* as follows:

“Let me offer my respectful obeisances unto the original Personality of Godhead, Govinda, whose plenary portion is the Mahā-Viṣṇu. All the Brahmās, the heads of the universes, live only for the period of His exhaling, after the universes are generated from the pores of His transcendental body.” (*Brahma-saṃhitā* 5.58)

Thus Govinda, or Lord Kṛṣṇa, is the cause of Mahā-Viṣṇu also. The ladies talking about this Vedic truth must have heard it from authoritative sources. An authoritative source is the only means of knowing about transcendental subject matter definitely. There is no alternative.

The merging of the living beings into the body of Mahā-Viṣṇu takes place automatically at the end of Brahmā’s one hundred years. But that does not mean that the individual living being loses his identity. The identity is there, and as soon as there is another creation by the supreme will of the Lord, all the sleeping, inactive living beings are again let loose to begin their activities in the continuation of past different spheres of life. It is called *suptotthita naya*, or awakening from sleep and again engaging in one’s respective continuous duty. When a man is asleep at night, he forgets himself, what he is, what his duty is and everything of his waking state. But as soon as he awakens from slumber, he remembers all that he has to do and thus engages himself again in his prescribed activities. The living beings also remain merged in the body of Mahā-Viṣṇu during the period of annihilation, but as soon as there is another creation they arise to take up their unfinished work. This is also confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita* (8.18–20).

The Lord existed before the creative energy was set in action. The Lord is not a product of the material energy. His body is completely spiritual, and there is no difference between His body and Himself. Before creation the Lord remained in His abode, which is absolute and one.

TEXT 22

Sa Wv >aUYaae iNaJavqYaRcaeidTaa&
SvJaqvMaaYaa& Pa[k*-iTaa& iSaSa*+aTaaMa()
ANaaMaæPaaTMaiNa æPaNaaMaNaq

iviDaTSaMaaNaae_NauSaSaar Xaañk*-Ta()) 22))

sa eva bhüyo nija-vérya-coditää

sva-jéva-mäyää prakâtià sisâkñatém

anäma-rüpätmani rüpa-nämané

vidhitsamäno 'nusasära çästra-kât

SYNONYMS

saù—He; *eva*—thus; *bhüyaù*—again; *nija*—own personal; *vérya*—potency; *coditäm*—performance of; *sva*—own; *jéva*—living being; *mäyäm*—external energy; *prakâtim*—unto material nature; *sisâkñatém*—while re-creating; *anäma*—without mundane designation; *rüpa-ätmani*—forms of the soul; *rüpa-nämané*—forms and names; *vidhitsamänaù*—desiring to award; *anusasära*—entrusted; *çästra-kât*—the compiler of revealed scripture.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead, again desiring to give names and forms to His parts and parcels, the living entities, placed them under the guidance of material nature. By His own potency, material nature is empowered to re-create.

PURPORT

The living entities are parts and parcels of the Lord. They are of two varieties, namely *nitya-mukta* and *nitya-baddha*. The *nitya-muktas* are eternally liberated souls, and they are eternally engaged in the reciprocation of transcendental loving service with the Lord in His eternal abode beyond the manifested mundane creations. But the *nitya-baddha*, or eternally conditioned souls, are entrusted to His external energy, *mäyä*, for rectification of their rebellious attitude toward the Supreme Father. *Nitya-baddhas* are eternally forgetful of their relation with the Lord as parts and parcels. They are bewildered by the illusory energy as products of matter,

and thus they are very busy in making plans in the material world for becoming happy. They go on merrily with plans, but by the will of the Lord both the planmakers and the plans are annihilated at the end of a certain period, as above mentioned. This is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita* as follows: “O son of Kunté, at the end of the millennium all the living entities merge into My nature, and again when the time of creation is ripe, I begin creation by the agency of My external energy.” (Bg. 9.7)

The word *bhüyaù* indicates again and again, that is to say the process of creation, maintenance and annihilation is going on perpetually by the external energy of the Lord. He is the cause of everything. But the living beings, who are constitutionally the parts and parcels of the Lord and are forgetful of the sweet relation, are given a chance again to get rid of the clutches of the external energy. And to revive his (the living being’s) consciousness, the revealed scriptures are also created by the Lord. Vedic literatures are the guiding directions for the conditioned souls so they can get free from the repetition of creation and annihilation of the material world and the material body.

The Lord says in the *Bhagavad-gita*, “This created world and material energy are under My control. Under the influence of *prakâti*, automatically they are created again and again, and this is done by Me through the agency of My external energy.”

Actually the spiritual spark living entities have no material names or forms. But in order to fulfill their desire to lord it over the material energy of material forms and names, they are given a chance for such false enjoyment, and at the same time they are given a chance to understand the real position through the revealed scriptures. The foolish and forgetful living being is always busy with false forms and false names. Modern nationalism is the culmination of such false names and false forms. Men are mad after false name and form. The form of body obtained under certain conditions is taken up as factual, and the name also taken bewilders the conditioned soul into misusing the energy in the name of so many “isms.” The scriptures, however, supply the clue for understanding the real position, but men are reluctant to take lessons from the scriptures created by the Lord for different places and times. For example, the *Bhagavad-gita*

is the guiding principle for every human being, but by the spell of material energy they do not take care to carry out the programs of life in terms of the *Bhagavad-gita*. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is the post-graduate study of knowledge for one who has thoroughly understood the principles of the *Bhagavad-gita*. Unfortunately people have no taste for them, and therefore they are under the clutches of *māyā* for repetition of birth and death.

TEXT 23

**Sa va AYa& YaTPadMa}a SaUrYaae
iJaTaeiNd]Yaa iNaiJaRTaMaaTairiNa")
PaXYaiNTa >aç-yuTk-il/TaaMal/aTMaNaa
NaNvez Satv& PairMaaíuRMahRiTà)) 23))**

sa vä ayaà yat padam atra sūrayo

jitendriyā nirjita-mātariçvanaù

paçyanti bhakty-utkalitāmalätmanä

nanv eña sattvaà parimärñöum arhati

SYNONYMS

saù—He; *vai*—by providence; *ayam*—this; *yat*—that which; *padam atra*—here is the same Personality of Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa; *sūrayaù*—great devotees; *jita-indriyäù*—who have overcome the influence of the senses; *nirjita*—thoroughly controlled; *mātariçvanaù*—life; *paçyanti*—can see; *bhakti*—by dint of devotional service; *utkalita*—developed; *amala-ätmanä*—those whose minds are thoroughly cleansed; *nanu eñaù*—certainly by this only; *sattvam*—existence; *parimärñöum*—for purifying the mind completely; *arhati*—deserve.

TRANSLATION

Here is the same Supreme Personality of Godhead whose transcendental form is experienced by the great devotees who are completely cleansed

of material consciousness by dint of rigid devotional service and full control of life and the senses. And that is the only way to purify existence.

PURPORT

As it is stated in *Bhagavad-gita*, the Lord can be known in His real nature by dint of pure devotional service only. So it is stated here that only the great devotees of the Lord who are able to clear the mind of all material dust by rigid devotional service can experience the Lord as He is. *Jitendriya* means one who has full control over the senses. The senses are active parts of the body, and their activities cannot be stopped. The artificial means of the yogic processes to make the senses inactive has proved to be abject failure, even in the case of great *yogés* like Viçvāmitra Muni. Viçvāmitra Muni controlled the senses by yogic trance, but when he happened to meet Menakā (a heavenly society woman), he became a victim of sex, and the artificial way of controlling the senses failed. But in the case of a pure devotee, the senses are not at all artificially stopped from doing anything, but they are given different good engagements. When the senses are engaged in more attractive activities, there is no chance of their being attracted by any inferior engagements. In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is said that *the senses can be controlled only by better engagements*. Devotional service necessitates purifying the senses or engaging them in the activities of devotional service. Devotional service is not inaction. Anything done in the service of the Lord becomes at once purified of its material nature. The material conception is due to ignorance only. There is nothing beyond Vāsudeva. The Vāsudeva conception gradually develops in the heart of the learned after a prolonged acceleration of the receptive organs. But the process ends in the knowledge of accepting Vāsudeva as all in all. In the case of devotional service, this very same method is accepted from the very beginning, and by the grace of the Lord all factual knowledge becomes revealed in the heart of a devotee due to dictation by the Lord from within. Therefore controlling the senses by devotional service is the only and easiest means.

TEXT 24

Sa va AYa& Sa:YaNauGaqTaSaTk-Qaae

vedezu Gauùezu c Gauùvaidi>a")
Ya Wk- wRXaae JaGadaTMal/Il/Yaa
Sa*JaTYavTYaita Na Ta}a SaÂTae)) 24))

sa vâ ayaà sakhy anugéta-sat-katho

vedeñu guhyeñu ca guhya-vädibhiù

ya eka éço jagad-ätma-lélayä

sâjaty avaty atti na tatra sajjate

SYNONYMS

saù—He; *vai*—also; *ayam*—this; *sakhi*—O my friend; *anugéta*—described; *sat-kathaù*—the excellent pastimes; *vedeñu*—in the Vedic literatures; *guhyeñu*—confidentially; *ca*—as also; *guhya-vädibhiù*—by the confidential devotees; *yaù*—one who; *ekaù*—one only; *éçaù*—the supreme controller; *jagat*—of the complete creation; *ätma*—Supersoul; *lélayä*—by manifestation of pastimes; *sâjati*—creates; *avati atti*—also maintains and annihilates; *na*—never; *tatra*—there; *sajjate*—becomes attached to it.

TRANSLATION

O dear friends, here is that very Personality of Godhead whose attractive and confidential pastimes are described in the confidential parts of Vedic literature by His great devotees. It is He only who creates, maintains and annihilates the material world and yet remains unaffected.

PURPORT

As it is stated in the *Bhagavad-gita*, all the Vedic literatures are glorifying the greatness of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. Here it is confirmed in the *Bhāgavatam* also. The *Vedas* are expanded by many branches and subbranches by great devotees and empowered incarnations of the Lord like Vyāsa, Nārada, Çukadeva Gosvami, the Kumāras, Kapila, Prahlaḍa, Janaka, Bali and Yamarāja, but in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* especially, the confidential parts

of His activities are described by the confidential devotee Çukadeva Gosvami. In the *Vedānta-sūtras* or *Upaniñads* there is only a hint of the confidential parts of His pastimes. In such Vedic literatures as the *Upaniñads*, the Lord has expressively been distinguished from the mundane conception of His existence. His identity being fully spiritual, His form, name, quality, and paraphernalia, etc., have been elaborately distinguished from matter, and therefore He is sometimes misunderstood by less intelligent persons as impersonal. But factually He is the Supreme Person, Bhagavān, and He is partially represented as Paramātmā or impersonal Brahman.

TEXT 25

**Yada ùDaMaeR<a TaMaaeiDaYaae Na*Paa
JaqviNTa Ta}aEz ih SatvTa" ik-I/)
Datae >aGa& SaTYaMa*Ta& dYaa& YaXaae
>avaYa æPaai<a dDaÛuGae YauGae)) 25))**

yadä hy adharmeëa tamo-dhiyo nãpä

jévanti tatraiña hi sattvataù kila

dhatte bhagaà satyam åtaà dayäà yaço

bhaväya rüpäëi dadhad yuge yuge

SYNONYMS

yadä—whenever; *hi*—assuredly; *adharmeëa*—against the principles of God’s will; *tamaù-dhiyaù*—persons in the lowest material modes; *nãpäù*—kings and administrators; *jévanti*—live like animals; *tatra*—thereupon; *eñaù*—He; *hi*—only; *sattvataù*—transcendental; *kila*—certainly; *dhatte*—is manifested; *bhagam*—supreme power; *satyam*—truth; *åtam*—positiveness; *dayäm*—mercy; *yaçaù*—wonderful activities; *bhaväya*—for the maintenance; *rüpäëi*—in various forms; *dadhat*—manifested; *yuge*—different periods; *yuge*—and ages.

TRANSLATION

Whenever there are kings and administrators living like animals in the lowest modes of existence, the Lord in His transcendental form manifests His supreme power, the Truth Positive, shows special mercy to the faithful, performs wonderful activities and manifests various transcendental forms as is necessary in different periods and ages.

PURPORT

As mentioned above, the cosmic creation is the property of the Supreme Lord. This is the basic philosophy of *Ēcopaniñad*: everything is the property of the Supreme Being. No one should encroach upon the property of the Supreme Lord. One should accept only what is kindly awarded by Him. Therefore, the earth or any other planet or universe is the absolute property of the Lord. The living beings are certainly His parts and parcels, or sons, and thus every one of them has a right to live at the mercy of the Lord to execute his prescribed work. No one, therefore, can encroach upon the right of another individual man or animal without being so sanctioned by the Lord. The king or the administrator is the representative of the Lord to look after the management of the Lord's will. He must therefore be a recognized person like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira or Parékñit. Such kings have full responsibility and knowledge from authorities about the administration of the world. But at times, due to the influence of the ignorance mode of material nature (*tamo-guëa*), the lowest of the material modes, kings and administrators come into power without knowledge and responsibility, and such foolish administrators live like animals for the sake of their own personal interest. The result is that the whole atmosphere becomes surcharged with anarchy and vicious elements. Nepotism, bribery, cheating, aggression and, therefore, famine, epidemic, war and similar other disturbing features become prominent in human society. And the devotees of the Lord or the faithful are persecuted by all means. All these symptoms indicate the time of an incarnation of the Lord to reestablish the principles of religion and to vanquish the maladministrators. This is also confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita*.

The Lord then appears in His transcendental form without any tinge of

material qualities. He descends just to keep the state of His creation in a normal condition. The normal condition is that the Lord has provided each and every planet with all the needs of the native living beings. They can happily live and execute their predestined occupations to attain salvation at the end, following the rules and regulations mentioned in the revealed scriptures. The material world is created to satisfy the whims of the *nitya-baddha*, or everlasting conditioned souls, just as naughty boys are provided with playing cradles. Otherwise, there was no need of the material world. But when they become intoxicated with the power of material science to exploit the resources unlawfully without the sanction of the Lord, and that also only for sense gratification, there is necessity of the Lord's incarnation to chastise the rebellious and to protect the faithful.

When He descends, He exhibits superhuman acts just to prove His supreme right, and materialists like Ravana, Hiraṇyakaśipu and Kaàsa are sufficiently punished. He acts in a manner which no one can imitate. For example, the Lord, when He appeared as Rāma, bridged the Indian Ocean. When He appeared as Kṛṣṇa, from His very childhood He showed superhuman activities by killing Pūtanā, Aghāsura, Çakaöāsura, Kāliya, etc., and then His maternal uncle Kaàsa. When He was at Dvārakā He married 16,108 queens, and all of them were blessed with a sufficient number of children. The sum total of His personal family members amounted to about 100,000, popularly known as the Yadu-vaàça. And again, during His lifetime, He managed to vanquish them all. He is famous as the Govardhana-dhäre Hari because He lifted at the age of only seven the hill known as Govardhana. The Lord killed many undesirable kings in His time, and as a *kñatriya* He fought chivalrously. He is famous as the *asamaurdhva*, unparalleled. No one is equal to or greater than Him.

TEXT 26

**Ahae Al&/ ëagYaTaMa& Yadae" ku-l/,
 Mahae Al&/ Pau<YaTaMa& MaDaaevRNaMa()
 Yadez Pau&SaaMa*z>a" ié[Ya" PaiTa"
 SvJaNMaNaa cx(k)-Ma<aeNa caÄiTa)) 26))**

aho alaà çläghyatamaà yadoù kulam

aho alaà puëyatamaà madhor vanam

yad eña puàsäm åñabhaù çriyaù patiù

sva-janmanä caikramaëena cäicati

SYNONYMS

aho—oh; *alam*—verily; *çlāghya-tamam*—supremely glorified; *yadoù*—of King Yadu; *kulam*—dynasty; *aho*—oh; *alam*—verily; *puëya-tamam*—supremely virtuous; *madhoù vanam*—the land of Mathurā; *yat*—because; *eñaù*—this; *puàsäm*—of all the living beings; *åñabhaù*—supreme leader; *çriyaù*—of the goddess of fortune; *patiù*—husband; *sva-janmanä*—by His appearance; *caikramaëena*—by crawling; *ca aicati*—glories.

TRANSLATION

Oh, how supremely glorified is the dynasty of King Yadu, and how virtuous is the land of Mathurā, where the supreme leader of all living beings, the husband of the goddess of fortune, has taken His birth and wandered in His childhood.

PURPORT

In the *Bhagavad-gita* the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa has expressively given a description of His transcendental appearance, disappearance and activities. The Lord appears in a particular family or place by His inconceivable potency. He does not take His birth as a conditioned soul quits his body and accepts another body. His birth is like the appearance and disappearance of the sun. The sun arises on the eastern horizon, but that does not mean that the eastern horizon is the parent of the sun. The sun is existent in every part of the solar system, but he becomes visible at a scheduled time and so also becomes invisible at another scheduled time. Similarly, the Lord appears in this universe like the sun and again leaves our sight at another time. He exists at all times and at every place, but by His causeless mercy when He appears before us we take it for granted that He has taken His birth. Anyone who can understand this truth, in terms of the

statements of revealed scriptures, certainly becomes liberated just after quitting the present body. Liberation is obtainable after many births and after great endeavor in patience and perseverance, in knowledge and renunciation. But simply by knowing in truth about the Lord's transcendental births and activities, one can get liberation at once. That is the verdict of the *Bhagavad-gita*. But those who are in the darkness of ignorance conclude that the Lord's birth and activities in the material world are similar to those of the ordinary living being. Such imperfect conclusions cannot give anyone liberation. His birth, therefore, in the family of King Yadu as the son of King Vasudeva and His transfer into the family of Nanda Mahārāja in the land of Mathurā are all transcendental arrangements made by the internal potency of the Lord. The fortunes of the Yadu dynasty and that of the inhabitants of the land of Mathurā cannot be materially estimated. If simply by knowing the transcendental nature of the birth and activities of the Lord one can get liberation easily, we can just imagine what is in store for those who actually enjoyed the company of the Lord in person as a family member or as a neighbor. All those who were fortunate enough to associate with the Lord, the husband of the goddess of fortune, certainly obtained something *more than what is known as liberation*. Therefore, rightly, the dynasty and the land are both ever glorious by the grace of the Lord.

TEXT 27

**Ahae bTa SvYaRXaSaiSTarSk-rq
ku-XaSQal/I Pau<YaYaXaSk-rq >auv")
PaXYaiNTa iNaTYa& YadNauGa]heizTa&
iSMaTaavl/aek&- SvPaiTa& SMa YaTPa[Jaa")) 27))**

aho bata svar-yaçasas tiraskaré

kuçasthalé puëya-yaçaskaré bhuvaù

paçyanti nityaà yad anugraheñitaà

smitävalokaà sva-patià sma yat-prajäù

SYNONYMS

aho bata—how wonderful this is; *svaù-yaçasaù*—the glories of the heavenly planets; *tiraskaré*—that which defeats; *kuçasthalé*—Dvārakā; *puëya*—virtue; *yaçaskaré*—famous; *bhuvaù*—the planet earth; *paçyanti*—see; *nityam*—constantly; *yat*—that which; *anugraha-iñitam*—to bestow benediction; *smita-avalokam*—glance with the favor of sweet smiling; *sva-patim*—unto the soul of the living being (Kṛṣṇa); *sma*—used to; *yat-prajäù*—the inhabitants of the place.

TRANSLATION

Undoubtedly it is wonderful that Dvārakā has defeated the glories of the heavenly planets and has enhanced the celebrity of the earth. The inhabitants of Dvārakā are always seeing the soul of all living beings [Kṛṣṇa] in His loving feature. He glances at them and favors them with sweet smiles.

PURPORT

The heavenly planets are inhabited by demigods like Indra, Candra, Varuëa and Väyu and the pious souls reach there after performance of many virtuous acts on earth. Modern scientists agree that the timing arrangement in higher planetary systems is different from that of the earth. Thus it is understood from the revealed scriptures that the duration of life there is ten thousand years (by our calculation). Six months on earth is equal to one day on the heavenly planets. Facilities of enjoyment are also similarly enhanced, and the beauty of the inhabitants is legendary. Common men on the earth are very much fond of reaching the heavenly planets because they have heard that comforts of life are far greater there than on the earth. They are now trying to reach the moon by spacecraft. Considering all this, the heavenly planets are more celebrated than the earth. But the celebrity of earth has defeated that of the heavenly planets because of Dvārakā, where Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa reigned as King. Three places, namely Våndāvana, Mathurā and Dvārakā, are more important than the famous planets within the universe. These places are perpetually sanctified because whenever the Lord descends on earth He displays His

transcendental activities particularly in these three places. They are perpetually the holy lands of the Lord, and the inhabitants still take advantage of the holy places, even though the Lord is now out of their sight. The Lord is the soul of all living beings, and He desires always to have all the living beings, in their *svarūpa*, in their constitutional position, to participate in transcendental life in His association. His attractive features and sweet smiles go deep into the heart of everyone, and once it is so done the living being is admitted into the kingdom of God, from which no one returns. This is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita*.

The heavenly planets may be very famous for offering better facilities of material enjoyment, but as we learn from the *Bhagavad-gita* (9.20–21), one has to come back again to the earth planet as soon as the acquired virtue is finished. Dvārakā is certainly more important than the heavenly planets because whoever has been favored with the smiling glance of the Lord shall never come back again to this rotten earth, which is certified by the Lord Himself as a place of misery. Not only this earth but also all the planets of the universes are places of misery because in none of the planets within the universe is there eternal life, eternal bliss and eternal knowledge. Any person engaged in the devotional service of the Lord is recommended to live in one of the above-mentioned three places, namely Dvārakā, Mathurā or Våndāvana. Because devotional service in these three places is magnified, those who go there to follow the principles in terms of instructions imparted in the revealed scriptures surely achieve the same result as obtained during the presence of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. His abode and He Himself are identical, and a pure devotee under the guidance of another experienced devotee can obtain all the results, even at present.

TEXT 28

NaUNa& v]TaòaNahuTaaïdNaeìr"
 SaMaicRTaae ùSYa Ga*hqTaPaai<ai>a")
 iPabiNTa Yaa" Sa:YaDaraMa*Ta& Mauhu,
 v]RJaiñYa" SaMMauMauhuYaRdaXaYaa")) 28))

nūnaà vrata-snāna-hutādineçvaraù

samarcito hy asya gâhéta-päëibhiù
pibanti yäù sakhy adharämâtaà muhur
vraja-striyaù sammumuhur yad-äçayäù

SYNONYMS

nūnam—certainly in the previous birth; *vrata*—vow; *snāna*—bath; *huta*—sacrifice in the fire; *ädinä*—by all these; *éçvaraù*—the Personality of Godhead; *samarcitaù*—perfectly worshiped; *hi*—certainly; *asya*—His; *gâhéta-päëibhiù*—by the married wives; *pibanti*—relishes; *yäù*—those who; *sakhi*—O friend; *adhara-amâtam*—the nectar from His lips; *muhuù*—again and again; *vraja-striyaù*—the damsels of Vrajabhūmi; *sammumuhuù*—often fainted; *yad-äçayäù*—expecting to be favored in that way.

TRANSLATION

O friends, just think of His wives, whose hands He has accepted. How they must have undergone vows, baths, fire sacrifices and perfect worship of the Lord of the universe to constantly relish now the nectar from His lips [by kissing]. The damsels of Vrajabhūmi would often faint just by expecting such favors.

PURPORT

Religious rites prescribed in the scriptures are meant to purify the mundane qualities of the conditioned souls to enable them to be gradually promoted to the stage of rendering transcendental service unto the Supreme Lord. Attainment of this stage of pure spiritual life is the highest perfection, and this stage is called *svarūpa*, or the factual identity of the living being. Liberation means renovation of this stage of *svarūpa*. In that perfect stage of *svarūpa*, the living being is established in five phases of loving service, one of which is the stage of *mādhurya-rasa*, or the humor of conjugal love. The Lord is always perfect in Himself, and thus He has no hankering for Himself. He, however, becomes a master, a friend, a son or a husband to

fulfill the intense love of the devotee concerned. Herein two classes of devotees of the Lord are mentioned in the stage of conjugal love. One is *svakéya*, and the other is *parakéya*. Both of them are in conjugal love with the Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa. The queens at Dvārakā were *svakéya*, or duly married wives, but the damsels of Vraja were young friends of the Lord while He was unmarried. The Lord stayed at Våndāvana till the age of sixteen, and His friendly relations with the neighboring girls were in terms of *parakéya*. These girls, as well as the queens, underwent severe penances by taking vows, bathing and offering sacrifices in the fire, as prescribed in the scriptures. The rites, as they are, are not an end in themselves, nor are fruitive action, culture of knowledge or perfection in mystic powers ends in themselves. They are all means to attain to the highest stage of *svarūpa*, to render constitutional transcendental service to the Lord. Each and every living being has his individual position in one of the above-mentioned five different kinds of reciprocating means with the Lord, and in one's pure spiritual form of *svarūpa* the relation becomes manifest without mundane affinity. The kissing of the Lord, either by His wives or His young girl friends who aspired to have the Lord as their fiancé, is not of any mundane perverted quality. Had such things been mundane, a liberated soul like Çukadeva would not have taken the trouble to relish them, nor would Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu have been inclined to participate in those subjects after renouncing worldly life. The stage is earned after many lives of penance.

TEXT 29

Yaa vqYaRéuLke-Na ôTaa" SvYa&vre
Pa[MaQYa cEÛPa[Mau%aN(ih éuiZMa<a")
Pa[ÛuManSaaMbaMbSauTaadYaae_Para
YaaêaôTaa >aaEMavDae SahóXa")) 29))

yä vérya-çulkena hâtäù svayaàvare

pramathya caidya-pramukhän hi çuñmiëaù

pradyumna-sämbämba-sutädayo 'parä

yäç cähâtä bhauma-vadhe sahasraçaù

SYNONYMS

yä—the lady; *vérya*—prowess; *çulkena*—by payment of the price; *hâtäù*—taken away by force; *svayaàvare*—in the open selection of the bridegroom; *pramathya*—harassing; *caidya*—King Çiçupäla; *pramukhän*—headed by; *hi*—positively; *çuñmiëaù*—all very powerful; *pradyumna*—Pradyumna (Kṛṣṇa's son); *sämba*—Sämba; *amba*—Amba; *suta-ädayaù*—children; *aparäù*—other ladies; *yäù*—those; *ca*—also; *ähâtäù*—similarly brought; *bhauma-vadhe*—after killing kings; *sahasraçaù*—by the thousands.

TRANSLATION

The children of these ladies are Pradyumna, Sämba, Amba, etc: Ladies like Rukmiëé, Satyabhämä and Jämbavaté were forcibly taken away by Him from their svayaàvara ceremonies after He defeated many powerful kings, headed by Çiçupäla. And other ladies were also forcibly taken away by Him after He killed Bhaumäsurä and thousands of his assistants. All of these ladies are glorious.

PURPORT

Exceptionally qualified daughters of powerful kings were allowed to make a choice of their own bridegrooms in open competition, and such ceremonies were called *svayaàvara*, or selection of the bridegroom. Because the *svayaàvara* was an open competition between the rival and valiant princes, such princes were invited by the father of the princess, and usually there were regular fights between the invited princely order in a sporting spirit. But it so happened that sometimes the belligerent princes were killed in such marriage-fighting, and the victorious prince was offered the trophy princess for whom so many princes died. Rukmiëé, the principal queen of Lord Kṛṣṇa, was the daughter of the King of Vidarbha, who wished that his qualified and beautiful daughter be given away to Lord Kṛṣṇa. But her eldest brother wanted her to be given away to King Çiçupäla, who happened to be a cousin of Kṛṣṇa. So there was open competition, and as usual Lord Kṛṣṇa emerged successful, after harassing Çiçupäla and other

princes by His unrivalled prowess. Rukmiëé had ten sons, like Pradyumna. There were other queens also taken away by Lord Kṛṣṇa in a similar way. Full description of this beautiful booty of Lord Kṛṣṇa will be given in the Tenth Canto. There were 16,100 beautiful girls who were daughters of many kings and were forcibly stolen by Bhaumāsura, who kept them captive for his carnal desire. These girls prayed piteously to Lord Kṛṣṇa for their deliverance, and the merciful Lord, called by their fervent prayer, released them all by fighting and killing Bhaumāsura. All these captive princesses were then accepted by the Lord as His wives, although in the estimation of society they were all fallen girls. The all-powerful Lord Kṛṣṇa accepted the humble prayers of these girls and married them with the adoration of queens. So altogether Lord Kṛṣṇa had 16,108 queens at Dvārakā, and in each of them He begot ten children. All these children grew up, and each had as many children as the father. The aggregate of the family numbered 10,000,000.

TEXT 30

WTaa" Par& ñqTvMaPaaSTaPaeXal&/
iNarSTaXaaEc& bTa SaaDau ku-vRTae)
YaaSaa& Ga*haTPauZk-rl/aecNa" PaiTa,
NaR JaaTvPaETYaaôiTai>aôRid SPa*XaNa()) 30))

etäù paraà strétvam apästapeçalaa

nirasta-çaucaà bata sädhu kurvate

yäsää gähät puñkara-locanaù patir

na jätv apaity ähâtibhir hâdi spâçan

SYNONYMS

etäù—all these women; *param*—highest; *strétvam*—womanhood; *apästapeçalam*—without individuality; *nirasta*—without; *çaucam*—purity; *bata sädhu*—auspiciously glorified; *kurvate*—do they make; *yäsäm*—from whose; *gähät*—homes; *puñkara-locanaù*—the lotus-eyed; *patiù*—husband;

na jätu—never at any time; *apaiti*—goes away; *ähätibhiù*—by presentation; *hådi*—in the heart; *spåçan*—endeared.

TRANSLATION

All these women auspiciously glorified their lives despite their being without individuality and without purity. Their husband, the lotus-eyed Personality of Godhead, never left them alone at home. He always pleased their hearts by making valuable presentations.

PURPORT

The devotees of the Lord are purified souls. As soon as the devotees surrender unto the lotus feet of the Lord sincerely, the Lord accepts them, and thus the devotees at once become free from all material contaminations. Such devotees are above the three modes of material nature. There is no bodily disqualification of a devotee, just as there is no qualitative difference between the Ganges water and the filthy drain water when they are amalgamated. Women, merchants and laborers are not very intelligent, and thus it is very difficult for them to understand the science of God or to be engaged in the devotional service of the Lord. They are more materialistic, and less than them are the Kirātas, Hübäs, Ändhras, Pulindas, Pulkaças, Äbhéras, Kaikas, Yavanas, Khasas, etc., but all of them can be delivered if they are properly engaged in the devotional service of the Lord. By engagement in the service of the Lord, the designative disqualifications are removed, and as pure souls they become eligible to enter into the kingdom of God.

The fallen girls under the clutches of Bhaumäsura sincerely prayed to Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa for their deliverance, and their sincerity of purpose made them at once pure by virtue of devotion. The Lord therefore accepted them as His wives, and thus their lives became glorified. Such auspicious glorification was still more glorified when the Lord played with them as the most devoted husband.

The Lord used to live with His 16,108 wives constantly. He expanded Himself into 16,108 plenary portions, and each and every one of them was

the Lord Himself without deviation from the Original Personality. The *Çruti-mantra* affirms that the Lord can expand Himself into many. As husband of so many wives, He pleased them all with presentations, even at a costly endeavor. He brought the *pārijāta* plant from heaven and implanted it at the palace of Satyabhāmā, one of the principal queens. If, therefore, anyone desires the Lord to become one's husband, the Lord fulfills such desires in full.

TEXT 31

**Wv&ivDaa GadNTaqNaa& Sa iGar" PaurYaaeizTaaMa()
iNarq+a<aeNaai>aNaNdNa(SaiSMaTaeNa YaYaaE hir")) 31))**

evaàvidhā gadanténā

sa giraù pura-yoñitām

nirékñāēenābhinandan

sasmitena yayau hariù

SYNONYMS

evaàvidhā—in this way; *gadanténām*—thus praying and talking about Him; *saù*—He (the Lord); *giraù*—of words; *pura-yoñitām*—of the ladies of the capital; *nirékñāēena*—by His grace of glancing over them; *abhinandan*—and greeting them; *sa-smitena*—with a smiling face; *yayau*—departed; *hariù*—the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

While the ladies of the capital of Hastināpura were greeting Him and talking in this way, the Lord, smiling, accepted their good greetings, and casting the grace of His glance over them, He departed from the city.

TEXT 32

AJaaTaXa}au" Pa*TaNa& GaaPaqQaaYa MaDauÜz")
Pare>Ya" Xai²Ta" òehaTPa[aYau» cTauri®<aqMa()) 32))

ajäta-çatruù pātanā

gopéthäya madhu-dviñau

parebhyaù çaikitaù snehät

präyuikta catur-aigiëém

SYNONYMS

ajäta-çatruù—Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira, who was no one's enemy; *pātanäm*—defensive forces; *gopéthäya*—for giving protection; *madhu-dviñau*—of the enemy of Madhu (Sri Kṛṣṇa); *parebhyaù*—from others (enemies); *çaikitaù*—being afraid of; *snehät*—out of affection; *präyuikta*—engaged; *catuù-aigiëém*—four defensive divisions.

TRANSLATION

Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira, although no one's enemy, engaged four divisions of defense [horse, elephant, chariot and army] to accompany Lord Kṛṣṇa, the enemy of the asuras [demons]. The Mahäräja did this because of the enemy, and also out of affection for the Lord.

PURPORT

Natural defensive measures are horses and elephants combined with chariots and men. Horses and elephants are trained to move to any part of the hills or forests and plains. The charioteers could fight with many horses and elephants by the strength of powerful arrows, even up to the standard of the *brahmästra* (similar to modern atomic weapons). Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira knew well that Kṛṣṇa is everyone's friend and well-wisher, and yet there were *asuras* who were by nature envious of the Lord. So out of fear of attack from others and out of affection also, he engaged all varieties of defensive forces as bodyguards of Lord Kṛṣṇa. If required, Lord Kṛṣṇa

Himself was sufficient to defend Himself from the attack of others who counted the Lord as their enemy, but still He accepted all the arrangements made by Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira because He could not disobey the King, who was His elder cousin. The Lord plays the part of a subordinate in His transcendental sporting, and thus sometimes He puts Himself in the care of Yaçodämätä for His protection in His so-called helplessness of childhood. That is the transcendental *lila*, or pastime of the Lord. The basic principle for all transcendental exchanges between the Lord and His devotees is exhibited to enjoy a transcendental bliss for which there is no comparison, even up to the level of *brahmānanda*.

TEXT 33

AQa dUraGaTaaNa(XaaEir" k-aErvaNa(ivrhaTauraNa()
SaiàvTYaR d*!& iòGDaaNa(Pa[aYaaTSvNaGarq& iPa[YaE")) 33))

atha dūrāgatān çauriù

kauravān virahāturān

sannivartya dāḍhaà snigdhān

prāyāt sva-nagaréà priyaiù

SYNONYMS

atha—thus; *dūrāgatān*—having accompanied Him for a long distance; *çauriù*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kauravān*—the Pāṇḍavas; *virahāturān*—overwhelmed by a sense of separation; *sannivartya*—politely persuaded; *dāḍham*—determined; *snigdhān*—full of affection; *prāyāt*—proceeded; *sva-nagarém*—towards His own city (Dvārakā); *priyaiù*—with dear companions.

TRANSLATION

Out of profound affection for Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Pāṇḍavas, who were of the Kuru dynasty, accompanied Him a considerable distance to see Him off. They were overwhelmed with the thought of future separation. The Lord,

however, persuaded them to return home, and He proceeded towards Dvārakā with His dear companions.

TEXTS 34–35

ku-åJaa®I/PaaÄal/aNa(éUrSaeNaaNa(SaYaaMauNaaNa()
b]øavTa| ku-å+ae}a& MaTSYaaNa(SaarSvTaaNaQa)) 34))
MaåDaNvMaiTa§-MYa SaaEvqra>aqrYaae" ParaNa()
AaNaTaaRNa(>aaGaRvaePaaGaaC^aNTavahae MaNaaiGv>au")) 35))

kuru-jäigala-päicälän

çürasenän sayämunän

brahmävartaà kurukñetraà

matsyän särasvatän atha

maru-dhanvam atikramya

sauvéräbhérayoù parän

änartän bhärgavopägäc

chräntaväho manäg vibhuù

SYNONYMS

kuru-jäigala—the province of Delhi; *päicälän*—part of the province Punjab; *çürasenän*—part of the province of Uttar Pradesh; *sa*—with; *yämunän*—the districts on the bank of the Yamunä; *brahmävartam*—part of northern Uttar Pradesh; *kurukñetram*—the place where the battle was fought; *matsyän*—the province Matsyā; *särasvatän*—part of Punjab; *atha*—and so on; *maru*—Rajasthan, the land of deserts; *dhanvam*—Madhya Pradesh, where water is very scanty; *ati-kramya*—after passing; *sauvéra*—Saurashtra; *äbhérayoù*—part of Gujarat; *parän*—western side; *änartän*—the province of Dvārakā; *bhärgava*—O Çaunaka; *upägät*—overtaken by; *çrānta*—fatigue;

vāhaù—the horses; *manäk vibhuù*—slightly, because of the long journey.

TRANSLATION

O Çaunaka, the Lord then proceeded towards Kurujäigala, Päicälä, Çürasenä, the land on the bank of the River Yamunä, Brahmävarta, Kurukñetra, Matsyä, Sārasvatä, the province of the desert and the land of scanty water. After crossing these provinces He gradually reached the Sauvëra and Äbhëra provinces, then west of these, reached Dvärakä at last.

PURPORT

The provinces passed over by the Lord in those days were differently named, but the direction given is sufficient to indicate that He traveled through Delhi, Punjab, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Saurashtra and Gujarat and at last reached His home province at Dvärakä. We do not gain any profit simply by researching the analogous provinces of those days up to now, but it appears that the desert of Rajasthan and the provinces of scanty water like Madhya Pradesh were present even five thousand years ago. The theory of soil experts that the desert developed in recent years is not supported by the statements of *Bhāgavatam*. We may leave the matter for expert geologists to research because the changing universe has different phases of geological development. We are satisfied that the Lord has now reached His own province, Dvärakādhāma, from the Kuru provinces. Kurukñetra continues to exist since the Vedic age, and it is sheer foolishness when interpreters ignore or deny the existence of Kurukñetra.

TEXT 36

**Ta}a Ta}a h Ta}aTYaEhRir" Pa[TYauÛTaahR<a")
SaaYa& >aeJae idXa& PaëaÓivïae Gaa& GaTaSTada)) 36))**

tatra tatra ha tatratyair

hariù pratyudyatärhaëaù

säyaà bheje diçaà paçcäd

gaviñöho gäà gatas tadä

SYNONYMS

tatra tatra—at different places; *ha*—it so happened; *tatratyaiù*—by local inhabitants; *hariù*—the Personality of Godhead; *pratyudyata-arhaëaù*—being offered presentations and worshipful regards; *säyam*—the evening; *bheje*—having overtaken; *diçam*—direction; *paçcät*—eastern; *gaviñöhaù*—the sun in the sky; *gäm*—to the ocean; *gataù*—having gone; *tadä*—at that time.

TRANSLATION

On His journey through these provinces He was welcomed, worshiped and given various presentations. In the evening, in all places, the Lord suspended His journey to perform evening rites. This was regularly observed after sunset.

PURPORT

It is said here that the Lord observed the religious principles regularly while He was on the journey. There are certain philosophical speculations that even the Lord is under the obligations of fruitive action. But actually this is not the case. He does not depend on the action of any good or bad work. *Since the Lord is absolute, everything done by Him is good for everyone.* But when He descends on earth, He acts for the protection of the devotees and for the annihilation of the impious nondevotees. Although He has no obligatory duty, still He does everything so that others may follow. That is the way of factual teaching; one must act properly himself and teach the same to others, otherwise no one will accept one's blind teaching. He is Himself the awarder of fruitive results. He is self-sufficient, and yet He acts according to the rulings of the revealed scripture in order to teach us the process. If He does not do so, the common man may go wrong. But in the advanced stage, when one can understand the transcendental nature of the Lord, one does not try to imitate Him. This is not possible.

The Lord in human society does what is the duty of everyone, but sometimes He does something extraordinary and not to be imitated by the living being. His acts of evening prayer as stated herein must be followed by the living being, but it is not possible to follow His mountain-lifting or dancing with the *gopés*. One cannot imitate the sun, which can exhaust water even from a filthy place; the most powerful can do something which is all-good, but our imitation of such acts will put us into endless difficulty. Therefore, in all actions, the experienced guide, the spiritual master, who is the manifested mercy of the Lord, should always be consulted, and the path of progress will be assured.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Tenth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "Departure of Lord Kṛṣṇa for Dvārakā."

Chapter Eleven

Lord Kṛṣṇa's Entrance into Dvārakā

TEXT 1

SaUTa ovac

AaNaTaaRNA(Sa oPav]JYa Sv*ÖaĀNaPadaNa(SvK-aNa()
dDMaaE drvr& Taeza& ivzad& XaMaYaiàv)) 1))

sūta uvāca

ānartān sa upavrajya

svāddhāi jana-padān svakān

dadhmau daravaraà teñhā

viñādaà çamayann iva

SYNONYMS

sūtaù uvāca—Sūta Gosvami said; *ānartān*—the country known as Ānartān (Dvārakā); *saù*—He; *upavrajya*—reaching the border of; *svāddhān*—most prosperous; *jana-padān*—city; *svakān*—His own; *dadhmau*—sounded; *daravaram*—the auspicious conchshell (Pāicajanya); *teñām*—of them; *viñādam*—dejection; *çamayan*—pacifying; *iva*—seemingly.

TRANSLATION

Sūta Gosvami said: Upon reaching the border of His most prosperous metropolis, known as the country of the Ānartas [Dvārakā], the Lord sounded His auspicious conchshell, heralding His arrival and apparently pacifying the dejection of the inhabitants.

PURPORT

The beloved Lord was away from His own prosperous metropolis of Dvārakā for a considerably long period because of the Battle of Kurukñetra, and thus all the inhabitants were overcome with melancholia due to the separation. When the Lord descends on the earth, His eternal associates also come with Him, just as the entourage of a king accompanies him. Such associates of the Lord are eternally liberated souls, and they cannot bear the separation of the Lord even for a moment because of intense affection for the Lord. Thus the inhabitants of the city of Dvārakā were in a mood of dejection and expected the arrival of the Lord at any moment. So the heralding sound of the auspicious conchshell was very encouraging, and apparently the sound pacified their dejection. They were still more aspirant to see the Lord amongst themselves, and all of them became alert to receive Him in the befitting manner. These are the signs of spontaneous love of Godhead.

TEXT 2

Sa oÀk-aXae Davl/aedrae drae
_PYauå\$-MaSYaaDarXaae<aXaaei<aMaa)
daDMaaYaMaaNa" k-rk-ÅSaMPau\$e=
YaQaaBJa%<@e k-l/h&Sa oTSvNa")) 2))

sa uccakäçe dhavalodaro daro

'py urukramasyädharaçoëa-çoëimä

dädhmäyamänaù kara-kaija-sampuöe

yathäbja-khaëöe kala-haàsa utsvanaù

SYNONYMS

saù—that; *uccakäçe*—became brilliant; *dhavala-udaraù*—white and fat-boweled; *daraù*—conchshell; *api*—although it is so; *urukramasya*—of the great adventurer; *adharaçoëa*—by the transcendental quality of His lips; *çoëimä*—reddened; *dädhmäyamänaù*—being sounded; *kara-kaija-sampuöe*—being caught by the grip of the lotus hand; *yathä*—as it is; *abja-khaëöe*—by the stems of lotus flowers; *kala-haàsaù*—ducking swan; *utsvanaù*—loudly sounding.

TRANSLATION

The white and fat-boweled conchshell, being gripped by the hand of Lord Kṛṣṇa and sounded by Him, appeared to be reddened by the touch of His transcendental lips. It seemed that a white swan was playing in the stems of red lotus flowers.

PURPORT

The redness of the white conchshell due to the lip-touch of the Lord is a symbol of spiritual significance. The Lord is all spirit, and matter is ignorance of this spiritual existence. Factually there is nothing like matter in spiritual enlightenment, and this spiritual enlightenment takes place at once by the contact of the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. The Lord is present in every particle of all existence, and He can manifest His presence in anyone. By ardent love and devotional service to the Lord, or in other words by spiritual contact with the Lord, everything becomes spiritually reddened like the conchshell in the grip of the Lord, and the *paramahamsa*, or the supremely intelligent person, plays the part of the ducking swan in the

water of spiritual bliss, eternally decorated by the lotus flower of the Lord's feet.

TEXT 3

**TaMauPaé[uTYa iNaNad& JaGaÛYa>aYaavhMa()
Pa[TYauÛYau" Pa[Jaa" SavaR >aTa*RdXaRNal/al/Saa")) 3))**

tam upaṣrutya ninadaà

jagad-bhaya-bhayävaham

pratyudyayuù prajāu sarvā

bhartā-darṣana-lālasäù

SYNONYMS

tam—that; *upaṣrutya*—having overheard; *ninadam*—sound; *jagat-bhaya*—the fear of material existence; *bhaya-ävaham*—the threatening principle; *prati*—towards; *udyayuù*—rapidly proceeded; *prajāu*—the citizens; *sarvāu*—all; *bhartā*—the protector; *darṣana*—audience; *lālasäù*—having so desired.

TRANSLATION

The citizens of Dvārakā, having heard that sound which threatens fear personified in the material world, began to run towards Him fast, just to have a long desired audience with the Lord, who is the protector of all devotees.

PURPORT

As already explained, the citizens of Dvārakā who lived at the time of Lord Kṛṣṇa's presence there were all liberated souls who descended there along with the Lord as entourage. All were very anxious to have an audience with the Lord, although because of spiritual contact they were never separated

from the Lord. Just as the *gopés* at Våndāvana used to think of Kṛṣṇa while He was away from the village for cowherding engagements, the citizens of Dvārakā were all immersed in thought of the Lord while He was away from Dvārakā to attend the Battle of Kurukñetra. Some distinguished fiction writer in Bengal concluded that the Kṛṣṇa of Våndāvana, that of Mathurā and that of Dvārakā were different personalities. Historically there is no truth in this conclusion. The Kṛṣṇa of Kurukñetra and the Kṛṣṇa of Dvārakā are one and the same personality.

The citizens of Dvārakā were thus in a state of melancholy due to the Lord's absence from the transcendental city, as much as we are put in a state of melancholy at night because of the absence of the sun. The sound heralded by Lord Kṛṣṇa was something like the heralding of the sunrise in the morning. So all the citizens of Dvārakā awoke from a state of slumber because of the sunrise of Kṛṣṇa, and they all hastened towards Him just to have an audience. The devotees of the Lord know no one else as protector.

This sound of the Lord is identical with the Lord, as we have tried to explain by the nondual position of the Lord. The material existence of our present status is full of fear. Out of the four problems of material existence, namely the food problem, the shelter problem, the fear problem and the mating problem, the fear problem gives us more trouble than the others. We are always fearful due to our ignorance of the next problem. The whole material existence is full of problems, and thus the fear problem is always prominent. This is due to our association with the illusory energy of the Lord, known as *māyā* or external energy, yet all fear is vanished as soon as there is the sound of the Lord, represented by His holy name, as it was sounded by Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu in the following sixteen words:

*Hare Kṛṣṇa, Hare Kṛṣṇa, Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa, Hare Hare
Hare Rāma, Hare Rāma, Rāma Rāma, Hare Hare*

We can take advantage of these sounds and be free from all threatening problems of material existence.

TEXTS 4–5

Ta}aaePaNaqTabl/Yaae rvedsPaiMavad*Taa")
AaTMaaraMa& PaU<aRk-aMa& iNaJal/a>aeNa iNaTYada)) 4))
Pa[qTYauTfu-çMau%a" Pa[aecuhRzRGaÓdYaa iGara)
iPaTar& SavRSauôdMaivTaariMava>aRk-a")) 5))

tatropanéta-balayo

raver déпам ivädâtäù

ätmärämaà pürëa-kämaà

nija-läbhena nityadä

préty-utphulla-mukhäù procur

harña-gadgadayä girä

pitaraà sarva-suhådam

avitäram ivärbhakäù

SYNONYMS

tatra—thereupon; *upanéta*—having offered; *balayaù*—presentations;
raveù—up to the sun; *déпам*—lamp; *iva*—like; *ädâtäù*—being evaluated;
ätma-ärämam—unto the self-sufficient; *pürëa-kämam*—fully satisfied; *nija-läbhena*—by His own potencies; *nitya-dä*—one who supplies incessantly;
préti—affection; *utphulla-mukhäù*—cheerful faces; *procuù*—said; *harña*—gladdened; *gadgadayä*—ecstatic; *girä*—speeches; *pitaram*—unto the father; *sarva*—all; *suhådam*—friends; *avitäram*—the guardian; *iva*—like; *arbhakäù*—wards.

TRANSLATION

The citizens arrived before the Lord with their respective presentations, offering them to the fully satisfied and self-sufficient one, who, by His own potency, incessantly supplies others. These presentations were like

the offering of a lamp to the sun. Yet the citizens began to speak in ecstatic language to receive the Lord, just as wards welcome their guardian and father.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa is described herein as *ātmārāma*. He is self-sufficient, and there is no need for Him to seek happiness from anything beyond Himself. He is self-sufficient because His very transcendental existence is total bliss. He is eternally existent; He is all-cognizant and all-blissful. Therefore, any presentation, however valuable it may be, is not needed by Him. But still, because He is the well-wisher for one and all, He accepts from everyone everything that is offered to Him in pure devotional service. It is not that He is in want for such things, because the things are themselves generated from His energy. The comparison is made herein that making offerings to the Lord is something like offering a lamp in the worship of the sun-god. Anything fiery and illuminating is but an emanation of the energy of the sun, and yet to worship the sun-god it is necessary to offer him a lamp. In the worship of the sun, there is some sort of demand made by the worshiper, but in the case of devotional service to the Lord, there is no question of demand from either side. It is all a sign of pure love and affection between the Lord and the devotee.

The Lord is the Supreme Father of all living beings, and therefore those who are conscious of this *vital* relation with God can make filial demands from the Father, and the Father is pleased to supply the demands of such obedient sons without bargaining. The Lord is just like the *desire tree*, and from Him everyone can have everything by the causeless mercy of the Lord. As the Supreme Father, the Lord, however, does not supply to a pure devotee what is considered to be a barrier to the discharge of devotional service. Those who are engaged in the devotional service of the Lord can rise to the position of unalloyed devotional service by His transcendental attraction.

TEXT 6

NaTaa" SMa Tae NaaQa Sadax(iga]Pa^aJa&

ivirÄvEirHCYaSaureNd]viNdTaMa()
ParaYa<a& +aeMaiMaheC^Taa& Par&
Na Ya}a k-al/" Pa[>aveTa(Par" Pa[>au")) 6))

natäù sma te nätha sadäìghri-paikajaà

virīica-vairīicya-surendra-vanditam

paräyaëaà kñemam ihecchatäà paraà

na yatra kälaù prabhavet paraù prabhuù

SYNONYMS

natäù—bowed down; *sma*—we had done so; *te*—unto You; *nätha*—O Lord; *sadä*—always; *aìghri-paikajam*—the lotus feet; *virīica*—Brahmä, the first living being; *vairīicya*—sons of Brahmä like Sanaka and Sanätana; *sura-indra*—the King of heaven; *vanditam*—worshiped by; *paräyaëam*—the supreme; *kñemam*—welfare; *iha*—in this life; *icchatäm*—one who so desires; *param*—the highest; *na*—never; *yatra*—wherein; *kälaù*—inevitable time; *prabhavet*—can exert its influence; *paraù*—transcendental; *prabhuù*—the Supreme Lord.

TRANSLATION

The citizens said: O Lord, You are worshiped by all demigods like Brahmä, the four Sanas and even the King of heaven. You are the ultimate rest for those who are really aspiring to achieve the highest benefit of life. You are the supreme transcendental Lord, and inevitable time cannot exert its influence upon You.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord is Sri Kṛṣṇa, as confirmed in *Bhagavad-gita*, *Brahma-saṃhitā* and other authorized Vedic literatures. No one is equal to or greater than Him, and that is the verdict of all scriptures. The influence of time and space is exerted upon the dependent living entities, who are all

parts and parcels of the Supreme Lord. The living entities are predominated Brahman, whereas the Supreme Lord is the predominating Absolute. As soon as we forget this clear fact, we are at once in illusion, and thus we are put into threefold miseries, as one is put into dense darkness. The clear consciousness of the cognizant living being is God consciousness, in which one bows down unto Him in all circumstances.

TEXT 7

>avaYa NaSTv& >av ivi>aavNa
TvMaeV MaaTaaQa SauôTPaiTa" iPaTaa)
Tv& Sad(GauãNaR" ParMa& c dEvTa&
YaSYaaNauv*tYaa k*-iTaNaae b>aUivMa)) 7))

bhaväya nas tvaà bhava viçva-bhävana

tvam eva mätätha suhât-patiù pitä

tvaà sad-gurur naù paramaà ca daivataà

yasyänuvâttyä kâtino babhüvima

SYNONYMS

bhaväya—for welfare; *naù*—for us; *tvam*—Your Lordship; *bhava*—just become; *viçva-bhävana*—the creator of the universe; *tvam*—Your Lordship; *eva*—certainly; *mätä*—mother; *atha*—as also; *suhât*—well-wisher; *patiù*—husband; *pitä*—father; *tvam*—Your Lordship; *sat-guruù*—spiritual master; *naù*—our; *paramam*—the supreme; *ca*—and; *daivatam*—worshipable Deity; *yasya*—whose; *anuvâttyä*—following in the footsteps; *kâtinaù*—successful; *babhüvima*—we have become.

TRANSLATION

O creator of the universe, You are our mother, well-wisher, Lord, father, spiritual master and worshipable Deity. By following in Your footsteps we have become successful in every respect. We pray, therefore, that You

continue to bless us with Your mercy.

PURPORT

The all-good Personality of Godhead, being the creator of the universe, also plans for the good of all good living beings. The good living beings are advised by the Lord to follow His good advice, and by doing so they become successful in all spheres of life. There is no need to worship any deity but the Lord. The Lord is all-powerful, and if He is satisfied by our obedience unto His lotus feet, He is competent to bestow upon us all kinds of blessings for the successful execution of both our material and spiritual lives. For attaining spiritual existence, the human form is a chance for all to understand our eternal relation with God. Our relation with Him is eternal; it can neither be broken nor vanquished. It may be forgotten for the time being, but it can be revived also by the grace of the Lord, if we follow His injunctions, which are revealed in the scriptures of all times and all places.

TEXT 8

Ahae SaNaaQaa >avTaa SMa YaÜYa&
}aEivíPaaNaaMaiPa dUrdXaRNaMa()
Pa[eMaiSMaTaiòGDaiNarq+a<aaNaNa&
PaXYaeMa æPa& Tav SavRSaaE>aGaMa()) 8))

aho sanäthä bhavatä sma yad vayaà

traiviñöapänäm api düra-darçanam

prema-smita-snigdha-nirékñäëänanaà

paçyema rüpaà tava sarva-saubhagam

SYNONYMS

aho—oh, it is our good luck; *sa-näthä*—to be under the protection of the master; *bhavatä*—by Your good self; *sma*—as we have become; *yat vayam*—as we are; *traiviñöa-pänäm*—of the demigods; *api*—also; *düra-*

darṣanam—very rarely seen; *prema-smita*—smiling with love; *snigdha*—affectionate; *nirékñāëa-ānanam*—face looking in that mode; *paçyema*—let us look; *rüpam*—beauty; *tava*—Your; *sarva*—all; *saubhagam*—auspiciousness.

TRANSLATION

Oh, it is our good luck that we have come again today under Your protection by Your presence, for Your Lordship rarely visits even the denizens of heaven. Now it is possible for us to look into Your smiling face, which is full of affectionate glances. We can now see Your transcendental form, full of all auspiciousness.

PURPORT

The Lord in His eternal personal form can be seen only by the pure devotees. The Lord is never impersonal, but He is the Supreme Absolute Personality of Godhead, possible to be visited by devotional service face to face, which is impossible to be done even by the denizens of higher planets. When Brahmäjé and other demigods want to consult Lord Viṣṇu, the plenary portion of Lord Kṛṣṇa, they have to wait on the shore of the ocean of milk where Lord Viṣṇu is lying on White Land (Çvetadvépa). This ocean of milk and the Çvetadvépa planet are the replica of Vaikunthaloka within the universe. Neither Brahmäjé nor the demigods like Indra can enter into this island of Çvetadvépa, but they can stand on the shore of the ocean of milk and transmit their message to Lord Viṣṇu, known as Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. Therefore, the Lord is rarely seen by them, but the inhabitants of Dvārakā, because of their being pure devotees without any tinge of the material contamination of fruitive activities and empiric philosophical speculation, can see Him face to face by the grace of the Lord. This is the original state of the living entities and can be attained by reviving our natural and constitutional state of life, which is discovered by devotional service only.

TEXT 9

**YaùRMbuJaa+aaPaSaSaar >aae >avaNa(
ku-æNa(MaDaUNa(vaQa SauôïÕd*+aYaa)**

Ta}aaBdk-aei\$=Pa[iTaMa" +a<aae >aved(
riv& ivNaa+<aaeirv NaSTavaCYauTa)) 9))

yarhy ambujäkñäpasasära bho bhavän

kurün madhün vätha suhåd-didåkñayä

taträbda-koöi-pratimaù kñäëo bhaved

ravià vinäkñëor iva nas taväcyuta

SYNONYMS

yarhi—whenever; *ambuja-akñä*—O lotus-eyed one; *apasasära*—You go away; *bho*—oh; *bhavän*—Yourself; *kurün*—the descendants of King Kuru; *madhün*—the inhabitants of Mathurä (Vrajabhümi); *vä*—either; *atha*—therefore; *suhåt-didåkñayä*—for meeting them; *tatra*—at that time; *abda-koöi*—millions of years; *pratimaù*—like; *kñäëaù*—moments; *bhaved*—becomes; *ravim*—the sun; *vinä*—without; *akñëo*—of the eyes; *iva*—like that; *naù*—ours; *tava*—Your; *acyuta*—O infallible one.

TRANSLATION

O lotus-eyed Lord, whenever You go away to Mathurä, Våndävana or Hastinäpura to meet Your friends and relatives, every moment of Your absence seems like a million years. O infallible one, at that time our eyes become useless, as if bereft of sun.

PURPORT

We are all proud of our material senses for making experiments to determine the existence of God. But we forget that our senses are not absolute by themselves. They can only act under certain conditions. For example, our eyes. As long as the sunshine is there, our eyes are useful to a certain extent. But in the absence of sunshine, the eyes are useless. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, being the primeval Lord, the Supreme Truth, is compared to the sun. Without Him all our knowledge is either false or partial. The opposite of the

sun is the darkness, and similarly the opposite of Kṛṣṇa is *māyā*, or illusion. The devotees of the Lord can see everything in true perspective due to the light disseminated by Lord Kṛṣṇa. By the grace of the Lord the pure devotee cannot be in the darkness of ignorance. Therefore, it is necessary that we must always be in the sight of Lord Kṛṣṇa so that we can see both ourselves and the Lord with His different energies. As we cannot see anything in the absence of the sun, so also we cannot see anything including our own self, without the factual presence of the Lord. Without Him all our knowledge is covered by illusion.

TEXT 10

k-Qa& vYa& NaaQa icraeizTae TviYa Pa[Saàd*íyai%/TaaPaXaaez<aMa()
 JaqveMa Tae SauNdrhaSaXaaei>aTaMaPaXYaMaaNaa vdNa&
 MaNaaehrMa()
 wiTa caedqirTaa vac" Pa[JaaNaa& >aç-vTSal/")
 é*<vaNaae_NauGa]h& d*íya ivTaNVNa(Pa[aivXaTa(PaurMa()) 10))

kathàà vayaà nātha ciroñite tvayi

prasanna-dāñöyākhila-tāpa-çoñāëam

jévema te sundara-hāsa-çobhitam

apaçyamānā vadanaà manoharam

iti codéritā vācaù

prajānāà bhakta-vatsalaù

çāëvāno 'nugrahaà dāñöyā

vitānvan prāviçat puram

SYNONYMS

katham—how; *vayam*—we; *nātha*—O Lord; *ciroñite*—being abroad almost

always; *tvayi*—by You; *prasanna*—satisfaction; *dāñöyā*—by the glance; *akhila*—universal; *tāpa*—miseries; *çoñäëam*—vanquishing; *jévema*—shall be able to live; *te*—Your; *sundara*—beautiful; *häsa*—smiling; *çobhitam*—decorated; *apaçyamänäù*—without seeing; *vadanam*—face; *manoharam*—attractive; *iti*—thus; *ca*—and; *udéritäù*—speaking; *väcaù*—words; *prajānäm*—of the citizens; *bhakta-vatsalaù*—kind to the devotees; *çäëvänaù*—thus learning; *anugraham*—kindness; *dāñöyā*—by glances; *vitānvan*—distributing; *präviçat*—entered; *puram*—Dvārakāpuré.

TRANSLATION

O master, if You live abroad all the time, then we cannot look at Your attractive face, whose smiles vanquish all our sufferings. How can we exist without Your presence? Upon hearing their speeches, the Lord, who is very kind to the citizens and the devotees, entered the city of Dvārakā and acknowledged all their greetings by casting His transcendental glance over them.

PURPORT

Lord Kṛṣṇa's attraction is so powerful that once being attracted by Him one cannot tolerate separation from Him. Why is this so? Because we are all eternally related with Him as the sun rays are eternally related with the sun disc. The sun rays are molecular parts of the solar radiation. Thus the sun rays and the sun cannot be separated. The separation by the cloud is temporary and artificial, and as soon as the cloud is cleared, the sun rays again display their natural effulgence in the presence of the sun. Similarly, the living entities, who are molecular parts of the whole spirit, are separated from the Lord by the artificial covering of *māyā*, illusory energy. This illusory energy, or the curtain of *māyā*, has to be removed, and when it is so done, the living entity can see the Lord face to face, and all his miseries are at once removed. Every one of us wants to remove the miseries of life, but we do not know how to do it. The solution is given here, and it rests on us to assimilate it or not.

TEXT 11

MaDau>aaeJadXaahaRhRku-ku-raNDak-v*iZ<ai>a")
AaTMaTauLYable/GauRaa& NaaGaE>aaeRGavTaqiMav)) 11))

madhu-bhoja-daçärhärha-

kukurändhaka-vãñëibhiù

ätma-tulya-balair guptäa

nägair bhogavatém iva

SYNONYMS

madhu—Madhu; *bhoja*—Bhoja; *daçärha*—Daçärha; *arha*—Arha; *kukura*—Kukura; *andhaka*—Andhaka; *vãñëibhiù*—by the descendants of Vãñëi; *ätma-tulya*—as good as Himself; *balaiù*—by strength; *guptäm*—protected; *nägaiù*—by the Nägas; *bhogavatém*—the capital of Nägaloka; *iva*—like.

TRANSLATION

As Bhogavaté, the capital of Nägaloka, is protected by the Nägas, so was Dvārakä protected by the descendants of Vãñëi—Bhoja, Madhu, Daçärha, Arha, Kukura, Andhaka, etc.—who were as strong as Lord Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

The Nägaloka planet is situated below the earth planet, and it is understood that the sun rays are hampered there. The darkness of the planet is, however, removed by the flashes of the jewels set on the heads of the Nägas (celestial serpents), and it is said that there are beautiful gardens, rivulets, etc., for the enjoyment of the Nägas. It is understood here also that the place is well protected by the inhabitants. So also the city of Dvārakä was well protected by the descendants of Vãñëi, who were as powerful as the Lord, insofar as He manifested His strength upon this earth.

TEXT 12

SavRTauRSavRiv>avPau<Yav*+al/Taaé[MaE")
oÔaNaaePavNaaraMaEv*RTaPaÚak-rié[YaMa()) 12))

sarvartu-sarva-vibhava-

puëya-våkña-latäçramaiù

udyānopavanārāmair

vāta-padmākara-çriyam

SYNONYMS

sarva—all; *ātu*—seasons; *sarva*—all; *vibhava*—opulences; *puëya*—pious; *våkña*—trees; *latä*—creepers; *äçramaiù*—with hermitages; *udyāna*—orchards; *upavana*—flower gardens; *ärāmaiù*—pleasure gardens and beautiful parks; *vāta*—surrounded by; *padma-ākara*—the birthplaces of lotuses or nice reservoirs of water; *çriyam*—increasing the beauty.

TRANSLATION

The city of Dvārakapuré was filled with the opulences of all seasons. There were hermitages, orchards, flower gardens, parks and reservoirs of water breeding lotus flowers all over.

PURPORT

Perfection of human civilization is made possible by utilizing the gifts of nature in their own way. As we find herewith in the description of its opulence, Dvārakā was surrounded by flower gardens and fruit orchards along with reservoirs of water and growing lotuses. There is no mention of mills and factories supported by slaughterhouses, which are the necessary paraphernalia of the modern metropolis. The propensity to utilize nature's own gifts is still there, even in the heart of modern civilized man. The leaders of modern civilization select their own residential quarters in a place where there are such naturally beautiful gardens and reservoirs of water, but they leave the common men to reside in congested areas

without parks and gardens. Herein of course we find a different description of the city of Dvārakā. It is understood that the whole *dhāma*, or residential quarter, was surrounded by such gardens and parks with reservoirs of water where lotuses grew. It is understood that all the people depended on nature's gifts of fruits and flowers without industrial enterprises promoting filthy huts and slums for residential quarters. Advancement of civilization is estimated not on the growth of mills and factories to deteriorate the finer instincts of the human being, but on developing the potent spiritual instincts of human beings and giving them a chance to go back to Godhead. Development of factories and mills is called *ugra-karma*, or pungent activities, and such activities deteriorate the finer sentiments of the human being and society to form a dungeon of demons.

We find herein the mention of pious trees which produce seasonal flowers and fruits. The impious trees are useless jungles only, and they can only be used to supply fuels. In the modern civilization such impious trees are planted on the sides of roads. Human energy should be properly utilized in developing the finer senses for spiritual understanding, in which lies the solution of life. Fruits, flowers, beautiful gardens, parks and reservoirs of water with ducks and swans playing in the midst of lotus flowers, and cows giving sufficient milk and butter are essential for developing the finer tissues of the human body. As against this, the dungeons of mines, factories and workshops develop demoniac propensities in the working class. The vested interests flourish at the cost of the working class, and consequently there are severe clashes between them in so many ways. The description of Dvārakā-dhāma is the ideal of human civilization.

TEXT 13

GaaePaurÜarMaaGaeRzu k*-Tak-aETauk-Taaer<aaMa()
ic}aßJaPaTaak-aGa]ErNTa" Pa[iTahTaaTaPaaMa()) 13))

gopura-dvāra-māgeṇu

kāta-kautuka-toraëäm

citra-dhvaja-patākāgrair

antaù pratihatätapäm

SYNONYMS

gopura—the gateway of the city; *dvära*—door; *märkeñu*—on different roads; *kāta*—undertaken; *kautuka*—because of the festival; *toraëäm*—decorated arch; *citra*—painted; *dhvaja*—flags; *patäkä-agraiù*—by the foremost signs; *antaù*—within; *pratihata*—checked; *ätapäm*—sunshine.

TRANSLATION

The city gateway, the household doors and festooned arches along the roads were all nicely decorated with festive signs like plantain trees and mango leaves, all to welcome the Lord. Flags, garlands and painted signs and slogans all combined to shade the sunshine.

PURPORT

Signs of decoration in special festivals were also collected from the gifts of nature, such as the plantain trees, the mango trees, fruits and flowers. Mango trees, coconut palms and plantain trees are still accepted as auspicious signs. The flags mentioned above were all painted with the picture of either Garuò or Hanumän, the two great servitors of the Lord. For devotees, such paintings and decorations are still adored, and the servitor of the master is paid more respects for the satisfaction of the Lord.

TEXT 14

**SaMMaaiJaRTaMahaMaaGaRrQYaaPa<ak-cTvraMa()
iSaÇ-a& GaNDaJalE/ååa& f-l/PauZPaa+aTaax(ku-rE")) 14))**

sammärjita-mahä-märga-

rathyäpaëaka-catvaräm

siktäà gandha-jalair uptäà

phala-puñpākñatāikuraiù

SYNONYMS

sammärjita—thoroughly cleansed; *mahä-märga*—highways; *rathya*—lanes and subways; *äpaëaka*—shopping marketplaces; *catvaräm*—public meeting places; *siktäm*—moistened with; *gandha-jalaiù*—scented water; *uptäm*—was strewn with; *phala*—fruits; *puñpa*—flowers; *akñata*—unbroken; *aikuraiù*—seeds.

TRANSLATION

The highways, subways, lanes, markets and public meeting places were all thoroughly cleansed and then moistened with scented water. And to welcome the Lord, fruits, flowers and unbroken seeds were strewn everywhere.

PURPORT

Scented waters prepared by distilling flowers like rose and *keora* were requisitioned to wet the roads, streets and lanes of Dvarakä-dhäma. Such places, along with the marketplace and public meeting places, were thoroughly cleansed. From the above description, it appears that the city of Dvarakädhäma was considerably big, containing many highways, streets and public meeting places with parks, gardens and reservoirs of water, all very nicely decorated with flowers and fruits. And to welcome the Lord such flowers and fruits with unbroken seeds of grain were also strewn over the public places. Unbroken seeds of grain or fruits in the seedling stage were considered auspicious, and they are still so used by the Hindus in general on festival days.

TEXT 15

Üair Üair Ga*ha<aa& c dDYa+aTaf-le/+aui>a")
Al/x(k*-Taa& PaU<aRku-M>aEbRil/i>aDaURPadqPakE-")) 15))

dväri dväri gähäëää ca

dadhy-akñata-phalekñubhiù

alaikâtäà pürëa-kumbhair

balibhir dhüpa-dépakaiù

SYNONYMS

dväri dväri—the door of each and every house; *gãhëäm*—of all the residential buildings; *ca*—and; *dadhi*—curd; *akñata*—unbroken; *phala*—fruit; *ikñubhiù*—sugarcane; *alaikâtäm*—decorated; *pürëa-kumbhaiù*—full water pots; *balibhiù*—along with articles for worship; *dhüpa*—incense; *dépakaiù*—with lamps and candles.

TRANSLATION

In each and every door of the residential houses, auspicious things like curd, unbroken fruits, sugarcane and full waterpots with articles for worship, incense and candles were all displayed.

PURPORT

The process of reception according to Vedic rites is not at all dry. The reception was made not simply by decorating the roads and streets as above mentioned, but by worshiping the Lord with requisite ingredients like incense, lamps, flowers, sweets, fruits and other palatable eatables, according to one's capacity. All were offered to the Lord, and the remnants of the foodstuff were distributed amongst the gathering citizens. So it was not like a dry reception of these modern days. Each and every house was ready to receive the Lord in a similar way, and thus each and every house on the roads and streets distributed such remnants of food to the citizens, and therefore the festival was successful. Without distribution of food, no function is complete, and that is the way of Vedic culture.

TEXTS 16–17

iNaXaMYa Pa[eiMaaYaaNTa& vSaudevae MahaMaNaa")

AṣU-rêaeGa]SaeNaê raMaêad(>auTaivṣ-Ma")) 16))
Pa[ŪuManêaâdeZ<aê SaaMbae JaaMbvTaqSauTa")
Pa[hzRveGaeeC^iXaTaXaYaNaSaNa>aaeJaNa")) 17))

niṣamyā preñōham āyānta

vasudevo mahā-manū

akrūraḥ cograsenaḥ ca

rāmaḥ cādbhuta-vikrama

pradyumnaḥ cārudeñēaḥ ca

sāmbho jāmbavaté-suta

praharṇa-vegocchaṣita-

ṣayanāsana-bhojanā

SYNONYMS

niṣamyā—just hearing; *preñōham*—the dearmost; *āyāntam*—coming home; *vasudeva*—Vasudeva (the father of Kṛṣṇa); *mahā-manū*—the magnanimous; *akrūra*—Akrūra; *ca*—and; *ugrasena*—Ugrasena; *ca*—and; *rāma*—Balarāma (the elder brother of Kṛṣṇa); *ca*—and; *adbhuta*—superhuman; *vikrama*—prowess; *pradyumna*—Pradyumna; *cārudeñēa*—Cārudeñēa; *ca*—and; *sāmba*—Sāmba; *jāmbavaté-suta*—the son of Jāmbavaté; *praharṇa*—extreme happiness; *vega*—force; *ucchaṣita*—being influenced by; *ṣayana*—lying down; *āsana*—sitting on; *bhojanā*—dining.

TRANSLATION

On hearing that the most dear Kṛṣṇa was approaching Dvārakādhāma, magnanimous Vasudeva, Akrūra, Ugrasena, Balarāma (the superhumanly powerful), Pradyumna, Cārudeñēa and Sāmba the son of Jāmbavaté, all

extremely happy, abandoned resting, sitting and dining.

PURPORT

Vasudeva: Son of King Çürasena, husband of Devaké and father of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. He is the brother of Kunté and father of Subhadrä. Subhadrä was married with her cousin Arjuna, and this system is still prevalent in some parts of India. Vasudeva was appointed minister of Ugrasena, and later on he married eight daughters of Ugrasena's brother Devaka. Devaké is only one of them. Kaàsa was his brother-in-law, and Vasudeva accepted voluntary imprisonment by Kaàsa on mutual agreement to deliver the eighth son of Devaké. This was foiled by the will of Kṛṣṇa. As maternal uncle of the Pääòavas, he took active parts in the purificatory process of the Pääòavas. He sent for the priest Kaçyapa at the Çatasâiga Parvata, and he executed the functions. When Kṛṣṇa appeared within the bars of Kaàsa's prison house, He was transferred by Vasudeva to the house of Nanda Mahäräja, the foster father of Kṛṣṇa, at Gokula. Kṛṣṇa disappeared along with Baladeva prior to the disappearance of Vasudeva, and Arjuna (Vasudeva's nephew) undertook the charge of the funeral ceremony after Vasudeva's disappearance.

Akrüra: The commander in chief of the Vãñëi dynasty and a great devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Akrüra attained success in devotional service to the Lord by the one single process of offering prayers. He was the husband of Sütané, daughter of Ahüka. He supported Arjuna when Arjuna took Subhadrä forcibly away by the will of Kṛṣṇa. Both Kṛṣṇa and Akrüra went to see Arjuna after his successful kidnapping of Subhadrä. Both of them presented dowries to Arjuna after this incidence. Akrüra was present also when Abhimanyu, the son of Subhadrä, was married with Uttarä, mother of Mahäräja Parékñit. Ahüka, the father-in-law of Akrüra, was not on good terms with Akrüra. But both of them were devotees of the Lord.

Ugrasena: One of the powerful kings of the Vãñëi dynasty and cousin of Mahäräja Kuntibhoja. His other name is Ahüka. His minister was Vasudeva, and his son was the powerful Kaàsa. This Kaàsa imprisoned his father and became the King of Mathurä. By the grace of Lord Kṛṣṇa and His brother, Lord Baladeva, Kaàsa was killed, and Ugrasena was reinstalled on the

throne. When Çälva attacked the city of Dvārakā, Ugrasena fought very valiantly and repulsed the enemy. Ugrasena inquired from Nāradaġé about the divinity of Lord Kṛṣṇa. When the Yadu dynasty was to be vanquished, Ugrasena was entrusted with the iron lump produced from the womb of Sāmba. He cut the iron lump into pieces and then pasted it and mixed it up with the sea water on the coast of Dvārakā. After this, he ordered complete prohibition within the city of Dvārakā and the kingdom. He got salvation after his death.

Baladeva: He is the divine son of Vasudeva by his wife Rohiġé. He is also known as Rohiġé-nandana, the beloved son of Rohiġé. He was also entrusted to Nanda Mahārāja along with His mother, Rohiġé, when Vasudeva embraced imprisonment by mutual agreement with Kaāsa. So Nanda Mahārāja is also the foster father of Baladeva along with Lord Kṛṣṇa. Lord Kṛṣṇa and Lord Baladeva were constant companions from Their very childhood, although They were stepbrothers. He is the plenary manifestation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and therefore He is as good and powerful as Lord Kṛṣṇa. He belongs to the *viṣṇu-tattva* (the principle of Godhead). He attended the *svayaṁvara* ceremony of Draupadé along with Sri Kṛṣṇa. When Subhadrā was kidnapped by Arjuna by the organized plan of Sri Kṛṣṇa, Baladeva was very angry with Arjuna and wanted to kill him at once. Sri Kṛṣṇa, for the sake of His dear friend, fell at the feet of Lord Baladeva and implored Him not to be so angry. Sri Baladeva was thus satisfied. Similarly, He was once very angry with the Kauravas, and He wanted to throw their whole city into the depths of the Yamunā. But the Kauravas satisfied Him by surrendering unto His divine lotus feet. He was actually the seventh son of Devaké prior to the birth of Lord Kṛṣṇa, but by the will of the Lord He was transferred to the womb of Rohiġé to escape the wrath of Kaāsa. His other name is therefore Saṅkarṣṇa, who is also the plenary portion of Sri Baladeva. Because He is as powerful as Lord Kṛṣṇa and can bestow spiritual power to the devotees, He is therefore known as Baladeva. In the *Vedas* also it is enjoined that no one can know the Supreme Lord without being favored by Baladeva. *Bala* means spiritual strength not physical. Some less intelligent persons interpret *bala* as the strength of the body. But no one can have spiritual realization by physical strength. Physical strength ends with the end of the physical body, but spiritual strength follows the spirit soul to the next transmigration, and

therefore the strength obtained by Baladeva is never wasted. The strength is eternal, and thus Baladeva is the original spiritual master of all devotees.

Sri Baladeva was also a class friend of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa as a student of Sāndépani Muni. In His childhood He killed many *asuras* along with Sri Kṛṣṇa, and specifically He killed the Dhenukāsura at Tālavana. During the Kurukṣetra battle, He remained neutral, and He tried His best not to bring about the fight. He was in favor of Duryodhana, but still He remained neutral. When there was a club-fight between Duryodhana and Bhémasena, He was present on the spot. He was angry at Bhémasena when the latter struck Duryodhana on the thigh or below the belt, and He wanted to retaliate the unfair action. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa saved Bhéma from His wrath. But He left the place at once, being disgusted at Bhémasena, and after His departure Duryodhana fell to the ground to meet his death. The funeral ceremony of Abhimanyu, the son of Arjuna, was performed by Him, as He was the maternal uncle. It was impossible to be performed by any one of the Pāṇḍavas, who were all overwhelmed with grief. At the last stage, He departed from this world by producing a great white snake from His mouth, and thus He was carried by Çeñanāga in the shape of a serpent.

Pradyumna: Incarnation of Kāmadeva or, according to others, incarnation of Sanat-kumāra, born as the son of the Personality of Godhead Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and Lakṣmīdevī Srimatī Rukmiṇī, the principal queen at Dvārakā. He was one of those who went to congratulate Arjuna upon his marrying Subhadrā. He was one of the great generals who fought with Çālva, and while fighting with him he became unconscious on the battlefield. His charioteer brought him back to the camp from the battlefield, and for this action he was very sorry and rebuked his charioteer. However, he fought again with Çālva and was victorious. He heard all about the different demigods from Nārada. He is one of the four plenary expansions of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. He is the third one. He inquired from his father, Sri Kṛṣṇa, about the glories of the *brahmanas*. During the fratricidal war amongst the descendants of Yadu, he died at the hand of Bhoja, another king of the Vāṇīs. After his death, he was installed in his original position.

Cārudeṇḍa: Another son of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and Rukmiṇīdevī. He was also present during the *svayaṁvara* ceremony of Draupadī. He was a great

warrior like his brothers and father. He fought with Vivinidhaka and killed him in the fight.

Sāmba: One of the great heroes of the Yadu dynasty and the son of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa by His wife Jāmbavaté. He learned the military art of throwing arrows from Arjuna, and he became a member of parliament during the time of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. He was present during the Rājasūya-yajña of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. When all the Vāñëis were assembled during the time of Prabhāsa-yajña, his glorious activities were narrated by Sātyaki before Lord Baladeva. He was also present along with his father, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, during the Aṣvamedha-yajña performed by Yudhiñöhira. He was presented before some *āñis* falsely dressed as a pregnant woman by his brothers, and in fun he asked the *āñis* what he was going to deliver. The *āñis* replied that he would deliver a lump of iron, which would be the cause of fratricidal war in the family of Yadu. The next day, in the morning, Sāmba delivered a large lump of iron, which was entrusted with Ugrasena for necessary action. Actually later on there was the foretold fratricidal war, and Sāmba died in that war.

So all these sons of Lord Kṛṣṇa left their respective palaces and leaving aside all engagements, including lying down, sitting and dining, hastened toward their exalted father.

TEXT 18

var<aeNd]& PaurSk*-TYa b]aø<aE" SaSauMa®IE/")
Xa«TaUYaRiNaNaadeNa b]øgaaeze<a cad*Taa")
Pa[TYauÂGMaU rQaEôRía" Pa[<aYaaGaTaSaaßSaa")) 18))

vāraëendraà puraskātya

brahmanaiù sasumaìgalaiù

çaikha-türya-ninädena

brahma-ghoñëëa cädâtäù

pratyujjagmü rathair hãñöäù

praëayägata-sädhvasäù

SYNONYMS

väraëa-indram—elephants on the auspicious mission; *puraskåtya*—putting in the front; *brahmanaiù*—by the *brahmanas*; *sa-sumaìgalaiù*—with all-auspicious signs; *çaikha*—conchshell; *türya*—bugle; *ninädena*—by the sound of; *brahma-ghoñeëa*—by chanting the hymns of the *Vedas*; *ca*—and; *ädåtäù*—glorified; *prati*—towards; *ujjagmuù*—proceeded hurriedly; *rathaiù*—on the chariots; *hãñöäù*—in cheerfulness; *praëayägata*—saturated with affection; *sädhvasäù*—all-respectful.

TRANSLATION

They hastened toward the Lord on chariots with brahmanas bearing flowers. Before them were elephants, emblems of good fortune. Conchshells and bugles were sounded, and Vedic hymns were chanted. Thus they offered their respects, which were saturated with affection.

PURPORT

The Vedic way of receiving a great personality creates an atmosphere of respect, which is saturated with affection and veneration for the person received. The auspicious atmosphere of such a reception depends on the paraphernalia described above, including conchshells, flowers, incense, decorated elephants, and the qualified *brahmanas* reciting verses from the Vedic literatures. Such a program of reception is full of sincerity, on the part of both the receiver and the received.

TEXT 19

**varMau:Yaaê XaTaXaae YaaNaESTaÕXaRNaaeTSauk-a")
I/SaTku-<@I/iNa>aaRTak-Paael/vdNaié[Ya")) 19))**

vāramukhyäç ca çataço

yänais tad-darṇanotsukäù

lasat-kuëòala-nirbhäta-

kapola-vadana-çriyaù

SYNONYMS

vāramukhyäù—well-known prostitutes; *ca*—and; *çataçaù*—hundreds of; *yänaiù*—by vehicles; *tat-darṇana*—for meeting Him (Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa); *utsukäù*—very much anxious; *lasat*—hanging; *kuëòala*—earrings; *nirbhäta*—dazzling; *kapola*—forehead; *vadana*—face; *çriyaù*—beauty.

TRANSLATION

At the same time, many hundreds of well-known prostitutes began to proceed on various vehicles. They were all very eager to meet the Lord, and their beautiful faces were decorated with dazzling earrings, which enhanced the beauty of their foreheads.

PURPORT

We may not hate even the prostitutes if they are devotees of the Lord. Even to date there are many prostitutes in great cities of India who are sincere devotees of the Lord. By tricks of chance one may be obliged to adopt a profession which is not very adorable in society, but that does not hamper one in executing devotional service to the Lord. Devotional service to the Lord is uncheckable in all circumstances. It is understood herewith that even in those days, about five thousand years ago, there were prostitutes in a city like Dvārakā, where Lord Kṛṣṇa resided. This means that prostitutes are necessary citizens for the proper upkeep of society. The government opens wine shops, but this does not mean that the government encourages the drinking of wine. The idea is that there is a class of men who will drink at any cost, and it has been experienced that prohibition in great cities encouraged illicit smuggling of wine. Similarly, men who are not satisfied at home require such concessions, and if there is no prostitute, then such low men will induce others into prostitution. It is

better that prostitutes be available in the marketplace so that the sanctity of society can be maintained. It is better to maintain a class of prostitutes than to encourage prostitutes within society. The real reformation is to enlighten all people to become devotees of the Lord, and that will check all kinds of deteriorating factors of life.

Sri Bilvamaṅgala Öhäkura, a great *äcärya* of the Viṣṇusvämé Vaiñëava sect, in his householder life was overly attached to a prostitute who happened to be a devotee of the Lord. One night when the Öhäkura came to Cintämaëi's house in torrents of rain and thunder, Cintämaëi was astonished to see how the Öhäkura could come on such a dreadful night after crossing a foaming river which was full of waves. She said to Öhäkura Bilvamaṅgala that his attraction for the flesh and bone of an insignificant woman like her would be properly utilized if it could be diverted to the devotional service of the Lord to achieve attraction for the transcendental beauty of the Lord. It was a momentous hour for the Öhäkura, and he took a turn towards spiritual realization by the words of a prostitute. Later on the Öhäkura accepted the prostitute as his spiritual master, and in several places of his literary works he has glorified the name of Cintämaëi, who showed him the right path.

In the *Bhagavad-gita* (9.32) the Lord says, "O son of Pāthä, even the low-born *caëðälas* and those who are born in a family of unbelievers, and even the prostitutes, shall attain perfection of life if they take shelter of unalloyed devotional service to Me, because in the path of devotional service there are no impediments due to degraded birth and occupation. The path is open for everyone who agrees to follow it."

It appears that the prostitutes of Dväarakä, who were so eager to meet the Lord, were all His unalloyed devotees, and thus they were all on the path of salvation according to the above version of the *Bhagavad-gita*. Therefore, the only reformation that is necessary in society is to make an organized effort to turn the citizens into devotees of the Lord, and thus all good qualities of the denizens of heaven will overtake them in their own way. On the other hand, those who are nondevotees have no good qualifications whatsoever, however they may be materially advanced. The difference is that the devotees of the Lord are on the path of liberation, whereas the nondevotees are on the path of further entanglement in material bondage.

The criterion of advancement of civilization is whether the people are educated and advanced on the path of salvation.

TEXT 20

**Na\$=NaTaRk-GaNdavaR" SaUTaMaaGaDaviNdNa")
GaaYaiNTa caetaMaëaek-cirTaaNYad(>auTaaiNa c)) 20))**

naöa-nartaka-gandharväù

süta-mägadha-vandinaù

gäyanti cottamaçloka-

caritäny adbhutäni ca

SYNONYMS

naöa—dramatists; *nartaka*—dancers; *gandharväù*—celestial singers; *süta*—professional historians; *mägadha*—professional genealogists; *vandinaù*—professional learned speakers; *gäyanti*—chant; *ca*—respectively; *uttamaçloka*—the Supreme Lord; *caritäni*—activities; *adbhutäni*—all superhuman; *ca*—and.

TRANSLATION

Expert dramatists, artists, dancers, singers, historians, genealogists and learned speakers all gave their respective contributions, being inspired by the superhuman pastimes of the Lord. Thus they proceeded on and on.

PURPORT

It appears that five thousand years ago the society also needed the services of the dramatists, artists, dancers, singers, historians, genealogists, public speakers, etc. Dancers, singers and dramatic artists mostly hailed from the *çüdra* community, whereas the learned historians, genealogists and public speakers hailed from the *brahmana* community. All of them belonged to a

particular caste, and they became so trained in their respective families. Such dramatists, dancers, singers, historians, genealogists and public speakers would dwell on the subject of the Lord's superhuman activities in different ages and millenniums, and not on ordinary events. Nor were they in chronological order. All the *Puranas* are historical facts described only in relation with the Supreme Lord in different ages and times as well as on different planets also. Therefore, we do not find any chronological order. The modern historians, therefore, cannot catch up the link, and thus they unauthoritatively remark that the *Puranas* are all imaginary stories only.

Even one hundred years ago in India, all dramatic performances were centered around the superhuman activities of the Supreme Lord. The common people would be verily entertained by the performances of dramas, and *yātrā* parties played wonderfully on the superhuman activities of the Lord, and thus even the illiterate agriculturist would be a participant in the knowledge of Vedic literature, despite a considerable lack of academic qualifications. Therefore, expert players in drama, dancers, singers, speakers, etc., are required for the spiritual enlightenment of the common man. The genealogists would give account completely of the descendants of a particular family. Even at the present moment the guides in the pilgrimage sites of India submit a complete account of genealogical tables before a newcomer. This wonderful act sometimes attracts more customers to receive such important information.

TEXT 21

>aGava&STa}a bNDaUNaa& PaaEra<aaMaNauviTaRNaaMa()
YaQaaivDYauPaSa®MYa SaveRza& MaaNaMaadDae)) 21))

bhagavāṁs tatra bandhūnā

paurāṇām anuvartinām

yathā-vidhy upasaṅgamyā

sarveṇnā mānam ādadhe

SYNONYMS

bhagavān—Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead; *tatra*—in that place; *bandhūnām*—of the friends; *paurāṇām*—of the citizens; *anuvartinām*—those who approached Him to receive and welcome; *yathā-vidhi*—as it behooves; *upasaṅgamyā*—going nearer; *sarveṇām*—for each and every one; *mānam*—honor and respects; *ādadhe*—offered.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, approached them and offered due honor and respect to each and every one of the friends, relatives, citizens and all others who came to receive and welcome Him.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord Personality of Godhead is neither impersonal nor an inert object unable to reciprocate the feelings of His devotees. Here the word *yathā-vidhi*, or “just as it behooves” is significant. He reciprocates “just as it behooves” with His different types of admirers and devotees. Of course, the pure devotees are of one type only because they have no other object for service but the Lord, and therefore the Lord also reciprocates with such pure devotees just as it behooves, namely, He is always attentive to all the matters of His pure devotees. There are others who designate Him as impersonal, and so the Lord also does not take any personal interest. He satisfies everyone in terms of one’s development of spiritual consciousness, and a sample of such reciprocation is exhibited here with His different welcomers.

TEXT 22

**Pa[ûai>avadNaaëezk-rSPaXaRiSMaTae+a<aE")
AaiaSYa caìPaake->Yaae vrEëai>aMaTaEivR>au")) 22))**

prahvābhivādanāçleña-

kara-sparça-smitekñāëaiù

äçväsya cäçvapäkebhyo

varaiç cäbhimatair vibhuù

SYNONYMS

prahvā—by bowing His head; *abhivādana*—by greeting with words; *äçleñā*—embracing; *kara-sparça*—shaking hands; *smita-ékñāëaiù*—by a glancing smile; *äçväsya*—by encouragement; *ca*—and; *äçvapäkebhyaù*—down to the lowest rank of dog-eaters; *varaiù*—by benedictions; *ca*—also; *abhimataiù*—as desired by; *vibhuù*—the Almighty.

TRANSLATION

The Almighty Lord greeted everyone present by bowing His head, exchanging greetings, embracing, shaking hands, looking and smiling, giving assurances and awarding benedictions, even to the lowest in rank.

PURPORT

To receive the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa there were all grades of population, beginning from Vasudeva, Ugrasena and Gargamuni—the father, grandfather and teacher—down to the prostitutes and *caëòälas*, who are accustomed to eat dogs. And every one of them was properly greeted by the Lord in terms of rank and position. As pure living entities, all are the separated parts and parcels of the Lord, and thus no one is alien by His eternal relation. Such pure living entities are graded differently in terms of contamination of the modes of material nature, but the Lord is equally affectionate to all His parts and parcels, despite material gradation. He descends only to recall these materialistic living beings back to His kingdom, and intelligent persons take advantage of this facility offered by the Personality of Godhead to all living beings. No one is rejected by the Lord from the kingdom of God, and it remains with the living being to accept this or not.

TEXT 23

SvYa& c Gauâi>aivR,,Pa[E" SadarE" SQaivrEriPa)

AaXaqi>aRYauRJYaMaaNaee_NYaEvRiNdi>aêaivXaTPaurMa()) 23))

svayaà ca gurubhir vipraiù

sadāraiù sthavirair api

äçérbhir yujyamāno 'nyair

vandibhiç cāviçat puram

SYNONYMS

svayam—Himself; *ca*—also; *gurubhiù*—by elderly relatives; *vipraiù*—by the *brahmanas*; *sadāraiù*—with their wives; *sthaviraiù*—invalid; *api*—also; *äçérbhiù*—by the blessing of; *yujyamānaù*—being praised by; *anyaiù*—by others; *vandibhiù*—admirers; *ca*—and; *aviçat*—entered; *puram*—the city.

TRANSLATION

Then the Lord personally entered the city accompanied by elderly relatives and invalid brahmanas with their wives, all offering benedictions and singing the glories of the Lord. Others also praised the glories of the Lord.

PURPORT

The *brahmanas* in society were never attentive to banking money for future retired life. When they were old invalids, they used to approach the assembly of the kings, and simply by praising the glorious deeds performed by the kings, along with their wives, they would be provided with all necessities of life. Such *brahmanas* were not, so to speak, flatterers of the kings, but the kings were actually glorified by their actions, and they were sincerely still more encouraged in pious acts by such *brahmanas* in a dignified way. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is worthy of all glories, and the praying *brahmanas* and others were glorified themselves by chanting the glories of the Lord.

TEXT 24

raJaMaaGa | GaTae k*-Z<ae Üark-aYaa" ku-l/iñYa")
hMYaaR<YaaååhuivRPa[Tadq+a<aMahaeTSava")) 24))

räja-märgaà gate kãñëe

dväarakäyäu kula-striyaù

harmyäëy äruruhur vipra

tad-ékñäëa-mahotsaväu

SYNONYMS

räja-märgam—the public roads; *gate*—while passing over; *kãñëe*—by Lord Kṛṣṇa; *dväarakäyäu*—of the city of Dvārakā; *kula-striyaù*—ladies of the respectable families; *harmyäëi*—on the palaces; *äruruhuù*—got up; *vipra*—O *brahmanas*; *tat-ékñäëa*—just to look upon Him (Kṛṣṇa); *mahä-utsaväu*—accepted as the greatest festival.

TRANSLATION

When Lord Kṛṣṇa passed over the public roads, all the ladies from the respectable families of Dvārakā went up to the roofs of their palaces just to have a look at the Lord. They considered this to be the greatest festival.

PURPORT

To have a look at the Lord is a great festive occasion undoubtedly, as it was considered by the metropolitan ladies of Dvārakā. This is still followed by the devout ladies of India. Especially during the days of the Jhulana and Janmāñöomé ceremonies, the ladies of India still throng up in the greatest number at the temple of the Lord, where His transcendental eternal form is worshiped. The transcendental form of the Lord installed in a temple is not different from the Lord personally. Such a form of the Lord is called *arca-vigraha*, or *arcä* incarnation, and is expanded by the Lord by His internal

potency just to facilitate the devotional service of His innumerable devotees who are in the material world. The material senses cannot perceive the spiritual nature of the Lord, and therefore the Lord accepts the *arca-vigraha*, which is apparently made of material elements like earth, wood and stone but actually there is no material contamination. The Lord being *kaivalya* (one alone), there is no matter in Him. He is one without a second, and therefore the Almighty Lord can appear in any form without being contaminated by the material conception. Therefore, festivities in the temple of the Lord, as held generally, are like festivals performed during the manifestive days of the Lord of Dvārakā, about five thousand years ago. The authorized *ācāryas*, who know the science perfectly, install such temples of the Lord under regulative principles just to offer facilities to the common man, but persons who are less intelligent, without being conversant with the science, mistake this great attempt to be *idol worship* and poke their nose into that to which they have no access. Therefore, the ladies or men who observe festivals in the temples of the Lord just to have a look at the transcendental form are a thousand times more glorious than those who are nonbelievers in the transcendental form of the Lord.

It appears from the verse that the inhabitants of Dvārakā were all owners of big palaces. This indicates the prosperity of the city. The ladies got up on the roofs just to have a look at the procession and the Lord. The ladies did not mix with the crowd on the street, and thus their respectability was perfectly observed. There was no artificial equality with the man. Female respectability is preserved more elegantly by keeping the woman separate from the man. The sexes should not mix unrestrictedly.

TEXT 25

**iNaTYa& iNarq+aMaa<aaNaa& YadiPa Üark-aEk-SaaMa()
Na ivTa*PYaiNTa ih d*Xa" ié[YaaeDaaMaa®MaCYauTaMa()) 25))**

nityaà nirékñamäëänäà

yad api dvārakaukasām

na vitāpyanti hi dāṣaù

çriyo dhämäìgam acyutam

SYNONYMS

nityam—regularly, always; *nirékñamäëñäm*—of those who look at Him; *yat*—although; *api*—in spite of; *dvārakā-okasām*—the inhabitants of Dvārakā; *na*—never; *vitāpyanti*—satisfied; *hi*—exactly; *dāçaù*—sight; *çriyaù*—beauties; *dhāma-aìgam*—the bodily reservoir; *acyutam*—the infallible.

TRANSLATION

The inhabitants of Dvārakā were regularly accustomed to look upon the reservoir of all beauty, the infallible Lord, yet they were never satiated.

PURPORT

When the ladies of the city of Dvārakā got up on the roofs of their palaces, they never thought that they had previously many times seen the beautiful body of the infallible Lord. This indicates that they had no satiation in desiring to see the Lord. Anything material seen for a number of times ultimately becomes unattractive by the law of satiation. The law of satiation acts materially, but there is no scope for it in the spiritual realm. The word infallible is significant here, because although the Lord has mercifully descended on earth, He is still infallible. The living entities are fallible because when they come in contact with the material world they lack their spiritual identity, and thus the body materially obtained becomes subjected to birth, growth, transformation, situation, deterioration and annihilation under the laws of nature. The Lord's body is not like that. He descends as He is and is never under the laws of the material modes. His body is the source of everything that be, the reservoir of all beauties beyond our experience. No one, therefore, is satiated by seeing the transcendental body of the Lord because there are always manifestations of newer and newer beauties. The transcendental name, form, qualities, entourage, etc., are all spiritual manifestations, and there is no satiation in chanting the holy name of the Lord, there is no satiation in discussing the qualities of the Lord, and there is no limitation of the entourage of the Lord.

He is the source of all and is limitless.

TEXT 26

ié[Yaae iNavaSaae YaSYaaer" PaaNaPaa}a& Mau%& d*XaaMa()
bahvae l/aek-Paal/aNaa& Saar®a<aa& PadaMbuJaMa()) 26))

çriyo nivāso yasyoraù

pāna-pātraà mukhaà dāçām

bāhavo loka-pālānāà

sāraigäëää padāmbujam

SYNONYMS

çriyaù—of the goddess of fortune; *nivāsaù*—residential place; *yasya*—one whose; *uraù*—chest; *pāna-pātram*—the drinking pot; *mukham*—face; *dāçām*—of eyes; *bāhavaù*—the arms; *loka-pālānām*—of the administrative demigods; *sāraigäëäm*—of the devotees who talk and sing of the essence or substance; *pada-ambujam*—the lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

The Lord’s chest is the abode of the goddess of fortune. His moonlike face is the drinking vessel for eyes which hanker after all that is beautiful. His arms are the resting places for the administrative demigods. And His lotus feet are the refuge of pure devotees who never talk or sing of any subject except His Lordship.

PURPORT

There are different classes of human beings, all seeking different enjoyments from different objects. There are persons who are seeking after the favor of the goddess of fortune, and for them the Vedic literatures give information that the Lord is always served with all reverence by thousands

and thousands of goddesses of fortune at the *cintāmañi-dhāma*,^{viii*} the transcendental abode of the Lord where the trees are all desire trees and the buildings are made of touchstone. The Lord Govinda is engaged there in herding the *surabhi* cows as His natural occupation. These goddesses of fortune can be seen automatically if we are attracted by the bodily features of the Lord. The impersonalists cannot observe such goddesses of fortune because of their dry speculative habit. And those who are artists, overtaken by the beautiful creation, should better see to the beautiful face of the Lord for complete satisfaction. The face of the Lord is the embodiment of beauty. What they call beautiful nature is but His smile, and what they call the sweet songs of the birds are but specimens of the whispering voice of the Lord. There are administrative demigods in charge of departmental service of cosmic management, and there are tiny administrative gods in the state service. They are always afraid of other competitors, but if they take shelter of the arms of the Lord, the Lord can protect them always from the attacks of enemies. A faithful servant of the Lord engaged in the service of administration is the ideal executive head and can well protect the interest of the people in general. Other so-called administrators are symbols of anachronisms leading to the acute distress of the people who are governed by them. The administrators can remain safely under the protection of the arms of the Lord. The essence of everything is the Supreme Lord: He is called the *sāram*. And those who sing and talk about Him are called the *sāraṅgas*, or the pure devotees. The pure devotees are always hankering after the lotus feet of the Lord. The lotus has a kind of honey which is transcendently relished by the devotees. They are like the bees who are always after the honey. Srila Rūpa Gosvami, the great devotee *ācārya* of the Gauḍeya-Vaiṣṇava-sampradāya, has sung a song about this lotus honey, comparing himself to the bee: “O my Lord Kṛṣṇa, I beg to offer my prayers unto You. My mind is like the bee, and it is after some honey. Kindly, therefore, give my bee-mind a place at Your lotus feet, which are the resources for all transcendental honey. I know that even big demigods like Brahmā do not see the rays of the nails of Your lotus feet, even though they are engaged in deep meditation for years together. Still, O infallible one, my ambition is such, for You are very merciful to your surrendered devotees. O Mādhava, I know also that I have no genuine devotion for the service of Your lotus feet, but because Your Lordship is inconceivably powerful, You can do what is impossible to be done. Your

lotus feet can deride even the nectar of the heavenly kingdom, and therefore I am very much attracted by them. O supreme eternal, please, therefore, let my mind be fixed at Your lotus feet so that eternally I may be able to relish the taste of Your transcendental service.” The devotees are satisfied with being placed at the lotus feet of the Lord and have no ambition to see His all-beautiful face or aspire for the protection of the strong arms of the Lord. They are humble by nature, and the Lord is always leaning towards such humble devotees.

TEXT 27

iSaTaaTaPa}aVYaJaNaEåPaSk*-Ta"
Pa[SaUNavzÆEri>avizRTa" PaiQa)
iPaXa®vaSaa vNaMaal/Yaa b>aaE
gaNaae YaQaak-aeR@uPacaPavEÛuTaE")) 27))

sitātapatra-vyajanaïr upaskātaù

prasūna-varñair abhivarñitaù pathi

piṣaṅga-vāsā vana-mālayā babhau

ghano yathārkoùpa-cāpa-vaidyutaiù

SYNONYMS

sita-ātapatra—white umbrella; *vyajanaïr*—with a *cāmara* fan; *upaskātaù*—being served by; *prasūna*—flowers; *varñaiù*—by the showers; *abhivarñitaù*—thus being covered; *pathi*—on the road; *piṣaṅga-vāsāù*—by the yellow garments; *vana-mālayā*—by the flower garlands; *babhau*—thus it became; *ghanaù*—cloud; *yathā*—as if; *arka*—the sun; *uòupa*—the moon; *cāpa*—the rainbow; *vaidyutaiù*—by the lightning.

TRANSLATION

As the Lord passed along the public road of Dvārakā, His head was protected from the sunshine by a white umbrella. White feathered fans

moved in semicircles, and showers of flowers fell upon the road. His yellow garments and garlands of flowers made it appear as if a dark cloud were surrounded simultaneously by sun, moon, lightning and rainbows.

PURPORT

The sun, moon, rainbow and lightning do not appear in the sky simultaneously. When there is sun, the moonlight becomes insignificant, and if there are clouds and a rainbow, there is no manifestation of lightning. The Lord's bodily hue is just like a new monsoon cloud. He is compared herein to the cloud. The white umbrella over His head is compared to the sun. The movement of the bunch-hair fan of flukes is compared to the moon. The showers of flowers are compared to the stars. His yellow garments are compared to the rainbow. So all these activities of the firmament, being impossible simultaneous factors, cannot be adjusted by comparison. The adjustment is possible only when we think of the inconceivable potency of the Lord. The Lord is all-powerful, and in His presence anything impossible can be made possible by His inconceivable energy. But the situation created at the time of His passing on the roads of Dvārakā was beautiful and could not be compared to anything besides the description of natural phenomena.

TEXT 28

**Pa[ivíSTau Ga*h& iPa}aae" PairZvç-" SvMaaTa*i>a")
vvNde iXarSaa Saá devk-IPa[Mau%a Mauda)) 28))**

praviñöas tu gâhaà pitrou

pariñvaktàù sva-mätåbhiù

vavande çirasä sapta

devaké-pramukhä mudä

SYNONYMS

praviñöaù—after entering; *tu*—but; *gāham*—houses; *pitroù*—of the father; *pariñvaktàù*—embraced; *sva-mätåbhiù*—by His own mothers; *vavande*—offered obeisances; *çirasä*—His head; *sapta*—seven; *devaké*—Devaké; *pramukhä*—headed by; *mudä*—gladly.

TRANSLATION

After entering the house of His father, He was embraced by the mothers present, and the Lord offered His obeisances unto them by placing His head at their feet. The mothers were headed by Devaké [His real mother].

PURPORT

It appears that Vasudeva, the father of Lord Kṛṣṇa, had completely separate residential quarters where he lived with his eighteen wives, out of whom Srimaté Devaké is the real mother of Lord Kṛṣṇa. But in spite of this, all other stepmothers were equally affectionate to Him, as will be evident from the following verse. Lord Kṛṣṇa also did not distinguish His real mother from His stepmothers, and He equally offered His obeisances unto all the wives of Vasudeva present on the occasion. According to scriptures also, there are seven mothers: (1) the real mother, (2) the wife of the spiritual master, (3) the wife of a *brahmana*, (4) the wife of the king, (5) the cow, (6) the nurse, and (7) the earth. All of them are mothers. Even by this injunction of the *sastras*, the stepmother, who is the wife of the father, is also as good as the mother because the father is also one of the spiritual masters. Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Lord of the universe, plays the part of an ideal son just to teach others how to treat their stepmothers.

TEXT 29

**Taa" Pau}aMa³MaaraePYa òehòuTaPaYaaeDara")
hzRivûil/TaaTMaaNa" iSaizcuNaeR}aJaEJaRIE/")) 29))**

täù putram àikam äropyä

sneha-snuta-payodharäù

harñā-vihvalitātmānau

siñicur netrajair jalaiu

SYNONYMS

täu—all of them; *putram*—the son; *aikam*—the lap; *äropya*—having placed on; *sneha-snuta*—moistened by affection; *payodharäu*—breasts filled up; *harñā*—delight; *vihvalita-ätmānau*—overwhelmed by; *siñicu*—wet; *netrajaiu*—from the eyes; *jalaiu*—water.

TRANSLATION

The mothers, after embracing their son, sat Him on their laps. Due to pure affection, milk sprang from their breasts. They were overwhelmed with delight, and the tears from their eyes wetted the Lord.

PURPORT

When Lord Kṛṣṇa was at Vāndāvana even the cows would become moistened by affection towards Him, and He would draw milk from the nipples of every affectionate living being, so what to speak of the stepmothers who were already as good as His own mother.

TEXT 30

**AQaaivXaTa(Sv>avNa& SavRk-aMaMaNautaMaMa()
Pa[aSaada Ya}a PaÒqNaa& Sahóai<a c zae@Xa)) 30))**

athäviçat sva-bhavanaà

sarva-kāmam anuttamam

präsädä yatra patnénäà

sahasräëi ca ñoòaçā

SYNONYMS

atha—thereafter; *aviṣat*—entered; *sva-bhavanam*—personal palaces; *sarva*—all; *kāmam*—desires; *anuttamam*—perfect to the fullest extent; *prāsādāu*—palaces; *yatra*—where; *patnénām*—of the wives numbering; *sahasrāṇi*—thousands; *ca*—over and above; *ṣoḍaśa*—sixteen.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, the Lord entered His palaces, which were perfect to the fullest extent. His wives lived in them, and they numbered over sixteen thousand.

PURPORT

Lord Kṛṣṇa had 16,108 wives, and for each and every one of them there was a fully equipped palace complete with necessary compounds and gardens. Full description of these palaces is given in the Tenth Canto. All the palaces were made of the best marble stone. They were illuminated by jewels and decorated by curtains and carpets of velvet and silk, nicely bedecked and embroidered with gold lace. The Personality of Godhead means one who is full with all power, all energy, all opulences, all beauties, all knowledge and all renunciation. Therefore, in the palaces of the Lord there was nothing wanting for fulfilling all desires of the Lord. The Lord is unlimited, and therefore His desires are also unlimited, and the supply is also unlimited. Everything being unlimited, it is concisely described here as *sama-kāmam*, or full with all desirable equipment.

TEXT 31

PaTNYa" PaiTa& Pa[aeZYa Ga*haNauPaaGaTa&
ivl/aeKYa SaÅaTaMaNaaeMahaeTSava")
otaSQauraraTa(SahSaaSaNaaXaYaaTa(
Saak&- v]TaEv]s,,i@Tal/aecNaaNaNaa")) 31))

patnyaù patià proñya gāhānupāgataà

vilokya saiñjāta-mano-mahotsavāu

uttasthur ārāt sahasāsanāçayāt

sākaà vratair vréòita-locanānanāu

SYNONYMS

patnyaù—the ladies (wives of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa); *patim*—husband; *proñya*—who was away from home; *gāha-anupāgatam*—now returned home; *vilokya*—thus seeing; *saiñjāta*—having developed; *manaù-mahā-utsavāu*—a sense of joyful ceremony within the mind; *uttasthuù*—got up; *ārāt*—from a distance; *sahasā*—all of a sudden; *āsanā*—from the seats; *āçayāt*—from the state of meditation; *sākam*—along with; *vrataiù*—the vow; *vréòita*—looking coyly; *locana*—eyes; *ānanāu*—with such faces.

TRANSLATION

The queens of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa rejoiced within their minds to see their husband home after a long period abroad. The queens got up at once from their seats and meditations. As was socially customary, they covered their faces shyly and looked about coyly.

PURPORT

As mentioned above, the Lord entered His home palaces occupied by 16,108 queens. This means that the Lord at once expanded Himself in as many plenary expansions as there were queens and palaces and entered in each and every one of them simultaneously and separately. Here is another manifestation of the feature of His internal potency. He can expand Himself in as many forms of spiritual identity as He desires, even though He is one without a second. It is confirmed by the *Çruti-mantra* that the Absolute is one alone, and yet He becomes many as soon as He so desires. These manifold expansions of the Supreme Lord are manifested as plenary and separated portions. The separated portions are representations of His energy, and the plenary portions are manifestations of His Personality. Thus the Personality of Godhead manifested Himself in 16,108 plenary

expansions and simultaneously entered into each and every one of the palaces of the queens. This is called *vaibhava*, or the transcendental potency of the Lord. And because He can do so, He is also known as Yogesvara. Ordinarily, a *yogé* or mystic living being is able to expand himself at utmost to tenfold expansions of his body, but the Lord can do so to the extent of as many thousands or infinitely, as He likes. Unbelievers become astonished to learn that Lord Kṛṣṇa married more than 16,000 queens because they think of Lord Kṛṣṇa as one of them and measure the potency of the Lord by their own limited potency. One should know, therefore, that the Lord is never on the level of the living beings, who are but expansions of His marginal potency, and one should never equalize the potent and the potency, although there is very little difference of quality between the potent and the potency. The queens were also expansions of His internal potency, and thus the potent and potencies are perpetually exchanging transcendental pleasures, known as pastimes of the Lord. One should not, therefore, become astonished to learn that the Lord married so many wives. On the contrary, one should affirm that even if the Lord marries sixteen thousand million wives, He is not completely manifesting His unlimited and inexhaustible potency. He married *only* 16,000 wives and entered in each and every one of the different palaces just to impress in the history of the human beings on the surface of the earth that the Lord is never equal to or less than any human being, however powerful he may be. No one, therefore, is either equal to or greater than the Lord. The Lord is always great in all respects. “God is great” is eternal truth.

Therefore, as soon as the queens saw from a distance their husband, who was away from home for long periods due to the Battle of Kurukñetra, they all arose from the slumber of meditation and prepared to receive their most beloved. According to Yājñavalkya’s religious injunctions, a woman whose husband is away from home should not take part in any social functions, should not decorate her body, should not laugh and should not go to any relative’s house in any circumstance. This is the vow of the ladies whose husbands are away from home. At the same time, it is also enjoined that a wife should never present herself before the husband in an unclean state. She must decorate herself with ornaments and good dress and should always be present before the husband in a happy and joyous mood. The queens of Lord Kṛṣṇa were all in meditation, thinking of the Lord’s

absence, and were always meditating upon Him. The Lord's devotees cannot live for a moment without meditating on the Lord, and what to speak of the queens, who were all goddesses of fortune incarnated as queens in the pastimes of the Lord at Dvārakā. They can never be separated from the Lord, either by presence or by trance. The *gopés* at Våndāvana could not forget the Lord when the Lord was away in the forest cow herding. When the Lord boy Kṛṣṇa was absent from the village, the *gopés* at home used to worry about Him traversing the rough ground with His soft lotus feet. By thinking thus, they were sometimes overwhelmed in trance and mortified in the heart. Such is the condition of the pure associates of the Lord. They are always in trance, and so the queens also were in trance during the absence of the Lord. Presently, having seen the Lord from a distance, they at once gave up all their engagements, including the vows of women as described above. According to Sri Visvanatha Carkavarté Öhäkura, there was a regular psychological reaction on the occasion. First of all, rising from their seats, although they wanted to see their husband, they were deterred because of feminine shyness. But due to strong ecstasy, they overcame that stage of weakness and became caught up with the idea of embracing the Lord, and this thought factually made them unconscious of their surrounding environment. This prime state of ecstasy annihilated all other formalities and social conventions, and thus they escaped all stumbling blocks on the path of meeting the Lord. And that is the perfect stage of meeting the Lord of the soul, Sri Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 32

**TaMaaTMaJaEd*Riî>arNTaraTMaNaa
durNTa>aava" Pairrei>are PaiTaMa()
iNaâÖMaPYaaóvdMbu Nae}aYaae,
ivRI/ÂTaqNaa& >a*GauvYaR vE©-vaTa()) 32))**

tam ätmajair dāñöibhir antarätmanä

duranta-bhäväu parirebhire patim

niruddham apy äsravad ambu netrayor

vilajjaténàà bhāgu-varya vaiklavät

SYNONYMS

tam—Him (the Lord); *ätma-jaiù*—by the sons; *dãñöibhiù*—by the sight; *antara-ätmanä*—by the innermost part of the heart; *duranta-bhäväù*—insuperable ecstasy; *parirebhire*—embraced; *patim*—husband; *niruddham*—choked up; *api*—in spite of; *äsavat*—tears; *ambu*—like drops of water; *netrayoù*—from the eyes; *vilajjaténäm*—of those situated in shyness; *bhāgu-varya*—O chief of the Bhāgus; *vaiklavät*—inadvertently.

TRANSLATION

The insuperable ecstasy was so strong that the queens, who were shy, first embraced the Lord in the innermost recesses of their hearts. Then they embraced Him visually, and then they sent their sons to embrace Him [which is equal to personal embracing]. But, O chief amongst the Bhāgus, though they tried to restrain their feelings, they inadvertently shed tears.

PURPORT

Although due to feminine shyness there were many hindrances to embracing the dear husband, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the queens performed that act by seeing Him, by putting Him in the cores of their hearts, and by sending their sons to embrace Him. Still, the act remained unfinished, and tears rolled down their cheeks despite all endeavors to check them. One indirectly embraces the husband by sending the son to embrace him because the son is developed as part of the mother's body. The embrace of the son is not exactly the embrace of husband and wife from the sexual point of view, but the embrace is satisfaction from the affectionate point of view. The embrace of the eyes is more effective in the conjugal relation, and thus according to Srila Jiva Gosvami there is nothing wrong in such an exchange of feeling between husband and wife.

TEXT 33

YaÛPYaSaaE PaaìRGaTaae rhaeGaTa,
STaQaaPa TaSYaax(iga]YauGa& Nav& NavMa()
Pade Pade k-a ivrMaeTa TaTPada,
Àl/aiPa YaC^\qNaR JahaiTa k-ihRicTa()) 33))

yadyapy asau pārçva-gato raho-gatas

tathäpi tasyäighri-yugaà navaà navam

pade pade kä virameta tat-padäc

caläpi yac chrér na jahäti karhicit

SYNONYMS

yadi—although; *api*—certainly; *asau*—He (Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa); *pārçva-gataù*—just by the side; *rahaù-gataù*—exclusively alone; *tathäpi*—still; *tasya*—His; *aighri-yugam*—the feet of the Lord; *navam navam*—newer and newer; *pade*—step; *pade*—in every step; *kä*—who; *virameta*—can be detached from; *tat-padät*—from His feet; *caläpi*—moving; *yat*—whom; *çréù*—the goddess of fortune; *na*—never; *jahäti*—quits; *karhicit*—at any time.

TRANSLATION

Although Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa was constantly by their sides, as well as exclusively alone, His feet appeared to them to be newer and newer. The goddess of fortune, although by nature always restless and moving, could not quit the Lord's feet. So what woman can be detached from those feet, having once taken shelter of them?

PURPORT

Conditioned living beings are always after the favor of the goddess of fortune, although by nature she is moving from one place to another. In the material world no one is permanently fortunate, however clever one may be. There have been so many big empires in different parts of the world, there have been so many powerful kings all over the world, and there have

been so many fortunate men, but all of them have been liquidated gradually. This is the law of material nature. But spiritually it is different. According to *Brahma-saṁhitā*, the Lord is served very respectfully by hundreds and thousands of goddesses of fortune. They are always in a lonely place also with the Lord. But still the association of the Lord is so inspiringly newer and newer that they cannot quit the Lord for a moment, even though they are by nature very restless and are moving about. The spiritual relation with the Lord is so enlivening and resourceful that no one can leave the company of the Lord, once having taken shelter of Him.

The living beings are by constitution feminine by nature. The male or enjoyer is the Lord, and all manifestations of His different potencies are feminine by nature. In the *Bhagavad-gita*, the living beings are designated as *parā-prakāṭi*, or the superior potency. The material elements are *aparā-prakāṭi*, or inferior potency. Such potencies are always employed for the satisfaction of the employer, or the enjoyer. The supreme enjoyer is the Lord Himself, as stated in the *Bhagavad-gita* (5.29). The potencies, therefore, when engaged directly in the service of the Lord, revive the natural color, and thus there is no disparity in the relation of the potent and potency.

Generally people engaged in service are always seeking some post under the government or the supreme enjoyer of the state. Since the Lord is the supreme enjoyer of everything in or outside the universe, it is happiness to be employed by Him. Once engaged in the supreme governmental service of the Lord, no living being wishes to be relieved from the engagement. The highest perfection of human life is to seek some employment under the Lord's supreme service. That will make one extremely happy. One need not seek the moving goddess of fortune without the relation of the Lord.

TEXT 34

Wv& Na*Paa<aa& i+aiTa>aarJaNMaNaa,
Ma+aaEih<aqi>a" Pairv*taTaeJaSaaMa()
ivDaaYa vEr& iSaNaee YaQaaNaI&/
iMaQaae vDaeNaeeParTaae iNaraYauDa")) 34))

evaà nãpãëää kñiti-bhära-janmanäm

akñauhiëébhiù parivåtta-tejasäm

vidhäya vairaà çvasano yathänalaà

mitho vadhenoparato niräyudhaù

SYNONYMS

evam—thus; *nãpãëää*—of the kings or administrators; *kñiti-bhära*—the burden of the earth; *janmanäm*—born in that way; *akñauhiëébhiù*—empowered by a military strength of horses, elephants, chariots and infantry; *parivåtta*—being puffed up by such surroundings; *tejasäm*—prowess; *vidhäya*—having created; *vairam*—hostility; *çvasanaù*—interaction of the wind and the pipe plants; *yathä*—as it is; *analam*—fire; *mithaù*—with one another; *vadhena*—by killing them; *uparataù*—relieved; *niräyudhaù*—by Himself without being a party to such fighting.

TRANSLATION

The Lord was pacified after killing those kings who were burdensome to the earth. They were puffed up with their military strength, their horses, elephants, chariots, infantry, etc. He Himself was not a party in the fight. He simply created hostility between the powerful administrators, and they fought amongst themselves. He was like the wind which causes friction between bamboos and so sparks a fire.

PURPORT

As stated above, the living beings are not factual enjoyers of things which are manifested as God's creation. The Lord is the genuine proprietor and enjoyer of everything manifested in His creation. Unfortunately, influenced by the deluding energy, the living being becomes *a false enjoyer* under the dictation of the modes of nature. Puffed up by such a false sense of becoming God, the deluded living being increases his material strength by so many activities and thus becomes the burden of the earth, so much so

that the earth becomes completely uninhabitable by the sane. This state of affairs is called *dharmasya glāëi*, or misuse of the energy of the human being. When such misuse of human energy is prominent, the saner living beings become perturbed by the awkward situation created by the vicious administrators, who are simply burdens of the earth, and the Lord appears by His internal potency just to save the saner section of humanity and to alleviate the burden due to the earthly administrators in different parts of the world. He does not favor either of the unwanted administrators, but by His potential power He creates hostility between such unwanted administrators, as the air creates fire in the forest by the friction of the bamboos. The fire in the forest takes place automatically by the force of the air, and similarly the hostility between different groups of politicians takes place by the unseen design of the Lord. The unwanted administrators, puffed up by false power and military strength, thus become engaged in fighting amongst themselves over ideological conflicts and so exhaust themselves of all powers. The history of the world reflects this factual will of the Lord, and it will continue to be enacted until the living beings are attached to the service of the Lord. In the *Bhagavad-gita* this fact is very vividly described (Bg. 7.14). It is said, “The deluding energy is My potency, and thus it is not possible for the dependent living beings to supersede the strength of the material modes. But those who take shelter in Me [the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa] can cross over the gigantic ocean of material energy.” This means that no one can establish peace and prosperity in the world by fruitive activities or by speculative philosophy or ideology. The only way is to surrender unto the Supreme Lord and thus become free from the illusion of the deluding energy.

Unfortunately persons who are engaged in destructive work are unable to surrender to the Personality of Godhead. They are all fools of the first order; they are the lowest of the human species of life; they are robbed of their knowledge, although apparently they seem to be academically educated. They are all of the demoniac mentality, always challenging the supreme power of the Lord. Those who are very materialistic, always hankering after material power and strength, are undoubtedly fools of the first order because they have no information of the living energy, and being ignorant of that supreme spiritual science, they are absorbed in material science, which ends with the end of the material body. They are the lowest

of human beings because the human life is especially meant for reestablishing the lost relation with the Lord, and they miss this opportunity by being engaged in material activities. They are robbed of their knowledge because even after prolonged speculation they cannot reach to the stage of knowing the Personality of Godhead, the *summum bonum* of everything. And all of them are men of demoniac principle, and they suffer the consequences, as did such materialistic heroes as Ravana, Hiraṇyakaśipu, Kaśa and others.

TEXT 35

Sa Wz Narl/aeke-_iSMAàvTaq<aR" SvMaaYaYaa)
reMae ñqrÒkU-ṣ=SQaae >aGavaNa(Pa[ak*-Taae YaQaa)) 35))

sa eña nara-loke 'sminn

avatérëaù sva-mäyayä

reme stré-ratna-küöastho

bhagavän prākāto yathä

SYNONYMS

saù—He (the Supreme Personality of Godhead); *eñaù*—all these; *nara-loke*—on this planet of human beings; *asmin*—on this; *avatérëaù*—having appeared; *sva*—personal, internal; *mäyayä*—causeless mercy; *reme*—enjoyed; *stré-ratna*—woman who is competent to become a wife of the Lord; *küöasthaù*—among; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *prākātaù*—mundane; *yathä*—as if it were.

TRANSLATION

That Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa, out of His causeless mercy, appeared on this planet by His internal potency and enjoyed Himself amongst competent women as if He were engaging in mundane affairs.

PURPORT

The Lord married and lived like a householder. This is certainly like a mundane affair, but when we learn that He married 16,108 wives and *lived with them separately* in each and every palace, certainly it is not mundane. Therefore, the Lord, living as a householder amongst His competent wives, is never mundane, and His behavior with them is never to be understood as mundane sex relation. The women who became the wives of the Lord are certainly not ordinary women, because to get the Lord as one's husband is the result of many, many millions of births' *tapasya* (austerity). When the Lord appears on different *lokas*, or planets, or on this planet of human beings, He displays His transcendental pastimes just to attract the conditioned souls to become His eternal servitors, friends, parents and lovers respectively in the transcendental world, where the Lord eternally reciprocates such exchanges of service. Service is pervertedly represented in the material world and broken untimely, resulting in sad experience. The illusioned living being conditioned by material nature cannot understand out of ignorance that all our relations here in the mundane world are temporary and full of inebrieties. Such relations cannot help us be happy perpetually, but if the same relation is established with the Lord, then we are transferred to the transcendental world after leaving this material body and become eternally related with Him in the relation we desire. The women amongst whom He lived as their husband are not, therefore, women of this mundane world, but are eternally related with Him as transcendental wives, a position which they attained by perfection of devotional service. That is their competency. The Lord is *paraà brahma*, or the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Conditioned souls seek after perpetual happiness in all places—not only on this earth but also on other planets throughout the universe—because constitutionally a spiritual spark, as he is, can travel to any part of God's creation. But being conditioned by the material modes, he tries to travel in space by spacecraft and so fails to reach his destination. The law of gravitation is binding upon him like the shackles of a prisoner. By other processes he can reach anywhere, but even if he reaches the highest planet, he cannot attain that perpetual happiness for which he is searching life after life. When he comes to his senses, however, he seeks after Brahman happiness, knowing it for certain that unlimited happiness, which he is seeking, is never attainable in the material

world. As such, the Supreme Being, Parabrahman, certainly does not seek His happiness anywhere in the material world. Nor can His paraphernalia of happiness be found in the material world. He is not impersonal. Because He is the leader and Supreme Being amongst innumerable living beings, He cannot be impersonal. He is exactly like us, and He has all the propensities of an individual living being in fullness. He marries exactly like us, but His marriage is neither mundane nor limited by our experience in the conditioned state. His wives, therefore, appear like mundane women, but factually they are all transcendental liberated souls, perfect manifestations of internal energy.

TEXT 36

oÕaMa>aaviPaéuNaaMal/vLGauhaSa,
v]q@avl/aek-iNahTaae MadNaae_iPa YaaSaaMa()
SaMMauù caPaMaJahaTPa[MadaetaMaaSTaa
YaSYaeiNd]Ya& ivMaiQaTau& ku-hkE-NaR Xaeku-")) 36))

uddāma-bhāva-piçunāmala-valgu-hāsa-

vréòävaloka-nihato madano 'pi yäsäm

sammuhya cāpam ajahāt pramadottamäs tä

yasyendriyā vimathituà kuhakair na çekuù

SYNONYMS

uddāma—very grave; *bhāva*—expression; *piçuna*—exciting; *amala*—spotless; *valgu-hāsa*—beautiful smiling; *vréòä*—corner of the eye; *avaloka*—looking; *nihataù*—conquered; *madanaù*—Cupid (or *amadana*—the greatly tolerant Siva); *api*—also; *yäsäm*—whose; *sammuhya*—being overpowered by; *cāpam*—bows; *ajahāt*—gave up; *pramada*—woman, who maddens; *uttamäù*—of high grade; *tä*—all; *yasya*—whose; *indriyam*—senses; *vimathitum*—to perturb; *kuhakaiù*—by magical feats; *na*—never; *çekuù*—was able.

TRANSLATION

Although the queens' beautiful smiles and furtive glances were all spotless and exciting, and although they could conquer Cupid himself by making him give up his bow in frustration, and although even the tolerant Siva could fall victim to them, still, despite all their magical feats and attractions, they could not agitate the senses of the Lord.

PURPORT

The path of salvation or the path going back to Godhead always forbids the association of women, and the complete *sanātana-dharma* or *varëāçrama-dharma* scheme forbids or restricts association with women. How, then, can one be accepted as the Supreme Personality of Godhead who is addicted to more than sixteen thousand wives? This question may be relevantly raised by inquisitive persons really anxious to know about the transcendental nature of the Supreme Lord. And to answer such questions, the sages at Naimiñāraëya have discussed the transcendental character of the Lord in this and in following verses. It is clear herein that the feminine attractive features which can conquer Cupid or even the supermost tolerant Lord Siva could not conquer the senses of the Lord. Cupid's business is to invoke mundane lust. The whole universe is moving being agitated by Cupid's arrow. The activities of the world are being carried on by the central attraction of male and female. A male is searching after a mate to his liking, and the female is looking after a suitable male. That is the way of material stimulus. And as soon as a male is combined with a female, the material bondage of the living being is at once tightly interlocked by sex relation, and as a result of this, both the male's and female's attraction for sweet home, motherland, bodily offspring, society and friendship and accumulation of wealth becomes the illusory field of activities, and thus a false but indefatigable attraction for the temporary material existence, which is full of miseries, is manifest. Those who are, therefore, on the path of salvation for going back home back to Godhead, are especially advised by all scriptural instruction to become free from such paraphernalia of material attraction. And that is possible only by the association of the devotees of the Lord, who are called the *mahātmās*. Cupid throws his arrow upon the living beings to make them mad after the

opposite sex, whether the party is actually beautiful or not. Cupid's provocations are going on, even among beastly societies who are all ugly-looking in the estimation of the civilized nations. Thus Cupid's influence is exerted even amongst the ugliest forms, and what to speak of the most perfect beauties. Lord Siva, who is considered to be most tolerant, was also struck by Cupid's arrow because he also became mad after the *Mohiné* incarnation of the Lord and acknowledged himself to be defeated. Cupid, however, was himself captivated by the grave and exciting dealings of the goddesses of fortune, and he voluntarily gave up his bow and arrow in a spirit of frustration. Such was the beauty and attraction of the queens of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Yet they could not disturb the transcendental senses of the Lord. This is because the Lord is all-perfect *ātmārāma*, or self-sufficient. He does not require anyone's extraneous help for His personal satisfaction. Therefore, the queens could not satisfy the Lord by their feminine attractiveness, but *they satisfied Him by their sincere affection and service*. Only by unalloyed transcendental loving service could they satisfy the Lord, and the Lord was pleased to treat them as wives in reciprocation. Thus being satisfied by their unalloyed service only, the Lord reciprocated the service just like a devout husband. Otherwise He had no business becoming the husband of so many wives. He is the husband of everyone, but to one who accepts Him as such, He reciprocates. This unalloyed affection for the Lord is never to be compared to mundane lust. It is purely transcendental. And the grave dealings, which the queens displayed in natural feminine ways, were also transcendental because the feelings were expressed out of transcendental ecstasy. It is already explained in the previous verse that the Lord appeared like a mundane husband, but factually His relation with His wives was transcendental, pure and unconditioned by the modes of material nature.

TEXT 37

**TaMaYa& MaNYaTae I/aek-ae ùSa®MaiPa Sai®NaMa()
AaTMaaEPaMYaeNa MaNauJa& VYaaPa*<vaNa& YaTaae_buDa")) 37))**

tam ayaà manyate loko

hy asaigam api saiginam

ätmaupamyena manujaà

vyäpäävänaà yato 'budhaù

SYNONYMS

tam—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ayam*—all these (common men); *manyate*—do speculate within the mind; *lokaù*—the conditioned souls; *hi*—certainly; *asaìgam*—unattached; *api*—in spite of; *saiginam*—affected; *ätma*—self; *aupamyena*—by comparison with the self; *manujam*—ordinary man; *vyäpäävänam*—being engaged in; *yataù*—because; *abudhaù*—foolish because of ignorance.

TRANSLATION

The common materialistic conditioned souls speculate that the Lord is one of them. Out of their ignorance they think that the Lord is affected by matter, although He is unattached.

PURPORT

The word *abudhaù* is significant here. Due to ignorance only, the foolish mundane wranglers misunderstand the Supreme Lord and spread their foolish imaginations amongst innocent persons by propaganda. The Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the original primeval Personality of Godhead, and when He was personally present before the eyes of everyone, He displayed full-fledged divine potency in every field of activities. As we have already explained in the first verse of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, He is completely independent to act however He likes, but all His actions are full of bliss, knowledge and eternity. Only the foolish mundaners misunderstand Him, unaware of His eternal form of knowledge and bliss, which is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita* and *Upaniñads*. His different potencies work in a perfect plan of natural sequence, and doing everything by the agency of His different potencies, He remains eternally the supreme independent. When He descends on the material world by His causeless mercy to different living beings, He does so by His own potency. He is not subject to any condition of the material modes of nature, and He descends as He is

originally. The mental speculators misunderstand Him as the Supreme Person, and they consider His impersonal features as inexplicable Brahman to be all. Such a conception is also the product of conditioned life because they cannot go beyond their own personal capacity. Therefore, one who considers the Lord on the level of one's limited potency is only a common man. Such a man cannot be convinced that the Personality of Godhead is always unaffected by the modes of material nature. He cannot understand that the sun is always unaffected by infectious matter. The mental speculators compare everything from the standpoint of experimental knowledge of their own selves. Thus when the Lord is found to act like an ordinary person in matrimonial bondage, they consider Him to be like one of them, without considering that the Lord can at once marry sixteen thousand wives or more. Due to a poor fund of knowledge they accept one side of the picture while disbelieving the other. This means that due to ignorance only they always think of Lord Kṛṣṇa as like themselves and make their own conclusions, which are absurd and unauthentic from the version of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 38

**WTadqXaNAMaqXaSYa Pa[k*-iTasQaae_iPa Tad(Gau<aE")
Na YauJYaTae SadaTMaSQaEYaRQaa buiÖSTadaé(Yaa)) 38))**

etat éçanam éçasya

prakâti-stho 'pi tad-guëaiù

na yujyate sadâtma-sthair

yathâ buddhis tad-äçrayä

SYNONYMS

etat—this; *éçanam*—divinity; *éçasya*—of the Personality of Godhead; *prakâti-sthaiù*—being in contact with material nature; *api*—in spite of; *tat-guëaiù*—by the qualities; *na*—never; *yujyate*—is affected; *sadâ âtma-sthaiù*—by those who are situated in eternity; *yathâ*—as is; *buddhiù*—

intelligence; *tat*—the Lord; *ācraṇā*—those who are under the shelter of.

TRANSLATION

This is the divinity of the Personality of Godhead: He is not affected by the qualities of material nature, even though He is in contact with them. Similarly, the devotees who have taken shelter of the Lord do not become influenced by the material qualities.

PURPORT

In the *Vedas* and Vedic literatures (*Ṛg-veda* and *Smṛiti*) it is affirmed that in the Divinity there is nothing material. He is transcendental (*nirguṇa*) only, the supreme cognizant. Hari, or the Personality of Godhead, is the supreme transcendental person situated beyond the range of material affection. These statements are also confirmed even by Ācārya Ṣaṅkara. One may argue that His relation with the goddesses of fortune may be transcendental, but what about His relation with the Yadu dynasty, being born in that family, or His killing the nonbelievers like Jarāsandha and other *asuras* directly in contact with the modes of material nature. The answer is that the divinity of the Personality of Godhead is never in contact with the qualities of material nature in any circumstances. Actually He is in contact with such qualities because He is the ultimate source of everything, yet He is above the actions of such qualities. He is known, therefore, as Yogesvara, or the master of mystic power, or in other words the all-powerful. Even His learned devotees are not affected by the influence of the material modes. The great six Gosvamis of Vāṇḍāvana all came from greatly rich and aristocratic families, but when they adopted the life of mendicants at Vāṇḍāvana, superficially they appeared to be in wretched conditions of life, but factually they were the richest of all in spiritual values. Such *mahā-bhāgavatas*, or first-grade devotees, although moving amongst men, are not contaminated by honor or insult, hunger or satisfaction, sleep or wakefulness, which are all resultant actions of the three modes of material nature. Similarly, some of them are engaged in worldly dealings, yet are unaffected. Unless these neutralities of life are there, one cannot be considered situated in transcendence. The Divinity and His associates are on the same transcendental plane, and their glories are always sanctified by

the action of *yogamäyā*, or the internal potency of the Lord. The devotees of the Lord are always transcendental, even if they are sometimes found to have fallen in their behavior. The Lord emphatically declares in the *Bhagavad-gita* (9.30) that even if an unalloyed devotee is found to be fallen due to a previous material contamination, he is nevertheless to be accepted as fully transcendental because of his being engaged cent percent in the devotional service of the Lord. The Lord protects him always because of his rendering service unto Him, and the fallen conditions are to be considered accidental and temporary. They will vanish in no time.

TEXT 39

Ta& MaeiNare_bl/a MaU!a" ñE<a& caNauv]Ta& rh")
APa[Maa<aivdae >aTauRrqir& MaTaYaae YaQaa)) 39))

taà menire 'balä müòhäu

straiëaà cānuvrataà rahaù

apramäëa-vido bhartur

éçvaraà matayo yathä

SYNONYMS

tam—unto Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *menire*—took it for granted; *abaläù*—delicate; *müòhäu*—because of simplicity; *straiëam*—one who is dominated by his wife; *ca*—also; *anuvratam*—follower; *rahaù*—lonely place; *apramäëa-vidaù*—unaware of the extent of glories; *bhartuù*—of their husband; *éçvaram*—the supreme controller; *matayaù*—thesis; *yathä*—as it is.

TRANSLATION

The simple and delicate women truly thought that Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, their beloved husband, followed them and was dominated by them. They were unaware of the extent of the glories of their husband, as the atheists are unaware of Him as the supreme controller.

PURPORT

Even the transcendental wives of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa did not know completely the unfathomable glories of the Lord. This ignorance is not mundane because there is some action of the internal potency of the Lord in the exchange of feelings between Him and His eternal associates. The Lord exchanges transcendental relations in five ways, as proprietor, master, friend, son and lover, and in each of these pastimes He plays fully by the potency of *yogamāyā*, the internal potency. He plays exactly like an equal friend with the cowherd boys or even with friends like Arjuna. He plays exactly like a son in the presence of Yaçodāmātā, He plays exactly like a lover in the presence of the cowherd damsels, and He plays exactly like a husband in the presence of the queens of Dvārakā. Such devotees of the Lord never think of the Lord as the Supreme, but think of Him exactly as a common friend, a pet son, or a lover or husband very much dear to heart and soul. That is the relation between the Lord and His transcendental devotees, who act as His associates in the spiritual sky, where there are innumerable Vaikuntha planets. When the Lord descends, He does so along with His entourage to display a complete picture of the transcendental world, where pure love and devotion for the Lord prevail without any mundane tinge of lording it over the creation of the Lord. Such devotees of the Lord are all liberated souls, perfect representations of the marginal or internal potency in complete negation of the influence of the external potency. The wives of Lord Kṛṣṇa were made to forget the immeasurable glories of the Lord by the internal potency so that there might not be any flaw of exchange, and they took it for granted that the Lord was a henpecked husband, always following them in lonely places. In other words, even the personal associates of the Lord do not know Him perfectly well, so what do the thesis writers or mental speculators know about the transcendental glories of the Lord? The mental speculators present different theses as to His becoming the causes of the creation, the ingredients of the creation, or the material and efficient cause of the creation, etc., but all this is but partial knowledge about the Lord. Factually they are as ignorant as the common man. The Lord can be known by the mercy of the Lord only, and by no other means. But since the dealings of the Lord with His wives are based on pure transcendental love and devotion, the wives are all on the transcendental plane without material

contamination.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Eleventh Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled “Lord Kṛṣṇa’s Entrance into Dvārakā.”

Chapter Twelve

Birth of Emperor Parékñit

TEXT 1

é[qXaaENak- ovac
AìTQaaManaePaSa*íeNa b]øXaqZ<aaeRåTaeJaSaa)
otaraYaa hTaae Ga>aR wRXaeNaaJaqivTa" PauNa")) 1))

çaunaka uvāca

açvatthāmnopasāññoena

brahma-çérñëoru-tejasā

uttarāyā hato garbha

éçenäjévitaù punaù

SYNONYMS

çaunakaù uvāca—the sage Çaunaka said; *açvatthāmna*—of Açvatthāmā (the son of Droëa); *upasāññoena*—by release of; *brahma-çérñëä*—the invincible weapon, *brahmāstra*; *uru-tejasā*—by high temperature; *uttarāyāù*—of Uttarā (mother of Parékñit); *hataù*—being spoiled; *garbhaù*—womb; *éçena*—by the Supreme Lord; *äjévitaù*—brought to life; *punaù*—again.

TRANSLATION

The sage Çaunaka said: The womb of Uttarä, mother of Mahäräja Parékñit, was spoiled by the dreadful and invincible brahmästra weapon released by Açvatthämä. But Mahäräja Parékñit was saved by the Supreme Lord.

PURPORT

The sages assembled in the forest of Naimiñäraëya inquired from Söta Gosvami about the birth of Mahäräja Parékñit, but in the course of the narration other topics like the release of the *brahmästra* by the son of Droëa, his punishment by Arjuna, Queen Kuntédevé's prayers, the Päëòavas' visit to the place where Bhéñmadeva was lying, his prayers and thereafter the Lord's departure for Dvärakä were discussed. His arrival at Dvärakä and residing with the sixteen thousand queens, etc., were narrated. The sages were absorbed in hearing such descriptions, but now they wanted to turn to the original topic, and thus the inquiry was made by Çaunaka Rsi. So the subject of the release of the *brahmästra* weapon by Açvatthämä is renewed.

TEXT 2

**TaSYa JaNMa MahabuÖe" k-MaaRi<a c MahaTMaNa")
iNaDaNa& c YaQaEvaSaqtSa Pa[eTYa GaTavaNa(YaQaa)) 2))**

tasya janma mahä-buddheù

karmäëi ca mahätmanaù

nidhanaà ca yathaiväsét

sa pretya gatavän yathä

SYNONYMS

tasya—his (of Mahäräja Parékñit); *janma*—birth; *mahä-buddheù*—of great intelligence; *karmäëi*—activities; *ca*—also; *mahä-ätmanaù*—of the great devotee; *nidhanam*—demise; *ca*—also; *yathä*—as it was; *eva*—of course;

äsét—happened; *saù*—he; *pretya*—destination after death; *gatavän*—achieved; *yathä*—as it were.

TRANSLATION

How was the great emperor Parékñit, who was a highly intelligent and great devotee, born in that womb? How did his death take place, and what did he achieve after his death?

PURPORT

The king of Hastinäpura (now Delhi) used to be the emperor of the world, at least till the time of the son of Emperor Parékñit. Mahäräja Parékñit was saved by the Lord in the womb of his mother, so he could certainly be saved from an untimely death due to the ill will of the son of a *brahmana*. Because the age of Kali began to act just after the assumption of power by Mahäräja Parékñit, the first sign of misgivings was exhibited in the cursing of such a greatly intelligent and devoted king as Mahäräja Parékñit. The king is the protector of the helpless citizens, and their welfare, peace and prosperity depend on him. Unfortunately, by the instigation of the fallen age of Kali, an unfortunate *brahmana*'s son was employed to condemn the innocent Mahäräja Parékñit, and so the King had to prepare himself for death within seven days. Mahäräja Parékñit is especially famous as one who is protected by Viṣṇu, and when he was unduly cursed by a *brahmana*'s son, he could have invoked the mercy of the Lord to save him, but he did not want to because he was a pure devotee. A pure devotee never asks the Lord for any undue favor. Mahäräja Parékñit knew that the curse of the *brahmana*'s son upon him was unjustified, as everyone else knew, but he did not want to counteract it because he knew also that the age of Kali had begun and that the first symptom of the age, namely degradation of the highly talented *brahmana* community, had also begun. He did not want to interfere with the current of the time, but he prepared himself to meet death very cheerfully and very properly. Being fortunate, he got at least seven days to prepare himself to meet death, and so he properly utilized the time in the association of Çukadeva Gosvami, the great saint and devotee of the Lord.

TEXT 3

**Taidd& é[aeTauMaC^aMaae GaidTau& Yaid MaNYaSae)
b]Uih Na" é[ÕDaaNaaNaa& YaSYa jaNaMadaC^uk-")) 3))**

tad idaà çrotum icchämo

gadituà yadi manyase

brühi naù çraddadhänänäà

yasya jñanam adäc chukaù

SYNONYMS

tat—all; *idam*—this; *çrotum*—to hear; *icchämaù*—all willing; *gaditum*—to narrate; *yadi*—if; *manyase*—you think; *brühi*—please speak; *naù*—we; *çraddadhänänäm*—who are very much respectful; *yasya*—whose; *jñanam*—transcendental knowledge; *adät*—delivered; *çukaù*—Sri Çukadeva Gosvami.

TRANSLATION

We all respectfully want to hear about him [Mahäräja Parékñit] to whom Çukadeva Gosvami imparted transcendental knowledge. Please speak on this matter.

PURPORT

Çukadeva Gosvami imparted transcendental knowledge to Mahäräja Parékñit during the remaining seven days of his life, and Mahäräja Parékñit heard him properly, just like an ardent student. The effect of such a bona fide hearing and chanting of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* was equally shared by both the hearer and the chanter. Both of them were benefited. Out of the nine different transcendental means of devotional service to the Lord prescribed in the *Bhägavatam*, either all of them, or some of them or even one of them are equally beneficial if properly discharged. Mahäräja

Parékñit and Çukadeva Gosvami were serious performers of the first two important items, namely the process of chanting and the process of hearing, and therefore both of them were successful in their laudable attempt. Transcendental realization is attained by such serious hearing and chanting and not otherwise. There is a type of spiritual master and disciple much advertised in this age of Kali. It is said that the master injects spiritual force into the disciple by an electrical current generated by the master, and the disciple begins to feel the shock. He becomes unconscious, and the master weeps for his exhausting his store of so-called spiritual assets. Such bogus advertisement is going on in this age, and the poor common man is becoming the victim of such advertisement. We do not find such folk tales in the dealings of Çukadeva Gosvami and his great disciple Mahäräja Parékñit. The sage recited *Srimad-Bhagavatam* in devotion, and the great King heard him properly. The King did not feel any shock of electrical current from the master, nor did he become unconscious while receiving knowledge from the master. One should not, therefore, become a victim of these unauthorized advertisements made by some bogus representative of Vedic knowledge. The sages of Naimiñäraëya were very respectful in hearing about Mahäräja Parékñit because of his receiving knowledge from Çukadeva Gosvami by means of *ardent hearing*. Ardent hearing from the bona fide master is the only way to receive transcendental knowledge, and there is no need for medical performances or occult mysticism for miraculous effects. The process is simple, but only the sincere party can achieve the desired result.

TEXT 4

SaUTa ovac

APaqPal/ÖMaRraJa" iPaTa*vd(rÅYaNa(Pa[Jaa")
iNa"SPa*h" SavRk-aMae>Ya" k*-Z<aPaadaNauSaevYaa)) 4))

süta uväca

apépalad dharma-räjaù

pitåvad raijayan prajäù

niùspåhaù sarva-kåmebhyaù

kåñëa-pädänusevayä

SYNONYMS

sütaù uväca—Sri Süta Gosvami said; *apépalat*—administered prosperity; *dharma-räjaù*—King Yudhiñöhira; *pitå-vat*—exactly like his father; *raiñjayan*—pleasing; *prajäù*—all those who took birth; *niùspåhaù*—without personal ambition; *sarva*—all; *kåmebhyaù*—from sense gratification; *kåñëa-päda*—the lotus feet of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *anusevayä*—by dint of rendering continuous service.

TRANSLATION

Sri Süta Gosvami said: Emperor Yudhiñöhira administered generously to everyone during his reign. He was exactly like his father. He had no personal ambition and was freed from all sorts of sense gratification because of his continuous service unto the lotus feet of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

As mentioned in our introduction, “There is a need for the science of Kṛṣṇa in human society for all the suffering humanity of the world, and we simply request the leading personalities of all nations to take to the science of Kṛṣṇa for their own good, for the good of society, and for the good of all the people of the world.” So it is confirmed herein by the example of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, the personality of goodness. In India the people hanker after *Rāma-rājya* because the Personality of Godhead was the ideal king and all other kings or emperors in India controlled the destiny of the world for the prosperity of every living being who took birth on the earth. Herein the word *prajäù* is significant. The etymological import of the word is “that which is born.” On the earth there are many species of life, from the aquatics up to the perfect human beings, and all are known as *prajäs*. Lord Brahmä, the creator of this particular universe, is known as the *prajāpati* because he is the grandfather of all who have taken birth. Thus *prajā* is used in a broader sense than it is now used. The king represents all living

beings, the aquatics, plants, trees, reptiles, birds, animals and man. Every one of them is a part and parcel of the Supreme Lord (Bg. 14.4), and the king, being the representative of the Supreme Lord, is duty-bound to give proper protection to every one of them. This is not the case with the presidents and dictators of this demoralized system of administration, where the lower animals are given no protection while the higher animals are given so-called protection. But this is a great science which can be learned only by one who knows the *science of Kṛṣṇa*. By knowing the science of Kṛṣṇa, one can become the most perfect man in the world, and unless one has knowledge in this science, all qualifications and doctorate diplomas acquired by academic education are spoiled and useless. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira knew this science of Kṛṣṇa very well, for it is stated here that by continuous cultivation of this science, or by continuous devotional service to Lord Kṛṣṇa, he acquired the qualification of administering the state. The father is sometimes seemingly cruel to the son, but that does not mean that the father has lost the qualification to be a father. A father is always a father because he always has the good of the son at heart. The father wants every one of his sons to become a better man than himself. Therefore, a king like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, who was the personality of goodness, wanted everyone under his administration, especially human beings who have better developed consciousness, to become devotees of Lord Kṛṣṇa so that everyone can become free from the trifles of material existence. His motto of administration was all good for the citizens, for as personified goodness he knew perfectly well what is actually good for them. He conducted the administration on that principle, and not on the *rākṇasi*, demonic, principle of sense gratification. As an ideal king, he had no personal ambition, and there was no place for sense gratification because all his senses at all times were engaged in the loving service of the Supreme Lord, which includes the partial service to the living beings, who form the parts and parcels of the complete whole. Those who are busy rendering service to the parts and parcels, leaving aside the whole, only spoil time and energy, as one does when watering the leaves of a tree without watering the root. If water is poured on the root, the leaves are enlivened perfectly and automatically, but if water is poured on the leaves only, the whole energy is spoiled. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, therefore, was constantly engaged in the service of the Lord, and thus the parts and parcels of the Lord, the living beings under his careful administration, were

perfectly attended with all comforts in this life and all progress in the next. That is the way of perfect management of state administration.

TEXT 5

SaMPad" §-Tavae I/aek-a Maihzq >a]aTarae Mahq)
JaMbUÜqPaaiDaPaTYa& c YaXaê i}aidv& GaTaMa()) 5))

sampadaù kratavo lokä

mahiñé bhrätaro mahé

jambüdvépädhpatyaà ca

yaçaç ca tri-divaà gatam

SYNONYMS

sampadaù—opulence; *kratavaù*—sacrifices; *lokäù*—future destination; *mahiñé*—the queens; *bhrätaraù*—the brothers; *mahé*—the earth; *jambüdvépa*—the globe or planet of our residence; *ädhpatyam*—sovereignty; *ca*—also; *yaçaù*—fame; *ca*—and; *tri-divam*—celestial planets; *gatam*—spread over.

TRANSLATION

News even reached the celestial planets about Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira's worldly possessions, the sacrifices by which he would attain a better destination, his queen, his stalwart brothers, his extensive land, his sovereignty over the planet earth, and his fame, etc.

PURPORT

Only a rich and great man's name and fame are known all over the world, and the name and fame of Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira reached the higher planets because of his good administration, worldly possessions, glorious wife Draupadé, the strength of his brothers Bhéma and Arjuna, and his

solid sovereign power over the world, known as Jambüdvépa. Here the word *lokäù* is significant. There are different *lokas* or higher planets scattered all over the sky, both material and spiritual. A person can reach them by dint of his work in the present life, as stated in *Bhagavad-gita* (9.25). No forceful entrance is allowed there. The tiny material scientists and engineers who have discovered vehicles to travel over a few thousand miles in outer space will not be allowed entrance. That is not the way to reach the better planets. One must qualify himself to enter into such happy planets by sacrifice and service. Those who are sinful in every step of life can expect only to be degraded into animal life to suffer more and more the pangs of material existence, and this is also stated in *Bhagavad-gita* (16.19). Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira's good sacrifices and qualifications were so lofty and virtuous that even the residents of the higher celestial planets were already prepared to receive him as one of them.

TEXT 6

**ik&- Tae k-aMaa" SaurSPaahaR Mauku-NdMaNaSaae iÜJaa")
AiDaJahꣳuMauRd& raj" +auiDaTaSYa YaQaeTare)) 6))**

kià te kämäù sura-spärhä

mukunda-manaso dvijäù

adhijahrur mudaà räjäù

kñudhitasya yathetare

SYNONYMS

kim—what for; *te*—all those; *kämäù*—objects of sense enjoyment; *sura*—of the denizens of heaven; *spärhäù*—aspirations; *mukunda-manasaù*—of one who is already God conscious; *dvijäù*—O *brahmanas*; *adhijahrur*—could satisfy; *mudam*—pleasure; *räjäù*—of the king; *kñudhitasya*—of the hungry; *yathä*—as it is; *itare*—in other things.

TRANSLATION

O brahmanas, the opulence of the King was so enchanting that the denizens of heaven aspired for it. But because he was absorbed in the service of the Lord, nothing could satisfy him except the Lord's service.

PURPORT

There are two things in the world which can satisfy living beings. When one is materially engrossed, he is satisfied only by sense gratification, but when one is liberated from the conditions of the material modes, he is satisfied only by rendering loving service for the satisfaction of the Lord. This means that the living being is constitutionally a *servitor*, and not one who is *served*. Being illusioned by the conditions of the external energy, one falsely thinks himself to be the served, but actually he is not served; he is servant of the senses like lust, desire, anger, avarice, pride, madness and intolerance. When one is in his proper senses by attainment of spiritual knowledge, he realizes that he is not the master of the material world, but is only a servant of the senses. At that time he begs for the service of the Lord and thus becomes happy without being illusioned by so-called material happiness. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was one of the liberated souls, and therefore for him there was no pleasure in a vast kingdom, good wife, obedient brothers, happy subjects and prosperous world. These blessings automatically follow for a pure devotee, even though the devotee does not aspire for them. The example set herein is exactly suitable. It is said that one who is hungry is never satisfied by anything other than food.

The whole material world is full of hungry living beings. The hunger is not for good food, shelter or sense gratification. *The hunger is for the spiritual atmosphere*. Due to ignorance only they think that the world is dissatisfied because there is not sufficient food, shelter, defense and objects of sense gratification. This is called illusion. When the living being is hungry for spiritual satisfaction, he is misrepresented by material hunger. But the foolish leaders cannot see that even the people who are most sumptuously materially satisfied are still hungry. And what is their hunger and poverty? This hunger is actually for spiritual food, spiritual shelter, spiritual defense and spiritual sense gratification. These can be obtained in the association of the Supreme Spirit, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and therefore one who has them cannot be attracted by the so-called food, shelter, defense and sense gratification

of the material world, even if they are relished by the denizens of the heavenly planets. Therefore, in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (8.16) it is said by the Lord that even in the topmost planet of the universe, namely the Brahmaloka, where the duration of life is multiplied by millions of years by earth calculation, one cannot satisfy his hunger. Such hunger can be satisfied only when the living being is situated in immortality, which is attained in the spiritual sky, far, far above the Brahmaloka, in the association of Lord Mukunda, the Lord who awards His devotees the transcendental pleasure of liberation.

TEXT 7

**MaaTauGaR>aRGaTaae vqr" Sa Tada >a*GauNaNdNa)
ddXaR Pauâ& k-iÄÖùMaaNaae_ñTaeJaSaa)) 7))**

mätur garbha-gato véraù

sa tadä bhågu-nandana

dadarça puruṣaà kaïcid

dahyamäno 'stra-tejasä

SYNONYMS

mätuù—mother; *garbha*—womb; *gataù*—being situated there; *véraù*—the great fighter; *saù*—child Parékñit; *tadä*—at that time; *bhågu-nandana*—O son of Bhågu; *dadarça*—could see; *puruṣam*—the Supreme Lord; *kaïcit*—as someone else; *dahyamänaù*—suffering from being burned; *astra*—the *brahmästra*; *tejasä*—temperature.

TRANSLATION

O son of Bhågu [Çaunaka], when the child Parékñit, the great fighter, was in the womb of his mother, Uttarä, and was suffering from the burning heat of the brahmästra [thrown by Açvatthämä], he could observe the Supreme Lord coming to him.

PURPORT

Death generally involves remaining in trance for seven months. A living being, according to his own action, is allowed to enter into the womb of a mother by the vehicle of a father's semina, and thus he develops his desired body. This is the law of birth in specific bodies according to one's past actions. When he is awake from trance, he feels the inconvenience of being confined within the womb, and thus he wants to come out of it and sometimes fortunately prays to the Lord for such liberation. Mahārāja Parékñit, while in the womb of his mother, was struck by the *brahmāstra* released by Aṣvatthāmā, and he was feeling the burning heat. But because he was a devotee of the Lord, the Lord at once appeared Himself within the womb by His all-powerful energy, and the child could see that someone else had come to save him. Even in that helpless condition, the child Parékñit endured the unbearable temperature due to his being a great fighter by nature. And for this reason the word *vēraù* has been used.

TEXT 8

**Ax(GauīMaa}aMaMal&/ Sfu-rTPaur\$=MaaEil/NaMa()
APaqVYadXaRNa& XYaaMa& Tai@ÜaSaSaMaCYauTaMa()) 8))**

aiguñōha-mātram amalaà

sphurat-puraōa-maulinam

apévya-darṣanaà çyāmaà

taòid vāsasam acyutam

SYNONYMS

aiguñōha—by the measure of a thumb; *mātram*—only; *amalam*—transcendental; *sphurat*—blazing; *puraōa*—gold; *maulinam*—helmet; *apévya*—very beautiful; *darṣanam*—to look at; *çyāmam*—blackish; *taòit*—lightning; *vāsasam*—clothing; *acyutam*—the Infallible (the Lord).

TRANSLATION

He [the Lord] was only thumb high, but He was all transcendental. He had a very beautiful, blackish, infallible body, and He wore a dress of lightning yellow and a helmet of blazing gold. Thus He was seen by the child.

TEXT 9

é[qMaÕqgaRcTaubarhu& Taák-aÄNaku-<@I/Ma()
+aTaJaa+a& GadaPaai<aMaaTMaNa" SavRTaaeidXaMa()
Pair>a]MaNTaMauLk-a>aa& >a]aMaYaNTa& Gada& Mauhu")) 9))

çrémad-dérgha-catur-bähuà

tapta-käicana-kuëòalam

kñatajäkñàà gadä-päëim

ätmanaù sarvato diçam

paribhramantam ulkäbhäà

bhrämayantaà gadäà muhuù

SYNONYMS

çrémat—enriched; *dérgha*—prolonged; *catuù-bähum*—four-handed; *tapta-käicana*—molten gold; *kuëòalam*—earrings; *kñataja-akñam*—eyes with the redness of blood; *gadä-päëim*—hand with a club; *ätmanaù*—own; *sarvataù*—all; *diçam*—around; *paribhramantam*—loitering; *ulkäbhäm*—like shooting stars; *bhrämayantam*—encircling; *gadäm*—the club; *muhuù*—constantly.

TRANSLATION

The Lord was enriched with four hands, earrings of molten gold and eyes blood red with fury. As He loitered about, His club constantly encircled

Him like a shooting star.

PURPORT

It is said in the *Brahma-saṁhitā* (Ch. 5) that the Supreme Lord Govinda, by His one plenary portion, enters into the halo of the universe and distributes himself as Paramātmā, or the Supersoul, not only within the heart of every living being, but also within every atom of the material elements. Thus the Lord is all-pervading by His inconceivable potency, and thus He entered the womb of Uttarā to save His beloved devotee Mahārāja Parékñit. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.31) the Lord assured everyone that His devotees are never to be vanquished. No one can kill a devotee of the Lord because he is protected by the Lord, and no one can save a person whom the Lord desires to kill. The Lord is all-powerful, and therefore He can both save and kill as He likes. He became visible to His devotee Mahārāja Parékñit even in that awkward position (in the womb of his mother) in a shape just suitable for his vision. The Lord can become bigger than thousands of universes and can become smaller than an atom at the same time. Merciful as He is, He becomes just suitable to the vision of the limited living being. He is unlimited. He is not limited by any measurement of our calculation. He can become bigger than what we can think of, and He can become smaller than what we can conceive. But in all circumstances He is the same all-powerful Lord. There is no difference between the thumblike Viṣṇu in the womb of Uttarā and the full-fledged Nārāyaṇa in the Vaikuntha-dhāma, the kingdom of Godhead. He accepts the form of *arca-vigraha* (worshipable Deity) just to accept service from His different incapable devotees. By the mercy of the *arca-vigraha*, the form of the Lord in material elements, the devotees who are in the material world can easily approach the Lord, although He is not conceivable by the material senses. The *arca-vigraha* is therefore an all-spiritual form of the Lord to be perceived by the material devotees; such an *arca-vigraha* of the Lord is never to be considered material. There is no difference between matter and spirit for the Lord, although there is a gulf of difference between the two in the case of the conditioned living being. For the Lord there is nothing but spiritual existence, and similarly there is nothing except spiritual existence for the pure devotee of the Lord in his intimate relation with the Lord.

TEXT 10

AñTaeJa" SvGadYaa NaqhariMav GaaePaiTa")
ivDaMaNTa& Saiàk-zeR PaYaCE+aTa k- wTYaSaaE)) 10))

astra-tejaù sva-gadayä

nehäram iva gopatiù

vidhamantaà sannikarñe

paryaikñata ka ity asau

SYNONYMS

astra-tejaù—radiation of the *brahmästra*; *sva-gadayä*—by means of His own club; *nehäram*—drops of dew; *iva*—like; *gopatiù*—the sun; *vidhamantam*—the act of vanishing; *sannikarñe*—nearby; *paryaikñata*—observing; *kaù*—who; *iti asau*—this body.

TRANSLATION

The Lord was thus engaged in vanquishing the radiation of the *brahmästra*, just as the sun evaporates a drop of dew. He was observed by the child, who thought about who He was.

TEXT 11

ivDaUYa TadMaeYaaTMaa >aGavaNDaMaRGaub(iv>au")
iMazTaae dXaMaaSaSYa Ta}aEvaNTadRDae hir")) 11))

vidhüya tad ameyätmä

bhagavän dharma-gub vibhuù

miñato daçamäsasya

tatraivāntardadhe hariù

SYNONYMS

vidhüya—having completely washed off; *tat*—that; *ameyātmā*—the all-pervading Supersoul; *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *dharma-gup*—the protector of righteousness; *vibhuù*—the Supreme; *miñataù*—while observing; *daçamāsasya*—of one who is dressed by all directions; *tatra eva*—then and there; *antaù*—out of sight; *dadhe*—became; *hariù*—the Lord.

TRANSLATION

While thus being observed by the child, the Supreme Lord Personality of Godhead, the Supersoul of everyone and the protector of the righteous, who stretches in all directions and who is unlimited by time and space, disappeared at once.

PURPORT

Child Parékñit was not observing a living being who is limited by time and space. There is a gulf of difference between the Lord and the individual living being. The Lord is mentioned herein as the supreme living being unlimited by time and space. Every living being is limited by time and space. Even though a living being is qualitatively one with the Lord, quantitatively there is a great difference between the Supreme Soul and the common individual soul. In the *Bhagavad-gita* both the living beings and the Supreme Being are said to be all-pervading (*yena sarvam idaà tatam*), yet there is a difference between these two kinds of all-pervasiveness. A common living being or soul can be all-pervading within his own limited body, but the supreme living being is all-pervading in all space and all time. A common living being cannot extend its influence over another common living being by its all-pervasiveness, but the Supreme Supersoul, the Personality of Godhead, is unlimitedly able to exert His influence over all places and all times and over all living beings. And because He is all-pervasive, unlimited by time and space, He can appear even within the womb of the mother of child Parékñit. He is mentioned herein as the

protector of the righteous. Anyone who is a surrendered soul unto the Supreme is righteous, and he is specifically protected by the Lord in all circumstances. The Lord is the indirect protector of the unrighteous also, for He rectifies their sins through His external potency. The Lord is mentioned herein as one who is dressed in the ten directions. This means dressed with garments on ten sides, up and down. He is present everywhere and can appear and disappear at His will from everywhere and anywhere. His disappearance from the sight of the child Parékñit does not mean that He appeared on the spot from any other place. He was present there, and even after His disappearance He was there, although invisible to the eyes of the child. This material covering of the effulgent firmament is also something like a womb of the mother nature, and we are all put into the womb by the Lord, the father of all living beings. He is present everywhere, even in this material womb of mother Durgä, and those who are deserving can see the Lord.

TEXT 12

**TaTa" SavRGau<aaedkeR- SaaNaukU-l/Ga]haedYae)
Jaje v&XaDar" Paa<@ae>aURYa" Paa<@uirvaEJaSaa)) 12))**

tataù sarva-guëodarke

sänuküla-grahodaye

jajïe vaàça-dharaù päëòor

bhüyaù päëòur ivaujasä

SYNONYMS

tataù—thereupon; *sarva*—all; *guëa*—good signs; *udarke*—having gradually evolved; *sa-anuküla*—all favorable; *grahodaye*—constellation of stellar influence; *jajïe*—took birth; *vaàça-dharaù*—heir apparent; *päëòou*—of Päëòu; *bhüyaù*—being; *päëòou iva*—exactly like Päëòu; *ojasä*—by prowess.

TRANSLATION

Thereupon, when all the good signs of the zodiac gradually evolved, the heir apparent of Pääòu, who would be exactly like him in prowess, took birth.

PURPORT

Astronomical calculations of stellar influences upon a living being are not suppositions, but are factual, as confirmed in *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Every living being is controlled by the laws of nature at every minute, just as a citizen is controlled by the influence of the state. The state laws are grossly observed, but the laws of material nature, being subtle to our gross understanding, cannot be experienced grossly. As stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (3.9), every action of life produces another reaction, which is binding upon us, and only those who are acting on behalf of Yajna (Viṣṇu) are not bound by reactions. Our actions are judged by the higher authorities, the agents of the Lord, and thus we are awarded bodies according to our activities. The law of nature is so subtle that every part of our body is influenced by the respective stars, and a living being obtains his working body to fulfill his terms of imprisonment by the manipulation of such astronomical influence. A man's destiny is therefore ascertained by the birthtime constellation of stars, and a factual horoscope is made by a learned astrologer. It is a great science, and misuse of a science does not make it useless. Mahārāja Parékñit or even the Personality of Godhead appear in certain constellations of good stars, and thus the influence is exerted upon the body thus born at an auspicious moment. The most auspicious constellation of stars takes place during the appearance of the Lord in this material world, and it is specifically called *jayanté*, a word not to be abused for any other purposes. Mahārāja Parékñit was not only a great *kñatriya* emperor, but also a great devotee of the Lord. Thus he cannot take his birth at any inauspicious moment. As a proper place and time is selected to receive a respectable personage, so also to receive such a personality as Mahārāja Parékñit, who was especially cared for by the Supreme Lord, a suitable moment is chosen when all good stars assembled together to exert their influence upon the King. Thus he took his birth just to be known as the great hero of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. This suitable arrangement of astral influences is never a creation of man's will, but is the arrangement of the superior management of the agency of the Supreme

Lord. Of course, the arrangement is made according to the good or bad deeds of the living being. Herein lies the importance of pious acts performed by the living being. Only by pious acts can one be allowed to get good wealth, good education and beautiful features. The *saàskāras* of the school of *sanātana-dharma* (man's eternal engagement) are highly suitable for creating an atmosphere for taking advantage of good stellar influences, and therefore *garbhādhāna-saàskāra*, or the first seedling purificatory process prescribed for the higher castes, is the beginning of all pious acts to receive a good pious and intelligent class of men in human society. There will be peace and prosperity in the world due to good and sane population only; there is hell and disturbance only because of the unwanted, insane populace addicted to sex indulgence.

TEXT 13

**TaSYa Pa[qTaMaNaa raJaa ivPa[EDaaCEMYak*-Paaidi>a")
JaaTak&- k-arYaaMaaSa vaciYaTva c Ma®l/Ma()) 13))**

tasya préta-manā rājā

viprair dhaumya-kāpādibhiù

jātakāà kārayām āsa

vācayitvā ca maìgalam

SYNONYMS

tasya—his; *préta-manāù*—satisfied; *rājā*—King Yudhiñöhira; *vipraiù*—by the learned *brahmanas*; *dhaumya*—Dhaumya; *kāpa*—Kāpa; *ādibhiù*—and others also; *jātakam*—one of the purificatory processes performed just after the birth of a child; *kārayām āsa*—had them performed; *vācayitvā*—by recitation; *ca*—also; *maìgalam*—auspicious.

TRANSLATION

King Yudhiñöhira, who was very satisfied with the birth of Mahārāja

Parékñit, had the purificatory process of birth performed. Learned brahmanas, headed by Dhaumya and Kåpa, recited auspicious hymns.

PURPORT

There is a need for a good and intelligent class of *brahmanas* who are expert in performing the purificatory processes prescribed in the system of *varëçrama-dharma*. Unless such purificatory processes are performed, there is no possibility of good population, and in the age of Kali the population all over the world is of *çüdra* quality or lower for want of this purificatory process. It is not possible, however, to revive the Vedic process of purification in this age, for want of proper facilities and good *brahmanas*, but there is the *Päicarätrika* system also recommended for this age. The *Päicarätrika* system acts on the *çüdra* class of men, supposedly the population of the Kali-yuga, and it is the prescribed purificatory process suitable to the age and time. Such a purificatory process is allowed only for spiritual upliftment and not for any other purpose. Spiritual upliftment is never conditioned by higher or lower parentage.

After the *garbhädhäna* purificatory process, there are certain other *saàskäras* like *sémantonnayana*, *sadhabhakñäëam*, etc., during the period of pregnancy, and when the child is born the first purificatory process is *jätakarman*. This was performed duly by Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira with the help of good and learned *brahmanas* like Dhaumya, the royal priest, and Kåpäcärya, who was not only a priest but also a great general. Both these learned and perfect priests, assisted by other good *brahmanas*, were employed by Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira to perform the ceremony. Therefore all the *saàskäras*, purificatory processes, are not mere formalities or social functions only, but they are all for practical purposes and can be successfully performed by expert *brahmanas* like Dhaumya and Kåpa. Such *brahmanas* are not only rare, but also not available in this age, and therefore, for the purpose of spiritual upliftment in this fallen age, the Gosvamis prefer the purificatory processes under *Päicarätrika* formulas to the Vedic rites.

Kåpäcärya is the son of the great Rsi Sardban and was born in the family of Gautama. The birth is said to be accidental. By chance, the great Rsi

Sardban met Janapadé, a famous society girl of heaven, and the Rsi Sardban discharged semina in two parts. By one part immediately a male child and by the other part a female child were born as twins. The male child was later on known as Kåpa, and the female child was known as Kåpé. Mahārāja Çantanu, while engaged in chase in the jungle, picked up the children and brought them up to the brahminical status by the proper purificatory process. Kåpācārya later became a great general like Droëācārya, and his sister was married to Droëācārya. Kåpācārya later on took part in the Battle of Kurukñetra and joined the party of Duryodhana. Kåpācārya helped kill Abhimanyu, the father of Mahārāja Parékñit, but he was still held in esteem by the family of the Pääòavas due to his being as great a *brahmana* as Droëācārya. When the Pääòavas were sent to the forest after being defeated in the gambling game with Duryodhana, Dhåtarāñöra entrusted the Pääòavas to Kåpācārya for guidance. After the end of the battle, Kåpācārya again became a member of the royal assembly, and he was called during the birth of Mahārāja Parékñit for recitation of auspicious Vedic hymns to make the ceremony successful. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, while quitting the palace for his great departure to the Himalayas, entrusted Kåpācārya with Mahārāja Parékñit as his disciple, and he left home satisfied because of Kåpācārya's taking charge of Mahārāja Parékñit. The great administrators, kings and emperors were always under the guidance of learned *brahmanas* like Kåpācārya and thus were able to act properly in the discharge of political responsibilities.

TEXT 14

ih<Ya& Gaa& Mahq& Ga]aMaaNa(hSTYaiaà*PaiTavRraNa()
Pa[adaTSv& c ivPa[e>Ya" Pa[JaaTaqQaeR Sa TaqQaRivTa()) 14))

hiraëyaà gäà mahéà grämän

hasty-açvän nãpatir varän

prädät svannaà ca viprebhyaù

prajā-térthe sa térthavit

SYNONYMS

hiraëyam—gold; *gäm*—cows; *mahém*—land; *grämän*—villages; *hasti*—elephants; *açvân*—horses; *nåpatiù*—the King; *varän*—rewards; *prädät*—gave in charity; *su-annam*—good food grains; *ca*—and; *viprebhyaù*—unto the *brahmanas*; *prajā-térthe*—on the occasion of giving in charity on the birthday of a son; *saù*—he; *tértha-vit*—one who knows how, when and where charity is to be given.

TRANSLATION

Upon the birth of a son, the King, who knew how, where and when charity should be given, gave gold, land, villages, elephants, horses and good food grains to the brahmanas.

PURPORT

Only the *brahmanas* and *sannyäsés* are authorized to accept charity from the householders. In all the different occasions of *saàskäras*, especially during the time of birth, marriage and death, wealth is distributed to the *brahmanas* because the *brahmanas* give the highest quality of service in regard to the prime necessity of humankind. The charity was substantial in the shape of gold, land, villages, horses, elephants and food grains, with other materials for cooking complete foodstuff. The *brahmanas* were not, therefore, poor in the actual sense of the term. On the contrary, because they possessed gold, land, villages, horses, elephants and sufficient grains, they had nothing to earn for themselves. They would simply devote themselves to the well-being of the entire society.

The word *térthavit* is significant because the King knew well where and when charity has to be given. Charity is never unproductive or blind. In the *sastras* charity was offered to persons who deserve to accept charity by dint of spiritual enlightenment. The so-called *daridra-näräyaëa*, a misconception of the Supreme Lord by unauthorized persons, is never to be found in the *sastras* as the object of charity. Nor can a wretched poor man receive much munificent charity in the way of horses, elephants, land and villages. The conclusion is that the intelligent men, or the *brahmanas*

specifically engaged in the service of the Lord, were properly maintained without anxiety for the needs of the body, and the King and other householders gladly looked after all their comforts.

It is enjoined in the *sastras* that as long as a child is joined with the mother by the navel pipe, the child is considered to be of one body with the mother, but as soon as the pipe is cut and the child is separated from the mother, the purificatory process of *jātakarman* is performed. The administrative demigods and past forefathers of the family come to see a newly born child, and such an occasion is specifically accepted as the proper time for distributing wealth to the right persons productively for the spiritual advancement of society.

TEXT 15

**TaMaUcub]aRø<aaSTauía raJaaNa& Pa[é[YaaiNvTaMa()
Wz ùiSMaNa(Pa[JaaTaNTaaE Pauæ<aa& PaaErvzR>a)) 15))**

tam ücur brähmaëäs tuñöä

räjānaà praçrayänvitam

eña hy asmin prajā-tantau

purüëää pauravarñabha

SYNONYMS

tam—unto him; *ücu*—addressed; *brähmaëä*—the learned *brahmanas*; *tuñöä*—very much satisfied; *räjānam*—unto the King; *praçraya-anvitam*—very much obliging; *eña*—this; *hi*—certainly; *asmin*—in the chain of; *prajā-tantau*—descending line; *purüëäm*—of the Pürus; *paurava-ñabha*—the chief among the Pürus.

TRANSLATION

The learned brahmanas, who were very satisfied with the charities of the

King, addressed him as the chief amongst the Pürus and informed him that his son was certainly in the line of descent from the Pürus.

TEXT 16

dEveNaaPa[iTagaaTaeNa éu©e- Sa&SQaaMauPaeYauiz)
raTaae vae_NauGa]haQaaRYa ivZ<auNaa Pa[>aivZ<auNaa)) 16))

daivenäpratighätena

çukle saàsthäm upeyuñi

räto vo 'nugrahärthäya

viṣṇunä prabhaviṣṇunä

SYNONYMS

daivena—by supernatural power; *apratighätena*—by what is irresistible; *çukle*—unto the pure; *saàsthäm*—destruction; *upeyuñi*—having been enforced; *rätaù*—restored; *vaù*—for you; *anugraha-arthäya*—for the sake of obliging; *viṣṇunä*—by the all-pervasive Lord; *prabhaviṣṇunä*—by the all-powerful.

TRANSLATION

The brahmanas said: This spotless son has been restored by the all-powerful and all-pervasive Lord Viṣṇu, the Personality of Godhead, in order to oblige you. He was saved when he was doomed to be destroyed by an irresistible supernatural weapon.

PURPORT

The child Parékñit was saved by the all-powerful and all-pervasive Viṣṇu (Lord Kṛṣṇa) for two reasons. The first reason is that the child in the womb of his mother was spotless due to his being a pure devotee of the Lord. The second reason is that the child was the only surviving male descendant of

Puru, the pious forefather of the virtuous King Yudhiñöhira. The Lord wants to continue the line of pious kings to rule over the earth as His representatives for the actual progress of a peaceful and prosperous life. After the Battle of Kurukñetra, even up to the next generation of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was annihilated, and there were none who could generate another son in the great royal family. Mahārāja Parékñit, the son of Abhimanyu, was the only surviving heir apparent in the family, and by the irresistible supernatural *brahmāstra* weapon of Aṣvatthämä, he was forced to be annihilated. Lord Kṛṣṇa is described herein as Viṣṇu, and this is also significant. Lord Kṛṣṇa, the original Personality of Godhead, does the work of protection and annihilation in His capacity of Viṣṇu. Lord Viṣṇu is the plenary expansion of Lord Kṛṣṇa. The all-pervasive activities of the Lord are executed by Him in His Viṣṇu feature. Child Parékñit is described here as spotlessly white because he is an unalloyed devotee of the Lord. Such unalloyed devotees of the Lord appear on the earth just to execute the mission of the Lord. The Lord desires the conditioned souls hovering in the material creation to be reclaimed to go back home, back to Godhead, and thus He helps them by preparing the transcendental literatures like the *Vedas*, by sending missionaries of saints and sages and by deputing His representative, the spiritual master. Such transcendental literatures, missionaries and representatives of the Lord are spotlessly white because the contamination of the material qualities cannot even touch them. They are always protected by the Lord when they are threatened with annihilation. Such foolish threats are made by the gross materialists. The *brahmāstra*, which was thrown by Aṣvatthämä at the child Parékñit, was certainly supernaturally powerful, and nothing of the material world could resist its force of penetration. But the all-powerful Lord, who is present everywhere, within and without, could counteract it by His all-powerful potency just to save a bona fide servant of the Lord and descendant of another devotee, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, who was always obliged by the Lord by His causeless mercy.

TEXT 17

**TaSMaaàaMana ivZ<auraTa wiTa l/aeke- >aivZYaiTa)
Na SaNdehae Maha>aaGa Maha>aaGavTaae MahaNa()) 17))**

tasmän nämnä viṣṇu-rāta

iti loka bhaviṇyati

na sandeho mahā-bhāga

mahā-bhāgavato mahän

SYNONYMS

tasmät—therefore; *nämnä*—by the name; *viṣṇu-rātaù*—protected by Viṣṇu, the Personality of Godhead; *iti*—thus; *loke*—in all the planets; *bhaviṇyati*—shall become well known; *na*—no; *sandehaù*—doubts; *mahā-bhāga*—most fortunate; *mahā-bhāgavataù*—the first-class devotee of the Lord; *mahän*—qualified by all good qualities.

TRANSLATION

For this reason this child will be well known in the world as one who is protected by the Personality of Godhead. O most fortunate one, there is no doubt that this child will become a first-class devotee and will be qualified with all good qualities.

PURPORT

The Lord gives protection to all living beings because He is their supreme leader. The Vedic hymns confirm that the Lord is the Supreme Person amongst all personalities. The difference between the two living beings is that the one, the Personality of Godhead, provides for all other living beings, and by knowing Him one can achieve eternal peace (*Kaöha Upaniñad*). Such protection is given by His different potencies to different grades of living beings. But as far as His unalloyed devotees are concerned, He gives the protection personally. Therefore, Mahārāja Parékñit is protected from the very beginning of his appearance in the womb of his mother. And because he is especially given protection by the Lord, the indication must be concluded that the child would be a first-grade devotee of the Lord with all good qualities. There are three grades of devotees,

namely the *mahā-bhāgavata*, *madhyam-adhikāré* and the *kaniñōha-adhikāré*. Those who go to the temples of the Lord and offer worshipful respect to the Deity without sufficient knowledge in the theological science and therefore without any respect for the devotees of the Lord are called materialistic devotees, or *kaniñōha-adhikāré*, the third-grade devotees. Secondly, the devotees who have developed a mentality of genuine service to the Lord and who thus make friendships only with similar devotees, show favor to the neophytes and avoid the atheists are called the second-grade devotees. But those who see everything in the Lord or everything of the Lord and also see in everything an eternal relation of the Lord, so that there is nothing within their purview of sight except the Lord, are called the *mahā-bhāgavatas*, or the first-grade devotees of the Lord. Such first-grade devotees of the Lord are perfect in all respects. A devotee who may be in any of these categories is automatically qualified by all good qualities, and thus a *mahā-bhāgavata* devotee like Mahārāja Parékñit is certainly perfect in all respects. And because Mahārāja Parékñit took his birth in the family of Mahārāja Yudhiñōhira, he is addressed herein as the *mahā-bhāgavata*, or the greatest of the fortunates. The family in which a *mahā-bhāgavata* takes his birth is fortunate because due to the birth of a first-grade devotee the members of the family, past, present and future up to one hundred generations, become liberated by the grace of the Lord, out of respect for His beloved devotee. Therefore, the highest benefit is done to one's family simply by becoming an unalloyed devotee of the Lord.

TEXT 18

é[graJaaevac

APYaez v&XYaaNa(raJazsNa(Pau<Yaëaek-aNa(MahaTMaNa")
ANauviTaRTaa iSvÛXaSaa SaaDauvadeNa SataMaa")) 18))

çré-räjoväca

apy eña vaàçyän räjarñén

puëya-çlokän mahätmanaù

anuvartitā svid yaçasä

sādhuvādēna sattamāu

SYNONYMS

çré-rājā—the all-good king (Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira); *uvāca*—said; *api*—whether; *eñau*—this; *vaāçyān*—family; *rāja-āñēn*—of saintly kings; *puēya-çlokān*—pious by the very name; *mahā-ātmanaù*—all great souls; *anuvartitā*—follower; *svit*—will it be; *yaçasā*—by achievements; *sādhuvādēna*—by glorification; *sat-tamāu*—O great souls.

TRANSLATION

The good King [Yudhiñöhira] inquired: O great souls, will he become as saintly a king, as pious in his very name and as famous and glorified in his achievements, as others who appeared in this great royal family?

PURPORT

The forefathers of King Yudhiñöhira were all great saintly kings, pious and glorified by their great achievements. They were all saints on the royal throne. And therefore all the members of the state were happy, pious, well behaved, prosperous and spiritually enlightened. Under strict guidance of the great souls and spiritual injunctions, such great saintly kings were trained up, and as a result the kingdom was full of saintly persons and was a happy land of spiritual life. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was himself a replica of his ancestors, and he desired that the next king after him become exactly like his great forefathers. He was happy to learn from the learned *brahmanas* that by astrological calculations the child would be born a first-grade devotee of the Lord, and more confidentially he wanted to know whether the child was going to follow in the footsteps of his great forefathers. That is the way of the monarchical state. The reigning king should be a pious, chivalrous devotee of the Lord and fear personified for the upstarts. He must also leave an heir apparent equally qualified to rule over the innocent citizens. In the modern setup of the democratic states, the people themselves are fallen to the qualities of the *sudras* or less, and the government is run by their representative, who is ignorant of the scriptural mode of administrative education. Thus the whole atmosphere is

surcharged with *çüdra* qualities, manifested by lust and avarice. Such administrators quarrel every day among themselves. The cabinet of ministers changes often due to party and group selfishness. Everyone wants to exploit the state resources till he dies. No one retires from political life unless forced to do so. How can such low-grade men do good to the people? The result is corruption, intrigue and hypocrisy. They should learn from the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* how ideal the administrators must be before they can be given charge of different posts.

TEXT 19

é[qb]aø<aa Ocu"
PaaQaR Pa[JaaivTaa Saa+aaaid+vaku-irv MaaNav")
b]ø<Ya" SaTYaSaNDaê raMaae daXariQaYaRQaa)) 19))

brähmaëä ücuù

pärtha prajävitä säkñäd

ikñväkur iva mänavaù

brahmaëyaù satya-sandhaç ca

rämo däçarathir yathä

SYNONYMS

brähmaëäù—the good *brahmanas*; *ücuù*—said; *pärtha*—O son of Pãthä (Kunté); *prajä*—those who are born; *avitä*—maintainer; *säkñät*—directly; *ikñväkuù iva*—exactly like King Ikñväku; *mänavaù*—son of Manu; *brahmaëyaù*—followers and respectful to the *brahmanas*; *satya-sandhaù*—truthful by promise; *ca*—also; *rämaù*—the Personality of Godhead Rāma; *däçarathiù*—the son of Mahārāja Daçaratha; *yathä*—like Him.

TRANSLATION

The learned brahmanas said: O son of Pãthä, this child shall be exactly like

King Ikṣvāku, son of Manu, in maintaining all those who are born. And as for following the brahminical principles, especially in being true to his promise, he shall be exactly like Rāma, the Personality of Godhead, the son of Mahārāja Daçaratha.

PURPORT

Prajā means the living being who has taken his birth in the material world. Actually the living being has no birth and no death, but because of his separation from the service of the Lord and due to his desire to lord it over material nature, he is offered a suitable body to satisfy his material desires. In doing so, one becomes conditioned by the laws of material nature, *and the material body is changed in terms of his own work*. The living entity thus transmigrates from one body to another in 8,400,000 species of life. But due to his being the part and parcel of the Lord, he not only is maintained with all necessities of life by the Lord, but also is protected by the Lord and His representatives, the saintly kings. These saintly kings give protection to all the *prajā*s, or living beings, to live and to fulfill their terms of imprisonment. Mahārāja Parékṣit was actually an ideal saintly king because while touring his kingdom he happened to see that a poor cow was about to be killed by the personified Kali, whom he at once took to task as a murderer. This means that even the animals were given protection by the saintly administrators, not from any sentimental point of view, but because those who have taken their birth in the material world have the right to live. All the saintly kings, beginning from the King of the sun globe down to the King of the earth, are so inclined by the influence of the Vedic literatures. The Vedic literatures are taught in higher planets also, as there is reference in the ***Bhagavad-gīta*** (4.1) about the teachings to the sun-god (Vivasvān) by the Lord, and such lessons are transferred by disciplic succession, as it was done by the sun-god to his son Manu, and from Manu to Mahārāja Ikṣvāku. There are fourteen Manus in one day of Brahmā, and the Manu referred to herein is the seventh Manu, who is one of the *prajāpatīs* (those who create progeny), and he is the son of the sun-god. He is known as the Vaivasvata Manu. He had ten sons, and Mahārāja Ikṣvāku is one of them. Mahārāja Ikṣvāku also learned *bhakti-yoga* as taught in the *Bhagavad-gīta* from his father, Manu, who got it from his father, the sun-god. Later on the teaching of the *Bhagavad-gīta* came down by disciplic

succession from Mahārāja Ikṣvāku, but in course of time the chain was broken by unscrupulous persons, and therefore it again had to be taught to Arjuna on the Battlefield of Kurukṣetra. So all the Vedic literatures are current from the very beginning of creation of the material world, and thus the Vedic literatures are known as *apauruṣeya* (not made by man). The Vedic knowledge was spoken by the Lord and first heard by Brahmā, the first created living being within the universe.

Mahārāja Ikṣvāku: One of the sons of Vaivasvata Manu. He had one hundred sons. He prohibited meat eating. His son Çaçāda became the next king after his death.

Manu: The Manu mentioned in this verse as the father of Ikṣvāku is the seventh Manu, of the name Vaivasvata Manu, the son of sun-god Vivasvān, to whom Lord Kṛṣṇa instructed the teachings of *Bhagavad-gīta* prior to His teaching them to Arjuna. Mankind is the descendant of Manu. This Vaivasvata Manu had ten sons, named Ikṣvāku, Nabhaga, Dhāñña, Çaryāti, Nariṇyanta, Nābhāga, Diñña, Karūṇa, Pāñadhra and Vasumān. The Lord's incarnation Matsya (the gigantic fish) was advented during the beginning of Vaivasvata Manu's reign. He learned the principles of *Bhagavad-gīta* from his father, Vivasvān, the sun-god, and he reinstructed the same to his son Mahārāja Ikṣvāku. In the beginning of the Tretā-yuga the sun-god instructed devotional service to Manu, and Manu in his turn instructed it to Ikṣvāku for the welfare of the whole human society.

Lord Rāma: The Supreme Personality of Godhead incarnated Himself as Sri Rāma, accepting the sonhood of His pure devotee Mahārāja Daçaratha, the King of Ayodhyā. Lord Rāma descended along with His plenary portions, and all of them appeared as His younger brothers. In the month of Caitra on the ninth day of the growing moon in the Tretā-yuga, the Lord appeared, as usual, to establish the principles of religion and to annihilate the disturbing elements. When He was just a young boy, He helped the great sage Viçvāmītra by killing Subahu and striking Mārēca, the she-demon, who was disturbing the sages in their daily discharge of duties. The *brahmanas* and *kṣatriyas* are meant to cooperate for the welfare of the mass of people. The *brahmana* sages endeavor to enlighten the people by perfect knowledge, and the *kṣatriyas* are meant for their protection. Lord Rāmacandra is the

ideal king for maintaining and protecting the highest culture of humanity, known as *brahmaëya-dharma*. The Lord is specifically the protector of the cows and the *brahmanas*, and hence He enhances the prosperity of the world. He rewarded the administrative demigods by effective weapons to conquer the demons through the agency of Viçvāmitra. He was present in the bow sacrifice of King Janaka, and by breaking the invincible bow of Siva, He married Sitadevé, daughter of Mahārāja Janaka.

After His marriage He accepted exile in the forest for fourteen years by the order of His father, Mahārāja Daçaratha. To help the administration of the demigods, He killed fourteen thousand demons, and by the intrigues of the demons, His wife, Sitadevé, was kidnapped by Ravana. He made friendship with Sugréva, who was helped by the Lord to kill Vali, brother of Sugréva. By the help of Lord Rāma, Sugréva became the king of the Vāëaras (a race of gorillas). The Lord built a floating bridge of stones on the Indian Ocean and reached Laikā, the kingdom of Ravana, who had kidnapped Sita. Later on Ravana was killed by Him, and Ravana's brother Vibhéñaëa was installed on the throne of Laikā. Vibhéñaëa was one of the brothers of Ravana, a demon, but Lord Rāma made him immortal by His blessings. On the expiry of fourteen years, after settling the affairs at Laikā, the Lord came back to His kingdom, Ayodhyā, by flower plane. He instructed His brother Çatrughna to attack Lavëäsurā, who reigned at Mathurā, and the demon was killed. He performed ten Açvamedha sacrifices, and later on He disappeared while taking a bath in the Çarayu River. The great epic *Ramayana* is the history of Lord Rāma's activities in the world, and the authoritative *Ramayana* was written by the great poet Vālméki.

TEXT 20

**Wz daTaa Xar<Yaê YaQaa àaEXaqNar" iXaib")
YaXaae ivTaiNaTaa SvāNaa& daEZYaiNTairv YaJvNaaMa()) 20))**

eña dātā çaraëyaç ca

yathā hy auçénaraù çibiù

yaço vitanitā svānāà

dauñyantir iva yajvanäm

SYNONYMS

eñau—this child; *dätä*—donor in charity; *çaraëyaù*—protector of the surrendered; *ca*—and; *yathä*—as; *hi*—certainly; *auçénaraù*—the country named Uçénara; *çibiù*—Çibi; *yaçaù*—fame; *vitaniä*—disseminator; *svänäm*—of the kinsmen; *dauñyantiù iva*—like Bharata, the son of Duñyanta; *yajvanäm*—of those who have performed many sacrifices.

TRANSLATION

This child will be a munificent donor of charity and protector of the surrendered, like the famous King Çibi of the Uçénara country. And he will expand the name and fame of his family like Bharata, the son of Mahäräja Duñyanta.

PURPORT

A king becomes famous by his acts of charity, performances of *yajñas*, protection of the surrendered, etc. A *kñatriya* king is proud to give protection to the surrendered souls. This attitude of a king is called *éçvara-bhava*, or factual power to give protection in a righteous cause. In the *Bhagavad-gita* the Lord instructs living beings to surrender unto Him, and He promises all protection. The Lord is all-powerful and true to His word, and therefore He never fails to give protection to His different devotees. The king, being the representative of the Lord, must possess this attitude of giving protection to the surrendered souls at all risk. Mahäräja Çibi, the King of Uçénara, was an intimate friend of Mahäräja Yayäti, who was able to reach the heavenly planets along with Mahäräja Çibi. Mahäräja Çibi was aware of the heavenly planet where he was to be transferred after his death, and the description of this heavenly planet is given in the *Mahäbhärata* (**Ädi-parva** 96.6–9). Mahäräja Çibi was so charitably disposed that he wanted to give over his acquired position in the heavenly kingdom to Yayäti, but he did not accept it. Yayäti went to the heavenly planet along with great *åñis* like Añöaka and others. On inquiry from the *åñis*, Yayäti gave an account of Çibi's pious acts when all of them were on the path to

heaven. He has become a member of the assembly of Yamarāja, who has become his worshipful deity. As confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita*, the worshiper of the demigods goes to the planets of the demigods (*yānti deva-vratā devān* [Bg. 9.25]); so Mahārāja Çibi has become an associate of the great Vaiñëava authority Yamarāja on that particular planet. While he was on the earth he became very famous as a protector of surrendered souls and a donor of charities. The King of heaven once took the shape of a pigeon-hunter bird (eagle), and Agni, the fire-god, took the shape of a pigeon. The pigeon, while being chased by the eagle, took shelter on the lap of Mahārāja Çibi, and the hunter eagle wanted the pigeon back from the King. The King wanted to give it some other meat to eat and requested the bird not to kill the pigeon. The hunter bird refused to accept the King's offer, but it was settled later on that the eagle would accept flesh from the body of the King of the pigeon's equivalent weight. The King began to cut flesh from his body to weigh in the balance equivalent to the weight of the pigeon, but the mystic pigeon always remained heavier. The King then put himself on the balance to equate with the pigeon, and the demigods were pleased with him. The King of heaven and the fire-god disclosed their identity, and the King was blessed by them. Devarñi Nārada also glorified Mahārāja Çibi for his great achievements, specifically in charity and protection. Mahārāja Çibi sacrificed his own son for the satisfaction of human beings in his kingdom. And thus child Parékñit was to become a second Çibi in charity and protection.

Dauñyanti Bharata: There are many Bharatas in history, of which Bharata the brother of Lord Rāma, Bharata the son of King Rsabha, and Bharata the son of Mahārāja Duñyanta are very famous. And all these Bharatas are historically known to the universe. This earth planet is known as Bhārata, or Bhārata-varña, due to King Bharata the son of Rsabha, but according to some this land is known as Bhārata due to the reign of the son of Duñyanta. So far as we are convinced, this land's name Bhārata-varña was established from the reign of Bharata the son of King Rsabha. Before him the land was known as Ilāvati-varña, but just after the coronation of Bharata, the son of Rsabha, this land became famous as Bhārata-varña.

But despite all this, Bharata, the son of Mahārāja Duñyanta was not less important. He is the son of the famous beauty Çakuntalā. Mahārāja

Duñyanta fell in love with Çakuntalä in the forest, and Bharata was conceived. After that, Mahäräja forgot his wife Çakuntalä by the curse of Kaëva Muni, and the child Bharata was brought up in the forest by his mother. Even in his childhood he was so powerful that he challenged the lions and elephants in the forest and would fight with them as little children play with cats and dogs. Because of the boy's becoming so strong, more than the so-called modern Tarzan, the *åñis* in the forest called him Sarvadaman, or one who is able to control everyone. A full description of Mahäräja Bharata is given in the *Mahābhārata, Ādi-parva*. The Pääòavas, or the Kurus, are sometimes addressed as Bhärata due to being born in the dynasty of the famous Mahäräja Bharata, the son of King Duñyanta.

TEXT 21

**DaiNvNaaMaGa]<aqrez TauLYaêaJauRNaYaaeÜRYaae")
huTaaXa wv duDaRzR" SaMaud] wv duSTar")) 21))**

dhanvinām agraëér eña

tulyaç cārjunayor dvayou

hutäça iva durdharñaù

samudra iva dustaraù

SYNONYMS

dhanvinām—of the great bowmen; *agraëéù*—the foreman; *eñaù*—this child; *tulyaù*—equally good; *ca*—and; *arjunayou*—of the Arjuna; *dvayou*—of the two; *hutäçaù*—fire; *iva*—like; *durdharñaù*—irresistible; *samudraù*—ocean; *iva*—like; *dustaraù*—unsurpassable.

TRANSLATION

Amongst great bowmen, this child will be as good as Arjuna. He will be as irresistible as fire and as unsurpassable as the ocean.

PURPORT

In history there are two Arjunas. One is Kārttavérya Arjuna, the King of Haihaya, and the other is the grandfather of the child. Both the Arjunas are famous for their bowmanship, and the child Parékñit is foretold to be equal to both of them, particularly in fighting. A short description of the Pāëòava Arjuna is given below:

Pāëòava Arjuna: The great hero of the *Bhagavad-gita*. He is the *kñatriya* son of Mahārāja Pāëòu. Queen Kuntédevé could call for any one of the demigods, and thus she called Indra, and Arjuna was born by him. Arjuna is therefore a plenary part of the heavenly King Indra. He was born in the month of Phalguna (February–March), and therefore he is also called Phalguni. When he appeared as the son of Kunté, his future greatness was proclaimed by air messages, and all the important personalities from different parts of the universe, such as the demigods, the Gandharvas, the Ādityas (from the sun globe), the Rudras, the Vasus, the Nāgas, the different *āñis* (sages) of importance, and the Apsarās (the society girls of heaven), all attended the ceremony. The Apsarās pleased everyone by their heavenly dances and songs. Vasudeva, the father of Lord Kṛṣṇa and the maternal uncle of Arjuna, sent his priest representative Kaçyapa to purify Arjuna by all the prescribed *saàskāras*, or reformatory processes. His *saàskāra* of being given a name was performed in the presence of the *āñis*, residents of Çatasāiga. He married four wives, Draupadé, Subhadrā, Citraigada and Ulüpé, from whom he got four sons of the names Çrutakérta, Abhimanyu, Babhruvāhana and Irāvān respectively.

During his student life he was entrusted to study under the great professor Droëäcārya, along with other Pāëòavas and the Kurus. But he excelled everyone by his studious intensity, and Droëäcārya was especially attracted by his disciplinary affection. Droëäcārya accepted him as a first-grade scholar and loved heartily to bestow upon him all the blessings of military science. He was so ardent a student that he used to practice bowmanship even at night, and for all these reasons Professor Droëäcārya was determined to make him the topmost bowman of the world. He passed very brilliantly the examination in piercing the target, and Droëäcārya was very pleased. Royal families at Maëipur and Tripura are descendants of

Arjuna's son Babhruvāhana. Arjuna saved Droëäcārya from the attack of a crocodile, and the Ācārya, being pleased with him, rewarded him with a weapon of the name *brahmaçira*. Mahārāja Drupada was inimical toward Droëäcārya, and thus when he attacked the Ācārya, Arjuna got him arrested and brought him before Droëäcārya. He besieged a city of the name Ahichhatra, belonging to Mahārāja Drupada, and after taking it over he gave it to Droëäcārya. The confidential treatment of the weapon *brahmaçira* was explained to Arjuna, and Droëäcārya was promised by Arjuna that he would use the weapon if necessary when he (Droëäcārya) personally became an enemy of Arjuna. By this, the Ācārya forecasted the future battle of Kurukñetra, in which Droëäcārya was on the opposite side. Mahārāja Drupada, although defeated by Arjuna on behalf of his professor Droëäcārya, decided to hand over his daughter Draupadé to his young combatant, but he was disappointed when he heard the false news of Arjuna's death in the fire of a shellac house intrigued by Duryodhana. He therefore arranged for Draupadé's personal selection of a groom who could pierce the eye of a fish hanging on the ceiling. This trick was especially made because only Arjuna could do it, and he was successful in his desire to hand over his equally worthy daughter to Arjuna. Arjuna's brothers were at that time living incognito under agreement with Duryodhana, and Arjuna and his brothers attended the meeting of Draupadé's selection in the dress of *brahmanas*. When all the *kñatriya* kings assembled saw that a poor *brahmana* had been garlanded by Draupadé for her lord, Sri Kṛṣṇa disclosed his identity to Balarāma.

He met Ulüpé at Haridvāra (Hardwar), and he was attracted by a girl belonging to Nāgaloka, and thus Iravān was born. Similarly, he met Citraigada, a daughter of the King of Maëipura, and thus Babhruvāhana was born. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa made a plan to help Arjuna to kidnap Subhadrā, sister of Sri Kṛṣṇa, because Baladeva was inclined to hand her over to Duryodhana. Yudhiñöhira also agreed with Sri Kṛṣṇa, and thus Subhadrā was taken by force by Arjuna and then married to him. Subhadrā's son is Abhimanyu, the father of Parékñit Mahārāja, the posthumous child. Arjuna satisfied the fire-god by setting fire to the Khäëòava Forest, and thus the fire-god gave him one weapon. Indra was angry when the fire was set in the Khäëòava Forest, and thus Indra, assisted by all other demigods, began fighting with Arjuna for his great challenge. They were defeated by Arjuna,

and Indradeva returned to his heavenly kingdom. Arjuna also promised all protection to one Mayāsura, and the latter presented him one valuable conchshell celebrated as the Devadatta. Similarly, he received many other valuable weapons from Indradeva when he was satisfied to see his chivalry.

When Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was disappointed in defeating the King of Magadha, Jaräsandha, it was Arjuna only who gave King Yudhiñöhira all kinds of assurances, and thus Arjuna, Bhéma and Lord Kṛṣṇa started for Magadha to kill Jaräsandha. When he went out to bring all other kings of the world under the subjection of the Pāṇḍavas, as was usual after the coronation of every emperor, he conquered the country named Kelinda and brought in subjugation King Bhagdutt. Then he traveled through countries like Antagiri, Ulukpur and Modapur and brought under subjugation all the rulers.

Sometimes he underwent severe types of penances, and later on he was rewarded by Indradeva. Lord Siva also wanted to try the strength of Arjuna, and in the form of an aborigine, Lord Siva met him. There was a great fight between the two, and at last Lord Siva was satisfied with him and disclosed his identity. Arjuna prayed to the lord in all humbleness, and the lord, being pleased with him, presented him the *paçupata* weapon. He acquired many other important weapons from different demigods. He received *daëðästra* from Yamarāja, *paçästra* from Varuëa, and *antardhana-astra* from Kuvera, the treasurer of the heavenly kingdom. Indra wanted him to come to the heavenly kingdom, the Indraloka planet beyond the moon planet. In that planet he was cordially received by the local residents, and he was awarded reception in the heavenly parliament of Indradeva. Then he met Indradeva, who not only presented him with his *vajra* weapon, but also taught him the military and musical science as used in the heavenly planet. In one sense, Indra is the real father of Arjuna, and therefore indirectly he wanted to entertain Arjuna with the famous society girl of heaven, Urvaçé, the celebrated beauty. The society girls of heaven are lusty, and Urvaçé was very eager to contact Arjuna, the strongest human being. She met him in his room and expressed her desires but Arjuna sustained his unimpeachable character by closing his eyes before Urvaçé, addressing her as mother of the Kuru dynasty and placing her in the category of his mothers Kunté, Mädré and Çacédevé, wife of Indradeva. Disappointed,

Urvaṣé cursed Arjuna and left. In the heavenly planet he also met the great celebrated ascetic Lomasa and prayed to him for the protection of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira.

When his inimical cousin Duryodhana was under the clutches of the Gandharvas, he wanted to save him and requested the Gandharvas to release Duryodhana, but the Gandharvas refused, and thus he fought with them and got Duryodhana released. When all the Pāṇḍavas lived incognito, he presented himself in the court of King Virāṭa as a eunuch and was employed as the musical teacher of Uttara, his future daughter-in-law, and was known in the Virāṭa court as the Bāhannala. As Bāhannala, he fought on behalf of Uttara, the son of King Virāṭa, and thus defeated the Kurus in the fight incognito. His secret weapons were safely kept in the custody of a *somi* tree, and he ordered Uttara to get them back. His identity and his brothers' identity were later on disclosed to Uttara. Droṇācārya was informed of Arjuna's presence in the fight of the Kurus and the Virāṭas. Later, on the Battlefield of Kurukṣetra, Arjuna killed many great generals like Karṇa and others. After the Battle of Kurukṣetra, he punished Aṣvatthāmā, who had killed all the five sons of Draupadī. Then all the brothers went to Bhīṣmadeva.

It is due to Arjuna only that the great philosophical discourses of the *Bhagavad-gītā* were again spoken by the Lord on the Battlefield of Kurukṣetra. His wonderful acts on the Battlefield of Kurukṣetra are vividly described in the *Mahābhārata*. Arjuna was defeated, however, by his son Babhruvāhana at Maṇipura and fell unconscious when Ulūpī saved him. After the disappearance of Lord Kṛṣṇa, the message was brought by Arjuna to Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. Again, Arjuna visited Dvārakā, and all the widow wives of Lord Kṛṣṇa lamented before him. He took them all in the presence of Vasudeva and pacified all of them. Later on, when Vasudeva passed away, he performed his funeral ceremony in the absence of Kṛṣṇa. While Arjuna was taking all the wives of Kṛṣṇa to Indraprastha, he was attacked on the way, and he could not protect the ladies in his custody. At last, advised by Vyāsadeva, all the brothers headed for Mahāprastha. On the way, at the request of his brother, he gave up all important weapons as useless, and he dropped them all in the water.

TEXT 22

Ma*GaeNd] wv iv\$-aNTaae iNazeVYaae ihMavaiNav)
iTaiTa+auvRSauDaevaSaaE SaihZ<au" iPaTaraivv)) 22))

māgendra iva vikrānto

niñevyo himavān iva

titikñur vasudhevāsau

sahiñēu pitarāv iva

SYNONYMS

māgendra—the lion; *iva*—like; *vikrānta*—powerful; *niñevya*—worthy of taking shelter; *himavān*—the Himalaya Mountains; *iva*—like; *titikñu*—forbearance; *vasudhā iva*—like the earth; *asau*—the child; *sahiñēu*—tolerant; *pitarau*—parents; *iva*—like.

TRANSLATION

This child will be as strong as a lion, and as worthy a shelter as the Himalaya Mountains. He will be forbearing like the earth, and as tolerant as his parents.

PURPORT

One is compared to the lion when one is very strong in chasing an enemy. One should be a lamb at home and a lion in the chase. The lion never fails in the chase of an animal; similarly, the head of the state should never fail in chasing an enemy. The Himalaya Mountains are famous for all richness. There are innumerable caves to live in, numberless trees of good fruits to eat, good springs to drink water from and profuse drugs and minerals to cure diseases. Any man who is not materially prosperous can take shelter of these great mountains, and he will be provided with everything required. Both the materialist and the spiritualist can take advantage of the great

shelter of the Himalayas. On the surface of the earth there are so many disturbances caused by the inhabitants. In the modern age the people have begun to detonate atomic weapons on the surface of the earth, and still the earth is forbearing to the inhabitants, like a mother who excuses a little child. Parents are always tolerant to children for all sorts of mischievous acts. An ideal king may be possessed of all these good qualities, and the child Parékñit is foretold to have all these qualities in perfection.

TEXT 23

iPaTaaMahSaMa" SaaMYae Pa[Saade iGairXaaePaMa")
Aaé[Ya" SavR>aUTaaNaa& YaQaa devae rMaaé[Ya")) 23))

pitāmaha-samaù sämye

prasāde giriçopamaù

äçrayaù sarva-bhütänäà

yathä devo ramäçrayaù

SYNONYMS

pitāmaha—the grandfather, or Brahmä; *samaù*—equally good; *sämye*—in the matter; *prasāde*—in charity or in munificence; *giriça*—Lord Siva; *upamaù*—comparison of equilibrium; *äçrayaù*—resort; *sarva*—all; *bhütänäm*—of the living beings; *yathä*—as; *devaù*—the Supreme Lord; *ramä-äçrayaù*—the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

This child will be like his grandfather Yudhiñöhira or Brahmä in equanimity of mind. He will be munificent like the lord of the Kailäsa Hill, Siva. And he will be the resort of everyone, like the Supreme Personality of Godhead Nārāyaṇa, who is even the shelter of the goddess of fortune.

PURPORT

Mental equanimity refers both to Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira and to Brahmā, the grandfather of all living beings. According to Sridhara Svāmé, the grandfather referred to is Brahmā, but according to Visvanatha Cakravarti, the grandfather is Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira himself. But in both cases the comparison is equally good because both of them are recognized representatives of the Supreme Lord, and thus both of them have to maintain mental equanimity, being engaged in welfare work for the living being. Any responsible executive agent at the top of administration has to tolerate different types of onslaughts from the very persons for whom he works. Brahmäjé was criticized even by the *gopés*, the highest perfectional devotees of the Lord. The *gopés* were dissatisfied with the work of Brahmäjé because Lord Brahmā, as creator of this particular universe, created eyelids which obstructed their seeing Lord Kṛṣṇa. They could not tolerate a moment's blinking of the eyes, for it kept them from seeing their beloved Lord Kṛṣṇa. So what to speak of others, who are naturally very critical of every action of a responsible man? Similarly, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira had to cross over many difficult situations created by his enemies, and he proved to be the most perfect maintainer of mental equanimity in all critical circumstances. Therefore the example of both grandfathers for maintaining equanimity of mind is quite fitting.

Lord Siva is a celebrated demigod who awards gifts to beggars. His name is therefore Āçutoña, or one who is pleased very easily. He is also called the Bhūtanātha, or the lord of the common folk, who are mainly attached to him because of his munificent gifts, even without consideration of the aftereffects. Ravana was very attached to Lord Siva, and by easily pleasing him, Ravana became so powerful that he wanted to challenge the authority of Lord Rāma. Of course, Ravana was never helped by Lord Siva when he fought with Rāma, the Supreme Personality of Godhead and the Lord of Lord Siva. To Vākāsura, Lord Siva awarded a benediction which was not only awkward, but also disturbing. Vākāsura became empowered, by the grace of Lord Siva, to vanish anyone's head simply by touching it. Although this was awarded by Lord Siva, the cunning fellow wanted to make an experiment of the power by touching the head of Lord Siva. Thus the lord had to take shelter of Viṣṇu to save himself from trouble, and the Lord Viṣṇu, by His illusory potency, asked Vākāsura to make an experiment with his own head. The fellow did it and was finished himself, and so the world

was saved from all sorts of trouble by such a cunning beggar of the demigods. The excellent point is that Lord Siva never denies anyone any sort of gift. He is therefore the most generous, although sometimes some kind of a mistake is made.

Ramā means the goddess of fortune. And her shelter is Lord Viṣṇu. Lord Viṣṇu is the maintainer of all living beings. There are innumerable living beings, not only on the surface of this planet but also in all other hundreds of thousands of planets. All of them are provided with all necessities of life for the progressive march towards the end of self-realization, but on the path of sense gratification they are put into difficulty by the agency of *māyā*, the illusory energy, and so travel the path of a false plan of economic development. Such economic development is never successful because it is illusory. These men are always after the mercy of the illusory goddess of fortune, but they do not know that the goddess of fortune can live only under the protection of Viṣṇu. Without Viṣṇu, the goddess of fortune is an illusion. We should therefore seek the protection of Viṣṇu instead of directly seeking the protection of the goddess of fortune. Only Viṣṇu and the devotees of Viṣṇu can give protection to all, and because Mahārāja Parékñit was himself protected by Viṣṇu, it was quite possible for him to give complete protection to all who wanted to live under his rule.

TEXT 24

SavRSad(Gau<aMaahaTMYae Wz k*-Z<aMaNauv]Ta")
riNTadev wvaedarae YaYaaiTairv DaaiMaRk-")) 24))

sarva-sad-guëa-mähätmye

eña kãñëam anuvratau

rantideva ivodäro

yayätir iva dhärmikaù

SYNONYMS

sarva-sat-guëa-mähätmye—glorified by all godly attributes; *eñau*—this child; *kãñëam*—like Lord Kṛṣṇa; *anuvratau*—a follower in His footsteps; *rantidevaù*—Rantideva; *iva*—like; *udäraù*—in the matter of magnanimity; *yayätiù*—Yayäti; *iva*—like; *dhärmikaù*—concerning religion.

TRANSLATION

This child will be almost as good as Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa by following in His footsteps. In magnanimity he will become as great as King Rantideva. And in religion he will be like Mahäräja Yayäti.

PURPORT

The last instruction of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa in the *Bhagavad-gita* is that one should give up everything and should follow in the footsteps of the Lord alone. Less intelligent persons do not agree to this great instruction of the Lord, as ill luck would have it, but one who is actually intelligent catches up this sublime instruction and is immensely benefited. Foolish people do not know that association is the cause of acquiring qualities. Association with fire makes an object hot, even in the material sense. Therefore, association with the Supreme Personality of Godhead makes one qualified like the Lord. As we have discussed previously, one can achieve seventy-eight percent of the godly qualities by the Lord's intimate association. To follow the instructions of the Lord is to associate with the Lord. *The Lord is not a material object whose presence one has to feel for such association.* The Lord is present everywhere and at all times. It is quite possible to have His association simply by following His instruction because the Lord and His instruction and the Lord and His name, fame, attributes and paraphernalia are all identical with Him, being absolute knowledge. Mahäräja Parékñit associated with the Lord even from the womb of his mother up to the last day of his valuable life, and thus he acquired all the essential good qualities of the Lord in all perfection.

Rantideva: An ancient king prior to the *Mahäbhärata* period, referred to by Nārada Muni while instructing Saijaya, as mentioned in *Mahäbhärata* (*Droëa-parva* 67). He was a great king, liberal for hospitality and distribution of foodstuff. Even Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa praised his acts of charity and

hospitality. He was blessed by the great Vasiñöha Muni for supplying him cold water, and thus he achieved the heavenly planet. He used to supply fruits, roots and leaves to the *āñis*, and thus he was blessed by them with fulfillment of his desires. *Although a kñatriya by birth, he never ate flesh in his life.* He was especially hospitable to Vasiñöha Muni, and by his blessings only he attained the higher planetary residence. He is one of those pious kings whose names are remembered in the morning and evening.

Yayāti: The great emperor of the world and the original forefather of all great nations of the world who belong to the Äryan and Indo-European stock. He is the son of Mahäräja Nabuña, and he became the emperor of the world due to his elder brother's becoming a great and liberated saintly mystic. He ruled over the world for several thousands of years and performed many sacrifices and pious activities recorded in history, although his early youth was very lustful and full of romantic stories. He fell in love with Devayäné, the most beloved daughter of Çukräcärya. Devayäné wished to marry him, but at first he refused to accept her because of her being a daughter of a *brahmana*. According to *sastras*, a *brahmana* could marry the daughter of a *kñatriya* but a *kñatriya* could not marry the daughter of a *brahmana*. They were very much cautious about *varëa-saikara* population in the world. Çukräcärya amended this law of forbidden marriage and induced Emperor Yayāti to accept Devayäné. Devayäné had a girl friend named Çarmiñöhä, who also fell in love with the emperor and thus went with her friend Devayäné. Çukräcärya forbade Emperor Yayāti to call Çarmiñöhä into his bedroom, but Yayāti could not strictly follow his instruction. He secretly married Çarmiñöhä also and begot sons by her. When this was known by Devayäné, she went to her father and lodged a complaint. Yayāti was much attached to Devayäné, and when he went to his father-in-law's place to call her, Çukräcärya was angry with him and cursed him to become impotent. Yayāti begged his father-in-law to withdraw his curse, but the sage asked Yayāti to ask youthfulness from his sons and let them become old as the condition of his becoming potent. He had five sons, two from Devayäné and three from Çarmiñöhä. From his five sons, namely (1) Yadu, (2) Turvasu, (3) Druhyu, (4) Anu and (5) Püru, five famous dynasties, namely (1) the Yadu dynasty, (2) the Yavana (Turk) dynasty, (3) the Bhoja dynasty, (4) the Mleccha dynasty (Greek) and (5) the Paurava dynasty, all emanated to spread all over the world. He reached the

heavenly planets by dint of his pious acts, but he fell down from there because of his self-advertisement and criticizing other great souls. After his fall, his daughter and grandson bestowed upon him their accumulated virtues, and by the help of his grandson and friend Çibi, he was again promoted to the heavenly kingdom, becoming one of the assembly members of Yamarāja, with whom he is staying as a devotee. He performed more than one thousand different sacrifices, gave in charity very liberally and was a very influential king. His majestic power was felt all over the world. His youngest son agreed to award him his youthfulness when he was troubled with lustful desires, even for one thousand years. Finally he became detached from worldly life and returned the youthfulness again to his son Pūru. He wanted to hand over the kingdom to Pūru, but his noblemen and the subjects did not agree. But when he explained to his subjects the greatness of Pūru, they agreed to accept Pūru as the King, and thus Emperor Yayāti retired from family life and left home for the forest.

TEXT 25

Da*TYaa bil/SaMa" k*-Z<ae Pa[hṛāda wv Sad(Ga]h")
AahTaÇEzæ_ìMaeDaaNaa& v*ÖaNaa& PaYauRPaaSak-")) 25))

dhātyä bali-samaù kãñēe

prahrāda iva sad-grahaù

āhartaiño 'çvamedhänää

vāddhänää paryupäsakaù

SYNONYMS

dhātyä—by patience; *bali-samaù*—like Bali Mahārāja; *kãñēe*—unto Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *prahrāda*—Prahāda Mahārāja; *iva*—like; *sat-grahaù*—devotee of; *āhartä*—performer; *eñaù*—this child; *açvamedhänäm*—of Açvamedha sacrifices; *vāddhänäm*—of the old and experienced men; *paryupäsakaù*—follower.

TRANSLATION

This child will be like Bali Mahārāja in patience, a staunch devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa like Prahlāda Mahārāja, a performer of many Aṣvamedha [horse] sacrifices and a follower of the old and experienced men.

PURPORT

Bali Mahārāja: One of the twelve authorities in the devotional service of the Lord. Bali Mahārāja is a great authority in devotional service because he sacrificed everything to please the Lord and relinquished the connection of his so-called spiritual master who obstructed him on the path of risking everything for the service of the Lord. The highest perfection of religious life is to attain to the stage of unqualified devotional service of the Lord without any cause or without being obstructed by any kind of worldly obligation. Bali Mahārāja was determined to give up everything for the satisfaction of the Lord, and he did not care for any obstruction whatsoever. He is the grandson of Prahlāda Mahārāja, another authority in the devotional service of the Lord. Bali Mahārāja and the history of his dealings with Viṣṇu Vāmanadeva are described in the Eighth Canto of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* (Chapter 11–24).

Prahlāda Mahārāja: A perfect devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa (Viṣṇu). His father, Hiraṇyakaśipu, chastised him severely when he was only five years old for his becoming an unalloyed devotee of the Lord. He was the first son of Hiraṇyakaśipu, and his mother's name was Kayādhu. Prahlāda Mahārāja was an authority in the devotional service of the Lord because he had his father killed by Lord Nṛsiṃhadeva, setting the example that even a father should be removed from the path of devotional service if such a father happens to be an obstacle. He had four sons, and the eldest son, Virocana, is the father of Bali Mahārāja, mentioned above. The history of Prahlāda Mahārāja's activities is described in the Seventh Canto of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 26

raJazs<aa& JaNaiYaTaa XaaSTaa caeTPaQaGaiMaNaaMa()

iNaGa]hqTaa k-le/rez >auvae DaMaRSYa k-ar<aaTa()) 26))

räjarñéëää janayitä

çästä cotpatha-gäminäm

nigrahétä kaler eña

bhuvo dharmasya käraëät

SYNONYMS

räja-ãñéëäm—of kings as good as sages; *janayitä*—producer; *çästä*—chastiser; *ca*—and; *utpatha-gäminäm*—of the upstarts; *nigrahétä*—molester; *kaleù*—of the quarrelsome; *eñaù*—this; *bhuvaù*—of the world; *dharmasya*—of religion; *käraëät*—on account of.

TRANSLATION

This child will be the father of kings who will be like sages. For world peace and for the sake of religion, he will be the chastiser of the upstarts and the quarrelsome.

PURPORT

The wisest man in the world is a devotee of the Lord. The sages are called wise men, and there are different types of wise men for different branches of knowledge. Unless, therefore, the king or the head of the state is the wisest man, he cannot control all types of wise men in the state. In the line of royal succession in the family of Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira, all the kings, without exception, were the wisest men of their times, and so also it is foretold about Mahäräja Parékñit and his son Mahäräja Janamejaya, who was yet to be born. Such wise kings can become chastisers of upstarts and uprooters of Kali, or quarrelsome elements. As will be clear in the chapters ahead, Mahäräja Parékñit wanted to kill the personified Kali, who was attempting to kill a cow, the emblem of peace and religion. The symptoms of Kali are (1) wine, (2) women, (3) gambling and (4) slaughterhouses. Wise

rulers of all states should take lessons from Mahārāja Parékñit in how to maintain peace and morality by subduing the upstarts and quarrelsome people who indulge in wine, illicit connection with women, gambling and meat-eating supplied by regularly maintained slaughterhouses. In this age of Kali, regular license is issued for maintaining all of these different departments of quarrel. So how can they expect peace and morality in the state? The state fathers, therefore, must follow the principles of becoming wiser by devotion to the Lord, by chastising the breaker of discipline and by uprooting the symptoms of quarrel, as mentioned above. If we want blazing fire, we must use dry fuel. Blazing fire and moist fuel go ill together. Peace and morality can prosper only by the principles of Mahārāja Parékñit and his followers.

TEXT 27

**Ta+ak-adaTMaNaae Ma*TYau& iÜJaPau}aaePaSaiJaRTaaTa()
Pa[PaTSYaTa oPaé[uTYa Mauç-Sa®" Pad& hre")) 27))**

takñakäd ätmano måtyuà

dvija-putropasarjität

prapatsyata upaçrutya

mukta-saigaù padaà hareù

SYNONYMS

takñakät—by the snake-bird; *ätmanaù*—of his personal self; *måtyum*—death; *dvija-putra*—the son of a *brahmana*; *upasarjität*—being sent by; *prapatsyate*—having taken shelter of; *upaçrutya*—after hearing; *mukta-saigaù*—freed from all attachment; *padam*—position; *hareù*—of the Lord.

TRANSLATION

After hearing about his death, which will be caused by the bite of a snake-bird sent by a son of a brahmana, he will get himself freed from all

material attachment and surrender unto the Personality of Godhead, taking shelter of Him.

PURPORT

Material attachment and taking shelter of the lotus feet of the Lord go ill together. Material attachment means ignorance of transcendental happiness under the shelter of the Lord. Devotional service to the Lord, while existing in the material world, is a way to practice one's transcendental relation with the Lord, and when it is matured, one gets completely free from all material attachment and becomes competent to go back home, back to Godhead. Mahārāja Parékṣīt, being especially attached to the Lord from the beginning of his body in the womb of his mother, was continuously under the shelter of the Lord, and the so-called warning of his death within seven days from the date of the curse by the *brahmana's* son was a boon to him to enable him to prepare himself to go back home, back to Godhead. Since he was always protected by the Lord, he could have avoided the effect of such a curse by the grace of the Lord, but he did not take such undue advantage for nothing. Rather, he made the best use of a bad bargain. For seven days continuously he heard *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from the right source, and thus he got shelter at the lotus feet of the Lord by that opportunity.

TEXT 28

**iJaiSaTaaTMaYaaQaaQYaaE MauNaeVYaaRSaSauTaadSaaE)
ihTved& Na*Pa Ga®aYaa& YaaSYaTYaÖaku-Taee>aYaMa()) 28))**

jijāsitātma-yāthārthyo

muner vyāsa-sutād asau

hitvedaà nāpa gaigāyāà

yāsyaty addhākutobhayam

SYNONYMS

jijñāsita—having inquired of; *ātma-yāthārthyaù*—right knowledge of one’s own self; *muneù*—from the learned philosopher; *vyāsa-sutāt*—the son of Vyāsa; *asau*—he; *hitvā*—quitting; *idam*—this material attachment; *nāpa*—O King; *gaigāyām*—on the bank of the Ganges; *yāsyati*—will go; *addhā*—directly; *akutaù-bhayam*—the life of fearlessness.

TRANSLATION

After inquiring about proper self-knowledge from the son of Vyāsadeva, who will be a great philosopher, he will renounce all material attachment and achieve a life of fearlessness.

PURPORT

Material knowledge means ignorance of the knowledge of one’s own self. Philosophy means to seek after the right knowledge of one’s own self, or the knowledge of self-realization. Without self-realization, philosophy is dry speculation or a waste of time and energy. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* gives the right knowledge of one’s own self, and by hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam* one can get free from material attachment and enter into the kingdom of fearlessness. This material world is fearfulness. Its prisoners are always fearful as within a prison house. In the prison house no one can violate the jail rules and regulations, and violating the rules means another term for extension of prison life. Similarly, we in this material existence are always fearful. This fearfulness is called anxiety. Everyone in the material life, in all species and varieties of life, is full of anxieties, either by breaking or without breaking the laws of nature. Liberation, or *mukti*, means getting relief from these constant anxieties. This is possible only when the anxiety is changed to the devotional service of the Lord. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* gives us the chance to change the quality of anxiety from matter to spirit. This is done in the association of a learned philosopher like the self-realized Çukadeva Gosvami, the great son of Sri Vyāsadeva. Mahārāja Parékñit, after receiving warning of his death, took advantage of this opportunity by association with Çukadeva Gosvami and achieved the desired result.

There is a sort of imitation of this reciting and hearing of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* by professional men, and their foolish audience thinks that

they will get free from the clutches of material attachment and attain the life of fearlessness. Such imitative hearing of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is a caricature only, and one should not be misled by such a performance of *bhāgavatam saptāha* undertaken by ridiculous greedy fellows to maintain an establishment of material enjoyment.

TEXT 29

**wiTa raj oPaaidXYa ivPa[a JaaTak-k-aeivda")
I/BDaaPaicTaYa" SaveR Pa[iTaJaGMau" Svk-aNa(Ga*haNa()) 29))**

iti rājā upādiṣya

viprā jātaka-kovidāu

labdhāpacitayaù sarve

pratijagmuù svakān gāhān

SYNONYMS

iti—thus; *rājā*—unto the King; *upādiṣya*—having advised; *viprāu*—persons well versed in the *Vedas*; *jātaka-kovidāu*—persons expert in astrology and in the performance of birth ceremonies; *labdhā-apacitayaù*—those who had received sumptuously as remuneration; *sarve*—all of them; *pratijagmuù*—went back; *svakān*—their own; *gāhān*—houses.

TRANSLATION

Thus those who were expert in astrological knowledge and in performance of the birth ceremony instructed King Yudhiñöhira about the future history of his child. Then, being sumptuously remunerated, they all returned to their respective homes.

PURPORT

The *Vedas* are the storehouse of knowledge, both material and spiritual.

But such knowledge aims at perfection of self-realization. In other words, the *Vedas* are the guides for the civilized man in every respect. Since human life is the opportunity to get free from all material miseries, it is properly guided by the knowledge of the *Vedas*, in the matters of both material needs and spiritual salvation. The specific intelligent class of men who were devoted particularly to the knowledge of the *Vedas* were called the *vipras*, or the graduates of the Vedic knowledge. There are different branches of knowledge in the *Vedas*, of which astrology and pathology are two important branches necessary for the common man. So the intelligent men, generally known as the *brahmanas*, took up all the different branches of Vedic knowledge to guide society. Even the department of military education (*Dhanur-veda*) was also taken up by such intelligent men, and the *vipras* were also teachers of this section of knowledge, as were Droëäcärya, Kåpäcärya, etc.

The word *vipra* mentioned herein is significant. There is a little difference between the *vipras* and the *brahmanas*. The *vipras* are those who are expert in *karma-käëða*, or fruitive activities, guiding the society towards fulfilling the material necessities of life, whereas the *brahmanas* are expert in spiritual knowledge of transcendence. This department of knowledge is called *jñäna-käëða*, and above this there is the *upäsanä-käëða*. The culmination of *upäsanä-käëða* is the devotional service of the Lord Viṣṇu, and when the *brahmanas* achieve perfection, they are called Vaiñëavas. Viṣṇu worship is the highest of the modes of worship. Elevated *brahmanas* are Vaiñëavas engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord, and thus *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, which is the science of devotional service, is very dear to the Vaiñëavas. And as explained in the beginning of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, it is the mature fruit of Vedic knowledge and is superior subject matter, above the three *käëðas*, namely *karma*, *jñäna* and *upäsanä*.

Amongst the *karma-käëða* experts, the *jätaka* expert *vipras* were good astrologers who could tell all the future history of a born child simply by the astral calculations of the time (lagna). Such expert *jätaka-vipras* were present during the birth of Mahäräja Parékñit, and his grandfather, Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira, awarded the *vipras* sufficiently with gold, land, villages, grains and other valuable necessities of life, which also include cows. There is a need of such *vipras* in the social structure, and it is the duty

of the state to maintain them comfortably, as designed in the Vedic procedure. Such expert *vipras*, being sufficiently paid by the state, could give free service to the people in general, and thus this department of Vedic knowledge could be available for all.

TEXT 30

Sa Wz I/aeke- iv:YaaTa" Parqi+aidiTa YaTPa[>au")
PaUv| d*íMaNauDYaaYaNa(Parq+aeTa NareiZvh)) 30))

sa eña loke vikhyätaù

parékñid iti yat prabhuù

pürvaà dñöam anudhyäyan

parékñeta nareñv iha

SYNONYMS

saù—he; *eñaù*—in this; *loke*—world; *vikhyätaù*—famous; *parékñit*—one who examines; *iti*—thus; *yat*—what; *prabhuù*—O my King; *pürvam*—before; *dñöam*—seen; *anudhyäyan*—constantly contemplating; *parékñeta*—shall examine; *nareñu*—unto every man; *iha*—here.

TRANSLATION

So his son would become famous in the world as Parékñit [examiner] because he would come to examine all human beings in his search after that personality whom he saw before his birth. Thus he would come to constantly contemplate Him.

PURPORT

Mahārāja Parékñit, fortunate as he was, got the impression of the Lord even in the womb of his mother, and thus his contemplation on the Lord was constantly with him. Once the impression of the transcendental form

of the Lord is fixed in one's mind, one can never forget Him in any circumstance. Child Parékñit, after coming out of the womb, was in the habit of examining everyone to see whether he was the same personality whom he first saw in the womb. But no one could be equal to or more attractive than the Lord, and therefore he never accepted anyone. But the Lord was constantly with him by such examination, and thus Mahārāja Parékñit was always engaged in the devotional service of the Lord by remembrance.

Srila Jiva Gosvami remarks in this connection that every child, if given an impression of the Lord from his very childhood, certainly becomes a great devotee of the Lord like Mahārāja Parékñit. One may not be as fortunate as Mahārāja Parékñit to have the opportunity to see the Lord in the womb of his mother, but even if he is not so fortunate, he can be made so if the parents of the child desire him to be so. There is a practical example in my personal life in this connection. My father was a pure devotee of the Lord, and when I was only four or five years old, my father gave me a couple of forms of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa. In a playful manner, I used to worship these Deities along with my sister, and I used to imitate the performances of a neighboring temple of Rādhā-Govinda. By constantly visiting this neighboring temple and copying the ceremonies in connection with my own Deities of play, I developed a natural affinity for the Lord. My father used to observe all the ceremonies befitting my position. Later on, these activities were suspended due to my association in the schools and colleges, and I became completely out of practice. But in my youthful days, when I met my spiritual master, Sri Srimad Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvaté Gosvami Mahārāja, again I revived my old habit, and the same playful Deities became my worshipful Deities in proper regulation. This was followed up until I left the family connection, and I am pleased that my generous father gave the first impression which was developed later into regulative devotional service by His Divine Grace. Mahārāja Prahāda also advised that such impressions of a godly relation must be impregnated from the beginning of childhood, otherwise one may miss the opportunity of the human form of life, which is very valuable although it is temporary like others.

TEXT 31

Sa raJaPau}aae vv*Dae Aaéu éu©- wvae@uPa")
AaPaUYaRMaa<a" iPaTa*i>a" k-aïai>airv Saae_NvhMa()) 31))

sa räja-putro vavådhe

äçu çukla ivoòupaù

äpüryamäëaù pitåbhiù

käñöhäbhir iva so 'nvaham

SYNONYMS

saù—that; *räja-putraù*—the royal prince; *vavådhe*—grew up; *äçu*—very soon; *çukle*—waxing moon; *iva*—like; *uòupaù*—the moon; *äpüryamäëaù*—luxuriantly; *pitåbhiù*—by the parental guardians; *käñöhäbhiù*—plenary development; *iva*—like; *saù*—he; *anvaham*—day after day.

TRANSLATION

As the moon, in its waxing fortnight, develops day after day, so the royal prince [Parékñit] very soon developed luxuriantly under the care and full facilities of his guardian grandfathers.

TEXT 32

Ya+YaMaa<aae_ìMaeDaeNa jaiTad]aehiJahaSaYaa)
raJaal/BDaDaNaee dDYaaENaaNYa}a k-rd<@Yaae")) 32))

yakñyamäëo 'çvamedhena

jñäti-droha-jihäsayä

räjä labdha-dhano dadhyau

nänyatra kara-daëòayòu

SYNONYMS

yakñyamäëaù—desiring to perform; *açvamedhena*—by the horse sacrifice ceremony; *jïäti-droha*—fighting with kinsmen; *jihäsayä*—for getting free; *räjä*—King Yudhiñöhira; *labdha-dhanaù*—for getting some wealth; *dadhyau*—thought about it; *na anyatra*—not otherwise; *kara-daëòayoù*—taxes and fines.

TRANSLATION

Just at this time, King Yudhiñöhira was considering performing a horse sacrifice to get freed from sins incurred from fighting with kinsmen. But he became anxious to get some wealth, for there were no surplus funds outside of fines and tax collection.

PURPORT

As the *brahmanas* and *vipras* had a right to be subsidized by the state, the state executive head had the right to collect taxes and fines from the citizens. After the Battle of Kurukñetra the state treasury was exhausted, and therefore there was no surplus fund except the fund from tax collection and fines. Such funds were sufficient only for the state budget, and having no excess fund, the King was anxious to get more wealth in some other way in order to perform the horse sacrifice. Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira wanted to perform this sacrifice under the instruction of Bhéñmadeva.

TEXT 33

**Tadi>aPa[eTaMaal/+Ya >a]aTarae_CYauTacaeidTaa")
DaNa& Pa[hq<aMaaJah?uâdqCYaa& idiXa >aUirXa")) 33))**

tad abhipretam älakñya

bhrätaro 'cyuta-coditäu

dhanaà prahéëam äjahrur

udécyäà diçi bhüriçaù

SYNONYMS

tat—his; *abhipretam*—wishes of the mind; *älakñya*—observing; *bhrätaraù*—his brothers; *acyuta*—the infallible (Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa); *coditäu*—being advised by; *dhanam*—riches; *prahéëam*—to collect; *äjahruù*—brought about; *udécyäm*—northern; *diçi*—direction; *bhüriçaù*—sufficient.

TRANSLATION

Understanding the hearty wishes of the King, his brothers, as advised by the infallible Lord Kṛṣṇa, collected sufficient riches from the North [left by King Marutta].

PURPORT

Mahārāja Marutta: one of the great emperors of the world. He reigned over the world long before the reign of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. He was the son of Mahārāja Avikñit and was a great devotee of the son of the sun-god, known as Yamarāja. His brother Samvarta was a rival priest of the great Båhaspati, the learned priest of the demigods. He conducted one sacrifice called Saikära-yajña by which the Lord was so satisfied that He was pleased to hand over to him the charge of a mountain peak of gold. This peak of gold is somewhere in the Himalaya Mountains, and modern adventurers may try to find it there. He was so powerful an emperor that at the day's end of sacrifice, the demigods from the other planets like Indra, Candra and Båhaspati used to visit his palace. And because he had the gold peak at his disposal, he had sufficient gold in his possession. The canopy of the sacrificial altar was completely made of gold. In his daily performances of the sacrificial ceremonies, some of the inhabitants of the Väyuloka (airy planets) were invited to expedite the cooking work of the ceremony. And the assembly of the demigods in the ceremony was led by Viçvadeva.

By his constant pious work he was able to drive out all kinds of diseases from the jurisdiction of his kingdom. All the inhabitants of higher planets like Devaloka and Pitåloka were pleased with him for his great sacrificial

ceremonies. Every day he used to give in charity to the learned *brahmanas* such things as beddings, seats, conveyances and sufficient quantities of gold. Because of munificent charities and performances of innumerable sacrifices, the King of heaven, Indradeva, was fully satisfied with him and always wished for his welfare. Due to his pious activities, he remained a young man throughout his life and reigned over the world for one thousand years, surrounded by his satisfied subjects, ministers, legitimate wife, sons and brothers. Even Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa praised his spirit of pious activities. He handed over his only daughter to Maharñi Aḡirä, and by his good blessings, he was elevated to the kingdom of heaven. First of all, he wanted to offer the priesthood of his sacrifices to learned Båhaspati, but the demigod refused to accept the post because of the King's being a human being, a man of this earth. He was very sorry for this, but on the advice of Nārada Muni he appointed Samvarta to the post, and he was successful in his mission.

The success of a particular type of sacrifice completely depends on the priest in charge. In this age, all kinds of sacrifice are forbidden because there is no learned priest amongst the so-called *brahmanas*, who go by the false notion of becoming sons of *brahmanas* without brahminical qualifications. In this age of Kali, therefore, only one kind of sacrifice is recommended, *saikértana-yajña*, as inaugurated by Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu.

TEXT 34

**TaeNa SaM>a*TaSaM>aarae DaMaRPau}aae Yauidaïir")
vaiJaMaeDaEiñi>a>asTaae YajE" SaMaYaJaÖirMa() 34)**

tena sambhāta-sambhāro

dharma-putro yudhiñöhiraù

väjimedhais tribhir bhéto

yajñaiù samayajad dharim

SYNONYMS

tena—with that wealth; *sambhāta*—collected; *sambhāra*—ingredients; *dharma-putra*—the pious king; *yudhiñöhira*—Yudhiñöhira; *vājimedhai*—by horse sacrifices; *tribhi*—three times; *bhéta*—being greatly afraid after the Battle of Kurukñetra; *yajñai*—sacrifices; *samayajat*—perfectly worshiped; *harim*—the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

By those riches, the King could procure the ingredients for three horse sacrifices. Thus the pious King Yudhiñöhira, who was very fearful after the Battle of Kurukñetra, pleased Lord Hari, the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was the ideal and celebrated pious King of the world, and still he was greatly afraid after the execution of the Battle of Kurukñetra because of the mass killing in the fight, all of which was done only to install him on the throne. He therefore took all the responsibility for sins committed in the warfare, and to get rid of all these sins, he wanted to perform three sacrifices in which horses are offered at the altar. Such a sacrifice is very costly. Even Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira had to collect the necessary heaps of gold left by Mahārāja Marutta and the *brahmanas* who were given gold in charity by King Marutta. The learned *brahmanas* could not take away all the loads of gold given by Mahārāja Marutta, and therefore they left behind the major portion of the gift. And Mahārāja Marutta also did not again collect such heaps of gold given away in charity. Besides that, all the golden plates and utensils which were used in the sacrifice were also thrown in the dustbins, and all such heaps of gold remained unclaimed property for a long time, till Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira collected them for his own purposes. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa advised the brothers of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira to collect the unclaimed property because it belonged to the King. The more astonishing thing is that no subject of the state also collected such unclaimed gold for industrial enterprise or anything like that. This means that the state citizens were completely satisfied with all necessities of life and therefore not inclined to accept

unnecessary productive enterprises for sense gratification. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira also requisitioned the heaps of gold for performing sacrifices and for pleasing the Supreme Hari Personality of Godhead. Otherwise he had no desire to collect them for the state treasury.

One should take lessons from the acts of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. He was afraid of sins committed on the battlefield, and therefore he wanted to satisfy the supreme authority. This indicates that unintentional sins are also committed in our daily occupational discharge of duties, and to counteract even such unintentional crimes, one must perform sacrifices as they are recommended in the revealed scriptures. The Lord says in *Bhagavad-gita* (*yajñārthāt karmaṇo 'nyatra loko 'yaà karma-bandhanaù* [Bg. 3.9]) that one must perform sacrifices recommended in the scriptures in order to get rid of commitments of all unauthorized work, or even unintentional crimes which we are apt to commit. By doing so, one shall be freed from all kinds of sins. And those who do not do so but work for self-interest or sense gratification have to undergo all tribulations accrued from committed sins. Therefore, the main purpose of performing sacrifices is to satisfy the Supreme Personality Hari. The process of performing sacrifices may be different in terms of different times, places and persons, but the aim of such sacrifices is one and the same at all times and in all circumstances, *viz.*, satisfaction of the Supreme Lord Hari. That is the way of pious life, and that is the way of peace and prosperity in the world at large. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira did all these as the ideal pious king in the world.

If Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira is a sinner in his daily discharge of duties, in royal administration of state affairs, wherein killing of man and animals is a recognized art, then we can just imagine the amount of sins committed consciously or unconsciously by the untrained population of the Kali-yuga who have no way to perform sacrifice to please the Supreme Lord. The *Bhāgavatam* says, therefore, that the prime duty of the human being is to satisfy the Supreme Lord by the performance of one's occupational duty (*Bhāg.* 1.2.13).

Let any man of any place or community, caste or creed be engaged in any sort of occupational duty, but he must agree to perform sacrifices as it is recommended in the scriptures for the particular place, time and person. In

the Vedic literatures it is recommended that in Kali-yuga people engage in glorifying the Lord by chanting the holy name of Kṛṣṇa (*kértanäd eva kãñëasya mukta-saigaù paraà vrajet*) without offense. By doing so one can be freed from all sins and thus can attain the highest perfection of life by returning home, back to Godhead. We have already discussed this more than once in this great literature in different places, especially in the introductory portion by sketching the life of Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and still we are repeating the same with a view to bring about peace and prosperity in society.

The Lord has declared openly in *Bhagavad-gita* how He becomes pleased with us, and the same process is practically demonstrated in the life and preaching work of Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu. The perfect process of performing *yajñas*, or sacrifice, to please the Supreme Lord Hari (the Personality of Godhead, who gets us free from all miseries of existence) is to follow the ways of Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu in this dark age of quarrel and dissension.

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira had to collect heaps of gold to secure the paraphernalia for the horse sacrifice *yajñas* in days of sufficiency, so we can hardly think of such performance of *yajñas* in these days of insufficiency and complete scarcity of gold. At the present moment we have heaps of papers and promises of their being converted into gold by economic development of modern civilization, and still there is no possibility of spending riches like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, either individually or collectively or by state patronization. Just suitable, therefore, for the age, is the method recommended by Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu in terms of the *çästra*. Such a method requires no expenditure at all and yet can award more benefit than other expensive methods of *yajña* performances.

The horse sacrifice *yajña* or cow sacrifice *yajña* performed by the Vedic regulations shouldn't be misunderstood as a process of killing animals. On the contrary, animals offered for the *yajña* were rejuvenated to a new span of life by the transcendental power of chanting the Vedic hymns, which, if properly chanted, are different from what is understood by the common layman. The *Veda-mantras* are all practical, and the proof is rejuvenation of the sacrificed animal.

There is no possibility of such methodical chanting of the Vedic hymns by the so-called *brahmanas* or priests of the present age. The untrained descendants of the twice-born families are no more like their forefathers, and thus they are counted amongst the *sudras*, or once-born men. The once-born man is unfit to chant the Vedic hymns, and therefore there is no practical utility of chanting the original hymns.

And to save them all, Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu propounded the *saikértana* movement or *yajña* for all practical purposes, and the people of the present age are strongly recommended to follow this sure and recognized path.

TEXT 35

AahUTaae >aGavaNa(raja YaaJaiYaTva iÜJaENa*RPaMa()
ovaSa k-iTaicNMaaSaaNa(Sauôda& iPa[Yak-aMYaYaa)) 35))

āhūto bhagavān rājñā

yājñitvā dvijair nāpam

uvāsa katicin māsān

suhādā priya-kāmyayā

SYNONYMS

āhūta—being called by; *bhagavān*—Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead; *rājñā*—by the King; *yājñitvā*—causing to be performed; *dvijai*—by the learned *brahmanas*; *nāpam*—on behalf of the King; *uvāsa*—resided; *katicit*—a few; *māsān*—months; *suhādā*—for the sake of the relatives; *priya-kāmyayā*—for the pleasure.

TRANSLATION

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, being invited to the sacrifices by Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, saw to it that they were performed by qualified

[twice-born] brahmanas. After that, for the pleasure of the relatives, the Lord remained a few months.

PURPORT

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa was invited by Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira to look into the supervision of the performances of *yajña*, and the Lord, to abide by the orders of His elderly cousin, caused the performance of *yajñas* by learned twice-born *brahmanas*. Simply taking birth in the family of a *brahmana* does not make one qualified to perform *yajñas*. One must be twice-born by proper training and initiation from the bona fide *ācārya*. The once-born scions of *brahmana* families are equal with the once-born *sudras*, and such *brahma-bandhus*, or unqualified once-born scions, must be rejected for any purpose of religious or Vedic function. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa was entrusted to look after this arrangement, and perfect as He is, He caused the *yajñas* to be performed by the bona fide twice-born *brahmanas* for successful execution.

TEXT 36

TaTaae raja>YaNaujaTa" k*-Z<aYaa Sah bNDaui>a")
YaYaaE ÜarvTaq& b]øNa(SaaJauRNaae Yadui>av*RTa")) 36))

tato räjäabhyanujiätà

kãñëayä saha-bandhubhiù

yayau dvāravatēà brahman

sārijuno yadubhir vātà

SYNONYMS

tatà—thereafter; *räjä*—by the King; *abhyanujiätà*—being permitted; *kãñëayä*—as well as by Draupadé; *saha*—along with; *bandhubhiù*—other relatives; *yayau*—went to; *dvāravatém*—Dvārakādhāma; *brahman*—O *brahmanas*; *sa-arjuna*—along with Arjuna; *yadubhiù*—by the members of

the Yadu dynasty; *vātaù*—surrounded.

TRANSLATION

O Çaunaka, thereafter the Lord, having bade farewell to King Yudhiñöhira, Draupadé and other relatives, started for the city of Dvārakā, accompanied by Arjuna and other members of the Yadu dynasty.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Twelfth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled “Birth of Emperor Parékñit.”

Chapter Thirteen

Dhātarāñöra Quits Home

TEXT 1

SaUTa ovac

ivdurSTaqQaRYaa}aaYaa& MaE}aeYaadaTMaNaae GaiTaMa()
jaTvaGaaÖaiSTaNaPaur& TaYaavaáiviviTSaTa")) 1))

sūta uvāca

viduras tērtha-yātrāyāà

maitreyād ātmano gatim

jīātvägād dhāstinapuraà

tayāvāpta-vivitsitaù

SYNONYMS

sūtaù uvāca—Sri Sūta Gosvami said; *viduraù*—Vidura; *tērtha-yātrāyām*—while traveling to different places of pilgrimage; *maitreyāt*—from the great sage Maitreya; *ātmanaù*—of the self; *gatim*—destination; *jīātvā*—by

knowing it; *ägät*—went back; *hästinapuram*—the city of Hastināpura; *tayä*—by that knowledge; *aväpta*—sufficiently a gainer; *vivitsitaù*—being well versed in everything knowable.

TRANSLATION

Sri Sūta Gosvami said: While traveling on a pilgrimage, Vidura received knowledge of the destination of the self from the great sage Maitreya and then returned to Hastināpura. He became as well versed in the subject as he desired.

PURPORT

Vidura: One of the prominent figures in the history of the *Mahābhārata*. He was conceived by Vyāsadeva in the womb of the maidservant of Ambikā, mother of Mahārāja Pāṇḍu. He is the incarnation of Yamarāja. Being cursed by Mañdhātā Muni, he was to become a *çūdra*. The story is narrated as follows. Once upon a time the state police caught some thieves who had concealed themselves in the hermitage of Mañdhātā Muni. The police constables, as usual, arrested all the thieves and Mañdhātā Muni along with them. The magistrate specifically punished the *muni* to death by being pierced with a lance. When he was just to be pierced, the news reached the king, and he at once stopped the act on consideration of his being a great *muni*. The king personally begged the *muni*'s pardon for the mistake of his men, and the saint at once went to Yamarāja, who prescribes the destiny of the living beings. Yamarāja, being questioned by the *muni*, replied that the *muni* in his childhood pierced an ant with a sharpened straw, and for that reason he was put into difficulty. The *muni* thought it unwise on the part of Yamarāja that he was punished for his childish innocence, and thus the *muni* cursed Yamarāja to become a *çūdra*, and this *çūdra* incarnation of Yamarāja was known as Vidura, the *çūdra* brother of Dhātārāṇḍra and Mahārāja Pāṇḍu. But this *çūdra* son of the Kuru dynasty was equally treated by Bhīṣmadeva, along with his other nephews, and in due course Vidura was married with a girl who was also born in the womb of a *çūdrāṇḍ* by a *brahmana*. Although Vidura did not inherit the property of his father (the brother of Bhīṣmadeva), still he was given sufficient state property by Dhātārāṇḍra, the elder brother of Vidura. Vidura was very much attached

to his elder brother, and all along he tried to guide him on the right path. During the fratricidal war of Kurukñetra, Vidura repeatedly implored his elder brother to do justice to the sons of Pääòu, but Duryodhana did not like such interference by his uncle, and thus he practically insulted Vidura. This resulted in Vidura's leaving home for pilgrimage and taking instructions from Maitreya.

TEXT 2

**YaavTa" k*-TavaNa(Pa[énaNa(+ataa k-aEzarvaGa]Ta")
JaaTaEk->aiç-GaaeRivNde Tae>YaêaeParraMa h)) 2))**

yävataù kâtavän praçñän

kñattä kauñäravägrataù

jätaika-bhaktir govinde

tebhyaç copararäma ha

SYNONYMS

yävataù—all that; *kâtavän*—did he put; *praçñän*—questions; *kñattä*—a name of Vidura; *kauñärava*—a name of Maitreya; *agrataù*—in the presence of; *jäta*—having grown up; *eka*—one; *bhaktiù*—transcendental loving service; *govinde*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; *tebhyaù*—regarding further questions; *ca*—and; *upararäma*—retired from; *ha*—in the past.

TRANSLATION

After asking various questions and becoming established in the transcendental loving service of Lord Kṛṣṇa, Vidura retired from putting questions to Maitreya Muni.

PURPORT

Vidura retired from putting questions before Maitreya Muni when he was

convinced by Maitreya Rsi that the *summum bonum* of life is to be finally situated in the transcendental loving service of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, who is Govinda, or one who satisfies His devotees in all respects. The conditioned soul, the living being in material existence, seeks happiness by employing his senses in the modes of materialism, but that cannot give him satisfaction. He then searches after the Supreme Truth by the empiric philosophic speculative method and intellectual feats. But if he does not find the ultimate goal, he again goes down to material activities and engages himself in various philanthropic and altruistic works, which all fail to give him satisfaction. So neither fruitive activities nor dry philosophical speculation can give one satisfaction because by nature a living being is the eternal servitor of the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and all the Vedic literatures give him direction towards that ultimate end. The ***Bhagavad-gita*** (15.15) confirms this statement.

Like Vidura, an inquisitive conditioned soul must approach a bona fide spiritual master like Maitreya and by intelligent inquiries must try to know everything about *karma* (fruitive activities), *jñāna* (philosophical research for the Supreme Truth) and *yoga* (the linking process of spiritual realization). One who is not seriously inclined to put questions before a spiritual master need not accommodate a show-bottle spiritual master, nor should a person who may be a spiritual master for others pose to be so if he is unable to engage his disciple ultimately in the transcendental loving service of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. Vidura was successful in approaching such a spiritual master like Maitreya, and he got the ultimate goal of life: *bhakti* unto Govinda. Thus there was nothing to be known further about spiritual progress.

TEXTS 3–4

Ta& bNDauMaaGaTa& d*îa DaMaRPau}a" SahaNauJa")
 Da*Taraí\ae YauYauTSauê SaUTa" XaarÜTa" Pa*Qaa)) 3))
 GaaN Daarq d]aEPadq b]øNa(Sau>ad]a caetara k*-Paq)
 ANYaaê JaaMaYa" Paa<@aejaRTaYa" SaSauTaa" iñYa")) 4))

taà bandhum ägataà dāñvā

dharmā-putrāu sahānujau

dhātārāññōro yuyutsuḥ ca

sūtau çāradvatau pāthā

gāndhārē draupadē brahman

subhadrā cottarā kâpé

anyāḥ ca jāmayaū pāḍōor

jīātayaū sasutāu striyaū

SYNONYMS

tam—him; *bandhum*—relative; *āgatam*—having arrived there; *dāññōvā*—by seeing it; *dharmā-putrāu*—Yudhiññōhira; *sahā-anujau*—along with his younger brothers; *dhātārāññōra*—Dhātārāññōra; *yuyutsu*—Sātyaki; *ca*—and; *sūta*—Saijaya; *çāradvata*—Kāpācārya; *pāthā*—Kunté; *gāndhārē*—Gāndhārē; *draupadē*—Draupadé; *brahman*—O *brahmanas*; *subhadrā*—Subhadrā; *ca*—and; *uttarā*—Uttarā; *kâpé*—Kâpé; *anyāu*—others; *ca*—and; *jāmaya*—wives of other family members; *pāḍōou*—of the Pāḍōavas; *jīātaya*—family members; *sa-sutāu*—along with their sons; *striya*—the ladies.

TRANSLATION

When they saw Vidura return to the palace, all the inhabitants—Mahārāja Yudhiññōhira, his younger brothers, Dhātārāññōra, Sātyaki, Saijaya, Kāpācārya, Kunté, Gāndhārē, Draupadé, Subhadrā, Uttarā, Kâpé, many other wives of the Kauravas, and other ladies with children—all hurried to him in great delight. It so appeared that they had regained their consciousness after a long period.

PURPORT

Gāndhārē: The ideal chaste lady in the history of the world. She was the daughter of Mahārāja Subala, the King of Gāndhāra (now Kandahar in Kabul), and in her maiden state she worshiped Lord Siva. Lord Siva is generally worshiped by Hindu maidens to get a good husband. Gāndhārē satisfied Lord Siva, and by his benediction to obtain one hundred sons, she was betrothed to Dhātārāññōra, despite his being blind forever. When Gāndhārē came to know that her would-be husband was a blind man, to follow her life companion she decided to become voluntarily blind. So she wrapped up her eyes with many silk linens, and she was married to Dhātārāññōra under the guidance of her elder brother Çakuni. She was the most beautiful girl of her time, and she was equally qualified by her womanly qualities, which endeared every member of the Kaurava court. But despite all her good qualities, she had the natural frailties of a woman, and she was envious of Kunté when the latter gave birth to a male child. Both the queens were pregnant, but Kunté first gave birth to a male child. Thus Gāndhārē became angry and gave a blow to her own abdomen. As a result, she gave birth to a lump of flesh only, but since she was a devotee of Vyāsadeva, by the instruction of Vyāsadeva the lump was divided into one hundred parts, and each part gradually developed to become a male child. Thus her ambition to become the mother of one hundred sons was fulfilled, and she began to nourish all the children according to her exalted position. When the intrigue of the Battle of Kurukñetra was going on, she was not in favor of fighting with the Pāṇḍavas; rather, she blamed Dhātārāññōra, her husband, for such a fratricidal war. She desired that the state be divided into two parts, for the sons of Pāṇḍu and her own. She was very affected when all her sons died in the Battle of Kurukñetra, and she wanted to curse Bhémasena and Yudhiñöhira, but she was checked by Vyāsadeva. Her mourning over the death of Duryodhana and Duçāsana before Lord Kṛṣṇa was very pitiful, and Lord Kṛṣṇa pacified her by transcendental messages. She was equally aggrieved on the death of Karēa, and she described to Lord Kṛṣṇa the lamentation of Karēa's wife. She was pacified by Srila Vyāsadeva when he showed her dead sons, then promoted to the heavenly kingdoms. She died along with her husband in the jungles of the Himalayas near the mouth of the Ganges; she burned in a forest fire. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira performed the death ceremony of his uncle and aunt.

Pāthā: Daughter of Mahārāja Çūrasena and sister of Vasudeva, Lord Kṛṣṇa's

father. Later she was adopted by Mahārāja Kuntibhoja, and hence she is known as Kunté. She is the incarnation of the success potency of the Personality of Godhead. The heavenly denizens from the upper planets used to visit the palace of King Kuntibhoja, and Kunté was engaged for their reception. She also served the great mystic sage Durvāsā, and being satisfied by her faithful service, Durvāsā Muni gave her a *mantra* by which it was possible for her to call for any demigod she pleased. As a matter of inquisitiveness, she at once called for the sun-god, who desired couplement with her, but she declined. But the sun-god assured her immunity from virgin adulteration, and so she agreed to his proposal. As a result of this couplement, she became pregnant, and Karēa was born by her. By the grace of the sun, she again turned into a virgin girl, but being afraid of her parents, she quitted the newly born child, Karēa. After that, when she actually selected her own husband, she preferred Pääòu to be her husband. Mahārāja Pääòu later wanted to retire from family life and adopt the renounced order of life. Kunté refused to allow her husband to adopt such life, but at last Mahārāja Pääòu gave her permission to become a mother of sons by calling some other suitable personalities. Kunté did not accept this proposal at first, but when vivid examples were set by Pääòu she agreed. Thus by dint of the *mantra* awarded by Durvāsā Muni she called for Dharmarāja, and thus Yudhiñöhira was born. She called for the demigod Väyu (air), and thus Bhéma was born. She called for Indra, the King of heaven, and thus Arjuna was born. The other two sons, namely Nakula and Sahadeva, were begotten by Pääòu himself in the womb of Mädre. Later on, Mahārāja Pääòu died at an early age, for which Kunté was so aggrieved that she fainted. Two co-wives, namely Kunté and Mädre, decided that Kunté should live for the maintenance of the five minor children, the Pääòavas, and Mädre should accept the *saté* rituals by meeting voluntary death along with her husband. This agreement was endorsed by great sages like Çatasāiga and others present on the occasion.

Later on, when the Pääòavas were banished from the kingdom by the intrigues of Duryodhana, Kunté followed her sons, and she equally faced all sorts of difficulties during those days. During the forest life one demon girl, Hiòimbä, wanted Bhéma as her husband. Bhéma refused, but when the girl approached Kunté and Yudhiñöhira, they ordered Bhéma to accept her proposal and give her a son. As a result of this combination, Ghaöotkaca

was born, and he fought very valiantly with his father against the Kauravas. In their forest life they lived with a *brahmana* family that was in trouble because of one Bakāsura demon, and Kunté ordered Bhéma to kill the Bakāsura to protect the *brahmana* family against troubles created by the demon. She advised Yudhiñöhira to start for the Päicäladeça. Draupadé was gained in this Päicäladeça by Arjuna, but by order of Kunté all five of the Päëòava brothers became equally the husbands of Päicälé, or Draupadé. She was married with five Päëòavas in the presence of Vyäsadeva. Kuntédevé never forgot her first child, Karëa, and after Karëa’s death in the Battle of Kurukñetra she lamented and admitted before her other sons that Karëa was her eldest son prior to her marriage with Mahäräja Päëòu. Her prayers for the Lord after the Battle of Kurukñetra, when Lord Kṛṣṇa was going back home, are excellently explained. Later she went to the forest with Gändhäré for severe penance. She used to take meals after each thirty days. She finally sat down in profound meditation and later burned to ashes in a forest fire.

Draupadé: The most chaste daughter of Mahäräja Drupada and partly an incarnation of goddess Çacé, the wife of Indra. Mahäräja Drupada performed a great sacrifice under the superintendence of the sage Yaja. By his first offering, Dhåñöadyumna was born, and by the second offering, Draupadé was born. She is therefore the sister of Dhåñöadyumna, and she is also named Päicälé. The five Päëòavas married her as a common wife, and each of them begot a son in her. Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira begot a son named Pratibhit, Bhémasena begot a son named Sutasoma, Arjuna begot Çrutakérti, Nakula begot Çatänéka, and Sahadeva begot Çrutakarmä. She is described as a most beautiful lady, equal to her mother-in-law, Kunté. During her birth there was an aeromessage that she should be called Kåñëä. The same message also declared that she was born to kill many a *kñatriya*. By dint of her blessings from Çaikara, she was awarded five husbands, equally qualified. When she preferred to select her own husband, princes and kings were invited from all the countries of the world. She was married with the Päëòavas during their exile in the forest, but when they went back home Mahäräja Drupada gave them immense wealth as a dowry. She was well received by all the daughters-in-law of Dhåtaråñöra. When she was lost in a gambling game, she was forcibly dragged into the assembly hall, and an attempt was made by Duùçäsana to

see her naked beauty, even though there were elderly persons like Bhéñma and Droëa present. She was a great devotee of Lord Kṛṣṇa, and by her praying, the Lord Himself became an unlimited garment to save her from the insult. A demon of the name Jaöäsurä kidnapped her, but her second husband, Bhémasena, killed the demon and saved her. She saved the Pääòavas from the curse of Maharñi Durväsä by the grace of Lord Kṛṣṇa. When the Pääòavas lived incognito in the palace of Viräöa, Kécaka was attracted by her exquisite beauty, and by arrangement with Bhéma the devil was killed and she was saved. She was very much aggrieved when her five sons were killed by Açvatthämä. At the last stage, she accompanied her husband Yudhiñöhira and others and fell on the way. The cause of her falling was explained by Yudhiñöhira, but when Yudhiñöhira entered the heavenly planet he saw Draupadé gloriously present there as the goddess of fortune in the heavenly planet.

Subhadrä: Daughter of Vasudeva and sister of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. She was not only a very dear daughter of Vasudeva, but also a very dear sister to both Kṛṣṇa and Baladeva. The two brothers and sister are represented in the famous Jagannätha temple of Puré, and the temple is still visited by thousands of pilgrims daily. This temple is in remembrance of the Lord's visit at Kurukñetra during an occasion of solar eclipse and His subsequent meeting with the residents of Vändävana. The meeting of Rädhä and Kṛṣṇa during this occasion is a very pathetic story, and Lord Sri Caitanya, in the ecstasy of Rädhäräëé, always pined for Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa at Jagannätha Puré. While Arjuna was at Dvärakä, he wanted to have Subhadrä as his queen, and he expressed his desire to Lord Kṛṣṇa. Sri Kṛṣṇa knew that His elder brother, Lord Baladeva, was arranging her marriage elsewhere, and since He did not dare to go against the arrangement of Baladeva, He advised Arjuna to kidnap Subhadrä. So when all of them were on a pleasure trip on the Raivata Hill, Arjuna managed to kidnap Subhadrä according to the plan of Sri Kṛṣṇa. Sri Baladeva was very angry at Arjuna, and He wanted to kill him, but Lord Kṛṣṇa implored His brother to excuse Arjuna. Then Subhadrä was duly married with Arjuna, and Abhimanyu was born of Subhadrä. At the premature death of Abhimanyu, Subhadrä was very mortified, but on the birth of Parékñit she was happy and solaced.

TEXT 5

Pa[TYauÂGMau" Pa[hzeR<a Pa[a<a& TaNv wvaGaTaMa()
Ai>aSa®MYa iviDavTa(PairZv®ai>avadNaE")) 5))

pratyujjagmuù praharñeëa

präëaà tanva ivägatam

abhisaigamya vidhivat

pariñvaigäbhivädanaiù

SYNONYMS

prati—towards; *ujjagmuù*—went; *praharñeëa*—with great delight; *präëam*—life; *tanvaù*—of the body; *iva*—like; *ägatam*—returned; *abhisaigamya*—approaching; *vidhi-vat*—in due form; *pariñvaiga*—embracing; *abhivädanaiù*—by obeisances.

TRANSLATION

With great delight they all approached him, as if life had returned to their bodies. They exchanged obeisances and welcomed each other with embraces.

PURPORT

In the absence of consciousness, the limbs of the body remain inactive. But when consciousness returns, the limbs and senses become active, and existence itself becomes delightful. Vidura was so dear to the members of the Kaurava family that his long absence from the palace was comparable to inactivity. All of them were feeling acute separation from Vidura, and therefore his return to the palace was joyful for all.

TEXT 6

MauMaucu" Pa[eMabaZPaaEga& ivrhaETk-<#yk-aTara")
raJaa TaMahRYaa& c§e- k*-TaaSaNaPairGa]hMa()) 6))

mumucuù prema-bāñpaughaà

virahautkaëöhya-kātaräù

rājā tam arhayäà cakre

kātāsana-parigraham

SYNONYMS

mumucuù—emanated; *prema*—affectionate; *bāñpa-ogham*—emotional tears; *viraha*—separation; *autkaëöhya*—anxiousness; *kātaräù*—being aggrieved; *rājā*—King Yudhiñöhira; *tam*—unto him (Vidura); *arhayäm cakre*—offered; *kāta*—performance of; *āsana*—sitting accommodations; *parigraham*—arrangement of.

TRANSLATION

Due to anxieties and long separation, they all cried out of affection. King Yudhiñöhira then arranged to offer sitting accommodations and a reception.

TEXT 7

**Ta& >auÇ-vNTa& ivé[aNTaMaaSaqNa& Sau%MaaSaNae)
Pa[é[YaavNaTaae raJaa Pa[ah Taeza& c é*<vTaaMa()) 7))**

taà bhuktavantaà viçrāntam

äsénaà sukham āsane

praçrayāvanato rājā

prāha teñäà ca çäëvatām

SYNONYMS

tam—him (Vidura); *bhuktavantam*—after feeding him sumptuously; *viçrāntam*—and having taken rest; *äsénam*—being seated; *sukham äsane*—on a comfortable seat; *praçraya-avanatau*—naturally very gentle and meek; *rājā*—King Yudhiñöhira; *prāha*—began to speak; *teñām ca*—and by them; *çāëvatām*—being heard.

TRANSLATION

After Vidura ate sumptuously and took sufficient rest, he was comfortably seated. Then the King began to speak to him, and all who were present there listened.

PURPORT

King Yudhiñöhira was expert in reception also, even in the case of his family members. Vidura was well received by all the family members by exchange of embraces and obeisances. After that, bathing and arrangements for a sumptuous dinner were made, and then he was given sufficient rest. After finishing his rest, he was offered a comfortable place to sit, and then the King began to talk about all happenings, both family and otherwise. That is the proper way to receive a beloved friend, or even an enemy. According to Indian moral codes, even an enemy received at home should be so well received that he will not feel any fearful situation. An enemy is always afraid of his enemy, but this should not be so when he is received at home by his enemy. This means that a person, when received at home, should be treated as a relative, so what to speak of a family member like Vidura, who was a well-wisher for all the members of the family. Thus Yudhiñöhira Mahārāja began to speak in the presence of all the other members.

TEXT 8

YauIDaiir ovac

AiPa SMarQa Naae YauZMaTPa+aC^aYaaSaMaeiDaTaaNa()
ivPaÓ<aaiÜzaGNYaadeMaaeRicTaa YaTSaMaaTa*k-a")) 8))

yudhiñöhira uvāca

api smaratha no yuñmat-

pakña-cchäyā-samedhitān

vipad-gaëäd viñägyäder

mocitā yat samätåkäu

SYNONYMS

yudhiñöhiraù uvāca—Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira said; *api*—whether; *smaratha*—you remember; *naù*—us; *yuñmat*—from you; *pakña*—partiality towards us like the wings of a bird; *chäyā*—protection; *samedhitān*—we who were brought up by you; *vipat-gaëät*—from various types of calamities; *viña*—by administration of poison; *agni-ädeù*—by setting on fire; *mocitäu*—released from; *yat*—what you have done; *sa*—along with; *mätåkäu*—our mother.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira said: My uncle, do you remember how you always protected us, along with our mother, from all sorts of calamities? Your partiality, like the wings of a bird, saved us from poisoning and arson.

PURPORT

Due to Pääòu’s death at an early age, his minor children and widow were the object of special care by all the elderly members of the family, especially Bhéñmadeva and Mahātmä Vidura. Vidura was more or less partial to the Pääòavas due to their political position. Although Dhåtaräñöra was equally careful for the minor children of Mahārāja Pääòu, he was one of the intriguing parties who wanted to wash away the descendants of Pääòu and replace them by raising his own sons to become the rulers of the kingdom. Mahātmä Vidura could follow this intrigue of Dhåtaräñöra and company, and therefore, even though he was a faithful servitor of his eldest brother, Dhåtaräñöra, he did not like his political ambition for the sake of his own sons. He was therefore very careful about

the protection of the Pääòavas and their widow mother. Thus he was, so to speak, partial to the Pääòavas, preferring them to the sons of Dhåtaråñöra, although both of them were equally affectionate in his ordinary eyes. He was equally affectionate to both the camps of nephews in the sense that he always chastised Duryodhana for his intriguing policy against his cousins. He always criticized his elder brother for his policy of encouragement to his sons, and at the same time he was always alert in giving special protection to the Pääòavas. All these different activities of Vidura within the palace politics made him well-known as partial to the Pääòavas. Mahåräja Yudhiñöhira has referred to the past history of Vidura before his going away from home for a prolonged pilgrim's journey. Mahåräja Yudhiñöhira reminded him that he was equally kind and partial to his grown-up nephews, even after the Battle of Kurukñetra, a great family disaster.

Before the Battle of Kurukñetra, Dhåtaråñöra's policy was peaceful annihilation of his nephews, and therefore he ordered Purocana to build a house at Våraävata, and when the building was finished Dhåtaråñöra desired that his brother's family live there for some time. When the Pääòavas were going there in the presence of all the members of the royal family, Vidura tactfully gave instructions to the Pääòavas about the future plan of Dhåtaråñöra. This is specifically described in the *Mahåbhårata (Ådi-parva 114)*. He indirectly hinted, "A weapon not made of steel or any other material element can be more than sharp to kill an enemy, and he who knows this is never killed." That is to say, he hinted that the party of the Pääòavas was being sent to Våraävata to be killed, and thus he warned Yudhiñöhira to be very careful in their new residential palace. He also gave indications of fire and said that fire cannot extinguish the soul but can annihilate the material body. But one who protects the soul can live. Kunté could not follow such indirect conversations between Mahåräja Yudhiñöhira and Vidura, and thus when she inquired from her son about the purport of the conversation, Yudhiñöhira replied that from the talks of Vidura it was understood that there was a hint of fire in the house where they were proceeding. Later on, Vidura came in disguise to the Pääòavas and informed them that the housekeeper was going to set fire to the house on the fourteenth night of the waning moon. It was an intrigue of Dhåtaråñöra that the Pääòavas might die all together with their mother. And by his warning the Pääòavas escaped through a tunnel underneath the

earth so that their escape was also unknown to Dhåtaråñöra, so much so that after setting the fire, the Kauravas were so certain of the death of the Pääòavas that Dhåtaråñöra performed the last rites of death with great cheerfulness. And during the mourning period all the members of the palace became overwhelmed with lamentation, but Vidura did not become so, because of his knowledge that the Pääòavas were alive somewhere. There are many such instances of calamities, and in each of them Vidura gave protection to the Pääòavas on one hand, and on the other he tried to restrain his brother Dhåtaråñöra from such intriguing policies. Therefore, he was always partial to the Pääòavas, just as a bird protects its eggs by its wing.

TEXT 9

k-Yaa v*tYaa viTaRTa& vêriÙ" i+aiTaMa<@I/Ma()
TaqQaaRiNa +ae}aMau:YaaiNa SaeivTaaNaqh >aUTale/)) 9))

kayä våtтыä vartitaà vaç

caradbhiù kñiti-maëòalam

térthäni kñetra-mukhyäni

sevitänéha bhütale

SYNONYMS

kayä—by which; *våtтыä*—means; *vartitam*—maintained your livelihood; *vaù*—your good self; *caradbhiù*—while traveling; *kñiti-maëòalam*—on the surface of the earth; *térthäni*—places of pilgrimage; *kñetra-mukhyäni*—the principal holy places; *sevitäni*—served by you; *iha*—in this world; *bhütale*—on this planet.

TRANSLATION

While traveling on the surface of the earth, how did you maintain your livelihood? At which holy places and pilgrimage sites did you render

service?

PURPORT

Vidura went out from the palace to detach himself from household affairs, especially political intrigues. As referred to hereinbefore, he was practically insulted by Duryodhana's calling him a son of a *çüdräëé*, although it was not out of place to talk loosely in the case of one's grandmother. Vidura's mother, although a *çüdräëé*, was the grandmother of Duryodhana, and funny talks are sometimes allowed between grandmother and grandchildren. But because the remark was an actual fact, it was unpalatable talk to Vidura, and it was accepted as a direct insult. He therefore decided to quit his paternal house and prepare for the renounced order of life. This preparatory stage is called *vānaprastha-āçrama*, or retired life for traveling and visiting the holy places on the surface of the earth. In the holy places of India, like Våndävana, Hardwar, Jagannätha Puré, and Prayäga, there are many great devotees, and there are still free kitchen houses for persons who desire to advance spiritually. Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira was inquisitive to learn whether Vidura maintained himself by the mercy of the free kitchen houses (*chatras*).

TEXT 10

>aviÜDaa >aaGavTaaSTaqQaR>aUTaa" SvYa& iv>aae)
TaqQasku-vRiNTa TaqQaaRiNa SvaNTa"SQaeNa Gada>a*Taa)) 10))

bhavat-vidhä bhägavatäs

tértha-bhütäù svayaà vibho

térthé-kurvanti térthäni

sväntaù-sthena gadäbhâtä

SYNONYMS

bhavat—your good self; *vidhäù*—like; *bhägavatäù*—devotees; *tértha*—the

holy places of pilgrimage; *bhütäù*—converted into; *svayam*—personally; *vibho*—O powerful one; *térthé-kurvanti*—make into a holy place of pilgrimage; *térthäni*—the holy places; *sva-antaù-sthena*—having been situated in the heart; *gadä-bhätä*—the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

My Lord, devotees like your good self are verily holy places personified. Because you carry the Personality of Godhead within your heart, you turn all places into places of pilgrimage.

PURPORT

The Personality of Godhead is omnipresent by His diverse potencies everywhere, just as the power of electricity is distributed everywhere within space. Similarly, the Lord's omnipresence is perceived and manifested by His unalloyed devotees like Vidura, just as electricity is manifested in an electric bulb. A pure devotee like Vidura always feels the presence of the Lord everywhere. He sees everything in the potency of the Lord and the Lord in everything. The holy places all over the earth are meant for purifying the polluted consciousness of the human being by an atmosphere surcharged with the presence of the Lord's unalloyed devotees. If anyone visits a holy place, he must search out the pure devotees residing in such holy places, take lessons from them, try to apply such instructions in practical life and thus gradually prepare oneself for the ultimate salvation, going back to Godhead. To go to some holy place of pilgrimage does not mean only to take a bath in the Ganges or Yamunä or to visit the temples situated in those places. One should also find representatives of Vidura who have no desire in life save and except to serve the Personality of Godhead. The Personality of Godhead is always with such pure devotees because of their unalloyed service, which is without any tinge of fruitive action or utopian speculation. They are in the actual service of the Lord, specifically by the process of hearing and chanting. The pure devotees hear from the authorities and chant, sing and write of the glories of the Lord. Mahämuni Vyäsadeva heard from Nārada, and then he chanted in writing; Çukadeva Gosvami studied from his father, and he described it to Parékñit; that is the way of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. So

by their actions the pure devotees of the Lord can render any place into a place of pilgrimage, and the holy places are worth the name only on their account. Such pure devotees are able to rectify the polluted atmosphere of any place, and what to speak of a holy place rendered unholy by the questionable actions of interested persons who try to adopt a professional life at the cost of the reputation of a holy place.

TEXT 11

**AiPa Na" SauôdSTaaTa baNDava" k*-Z<adevTaa")
d*ía" é[uTaa va Yadv" SvPauYaa| Sau%MaaSaTae)) 11))**

api naù suhâdas tâta

bândhaväù kâñëa-devatäù

dâñöäù çrutä vä yadavaù

sva-puryäà sukham äsate

SYNONYMS

api—whether; *naù*—our; *suhâdaù*—well-wishers; *tâta*—O my uncle; *bândhaväù*—friends; *kâñëa-devatäù*—those who are always rapt in the service of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *dâñöäù*—by seeing them; *çrutäù*—or by hearing about them; *vä*—either; *yadavaù*—the descendants of Yadu; *sva-puryäm*—along with their residential place; *sukham äsate*—if they are all happy.

TRANSLATION

My uncle, you must have visited Dvārakā. In that holy place are our friends and well-wishers, the descendants of Yadu, who are always rapt in the service of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. You might have seen them or heard about them. Are they all living happily in their abodes?

PURPORT

The particular word *kāñḍa-devatā*, i.e., those who are always rapt in the service of Lord Kṛṣṇa, is significant. The Yādavas and the Pāṇḍavas, who were always rapt in the thought of the Lord Kṛṣṇa and His different transcendental activities, were all pure devotees of the Lord like Vidura. Vidura left home in order to devote himself completely to the service of the Lord, but the Pāṇḍavas and the Yādavas were always rapt in the thought of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Thus there is no difference in their pure devotional qualities. Either remaining at home or leaving home, the real qualification of a pure devotee is to become rapt in the thought of Kṛṣṇa favorably, i.e., knowing well that Lord Kṛṣṇa is the Absolute Personality of Godhead. Kaśa, Jarāsandha, Çiçupāla and other demons like them were also always rapt in the thought of Lord Kṛṣṇa, but they were absorbed in a different way, namely unfavorably, or thinking Him to be a powerful man only. Therefore, Kaśa and Çiçupāla are not on the same level as pure devotees like Vidura, the Pāṇḍavas and the Yādavas.

Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira was also always rapt in the thought of Lord Kṛṣṇa and His associates at Dvārakā. Otherwise he could not have asked all about them from Vidura. Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira was therefore on the same level of devotion as Vidura, although engaged in the state affairs of the kingdom of the world.

TEXT 12

**wTYauç-ae DaMaRraJaeNa Sav | TaTa(SaMav<aRYaTa()
YaQaaNau>aUTa& §-MaXaae ivNaa Yaduku-l/+aYaMa()) 12))**

ity ukto dharma-rājena

sarvā tat samavarēayat

yathānubhūta kramaṇo

vinā yadu-kula-kñayam

SYNONYMS

iti—thus; *ukta*—being asked; *dharma-rājena*—by King Yudhiñöhira; *sarvam*—all; *tat*—that; *samavarēayat*—properly described; *yathā-anubhūtam*—as he experienced; *kramaça*—one after another; *vinā*—without; *yadu-kula-kñayam*—annihilation of the Yadu dynasty.

TRANSLATION

Thus being questioned by Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, Mahātmā Vidura gradually described everything he had personally experienced, except news of the annihilation of the Yadu dynasty.

TEXT 13

NaNviPa[Ya& duivRzh& Na*<aa& SvYaMauPaiSQaTaMa()
NaavedYaTa(Sak-å<aae du"i%TaaNa(d]íuMa+aMa")) 13))

nanv apriyā durviñahā

nāëā svayam upasthitam

nāvedayat sakaruëo

duùkhitān drañöum akñamaù

SYNONYMS

nanu—as a matter of fact; *apriyam*—unpalatable; *durviñaham*—unbearable; *nāëām*—of humankind; *svayam*—in its own way; *upasthitam*—appearance; *na*—did not; *āvedayat*—expressed; *sakaruëa*—compassionate; *duùkhitān*—distressed; *drañöum*—to see; *akñamaù*—unable.

TRANSLATION

Compassionate Mahātmā Vidura could not stand to see the Pāëòavas distressed at any time. Therefore he did not disclose this unpalatable and unbearable incident because calamities come of their own accord.

PURPORT

According to *Néti-çästra* (civic laws) one should not speak an unpalatable truth to cause distress to others. Distress comes upon us in its own way by the laws of nature, so one should not aggravate it by propaganda. For a compassionate soul like Vidura, especially in his dealings with the beloved Pääòavas, it was almost impossible to disclose an unpalatable piece of news like the annihilation of the Yadu dynasty. Therefore he purposely refrained from it.

TEXT 14

k-iÄTk-al/MaQaavaTSaqTSaTk*-Taae devvTSau%Ma()
>a]aTauJYaeRiSYa é[eYaSk*-TSaveRza& Sau%MaavhNa()) 14))

kaicit kalam athävätsét

sat-kâto devavat sukham

bhrätur jyeñöhasya çreyas-kât

sarveñää sukham ävahan

SYNONYMS

kaicit—for a few days; *kalam*—time; *atha*—thus; *avätsét*—resided; *sat-kâtaù*—being well treated; *deva-vat*—just like a godly personality; *sukham*—amenities; *bhrätuù*—of the brother; *jyeñöhasya*—of the elder; *çreyaù-kât*—for doing good to him; *sarveñäm*—all others; *sukham*—happiness; *ävahan*—made it possible.

TRANSLATION

Thus Mahätmä Vidura, being treated just like a godly person by his kinsmen, remained there for a certain period just to rectify the mentality of his eldest brother and in this way bring happiness to all the others.

PURPORT

Saintly persons like Vidura must be treated as well as a denizen from heaven. In those days denizens of heavenly planets used to visit homes like that of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, and sometimes persons like Arjuna and others used to visit higher planets. Nārada is a spaceman who can travel unrestrictedly, not only within the material universes but also in the spiritual universes. Even Nārada used to visit the palace of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira and what to speak of other celestial demigods. It is only the spiritual culture of the people concerned that makes interplanetary travel possible, even in the present body. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira therefore received Vidura in the manner of reception offered to the demigods.

Mahātmā Vidura had already adopted the renounced order of life, and therefore he did not return to his paternal palace to enjoy some material comforts. He accepted out of his own mercy what was offered to him by Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, but the purpose of living in the palace was to deliver his elder brother, Dhātārāñöra, who was too much materially attached. Dhātārāñöra lost all his state and descendants in the fight with Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, and still, due to his sense of helplessness, he did not feel ashamed to accept the charity and hospitality of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. On the part of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, it was quite in order to maintain his uncle in a befitting manner, but acceptance of such magnanimous hospitality by Dhātārāñöra was not at all desirable. He accepted it because he thought that there was no alternative. Vidura particularly came to enlighten Dhātārāñöra and to give him a lift to the higher status of spiritual cognition. It is the duty of enlightened souls to deliver the fallen ones, and Vidura came for that reason. But talks of spiritual enlightenment are so refreshing that while instructing Dhātārāñöra, Vidura attracted the attention of all the members of the family, and all of them took pleasure in hearing him patiently. This is the way of spiritual realization. The message should be heard attentively, and if spoken by a realized soul, it will act on the dormant heart of the conditioned soul. And by continuously hearing, one can attain the perfect stage of self-realization.

TEXT 15

Aib>a]dYaRMaa d<@& YaQaavdgak-airzu)
YaavÕDaar éUd]Tv& XaaPaaÜzRXaTa& YaMa")) 15))

abibhrat aryamä daëòaa

yathävat agha-käriñu

yävat dadhära çüdratvaà

çäpäd varña-çataà yamaù

SYNONYMS

abibhrat—administered; *aryamä*—Aryamä; *daëòam*—punishment; *yathävat*—as it was suitable; *agha-käriñu*—unto persons who had committed sins; *yävat*—as long as; *dadhära*—accepted; *çüdratvam*—the tabernacle of a *çüdra*; *çäpät*—as the result of a curse; *varña-çatam*—for one hundred years; *yamaù*—Yamarāja.

TRANSLATION

As long as Vidura played the part of a çüdra, being cursed by Maëòüka Muni, Aryamä officiated at the post of Yamarāja to punish those who committed sinful acts.

PURPORT

Vidura, born in the womb of a *çüdra* woman, was forbidden even to be a party of royal heritage along with his brothers Dhâtaräñöra and Päëòu. Then how could he occupy the post of a preacher to instruct such learned kings and *kṣatriyas* as Dhâtaräñöra and Mahärāja Yudhiñöhira? The first answer is that even though it is accepted that he was a *çüdra* by birth, because he renounced the world for spiritual enlightenment by the authority of Rsi Maitreya and was thoroughly educated by him in transcendental knowledge, he was quite competent to occupy the post of an *äcärya*, or spiritual preceptor. According to Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu, anyone who is conversant in the transcendental knowledge, or the science

of Godhead, be he a *brahmana* or a *çüdra*, a householder or a *sannyäse*, is eligible to become a spiritual master. Even in the ordinary moral codes (maintained by Cäëakya Paëòita, the great politician and moralist) there is no harm in taking lessons from a person who may be by birth less than a *çüdra*. This is one part of the answer. The other is that Vidura was not actually a *çüdra*. He was to play the part of a so-called *çüdra* for one hundred years, being cursed by Maëòüka Muni. He was the incarnation of Yamaräja, one of the twelve *mahäjanas*, on the level with such exalted personalities as Brahmä, Närada, Siva, Kapila, Bhéñma, Prahläda, etc. Being a *mahäjana*, it is the duty of Yamaräja to preach the cult of devotion to the people of the world, as Närada, Brahmä, and other *mahäjanas* do. But Yamaräja is always busy in his plutonic kingdom punishing the doers of sinful acts. Yamaräja is deputed by the Lord to a particular planet, some hundreds of thousands of miles away from the planet of earth, to take away the corrupt souls after death and convict them in accordance with their respective sinful activities. Thus Yamaräja has very little time to take leave from his responsible office of punishing the wrongdoers. There are more wrongdoers than righteous men. Therefore Yamaräja has to do more work than other demigods who are also authorized agents of the Supreme Lord. But he wanted to preach the glories of the Lord, and therefore by the will of the Lord he was cursed by Maëòüka Muni to come into the world in the incarnation of Vidura and work very hard as a great devotee. Such a devotee is neither a *çüdra* nor a *brahmana*. He is transcendental to such divisions of mundane society, just as the Personality of Godhead assumes His incarnation as a hog, but He is neither a hog nor a Brahmä. He is above all mundane creatures. The Lord and His different authorized devotees sometimes have to play the role of many lower creatures to claim the conditioned souls, but both the Lord and His pure devotees are always in the transcendental position. When Yamaräja thus incarnated himself as Vidura, his post was officiated by Aryamä, one of the many sons of Kaçyapa and Aditi. The Ädityas are sons of Aditi, and there are twelve Ädityas. Aryamä is one of the twelve Ädityas, and therefore it was quite possible for him to take charge of the office of Yamaräja during his one hundred years' absence in the form of Vidura. The conclusion is that Vidura was never a *çüdra*, but was greater than the purest type of *brahmana*.

TEXT 16

Yauidaiïrae l/BDaraJYaae d*îa PaaE}a& ku-l/NDarMa()
>a]aTa*i>al/aeRk-Paal/a>aEMauRMaude ParYaa ié[Yaa)) 16))

yudhiñöhira labdha-räjyo

dāñövā pautraà kulan-dharam

bhrätābhir loka-pālābhair

mumude parayā çriyā

SYNONYMS

*yudhiñöhira*ù—Yudhiñöhira; *labdha-rājya*ù—possessing his paternal kingdom; *dāñövā*—by seeing; *pautram*—the grandson; *kulam-dharam*—just suitable for the dynasty; *bhrätābhi*ù—by the brothers; *loka-pālābhai*ù—who were all expert administrators; *mumude*—enjoyed life; *parayā*—uncommon; *çriyā*—opulence.

TRANSLATION

Having won his kingdom and observed the birth of one grandson competent to continue the noble tradition of his family, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira reigned peacefully and enjoyed uncommon opulence in cooperation with his younger brothers, who were all expert administrators to the common people.

PURPORT

Both Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira and Arjuna were unhappy from the beginning of the Battle of Kurukñetra, but even though they were unwilling to kill their own men in the fight, it had to be done as a matter of duty, for it was planned by the supreme will of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. After the battle, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was unhappy over such mass killings. Practically there was none to continue the Kuru dynasty after them, the Pāṇḍavas. The only remaining hope was the child in the womb of his daughter-in-law, Uttarā, and he was also attacked by Açvatthāmā, but by the grace of the Lord the

child was saved. So after the settlement of all disturbing conditions and reestablishment of the peaceful order of the state, and after seeing the surviving child, Parékñit, well satisfied, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira felt some relief as a human being, although he had very little attraction for material happiness, which is always illusory and temporary.

TEXT 17

**Wv& Ga*hezu Saç-aNaa& Pa[MataaNaa& TadqhYaa)
ATYaŞ-aMadivjaTa" k-al/" ParMaduSTar")) 17))**

evaà gāheñu saktänäà

pramattänäà tad-éhayä

atyakrämad avijjātaù

kālaù parama-dustaraù

SYNONYMS

evam—thus; *gāheñu*—in the family affairs; *saktänäm*—of persons who are too attached; *pramattänäm*—insanely attached; *tat-éhayä*—engrossed in such thoughts; *atyakrämat*—surpassed; *avijjātaù*—imperceptibly; *kālaù*—eternal time; *parama*—supremely; *dustaraù*—insurmountable.

TRANSLATION

Insurmountable, eternal time imperceptibly overcomes those who are too much attached to family affairs and are always engrossed in their thought.

PURPORT

“I am now happy; I have everything in order; my bank balance is quite enough; I can now give my children enough estate; I am now successful; the poor beggar *sannyāsés* depend on God, but they come to beg from me;

therefore I am more than the Supreme God.” These are some of the thoughts which engross the insanely attached householder who is blind to the passing of eternal time. Our duration of life is measured, and no one is able to enhance it even by a second against the scheduled time ordained by the supreme will. Such valuable time, especially for the human being, should be cautiously spent because even a second passed away imperceptibly cannot be replaced, even in exchange for thousands of golden coins amassed by hard labor. Every second of human life is meant for making an ultimate solution to the problems of life, i.e. repetition of birth and death and revolving in the cycle of 8,400,000 different species of life. The material body, which is subject to birth and death, diseases and old age, is the cause of all sufferings of the living being, otherwise the living being is eternal; he is never born, nor does he ever die. Foolish persons forget this problem. They do not know at all how to solve the problems of life, but become engrossed in temporary family affairs not knowing that eternal time is passing away imperceptibly and that their measured duration of life is diminishing every second, without any solution to the big problem, namely repetition of birth and death, disease and old age. This is called illusion.

But such illusion cannot work on one who is awake in the devotional service of the Lord. Yudhiñöhira Mahārāja and his brothers the Pääòavas were all engaged in the service of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and they had very little attraction for the illusory happiness of this material world. As we have discussed previously, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was fixed in the service of the Lord Mukunda (the Lord, who can award salvation), and therefore he had no attraction even for such comforts of life as are available in the kingdom of heaven, because even the happiness obtained on the planet Brahmaloaka is also temporary and illusory. Because the living being is eternal, he can be happy only in the eternal abode of the kingdom of God (*paravyoma*), from which no one returns to this region of repeated birth and death, disease and old age. Therefore, any comfort of life or any material happiness which does not warrant an eternal life is but illusion for the eternal living being. One who understands this factually is learned, and such a learned person can sacrifice any amount of material happiness to achieve the desired goal known as *brahma-sukham*, or absolute happiness. Real transcendentalists are hungry for this happiness, and as a hungry man cannot be made happy

by all comforts of life minus foodstuff, so the man hungry for eternal absolute happiness cannot be satisfied by any amount of material happiness. Therefore, the instruction described in this verse cannot be applied to Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira or his brothers and mother. It was meant for persons like Dhātarañöra, for whom Vidura came especially to impart lessons.

TEXT 18

ivdurSTadi>aPa[eTYa Da*Tarai\Ma>aazTa)
raJaiàGaRMYaTaa& Xaqga]& PaXYaed& >aYaMaaGaTaMa()) 18))

viduras tad abhipretya

dhātarañöram abhāñata

rājan nirgamyatāà çéghraà

paçyedaà bhayam ägatam

SYNONYMS

vidura—Mahātmā Vidura; *tat*—that; *abhipretya*—knowing it well; *dhātarañöram*—unto Dhātarañöra; *abhāñata*—said; *rājan*—O King; *nirgamyatām*—please get out immediately; *çéghram*—without the least delay; *paçya*—just see; *idam*—this; *bhayam*—fear; *ägatam*—already arrived.

TRANSLATION

Mahātmā Vidura knew all this, and therefore he addressed Dhātarañöra, saying: My dear King, please get out of here immediately. Do not delay. Just see how fear has overtaken you.

PURPORT

Cruel death cares for no one, be he Dhātarañöra or even Mahārāja

Yudhiñöhira; therefore spiritual instruction, as was given to old Dhåtaråñöra, was equally applicable to younger Mahåräja Yudhiñöhira. As a matter of fact, everyone in the royal palace, including the King and his brothers and mother, was raptly attending the lectures. But it was known to Vidura that his instructions were especially meant for Dhåtaråñöra, who was too materialistic. The word *råjan* is especially addressed to Dhåtaråñöra significantly. Dhåtaråñöra was the eldest son of his father, and therefore according to law he was to be installed on the throne of Hastinåpura. But because he was blind from birth, he was disqualified from his rightful claim. But he could not forget the bereavement, and his disappointment was somewhat compensated after the death of Pääòu, his younger brother. His younger brother left behind him some minor children, and Dhåtaråñöra became the natural guardian of them, but at heart he wanted to become the factual king and hand the kingdom over to his own sons, headed by Duryodhana. With all these imperial ambitions, Dhåtaråñöra wanted to become a king, and he contrived all sorts of intrigues in consultation with his brother-in-law Çakuni. But everything failed by the will of the Lord, and at the last stage, even after losing everything, men and money, he wanted to remain as king, being the eldest uncle of Mahåräja Yudhiñöhira. Mahåräja Yudhiñöhira, as a matter of duty, maintained Dhåtaråñöra in royal honor, and Dhåtaråñöra was happily passing away his numbered days in the illusion of being a king or the royal uncle of King Yudhiñöhira. Vidura, as a saint and as the duty-bound affectionate youngest brother of Dhåtaråñöra, wanted to awaken Dhåtaråñöra from his slumber of disease and old age. Vidura therefore sarcastically addressed Dhåtaråñöra as the “King,” which he was actually not. Everyone is the servant of eternal time, and therefore no one can be king in this material world. King means the person who can order. The celebrated English king wanted to order time and tide, but the time and tide refused to obey his order. Therefore one is a false king in the material world, and Dhåtaråñöra was particularly reminded of this false position and of the factual fearful happenings which had already approached him at that time. Vidura asked him to get out immediately, if he wanted to be saved from the fearful situation which was approaching him fast. He did not ask Mahåräja Yudhiñöhira in that way because he knew that a king like Mahåräja Yudhiñöhira is aware of all the fearful situations of this flimsy world and would take care of himself, in due course, even though Vidura

might not be present at that time.

TEXT 19

**Pa[iTaiṣ-Yaa Na YaSYaeh ku-TaiêTk-ihRicTPa[>aae)
Sa Wz >aGavaNa(k-al/" SaveRza& Na" SaMaaGaTa")) 19))**

pratikriyā na yasyeha

kutaṣcit karhicit prabho

sa eña bhagavān kälau

sarveñā na samāgatau

SYNONYMS

pratikriyā—remedial measure; *na*—there is none; *yasya*—of which; *iha*—in this material world; *kutaṣcit*—by any means; *karhicit*—or by anyone; *prabho*—O my lord; *sa*—that; *eña*—positively; *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *kälau*—eternal time; *sarveñām*—of all; *na*—of us; *samāgatau*—arrived.

TRANSLATION

This frightful situation cannot be remedied by any person in this material world. My lord, it is the Supreme Personality of Godhead as eternal time [kāla] that has approached us all.

PURPORT

There is no superior power which can check the cruel hands of death. No one wants to die, however acute the source of bodily sufferings may be. Even in the days of so-called scientific advancement of knowledge, there is no remedial measure either for old age or for death. Old age is the notice of the arrival of death served by cruel time, and no one can refuse to accept either summon calls or the supreme judgment of eternal time. This is

explained before Dhåtaråñöra because he might ask Vidura to find out some remedial measure for the imminent fearful situation, as he had ordered many times before. Before ordering, however, Vidura informed Dhåtaråñöra that there was no remedial measure by anyone or from any source in this material world. And because there is no such thing in the material world, death is identical with the Supreme Personality of Godhead, as it is said by the Lord Himself in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (10.34).

Death cannot be checked by anyone or from any source within this material world. Hiraṇyakaśipu wanted to be immortal and underwent a severe type of penance by which the whole universe trembled, and Brahmā himself approached him to dissuade Hiraṇyakaśipu from such a severe type of penance. Hiraṇyakaśipu asked Brahmā to award him the blessings of immortality, but Brahmā said that he himself was subject to death, even in the topmost planet, so how could he award him the benediction of immortality? So there is death even in the topmost planet of this universe, and what to speak of other planets, which are far, far inferior in quality to Brahmāloka, the residing planet of Brahmā. Wherever there is the influence of eternal time, there is this set of tribulations, namely birth, disease, old age and death, and all of them are invincible.

TEXT 20

YaeNa cEvai>aPaàae_Ya& Pa[a<aE" iPa[YaTaMaEriPa)
JaNa" SaÛae ivYauJYaeTa ik-MauTaaNYaEDaRNaaidi>a")) 20))

yena caivābhipanno 'yaà

prāēaiù priyatamair api

janaù sadyo viyujyeta

kim utānyair dhanādibhiù

SYNONYMS

yena—pulled by such time; *ca*—and; *eva*—certainly; *abhipannaù*—

overtaken; *ayam*—this; *präëaiù*—with life; *priya-tamaiù*—which is most dear to everyone; *api*—even though; *janaù*—person; *sadyaù*—forthwith; *viyujoyeta*—do give up; *kim uta anyaiù*—what to speak of any other thing; *dhana-ädibhiù*—such as wealth, honor, children, land and house.

TRANSLATION

Whoever is under the influence of supreme kälä [eternal time] must surrender his most dear life, and what to speak of other things, such as wealth, honor, children, land and home.

PURPORT

A great Indian scientist, busy in the planmaking business, was suddenly called by invincible eternal time while going to attend a very important meeting of the planning commission, and he had to surrender his life, wife, children, house, land, wealth, etc. During the political upsurge in India and its division into Pakistan and Hindustan, so many rich and influential Indians had to surrender life, property and honor due to the influence of time, and there are hundreds and thousands of examples like that all over the world, all over the universe, which are all effects of the influence of time. Therefore, the conclusion is that there is no powerful living being within the universe who can overcome the influence of time. Many poets have written verses lamenting the influence of time. Many devastations have taken place over the universes due to the influence of time, and no one could check them by any means. Even in our daily life, so many things come and go in which we have no hand, but we have to suffer or tolerate them without remedial measure. That is the result of time.

TEXT 21

**iPaTa*>a]aTa*SauôTPau}aa hTaaSTae ivGaTa& vYaMa()
AaTMaa c JarYaa Ga]STa" ParGaehMauPaaSaSae)) 21))**

pitâ-bhrätâ-suhât-puträ

hatäs te vigataà vayam

ätmä ca jarayä grastau

para-geham upäsase

SYNONYMS

pitā—father; *bhrātā*—brother; *suhāt*—well-wishers; *putrāu*—sons; *hatāu*—all dead; *te*—yours; *vigatam*—expended; *vayam*—age; *ätmä*—the body; *ca*—also; *jarayä*—by invalidity; *grastau*—overcome; *para-geham*—another’s home; *upäsase*—you do live.

TRANSLATION

Your father, brother, well-wishers and sons are all dead and passed away. You yourself have expended the major portion of your life, your body is now overtaken by invalidity, and you are living in the home of another.

PURPORT

The King is reminded of his precarious condition, influenced by cruel time, and by his past experience he should have been more intelligent to see what was going to happen to his own life. His father, Vicitravérya, died long ago, when he and his younger brothers were all little children, and it was due to the care and kindness of Bhéñmadeva that they were properly brought up. Then again his brother Pääu died also. Then in the Battlefield of Kurukñetra his one hundred sons and his grandsons all died, along with all other well-wishers like Bhéñmadeva, Droëäcärya, Karëa and many other kings and friends. So he had lost all men and money, and now he was living at the mercy of his nephew, whom he had put into troubles of various types. And despite all these reverses, he thought that he would prolong his life more and more. Vidura wanted to point out to Dhåtaråñöra that everyone has to protect himself by his action and the grace of the Lord. One has to execute his duty faithfully, depending for the result on the supreme authority. No friend, no children, no father, no brother, no state and no one else can protect a person who is not protected by the Supreme Lord. One should, therefore, seek the protection of the Supreme Lord, for the human form of life is meant for seeking that protection. He was warned

of his precarious conditions more and more by the following words.

TEXT 22

**ANDa" PaurEv viDarae MaNdPa[jaê SaaMPa[TaMa()
ivXaq<aRdNTaae MaNdaiGan" SaraGa" k-f-MauÜhNa()) 22))**

andhaù puraiva vadhiro

manda-prajjâç ca sâmpratam

viçérëa-danto mandägniù

sarägaù kapham udvahan

SYNONYMS

andhaù—blind; *purä*—from the beginning; *eva*—certainly; *vadhiraù*—hard of hearing; *manda-prajjâù*—memory shortened; *ca*—and; *sâmpratam*—recently; *viçérëa*—loosened; *dantaù*—teeth; *manda-agniù*—liver action decreased; *sa-rägaù*—with sound; *kapham*—coughing much mucus; *udvahan*—coming out.

TRANSLATION

You have been blind from your very birth, and recently you have become hard of hearing. Your memory is shortened, and your intelligence is disturbed. Your teeth are loose, your liver is defective, and you are coughing up mucus.

PURPORT

The symptoms of old age, which had already developed in Dhåtaräñöra, were all one after another pointed out to him as warning that death was nearing very quickly, and still he was foolishly carefree about his future. The signs pointed out by Vidura in the body of Dhåtaräñöra were signs of *apakñaya*, or dwindling of the material body before the last stroke of

death. The body is born, it develops, stays, creates other bodies, dwindles and then vanishes. But foolish men want to make a permanent settlement of the perishable body and think that their estate, children, society, country, etc., will give them protection. With such foolish ideas, they become overtaken by such temporary engagements and forget altogether that they must give up this temporary body and take a new one, again to arrange for another term of society, friendship and love, again to perish ultimately. They forget their permanent identity and become foolishly active for impermanent occupations, forgetting altogether their prime duty. Saints and sages like Vidura approach such foolish men to awaken them to the real situation, but they take such *sādhus* and saints as parasites of society, and almost all of them refuse to hear the words of such *sādhus* and saints, although they welcome show-bottle *sādhus* and so-called saints who can satisfy their senses. Vidura was not a *sādhū* to satisfy the ill-gotten sentiment of Dhātarañña. He was correctly pointing out the real situation of life, and how one can save oneself from such catastrophies.

TEXT 23

**Ahae MahqYaSaq JaNTaaeJas,,ivTaaXaa YaQaa >avaNa()
>aqMaaPaviJaRTa& iPa<@Maadtae Ga*hPaal/vTa()) 23))**

aho mahéyasé jantor

jévitäçä yathä bhavän

bhémäpavarjitaà piëòam

ädatte gāha-pālavat

SYNONYMS

aho—alas; *mahéyasé*—powerful; *jantou*—of the living beings; *jévita-äçä*—hope for life; *yathä*—as much as; *bhavän*—you are; *bhéma*—of Bhémasena (a brother of Yudhiñöhira’s); *apavarjitam*—remnants; *piëòam*—foodstuff; *ädatte*—eaten by; *gāha-pāla-vat*—like a household dog.

TRANSLATION

**Alas, how powerful are the hopes of a living being to continue his life.
Verily, you are living just like a household dog and are eating remnants of
food given by Bhéma.**

PURPORT

A *sādhū* should never flatter kings or rich men to live comfortably at their cost. A *sādhū* is to speak to the householders about the naked truth of life so that they may come to their senses about the precarious life in material existence. Dhātaraññōra is a typical example of an attached old man in household life. He had become a pauper in the true sense, yet he wanted to live comfortably in the house of the Pāëòavas, of whom Bhéma especially is mentioned because personally he killed two prominent sons of Dhātaraññōra, namely Duryodhana and Duùçāsana. These two sons were very much dear to him for their notorious and nefarious activities, and Bhéma is particularly pointed out because he killed these two pet sons. Why was Dhātaraññōra living there at the house of the Pāëòavas? Because he wanted to continue his life comfortably, even at the risk of all humiliation. Vidura, therefore, was astonished how powerful is the urge to continue life. This sense of continuing one's life indicates that a living being is eternally a living entity and does not want to change his bodily habitation. The foolish man does not know that a particular term of bodily existence is awarded to him to undergo a term of imprisonment, and the human body is awarded, after many, many births and deaths, as a chance for self-realization to go back home, back to Godhead. But persons like Dhātaraññōra try to make plans to live there in a comfortable position with profit and interest, for they do not see things as they are. Dhātaraññōra is blind and continues to hope to live comfortably in the midst of all kinds of reverses of life. A *sādhū* like Vidura is meant to awaken such blind persons and thus help them go back to Godhead, where life is eternal. Once going there, no one wants to come back to this material world of miseries. We can just imagine how responsible a task is entrusted to a *sādhū* like Mahātmā Vidura.

TEXT 24

**AiGaniNaRSa*íae dtaê Garae daraê dUizTaa")
ôTa& +ae}a& DaNa& Yaeza& TaÕtaErSaui>a" ik-YaTa()) 24))**

agnir nisãñöo dattaç ca

garo dārāç ca düñitāù

hātaà kñetraà dhanaà yeñää

tad-dattair asubhiù kiyat

SYNONYMS

agniù—fire; *nisãñöaù*—set; *dattaù*—given; *ca*—and; *garaù*—poison; *däräù*—married wife; *ca*—and; *düñitäù*—insulted; *hātām*—usurped; *kñetram*—kingdom; *dhanam*—wealth; *yeñām*—of those; *tat*—their; *dattaiù*—given by; *asubhiù*—subsisting; *kiyat*—is unnecessary.

TRANSLATION

There is no need to live a degraded life and subsist on the charity of those whom you tried to kill by arson and poisoning. You also insulted one of their wives and usurped their kingdom and wealth.

PURPORT

The system of *varëäçrama* religion sets aside a part of one’s life completely for the purpose of self-realization and attainment of salvation in the human form of life. That is a routine division of life, but persons like Dhātārāñöra, even at their weary ripened age, want to stay home, even in a degraded condition of accepting charity from enemies. Vidura wanted to point this out and impressed upon him that it was better to die like his sons than accept such humiliating charity. Five thousand years ago there was one Dhātārāñöra, but at the present moment there are Dhātārāñöras in every home. Politicians especially do not retire from political activities unless they are dragged by the cruel hand of death or killed by some opposing element. To stick to family life to the end of one’s human life is the grossest type of

degradation and there is an absolute need for the Viduras to educate such Dhātarañōras, even at the present moment.

TEXT 25

TaSYaaiPa Tav dehae_Ya& k*-Pa<aSYa iJaJaqvzae")
ParETYaiNaC^Taae Jaq<aaer JarYaa vaSaSaq wv)) 25))

tasyāpi tava deho 'yaà

kāpaēasya jijéviñōù

paraity anicchato jérëo

jarayä vāsasé iva

SYNONYMS

tasya—of this; *api*—in spite of; *tava*—your; *dehaù*—body; *ayam*—this; *kāpaēasya*—of one who is miserly; *jijéviñōù*—of you who desire life; *paraity*—will dwindle; *anicchataù*—even unwilling; *Jérëaù*—deteriorated; *jarayä*—old; *vāsasé*—garments; *iva*—like.

TRANSLATION

Despite your unwillingness to die and your desire to live even at the cost of honor and prestige, your miserly body will certainly dwindle and deteriorate like an old garment.

PURPORT

The words *kāpaēasya jijéviñōù* are significant. There are two classes of men. One is called the *kāpaëa*, and the other is called the *brahmana*. The *kāpaëa*, or the miserly man, has no estimation of his material body, but the *brahmana* has a true estimation of himself and the material body. The *kāpaëa*, having a wrong estimation of his material body, wants to enjoy sense gratification with his utmost strength, and even in old age he wants

to become a young man by medical treatment or otherwise. Dhåtaråñöra is addressed herein as a *kåpaëa* because without any estimation of his material body he wants to live at any cost. Vidura is trying to open his eyes to see that he cannot live more than his term and that he must prepare for death. Since death is inevitable, why should he accept such a humiliating position for living? It is better to take the right path, even at the risk of death. Human life is meant for finishing all kinds of miseries of material existence, and life should be so regulated that one can achieve the desired goal. Dhåtaråñöra, due to his wrong conception of life, had already spoiled eighty percent of his achieved energy, so it behooved him to utilize the remaining days of his miserly life for the ultimate good. Such a life is called miserly because one cannot properly utilize the assets of the human form of life. Only by good luck does such a miserly man meet a self-realized soul like Vidura and by his instruction gets rid of the nescience of material existence.

TEXT 26

**GaTaSvaQaRiMaMa& deh& ivrç-ae Mauç-bNDaNa")
AivjaTaGaiTaJaRùaTa(Sa vE Daqr odaôTa")) 26))**

gata-svärtham imaà dehaà

virakto mukta-bandhanaù

avijjåta-gatir jahyät

sa vai dhéra udähåtaù

SYNONYMS

gata-sva-artham—without being properly utilized; *imam*—this; *deham*—material body; *viraktaù*—indifferently; *mukta*—being freed; *bandhanaù*—from all obligations; *avijjåta-gatiù*—unknown destination; *jahyät*—one should give up this body; *saù*—such a person; *vai*—certainly; *dhéraù*—undisturbed; *udähåtaù*—is said to be so.

TRANSLATION

He is called undisturbed who goes to an unknown, remote place and, freed from all obligations, quits his material body when it has become useless.

PURPORT

Narottama dāsa Ōhākura, a great devotee and *ācārya* of the Gauḍeya Vaiṣṇava sect, has sung: “My Lord, I have simply wasted my life. Having obtained the human body, I have neglected to worship Your Lordship, and therefore I have willingly drunk poison.” In other words, the human body is especially meant for cultivating knowledge of devotional service to the Lord, without which life becomes full of anxieties and miserable conditions. Therefore, one who has spoiled his life without such cultural activities is advised to leave home without knowledge of friends and relatives and, being thus freed from all obligations of family, society, country, etc., give up the body at some unknown destination so that others may not know where and how he has met his death. *Dhéra* means one who is not disturbed, even when there is sufficient provocation. One cannot give up a comfortable family life due to his affectionate relation with wife and children. Self-realization is obstructed by such undue affection for family, and if anyone is at all able to forget such a relation, he is called undisturbed, or *dhéra*. This is, however, the path of renunciation based on a frustrated life, but stabilization of such renunciation is possible only by association with bona fide saints and self-realized souls by which one can be engaged in the loving devotional service of the Lord. Sincere surrender unto the lotus feet of the Lord is possible by awakening the transcendental sense of service. This is made possible by association with pure devotees of the Lord. Dhātārāṇōra was lucky enough to have a brother whose very association was a source of liberation for his frustrated life.

TEXT 27

**Ya" SvkaTParTaae veh JaaTaiNaveRd AaTMavaNa()
ôid k*-Tva hir,,& GaehaTPa[v]JaeTSa NaraetaMa")) 27))**

yaù svakät parato vèha

jäta-nirveda ätmavän

hådi kåtvä harià gehät

pravrajat sa narottamaù

SYNONYMS

yaù—anyone who; *svakät*—by his own awakening; *parataù vä*—or by hearing from another; *iha*—here in this world; *jäta*—becomes; *nirvedaù*—indifferent to material attachment; *ätmavän*—consciousness; *hådi*—within the heart; *kåtvä*—having been taken by; *harim*—the Personality of Godhead; *gehät*—from home; *pravrajat*—goes away; *saù*—he is; *nara-uttamaù*—the first-class human being.

TRANSLATION

He is certainly a first-class man who awakens and understands, either by himself or from others, the falsity and misery of this material world and thus leaves home and depends fully on the Personality of Godhead residing within his heart.

PURPORT

There are three classes of transcendentalists, namely, (1) the *dhéraq*, or the one who is not disturbed by being away from family association, (2) one in the renounced order of life, a *sannyäsé* by frustrated sentiment, and (3) a sincere devotee of the Lord, who awakens God consciousness by hearing and chanting and leaves home depending completely on the Personality of Godhead, who resides in his heart. The idea is that the renounced order of life, after a frustrated life of sentiment in the material world, may be the stepping stone on the path of self-realization, *but real perfection of the path of liberation is attained when one is practiced to depend fully on the Supreme Personality of Godhead*, who lives in everyone's heart as Paramätmä. One may live in the darkest jungle alone out of home, but a

steadfast devotee knows very well that he is not alone. The Supreme Personality of Godhead is with him, and He can protect His sincere devotee in any awkward circumstance. One should therefore practice devotional service at home, hearing and chanting the holy name, quality, form, pastimes, entourage, etc., in association with pure devotees, and this practice will help one awaken God consciousness in proportion to one's sincerity of purpose. One who desires material benefit by such devotional activities can never depend on the Supreme Personality of Godhead, although He sits in everyone's heart. Nor does the Lord give any direction to persons who worship Him for material gain. Such materialistic devotees may be blessed by the Lord with material benefits, but they cannot reach the stage of the first-class human being, as above mentioned. There are many examples of such sincere devotees in the history of the world, especially in India, and they are our guides on the path of self-realization. Mahātmā Vidura is one such great devotee of the Lord, and we should all try to follow in his lotus footsteps for self-realization.

TEXT 28

**AQaaedqcq& idXa& YaaTau SvErjaTaGaiTa>aRvaNa()
wTaae_vaRKPa[aYaXa" k-al/" Pau&Saa& Gau<aivk-zR<a")) 28))**

athodécéà diçaà yātu

svair ajiāta-gatir bhavān

ito 'rvāk prāyaçaù kālaù

puàsäà guëa-vikarñäëaù

SYNONYMS

atha—therefore; *udécém*—northern side; *diçam*—direction; *yātu*—please go away; *svaiù*—by your relatives; *ajiāta*—without knowledge; *gatiù*—movements; *bhavān*—of yourself; *itaù*—after this; *arvāk*—will usher in; *prāyaçaù*—generally; *kālaù*—time; *puàsäm*—of men; *guëa*—qualities; *vikarñäëaù*—diminishing.

TRANSLATION

Please, therefore, leave for the North immediately, without letting your relatives know, for soon that time will approach which will diminish the good qualities of men.

PURPORT

One can compensate for a life of frustration by becoming a *dhéra*, or leaving home for good without communicating with relatives, and Vidura advised his eldest brother to adopt this way without delay because very quickly the age of Kali was approaching. A conditioned soul is already degraded by the material association, and still in the Kali-yuga the good qualities of a man will deteriorate to the lowest standard. He was advised to leave home before Kali-yuga approached because the atmosphere which was created by Vidura, his valuable instructions on the facts of life, would fade away due to the influence of the age which was fast approaching. To become *narottama*, or a first-class human being depending completely on the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, is not possible for any ordinary man. It is stated in ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.28) that a person who is completely relieved of all taints of sinful acts can alone depend on the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead. Dhātārāṇōra was advised by Vidura at least to become a *dhéra* in the beginning if it were impossible for him to become a *sannyāsé* or a *narottama*. Persistently endeavoring on the line of self-realization helps a person to rise to the conditions of a *narottama* from the stage of a *dhéra*. The *dhéra* stage is attained after prolonged practice of the *yoga* system, but by the grace of Vidura one can attain the stage immediately simply by willing to adopt the means of the *dhéra* stage, which is the preparatory stage for *sannyāsa*. The *sannyāsa* stage is the preparatory stage of *paramahamsa*, or the first-grade devotee of the Lord.

TEXT 29

Wv& raJaa ivdure<aaNauJaeNa
Pa[jac+aubaeRiDaTa AaJaMaq!")
i^tva Svezu òehPaaXaaNd]i!Manae
iNaê§-aMa >a]aTa*SaNdiXaRTaaßa)) 29))

evaà rājā vidureëānujena

prajīā-cakñur bodhita ājaméòhaù

chittvā sveñu sneha-pāçān draòhimno

niçcakraṁa bhrātā-sandarçitādhvā

SYNONYMS

evam—thus; *rājā*—King Dhātaraññōra; *vidureëa anujena*—by his younger brother Vidura; *prajīā*—introspective knowledge; *cakñuù*—eyes; *bodhitaù*—being understood; *ājaméòhaù*—Dhātaraññōra, scion of the family of Ajaméòha; *chittvā*—by breaking; *sveñu*—regarding kinsmen; *sneha-pāçān*—strong network of affection; *draòhimnaù*—because of steadfastness; *niçcakraṁa*—got out; *bhrātā*—by his brother; *sandarçita*—direction to; *adhvā*—the path of liberation.

TRANSLATION

Thus Mahārāja Dhātaraññōra, the scion of the family of Ajaméòha, firmly convinced by introspective knowledge [prajīā], broke at once the strong network of familial affection by his resolute determination. Thus he immediately left home to set out on the path of liberation, as directed by his younger brother Vidura.

PURPORT

Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu, the great preacher of the principles of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, has stressed the importance of association with *sādhus*, pure devotees of the Lord. He said that even by a moments association with a pure devotee, one can achieve all perfection. We are not ashamed to admit that this fact was experienced in our practical life. Were we not favored by His Divine Grace Srimad Bhaktisiddhānta Sarasvaté Gosvami Mahārāja, by our first meeting for a few minutes only, it would have been impossible for us to accept this mighty task of describing *Srimad-Bhagavatam* in English. Without seeing him at that opportune moment, we

could have become a very great business magnate, but never would we have been able to walk the path of liberation and be engaged in the factual service of the Lord under instructions of His Divine Grace. And here is another practical example by the action of Vidura's association with Dhātārāñōra. Mahārāja Dhātārāñōra was tightly bound in a network of material affinities related to politics, economy and family attachment, and he did everything in his power to achieve so-called success in his planned projects, but he was frustrated from the beginning to the end so far as his material activities were concerned. And yet, despite his life of failure, he achieved the greatest of all success in self-realization by the forceful instructions of a pure devotee of the Lord, who is the typical emblem of a *sādhū*. The scriptures enjoin, therefore, that one should associate with *sādhūs* only, rejecting all other kinds of association, and by doing so one will have ample opportunity to hear the *sādhūs*, who can cut to pieces the bonds of illusory affection in the material world. It is a fact that the material world is a great illusion because everything appears to be a tangible reality but at the next moment evaporates like the dashing foam of the sea or a cloud in the sky. A cloud in the sky undoubtedly appears to be a reality because it rains, and due to rains so many temporary green things appear, but in the ultimate issue, everything disappears, namely the cloud, rain and green vegetation, all in due course. But the sky remains, and the varieties of sky or luminaries also remain forever. Similarly, the Absolute Truth, which is compared to the sky, remains eternally, and the temporary cloudlike illusion comes and goes away. Foolish living beings are attracted by the temporary cloud, but intelligent men are more concerned with the eternal sky with all its variegatedness.

TEXT 30

PaiTa& Pa[YaaNTa& Saubl/SYa Pau}aq
 PaiTav]Taa caNauJaGaaMa Saaßq)
 ihMaal/Ya& NYaSTad<@Pa[hz|
 MaNaiSvNaaiMav SaTSaMPa[har")) 30))

patiā prayāntā subalasya putré

pati-vratā cānujagāma sādhvé

himālayaà nyasta-daëòà-praharñà

manasvinām iva sat samprahāraù

SYNONYMS

patim—her husband; *prayāntam*—while leaving home; *subalasya*—of King Subala; *putré*—the worthy daughter; *pati-vratā*—devoted to her husband; *ca*—also; *anujagāma*—followed; *sādhvé*—the chaste; *himālayam*—towards the Himalaya Mountains; *nyasta-daëòà*—one who has accepted the rod of the renounced order; *praharñam*—object of delight; *manasvinām*—of the great fighters; *iva*—like; *sat*—legitimate; *samprahāraù*—good lashing.

TRANSLATION

The gentle and chaste Gāndhāré, who was the daughter of King Subala of Kandahar [or Gāndhāra], followed her husband, seeing that he was going to the Himalaya Mountains, which are the delight of those who have accepted the staff of the renounced order like fighters who have accepted a good lashing from the enemy.

PURPORT

Saubaliné, or Gāndhāré, daughter of King Subala and wife of King Dhātārāñōra, was ideal as a wife devoted to her husband. The Vedic civilization especially prepares chaste and devoted wives, of whom Gāndhāré is one amongst many mentioned in history. Lakṣmījé Sitadevé was also a daughter of a great king, but she followed her husband, Lord Rāmacandra, into the forest. Similarly, as a woman Gāndhāré could have remained at home or at her father's house, but as a chaste and gentle lady she followed her husband without consideration. Instructions for the renounced order of life were imparted to Dhātārāñōra by Vidura, and Gāndhāré was by the side of her husband. But he did not ask her to follow him because he was at that time fully determined, like a great warrior who faces all kinds of dangers in the battlefield. He was no longer attracted to so-called wife or relatives, and he decided to start alone, but as a chaste lady Gāndhāré decided to follow her husband till the last moment.

Mahārāja Dhātaraññōra accepted the order of *vānaprastha*, and at this stage the wife is allowed to remain as a voluntary servitor, but in the *sannyāsa* stage no wife can stay with her former husband. A *sannyāsé* is considered to be a dead man civilly, and therefore the wife becomes a civil widow without connection with her former husband. Mahārāja Dhātaraññōra did not deny his faithful wife, and she followed her husband at her own risk.

The *sannyāsés* accept a rod as the sign of the renounced order of life. There are two types of *sannyāsés*. Those who follow the Māyāvādé philosophy, headed by Sripāda Čaikarācārya, accept only one rod (*eka-daēḍa*), but those who follow the Vaiñēavite philosophy accept three combined rods (*tri-daēḍa*). The Māyāvādé *sannyāsés* are *ekadaēḍi-svāmés*, whereas the Vaiñēava *sannyāsés* are known as *tridaēḍi-svāmés*, or more distinctly, *tridaēḍi-gosvāmés*, in order to be distinguished from the Māyāvādé philosophers. The *ekadaēḍi-svāmés* are mostly fond of the Himalayas, but the Vaiñēava *sannyāsés* are fond of Vāndāvana and Puré. The Vaiñēava *sannyāsés* are *narottamas*, whereas the Māyāvādé *sannyāsés* are *dhéras*. Mahārāja Dhātaraññōra was advised to follow the *dhéras* because at that stage it was difficult for him to become a *narottama*.

TEXT 31

AJaaTaXa}au" k*-TaMaE}aae huTaaiGan,
ivRPa[aNa(NaTva iTal/Gaae>aUiMaåKMaE")
Ga*h& Pa[ivíae GauåvNdNaaYa
Na caPaXYaiTPaTaraE SaaEbl/I& c)) 31))

ajāta-çatruḥ kâta-maitro hutāgnir

viprān natvā tila-go-bhūmi-rukmaiḥ

gāhaṇḍaḥ praviñño guru-vandanāya

na cāpaçyat pitarau saubalēḥ ca

SYNONYMS

ajāta—never born; *çatru*—enemy; *kāta*—having performed; *maitra*—worshipping the demigods; *huta-agni*—and offering fuel in the fire; *viprān*—the *brahmanas*; *natvā*—offering obeisances; *tila-go-bhūmi-rukmai*—along with grains, cows, land and gold; *gāham*—within the palace; *praviññā*—having entered into; *guru-vandanāya*—for offering respect to the elderly members; *na*—did not; *ca*—also; *apaçyat*—see; *pitarau*—his uncles; *saubalém*—Gāndhārē; *ca*—also.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, whose enemy was never born, performed his daily morning duties by praying, offering fire sacrifice to the sun-god, and offering obeisances, grains, cows, land and gold to the brahmanas. He then entered the palace to pay respects to the elderly. However, he could not find his uncles or aunt, the daughter of King Subala.

PURPORT

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was the most pious king because he personally practiced daily the pious duties for the householders. The householders are required to rise early in the morning, and after bathing they should offer respects to the Deities at home by prayers, by offering fuel in the sacred fire, by giving the *brahmanas* in charity land, cows, grains, gold, etc., and at last offering to the elderly members due respects and obeisances. One who is not prepared to practice injunctions prescribed in the *sastras* cannot be a good man simply by book knowledge. Modern householders are practiced to different modes of life, namely to rise late and then take bed tea without any sort of cleanliness and without any purificatory practices as mentioned above. The household children are taken to practice what the parents practice, and therefore the whole generation glides towards hell. Nothing good can be expected from them unless they associate with *sādhus*. Like Dhātārāñöra, the materialistic person may take lessons from a *sādhu* like Vidura and thus be cleansed of the effects of modern life.

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, however, could not find in the palace his two uncles, namely Dhātārāñöra and Vidura, along with Gāndhārē, the daughter of King Subala. He was anxious to see them and therefore asked Saījaya,

the private secretary of Dhâtaräñöra.

TEXT 32

**Ta}a SaÅYaMaaSaqNa& PaPa[C^aeiÜGanMaaNaSa")
GaavLGa<ae Kv NaSTaaTaae v*Öae hqNaê Nae}aYaae")) 32))**

tatra saiṣṣayam äsénàà

papracchodvigna-mānasaù

gāvalgaëe kva nas tātò

vāddho hēnaç ca netrayoù

SYNONYMS

tatra—there; *saiṣṣayam*—unto Saiṣṣajaya; *äsénam*—seated; *papraccha*—he inquired from; *udvigna-mānasaù*—filled with anxiety; *gāvalgaëe*—the son of Gavalgaëa, Saiṣṣajaya; *kva*—where is; *naù*—our; *tātò*—uncle; *vāddhaù*—old; *hēnaù ca*—and bereft of; *netrayoù*—the eyes.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, full of anxiety, turned to Saiṣṣajaya, who was sitting there, and said: O Saiṣṣajaya, where is our uncle, who is old and blind?

TEXT 33

**AMba c hTaPau}aaTaaR iPaTa*VYa" Kv GaTa" SauôTa()
AiPa MaYYak*-TaPa[je hTabNDau" Sa >aaYaRYaa)
AaXa&SaMaaNa" XaMal&/ Ga®aYaa& du"i%Taae_PaTaTa()) 33))**

ambä ca hata-puträrtä

pitāvyaù kva gataù suhât

api mayy akâta-prajïe

hata-bandhuù sa bhäryayä

äçaàsamänaù çamalaà

gaigäyää duùkhito 'patat

SYNONYMS

ambä—mother aunt; *ca*—and; *hata-puträ*—who had lost all her sons; *ärtä*—in a sorry plight; *pitävyau*—uncle Vidura; *kva*—where; *gataù*—gone; *suhât*—well-wisher; *api*—whether; *mayi*—unto me; *akâta-prajïe*—ungrateful; *hata-bandhuù*—one who has lost all his sons; *saù*—Dhâtaräñöra; *bhäryayä*—with his wife; *äçaàsamänaù*—in doubtful mind; *çamalam*—offenses; *gaigäyäm*—in the Ganges water; *duùkhitaù*—in distressed mind; *apatat*—fell down.

TRANSLATION

Where is my well-wisher, uncle Vidura, and mother Gändhäre, who is very afflicted due to all her sons' demise? My uncle Dhâtaräñöra was also very mortified due to the death of all his sons and grandsons. Undoubtedly I am very ungrateful. Did he, therefore, take my offenses very seriously and, along with his wife, drown himself in the Ganges?

PURPORT

The Pääòavas, especially Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira and Arjuna, anticipated the aftereffects of the Battle of Kurukñetra, and therefore Arjuna declined to execute the fighting. The fight was executed by the will of the Lord, but the effects of family aggrievement, as they had thought of it before, had come to be true. Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira was always conscious of the great plight of his uncle Dhâtaräñöra and aunt Gändhäre, and therefore he took all possible care of them in their old age and aggrieved conditions. When, therefore, he could not find his uncle and aunt in the palace, naturally his doubts arose, and he conjectured that they had gone down to the water of

the Ganges. He thought himself ungrateful because when the Pääòavas were fatherless, Mahäräja Dhåtaråñöra had given them all royal facilities to live, and in return he had killed all Dhåtaråñöra's sons in the Battle of Kurukñetra. As a pious man, Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira took into account all his unavoidable misdeeds, and he never thought of the misdeeds of his uncle and company. Dhåtaråñöra had suffered the effects of his own misdeeds by the will of the Lord, but Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira was thinking only of his own unavoidable misdeeds. That is the nature of a good man and devotee of the Lord. A devotee never finds fault with others, but tries to find his own and thus rectify them as far as possible.

TEXT 34

iPaTaYauRParTae Paa<@aE SavaRà" Sauôd" iXaéUNa()
Ar+aTaa& VYaSaNaTa" iPaTa*VYaaE Kv GaTaaivTa")) 34))

pitary uparate päëòau

sarvån naù suhådaù çïçün

arakñatää vyasanataù

pitåvyau kva gatäv itaù

SYNONYMS

pitari—upon my father; *uparate*—falling down; *päëòau*—Mahäräja Pääòu; *sarvån*—all; *naù*—of us; *suhådaù*—well-wishers; *çïçün*—small children; *arakñatäm*—protected; *vyasanataù*—from all kinds of dangers; *pitåvyau*—uncles; *kva*—where; *gatau*—have departed; *itaù*—from this place.

TRANSLATION

When my father, Pääòu, fell down and we were all small children, these two uncles gave us protection from all kinds of calamities. They were always our good well-wishers. Alas, where have they gone from here?

TEXT 35

SaUTa ovac

k*-PaYaa òehvE©-VYaaTSaUTaae ivrhk-iXaRTa")
AaTMaeìrMac+aa<aae Na Pa[TYaahaiTaPaqi@Ta")) 35))

süta uväca

kâpayä sneha-vaiklavyät

süto viraha-karçitaù

ätmeçvaram acakñäëo

na pratyähätipéditaù

SYNONYMS

sütaù uväca—Süta Gosvami said; *kâpayä*—out of full compassion; *sneha-vaiklavyät*—mental derangement due to profound affection; *sütaù*—Saijaya; *viraha-karçitaù*—distressed by separation; *ätma-éçvaram*—his master; *acakñäëaù*—having not seen; *na*—did not; *pratyäha*—replied; *ati-péditaù*—being too aggrieved.

TRANSLATION

Süta Gosvami said: Because of compassion and mental agitation, Saijaya, not having seen his own master, Dhåtaräñöra, was aggrieved and could not properly reply to Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira.

PURPORT

Saijaya was the personal assistant of Mahäräja Dhåtaräñöra for a very long time, and thus he had the opportunity to study the life of Dhåtaräñöra. And when he saw at last that Dhåtaräñöra had left home without his knowledge, his sorrows had no bound. He was fully compassionate toward Dhåtaräñöra because in the game of the Battle of Kurukñetra, King

Dhåtaråñöra had lost everything, men and money, and at last the King and the Queen had to leave home in utter frustration. He studied the situation in his own way because he did not know that the inner vision of Dhåtaråñöra has been awakened by Vidura and that therefore he had left home in enthusiastic cheerfulness for a better life after departure from the dark well of home. Unless one is convinced of a better life after renunciation of the present life, one cannot stick to the renounced order of life simply by artificial dress or staying out of the home.

TEXT 36

ivMa*JYaaé[Ui<a Paai<a>Yaa& iví>YaaTMaaNaMaaTMaNaa)
AJaaTaXa}au& Pa[TYaUce Pa[>aae" PaadavNauSMarNa()) 36))

vimåjyåçrûëi päëibhyäà

viñöabhyätmänam ätmanä

ajäta-çatruà pratyüce

prabhoù pädäv anusmaran

SYNONYMS

vimåjya—smearing; *açrûëi*—tears of the eyes; *päëibhyäm*—with his hands; *viñöabhya*—situated; *ätmänam*—the mind; *ätmanä*—by intelligence; *ajäta-çatrum*—unto Mahäråja Yudhiñöhira; *pratyüce*—began to reply; *prabhoù*—of his master; *pädau*—feet; *anusmaran*—thinking after.

TRANSLATION

First he slowly pacified his mind by intelligence, and wiping away his tears and thinking of the feet of his master, Dhåtaråñöra, he began to reply to Mahäråja Yudhiñöhira.

TEXT 37

SaÅYa ovac
Naah& ved VYaviSaTa& iPa}aaevR" ku-l/NaNdNa)
GaaNDaaYaaR va Mahabahae MauizTaae_iSMa MahaTMai>a")) 37))

saijaya uvāca

nāhaà veda vyavasitaà

pitror vaù kula-nandana

gāndhāryā vā mahā-bāho

muñito 'smi mahātmabhiù

SYNONYMS

saijayaù uvāca—Saijaya said; *na*—not; *aham*—I; *veda*—know; *vyavasitam*—determination; *pitroù*—of your uncles; *vaù*—your; *kula-nandana*—O descendant of the Kuru dynasty; *gāndhāryāù*—of Gāndhāré; *vā*—or; *mahā-bāho*—O great King; *muñitaù*—cheated; *asmi*—I have been; *mahā-ātmabhiù*—by those great souls.

TRANSLATION

Saijaya said: My dear descendant of the Kuru dynasty, I have no information of the determination of your two uncles and Gāndhāré. O King, I have been cheated by those great souls.

PURPORT

That great souls cheat others may be astonishing to know, but it is a fact that great souls cheat others for a great cause. It is said that Lord Kṛṣṇa also advised Yudhiñöhira to tell a lie before Droëäcārya, and it was also for a great cause. The Lord wanted it, and therefore it was a great cause. Satisfaction of the Lord is the criterion of one who is bona fide, and the highest perfection of life is to satisfy the Lord by one's occupational duty. That is the verdict of *Gétä* and *Bhāgavatam*.^{ix*} Dhātarañöra and Vidura,

followed by Gāndhāré, did not disclose their determination to Saijaya, although he was constantly with Dhātārāññōra as his personal assistant. Saijaya never thought that Dhātārāññōra could perform any act without consulting him. But Dhātārāññōra's going away from home was so confidential that it could not be disclosed even to Saijaya. Sanātana Gosvami also cheated the keeper of the prison house while going away to see Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and similarly Raghunātha dāsa Gosvami also cheated his priest and left home for good to satisfy the Lord. To satisfy the Lord, anything is good, for it is in relation with the Absolute Truth. We also had the same opportunity to cheat the family members and leave home to engage in the service of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Such cheating was necessary for a great cause, and there is no loss for any party in such transcendental fraud.

TEXT 38

AQaaJaGaaMa >aGavaNa(Naard" SahTauMbuå")
Pa[TYauTQaaYaai>avaÛah SaaNauJaae_>YacRYaNMauiNaMa()) 38))

athājagāma bhagavān

nāradaù saha-tumburuù

pratyutthāyābhivādyāha

sānujo 'bhyarcayan munim

SYNONYMS

atha—thereafter; *ājagāma*—arrived; *bhagavān*—the godly personality; *nāradaù*—Nārada; *saha-tumburuù*—along with his *tumburu* (musical instrument); *pratyutthāya*—having gotten up from their seats; *abhivādyā*—offering their due obeisances; *āha*—said; *sa-anujaù*—along with younger brothers; *abhyarcayan*—thus while receiving in a proper mood; *munim*—the sage.

TRANSLATION

While Saijaya was thus speaking, Sri Nārada, the powerful devotee of the Lord, appeared on the scene carrying his tumburu. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira and his brothers received him properly by getting up from their seats and offering obeisances.

PURPORT

Devarñi Nārada is described herein as *bhagavān* due to his being the most confidential devotee of the Lord. The Lord and His very confidential devotees are treated on the same level by those who are actually engaged in the loving service of the Lord. Such confidential devotees of the Lord are very much dear to the Lord because they travel everywhere to preach the glories of the Lord in different capacities and try their utmost to convert the nondevotees of the Lord into devotees in order to bring them to the platform of sanity. Actually a living being cannot be a nondevotee of the Lord because of his constitutional position, but when one becomes a nondevotee or nonbeliever, it is to be understood that the person concerned is not in a sound condition of life. The confidential devotees of the Lord treat such illusioned living beings, and therefore they are most pleasing in the eyes of the Lord. The Lord says in the *Bhagavad-gītā* that no one is dearer to Him than one who actually preaches the glories of the Lord to convert the nonbelievers and nondevotees. Such personalities as Nārada must be offered all due respects, like those offered to the Personality of Godhead Himself, and Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, along with his noble brothers, were examples for others in receiving a pure devotee of the Lord like Nārada, who had no other business save and except singing the glories of the Lord along with his *véëä*, a musical stringed instrument.

TEXT 39

YauiDaiir ovac

Naah& ved GaiTa& iPa}aae>aRGavNa(Kv GaTaaivTa")
AMba va hTaPau}aaTaaR Kv GaTaa c TaPaiSvNaq)) 39))

yudhiñöhira uvāca

nāhaà veda gatià pitror

bhagavan kva gatäv itaù

ambä vä hata-puträrtä

kva gatä ca tapasviné

SYNONYMS

yudhiñöhiraù uväca—Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira said; *na*—do not; *aham*—myself; *veda*—know it; *gatim*—departure; *pitrou*—of the uncles; *bhagavan*—O godly personality; *kva*—where; *gatau*—gone; *itaù*—from this place; *ambä*—mother aunt; *vä*—either; *hata-puträ*—bereft of her sons; *ärtä*—aggrieved; *kva*—where; *gatä*—gone; *ca*—also; *tapasviné*—ascetic.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira said: O godly personality, I do not know where my two uncles have gone. Nor can I find my ascetic aunt who is grief-stricken by the loss of all her sons.

PURPORT

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, as a good soul and devotee of the Lord, was always conscious of the great loss of his aunt and her sufferings as an ascetic. An ascetic is never disturbed by all kinds of sufferings, and that makes him strong and determined on the path of spiritual progress. Queen Gāndhārī is a typical example of an ascetic because of her marvelous character in many trying situations. She was an ideal woman as mother, wife and ascetic, and in the history of the world such character in a woman is rarely found.

TEXT 40

**k-<aRDaar wvaPaare >aGavaNa(PaardXaRk-")
AQaab>aaze >aGavaNa(Naardae MauiNaSataMa")) 40))**

karēadhāra ivāpāre

bhagavān pāra-darçakaù

athābabhāñe bhagavān

nārada muni-sattamaù

SYNONYMS

karēa-dhāraù—captain of the ship; *iva*—like; *apāre*—in the extensive oceans; *bhagavān*—representative of the Lord; *pāra-darçakaù*—one who can give directions to the other side; *atha*—thus; *ābabhāñe*—began to say; *bhagavān*—the godly personality; *nāradaù*—the great sage Nārada; *muni-sat-tamaù*—the greatest among the devotee philosophers.

TRANSLATION

You are like a captain of a ship in a great ocean and you can direct us to our destination. Thus addressed, the godly personality, Devarñi Nārada, greatest of the philosopher devotees, began to speak.

PURPORT

There are different types of philosophers, and the greatest of all of them are those who have seen the Personality of Godhead and have surrendered themselves in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. Among all such pure devotees of the Lord, Devarñi Nārada is the chief, and therefore he has been described herein as the greatest of all philosopher devotees. Unless one has become a sufficiently learned philosopher by hearing the Vedānta philosophy from a bona fide spiritual master, one cannot be a learned philosopher devotee. One must be very faithful, learned and renounced, otherwise one cannot be a pure devotee. A pure devotee of the Lord can give us direction towards the other end of nescience. Devarñi Nārada used to visit the palace of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira because the Pāëòavas were all pure devotees of the Lord, and the Devarñi was always ready to give them good counsel whenever needed.

TEXT 41

Naard ovaç
Maa k-ÄNa éucae raJaNa(YadqìrvXa& JaGaTa()
I/aek-a" SaPaal/a YaSYaeMae vhiNTa bil/MaqiXaTau")
Sa Sa&YauNaiç- >aUTaaiNa Sa Wv ivYauNaiç- c)) 41))

nārada uvāca

mā kaīcana çuco rājan

yad éçvara-vaçaà jagat

lokäù sapälä yasyeme

vahanti balim éçituù

sa saàyunakti bhütäni

sa eva viyunakti ca

SYNONYMS

nāradaù uvāca—Nārada said; *mā*—never; *kaīcana*—by all means; *çucaù*—do you lament; *rājan*—O King; *yat*—because; *éçvara-vaçam*—under the control of the Supreme Lord; *jagat*—world; *lokäù*—all living beings; *sa-päläù*—including their leaders; *yasya*—whose; *ime*—all these; *vahanti*—do bear; *balim*—means of worship; *éçituù*—for being protected; *saù*—He; *saàyunakti*—gets together; *bhütäni*—all living beings; *saù*—He; *eva*—also; *viyunakti*—disperses; *ca*—and.

TRANSLATION

Sri Nārada said: O pious King, do not lament for anyone, for everyone is under the control of the Supreme Lord. Therefore all living beings and their leaders carry on worship to be well protected. It is He only who brings them together and disperses them.

PURPORT

Every living being, either in this material world or in the spiritual world, is under the control of the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead. Beginning from Brahmäjé, the leader of this universe, down to the insignificant ant, all are abiding by the order of the Supreme Lord. Thus the constitutional position of the living being is subordination under the control of the Lord. The foolish living being, especially man, artificially rebels against the law of the Supreme and thus becomes chastised as an *asura*, or lawbreaker. A living being is placed in a particular position by the order of the Supreme Lord, and he is again shifted from that place by the order of the Supreme Lord or His authorized agents. Brahmä, Siva, Indra, Candra, Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira or, in modern history, Napoleon, Akbar, Alexander, Gandhi, Shubhash and Nehru all are servants of the Lord, and they are placed in and removed from their respective positions by the supreme will of the Lord. None of them is independent. Even though such men or leaders rebel so as not to recognize the supremacy of the Lord, they are put under still more rigorous laws of the material world by different miseries. Only the foolish man, therefore, says that there is no God. Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira was being convinced of this naked truth because he was greatly overwhelmed by the sudden departure of his old uncles and aunt. Mahäräja Dhåtaråñöra was placed in that position according to his past deeds; he had already suffered or enjoyed the benefits accrued to him in the past, but due to his good luck, somehow or other he had a good younger brother, Vidura, and by his instruction he left to achieve salvation by closing all accounts in the material world.

Ordinarily one cannot change the course of one's due happiness and distress by plan. Everyone has to accept them as they come under the subtle arrangement of *kåla*, or invincible time. There is no use trying to counteract them. The best thing is, therefore, that one should endeavor to achieve salvation, and this prerogative is given only to man because of his developed condition of mental activities and intelligence. Only for man are there different Vedic instructions for attainment of salvation during the human form of existence. One who misuses this opportunity of advanced intelligence is verily condemned and put into different types of miseries, either in this present life or in the future. That is the way the Supreme controls everyone.

TEXT 42

YaQaa Gaavae NaiSa Pa[aeTaaSTaNTYaa& bÖaê daMai>a")
vaÇ-NTYaa& NaaMai>abRÖa vhiNTa bil/MaqiXaTau")) 42))

yathä Gävo nasi protäs

tantyäà baddhäç ca dämabhiù

väk-tantyäà nāmabhir baddhä

vahanti balim éçituù

SYNONYMS

yathä—as much as; *gävaù*—cow; *nasi*—by the nose; *protäù*—strung;
tantyäm—by the thread; *baddhäù*—bound by; *ca*—also; *dämabhiù*—by
ropes; *väk-tantyäm*—in the network of Vedic hymns; *nāmabhiù*—by
nomenclatures; *baddhäù*—conditioned; *vahanti*—carry on; *balim*—orders;
éçituù—for being controlled by the Supreme Lord.

TRANSLATION

As a cow, bound through the nose by a long rope, is conditioned, so also human beings are bound by different Vedic injunctions and are conditioned to obey the orders of the Supreme.

PURPORT

Every living being, whether a man or an animal or a bird, thinks that he is free by himself, but actually no one is free from the severe laws of the Lord. The laws of the Lord are severe because they cannot be disobeyed in any circumstance. The man-made laws may be evaded by cunning outlaws, but in the codes of the supreme lawmaker there is not the slightest possibility of neglecting the laws. A slight change in the course of God-made law can bring about a massive danger to be faced by the lawbreaker. Such laws of the Supreme are generally known as the codes of religion, under different

conditions, but the principle of religion everywhere is one and the same, namely, obey the orders of the Supreme God, the codes of religion. That is the condition of material existence. All living beings in the material world have taken up the risk of conditioned life by their own selection and are thus entrapped by the laws of material nature. The only way to get out of the entanglement is to agree to obey the Supreme. But instead of becoming free from the clutches of *māyā*, or illusion, foolish human beings become bound up by different nomenclatures, being designated as *brahmanas*, *kṣatriyas*, *vaisyas*, *sudras*, Hindus, Mohammedans, Indians, Europeans, Americans, Chinese, and many others, and thus they carry out the orders of the Supreme Lord under the influence of respective scriptural or legislative injunctions. The statutory laws of the state are imperfect imitation replicas of religious codes. The secular state, or the godless state, allows the citizens to break the laws of God, but restricts them from disobeying the laws of the state; the result is that the people in general suffer more by breaking the laws of God than by obeying the imperfect laws made by man. Every man is imperfect by constitution under conditions of material existence, and there is not the least possibility that even the most materially advanced man can enact perfect legislation. On the other hand, there is no such imperfection in the laws of God. If leaders are educated in the laws of God, there is no necessity of a makeshift legislative council of aimless men. There is necessity of change in the makeshift laws of man, but there is no change in the God-made laws because they are made perfect by the all-perfect Personality of Godhead. The codes of religion, scriptural injunctions, are made by liberated representatives of God in consideration of different conditions of living, and by carrying out the orders of the Lord, the conditioned living beings gradually become free from the clutches of material existence. The factual position of the living being is, however, that he is the eternal servitor of the Supreme Lord. In his liberated state he renders service to the Lord in transcendental love and thus enjoys a life of full freedom, even sometimes on an equal level with the Lord or sometimes more than the Lord. But in the conditioned material world, every living being wants to be the Lord of other living beings, and thus by the illusion of *māyā* this mentality of lording it over becomes a cause of further extension of conditional life. So in the material world the living being is still more conditioned, until he surrenders unto the Lord by reviving his original state of eternal servitorship. That is the last instruction

of the *Bhagavad-gita* and all other recognized scriptures of the world.

TEXT 43

YaQaa §-l@aePaSk-ra<aa& Sa&YaaeGaivGaMaaivh)
wC^Yaa §-li@Tau" SYaaTaa& TaQaEveXaeC^Yaa Na*<aaMa()) 43))

yathä kréòopaskaräëää

saàyoga-vigamäv iha

icchayä kréòituù syätää

tathaiveçecchayä nâëäm

SYNONYMS

yathä—as much as; *kréòopaskaräëäm*—playthings; *saàyoga*—union; *vigamau*—disunion; *iha*—in this world; *icchayä*—by the will of; *kréòituù*—just to play a part; *syätäm*—takes place; *tathä*—so also; *eva*—certainly; *éça*—the Supreme Lord; *icchayä*—by the will of; *nâëäm*—of the human beings.

TRANSLATION

As a player sets up and disperses his playthings according to his own sweet will, so the supreme will of the Lord brings men together and separates them.

PURPORT

We must know for certain that the particular position in which we are now set up is an arrangement of the supreme will in terms of our own acts in the past. The Supreme Lord is present as the localized Paramätmä in the heart of every living being, as it is said in the *Bhagavad-gita* (13.23), and therefore he knows everything of our activities in every stage of our lives. He rewards the reactions of our actions by placing us in some particular

place. A rich man gets his son born with a silver spoon in his mouth, but the child who came as the rich man's son deserved such a place, and therefore he is placed there by the will of the Lord. And at a particular moment when the child has to be removed from that place, he is also carried by the will of the Supreme, even if the child or the father does not wish to be separated from the happy relation. The same thing happens in the case of a poor man also. Neither rich man nor poor man has any control over such meetings or separations of living beings. The example of a player and his playthings should not be misunderstood. One may argue that since the Lord is bound to award the reactionary results of our own actions, the example of a player cannot be applied. But it is not so. We must always remember that the Lord is the supreme will, and He is not bound by any law. Generally the law of *karma* is that one is awarded the result of one's own actions, but in special cases, by the will of the Lord, such resultant actions are changed also. But this change can be affected by the will of the Lord only, and no other. Therefore, the example of the player cited in this verse is quite appropriate, for the Supreme Will is absolutely free to do whatever He likes, and because He is all-perfect, there is no mistake in any of His actions or reactions. These changes of resultant actions are especially rendered by the Lord when a pure devotee is involved. It is assured in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.30–31) that the Lord saves a pure devotee who has surrendered unto Him without reservation from all sorts of reactions of sins, and there is no doubt about this. There are hundreds of examples of reactions changed by the Lord in the history of the world. If the Lord is able to change the reactions of one's past deeds, then certainly He is not Himself bound by any action or reaction of His own deeds. He is perfect and transcendental to all laws.

TEXT 44

YaNMaNYaSae Da]uv& I/aek-MaDa]uv& va Na cae>aYaMa()
SavRQaa Na ih XaaeCYaaSTae òehadNYa}a MaaehJaaTa()) 44))

yan manyase dhruvaà lokam

adhruvaà vā na cobhayam

sarvathä na hi çocyäs te

snehäd anyatra mohajät

SYNONYMS

yat—even though; *manyase*—you think; *dhruvam*—Absolute Truth; *lokam*—persons; *adhruvam*—nonreality; *vä*—either; *na*—or not; *ca*—also; *ubhayam*—or both; *sarvathä*—in all circumstances; *na*—never; *hi*—certainly; *çocyäù*—subject for lamentation; *te*—they; *snehät*—due to affection; *anyatra*—or otherwise; *moha-jät*—due to bewilderment.

TRANSLATION

O King, in all circumstances, whether you consider the soul to be an eternal principle, or the material body to be perishable, or everything to exist in the impersonal Absolute Truth, or everything to be an inexplicable combination of matter and spirit, feelings of separation are due only to illusory affection and nothing more.

PURPORT

The actual fact is that every living being is an individual part and parcel of the Supreme Being, and his constitutional position is subordinate cooperative service. Either in his conditional material existence or in his liberated position of full knowledge and eternity, the living entity is eternally under the control of the Supreme Lord. But those who are not conversant with factual knowledge put forward many speculative propositions about the real position of the living entity. It is admitted, however, by all schools of philosophy, that the living being is eternal and that the covering body of the five material elements is perishable and temporary. The eternal living entity transmigrates from one material body to another by the law of *karma*, and material bodies are perishable by their fundamental structures. Therefore there is nothing to be lamented in the case of the soul's being transferred into another body, or the material body's perishing at a certain stage. There are others also who believe in the merging of the spirit soul in the Supreme Spirit when it is uncovered by the

material encagement, and there are others also who do not believe in the existence of spirit or soul, but believe in tangible matter. In our daily experience we find so many transformations of matter from one form to another, but we do not lament such changing features. In either of the above cases, the force of divine energy is uncheckable; no one has any hand in it, and thus there is no cause of grief.

TEXT 45

**TaSMaaÂù® vE©-VYaMajaNak*-TaMaaTMaNa")
k-Qa& TvNaaQaa" k*-Pa<aa vTaeRr&STae c Maa& ivNaa)) 45))**

tasmäj jahy aìga vaiklavyam

ajjāna-kātam ātmanaù

kathaà tv anāthäù kāpaëä

varteraàs te ca mää vinä

SYNONYMS

tasmät—therefore; *jahi*—give up; *aìga*—O King; *vaiklavyam*—mental disparity; *ajjāna*—ignorance; *kātam*—due to; *ātmanaù*—of yourself; *katham*—how; *tu*—but; *anāthäù*—helpless; *kāpaëäù*—poor creatures; *varteran*—be able to survive; *te*—they; *ca*—also; *mäm*—me; *vinä*—without.

TRANSLATION

Therefore give up your anxiety due to ignorance of the self. You are now thinking of how they, who are helpless poor creatures, will exist without you.

PURPORT

When we think of our kith and kin as being helpless and dependent on us, it

is all due to ignorance. Every living creature is allowed all protection by the order of the Supreme Lord in terms of each one's acquired position in the world. The Lord is known as *bhūta-bhāt*, one who gives protection to all living beings. One should discharge his duties only, for no one but the Supreme Lord can give protection to anyone else. This is explained more clearly in the following verse.

TEXT 46

k-al/k-MaRGau<aaDaqNaae dehae_Ya& PaaÄ>aaEiTak-")
k-QaMaNYaa&STau GaaePaaYaeTSaPaRGa]STaae YaQaa ParMa()) 46))

kāla-karma-guëädhéno

deho 'yaà päïca-bhautikaù

katham anyäàs tu gopäyet

sarpa-grasto yathä param

SYNONYMS

kāla—eternal time; *karma*—action; *guëa*—modes of nature; *adhénaù*—under the control of; *dehaù*—material body and mind; *ayam*—this; *päïca-bhautikaù*—made of the five elements; *katham*—how; *anyän*—others; *tu*—but; *gopäyet*—give protection; *sarpa-grastaù*—one who is bitten by the snake; *yathä*—as much as; *param*—others.

TRANSLATION

This gross material body made of five elements is already under the control of eternal time [kāla], action [karma] and the modes of material nature [guëa]. How, then, can it, being already in the jaws of the serpent, protect others?

PURPORT

The world's movements for freedom through political, economic, social, and cultural propaganda can do no benefit to anyone, for they are controlled by superior power. A conditioned living being is under the full control of material nature, represented by eternal time and activities under the dictation of different modes of nature. There are three material modes of nature, namely goodness, passion and ignorance. Unless one is situated in the mode of goodness, one cannot see things as they are. The passionate and the ignorant cannot even see things as they are. Therefore a person who is passionate and ignorant cannot direct his activities on the right path. Only the man in the quality of goodness can help to a certain extent. Most persons are passionate and ignorant, and therefore their plans and projects can hardly do any good to others. Above the modes of nature is eternal time, which is called *kāla* because it changes the shape of everything in the material world. Even if we are able to do something temporarily beneficial, time will see that the good project is frustrated in course of time. The only thing possible to be done is to get rid of eternal time, *kāla*, which is compared to *kāla-sarpa*, or the cobra snake, whose bite is always lethal. No one can be saved from the bite of a cobra. The best remedy for getting out of the clutches of the cobralike *kāla* or its integrity, the modes of nature, is *bhakti-yoga*, as it is recommended in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (14.26). The highest perfectional project of philanthropic activities is to engage everyone in the act of preaching *bhakti-yoga* all over the world because that alone can save the people from the control of *māyā*, or the material nature represented by *kāla*, *karma* and *guṇa*, as described above. The ***Bhagavad-gita*** (14.26) confirms this definitely.

TEXT 47

AhSTaaiNa SahSTaaNaaMaPadaiNa cTauZPadaMa()
f-LGaUiNa Ta}a MahTaa& Jaqvae JaqvSYa JaqvNaMa()) 47))

ahastāni sahaṣṭānām

apadāni catuṣṭ-padām

phalgūni tatra mahatāā

jévo jivasya jévanam

SYNONYMS

ahastāni—those who are devoid of hands; *sa-hastānām*—of those who are endowed with hands; *apadāni*—those who are devoid of legs; *catuṣ-padām*—of those who have four legs; *phalgūni*—those who are weak; *tatra*—there; *mahatām*—of the powerful; *jévaṁ*—the living being; *jivasya*—of the living being; *jévanam*—subsistence.

TRANSLATION

Those who are devoid of hands are prey for those who have hands; those devoid of legs are prey for the four-legged. The weak are the subsistence of the strong, and the general rule holds that one living being is food for another.

PURPORT

A systematic law of subsistence in the struggle for existence is there by the supreme will, and there is no escape for anyone by any amount of planning. The living beings who have come to the material world against the will of the Supreme Being are under the control of a supreme power called *māyā-çakti*, the deputed agent of the Lord, and this *daivé māyā* is meant to pinch the conditioned souls by threefold miseries, one of which is explained here in this verse: *the weak are the subsistence of the strong*. No one is strong enough to protect himself from the onslaught of a stronger, and by the will of the Lord there are systematic categories of the weak, the stronger and the strongest. There is nothing to be lamented if a tiger eats a weaker animal, including a man, because that is the law of the Supreme Lord. But although the law states that a human being must subsist on another living being, there is the law of good sense also, for the human being is meant to obey the laws of the scriptures. This is impossible for other animals. The human being is meant for self-realization, and for that purpose he is not to eat anything which is not first offered to the Lord. The Lord accepts from His devotee all kinds of food preparations made of vegetables, fruits, leaves and grains. Fruits, leaves and milk in different varieties can be offered to

the Lord, and after the Lord accepts the foodstuff, the devotee can partake of the *prasāda*, by which all suffering in the struggle for existence will be gradually mitigated. This is confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.26). Even those who are accustomed to eat animals can offer foodstuff, not to the Lord directly, but to an agent of the Lord, under certain conditions of religious rites. Injunctions of the scriptures are meant not to encourage the eaters of animals, but to restrict them by regulated principles.

The living being is the source of subsistence for other, stronger living beings. No one should be very anxious for his subsistence in any circumstances because there are living beings everywhere, and no living being starves for want of food at any place. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira is advised by Nārada not to worry about his uncles' suffering for want of food, for they could live on vegetables available in the jungles as *prasāda* of the Supreme Lord and thus realize the path of salvation.

Exploitation of the weaker living being by the stronger is the natural law of existence; there is always an attempt to devour the weak in different kingdoms of living beings. There is no possibility of checking this tendency by any artificial means under material conditions; it can be checked only by awakening the spiritual sense of the human being by practice of spiritual regulations. The spiritual regulative principles, however, do not allow a man to slaughter weaker animals on one side and teach others peaceful coexistence. If man does not allow the animals peaceful coexistence, how can he expect peaceful existence in human society? The blind leaders must therefore understand the Supreme Being and then try to implement the kingdom of God. The kingdom of God, or Rāma-rājya, is impossible without the awakening of God consciousness in the mass mind of the people of the world.

TEXT 48

Taidd& >aGavaNa(raJaàek- AaTMaaTMaNaa& Svd*k(-)
ANTarae_NaNTarae >aaiTa PaXYa Ta& MaaYaYaaeåDaa)) 48))

tad idaà bhagavān rājann

eka ätmätmanää sva-dåk

antaro 'nantaro bhäti

paçya taà mäyayorudhä

SYNONYMS

tat—therefore; *idam*—this manifestation; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *räjan*—O King; *eka*—one without a second; *ätmä*—the Supersoul; *ätmanäm*—by His energies; *sva-dåk*—qualitatively like Him; *antara*—without; *anantara*—within and by Himself; *bhäti*—so manifests; *paçya*—look; *tam*—unto Him only; *mäyayä*—by manifestations of different energies; *urudhä*—appears to be many.

TRANSLATION

Therefore, O King, you should look to the Supreme Lord only, who is one without a second and who manifests Himself by different energies and is both within and without.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord Personality of Godhead is one without a second, but He manifests Himself by different energies because He is by nature blissful. The living beings are also manifestations of His marginal energy, qualitatively one with the Lord, and there are innumerable living beings both within and without the external and internal energies of the Lord. Since the spiritual world is a manifestation of the Lord's internal energy, the living beings within that internal potency are qualitatively one with the Lord without contamination from the external potency. Although qualitatively one with the Lord, the living being, due to contamination of the material world, is pervertedly manifested, and therefore he experiences so-called happiness and distress in the material world. Such experiences are all ephemeral and do not affect the spirit soul. The perception of such ephemeral happiness and distress is due only to the forgetfulness of his qualities, which are equal to the Lord's. There is, however, a regular current

from the Lord Himself, from within and without, by which to rectify the fallen condition of the living being. From within He corrects the desiring living beings as localized Paramātmā, and from without He corrects by His manifestations, the spiritual master and the revealed scriptures. One should look unto the Lord; one should not be disturbed by the so-called manifestations of happiness or distress, but he should try to cooperate with the Lord in His outward activities for correcting the fallen souls. By His order only, one should become a spiritual master and cooperate with the Lord. One should not become a spiritual master for one's personal benefit, for some material gain or as an avenue of business or occupation for earning livelihood. Bona fide spiritual masters who look unto the Supreme Lord to cooperate with Him are actually qualitatively one with the Lord, and the forgetful ones are perverted reflections only. Yudhiñöhira Mahārāja is advised by Nārada, therefore, not to be disturbed by the affairs of so-called happiness and distress, but to look only unto the Lord to execute the mission for which the Lord has descended. That was his prime duty.

TEXT 49

Saae_YaMaû MaharaJa >aGavaNa(>aUTa>aavNa")
k-al/æPaae_vTaq<aaeR_SYaaMa>aavaYa SauriÜzaMa()) 49))

so 'yam adya mahārāja

bhagavān bhūta-bhāvanaù

kāla-rūpo 'vatérëo 'syām

abhäväya sura-dviñäm

SYNONYMS

saù—that Supreme Lord; *ayam*—the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *adya*—at present; *mahārāja*—O King; *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *bhūta-bhāvanaù*—the creator or the father of everything created; *kāla-rūpaù*—in the disguise of all-devouring time; *avatérëaù*—descended; *asyām*—upon the world; *abhäväya*—for eliminating; *sura-dviñäm*—those who are against

the will of the Lord.

TRANSLATION

That Supreme Personality of Godhead, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, in the guise of all-devouring time [kāla-rūpa] has now descended on earth to eliminate the envious from the world.

PURPORT

There are two classes of human beings, namely the envious and the obedient. Since the Supreme Lord is one and the father of all living beings, the envious living beings are also His sons, but they are known as the *asuras*. But the living beings who are obedient to the supreme father are called *devatās*, or demigods, because they are not contaminated by the material conception of life. Not only are the *asuras* envious of the Lord in even denying the existence of the Lord, but they are also envious of all other living beings. The predominance of *asuras* in the world is occasionally rectified by the Lord when He eliminates them from the world and establishes a rule of *devatās* like the Pāṇḍavas. His designation as *kāla* in disguise is significant. He is not at all dangerous, but He is the transcendental form of eternity, knowledge and bliss. For the devotees His factual form is disclosed, and for the nondevotees He appears like *kāla-rūpa*, which is causal form. This causal form of the Lord is not at all pleasing to the *asuras*, and therefore they think of the Lord as formless in order to feel secure that they will not be vanquished by the Lord.

TEXT 50

iNaZPaaidTa& devk*-TYaMavXaez& Pa[Taq+aTae)
Taavd(YaUYaMave+aß& >aved(Yaavidheir")) 50))

niñpāditaà deva-kātyam

avaṇeñāà pratékñate

tāvad yüyam avekñadhvaà

bhaved yāvad iheçvaraù

SYNONYMS

niñpāditam—performed; *deva-kātyam*—what was to be done on behalf of the demigods; *avaçeñam*—the rest; *pratékñate*—being awaited; *tāvat*—up to that time; *yüyam*—all of you Pääòavas; *avekñadhvam*—observe and wait; *bhabet*—may; *yāvat*—as long as; *iha*—in this world; *éçvaraù*—the Supreme Lord.

TRANSLATION

The Lord has already performed His duties to help the demigods, and He is awaiting the rest. You Pääòavas may wait as long as the Lord is here on earth.

PURPORT

The Lord descends from His abode (Kṛṣṇaloka), the topmost planet in the spiritual sky, in order to help the demigod administrators of this material world when they are greatly vexed by the *asuras*, who are envious not only of the Lord but also of His devotees. As referred to above, the conditioned living beings contact material association by their own choice, dictated by a strong desire to lord it over the resources of the material world and become imitation lords of all they survey. Everyone is trying to become an imitation God; there is keen competition amongst such imitation gods, and such competitors are generally known as *asuras*. When there are too many *asuras* in the world, then it becomes a hell for those who are devotees of the Lord. Due to the growth of the *asuras*, the mass of people who are generally devoted to the Lord by nature and the pure devotees of the Lord, including the demigods in higher planets, pray to the Lord for relief, and the Lord either descends personally from His abode or deposes some of His devotees to remodel the fallen condition of human society, or even animal society. Such disruptions take place not only in human society but also among animals, birds or other living beings, including the demigods in the higher planets. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa descended personally to vanquish *asuras* like Kaàsa, Jaräsandha and Çiçupäla, and during the reign of Mahārāja

Yudhiñöhira almost all these *asuras* were killed by the Lord. Now he was awaiting the annihilation of His own dynasty, called the Yadu-vaàça, who appeared by His will in this world. He wanted to take them away before His own departure to His eternal abode. Nārada, like Vidura, did not disclose the imminent annihilation of the Yadu dynasty, but indirectly gave a hint to the King and his brothers to wait till the incident happened and the Lord departed.

TEXT 51

Da*Taraí\" Sah >a]a}aa GaaNDaaYaaR c Sv>aaYaRYaa)
di+a<aeNa ihMavTa %ºzq<aaMaaé[Ma& GaTa")) 51))

dhâtarāñörau saha bhrātrā

gāndhāryā ca sva-bhāryayā

dakñiëena himavata

añëëäm āçramaà gatau

SYNONYMS

dhâtarāñörau—Dhâtarāñöra; *saha*—along with; *bhrātrā*—his brother Vidura; *gāndhāryā*—Gāndhäre also; *ca*—and; *sva-bhāryayā*—his own wife; *dakñiëena*—by the southern side; *himavatau*—of the Himalaya Mountains; *añëëäm*—of the *añis*; *āçramam*—in shelter; *gatau*—he has gone.

TRANSLATION

O King, your uncle Dhâtarāñöra, his brother Vidura and his wife Gāndhäre have gone to the southern side of the Himalaya Mountains, where there are shelters of the great sages.

PURPORT

To pacify the mourning Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, Nārada first of all spoke

from the philosophical point of view, and then he began to describe the future movements of his uncle, which he could see by his foreseeing powers, and thus began to describe as follows.

TEXT 52

óaeTaaei>a" Saái>aYaaR vE SvDauRNAq SaáDaa VYaDaaTa()
SaáaNaa& Pa[qTaYae NaaNaa SaáóaeTa" Pa[c+aTae)) 52))

srotobhiù saptabhir yā vai

svardhuné saptadhā vyadhāt

saptānāà prēṭaye nānā

sapta-srotaù pracakñate

SYNONYMS

srotobhiù—by currents; *saptabhiù*—by seven (divisions); *yā*—the river; *vai*—certainly; *svardhuné*—the sacred Ganges; *saptadhā*—seven branches; *vyadhāt*—created; *saptānām*—of the seven; *prēṭaye*—for the satisfaction of; *nānā*—various; *sapta-srotaù*—seven sources; *pracakñate*—known by name.

TRANSLATION

The place is called Saptasrota [“divided by seven”] because there the waters of the sacred Ganges were divided into seven branches. This was done for the satisfaction of the seven great āñis.

TEXT 53

òaTvauNauSavNa& TaiSMaNHuTva caGanqNYaQaaiviDa)
AB>a+a oPaXaaNTaaTMaa Sa AaSTae ivGaTaEz<a")) 53))

snātvānusavanaà tasmin

hutvā cāgnén yathā-vidhi

ab-bhakñā upaṣāntātmā

sa āste vigataiñāēaù

SYNONYMS

snātvā—by taking bath; *anusavanam*—regularly three times (morning, noon and evening); *tasmin*—in that Ganges divided into seven; *hutvā*—by performing the Agni-hotra sacrifice; *ca*—also; *agnén*—in the fire; *yathā-vidhi*—just according to the tenets of the scripture; *ap-bhakñāù*—fasting by drinking only water; *upaṣānta*—completely controlled; *ātmā*—the gross senses and the subtle mind; *saù*—Dhātārāññōra; *āste*—would be situated; *vigata*—devoid of; *eñāēaù*—thoughts in relation with family welfare.

TRANSLATION

On the banks at Saptasrota, Dhātārāññōra is now engaged in beginning añōāga-yoga by bathing three times daily, in the morning, noon and evening, by performing the Agni-hotra sacrifice with fire and by drinking only water. This helps one control the mind and the senses and frees one completely from thoughts of familial affection.

PURPORT

The *yoga* system is a mechanical way to control the senses and the mind and divert them from matter to spirit. The preliminary processes are the sitting posture, meditation, spiritual thoughts, manipulation of air passing within the body, and gradual situation in trance, facing the Absolute Person, Paramātmā. Such mechanical ways of rising to the spiritual platform prescribe some regulative principles of taking bath daily three times, fasting as far as possible, sitting and concentrating the mind on spiritual matters and thus gradually becoming free from *viñaya*, or material objectives. Material existence means to be absorbed in the material objective, which is simply illusory. House, country, family, society, children, property, and business are some of the material coverings of the spirit,

ätmä, and the *yoga* system helps one to become free from all these illusory thoughts and gradually turn towards the Absolute Person, Paramätmä. By material association and education, we learn simply to concentrate on flimsy things, but *yoga* is the process of forgetting them altogether. Modern so-called *yogés* and *yoga* systems manifest some magical feats, and ignorant persons are attracted by such false things, or they accept the *yoga* system as a cheap healing process for diseases of the gross body. But factually the *yoga* system is the process of learning to forget what we have acquired throughout the struggle for existence. Dhåtaråñöra was all along engaged in improving family affairs by raising the standard of living of his sons or by usurping the property of the Pääòavas for the sake of his own sons. These are common affairs for a man grossly materialistic and without knowledge of the spiritual force. He does not see how this can drag one from heaven to hell. By the grace of his younger brother Vidura, Dhåtaråñöra was enlightened and could see his grossly illusory engagements, and by such enlightenment he was able to leave home for spiritual realization. Sri Näradadeva was just foretelling the way of his spiritual progress in a place which was sanctified by the flow of the celestial Ganges. Drinking water only, without solid food, is also considered fasting. This is necessary for advancement of spiritual knowledge. A foolish man wants to be a cheap *yogé* without observing the regulative principles. A man who has no control over the tongue at first can hardly become a *yogé*. *Yogé* and *bhogé* are two opposite terms. The *bhogé*, or the merry man who eats and drinks, cannot be a *yogé*, for a *yogé* is never allowed to eat and drink unrestrictedly. We may note with profit how Dhåtaråñöra began his *yoga* system by drinking water only and sitting calmly in a place with a spiritual atmosphere, deeply absorbed in the thoughts of the Lord Hari, the Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 54

iJaTaaSaNaæe iJaTaiaSa" Pa[TYaaôTazi@iNd]Ya")
 hir>aavNaYaa ßSTarJa"SatvTaMaaeMal/")) 54))

jitäsano jita-çväsau

pratyähåta-ñåò-indriyaù

hari-bhāvanayā dhvasta-

rajaù-sattva-tamaù

SYNONYMS

jita-āsanaù—one who has controlled the sitting posture; *jita-çvāsaù*—one who has controlled the breathing process; *pratyāhāta*—turning back; *ñāō*—six; *indriyaù*—senses; *hari*—the Absolute Personality of Godhead; *bhāvanayā*—absorbed in; *dhvasta*—conquered; *rajaù*—passion; *sattva*—goodness; *tamaù*—ignorance; *malaù*—contaminations.

TRANSLATION

One who has controlled the sitting postures [the yogic āsanās] and the breathing process can turn the senses toward the Absolute Personality of Godhead and thus become immune to the contaminations of the modes of material nature, namely mundane goodness, passion and ignorance.

PURPORT

The preliminary activities of the way of *yoga* are *āsana*, *prāëyāma*, *pratyāhāra*, *dhyāna*, *dhāraëä*, etc. Mahārāja Dhātārāñōra was to attain success in those preliminary actions because he was seated in a sanctified place and was concentrating upon one objective, namely the Supreme Personality of Godhead (Hari). Thus all his senses were being engaged in the service of the Lord. This process directly helps the devotee to get freedom from the contaminations of the three material modes of nature. Even the highest mode, the material mode of goodness, is also a cause of material bondage, and what to speak of the other qualities, namely passion and ignorance. Passion and ignorance increase the material propensities of hankering for material enjoyment, and a strong sense of lust provokes the accumulation of wealth and power. One who has conquered these two base mentalities and has raised himself to the platform of goodness, which is full of knowledge and morality, cannot also control the senses, namely the eyes, the tongue, the nose, the ear and touch. But one who has surrendered himself unto the lotus feet of Lord Hari, as above mentioned,

can transcend all influences of the modes of material nature and be fixed in the service of the Lord. The *bhakti-yoga* process, therefore, directly applies the senses to the loving service of the Lord. This prohibits the performer from engaging in material activities. This process of turning the senses from material attachment to the loving transcendental service of the Lord is called *pratyāhāra*, and the very process is called *prāëyāma*, ultimately ending in *samādhi*, or absorption in pleasing the Supreme Lord Hari by all means.

TEXT 55

ivjaNaaTMaiNa Sa&YaaeJYa +ae}aje Pa[ivl/aPYa TaMa()
b]ø<YaaTMaaNaMaaDaare ga\$=aMbriMavaMbre)) 55))

vijñānātmani saàyojya

kñetrajñe pravilāpya tam

brahmaëy ātmānam ādhāre

ghaöāmbaram ivāmbare

SYNONYMS

vijñāna—purified identity; *ātmani*—in intelligence; *saàyojya*—perfectly fixing; *kñetra-jñe*—in the matter of the living being; *pravilāpya*—merging; *tam*—him; *brahmaëi*—in the Supreme; *ātmānam*—pure living being; *ādhāre*—in the reservoir; *ghaöa-ambaram*—sky within the block; *iva*—like; *ambare*—in the supreme sky.

TRANSLATION

Dhātaraññōra will have to amalgamate his pure identity with intelligence and then merge into the Supreme Being with knowledge of his qualitative oneness, as a living entity, with the Supreme Brahman. Being freed from the blocked sky, he will have to rise to the spiritual sky.

PURPORT

The living being, by his desiring to lord it over the material world and declining to cooperate with the Supreme Lord, contacts the sum total of the material world, namely the *mahat-tattva*, and from the *mahat-tattva* his false identity with the material world, intelligence, mind and senses is developed. This covers his pure spiritual identity. By the yogic process, when his pure identity is realized in self-realization, one has to revert to the original position by amalgamating the five gross elements and the subtle elements, mind and intelligence, into the *mahat-tattva* again. Thus getting freed from the clutches of the *mahat-tattva*, he has to merge in the existence of the Supersoul. In other words, he has to realize that qualitatively he is nondifferent from the Supersoul, and thus he transcends the material sky by his pure identical intelligence and thus becomes engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. This is the highest perfectional development of spiritual identity, which was attained by Dhātarañña by the grace of Vidura and the Lord. The Lord's mercy was bestowed upon him by his personal contact with Vidura, and when he was actually practicing the instructions of Vidura, the Lord helped him to attain the highest perfectional stage.

A pure devotee of the Lord does not live on any planet of the material sky, nor does he feel any contact with material elements. His so-called material body does not exist, being surcharged with the spiritual current of the Lord's identical interest, and thus he is permanently freed from all contaminations of the sum total of the *mahat-tattva*. He is always in the spiritual sky, which he attains by being transcendental to the sevenfold material covering by the effect of his devotional service. The conditioned souls are within the coverings, whereas the liberated soul is far beyond the cover.

TEXT 56

ṬSTaMaaYaaGau<aaedk-aeR iNaãÖk-r<aaXaYa")
iNaviTaRTaai%/ahar AaSTae SQaa<auirvacI/")
TaSYaaNTaraYaae MaEva>aU" Sa&NYaSTaai%/k-MaR<a")) 56))

dhvasta-mäyā-guëodarko

niruddha-karaëäçayaù

nivartitākhilāhāra

āste sthāëur ivācalaù

tasyāntarāyo maivābhüù

sannyastākhila-karmaëaù

SYNONYMS

dhvasta—being destroyed; *mäyā-guëa*—the modes of material nature; *udarkaù*—after effects; *niruddha*—being suspended; *karaëa-äçayaù*—the senses and the mind; *nivartita*—stopped; *akhila*—all; *ähāraù*—food for the senses; *āste*—is sitting; *sthāëuù*—immovable; *iva*—like; *acalaù*—fixed; *tasya*—his; *antarāyaù*—hindrances; *mā eva*—never like that; *abhüù*—be; *sannyasta*—renounced; *akhila*—all sorts; *karmaëaù*—material duties.

TRANSLATION

He will have to suspend all the actions of the senses, even from the outside, and will have to be impervious to interactions of the senses, which are influenced by the modes of material nature. After renouncing all material duties, he must become immovably established, beyond all sources of hindrances on the path.

PURPORT

Dhātārāñōra had attained, by the yogic process, the stage of negation of all sorts of material reaction. The effects of the material modes of nature draw the victim to indefatigable desires of enjoying matter, but one can escape such false enjoyment by the yogic process. Every sense is always busy in searching for its food, and thus the conditioned soul is assaulted from all sides and has no chance to become steady in any pursuit. Mahārāja

Yudhiñöhira was advised by Nārada not to disturb his uncle by attempting to bring him back home. He was now beyond the attraction of anything material. The material modes of nature (the *guṇas*) have their different modes of activities, but above the material modes of nature is a spiritual mode, which is absolute. *Nirguṇa* means without reaction. The spiritual mode and its effect are identical; therefore the spiritual quality is distinguished from its material counterpart by the word *nirguṇa*. After complete suspension of the material modes of nature, one is admitted to the spiritual sphere, and action dictated by the spiritual modes is called devotional service, or *bhakti*. *Bhakti* is therefore *nirguṇa* attained by direct contact with the Absolute.

TEXT 57

Sa va AÛTaNaad(raJaNa(ParTa" PaÄMae_hiNa)
k-le/vr& haSYaiTa Sv& TaÀ >aSMaq>aivZYaiTa)) 57))

sa vä adyatanäd räjan

parataù païcame 'hani

kalevaraà häsyati svaà

tac ca bhasmé-bhaviñyati

SYNONYMS

saù—he; *vä*—in all probability; *adya*—today; *tanät*—from; *räjan*—O King; *parataù*—ahead; *païcame*—on the fifth; *ahani*—day; *kalevaram*—body; *häsyati*—shall quit; *svam*—his own; *tat*—that; *ca*—also; *bhasmé*—ashes; *bhaviñyati*—will turn into.

TRANSLATION

**O King, he will quit his body, most probably on the fifth day from today.
And his body will turn to ashes.**

PURPORT

Nārada Muni's prophecy prohibited Yudhiñöhira Mahārāja from going to the place where his uncle was staying because even after quitting the body by his own mystic power, Dhātarāñöra would not be in need of any funeral ceremony; Nārada Muni indicated that his body by itself would burn to ashes. The perfection of the *yoga* system is attained by such mystic power. The *yogé* is able to quit his body by his own choice of time and can attain any planet he desires by turning the present body into ashes by self-made fire.

TEXT 58

dùMaaNae_iGani>adeRhe PaTYau" PaÒq Sahae\$=Jae)
bih" iSQaTaa PaiTa& Saaßq TaMaiGanMaNau ve+YaiTa)) 58))

dahyamäne 'gnibhir dehe

patyuù patné sahoöaje

bahiù sthitä patià sädhvé

tam agnim anu vekñyati

SYNONYMS

dahyamäne—while it is burning; *agnibhiù*—by the fire; *dehe*—the body; *patyuù*—of the husband; *patné*—the wife; *saha-uöaje*—along with the thatched cottage; *bahiù*—outside; *sthitä*—situated; *patim*—unto the husband; *sädhvé*—the chaste lady; *tam*—that; *agnim*—fire; *anu vekñyati*—looking with great attention will enter the fire.

TRANSLATION

While outside observing her husband, who will burn in the fire of mystic power along with his thatched cottage, his chaste wife will enter the fire with rapt attention.

PURPORT

Gāndhārē was an ideal chaste lady, a life companion of her husband, and therefore when she saw her husband burning in the fire of mystic *yoga* along with his cottage of leaves, she despaired. She left home after losing her one hundred sons, and in the forest she saw that her most beloved husband was also burning. Now she actually felt alone, and therefore she entered the fire of her husband and followed her husband to death. This entering of a chaste lady into the fire of her dead husband is called the *saté* rite, and the action is considered to be most perfect for a woman. In a later age, this *saté* rite became an obnoxious criminal affair because the ceremony was forced upon even an unwilling woman. In this fallen age it is not possible for any lady to follow the *saté* rite as chastely as it was done by Gāndhārē and others in past ages. A chaste wife like Gāndhārē would feel the separation of her husband to be more burning than actual fire. Such a lady can observe the *saté* rite voluntarily, and there is no criminal force by anyone. When the rite became a formality only and force was applied upon a lady to follow the principle, actually it became criminal, and therefore the ceremony was to be stopped by state law. This prophecy of Nārada Muni to Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira forbade him to go to his widowed aunt.

TEXT 59

ivdurSTau TadaêYa | iNaXaaMYa ku-âNaNdNa)
hzRXaaek-YauTaSTaSMaad(GaNTaa TaqQaRiNazevk-")) 59))

viduras tu tad äçcaryà

niçämya kuru-nandana

harña-çoka-yutas tasmäd

gantä tértha-niñevakaù

SYNONYMS

viduraù—Vidura also; *tu*—but; *tat*—that incident; *äçcaryam*—wonderful;

niçämya—seeing; *kuru-nandana*—O son of the Kuru dynasty; *harña*—delight; *çoka*—grief; *yutaù*—affected by; *tasmät*—from that place; *gantä*—will go away; *tértha*—place of pilgrimage; *niñevakaù*—for being enlivened.

TRANSLATION

Vidura, being affected with delight and grief, will then leave that place of sacred pilgrimage.

PURPORT

Vidura was astonished to see the marvelous departure of his brother Dhâtaräñöra as a liberated *yogé*, for in his past life he was much attached to materialism. Of course it was only due to Vidura that his brother attained the desirable goal of life. Vidura was therefore glad to learn about it. But he was sorry that he could not make his brother turn into a pure devotee. This was not done by Vidura because of Dhâtaräñöra's being inimical to the Pääòavas, who were all devotees of the Lord. An offense at the feet of a Vaiñëava is more dangerous than an offense at the lotus feet of the Lord. Vidura was certainly very liberal to bestow mercy upon his brother Dhâtaräñöra, whose past life was very materialistic. But ultimately the result of such mercy certainly depended on the will of the Supreme Lord in the present life; therefore Dhâtaräñöra attained liberation only, and after many such liberated states of life one can attain to the stage of devotional service. Vidura was certainly very mortified by the death of his brother and sister-in-law, and the only remedy to mitigate such lamentation was to go out to pilgrimage. Thus Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira had no chance to call back Vidura, his surviving uncle.

TEXT 60

**wTYauṁ-aQaañTa(SvGa| Naard" SahTauMbuå")
YauiDaiïrae vcSTaSYa ôid k*-TvaJahaC^uc")) 60))**

ity uktväthäruhat svargaà

näradaù saha-tumburuù

yudhiñöhira vacas tasya

hådi kåtvajahäc chucaù

SYNONYMS

iti—thus; *uktvä*—having addressed; *atha*—thereafter; *äruhat*—ascended; *svargam*—into outer space; *nāradaù*—the great sage Nārada; *saha*—along with; *tumburuù*—his stringed instrument; *yudhiñöhiraù*—Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira; *vacaù*—instructions; *tasya*—of his; *hådi kåtvä*—keeping in the heart; *ajahät*—gave up; *çucaù*—all lamentations.

TRANSLATION

Having spoken thus, the great sage Nārada, along with his véëä, ascended into outer space. Yudhiñöhira kept his instruction in his heart and so was able to get rid of all lamentations.

PURPORT

Sri Nārada-jé is an eternal spaceman, having been endowed with a spiritual body by the grace of the Lord. He can travel in the outer spaces of both the material and spiritual worlds without restriction and can approach any planet in unlimited space within no time. We have already discussed his previous life as the son of a maidservant. Because of his association with pure devotees, he was elevated to the position of an eternal spaceman and thus had freedom of movement. One should therefore try to follow in the footsteps of Nārada Muni and not make a futile effort to reach other planets by mechanical means. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was a pious king, and therefore he could see Nārada Muni occasionally; anyone who desires to see Nārada Muni must first be pious and follow in the footsteps of Nārada Muni.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Thirteenth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled “Dhåtaräñöra Quits Home.”

Chapter Fourteen

The Disappearance of Lord Kṛṣṇa

TEXT 1

SaUTa ovac

SaMPa[iSQaTae Üark-aYaa& iJaZ<aaE bNDauidd*+aYaa)
jaTau& c Pau<Yaëaek-SYa k*-Z<aSYa c ivceiíTaMa()) 1))

sūta uvāca

samprasthite dvārakāyā

jīñēau bandhu-didāṅṇayā

jīātuà ca puēya-çlokasya

kāñēasya ca viceñōitam

SYNONYMS

sūtaù uvāca—Sri Sūta Gosvami said; *samprasthite*—having gone to; *dvārakāyām*—the city of Dvārakā; *jīñēau*—Arjuna; *bandhu*—friends and relatives; *didāṅṇayā*—for meeting them; *jīātum*—to know; *ca*—also; *puēya-çlokasya*—of one whose glories are sung by Vedic hymns; *kāñēasya*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ca*—and; *viceñōitam*—further programs of work.

TRANSLATION

Sri Sūta Gosvami said: Arjuna went to Dvārakā to see Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and other friends and also to learn from the Lord of His next activities.

PURPORT

As stated in *Bhagavad-gita*, the Lord descended on earth for the protection of the faithful and annihilation of the impious, so after the Battle of Kurukṣetra and establishment of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, the mission of the

Lord was complete. The Pääòavas, especially Sri Arjuna, were eternal companions of the Lord, and therefore Arjuna went to Dvārakā to hear from the Lord of His next program of work.

TEXT 2

VYaTaqTaa" k-iTaicNMaaSaaSTada NaaYaataTaae_JauRNa")
ddXaR gaaeræPaai<a iNaiMataaiNa ku-æÜh")) 2))

vyatétäù katicin mäsäs

tadä näyät tato 'rjunaù

dadarça ghora-rüpäëi

nimittäni kurüdvahaù

SYNONYMS

vyatétäù—after passing; *katicit*—a few; *mäsäù*—months; *tadä*—at that time; *na äyät*—did not return; *tataù*—from there; *arjunaù*—Arjuna; *dadarça*—observed; *ghora*—fearful; *rüpäëi*—appearances; *nimittäni*—various causes; *kuru-udvahaù*—Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira.

TRANSLATION

A few months passed, and Arjuna did not return. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira then began to observe some inauspicious omens, which were fearful in themselves.

PURPORT

Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa the Supreme Personality of Godhead is *ad infinitum*, more powerful than the most powerful sun of our experience. Millions and billions of suns are created by Him and annihilated by Him within His one breathing period. In the material world the sun is considered to be the source of all productivity and material energy, and only due to the sun can

we have the necessities of life. Therefore, during the personal presence of the Lord on the earth, all paraphernalia for our peace and prosperity, especially religion and knowledge, were in full display because of the Lord's presence, just as there is a full flood of light in the presence of the glowing sun. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira observed some discrepancies in his kingdom, and therefore he became very anxious about Arjuna, who was long absent, and there was also no news about Dvārakā's well-being. He suspected the disappearance of Lord Kṛṣṇa, otherwise there would have been no possibility of fearful omens.

TEXT 3

k-al/SYa c GaiTa& raEd]a& ivPaYaRSTaTauRDaiMaR<a")
PaaPaqYaSaq& Na*<aa& vaTaa| §-aeDal/ae>aaNa*TaaTManaaMa()) 3))

kālasya ca gatiā raudrā

viparyastatu-dharmiëaù

pāpéyaséà nāëää vārtää

krodha-lobhänâtätmanäm

SYNONYMS

kālasya—of eternal time; *ca*—also; *gati*—direction; *raudrā*—fearful; *viparyasta*—reversed; *âtu*—seasonal; *dharmiëaù*—regularities; *pāpéyasém*—sinful; *nāëäm*—of the human being; *vārtäm*—means of livelihood; *krodha*—anger; *lobha*—greed; *anâta*—falsehood; *âtmanäm*—of the people.

TRANSLATION

He saw that the direction of eternal time had changed, and this was very fearful. There were disruptions in the seasonal regularities. The people in general had become very greedy, angry and deceitful. And he saw that they were adopting foul means of livelihood.

PURPORT

When civilization is disconnected from the loving relation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, symptoms like changes of seasonal regulations, foul means of livelihood, greed, anger and fraudulence become rampant. The change of seasonal regulations refers to one season's atmosphere becoming manifest in another season—for example the rainy season's being transferred to autumn, or the fructification of fruits and flowers from one season in another season. A godless man is invariably greedy, angry and fraudulent. Such a man can earn his livelihood by any means, black or white. During the reign of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, all the above symptoms were conspicuous by their absence. But Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was astonished to experience even a slight change in the godly atmosphere of his kingdom, and at once he suspected the disappearance of the Lord. Foul means of livelihood implies deviation from one's occupational duty. There are prescribed duties for everyone, such as the *brahmana*, *kñatriya*, *vaiçya* and *çüdra*, but anyone who deviates from his prescribed duty and declares another's duty to be his own is following a foul and improper duty. A man becomes too greedy for wealth and power when he has no higher objective in life and when he thinks that this earthly life of a few years is all in all. Ignorance is the cause for all these anomalies in human society, and to remove this ignorance, especially in this age of degradation, the powerful sun is there to distribute light in the shape of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 4

iJaøPa[aYa& VYavôTa& Xaa#yiMaé[& c SaaEôdMa()
iPaTa*MaaTa*Sauôd(>a]aTa*dMPaTaqNaa& c k-Lk-NaMa()) 4))

jihma-präyaà vyavahâtaà

çäöhya-miçraà ca sauhâdam

pitâ-mâtâ-suhâd-bhrâtâ-

dam-paténäà ca kalkanam

SYNONYMS

jihma-prāyam—cheating; *vyavahātam*—in all ordinary transactions; *çäöhya*—duplicity; *miçram*—adulterated in; *ca*—and; *sauhādam*—regarding friendly well-wishers; *pitā*—father; *mātā*—regarding the mother; *suhāt*—well-wishers; *bhrātā*—one’s own brother; *dam-paténām*—regarding husband and wife; *ca*—also; *kalkanam*—mutual quarrel.

TRANSLATION

All ordinary transactions and dealings became polluted with cheating, even between friends. And in familial affairs, there was always misunderstanding between fathers, mothers and sons, between well-wishers, and between brothers. Even between husband and wife there was always strain and quarrel.

PURPORT

A conditioned living being is endowed with four principles of malpractice, namely errors, insanity, inability and cheating. These are signs of imperfection, and out of the four the propensity to cheat others is most prominent. And this cheating practice is there in the conditioned souls because the conditioned souls are primarily in the material world imbued with an unnatural desire to lord it over the material world. A living being in his pure state is not conditioned by the laws because in his pure state he is conscious that a living being is eternally subservient to the Supreme Being, and thus it is always good for him to remain subservient, instead of falsely trying to lord it over the property of the Supreme Lord. In the conditioned state the living being is not satisfied even if he actually becomes the lord of all that he surveys, which he never becomes, and therefore he becomes the victim of all kinds of cheating, even with his nearest and most intimate relations. In such an unsatisfactory state of affairs, there is no harmony, even between father and sons or between husband and wife. But all these contending difficulties can be mitigated by one process, and that is the devotional service of the Lord. The world of hypocrisy can be checked only by counteraction through devotional service to the Lord and nothing else. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, having observed the disparities, conjectured the

disappearance of the Lord from the earth.

TEXT 5

iNaiMataaNYaTYairíaiNa k-ale/ TvNauGaTae Na*<aaMa()
l/ae>aaûDaMaRPa[k*-iT& d*îaevacaNauJa& Na*Pa")) 5))

nimittāny atyariññōāni

kāle tv anugate nāëām

lobhādy-adharma-prakātiā

dāñvovācānujaā nāpaù

SYNONYMS

nimittāni—causes; *ati*—very serious; *ariññōāni*—bad omens; *kāle*—in course of time; *tu*—but; *anugate*—passing away; *nāëām*—of humanity at large; *lobha-ādi*—such as greed; *adharma*—irreligious; *prakātim*—habits; *dāñvā*—having observed; *uvāca*—said; *anujam*—younger brother; *nāpaù*—the King.

TRANSLATION

In course of time it came to pass that people in general became accustomed to greed, anger, pride, etc. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, observing all these omens, spoke to his younger brother.

PURPORT

Such a pious king as Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira at once became perturbed when there were such inhuman symptoms as greed, anger, irreligiosity and hypocrisy rampant in society. It appears from this statement that all these symptoms of degraded society were unknown to the people of the time, and it was astonishing for them to have experienced them with the advent of the Kali-yuga, or the age of quarrel.

TEXT 6

YauiDaiir ovac

SaMPa[eizTaae Üark-aYaa& iJaZ<aubRNDauidd*+aYaa)
jaTau& c Pau<Yaëaek-SYa k*-Z<aSYa c ivceiíTaMa()) 6))

yudhiñöhira uväca

sampreñito dväarakäyää

jiñëur bandhu-didâkñayä

jïätuà ca puëya-çlokasya

kãñëasya ca viceñöitam

SYNONYMS

yudhiñöhiraù uväca—Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira said; *sampreñitaù*—has gone to; *dväarakäyäm*—Dväarakä; *jiñëuù*—Arjuna; *bandhu*—friends; *didâkñayä*—for the sake of meeting; *jïätum*—to know; *ca*—also; *puëya-çlokasya*—of the Personality of Godhead; *kãñëasya*—of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *ca*—and; *viceñöitam*—program of work.

TRANSLATION

Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira said to his younger brother Bhémasena, I sent Arjuna to Dväarakä to meet his friends and to learn from the Personality of Godhead Kṛṣṇa of His program of work.

TEXT 7

GaTaa" SaáaDauNaa MaaSaa >aqMaSaeNa TavaNauJa")
NaaYaaiTa k-SYa va heTaaeNaaRh& vededMaÅSaa)) 7))

gatäù saptädhunä mäsä

bhémasena tavānujaù

näyāti kasya vä hetor

nāhaà vededam aījasä

SYNONYMS

gatäù—has gone; *sapta*—seven; *adhunä*—to date; *mäsäù*—months; *bhémasena*—O Bhémasena; *tava*—your; *anujaù*—younger brother; *na*—does not; *äyāti*—come back; *kasya*—for what; *vä*—or; *hetoù*—reason; *na*—not; *aham*—I; *veda*—know; *idam*—this; *aījasä*—factually.

TRANSLATION

Since he departed, seven months have passed, yet he has not returned. I do not know factually how things are going there.

TEXT 8

AiPa devizR<aaidí" Sa k-al/ae_YaMauPaiSQaTa")
YadaTMaNaae_®Maa§-l@& >aGavaNauITSaSa*+aiTa)) 8))

api devarñiëädiñöaù

sa kälö 'yam upasthitaù

yadätmano 'igam äkrédaà

bhagavän utsisåkñati

SYNONYMS

api—whether; *deva-ñiëä*—by the demigod-saint (Nārada); *ädiñöaù*—instructed; *saù*—that; *käläù*—eternal time; *ayam*—this; *upasthitaù*—

arrived; *yadä*—when; *ätmanaù*—of His own self; *aìgam*—plenary portion; *äkréòam*—manifestation; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *utsisåkñati*—is going to quit.

TRANSLATION

Is He going to quit His earthly pastimes, as Devarñi Nārada indicated? Has that time already arrived?

PURPORT

As we have discussed many times, the Supreme Personality of Godhead Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa has many plenary expansions, and each and every one of them, although equally powerful, executes different functions. In *Bhagavad-gita* there are different statements by the Lord, and each of these statements is meant for different plenary portions or portions of the plenary portions. For example, Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Lord, says in *Bhagavad-gita*:

“Whenever and wherever there is a decline in religious practice, O descendant of Bharata, and a predominant rise of irreligion—at that time I descend Myself.” (Bg. 4.7)

“To deliver the faithful, to annihilate the miscreants and also to reestablish the principles of occupational duty, I appear in every age.” (Bg. 4.8)

“If I should cease to work, then all humanity would be misdirected. I would also be the cause of creating unwanted population, and I would thereby destroy the peace of all sentient beings.” (Bg. 3.24)

“Whatever action a great man performs, common men will follow. And whatever standards he sets by exemplary acts, all the world pursues.” (Bg. 3.21)

All the above statements by the Lord apply to different plenary portions of the Lord, namely His expansions such as Saṅkarṣṇa, Vāsudeva, Pradyumna, Aniruddha and Nārāyaṇa. These are all He Himself in different transcendental expansions, and still the Lord as Sri Kṛṣṇa functions in a

different sphere of transcendental exchange with different grades of devotees. And yet Lord Kṛṣṇa as He is appears once every twenty-four hours of Brahmā's time (or after a lapse of 8,640,000,000 solar years) in each and every universe, and all His transcendental pastimes are displayed in each and every universe in a routine spool. But in that routine spool the functions of Lord Kṛṣṇa, Lord Vāsudeva, etc., are complex problems for the layman. There is no difference between the Lord's Self and the Lord's transcendental body. The expansions execute differential activities. When the Lord, however, appears in His person as Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, His other plenary portions also join in Him by His inconceivable potency called *yogamāyā*, and thus the Lord Kṛṣṇa of Våndāvana is different from the Lord Kṛṣṇa of Mathurā or the Lord Kṛṣṇa of Dvārakā. The *virāṭ-rūpa* of Lord Kṛṣṇa is also different from Him, by His inconceivable potency. The *virāṭ-rūpa* exhibited on the Battlefield of Kurukṣetra is the material conception of His form. Therefore it should be understood that when Lord Kṛṣṇa was apparently killed by the bow and arrow of the hunter, the Lord left His so-called material body in the material world. The Lord is *kaivalya*, and for Him there is no difference between matter and spirit because everything is created from Him. Therefore His quitting one sort of body or accepting another body does not mean that He is like the ordinary living being. All such activities are simultaneously one and different by His inconceivable potency. When Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira was lamenting the possibility of His disappearance, it was just in pursuance of a custom of lamenting the disappearance of a great friend, but factually the Lord never quits His transcendental body, as is misconceived by less intelligent persons. Such less intelligent persons have been condemned by the Lord Himself in *Bhagavad-gītā*, and they are known as the *mūḍhas*. That the Lord left His body means that He left again His plenary portions in the respective *dhāmas* (transcendental abodes), as He left His *virāṭ-rūpa* in the material world.

TEXT 9

YaSMaaà" SaMPadae raJYa& dara" Pa[a<aa" ku-l&/ Pa[Jaa")
AaSaNa(SaPaÒivJaYaae l/aek-aê YadNauGa]haTa()) 9))

yasmān naù sampado rājyāà

däräù prääùù kulaà prajäù

äsan sapatna-vijayo

lokäç ca yad-anugrahät

SYNONYMS

yasmät—from whom; *naù*—our; *sampadaù*—opulence; *räjyam*—kingdom; *däräù*—good wives; *prääùù*—existence of life; *kulam*—dynasty; *prajäù*—subjects; *äsan*—have become possible; *sapatna*—competitors; *vijayaù*—conquering; *lokäù*—future accommodation in higher planets; *ca*—and; *yat*—by whose; *anugrahät*—by the mercy of.

TRANSLATION

From Him only, all our kingly opulence, good wives, lives, progeny, control over our subjects, victory over our enemies, and future accommodations in higher planets have become possible. All this is due to His causeless mercy upon us.

PURPORT

Material prosperity consists of a good wife, good home, sufficient land, good children, aristocratic family relations, victory over competitors and, by pious work, attainment of accommodations in the higher celestial planets for better facilities of material amenities. These facilities are earned not only by one's hard manual labor or by unfair means, but by the mercy of the Supreme Lord. Prosperity earned by one's personal endeavor also depends on the mercy of the Lord. Personal labor must be there in addition to the Lord's benediction, but without the Lord's benediction no one is successful simply by personal labor. The modernized man of Kali-yuga believes in personal endeavor and denies the benediction of the Supreme Lord. Even a great *sannyäse* of India delivered speeches in Chicago protesting the benedictions of the Supreme Lord. But as far as Vedic *sastras* are concerned, as we find in the pages of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, the ultimate sanction for all success rests in the hands of the Supreme Lord. Mahäräja

Yudhiñöhira admits this truth in his personal success, and it behooves one to follow in the footsteps of a great king and devotee of the Lord to make life a full success. If one could achieve success without the sanction of the Lord then no medical practitioner would fail to cure a patient. Despite the most advanced treatment of a suffering patient by the most up-to-date medical practitioner, there is death, and even in the most hopeless case, without medical treatment, a patient is cured astonishingly. Therefore the conclusion is that God’s sanction is the immediate cause for all happenings, good or bad. Any successful man should feel grateful to the Lord for all he has achieved.

TEXT 10

**PaXYaaeTPaaTaaàrVYaaga] idVYaaNa(>aaEMaaNa(SadEihk-aNa()
daâ<aaNa(Xa&SaTaae_dUraÜYa& Naae buiÖMaaehNaMa()) 10))**

paçyotpätän nara-vyāghra

divyän bhaumän sadaihikän

däruëän çaàsato ’düräd

bhayaà no buddhi-mohanam

SYNONYMS

paçya—just see; *utpätän*—disturbances; *nara-vyāghra*—O man of tigerlike strength; *divyän*—happenings in the sky or by planetary influence; *bhaumän*—happenings on the earth; *sa-daihikän*—happenings of the body and the mind; *däruëän*—awfully dangerous; *çaàsataù*—indicating; *adürät*—in the near future; *bhayam*—danger; *naù*—our; *buddhi*—intelligence; *mohanam*—deluding.

TRANSLATION

Just see, O man with a tiger’s strength, how many miseries due to celestial influences, earthly reactions and bodily pains—all very

dangerous in themselves—are foreboding danger in the near future by deluding our intelligence.

PURPORT

Material advancement of civilization means advancement of the reactions of the threefold miseries due to celestial influence, earthly reactions and bodily or mental pains. By the celestial influence of the stars there are many calamities like excessive heat, cold, rains or no rains, and the aftereffects are famine, disease and epidemic. The aggregate result is agony of the body and the mind. Man-made material science cannot do anything to counteract these threefold miseries. They are all punishments from the superior energy of *māyā* under the direction of the Supreme Lord. Therefore our constant touch with the Lord by devotional service can give us relief without our being disturbed in the discharge of our human duties. The *asuras*, however, who do not believe in the existence of God, make their own plans to counteract all these threefold miseries, and so they meet with failures every time. The ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.14) clearly states that the reaction of material energy is never to be conquered, because of the binding effects of the three modes. They can simply be overcome by one who surrenders fully in devotion under the lotus feet of the Lord.

TEXT 11

OvRi+abahvae Maù& Sfu-rNTYa® PauNa" PauNa")
vePaQauêaiPa ôdYae AaraÕaSYaiNTa iviPa[YaMa()) 11))

ürv-akñi-bāhavo mahyā

sphuranty aiga punaù punaù

vepathuḥ cāpi hādaye

ārād dāsyanti vipriyam

SYNONYMS

üru—thighs; *akñi*—eyes; *bähavaù*—the arms; *mahyam*—in my; *sphuranti*—quivering; *aiga*—left side of the body; *punaù punaù*—again and again; *vepathuù*—palpitations; *ca*—also; *api*—certainly; *hådaye*—in the heart; *ärät*—due to fear; *däsyanti*—indicating; *vipriyam*—undesirables.

TRANSLATION

The left side of my body, my thighs, arms and eyes are all quivering again and again. I am having heart palpitations due to fear. All this indicates undesirable happenings.

PURPORT

Material existence is full of undesirables. Things we do not want are forced upon us by some superior energy, and we do not see that these undesirables are under the grip of the three modes of material nature. When a man's eyes, arms and thighs all quiver constantly, one must know that something is going to happen which is undesirable. These undesirables are compared to fire in a forest. No one goes into the forest to set fires, but fires automatically take place in the forest, creating inconceivable calamities for the living beings of the forest. Such a fire cannot be extinguished by any human efforts. The fire can be extinguished only by the mercy of the Lord, who sends clouds to pour water on the forest. Similarly, undesirable happenings in life cannot be checked by any number of plans. Such miseries can be removed only by the mercy of the Lord, who sends His bona fide representatives to enlighten human beings and thus save them from all calamities.

TEXT 12

**iXavEzaeÛNTaMaaidTYaMai>araETYaNaI/aNaNaa)
MaaMa® SaarMaeYaae_YaMai>are>aTYa>aqãvTa()) 12))**

çivaiñodyantam ädityam

abhirauty analānanā

mām aiga sārameyo 'yam

abhirebhaty abhéruvat

SYNONYMS

çivā—jackal; *eñā*—this; *udyantam*—rising; *ādityam*—unto the sun; *abhi*—towards; *rauti*—crying; *anala*—fire; *ānanā*—face; *mām*—unto me; *aiga*—O Bhéma; *sārameyaù*—dog; *ayam*—this; *abhirebhati*—barks towards; *abhéru-vat*—without fear.

TRANSLATION

Just see, O Bhéma, how the she jackal cries at the rising sun and vomits fire, and how the dog barks at me fearlessly.

PURPORT

These are some bad omens indicating something undesirable in the near future.

TEXT 13

**XaSTaa" ku-vRiNTa Maa& SaVYa& di+a<a& PaXavae_Pare)
vaha&ê PauâzVYaaga] I/+aYae âdTaae MaMa)) 13))**

çastäù kurvanti mää savyaà

dakñiëaà paçavo 'pare

vähäàç ca puruṣa-vyāghra

lakñaye rudato mama

SYNONYMS

çastäù—useful animals like the cow; *kurvanti*—are keeping; *mām*—me;

savyam—on the left; *dakñiëam*—circumambulating; *paçavaù apare*—other lower animals like asses; *vähän*—the horses (carriers); *ca*—also; *puruṣa-vyāghra*—O tiger among men; *lakñaye*—I see; *rudataù*—weeping; *mama*—of mine.

TRANSLATION

O Bhémasena, tiger amongst men, now useful animals like cows are passing me on my left side, and lower animals like the asses are circumambulating me. My horses appear to weep upon seeing me.

TEXT 14

**Ma*TYaudUTa" k-PaaeTaae_YaMaulU/k-" k-MPaYaNa(MaNa")
Pa[TYaulU/k-ê ku-ûaNaEivRi& vEéUNYaiMaC^Ta")) 14))**

mātyu-dūtaù kapoto 'yam

ulūkaù kampayan manaù

pratyulūkaç ca kuhvānair

viçvaà vai çünyam icchataù

SYNONYMS

mātyu—death; *dūtaù*—messenger of; *kapotaù*—pigeon; *ayam*—this; *ulūkaù*—owl; *kampayan*—trembling; *manaù*—mind; *pratyulūkaù*—the rivals of owls (crows); *ca*—and; *kuhvānaiù*—shrieking scream; *viçvam*—the cosmos; *vai*—either; *çünyam*—void; *icchataù*—wishing.

TRANSLATION

Just see! This pigeon is like a messenger of death. The shrieks of the owls and their rival crows make my heart tremble. It appears that they want to make a void of the whole universe.

TEXT 15

DaUMa]a idXa" PairDaYa" k-MPaTae >aU" Sahaid]i>a")
iNagaaRTaê Maha&STaaTa Saak&- c STaNaiYaÒui>a")) 15))

dhümrä diçaù paridhayaù

kampate bhüù sahädribhiù

nirghätaç ca mahäàs täta

säkaà ca stanayitnubhiù

SYNONYMS

dhümräù—smoky; *diçaù*—all directions; *paridhayaù*—encirclement;
kampate—throbbing; *bhüù*—the earth; *saha adribhiù*—along with the hills
and mountains; *nirghätaù*—bolt from the blue; *ca*—also; *mahän*—very
great; *täta*—O Bhéma; *säkam*—with; *ca*—also; *stanayitnubhiù*—thundering
sound without any cloud.

TRANSLATION

Just see how the smoke encircles the sky. It appears that the earth and
mountains are throbbing. Just hear the cloudless thunder and see the
bolts from the blue.

TEXT 16

vaYauvaRiTä %rSPaXaaER rJaSaa ivSa*Ja&STaMa")
ASa*Ga(vzRiNTa Jal/da bq>aTSaiMav SavRTa")) 16))

väyur väti khara-sparço

rajasä visåjaàs tamaù

asåg varñanti jaladä

bébhatsam iva sarvataù

SYNONYMS

väyuù—wind; *väti*—blowing; *khara-sparçaù*—sharply; *rajasä*—by the dust; *visåjan*—creating; *tamaù*—darkness; *asåk*—blood; *varñanti*—are raining; *jaladäù*—the clouds; *bébhatsam*—disastrous; *iva*—like; *sarvataù*—everywhere.

TRANSLATION

The wind blows violently, blasting dust everywhere and creating darkness. Clouds are raining everywhere with bloody disasters.

TEXT 17

SaUYa | hTaPa[>a& PaXYa Ga]hMad | iMaQaae idiv)
SaSax(ku-IE/>aURTaGa<aEJvRil/Tae wv raedSaq)) 17))

süryaà hata-prabhaà paçya

graha-mardaà mitho divi

sasaikulair bhüta-gaëair

jvalite iva rodasé

SYNONYMS

süryam—the sun; *hata-prabham*—its rays declining; *paçya*—just see; *graha-mardam*—clashes of the stars; *mithaù*—among one another; *divi*—in the sky; *sa-saikulaiù*—being mixed with; *bhüta-gaëaiù*—by the living entities; *jvalite*—being ignited; *iva*—as if; *rodasé*—crying.

TRANSLATION

The rays of the sun are declining, and the stars appear to be fighting

amongst themselves. Confused living entities appear to be ablaze and weeping.

TEXT 18

NaŪae Nadaê +aui>aTaa" Sara&iSa c MaNaa&iSa c)
Na Jvl/TYaiGanraJYaeNa k-al/ae_Ya& ik&- ivDaaSYaiTa)) 18))

nadyo nadäç ca kñubhitäù

saräàsi ca manäàsi ca

na jvalaty agnir äjyena

kälo 'yaà kià vidhäsyati

SYNONYMS

nadyaù—rivers; *nadäù ca*—and the tributaries; *kñubhitäù*—all perturbed; *saräàsi*—reservoirs of water; *ca*—and; *manäàsi*—the mind; *ca*—also; *na*—does not; *jvalati*—ignite; *agniù*—fire; *äjyena*—with the help of butter; *kälaù*—the time; *ayam*—extraordinary it is; *kim*—what; *vidhäsyati*—going to happen.

TRANSLATION

Rivers, tributaries, ponds, reservoirs and the mind are all perturbed. Butter no longer ignites fire. What is this extraordinary time? What is going to happen?

TEXT 19

Na iPabiNTa STaNa& vTSaa Na duùINTa c MaaTar")
ädNTYaé[uMau%a Gaavae Na ôZYaNTYa*z>aa v]Jae)) 19))

na pibanti stanaà vatsä

na duhyanti ca mätaraù

rudanty açru-mukhä Gävo

na hãñyanty añabhä vraje

SYNONYMS

na—does not; *pibanti*—suck; *stanam*—breast; *vatsäù*—the calves; *na*—do not; *duhyanti*—allow milking; *ca*—also; *mätaraù*—the cows; *rudanti*—crying; *açru-mukhäù*—with a tearful face; *gävaù*—the cows; *na*—do not; *hãñyanti*—take pleasure; *añabhäù*—the bulls; *vraje*—in the pasturing ground.

TRANSLATION

The calves do not suck the teats of the cows, nor do the cows give milk. They are standing, crying, tears in their eyes, and the bulls take no pleasure in the pasturing grounds.

TEXT 20

dEvTaaNa ådNTaqv iSvÛiNTa ùuÀl/iNTa c)
wMae JaNaPada Ga]aMaa" PauraeÛaNaak-raé[Maa")
>a]íié[Yaae iNaraNaNda" ik-Maga& dXaRYaiNTa Na")) 20))

daivatäni rudantéva

svidyanti hy uccalanti ca

ime jana-padä grämäù

purodyänäkaräçramäù

bhrañöa-çriyo niränandäù

kim aghaà darçayanti naù

SYNONYMS

daivatäni—the Deities in the temples; *rudanti*—seem to be crying; *iva*—like that; *svidyanti*—perspiring; *hi*—certainly; *uccalanti*—as if going out; *ca*—also; *ime*—these; *jana-padäù*—cities; *grämäù*—villages; *pura*—towns; *udyäna*—gardens; *äkara*—mines; *äçramäù*—hermitages, etc.; *bhrañöa*—devoid of; *çriyaù*—beauty; *niränandäù*—bereft of all happiness; *kim*—what sort of; *agham*—calamities; *darçayanti*—shall manifest; *naù*—to us.

TRANSLATION

The Deities seem to be crying in the temple, lamenting and perspiring. They seem about to leave. All the cities, villages, towns, gardens, mines and hermitages are now devoid of beauty and bereft of all happiness. I do not know what sort of calamities are now awaiting us.

TEXT 21

MaNYa WTaEMaRhaeTPaaTaENaURNa& >aGavTa" PadE")
ANaNYaPauâzé[qi>ahsNaa >aUhRTaSaaE>aGaa)) 21))

manya etair mahotpätair

nünaà bhagavataù padaiù

ananya-puruṣa-çrébhir

hénä bhür hata-saubhagä

SYNONYMS

manye—I take it for granted; *etaiù*—by all these; *mahä*—great; *utpätaiù*—upsurges; *nünam*—for want of; *bhagavataù*—of the Personality of Godhead; *padaiù*—the marks on the sole of the foot; *ananya*—extraordinary; *puruṣa*—of the Supreme Personality; *çrébhiù*—by the auspicious signs; *hénä*—dispossessed; *bhüù*—the earth; *hata-saubhagä*—without the fortune.

TRANSLATION

I think that all these earthly disturbances indicate some greater loss to the good fortune of the world. The world was fortunate to have been marked with the footprints of the lotus feet of the Lord. These signs indicate that this will no longer be.

TEXT 22

wiTa icNTaYaTaSTaSYa d*íairíeNa ceTaSaa)
raj" Pa[TYaaGaMad(b]øNa(YaduPauYaaR" k-iPaßJa")) 22))

iti cintayatas tasya

dåñöäriñöena cetasä

räjiaù pratyägamad brahman

yadu-puryäù kapi-dhvajaù

SYNONYMS

iti—thus; *cintayataù*—while thinking to himself; *tasya*—he; *dåñöä*—by observing; *ariñöena*—bad omens; *cetasä*—by the mind; *räjiaù*—the King; *prati*—back; *ägamat*—came; *brahman*—O *brahmana*; *yadu-puryäù*—from the kingdom of the Yadus; *kapi-dhvajaù*—Arjuna.

TRANSLATION

O Brähmaëa Çaunaka, while Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira, observing the inauspicious signs on the earth at that time, was thus thinking to himself, Arjuna came back from the city of the Yadus [Dvärakä].

TEXT 23

Ta& PaadYaaeiNaRPaiTaTaMaYaQaaPaUvRMaaTaurMa()
ADaaevdNaMaiBbNdUNa(Sa*JaNTa& NaYaNaabJaYaae")) 23))

taà pädayor nipatitam

ayathä-pürvam äturam

adho-vadanam ab-bindün

såjantaà nayanäbjayoù

SYNONYMS

tam—him (Arjuna); *pädayoù*—at the feet; *nipatitam*—bowing down; *ayathä-pürvam*—unprecedented; *äturam*—dejected; *adhaù-vadanam*—downward face; *ap-bindün*—drops of water; *såjantam*—creating; *nayana-abjayoù*—from the lotuslike eyes.

TRANSLATION

When he bowed at his feet, the King saw that his dejection was unprecedented. His head was down, and tears glided from his lotus eyes.

TEXT 24

ivl/aeKYaaeiÜGanôdYaae ivC^aYaMaNauJa& Na*Pa")
Pa*C^iTä SMa SauôNMaDYae Sa&SMaràardeirTaMa()) 24))

vilokyodvigna-hådayo

vicchäyam anujaà nãpaù

påcchati sma suhån madhye

saàsmaran nãraderitam

SYNONYMS

vilokya—by seeing; *udvigna*—anxious; *hådayaù*—heart; *vicchäyam*—pale appearance; *anujam*—Arjuna; *nãpaù*—the King; *påcchati sma*—asked;

suhât—friends; *madhye*—amongst; *saàsmaran*—remembering; *nārada*—Sage Nārada; *éritam*—indicated by.

TRANSLATION

Seeing Arjuna pale due to heartfelt anxieties, the King, remembering the indications of the sage Nārada, questioned him in the midst of friends.

TEXT 25

YauIDaiir ovac

k-iÀdaNaTaRPauYaa | Na" SvJaNaa" Sau%MaaSaTae)
MaDau>aaeJadXaahaRhRSaaTvTaaNDak-v*Z<aYa")) 25))

yudhiñöhira uvāca

kaccid ānarta-puryāṇaṁ naṁ

sva-janāṁ sukham āsate

madhu-bhoja-daçärhärha-

sätvatāndhaka-vāñēayaṁ

SYNONYMS

yudhiñöhiraṁ uvāca—Yudhiñöhira said; *kaccit*—whether; *ānarta-puryām*—of Dvārakā; *naṁ*—our; *sva-janāṁ*—relatives; *sukham*—happily; *āsate*—are passing their days; *madhu*—Madhu; *bhoja*—Bhoja; *daçärha*—Daçärha; *ärha*—Ärha; *sätvata*—Sätvata; *andhaka*—Andhaka; *vāñēayaṁ*—of the family of Vāñēi.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira said: My dear brother, please tell me whether our friends and relatives, such as Madhu, Bhoja, Daçärha, Ärha, Sätvata, Andhaka and the members of the Yadu family are all passing their days in

happiness.

TEXT 26

éUrae MaaTaaMah" k-iÀTSvSTYaaSTae vaQa Maairz")
MaaTaul/" SaaNauJa" k-iÀTku-XaLYaaNak-duNdui>a")) 26))

çüro mätāmahaù kaccit

svasty āste vātha mārīñau

mātulaù sānujaù kaccit

kuçaly ānakadundubhiù

SYNONYMS

çüraù—Çürasena; *mätāmahaù*—maternal grandfather; *kaccit*—whether; *svasti*—all good; *āste*—passing his days; *vā*—or; *atha*—therefore; *mārīñau*—respectful; *mātulaù*—maternal uncle; *sa-anujaù*—with his younger brothers; *kaccit*—whether; *kuçalé*—all well; *ānaka-dundubhiù*—Vasudeva.

TRANSLATION

Is my respectable grandfather Çürasena in a happy mood? And are my maternal uncle Vasudeva and his younger brothers all doing well?

TEXT 27

Saá SvSaarSTaTPaTNYaae MaaTaul/aNYa" SahaTMAJaa")
AaSaTae Saòuza" +aeMa& devk-IPa[Mau%a" SvYaMa()) 27))

sapta sva-sāras tat-patnyo

mätulānyaù sahātmajäù

äsate sasnuñäù kñemaà

devaké-pramukhäù svayam

SYNONYMS

sapta—seven; *sva-säraù*—own sisters; *tat-patnyaù*—his wives; *mätulänyaù*—maternal aunts; *saha*—along with; *ätma-jäù*—sons and grandsons; *äsate*—are all; *sasnuñäù*—with their daughters-in-law; *kñemam*—happiness; *devaké*—Devaké; *pramukhäù*—headed by; *svayam*—personally.

TRANSLATION

His seven wives, headed by Devaké, are all sisters. Are they and their sons and daughters-in-law all happy?

TEXTS 28–29

k-iÀd]aJaahuk-ae JaqvTYaSaTPau}aae_SYa caNauJa")
ôdqm-" SaSauTaae_§U-rae JaYaNTaGadSaar<aa")) 28))
AaSaTae ku-Xal&/ k-iÀÛe c Xa}auiJadadYa")
k-iÀdaSTae Sau%& raMaae >aGavaNa(SaaTvTaa& Pa[>au")) 29))

kaccid räjähuko jévaty

asat-putro 'sya cānujaù

hādēkaù sasuto 'krūro

jayanta-gada-säraëù

äsate kuçalaà kaccid

ye ca çatrujid-ädayaù

kaccid äste sukhaà rämo

SYNONYMS

kaccit—whether; *räjä*—the King; *ähukaù*—another name of Ugrasena; *jévati*—still living; *asat*—mischievous; *putraù*—son; *asya*—his; *ca*—also; *anujaù*—younger brother; *hådékaù*—Hådéka; *sa-sutaù*—along with son, Kåtavarmä; *akrüraù*—Akrüra; *jayanta*—Jayanta; *gada*—Gada; *säraëäù*—Säraëa; *äsate*—are they all; *kuçalam*—in happiness; *kaccit*—whether; *ye*—they; *ca*—also; *çatrujit*—Çatrujit; *ädayaù*—headed by; *kaccit*—whether; *äste*—are they; *sukham*—all right; *rämaù*—Balaräma; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *sätvatäm*—of the devotees; *prabhuù*—protector.

TRANSLATION

Are Ugrasena, whose son was the mischievous Kaàsa, and his younger brother still living? Are Hådéka and his son Kåtavarmä happy? Are Akrüra, Jayanta, Gada, Säraëa and Çatrujit all happy? How is Balaräma, the Personality of Godhead and the protector of devotees?

PURPORT

Hastinäpura, the capital of the Pääòavas, was situated somewhere near present New Delhi, and the kingdom of Ugrasena was situated in Mathurä. While returning to Delhi from Dvärakä, Arjuna must have visited the city of Mathurä, and therefore the inquiry about the King of Mathurä is valid. Amongst various names of the relatives, the name of Rāma or Balaräma, eldest brother of Lord Kṛṣṇa, is added with the words “the Personality of Godhead” because Lord Balaräma is the immediate expansion of *viṣṇu-tattva* as *prakāça-vigraha* of Lord Kṛṣṇa. The Supreme Lord, although one without a second, expands Himself as many other living beings. The *viṣṇu-tattva* living beings are expansions of the Supreme Lord, and all of them are qualitatively and quantitatively equal with the Lord. But expansions of the *jéva-çakti*, the category of the ordinary living beings, are not at all equal with the Lord. One who considers the *jéva-çakti* and the *viṣṇu-tattva* to be on an equal level is considered a condemned soul of the world. Sri Rāma, or Balaräma, is the protector of the devotees of the Lord. Baladeva acts as the

spiritual master of all devotees, and by His causeless mercy the fallen souls are delivered. Sri Baladeva appeared as Sri Nityānanda Prabhu during the advent of Lord Caitanya, and the great Lord Nityānanda Prabhu exhibited His causeless mercy by delivering a pair of extremely fallen souls, namely Jagāi and Mādhāi. Therefore it is particularly mentioned herein that Balarāma is the protector of the devotees of the Lord. By His divine grace only one can approach the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and thus Sri Balarāma is the mercy incarnation of the Lord, manifested as the spiritual master, the savior of the pure devotees.

TEXT 30

Pa[ŪuMan" SavRv*Z<aqNaa& Sau%MaaSTae MaharQa")
GaM>aqrrYaae_iNaãÖae vDaRTae >aGavaNauTa)) 30))

pradyumnaù sarva-vãñëénää

sukham äste mahä-rathaù

gambhéra-rayo 'niruddho

vardhate bhagavän uta

SYNONYMS

pradyumnaù—Pradyumna (a son of Lord Kṛṣṇa); *sarva*—all; *vãñëénäm*—of the members of the Vãñëi family; *sukham*—happiness; *äste*—are in; *mahä-rathaù*—the great general; *gambhéra*—deeply; *rayaù*—dexterity; *aniruddhaù*—Aniruddha (a grandson of Lord Kṛṣṇa); *vardhate*—flourishing; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *uta*—must.

TRANSLATION

**How is Pradyumna, the great general of the Vãñëi family? Is He happy?
And is Aniruddha, the plenary expansion of the Personality of Godhead,
faring well?**

PURPORT

Pradyumna and Aniruddha are also expansions of the Personality of Godhead, and thus They are also *viṣṇu-tattva*. At Dvārakā Lord Vāsudeva is engaged in His transcendental pastimes along with His plenary expansions, namely Saṅkarṣṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha, and therefore each and every one of Them can be addressed as the Personality of Godhead, as it is mentioned in connection with the name Aniruddha.

TEXT 31

Sauze<aêaâdeZ<aê SaaMbae JaaMbvTaqSauTa")
ANYae c k-aiZ<aRPa[vra" SaPau}aa %oz>aadYa")) 31))

suñeëaç cārudeñeëaç ca

sāmbo jāmbavaté-sutaù

anye ca kārñëi-pravaräù

saputrä åñabhädayaù

SYNONYMS

suñeëaù—Suñeëa; *cārudeñeëaù*—Cārudeñeëa; *ca*—and; *sāmbaù*—Sāmbo; *jāmbavaté-sutaù*—the son of Jāmbavaté; *anye*—others; *ca*—also; *kārñëi*—the sons of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *pravaräù*—all chieftains; *sa-puträù*—along with their sons; *åñabha*—Rsabha; *ädayaù*—etc.

TRANSLATION

Are all the chieftain sons of Lord Kṛṣṇa, such as Suñeëa, Cārudeñeëa, Sāmbo the son of Jāmbavaté, and Rsabha, along with their sons, all doing well?

PURPORT

As already mentioned, Lord Kṛṣṇa married 16,108 wives, and each of them had ten sons. Therefore 16,108 x 10 161,080 sons. They all grew up, and each of them had as many sons as their father, and the whole aggregate was something near 1,610,800 family members of the Lord. The Lord is the father of all living beings, who are countless in number; therefore only a few of them are called to associate with the Lord in His transcendental pastimes as the Lord of Dvārakā on this earth. It is not astonishing that the Lord maintained a visible family consisting of so many members. It is better to refrain from comparing the Lord's position to ours, and it becomes a simple truth as soon as we understand at least a partial calculation of the Lord's transcendental position. King Yudhiñöhira, while inquiring about the Lord's sons and grandsons at Dvārakā, mentioned only the chieftains amongst them, for it was impossible for him to remember all the names of the Lord's family members.

TEXTS 32–33

**TaQaEvaNaukra" XaaEre" é[uTadevaeÖvadYa")
SauNaNdNaNdXaqzR<Yaa Yae caNYae SaaTvTazR>aa")) 32))
AiPa SvSTYaaSaTae SaveR raMak*-Z<a>auJaaé[Yaa")
AiPa SMariNTa ku-Xal/MaSMaak&- bÖSaaEôda")) 33))**

tathaivānucarāuṁ çaureuṁ

çrutadevoddhavādayauṁ

sunanda-nanda-çérñāëyā

ye cānye sätvatarñabhäuṁ

api svasty äsate sarve

rāma-kāñëa-bhujäçrayauṁ

api smaranti kuçalam

asmäkaà baddha-sauhådäüṁ

SYNONYMS

tathä eva—similarly; *anucaräù*—constant companions; *çasureù*—of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa such as; *çrutadeva*—Çrutadeva; *uddhava-ädayaù*—Uddhava and others; *sunanda*—Sunanda; *nanda*—Nanda; *çérñäëyäù*—other leaders; *ye*—all of them; *ca*—and; *anye*—others; *sätvata*—liberated souls; *añabhäù*—the best men; *api*—if; *svasti*—doing well; *äsate*—are; *sarve*—all of them; *räma*—Balaräma; *kāñëa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhuja-äçrayäù*—under the protection of; *api*—if also; *smaranti*—do remember; *kuçalam*—welfare; *asmäkam*—about ourselves; *baddha-sauhädäù*—bound by eternal friendship.

TRANSLATION

Also, Çrutadeva, Uddhava and others, Nanda, Sunanda and other leaders of liberated souls who are constant companions of the Lord are protected by Lord Balaräma and Kṛṣṇa. Are they all doing well in their respective functions? Do they, who are all eternally bound in friendship with us, remember our welfare?

PURPORT

The constant companions of Lord Kṛṣṇa, such as Uddhava, are all liberated souls, and they descended along with Lord Kṛṣṇa to this material world to fulfill the mission of the Lord. The Pääòavas are also liberated souls who descended along with Lord Kṛṣṇa to serve Him in His transcendental pastimes on this earth. As stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (4.8), the Lord and His eternal associates, who are also liberated souls like the Lord, come down on this earth at certain intervals. The Lord remembers them all, but His associates, although liberated souls, forget due to their being *taöasthä çakti*, or marginal potency of the Lord. That is the difference between the *vişnu-tattva* and *jiva-tattva*. The *jiva-tattvas* are infinitesimal potential particles of the Lord, and therefore they require the protection of the Lord at all times. And to the eternal servitors of the Lord, the Lord is pleased to give all protection at all times. The liberated souls never, therefore, think themselves as free as the Lord or as powerful as the Lord, but they always seek the protection of the Lord in all circumstances, both in the material

world and in the spiritual world. This dependence of the liberated soul is constitutional, for the liberated souls are like sparks of a fire that are able to exhibit the glow of fire along with the fire and not independently. Independently the glow of the sparks is extinguished, although the quality of fire or the glowing is there. Thus those who give up the protection of the Lord and become so-called lords themselves, out of spiritual ignorance, come back again to this material world, even after prolonged *tapasya* of the severest type. That is the verdict of all Vedic literature.

TEXT 34

>aGavaNaiPa GaaeivNdae b]ø<Yaae >aç-vTSaI/")
k-iÀTPaure SauDaMaaRYaa& Sau%MaaSTae Sauôd(v*Ta")) 34))

bhagavān api govindo

brahmaëyo bhakta-vatsalaù

kaccit pure sudharmäyää

sukham äste suhåd-våtaù

SYNONYMS

bhagavān—the Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa; *api*—also; *govindaù*—one who enlivens the cows and the senses; *brahmaëyaù*—devoted to the devotees of the *brahmanas*; *bhakta-vatsalaù*—affectionate to the devotees; *kaccit*—whether; *pure*—in Dvārakā Puré; *sudharmäyäm*—pious assembly; *sukham*—happiness; *äste*—does enjoy; *suhåt-våtaù*—surrounded by friends.

TRANSLATION

Is Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who gives pleasure to the cows, the senses and the brahmanas, who is very affectionate towards His devotees, enjoying the pious assembly at Dvārakā Puré surrounded by friends?

PURPORT

Here in this particular verse the Lord is described as *bhagavān*, *govinda*, *brahmaëya* and *bhakta-vatsala*. He is *bhagavān svayam*, or the original Supreme Personality of Godhead, full with all opulences, all power, all knowledge, all beauty, all fame and all renunciation. No one is equal to or greater than Him. He is Govinda because He is the pleasure of the cows and the senses. Those who have purified their senses by the devotional service of the Lord can render unto Him real service and thereby derive transcendental pleasure out of such purified senses. Only the impure conditioned living being cannot derive any pleasure from the senses, but being illusioned by false pleasures of the senses, he becomes servant of the senses. Therefore, we need His protection for our own interest. The Lord is the protector of cows and the brahminical culture. A society devoid of cow protection and brahminical culture is not under the direct protection of the Lord, just as the prisoners in the jails are not under the protection of the king but under the protection of a severe agent of the king. Without cow protection and cultivation of the brahminical qualities in human society, at least for a section of the members of society, no human civilization can prosper at any length. By brahminical culture, the development of the dormant qualities of goodness, namely truthfulness, equanimity, sense control, forbearance, simplicity, general knowledge, transcendental knowledge, and firm faith in the Vedic wisdom, one can become a *brahmana* and thus see the Lord as He is. And after surpassing the brahminical perfection, one has to become a devotee of the Lord so that His loving affection in the form of proprietor, master, friend, son and lover can be transcendently achieved. The stage of a devotee, which attracts the transcendental affection of the Lord, does not develop unless one has developed the qualities of a *brahmana* as above mentioned. The Lord is inclined to a *brahmana* of quality and not of false prestige. Those who are less than a *brahmana* by qualification cannot establish any relation with the Lord, just as fire cannot be kindled from the raw earth unless there is wood, although there is a relation between wood and the earth. Since the Lord is all-perfect in Himself, there could not be any question of His welfare, and Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira refrained from asking this question. He simply inquired about His residential place, Dvārakā Puré, where pious men assemble. The Lord stays only where pious men assemble and takes

pleasure in their glorifying the Supreme Truth. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was anxious to know about the pious men and their pious acts in the city of Dvārakā.

TEXTS 35–36

Ma®I/aYa c I/aek-aNaa& +aeMaaYa c >avaYa c)
AaSTae Yaduku-I/aM>aaeDaavaŪae_NaN-TaSa%" PauMaaNa()) 35))
YaØahud<@GauáaYaa& SvPauYaa| Yadvae_icRTaa")
§-I@iNTa ParMaaNaNd& MahaPaaEåizk-a wv)) 36))

maìgaläya ca lokänää

kñemäya ca bhaväya ca

äste yadu-kulämbhodhäv

ädyo 'nanta-sakhaù pumän

yad bähu-daëò-a-guptäyää

sva-puryää yadavo 'rcitäù

kréòanti paramänandaà

mahä-pauruñikä iva

SYNONYMS

maìgaläya—for all good; *ca*—also; *lokänäm*—of all the planets; *kñemäya*—for protection; *ca*—and; *bhaväya*—for elevation; *ca*—also; *äste*—is there; *yadu-kula-ambhodhau*—in the ocean of the Yadu dynasty; *ädyau*—the original; *ananta-sakhaù*—in the company of Ananta (Balaräma); *pumän*—the supreme enjoyer; *yat*—whose; *bähu-daëò-a-guptäyäm*—being protected by His arms; *sva-puryäm*—in His own city; *yadavaù*—the members of the Yadu family; *arcitäù*—as they deserve; *kréòanti*—are relishing; *parama-änandam*—transcendental pleasure; *mahä-pauruñikäu*—

the residents of the spiritual sky; *iva*—like.

TRANSLATION

The original Personality of Godhead, the enjoyer, and Balarāma, the primeval Lord Ananta, are staying in the ocean of the Yadu dynasty for the welfare, protection and general progress of the entire universe. And the members of the Yadu dynasty, being protected by the arms of the Lord, are enjoying life like the residents of the spiritual sky.

PURPORT

As we have discussed many times, the Personality of Godhead Viṣṇu resides within each and every universe in two capacities, namely as the Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu and the Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu. The Kṣīrodakaśāyī Viṣṇu has His own planet on the northern top of the universe, and there is a great ocean of milk where the Lord resides on the bed of the Ananta incarnation of Baladeva. Thus Mahārāja Yudhiṇṇōhira has compared the Yadu dynasty to the ocean of milk and Sri Balarāma to the Ananta where Lord Kṛṣṇa resides. He has compared the citizens of Dvārakā to the liberated inhabitants of the Vaikunthalokas. Beyond the material sky, further than we can see with our eyes and beyond the sevenfold coverings of the universe, there is the Causal Ocean in which all the universes are floating like footballs, and beyond the Causal Ocean there is an unlimited span of spiritual sky generally known as the effulgence of Brahman. Within this effulgence there are innumerable spiritual planets, and they are known as the Vaikuntha planets. Each and every Vaikuntha planet is many, many times bigger than the biggest universe within the material world, and in each of them there are innumerable inhabitants who look exactly like Lord Viṣṇu. These inhabitants are known as the Mahā-pauruṇikas, or persons directly engaged in the service of the Lord. They are happy in those planets and are without any kind of misery, and they live perpetually in full youthfulness, enjoying life in full bliss and knowledge without fear of birth, death, old age or disease, and without the influence of *kāla*, eternal time. Mahārāja Yudhiṇṇōhira has compared the inhabitants of Dvārakā to the Mahā-pauruṇikas of Vaikunthaloka because they are so happy with the Lord. In the *Bhagavad-gita* there are many references to the Vaikunthalokas, and

they are mentioned there as *mad-dhāma*, or the kingdom of the Lord.

TEXT 37

YaTPaadéu[Uz<aMau:Yak-MaR<aa
SaTYaadYaae ÜyíSahóYaaeizTa")
iNaiJaRTYa Sa&:Yae i}adXaa&STadaiXazae
hriNTa vJa]aYauDavç>aaeicTaa")) 37))

yat-pāda-ṣuṣṛūñāḍa-mukhya-karmaḍā

satyādayo dvy-añḍa-sahasra-yoñitaḁ

nirjitya saikhye tri-daṣḁās tad-āṣiñḁ

haranti vajrāyudha-vallabhocitāḁ

SYNONYMS

yat—whose; *pāda*—feet; *ṣuṣṛūñāḍa*—administration of comforts; *mukhya*—the most important; *karmaḍā*—by the acts of; *satya-ādayaḁ*—queens headed by Satyabhāmā; *dvi-añḍa*—twice eight; *sahasra*—thousand; *yoñitaḁ*—the fair sex; *nirjitya*—by subduing; *saikhye*—in the battle; *tri-daṣḁān*—of the denizens of heaven; *tad-āṣiñḁ*—what is enjoyed by the demigods; *haranti*—do take away; *vajra-āyudha-vallabhā*—the wives of the personality who controls the thunderbolt; *ucitāḁ*—deserving.

TRANSLATION

Simply by administering comforts at the lotus feet of the Lord, which is the most important of all services, the queens at Dvārakā, headed by Satyabhāmā, induced the Lord to conquer the demigods. Thus the queens enjoy things which are prerogatives of the wives of the controller of thunderbolts.

PURPORT

Satyabhämä: One of the principal queens of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa at Dvārakā. After killing Narakāsura, Lord Kṛṣṇa visited the palace of Narakāsura accompanied by Satyabhämä. He went to Indraloka also with Satyabhämä, and she was received by Çacédevé, who introduced her to the mother of the demigods, Aditi. Aditi was very much pleased with Satyabhämä, and she blessed her with the benediction of permanent youth as long as Lord Kṛṣṇa remained on the earth. Aditi also took her with her to show her the special prerogatives of the demigods in the heavenly planets. When Satyabhämä saw the *pärijäta* flower, she desired to have it in her palace at Dvārakā. After that, she came back to Dvārakā along with her husband and expressed her willingness to have the *pärijäta* flower at her palace. Satyabhämä's palace was especially bedecked with valuable jewels, and even in the hottest season of summer the inside of the palace remained cool, as if air-conditioned. She decorated her palace with various flags, heralding the news of her great husband's presence there. Once, along with her husband, she met Draupadé, and she was anxious to be instructed by Draupadé in the ways and means of pleasing her husband. Draupadé was expert in this affair because she kept five husbands, the Pääòavas, and all were very much pleased with her. On receipt of Draupadé's instructions, she was very much pleased and offered her good wishes and returned to Dvārakā. She was the daughter of Saträjit. After the departure of Lord Kṛṣṇa, when Arjuna visited Dvārakā, all the queens, including Satyabhämä and Rukmiëé, lamented for the Lord with great feeling. At the last stage of her life, she left for the forest to undergo severe penance.

Satyabhämä instigated her husband to get the *pärijäta* flower from the heavenly planets, and the Lord got it even by force from the demigods, as a common husband secures things to please his wife. As already explained, the Lord had very little to do with so many wives to carry out their orders like an ordinary man. But because the queens accepted the high quality of devotional service, namely administering the Lord all comforts, the Lord played the part of a faithful and complete husband. No earthly creature can expect to have things from the heavenly kingdom, especially the *pärijäta* flowers, which are simply to be used by the demigods. But due to their becoming the Lord's faithful wives, all of them enjoyed the special prerogatives of the great wives of the denizens of heaven. In other words, since the Lord is the proprietor of everything within His creation, it is not

very astonishing for the queens of Dvārakā to have any rare thing from any part of the universe.

TEXT 38

YaØahud<@a>YaudYaaNauJaqivNaae
YaduPa[vqra ùku-Taae>aYaa Mauhu")
AiDaṣ-MaNTYax(iga]i>araôTaa& bl/aTa(
Sa>aa& SauDaMaa | SaurSataMaaeicTaaMa()) 38))

yad bāhu-daëòäbhyudayānujévinò

yadu-pravérä hy akutobhayä muhuù

adhikramanty aìghribhir ähâtäà balät

sabhäà sudharmäà sura-sattamocitäm

SYNONYMS

yat—whose; *bāhu-daëòä*—arms; *abhyudaya*—influenced by; *anujévinàù*—always living; *yadu*—the members of the Yadu dynasty; *pravéräù*—great heroes; *hi akutobhayäù*—fearless in every respect; *muhuù*—constantly; *adhikramanti*—traversing; *aìghribhiù*—by foot; *ähâtäm*—brought about; *balät*—by force; *sabhäm*—assembly house; *sudharmäm*—Sudharmä; *sura-sat-tama*—the best among the demigods; *ucitäm*—deserving.

TRANSLATION

The great heroes of the Yadu dynasty, being protected by the arms of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, always remain fearless in every respect. And therefore their feet trample over the Sudharmä assembly house, which the best demigods deserved but which was taken away from them.

PURPORT

Those who are directly servitors of the Lord are protected by the Lord from

all fearfulness, and they also enjoy the best of things, even if they are forcibly accumulated. The Lord is equal in behavior to all living beings, but He is partial to His pure devotees, being very affectionate toward them. The city of Dvārakā was flourishing, being enriched with the best of things in the material world. The state assembly house is constructed according to the dignity of the particular state. In the heavenly planets, the state assembly house called Sudharmā was deserving of the dignity of the best of the demigods. Such an assembly house is never meant for any state on the globe because the human being on the earth is unable to construct it, however far a particular state may be materially advanced. But during the time of Lord Kṛṣṇa's presence on the earth, the members of the Yadu family forcibly brought the celestial assembly house to earth and placed it at Dvārakā. They were able to use such force because they were certain of the indulgence and protection of the Supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa. In other words, the Lord is provided with the best things in the universe by His pure devotees. Lord Kṛṣṇa was provided with all kinds of comforts and facilities available within the universe by the members of the Yadu dynasty, and in return such servitors of the Lord were protected and fearless.

A forgetful, conditioned soul is fearful. But a liberated soul is never fearful, just as a small child completely dependent on the mercy of his father is never fearful of anyone. Fearfulness is a sort of illusion for the living being when he is in slumber and forgetting his eternal relation with the Lord. Since the living being is never to die by his constitution, as stated in ***Bhagavad-gita*** (2.20), then what is the cause of fearfulness? A person may be fearful of a tiger in a dream, but another man who is awake by his side sees no tiger there. The tiger is a myth for both of them, namely the person dreaming and the person awake, because actually there is no tiger; but the man forgetful of his awakened life is fearful, whereas the man who has not forgotten his position is not at all fearful. Thus the members of the Yadu dynasty were fully awake in their service to the Lord, and therefore there was no tiger for them to be afraid of at any time. Even if there were a real tiger, the Lord was there to protect them.

TEXT 39

k-iĀtae_NaaMaYa& TaaTa >a]íTaeJaa iv>aaiSa Mae)

AI/BDaMaaNaae_vjaTa" ik&- va TaaTa icraeizTa")) 39))

kaccit te 'nāmayaà tātā

bhrañña-tejā vibhāsi me

alabdha-māno 'vajjātaù

kià vā tātā ciroñitaù

SYNONYMS

kaccit—whether; *te*—your; *anāmayam*—health is all right; *tātā*—my dear brother; *bhrañña*—bereft; *tejā*—luster; *vibhāsi*—appear; *me*—to me; *alabdha-mānaù*—without respect; *avajjātaù*—neglected; *kim*—whether; *vā*—or; *tātā*—my dear brother; *ciroñitaù*—because of long residence.

TRANSLATION

My brother Arjuna, please tell me whether your health is all right. You appear to have lost your bodily luster. Is this due to others disrespecting and neglecting you because of your long stay at Dvārakā?

PURPORT

From all angles of vision, the Mahārāja inquired from Arjuna about the welfare of Dvārakā, but he concluded at last that as long as Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa Himself was there, nothing inauspicious could happen. But at the same time, Arjuna appeared to be bereft of his bodily luster, and thus the King inquired of his personal welfare and asked so many vital questions.

TEXT 40

k-iÀàai>ahTaae_>aavE" XaBdaidi>arMa®IE/")
Na dtaMauç-MaiQaR>Ya AaXaYaa YaTPa[iTaé[uTaMa()) 40))

kaccin nābhihato 'bhāvaiù

çabdädibhir amaìgalaiù

na dattam uktam arthibhya

äçayä yat pratiçrutam

SYNONYMS

kaccit—whether; *na*—could not; *abhihataù*—addressed by; *abhävaiù*—unfriendly; *çabda-ädibhiù*—by sounds; *amaìgalaiù*—inauspicious; *na*—did not; *dattam*—give in charity; *uktam*—is said; *arthibhyaù*—unto one who asked; *äçayä*—with hope; *yat*—what; *pratiçrutam*—promised to be paid.

TRANSLATION

**Has someone addressed you with unfriendly words or threatened you?
Could you not give charity to one who asked, or could you not keep your
promise to someone?**

PURPORT

A *kñatriya* or a rich man is sometimes visited by persons who are in need of money. When they are asked for a donation, it is the duty of the possessor of wealth to give in charity in consideration of the person, place and time. If a *kñatriya* or a rich man fails to comply with this obligation, he must be very sorry for this discrepancy. Similarly, one should not fail to keep his promise to give in charity. These discrepancies are sometimes causes of despondency, and thus failing, a person becomes subjected to criticism, which might also be the cause of Arjuna's plight.

TEXT 41

k-iÀtv& b]aø<a& bal&/ Gaa& v*Ö& raeiGa<a& iñYaMa()
Xar<aaePaSa*Ta& Satv& NaaTYaa+aq" Xar<aPa[d")) 41))

kaccit tvaà brahmanaà bälàà

gäà vâddhaà rogiëaà striyam

çaraëopasâtaà sattvaà

nätyäkñéù çaraëa-pradaù

SYNONYMS

kaccit—whether; *tvam*—yourself; *brahmanam*—the *brahmanas*; *bālam*—the child; *gām*—the cow; *vâddham*—old; *rogiëam*—the diseased; *striyam*—the woman; *çaraëa-upasâtam*—having approached for protection; *sattvam*—any living being; *na*—whether; *atyäkñéù*—not given shelter; *çaraëa-pradaù*—deserving protection.

TRANSLATION

You are always the protector of the deserving living beings, such as brahmanas, children, cows, women and the diseased. Could you not give them protection when they approached you for shelter?

PURPORT

The *brahmanas*, who are always engaged in researching knowledge for the society's welfare work, both materially and spiritually, deserve the protection of the king in all respects. Similarly, the children of the state, the cow, the diseased person, the woman and the old man specifically require the protection of the state or a *kñatriya* king. If such living beings do not get protection by the *kñatriya*, or the royal order, or by the state, it is certainly shameful for the *kñatriya* or the state. If such things had actually happened to Arjuna, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was anxious to know about these discrepancies.

TEXT 42

**k-iÀtv& NaaGaMaae_GaMYaa& GaMYaa& vaSaTk*-Taa& iñYaMa()
ParaiJaTaae vaQa >avaàaetaMaENaaRSaMaE" PaiQa)) 42))**

kaccit tvaà nāgamo 'gamyāà

gamyāà vāsāt-kātāà striyam

parājito vātha bhavān

nottamair nāsamaiù pathi

SYNONYMS

kaccit—whether; *tvam*—yourself; *na*—not; *agamaù*—did contact; *agamyām*—impeachable; *gamyām*—acceptable; *vā*—either; *asāt-kātām*—improperly treated; *striyam*—a woman; *parājitaù*—defeated by; *vā*—either; *atha*—after all; *bhavān*—your good self; *na*—nor; *uttamaiù*—by superior power; *na*—not; *asamaiù*—by equals; *pathi*—on the road.

TRANSLATION

Have you contacted a woman of impeachable character, or have you not properly treated a deserving woman? Or have you been defeated on the way by someone who is inferior or equal to you?

PURPORT

It appears from this verse that during the time of the Pāṇḍavas free contact between man and woman was allowed in certain conditions only. The higher-caste men, namely the *brahmanas* and *kṣatriyas*, could accept a woman of the *vaiçya* or the *çūdra* community, but a man from the lower castes could not contact a woman of the higher caste. Even a *kñatriya* could not contact a woman of the *brahmana* caste. The wife of a *brahmana* is considered one of the seven mothers (namely one's own mother, the wife of the spiritual master or teacher, the wife of a *brahmana*, the wife of a king, the cow, the nurse, and the earth). Such contact between man and woman was known as *uttama* and *adhama*. Contact of a *brahmana* with a *kñatriya* woman is *uttama*, but the contact of a *kñatriya* with a *brahmana* woman is *adhama* and therefore condemned. A woman approaching a man for contact should never be refused, but at the same time the discretion as

above mentioned may also be considered. Bhéma was approached by Hiòimbé from a community lower than the *sudras*, and Yayāti refused to marry the daughter of Çukrācārya because of Çukrācārya's being a *brahmana*. Vyāsadeva, a *brahmana*, was called to beget Pääòu and Dhātarāñöra. Satyavati belonged to a family of fishermen, but Parāçara, a great *brahmana*, begot in her Vyāsadeva. So there are so many examples of contacts with woman, but in all cases the contacts were not abominable nor were the results of such contacts bad. Contact between man and woman is natural, but that also must be carried out under regulative principles so that social consecration may not be disturbed or unwanted worthless population be increased for the unrest of the world.

It is abominable for a *kñatriya* to be defeated by one who is inferior in strength or equal in strength. If one is defeated at all, he should be defeated by some superior power. Arjuna was defeated by Bhéñmadeva, and Lord Kṛṣṇa saved him from the danger. This was not an insult for Arjuna because Bhéñmadeva was far superior to Arjuna in all ways, namely age, respect and strength. But Karëa was equal to Arjuna, and therefore Arjuna was in crisis when fighting with Karëa. It was felt by Arjuna, and therefore Karëa was killed even by crooked means. Such are the engagements of the *kṣatriyas*, and Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira inquired from his brother whether anything undesirable happened on the way home from Dvārakä.

TEXT 43

AiPa iSvTPaYaR>au&KQaaSTv& SaM>aaeJYaaNa(v*Öbal/k-aNa()
JauGauIPSaTa& k-MaR ik-iÄTk*-Tavaà Yad+aMaMa()) 43))

api svit parya-bhuìkthäs tvaà

sambhojyän vâddha-bälakän

jugupsitaà karma kiicit

kâtavän na yad akñamam

SYNONYMS

api svit—if it were so that; *parya*—by leaving aside; *bhuikthäù*—have dined; *tvam*—yourself; *sambhojyän*—deserving to dine together; *vāddha*—the old men; *bālakän*—boys; *jugupsitam*—abominable; *karma*—action; *kīicit*—something; *kātavän*—you must have done; *na*—not; *yat*—that which; *akñamam*—unpardonable.

TRANSLATION

Have you not taken care of old men and boys who deserve to dine with you? Have you left them and taken your meals alone? Have you committed some unpardonable mistake which is considered to be abominable?

PURPORT

It is the duty of a householder to feed first of all the children, the old members of the family, the *brahmanas* and the invalids. Besides that, an ideal householder is required to call for any unknown hungry man to come and dine before he himself goes to take his meals. He is required to call for such a hungry man thrice on the road. The neglect of this prescribed duty of a householder, especially in the matter of the old men and children, is unpardonable.

TEXT 44

**k-iÀTa(Pa[eiTaeMaeNaaQa ôdYaeNaaTMabNDauNaa)
éUNYaae_iSMa rihTaae iNaTYa& MaNYaSae Tae_NYaQaa Na åk(-)) 44))**

kaccit preñöhatamenätha

hādayenätma-bandhunä

çünyo 'smi rahito nityaà

manyase te 'nyathä na ruk

SYNONYMS

kaccit—whether; *preñöha-tamena*—unto the most dear one; *atha*—my brother Arjuna; *hådayena*—most intimate; *ätma-bandhunä*—own friend Lord Kṛṣṇa; *çünyaù*—void; *asmi*—I am; *rahitaù*—having lost; *nityam*—for all time; *manyase*—you think; *te*—your; *anyathä*—otherwise; *na*—never; *ruk*—mental distress.

TRANSLATION

Or is it that you are feeling empty for all time because you might have lost your most intimate friend, Lord Kṛṣṇa? O my brother Arjuna, I can think of no other reason for your becoming so dejected.

PURPORT

All the inquisitiveness of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira about the world situation was already conjectured by Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira on the basis of Lord Kṛṣṇa’s disappearance from the vision of the world, and this was now disclosed by him because of the acute dejection of Arjuna, which could not have been possible otherwise. So even though he was doubtful about it, he was obliged to inquire frankly from Arjuna on the basis of Sri Nārada’s indication.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Fourteenth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled “The Disappearance of Lord Kṛṣṇa.”

Chapter Fifteen

The Pääòavas Retire Timely

TEXT 1

SaUTa ovac

Wv& k*-Z<aSa%" k*-Z<aæ >a]a}aa rajaivk-iLPaTa")
NaaNaaXa³aSPad& æPa& k*-Z<aivëezk-iXaRTa")) 1))

süta uväca

evaà kãñëa-sakhaù kãñëo

bhräträ räjä vikalpitaù

nänä-çaikäspadaà rüpaà

kãñëa-viçleña-karçitaù

SYNONYMS

sütaù uväca—Süta Gosvami said; *evam*—thus; *kãñëa-sakhaù*—the celebrated friend of Kṛṣṇa; *kãñëaù*—Arjuna; *bhräträ*—by his elder brother; *räjä*—King Yudhiñöhira; *vikalpitaù*—speculated; *nänä*—various; *çaika-äspadam*—based on many doubts; *rüpa*—forms; *kãñëa*—Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *viçleña*—feelings of separation; *karçitaù*—became greatly bereaved.

TRANSLATION

Süta Gosvami said: Arjuna, the celebrated friend of Lord Kṛṣṇa, was grief-stricken because of his strong feeling of separation from Kṛṣṇa, over and above all Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira’s speculative inquiries.

PURPORT

Being too much aggrieved, Arjuna practically became choked up, and therefore it was not possible for him to reply properly to the various speculative inquiries of Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira.

TEXT 2

**Xaaeke-Na éuZYaÜdNaôTSaraeJaae hTaPa[>a")
iv>au& TaMaevaNauSMaràaXa¥-aeTPa[iTa>aaizTauMa()) 2))**

çokena çuñyad-vadana-

hāt-sarojo hata-prabhaù

vibhuà tam evānusmaran

nāçaknot pratibhāñitum

SYNONYMS

çokena—due to bereavement; *çuñyat-vadana*—drying up of the mouth; *hāt-sarojaù*—lotuslike heart; *hata*—lost; *prabhaù*—bodily luster; *vibhum*—the Supreme; *tam*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; *eva*—certainly; *anusmaran*—thinking within; *na*—could not; *açaknot*—be able; *pratibhāñitum*—properly replying.

TRANSLATION

Due to grief, Arjuna's mouth and lotuslike heart had dried up. Therefore his body lost all luster. Now, remembering the Supreme Lord, he could hardly utter a word in reply.

TEXT 3

k*-C^\e<a Sa&STa>Ya éuc" Paai<aNaaMa*JYa Nae}aYaae")
Parae+ae<a SaMauàÖPa[<aYaaETk-<#yk-aTar")) 3))

kācchreëa saàstabhya çucaù

päëināmājya netrayoù

parokñeëa samunnaddha-

praëayautkaëöhya-kätaraù

SYNONYMS

kācchreëa—with great difficulty; *saàstabhya*—by checking the force; *çucaù*—of bereavement; *päëinā*—with his hands; *āmājya*—smearing;

netrayoù—the eyes; *parokñeëa*—due to being out of sight;
samunnaddha—increasingly; *praëaya-autkaëöhya*—eagerly thinking of the
affection; *kätaraù*—distressed.

TRANSLATION

**With great difficulty he checked the tears of grief that smeared his eyes.
He was very distressed because Lord Kṛṣṇa was out of his sight, and he
increasingly felt affection for Him.**

TEXT 4

**Sa:Ya& MaE}aq& SaaEôd& c SaarQYaaidzu Sa&SMarNa()
Na*PaMaGa]JaiMaTYaah baZPaGaÓdYaa iGara)) 4))**

sakhyaà maitréà sauhādaà ca

sārathyādiñu saàsmaran

nāpam agraJam ity āha

bāñpa-gadgadayä girä

SYNONYMS

sakhyam—well-wishing; *maitrém*—benediction; *sauhādam*—intimately
related; *ca*—also; *sārathya-ādiñu*—in becoming the chariot driver;
saàsmaran—remembering all these; *nāpam*—unto the King; *agraJam*—the
eldest brother; *iti*—thus; *āha*—said; *bāñpa*—heavily breathing;
gadgadayä—overwhelmingly; *girä*—by speeches.

TRANSLATION

**Remembering Lord Kṛṣṇa and His well-wishes, benefactions, intimate
familial relations and His chariot driving, Arjuna, overwhelmed and
breathing very heavily, began to speak.**

PURPORT

The Supreme Living Being is perfect in all relations with His pure devotee. Sri Arjuna is one of the typical pure devotees of the Lord reciprocating in the fraternal relationship, and the Lord's dealings with Arjuna are displays of friendship of the highest perfect order. He was not only a well-wisher of Arjuna but actually a benefactor, and to make it still more perfect the Lord tied him into a family relationship by arranging Subhadrā's marriage with him. And above all, the Lord agreed to become a chariot driver of Arjuna in order to protect His friend from warfare risks, and the Lord became actually happy when He established the Pāṇḍavas to rule over the world. Arjuna remembered all these one after another, and thus he became overwhelmed with such thoughts.

TEXT 5

**AJauRNa ovac
viĀTaae_h& MaharaJa hir<aa bNDauæiPa<aa)
YaeNa Mae_PaôTa& TaeJaae devivSMaaPaNa& MahTa()) 5))**

arjuna uvāca

vaicitō 'haà mahā-rāja

hariēā bandhu-rūpiēā

yena me 'pahātaà tejo

deva-vismāpanaà mahat

SYNONYMS

*arjuna*ù *uvāca*—Arjuna said; *vaicitā*ù—left by Him; *aham*—myself; *mahā-rāja*—O King; *hariēā*—by the Personality of Godhead; *bandhu-rūpiēā*—as if an intimate friend; *yena*—by whom; *me*—my; *apahātam*—I have been bereft; *teja*ù—power; *deva*—the demigods; *vismāpanam*—astonishing; *mahat*—astounding.

TRANSLATION

Arjuna said: O King! The Supreme Personality of Godhead Hari, who treated me exactly like an intimate friend, has left me alone. Thus my astounding power, which astonished even the demigods, is no longer with me.

PURPORT

In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (10.41) the Lord says, “Anyone specifically powerful and opulent in wealth, strength, beauty, knowledge and all that is materially desirable is to be considered but a product of an insignificant portion of the complete whole of My energy.” No one, therefore, can be independently powerful in any measure without being endowed by the Lord. When the Lord descends on the earth along with His eternal ever-liberated associates, He not only displays the divine energy possessed by Himself, but also empowers His associate devotees with the required energy to execute His mission of incarnation. It is also stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (4.5) that the Lord and His eternal associates descend on the earth many times, but the Lord remembers all the different roles of incarnations, whereas the associates, by His supreme will, forget them. Similarly, the Lord takes away with Him all His associates when He disappears from the earth. The power and energy which were bestowed upon Arjuna were required for fulfillment of the mission of the Lord, but when His mission was fulfilled, the emergency powers were withdrawn from Arjuna because the astounding powers of Arjuna, which were astonishing even to the denizens of heaven, were no longer required, and they were not meant for going back home, back to Godhead. If endowment of powers and withdrawal of powers by the Lord are possible even for a great devotee like Arjuna, or even the demigods in heaven, then what to speak of the ordinary living beings who are but figs compared to such great souls. The lesson is, therefore, that no one should be puffed up for his powers borrowed from the Lord. The sane man should rather feel obliged to the Lord for such benefactions and must utilize such power for the service of the Lord. Such power can be withdrawn at any time by the Lord, so the best use of such power and opulence is to engage them in the service of the Lord.

TEXT 6

YaSYa +a<aivYaaeGaeNa l/aek-ae ùiPa[YadXaRNa")
oKQaeNa rihTaae ùez Ma*Tak-" Pa[aeCYaTae YaQaa)) 6))

yasya kñāëa-viyogena

loko hy apriya-darçanaù

ukthena rahito hy eña

måtakaù procyate yathä

SYNONYMS

yasya—whose; *kñāëa*—a moment; *viyogena*—by separation; *lokaù*—all the universes; *hi*—certainly; *apriya-darçanaù*—everything appears unfavorable; *ukthena*—by life; *rahitaù*—being devoid of; *hi*—certainly; *eñaù*—all these bodies; *måtakaù*—dead bodies; *procyate*—are designated; *yathä*—as it were.

TRANSLATION

I have just lost Him whose separation for a moment would render all the universes unfavorable and void, like bodies without life.

PURPORT

Factually for a living being there is no one dearer than the Lord. The Lord expands Himself by innumerable parts and parcels as *svāḍṇa* and *vibhinnāḍṇa*. Paramātmā is the *svāḍṇa* part of the Lord, whereas the *vibhinnāḍṇa* parts are the living beings. As the living being is the important factor in the material body, for without the living being the material body has no value, similarly without Paramātmā the living being has no status quo. Similarly, Brahman or Paramātmā has no *locus standi* without the Supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa. This is thoroughly explained in the *Bhagavad-gita*. They are all interlinked with one another, or interdependent factors; thus in

the ultimate issue the Lord is the *summum bonum* and therefore the vital principle of everything.

TEXT 7

YaTSa&é[Yaad(d]uPadGaehMauPaaGaTaaNaa&
raja& SvYa&vrMau%e SMarduMaRdaNaaMa()
TaeJaae ôTa& %lu/ MaYaai>ahTaê MaTSYa"
SaÂqk*-TaeNa DaNauzaiDaGaTaa c k*-Z<aa)) 7))

yat-saàçrayäd drupada-geham upägatänää

räjïää svayaàvara-mukhe smara-durmadänäm

tejo hâtaà khalu mayäbhihataç ca matsyaù

sajjékâtena dhanuñädhigatä ca kãñëä

SYNONYMS

yat—by whose merciful; *saàçrayät*—by strength; *drupada-geham*—in the palace of King Drupada; *upägatänäm*—all those assembled; *räjïäm*—of the princes; *svayaàvara-mukhe*—on the occasion of the selection of the bridegroom; *smara-durmadänäm*—all lusty in thought; *tejaù*—power; *hâtam*—vanquished; *khalu*—as it were; *mayä*—by me; *abhihataù*—pierced; *ca*—also; *matsyaù*—the fish target; *sajjé-kâtena*—by equipping the bow; *dhanuñä*—by that bow also; *adhigatä*—gained; *ca*—also; *kãñëä*—Draupadé.

TRANSLATION

Only by His merciful strength was I able to vanquish all the lusty princes assembled at the palace of King Drupada for the selection of the bridegroom. With my bow and arrow I could pierce the fish target and thereby gain the hand of Draupadé.

PURPORT

Draupadé was the most beautiful daughter of King Drupada, and when she was a young girl almost all the princes desired her hand. But Drupada Mahārāja decided to hand over his daughter to Arjuna only and therefore contrived a peculiar way. There was a fish hanging on the inner roof of the house under the protection of a wheel. The condition was that out of the princely order, one must be able to pierce the fish's eyes through the wheel of protection, and no one would be allowed to look up at the target. On the ground there was a waterpot in which the target and wheel were reflected, and one had to fix his aim towards the target by looking at the trembling water in the pot. Mahārāja Drupada well knew that only Arjuna or alternately Karēa could successfully carry out the plan. But still he wanted to hand his daughter to Arjuna. And in the assembly of the princely order, when Dhāñöadyumna, the brother of Draupadé, introduced all the princes to his grown-up sister, Karēa was also present in the game. But Draupadé tactfully avoided Karēa as the rival of Arjuna, and she expressed her desires through her brother Dhāñöadyumna that she was unable to accept anyone who was less than a *kñatriya*. The *vaisyas* and the *sudras* are less important than the *kṣatriyas*. Karēa was known as the son of a carpenter, a *çüdra*. So Draupadé avoided Karēa by this plea. When Arjuna, in the dress of a poor *brahmana*, pierced the difficult target, everyone was astonished, and all of them, especially Karēa, offered a stiff fight to Arjuna, but as usual by the grace of Lord Kṛṣṇa he was able to emerge very successful in the princely fight and thus gain the valuable hand of Kāñëä, or Draupadé. Arjuna was lamentingly remembering the incident in the absence of the Lord, by whose strength only he was so powerful.

TEXT 8

YaTSaiàDaavhMau %a<@vMaGanYae_da,
iMaNd]& c SaaMarGa<a& TarSaa iviJaTYa)
I/BDaa Sa>aa MaYak*-Taad(>auTaiXaLPaMaaYaa
idG>Yaae_hrä*PaTaYaae bil/Maßre Tae)) 8))

yat-sannidhäv aham u khäëòavam agnaye 'däm

indraà ca sämara-gaëà tarasä vijitya

labdhä sabhā maya-kātādbhuta-çilpa-mäyā

digbhyo 'haran nāpatayo balim adhware te

SYNONYMS

yat—whose; *sannidhau*—being nearby; *aham*—myself; *u*—note of astonishment; *khäëòavam*—the protected forest of Indra, King of heaven; *agnaye*—unto the fire-god; *adām*—delivered; *indram*—Indra; *ca*—also; *sa*—along with; *amara-gaëam*—the demigods; *tarasä*—with all dexterity; *vijitya*—having conquered; *labdhä*—having obtained; *sabhā*—assembly house; *maya-kātā*—built by Maya; *adbhuta*—very wonderful; *çilpa*—art and workmanship; *mäyā*—potency; *digbhyau*—from all directions; *aharan*—collected; *nāpatayaù*—all princes; *balim*—presentations; *adhware*—brought; *te*—your.

TRANSLATION

Because He was near me, it was possible for me to conquer with great dexterity the powerful King of heaven, Indradeva, along with his demigod associates and thus enable the fire-god to devastate the Khäëòava Forest. And only by His grace was the demon named Maya saved from the blazing Khäëòava Forest, and thus we could build our assembly house of wonderful architectural workmanship, where all the princes assembled during the performance of Rājasüya-yajña and paid you tributes.

PURPORT

The demon Maya Dānava was an inhabitant of the forest Khäëòava, and when the Khäëòava Forest was set on fire, he asked protection from Arjuna. Arjuna saved his life, and as a result of this the demon felt obliged. He reciprocated by building a wonderful assembly house for the Pääòavas, which attracted the extraordinary attention of all state princes. They felt the supernatural power of the Pääòavas, and thus without grudge all of them submitted and paid tributes to the Emperor. The demons possess wonderful and supernatural powers to create material wonders. But they are always disturbing elements of the society. The modern demons are the

harmful material scientists who create some material wonders for disturbance in the society. For example, the creation of nuclear weapons has caused some panic in human society. Maya was also a materialist like that, and he knew the art of creating such wonderful things. And yet Lord Kṛṣṇa wanted to kill him. When he was chased both by the fire and by the wheel of Lord Kṛṣṇa, he took shelter of such a devotee as Arjuna, who saved him from the wrath of the fire of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. Devotees are therefore more merciful than the Lord, and in devotional service the mercy of a devotee is more valuable than the mercy of the Lord. Both the fire and the Lord ceased from chasing the demon as soon as both of them saw that the demon was given shelter by such a devotee as Arjuna. This demon, feeling obliged to Arjuna, wanted to do him some service to show his gratefulness, but Arjuna declined to accept anything from him in exchange. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, however, being pleased with Maya for his taking shelter of a devotee, asked him to render service unto King Yudhiṣṭhira by building a wonderful assembly house. The process is that by the grace of the devotee the mercy of the Lord is obtained, and by the mercy of the Lord a chance to serve the Lord's devotee is obtained. The club of Bhémasena was also a gift of Maya Dānava.

TEXT 9

**YataeJaSaa Na*PaiXarae_x(iga]MahNMa%aQaRMa(
AaYaaeR_NauJaSTav GaJaaYauTaSatvvqYaR")
TaeNaaôTaa" Pa[MaQaNaaQaMa%aYa >aUPaa
YaNMaaeicTaaSTadNaYaNa(bil/Maßre Tae)) 9))**

yat-tejasä nāpa-çiro-îghrim ahan makhārtham

äryo 'nujas tava gajäyuta-sattva-véryaù

tenähâtäù pramatha-nätha-makhäya bhüpä

yan-mocitäs tad-anayan balim adhware te

SYNONYMS

yat—whose; *tejasä*—by influence; *nāpa-çiraù-aighrim*—one whose feet are adored by the heads of kings; *ahan*—killed; *makha-artham*—for the sacrifice; *äryaù*—respectable; *anujaù*—younger brother; *tava*—your; *gaja-ayuta*—ten thousand elephants; *sattva-véryaù*—powerful existence; *tena*—by him; *ähâtäù*—collected; *pramatha-nätha*—the lord of the ghosts (Mahābhairava); *makhäya*—for sacrifice; *bhüpäù*—kings; *yat-mocitäù*—by whom they were released; *tat-anayan*—all of them brought; *balim*—taxes; *adhvare*—presented; *te*—your.

TRANSLATION

Your respectable younger brother, who possesses the strength of ten thousand elephants, killed, by His grace, Jaräsandha, whose feet were worshiped by many kings. These kings had been brought for sacrifice in Jaräsandha’s Mahābhairava-yajña, but they were thus released. Later they paid tribute to Your Majesty.

PURPORT

Jaräsandha was a very powerful king of Magadha, and the history of his birth and activities is also very interesting. His father, King Bāhadratha, was also a very prosperous and powerful king of Magadha, but he had no son, although he married two daughters of the King of Kāçé. Being disappointed in not getting a son from either of the two queens, the King, along with his wives, left home to live in the forest for austerities, but in the forest he was blessed by one great *āñi* to have a son, and he gave him one mango to be eaten by the queens. The queens did so and were very soon pregnant. The King was very happy to see the queens bearing children, but when the ripe time approached, the queens delivered one child in two parts, one from each of the queens’ wombs. The two parts were thrown in the forest, where a great she-demon used to live, and she was glad to have some delicate flesh and blood from the newly born child. Out of curiosity she joined the two parts, and the child became complete and regained life. The she-demon was known as Jarä, and being compassionate on the childless King, she went to the King and presented him with the nice child, The King was very pleased with the she-demon and wanted to reward her according to her desire. The she-demon expressed her desire that the child be named

after her, and thus the child was surnamed Jaräsandha, or one who was joined by Jarä, the she-demon. In fact, this Jaräsandha was born as one of the parts and parcels of the demon Vipracitti. The saint by whose benedictions the queens bore the child was called Candra Kauçika, who foretold of the child before his father Bâhadratha.

Since he possessed demoniac qualities from birth, naturally he became a great devotee of Lord Siva, who is the lord of all ghostly and demoniac men. Ravana was a great devotee of Lord Siva, and so also King Jaräsandha. He used to sacrifice all arrested kings before Lord Mahâbhairava (Siva) and by his military power he defeated many small kings and arrested them to butcher before Mahâbhairava. There are many devotees of Lord Mahâbhairava, or Kâlabhairava, in the province of Bihar, formerly called Magadha. Jaräsandha was a relative of Kaàsa, the maternal uncle of Kṛṣṇa, and therefore after Kaàsa's death King Jaräsandha became a great enemy of Kṛṣṇa, and there were many fights between Jaräsandha and Kṛṣṇa. Lord Kṛṣṇa wanted to kill him, but He also wanted that those who served as military men for Jaräsandha might not be killed. Therefore a plan was adopted to kill him. Kṛṣṇa, Bhéma and Arjuna together went to Jaräsandha in the dress of poor *brahmanas* and begged charity from King Jaräsandha. Jaräsandha never refused charity to any *brahmana*, and he performed many sacrifices also, yet he was not on a par with devotional service. Lord Kṛṣṇa, Bhéma and Arjuna asked Jaräsandha for the facility of fighting him, and it was settled that Jaräsandha would fight with Bhéma only. So all of them were both guests and combatants of Jaräsandha, and Bhéma and Jaräsandha fought every day for several days. Bhéma became disappointed, but Kṛṣṇa gave him hints about Jaräsandha's being joined together as an infant, and thus Bhéma dissected him again and so killed him. All the kings who were detained in the concentration camp to be killed before Mahâbhairava were thus released by Bhéma. Feeling thus obliged to the Pãëòavas, they paid tribute to King Yudhiñöhira.

TEXT 10

**PaTNYaaSTavaiDaMa%œáMahai>azek-,
ëaigaïcaåk-br& ik-TavE" Sa>aaYaaMa()
SPa*í& ivk-IYaR PadYaae" PaiTaTaaé[uMau:Yaa**

YaSTaiTñYaae_k*-TahTaeXaivMauç-ke-Xaa")) 10))

patnyäs tavädhimakha-kÿpta-mahäbhiñeka-

çläghiñöha-cäru-kabaraà kitavaiù sabhäyäm

spãñöaà vikérya padayoù patitäçru-mukhyä

yas tat-striyo 'kâta-hateça-vimukta-keçäù

SYNONYMS

patnyäù—of the wife; *tava*—your; *adhimakha*—during the great sacrificial ceremony; *kÿpta*—dressed; *mahä-abhiñeka*—greatly sanctified; *çläghiñöha*—thus glorified; *cäru*—beautiful; *kabaram*—clustered hair; *kitavaiù*—by the miscreants; *sabhäyäm*—in the great assembly; *spãñöam*—being caught; *vikérya*—being loosened; *padayoù*—on the feet; *patita-açru-mukhyäù*—of the one who fell down with tears in the eyes; *yaù*—He; *tat*—their; *striyaù*—wives; *akâta*—became; *hata-éça*—bereft of husbands; *vimukta-keçäù*—loosened hair.

TRANSLATION

It was He only who loosened the hair of all the wives of the miscreants who dared open the cluster of your Queen's hair, which had been nicely dressed and sanctified for the great Rājasūya sacrificial ceremony. At that time she fell down at the feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa with tears in her eyes.

PURPORT

Queen Draupadé had a beautiful bunch of hair which was sanctified in the ceremonial function of Rājasūya-yajña. But when she was lost in a bet, Duçāsana touched her glorified hair to insult her. Draupadé then fell down at the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa, and Lord Kṛṣṇa decided that all the wives of Duçāsana and company should have their hair loosened as a result of the Battle of Kurukñetra. Thus after the Battle of Kurukñetra, after all the sons and grandsons of Dhātarañña died in battle, all the wives of the family

were obliged to loosen their hair as widows. In other words, all the wives of the Kuru family became widows because of Duùçäsana's insulting a great devotee of the Lord. The Lord can tolerate insults upon Himself by any miscreant because the father tolerates even insults from the son. But He never tolerates insults upon His devotees. By insulting a great soul, one has to forego all the results of pious acts and benedictions also.

TEXT 11

**Yaae Naae JauGaaePa vNa WTYa durNTak*-C^\ad(
duvaRSaSaae_irricTaadYauTaaGa]>auGa(Ya")
Xaak-aàìXaíMauPaYauJYa YaTaiñl/aek-I&
Ta*áaMaMa&STa Sail/Ie/ iviNaMaGanSa°")) 11))**

yo no jugopa vana etya duranta-kâcchrâd

durväsaso 'ri-racitâd ayutâgra-bhug yaù

çäkänna-çiñöam upayujya yatas tri-lokéa

tâptäm amaàsta salile vinimagna-saìghaù

SYNONYMS

yaù—one who; *naù*—us; *jugopa*—gave protection; *vane*—forest; *etya*—getting in; *duranta*—dangerously; *kâcchrât*—trouble; *durväsasaù*—of Durväsä Muni; *ari*—enemy; *racitât*—fabricated by; *ayuta*—ten thousand; *agra-bhuk*—one who eats before; *yaù*—that person; *çäka-anna-çiñöam*—remnants of foodstuff; *upayujya*—having accepted; *yataù*—because; *tri-lokém*—all the three worlds; *tâptäm*—satisfied; *amaàsta*—thought within the mind; *salile*—while in the water; *vinimagna-saìghaù*—all merged into the water.

TRANSLATION

During our exile, Durväsä Muni, who eats with his ten thousand disciples, intrigued with our enemies to put us in dangerous trouble. At that time

He [Lord Kṛṣṇa], simply by accepting the remnants of food, saved us. By His accepting food thus, the assembly of munis, while bathing in the river, felt sumptuously fed. And all the three worlds were also satisfied.

PURPORT

Durvāsā Muni: A powerful mystic *brahmana* determined to observe the principles of religion with great vows and under strict austerities. His name is associated with many historical events, and it appears that the great mystic could be both easily satisfied and easily annoyed, like Lord Siva. When he was satisfied, he could do tremendous good to the servitor, but if he was dissatisfied he could bring about the greatest calamity. Kumāré Kunté, at her father's house, used to minister all kinds of services to all great *brahmanas*, and being satisfied with her good reception Durvāsā Muni blessed her with a power to call any demigod she desired. It is understood that he was a plenary incarnation of Lord Siva, and thus he could be either easily satisfied or annoyed. He was a great devotee of Lord Siva, and by Lord Siva's order he accepted the priesthood of King Çvetaketu because of the King's performance of sacrifice for one hundred years. Sometimes he used to visit the parliamentary assembly of the heavenly kingdom of Indradeva. He could travel in space by his great mystic powers, and it is understood that he traveled a great distance through space, even up to the Vaikuntha planets beyond material space. He traveled all these long distances within one year, during his quarrel with King Ambaréña, the great devotee and Emperor of the world.

He had about ten thousand disciples, and wherever he visited and became a guest of the great *kñatriya* kings, he used to be accompanied by a number of followers. Once he visited the house of Duryodhana, the enemy cousin of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. Duryodhana was intelligent enough to satisfy the *brahmana* by all means, and the great *āñi* wanted to give some benediction to Duryodhana. Duryodhana knew his mystic powers, and he knew also that the mystic *brahmana*, if dissatisfied, could cause some havoc, and thus he designed to engage the *brahmana* to show his wrath upon his enemy cousins, the Pāṇḍavas. When the *āñi* wanted to award some benediction to Duryodhana, the latter wished that he should visit the house of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, who was the eldest and chief among all his cousins. But by his

request he would go to him after he had finished his meals with his Queen, Draupadé. Duryodhana knew that after Draupadé's dinner it would be impossible for Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira to receive such a large number of *brahmana* guests, and thus the *āñi* would be annoyed and would create some trouble for his cousin Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. That was the plan of Duryodhana. Durvāsā Muni agreed to this proposal, and he approached the King in exile, according to the plan of Duryodhana, after the King and Draupadé had finished their meals.

On his arrival at the door of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, he was at once well received, and the King requested him to finish his noontime religious rites in the river, for by that time the foodstuff would be prepared. Durvāsā Muni, along with his large number of disciples, went to take a bath in the river, and Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was in great anxiety about the guests. As long as Draupadé had not taken her meals, food could be served to any number of guests, but the *āñi*, by the plan of Duryodhana, reached there after Draupadé had finished her meals.

When the devotees are put into difficulty, they have an opportunity to recollect the Lord with rapt attention. So Draupadé was thinking of Lord Kṛṣṇa in that dangerous position, and the all-pervading Lord could at once know the dangerous position of His devotees. He therefore came there on the scene and asked Draupadé to give whatever food she might have in her stock. On her being so requested by the Lord, Draupadé was sorrowful because the Supreme Lord asked her for some food and she was unable to supply it at that time. She said to the Lord that the mysterious dish which she had received from the sun-god could supply any amount of food if she herself had not eaten. But on that day she had already taken her meals, and thus they were in danger. By expressing her difficulties she began to cry before the Lord as only a woman would do in such a position. The Lord, however, asked Draupadé to bring up the cooking pots to see if there was any particle of foodstuff left, and on Draupadé's doing so, the Lord found some particle of vegetable sticking to the pot. The Lord at once picked it up and ate it. After doing so, the Lord asked Draupadé to call for her guests, the company of Durvāsā.

Bhéma was sent to call them from the river. Bhéma said, "Why are you

delaying, sirs? Come on, the food is ready for you.” But the *brahmanas*, because of Lord Kṛṣṇa’s accepting a little particle of food, felt sumptuously fed, even while they were in the water. They thought that since Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira must have prepared many valuable dishes for them and since they were not hungry and could not eat, the King would feel very sorry, so it was better not to go there. Thus they decided to go away.

This incident proves that the Lord is the greatest mystic, and therefore He is known as Yogesvara. Another instruction is that every householder must offer food to the Lord, and the result will be that everyone, even a company of guests numbering ten thousand, will be satisfied because of the Lord’s being satisfied. That is the way of devotional service.

TEXT 12

**YataeJaSaaQa >aGavaNa(YauDa éUI/Paaia<a,
ivRSMaaPaTa" SaiGairJaae_ñMadaiàJa& Mae)
ANYae_iPa cahMaMauNaEv k-le/vre<a
Pa[aáae MaheNd]>avNae MahdaSaNaDaRMa()) 12))**

yat-tejasätha bhagavän yudhi çüla-päëir

vismäpitaù sagirijo ’stram adän nijaà me

anye ’pi cäham amunaiva kalevareëa

präpto mahendra-bhavane mahad-äsanärdham

SYNONYMS

yat—by whose; *tejasä*—by influence; *atha*—at one time; *bhagavän*—the personality of god (Lord Siva); *yudhi*—in the battle; *çüla-päëiù*—one who has a trident in his hand; *vismäpitaù*—astonished; *sa-girijaù*—along with the daughter of the Himalaya Mountains; *astram*—weapon; *adät*—awarded; *nijam*—of his own; *me*—unto me; *anye api*—so also others; *ca*—and; *aham*—myself; *amunä*—by this; *eva*—definitely; *kalevareëa*—by the body; *präptaù*—obtained; *mahä-indra-bhavane*—in the house of

Indradeva; *mahat*—great; *āsana-ardham*—half-elevated seat.

TRANSLATION

It was by His influence only that in a fight I was able to astonish the personality of god Lord Siva and his wife, the daughter of Mount Himalaya. Thus he [Lord Siva] became pleased with me and awarded me his own weapon. Other demigods also delivered their respective weapons to me, and in addition I was able to reach the heavenly planets in this present body and was allowed a half-elevated seat.

PURPORT

By the grace of the Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa, all the demigods, including Lord Siva, were pleased with Arjuna. The idea is that one who is favored by Lord Siva or any other demigod may not necessarily be favored by the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. Ravana was certainly a great devotee of Lord Siva, but he could not be saved from the wrath of the Supreme Personality of Godhead Lord Rāmacandra. And there are many instances like that in the histories of the *Puranas*. But here is an instance where we can see that Lord Siva became pleased even in the fight with Arjuna. The devotees of the Supreme Lord know how to respect the demigods, but the devotees of the demigods sometimes foolishly think that the Supreme Personality of Godhead is no greater than the demigods. By such a conception, one becomes an offender and ultimately meets with the same end as Ravana and others. The instances described by Arjuna during his friendly dealings with Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa are instructive for all who may be convinced by the lessons that one can achieve all favors simply by pleasing the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, whereas the devotees or worshipers of the demigods may achieve only partial benefits, which are also perishable, just as the demigods themselves are.

Another significance of the present verse is that Arjuna, by the grace of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, was able to reach the heavenly planet even with the selfsame body and was honored by the heavenly demigod Indradeva, being seated with him half-elevated. One can reach the heavenly planets by the pious acts recommended in the *sastras* in the category of fruitive activities.

And as stated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.21), when the reactions of such pious acts are spent, the enjoyer is again degraded to this earthly planet. The moon is also on the level with the heavenly planets, and only persons who have performed virtues only—performing sacrifices, giving charity and undergoing severe austerities—can be allowed to enter into the heavenly planets after the duration of life of the body. Arjuna was allowed to enter into the heavenly planets in the selfsame body simply by the grace of the Lord, otherwise it is not possible to do so. The present attempts to enter into the heavenly planets by the modern scientists will certainly prove futile because such scientists are not on the level of Arjuna. They are ordinary human beings, without any assets of sacrifice, charity or austerities. The material body is influenced by the three modes of material nature, namely goodness, passion and ignorance. The present population is more or less influenced by the modes of passion and ignorance, and the symptoms for such influence are exhibited in their becoming very lusty and greedy. Such degraded fellows can hardly approach the higher planetary systems. Above the heavenly planets there are many other planets also, which only those who are influenced by goodness can reach. In heavenly and other planets within the universe, the inhabitants are all highly intelligent, many more times than the human beings, and they are all pious in the higher and highest mode of goodness. They are all devotees of the Lord, and although their goodness is not unadulterated, still they are known as demigods possessing the maximum amount of good qualities possible within the material world.

TEXT 13

Ta}aEv Mae ivhrTaae >auJad<@YauGMa&
 Gaa<@qvl/+a<aMaraiTavDaaYa deva")
 SaeNd]a" ié[Taa YadNau>aaivTaMaaJaMaq!
 TaeNaahMaÛ MauizTa" Pauåze<a >aUMana)) 13))

tatraiva me viharato bhuja-daëòà-yugmaà

gäëòéva-lakñäëam aräti-vadhäya deväù

sendräù çritä yad-anubhävitaṁ äjaméòha

tenāham adya muñitaù puruñeëa bhümnä

SYNONYMS

tatra—in that heavenly planet; *eva*—certainly; *me*—myself; *viharataù*—while staying as a guest; *bhuja-daëò-a-yugmam*—both of my arms; *gäëòéva*—the bow named Gäëòéva; *lakñäëam*—mark; *aräti*—a demon named Nivātakavaca; *vadhäya*—for killing; *deväù*—all the demigods; *sa*—along with; *indräù*—the heavenly King, Indra; *çritäù*—taken shelter of; *yat*—by whose; *anubhāvitam*—made it possible to be powerful; *äjaméòha*—O descendant of King Ajaméòha; *tena*—by Him; *aham*—myself; *adya*—at the present moment; *muñitaù*—bereft of; *puruñeëa*—the personality; *bhümnä*—supreme.

TRANSLATION

When I stayed for some days as a guest in the heavenly planets, all the heavenly demigods, including King Indradeva, took shelter of my arms, which were marked with the Gäëòéva bow, to kill the demon named Nivātakavaca. O King, descendant of Ajaméòha, at the present moment I am bereft of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, by whose influence I was so powerful.

PURPORT

The heavenly demigods are certainly more intelligent, powerful and beautiful, and yet they had to take help from Arjuna because of his Gäëòéva bow, which was empowered by the grace of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. The Lord is all-powerful, and by His grace His pure devotee can be as powerful as He may desire, and there is no limit to it. And when the Lord withdraws His power from anyone, he is powerless by the will of the Lord.

TEXT 14

**YaøaNDav" ku-åbl/aiBDaMaNaNTaPaar,
Maek-ae rQaeNa TaTare_hMaTaqYaRSatvMa()
Pa[TYaaôTa& bhu DaNa& c MaYaa Pareza&**

TaeJaaSPad& Mai<aMaYa& c ôTa& iXarae>Ya")) 14))

yad-bāndhavaù kuru-balābḍhim ananta-pāram

eko rathena tatare 'ham atérya-sattvam

pratyāhātaà bahu dhanaà ca mayä pareñäà

tejäs-padaà maëimayaà ca hātaà çirobhyaù

SYNONYMS

yat-bāndhavaù—by whose friendship only; *kuru-bala-abḍhim*—the ocean of the military strength of the Kurus; *ananta-pāram*—which was insurmountable; *ekaù*—alone; *rathena*—being seated on the chariot; *tatare*—was able to cross over; *aham*—myself; *atérya*—invincible; *sattvam*—existence; *pratyāhātam*—drew back; *bahu*—very large quantity; *dhanam*—wealth; *ca*—also; *mayä*—by my; *pareñäm*—of the enemy; *tejäù-padam*—source of brilliance; *maëi-mayam*—bedecked with jewels; *ca*—also; *hātam*—taken by force; *çirobhyaù*—from their heads.

TRANSLATION

The military strength of the Kauravas was like an ocean in which there dwelled many invincible existences, and thus it was insurmountable. But because of His friendship, I, seated on the chariot, was able to cross over it. And only by His grace was I able to regain the cows and also collect by force many helmets of the kings which were bedecked with jewels that were sources of all brilliance.

PURPORT

On the Kaurava side there were many stalwart commanders like Bhéñma, Droëa, Kāpa and Karëa, and their military strength was as insurmountable as the great ocean. And yet it was due to Lord Kṛṣṇa's grace that Arjuna alone, sitting on the chariot, could manage to vanquish them one after another without difficulty. There were many changes of commanders on

the other side, but on the Pääòavas’ side Arjuna alone on the chariot driven by Lord Kṛṣṇa could manage the whole responsibility of the great war. Similarly, when the Pääòavas were living at the palace of Viräöa incognito, the Kauravas picked a quarrel with King Viräöa and decided to take away his large number of cows. While they were taking away the cows, Arjuna fought with them incognito and was able to regain the cows along with some booty taken by force—the jewels set on the turbans of the royal order. Arjuna remembered that all this was possible by the grace of the Lord.

TEXT 15

Yaae >aqZMak-<aRGauâXaLYacMaUZvd>a],
 raJaNYavYaRrQaMa<@I/Mai<@TaaSau)
 AGa]ecrae MaMa iv>aae rQaYaUQaPaaNaa,
 MaaYauMaRNaa&iSa c d*Xaa Sah AaeJa AaC^RTa()) 15))

yo bhéñma-karëa-guru-çalya-camüñv adabhra-

räjanya-varya-ratha-maëòala-maëòitäsü

agrecaro mama vibho ratha-yüthapänäm

äyur manäàsi ca dâçä saha oja ärcchat

SYNONYMS

yaù—it is He only; *bhéñma*—Bhéñma; *karëa*—Karëa; *guru*—Droëäcärya; *çalya*—Çalya; *camüñu*—in the midst of the military phalanx; *adabhra*—immense; *räjanya-varya*—great royal princes; *ratha-maëòala*—chain of chariots; *maëòitäsü*—being decorated with; *agrecaraù*—going forward; *mama*—of mine; *vibho*—O great King; *ratha-yütha-pänäm*—all the charioteers; *äyuù*—duration of life or fruitive activities; *manäàsi*—mental upsurges; *ca*—also; *dâçä*—by glance; *sahaù*—power; *ojaù*—strength; *ärcchat*—withdrew.

TRANSLATION

It was He only who withdrew the duration of life from everyone and who, in the battlefield, withdrew the speculative power and strength of enthusiasm from the great military phalanx made by the Kauravas, headed by Bhéñma, Karëa, Droëa, Çalya, etc. Their arrangement was expert and more than adequate, but He [Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa], while going forward, did all this.

PURPORT

The Absolute Personality of Godhead, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, expands Himself by His plenary Paramātmā portion in everyone's heart, and thus He directs everyone in the matter of recollection, forgetfulness, knowledge, the absence of intelligence and all psychological activities (Bg. 15.15). As the Supreme Lord, He can increase or decrease the duration of life of a living being. Thus the Lord conducted the Battle of Kurukṣetra according to His own plan. He wanted that battle to establish Yudhiṣṭhira as the Emperor of this planet, and to facilitate this transcendental business He killed all who were on the opposite party by His omnipotent will. The other party was equipped with all military strength supported by big generals like Bhéñma, Droëa and Çalya and it would have been physically impossible for Arjuna to win the battle had the Lord not helped him by every kind of tactic. Such tactics are generally followed by every statesman, even in modern warfare, but they are all done materially by powerful espionages, military tactics and diplomatic maneuvers. But because Arjuna was the Lord's affectionate devotee, the Lord did all this Himself without personal anxiety by Arjuna. That is the way of the devotional service to the Lord.

TEXT 16

**YaŌae"zu Maa Pa[i<aihTa& Gauâ>aqZMak-<aR,
Naá*i}aGaTaRXaLYaSaENDavbaiúk-aŪE")
Aña<YaMaaegaMaihMaaiNa iNaæiPaTaaNa
NaaePaSPa*éuNa*RhirdaSaiMavaSaurai<a)) 16))**

yad-douñu mä praëihitaà guru-bhéñma-karëa-

naptâ-trigarta-çalya-saindhava-bählikädyaiù

asträëy amogha-mahimäni nirüpitäni

nopaspåçur nâhari-däsam iväsuräëi

SYNONYMS

yat—under whose; *doùñu*—protection of arms; *mä praëihitam*—myself being situated; *guru*—Droëäcärya; *bhéñma*—Bhéñma; *karëa*—Karëa; *naptâ*—Bhüriçravä; *trigarta*—King Suçarmä; *çalya*—Çalya; *saindhava*—King Jayadratha; *bählika*—brother of Mahäräja Çäntanu (Bhéñma’s father); *ädyaiù*—etc.; *asträëi*—weapons; *amogha*—invincible; *mahimäni*—very powerful; *nirüpitäni*—applied; *na*—not; *upaspåçuù*—touched; *nâhari-däsam*—servitor of Nṛsiṃhadeva (Prahläda); *iva*—like; *asuräëi*—weapons employed by the demons.

TRANSLATION

Great generals like Bhéñma, Droëa, Karëa, Bhüriçravä, Suçarmä, Çalya, Jayadratha, and Bählika all directed their invincible weapons against me. But by His [Lord Kṛṣṇa’s] grace they could not even touch a hair on my head. Similarly, Prahläda Mahäräja, the supreme devotee of Lord Nṛsiṃhadeva, was unaffected by the weapons the demons used against him.

PURPORT

The history of Prahläda Mahäräja, the great devotee of Nṛsiṃhadeva, is narrated in the Seventh Canto of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Prahläda Mahäräja, a small child of only five years, became the object of envy for his great father, Hiranyakaśipu, only because of his becoming a pure devotee of the Lord. The demon father employed all his weapons to kill the devotee son, Prahläda, but by the grace of the Lord he was saved from all sorts of dangerous actions by his father. He was thrown in a fire, in boiling oil, from the top of a hill, underneath the legs of an elephant, and he was administered poison. At last the father himself took up a chopper to kill his son, and thus Nṛsiṃhadeva appeared and killed the heinous father in the presence of the son. Thus no one can kill the devotee of the Lord. Similarly,

Arjuna was also saved by the Lord, although all dangerous weapons were employed by his great opponents like Bhéñma.

Karëa: Born of Kunté by the sun-god prior to her marriage with Mahäräja Pääòu, Karëa took his birth with bangles and earrings, extraordinary signs for an undaunted hero. In the beginning his name was Vasusena, but when he grew up he presented his natural bangles and earrings to Indradeva, and thenceforward he became known as Vaikartana. After his birth from the maiden Kunté, he was thrown in the Ganges. Later he was picked up by Adhiratha, and he and his wife Rädhä brought him up as their own offspring. Karëa was very charitable, especially toward the *brahmanas*. There was nothing he could not spare for a *brahmana*. In the same charitable spirit he gave in charity his natural bangles and earrings to Indradeva, who, being very much satisfied with him, gave him in return a great weapon called Çakti. He was admitted as one of the students of Droëäcärya, and from the very beginning there was some rivalry between him and Arjuna. Seeing his constant rivalry with Arjuna, Duryodhana picked him up as his companion, and this gradually grew into greater intimacy. He was also present in the great assembly of Draupadé's *svayaàvara* function, and when he attempted to exhibit his talent in that meeting, Draupadé's brother declared that Karëa could not take part in the competition because of his being the son of a *çüdra* carpenter. Although he was refused in the competition, still when Arjuna was successful in piercing the fish target on the ceiling and Draupadé bestowed her garland upon Arjuna, Karëa and the other disappointed princes offered an unusual stumbling block to Arjuna while he was leaving with Draupadé. Specifically, Karëa fought with him very valiantly, but all of them were defeated by Arjuna. Duryodhana was very much pleased with Karëa because of his constant rivalry with Arjuna, and when he was in power he enthroned Karëa in the state of Aìga. Being baffled in his attempt to win Draupadé, Karëa advised Duryodhana to attack King Drupada, for after defeating him both Arjuna and Draupadé could be arrested. But Droëäcärya rebuked them for this conspiracy, and they refrained from the action. Karëa was defeated many times, not only by Arjuna but also by Bhémasena. He was the king of the kingdom of Bengal, Orissa and Madras combined. Later on he took an active part in the Räjäsüya sacrifice of Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira, and when there was gambling between the rival brothers, designed by Çakuni, Karëa took part in the

game, and he was very pleased when Draupadé was offered as a bet in the gambling. This fed his old grudge. When Draupadé was in the game he was very enthusiastic to declare the news, and it is he who ordered Duùçäsana to take away the garments of both the Pääòavas and Draupadé. He asked Draupadé to select another husband because, being lost by the Pääòavas, she was rendered a slave of the Kurus. He was always an enemy of the Pääòavas, and whenever there was an opportunity, he tried to curb them by all means. During the Battle of Kurukñetra, he foresaw the conclusive result, and he expressed his opinion that due to Lord Kṛṣṇa's being the chariot driver of Arjuna, the battle should be won by Arjuna. He always differed with Bhéñma, and sometimes he was proud enough to say that within five days he could finish up the Pääòavas, if Bhéñma would not interfere with his plan of action. But he was much mortified when Bhéñma died. He killed Ghaöotkaca with the Çakti weapon obtained from Indradeva. His son, Våñasena, was killed by Arjuna. He killed the largest number of Pääòava soldiers. At last there was a severe fight with Arjuna, and it was he only who was able to knock off the helmet of Arjuna. But it so happened that the wheel of his chariot stuck in the battlefield mud, and when he got down to set the wheel right, Arjuna took the opportunity and killed him, although he requested Arjuna not to do so.

Naptä, or Bhüriçravä: Bhüriçravä was the son of Somadatta, a member of the Kuru family. His other brother was Çalya. Both the brothers and the father attended the *svayaàvara* ceremony of Draupadé. All of them appreciated the wonderful strength of Arjuna due to his being the devotee friend of the Lord, and thus Bhüriçravä advised the sons of Dhåtaråñöra not to pick any quarrel or fight with them. All of them also attended the Råjasüya *yajña* of Mahåraja Yudhiñöhira. He possessed one *akñauhiëé* regiment of army, cavalry, elephants and chariots, and all these were employed in the Battle of Kurukñetra on behalf of Duryodhana's party. He was counted by Bhéma as one of the *yütha-patis*. In the Battle of Kurukñetra he was especially engaged in a fight with Sätyaki, and he killed ten sons of Sätyaki. Later on, Arjuna cut off his hands, and he was ultimately killed by Sätyaki. After his death he merged into the existence of Viçvadeva.

Trigarta, or Suçarmä: Son of Mahåraja Våddhakñetra, he was the King of

Trigartadeça, and he was also present in the *svayaàvara* ceremony of Draupadé. He was one of the allies of Duryodhana, and he advised Duryodhana to attack the Matsyadeça (Darbhaga). During the time of cow-stealing in Viräöa-nagara, he was able to arrest Mahäräja Viräöa, but later Mahäräja Viräöa was released by Bhéma. In the Battle of Kurukñetra he also fought very valiantly, but at the end he was killed by Arjuna.

Jayadratha: Another son of Mahäräja Vâddhakñetra. He was the King of Sindhudeça (modern Sind Pakistan). His wife's name was Duùçalä. He was also present in the *svayaàvara* ceremony of Draupadé, and he desired very strongly to have her hand, but he failed in the competition. But since then he always sought the opportunity to get in touch with Draupadé. When he was going to marry in the Çalyadeça, on the way to Kämyavana he happened to see Draupadé again and was too much attracted to her. The Pääòavas and Draupadé were then in exile, after losing their empire in gambling, and Jayadratha thought it wise to send news to Draupadé in an illicit manner through Koöiçañya, one of his associates. Draupadé at once refused vehemently the proposal of Jayadratha, but being so much attracted by the beauty of Draupadé, he tried again and again. Every time he was refused by Draupadé. He tried to take her away forcibly on his chariot, and at first Draupadé gave him a good dashing, and he fell like a cut-root tree. But he was not discouraged, and he was able to force Draupadé to sit on the chariot. This incident was seen by Dhaumya Muni, and he strongly protested the action of Jayadratha. He also followed the chariot, and through Dhätreyikä the matter was brought to the notice of Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira. The Pääòavas then attacked the soldiers of Jayadratha and killed them all, and at last Bhéma caught hold of Jayadratha and beat him very severely, almost dead. Then all but five hairs were cut off his head and he was taken to all the kings and introduced as the slave of Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira. He was forced to admit himself to be the slave of Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira before all the princely order, and in the same condition he was brought before Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira. Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira was kind enough to order him released, and when he admitted to being a tributary prince under Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira, Queen Draupadé also desired his release. After this incident, he was allowed to return to his country. Being so insulted, he went to Gaigätri in the Himalayas and undertook a severe type of penance to please Lord Siva. He asked his

benediction to defeat all the Pääðavas, at least one at a time. Then the Battle of Kurukñetra began, and he took sides with Duryodhana. In the first day's fight he was engaged with Mahārāja Drupada, then with Viräöa and then with Abhimanyu. While Abhimanyu was being killed, mercilessly surrounded by seven great generals, the Pääðavas came to his help, but Jayadratha, by the mercy of Lord Siva, repulsed them with great ability. At this, Arjuna took a vow to kill him, and on hearing this, Jayadratha wanted to leave the warfield and asked permission from the Kauravas for this cowardly action. But he was not allowed to do so. On the contrary, he was obliged to fight with Arjuna, and while the fight was going on Lord Kṛṣṇa reminded Arjuna that the benediction of Siva upon Jayadratha was that whoever would cause his head to fall on the ground would die at once. He therefore advised Arjuna to throw the head of Jayadratha directly onto the lap of his father, who was engaged in penances at the Samanta-paīcaka pilgrimage. This was actually done by Arjuna. Jayadratha's father was surprised to see a severed head on his lap, and he at once threw it to the ground. The father immediately died, his forehead being cracked in seven pieces.

TEXT 17

SaaETYae v*Ta" ku-MaiTaNaatTMad wRìrae Mae
 YaTPaadPaÚMa>avaYa >aJaiNTa >aVYaa")
 Maa& é[aNTavahMarYaae riQaNaae >auivi&
 Na Pa[ahrNa(YadNau>aaviNarSTaictaa")) 17))

sautye vātaù kumatinātmada éçvaro me

yat-pāda-padmaṁ abhavāya bhajanti bhavyāu

māḥ çrānta-vāhaṁ arayo rathino bhuvi-ñōhaḥ

na prāharan yad-anubhāva-nirasta-cittāu

SYNONYMS

sautye—regarding a chariot driver; *vātaù*—engaged; *kumatinā*—by bad

consciousness; *ätma-daù*—one who delivers; *éçvaraù*—the Supreme Lord; *me*—my; *yat*—whose; *päda-padma*—lotus feet; *abhaväya*—in the matter of salvation; *bhajanti*—do render service; *bhavyäù*—the intelligent class of men; *mäm*—unto me; *çränta*—thirsty; *väham*—my horses; *arayaù*—the enemies; *rathinaù*—a great general; *bhuvi-ñöham*—while standing on the ground; *na*—did not; *präharan*—attack; *yat*—whose; *anubháva*—mercy; *nirasta*—being absent; *cittäù*—mind.

TRANSLATION

It was by His mercy only that my enemies neglected to kill me when I descended from my chariot to get water for my thirsty horses. And it was due to my lack of esteem for my Lord that I dared engage Him as my chariot driver, for He is worshiped and offered services by the best men to attain salvation.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa, is the object of worship both by impersonalists and by the devotees of the Lord. The impersonalists worship His glowing effulgence, emanating from His transcendental body of eternal form, bliss and knowledge, and the devotees worship Him as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Those who are below even the impersonalists consider Him to be one of the great historical personalities. The Lord, however, descends to attract all by His specific transcendental pastimes, and thus He plays the part of the most perfect master, friend, son and lover. His transcendental relation with Arjuna was in friendship, and the Lord therefore played the part perfectly, as He did with His parents, lovers and wives. While playing in such a perfect transcendental relation, the devotee forgets, by the internal potency of the Lord, that his friend or son is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, although sometimes the devotee is bewildered by the acts of the Lord. After the departure of the Lord, Arjuna was conscious of his great friend, but there was no mistake on the part of Arjuna, nor any ill estimation of the Lord. Intelligent men are attracted by the transcendental acting of the Lord with a pure, unalloyed devotee like Arjuna.

In the warfield, scarcity of water is a well-known fact. Water is very rare there, and both the animals and men, working strenuously on the warfield, constantly require water to quench their thirst. Especially wounded soldiers and generals feel very thirsty at the time of death, and it sometimes so happens that simply for want of water one has to die unavoidably. But such scarcity of water was solved in the Battle of Kurukñetra by means of boring the ground. By God's grace, water can be easily obtained from any place if there is facility for boring the ground. The modern system works on the same principle of boring the ground, but modern engineers are still unable to dig immediately wherever necessary. It appears, however, from the history as far back as the days of the Pãëòavas, that big generals like Arjuna could at once supply water even to the horses, and what to speak of men, by drawing water from underneath the hard ground simply by penetrating the stratum with a sharp arrow, a method still unknown to the modern scientists.

TEXT 18

**NaMaaR<YaudarâicriSMaTaXaaei>aTaaNa
he PaaQaR he_JauRNa Sa%e ku-âNaNdNaeiTa)
SaÂiLPaTaaNa Nardev ôidSPa*XaaNa
SMaTauRluR/#=iNTa ôdYa& MaMa MaaDavSYa)) 18))**

narmäëy udära-rucira-smita-çobhitäni

he pärtha he 'rjuna sakhe kuru-nandaneti

saijalpitäni nara-deva hâdi-spâçäni

smartur luöhanti hâdayaà mama mädhavasya

SYNONYMS

narmäëi—conversation in jokes; *udära*—talked very frankly; *rucira*—pleasing; *smita-çobhitäni*—decorated with a smiling face; *he*—note of address; *pärtha*—O son of Pãthä; *he*—note of address; *arjuna*—Arjuna; *sakhe*—friend; *kuru-nandana*—son of the Kuru dynasty; *iti*—and so on;

saijalpitäni—such conversation; *nara-deva*—O King; *hådi*—heart; *spåçäni*—touching; *smartuù*—by remembering them; *luöhanti*—overwhelms; *hådayam*—heart and soul; *mama*—my; *mādhavasya*—of Mādhava (Kṛṣṇa).

TRANSLATION

O King! His jokings and frank talks were pleasing and beautifully decorated with smiles. His addresses unto me as “O son of Pāthā, O friend, O son of the Kuru dynasty,” and all such heartiness are now remembered by me, and thus I am overwhelmed.

TEXT 19

XaYYaaSaNaas\$=Naivk-TQaNa>aaeJaNaaid,
ZvEKYaaÜYaSYa %TavaiNaiTa ivPa[l/BDa")
Sa:Yau" Sa%ev iPaTa*vtaNaYaSYa Sav|
Saehe MahaNMaiahTaYaa ku-MaTaerga& Mae)) 19))

çayyāsanaöāna-vikatthana-bhojanādiñv

aikyād vayasya ātavän iti vipralabdhaù

sakhyuù sakheva pitāvat tanayasya sarvaà

sehe mahän mahitayä kumater aghaà me

SYNONYMS

çayya—sleeping on one bed; *āsana*—sitting on one seat; *aöāna*—walking together; *vikatthana*—self-adoration; *bhojana*—dining together; *ādiñu*—and in all such dealings; *aikyāt*—because of oneness; *vayasya*—O my friend; *ātavän*—truthful; *iti*—thus; *vipralabdhaù*—misbehaved; *sakhyuù*—unto a friend; *sakhä iva*—just like a friend; *pitāvat*—just like the father; *tanayasya*—of a child; *sarvam*—all; *sehe*—tolerated; *mahän*—great; *mahitayä*—by glories; *kumateù*—of one who is of low mentality; *agham*—offense; *me*—mine.

TRANSLATION

Generally both of us used to live together and sleep, sit and loiter together. And at the time of advertising oneself for acts of chivalry, sometimes, if there were any irregularity, I used to reproach Him by saying, “My friend, You are very truthful.” Even in those hours when His value was minimized, He, being the Supreme Soul, used to tolerate all those utterings of mine, excusing me exactly as a true friend excuses his true friend, or a father excuses his son.

PURPORT

Since the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is all-perfect, His transcendental pastimes with His pure devotees never lack anything in any respect, either as a friend, son or lover. The Lord relishes the reproaches of friends, parents or fiancées more than the Vedic hymns offered to Him by great learned scholars and religionists in an official fashion.

TEXT 20

Saae_h& Na*PaeNd] rihTa" PauāzaetaMaeNa
Sa:Yaa iPa[Yae<a Sauôda ôdYaeNa éUNYa")
AßNYauâ§-MaPairGa]hMa® r+aNa(
GaaePaErSaiÛrble/v iviNaiJaRTaae_iSMa)) 20))

so 'haà nāpendra rahitaù puruñottamena

sakhyä priyeëa suhādä hādayena çünyaù

adhvany urukrama-parigraham aḡga rakñan

gopair asadbhir abaleva vinirjito 'smi

SYNONYMS

saù—that; *aham*—myself; *nāpa-indra*—O Emperor; *rahitaù*—bereft of; *puruṣa-uttamena*—by the Supreme Lord; *sakhyä*—by my friend; *priyeëa*—

by my dearmost; *suhādā*—by the well-wisher; *hādayena*—by the heart and soul; *çünyaù*—vacant; *adhvani*—recently; *urukrama-parigraham*—the wives of the all-powerful; *aiga*—bodies; *rakñan*—while protecting; *gopaiù*—by the cowherds; *asadbhiù*—by the infidels; *abalā iva*—like a weak woman; *vinirjitaù asmi*—I have been defeated.

TRANSLATION

O Emperor, now I am separated from my friend and dearmost well-wisher, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and therefore my heart appears to be void of everything. In His absence I have been defeated by a number of infidel cowherd men while I was guarding the bodies of all the wives of Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

The important point in this verse is how it was possible that Arjuna could be defeated by a gang of ignoble cowherd men and how such mundane cowherd men could touch the bodies of the wives of Lord Kṛṣṇa, who were under the protection of Arjuna. Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Ōhākura has justified the contradiction by research in the *Viṣṇu Purana* and *Brahma Purana*. In these *Puranas* it is said that once the fair denizens of heaven pleased Añöäväkra Muni by their service and were blessed by the *muni* to have the Supreme Lord as their husband. Añöäväkra Muni was curved in eight joints of his body, and thus he used to move in a peculiar curved manner. The daughters of the demigods could not check their laughter upon seeing the movements of the *muni*, and the *muni*, being angry at them, cursed them that they would be kidnapped by rogues, even if they would get the Lord as their husband. Later on, the girls again satisfied the *muni* by their prayers, and the *muni* blessed them that they would regain their husband even after being robbed by the rogues. So, in order to keep the words of the great *muni*, the Lord Himself kidnapped His wives from the protection of Arjuna, otherwise they would have at once vanished from the scene as soon as they were touched by the rogues. Besides that, some of the *gopés* who prayed to become wives of the Lord returned to their respective positions after their desire was fulfilled. After the departure of Lord Kṛṣṇa, He wanted all His entourage back to Godhead, and they were

called back under different conditions only.

TEXT 21

TaÜE DaNauSTa wzv" Sa rQaae hYaaSTae
Saae_h& rQaq Na*PaTaYaae YaTa AaNaMaiNTa)
Sav| +a<aeNa Tad>aUdSadqXairÇ&-
>aSMaNa(huTa& ku-hk-raÖiMavaeáMaUZYaaMa()) 21))

tad vai dhanus ta iñavaù sa ratho hayäs te

so 'haà rathé nãpatayo yata änamanti

sarvaà kñäëena tad abhüd asad éça-riktaà

bhasman hutaà kuhaka-räddham ivoptam üñyäm

SYNONYMS

tat—the same; *vai*—certainly; *dhanuù te*—the same bow; *iñavaù*—arrows; *saù*—the very same; *rathaù*—chariot; *hayäù te*—the very same horses; *saù aham*—I am the same Arjuna; *rathé*—the chariot-fighter; *nãpatayaù*—all the kings; *yataù*—whom; *änamanti*—offered their respects; *sarvam*—all; *kñäëena*—at a moment's notice; *tat*—all those; *abhüt*—became; *asat*—useless; *éça*—because of the Lord; *riktam*—being void; *bhasman*—ashes; *hutam*—offering butter; *kuhaka-räddham*—money created by magical feats; *iva*—like that; *uptam*—sown; *üñyäm*—in barren land.

TRANSLATION

I have the very same Gäëòéva bow, the same arrows, the same chariot drawn by the same horses, and I use them as the same Arjuna to whom all the kings offered their due respects. But in the absence of Lord Kṛṣṇa, all of them, at a moment's notice, have become null and void. It is exactly like offering clarified butter on ashes, accumulating money with a magic wand or sowing seeds on barren land.

PURPORT

As we have discussed more than once, one should not be puffed up by borrowed plumes. All energies and powers are derived from the supreme source, Lord Kṛṣṇa, and they act as long as He desires and cease to function as soon as He withdraws. All electrical energies are received from the powerhouse, and as soon as the powerhouse stops supplying energy, the bulbs are of no use. In a moment's time such energies can be generated or withdrawn by the supreme will of the Lord. Material civilization without the blessing of the Lord is child's play only. As long as the parents allow the child to play, it is all right. As soon as the parents withdraw, the child has to stop. Human civilization and all activities thereof must be dovetailed with the supreme blessing of the Lord, and without this blessing all advancement of human civilization is like decoration on a dead body. It is said here that a dead civilization and its activities are something like clarified butter on ashes, the accumulation of money by a magic wand and the sowing of seeds in a barren land.

TEXTS 22–23

**raJa&STvYaaNauPa*íaNaa& Sauôda& Na" SauôTPaure)
ivPa[XaaPaivMaU!aNaa& iNaganTaa& Mauiíi>aiMaRQa")) 22))
vaå<aq& Maidra& PaqTva MadaeNMaiQaTaceTaSaaMa()
AJaaNaTaaiMavaNYaaeNYa& cTau"PaÄavXaeizTaa")) 23))**

räjaàs tvayänupaññänää

suhådäà naù suhât-pure

vipra-çäpa-vimüòhänää

nighnatäà muñöibhir mithaù

väruëèà madiräà pétvä

madonmathita-cetasäm

ajānatām ivānyonyaà

catuù-païcävaçeñitäu

SYNONYMS

rājan—O King; *tvayä*—by you; *anupāññānām*—as you inquired; *suhādam*—of friends and relatives; *naù*—our; *suhāt-pure*—in the city of Dvārakā; *vipra*—the *brahmanas*; *çäpa*—by the curse of; *vimüòhānām*—of the befooled; *nighnatām*—of the killed; *muñöibhiù*—with bunches of sticks; *mithaù*—among themselves; *vāruëém*—fermented rice; *madirām*—wine; *pétvā*—having drunk; *mada-unmathita*—being intoxicated; *cetasām*—of that mental situation; *ajānatām*—of the unrecognized; *iva*—like; *anyonyam*—one another; *catuù*—four; *pañca*—five; *avaçeñitäu*—now remaining.

TRANSLATION

O King, since you have asked me about our friends and relatives in the city of Dvārakā, I will inform you that all of them were cursed by the brahmanas, and as a result they all became intoxicated with wine made of putrefied rice and fought among themselves with sticks, not even recognizing one another. Now all but four or five of them are dead and gone.

TEXT 24

**Pa[aYae<aETad(>aGavTa wRìrSYa ivceiíTaMa()
iMaQaae iNaganiNTa >aUTaaNa >aavYaiNTa c YaiNMaQa")) 24))**

prāyeëaitad bhagavata

éçvarasya viceñöitam

mitho nighnanti bhütāni

bhāvayanti ca yan mithaù

SYNONYMS

prāyeëa etat—it is almost by; *bhagavatau*—of the Personality of Godhead; *éçvarasya*—of the Lord; *viceñöitam*—by the will of; *mithau*—one another; *nighnanti*—do kill; *bhütäni*—the living beings; *bhävayanti*—as also protect; *ca*—also; *yat*—of whom; *mithau*—one another.

TRANSLATION

Factually this is all due to the supreme will of the Lord, the Personality of Godhead. Sometimes people kill one another, and at other times they protect one another.

PURPORT

According to the anthropologists, there is nature's law of struggle for existence and survival of the fittest. But they do not know that behind the law of nature is the supreme direction of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. In the *Bhagavad-gita* it is confirmed that the law of nature is executed under the direction of the Lord. Whenever, therefore, there is peace in the world, it must be known that it is due to the good will of the Lord. And whenever there is upheaval in the world, it is also due to the supreme will of the Lord. Not a blade of grass moves without the will of the Lord. Whenever, therefore, there is disobedience of the established rules enacted by the Lord, there is war between men and nations. The surest way to the path of peace, therefore, is dovetailing everything to the established rule of the Lord. The established rule is that whatever we do, whatever we eat, whatever we sacrifice or whatever we give in charity must be done to the full satisfaction of the Lord. No one should do anything, eat anything, sacrifice anything or give anything in charity against the will of the Lord. Discretion is the better part of valor, and one must learn how to discriminate between actions which may be pleasing to the Lord and those which may not be pleasing to the Lord. An action is thus judged by the Lord's pleasure or displeasure. There is no room for personal whims; we must always be guided by the pleasure of the Lord. Such action is called *yogaù karmasu kauçalam*, or actions performed which are linked with the Supreme Lord. That is the art of doing a thing perfectly.

TEXTS 25–26

Jal/aEk-Saa& Jale/ YaÜNMahaNTaae_dNTYa<aqYaSa")
dubRI/aNbil/Naae raJaNMahaNTaae bil/Naae iMaQa")) 25))
Wv& bil/iEYaRdui>aMaRhiÜirTaraNa(iv>au")
YadUNa(Yadui>arNYaaeNYa& >aU>aaraNa(SaÅhar h)) 26))

jalaukasää jale yadvan

mahänto 'danty aëéyasaù

durbalän balino räjan

mahänto balino mithaù

evaà baliñöhair yadubhir

mahadbhir itarän vibhuù

yadün yadubhir anyonyaà

bhü-bhärän saïjahära ha

SYNONYMS

jalaukasäm—of the aquatics; *jale*—in the water; *yadvat*—as it is;
mahäntaù—the larger one; *adanti*—swallows; *aëéyasaù*—smaller ones;
durbalän—the weak; *balinaù*—the stronger; *räjan*—O King; *mahäntaù*—
the strongest; *balinaù*—less strong; *mithaù*—in a duel; *evam*—thus;
baliñöhaiù—by the strongest; *yadubhiù*—by the descendants of Yadu;
mahadbhiù—one who has greater strength; *itarän*—the common ones;
vibhuù—the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *yadün*—all the Yadus;
yadubhiù—by the Yadus; *anyonyam*—among one another; *bhü-bhärän*—
the burden of the world; *saïjahära*—has unloaded; *ha*—in the past.

TRANSLATION

O King, as in the ocean the bigger and stronger aquatics swallow up the smaller and weaker ones, so also the Supreme Personality of Godhead, to lighten the burden of the earth, has engaged the stronger Yadu to kill the weaker, and the bigger Yadu to kill the smaller.

PURPORT

In the material world the struggle for existence and survival of the fittest are laws because in the material world there is disparity between conditioned souls due to everyone's desire to lord it over the material resources. This very mentality of lording it over the material nature is the root cause of conditioned life. And to give facility to such imitation lords, the illusory energy of the Lord has created a disparity between conditioned living beings by creating the stronger and the weaker in every species of life. The mentality of lording it over the material nature and the creation has naturally created a disparity and therefore the law of struggle for existence. In the spiritual world there is no such disparity, nor is there such a struggle for existence. In the spiritual world there is no struggle for existence because everyone there exists eternally. There is no disparity because everyone wants to render service to the Supreme Lord, and no one wants to imitate the Lord in becoming the beneficiary. The Lord, being creator of everything, including the living beings, factually is the proprietor and enjoyer of everything that be, but in the material world, by the spell of *māyā*, or illusion, this eternal relation with the Supreme Personality of Godhead is forgotten, and so the living being is conditioned under the law of struggle for existence and survival of the fittest.

TEXT 27

**deXak-al/aQaRYauç-aiNa ôtaaPaaePaXaMaaiNa c)
hriNTa SMarTaiêta& GaaeivNdai>aihTaaNa Mae)) 27))**

deça-kälärtha-yuktäni

hât-täpopaçamäni ca

haranti smarataç cittaà

govindābhihitāni me

SYNONYMS

deça—space; *kāla*—time; *artha*—importance; *yuktāni*—impregnated with; *hāt*—the heart; *tāpa*—burning; *upaçamāni*—extinguishing; *ca*—and; *haranti*—are attracting; *smarataù*—by remembering; *cittam*—mind; *govinda*—the Supreme Personality of pleasure; *abhihitāni*—narrated by; *me*—unto me.

TRANSLATION

Now I am attracted to those instructions imparted to me by the Personality of Godhead [Govinda] because they are impregnated with instructions for relieving the burning heart in all circumstances of time and space.

PURPORT

Herein Arjuna refers to the instruction of the *Bhagavad-gita*, which was imparted to him by the Lord on the Battlefield of Kurukñetra. The Lord left behind Him the instructions of the *Bhagavad-gita* not for the benefit of Arjuna alone, but also for all time and in all lands. The *Bhagavad-gita*, being spoken by the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is the essence of all Vedic wisdom. It is nicely presented by the Lord Himself for all who have very little time to go through the vast Vedic literatures like the *Upaniñads*, *Puranas* and *Vedānta-sūtras*. It is put within the study of the great historical epic *Mahābhārata*, which was especially prepared for the less intelligent class, namely the women, the laborers and those who are worthless descendants of the *brahmanas*, *kṣatriyas* and higher sections of the *vaīsyas*. The problem which arose in the heart of Arjuna on the Battlefield of Kurukñetra was solved by the teachings of the *Bhagavad-gita*. Again, after the departure of the Lord from the vision of earthly people, when Arjuna was face to face with being vanquished in his acquired power and prominence, he wanted again to remember the great teachings of the *Bhagavad-gita* just to teach all concerned that the *Bhagavad-gita* can be consulted in all critical times, not only for solace from all kinds of mental

agonies, but also for the way out of great entanglements which may embarrass one in some critical hour.

The merciful Lord left behind Him the great teachings of the *Bhagavad-gita* so that one can take the instructions of the Lord even when He is not visible to material eyesight. Material senses cannot have any estimation of the Supreme Lord, but by His inconceivable power the Lord can incarnate Himself to the sense perception of the conditioned souls in a suitable manner through the agency of matter, which is also another form of the Lord's manifested energy. Thus the *Bhagavad-gita*, or any authentic scriptural sound representation of the Lord, is also the incarnation of the Lord. There is no difference between the sound representation of the Lord and the Lord Himself. One can derive the same benefit from the *Bhagavad-gita* as Arjuna did in the personal presence of the Lord.

The faithful human being who is desirous of being liberated from the clutches of material existence can very easily take advantage of the *Bhagavad-gita*, and with this in view, the Lord instructed Arjuna as if Arjuna were in need of it. In the *Bhagavad-gita*, five important factors of knowledge have been delineated pertaining to (1) the Supreme Lord, (2) the living being, (3) nature, (4) time and space and (5) the process of activity. Out of these, the Supreme Lord and the living being are qualitatively one. The difference between the two has been analyzed as the difference between the whole and the part and parcel. Nature is inert matter displaying the interaction of three different modes, and eternal time and unlimited space are considered to be beyond the existence of the material nature. Activities of the living being are different varieties of aptitudes which can entrap or liberate the living being within and without material nature. All these subject matters are concisely discussed in the *Bhagavad-gita*, and later the subject matters are elaborated in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* for further enlightenment. Out of the five subjects, the Supreme Lord, the living entity, nature, and time and space are eternal, but the living entity, nature and time are under the direction of the Supreme Lord, who is absolute and completely independent of any other control. The Supreme Lord is the supreme controller. The material activity of the living being is beginningless, but it can be rectified by transferral into the spiritual quality. Thus it can cease its material qualitative reactions. Both

the Lord and the living entity are cognizant, and both have the sense of identification, of being conscious as a living force. But the living being under the condition of material nature, called *mahat-tattva*, misidentifies himself as being different from the Lord. The whole scheme of Vedic wisdom is targeted to the aim of eradicating such a misconception and thus liberating the living being from the illusion of material identification. When such an illusion is eradicated by knowledge and renunciation, the living beings are responsible actors and enjoyers also. The sense of enjoyment in the Lord is real, but such a sense in the living being is a sort of wishful desire only. This difference in consciousness is the distinction of the two identities, namely the Lord and the living being. Otherwise there is no difference between the Lord and the living being. The living being is therefore eternally one and different simultaneously. The whole instruction of the *Bhagavad-gita* stands on this principle.

In the *Bhagavad-gita* the Lord and the living beings are both described as *sanātana*, or eternal, and the Lord's abode, far beyond the material sky, is also described as *sanātana*. The living being is invited to live in the *sanātana* existence of the Lord, and the process which can help a living being to approach the Lord's abode, where the liberated activity of the soul is exhibited, is called *sanātana-dharma*. One cannot, however, reach the eternal abode of the Lord without being free from the misconception of material identification, and the *Bhagavad-gita* gives us the clue how to achieve this stage of perfection. The process of being liberated from the misconception of material identification is called, in different stages, fruitive activity, empiric philosophy and devotional service, up to transcendental realization. Such transcendental realization is made possible by dovetailing all the above items in relation with the Lord. Prescribed duties of the human being, as directed in the *Vedas*, can gradually purify the sinful mind of the conditioned soul and raise him to the stage of knowledge. The purified stage of acquiring knowledge becomes the basis of devotional service to the Lord. As long as one is engaged in researching the solution of the problems of life, his knowledge is called *jñāna*, or purified knowledge, but on realizing the actual solution of life, one becomes situated in the devotional service of the Lord. The *Bhagavad-gita* begins with the problems of life by discriminating the soul from the elements of matter and proves by all reason and argument that the soul is

indestructible in all circumstances and that the outer covering of matter, the body and the mind, change for another term of material existence which is full of miseries. The *Bhagavad-gita* is therefore meant for terminating all different types of miseries, and Arjuna took shelter of this great knowledge, which had been imparted to him during the Kurukñetra battle.

TEXT 28

SaUTa ovac

**Wv& icNTaYaTaae iJaZ<aae" k*-Z<aPaadSaraeåhMa()
SaaEhadeRNAaiTaGaa!eNa XaaNTaaSaqiÜMal/a MaiTa")) 28))**

süta uväca

evaà cintayato jiñëoü

kãñëa-päda-saroruham

sauhärdenätigäöhena

çäntäséd vimalä matiù

SYNONYMS

sütaù uväca—Süta Gosvami said; *evam*—thus; *cintayataù*—while thinking of the instructions; *jiñëoü*—of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *kãñëa-päda*—the feet of Kṛṣṇa; *saroruham*—resembling lotuses; *sauhärdena*—by deep friendship; *ati-gäöhena*—in great intimacy; *çäntä*—pacified; *äsét*—it so became; *vimalä*—without any tinge of material contamination; *matiù*—mind.

TRANSLATION

Süta Gosvami said: Thus being deeply absorbed in thinking of the instructions of the Lord, which were imparted in the great intimacy of friendship, and in thinking of His lotus feet, Arjuna's mind became

pacified and free from all material contamination.

PURPORT

Since the Lord is absolute, deep meditation upon Him is as good as yogic trance. The Lord is nondifferent from His name, form, quality, pastimes, entourage and specific actions. Arjuna began to think of the Lord's instructions to him on the Battlefield of Kurukñetra. Only those instructions began to eliminate the tinges of material contamination in the mind of Arjuna. The Lord is like the sun; the sun's appearance means immediate dissipation of darkness, or ignorance, and the Lord's appearance within the mind of the devotee can at once drive away the miserable material effects. Lord Caitanya has therefore recommended constant chanting of the name of the Lord for protection from all contamination of the material world. The feeling of separation from the Lord is undoubtedly painful to the devotee, but because it is in connection with the Lord, it has a specific transcendental effect which pacifies the heart. Feelings of separation are also sources of transcendental bliss, and they are never comparable to contaminated material feelings of separation.

TEXT 29

**vaSaudevax(ga[yNauDYaaNaPairb*&ihTar&hSaa)
>aç-ya iNaMaRiQaTaaXaezk-zaYaiDaz<aae_JauRNa")) 29))**

väsudevä'ighry-anudhyäna-

paribåhita-raàhasä

bhaktyä nirmathitāçeña-

kañäya-dhiñäëo 'rjunaù

SYNONYMS

väsudeva-a'ighri—the lotus feet of the Lord; *anudhyäna*—by constant remembrance; *paribåhita*—expanded; *raàhasä*—with great velocity;

bhaktyä—in devotion; *nirmathita*—subsided; *açeña*—unlimited; *kañäya*—dint; *dhiñaëaù*—conception; *arjunaù*—Arjuna.

TRANSLATION

Arjuna's constant remembrance of the lotus feet of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa rapidly increased his devotion, and as a result all the trash in his thoughts subsided.

PURPORT

Material desires in the mind are the trash of material contamination. By such contamination, the living being is faced with so many compatible and incompatible things that discourage the very existence of spiritual identity. Birth after birth the conditioned soul is entrapped with so many pleasing and displeasing elements, which are all false and temporary. They accumulate due to our reactions to material desires, but when we get in touch with the transcendental Lord in His variegated energies by devotional service, the naked forms of all material desires become manifest, and the intelligence of the living being is pacified in its true color. As soon as Arjuna turned his attention towards the instructions of the Lord, as they are inculcated in the *Bhagavad-gita*, his true color of eternal association with the Lord became manifest, and thus he felt freed from all material contaminations.

TEXT 30

**GaqTa& >aGavTaa jaNa& YaTa(TaTa(Sa°aMaMaUDaRiNa)
k-al/k-MaRTaMaaeãÖ& PauNarDYaGaMaTa(Pa[>au")) 30))**

gétaà bhagavatä jïänaà

yat tat saigräma-mürdhani

käla-karma-tamo-ruddhaà

punar adhyagamat prabhuù

SYNONYMS

gétam—instructed; *bhagavatä*—by the Personality of Godhead; *jïanam*—transcendental knowledge; *yat*—which; *tat*—that; *saigräma-mürdhani*—in the midst of battle; *käla-karma*—time and actions; *tamaù-ruddham*—enwrapped by such darkness; *punaù adhyagamat*—revived them again; *prabhuù*—the lord of his senses.

TRANSLATION

Because of the Lord’s pastimes and activities and because of His absence, it appeared that Arjuna forgot the instructions left by the Personality of Godhead. But factually this was not the case, and again he became lord of his senses.

PURPORT

A conditioned soul is enwrapped in his fruitive activities by the force of eternal time. But the Supreme Lord, when He incarnates on the earth, is not influenced by *käla*, or the material conception of past, present and future. The activities of the Lord are eternal, and they are manifestations of His *ätma-mäyä*, or internal potency. All pastimes or activities of the Lord are spiritual in nature, but to the laymen they appear to be on the same level with material activities. It so appeared that Arjuna and the Lord were engaged in the Battle of Kurukñetra as the other party was also engaged, but factually the Lord was executing His mission of incarnation and association with His eternal friend Arjuna. Therefore such apparently material activities of Arjuna did not drive him away from his transcendental position, but on the contrary revived his consciousness of the songs of the Lord, as He sang them personally. This revival of consciousness is assured by the Lord in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.65) as follows:

*man-manä bhava mad-bhakto
mad-yäjä mäà namaskuru
mäm evaiñyasi satyaà te
pratijäne priyo ’si me*

One should think of the Lord always; the mind should not forget Him. One should become a devotee of the Lord and offer obeisances unto Him. One who lives in that fashion becomes undoubtedly endowed with the blessing of the Lord by achieving the shelter of His lotus feet. There is nothing to doubt about this eternal truth. Because Arjuna was His confidential friend, the secret was disclosed to him.

Arjuna had no desire to fight with his relatives, but he fought for the mission of the Lord. He was always engaged in the execution of His mission only, and therefore after the Lord's departure he remained in the same transcendental position, even though it appeared that he forgot all the instructions of the *Bhagavad-gita*. One should, therefore, adjust the activities of life in pace with the mission of the Lord, and by doing this one is sure to return back home, back to Godhead. This is the highest perfection of life.

TEXT 31

ivXaaek-ae b]øSaMPatYaa SaiH^àÜETaSa&XaYa")
I/INaPa[k*-iTaNaeGauR<Yaadil/®TvadSaM>av")) 31))

viçoko brahma-sampattyä

saïchinna-dvaita-saàçayaù

léna-prakâti-nairguëyäd

aliìgatväd asambhavaù

SYNONYMS

viçokaù—free from bereavement; *brahma-sampattyä*—by possession of spiritual assets; *saïchinna*—being completely cut off; *dvaita-saàçayaù*—from the doubts of relativity; *léna*—merged in; *prakâti*—material nature; *nairguëyät*—due to being in transcendence; *aliìgatvät*—because of being devoid of a material body; *asambhavaù*—free from birth and death.

TRANSLATION

Because of his possessing spiritual assets, the doubts of duality were completely cut off. Thus he was freed from the three modes of material nature and placed in transcendence. There was no longer any chance of his becoming entangled in birth and death, for he was freed from material form.

PURPORT

Doubts of duality begin from the misconception of the material body, which is accepted as the self by less intelligent persons. The most foolish part of our ignorance is our identifying this material body with the self. Everything in relation with the body is ignorantly accepted as our own. Doubts due to misconceptions of “myself” and “mine”—in other words, “my body,” “my relatives,” “my property,” “my wife,” “my children,” “my wealth,” “my country,” “my community,” and hundreds and thousands of similar illusory contemplations—cause bewilderment for the conditioned soul. By assimilating the instructions of the *Bhagavad-gita*, one is sure to be released from such bewilderment because real knowledge is knowledge that the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Vāsudeva, Lord Kṛṣṇa, is everything, including one’s self. Everything is a manifestation of His potency as part and parcel. The potency and the potent are nondifferent, so the conception of duality is at once mitigated by attainment of perfect knowledge. As soon as Arjuna took up the instructions of the *Bhagavad-gita*, expert as he was, he could at once eradicate the material conception of Lord Kṛṣṇa, his eternal friend. He could realize that the Lord was still present before him by His instruction, by His form, by His pastimes, by His qualities and everything else related to Him. He could realize that Lord Kṛṣṇa, his friend, was still present before him by His transcendental presence in different nondual energies, and there was no question of attainment of the association of the Lord by another change of body under the influence of time and space. By attainment of absolute knowledge, one can be in association with the Lord constantly, even in this present life, simply by hearing, chanting, thinking of and worshiping the Supreme Lord. One can see Him, one can feel His presence even in this present life simply by understanding the *advaya-jīāna* Lord, or the Absolute Lord, through the

process of devotional service, which begins with hearing about Him. Lord Caitanya says that simply by chanting the holy name of the Lord one can at once wash off the dust on the mirror of pure consciousness, and as soon as the dust is removed, one is at once freed from all material conditions. To become free from material conditions means to liberate the soul. As soon as one is, therefore, situated in absolute knowledge, his material conception of life is removed, or he emerges from a false conception of life. Thus the function of the pure soul is revived in spiritual realization. This practical realization of the living being is made possible due to his becoming free from the reaction of the three modes of material nature, namely goodness, passion and ignorance. By the grace of the Lord, a pure devotee is at once raised to the place of the Absolute, and there is no chance of the devotee's becoming materially entangled again in conditioned life. One is not able to feel the presence of the Lord in all circumstances until one is endowed with the required transcendental vision made possible by devotional service prescribed in the revealed scriptures. Arjuna had attained this stage long before on the Battlefield of Kurukñetra, and when he apparently felt the absence of the Lord, he at once took shelter of the instructions of the *Bhagavad-gita*, and thus again he was placed in his original position. This is the position of *viçoka*, or the stage of being freed from all grief and anxieties.

TEXT 32

iNaXaMYa >aGavNMaaGa| Sa&SQaa& Yaduku-l/SYa c)
Sv"PaQaaYa MaiTa& cŕe- iNa>a*TaaTMaa Yauidaiir")) 32))

niçamyā bhagavan-mārgaà

saàsthää yadu-kulasya ca

svaù-pathäya matià cakre

nibhâtätmä yudhiñöhiraù

SYNONYMS

niṣāmya—deliberating; *bhagavat*—regarding the Lord; *mārgam*—the ways of His appearance and disappearance; *saàsthām*—end; *yadu-kulasya*—of the dynasty of King Yadu; *ca*—also; *svaù*—the abode of the Lord; *pathāya*—on the way of; *matim*—desire; *cakre*—gave attention; *nibhāta-ātmā*—lonely and alone; *yudhiñöhiraù*—King Yudhiñöhira.

TRANSLATION

Upon hearing of Lord Kṛṣṇa's returning to His abode, and upon understanding the end of the Yadu dynasty's earthly manifestation, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira decided to go back home, back to Godhead.

PURPORT

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira also turned his attention to the instructions of the *Bhagavad-gita* after hearing about the Lord's departure from the vision of earthly people. He began to deliberate on the Lord's way of appearance and departure. The mission of the Lord's appearance and disappearance in the mortal universe is completely dependent on His supreme will. He is not forced to appear or disappear by any superior energy, as the living beings appear and disappear, being forced by the laws of nature. Whenever the Lord likes, He can appear Himself from anywhere and everywhere without disturbing His appearance and disappearance in any other place. He is like the sun. The sun appears and disappears on its own accord at any place without disturbing its presence in other places. The sun appears in the morning in India without disappearing from the Western Hemisphere. The sun is present everywhere and anywhere all over the solar system, but it so appears that in a particular place the sun appears in the morning and also disappears at some fixed time in the evening. The time limitation even of the sun is of no concern, and so what to speak of the Supreme Lord who is the creator and controller of the sun. Therefore, in the *Bhagavad-gita* it is stated that anyone who factually understands the transcendental appearance and disappearance of the Lord by His inconceivable energy becomes liberated from the laws of birth and death and is placed in the eternal spiritual sky where the Vaikuntha planets are. There such liberated persons can eternally live without the pangs of birth, death, old age and disease. In the spiritual sky the Lord and those who are eternally engaged in

the transcendental loving service of the Lord are all eternally young because there is no old age and disease and there is no death. Because there is no death there is no birth. It is concluded, therefore, that simply by understanding the Lord's appearance and disappearance in truth, one can attain the perfectional stage of eternal life. Therefore, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira also began to consider going back to Godhead. The Lord appears on the earth or any other mortal planet along with His associates who live with Him eternally, and the members of the Yadu family who were engaged in supplementing the pastimes of the Lord are no other than His eternal associates, and so also Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira and his brothers and mother, etc. Since the appearance and disappearance of the Lord and His eternal associates are transcendental, one should not be bewildered by the external features of appearance and disappearance.

TEXT 33

**Pa*QaaPYaNaué[uTYa DaNaÅYaeidTa&
NaaXa& YadUNaa& >aGavÓiTa& c TaaMa()
Wk-aNTa>aÇ-ya >aGavTYaDaae+aJae
iNaveiXaTaaTMaaeParraMa Sa&Sa*Tae")) 33))**

pāthāpy anuṣṛutya dhanaijyoditaà

nāṣaà yadünää bhagavad-gatià ca tām

ekānta-bhaktyä bhagavaty adhokñaje

niveṣitātmopararāma saàsāteu

SYNONYMS

pāthā—Kunté; *api*—also; *anuṣṛutya*—overhearing; *dhanaijaya*—Arjuna; *uditam*—uttered by; *nāṣam*—end; *yadünām*—of the Yadu dynasty; *bhagavat*—of the Personality of Godhead; *gatim*—disappearance; *ca*—also; *tām*—all those; *eka-anta*—unalloyed; *bhaktyä*—devotion; *bhagavati*—unto the Supreme Lord, Sri Kṛṣṇa; *adhokñaje*—transcendence; *niveṣita-ātmā*—with full attention; *upararāma*—became released from;

saàsāteù—material existence.

TRANSLATION

Kunté, after overhearing Arjuna's telling of the end of the Yadu dynasty and disappearance of Lord Kṛṣṇa, engaged in the devotional service of the transcendental Personality of Godhead with full attention and thus gained release from the course of material existence.

PURPORT

The setting of the sun does not mean the end of the sun. It means that the sun is out of our sight. Similarly, the end of the mission of the Lord on a particular planet or universe only means that He is out of our sight. The end of the Yadu dynasty also does not mean that it is annihilated. It disappears, along with the Lord, out of our sight. As Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira decided to prepare to go back to Godhead, so also Kunté decided, and thus she fully engaged herself in the transcendental devotional service of the Lord which guarantees one a passport for going back to Godhead after quitting this present material body. The beginning of devotional service to the Lord is the beginning of spiritualizing the present body, and thus an unalloyed devotee of the Lord loses all material contact in the present body. The abode of the Lord is not a myth, as is thought by the unbelievers or ignorant people, but one cannot reach there by any material means like a sputnik or space capsule. But one can certainly reach there after leaving this present body, and one must prepare himself to go back to Godhead by practicing devotional service. That guarantees a passport for going back to Godhead, and Kunté adopted it.

TEXT 34

**YaYaahrd(>auvae >aar& Taa& TaNau& ivJahavJa")
k-<\$=k&- k-<\$=ke-Naev ÜYa& caPaqiXaTau" SaMaMa()) 34))**

yayäharad bhuvo bhäraà

täà tanuà vijahäv ajaù

kaëöakaà kaëöakeneva

dvayaà cäpéçituù samam

SYNONYMS

yayä—that by which; *aharat*—took away; *bhuvaù*—of the world; *bhāram*—burden; *tām*—that; *tanum*—body; *vijahau*—relinquished; *ajaù*—the unborn; *kaëöakam*—thorn; *kaëöakena*—by the thorn; *iva*—like that; *dvayam*—both; *ca*—also; *api*—although; *éçituù*—controlling; *samam*—equal.

TRANSLATION

The supreme unborn, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, caused the members of the Yadu dynasty to relinquish their bodies, and thus He relieved the burden of the world. This action was like picking out a thorn with a thorn, though both are the same to the controller.

PURPORT

Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Öhäkura suggests that the *āñis* like Çaunaka and others who were hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from Sūta Gosvami at Naimiñāraëya were not happy to hear about the Yadu's dying in the madness of intoxication. To give them relief from this mental agony, Sūta Gosvami assured them that the Lord caused the members of the Yadu dynasty to relinquish their bodies by which they had to take away the burden of the world. The Lord and His eternal associates appeared on earth to help the administrative demigods in eradicating the burden of the world. He therefore called for some of the confidential demigods to appear in the Yadu family and serve Him in His great mission. After the mission was fulfilled, the demigods, by the will of the Lord, relinquished their corporeal bodies by fighting amongst themselves in the madness of intoxication. The demigods are accustomed to drinking the *soma-rasa* beverage, and therefore the drinking of wine and intoxication are not unknown to them. Sometimes they were put into trouble for indulging in intoxication. Once the sons of Kuvera fell in the wrath of Nārada for being intoxicated, but

afterwards they regained their original forms by the grace of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. We shall find this story in the Tenth Canto. For the Supreme Lord, both the *asuras* and the demigods are equal, but the demigods are obedient to the Lord, whereas the *asuras* are not. Therefore, the example of picking out a thorn by another thorn is quite befitting. One thorn, which causes pinpricks on the leg of the Lord, is certainly disturbing to the Lord, and the other thorn, which takes out the disturbing elements, certainly gives service to the Lord. So although every living being is a part and parcel of the Lord, still one who is a pinprick to the Lord is called an *asura*, and one who is a voluntary servitor of the Lord is called a *devatā*, or demigod. In the material world the *devatās* and *asuras* are always contending, and the *devatās* are always saved from the hands of the *asuras* by the Lord. Both of them are under the control of the Lord. The world is full of two kinds of living beings, and the Lord's mission is always to protect the *devatās* and destroy the *asuras*, whenever there is such a need in the world, and to do good to both of them.

TEXT 35

YaQaa MaTSYaaidæPaai<a Datae Jaùad(YaQaa Na\$=")
>aU>aar" +aiPaTaae YaeNa JahaE TaÀ k-le/vrMa()) 35))

yathā matsyādi-rüpāi

dhatte jahyād yathā naöaù

bhü-bhāraù kñapito yena

jahau tac ca kalevaram

SYNONYMS

yathā—as much as; *matsya-ādi*—incarnation as a fish, etc.; *rüpāi*—forms; *dhatte*—eternally accepts; *jahyāt*—apparently relinquishes; *yathā*—exactly like; *naöaù*—magician; *bhü-bhāraù*—burden of the world; *kñapitaù*—relieved; *yena*—by which; *jahau*—let go; *tat*—that; *ca*—also; *kalevaram*—body.

TRANSLATION

The Supreme Lord relinquished the body which He manifested to diminish the burden of the earth. Just like a magician, He relinquishes one body to accept different ones, like the fish incarnation and others.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord Personality of Godhead is neither impersonal nor formless, but His body is nondifferent from Him, and therefore He is known as the embodiment of eternity, knowledge and bliss. In the *Båhad-vaiñëava Tantra* it is clearly mentioned that anyone who considers the form of Lord Kṛṣṇa to be made of material energy must be ostracized by all means. And if by chance the face of such an infidel is seen, one must clean himself by jumping in the river with his clothing. The Lord is described as *amåta*, or deathless, because He has no material body. Under the circumstances, the Lord's dying or quitting His body is like the jugglery of a magician. The magician shows by his tricks that he is cut to pieces, burnt to ashes or made unconscious by hypnotic influences, but all are false shows only. Factually the magician himself is neither burnt to ashes nor cut to pieces, nor is he dead or unconscious at any stage of his magical demonstration. Similarly, the Lord has His eternal forms of unlimited variety, of which the fish incarnation, as was exhibited within this universe, is also one. Because there are innumerable universes, somewhere or other the fish incarnation must be manifesting His pastimes without cessation. In this verse, the particular word *dhatte* ("eternally accepted," and not the word *dhitvå*, "accepted for the occasion") is used. The idea is that the Lord does not create the fish incarnation; He eternally has such a form, and the appearance and disappearance of such an incarnation serves particular purposes. In the *Bhagavad-gita* (7.24–25) the Lord says, "The impersonalists think that I have no form, that I am formless, but that at present I have accepted a form to serve a purpose, and now I am manifested. But such speculators are factually without sharp intelligence. Though they may be good scholars in the Vedic literatures, they are practically ignorant of My inconceivable energies and My eternal forms of personality. The reason is that I reserve the power of not being exposed to the nondevotees by My mystic curtain. The less intelligent fools are

therefore unaware of My eternal form, which is never to be vanquished and is unborn.” In the *Padma Purana* it is said that those who are envious and always angry at the Lord are unfit to know the actual and eternal form of the Lord. In the *Bhāgavatam* also it is said that the Lord appeared like a thunderbolt to those who were wrestlers. Çiçupāla, at the time of being killed by the Lord, could not see Him as Kṛṣṇa, being dazzled by the glare of the *brahmajyoti*. Therefore, the temporary manifestation of the Lord as a thunderbolt to the wrestlers appointed by Kaśa, or the glaring appearance of the Lord before Çiçupāla, was relinquished by the Lord, but the Lord as a magician is eternally existent and is never vanquished in any circumstance. Such forms are temporarily shown to the *asuras* only, and when such exhibitions are withdrawn, the *asuras* think that the Lord is no more existent, just as the foolish audience thinks the magician to be burnt to ashes or cut to pieces. The conclusion is that the Lord has no material body, and therefore He is never to be killed or changed by His transcendental body.

TEXT 36

**Yada Mauku-Ndae >aGavaiNaMaa& Mahq&
JahaE SvTaNva é[v<aqYaSaTk-Qa")
TadahrevaPa[iTabuÖceTaSaa,
Ma>ad]heTau" k-il/rNvvTaRTa)) 36))**

yadä mukundo bhagavän imäà mahéà

jahau sva-tanvä çravaëéya-sat-kathaù

tadähar eväpratibuddha-cetasäm

abhadra-hetuù kalir anvavartata

SYNONYMS

yadä—when; *mukundaù*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *imäm*—this; *mahém*—earth; *jahau*—left; *sva-tanvä*—with His selfsame body; *çravaëéya-sat-kathaù*—hearing about Him is worthwhile;

tadä—at that time; *ahaù eva*—from the very day; *apraṭi-buddha-cetasām*—of those whose minds are not sufficiently developed; *abhadra-hetuù*—cause of all ill fortune; *kaliù anvavartata*—Kali fully manifested.

TRANSLATION

When the Personality of Godhead, Lord Kṛṣṇa, left this earthly planet in His selfsame form, from that very day Kali, who had already partially appeared, became fully manifest to create inauspicious conditions for those who are endowed with a poor fund of knowledge.

PURPORT

The influence of Kali can be enforced only upon those who are not fully developed in God consciousness. One can neutralize the effects of Kali by keeping oneself fully under the supreme care of the Personality of Godhead. The age of Kali ensued just after the Battle of Kurukñetra, but it could not exert its influence because of the presence of the Lord. The Lord, however, left this earthly planet in His own transcendental body, and as soon as He left, the symptoms of the Kali-yuga, as were envisioned by Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira prior to Arjuna's arrival from Dvārakā, began to manifest, and Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira rightly conjectured on the departure of the Lord from the earth. As we have already explained, the Lord left our sight just as when the sun sets it is out of our sight.

TEXT 37

YauiDaiirSTaTPairSaPaR<a& buDa"
Paure c raí\è c Ga*he TaQaaTMaiNa)
iv>aaVYa I/ae>aaNa*TaiJaøih&SaNaa,
ÛDaMaRc\$&- GaMaNaaYa PaYaRDaaTa()) 37))

yudhiñöhiras tat parisarpaëaà budhaù

pure ca rāñöre ca gāhe tathätmani

vibhävya lobhänåta-jihma-hiàsanädy-

adharmā-cakraṁ gamanāya paryadhāt

SYNONYMS

yudhiñöhiraṁ—Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira; *tat*—that; *parisarpaṇam*—expansion; *budhaṁ*—thoroughly experienced; *pure*—in the capital; *ca*—as also; *rāñōre*—in the state; *ca*—and; *gāhe*—at home; *tathā*—as also; *ātmani*—in person; *vibhāvya*—observing; *lobha*—avarice; *anāta*—untruth; *jihma*—diplomacy; *hiāsana-ādi*—violence, envy; *adharmā*—irreligion; *cakram*—a vicious circle; *gamanāya*—for departure; *paryadhāt*—dressed himself accordingly.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was intelligent enough to understand the influence of the age of Kali, characterized by increasing avarice, falsehood, cheating and violence throughout the capital, state, home and among individuals. So he wisely prepared himself to leave home, and he dressed accordingly.

PURPORT

The present age is influenced by the specific qualities of Kali. Since the days of the Battle of Kurukñetra, about five thousand years ago, the influence of the age of Kali began manifesting, and from authentic scriptures it is learned that the age of Kali is still to run on for 427,000 years. The symptoms of the Kali-yuga, as mentioned above, namely avarice, falsehood, diplomacy, cheating, nepotism, violence and all such things, are already in vogue, and no one can imagine what is going to happen gradually with further increase of the influence of Kali till the day of annihilation. We have already come to know that the influence of the age of Kali is meant for godless so-called civilized man; those who are under the protection of the Lord have nothing to fear from this horrible age. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira was a great devotee of the Lord, and there was no necessity of his being afraid of the age of Kali, but he preferred to retire from active household life and prepare himself to go back home, back to Godhead. The Pāṇḍavas are eternal companions of the Lord, and therefore they are more interested in the company of the Lord than anything else. Besides that, being an ideal

king, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira wanted to retire just to set an example for others. As soon as there is some young fellow to look after the household affairs, one should at once retire from family life to uplift oneself to spiritual realization. One should not rot in the dark well of household life till one is dragged out by the will of Yamarāja. Modern politicians should take lessons from Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira about voluntary retirement from active life and should make room for the younger generation. Also retired old gentlemen should take lessons from him and leave home for spiritual realization before forcefully dragged away to meet death.

TEXT 38

**Svra\$(PaaE}a& ivNaiYaNaMaaTMaNa" SauSaMa& Gau<aE")
TaaeYaNaqVYaa" PaiTa& >aUMaer>YaizÄÓJaaûYae)) 38))**

sva-räö pautraà vinayinam

ätmanaù susamaà guëaiù

toya-névyäù patia bhümer

abhyañiicad gajähvaye

SYNONYMS

sva-räö—the emperor; *pautram*—unto the grandson; *vinayinam*—properly trained; *ätmanaù*—his own self; *su-samam*—equal in all respects; *guëaiù*—by the qualities; *toya-névyäù*—bordered by the seas; *patim*—master; *bhümeù*—of the land; *abhyañiicat*—enthroned; *gajähvaye*—in the capital of Hastināpura.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, in the capital of Hastināpura, he enthroned his grandson, who was trained and equally qualified, as the emperor and master of all land bordered by the seas.

PURPORT

The total land on the earth bordered by the seas was under the subjugation of the King of Hastināpura. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira trained his grandson, Mahārāja Parékñit, who was equally qualified, in state administration in terms of the king's obligation to the citizens. Thus Parékñit was enthroned on the seat of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira prior to his departure back to Godhead. Concerning Mahārāja Parékñit, the specific word used, *vinayinam*, is significant. Why was the King of Hastināpura, at least till the time of Mahārāja Parékñit, accepted as the Emperor of the world? The only reason is that the people of the world were happy because of the good administration of the emperor. The happiness of the citizens was due to the ample production of natural produce such as grains, fruits, milk, herbs, valuable stones, minerals and everything that the people needed. They were even free from all bodily miseries, anxieties of mind, and disturbances caused by natural phenomena and other living beings. Because everyone was happy in all respects, there was no resentment, although there were sometimes battles between the state kings for political reasons and supremacy. Everyone was trained to attain the highest goal of life, and therefore the people were also enlightened enough not to quarrel over trivialities. The influence of the age of Kali gradually infiltrated the good qualities of both the kings and the citizens, and therefore a tense situation developed between the ruler and the ruled, but still even in this age of disparity between the ruler and the ruled, there can be spiritual emolument and God consciousness. That is a special prerogative.

TEXT 39

**MaQauraYaa& TaQaa vJa]& éUrSaeNaPaiTa& TaTa")
Pa[aJaaPaTYaa& iNaæPYaeííMaGanqNaiPabdqir")) 39))**

mathuräyää tathä vajraà

çürasena-patià tataù

präjäpatyää nirüpyeñöim

agnén apibad éçvaraù

SYNONYMS

mathuräyäm—at Mathurä; *tathä*—also; *vajram*—Vajra; *çürasena-patim*—King of the Çürasenas; *tataù*—thereafter; *präjäpatyäm*—Präjäpatya sacrifice; *nirüpya*—having performed; *iñöim*—goal; *agnén*—fire; *apibat*—placed in himself; *éçvaraù*—capable.

TRANSLATION

Then he posted Vajra, the son of Aniruddha [grandson of Lord Kṛṣṇa], at Mathurä as the King of Çürasena. Afterwards Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira performed a Präjäpatya sacrifice and placed in himself the fire for quitting household life.

PURPORT

Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira, after placing Mahäräja Parékñit on the imperial throne of Hastinäpura, and after posting Vajra, the great-grandson of Lord Kṛṣṇa, as the King of Mathurä, accepted the renounced order of life. The system of four orders of life and four castes in terms of quality and work, known as *varëäçrama-dharma*, is the beginning of real human life, and Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira, as the protector of this system of human activities, timely retired from active life as a *sannyäse*, handing over the charge of the administration to a trained prince, Mahäräja Parékñit. The scientific system of *varëäçrama-dharma* divides the human life into four divisions of occupation and four orders of life. The four orders of life as *brahmacäre*, *gähastha*, *vänaprastha* and *sannyäse* are to be followed by all, irrespective of the occupational division. Modern politicians do not wish to retire from active life, even if they are old enough, but Yudhiñöhira Mahäräja, as an ideal king, voluntarily retired from active administrative life to prepare himself for the next life. Everyone's life must be so arranged that the last stage of life, say at least the last fifteen to twenty years prior to death, can be absolutely devoted to the devotional service of the Lord to attain the highest perfection of life. It is really foolishness to engage oneself all the days of one's life in material enjoyment and fruitive activities, because as

long as the mind remains absorbed in fruitive work for material enjoyment, there is no chance of getting out from conditioned life, or material bondage. No one should follow the suicidal policy of neglecting one's supreme task of attaining the highest perfection of life, namely going back home, back to Godhead.

TEXT 40

ivSa*JYa Ta}a TaTa(Sav| dukU-I/vI/Yaaidk-Ma()
iNaMaRMaae iNarh²ar" SaiH^àaXaezbNDaNa")) 40))

visājya tatra tat sarvaà

dukūla-valayādikam

nirmamo nirahaikāraù

saichinnāṇa-bandhanaù

SYNONYMS

visājya—relinquishing; *tatra*—all those; *tat*—that; *sarvam*—everything; *dukūla*—belt; *valaya-ādikam*—and bangles; *nirmamaù*—uninterested; *nirahaikāraù*—unattached; *saichinna*—perfectly cut off; *aṇa-bandhanaù*—unlimited attachment.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira at once relinquished all his garments, belt and ornaments of the royal order and became completely disinterested and unattached to everything.

PURPORT

To become purified of material contamination is the necessary qualification for becoming one of the associates of the Lord. No one can become an associate of the Lord or can go back to Godhead without such purification.

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, therefore, to become spiritually pure, at once gave up his royal opulence, relinquishing his royal dress and garments. The *kañäya*, or saffron loincloth of a *sannyäse*, indicates freedom from all attractive material garments, and thus he changed his dress accordingly. He became disinterested in his kingdom and family and thus became free from all material contamination, or material designation. People are generally attached to various kinds of designations—the designations of family, society, country, occupation, wealth, position and many others. As long as one is attached to such designations, he is considered materially impure. The so-called leaders of men in the modern age are attached by national consciousness, but they do not know that such false consciousness is also another designation of the materially conditioned soul; one has to relinquish such designations before one can become eligible to go back to Godhead. Foolish people adore such men who die in national consciousness, but here is an example of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, a royal king who prepared himself to leave this world without such national consciousness. And yet he is remembered even today because he was a great pious king, almost on the same level with the Personality of Godhead Sri Rāma. And because people of the world were dominated by such pious kings, they were happy in all respects, and it was quite possible for such great emperors to rule the world.

TEXT 41

**vac& Jauhav MaNaiSa TaTPa[a<a wTare c TaMa()
Ma*TYaavPaaNa& SaaeTSaGa| Ta& PaÄTve ùJaaehvqTa()) 41))**

vācaà juhāva manasi

tat prāëa itare ca tam

mātyāv apānaà sotsargaà

taà païcatve hy ajohavét

SYNONYMS

vācam—speeches; *juhāva*—relinquished; *manasi*—into the mind; *tat* *prāṇe*—mind into breathing; *itare ca*—other senses also; *tam*—into that; *mātyau*—into death; *apānam*—breathing; *sa-utsargam*—with all dedication; *tam*—that; *pañcatve*—into the body made of five elements; *hi*—certainly; *ajohavét*—amalgamated it.

TRANSLATION

Then he amalgamated all the sense organs into the mind, then the mind into life, life into breathing, his total existence into the embodiment of the five elements, and his body into death. Then, as pure self, he became free from the material conception of life.

PURPORT

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, like his brother Arjuna, began to concentrate and gradually became freed from all material bondage. First he concentrated all the actions of the senses and amalgamated them into the mind, or in other words he turned his mind toward the transcendental service of the Lord. He prayed that since all material activities are performed by the mind in terms of actions and reactions of the material senses, and since he was going back to Godhead, the mind would wind up its material activities and be turned towards the transcendental service to the Lord. There was no longer a need for material activities. Actually the activities of the mind cannot be stopped, for they are the reflection of the eternal soul, but the quality of the activities can be changed from matter to the transcendental service of the Lord. The material color of the mind is changed when one washes it from contaminations of life-breathing and thereby frees it from the contamination of repeated births and deaths and situates it in pure spiritual life. All is manifested by the temporary embodiment of the material body, which is a production of the mind at the time of death, and if the mind is purified by practice of transcendental loving service to the Lord and is constantly engaged in the service of the lotus feet of the Lord, there is no more chance of the mind's producing another material body after death. It will be freed from absorption in material contamination. The pure soul will be able to return home, back to Godhead.

TEXT 42

i}aTve huTva c PaÄTv& TaÀEk-Tve_JauhaeNMauiNa")
SavRMaaTMaNYaJauhvqd(b]ø<YaaTMaaNaMaVYaYae)) 42))

tritve hutvā ca paīcatvaà

tac caikatve 'juhon muniù

sarvam ātmany ajuhavéd

brahmaëy ātmānam avyaye

SYNONYMS

tritve—into the three qualities; *hutvā*—having offered; *ca*—also; *paīcatvam*—five elements; *tat*—that; *ca*—also; *ekatve*—in one nescience; *ajuhot*—amalgamated; *muniù*—the thoughtful; *sarvam*—the sum total; *ātmani*—in the soul; *ajuhavét*—fixed; *brahmaëi*—unto the spirit; *ātmānam*—the soul; *avyaye*—unto the inexhaustible.

TRANSLATION

Thus annihilating the gross body of five elements into the three qualitative modes of material nature, he merged them in one nescience and then absorbed that nescience in the self, Brahman, which is inexhaustible in all circumstances.

PURPORT

All that is manifested in the material world is the product of the *mahat-tattva-avyakta*, and things that are visible in our material vision are nothing but combinations and permutations of such variegated material products. But the living entity is different from such material products. It is due to the living entity's forgetfulness of his eternal nature as eternal servitor of the Lord, and his false conception of being a so-called lord of the material nature, that he is obliged to enter into the existence of false sense

enjoyment. Thus a concomitant generation of material energies is the principal cause of the mind's being materially affected. Thus the gross body of five elements is produced. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira reversed the action and merged the five elements of the body in the three modes of material nature. The qualitative distinction of the body as being good, bad or mediocre is extinguished, and again the qualitative manifestations become merged in the material energy, which is produced from a false sense of the pure living being. When one is thus inclined to become an associate of the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead, in one of the innumerable planets of the spiritual sky, especially in Goloka Våndävana, one has to think always that he is different from the material energy; he has nothing to do with it, and he has to realize himself as pure spirit, Brahman, qualitatively equal with the Supreme Brahman (Parameçvara). Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, after distributing his kingdom to Parékñit and Vajra, did not think himself Emperor of the world or head of the Kuru dynasty. This sense of freedom from material relations, as well as freedom from the material encagement of the gross and subtle encirclement, makes one free to act as the servitor of the Lord, even though one is in the material world. This stage is called the *jévan-mukta* stage, or the liberated stage, even in the material world. That is the process of ending material existence. One must not only think that he is Brahman, but must act like Brahman. One who only thinks himself Brahman is an impersonalist. And one who acts like Brahman is the pure devotee.

TEXT 43

**cqrvaSaa iNaraharae bÖvax(Mauç-MaUDaRJa")
dXaRYaàaTMaNaae æPa& Ja@aeNMataiPaXaacvTa()
ANave+aMaa<aae iNarGaadé*<vNa(biDarae YaQaa)) 43))**

céra-väsä nirähäro

baddha-väi mukta-mürdhajaù

darçayann ätmano rūpaà

jaòonmatta-piçäcavat

anavekñamäëo niragäd

açåëvan badhiro yathä

SYNONYMS

céra-väsäù—accepted torn clothing; *nirähäraù*—gave up all solid foodstuff; *baddha-väk*—stopped talking; *mukta-mürdhajaù*—untied his hair; *darçayan*—began to show; *ätmanaù*—of himself; *rüpam*—bodily features; *jaòä*—inert; *unmatta*—mad; *piçäca-vat*—just like an urchin; *anavekñamäëaù*—without waiting for; *niragät*—was situated; *açåëvan*—without hearing; *badhiraù*—just like a deaf man; *yathä*—as if.

TRANSLATION

After that, Mahäräja Yudhiñöhira dressed himself in torn clothing, gave up eating all solid foods, voluntarily became dumb and let his hair hang loose. All this combined to make him look like an urchin or madman with no occupation. He did not depend on his brothers for anything. And, just like a deaf man, he heard nothing.

PURPORT

Thus being freed from all external affairs, he had nothing to do with imperial life or family prestige, and for all practical purposes he posed himself exactly like an inert mad urchin and did not speak of material affairs. He had no dependence on his brothers, who had all along been helping him. This stage of complete independence from everything is also called the purified stage of fearlessness.

TEXT 44

**odqcq& Pa[ivveXaaXaa& GaTaPaUva| MahaTMai>a")
ôid b]ø Par& DYaaYaàavTaeRTa YaTaae GaTa")) 44))**

udécéà praviveçäçäà

gata-pūrvā mahātmabhiù

hādi brahma paraà dhyāyan

nāvarteta yato gataù

SYNONYMS

udécém—the northern side; *praviveça-āçām*—those who wanted to enter there; *gata-pūrvām*—the path accepted by his forefathers; *mahā-ātmabhiù*—by the broad-minded; *hādi*—within the heart; *brahma*—the Supreme; *param*—Godhead; *dhyāyan*—constantly thinking of; *naāvarteta*—passed his days; *yataù*—wherever; *gataù*—went.

TRANSLATION

He then started towards the north, treading the path accepted by his forefathers and great men, to devote himself completely to the thought of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. And he lived in that way wherever he went.

PURPORT

It is understood from this verse that Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira followed in the footsteps of his forefathers and the great devotees of the Lord. We have discussed many times before that the system of *varëāçrama-dharma*, as it was strictly followed by the inhabitants of the world, specifically by those who inhabited the Äryāvarta province of the world, emphasizes the importance of leaving all household connections at a certain stage of life. The training and education was so imparted, and thus a respectable person like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira had to leave all family connection for self-realization and going back to Godhead. No king or respectable gentleman would continue family life till the end, because that was considered suicidal and against the interest of the perfection of human life. In order to be free from all family encumbrances and devote oneself cent percent in the devotional service of Lord Kṛṣṇa, this system is always recommended for everyone because it is the path of authority. The Lord instructs in the

Bhagavad-gita (18.62) that one must become a devotee of the Lord at least at the last stage of one's life. A sincere soul of the Lord like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira must abide by this instruction of the Lord for his own interest.

The specific words *brahma param* indicate Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. This is corroborated in the **Bhagavad-gita** (10.13) by Arjuna with reference to great authorities like Asita, Devala, Nārada and Vyāsa. Thus Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, while leaving home for the north, constantly remembered Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa within himself, following in the footsteps of his forefathers as well as the great devotees of all times.

TEXT 45

SaveR TaMaNauINaJaRGMau>a]aRTar" k*-TaiNaêYaa")
k-il/NaaDaMaRiMa}ae<a d*îa SPa*îa" Pa[Jaa >auiv)) 45))

sarve tam anunirjagmur

bhrätaraù kâta-niçcayäù

kalinädharma-mitreëa

dãñövä spãñöäù prajā bhuvi

SYNONYMS

sarve—all his younger brothers; *tam*—him; *anunirjagmuù*—left home by following the elder; *bhrätaraù*—brothers; *kâta-niçcayäù*—decidedly; *kalinä*—by the age of Kali; *adharma*—principle of irreligion; *mitreëa*—by the friend; *dãñövä*—observing; *spãñöäù*—having overtaken; *prajā*—all citizens; *bhuvi*—on the earth.

TRANSLATION

The younger brothers of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira observed that the age of Kali had already arrived throughout the world and that the citizens of the kingdom were already affected by irreligious practice. Therefore they

decided to follow in the footsteps of their elder brother.

PURPORT

The younger brothers of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira were already obedient followers of the great Emperor, and they had sufficiently been trained to know the ultimate goal of life. They therefore decidedly followed their eldest brother in rendering devotional service to Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. According to the principles of *sanātana-dharma*, one must retire from family life after half the duration of life is finished and must engage himself in self-realization. But the question of engaging oneself is not always decided. Sometimes retired men are bewildered about how to engage themselves for the last days of life. Here is a decision by authorities like the Pāṇḍavas. All of them engaged themselves in favorably culturing the devotional service of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. According to Svāmé Sridhara, *dharma*, *artha*, *kāma* and *mokṣa*, or fruitive activities, philosophical speculations and salvation, as conceived by several persons, are not the ultimate goal of life. They are more or less practiced by persons who have no information of the ultimate goal of life. The ultimate goal of life is already indicated by the Lord Himself in the ***Bhagavad-gītā*** (18.64), and the Pāṇḍavas were intelligent enough to follow it without hesitation.

TEXT 46

**Tae SaaDauk*-TaSavaRQaaR jaTvaTYaiNTak-MaaTMaNa")
MaNaSaa DaarYaaMaaSauvCEku-<#<cr<aaMbuJaMa()) 46))**

te sādhu-kāta-sarvārthā

jīātvātyantikam ātmanaù

manasā dhārayām āsur

vaikuṇṭha-caraṇāmbujam

SYNONYMS

te—all of them; *sādhukāta*—having performed everything worthy of a saint; *sarva-arthāu*—that which includes everything worthy; *jīātvā*—knowing it well; *ātyantikam*—the ultimate; *ātmanaù*—of the living being; *manasā*—within the mind; *dhārayām āsuù*—sustained; *vaikuëöha*—the Lord of the spiritual sky; *caraëa-ambujam*—the lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

They all had performed all the principles of religion and as a result rightly decided that the lotus feet of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa are the supreme goal of all. Therefore they meditated upon His feet without interruption.

PURPORT

In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (7.28) the Lord says that only those who have done pious deeds in previous lives and have become freed from the results of all impious acts can concentrate upon the lotus feet of the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. The Pāëðavas, not only in this life but also in their previous lives, had always performed the supreme pious work, and thus they are ever free from all the reactions of impious work. It is quite reasonable, therefore, that they concentrated their minds upon the lotus feet of the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. According to Sri Visvanatha Cakravarti, *dharma*, *artha*, *kāma* and *mokñā* principles are accepted by persons who are not free from the results of impious action. Such persons affected with the contaminations of the above four principles cannot at once accept the lotus feet of the Lord in the spiritual sky. The Vaikuntha world is situated far beyond the material sky. The material sky is under the management of Durgā Devé, or the material energy of the Lord, but the Vaikuntha world is managed by the personal energy of the Lord.

TEXTS 47–48

**TaÖyaNaaeid]ç-Yaa >aç-ya ivéuÖiDaz<aa" Pare)
TaiSMaNa(NaaraYa<aPade Wk-aNTaMaTaYaae GaiTaMa()) 47))
AvaPauduRrvaPaa& Tae ASaiÜivRzYaaTMai>a")
ivDaUTak-LMaza SQaaNa& ivrJaeNaaTMaNaEv ih)) 48))**

tad-dhyānodriktayā bhaktyā

viçuddha-dhiñāëù pare

tasmin nārāyaëa-pade

ekānta-matayo gatim

avāpur duravāpā te

asadbhir viñayātmabhiù

vidhūta-kalmañā sthānā

virajenātmanaiva hi

SYNONYMS

tat—that; *dhyāna*—positive meditation; *utriktayā*—being freed from; *bhaktyā*—by a devotional attitude; *viçuddha*—purified; *dhiñāëù*—by intelligence; *pare*—unto the Transcendence; *tasmin*—in that; *nārāyaëa*—the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa; *pade*—unto the lotus feet; *ekānta-matayaù*—of those who are fixed in the Supreme, who is one; *gatim*—destination; *avāpuù*—attained; *duravāpām*—very difficult to obtain; *te*—by them; *asadbhiù*—by the materialists; *viñaya-ātmabhiù*—absorbed in material needs; *vidhūta*—washed off; *kalmañäù*—material contaminations; *sthānam*—abode; *virajena*—without material passion; *ātmanā eva*—by the selfsame body; *hi*—certainly.

TRANSLATION

Thus by pure consciousness due to constant devotional remembrance, they attained the spiritual sky, which is ruled over by the Supreme Nārāyaṇa, Lord Kṛṣṇa. This is attained only by those who meditate upon the one Supreme Lord without deviation. This abode of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, known as Goloka Vāndāvana, cannot be attained by persons who are absorbed in the material conception of life. But the Pāëòavas, being

completely washed of all material contamination, attained that abode in their very same bodies.

PURPORT

According to Srila Jiva Gosvami, a person freed from the three modes of material qualities, namely goodness, passion and ignorance, and situated in transcendence can reach the highest perfection of life without change of body. Srila Sanātana Gosvami in his *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* says that a person, whatever he may be, can attain the perfection of a twice-born *brahmana* by undergoing the spiritual disciplinary actions under the guidance of a bona fide spiritual master, exactly as a chemist can turn gun metal into gold by chemical manipulation. It is therefore the actual guidance that matters in the process of becoming a *brahmana*, even without change of body, or in going back to Godhead without change of body. Srila Jiva Gosvami remarks that the word *hi* used in this connection positively affirms this truth, and there is no doubt about this factual position. The ***Bhagavad-gita*** (14.26) also affirms this statement of Srila Jiva Gosvami when the Lord says that anyone who executes devotional service systematically without deviation can attain the perfection of Brahman by surpassing the contamination of the three modes of material nature, and when the Brahman perfection is still more advanced by the selfsame execution of devotional service, there is no doubt at all that one can attain the supreme spiritual planet, Goloka Våndāvana, without change of body, as we have already discussed in connection with the Lord's returning to His abode without a change of body.

TEXT 49

ivdurae_iPa PairTYaJYa Pa[>aaSae dehMaaTMaNa")
k*-Z<aaveXaeNa TaiÀta" iPaTa*i>a" Sv+aYa& YaYaaE)) 49))

viduro 'pi parityajya

prabhāse deham ātmanaù

kāññäveçena tac-cittaù

pitābhiù sva-kñayaà yayau

SYNONYMS

viduraù—Vidura (the uncle of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira); *api*—also; *parityajya*—after quitting the body; *prabhāse*—in the place of pilgrimage at Prabhāsa; *deham ātmanaù*—his body; *kāññēa*—the Personality of Godhead; *āveçena*—being absorbed in that thought; *tat*—his; *cittaù*—thoughts and actions; *pitābhiù*—along with the residents of Pitāloka; *sva-kñayam*—his own abode; *yayau*—departed.

TRANSLATION

Vidura, while on pilgrimage, left his body at Prabhāsa. Because he was absorbed in thought of Lord Kṛṣṇa, he was received by the denizens of Pitāloka planet, where he returned to his original post.

PURPORT

The difference between the Pāëòavas and Vidura is that the Pāëòavas are eternal associates of the Lord, the Personality of Godhead, whereas Vidura is one of the administrative demigods in charge of the Pitāloka planet and is known as Yamarāja. Men are afraid of Yamarāja because it is he only who awards punishment to the miscreants of the material world, but those who are devotees of the Lord have nothing to fear from him. To the devotees he is a cordial friend, but to the nondevotees he is fear personified. As we have already discussed, it is understood that Yamarāja was cursed by Maëòüka Muni to be degraded as a *çüdra*, and therefore Vidura was an incarnation of Yamarāja. As an eternal servitor of the Lord, he displayed his devotional activities very ardently and lived a life of a pious man, so much so that a materialistic man like Dhātārāññōra also got salvation by his instruction. So by his pious activities in the devotional service of the Lord he was able to always remember the lotus feet of the Lord, and thus he became washed of all contamination of a *çüdra*-born life. At the end he was again received by the denizens of Pitāloka and posted in his original position. The demigods are also associates of the Lord without personal touch, whereas the direct associates of the Lord are in constant personal

touch with Him. The Lord and His personal associates incarnate in many universes without cessation. The Lord remembers them all, whereas the associates forget due to their being very minute parts and parcels of the Lord; they are apt to forget such incidents due to being infinitesimal. This is corroborated in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (4.5).

TEXT 50

**d]aEPadq c TadaJaYa PaTaqNaaMaNaPae+aTaaMa()
vaSaudeve >aGaviTa ùek-aNTaMaiTaraPa TaMa()) 50))**

draupadé ca tadäjjäya

paténäm anapekñatäm

väsudeve bhagavati

hy ekänta-matir äpa tam

SYNONYMS

draupadé—Draupadé (the wife of the Pääòavas); *ca*—and; *tadä*—at that time; *äjjäya*—knowing Lord Kṛṣṇa fully well; *paténäm*—of the husbands; *anapekñatäm*—who did not care for her; *väsudeve*—unto Lord Väsudeva (Kṛṣṇa); *bhagavati*—the personality of Godhead; *hi*—exactly; *eka-anta*—absolutely; *matiù*—concentration; *äpa*—got; *tam*—Him (the Lord).

TRANSLATION

Draupadé also saw that her husbands, without caring for her, were leaving home. She knew well about Lord Väsudeva, Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead. Both she and Subhadrä became absorbed in thoughts of Kṛṣṇa and attained the same results as their husbands.

PURPORT

When flying an airplane, one cannot take care of other planes. Everyone

has to take care of his own plane, and if there is any danger, no other plane can help another in that condition. Similarly, at the end of life, when one has to go back home, back to Godhead, everyone has to take care of himself without help rendered by another. The help is, however, offered on the ground before flying in space. Similarly, the spiritual master, the father, the mother, the relatives, the husband and others can all render help during one's lifetime, but while crossing the sea one has to take care of himself and utilize the instructions formerly received. Draupadé had five husbands, and no one asked Draupadé to come; Draupadé had to take care of herself without waiting for her great husbands. And because she was already trained, she at once took to concentration upon the lotus feet of Lord Vāsudeva, Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead. The wives also got the same result as their husbands, in the same manner; that is to say, without changing their bodies they reached the destination of Godhead. Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Öhäkura suggests that both Draupadé and Subhadrä, although her name is not mentioned herein, got the same result. None of them had to quit the body.

TEXT 51

Ya" é[ÖYaETad(>aGaviTPa[Yaa<aa&
Paa<@ae" SauTaaNaaiMaiTa SaMPa[Yaa<aMa()
é*<aaeTYal&/ SvSTYaYaNa& Paiv}a&
I/Bßa hraE >aiç-MauPaEiTa iSaiÖMa()) 51))

yaù çraddhayaitad bhagavat-priyäää

pääëoò sutänäm iti samprayääam

çääëoty alaà svastyayanaà pavitraà

labdhvä harau bhaktim upaiti siddhim

SYNONYMS

yaù—anyone who; *çraddhayä*—with devotion; *etat*—this; *bhagavat-priyäääm*—of those who are very dear to the Personality of Godhead;

päëòò—of Pääòu; *sutänäm*—of the sons; *iti*—thus; *samprayäëam*—departure for the ultimate goal; *çäëoti*—hears; *alam*—only; *svastyayanam*—good fortune; *pavitram*—perfectly pure; *labdhvä*—by obtaining; *harau*—unto the Supreme Lord; *bhaktim*—devotional service; *upaiti*—gains; *siddhim*—perfection.

TRANSLATION

The subject of the departure of the sons of Pääòu for the ultimate goal of life, back to Godhead, is fully auspicious and is perfectly pure. Therefore anyone who hears this narration with devotional faith certainly gains the devotional service of the Lord, the highest perfection of life.

PURPORT

Srimad-Bhagavatam is a narration about the Personality of Godhead and the devotees of the Lord like the Pääòavas. The narration of the Personality of Godhead and His devotees is absolute in itself, and thus to hear it with a devotional attitude is to associate with the Lord and constant companions of the Lord. By the process of hearing *Srimad-Bhagavatam* one can attain the highest perfection of life, namely going back home, back to Godhead, without failure.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Fifteenth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "The Pääòavas Retire Timely."

Chapter Sixteen

How Parékñit Received the Age of Kali

TEXT 1

SaUTa ovac

TaTa" Parqi+ad(iÜJavYaRiXa+aYaa
Mahq& Maha>aaGavTa" XaXaaSa h)
YaQaa ih SaUTYaaMai>aJaaTak-aeivda"

SaMaaidXaNa(ivPa[Mahd(Gau<aSTaQaa)) 1))

süta uväca

tataù parékñid dvija-varya-çikñayä

mahéà mahä-bhägavataù çaçäsa ha

yathä hi sütyäm abhijäta-kovidäù

samädiçan vipra mahad-guëas tathä

SYNONYMS

sütaù uväca—Süta Gosvami said; *tataù*—thereafter; *parékñit*—Mahäräja Parékñit; *dvija-varya*—the great twice-born *brahmanas*; *çikñayä*—by their instructions; *mahém*—the earth; *mahä-bhägavataù*—the great devotee; *çaçäsa*—ruled; *ha*—in the past; *yathä*—as they told it; *hi*—certainly; *sütyäm*—at the time of his birth; *abhijäta-kovidäù*—expert astrologers at the time of birth; *samädiçan*—gave their opinions; *vipra*—O *brahmanas*; *mahat-guëaù*—great qualities; *tathä*—true to that.

TRANSLATION

Süta Gosvami said: O learned brahmanas, Mahäräja Parékñit then began to rule over the world as a great devotee of the Lord under the instructions of the best of the twice-born brahmanas. He ruled by those great qualities which were foretold by expert astrologers at the time of his birth.

PURPORT

At the time of Mahäräja Parékñit's birth, the expert astrologer-*brahmanas* foretold some of his qualities. Mahäräja Parékñit developed all those qualities, being a great devotee of the Lord. The real qualification is to become a devotee of the Lord, and gradually all the good qualities worthy of possession develop. Mahäräja Parékñit was a *mahä-bhägavata*, or a

first-class devotee, who was not only well versed in the science of devotion but also able to convert others to become devotees by his transcendental instructions. Mahārāja Parékñit was, therefore, a devotee of the first order, and thus he used to consult great sages and learned *brahmanas*, who could advise him by the *sastras* how to execute the state administration. Such great kings were more responsible than modern elected executive heads because they obliged the great authorities by following their instructions left in Vedic literatures. There was no need for impractical fools to enact daily a new legislative bill and to conveniently alter it again and again to serve some purpose. The rules and regulations were already set forth by great sages like Manu, Yājñavalkya, Parāçara and other liberated sages, and the enactments were all suitable for all ages in all places. Therefore the rules and regulations were standard and without flaw or defect. Kings like Mahārāja Parékñit had their council of advisers, and all the members of that council were either great sages or *brahmanas* of the first order. They did not accept any salary, nor had they any necessity for such salaries. *The state would get the best advice without expenditure.* They were themselves *sama-darçé*, equal to everyone, both man and animal. They would not advise the king to give protection to man and instruct him to kill the poor animals. Such council members were not fools or representatives to compose a fool's paradise. They were all self-realized souls, and they knew perfectly well how all living beings in the state would be happy, both in this life and in the next. They were not concerned with the hedonistic philosophy of eat, drink, be merry and enjoy. They were philosophers in the real sense, and they knew well what is the mission of human life. Under all these obligations, the advisory council of the king would give correct directions, and the king or executive head, being himself a qualified devotee of the Lord, would scrutinizingly follow them for the welfare of the state. The state in the days of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira or Mahārāja Parékñit was a welfare state in the real sense of the term because no one was unhappy in that state, be he man or animal. Mahārāja Parékñit was an ideal king for a welfare state of the world.

TEXT 2

**Sa otarSYa TaNaYaaMauPaYaeMa wravTaqMa()
JaNaMaeJaYaadq&êTaurSTaSYaaMauTPaadYaTa(SauTaaNa()) 2))**

sa uttarasya tanayäm

upayema irävatém

janamejayädéàç caturas

tasyäm utpädayat sutän

SYNONYMS

saù—he; *uttarasya*—of King Uttara; *tanayäm*—daughter; *upayeme*—married; *irävatém*—Irävaté; *janamejaya-ädén*—headed by Mahäräja Janamejaya; *caturaù*—four; *tasyäm*—in her; *utpädayat*—begot; *sutän*—sons.

TRANSLATION

King Parékñit married the daughter of King Uttara and begot four sons, headed by Mahäräja Janamejaya.

PURPORT

Mahäräja Uttara was the son of Viräöa and maternal uncle of Mahäräja Parékñit. Irävaté, being the daughter of Mahäräja Uttara, was the cousin-sister of Mahäräja Parékñit, but cousin-brothers and -sisters were allowed to get married if they did not belong to the same *gotra*, or family. In the Vedic system of marriage, the importance of the *gotra*, or family, was stressed. Arjuna also married Subhadrä, although she was his maternal cousin-sister.

Janamejaya: One of the *räjarñi* kings and the famous son of Mahäräja Parékñit. His mother's name was Irävaté, or according to some, Mädgravaté. Mahäräja Janamejaya begot two sons of the names Jätänéka and Çaikukarëa. He celebrated several sacrifices in the Kurukñetra pilgrimage site, and he had three younger brothers named Çrutasena, Ugrasena and Bhémasena II. He invaded Takñälä (Ajanta), and he decided to avenge the unlawful curse upon his great father, Mahäräja Parékñit. He performed a

great sacrifice called Sarpa-yajña, to kill the race of serpents, including the *takṇaka*, which had bitten his father to death. On request from many influential demigods and sages, he had to change his decision to kill the race of snakes, but despite stopping the sacrifice, he satisfied everyone concerned in the sacrifice by rewarding them properly. In the ceremony, Mahāmuni Vyāsadeva also was present, and he personally narrated the history of the Battle of Kurukṇetra before the King. Later on by the order of Vyāsadeva, his disciple Vaiṣampāyana narrated before the King the subject matter of *Mahābhārata*. He was much affected by his great father's untimely death and was very anxious to see him again, and he expressed his desire before the great sage Vyāsadeva. Vyāsadeva also fulfilled his desire. His father was present before him, and he worshiped both his father and Vyāsadeva with great respect and pomp. Being fully satisfied, he most munificently gave charities to the *brahmanas* present at the sacrifice.

TEXT 3

AaJaharaiMaeDaa&ñqNa(Ga®aYaa& >aUirdi+a<aaNa()
XaarÜTa& Gauå& k*-Tva deva Ya}aai+aGaaecra")) 3))

ājahārāçva-medhāś trén

gaigāyāā bhūri-dakṇiēān

çāradvatāā guruā kâtvā

devā yatrākṇi-gocarāù

SYNONYMS

ājahāra—performed; *açva-medhān*—horse sacrifices; *trén*—three; *gaigāyām*—the bank of the Ganges; *bhūri*—sufficiently; *dakṇiēān*—rewards; *çāradvatam*—unto Kāpācārya; *gurum*—spiritual master; *kâtvā*—having selected; *devāù*—the demigods; *yatra*—wherein; *akṇi*—eyes; *gocarāù*—within the purview.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Parékṇit, after having selected Kāpācārya for guidance as his spiritual master, performed three horse sacrifices on the banks of the Ganges. These were executed with sufficient rewards for the attendants. And at these sacrifices, even the common man could see demigods.

PURPORT

It appears from this verse that interplanetary travel by the denizens of higher planets is easy. In many statements in *Bhāgavatam*, we have observed that the demigods from heaven used to visit this earth to attend sacrifices performed by influential kings and emperors. Herein also we find that during the time of the horse sacrifice ceremony of Mahārāja Parékṇit, the demigods from other planets were visible even to the common man, due to the sacrificial ceremony. The demigods are not generally visible to common men, as the Lord is not visible. But as the Lord, by His causeless mercy, descends to be visible to the common man, similarly the demigods also become visible to the common man by their own grace. Although celestial beings are not visible to the naked eyes of the inhabitants of this earth, it was due to the influence of Mahārāja Parékṇit that the demigods also agreed to be visible. The kings used to spend lavishly during such sacrifices, as a cloud distributes rains. A cloud is nothing but another form of water, or, in other words, the waters of the earth transform into clouds. Similarly, the charity made by the kings in such sacrifices are but another form of the taxes collected from the citizens. But, as the rains fall down very lavishly and appear to be more than necessary, the charity made by such kings also seems to be more than what the citizen needs. Satisfied citizens will never organize agitation against the king, and thus there was no need in changing the monarchical state.

Even for a king like Mahārāja Parékṇit there was need of a spiritual master for guidance. Without such guidance one cannot make progress in spiritual life. The spiritual master must be bona fide, and one who wants to have self-realization must approach and take shelter of a bona fide spiritual master to achieve real success.

TEXT 4

iNaJaGa]ahaEJaSaa vqr" k-il&/ idiGvJaYae KvicTa()
Na*Pail/®Dar& éUd]& ganNTa& GaaeiMaQauNa& Pada)) 4))

nijagrāhaujasā véraù

kalià digvijaye kvacit

nāpa-liiga-dharaà çüdraà

ghnantaà go-mithunaà padä

SYNONYMS

nijagrāha—sufficiently punished; *ojasā*—by prowess; *véraù*—valiant hero; *kalim*—unto Kali, the master of the age; *digvijaye*—on his way to conquer the world; *kvacit*—once upon a time; *nāpa-liiga-dharam*—one who passes in the dress of a king; *çüdrām*—the lower class; *ghnantam*—hurting; *go-mithunam*—a cow and bull; *padä*—on the leg.

TRANSLATION

Once, when Mahārāja Parékñit was on his way to conquer the world, he saw the master of Kali-yuga, who was lower than a çüdra, disguised as a king and hurting the legs of a cow and bull. The King at once caught hold of him to deal sufficient punishment.

PURPORT

The purpose of a king's going out to conquer the world is not for self-aggrandizement. Mahārāja Parékñit went out to conquer the world after his ascendance to the throne, but this was not for the purpose of aggression on other states. He was the Emperor of the world, and all small states were already under his regime. His purpose in going out was to see how things were going on in terms of the godly state. The king, being the representative of the Lord, has to execute the will of the Lord duly. There is no question of self-aggrandizement. Thus as soon as Mahārāja Parékñit saw that a lower-class man in the dress of a king was hurting the legs of a cow

and a bull, at once he arrested and punished him. The king cannot tolerate insults to the most important animal, the cow, nor can he tolerate disrespect for the most important man, the *brahmana*. Human civilization means to advance the cause of brahminical culture, and to maintain it, cow protection is essential. There is a miracle in milk, for it contains all the necessary vitamins to sustain human physiological conditions for higher achievements. Brahminical culture can advance only when man is educated to develop the quality of goodness, and for this there is a prime necessity of food prepared with milk, fruits and grains. Mahārāja Parékñit was astonished to see that a black *çüdra*, dressed like a ruler, was mistreating a cow, the most important animal in human society.

The age of Kali means mismanagement and quarrel. And the root cause of all mismanagement and quarrel is that worthless men with the modes of lower-class men, who have no higher ambition in life, come to the helm of the state management. Such men at the post of a king are sure to first hurt the cow and the brahminical culture, thereby pushing all society towards hell. Mahārāja Parékñit, trained as he was, got the scent of this root cause of all quarrel in the world. Thus he wanted to stop it in the very beginning.

TEXT 5

XaaENak- ovac

**k-SYa heTaaeiNaRJaGa]ah k-il&/ idiGvJaYae Na*Pa")
Na*devicöDa*k(- éUd]k-ae_SaaE Gaa& Ya" PadahNaTa()
TaTk-QYaTaa& Maha>aaGa Yaid k*-Z<ak-Qaaé[YaMa()) 5))**

çaunaka uvāca

kasya hetor nijagrāha

kaliā digvijaye nāpau

nādeva-cihna-dhāk çüdra-

ko 'sau gāà yaù padāhanat

tat kathyatää mahä-bhäga

yadi kãñëa-kathäçrayam

SYNONYMS

çaunakaù uväca—Çaunaka Rsi said; *kasya*—for what; *hetoù*—reason; *nijagräha*—sufficiently punished; *kalim*—the master of the age of Kali; *digvijaye*—during the time of his world tour; *näpaù*—the King; *nä-deva*—royal person; *cihna-dhåk*—decorated like; *çüdrakaù*—lowest of the *sudras*; *asau*—he; *gäm*—cow; *yaù*—one who; *padä ahanat*—struck on the leg; *tat*—all that; *kathyatäm*—please describe; *mahä-bhäga*—O greatly fortunate one; *yadi*—if, however; *kãñëa*—about Kṛṣṇa; *kathä-äçrayam*—related with His topics.

TRANSLATION

Çaunaka Rsi inquired: Why did Mahäräja Parékñit simply punish him, since he was the lowest of the sudras, having dressed as a king and having struck a cow on the leg? Please describe all these incidents if they relate to the topics of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

Çaunaka and the *åñis* were astonished to hear that the pious Mahäräja Parékñit simply punished the culprit and did not kill him. This suggests that a pious king like Mahäräja Parékñit should have at once killed an offender who wanted to cheat the public by dressing like a king and at the same time daring to insult the purest of the animals, a cow. The *åñis* in those days, however, could not even imagine that in the advanced days of the age of Kali the lowest of the *sudras* will be elected as administrators and will open organized slaughterhouses for killing cows. Anyway, although hearing about a *çüdraka* who was a cheat and insulter of a cow was not very interesting to the great *åñis*, they nevertheless wanted to hear about it to see if the event had any connection with Lord Kṛṣṇa. They were simply interested in the topics of Lord Kṛṣṇa, for anything that is dovetailed with the narration of Kṛṣṇa is worth hearing. There are many topics in the

Bhāgavatam about sociology, politics, economics, cultural affairs, etc., but all of them are in relation with Kṛṣṇa, and therefore all of them are worth hearing. Kṛṣṇa is the purifying ingredient in all matters, regardless of what they are. In the mundane world, everything is impure due to its being a product of the three mundane qualities. The purifying agent, however, is Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 6

AQavaSYa PadaM>aaeJaMak-rNdil/ha& SaTaaMa()
ik-MaNYaErSadai/aPaEraYauzae YadSaÜyYa")) 6))

athaväsya padāmbhoja-

makaranda-lihāà satām

kim anyair asad-älāpair

äyüñö yad asad-vyayaù

SYNONYMS

athavä—otherwise; *asya*—of His (Lord Kṛṣṇa's); *pada-ambhoja*—lotus feet; *makaranda-lihäm*—of those who lick the honey from such a lotus flower; *satām*—of those who are to exist eternally; *kim anyaiù*—what is the use of anything else; *asad*—illusory; *älāpaiù*—topics; *äyüñau*—of the duration of life; *yad*—that which is; *asad-vyayaù*—unnecessary waste of life.

TRANSLATION

The devotees of the Lord are accustomed to licking up the honey available from the lotus feet of the Lord. What is the use of topics which simply waste one's valuable life?

PURPORT

Lord Kṛṣṇa and His devotees are both on the transcendental plane;

therefore the topics of Lord Kṛṣṇa and of His pure devotees are equally good. The Battle of Kurukṣetra is full of politics and diplomacy, but because the topics are related with Lord Kṛṣṇa, the *Bhagavad-gita* is therefore adored all over the world. There is no need to eradicate politics, economics, sociology, etc., which are mundane to the mundaners. To a pure devotee, who is actually related with the Lord, such mundane things are transcendental if dovetailed with the Lord or with His pure devotees. We have heard and talked about the activities of the Pāṇḍavas, and we now are dealing with the topics of Mahārāja Parīkṣit, but because all these topics are related to the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, they are all transcendental, and pure devotees have great interest in hearing them. We have already discussed this matter in connection with the prayers of Bhīṣmadeva.

Our duration of life is not very long, and there is no certainty of when we shall be ordered to leave everything for the next stage. Thus it is our duty to see that not a moment of our life is wasted in topics which are not related with Lord Kṛṣṇa. Any topic, however pleasant, is not worth hearing if it is devoid of its relation to Kṛṣṇa.

The spiritual planet, Goloka Vāṇḍāvana, the eternal abode of Lord Kṛṣṇa, is shaped like the whorl of a lotus flower. Even when the Lord descends to any one of the mundane planets, He does so by manifesting His own abode as it is. Thus His feet remain always on the same big whorl of the lotus flower. His feet are also as beautiful as the lotus flower. Therefore it is said that Lord Kṛṣṇa has lotus feet.

A living being is eternal by constitution. He is, so to speak, in the whirlpool of birth and death due to his contact with material energy. Freed from such material energy, a living entity is liberated and is eligible to return home, back to Godhead. Those who want to live forever without changing their material bodies should not waste valuable time with topics other than those relating to Lord Kṛṣṇa and His devotees.

TEXT 7

**+aud]aYauza& Na*<aaMa® MaTYaaRNaaMa*TaiMaC^TaaMa()
whaePahUTaae >aGavaNa(Ma*TYau" XaaiMa}ak-MaRi<a)) 7))**

kñudräyuñää nãëäm aìga

martyänäm âtam icchatäm

ihopahüto bhagavän

måtyuù çämitra-karmaëi

SYNONYMS

kñudra—very small; *äyuñäm*—of the duration of life; *nãëäm*—of the human beings; *aìga*—O Sùta Gosvami; *martyänäm*—of those who are sure to meet death; *âtam*—eternal life; *icchatäm*—of those who desire it; *iha*—herein; *upahütaù*—called for being present; *bhagavän*—representing the Lord; *måtyuù*—the controller of death, Yamarāja; *çämitra*—suppressing; *karmaëi*—performances.

TRANSLATION

O Sùta Gosvami, there are those amongst men who desire freedom from death and get eternal life. They escape the slaughtering process by calling the controller of death, Yamarāja.

PURPORT

The living entity, as he develops from lower animal life to a higher human being and gradually to higher intelligence, becomes anxious to get free from the clutches of death. Modern scientists try to avoid death by physiochemical advancement of knowledge, but alas, the controller of death, Yamarāja, is so cruel that he does not spare even the very life of the scientist himself. The scientist, who puts forward the theory of stopping death by advancement of scientific knowledge, becomes himself a victim of death when he is called by Yamarāja. What to speak of stopping death, no one can enhance the short period of life even by a fraction of a moment. The only hope of suspending the cruel slaughtering process of Yamarāja is to call him to hear and chant the holy name of the Lord. Yamarāja is a great devotee of the Lord, and he likes to be invited to *kértanas* and sacrifices by

the pure devotees, who are constantly engaged in the devotional service of the Lord. Thus the great sages, headed by Çaunaka and others, invited Yamarāja to attend the sacrifice performed at Naimiñāraëya. This was good for those who did not want to die.

TEXT 8

**Na k-iêiNMa]YaTae Taavd(YaavdaSTa whaNTak-")
WTadQa| ih >aGavaNaahUTa" ParMaizRi>a")
Ahae Na*I/aeke- PaqYaeTa hirl/Il/aMa*Ta& vc")) 8))**

na kaçcin mriyate tävad

yävad ästa ihäntakaù

etad-arthaà hi bhagavän

ähütaù paramarñibhiù

aho nâ-loke péyeta

hari-lilamâtaà vacaù

SYNONYMS

na—not; *kaçcit*—anyone; *mriyate*—will die; *tävat*—so long; *yävat*—as long as; *äste*—is present; *iha*—herein; *antakaù*—one who causes the end of life; *etad*—this; *artham*—reason; *hi*—certainly; *bhagavän*—the representative of the Lord; *ähütaù*—invited; *parama-ñibhiù*—by the great sages; *aho*—alas; *nâ-loke*—in human society; *péyeta*—let them drink; *hari-lila*—transcendental pastimes of the Lord; *amâtam*—nectar for eternal life; *vacaù*—narrations.

TRANSLATION

As long as Yamarāja, who causes everyone's death, is present here, no one shall meet with death. The great sages have invited the controller of

death, Yamarāja, who is the representative of the Lord. Living beings who are under his grip should take advantage by hearing the deathless nectar in the form of this narration of the transcendental pastimes of the Lord.

PURPORT

Every human being dislikes meeting death, but he does not know how to get rid of death. The surest remedy for avoiding death is to accustom oneself to hearing the nectarean pastimes of the Lord as they are systematically narrated in the text of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. It is advised herein, therefore, that any human being who desires freedom from death should take to this course of life as recommended by the *āñis* headed by Çaunaka.

TEXT 9

MaNdSYa MaNdPa[jSYa vYaae MaNdaYauzê vE)
iNad]Yaa ih²YaTae Naç&- idva c VYaQaRk-MaRi>a")) 9))

mandasya manda-prajñasya

vayo mandāyūñāṣ ca vai

nidrayā hriyate naktā

divā ca vyārtha-karmabhī

SYNONYMS

mandasya—of the lazy; *manda*—paltry; *prajñasya*—of intelligence; *vaya*—age; *manda*—short; *āyūñā*—of duration of life; *ca*—and; *vai*—exactly; *nidrayā*—by sleeping; *hriyate*—passes away; *naktam*—night; *divā*—daytime; *ca*—also; *vyārtha*—for nothing; *karmabhī*—by activities.

TRANSLATION

Lazy human beings with paltry intelligence and a short duration of life

pass the night sleeping and the day performing activities that are for naught.

PURPORT

The less intelligent do not know the real value of the human form of life. The human form is a special gift of material nature in the course of her enforcing stringent laws of miseries upon the living being. It is a chance to achieve the highest boon of life, namely to get out of the entanglement of repeated birth and death. The intelligent take care of this important gift by strenuously endeavoring to get out of the entanglement. But the less intelligent are lazy and unable to evaluate the gift of the human body to achieve liberation from the material bondage; they become more interested in so-called economic development and work very hard throughout life simply for the sense enjoyment of the temporary body. Sense enjoyment is also allowed to the lower animals by the law of nature, and thus a human being is also destined to a certain amount of sense enjoyment according to his past or present life. But one should definitely try to understand that sense enjoyment is not the ultimate goal of human life. Herein it is said that during the daytime one works “for nothing” because the aim is nothing but sense enjoyment. We can particularly observe how the human being is engaged for nothing in the great cities and industrial towns. There are so many things manufactured by human energy, but they are all meant for sense enjoyment, and not for getting out of material bondage. And after working hard during the daytime, a tired man either sleeps or engages in sex habits at night. That is the program of materialistic civilized life for the less intelligent. Therefore they are designated herein as lazy, unfortunate and short-lived.

TEXT 10

SaUTa ovac

**Yada Parqi+aTa(ku-åJaa®le/_vSaTa(
k-il&/ Pa[iví& iNaJac§-viTaRTae)
iNaXaMYa vaTaaRMaNaiTaiPa[Yaa& TaTa"
XaraSaNa& Sa&YauGaXaaEi<@radde)) 10))**

süta uväca

yadä parékñit kuru-jägale 'vasat

kalià praviñöaà nija-cakravartite

niçamya värtäm anatipriyää tataù

çaräsanaà saàyuga-çauëòir ädade

SYNONYMS

sütaù uväca—Süta Gosvami said; *yadä*—when; *parékñit*—Mahäräja Parékñit; *kuru-jägale*—in the capital of Kuru's empire; *avasat*—was residing; *kalim*—the symptoms of the age of Kali; *praviñöam*—entered; *nija-cakravartite*—within his jurisdiction; *niçamya*—thus hearing; *värtäm*—news; *anati-priyäm*—not very palatable; *tataù*—thereafter; *çaräsanam*—arrows and bow; *saàyuga*—having gotten a chance for; *çauëòir*—martial activities; *ädade*—took up.

TRANSLATION

Süta Gosvami said: While Mahäräja Parékñit was residing in the capital of the Kuru empire, the symptoms of the age of Kali began to infiltrate within the jurisdiction of his state. When he learned about this, he did not think the matter very palatable. This did, however, give him a chance to fight. He took up his bow and arrows and prepared himself for military activities.

PURPORT

The state administration of Mahäräja Parékñit was so perfect that he was sitting in his capital peacefully. But he got the news that the symptoms of the age of Kali had already infiltrated into the jurisdiction of his state, and he did not like this news. What are the symptoms of the age of Kali? They are (1) illicit connection with women, (2) indulgence in meat-eating, (3) intoxication and (4) taking pleasure in gambling. The age of Kali literally

means the age of quarrel, and the abovementioned four symptoms in human society are the root causes for all kinds of quarrel. Mahārāja Parékñit heard that some of the people of the state had already taken to those symptoms, and he wanted to take immediate steps against such causes of unrest. This means that at least up to the regime of Mahārāja Parékñit, such symptoms of public life were practically unknown, and as soon as they were slightly detected, he wanted to root them out. The news was not palatable for him, but in a way it was, because Mahārāja Parékñit got a chance to fight. There was no need to fight with small states because everyone was peacefully under his subordination, but the Kali-yuga miscreants gave his fighting spirit a chance for exhibition. A perfect *kñatriya* king is always jubilant as soon as he gets a chance to fight, just as a sportsman is eager when there is a chance for a sporting match. It is no argument that in the age of Kali such symptoms are predestined. If so, then why was there preparation for fighting out such symptoms? Such arguments are offered by lazy and unfortunate men. In the rainy season, rain is predestined, and yet people take precautions to protect themselves. Similarly, in the age of Kali the symptoms as above mentioned are sure to infiltrate into social life, but it is the duty of the state to save the citizens from the association of the agents of the age of Kali. Mahārāja Parékñit wanted to punish the miscreants indulging in the symptoms of Kali, and thus save the innocent citizens who were pure in habit by culture of religion. It is the duty of the king to give such protection, and Mahārāja Parékñit was perfectly right when he prepared himself to fight.

TEXT 11

**SvI/x(k*-Ta& XYaaMaTaur®YaaeiJaTa&
rQa& Ma*GaeNd]ßJaMaaié[Ta" PauraTa()
v*Taae rQaaüÜPaPaitaYauç-Yaa
SvSaeNaYaa idiGvJaYaaYa iNaGaRTa")) 11))**

svalaikâtaà çyâma-turaiga-yojitaà

rathaà mângendra-dhvajam äçritaù purät

vâto rathäçva-dvipapatti-yuktayä

sva-senayä digvijayäya nirgatau

SYNONYMS

su-alaikātam—very well decorated; *çyāma*—black; *turaiga*—horses; *yojitam*—tackled; *ratham*—chariot; *māga-indra*—lion; *dhvajam*—flagged; *āçritaù*—under the protection; *purāt*—from the capital; *vātaù*—surrounded by; *ratha*—charioteers; *açva*—cavalry; *dvipapatti*—elephants; *yuktayä*—thus being equipped; *sva-senayä*—along with infantry; *digvijayäya*—for the purpose of conquering; *nirgataù*—went out.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Parékñit sat on a chariot drawn by black horses. His flag was marked with the sign of a lion. Being so decorated and surrounded by charioteers, cavalry, elephants and infantry soldiers, he left the capital to conquer in all directions.

PURPORT

Mahārāja Parékñit is distinguished from his grandfather Arjuna, for black horses pulled his chariot instead of white horses. He marked his flag with the mark of a lion, and his grandfather marked his with the mark of Hanumānjé. A royal procession like that of Mahārāja Parékñit surrounded by well-decorated chariots, cavalry, elephants, infantry and band not only is pleasing to the eyes, but also is a sign of a civilization that is aesthetic even on the fighting front.

TEXT 12

>ad]ai& ke-TauMaal&/ c >aarTa& caetaraNa(ku-æNa()
ik-MPauāzadqiNa vzaRi<a iviJaTYa JaGa*he bil/Ma()) 12))

bhadrāçvaà ketumālaà ca

bhārataà cottarän kurün

kimpuruñädéni varñäëi

vijitya jagåhe balim

SYNONYMS

bhadräçvam—Bhadräçva; *ketumālam*—Ketumāla; *ca*—also; *bhāratam*—Bhārata; *ca*—and; *uttarān*—the northern countries; *kurūn*—the kingdom of the Kuru dynasty; *kimpuruṣa-ädéni*—a country beyond the northern side of the Himalayas; *varñäëi*—parts of the earth planet; *vijitya*—conquering; *jagåhe*—exacted; *balim*—strength.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Parékñit then conquered all parts of the earthly planet—Bhadräçva, Ketumāla, Bhārata, the northern Kuru, Kimpuruṣa, etc.—and exacted tributes from their respective rulers.

PURPORT

Bhadräçva: It is a tract of land near Meru Parvata, and it extends from Gandha-mädana Parvata to the saltwater ocean. There is a description of this *varña* in the *Mahābhārata* (***Bhéñma-parva* 7.14–18**). The description was narrated by Saijaya to Dhātārāñöra.

Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira also conquered this *varña*, and thus the province was included within the jurisdiction of his empire. Mahārāja Parékñit was formerly declared to be the emperor of all lands ruled by his grandfather, but still he had to establish his supremacy while he was out of his capital to exact tribute from such states.

Ketumāla: This earth planet is divided into seven *dvépas* by seven oceans, and the central *dvépa*, called Jambüdvépa, is divided into nine *varñas*, or parts, by eight huge mountains. Bhārata-varña is one of the above-mentioned nine *varñas*, and Ketumāla is also described as one of the above *varñas*. It is said that in Ketumāla *varña*, women are the most beautiful. This *varña* was conquered by Arjuna also. A description of this part of the

world is available in the *Mahābhārata* (***Sabhā*** 28.6).

It is said that this part of the world is situated on the western side of the Meru Parvata, and inhabitants of this province used to live up to ten thousand years (***Bhéñma-parva*** 6.31). Human beings living in this part of the globe are of golden color, and the women resemble the angels of heaven. The inhabitants are free from all kinds of diseases and grief.

Bhārata-varña: This part of the world is also one of the nine *varñas* of the Jambūdvépa. A description of Bhārata-varña is given in the *Mahābhārata* (***Bhéñma-parva***, Chapters 9 and 10).

In the center of Jambūdvépa is Ilāvāta-varña, and south of Ilāvāta-varña is Hari-varña. The description of these *varñas* is given in the *Mahābhārata* (***Sabhā-parva*** 28.7–8) as follows:

*nagarāḍḥ ca vanāḍḥ caiva
nadéç ca vimalodakāu
puruñān deva-kalpāḍḥ ca
nāréç ca priya-darçanāu*

*adāñña-pūrvān subhagān
sa dadarça dhanāijayau
sadanāni ca çubhrāēi
nāréç cāpsarasā nībhāu*

It is mentioned here that the women in both these *varñas* are beautiful, and some of them are equal to the Apsarās, or heavenly women.

Uttarakuru: According to Vedic geography the northernmost portion of Jambūdvépa is called Uttarakuru-varña. It is surrounded by the saltwater ocean from three sides and divided by Çāṅgavān Mountain from the Hiraemaya-varña.

Kimpuruṣa-varña: It is stated to be situated north of the great Himalaya Mountain, which is eighty thousand miles in length and height and which covers sixteen thousand miles in width. These parts of the world were also

conquered by Arjuna (**Sabhä** 28.1–2). The Kimpuruṣas are descendants of a daughter of Dakṣa. When Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira performed a horse sacrifice *yajña*, the inhabitants of these countries were also present to take part in the festival, and they paid tributes to the Emperor. This part of the world is called Kimpuruṣa-varṇa, or sometimes the Himalayan provinces (Himavaté). It is said that Çukadeva Gosvami was born in these Himalayan provinces and that he came to Bhārata-varṇa after crossing the Himalayan countries.

In other words, Mahārāja Parékṣit conquered all the world. He conquered all the continents adjoining all the seas and oceans in all directions, namely the eastern, western, northern and southern parts of the world.

TEXTS 13–15

Ta}a Ta}aaePaé*<vaNa" SvPaUveRza& MahaTMaNaaMa()
Pa[GaqYaMaa<a& c YaXa" k*-Z<aMaahaTMYaSaUck-Ma()) 13))
AaTMaaNa& c Pair}aaTaMaìTQaaManae_ñTaeJaSa")
òeh& c v*iZ<aPaaQaaRNaa& Taeza& >aiç&- c ke-Xave)) 14))
Tae>Ya" ParMaSaNTauí" Pa[qTYauÂ*iM>aTal/aecNa")
MahaDaNaaiNa vaSaa&iSa ddaE haraNa(MahaMaNaa")) 15))

tatra tatropaçãëvānaù

sva-pürveñää mahätmanäm

pragéyamäëää ca yaçaù

kãñëa-mähätmya-sücakam

ätmänaà ca pariträtam

açvatthämno 'stra-tejasaù

snehaà ca vãñëi-pärthänää

teñää bhaktià ca keçave

tebhyaù parama-santuñöaù

préty-ujjåmbhita-locanaù

mahä-dhanäni väsäàsi

dadau härän mahä-manäù

SYNONYMS

tatra tatra—everywhere the King visited; *upaçåëvånaù*—continuously he heard; *sva-pürveñäm*—about his own forefathers; *mahä-ätmanäm*—who were all great devotees of the Lord; *pragéyamäëam*—unto those who were thus addressing; *ca*—also; *yaçaù*—glories; *kåñëa*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *mähätmya*—glorious acts; *sücakam*—indicating; *ätmänam*—his personal self; *ca*—also; *pariträtam*—delivered; *açvatthåmnaù*—of Açvatthämä; *astra*—weapon; *tejasaù*—powerful rays; *sneham*—affection; *ca*—also; *våñëi-pårthånäm*—between descendants of Våñëi and those of Pårthä; *teñäm*—of all of them; *bhaktim*—devotion; *ca*—also; *keçave*—unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; *tebhyaù*—unto them; *parama*—extremely; *santuñöaù*—pleased; *préti*—attraction; *ujjåmbhita*—pleasingly open; *locanaù*—one who has such eyes; *mahä-dhanäni*—valuable riches; *väsäàsi*—clothing; *dadau*—gave in charity; *härän*—necklace; *mahä-manäù*—one who has a broader outlook.

TRANSLATION

Wherever the King visited, he continuously heard the glories of his great forefathers, who were all devotees of the Lord, and also of the glorious acts of Lord Kṛṣṇa. He also heard how he himself had been protected by the Lord from the powerful heat of the weapon of Açvatthämä. People also mentioned the great affection between the descendants of Våñëi and Pårthä due to the latter's great devotion to Lord Keçava. The King, being very pleased with the singers of such glories, opened his eyes in great satisfaction. Out of magnanimity he was pleased to award them very valuable necklaces and clothing.

PURPORT

Kings and great personalities of the state are presented with welcome addresses. This is a system from time immemorial, and Mahārāja Parékñit, since he was one of the well-known emperors of the world, was also presented with addresses of welcome in all parts of the world as he visited those places. The subject matter of those welcome addresses was Kṛṣṇa. Kṛṣṇa means Kṛṣṇa and His eternal devotees, as the king means the king and his confidential associates.

Kṛṣṇa and His unalloyed devotees cannot be separated, and therefore glorifying the devotee means glorifying the Lord and vice versa. Mahārāja Parékñit would not have been glad to hear about the glories of his forefathers like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira and Arjuna had they not been connected with the acts of Lord Kṛṣṇa. The Lord descends specifically to deliver His devotees (*pariträëäya sädhünäm*). The devotees are glorified by the presence of the Lord because they cannot live for a moment without the presence of the Lord and His different energies. The Lord is present for the devotee by His acts and glories, and therefore Mahārāja Parékñit felt the presence of the Lord when He was glorified by His acts, especially when he was saved by the Lord in the womb of his mother. The devotees of the Lord are never in danger, but in the material world which is full of dangers at every step, the devotees are apparently placed into dangerous positions, and when they are saved by the Lord, the Lord is glorified. Lord Kṛṣṇa would not have been glorified as the speaker of the *Bhagavad-gita* had His devotees like the Pääòavas not been entangled in the Battlefield of Kurukñetra. All such acts of the Lord were mentioned in the addresses of welcome, and Mahārāja Parékñit, in full satisfaction, rewarded those who presented such addresses. The difference between the presentation of welcome addresses today and in those days is that formerly the welcome addresses were presented to a person like Mahārāja Parékñit. The welcome addresses were full of facts and figures, and those who presented such addresses were sufficiently rewarded, whereas in the present days the welcome addresses are presented not always with factual statements but to please the postholder, and often they are full of flattering lies. And rarely are those who present such welcome addresses rewarded by the poor receiver.

TEXT 16

SaarQYaPaarzdSaevNaSa:YadaETYa,
vqraSaNaanauGaMaNaSTavNaPa[<aaMaaNa()
iòGDaezu Paa<@uzu JaGaTPa[<aiTa& civZ<aae,
>aRiç&- k-raeiTa Na*PaiTaêr<aarivNde)) 16))

sārathya-pārañada-sevana-sakhya-dautya-

véraśanānugamana-stavana-praëmān

snigdheñu päëòuñu jagat-praëtià ca viñëor

bhaktià karoti nā-patiç caraëäravinde

SYNONYMS

sārathya—acceptance of the post of a chariot driver; *pārañada*—acceptance of the presidency in the assembly of the Rājasūya sacrifice; *sevana*—engaging the mind constantly in the service of the Lord; *sakhya*—to think of the Lord as a friend; *dautya*—acceptance of the post of a messenger; *véra-āsana*—acceptance of the post of a watchman with a drawn sword at night; *anugamana*—following in the footsteps; *stavana*—offering of prayers; *praëmān*—offering obeisances; *snigdheñu*—unto them who are malleable to the will of the Lord; *päëòuñu*—unto the sons of Pääòu; *jagat*—the universal; *praëtim*—one who is obeyed; *ca*—and; *viñëòu*—of Viṣṇu; *bhaktim*—devotion; *karoti*—does; *nā-patiù*—the King; *caraëa-aravinde*—unto His lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Parékñit heard that out of His causeless mercy Lord Kṛṣṇa [Viṣṇu], who is universally obeyed, rendered all kinds of service to the malleable sons of Pääòu by accepting posts ranging from chariot driver to president to messenger, friend, night watchman, etc., according to the will of the Pääòavas, obeying them like a servant and offering obeisances like one younger in years. When he heard this, Mahārāja Parékñit became overwhelmed with devotion to the lotus feet of the Lord.

PURPORT

Lord Kṛṣṇa is everything to the unalloyed devotees like the Pāñḍavas. The Lord was for them the Supreme Lord, the spiritual master, the worshipable Deity, the guide, the chariot driver, the friend, the servant, the messenger and everything they could conceive of. And thus the Lord also reciprocated the feelings of the Pāñḍavas. Mahārāja Parīkṣit, as a pure devotee of the Lord, could appreciate the Lord's transcendental reciprocation of the feelings of His devotees, and thus he himself also was overwhelmed with the dealings of the Lord. Simply by appreciating the dealings of the Lord with His pure devotees, one can attain salvation. The Lord's dealings with His devotees appear to be ordinary human dealings, but one who knows them in truth becomes at once eligible to go back home, back to Godhead. The Pāñḍavas were so malleable to the will of the Lord that they could sacrifice any amount of energy for the service of the Lord, and by such unalloyed determination they could secure the Lord's mercy in any shape they desired.

TEXT 17

**TaSYaEv& vTaRMaaNaSYa PaUveRza& v*itaMaNvhMa()
NaaiTadUre ik-I/aêYa | YadaSaqTa(TaiàbaeDa Mae)) 17))**

tasyaivaà vartamānasya

pūrveñāà vāttim anvaham

nātidüre kilāçcaryāà

yad āsét tan nibodha me

SYNONYMS

tasya—of Mahārāja Parīkṣit; *evam*—thus; *vartamānasya*—remaining absorbed in such thought; *pūrveñām*—of his forefathers; *vāttim*—good engagement; *anvaham*—day after day; *na*—not; *ati-düre*—far off; *kila*—verily; *āçcaryam*—astonishing; *yat*—that; *āsét*—was; *tat*—which;

nibodha—know it; *me*—from me.

TRANSLATION

Now you may hear from me of what happened while Mahārāja Parékñit was passing his days hearing of the good occupations of his forefathers and being absorbed in thought of them.

TEXT 18

DaMaR" PadEke-Na crNa(ivC^aYaaMauPal/>Ya GaaMa()
Pa*C^iTa SMaaé[uvdNaa& ivvTSaaiMav MaaTarMa()) 18))

dharmaù padaikena caran

vicchäyäm upalabhya gäm

pācchati smāçru-vadanää

vivatsäm iva mātaram

SYNONYMS

dharmaù—the personality of religious principles; *padä*—leg; *ekena*—on one only; *caran*—wandering; *vicchäyäm*—overtaken by the shadow of grief; *upalabhya*—having met; *gäm*—the cow; *pācchati*—asking; *sma*—with; *açru-vadanäm*—with tears on the face; *vivatsäm*—one who has lost her offspring; *iva*—like; *mātaram*—the mother.

TRANSLATION

The personality of religious principles, Dharma, was wandering about in the form of a bull. And he met the personality of earth in the form of a cow who appeared to grieve like a mother who had lost her child. She had tears in her eyes, and the beauty of her body was lost. Thus Dharma questioned the earth as follows.

PURPORT

The bull is the emblem of the moral principle, and the cow is the representative of the earth. When the bull and the cow are in a joyful mood, it is to be understood that the people of the world are also in a joyful mood. The reason is that the bull helps production of grains in the agricultural field, and the cow delivers milk, the miracle of aggregate food values. The human society, therefore, maintains these two important animals very carefully so that they can wander everywhere in cheerfulness. But at the present moment in this age of Kali both the bull and the cow are now being slaughtered and eaten up as foodstuff by a class of men who do not know the brahminical culture. The bull and the cow can be protected for the good of all human society simply by the spreading of brahminical culture as the topmost perfection of all cultural affairs. By advancement of such culture, the morale of society is properly maintained, and so peace and prosperity are also attained without extraneous effort. When brahminical culture deteriorates, the cow and bull are mistreated, and the resultant actions are prominent by the following symptoms.

TEXT 19

DaMaR ovac

k-iÀÜd]e_NaaMaYaMaaTMaNaSTae
ivC^aYaaSa ãaYaTaezNMau%eNa)
Aal/+aYae >avTaqMaNTaraiDa&
dUre bNDau& XaaeciSa k-ÄNaaMb)) 19))

dharma uvāca

kaccid bhadre 'nāmayam ātmanas te

vicchāyāsi mlāyateñan mukhena

ālakñaye bhavatém antarādhià

düre bandhuà çocasi kaïcanāmba

SYNONYMS

dharma—Dharma inquired; *kaccit*—whether; *bhadre*—madam; *anāmayam*—quite hale and hearty; *ātmana*—self; *te*—unto you; *vicchāyā*—appear to be covered with the shadow of grief; *mlāyatā*—which darkens; *éñat*—slightly; *mukhena*—by the face; *ālakñaye*—you look; *bhavatém*—unto yourself; *antarādhim*—some disease within; *düre*—long distant; *bandhum*—friend; *çocasi*—thinking of; *kaicana*—someone; *amba*—O mother.

TRANSLATION

Dharma [in the form of a bull] asked: Madam, are you not hale and hearty? Why are you covered with the shadow of grief? It appears by your face that you have become black. Are you suffering from some internal disease, or are you thinking of some relative who is away in a distant place?

PURPORT

The people of the world in this age of Kali are always full of anxieties. Everyone is diseased with some kind of ailment. From the very faces of the people of this age, one can find out the index of the mind. Everyone feels the absence of his relative who is away from home. The particular symptom of the age of Kali is that no family is now blessed to live together. To earn a livelihood, the father lives at a place far away from the son, or the wife lives far away from the husband and so on. There are sufferings from internal diseases, separation from those near and dear, and anxieties for maintaining the status quo. These are but some important factors which make the people of this age always unhappy.

TEXT 20

PaadENYaURNa& XaaeciSa MaEk-Paad,
MaaTMaaNa& va v*zIE/>aaeR+YaMaa<aMa()
Aahae SauradqNa(ôTaYaj>aaGaaNa(
Pa[Jaa oTa iSvNMagavTYavzRiTā)) 20))

pädair nyünaà çocasi maika-pädam

ätmänaà vä vññalair bhokñyamäëam

äho surädén hāta-yajña-bhägän

prajā uta svin maghavaty avarñati

SYNONYMS

pädaiù—by three legs; *nyünam*—diminished; *çocasi*—if you are lamenting for that; *mä*—my; *eka-pädam*—only one leg; *ätmänam*—own body; *vä*—or; *vññalaiù*—by the unlawful meat-eaters; *bhokñyamäëam*—to be exploited; *ähoù*—in sacrifice; *sura-ädén*—the authorized demigods; *hāta-yajña*—devoid of sacrificial; *bhägän*—share; *prajāù*—the living beings; *uta*—increasing; *svit*—whether; *maghavaty*—in famine and scarcity; *avarñati*—because of rainlessness.

TRANSLATION

I have lost my three legs and am now standing on one only. Are you lamenting for my state of existence? Or are you in great anxiety because henceforward the unlawful meat-eaters will exploit you? Or are you in a sorry plight because the demigods are now bereft of their share of sacrificial offerings because no sacrifices are being performed at present? Or are you grieving for living beings because of their sufferings due to famine and drought?

PURPORT

With the progress of the age of Kali, four things particularly, namely the duration of life, mercy, the power of recollection, and moral or religious principles will gradually diminish. Since Dharma, or the principles of religion, would be lost in the proportion of three out of four, the symbolic bull was standing on one leg only. When three fourths of the population of the whole world become irreligious, the situation is converted into hell for the animals. In the age of Kali, godless civilizations will create so many so-

called religious societies in which the Personality of Godhead will be directly or indirectly defied. And thus faithless societies of men will make the world uninhabitable for the saner section of people. There are gradations of human beings in terms of proportionate faith in the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The first-class faithful men are the Vaiñëavas and the *brahmanas*, then the *kṣatriyas*, then the *vaisyas*, then the *sudras*, then the *mlecchas*, the *yavanas* and at last the *caëðälas*. The degradation of the human instinct begins from the *mlecchas*, and the *caëðäla* state of life is the last word in human degradation. All the above terms mentioned in the Vedic literatures are never meant for any particular community or birth. They are different qualifications of human beings in general. There is no question of birthright or community. One can acquire the respective qualifications by one's own efforts, and thus the son of a Vaiñëava can become a *mleccha*, or the son of a *caëðäla* can become more than a *brahmana*, all in terms of their association and intimate relation with the Supreme Lord.

The meat-eaters are generally called *mlecchas*. But all meat-eaters are not *mlecchas*. Those who accept meat in terms of scriptural injunctions are not *mlecchas*, but those who accept meat without restriction are called *mlecchas*. Beef is forbidden in the scriptures, and the bulls and cows are offered special protection by followers of the *Vedas*. But in this age of Kali, people will exploit the body of the bull and the cow as they like, and thus they will invite sufferings of various types.

The people of this age will not perform any sacrifice. The *mleccha* population will care very little for performances of sacrifices, although performance of sacrifice is essential for persons who are materially engaged in sense enjoyment. In the *Bhagavad-gita* performance of sacrifices is strongly recommended (Bg. 3.14–16).

The living beings are created by the creator Brahmä, and just to maintain the created living being progressively towards the path back to Godhead, the system of performing sacrifice is also created by him. The system is that living beings live on the produce of grains and vegetables, and by eating such foodstuff they get vital power of the body in the shape of blood and semen, and from blood and semen one living being is able to create other

living beings. But the production of grains, grass, etc. becomes possible by rain, and this rain is made to shower properly by performance of recommended sacrifices. Such sacrifices are directed by the rites of the *Vedas*, namely *Sāma*, *Yajur*, *Āg* and *Atharva*. In the *Manu-smṛiti* it is recommended that by offerings of sacrifice on the altar of the fire, the sun-god is pleased. When the sun-god is pleased, he properly collects water from the sea, and thus sufficient clouds collect on the horizon and rains fall. After sufficient rains fall, there is sufficient production of grains for men and all animals, and thus there is energy in the living being for progressive activity. The *mlecchas*, however, make plans to install slaughterhouses for killing bulls and cows along with other animals, thinking that they will prosper by increasing the number of factories and live on animal food without caring for performance of sacrifices and production of grains. But they must know that even for the animals they must produce grass and vegetables, otherwise the animals cannot live. And to produce grass for the animals, they require sufficient rains. Therefore they have to depend ultimately on the mercy of the demigods like the sun-god, Indra and Candra, and such demigods must be satisfied by performances of sacrifice.

This material world is a sort of prison house, as we have several times mentioned. The demigods are the servants of the Lord who see to the proper upkeep of the prison house. These demigods want to see that the rebel living beings, who want to survive faithlessly, are gradually turned towards the supreme power of the Lord. Therefore, the system of offering sacrifice is recommended in the scriptures.

The materialistic men want to work hard and enjoy fruitive results for sense enjoyment. Thus they are committing many types of sins at every step of life. Those, however, who are consciously engaged in the devotional service of the Lord are transcendental to all varieties of sin and virtue. Their activities are free from the contamination of the three modes of material nature. For the devotees there is no need for performance of prescribed sacrifices because the very life of the devotee is a symbol of sacrifice. But persons who are engaged in fruitive activities for sense enjoyment must perform the prescribed sacrifices because that is the only means to get free from the reaction of all sins committed by fruitive workers. Sacrifice is the means for counteracting such accumulated sins. The demigods are pleased

when such sacrifices are performed, just as prison officers are satisfied when the prisoners are turned into obedient subjects. Lord Caitanya, however, has recommended only one *yajña*, or sacrifice, called the *saikértana-yajña*, the chanting of Hare Kṛṣṇa, in which everyone can take part. Thus both devotees and fruitive workers can derive equal benefit from the performances of *saikértana-yajña*.

TEXT 21

Ar+YaMaa<aa" iñYa oivR bal/aNa(
XaaecSYaQaae PauåzadEirvaTaaRNA()
vac& devq& b]øku-le/ ku-k-MaR,
<Yab]ø<Yae raJaku-le/ ku-l/aGY[aaNa()) 21))

arakñyamäëü striya urvi bälän

çocasy atho puruñädair ivärtän

väcaà devéà brahma-kule kukarmaëy

abrahmaëye räja-kule kulägryän

SYNONYMS

arakñyamäëü—unprotected; *striyaü*—women; *urvi*—on the earth; *bälän*—children; *çocasi*—you are feeling compassion; *atho*—as such; *puruṣa-ädaiü*—by men; *iva*—like that; *ärtän*—those who are unhappy; *väcam*—vocabulary; *devém*—the goddess; *brahma-kule*—in the family of the *brahmana*; *kukarmaëi*—acts against the principles of religion; *abrahmaëye*—persons against the brahminical culture; *räja-kule*—in the administrative family; *kula-agryän*—most of all the families (the *brahmanas*).

TRANSLATION

Are you feeling compunction for the unhappy women and children who are left forlorn by unscrupulous persons? Or are you unhappy because the

goddess of learning is being handled by brahmanas addicted to acts against the principles of religion? Or are you sorry to see that the brahmanas have taken shelter of administrative families that do not respect brahminical culture?

PURPORT

In the age of Kali, the women and the children, along with *brahmanas* and cows, will be grossly neglected and left unprotected. In this age illicit connection with women will render many women and children uncared for. Circumstantially, the women will try to become independent of the protection of men, and marriage will be performed as a matter of formal agreement between man and woman. In most cases, the children will not be taken care of properly. The *brahmanas* are traditionally intelligent men, and thus they will be able to pick up modern education to the topmost rank, but as far as moral and religious principles are concerned, they shall be the most fallen. Education and bad character go ill together, but such things will run parallel. The administrative heads as a class will condemn the tenets of Vedic wisdom and will prefer to conduct a so-called secular state, and the so-called educated *brahmanas* will be purchased by such unscrupulous administrators. Even a philosopher and writer of many books on religious principles may also accept an exalted post in a government which denies all the moral codes of the *sastras*. The *brahmanas* are specifically restricted from accepting such service. But in this age they will not only accept service, but they will do so even if it is of the meanest quality. These are some of the symptoms of the Kali age which are harmful to the general welfare of human society.

TEXT 22

ik&- +a}abNDaUNa(k-il/NaaePaSa*íaNa(
raí\ai<a va TaErvraeiPaTaaNa)
wTaSTaTaae vaXaNaPaaNavaSa",
òaNavyavaYaaeNMau%Jaql/aek-Ma()) 22))

kià kñātra-bandhūn kalinopasāññān

rãñöräëi vâ tair avaropitâni

itas tato vâçana-pâna-vâsaù-

snâna-vyaväyonmukha-jéva-lokam

SYNONYMS

kim—whether; *kñatra-bandhün*—the unworthy administrators; *kalinä*—by the influence of the age of Kali; *upasãñöän*—bewildered; *rãñöräëi*—state affairs; *vâ*—or; *taiù*—by them; *avaropitâni*—put into disorder; *itaù*—here; *tataù*—there; *vâ*—or; *açana*—accepting foodstuff; *pâna*—drink; *vâsaù*—residence; *snâna*—bath; *vyaväya*—sexual intercourse; *unmukha*—inclined; *jéva-lokam*—human society.

TRANSLATION

The so-called administrators are now bewildered by the influence of this age of Kali, and thus they have put all state affairs into disorder. Are you now lamenting this disorder? Now the general populace does not follow the rules and regulations for eating, sleeping, drinking, mating, etc., and they are inclined to perform such anywhere and everywhere. Are you unhappy because of this?

PURPORT

There are some necessities of life on a par with those of the lower animals, and they are eating, sleeping, fearing and mating. These bodily demands are for both the human beings and the animals. But the human being has to fulfill such desires not like animals, but like a human being. A dog can mate with a bitch before the public eyes without hesitation, but if a human being does so the act will be considered a public nuisance, and the person will be criminally prosecuted. Therefore for the human being there are some rules and regulations, even for fulfilling common demands. The human society avoids such rules and regulations when it is bewildered by the influence of the age of Kali. In this age, people are indulging in such necessities of life without following the rules and regulations, and this deterioration of social

and moral rules is certainly lamentable because of the harmful effects of such beastly behavior. In this age, the fathers and the guardians are not happy with the behavior of their wards. They should know that so many innocent children are victims of bad association awarded by the influence of this age of Kali. We know from *Srimad-Bhagavatam* that Ajāmila, an innocent son of a *brahmana*, was walking down a road and saw a *çüdra* pair sexually embracing. This attracted the boy, and later on the boy became a victim of all debaucheries. From a pure *brahmana*, he fell down to the position of a wretched urchin, and it was all due to bad association. There was but one victim like Ajāmila in those days, but in this age of Kali the poor innocent students are daily victims of cinemas which attract men only for sex indulgence. The so-called administrators are all untrained in the affairs of a *kñātriya*. The *kṣatriyas* are meant for administration, as the *brahmanas* are meant for knowledge and guidance. The word *kñātra-bandhu* refers to the so-called administrators or persons promoted to the post of the administrator without proper training by culture and tradition. Nowadays they are promoted to such exalted posts by the votes of the people who are themselves fallen in the rules and regulations of life. How can such people select a proper man when they are themselves fallen in the standard of life? Therefore, by the influence of the age of Kali, everywhere, politically, socially or religiously, everything is topsy-turvy, and therefore for the sane man it is all regrettable.

TEXT 23

YaÜaMb Tae >aUir>aravTaar,
 k*-TaavTaarSYa hreDaRiri}a)
 ANTaihRTaSYa SMarTaq ivSa*ía
 k-MaaRi<a iNavaR<aivl/iMbTaaiNa)) 23))

yadvämba te bhüri-bharävatära-

kätävatärasya harer dharitri

antarhitasya smaraté visãñöä

karmäëi nirväëa-vilambitäni

SYNONYMS

yadvä—that may be; *amba*—O mother; *te*—your; *bhüri*—heavy; *bhara*—load; *avatära*—decreasing the load; *kâta*—done; *avatärasya*—one who incarnated; *hareù*—of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *dharitri*—O earth; *antarhitasya*—of Him who is now out of sight; *smaraté*—while thinking of; *visåñöä*—all that were performed; *karmäei*—activities; *nirväëa*—salvation; *vilambitäni*—that which entails.

TRANSLATION

O mother earth, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Hari, incarnated Himself as Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa just to unload your heavy burden. All His activities here are transcendental, and they cement the path of liberation. You are now bereft of His presence. You are probably now thinking of those activities and feeling sorry in their absence.

PURPORT

The activities of the Lord include liberation, but they are more relishable than the pleasure derived from *nirväëa*, or liberation. According to Srila Jiva Gosvami and Visvanatha Cakravarti Öhäkura, the word used here is *nirväëa-vilambitäni*, that which minimizes the value of liberation. To attain *nirväëa*, liberation, one has to undergo a severe type of *tapasya*, austerity, but the Lord is so merciful that He incarnates to diminish the burden of the earth. Simply by remembering such activities, one can defy the pleasure derived from *nirväëa* and reach the transcendental abode of the Lord to associate with Him, eternally engaged in His blissful loving service.

TEXT 24

wd& MaMaac+v TavaiDaMaUI&/
vSauNDare YaeNa ivk-iXaRTaaiSa)
k-ale/Na va Tae bil/Naa& bl/IYaSaa
SauraicRTa& ik&- ôTaMaMb SaaE>aGaMa()) 24))

idaà mamäcakñva tavädhi-mülaà

vasundhare yena vikaṛṇitāsi

kālena vā te balināḥ baléyasā

surārcitaḥ kiṁ hātam amba saubhagam

SYNONYMS

idam—this; *mama*—unto me; *ācakṣva*—kindly inform; *tava*—your; *ādhimūlam*—the root cause of your tribulations; *vasundhare*—O reservoir of all riches; *yena*—by which; *vikaṛṇitā asi*—reduced to much weakness; *kālena*—by the influence of time; *vā*—or; *te*—your; *balinām*—very powerful; *baléyasā*—more powerful; *sura-arcitam*—adored by the demigods; *kim*—whether; *hātam*—taken away; *amba*—mother; *saubhagam*—fortune.

TRANSLATION

Mother, you are the reservoir of all riches. Please inform me of the root cause of your tribulations by which you have been reduced to such a weak state. I think that the powerful influence of time, which conquers the most powerful, might have forcibly taken away all your fortune, which was adored even by the demigods.

PURPORT

By the grace of the Lord, each and every planet is created fully equipped. So not only is this earth fully equipped with all the riches for the maintenance of its inhabitants, but also when the Lord descends on the earth the whole earth becomes so enriched with all kinds of opulences that even the denizens of heaven worship it with all affection. But by the will of the Lord, the whole earth can at once be changed. He can do and undo a thing by His sweet will. Therefore no one should consider himself to be self-sufficient or independent of the Lord.

TEXT 25

Dar<Yauvac
>avaNa(ih ved TaTSav| YaNMaa& DaMaaRNauPa*C^iSa)
cTauiaRvRTaRSae YaeNa PaadEI/aeRk-Sau%avhE")) 25))

dharaëy uväca

bhavän hi veda tat sarvaà

yan mäà dharmänupâcchasi

caturbhir vartase yena

pädair loka-sukhävahaiù

SYNONYMS

dharaëé uväca—mother earth replied; *bhavän*—your good self; *hi*—certainly; *veda*—know; *tat sarvam*—all that you have inquired from me; *yat*—that; *mäm*—from me; *dharmä*—O personality of religious principles; *anupâcchasi*—you have inquired one after another; *caturbhiù*—by four; *vartase*—you exist; *yena*—by which; *pädaiù*—by the legs; *loka*—in each and every planet; *sukha-ävahaiù*—increasing the happiness.

TRANSLATION

The earthly deity [in the form of a cow] thus replied to the personality of religious principles [in the form of a bull]: O Dharma, whatever you have inquired from me shall be known to you. I shall try to reply to all those questions. Once you too were maintained by your four legs, and you increased happiness all over the universe by the mercy of the Lord.

PURPORT

The principles of religion are laid down by the Lord Himself, and the executor of such laws is Dharmarāja, or Yamarāja. Such principles work fully in the age of Satya-yuga; in the Tretā-yuga they are reduced by a fraction of one fourth; in the Dvāpara-yuga they are reduced to one half, and in the

Kali-yuga they are reduced to one fourth, gradually diminishing to the zero point, and then devastation takes place. Happiness in the world depends proportionately on the maintenance of the religious principles, individually or collectively. The best part of valor is to maintain the principles despite all kinds of odds. Thus one can be happy during the span of life and ultimately return to Godhead.

TEXTS 26–30

SaTYa& XaaEc& dYaa +aaINTaSTYaaGa" SaNTaaez AaJaRvMa()
 XaMaae dMaSTaPa" SaaMYa& iTaiTa+aaPariTa" é[uTaMa()) 26))
 jaNa& ivriÇ-rEiYa| XaaEYa| TaeJaae bl&/ SMa*iTa")
 SvaTaN}Ya& k-aEXal&/ k-aiNTaDaCEYa| MaadRvMaev c)) 27))
 Pa[aGaL>Ya& Pa[é[Ya" Xaql&/ Sah AaeJaae bl&/ >aGa")
 GaaM>aqYa| SQaEYaRMaaiSTaKYa& k-liTaRMaaRNaae_Nahx(k*-iTa"))
 28))
 WTae caNYae c >aGaviàTYaa Ya}a MahaGau<aa")
 Pa[aQYaaR MahtviMaC^iÜNaR ivYaiNTa SMa k-ihRicTa()) 29))
 TaeNaah& Gau<aPaa}ae<a é[qiNavaSaeNa SaaMPa[TaMa()
 XaaecaiMa rihTa& l/aek&- PaaPMaNaa k-il/Naei+aTaMa()) 30))

satyaà çaucaà dayä kñāntis

tyāgaù santoña ārjavam

çamo damas tapaù sämyaà

titikñoparatiù çrutam

jīānaà viraktir aiçvaryaà

çauryaà tejo balaà smātiù

svātantryaà kauçalaà kāntir

dhairyaà mārḍavam eva ca

prägalbhyaà praçrayaù çélaà

saha ojo balaà bhagaù

gämbhéryaà sthairyam ästikyaà

kértir mäno 'nahaikåtiù

ete cänye ca bhagavan

nityä yatra mahä-guëäù

prärthyä mahattvam icchadbhir

na viyanti sma karhicit

tenähaà guëa-pätreëa

çré-niväsena sämpratam

çocämi rahitaà lokaà

päpmanä kalinekñitam

SYNONYMS

satyam—truthfulness; *çaucam*—cleanliness; *dayä*—intolerance of others' unhappiness; *kñäntiù*—self-control even if there is cause of anger; *tyägaù*—magnanimity; *santoñaù*—self-satisfaction; *ärjavam*—straightforwardness; *çamaù*—fixing of the mind; *damaù*—control of the sense organs; *tapaù*—trueness to one's responsibility; *sämyam*—indiscrimination between friend and foe; *titikñä*—tolerance of the offenses of others; *uparatiù*—indifference to loss and gain; *çrutam*—following scriptural injunctions; *jñänam*—knowledge (self-realization); *viraktiù*—detachment from sense enjoyment; *aicçvaryam*—leadership; *çauryam*—chivalry; *tejaù*—influence; *balam*—to render possible that which is impossible; *småtiù*—to find one's proper duty; *svätantryam*—not to

depend on others; *kauçalam*—dexterity in all activities; *käntiù*—beauty; *dhairyam*—freedom from disturbance; *märdavam*—kindheartedness; *eva*—thus; *ca*—also; *prägalbhyam*—ingenuity; *praçrayaù*—gentility; *çélam*—mannerliness; *sahaù*—determination; *ojaù*—perfect knowledge; *balam*—proper execution; *bhagaù*—object of enjoyment; *gämbhéryam*—joyfulness; *sthairyam*—immovability; *ästikyam*—faithfulness; *kértiù*—fame; *mänaù*—worthy of being worshiped; *anahaikâtiù*—pridelessness; *ete*—all these; *ca anye*—also many others; *ca*—and; *bhagavan*—the Personality of Godhead; *nityäù*—everlasting; *yatra*—where; *mahä-guëäù*—great qualities; *prärthyäù*—worthy to possess; *mahattvam*—greatness; *icchadbhiù*—those who desire so; *na*—never; *viyanti*—deteriorates; *sma*—ever; *karhicit*—at any time; *tena*—by Him; *aham*—myself; *guëa-pätreëa*—the reservoir of all qualities; *çré*—the goddess of fortune; *niväsenä*—by the resting place; *sämpratam*—very recently; *çocämi*—I am thinking of; *rahitam*—bereft of; *lokam*—planets; *päpmanä*—by the store of all sins; *kalinä*—by Kali; *ékñitam*—is seen.

TRANSLATION

In Him reside (1) truthfulness, (2) cleanliness, (3) intolerance of another's unhappiness, (4) the power to control anger, (5) self-satisfaction, (6) straightforwardness, (7) steadiness of mind, (8) control of the sense organs, (9) responsibility, (10) equality, (11) tolerance, (12) equanimity, (13) faithfulness, (14) knowledge, (15) absence of sense enjoyment, (16) leadership, (17) chivalry, (18) influence, (19) the power to make everything possible, (20) the discharge of proper duty, (21) complete independence, (22) dexterity, (23) fullness of all beauty, (24) serenity, (25) kindheartedness, (26) ingenuity, (27) gentility, (28) magnanimity, (29) determination, (30) perfection in all knowledge, (31) proper execution, (32) possession of all objects of enjoyment, (33) joyfulness, (34) immovability, (35) fidelity, (36) fame, (37) worship, (38) pridelessness, (39) being (as the Personality of Godhead), (40) eternity, and many other transcendental qualities which are eternally present and never to be separated from Him. That Personality of Godhead, the reservoir of all goodness and beauty, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, has now closed His transcendental pastimes on the face of the earth. In His absence the age of Kali has spread its influence everywhere, so I am sorry to see this condition of

existence.

PURPORT

Even if it were possible to count the atoms after smashing the earth into powder, still it would not be possible to estimate the unfathomable transcendental qualities of the Lord. It is said that Lord Anantadeva has tried to expound the transcendental qualities of the Supreme Lord with His numberless tongues, and that for numberless years together it has been impossible to estimate the qualities of the Lord. The above statement of the qualities of the Lord is just to estimate His qualities as far as a human being is able to see Him. But even if it is so, the above qualities can be divided into many subheadings. According to Srila Jiva Gosvami, the third quality, intolerance of another's unhappiness, can be subdivided into (1) protection of the surrendered souls and (2) well wishes for the devotees. In the *Bhagavad-gita* the Lord states that He wants every soul to surrender unto Him only, and He assures everyone that if one does so He will give protection from the reactions of all sins. Unsurrendered souls are not devotees of the Lord, and thus there is no particular protection for everyone in general. For the devotees He has all good wishes, and for those who are actually engaged in loving transcendental service of the Lord, He gives particular attention. He gives direction to such pure devotees to help them discharge their responsibilities on the path back to Godhead. By equality (10), the Lord is equally kind to everyone, as the sun is equal in distributing its rays over everyone. Yet there are many who are unable to take advantage of the sun's rays. Similarly, the Lord says that surrendering unto Him is the guarantee for all protection from Him, but unfortunate persons are unable to accept this proposition, and therefore they suffer from all material miseries. So even though the Lord is equally well-wishing to everyone, the unfortunate living being, due to bad association only, is unable to accept His instructions *in toto*, and for this the Lord is never to be blamed. He is called the well-wisher for the devotees only. He appears to be partial to His devotees, but factually the matter rests on the living being to accept or reject equal treatment by the Lord.

The Lord never deviates from His word of honor. When He gives assurance for protection, the promise is executed in all circumstances. It is the duty of

the pure devotee to be fixed in the discharge of the duty entrusted to him by the Lord or the Lord's bona fide representative, the spiritual master. The rest is carried on by the Lord without a break.

The responsibility of the Lord is also unique. The Lord has no responsibility because all His work is done by His different appointed energies. But still He accepts voluntary responsibilities in displaying different roles in His transcendental pastimes. As a boy, He was playing the part of a cowboy. As the son of Nanda Mahārāja, He discharged responsibility perfectly. Similarly, when He was playing the part of a *kñātriya* as the son of Mahārāja Vasudeva, He displayed all the skill of a martially spirited *kñātriya*. In almost all cases, the *kñātriya* king has to secure a wife by fighting or kidnapping. This sort of behavior for a *kñātriya* is praiseworthy in the sense that a *kñātriya* must show his power of chivalry to his would-be wife so that the daughter of a *kñātriya* can see the valor of her would-be husband. Even the Personality of Godhead Sri Rāma displayed such a spirit of chivalry during His marriage. He broke the strongest bow, called Haradhanur, and achieved the hand of Sitadevī, the mother of all opulence. The *kñātriya* spirit is displayed during marriage festivals, and there is nothing wrong in such fighting. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa discharged such responsibility fully because although He had more than sixteen thousand wives, in each and every case He fought like a chivalrous *kñātriya* and thus secured a wife. To fight sixteen thousand times to secure sixteen thousand wives is certainly possible only for the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Similarly, He displayed full responsibility in every action of His different transcendental pastimes.

The fourteenth quality, knowledge, can be further extended into five subheadings, namely (1) intelligence, (2) gratefulness, (3) power of understanding the circumstantial environments of place, object and time, (4) perfect knowledge of everything, and (5) knowledge of the self. Only fools are ungrateful to their benefactors. The Lord, however, does not require benefit from anyone besides Himself because He is full in Himself; still He feels benefited by the unalloyed services of His devotees. The Lord feels grateful to His devotees for such unsophisticated, unconditional service and tries to reciprocate it by rendering service, although the devotee also has no such desire in his heart. The transcendental service of

the Lord is itself a transcendental benefit for the devotee, and therefore the devotee has nothing to expect from the Lord. On the assertion of the Vedic aphorism *sarvaà khalv idaà brahma*, we can understand that the Lord, by the omnipresent rays of His effulgence, called *brahmajyoti*, is all-pervading inside or outside of everything, like the omnipresent material sky, and thus He is also omniscient.

As far as the beauty of the Lord is concerned, He has some special features that distinguish Him from all other living beings, and over and above that He has some special attractive beautiful features by which He attracts the mind of even Rādhārāṣī, the supermost beautiful creation of the Lord. He is known, therefore, as Madana-mohana, or one who attracts the mind of even Cupid. Srila Jiva Gosvami Prabhu has scrutinizingly analyzed other transcendental qualities of the Lord and affirms that Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa is the Absolute Supreme Personality of Godhead (Parabrahman). He is omnipotent by His inconceivable energies, and therefore He is the Yogesvara, or the supreme master of all mystic powers. Being the Yogesvara, His eternal form is spiritual, a combination of eternity, bliss and knowledge. The nondevotee class cannot understand the dynamic nature of His knowledge because they are satisfied to reach up to His eternal form of knowledge. All great souls aspire to be equal in knowledge with Him. This means that all other knowledge is ever insufficient, flexible and measurable, whereas the knowledge of the Lord is ever fixed and unfathomable. Srila Sūta Gosvami affirms in the *Bhāgavatam* that although He was observed by the citizens of Dvārakā every day, they were ever increasingly anxious to see Him again and again. The living beings can appreciate the qualities of the Lord as the ultimate goal, but they cannot attain the status quo of such equality. This material world is a product of the *mahat-tattva*, which is a state of the Lord's dreaming condition in His *yoga-nidrā* mystic slumber in the Causal Ocean, and yet the whole creation appears to be a factual presentation of His creation. This means that the Lord's dreaming conditions are also factual manifestations. He can therefore bring everything under His transcendental control, and thus whenever and wherever He does appear, He does so in His fullness.

The Lord, being all that is described above, maintains the affairs of the creation, and by His so doing He gives salvation even to His enemies who

are killed by Him. He is attractive even to the topmost liberated soul, and thus He is worshipable even by Brahmā and Siva, the greatest of all demigods. Even in His incarnation of *puruṣa-avatāra* He is the Lord of the creative energy. The creative material energy is working under His direction, as confirmed in the ***Bhagavad-gīta*** (9.10). He is the control switch of the material energy, and to control the material energy in the innumerable universes, He is the root cause of innumerable incarnations in all the universes. There are more than five hundred thousand incarnations of Manu in only one universe, besides other incarnations in different universes. In the spiritual world, however, beyond the *mahat-tattva*, there is no question of incarnations, but there are plenary expansions of the Lord in different Vaikunthas. The planets in the spiritual sky are at least three times the number of those within the innumerable universes in the *mahat-tattva*. And all the Nārāyaṇa forms of the Lord are but expansions of His Vāsudeva feature, and thus He is Vāsudeva, Nārāyaṇa and Kṛṣṇa simultaneously. He is *ṣré-kāñḍea govinda hare murāre, he nātha nārāyaṇa vāsudeva*, all in one. His qualities, therefore, cannot be counted by anyone, however great one may be.

TEXT 31

AaTMaaNa& caNauXaaecaiMa >avNTa& caMaraetaMaMa()
devaNa(iPaTa>Na*zqNa(SaaDaUNa(SavaRNa(v<aa|STaQaaé[MaaNa())
31))

ātmānaà cānuṣocāmi

bhavantaà cāmarottamam

devān pitēn āñēn sādḥūn

sarvān varēāś tathāṣramān

SYNONYMS

ātmānam—myself; *ca*—also; *anuṣocāmi*—lamenting; *bhavantam*—yourself; *ca*—as well as; *amara-uttamam*—the best amongst the demigods;

devän—about the demigods; *pitèn*—about the denizens of the Pitåloka planet; *åñén*—about the sages; *sādhün*—about the devotees; *sarvän*—all of them; *varëän*—sections; *tathä*—as also; *äçramän*—orders of human society.

TRANSLATION

I am thinking about myself and also, O best amongst the demigods, about you, as well as about all the demigods, sages, denizens of Pitåloka, devotees of the Lord and all men obedient to the system of varëa and äçrama in human society.

PURPORT

To effect the perfection of human life there is cooperation between men and demigods, sages, denizens of the Pitåloka, devotees of the Lord and the scientific system of *varëa* and *äçrama* orders of life. The distinction between human life and animal life therefore begins with the scientific system of *varëa* and *äçrama*, guided by the experience of the sages in relation with the demigods, gradually rising to the summit of reestablishing our eternal relation with the Supreme Absolute Truth, the Personality of Godhead, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. When God-made *varëäçrama-dharma*, which is strictly meant for developing animal consciousness into human consciousness and human consciousness into godly consciousness, is broken by advancement of foolishness, the whole system of peaceful and progressive life is at once disturbed. In the age of Kali, the first attack of the venomous snake strikes against the God-made *varëäçrama-dharma*, and thus a person properly qualified as a *brahmana* is called a *çüdra*, and a *çüdra* by qualification is passing as a *brahmana*, all on a false birthright claim. To become a *brahmana* by a birthright claim is not at all bona fide, although it may be a fulfillment of one of the conditions. But the real qualification of a *brahmana* is to control the mind and the senses, and to cultivate tolerance, simplicity, cleanliness, knowledge, truthfulness, devotion and faith in the Vedic wisdom. In the present age, consideration of the necessary qualification is being neglected, and the false birthright claim is being supported even by a popular, sophisticated poet, the author of *Rāma-carita-mānasa*.

This is all due to the influence of the age of Kali. Thus mother earth, represented as a cow, was lamenting the regrettable condition.

TEXTS 32–33

b]øadYaae bhuiTaQa& YadPaa®Maae+a,
k-aMaaSTaPa" SaMacrNa(>aGavTPa[Paàa")
Saa é[q" SvvaSaMarivNdvNa& ivhaYa
YaTPaadSaaE>aGaMal&/ >aJaTae_Naurç-a)) 32))
TaSYaahMaBJaku-il/Xaax(ku-Xake-Tauke-TaE"
é[qMaTPadE>aRGavTa" SaMal/x(k*-Taa®q)
}aqNaTYaraec oPal/>Ya TaTaae iv>aUiTa&
l/aek-aNa(Sa Maa& VYaSa*JaduTSMaYaTaq& TadNTae)) 33))

brahmādayo bahu-tithaà yad-apäiga-mokñā-

kāmās tapaù samacaran bhagavat-prapannäù

sä çréù sva-väsam aravinda-vanaà vihäya

yat-päda-saubhagam alaà bhajate 'nuraktä

tasyäham abja-kuliçäikuça-ketu-ketaiù

çrémat-padair bhagavataù samalaikâtäigé

trén atyaroca upalabhya tato vibhütià

lokän sa mäà vyaśjad utsmayatéà tad-ante

SYNONYMS

brahma-ādayaù—demigods such as Brahmä; *bahu-titham*—for many days; *yat*—of Lakñmé, the goddess of fortune; *apäiga-mokñā*—glance of grace; *kāmäù*—being desirous of; *tapaù*—penances; *samacaran*—executing; *bhagavat*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *prapannäù*—surrendered; *sä*—she (the goddess of fortune); *çréù*—Lakñméjé; *sva-väsam*—her own

abode; *aravinda-vanam*—the forest of lotus flowers; *vihāya*—leaving aside; *yat*—whose; *pāda*—feet; *saubhagam*—all-blissful; *alam*—without hesitation; *bhajate*—worships; *anuraktā*—being attached; *tasya*—His; *aham*—myself; *abja*—lotus flower; *kuliça*—thunderbolt; *aṅkuça*—rod for driving elephants; *ketu*—flag; *ketaiù*—impressions; *çrémat*—the owner of all opulence; *padaiù*—by the soles of the feet; *bhagavataù*—of the Personality of Godhead; *samalaikāta-aigé*—one whose body is so decorated; *trén*—three; *ati*—superseding; *aroce*—beautifully decorated; *upalabhya*—having obtained; *tataù*—thereafter; *vibhūtim*—specific powers; *lokān*—planetary systems; *saù*—He; *mām*—me; *vyasājat*—gave up; *utsmayatém*—while feeling proud; *tat-ante*—at the end.

TRANSLATION

Lakṣmījé, the goddess of fortune, whose glance of grace was sought by demigods like Brahmā and for whom they surrendered many a day unto the Personality of Godhead, gave up her own abode in the forest of lotus flowers and engaged herself in the service of the lotus feet of the Lord. I was endowed with specific powers to supersede the fortune of all the three planetary systems by being decorated with the impressions of the flag, thunderbolt, elephant-driving rod and lotus flower, which are signs of the lotus feet of the Lord. But at the end, when I felt I was so fortunate, the Lord left me.

PURPORT

The beauty and opulence of the world can be enhanced by the grace of the Lord and not by any man-made planning. When the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa was present on this earth, the impressions of the special signs of His lotus feet were stamped on the dust, and as a result of this specific grace, the whole earth was made as perfect as possible. In other words, the rivers, the seas, the forests, the hills and the mines, which are the supplying agents for the necessities of men and animals, were fully discharging their respective duties. Therefore the riches of the world surpassed all the riches of all other planets in the three planetary systems of the universe. One should, therefore, ask that the grace of the Lord always be present on earth so that we may be favored with His causeless mercy and be happy, having all

necessities of life. One may ask how we can detain the Supreme Lord on this earth after His mission is fulfilled and He has left this earth for His own abode. The answer is that there is no need to detain the Lord. The Lord, being omnipresent, can be present with us if we want Him at all. By His omnipresence, He can always be with us if we are attached to His devotional service by hearing, chanting, remembering, etc.

There is nothing in the world with which the Lord is disconnected. The only thing we must learn is to excavate the source of connection and thus be linked with Him by offenseless service. We can be connected with Him by the transcendental sound representation of the Lord. The holy name of the Lord and the Lord Himself are identical, and one who chants the holy name of the Lord in an offenseless manner can at once realize that the Lord is present before him. Even by the vibration of radio sound, we can partially realize sound relativity, and by resounding the sound of transcendence we can verily feel the presence of the Lord. In this age, when everything is polluted by the contamination of Kali, it is instructed in the scriptures and preached by Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu that by chanting the holy name of the Lord, we can at once be free from contamination and gradually rise to the status of transcendence and go back to Godhead. The offenseless chanter of the holy name of the Lord is as auspicious as the Lord Himself, and the movement of pure devotees of the Lord all over the world can at once change the troublesome face of the world. Only by the propagation of the chanting of the holy name of the Lord can we be immune from all effects of the age of Kali.

TEXT 34

**Yaae vE MaMaaiTa>arMaaSaurv&Xaraja,
Ma+aaEih<aqXaTaMaPaaNaudaTMaTaN}a")
Tva& du"SQaMaUNaPadMaaTMaiNa PaaEāze<a
SaMPaadYaNa(Yaduzu rMYaMaib>a]d®Ma()) 34))**

yo vai mamätibharam āsura-vaàça-räjäam

akñauhiëé-çatam apānudad ātma-tantrau

tvää duùstham üna-padam ätmani pauruñeëa

sampädayan yaduñu ramyam abibhrad aìgam

SYNONYMS

yaù—He who; *vai*—certainly; *mama*—mine; *ati-bharam*—too burdensome; *äsuravaàça*—unbelievers; *räjjäm*—of the kings; **akñauhiëë*—one military division; *çatam*—hundreds of such divisions; *apänudat*—extirpated; *ätma-tantraù*—self-sufficient; *tväm*—unto you; *duùstham*—put into difficulty; *üna-padam*—devoid of strength to stand; *ätmani*—internal; *pauruñeëa*—by dint of energy; *sampädayan*—for executing; *yaduñu*—in the Yadu dynasty; *ramyam*—transcendentally beautiful; *abibhrat*—accepted; *aìgam*—body.

TRANSLATION

O personality of religion, I was greatly overburdened by the undue military phalanxes arranged by atheistic kings, and I was relieved by the grace of the Personality of Godhead. Similarly you were also in a distressed condition, weakened in your standing strength, and thus He also incarnated by His internal energy in the family of the Yadus to relieve you.

PURPORT

The *asuras* want to enjoy a life of sense gratification, even at the cost of others' happiness. In order to fulfill this ambition, the *asuras*, especially atheistic kings or state executive heads, try to equip themselves with all kinds of deadly weapons to bring about a war in a peaceful society. They have no ambition other than personal aggrandizement, and thus mother earth feels overburdened by such undue increases of military strength. By increase of the asuric population, those who follow the principles of religion become unhappy, especially the devotees, or *devas*.

In such a situation, the Personality of Godhead incarnates to vanquish the unwanted *asuras* and to reestablish the true principles of religion. This was

the mission of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and He fulfilled it.

TEXT 35

k-a va SaheTa ivrh& PauāzaetaMaSYa
Pa[eMaavl/aek-āicriSMaTavLGauJaLPaE")
SQaEYa | SaMaaNaMahrNMaDauMaaiNaNaqNaa&
raeMaaeTSavae MaMa Yadx(iga]iv\$=iāTaaYaa")) 35))

kā vā saheta virahaà puruñottamasya

premāvaloka-rucira-smita-valgu-jalpaiù

sthairyaà samānam aharan madhu-māninénää

romotsavo mama yad-aighri-viöaikitäyäu

SYNONYMS

kā—who; *vā*—either; *saheta*—can tolerate; *viraham*—separation; *puruṣa-uttamasya*—of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; *prema*—loving; *avaloka*—glancing; *rucira-smita*—pleasing smile; *valgu-jalpaiù*—heartly appeals; *sthairyam*—gravity; *sa-mānam*—along with passionate wrath; *aharat*—conquered; *madhu*—sweethearts; *māninénäm*—women such as Satyabhāmā; *roma-utsavaù*—hair standing on end out of pleasure; *mama*—mine; *yat*—whose; *aighri*—feet; *viöaikitäyäu*—imprinted with.

TRANSLATION

Who, therefore, can tolerate the pangs of separation from that Supreme Personality of Godhead? He could conquer the gravity and passionate wrath of His sweethearts like Satyabhāmā by His sweet smile of love, pleasing glance and hearty appeals. When He traversed my [earth's] surface, I would be immersed in the dust of His lotus feet and thus would be sumptuously covered with grass which appeared like hairs standing on me out of pleasure.

PURPORT

There were chances of separation between the Lord and His thousands of queens because of the Lord's being absent from home, but as far as His connection with earth was concerned, the Lord would traverse the earth with His lotus feet, and therefore there was no chance of separation. When the Lord left the surface of the earth to return to His spiritual abode, the earth's feelings of separation were therefore more acute.

TEXT 36

**TaYaaerev& k-QaYaTaae" Pa*iQavqDaMaRYaaeSTada)
Parqi+aàaMa raJaizR" Pa[aa" Pa[acq& SarSvTaqMa()) 36))**

tayor evaà kathayatoù

pāthivé-dharmayos tadā

parékñin nāma rājarñiù

prāptaù prācém sarasvatém

SYNONYMS

tayou—between them; *evam*—thus; *kathayatoù*—engaged in conversation; *pāthivé*—earth; *dharmayo*—and the personality of religion; *tadā*—at that time; *parékñit*—King Parékñit; *nāma*—of the name; *rāja-āñiù*—a saint amongst kings; *prāptaù*—arrived; *prācém*—flowing towards the east; *sarasvatém*—River Sarasvaté.

TRANSLATION

While the earth and the personality of religion were thus engaged in conversation, the saintly King Parékñit reached the shore of the Sarasvaté River, which flowed towards the east.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Sixteenth Chapter,

of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled “How Parékñit Received the Age of Kali.”

Chapter Seventeen

Punishment and Reward of Kali

TEXT 1

SaUTa ovac

Ta}a GaaeiMaQauNa& raJaa hNYaMaaNaMaNaaQavTa()
d<@hSTa& c v*zl&/ dd*Xae Na*Pal/aH^NaMa()) 1))

süta uväca

tatra go-mithunaà räjä

hanyamānam anāthavat

daëò-a-hastaà ca vāñalaà

dadâçe nâpa-läïchanam

SYNONYMS

sütaù uväca—Sri Süta Gosvami said; *tatra*—thereupon; *go-mithunam*—a cow and a bull; *räjä*—the King; *hanyamānam*—being beaten; *anātha-vat*—appearing to be bereft of their owner; *daëò-a-hastam*—with a club in hand; *ca*—also; *vāñalam*—lower-caste çüdra; *dadâçe*—observed; *nâpa*—a king; *läïchanam*—dressed like.

TRANSLATION

Süta Gosvami said: After reaching that place, Mahäräja Parékñit observed that a lower-caste çüdra, dressed like a king, was beating a cow and a bull with a club, as if they had no owner.

PURPORT

The principal sign of the age of Kali is that lower-caste *sudras*, i.e., men without brahminical culture and spiritual initiation, will be dressed like administrators or kings, and the principal business of such non-*kñatriya* rulers will be to kill the innocent animals, especially the cows and the bulls, who shall be unprotected by their masters, the bona fide *vaisyas*, the mercantile community. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.44), it is said that the *vaisyas* are meant to deal in agriculture, cow protection and trade. In the age of Kali, the degraded *vaisyas*, the mercantile men, are engaged in supplying cows to slaughterhouses. The *kṣatriyas* are meant to protect the citizens of the state, whereas the *vaisyas* are meant to protect the cows and bulls and utilize them to produce grains and milk. The cow is meant to deliver milk, and the bull is meant to produce grains. But in the age of Kali, the *çüdra* class of men are in the posts of administrators, and the cows and bulls, or the mothers and the fathers, unprotected by the *vaisyas*, are subjected to the slaughterhouses organized by the *çüdra* administrators.

TEXT 2

v*z& Ma*<aal/Davl&/ MaehNTaiMav ib>YaTaMa()
vePaMaaNa& PadEke-Na SaqdNTa& éUd]Taai@TaMa()) 2))

vãñaà mãëäla-dhavalaa

mehantam iva bibhyatam

vepamãnaà padaikena

sédantaà çüdra-täòitam

SYNONYMS

vãñam—the bull; *mãëäla-dhavalam*—as white as a white lotus;
mehantam—urinating; *iva*—as if; *bibhyatam*—being too afraid;
vepamãnam—trembling; *padä ekena*—standing on only one leg;
sédantam—terrified; *çüdra-täòitam*—being beaten by a *çüdra*.

TRANSLATION

The bull was as white as a white lotus flower. He was terrified of the çüdra who was beating him, and he was so afraid that he was standing on one leg, trembling and urinating.

PURPORT

The next symptom of the age of Kali is that principles of religion, which are all spotlessly white, like the white lotus flower, will be attacked by the uncultured çüdra population of the age. They may be descendants of *brahmana* or *kñatriya* forefathers, but in the age of Kali, for want of sufficient education and culture of Vedic wisdom, such a çüdra-like population will defy the principles of religion, and persons who are religiously endowed will be terrified by such men. They will declare themselves as adherents of no religious principles, and many “isms” and cults will spring up in Kali-yuga only to kill the spotless bull of religion. The state will be declared to be secular, or without any particular principle of religion, and as a result there will be total indifference to the principles of religion. The citizens will be free to act as they like, without respect for *sādhu*, *çāstra* and *guru*. The bull standing on one leg indicates that the principles of religion are gradually diminishing. Even the fragmental existence of religious principles will be embarrassed by so many obstacles as if in the trembling condition of falling down at any time.

TEXT 3

Gaa& c DaMaRdugaa& dqNaa& >a*Xa& éUd]PadahTaaMa()
ivvTSaaMaaé[uvdNaa& +aaMaa& YavSaiMaC^TaqMa()) 3))

gää ca dharma-dughää dénää

bhåçaa çüdra-padāhatām

vivatsām āçru-vadanää

kñämää yavasam icchatém

SYNONYMS

gām—the cow; *ca*—also; *dharma-dughām*—beneficial because one can draw religion from her; *dénām*—now rendered poor; *bhāṣam*—distressed; *çüdra*—the lower caste; *pada-āhatām*—beaten on the legs; *vivatsām*—without any calf; *āçru-vadanām*—with tears in her eyes; *kñāmām*—very weak; *yavasam*—grass; *icchatém*—as if desiring to have some grass to eat.

TRANSLATION

Although the cow is beneficial because one can draw religious principles from her, she was now rendered poor and calfless. Her legs were being beaten by a çüdra. There were tears in her eyes, and she was distressed and weak. She was hankering after some grass in the field.

PURPORT

The next symptom of the age of Kali is the distressed condition of the cow. Milking the cow means drawing the principles of religion in a liquid form. The great *āñis* and *munis* would live only on milk. Srila Çukadeva Gosvami would go to a householder while he was milking a cow, and he would simply take a little quantity of it for subsistence. Even fifty years ago, no one would deprive a *sādhū* of a quart or two of milk, and every householder would give milk like water. For a Sanātanist (a follower of Vedic principles) it is the duty of every householder to have cows and bulls as household paraphernalia, not only for drinking milk, but also for deriving religious principles. The Sanātanist worships cows on religious principles and respects *brahmanas*. The cow's milk is required for the sacrificial fire, and by performing sacrifices the householder can be happy. The cow's calf not only is beautiful to look at, but also gives satisfaction to the cow, and so she delivers as much milk as possible. But in the Kali-yuga, the calves are separated from the cows as early as possible for purposes which may not be mentioned in these pages of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. The cow stands with tears in her eyes, the *çüdra* milkman draws milk from the cow artificially, and when there is no milk the cow is sent to be slaughtered. These greatly sinful acts are responsible for all the troubles in present society. People do not know what they are doing in the name of economic development. The

influence of Kali will keep them in the darkness of ignorance. Despite all endeavors for peace and prosperity, they must try to see the cows and the bulls happy in all respects. Foolish people do not know how one earns happiness by making the cows and bulls happy, but it is a fact by the law of nature. Let us take it from the authority of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* and adopt the principles for the total happiness of humanity.

TEXT 4

PaPa[C^ rQaMaaæ!" k-aTaRSvrPairC^dMa()
MaegaGaM>aqrYaa vaca SaMaaraeiPaTak-aMauRk-")) 4))

papraccha ratham ärüðhaù

kārtasvara-paricchadam

megha-gambhērayā vācā

samāropita-kārmukaù

SYNONYMS

papraccha—inquired; *ratham*—chariot; *ärüðhaù*—seated on; *kārtasvara*—gold; *paricchadam*—embossed with; *megha*—cloud; *gambhērayā*—exonerating; *vācā*—sound; *samāropita*—well equipped; *kārmukaù*—arrows and bow.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Parékñit, well equipped with arrows and bow and seated on a gold-embossed chariot, spoke to him [the çüdra] with a deep voice sounding like thunder.

PURPORT

An administrative head or king like Mahārāja Parékñit, with full majestic authority, well equipped with weapons to chastise miscreants, can

challenge the agents of the age of Kali. Then only will it be possible to counteract the degraded age. And in the absence of such strong executive heads, there is always disruption of tranquillity. The elected show-bottle executive head, as representative of a degraded public, cannot be equal with a strong king like Mahārāja Parékñit. The dress or style of royal order does not count. It is one's actions which are counted.

TEXT 5

k-STv& MaC^r<ae l/aeke- bl/aÖ&SYabl/aNa(bl/l)
Nardevae_iSa veze<a Na\$=vTk-MaR<aaiÜJa")) 5))

kas tvaà mac-charaëe loke

baläd dhaàsya abalän balé

nara-devo 'si veñeëa

naöavat karmaëädvijaù

SYNONYMS

kaù—who are; *tvam*—you; *mat*—my; *çaraëe*—under protection; *loke*—in this world; *balät*—by force; *haàsi*—killing; *abalän*—those who are helpless; *balé*—although full of strength; *nara-devaù*—man-god; *asi*—appear to be; *veñeëa*—by your dress; *naöa-vat*—like a theatrical player; *karmaëä*—by deeds; *advi-jaù*—a man not twice-born by culture.

TRANSLATION

Oh, who are you? You appear to be strong and yet you dare kill, within my protection, those who are helpless! By your dress you pose yourself to be a godly man [king], but by your deeds you are opposing the principles of the twice-born kṣatriyas.

PURPORT

The *brahmanas*, *kṣatriyas* and *vaisyas* are called twice-born because for these higher classes of men there is one birth by parental conjugation and there is another birth of cultural rejuvenation by spiritual initiation from the bona fide *ācārya*, or spiritual master. So a *kñātriya* is also twice-born like a *brahmana*, and his duty is to give protection to the helpless. The *kñātriya* king is considered to be the representative of God to give protection to the helpless and chastise the miscreants. Whenever there are anomalies in this routine work by the administrators, there is an incarnation of the Lord to reestablish the principles of a godly kingdom. In the age of Kali, the poor helpless animals, especially the cows, which are meant to receive all sorts of protection from the administrative heads, are killed without restriction. Thus the administrative heads under whose noses such things happen are representatives of God in name only. Such powerful administrators are rulers of the poor citizens by dress or office, but factually they are worthless, lower-class men without the cultural assets of the twice-born. No one can expect justice or equality of treatment from once-born (spiritually uncultured) lower-class men. Therefore in the age of Kali everyone is unhappy due to the maladministration of the state. The modern human society is not twice-born by spiritual culture. Therefore the people's government, by the people who are not twice-born, must be a government of Kali in which everyone is unhappy.

TEXT 6

**YaSTv& k*-Z<ae GaTae dUr& SahGaa<@qvDaNvNaa)
XaaeCYaae_SYaXaaeCYaaNa(rhiSa Pa[hrNa(vDaMahRiSa)) 6))**

yas tvaà kñēe gate dūraà

saha-gäëòéva-dhanvanä

çocyô 'sy açocyän rahasi

praharan vadham arhasi

SYNONYMS

yaù—on account of; *tvam*—you rogue; *kāñēe*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *gate*—having gone away; *dūram*—out of sight; *saha*—along with; *gäëðéva*—the bow named Gäëðéva; *dhanvanä*—the carrier, Arjuna; *çocyaù*—culprit; *asi*—you are considered; *açocyän*—innocent; *rahasi*—in a secluded place; *praharan*—beating; *vadham*—to be killed; *arhasi*—deserve.

TRANSLATION

You rogue, do you dare beat an innocent cow because Lord Kṛṣṇa and Arjuna, the carrier of the Gäëðéva bow, are out of sight? Since you are beating the innocent in a secluded place, you are considered a culprit and therefore deserve to be killed.

PURPORT

In a civilization where God is conspicuously banished, and there is no devotee warrior like Arjuna, the associates of the age of Kali take advantage of this lawless kingdom and arrange to kill innocent animals like the cow in secluded slaughterhouses. Such murderers of animals stand to be condemned to death by the order of a pious king like Mahārāja Parékñit. For a pious king, the culprit who kills an animal in a secluded place is punishable by the death penalty, exactly like a murderer who kills an innocent child in a secluded place.

TEXT 7

**Tv& va Ma*<aal/Davl/" PaadENYaURNa" Pada crNa()
v*zæPae<a ik&- k-iêd(devae Na" Pair%edYaNa()) 7))**

tvaà vâ mãëäla-dhavalau

pädair nyünaù padä caran

vãña-rüpeëa kià kaçcid

devo naù parikhedayan

SYNONYMS

tvam—you; *vä*—either; *māëäla-dhavalau*—as white as a lotus; *pādaiù*—of three legs; *nyūnaù*—being deprived; *padä*—on one leg; *caran*—moving; *vāñä*—bull; *rūpeëa*—in the form of; *kim*—whether; *kaçcit*—someone; *devau*—demigod; *naù*—us; *parikhedayan*—causing grief.

TRANSLATION

Then he [Mahārāja Parékñit] asked the bull: Oh, who are you? Are you a bull as white as a white lotus, or are you a demigod? You have lost three of your legs and are moving on only one. Are you some demigod causing us grief in the form of a bull?

PURPORT

At least up to the time of Mahārāja Parékñit, no one could imagine the wretched conditions of the cow and the bull. Mahārāja Parékñit, therefore, was astonished to see such a horrible scene. He inquired whether the bull was not a demigod assuming such a wretched condition to indicate the future of the cow and the bull.

TEXT 8

**Na JaaTau k-aErveNd]a<aa& daedR<@PairriM>aTae)
>aUTale/_NauPaTaNTYaiSMaNa(ivNaa Tae Pa[ai<aNaa& éuc")) 8))**

na jätu kauravendräëää

dordaëòa-parirambhite

bhü-tale 'nupatanty asmin

vinä te präëinäà çucaù

SYNONYMS

na—not; *jätu*—at any time; *kaurava-indräääm*—of the kings in the Kuru dynasty; *dordaëða*—strength of arms; *parirambhite*—protected by; *bhü-tale*—on the surface of the earth; *anupatanti*—grieving; *asmin*—up till now; *vinä*—save and except; *te*—you; *präëinäm*—of the living being; *çucaù*—tears in the eyes.

TRANSLATION

Now for the first time in a kingdom well protected by the arms of the kings of the Kuru dynasty, I see you grieving with tears in your eyes. Up till now no one on earth has ever shed tears because of royal negligence.

PURPORT

The protection of the lives of both the human beings and the animals is the first and foremost duty of a government. A government must not discriminate in such principles. It is simply horrible for a pure-hearted soul to see organized animal-killing by the state in this age of Kali. Mahārāja Parékñit was lamenting for the tears in the eyes of the bull, and he was astonished to see such an unprecedented thing in his good kingdom. Men and animals were equally protected as far as life was concerned. That is the way in God’s kingdom.

TEXT 9

**Maa SaaEr>aeYaa}a éucaē VYaeTau Tae v*zl/ad(>aYaMa()
Maa raedqrMb >ad]& Tae %l/aNaa& MaiYa XaaSTair)) 9))**

mä saurabheyätra çuco

vyetu te vñäläd bhayam

mä rodér amba bhadraà te

khalänäà mayi çästari

SYNONYMS

mä—do not; *saurabheya*—O son of Surabhi; *atra*—in my kingdom; *çucaù*—lamentation; *vyetu*—let there be; *te*—your; *vãñalät*—by the *çüdra*; *bhayam*—cause of fear; *mä*—do not; *rodéù*—cry; *amba*—mother cow; *bhadram*—all good; *te*—unto you; *khalänäm*—of the envious; *mayi*—while I am living; *çästari*—the ruler or subduer.

TRANSLATION

O son of Surabhi, you need lament no longer now. There is no need to fear this low-class çüdra. And, O mother cow, as long as I am living as the ruler and subduer of all envious men, there is no cause for you to cry. Everything will be good for you.

PURPORT

Protection of bulls and cows and all other animals can be possible only when there is a state ruled by an executive head like Mahäräja Parékñit. Mahäräja Parékñit addresses the cow as mother, for he is a cultured, twice-born, *kñatriya* king. *Surabhi* is the name of the cows which exist in the spiritual planets and are especially reared by Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa Himself. As men are made after the form and features of the Supreme Lord, so also the cows are made after the form and features of the *surabhi* cows in the spiritual kingdom. In the material world the human society gives all protection to the human being, but there is no law to protect the descendants of Surabhi, who can give all protection to men by supplying the miracle food, milk. But Mahäräja Parékñit and the Pääòavas were fully conscious of the importance of the cow and bull, and they were prepared to punish the cow-killer with all chastisement, including death. There has sometimes been agitation for the protection of the cow, but for want of pious executive heads and suitable laws, the cow and the bull are not given protection. The human society should recognize the importance of the cow and the bull and thus give all protection to these important animals, following in the footsteps of Mahäräja Parékñit. For protecting the cows and brahminical culture, the Lord, who is very kind to the cow and the *brahmanas* (*go-brahmana-hitäya*), will be pleased with us and will bestow upon us real peace.

TEXTS 10–11

YaSYa raí\e Pa[Jaa" SavaRñSYaNTae SaaDvYaSaaDau>a")
TaSYa MataSYa NaXYaiNTa k-liTaRraYau>aRGaae GaiTa")) 10))
Wz raja& Parae DaMaaeR àaTaaRNaaMaaiTaRiNaGa]h")
ATa WNa& viDaZYaaMa >aUTad]uhMaSataMaMa()) 11))

yasya räñöre prajäù sarväs

trasyante sädhvy asädhubhiù

tasya mattasya naçyanti

kértir äyur bhago gatiù

eña räjiäà paro dharmo

hy ärtänäm ärti-nigrahaù

ata enaà vadhiñyämi

bhüta-druham asattamam

SYNONYMS

yasya—one whose; *räñöre*—in the state; *prajäù*—living beings; *sarväu*—one and all; *trasyante*—are terrified; *sädhvi*—O chaste one; *asädhubhiù*—by the miscreants; *tasya*—his; *mattasya*—of the illusioned; *naçyanti*—vanishes; *kértiù*—fame; *äyuù*—duration of life; *bhagaù*—fortune; *gatiù*—good rebirth; *eñaù*—these are; *räjiäm*—of the kings; *paraù*—superior; *dharmaù*—occupation; *hi*—certainly; *ärtänäm*—of the sufferers; *ärti*—sufferings; *nigrahaù*—subduing; *ataù*—therefore; *enam*—this man; *vadhiñyämi*—I shall kill; *bhüta-druham*—revolter against other living beings; *asat-tamam*—the most wretched.

TRANSLATION

O chaste one, the king's good name, duration of life and good rebirth vanish when all kinds of living beings are terrified by miscreants in his kingdom. It is certainly the prime duty of the king to subdue first the sufferings of those who suffer. Therefore I must kill this most wretched man because he is violent against other living beings.

PURPORT

When there is some disturbance caused by wild animals in a village or town, the police or others take action to kill them. Similarly, it is the duty of the government to kill at once all bad social elements such as thieves, dacoits and murderers. The same punishment is also due to animal-killers because the animals of the state are also the *prajā*. *Prajā* means one who has taken birth in the state, and this includes both men and animals. Any living being who takes birth in a state has the primary right to live under the protection of the king. The jungle animals are also subject to the king, and they also have a right to live. So what to speak of domestic animals like the cows and bulls.

Any living being, if he terrifies other living beings, is a most wretched subject, and the king should at once kill such a disturbing element. As the wild animal is killed when it creates disturbances, similarly any man who unnecessarily kills or terrifies the jungle animals or other animals must be punished at once. By the law of the Supreme Lord, all living beings, in whatever shape they may be, are the sons of the Lord, and no one has any right to kill another animal, unless it is so ordered by the codes of natural law. The tiger can kill a lower animal for his subsistence, but a man cannot kill an animal for his subsistence. That is the law of God, who has created the law that a living being subsists by eating another living being. Thus the vegetarians are also living by eating other living beings. Therefore, the law is that one should live only by eating specific living beings, as ordained by the law of God. The *Ēcōpaniñad* directs that one should live by the direction of the Lord and not at one's sweet will. A man can subsist on varieties of grains, fruits and milk ordained by God, and there is no need of animal food, save and except in particular cases.

The illusioned king or executive head, even though sometimes advertised

as a great philosopher and learned scholar, will allow slaughterhouses in the state without knowing that torturing poor animals clears the way to hell for such foolish kings or executive heads. The executive head must always be alert to the safety of the *prajās*, both man and animal, and inquire whether a particular living being is harassed at any place by another living being. The harassing living being must at once be caught and put to death, as shown by Mahārāja Parékñit.

The people's government, or government by the people, should not allow killing of innocent animals by the sweet will of foolish government men. They must know the codes of God, as mentioned in the revealed scriptures. Mahārāja Parékñit quotes here that according to the codes of God the irresponsible king or state executive jeopardizes his good name, duration of life, power and strength and ultimately his progressive march towards a better life and salvation after death. Such foolish men do not even believe in the existence of a next life.

While commenting on this particular verse, we have in our presence the statement of a great modern politician who has recently died and left his will, which discloses his poor fund of knowledge of the codes of God mentioned by Mahārāja Parékñit. The politician was so ignorant of the codes of God that he writes: "I do not believe in any such ceremonies, and to submit to them, even as a matter of form, would be hypocrisy and an attempt to delude ourselves and others... I have no religious sentiment in the matter."

Contrasting these statements of a great politician in the modern age with those of Mahārāja Parékñit, we find a vast difference. Mahārāja Parékñit was pious according to the scriptural codes, whereas the modern politician goes by his personal belief and sentiments. Any great man of the material world is, after all, a conditioned soul. He is bound by his hands and feet by the ropes of material nature, and still the foolish conditioned soul thinks of himself as free to act by his whimsical sentiments. The conclusion is that people in the time of Mahārāja Parékñit were happy, and the animals were given proper protection because the executive head was not whimsical or ignorant of God's law. Foolish, faithless creatures try to avoid the existence of the Lord and proclaim themselves secular at the cost of valuable human

life. The human life is especially meant for knowing the science of God, but foolish creatures, especially in this age of Kali, instead of knowing God scientifically, make propaganda against religious belief as well as the existence of God, even though they are always bound by the laws of God by the symptoms of birth, death, old age and disease.

TEXT 12

**k-ae_v*êTa(Tav Paada&ñqNa(SaaEr>aeYa cTauZPad)
Maa >aUv&STvad*Xaa raí\ e raja& k*-Z<aaNauviTaRNaaMa()) 12))**

ko 'vâçcat tava pädäàs trén

saurabheya catuñ-pada

mä bhüvaàs tvädâçä räñöre

räjjäà kãñëänuvartinäm

SYNONYMS

kaù—who is he; *avâçcat*—cut off; *tava*—your; *pädän*—legs; *trén*—three; *saurabheya*—O son of Surabhi; *catuñ-pada*—you are four-legged; *mä*—never to be; *bhüvan*—it so happened; *tvädâçäù*—as yourself; *räñöre*—in the state; *räjjäam*—of the kings; *kãñëa-anuvartinäm*—those who follow the codes of Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

He [Mahārāja Parékñit] repeatedly addressed and questioned the bull thus: O son of Surabhi, who has cut off your three legs? In the state of the kings who are obedient to the laws of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Kṛṣṇa, there is no one as unhappy as you.

PURPORT

The kings or the executive heads of all states must know the codes of Lord

Kṛṣṇa (generally *Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam*) and must act accordingly in order to fulfill the mission of human life, which is to make an end to all miseries of material conditions. One who knows the codes of Lord Kṛṣṇa can achieve this end without any difficulty. In the *Bhagavad-gita*, in a synopsis, we can understand the codes of Godhead, and in the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* the same codes are explained further.

In a state where the codes of Kṛṣṇa are followed, no one is unhappy. Where such codes are not followed, the first sign is that three legs of the representative of religion are cut off, and thereby all miseries follow. When Kṛṣṇa was personally present, the codes of Kṛṣṇa were being followed without question, but in His absence such codes are presented in the pages of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* for the guidance of the blind persons who happen to be at the helm of all affairs.

TEXT 13

Aa:Yaaih v*z >ad]& v" SaaDaUNaaMak*-TaaGaSaaMa()
AaTMavEæPYak-TaaRr& PaaQaaRNaa& k-liTaRdUz<aMa()) 13))

ākhyāhi vāṇa bhadraà vaù

sādhünām akātagasām

ātma-vairūpya-kartāraà

pārthānāà kērti-dūṇaëam

SYNONYMS

ākhyāhi—just let me know; *vāṇa*—O bull; *bhadram*—good; *vaù*—for you; *sādhünām*—of the honest; *akāta-āgasām*—of those who are offenseless; *ātma-vairūpya*—deformation of the self; *kartāram*—the doer; *pārthānām*—of the sons of Pāthā; *kērti-dūṇaëam*—blackmailing the reputation.

TRANSLATION

O bull, you are offenseless and thoroughly honest; therefore I wish all good to you. Please tell me of the perpetrator of these mutilations, which blackmail the reputation of the sons of Pāthā.

PURPORT

The reputation of the reign of Mahārāja Rāmacandra and that of the kings who followed in the footsteps of Mahārāja Rāmacandra, like the Pāëðavas and their descendants, are never to be forgotten because in their kingdom offenseless and honest living beings were never in trouble. The bull and the cow are the symbols of the most offenseless living beings because even the stool and urine of these animals are utilized to benefit human society. The descendants of the sons of Pāthā, like Mahārāja Parékñit, were afraid of losing their reputations, but in the modern days the leaders are not even afraid of killing such offenseless animals. Herein lies the difference between the reign of those pious kings and the modern states ruled by irresponsible executive heads without knowledge of the codes of God.

TEXT 14

**JaNae_NaaGaSYaga& YauĀNa(SavRTaae_SYa c MaÛYaMa()
SaaDaUNaa& >ad]Maev SYaadSaaDaudMaNae k*-Tae)) 14))**

jane 'nāgasy aghaà yuijan

sarvato 'sya ca mad-bhayam

sādhünāà bhadram eva syād

asādhu-damane kâte

SYNONYMS

jane—to the living beings; *anāgasi*—those who are offenseless; *agham*—sufferings; *yuijan*—by applying; *sarvataù*—anywhere and everywhere; *asya*—of such offenders; *ca*—and; *mat-bhayam*—fear me; *sādhünām*—of the honest persons; *bhadram*—good fortune; *eva*—certainly; *syāt*—will

take place; *asādhū*—dishonest miscreants; *damane*—curbed; *kāte*—being so done.

TRANSLATION

Whoever causes offenseless living beings to suffer must fear me anywhere and everywhere in the world. By curbing dishonest miscreants, one automatically benefits the offenseless.

PURPORT

Dishonest miscreants flourish because of cowardly and impotent executive heads of state. But when the executive heads are strong enough to curb all sorts of dishonest miscreants, in any part of the state, certainly they cannot flourish. When the miscreants are punished in an exemplary manner, automatically all good fortune follows. As said before, it is the prime duty of the king or the executive head to give protection in all respects to the peaceful, offenseless citizens of the state. The devotees of the Lord are by nature peaceful and offenseless, and therefore it is the prime duty of the state to arrange to convert everyone to become a devotee of the Lord. Thus automatically there will be peaceful, offenseless citizens. Then the only duty of the king will be to curb the dishonest miscreants. That will bring about peace and harmony all over human society.

TEXT 15

**ANaaGa"iSvh >aUTaezu Ya AaGaSk*-iàrx(ku-Xa")
AahTaaRiSMa >auJa& Saa+aadMaTYaRSYaaiPa Saa®dMa()) 15))**

anāgaùsv iha bhüteñu

ya āgas-kān niraikuçaù

āhartāsmi bhujaà sākñād

amartyasyāpi sāigadam

SYNONYMS

anägaùsu iha—to the offenseless; *bhüteñu*—living beings; *yaù*—the person; *ägaù-kât*—commits offense; *niraikuçaù*—upstart; *ähartä asmi*—I shall bring forth; *bhujam*—arms; *säkñät*—directly; *amartyasya api*—even one who is a demigod; *sa-aigadam*—with decorations and armor.

TRANSLATION

An upstart living being who commits offenses by torturing those who are offenseless shall be directly uprooted by me, even though he be a denizen of heaven with armor and decorations.

PURPORT

The denizens of the heavenly kingdom are called *amara*, or deathless, due to their possessing a long span of life, far greater than that of the human beings. For a human being, who has only a maximum one-hundred-year duration of life, a span of life spreading over millions of years is certainly considered to be deathless. For example, from the *Bhagavad-gita* we learn that on the Brahmaloka planet the duration of one day is calculated to be 4,300,000 x 1,000 solar years. Similarly, in other heavenly planets one day is calculated to be six months of this planet, and the inhabitants get a life of ten million of their years. Therefore, in all higher planets, since the span of life is far greater than that of the human being, the denizens are called deathless by imagination, although actually no one within the material universe is deathless.

Mahäräja Parékñit challenges even such denizens of heaven if they torture the offenseless. This means that the state executive head must be as strong as Mahäräja Parékñit so that he may be determined to punish the strongest offenders. It should be the principle of a state executive head that the offender of the codes of God is always punished.

TEXT 16

rajae ih ParMaae DaMaR" SvDaMaRSQaaNauPaal/NaMa()

XaaSaTaae_NYaaNa(YaQaaXaañMaNaaPaûTPaQaaINah)) 16))

räjjio hi paramo dharmaù

sva-dharma-sthänupälanam

çäsato 'nyän yathä-çästram

anäpady utpathän iha

SYNONYMS

räjjiaù—of the king or the executive head; *hi*—certainly; *paramaù*—supreme; *dharmaù*—occupational duty; *sva-dharma-stha*—one who is faithful to his prescribed duty; *anupälanam*—giving protection always; *çäsataù*—while ruling; *anyän*—others; *yathä*—according to; *çästram*—rulings of scriptures; *anäpadi*—without danger; *utpathän*—persons going astray; *iha*—as a matter of fact.

TRANSLATION

The supreme duty of the ruling king is to give all protection to law-abiding persons and to chastise those who stray from the ordinances of the scriptures in ordinary times, when there is no emergency.

PURPORT

In the scriptures there is mention of *äpad-dharma*, or occupational duty at times of extraordinary happenings. It is said that sometimes the great sage Viçvämitra had to live on the flesh of dogs in some extraordinary dangerous position. In cases of emergency, one may be allowed to live on the flesh of animals of all description, but that does not mean that there should be regular slaughterhouses to feed the animal-eaters and that this system should be encouraged by the state. No one should try to live on flesh in ordinary times simply for the sake of the palate. If anyone does so, the king or the executive head should punish him for gross enjoyment.

There are regular scriptural injunctions for different persons engaged in different occupational duties, and one who follows them is called *svadharma-stha*, or faithful in one's prescribed duties. In the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.48) it is advised that one should not give up his occupational prescribed duties, even if they are not always flawless. Such *sva-dharma* might be violated in cases of emergency, if one is forced by circumstances, but they cannot be violated in ordinary times. The state executive head is to see that such *sva-dharma* is not changed by the follower, whatever it may be, and he should give all protection to the follower of *sva-dharma*. The violator is subject to punishment in terms of the *çästra*, and the duty of the king is to see that everyone strictly follows his occupational duty, as prescribed in the scripture.

TEXT 17

DaMaR ovac

WTad(v" Paa<@veYaaNaa& Yauç-MaaTaaR>aYa& vc")
Yaeza& Gau<aGa<aE" k*-Z<aae daETYaadaE >aGavaNa(k*-Ta")) 17))

dharma uvāca

etat vaù päëðaveyänäà

yuktam ärtābhayaà vacaù

yeñäà guëa-gaëaiù kãñëo

dautyādaù bhagavän kãtaù

SYNONYMS

dharmaù uvāca—the personality of religion said; *etat*—all these; *vaù*—by you; *päëðaveyänäm*—of those who are in the Päëðava dynasty; *yuktam*—just befitting; *ärta*—the sufferer; *abhayam*—freedom from all fears; *vacaù*—speeches; *yeñäm*—those; *guëa-gaëaiù*—by the qualifications; *kãñëaù*—even Lord Kṛṣṇa; *dautya-ādaù*—the duty of a messenger, etc.; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *kãtaù*—performed.

TRANSLATION

The personality of religion said: These words just spoken by you befit a person of the Pääòava dynasty. Captivated by the devotional qualities of the Pääòavas, even Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, performed duties as a messenger.

PURPORT

The assurances and challenges made by Mahārāja Parékñit are never exaggerations of his real power. The Mahārāja said that even the denizens of heaven could not escape his stringent government if they were violators of religious principles. He was not falsely proud, for a devotee of the Lord is equally as powerful as the Lord or sometimes more powerful by His grace, and any promise made by a devotee, though it may be ordinarily very difficult to fulfill, is properly executed by the grace of the Lord. The Pääòavas, by their unalloyed devotional service and full surrender unto the Lord, made it possible for the Lord to become a chariot driver or sometimes their letter messenger. Such duties executed by the Lord for His devotee are always very pleasing to the Lord because the Lord wants to render service to His unalloyed devotee, whose life has no other engagement than to serve the Lord with full love and devotion. Mahārāja Parékñit, grandson of Arjuna, the celebrated friendly servitor of the Lord, was a pure devotee of the Lord like his grandfather, and therefore the Lord was always with him, even from the time when he was helplessly lying in the womb of his mother and was attacked by the blazing *brahmāstra* weapon of Aṣvatthāmā. A devotee is always under the protection of the Lord, and therefore the assurance of protection by Mahārāja Parékñit could never be without meaning. The personality of religion accepted this fact and thus thanked the King for his being true to his exalted position.

TEXT 18

Na vYa& ©e-XabqJaaNa YaTa" SYau" PauâzzR>a)
Pauâz& Ta& ivJaaNaqMaae vaKYa>aedivMaaeihTaa")) 18))

na vayaà kleṣa-béjāni

yataù syuù puruṣarñabha

puruṣaà taà vijānémo

vākya-bheda-vimohitāù

SYNONYMS

na—not; *vayam*—we; *kleṣa-béjāni*—the root cause of sufferings; *yataù*—wherefrom; *syuù*—it so happens; *puruṣa-āñabha*—O greatest of all human beings; *puruṣam*—the person; *tam*—that; *vijānémaù*—know; *vākya-bheda*—difference of opinion; *vimohitāù*—bewildered by.

TRANSLATION

O greatest among human beings, it is very difficult to ascertain the particular miscreant who has caused our sufferings, because we are bewildered by all the different opinions of theoretical philosophers.

PURPORT

There are many theoretical philosophers in the world who put forward their own theories of cause and effect especially about the cause of suffering and its effect on different living beings. Generally there are six great philosophers: Kaēāda, the author of Vaiṣeṇika philosophy; Gautama, the author of logic; Patañjali, the author of mystic *yoga*; Kapila, the author of Sāikhya philosophy; Jaimini, the author of Karma-mémāāsā; and Vyāsadeva, the author of Vedānta-darṣana.

Although the bull, or the personality of religion, and the cow, the personality of the earth, knew perfectly well that the personality of Kali was the direct cause of their sufferings, still, as devotees of the Lord, they knew well also that without the sanction of the Lord no one could inflict trouble upon them. According to the *Padma Purana*, our present trouble is due to the fructifying of seedling sins, but even those seedling sins also gradually fade away by execution of pure devotional service. Thus even if the devotees see the mischief-mongers, they do not accuse them for the

sufferings inflicted. They take it for granted that the mischief-monger is made to act by some indirect cause, and therefore they tolerate the sufferings, thinking them to be God-given in small doses, for otherwise the sufferings should have been greater.

Mahārāja Parékñit wanted to get a statement of accusation against the direct mischief-monger, but they declined to give it on the abovementioned grounds. Speculative philosophers, however, do not recognize the sanction of the Lord; they try to find out the cause of sufferings in their own way, as will be described in the following verses. According to Srila Jiva Gosvami, such speculators are themselves bewildered, and thus they cannot know that the ultimate cause of all causes is the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 19

ke-icd(ivk-LPavSaNaA AahuraTMaaNaMaaTMaNa")
dEvMaNYae_Pare k-MaR Sv>aavMaPare Pa[>auMa()) 19))

kecid vikalpa-vasanā

āhur ātmānam ātmanaù

daivam anye 'pare karma

svabhāvam apare prabhum

SYNONYMS

kecit—some of them; *vikalpa-vasanāù*—those who deny all kinds of duality; *āhuù*—declare; *ātmānam*—own self; *ātmanaù*—of the self; *daivam*—superhuman; *anye*—others; *apare*—someone else; *karma*—activity; *svabhāvam*—material nature; *apare*—many other; *prabhum*—authorities.

TRANSLATION

Some of the philosophers, who deny all sorts of duality, declare that one's

own self is responsible for his personal happiness and distress. Others say that superhuman powers are responsible, while yet others say that activity is responsible, and the gross materialists maintain that nature is the ultimate cause.

PURPORT

As referred to above, philosophers like Jaimini and his followers establish that fruitive activity is the root cause of all distress and happiness, and that even if there is a superior authority, some superhuman powerful God or gods, He or they are also under the influence of fruitive activity because they reward result according to one's action. They say that action is not independent because action is performed by some performer; therefore, the performer himself is the cause of his own happiness or distress. In the *Bhagavad-gita* (6.5) also it is confirmed that by one's mind, freed from material affection, one can deliver himself from the sufferings of material pangs. So one should not entangle oneself in matter by the mind's material affections. Thus one's own mind is one's friend or enemy in one's material happiness and distress.

Atheistic, materialistic Sāikhyaitees conclude that material nature is the cause of all causes. According to them, combinations of material elements are the causes of material happiness and distress, and disintegration of matter is the cause of freedom from all material pangs. Gautama and Kaēāda find that atomic combination is the cause of everything, and impersonalists like Añöāvakra discover that the spiritual effulgence of Brahman is the cause of all causes. But in the *Bhagavad-gita* the Lord Himself declares that He is the source of impersonal Brahman, and therefore He, the Personality of Godhead, is the ultimate cause of all causes. It is also confirmed in the *Brahma-saṃhitā* that Lord Kṛṣṇa is the ultimate cause of all causes.

TEXT 20

APa[TaKYaaRdiNadeRXYaaidiTa ke-ZviPa iNaêYa")
A}aaNauæPa& raJazeR ivMa*Xa SvMaNaqzYaa)) 20))

apratarkyād anirdeçyād

iti keñv api niçcayaù

atrānurüpaà räjarñe

vimāça sva-manéñayä

SYNONYMS

apratarkyāt—beyond the power of reasoning; *anirdeçyāt*—beyond the power of thinking; *iti*—thus; *keñu*—someone; *api*—also; *niçcayaù*—definitely concluded; *atra*—herein; *anurüpam*—which of them is right; *räja-āñe*—O sage amongst the kings; *vimāça*—judge yourself; *sva*—by your own; *manéñayä*—power of intelligence.

TRANSLATION

There are also some thinkers who believe that no one can ascertain the cause of distress by argumentation, nor know it by imagination, nor express it by words. O sage amongst kings, judge for yourself by thinking over all this with your own intelligence.

PURPORT

The Vaiñëavites, the devotees of the Lord, do believe, as above explained, that nothing can take place without the sanction of the Supreme Lord. He is the supreme director, for He confirms in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (15.15) that He, as all-pervading Paramātmä, stays in everyone’s heart and keeps vigilance over all actions and witnesses all activities. The argument of the atheist that one cannot be punished for one’s misdeeds unless proved before a qualified justice is refuted herein, for we accept the perpetual witness and constant companion of the living being. A living being may forget all that he might have done in his past or present life, but one must know that in the same tree of the material body, the individual soul and the Supreme Soul as Paramātmä are sitting like two birds. One of them, the living being, is enjoying the fruits of the tree, whereas the Supreme Being is

there to witness the activities. Therefore the Paramātmā feature, the Supreme Soul, is actually the witness of all activities of the living being, and only by His direction can the living being remember or forget what he might have done in the past. He is, therefore, both the all-pervading impersonal Brahman and the localized Paramātmā in everyone's heart. He is the knower of all past, present and future, and nothing can be concealed from Him. The devotees know this truth, and therefore they discharge their duties sincerely, without being overly anxious for rewards. Besides that, one cannot estimate the Lord's reactions, either by speculation or by scholarship. Why does He put some into difficulty and not others? He is the supreme knower of the Vedic knowledge, and thus He is the factual Vedāntist. At the same time He is the compiler of the *Vedānta*. No one is independent of Him, and everyone is engaged in His service in different ways. In the conditioned state, such services are rendered by the living being under force of the material nature, whereas in the liberated state the living being is helped by the spiritual nature in the voluntary loving service of the Lord. There is no incongruity or inebriety in His actions. All are on the path of Absolute Truth. Bhéñmadeva correctly estimated the inconceivable actions of the Lord. The conclusion is, therefore, that the sufferings of the representative of religion and the representative of the earth, as present before Mahārāja Parékñit, were planned to prove that Mahārāja Parékñit was the ideal executive head because he knew well how to give protection to the cows (the earth) and the *brahmanas* (religious principles), the two pillars of spiritual advancement. Everyone is under the full control of the Lord. He is quite correct in His action when He desires something to be done by someone, irrespective of the consideration of the particular case. Mahārāja Parékñit was thus put to test for his greatness. Now let us see how he solves it by his sagacious mind.

TEXT 21

SaUTa ovac

Wv& DaMaeR Pa[vdiTa Sa SaMa]a@(iÜJaSataMaa")
SaMaaihTaeNa MaNaSaa iv%ed" PaYaRcí TaMa()) 21))

süta uvāca

evaà dharme pravadati

sa samrädò dvija-sattamäù

samāhitena manasä

vikhedaù paryacañöa tam

SYNONYMS

sütaù uväca—Süta Gosvami said; *evam*—so; *dharme*—the personality of religion; *pravadati*—thus having spoken; *saù*—he; *samrädò*—the Emperor; *dvija-sattamäù*—O best among the *brahmanas*; *samāhitena*—with proper attention; *manasä*—by the mind; *vikhedaù*—without any mistake; *paryacañöa*—counterreplied; *tam*—unto him.

TRANSLATION

Süta Gosvami said: O best among the brahmanas, the Emperor Parékñit, thus hearing the personality of religion speak, was fully satisfied, and without mistake or regret he gave his reply.

PURPORT

The statement of the bull, the personality of religion, was full of philosophy and knowledge, and the King was satisfied, since he could understand that the suffering bull was not an ordinary one. Unless one is perfectly conversant with the law of the Supreme Lord, one cannot speak such things touching philosophical truths. The Emperor, being also on an equal level of sagacity, replied to the point, without doubts or mistakes.

TEXT 22

raJaaevac

**DaMa| b]vqiz DaMaRj DaMaaER_iSa v*zæPaDa*k(-)
YadDaMaRk*-Ta" SQaaNa& SaUck-SYaaiPa TaÙveTa()) 22))**

räjoväca

dharmaà bravéñi dharma-jia

dharmo 'si vāñā-rüpa-dhåk

yad adharmā-kåtaù sthānaà

sücakasyäpi tad bhavet

SYNONYMS

räjä uväca—the King said; *dharmam*—religion; *bravéñi*—as you speak; *dharma-jia*—O one who knows the codes of religion; *dharmaù*—the personality of religion; *asi*—you are; *vāñā-rüpa-dhåk*—in the disguise of a bull; *yat*—whatever; *adharmā-kåtaù*—one who acts irreligiously; *sthānam*—place; *sücakasya*—of the identifier; *api*—also; *tat*—that; *bhavet*—becomes.

TRANSLATION

The King said: O you, who are in the form of a bull! You know the truth of religion, and you are speaking according to the principle that the destination intended for the perpetrator of irreligious acts is also intended for one who identifies the perpetrator. You are no other than the personality of religion.

PURPORT

A devotee's conclusion is that no one is directly responsible for being a benefactor or mischief-monger without the sanction of the Lord; therefore he does not consider anyone to be directly responsible for such action. But in both the cases he takes it for granted that either benefit or loss is God-sent, and thus it is His grace. In case of benefit, no one will deny that it is God-sent, but in case of loss or reverses one becomes doubtful about how the Lord could be so unkind to His devotee as to put him in great difficulty. Jesus Christ was seemingly put into such great difficulty, being crucified by

the ignorant, but he was never angry at the mischief-mongers. That is the way of accepting a thing, either favorable or unfavorable. Thus for a devotee the identifier is equally a sinner, like the mischief-monger. By God's grace, the devotee tolerates all reverses. Mahārāja Parékñit observed this, and therefore he could understand that the bull was no other than the personality of religion himself. In other words, a devotee has no suffering at all because so-called suffering is also God's grace for a devotee who sees God in everything. The cow and bull never placed any complaint before the King for being tortured by the personality of Kali, although everyone lodges such complaints before the state authorities. The extraordinary behavior of the bull made the King conclude that the bull was certainly the personality of religion, for no one else could understand the finer intricacies of the codes of religion.

TEXT 23

AQava devMaaYaaYaa NaUNa& GaiTarGaaecra)
ceTaSaae vcSaêaiPa >aUTaaNaaiMaiTa iNaêYa")) 23))

athavä deva-mäyâyä

nünaà gatiṛ agocarä

cetaso vacasaç cäpi

bhütänäm iti niçcayaù

SYNONYMS

athavä—alternatively; *deva*—the Lord; *mäyâyäù*—energies; *nünam*—very little; *gatiù*—movement; *agocarä*—inconceivable; *cetasaù*—either by the mind; *vacasaù*—by words; *ca*—or; *api*—also; *bhütänäm*—of all living beings; *iti*—thus; *niçcayaù*—concluded.

TRANSLATION

Thus it is concluded that the Lord's energies are inconceivable. No one

can estimate them by mental speculation or by word jugglery.

PURPORT

A question may be raised as to why a devotee should refrain from identifying an actor, although he knows definitely that the Lord is the ultimate doer of everything. Knowing the ultimate doer, one should not pose himself as ignorant of the actual performer. To answer this doubt, the reply is that the Lord is also not directly responsible, for everything is done by His deputed *mäyā-çakti*, or material energy. The material energy is always provoking doubts about the supreme authority of the Lord. The personality of religion knew perfectly well that nothing can take place without the sanction of the Supreme Lord, and still he was put into doubts by the deluding energy, and thus he refrained from mentioning the supreme cause. This doubtfulness was due to the contamination of both Kali and the material energy. The whole atmosphere of the age of Kali is magnified by the deluding energy, and the proportion of measurement is inexplicable.

TEXT 24

**TaPa" XaaEc& dYaa SaTYaiMaiTa Paada" k*-Tae k*-Taa")
ADaMaa|XaEñYaae >aGana" SMaYaSa®MadESTav)) 24))**

tapaù çaucaà dayä satyam

iti pädäù kâte kätäù

adharmäàçais trayo bhagnäù

smaya-saiga-madais tava

SYNONYMS

tapaù—austerity; *çaucam*—cleanliness; *dayä*—mercy; *satyam*—truthfulness; *iti*—thus; *pädäù*—legs; *kâte*—in the age of Satya; *kätäù*—established; *adharma*—irreligiosity; *aàçaiù*—by the parts; *trayaù*—three

combined; *bhagnäù*—broken; *smaya*—pride; *saiga*—too much association with women; *madaiù*—intoxication; *tava*—your.

TRANSLATION

In the age of Satya [truthfulness] your four legs were established by the four principles of austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness. But it appears that three of your legs are broken due to rampant irreligion in the form of pride, lust for women, and intoxication.

PURPORT

The deluding energy, or material nature, can act upon the living beings proportionately in terms of the living beings' falling prey to the deluding attraction of *mäyā*. Moths are captivated by the glaring brightness of light, and thus they become prey to the fire. Similarly, the deluding energy is always captivating the conditioned souls to become prey to the fire of delusion, and the Vedic scriptures warn the conditioned souls not to become prey to delusion but to get rid of it. The *Vedas* warn us to go not to the darkness of ignorance but to the progressive path of light. The Lord Himself also warns that the deluding power of material energy is too powerful to overcome, but one who completely surrenders unto the Lord can easily do so. But to surrender unto the lotus feet of the Lord is also not very easy. Such surrender is possible by persons of austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness. These four principles of advanced civilization were remarkable features in the age of Satya. In that age, every human being was practically a qualified *brahmana* of the highest order, and in the social orders of life they were all *paramahamsas*, or the topmost in the renounced order. By cultural standing, the human beings were not at all subjected to the deluding energy. Such strong men of character were competent enough to get away from the clutches of *mäyā*. But gradually, as the basic principles of brahminical culture, namely austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness, became curtailed by proportionate development of pride, attachment for women and intoxication, the path of salvation or the path of transcendental bliss retreated far, far away from human society. With the progression of the age of Kali, people are becoming very proud, and attached to women and intoxication. By the influence of the age of

Kali, even a pauper is proud of his penny, the women are always dressed in an overly attractive fashion to victimize the minds of men, and the man is addicted to drinking wine, smoking, drinking tea and chewing tobacco, etc. All these habits, or so-called advancement of civilization, are the root causes of all irreligiosities, and therefore it is not possible to check corruption, bribery and nepotism. Man cannot check all these evils simply by statutory acts and police vigilance, but he can cure the disease of the mind by the proper medicine, namely advocating the principles of brahminical culture or the principles of austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness. Modern civilization and economic development are creating a new situation of poverty and scarcity with the result of blackmailing the consumer's commodities. If the leaders and the rich men of the society spend fifty percent of their accumulated wealth mercifully for the misled mass of people and educate them in God consciousness, the knowledge of *Bhāgavatam*, certainly the age of Kali will be defeated in its attempt to entrap the conditioned souls. We must always remember that false pride, or too high an estimation of one's own values of life, undue attachment to women or association with them, and intoxication will divert human civilization from the path of peace, however much the people clamor for peace in the world. The preaching of the *Bhāgavatam* principles will automatically render all men austere, clean both inside and outside, merciful to the suffering, and truthful in daily behavior. That is the way of correcting the flaws of human society, which are very prominently exhibited at the present moment.

TEXT 25

**wdaNaq& DaMaR PaadSTae SaTYa& iNavRTaRYaeÛTa")
Ta& iJaga*+aTYaDaMaaeR_YaMaNa*TaeNaEiDaTa" k-il/")) 25))**

idānéà dharma pädas te

satyaà nirvartayed yataù

taà jighâkñaty adharmo 'yam

anâtenaidhitaù kaliù

SYNONYMS

idäném—at the present moment; *dharma*—O personality of religion; *pädaù*—leg; *te*—of you; *satyam*—truthfulness; *nirvartayet*—hobbling along somehow or other; *yataù*—whereby; *tam*—that; *jighâkñati*—trying to destroy; *adharmatù*—the personality of irreligion; *ayam*—this; *anâtena*—by deceit; *edhitaù*—flourishing; *kaliù*—quarrel personified.

TRANSLATION

You are now standing on one leg only, which is your truthfulness, and you are somehow or other hobbling along. But quarrel personified [Kali], flourishing by deceit, is also trying to destroy that leg.

PURPORT

The principles of religion do not stand on some dogmas or man-made formulas, but they stand on four primary regulative observances, namely austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness. The mass of people must be taught to practice these principles from childhood. Austerity means to accept voluntarily things which may not be very comfortable for the body but are conducive for spiritual realization, for example, fasting. Fasting twice or four times a month is a sort of austerity which may be voluntarily accepted for spiritual realization only, and not for any other purposes, political or otherwise. Fastings which are meant not for self-realization but for some other purposes are condemned in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (17.5–6). Similarly, cleanliness is necessary both for the mind and for the body. Simply bodily cleanliness may help to some extent, but cleanliness of the mind is necessary, and it is effected by glorifying the Supreme Lord. No one can cleanse the accumulated mental dust without glorifying the Supreme Lord. A godless civilization cannot cleanse the mind because it has no idea of God, and for this simple reason people under such a civilization cannot have good qualifications, however they may be materially equipped. We have to see things by their resultant action. The resultant action of human civilization in the age of Kali is dissatisfaction, so everyone is anxious to get peace of mind. This peace of mind was complete in the Satya age because of the existence of the above-mentioned attributes of the human beings.

Gradually these attributes have diminished in the Tretä-yuga to three fourths, in the Dväpara to half, and in this age of Kali to one fourth, which is also gradually diminishing on account of prevailing untruthfulness. By pride, either artificial or real, the resultant action of austerity is spoiled; by too much affection for female association, cleanliness is spoiled; by too much addiction to intoxication, mercy is spoiled; and by too much lying propaganda, truthfulness is spoiled. The revival of *bhägavata-dharma* can save human civilization from falling prey to evils of all description.

TEXT 26

wYa& c >aUiMa>aRGavTaa NYaaiSaTaaeå>ara SaTaq)
 é[qMaiÛSTaTPadNYaaSaE" SavRTa" k*-Tak-aETauk-a)) 26))

iyaa ca bhümir bhagavatä

nyäsitoru-bharä saté

çrémadbhis tat-pada-nyäsaiù

sarvataù kåta-kautukä

SYNONYMS

iyam—this; *ca*—and; *bhümiù*—surface of the earth; *bhagavatä*—by the Personality of Godhead; *nyäsita*—being performed personally as well as by others; *uru*—great; *bharä*—burden; *saté*—being so done; *çrémadbhiù*—by the all-auspicious; *tat*—that; *pada-nyäsaiù*—footprints; *sarvataù*—all around; *kåta*—done; *kautukä*—good fortune.

TRANSLATION

The burden of the earth was certainly diminished by the Personality of Godhead and by others as well. When He was present as an incarnation, all good was performed because of His auspicious footprints.

TEXT 27

XaaecTYaé[uk-l/a Saaßq du>aRGaevaeiJ#TaaSaTaq)
Ab]ø<Yaa Na*PaVYaaJaa" éUd]a >aae+YaiNTa MaaiMaiTa)) 27))

çocaty açru-kalä sädhvé

durbhagevojhitä saté

abrahmaëyā nāpa-vyājāu

çüdrä bhokñyanti mām iti

SYNONYMS

çocati—lamenting; *açru-kalä*—with tears in the eyes; *sädhvé*—the chaste; *durbhagä*—as if the most unfortunate; *iva*—like; *ujjhitä*—forlorn; *saté*—being so done; *abrahmaëyāu*—devoid of brahminical culture; *nāpa-vyājāu*—posed as the ruler; *çüdräu*—lower class; *bhokñyanti*—would enjoy; *mām*—me; *iti*—thus.

TRANSLATION

Now she, the chaste one, being unfortunately forsaken by the Personality of Godhead, laments her future with tears in her eyes, for now she is being ruled and enjoyed by lower-class men who pose as rulers.

PURPORT

The *kñatriya*, or the man who is qualified to protect the sufferers, is meant to rule the state. Untrained lower-class men, or men without ambition to protect the sufferers, cannot be placed on the seat of an administrator. Unfortunately, in the age of Kali the lower-class men, without training, occupy the post of a ruler by strength of popular votes, and instead of protecting the sufferers, such men create a situation quite intolerable for everyone. Such rulers illegally gratify themselves at the cost of all comforts of the citizens, and thus the chaste mother earth cries to see the pitiable condition of her sons, both men and animals. That is the future of the world in the age of Kali, when irreligiosity prevails most prominently. And in the

absence of a suitable king to curb irreligious tendencies, educating the people systematically in the teaching of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* will clear up the hazy atmosphere of corruption, bribery, blackmail, etc.

TEXT 28

**wiTa DaMa | Mahq& cEv SaaNTviYaTva MaharQa")
iNaXaaTaMaadde %É& k-l/Yae_DaMaRheTave)) 28))**

iti dharmà mahéà caiva

säntvayitvä mahä-rathaù

niçätam ädade khaògaà

kalaye 'dharma-hetave

SYNONYMS

iti—thus; *dharmam*—the personality of religion; *mahém*—the earth; *ca*—also; *eva*—as; *säntvayitvä*—after pacifying; *mahä-rathaù*—the general who could fight alone with thousands of enemies; *niçätam*—sharp; *ädade*—took up; *khaògam*—sword; *kalaye*—to kill the personified Kali; *adharma*—irreligion; *hetave*—the root cause.

TRANSLATION

Mahärāja Parékñit, who could fight one thousand enemies single-handedly, thus pacified the personality of religion and the earth. Then he took up his sharp sword to kill the personality of Kali, who is the cause of all irreligion.

PURPORT

As described above, the personality of Kali is he who deliberately commits all kinds of sinful acts which are forbidden in the revealed scriptures. This age of Kali will certainly be full of all activities of Kali, but this does not

mean that the leaders of society, the executive heads, the learned and intelligent men, or above all the devotees of the Lord should sit down tightly and become callous to the reactions of the age of Kali. In the rainy season certainly there will be profuse rainfalls, but that does not mean that men should not take means to protect themselves from the rains. It is the duty of the executive heads of state and others to take all necessary actions against the activities of Kali or the persons influenced by the age of Kali; and Mahārāja Parékñit is the ideal executive head of the state, for at once he was ready to kill the personality of Kali with his sharp sword. The administrators should not simply pass resolutions for anticorruptional steps, but they must be ready with sharp swords to kill the persons creating corruptions from the angle of vision of the recognized *sastras*. The administrators cannot prevent corrupt activities by allowing wine shops. They must at once close all shops of intoxicating drugs and wine and force punishment even by death for those who indulge in habits of intoxication of all description. That is the way of stopping the activities of Kali, as exhibited herein by Mahārāja Parékñit, the *mahā-ratha*.

TEXT 29

**Ta& iJagaa&SauMai>aPa[eTYa ivhaYa Na*Pal/aH^NaMa()
TaTPaadMaUI&/ iXarSaa SaMaGaad(>aYaivûl/")) 29))**

taà jighäàsum abhipretya

vihäya nâpa-läïchanam

tat-päda-mûlaà çirasä

samagäd bhaya-vihvalaù

SYNONYMS

tam—him; *jighäàsum*—willing to kill; *abhipretya*—knowing it well; *vihäya*—leaving aside; *nâpa-läïchanam*—the dress of a king; *tat-päda-mûlam*—at his feet; *çirasä*—by the head; *samagät*—fully surrendered; *bhaya-vihvalaù*—under pressure of fearfulness.

TRANSLATION

When the personality of Kali understood that the King was willing to kill him, he at once abandoned the dress of a king and, under pressure of fear, completely surrendered to him, bowing his head.

PURPORT

The royal dress of the personality of Kali is artificial. The royal dress is suitable for a king or *kñatriya*, but when a lower-class man artificially dresses himself as a king, his real identity is disclosed by the challenge of a bona fide *kñatriya* like Mahārāja Parékñit. A real *kñatriya* never surrenders. He accepts the challenge of his rival *kñatriya*, and he fights either to die or to win. Surrender is unknown to a real *kñatriya*. In the age of Kali there are so many pretenders dressed and posed like administrators or executive heads, but their real identity is disclosed when they are challenged by a real *kñatriya*. Therefore when the artificially dressed personality of Kali saw that to fight Mahārāja Parékñit was beyond his ability, he bowed down his head like a subordinate and gave up his royal dress.

TEXT 30

PaiTaTa& PaadYaaevsr" k*-PaYaa dqNavTSal/")
Xar<Yaae NaavDaqC^(I/aeKYa Aah ced& hSaiàv)) 30))

patitaà pädayor véraù

kāpayä déna-vatsalaù

çaraëyo nävadhéc chlokya

äha cedaà hasann iva

SYNONYMS

patitam—fallen; *pädayoù*—at the feet; *véraù*—the hero; *kāpayä*—out of compassion; *déna-vatsalaù*—kind to the poor; *çaraëyaù*—one who is

qualified to accept surrender; *na*—not; *avadhét*—did kill; *çlokyau*—one who is worthy of being sung; *äha*—said; *ca*—also; *idam*—this; *hasan*—smiling; *iva*—like.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Parékñit, who was qualified to accept surrender and worthy of being sung in history, did not kill the poor surrendered and fallen Kali, but smiled compassionately, for he was kind to the poor.

PURPORT

Even an ordinary *kñatriya* does not kill a surrendered person, and what to speak of Mahārāja Parékñit, who was by nature compassionate and kind to the poor. He was smiling because the artificially dressed Kali had disclosed his identity as a lower-class man, and he was thinking how ironic it was that although no one was saved from his sharp sword when he desired to kill, the poor lower-class Kali was spared by his timely surrender. Mahārāja Parékñit's glory and kindness are therefore sung in history. He was a kind and compassionate emperor, fully worthy of accepting surrender even from his enemy. Thus the personality of Kali was saved by the will of Providence.

TEXT 31

raJaaevac

Na Tae Gau@ake-XaYaXaaeDara<aa&
bÖaÅle/vCE >aYaMaiSTa ik-iÄTa()
Na viTaRTaVYa& >avTaa k-QaÄNa
+ae}ae MadqYae TvMaDaMaRbNDau")) 31))

räjoväca

na te guòäkeça-yaço-dharäëä

baddhäijaler vai bhayam asti kiicit

na vartitavyaà bhavatä kathaicana

kñetre madéye tvam adharma-bandhuù

SYNONYMS

rājā uvāca—the King said; *na*—not; *te*—your; *guḍākeṣa*—Arjuna; *yaṣaù-dharāëäm*—of us who inherited the fame; *baddha-añjaleù*—one with folded hands; *vai*—certainly; *bhayam*—fear; *asti*—there is; *kñicit*—even a slight; *na*—neither; *vartitavyam*—can be allowed to live; *bhavatā*—by you; *kathaïcana*—by all means; *kñetre*—in the land; *madéye*—in my kingdom; *tvam*—you; *adharma-bandhuù*—the friend of irreligion.

TRANSLATION

The King thus said: We have inherited the fame of Arjuna; therefore since you have surrendered yourself with folded hands you need not fear for your life. But you cannot remain in my kingdom, for you are the friend of irreligion.

PURPORT

The personality of Kali, who is the friend of all kinds of irreligiosities, may be excused if he surrenders, but in all circumstances he cannot be allowed to live as a citizen in any part of a welfare state. The Pāëòavas were entrusted representatives of the Personality of Godhead, Lord Kṛṣṇa, who practically brought into being the Battle of Kurukñetra, but not for any personal interest. He wanted an ideal king like Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira and his descendants like Mahārāja Parékñit to rule the world, and therefore a responsible king like Mahārāja Parékñit could not allow the friend of irreligiosity to flourish in his kingdom at the cost of the good fame of the Pāëòavas. That is the way of wiping out corruption in the state, and not otherwise. The friends of irreligiosity should be banished from the state, and that will save the state from corruption.

TEXT 32

**Tva& vTaRMaaNa& Nardevdehe,
ZvNauPa[v*taae_YaMaDaMaRPaUGa")**

I/ae>aae_Na*Ta& caEYaRMaNaaYaRMa&hae
JYaeïa c MaaYaa k-l/hê dM>a")) 32))

tvää vartamānaà nara-deva-deheñv

anupravatto 'yam adharmā-pūgaù

lobho 'nātaà cauryam anāryam aàho

jyeñöhä ca māvā kalahaç ca dambhaù

SYNONYMS

tvām—you; *vartamānam*—while present; *nara-deva*—a man-god, or a king; *deheñu*—in the body; *anupravattaù*—taking place everywhere; *ayam*—all these; *adharma*—irreligious principles; *pūgaù*—in the masses; *lobhaù*—greed; *anātam*—falsity; *cauryam*—robbery; *anāryam*—incivility; *aàhaù*—treachery; *jyeñöhä*—misfortune; *ca*—and; *māvā*—cheating; *kalahaù*—quarrel; *ca*—and; *dambhaù*—vanity.

TRANSLATION

If the personality of Kali, irreligion, is allowed to act as a man-god or an executive head, certainly irreligious principles like greed, falsehood, robbery, incivility, treachery, misfortune, cheating, quarrel and vanity will abound.

PURPORT

The principles of religion, namely *austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness*, as we have already discussed, may be followed by the follower of any faith. There is no need to turn from Hindu to Mohammedan to Christian or some other faith and thus become a renegade and not follow the principles of religion. The *Bhāgavatam religion* urges following the *principles of religion*. The principles of religion are not the dogmas or regulative principles of a certain faith. Such regulative principles may be different in terms of the time and place concerned. One has to see whether

the aims of religion have been achieved. Sticking to the dogmas and formulas without attaining the real principles is not good. A secular state may be impartial to any particular type of faith, but the state cannot be indifferent to the principles of religion as above-mentioned. But in the age of Kali, the executive heads of state will be indifferent to such religious principles, and therefore under their patronage the opponents of religious principles, such as greed, falsehood, cheating and pilfering, will naturally follow, and so there will be no meaning to propaganda crying to stop corruption in the state.

TEXT 33

**Na viTaRTaVYa& TadDaMaRbNDaae
DaMaeR<a SaTYaeNa c viTaRTaVYae)
b]øavTaeR Ya}a YaJaiNTa YajE,
YaRjeir& YajivTaaNaivja")) 33))**

na vartitavyaà tad adharma-bandho

dharmeëa satyena ca vartitavye

brahmävarte yatra yajanti yajñair

yajñeçvaraà yajña-vitāna-vijñāu

SYNONYMS

na—not; *vartitavyam*—deserve to remain; *tad*—therefore; *adharma*—irreligiosity; *bandho*—friend; *dharmeëa*—with religion; *satyena*—with truth; *ca*—also; *vartitavye*—being situated in; *brahma-ävarte*—place where sacrifice is performed; *yatra*—where; *yajanti*—duly perform; *yajñaiù*—by sacrifices or devotional services; *yajña-éçvaram*—unto the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead; *yajña*—sacrifice; *vitāna*—spreading; *vijñāu*—experts.

TRANSLATION

Therefore, O friend of irreligion, you do not deserve to remain in a place where experts perform sacrifices according to truth and religious principles for the satisfaction of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

Yajñeçvara, or the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is the beneficiary of all kinds of sacrificial ceremonies. Such sacrificial ceremonies are prescribed differently in the scriptures for different ages. In other words, sacrifice means to accept the supremacy of the Lord and thereby perform acts by which the Lord may be satisfied in all respects. The atheists do not believe in the existence of God, and they do not perform any sacrifice for the satisfaction of the Lord. Any place or country where the supremacy of the Lord is accepted and thus sacrifice is performed is called *brahmāvarta*. There are different countries in different parts of the world, and each and every country may have different types of sacrifice to please the Supreme Lord, but the central point in pleasing Him is ascertained in the *Bhāgavatam*, and it is truthfulness. The basic principle of religion is truthfulness, and the ultimate goal of all religions is to satisfy the Lord. In this age of Kali, the greatest common formula of sacrifice is the *saikértana-yajña*. That is the opinion of the experts who know how to propagate the process of *yajña*. Lord Caitanya preached this method of *yajña*, and it is understood from this verse that the sacrificial method of *saikértana-yajña* may be performed anywhere and everywhere in order to drive away the personality of Kali and save human society from falling prey to the influence of the age.

TEXT 34

**YaiSMaNa(hir>aRGavaiNaJYaMaaNa
wJYaaTMaMaUiTaRYaRJaTaa& Xa& TaNaaeiTa)
k-aMaaNaMaaegaaNa(iSQarJa®MaaNaa,
MaNTabRihvaRYauirvEz AaTMaa)) 34))**

yasmin harir bhagavān iṣyamāna

iṣyātma-mūrtir yajatāḥ ṣaḍ tanoti

kämän amoghän sthira-jaìgamänäm

antar bahir väyur ivaiña ätmä

SYNONYMS

yasmin—in such sacrificial ceremonies; *hariù*—the Supreme Lord; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *ijyamänaù*—being worshiped; *ijya-ätma*—the soul of all worshipable deities; *mürtiù*—in the forms; *yajatäm*—those who worship; *çam*—welfare; *tanoti*—spreads; *kämän*—desires; *amoghän*—inviolable; *sthira-jaìgamänäm*—of all the moving and nonmoving; *antaù*—within; *bahiù*—outside; *väyuù*—air; *iva*—like; *eñaù*—of all of them; *ätmä*—spirit soul.

TRANSLATION

In all sacrificial ceremonies, although sometimes a demigod is worshiped, the Supreme Lord Personality of Godhead is worshiped because He is the Supersoul of everyone, and exists both inside and outside like the air. Thus it is He only who awards all welfare to the worshiper.

PURPORT

It is even sometimes seen that demigods like Indra and Candra are worshiped and offered sacrificial awards, yet the rewards of all such sacrifices are awarded to the worshiper by the Supreme Lord, and it is the Lord only who can offer all welfare to the worshiper. The demigods, although worshiped, cannot do anything without the sanction of the Lord because the Lord is the Supersoul of everyone, both moving and nonmoving.

In ***Bhagavad-gita*** (9.23) the Lord Himself confirms this in the following *çloka*:

*ye 'py anya-devatä-bhaktä
yajante çraddhayänvitäu
te 'pi mäm eva kaunteya*

yajanty avidhi-pūrvakam

“Whatever a man may sacrifice to other gods, O son of Kunté, is really meant for Me alone, but it is offered without true understanding.”

The fact is that the Supreme Lord is one without a second. There is no God other than the Lord Himself. Thus the Supreme Lord is eternally transcendental to the material creation. But there are many who worship the demigods like the sun, the moon and Indra, who are only material representatives of the Supreme Lord. These demigods are indirect, qualitative representations of the Supreme Lord. A learned scholar or devotee, however, knows who is who. Therefore he directly worships the Supreme Lord and is not diverted by the material, qualitative representations. Those who are not so learned worship such qualitative, material representations, but their worship is unceremonious because it is irregular.

TEXT 35

SaUTa ovac

**Parqi+aTaEvMaaidí" Sa k-il/JaaRTavePaQau")
TaMauÛTaaSaMaahed& d<@Paai<aiMavaeÛTaMa()) 35))**

sūta uvāca

parékñitaivam ādiññāu

sa kalir jāta-vepathu

tam udyatāsim āheda

daēḍa-pāḍim ivodyatam

SYNONYMS

sūta—Sri Sūta Gosvami said; *parékñitā*—by Mahārāja Parékñit; *evam*—thus; *ādiññāu*—being ordered; *sa*—he; *kali*—the personality of

Kali; *jāta*—there was; *vepathu*—trembling; *tam*—him; *udyata*—raised; *asim*—sword; *āha*—said; *idam*—thus; *daēḍa-pāëim*—Yamarāja, the personality of death; *iva*—like; *udyatam*—almost ready.

TRANSLATION

Sri Sūta Gosvami said: The personality of Kali, thus being ordered by Mahārāja Parékñit, began to tremble in fear. Seeing the King before him like Yamarāja, ready to Kill him, Kali spoke to the King as follows.

PURPORT

The King was ready to kill the personality of Kali at once, as soon as he disobeyed his order. Otherwise the King had no objection to allowing him to prolong his life. The personality of Kali also, after attempting to get rid of the punishment in various ways, decided that he must surrender unto him, and thus he began to tremble in fear of his life. The king, or the executive head, must be so strong as to stand before the personality of Kali like the personality of death, Yamarāja. The King's order must be obeyed, otherwise the culprit's life is in risk. That is the way to rule the personalities of Kali who create disturbance in the normal life of the state citizens.

TEXT 36

k-il/āvac

Ya}a KvvaQa vTSYaaiMa SaavR>aaEMa TavajYaa)
I/+aYae Ta}a Ta}aaiPa TvaMaataezuXaraSaNaMa()) 36))

kalir uvāca

yatra kva vātha vatsyāmi

sārva-bhauma tavājīyā

lakṇaye tatra tatrāpi

tvām ātteṇu-ṣarāsanam

SYNONYMS

kaliù uvāca—the personality of Kali said; *yatra*—anywhere; *kva*—and everywhere; *vā*—either; *atha*—thereof; *vatsyāmi*—I shall reside; *sārva-bhauma*—O lord (or emperor) of the earth; *tava*—your; *ājīayā*—by the order; *lakṣṇaye*—I see; *tatra tatra*—anywhere and everywhere; *api*—also; *tvām*—Your Majesty; *ātta*—taken over; *iṅu*—arrows; *ṣarāsanam*—bows.

TRANSLATION

O Your Majesty, though I may live anywhere and everywhere under your order, I shall but see you with bow and arrows wherever I look.

PURPORT

The personality of Kali could see that Mahārāja Parékṣīt was the emperor of all lands all over the world, and thus anywhere he might live he would have to meet with the same mood of the King. The personality of Kali was meant for mischief, and Mahārāja Parékṣīt was meant for subduing all kinds of mischief-mongers, especially the personality of Kali. It was better, therefore, for the personality of Kali to have been killed by the King then and there instead of being killed elsewhere. He was, after all, a surrendered soul before the King, and it was for the King to do what was required.

TEXT 37

**TaNMae DaMaR>a*Taa& é[eī SQaaNa& iNadeRíuMahRiSa)
Ya}aEv iNaYaTaae vTSYa AaiTai&STae_NauXaaSaNaMa()) 37))**

tan me dharma-bhātā çreñöha

sthānā nirdeñöum arhasi

yatraiva niyato vatsya

ātiñöhaàs te ’nuçāsanam

SYNONYMS

tat—therefore; *me*—me; *dharma-bhātām*—of all the protectors of religion; *creñöha*—O chief; *sthānam*—place; *nirdeñöum*—fix; *arhasi*—may you do so; *yatra*—where; *eva*—certainly; *niyatau*—always; *vatsye*—can reside; *ätiñöhan*—permanently situated; *te*—your; *anuçäsanam*—under your rule.

TRANSLATION

Therefore, O chief amongst the protectors of religion, please fix some place for me where I can live permanently under the protection of your government.

PURPORT

The personality of Kali addressed Mahārāja Parékñit as the chief amongst the protectors of religiosity because the King refrained from killing a person who surrendered unto him. A surrendered soul should be given all protection, even though he may be an enemy. That is the principle of religion. And we can just imagine what sort of protection is given by the Personality of Godhead to the person who surrenders unto Him, not as an enemy but as a devoted servitor. The Lord protects the surrendered soul from all sins and all resultant reactions of sinful acts (Bg. 18.66).

TEXT 38

SaUTa ovac

**A>YaiQaRTaSTada TaSMaE SQaaNaaiNa k-l/Yae ddaE)
ÛUTa& PaaNa& iñYa" SaUNaa Ya}aaDaMaRêTauivRDa")) 38))**

süta uväca

abhyarthitas tadä tasmai

sthänäni kalaye dadau

dyütaà pänaà striyaù sünä

SYNONYMS

sūtaù uvāca—Sūta Gosvami said; *abhyarthitaù*—thus being petitioned; *tadā*—at that time; *tasmai*—unto him; *sthānāni*—places; *kalaye*—to the personality of Kali; *dadau*—gave him permission; *dyūtam*—gambling; *pānam*—drinking; *striyaù*—illicit association with women; *sūnā*—animal slaughter; *yatra*—wherever; *adharmāù*—sinful activities; *catuù-vidhau*—four kinds of.

TRANSLATION

Sūta Gosvami said: Mahārāja Parékñit, thus being petitioned by the personality of Kali, gave him permission to reside in places where gambling, drinking, prostitution and animal slaughter were performed.

PURPORT

The basic principles of irreligiosity, such as pride, prostitution, intoxication and falsehood, counteract the four principles of religion, namely austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness. The personality of Kali was given permission to live in four places particularly mentioned by the King, namely the place of gambling, the place of prostitution, the place of drinking and the place of animal slaughter.

Srila Jiva Gosvami directs that drinking against the principles of scriptures, such as the *sautrāmaëé-yajña*, association with women outside marriage, and killing animals against the injunctions of scriptures are irreligious. In the *Vedas* two different types of injunctions are there for the *pravāttas*, or those who are engaged in material enjoyment, and for the *nivāttas*, or those who are liberated from material bondage. The Vedic injunction for the *pravāttas* is to gradually regulate their activities towards the path of liberation. Therefore, for those who are in the lowest stage of ignorance and who indulge in wine, women and flesh, drinking by performing *sautrāmaëé-yajña*, association of women by marriage and flesh-eating by sacrifices are sometimes recommended. Such recommendations in the

Vedic literature are meant for a particular class of men, and not for all. But because they are injunctions of the *Vedas* for particular types of persons, such activities by the *pravāttas* are not considered *adharma*. One man's food may be poison for others; similarly, what is recommended for those in the mode of ignorance may be poison for those in the mode of goodness. Srila Jiva Gosvami Prabhu, therefore, affirms that recommendations in the scriptures for a certain class of men are never to be considered *adharma*, or irreligious. But such activities are factually *adharma*, and they are never to be encouraged. The recommendations in the scriptures are not meant for the encouragement of such *adharma*, but for regulating the necessary *adharma* gradually toward the path of *dharma*.

Following in the footsteps of Mahārāja Parékñit, it is the duty of all executive heads of states to see that the principles of religion, namely austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness, are established in the state, and that the principles of irreligion, namely pride, illicit female association or prostitution, intoxication and falsity, are checked by all means. And to make the best use of a bad bargain, the personality of Kali may be transferred to places of gambling, drinking, prostitution and slaughterhouses, if there are any places like that. Those who are addicted to these irreligious habits may be regulated by the injunctions of the scripture. In no circumstances should they be encouraged by any state. In other words, the state should categorically stop all sorts of gambling, drinking, prostitution and falsity. The state which wants to eradicate corruption by majority may introduce the principles of religion in the following manner:

1. Two compulsory fasting days in a month, if not more (austerity). Even from the economic point of view, such two fasting days in a month in the state will save tons of food, and the system will also act very favorably on the general health of the citizens.
2. There must be compulsory marriage of young boys and girls attaining twenty-four years of age and sixteen years of age respectively. There is no harm in coeducation in the schools and colleges, provided the boys and girls are duly married, and in case there is any intimate connection between a male and female student, they should be married properly without illicit

relation. The divorce act is encouraging prostitution, and this should be abolished.

3. The citizens of the state must give in charity up to fifty percent of their income for the purpose of creating a spiritual atmosphere in the state or in human society, both individually and collectively. They should preach the principles of *Bhāgavatam* by (a) *karma-yoga*, or doing everything for the satisfaction of the Lord, (b) regular hearing of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from authorized persons or realized souls, (c) chanting of the glories of the Lord congregationally at home or at places of worship, (d) rendering all kinds of service to *bhāgavatas* engaged in preaching *Srimad-Bhagavatam* and (e) residing in a place where the atmosphere is saturated with God consciousness. If the state is regulated by the above process, naturally there will be God consciousness everywhere.

Gambling of all description, even speculative business enterprise, is considered to be degrading, and when gambling is encouraged in the state, there is a complete disappearance of truthfulness. Allowing young boys and girls to remain unmarried more than the above-mentioned ages and licensing animal slaughterhouses of all description should be at once prohibited. The flesh-eaters may be allowed to take flesh as mentioned in the scriptures, and not otherwise. Intoxication of all description—even smoking cigarettes, chewing tobacco or the drinking of tea—must be prohibited.

TEXT 39

**PauNaê YaacMaaNaaYa JaaTaæPaMadaTPa[>au")
TaTaae_Na*Ta& Mad& k-aMa& rJaae vEr& c PaÄMaMa()) 39))**

punaç ca yācamānāya

jāta-rūpam adāt prabhuù

tato 'nātaà madaà kāmāà

rajo vairaà ca paīcamam

SYNONYMS

punaù—again; *ca*—also; *yācamānāya*—to the beggar; *jāta-rūpam*—gold; *adāt*—gave away; *prabhuù*—the King; *tataù*—whereby; *anātam*—falsehood; *madam*—intoxication; *kāmam*—lust; *rajaù*—on account of a passionate mood; *vairam*—enmity; *ca*—also; *pañcamam*—the fifth one.

TRANSLATION

The personality of Kali asked for something more, and because of his begging, the King gave him permission to live where there is gold because wherever there is gold there is also falsity, intoxication, lust, envy and enmity.

PURPORT

Although Mahārāja Parékñit gave Kali permission to live in four places, it was very difficult for him to find the places because during the reign of Mahārāja Parékñit there were no such places. Therefore Kali asked the King to give him something practical which could be utilized for his nefarious purposes. Mahārāja Parékñit thus gave him permission to live in a place where there is gold, because wherever there is gold there are all the above-mentioned four things, and over and above them there is enmity also. So the personality of Kali became gold-standardized. According to *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, gold encourages falsity, intoxication, prostitution, envy and enmity. Even a gold-standard exchange and currency is bad. Gold-standard currency is based on falsehood because the currency is not on a par with the reserved gold. The basic principle is falsity because currency notes are issued in value beyond that of the actual reserved gold. This artificial inflation of currency by the authorities encourages prostitution of the state economy. The price of commodities becomes artificially inflated because of bad money, or artificial currency notes. Bad money drives away good money. Instead of paper currency, actual gold coins should be used for exchange, and this will stop prostitution of gold. Gold ornaments for women may be allowed by control, not by quality, but by quantity. This will discourage lust, envy and enmity. When there is actual gold currency in the form of coins, the influence of gold in producing falsity, prostitution, etc.,

will automatically cease. There will be no need of an anticorruption ministry for another term of prostitution and falsity of purpose.

TEXT 40

AMaUiNa PaÄ SQaaNaaiNa ùDaMaRPa[>av" k-il/")
AaEtareYae<a dtaaiNa NYavSaTa(TaiàdeXak*-Ta()) 40))

amüni païca sthänäni

hy adharmā-prabhavaù kaliù

auttareyeëa dattäni

nyavasat tan-nideça-kât

SYNONYMS

amüni—all those; *païca*—five; *sthänäni*—places; *hi*—certainly; *adharmā*—irreligious principles; *prabhavaù*—encouraging; *kaliù*—the age of Kali; *auttareyeëa*—by the son of Uttarä; *dattäni*—delivered; *nyavasat*—dwelt; *tat*—by him; *nideça-kât*—directed.

TRANSLATION

Thus the personality of Kali, by the directions of Mahäräja Parékñit, the son of Uttarä, was allowed to live in those five places.

PURPORT

Thus the age of Kali began with gold standardization, and therefore falsity, intoxication, animal slaughter and prostitution are rampant all over the world, and the saner section is eager to drive out corruption. The counteracting process is suggested above, and everyone can take advantage of this suggestion.

TEXT 41

AQaETaaiNa Na SaeveTa bu>aUzu" Pauåz" KvicTa()
ivXaezTaae DaMaRXaqI/ae raJaa I/aek-PaiTaGauRå")) 41))

athaitäni na seveta

bubhüñuù puruṣaù kvacit

viṣeñato dharma-çélo

räjä loka-patir guruù

SYNONYMS

atha—therefore; *etäni*—all these; *na*—never; *seveta*—come in contact; *bubhüñuù*—those who desire well-being; *puruṣaù*—person; *kvacit*—in any circumstances; *viṣeñataù*—specifically; *dharma-çélaù*—those who are on the progressive path of liberation; *räjä*—the king; *loka-patiù*—public leader; *guruù*—the *brahmanas* and the *sannyäsés*.

TRANSLATION

Therefore, whoever desires progressive well-being, especially kings, religionists, public leaders, brahmanas and sannyäsés, should never come in contact with the four above-mentioned irreligious principles.

PURPORT

The *brahmanas* are the religious preceptors for all other castes, and the *sannyäsés* are the spiritual masters for all the castes and orders of society. So also are the king and the public leaders who are responsible for the material welfare of all people. The progressive religionists and those who are responsible human beings or those who do not want to spoil their valuable human lives should refrain from all the principles of irreligiosity, especially illicit connection with women. If a *brahmana* is not truthful, all his claims as a *brahmana* at once become null and void. If a *sannyäse* is illicitly connected with women, all his claims as a *sannyäse* at once become false. Similarly, if the king and the public leader are unnecessarily proud or

habituated to drinking and smoking, certainly they become disqualified to discharge public welfare activities. Truthfulness is the basic principle for all religions. The four leaders of the human society, namely the *sannyāsés*, the *brahmana*, the king and the public leader, must be tested crucially by their character and qualification. Before one can be accepted as a spiritual or material master of society, he must be tested by the above-mentioned criteria of character. Such public leaders may be less qualified in academic qualifications, but it is necessary primarily that they be free from the contamination of the four disqualifications, namely gambling, drinking, prostitution and animal slaughter.

TEXT 42

v*zSYa Naía&ñqNa(PaadaNa(TaPa" XaaEc& dYaaiMaiTa)
Pa[iTaSaNdDa AaiaSYa Mahq& c SaMavDaRYaTa()) 42))

vãñasya nañöäàs trén pädän

tapaù çaucaà dayäm iti

pratisandadha äçväsyä

mahéà ca samavardhayat

SYNONYMS

vãñasya—of the bull (the personality of religion); *nañöän*—lost; *trén*—three; *pädän*—legs; *tapaù*—austerity; *çaucam*—cleanliness; *dayäm*—mercy; *iti*—thus; *pratisandadhe*—reestablished; *äçväsyä*—by encouraging activities; *mahém*—the earth; *ca*—and; *samavardhayat*—perfectly improved.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter the King reestablished the lost legs of the personality of religion [the bull], and by encouraging activities he sufficiently improved the condition of the earth.

PURPORT

By designating particular places for the personality of Kali, Mahārāja Parékñit practically cheated Kali. In the presence of Kali, Dharma (in the shape of a bull), and the earth (in the shape of a cow), he could actually estimate the general condition of his kingdom, and therefore he at once took proper steps to reestablish the legs of the bull, namely austerity, cleanliness and mercy. And for the general benefit of the people of the world, he saw that the gold stock might be employed for stabilization. Gold is certainly a generator of falsity, intoxication, prostitution, enmity and violence, but under the guidance of a proper king or public leader, or a *brahmana* or *sannyāsé*, the same gold can be properly utilized to reestablish the lost legs of the bull, the personality of religion.

Mahārāja Parékñit, therefore, like his grandfather Arjuna, collected all illicit gold kept for the propensities of Kali and employed it in the *saikértana-yajña*, as per instruction of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. As we have suggested before, one's accumulated wealth may be divided into three parts for distribution, namely fifty percent for the service of the Lord, twenty-five percent for the family members and twenty-five percent for personal necessities. Spending fifty percent for the service of the Lord or for propagation of spiritual knowledge in society by way of the *saikértana-yajña* is the maximum display of human mercy. People of the world are generally in darkness regarding spiritual knowledge, especially in regard to the devotional service of the Lord, and therefore to propagate the systematic transcendental knowledge of devotional service is the greatest mercy that one can show in this world. When everyone is taught to sacrifice fifty percent of his accumulated gold for the Lord's service, certainly austerity, cleanliness and mercy automatically ensue, and thus the lost three legs of the personality of religion are automatically established. When there is sufficient austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness, naturally mother earth is completely satisfied, and there is very little chance for Kali to infiltrate the structure of human society.

TEXTS 43–44

Sa Wz WTauRDYaaSTa AaSaNa& PaaiQaRvaeicTaMa()

iPaTaaMaheNaaePaNYaSTa& rajar<Ya& iviv+aTaa)) 43))
AaSTae_DauNaa Sa raJaizR" k-aErveNd]ié[YaaeçSaNa()
GaJaaûYae Maha>aaGaê§-vTas b*hC^\va")) 44))

sa eña etarhy adhyästa

äsanaà päarthivocitam

pitāmahenopanyastaà

räjiäraëyaà vivikñatä

äste 'dhunä sa räjarñiù

kauravendra-çriyollasan

gajähvaye mahä-bhāgaç

cakravarté bāhac-chraväù

SYNONYMS

saù—he; *eñaù*—this; *etarhi*—at the present; *adhyäste*—is ruling over; *äsanam*—the throne; *pärthiva-ucitam*—just befitting a king; *pitāmahena*—by the grandfather; *upanyastam*—being handed over; *räjiä*—by the King; *araëyam*—forest; *vivikñatä*—desiring; *äste*—is there; *adhunä*—at present; *saù*—that; *räja-āñiù*—the sage amongst the kings; *kaurava-indra*—the chief amongst the Kuru kings; *çriyā*—glories; *ullasan*—spreading; *gajähvaye*—in Hastināpura; *mahä-bhāgaù*—the most fortunate; *cakravarté*—the Emperor; *bāhat-çraväù*—highly famous.

TRANSLATION

The most fortunate Emperor Mahārāja Parékñit, who was entrusted with the kingdom of Hastināpura by Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira when he desired to retire to the forest, is now ruling the world with great success due to his being glorified by the deeds of the kings of the Kuru dynasty.

PURPORT

The prolonged sacrificial ceremonies undertaken by the sages of Naimiñāraëya were begun shortly after the demise of Mahārāja Parékñit. The sacrifice was to continue for one thousand years, and it is understood that in the beginning some of the contemporaries of Baladeva, the elder brother of Lord Kṛṣṇa, also visited the sacrificial place. According to some authorities, the present tense is also used to indicate the nearest margin of time from the past. In that sense, the present tense is applied to the reign of Mahārāja Parékñit here. For a continuous fact, also, present tense can be used. The principles of Mahārāja Parékñit can be still continued, and human society can still be improved if there is determination by the authorities. We can still purge out from the state all the activities of immorality introduced by the personality of Kali if we are determined to take action like Mahārāja Parékñit. He allotted some place for Kali, but in fact Kali could not find such places in the world at all because Mahārāja Parékñit was strictly vigilant to see that there were no places for gambling, drinking, prostitution and animal slaughter. Modern administrators want to banish corruption from the state, but fools as they are, they do not know how to do it. They want to issue licenses for gambling houses, wine and other intoxicating drug houses, brothels, hotel prostitution and cinema houses, and falsity in every dealing, even in their own, and they want at the same time to drive out corruption from the state. They want the kingdom of God without God consciousness. How can it be possible to adjust two contradictory matters? If we want to drive out corruption from the state, we must first of all organize society to accept the principles of religion, namely austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness, and to make the condition favorable we must close all places of gambling, drinking, prostitution and falsity. These are some of the practical lessons from the pages of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 45

**wTQaM>aUTaaNau>aavae_YaMai>aMaNYauSauTaae Na*Pa")
YaSYa Paal/YaTa" +aaE<aq& YaUYa& Sa}aaYa dqI+aTaa")) 45))**

ittham-bhütānubhāvo 'yam

abhimanyu-suto nāpaù

yasya pälayataù kñauëéà

yüyaà saträya dékñitäu

SYNONYMS

ittham-bhüta—being thus; *anubhāvaù*—experience; *ayam*—of this; *abhimanyu-sutaù*—son of Abhimanyu; *nāpaù*—the king; *yasya*—whose; *pälayataù*—on account of his ruling; *kñauëém*—on the earth; *yüyam*—you all; *saträya*—in performing sacrifices; *dékñitäu*—initiated.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Parékñit, the son of Abhimanyu, is so experienced that by dint of his expert administration and patronage, it has been possible for you to perform a sacrifice such as this.

PURPORT

The *brahmanas* and the *sannyāsés* are expert in the spiritual advancement of society, whereas the *kṣatriyas* or the administrators are expert in the material peace and prosperity of human society. Both of them are the pillars of all happiness, and therefore they are meant for full cooperation for common welfare. Mahārāja Parékñit was experienced enough to drive away Kali from his field of activities and thereby make the state receptive to spiritual enlightenment. If the common people are not receptive, it is very difficult to impress upon them the necessity of spiritual enlightenment. Austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness, the basic principles of religion, prepare the ground for the reception of advancement in spiritual knowledge, and Mahārāja Parékñit made this favorable condition possible. Thus the *āñis* of Naimiñāraëya were able to perform the sacrifices for a thousand years. In other words, without state support, no doctrines of philosophy or religious principles can progressively advance. There should be complete cooperation between the *brahmanas* and the *kṣatriyas* for this common good. Even up to Mahārāja Açoka, the same

spirit was prevailing. Lord Buddha was sufficiently supported by King Açoka, and thus his particular cult of knowledge was spread all over the world.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Seventeenth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "Punishment and Reward of Kali."

Chapter Eighteen

Mahäräja Parékñit Cursed by a Brähmaëa Boy

TEXT 1

SaUTa ovac

Yaae vE d]aE<YañivPlu/íae Na MaaTauådre Ma*Ta")
ANauGa]had(>aGavTa" k*-Z<aSYaad(>auTak-MaR<a")) 1))

süta uväca

yo vai drauëy-astra-vipluñöö

na mätur udare mätuà

anugrahäd bhagavatau

kãñëasyädbhuta-karmaëau

SYNONYMS

sütaù uväca—Sri Süta Gosvami said; *yaù*—one who; *vai*—certainly; *drauëi-astra*—by the weapon of the son of Droëa; *vipluñööaù*—burned by; *na*—never; *mätuà*—of the mother; *udare*—in the womb; *mätuà*—met his death; *anugrahät*—by the mercy; *bhagavatau*—of the Personality of Godhead; *kãñëasya*—Kṛṣṇa; *adbhuta-karmaëau*—who acts wonderfully.

TRANSLATION

Sri Sūta Gosvami said: Due to the mercy of the Personality of Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa, who acts wonderfully, Mahārāja Parékñit, though struck by the weapon of the son of Droëa in his mother's womb, could not be burned.

PURPORT

The sages of Naimiñāraëya became struck with wonder after hearing about the wonderful administration of Mahārāja Parékñit, especially in reference to his punishing the personality of Kali and making him completely unable to do any harm within the kingdom. Sūta Gosvami was equally anxious to describe Mahārāja Parékñit's wonderful birth and death, and this verse is stated by Sūta Gosvami to increase the interest of the sages of Naimiñāraëya.

TEXT 2

**b]øk-aePaaeiTQaTaad(YaSTau Ta+ak-aTPa[a<aivâvaTa()
Na SaMMauMaaehaeâ>aYaad(>aGavTYaiPaRTaaXaYa")) 2))**

brahma-kopotthitād yas tu

takñakāt prāëa-viplavāt

na sammumohorubhayād

bhagavaty arpitäçayaù

SYNONYMS

brahma-kopa—fury of a *brahmana*; *utthitāt*—caused by; *yaù*—what was; *tu*—but; *takñakāt*—by the snake-bird; *prāëa-viplavāt*—from dissolution of life; *na*—never; *sammumoha*—was overwhelmed; *uru-bhayāt*—great fear; *bhagavati*—unto the Personality of Godhead; *arpita*—surrendered; *äçayaù*—consciousness.

TRANSLATION

Furthermore, Mahārāja Parékñit was always consciously surrendered to the Personality of Godhead, and therefore he was neither afraid nor overwhelmed by fear due to a snake-bird which was to bite him because of the fury of a brahmana boy.

PURPORT

A self-surrendered devotee of the Lord is called *nārāyaṇa-parāyaṇa*. Such a person is never afraid of any place or person, not even of death. For him nothing is as important as the Supreme Lord, and thus he gives equal importance to heaven and hell. He knows well that both heaven and hell are creations of the Lord, and similarly life and death are different conditions of existence created by the Lord. But in all conditions and in all circumstances, remembrance of Nārāyaṇa is essential. The *nārāyaṇa-parāyaṇa* practices this constantly. Mahārāja Parékñit was such a pure devotee. He was wrongfully cursed by an inexperienced son of a *brahmana*, who was under the influence of Kali, and Mahārāja Parékñit took this to be sent by Nārāyaṇa. He knew that Nārāyaṇa (Lord Kṛṣṇa) had saved him when he was burned in the womb of his mother, and if he were to be killed by a snake bite, it would also take place by the will of the Lord. The devotee never goes against the will of the Lord; anything sent by God is a blessing for the devotee. Therefore Mahārāja Parékñit was neither afraid of nor bewildered by such things. That is the sign of a pure devotee of the Lord.

TEXT 3

oTSa*JYa SavRTa" Sa®& ivjaTaaiJaTaSa&iSQaiTa")
vEYaaSake-JaRhaE iXaZYaae Ga®aYaa& Sv& k-le/vrMa()) 3))

utsājya sarvataṁ saigaṁ

vijñātājita-saṁsthitiṁ

vaiyāsaker jahau cīṇyo

gaigāyāṁ svaṁ kalevaram

SYNONYMS

utsājya—after leaving aside; *sarvataù*—all around; *saìgam*—association; *vijñāta*—being understood; *ajita*—one who is never conquered (the Personality of Godhead); *saàsthitiù*—actual position; *vaiyāsakeù*—unto the son of Vyāsa; *jahau*—gave up; *çiñyaù*—as a disciple; *gaìgäyām*—on the bank of the Ganges; *svam*—his own; *kalevaram*—material body.

TRANSLATION

Furthermore, after leaving all his associates, the King surrendered himself as a disciple to the son of Vyāsa [Çukadeva Gosvami], and thus he was able to understand the actual position of the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

The word *ajita* is significant here. The Personality of Godhead, Sri Kṛṣṇa, is known as Ajita, or unconquerable, and He is so in every respect. No one can know His actual position. He is unconquerable by knowledge also. We have heard about His *dhāma*, or place, eternal Goloka Vāndāvana, but there are many scholars who interpret this abode in different ways. But by the grace of a spiritual master like Çukadeva Gosvami, unto whom the King gave himself up as a most humble disciple, one is able to understand the actual position of the Lord, His eternal abode, and His transcendental paraphernalia in that *dhāma*, or abode. Knowing the transcendental position of the Lord and the transcendental method by which one can approach that transcendental *dhāma*, the King was confident about his ultimate destination, and by knowing this he could leave aside everything material, even his own body, without any difficulty of attachment. In the *Bhagavad-gita*, it is stated, *paraà dāñövä nivartate*: one can give up all connection with material attachment when one is able to see the *param*, or the superior quality of things. From *Bhagavad-gita* we understand the quality of the Lord's energy that is superior to the material quality of energy, and by the grace of a bona fide spiritual master like Çukadeva Gosvami, it is quite possible to know everything of the superior energy of the Lord by which the Lord manifests His eternal name, quality, pastimes, paraphernalia and variegatedness. Unless one thoroughly understands this

superior or eternal energy of the Lord, it is not possible to leave the material energy, however one may theoretically speculate on the true nature of the Absolute Truth. By the grace of Lord Kṛṣṇa, Mahārāja Parékṣīt was able to receive the mercy of such a personality as Çukadeva Gosvami, and thus he was able to know the actual position of the unconquerable Lord. It is very difficult to find the Lord from the Vedic literatures, but it is very easy to know Him by the mercy of a liberated devotee like Çukadeva Gosvami.

TEXT 4

NaaetaMaëaek-vaTaaRNaa& JauzTaa& TaTk-QaaMa*TaMa()
SYaaTSaM>a]Maae_NTak-ale/_iPa SMarTaa& TaTPadaMbuJaMa()) 4))

nottamaçloka-värtänää

juñatää tat-kathämâtam

syät sambhramo 'nta-käle 'pi

smaratää tat-padämbujam

SYNONYMS

na—never; *uttama-çloka*—the Personality of Godhead, of whom the Vedic hymns sing; *värtänäm*—of those who live on them; *juñatäm*—of those who are engaged in; *tat*—His; *kathä-amâtam*—transcendental topics about Him; *syät*—it so happens; *sambhramaù*—misconception; *anta*—at the end; *käle*—in time; *api*—also; *smaratäm*—remembering; *tat*—His; *pada-ambujam*—lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

This was so because those who have dedicated their lives to the transcendental topics of the Personality of Godhead, of whom the Vedic hymns sing, and who are constantly engaged in remembering the lotus feet of the Lord, do not run the risk of having misconceptions even at the

last moment of their lives.

PURPORT

The highest perfection of life is attained by remembering the transcendental nature of the Lord at the last moment of one's life. This perfection of life is made possible by one who has learned the actual transcendental nature of the Lord from the Vedic hymns sung by a liberated soul like Çukadeva Gosvami or someone in that line of disciplic succession. There is no gain in hearing the Vedic hymns from some mental speculator. When the same is heard from an actual self-realized soul and is properly understood by service and submission, everything becomes transparently clear. Thus a submissive disciple is able to live transcendently and continue to the end of life. By scientific adaptation, one is able to remember the Lord even at the end of life, when the power of remembrance is slackened due to derangement of bodily membranes. For a common man, it is very difficult to remember things as they are at the time of death, but by the grace of the Lord and His bona fide devotees, the spiritual masters, one can get this opportunity without difficulty. And it was done in the case of Mahārāja Parékñit.

TEXT 5

TaavTk-il/NaR Pa[>aveTa(Pa[ivíae_Paqh SavRTa")
YaavdqXaae MahaNauVYaaRMaai>aMaNYav Wk-ra\$()) 5))

tävat kalir na prabhavet

praviñño 'péha sarvataù

yävad éço mahän urvyäm

äbhimanyava eka-räö

SYNONYMS

tävat—so long; *kaliù*—the personality of Kali; *na*—cannot; *prabhavet*—

flourish; *praviñööaù*—entered in; *api*—even though; *iha*—here; *sarvataù*—everywhere; *yävat*—as long as; *éçaù*—the lord; *mahän*—great; *urvyäm*—powerful; *äbhimanyavaù*—the son of Abhimanyu; *eka-räö*—the one emperor.

TRANSLATION

As long as the great, powerful son of Abhimanyu remains the Emperor of the world, there is no chance that the personality of Kali will flourish.

PURPORT

As we have already explained, the personality of Kali had entered the jurisdiction of this earth long ago, and he was looking for an opportunity to spread his influence all over the world. But he could not do so satisfactorily due to the presence of Mahäräja Parékñit. That is the way of good government. The disturbing elements like the personality of Kali will always try to extend their nefarious activities, but it is the duty of the able state to check them by all means. Although Mahäräja Parékñit allotted places for the personality of Kali, at the same time he gave no chance for the citizens to be swayed by the personality of Kali.

TEXT 6

**YaiSMaàhiNa YaùeRv >aGavaNauTSaSaJaR GaaMa()
TadEvehaNauv*taae_SaavDaMaRPa[>av" k-il/")) 6))**

yasminn ahani yarhy eva

bhagavän utsasarja gäm

tadaivehänuvåtto 'säv

adharmā-prabhavaù kaliù

SYNONYMS

yasmin—on that; *ahani*—very day; *yarhi eva*—in the very moment; *bhagavän*—the Personality of Godhead; *utsasarja*—left aside; *gäm*—the earth; *tadä*—at that time; *eva*—certainly; *iha*—in this world; *anuvåttaù*—followed; *asau*—he; *adharmā*—irreligion; *prabhavaù*—accelerating; *kaliù*—the personality of quarrel.

TRANSLATION

The very day and moment the Personality of Godhead, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, left this earth, the personality of Kali, who promotes all kinds of irreligious activities, came into this world.

PURPORT

The Personality of Godhead and His holy name, qualities, etc., are all identical. The personality of Kali was not able to enter the jurisdiction of the earth due to the presence of the Personality of Godhead. And similarly, if there is an arrangement for the constant chanting of the holy names, qualities, etc., of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, there is no chance at all for the personality of Kali to enter. That is the technique of driving away the personality of Kali from the world. In modernized human society there are great advancements of material science, and they have invented the radio to distribute sound in the air. So instead of vibrating some nuisance sound for sense enjoyment, if the state arranges to distribute transcendental sound by resounding the holy name, fame and activities of the Lord, as they are authorized in the *Bhagavad-gita* or *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, then a favorable condition will be created, the principles of religion in the world will be reestablished, and thus the executive heads, who are so anxious to drive away corruption from the world, will be successful. Nothing is bad if properly used for the service of the Lord.

TEXT 7

**NaaNauÜeií k-il&/ SaMa]a\$(Saar® wv Saar>auk(-)
ku-Xal/aNYaaéu iSaÖyiNTa NaeTarai<a k*-TaaiNa YaTa()) 7))**

nānudveññi kalià samrāö

säraiga iva sära-bhuk

kuçaläny äçu siddhyanti

netaräëi kâtäni yat

SYNONYMS

na—never; *anudveñöi*—envious; *kalim*—unto the personality of Kali; *samräö*—the Emperor; *säram-ga*—realist, like the bees; *iva*—like; *sära-bhuk*—one who accepts the substance; *kuçaläni*—auspicious objects; *äçu*—immediately; *siddhyanti*—become successful; *na*—never; *itaräëi*—which are inauspicious; *kâtäni*—being performed; *yat*—as much as.

TRANSLATION

Mahäräja Parékñit was a realist, like the bees who only accept the essence [of a flower]. He knew perfectly well that in this age of Kali, auspicious things produce good effects immediately, whereas inauspicious acts must be actually performed [to render effects]. So he was never envious of the personality of Kali.

PURPORT

The age of Kali is called the fallen age. In this fallen age, because the living beings are in an awkward position, the Supreme Lord has given some special facilities to them. So by the will of the Lord, a living being does not become a victim of a sinful act until the act is actually performed. In other ages, simply by thinking of performing a sinful act, one used to become a victim of the act. On the contrary, a living being in this age is awarded with the results of pious acts simply by thinking of them. Mahäräja Parékñit, being the most learned and experienced king by the grace of the Lord, was not unnecessarily envious of the personality of Kali because he did not intend to give him any chance to perform any sinful act. He protected his subjects from falling prey to the sinful acts of the age of Kali, and at the same time he gave full facility to the age of Kali by allotting him some particular places. At the end of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* it is said that even

though all nefarious activities of the personality of Kali are present, there is a great advantage in the age of Kali. One can attain salvation simply by chanting the holy name of the Lord. Thus Mahārāja Parékñit made an organized effort to propagate the chanting of the Lord's holy name, and thus he saved the citizens from the clutches of Kali. It is for this advantage only that great sages sometimes wish all good for the age of Kali. In the *Vedas* also it is said that by discourse on Lord Kṛṣṇa's activities, one can get rid of all the disadvantages of the age of Kali. In the beginning of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam* it is also said that by the recitation of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, the Supreme Lord becomes at once arrested within one's heart. These are some of the great advantages of the age of Kali, and Mahārāja Parékñit took all the advantages and did not think any ill of the age of Kali, true to his Vaiñëavite cult.

TEXT 8

ik&- Nau bale/zu éUre<a k-il/Naa Daqr>aqå<aa)
APa[Mata" Pa[Mataezu Yaae v*k-ae Na*zu vTaRTae)) 8))

kià nu bāleñu çüreëa

kalinā dhéra-bhéruëä

apramattaù pramatteñu

yo vāko nāñu vartate

SYNONYMS

kim—what; *nu*—may be; *bāleñu*—among the less intelligent persons; *çüreëa*—by the powerful; *kalinā*—by the personality of Kali; *dhéra*—self-controlled; *bhéruëä*—by one who is afraid of; *apramattaù*—one who is careful; *pramatteñu*—among the careless; *yaù*—one who; *vākaù*—tiger; *nāñu*—among men; *vartate*—exists.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Parékñit considered that less intelligent men might find the personality of Kali to be very powerful, but that those who are self-controlled would have nothing to fear. The King was powerful like a tiger and took care for the foolish, careless persons.

PURPORT

Those who are not devotees of the Lord are careless and unintelligent. Unless one is thoroughly intelligent, one cannot be a devotee of the Lord. Those who are not devotees of the Lord fall prey to the actions of Kali. It will not be possible to bring about a saner condition in society unless we are prepared to accept the modes of action adopted by Mahārāja Parékñit, i.e., propagation of the devotional service of the Lord to the common man.

TEXT 9

**oPavi<aRTaMaeTaÜ" Pau<Ya& Paarqi+aTa& MaYaa)
vaSaudevk-QaaePaeTaMaa:YaaNa& YadPa*C^Ta)) 9))**

upavarëitam etad vaù

puëyaà pärékñitaà mayä

väsudeva-kathopetam

äkhyänaà yad apâcchata

SYNONYMS

upavarëitam—almost everything described; *etat*—all these; *vaù*—unto you; *puëyam*—pious; *pärékñitam*—about Mahārāja Parékñit; *mayä*—by me; *väsudeva*—of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *kathä*—narrations; *upetam*—in connection with; *äkhyänam*—statements; *yat*—what; *apâcchata*—you asked from me.

TRANSLATION

O sages, as you did ask me, now I have described almost everything

regarding the narrations about Lord Kṛṣṇa in connection with the history of the pious Mahārāja Parékñit.

PURPORT

Srimad-Bhagavatam is the history of the activities of the Lord. And the activities of the Lord are performed in relation with the devotees of the Lord. Therefore, the history of the devotees is not different from the history of Lord Kṛṣṇa's activities. A devotee of the Lord regards both the activities of the Lord and those of His pure devotees on an equal level, for they are all transcendental.

TEXT 10

Yaa Yaa" k-Qaa >aGavTa" k-QaNaqYaaeåk-MaR<a")
Gau<ak-MaaRé[Yaa" PauiM>a" Sa&SaeVYaaSTaa bu>aUzui>a")) 10))

yä yäù kathä bhagavataù

kathanéyuru-karmaëaù

guëa-karmäçrayäù pumbhiù

saàsevyäs tä bubhüñubhiù

SYNONYMS

yäù—whatever; *yäù*—and whatsoever; *kathäù*—topics; *bhagavataù*—about the Personality of Godhead; *kathanéya*—were to be spoken by me; *uru-karmaëaù*—of Him who acts wonderfully; *guëa*—transcendental qualities; *karma*—uncommon deeds; *äçrayäù*—involving; *pumbhiù*—by persons; *saàsevyäù*—ought to be heard; *täù*—all of them; *bubhüñubhiù*—by those who want their own welfare.

TRANSLATION

Those who are desirous of achieving complete perfection in life must

submissively hear all topics that are connected with the transcendental activities and qualities of the Personality of Godhead, who acts wonderfully.

PURPORT

The systematic hearing of the transcendental activities, qualities and names of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa pushes one towards eternal life. Systematic hearing means knowing Him gradually in truth and fact, and this knowing Him in truth and fact means attaining eternal life, as stated in the *Bhagavad-gita*. Such transcendental, glorified activities of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa are the prescribed remedy for counteracting the process of birth, death, old age and disease, which are considered to be material awards for the conditioned living being. The culmination of such a perfectional stage of life is the goal of human life and the attainment of transcendental bliss.

TEXT 11

%ozYa Ocu"

SaUTa Jaqv SaMaa" SaaEMYa XaaìTaqivRXad& YaXa")
YaSTv& Xa&SaiSa k*-Z<aSYa MaTYaaRNaaMaMa*Ta& ih Na")) 11))

añaya ücuù

süta jéva samäù saumya

çäçvatér viçadaà yaçaù

yas tvaà çààsasi kãñëasya

martyänäm amâtaà hi naù

SYNONYMS

añayaù ücuù—the good sages said; *süta*—O Süta Gosvami; *jéva*—we wish you life for; *samäù*—many years; *saumya*—grave; *çäçvatéù*—eternal; *viçadam*—particularly; *yaçaù*—in fame; *yaù tvam*—because you; *çààsasi*—

speaking nicely; *kāñēasya*—of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *martyānām*—of those who die; *amātam*—eternity of life; *hi*—certainly; *naù*—our.

TRANSLATION

The good sages said: O grave Sūta Gosvami! May you live many years and have eternal fame, for you are speaking very nicely about the activities of Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead. This is just like nectar for mortal beings like us.

PURPORT

When we hear about the transcendental qualities and activities of the Personality of Godhead, we may always remember what has been spoken by the Lord Himself in the *Bhagavad-gita* (4.9). His acts, even when He acts in human society, are all transcendental, for they are all accentuated by the spiritual energy of the Lord, which is distinguished from His material energy. As stated in the *Bhagavad-gita*, such acts are called *divyam*. This means that He does not act or take His birth like an ordinary living being under the custody of material energy. Nor is His body material or changeable like that of ordinary living beings. And one who understands this fact, either from the Lord or from authorized sources, is not reborn after leaving the present material body. Such an enlightened soul is admitted into the spiritual realm of the Lord and engages in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. Therefore, the more we hear about the transcendental activities of the Lord, as they are stated in the *Bhagavad-gita* and *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, the more we can know about His transcendental nature and thus make definite progress on the path back to Godhead.

TEXT 12

**k-MaR<YaiSMaàNaaiaSae DaUMaDaUMa]aTMaNaa& >avaNa()
AaPaaYaYaiTa GaaeivNdPaadPaÚaSav& MaDau)) 12))**

karmaëy asminn anäçväse

dhüma-dhümrätmanäà bhavän

äpäyayati govinda-

päda-padmäsavaà madhu

SYNONYMS

karmaëi—performance of; *asmin*—in this; *anäçväse*—without certainty; *dhüma*—smoke; *dhümra-ätmanäm*—tinged body and mind; *bhavän*—your good self; *äpäyayati*—very much pleasing; *govinda*—the Personality of Godhead; *päda*—feet; *padma-äsavam*—nectar of the lotus flower; *madhu*—honey.

TRANSLATION

We have just begun the performance of this fruitive activity, a sacrificial fire, without certainty of its result due to the many imperfections in our action. Our bodies have become black from the smoke, but we are factually pleased by the nectar of the lotus feet of the Personality of Godhead, Govinda, which you are distributing.

PURPORT

The sacrificial fire kindled by the sages of Naimiñäraëya was certainly full of smoke and doubts because of so many flaws. The first flaw is that there is an acute scarcity of expert *brahmanas* able to carry out such performances successfully in this age of Kali. Any discrepancy in such sacrifices spoils the whole show, and the result is uncertain, like agricultural enterprises. The good result of tilling the paddy field depends on providential rain, and therefore the result is uncertain. Similarly, performance of any kind of sacrifice in this age of Kali is also uncertain. Unscrupulous greedy *brahmanas* of the age of Kali induce the innocent public to such uncertain sacrificial shows without disclosing the scriptural injunction that in the age of Kali there is no fruitful sacrificial performance but the sacrifice of the congregational chanting of the holy name of the Lord. Söta Gosvami was narrating the transcendental activities of the Lord before the congregation

of sages, and they were factually perceiving the result of hearing these transcendental activities. One can feel this practically, as one can feel the result of eating food. Spiritual realization acts in that way.

The sages of Naimiñāraëya were practically sufferers from the smoke of a sacrificial fire and were doubtful about the result, but by hearing from a realized person like Sūta Gosvami, they were fully satisfied. In the *Brahma-vaivarta Purana*, Viṣṇu tells Siva that in the age of Kali, men full of anxieties of various kinds can vainly labor in fruitive activity and philosophical speculations, but when they are engaged in devotional service, the result is sure and certain, and there is no loss of energy. In other words, nothing performed for spiritual realization or for material benefit can be successful without the devotional service to the Lord.

TEXT 13

Taul/YaaMa l/veNaaiPa Na SvGa| NaaPauNa>aRvMa()
>aGavTSai®Sa®SYa MaTYaaRNaa& ik-MauTaaiXaz")) 13))

tulayāma lavenāpi

na svargaà nāpunar-bhavam

bhagavat-saìgi-saìgasya

martyänäà kim utäçiñau

SYNONYMS

tulayāma—to be balanced with; *lavena*—by a moment; *api*—even; *na*—never; *svargam*—heavenly planets; *na*—nor; *apunaù-bhavam*—liberation from matter; *bhagavat-saìgi*—devotee of the Lord; *saìgasya*—of the association; *martyänām*—those who are meant for death; *kim*—what is there; *uta*—to speak of; *äçiñau*—worldly benediction.

TRANSLATION

The value of a moment's association with the devotee of the Lord cannot even be compared to the attainment of heavenly planets or liberation from matter, and what to speak of worldly benedictions in the form of material prosperity, which are for those who are meant for death.

PURPORT

When there are some similar points, it is possible to compare one thing to another. One cannot compare the association of a pure devotee to anything material. Men who are addicted to material happiness aspire to reach the heavenly planets like the moon, Venus and Indraloka, and those who are advanced in material philosophical speculations aspire after liberation from all material bondage. When one becomes frustrated with all kinds of material advancement, one desires the opposite type of liberation, which is called *apunar-bhava*, or no rebirth. But the pure devotees of the Lord do not aspire after the happiness obtained in the heavenly kingdom, nor do they aspire after liberation from material bondage. In other words, for the pure devotees of the Lord the material pleasures obtainable in the heavenly planets are like phantasmagoria, and because they are already liberated from all material conceptions of pleasure and distress, they are factually liberated even in the material world. This means that the pure devotees of the Lord are engaged in a transcendental existence, namely in the loving service of the Lord, both in the material world and in the spiritual world. As a government servant is always the same, either in the office or at home or at any place, so a devotee has nothing to do with anything material, for he is exclusively engaged in the transcendental service of the Lord. Since he has nothing to do with anything material, what pleasure can he derive from material benedictions like kingship or other overlords, which are finished quickly with the end of the body? Devotional service is eternal; it has no end, because it is spiritual. Therefore, since the assets of a pure devotee are completely different from material assets, there is no comparison between the two. Sūta Gosvami was a pure devotee of the Lord, and therefore his association with the *āñis* in Naimiñāraēya is unique. In the material world, association with gross materialists is veritably condemned. The materialist is called *yoñit-saigé*, or one who is much attached to material entanglement (women and other paraphernalia). Such attachment is conditioned because it drives away the benedictions of life

and prosperity. And just the opposite is *bhāgavata-saigé*, or one who is always in the association with the Lord's name, form, qualities, etc. Such association is always desirable; it is worshipable, it is praiseworthy, and one may accept it as the highest goal of life.

TEXT 14

k-ae NaaMa Ta*PYaed(rSaivTk-QaaYaa&
MahtaMaEk-aNTaParaYa<aSYa)
NaaNTa& Gau<aaNaaMaGau<aSYa JaGMau,
YaaeRGaeira Yae >avPaaÚMau:Yaa")) 14))

ko nāma tāpyed rasavit kathāyāà

mahattamaikānta-parāyaēasya

nāntaà guēānām aguēasya jagmur

yogeçvarā ye bhava-pādma-mukhyāù

SYNONYMS

kaù—who is he; *nāma*—specifically; *tāpyet*—get full satisfaction; *rasa-vit*—expert in relishing mellow nectar; *kathāyām*—in the topics of; *mahat-tama*—the greatest amongst the living beings; *ekānta*—exclusively; *parāyaēasya*—of one who is the shelter of; *na*—never; *antam*—end; *guēānām*—of attributes; *aguēasya*—of the Transcendence; *jagmuù*—could ascertain; *yoga-éçvaräù*—the lords of mystic power; *ye*—all they; *bhava*—Lord Siva; *pādma*—Lord Brahmā; *mukhyäù*—heads.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead, Lord Kṛṣṇa [Govinda], is the exclusive shelter for all great living beings, and His transcendental attributes cannot even be measured by such masters of mystic powers as Lord Siva and Lord Brahmā. Can anyone who is expert in relishing nectar [rasa] ever be fully satiated by hearing topics about Him?

PURPORT

Lord Siva and Lord Brahmā are two chiefs of the demigods. They are full of mystic powers. For example, Lord Siva drank an ocean of poison of which one drop was sufficient to kill an ordinary living being. Similarly, Brahmā could create many powerful demigods, including Lord Siva. So they are *éçvaras*, or lords of the universe. But they are not the supreme powerful. The supreme powerful is Govinda, Lord Kṛṣṇa. He is the Transcendence, and His transcendental attributes cannot be measured even by such powerful *éçvaras* as Siva and Brahmā. Therefore Lord Kṛṣṇa is the exclusive shelter of the greatest of all living beings. Brahmā is counted amongst the living beings, but he is the greatest of all of us. And why is the greatest of all the living beings so much attached to the transcendental topics of Lord Kṛṣṇa? Because He is the reservoir of all enjoyment. Everyone wants to relish some kind of taste in everything, but one who is engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord can derive unlimited pleasure from such engagement. The Lord is unlimited, and His name, attributes, pastimes, entourage, variegatedness, etc. are unlimited, and those who relish them can do so unlimitedly and still not feel satiated. This fact is confirmed in the *Padma Purana*:

*ramante yogino 'nante
satyānanda-cid-ātmani
iti rāma-padenāsau
paraà brahmābhidhēyate*

“The mystics derive unlimited transcendental pleasures from the Absolute Truth, and therefore the Supreme Absolute Truth, the Personality of Godhead, is also known as Rāma.”

There is no end to such transcendental discourses. In mundane affairs there is the law of satiation, but in transcendence there is no such satiation. Sūta Gosvami desired to continue the topics of Lord Kṛṣṇa before the sages of Naimiṣāraēya, and the sages also expressed their readiness to hear from him continuously. Since the Lord is transcendence and His attributes are transcendental, such discourses increase the receptive mood of the purified audience.

TEXT 15

Taàae >avaNa(vE >aGavTPa[DaaNaae
MahtaMaEk-aNTaParaYa<aSYa)
hreâdar& cirTa& ivéuÖ&
éué[UzTaa& Naae ivTaNaeeTau ivÜNa()) 15))

tan no bhavän vai bhagavat-pradhäno

mahattamaikänta-paräyaëasya

harer udäraà caritaà viçuddhaà

çuçrüñatää no vitanotu vidvan

SYNONYMS

tat—therefore; *naù*—of us; *bhavän*—your good self; *vai*—certainly; *bhagavat*—in relation with the Personality of Godhead; *pradhänaù*—chiefly; *mahat-tama*—the greatest of all greats; *ekänta*—exclusively; *paräyaëasya*—of the shelter; *hareù*—of the Lord; *udäram*—impartial; *caritam*—activities; *viçuddham*—transcendental; *çuçrüñatäm*—those who are receptive; *naù*—ourselves; *vitānotu*—kindly describe; *vidvan*—O learned one.

TRANSLATION

O Sūta Gosvami, you are a learned and pure devotee of the Lord because the Personality of Godhead is your chief object of service. Therefore please describe to us the pastimes of the Lord, which are above all material conception, for we are anxious to receive such messages.

PURPORT

The speaker on the transcendental activities of the Lord should have only one object of worship and service, Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. And the audience for such topics should be anxious to hear about

Him. When such a combination is possible, namely a qualified speaker and a qualified audience, it is then and there very much congenial to continue discourses on the Transcendence. Professional speakers and a materially absorbed audience cannot derive real benefit from such discourses. Professional speakers make a show of *Bhāgavata-saptāha* for the sake of family maintenance, and the materially disposed audience hears such discourses of *Bhāgavata-saptāha* for some material benefit, namely religiosity, wealth, gratification of the senses, or liberation. Such *Bhāgavatam* discourses are not purified from the contamination of the material qualities. But the discourses between the saints of Naimiñāraëya and Sri Sūta Gosvami are on the transcendental level. There is no motive for material gain. In such discourses, unlimited transcendental pleasure is relished both by the audience and by the speaker, and therefore they can continue the topics for many thousands of years. Now *Bhāgavata-saptāhas* are held for seven days only, and after finishing the show, both the audience and the speaker become engaged in material activities as usual. They can do so because the speaker is not *bhagavat-pradhāna* and the audience is not *çuçrūñatām*, as explained above.

TEXT 16

Sa vE Maha>aaGavTa" Parqi+ad(
YaeNaaPavGaaR:YaMad>a]buiÖ")
jaNaeNa vEYaaSaik-XaiBdTaeNa
>aeJae %GaeNd]ßJaPaadMaUl/Ma()) 16))

sa vai mahā-bhāgavataù parékñid

yenāpavargākhyam adabhra-buddhiù

jñānena vaiyāsaki-çabditena

bheje khagendra-dhvaja-pāda-mūlam

SYNONYMS

saù—he; *vai*—certainly; *mahā-bhāgavataù*—first-class devotee; *parékñit*—

the King; *yena*—by which; *apavarga-ākhyam*—by the name of liberation; *adabhra*—fixed; *buddhiù*—intelligence; *jñānena*—by knowledge; *vaiyāsaki*—the son of Vyāsa; *ṣabdītena*—vibrated by; *bheje*—taken to; *khaga-indra*—Garuḍa, the king of the birds; *dhvaja*—flag; *pāda-mūlam*—soles of the feet.

TRANSLATION

O Sūta Gosvami, please describe those topics of the Lord by which Mahārāja Parékñit, whose intelligence was fixed on liberation, attained the lotus feet of the Lord, who is the shelter of Garuḍa, the king of birds. Those topics were vibrated by the son of Vyāsa [Srila Çukadeva].

PURPORT

There is some controversy amongst the students on the path of liberation. Such transcendental students are known as impersonalists and devotees of the Lord. The devotee of the Lord worships the transcendental form of the Lord, whereas the impersonalist meditates upon the glaring effulgence, or the bodily rays of the Lord, known as the *brahmajyoti*. Here in this verse it is said that Mahārāja Parékñit attained the lotus feet of the Lord by instructions in knowledge delivered by the son of Vyāsadeva, Srila Çukadeva Gosvami. Çukadeva Gosvami was also an impersonalist in the beginning, as he himself has admitted in the *Bhāgavatam* (2.1.9), but later on he was attracted by the transcendental pastimes of the Lord and thus became a devotee. Such devotees with perfect knowledge are called *mahā-bhāgavatas*, or first-class devotees. There are three classes of devotees, namely the *prākāṣa*, *madhyama*, and *mahā-bhāgavata*. The *prākāṣa*, or third-class devotees, are temple worshipers without specific knowledge of the Lord and the Lord's devotees. The *madhyama*, or the second-class devotee, knows well the Lord, the Lord's devotees, the neophytes, and the nondevotees also. But the *mahā-bhāgavata*, or the first-class devotee, sees everything in relation with the Lord and the Lord present in everyone's relation. The *mahā-bhāgavata*, therefore, does not make any distinction, particularly between a devotee and nondevotee. Mahārāja Parékñit was such a *mahā-bhāgavata* devotee because he was initiated by a *mahā-bhāgavata* devotee, Çukadeva Gosvami. He was equally kind, even to the

personality of Kali, and what to speak of others.

So there are many instances in the transcendental histories of the world of an impersonalist who has later become a devotee. But a devotee has never become an impersonalist. This very fact proves that on the transcendental steps, the step occupied by a devotee is higher than the step occupied by an impersonalist. It is also stated in the **Bhagavad-gita** (12.5) that persons stuck on the impersonal step undergo more sufferings than achievement of reality. Therefore knowledge imparted by Çukadeva Gosvami unto Mahārāja Parékñit helped him attain the service of the Lord. And this stage of perfection is called *apavarga*, or the perfect stage of liberation. Simple knowledge of liberation is material knowledge. Actual freedom from material bondage is called liberation, but attainment of the transcendental service of the Lord is called the perfect stage of liberation. Such a stage is attained by knowledge and renunciation, as we have already explained (**Bhäg.** 1.2.12), and perfect knowledge, as delivered by Srila Çukadeva Gosvami, results in the attainment of the transcendental service of the Lord.

TEXT 17

Taà" Par& Pau<YaMaSa&v*TaaQaR,
Maa:YaaNaMaTYad(>auTaYaaeGaiNaïMa()
Aa:YaaùNaNTaacirTaaePaPaà&
Paarqi+aTa& >aaGavTaai>araMaMa()) 17))

tan naù paraà puëyam asaàvâtärtham

äkhyänam atyadbhuta-yoga-niñöham

äkhyähy anantäcaritopapannaà

pärékñitaà bhägavatäbhirämam

SYNONYMS

tat—therefore; *naù*—unto us; *param*—supreme; *puëyam*—purifying;

asaàvāta-artham—as it is; *ākhyānam*—narration; *ati*—very; *adbhuta*—wonderful; *yoga-niñōham*—compact in *bhakti-yoga*; *ākhyāhi*—describe; *ananta*—the Unlimited; *ācarita*—activities; *upapannam*—full of; *pārékñitam*—spoken to Mahārāja Parékñit; *bhāgavata*—of the pure devotees; *abhirāmam*—particularly very dear.

TRANSLATION

Thus please narrate to us the narrations of the Unlimited, for they are purifying and supreme. They were spoken to Mahārāja Parékñit, and they are very dear to the pure devotees, being full of bhakti-yoga.

PURPORT

What was spoken to Mahārāja Parékñit and what is very dear to the pure devotees is *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. *Srimad-Bhagavatam* is mainly full of the narrations of the activities of the Supreme Unlimited, and therefore it is the science of *bhakti-yoga*, or the devotional service of the Lord. Thus it is *para*, or supreme, because although it is enriched with all knowledge and religion, it is specifically enriched with the devotional service of the Lord.

TEXT 18

SaUTa ovac

Ahae vYa& JaNMa>a*Taae_Ū haSMa
v*ÖaNauv*tYaaIPa ivl/aeMaJaaTaa")
daEZku-LYaMaaiDa& ivDauNaaeiTa Xaqga]&
MahtaMaaNaaMai>aDaaNaYaaeGa")) 18))

sūta uvāca

aho vayaà janma-bhāto 'dya hāsma

vāddhānuvāṭṭyāpi viloma-jātāu

dauñkulyam ādhià vidhunoti çéghraà

SYNONYMS

sūtaù uvāca—Sūta Gosvami said; *aho*—how; *vayam*—we; *janma-bhātaù*—promoted in birth; *adya*—today; *ha*—clearly; *āsma*—have become; *vāddha-anuvāṭṭyā*—by serving those who are advanced in knowledge; *api*—although; *viloma-jātāù*—born in a mixed caste; *dauṅkulyam*—disqualification of birth; *ādhim*—sufferings; *vidhunoti*—purifies; *çéghram*—very soon; *mahat-tamānām*—of those who are great; *abhidhāna*—conversation; *yogaù*—connection.

TRANSLATION

Sri Sūta Gosvami said: O God, although we are born in a mixed caste, we are still promoted in birthright simply by serving and following the great who are advanced in knowledge. Even by conversing with such great souls, one can without delay cleanse oneself of all disqualifications resulting from lower births.

PURPORT

Sūta Gosvami did not take his birth in a *brahmana* family. He was born in a family of mixed caste, or an uncultured low family. But because of higher association, like Sri Çukadeva Gosvami and the great *āñis* of Naimiñāraëya, certainly the disqualification of inferior birth was washed off. Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu followed this principle in pursuance of the Vedic usages, and by His transcendental association He elevated many lowborn, or those disqualified by birth or action, to the status of devotional service and established them in the position of *ācāryas*, or authorities. He clearly stated that any man, whatever he may be, whether a *brahmana* or *çūdra* by birth, or a householder or mendicant in the order of society, if he is conversant with the science of Kṛṣṇa, he can be accepted as an *ācārya* or *guru*, a spiritual master.

Sūta Gosvami learned the science of Kṛṣṇa from great *āñis* and authorities like Çukadeva and Vyāsadeva and he was so qualified that even the sages of

Naimiñāraëya eagerly wanted to hear from him the science of Kṛṣṇa in the form of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. So he had the double association of great souls by hearing and preaching. Transcendental science, or the science of Kṛṣṇa, has to be learned from the authorities, and when one preaches the science, he becomes still more qualified. So Sūta Gosvami had both the advantages, and thus undoubtedly he was completely freed from all disqualifications of low birth and mental agonies. This verse definitely proves that Srila Çukadeva Gosvami did not refuse to teach Sūta Gosvami about the transcendental science nor did the sages of Naimiñāraëya refuse to hear lessons from him because of his inferior birth. This means that thousands of years ago there was no bar to learning or preaching the transcendental science because of inferior birth. The rigidity of the so-called caste system in Hindu society became prominent within only one hundred years or so when the number of *dvija-bandhus*, or disqualified men in the families of higher castes, increased. Lord Sri Caitanya revived the original Vedic system, and He elevated Öhäkura Haridäsa to the position of *nāmācärya*, or the authority in preaching the glories of the holy name of the Lord, although His Holiness Srila Haridäsa Öhäkura was pleased to appear in a family of Mohammedans.

Such is the power of pure devotees of the Lord. The Ganges water is accepted as pure, and one can become purified after taking a bath in the waters of the Ganges. But as far as the great devotees of the Lord are concerned, they can purify a degraded soul even by being seen by the lowborn, and what to speak of association. Lord Sri Caitanya Mahäprabhu wanted to purify the whole atmosphere of the polluted world by sending qualified preachers all over the world, and it remains with the Indians to take up this task scientifically and thus do the best kind of humanitarian work. The mental diseases of the present generation are more acute than bodily diseases; it is quite fit and proper to take up the preaching of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* all over the world without delay. *Mahattamänäm abhidhāna* also means dictionary of great devotees, or a book full of the words of great devotees. Such a dictionary of the words of great devotees and those of the Lord are in the *Vedas* and allied literatures, specifically the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*.

TEXT 19

ku-Ta" PauNaGa*R<aTaae NaaMa TaSYa
MahtaMaEk-aNTaParaYa<aSYa)
Yaae_NaNTaXaiç->aRGavaNaNaNTaae
Mahd(Gau<aTvad(YaMaNaNTaMaahu")) 19))

kutaù punar gâëato nâma tasya

mahattamaikânta-paräyaëasya

yo 'nanta-çaktir bhagavân ananto

mahad-guëatväd yam anantam ähuù

SYNONYMS

kutaù—what to say; *punaù*—again; *gâëataù*—one who chants; *nâma*—holy name; *tasya*—His; *mahat-tama*—great devotees; *ekânta*—exclusive; *paräyaëasya*—of one who takes shelter of; *yaù*—He who; *ananta*—is the Unlimited; *çaktiù*—potency; *bhagavân*—the Personality of Godhead; *anantaù*—immeasurable; *mahat*—great; *guëatvät*—on account of such attributes; *yam*—whom; *anantam*—by the name *ananta*; *ähuù*—is called.

TRANSLATION

And what to speak of those who are under the direction of the great devotees, chanting the holy name of the Unlimited, who has unlimited potency? The Personality of Godhead, unlimited in potency and transcendental by attributes, is called the ananta [Unlimited].

PURPORT

The *dvija-bandhu*, or the less intelligent, uncultured men born of higher castes, put forward many arguments against the lower-caste men becoming *brahmanas* in this life. They argue that birth in a family of *sudras* or less than *sudras* is made possible by one's previous sinful acts and that one therefore has to complete the terms of disadvantages due to lower birth. And to answer these false logicians, *Srimad-Bhagavatam* asserts that

one who chants the holy name of the Lord under the direction of a pure devotee can at once get free from the disadvantages due to a lower-caste birth. A pure devotee of the Lord does not commit any offense while chanting the holy name of the Lord. There are ten different offenses in the chanting of the holy name of the Lord. To chant the holy name under the direction of a pure devotee is offenseless chanting. Offenseless chanting of the holy name of the Lord is transcendental, and, therefore, such chanting can at once purify one from the effects of all kinds of previous sins. This offenseless chanting indicates that one has fully understood the transcendental nature of the holy name and has thus surrendered unto the Lord. Transcendentally the holy name of the Lord and the Lord Himself are identical, being absolute. The holy name of the Lord is as powerful as the Lord. The Lord is the all-powerful Personality of Godhead, and He has innumerable names, which are all nondifferent from Him and are equally powerful also. In the last word of the *Bhagavad-gita* the Lord asserts that one who surrenders fully unto Him is protected from all sins by the grace of the Lord. Since His name and He Himself are identical, the holy name of the Lord can protect the devotee from all effects of sins. The chanting of the holy name of the Lord can undoubtedly deliver one from the disadvantages of a lower-caste birth. The Lord's unlimited power is extended on and on by the unlimited expansion of the devotees and incarnations, and thus every devotee of the Lord and incarnations also can be equally surcharged with the potency of the Lord. Since the devotee is surcharged with the potency of the Lord, even fractionally, the disqualification due to lower birth cannot stand in the way.

TEXT 20

WTaavTaal&/ NaNau SaUicTaeNa
 Gau<aErSaaMYaaNaiTaXaaYaNaSYa)
 ihTveTaraNa(Pa[aQaRYaTaae iv>aUiTa,
 YaRSYaax(iga]re<au& JauzTae_Na>aqPSaa")) 20))

etävatālaà nanu sücitena

guëair asämyänatiçäyanasya

hitvetarän prärthayato vibhütir

yasyäìghri-reëuà juñate 'nabhépsoù

SYNONYMS

etävatä—so far; *alam*—unnecessary; *nanu*—if at all; *sücitenä*—by description; *guëaiù*—by attributes; *asämya*—immeasurable; *anati-çäyanasya*—of one who is unexcelled; *hitvä*—leaving aside; *itarän*—others; *prärthayataù*—of those who ask for; *vibhütiù*—favor of the goddess of fortune; *yasya*—one whose; *aìghri*—feet; *reëum*—dust; *juñate*—serves; *anabhépsoù*—of one who is unwilling.

TRANSLATION

It is now ascertained that He [the Personality of Godhead] is unlimited and there is none equal to Him. Consequently no one can speak of Him adequately. Great demigods cannot obtain the favor of the goddess of fortune even by prayers, but this very goddess renders service unto the Lord, although He is unwilling to have such service.

PURPORT

The Personality of Godhead, or the Parameçvara Parabrahman, according to the *śrutis*, has nothing to do. He has no equal. Nor does anyone excel Him. He has unlimited potencies, and His every action is carried out systematically in His natural and perfect ways. Thus the Supreme Personality of Godhead is full in Himself, and He has nothing to accept from anyone else, including the great demigods like Brahmä. Others ask for the favor of the goddess of fortune, and despite such prayers she declines to award such favors. But still she renders service unto the Supreme Personality of Godhead, although He has nothing to accept from her. The Personality of Godhead in His Garbhodakaśāyī Viṣṇu feature begets Brahmä, the first created person in the material world, from His navel lotus stem and not in the womb of the goddess of fortune, who is eternally engaged in His service. These are some of the instances of His complete independence and perfection. That He has nothing to do does not mean

that He is impersonal. He is transcendently so full of inconceivable potencies that simply by His willing, everything is done without physical or personal endeavor. He is called, therefore, Yogesvara, or the Lord of all mystic powers.

TEXT 21

AQaaiPa YaTPaadNa%avSa*í&
JaGaiÜirÄaePaôTaahR<aaM>a")
SaeXa& PauNaaTYaNYaTaMaae Mauku-NdaTa(
k-ae NaaMa l/aeke- >aGavTPadaQaR")) 21))

athäpi yat-päda-nakhävasãñöaà

jagad viriicopahâtärhaëämbhaù

seçaà punäty anyatamo mukundät

ko nâma loke bhagavat-padärthaù

SYNONYMS

atha—therefore; *api*—certainly; *yat*—whose; *päda-nakha*—nails of the feet; *avasãñöam*—emanating; *jagat*—the whole universe; *viriiica*—Brahmäjé; *upahâta*—collected; *arhaëa*—worship; *ambhaù*—water; *sa*—along with; *éçam*—Lord Siva; *punäti*—purifies; *anyatamaù*—who else; *mukundät*—besides the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa; *kaù*—who; *nâma*—name; *loke*—within the world; *bhagavat*—Supreme Lord; *pada*—position; *arthaù*—worth.

TRANSLATION

Who can be worthy of the name of the Supreme Lord but the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa? Brahmäjé collected the water emanating from the nails of His feet in order to award it to Lord Siva as a worshipful welcome. This very water [the Ganges] is purifying the whole universe, including Lord Siva.

PURPORT

The conception of many gods in the Vedic literatures by the ignorant is completely wrong. The Lord is one without a second, but He expands Himself in many ways, and this is confirmed in the *Vedas*. Such expansions of the Lord are limitless, but some of them are the living entities. The living entities are not as powerful as the Lord's plenary expansions, and therefore there are two different types of expansions. Lord Brahmā is generally one of the living entities, and Lord Siva is the via medium between the Lord and the living entities. In other words, even demigods like Lord Brahmā and Lord Siva, who are the chief amongst all demigods, are never equal to or greater than Lord Viṣṇu, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The goddess of fortune, Lakṣmī, and all-powerful demigods like Brahmā and Siva are engaged in the worship of Viṣṇu or Lord Kṛṣṇa; therefore who can be more powerful than Mukunda (Lord Kṛṣṇa) to be factually called the Supreme Personality of Godhead? The goddess of fortune, Lakṣmījé, Lord Brahmā and Lord Siva are not independently powerful; they are powerful as expansions of the Supreme Lord, and all of them are engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord, and so also are the living entities. There are four sects of worshipful devotees of the Lord, and the chief amongst them are the Brahma-sampradāya, Rudra-sampradāya and Sri-sampradāya, descending directly from Lord Brahmā, Lord Siva and the goddess of fortune, Lakṣmī, respectively. Besides the above-mentioned three *sampradāyas*, there is the Kumāra-sampradāya, descending from Sanat-kumāra. All of the four original *sampradāyas* are still scrupulously engaged in the transcendental service of the Lord up to date, and they all declare that Lord Kṛṣṇa, Mukunda, is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and no other personality is equal to Him or greater than Him.

TEXT 22

Ya}aaNaurç-a" SahSaEv Daqra
VYaPaaeù dehaidzu Sa®MaU!Ma()
v]JaiNTa TaTPaarMah&SYaMaNTYa&
YaiSMaèih&SaaePaXaMa" SvDaMaR")) 22))

yatrānuraktāu sahasaiva dhérā

vyapohya dehädiñu saìgam üòham

vrajanti tat pärama-haàsyam antyaà

yasminn ahiàsopaçamaù sva-dharmaù

SYNONYMS

yatra—unto whom; *anuraktäù*—firmly attached; *sahasä*—all of a sudden; *eva*—certainly; *dhéräù*—self-controlled; *vyapohya*—leaving aside; *deha*—the gross body and subtle mind; *ädiñu*—relating to; *saìgam*—attachment; *üòham*—taken to; *vrajanti*—go away; *tat*—that; *pärama-haàsyam*—the highest stage of perfection; *antyaam*—and beyond that; *yasmin*—in which; *ahiàsä*—nonviolence; *upaçamaù*—and renunciation; *sva-dharmaù*—consequential occupation.

TRANSLATION

Self-controlled persons who are attached to the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa can all of a sudden give up the world of material attachment, including the gross body and subtle mind, and go away to attain the highest perfection of the renounced order of life, by which nonviolence and renunciation are consequential.

PURPORT

Only the self-controlled can gradually be attached to the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Self-controlled means not indulging in sense enjoyment more than is necessary. And those who are not self-controlled are given over to sense enjoyment. Dry philosophical speculation is a subtle sense enjoyment of the mind. Sense enjoyment leads one to the path of darkness. Those who are self-controlled can make progress on the path of liberation from the conditional life of material existence. The *Vedas*, therefore, enjoin that one should not go on the path of darkness but should make a progressive march towards the path of light or liberation. Self-control is actually achieved not by artificially stopping the senses from material enjoyment, but by becoming factually attached to the Supreme

Lord by engaging one's unalloyed senses in the transcendental service of the Lord. The senses cannot be forcibly curbed, but they can be given proper engagement. Purified senses, therefore, are always engaged in the transcendental service of the Lord. This perfectional stage of sense engagement is called *bhakti-yoga*. So those who are attached to the means of *bhakti-yoga* are factually self-controlled and can all of a sudden give up their homely or bodily attachment for the service of the Lord. This is called the *paramahamsa* stage. *Haàsas*, or swans, accept only milk out of a mixture of milk and water. Similarly, those who accept the service of the Lord instead of *mäyā's* service are called the *paramahamsas*. They are naturally qualified with all the good attributes, such as pridelessness, freedom from vanity, nonviolence, tolerance, simplicity, respectability, worship, devotion and sincerity. All these godly qualities exist in the devotee of the Lord spontaneously. Such *paramahamsas*, who are completely given up to the service of the Lord, are very rare. They are very rare even amongst the liberated souls. Real nonviolence means freedom from envy. In this world everyone is envious of his fellow being. But a perfect *paramahamsa*, being completely given up to the service of the Lord, is perfectly nonenvious. He loves every living being in relation with the Supreme Lord. Real renunciation means perfect dependence on God. Every living being is dependent on someone else because he is so made. Actually everyone is dependent on the mercy of the Supreme Lord, but when one forgets his relation with the Lord, he becomes dependent on the conditions of material nature. Renunciation means renouncing one's dependence on the conditions of material nature and thus becoming completely dependent on the mercy of the Lord. Real independence means complete faith in the mercy of the Lord without dependence on the conditions of matter. This *paramahamsa* stage is the highest perfectional stage in *bhakti-yoga*, the process of devotional service to the Supreme Lord.

TEXT 23

Ah& ih Pa*íae_YaRMa<aae >aviÜ,
 rac+a AaTMAavGaMaee_}a YaavaNa()
 Na>a" PaTaNTYaaTMaSaMa& PaTaiT}a<a,
 STaQaa SaMa& ivZ<auGaiTa& ivPaiêTa")) 23))

ahaà hi pãñöö 'ryamaëo bhavadbhir

äcakña ätmävagamo 'tra yävän

nabhaù patanty ätma-samaà patattriëas

tathä samaà viṣṇu-gatià vipaçcitaù

SYNONYMS

aham—my humble self; *hi*—certainly; *pãñööaù*—asked by you; *aryamaëaù*—as powerful as the sun; *bhavadbhiù*—by you; *äcakñe*—may describe; *ätmä-avagamaù*—as far as my knowledge is concerned; *atra*—herein; *yävän*—so far; *nabhaù*—sky; *patanti*—fly; *ätmä-samam*—as far as it can; *patattriëaù*—the birds; *tathä*—thus; *samam*—similarly; *viṣṇu-gatim*—knowledge of Viṣṇu; *vipaçcitaù*—even though learned.

TRANSLATION

O āñis, who are as powerfully pure as the sun, I shall try to describe to you the transcendental pastimes of Viṣṇu as far as my knowledge is concerned. As the birds fly in the sky as far as their capacity allows, so do the learned devotees describe the Lord as far as their realization allows.

PURPORT

The Supreme Absolute Truth is unlimited. No living being can know about the unlimited by his limited capacity. The Lord is impersonal, personal and localized. By His impersonal feature He is all-pervading Brahman, by His localized feature He is present in everyone's heart as the Supreme Soul, and by His ultimate personal feature He is the object of transcendental loving service by His fortunate associates the pure devotees. The pastimes of the Lord in different features can only be estimated partly by the great learned devotees. So Srila Sūta Gosvami has rightly taken this position in describing the pastimes of the Lord as far as he has realized. Factually only the Lord Himself can describe Himself, and His learned devotee also can describe Him as far as the Lord gives him the power of description.

TEXTS 24–25

Wk-da DaNauâÛMYa ivcrNa(Ma*GaYaa& vNae)
Ma*GaaNaNauGaTa" é[aNTa" +auDaTaSTa*izTaae >a*XaMa()) 24))
Jal/aXaYaMac+aa<a" Pa[ivveXa TaMaaé[MaMa()
ddXaR MauiNaMaaSaqNa& XaaNTa& Maqil/Tal/aecNaMa()) 25))

ekadä dhanur udyamya

vicaran mägayäà vane

mägän anugataù çräntaù

kñudhitas tãñito bhâçam

jaläçayam acakñäëaù

praviveça tam äçramam

dadarça munim äsénaà

çäntaà mélita-locanam

SYNONYMS

ekadä—once upon a time; *dhanuù*—arrows and bow; *udyamya*—taking firmly; *vicaran*—following; *mägayäm*—hunting excursion; *vane*—in the forest; *mägän*—stags; *anugataù*—while following; *çräntaù*—fatigued; *kñudhitaù*—hungry; *tãñitaù*—being thirsty; *bhâçam*—extremely; *jala-äçayam*—reservoir of water; *acakñäëaù*—while searching for; *praviveça*—entered into; *tam*—that famous; *äçramam*—hermitage of Çaméka Rsi; *dadarça*—saw; *munim*—the sage; *äsénam*—seated; *çäntam*—all silent; *mélita*—closed; *locanam*—eyes.

TRANSLATION

Once upon a time Mahäräja Parékñit, while engaged in hunting in the

forest with bow and arrows, became extremely fatigued, hungry and thirsty while following the stags. While searching for a reservoir of water, he entered the hermitage of the well-known Çaméka Rsi and saw the sage sitting silently with closed eyes.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord is so kind to His pure devotees that in proper time He calls such devotees up to Him and thus creates an auspicious circumstance for the devotee. Mahārāja Parékñit was a pure devotee of the Lord, and there was no reason for him to become extremely fatigued, hungry and thirsty because a devotee of the Lord never becomes perturbed by such bodily demands. But by the desire of the Lord, even such a devotee can become apparently fatigued and thirsty just to create a situation favorable for his renunciation of worldly activities. One has to give up all attachment for worldly relations before one is able to go back to Godhead, and thus when a devotee is too much absorbed in worldly affairs, the Lord creates a situation to cause indifference. The Supreme Lord never forgets His pure devotee, even though he may be engaged in so-called worldly affairs. Sometimes He creates an awkward situation, and the devotee becomes obliged to renounce all worldly affairs. The devotee can understand by the signal of the Lord, but others take it to be unfavorable and frustrating. Mahārāja Parékñit was to become the medium for the revelation of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* by Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, as his grandfather Arjuna was the medium for the *Bhagavad-gita*. Had Arjuna not been taken up with an illusion of family affection by the will of the Lord, the *Bhagavad-gita* would not have been spoken by the Lord Himself for the good of all concerned. Similarly, had Mahārāja Parékñit not been fatigued, hungry and thirsty at this time, *Srimad-Bhagavatam* would not have been spoken by Srila Çukadeva Gosvami, the prime authority of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. So this is a prelude to the circumstances under which *Srimad-Bhagavatam* was spoken for the benefit of all concerned. The prelude, therefore, begins with the words “once upon a time.”

TEXT 26

Pa[iTaåÖeiNd]YaPa[a<aMaNaaebuiÖMauPaarTaMa()

SQaaNa}aYaaTPar& Pa[aá& b]ø>aUTaMaivi§-YaMa()) 26))

pratiruddhendriya-präëa-

mano-buddhim upäratam

sthäna-trayät paraà prāptaà

brahma-bhütam avikriyam

SYNONYMS

pratiruddha—restrained; *indriya*—the sense organs; *präëa*—air of respiration; *manaù*—the mind; *buddhim*—intelligence; *upäratam*—inactive; *sthäna*—places; *trayät*—from the three; *param*—transcendental; *prāptam*—achieved; *brahma-bhütam*—qualitatively equal with the Supreme Absolute; *avikriyam*—unaffected.

TRANSLATION

The muni's sense organs, breath, mind and intelligence were all restrained from material activities, and he was situated in a trance apart from the three [wakefulness, dream and unconsciousness], having achieved a transcendental position qualitatively equal with the Supreme Absolute.

PURPORT

It appears that the *muni*, in whose hermitage the King entered, was in yogic trance. The transcendental position is attained by three processes, namely the process of *jñāna*, or theoretical knowledge of transcendence, the process of *yoga*, or factual realization of trance by manipulation of the physiological and psychological functions of the body, and the most approved process of *bhakti-yoga*, or the engagement of senses in the devotional service of the Lord. In the *Bhagavad-gita* also we have the information of the gradual development of perception from matter to a living entity. Our material mind and body develop from the living entity, the

soul, and being influenced by the three qualities of matter, we forget our real identity. The *jñāna* process theoretically speculates about the reality of the soul. But *bhakti-yoga* factually engages the spirit soul in activities. The perception of matter is transcended to still subtler states of the senses. The senses are transcended to the subtler mind, and then to breathing activities and gradually to intelligence. Beyond the intelligence, the living soul is realized by the mechanical activities of the *yoga* system, or practice of meditation restraining the senses, regulating the breathing system and applying intelligence to rise to the transcendental position. This trance stops all material activities of the body. The King saw the *muni* in that position. He also saw the *muni* as follows.

TEXT 27

ivPa[k-l<aRJa\$=aC^à& raErve<aaiJaNaeNa c)
ivéuZYataalu/âdk&- TaQaa>aUTaMaYaacTa)) 27))

viprakérëa-jaöäcchannaà

rauraveëäjina ca

viçuñyat-tälur udakaà

tathä-bhütam ayäcata

SYNONYMS

viprakérëa—all scattered; *jaöa-äcchannam*—covered with compressed, long hair; *rauraveëa*—by the skin of a stag; *ajinena*—by the skin; *ca*—also; *viçuñyat*—dried up; *tälu*—palate; *udakam*—water; *tathä-bhütam*—in that state; *ayäcata*—asked for.

TRANSLATION

The sage, in meditation, was covered by the skin of a stag, and long, compressed hair was scattered all over him. The King, whose palate was dry from thirst, asked him for water.

PURPORT

The King, being thirsty, asked the sage for water. That such a great devotee and king asked for water from a sage absorbed in trance was certainly providential. Otherwise there was no chance of such a unique happening. Mahārāja Parékñit was thus placed in an awkward position so that gradually *Srimad-Bhagavatam* could be revealed.

TEXT 28

AI/BDaTa*<a>aUMYaaidrSaMPa[aáagYaRSaUNa*Ta")
AvjaTaiMavaTMaaNa& MaNYaMaaNaêuk-aePa h)) 28))

alabdha-tāëa-bhümy-ädir

asamprāptārghya-sünâtaù

avajjātam ivātmānaà

manyamānaç cukopa ha

SYNONYMS

alabdha—having not received; *tāëa*—seat of straw; *bhümi*—place; *ädiù*—and so on; *asamprāpta*—not properly received; *arghya*—water for reception; *sünâtaù*—sweet words; *avajjātam*—thus being neglected; *iva*—like that; *ätmānam*—personally; *manyamānaù*—thinking like that; *cukopa*—became angry; *ha*—in that way.

TRANSLATION

The King, not received by any formal welcome by means of being offered a seat, place, water and sweet addresses, considered himself neglected, and so thinking he became angry.

PURPORT

The law of reception in the codes of the Vedic principles states that even if an enemy is received at home, he must be received with all respects. He should not be given a chance to understand that he has come into the house of an enemy. When Lord Kṛṣṇa, accompanied by Arjuna and Bhéma, approached Jaräsandha in Magadha, the respectable enemies were given a royal reception by King Jaräsandha. The guest enemy, namely Bhéma, was to fight with Jaräsandha, and yet they were given a grand reception. At night they used to sit down together as friends and guests, and in the day they used to fight, risking life and death. That was the law of reception. The reception law enjoins that a poor man, who has nothing to offer his guest, should be good enough to offer a straw mat for sitting, a glass of water for drinking and some sweet words. Therefore, to receive a guest, either friend or foe, there is no expense. It is only a question of good manners.

When Mahārāja Parékñit entered the door of Çaméka Rsi, he did not expect a royal reception by the *āñi* because he knew that saints and *āñis* are not materially rich men. But he never expected that a seat of straw, a glass of water and some sweet words would be denied to him. He was not an ordinary guest, nor was he an enemy of the *āñi*, and therefore the cold reception by the *āñi* astonished the King greatly. As a matter of fact, the King was right to get angry with the *āñi* when he needed a glass of water very badly. To become angry in such a grave situation was not unnatural for the King, but because the King himself was not less than a great saint, his becoming angry and taking action were astonishing. So it must be accepted that it was so ordained by the supreme will of the Lord. The King was a great devotee of the Lord, and the saint was also as good as the King. But by the will of the Lord, the circumstances were so created that they became ways to the King's becoming unattached to family connection and governmental activities and thus becoming a completely surrendered soul unto the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa. The merciful Lord sometimes creates such awkward positions for his pure devotees in order to drag them towards Himself from the mire of material existence. But outwardly the situations appear to be frustrating to the devotees. The devotees of the Lord are always under the protection of the Lord, and in any condition, frustration or success, the Lord is the supreme guide for the devotees. The pure devotees, therefore, accept all conditions of frustration as blessings from the Lord.

TEXT 29

A>aUTaPaUvR" SahSaa +auta*@(>YaaMaidRTaaTMaNa")
b]aø<a& Pa[TYa>aUd(b]øNa(MaTSarae MaNYaurev c)) 29))

abhüta-pürvaù sahasä

kñut-tåòbhyäm arditätmanaù

brahmanaà praty abhüd brahman

matsaro manyur eva ca

SYNONYMS

abhüta-pürvaù—unprecedented; *sahasä*—circumstantially; *kñut*—hunger; *tåòbhyäm*—as well as by thirst; *ardita*—being distressed; *ätmanaù*—of his self; *brahmanam*—unto a *brahmana*; *prati*—against; *abhüt*—became; *brahman*—O *brahmanas*; *matsaraù*—envious; *manyuù*—angry; *eva*—thus; *ca*—and.

TRANSLATION

O brahmanas, the King's anger and envy, directed toward the brahmana sage, were unprecedented, being that circumstances had made him hungry and thirsty.

PURPORT

For a king like Mahäräja Parékñit to become angry and envious, especially at a sage and *brahmana*, was undoubtedly unprecedented. The King knew well that *brahmanas*, sages, children, women and old men are always beyond the jurisdiction of punishment. Similarly, the king, even though he commits a great mistake, is never to be considered a wrongdoer. But in this case, Mahäräja Parékñit became angry and envious at the sage due to his thirst and hunger, by the will of the Lord. The King was right to punish his subject for coldly receiving him or neglecting him, but because the culprit

was a sage and a *brahmana*, it was unprecedented. As the Lord is never envious of anyone, so also the Lord's devotee is never envious of anyone. The only justification for Mahārāja Parékṣīt's behavior is that it was ordained by the Lord.

TEXT 30

Sa Tau b]ø%øzer&Sae GaTaaSauMaurGa& åza)
iviNaGaRC^NDaNauZk-ae\$ya iNaDaaYa PaurMaaGaTa")) 30))

sa tu brahma-åñer aàse

gatäsum uragaà ruñä

vinirgacchan dhanuñ-koöyā

nidhäya puram ägataù

SYNONYMS

saù—the King; *tu*—however; *brahma-åñeù*—of the *brahmana* sage; *aàse*—on the shoulder; *gata-asum*—lifeless; *uragam*—snake; *ruñä*—in anger; *vinirgacchan*—while leaving; *dhanuù-koöyā*—with the front of the bow; *nidhäya*—by placing it; *puram*—palace; *ägataù*—returned.

TRANSLATION

While leaving, the King, being so insulted, picked up a lifeless snake with his bow and angrily placed it on the shoulder of the sage. Then he returned to his palace.

PURPORT

The King thus treated the sage tit for tat, although he was never accustomed to such silly actions. By the will of the Lord, the King, while going away, found a dead snake in front of him, and he thought that the sage, who had coldly received him, thus might be coldly rewarded by being

offered a garland of a dead snake. In the ordinary course of dealing, this was not very unnatural, but in the case of Mahārāja Parékñit's dealing with a *brahmana* sage, this was certainly unprecedented. It so happened by the will of the Lord.

TEXT 31

**Wz ik&- iNa>a*TaaXaezk-r<aae Maqil/Tae+a<a")
Ma*zaSaMaaiDarahaeiSviTk&- Nau SYaaT+a}abNDaui>a")) 31))**

eña kià nibhâtäçeña-

karaëo mélitekñaëaù

mãñä-samädhir ähosvit

kià nu syät kñatra-bandhubhiù

SYNONYMS

eñaù—this; *kim*—whether; *nibhâta-açeña*—meditative mood; *karaëaù*—senses; *mélita*—closed; *ékñaëaù*—eyes; *mãñä*—false; *samädhìù*—trance; *äho*—remains; *svit*—if it is so; *kim*—either; *nu*—but; *syät*—may be; *kñatra-bandhubhiù*—by the lower *kñatriya*.

TRANSLATION

Upon returning, he began to contemplate and argue within himself whether the sage had actually been in meditation, with senses concentrated and eyes closed, or whether he had just been feigning trance just to avoid receiving a lower *kñatriya*.

PURPORT

The King, being a devotee of the Lord, did not approve of his own action, and thus he began to wonder whether the sage was really in a trance or was just pretending in order to avoid receiving the King, who was a *kñatriya*

and therefore lower in rank. Repentance comes in the mind of a good soul as soon as he commits something wrong. Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Öhäkura and Srila Jiva Gosvami do not believe that the King's action was due to his past misdeeds. The arrangement was so made by the Lord just to call the King back home, back to Godhead.

According to Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti, the plan was made by the will of the Lord, and by the will of the Lord the situation of frustration was created. The plan was that for his so-called misdeed the King could be cursed by an inexperienced *brahmana* boy infected by the influence of Kali, and thus the King would leave his hearth and home for good. His connections with Srila Çukadeva Gosvami would enable the presentation of the great *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, which is considered to be the book incarnation of the Lord. This book incarnation of the Lord gives much fascinating information of the transcendental pastimes of the Lord, like His *räsa-léla* with the spiritual cowherd damsels of Vrajabhümi. This specific pastime of the Lord has a special significance because anyone who properly learns about this particular pastime of the Lord will certainly be dissuaded from mundane sex desire and be placed on the path of sublime devotional service to the Lord. The pure devotee's mundane frustration is meant to elevate the devotee to a higher transcendental position. By placing Arjuna and the Pääòavas in frustration due to the intrigue of their cousin-brothers, the prelude of the Battle of Kurukñetra was created by the Lord. This was to incarnate the sound representative of the Lord, *Bhagavad-gita*. So by placing King Parékñit in an awkward position, the incarnation of *Srimad-Bhagavatam* was created by the will of the Lord. Being distressed by hunger and thirst was only a show, because the King endured much, even in the womb of his mother. He was never disturbed by the glaring heat of the *brahmästra* released by Açvatthämä. The King's distressed condition was certainly unprecedented. The devotees like Mahäräja Parékñit are powerful enough to forbear such distresses, by the will of the Lord, and they are never disturbed. The situation, in this case, was therefore all planned by the Lord.

TEXT 32

TaSYa Pau}aae_iTaTaeJaSvq ivhrNa(bal/k-ae_>aRkE-")

rajaga& Pa[aiPaTa& TaaTa& é[uTva Ta}aedMab]vqTa()) 32))

tasya putro 'titejasvé

viharan bälako 'rbhakaiù

räjïäghaà präpitaà tätaà

çrutvä tatredam abravét

SYNONYMS

tasya—his (the sage's); *putraù*—son; *ati*—extremely; *tejasvé*—powerful; *viharan*—while playing; *bälakaù*—with boys; *arbhakaiù*—who were all childish; *räjïä*—by the King; *agham*—distress; *präpitam*—made to have; *tätam*—the father; *çrutvä*—by hearing; *tatra*—then and there; *idam*—this; *abravét*—spoke.

TRANSLATION

The sage had a son who was very powerful, being a brahmana's son. While he was playing with inexperienced boys, he heard of his father's distress, which was occasioned by the King. Then and there the boy spoke as follows.

PURPORT

Due to Mahäräja Parékñit's good government, even a boy of tender age, who was playing with other inexperienced boys, could become as powerful as a qualified *brahmana*. This boy was known as Çäigi, and he achieved good training in *brahmacarya* by his father so that he could be as powerful as a *brahmana*, even at that age. But because the age of Kali was seeking an opportunity to spoil the cultural heritage of the four orders of life, the inexperienced boy gave a chance for the age of Kali to enter into the field of Vedic culture. Hatred of the lower orders of life began from this *brahmana* boy, under the influence of Kali, and thus cultural life began to dwindle day after day. The first victim of brahminical injustice was Mahäräja Parékñit,

and thus the protection given by the King against the onslaught of Kali was slackened.

TEXT 33

Ahae ADaMaR" Paal/aNaa& Paqvna& bil/>auJaaiMav)
SvaiMaNYaga& Yad(daSaaNaa& ÜarPaaNaa& éuNaaiMav)) 33))

aho adharmau pälänää

pévnää bali-bhujäm iva

sväminy aghaà yad däsänää

dvāra-pänää çunām iva

SYNONYMS

aho—just look at; *adharmau*—irreligion; *pälänām*—of the rulers; *pévnām*—of one who is brought up; *bali-bhujäm*—like the crows; *iva*—like; *svāmini*—unto the master; *agham*—sin; *yat*—what is; *däsänām*—of the servants; *dvāra-pänām*—keeping watch at the door; *çunām*—of the dogs; *iva*—like.

TRANSLATION

[The brahmana’s son, Çāṅgi, said:] O just look at the sins of the rulers who, like crows and watchdogs at the door, perpetrate sins against their masters, contrary to the principles governing servants.

PURPORT

The *brahmanas* are considered to be the head and brains of the social body, and the *kṣatriyas* are considered to be the arms of the social body. The arms are required to protect the body from all harm, but the arms must act according to the directions of the head and brain. That is a natural arrangement made by the supreme order, for it is confirmed in the *Bhagavad-gita* that four social orders or castes, namely the *brahmanas*, the

kṣatriyas, the *vaishyas* and the *sudras*, are set up according to quality and work done by them. Naturally the son of a *brahmana* has a good chance to become a *brahmana* by the direction of his qualified father, as a son of a medical practitioner has a very good chance to become a qualified medical practitioner. So the caste system is quite scientific. The son must take advantage of the father's qualification and thus become a *brahmana* or medical practitioner, and not otherwise. Without being qualified, one cannot become a *brahmana* or medical practitioner, and that is the verdict of all scriptures and social orders. Herein Çāṅgi, a qualified son of a great *brahmana*, attained the required brahminical power both by birth and by training, but he was lacking in culture because he was an inexperienced boy. By the influence of Kali, the son of a *brahmana* became puffed up with brahminical power and thus wrongly compared Mahārāja Parékñit to crows and watchdogs. The King is certainly the watchdog of the state in the sense that he keeps vigilant eyes over the border of the state for its protection and defense, but to address him as a watchdog is the sign of a less-cultured boy. Thus the downfall of the brahminical powers began as they gave importance to birthright without culture. The downfall of the *brahmana* caste began in the age of Kali. And since *brahmanas* are the heads of the social order, all other orders of society also began to deteriorate. This beginning of brahminical deterioration was highly deplored by the father of Çāṅgi, as we will find.

TEXT 34

b]aø<aE" +a}abNDauihR Ga*hPaal/ae iNaæiPaTa")
Sa k-Qa& Tad(Ga*he Üa"SQa" Sa>aa<@& >aaeçu-MahRiTā)) 34))

brahmanaiù kñātra-bandhur hi

gāha-pālo nirūpitaù

sa kathaà tad-gāhe dväù-sthaù

sabhäëòàà bhoktum arhati

SYNONYMS

brahmanaiù—by the brahminical order; *kñātra-bandhuù*—the sons of the *kṣatriyas*; *hi*—certainly; *gāha-pālaù*—the watchdog; *nirüpitaù*—designated; *saù*—he; *katham*—on what grounds; *tat-gāhe*—in the home of him (the master); *dväù-sthaù*—keeping at the door; *sa-bhāëòam*—in the same pot; *bhoktum*—to eat; *arhati*—deserves.

TRANSLATION

The descendants of the kingly orders are definitely designated as watchdogs, and they must keep themselves at the door. On what grounds can dogs enter the house and claim to dine with the master on the same plate?

PURPORT

The inexperienced *brahmana* boy certainly knew that the King asked for water from his father and the father did not respond. He tried to explain away his father's inhospitality in an impertinent manner befitting an uncultured boy. He was not at all sorry for the King's not being well received. On the contrary, he justified the wrong act in a way characteristic of the *brahmanas* of Kali-yuga. He compared the King to a watchdog, and so it was wrong for the King to enter the home of a *brahmana* and ask for water from the same pot. The dog is certainly reared by its master, but that does not mean that the dog shall claim to dine and drink from the same pot. This mentality of false prestige is the cause of downfall of the perfect social order, and we can see that in the beginning it was started by the inexperienced son of a *brahmana*. As the dog is never allowed to enter within the room and hearth, although it is reared by the master, similarly, according to Çāṅgi, the King had no right to enter the house of Çaméka Rsi. According to the boy's opinion, the King was on the wrong side and not his father, and thus he justified his silent father.

TEXT 35

k*-Z<ae GaTae >aGaviTa XaaSTaYauRTPaQaGaaiMaNaaMa()
TaiÜàSaeTaUNaÛah& XaaISMa PaXYaTa Mae bl/Ma()) 35))

kāñḥē gate bhagavati

ṣāstary utpatha-gāminām

tad bhinna-setün adyāhaà

ṣāsmi paṣyata me balam

SYNONYMS

kāñḥē—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *gate*—having departed from this world; *bhagavati*—the Personality of Godhead; *ṣāstari*—the supreme ruler; *utpatha-gāminām*—of those who are upstarts; *tad bhinna*—being separated; *setün*—the protector; *adya*—today; *aham*—myself; *ṣāsmi*—shall punish; *paṣyata*—just see; *me*—my; *balam*—prowess.

TRANSLATION

After the departure of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead and supreme ruler of everyone, these upstarts have flourished, our protector being gone. Therefore I myself shall take up this matter and punish them. Just witness my power.

PURPORT

The inexperienced *brahmana*, puffed up by a little *brahma-tejas*, became influenced by the spell of Kali-yuga. Mahārāja Parékñit gave license to Kali to live in four places as mentioned hereinbefore, but by his very expert government the personality of Kali could hardly find the places allotted him. The personality of Kali-yuga, therefore, was seeking the opportunity to establish authority, and by the grace of the Lord he found a hole in the puffed-up, inexperienced son of a *brahmana*. The little *brahmana* wanted to show his prowess in destruction, and he had the audacity to punish such a great king as Mahārāja Parékñit. He wanted to take the place of Lord Kṛṣṇa after His departure. These are the principal signs of upstarts who want to take the place of Sri Kṛṣṇa under the influence of the age of Kali. An upstart with a little power wants to become an incarnation of the Lord.

There are many false incarnations after the departure of Lord Kṛṣṇa from the face of the globe, and they are misleading the innocent public by accepting the spiritual obedience of the general mass of people to maintain false prestige. In other words, the personality of Kali got the opportunity to reign through this son of a *brahmana*, Çàigi.

TEXT 36

wTYauṁ-a raezTaaMa]a+aae vYaSYaaNa*izbal/k-")
k-aEiXaKYaaPa oPaSPa*XYa vaGvJa]& ivSaSaJaR h)) 36))

ity uktvā roṇa-tāmrākṇo

vayasyān āṇi-bālakaù

kauçiky-äpa upaspåçya

väg-vajraà visasarja ha

SYNONYMS

iti—thus; *uktvā*—saying; *roṇa-tāmra-akṇaù*—with red-hot eyes due to being angry; *vayasyān*—unto the playmates; *āṇi-bālakaù*—the son of a *āṇi*; *kauçiké*—the River Kauçika; *äpaù*—water; *upaspåçya*—by touching; *väk*—words; *vajram*—thunderbolt; *visasarja*—threw; *ha*—in the past.

TRANSLATION

The son of the āṇi, his eyes red-hot with anger, touched the water of the River Kauçika while speaking to his playmates and discharged the following thunderbolt of words.

PURPORT

The circumstances under which Mahārāja Parékṇit was cursed were simply childish, as it appears from this verse. Çàigi was showing his impudency amongst his playmates, who were innocent. Any sane man would have

prevented him from doing such great harm to all human society. By killing a king like Mahārāja Parékñit, just to make a show of acquired brahminical power, the inexperienced son of a *brahmana* committed a great mistake.

TEXT 37

wiTa l/i°TaMaYaaRd& Ta+ak-" SaáMae_hiNa)
d&+YaiTa SMa ku-l/a®ar& caeidTaae Mae TaTad]uhMa()) 37))

iti laìghita-maryädaà

takñakaù saptame 'hani

daikñyati sma kuläìgäraà

codito me tata-druham

SYNONYMS

iti—thus; *laìghita*—surpassing; *maryädam*—etiquette; *takñakaù*—snake-bird; *saptame*—on the seventh; *ahani*—day; *daikñyati*—will bite; *sma*—certainly; *kula-aìgäram*—the wretched of the dynasty; *coditaù*—having done; *me*—my; *tata-druham*—enmity towards the father.

TRANSLATION

The brahmana's son cursed the King thus: On the seventh day from today a snake-bird will bite the most wretched one of that dynasty [Mahārāja Parékñit] because of his having broken the laws of etiquette by insulting my father.

PURPORT

Thus the beginning of the misuse of brahminical power began, and gradually the *brahmanas* in the age of Kali became devoid of both brahminical powers and culture. The *brahmana* boy considered Mahārāja Parékñit to be *kuläìgära*, or the wretched of the dynasty, but factually the

brahmana boy himself was so because only from him did the *brahmana* caste become powerless, like the snake whose poisoned teeth are broken. The snake is fearful as long as his poison teeth are there, otherwise he is fearful only to children. The personality of Kali conquered the *brahmana* boy first, and gradually the other castes. Thus the whole scientific system of the orders of society in this age has assumed the form of a vitiated caste system, which is now being uprooted by another class of men similarly influenced by the age of Kali. One should see to the root cause of vitiation and not try to condemn the system as it is, without knowledge of its scientific value.

TEXT 38

TaTaae_>YaeTYaaé[Ma& bal/ae Gale/ SaPaRk-le/vrMa()
iPaTar& vq+Ya du"%aTaaeR Mauç-k-<#=ae åraed h)) 38))

tato 'bhyetyäçramaà bālo

gale sarpa-kalevaram

pitaraà vékñya duùkhārto

mukta-kaëöho ruroda ha

SYNONYMS

tataù—thereafter; *abhyetya*—after entering into; *äçramam*—the hermitage; *bālaù*—boy; *gale sarpa*—the snake on the shoulder; *kalevaram*—body; *pitaram*—unto the father; *vékñya*—having seen; *duùkha-ärtaù*—in a sorry plight; *mukta-kaëöhaù*—loudly; *ruroda*—cried; *ha*—in the past.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, when the boy returned to the hermitage, he saw a snake on his father's shoulder, and out of his grief he cried very loudly.

PURPORT

The boy was not happy because he committed a great mistake, and he wanted to be relieved of the burden on his heart by crying. So after entering the hermitage and seeing his father in that condition, he cried loudly so that he might be relieved. But it was too late. The father regretted the whole incident.

TEXT 39

**Sa va Aai®rSaae b]øNa(é[uTva SauTaivl/aPaNaMa()
oNMaqLYa XaNakE-NaeR}ae d*îa ca&Sae Ma*TaaerGaMa()) 39))**

sa vä äìgiraso brahman

çrutvä suta-viläpanam

unmélya çanakair netre

dãñövä cäàse mâtoraḡam

SYNONYMS

saù—he; *vai*—also; *äìgirasaù*—the *ãñi* born in the family of Aìgirä; *brahman*—O Çaunaka; *çrutvä*—on hearing; *suta*—his son; *viläpanam*—crying in distress; *unmélya*—opening; *çanakaiù*—gradually; *netre*—by the eyes; *dãñövä*—by seeing; *ca*—also; *aàse*—on the shoulder; *mâta*—dead; *uragam*—snake.

TRANSLATION

O brahmanas, the *ãñi*, who was born in the family of Aìgirä Muni, hearing his son crying, gradually opened his eyes and saw the dead snake around his neck.

TEXT 40

ivSa*JYa Ta& c PaPa[C^ vTSa k-SMaaiÖ raeidiz)
ke-Na va Tae_Pak*-TaiMaTYauç-" Sa NYavedYaTa()) 40))

visājya taà ca papraccha

vatsa kasmäd dhi rodiñi

kena vä te 'pakātam

ity uktaù sa nyavedayat

SYNONYMS

visājya—throwing aside; *tam*—that; *ca*—also; *papraccha*—asked; *vatsa*—my dear son; *kasmät*—what for; *hi*—certainly; *rodiñi*—crying; *kena*—by whom; *vä*—otherwise; *te*—they; *apakātam*—misbehaved; *iti*—thus; *uktaù*—being asked; *saù*—the boy; *nyavedayat*—informed of everything.

TRANSLATION

He threw the dead snake aside and asked his son why he was crying, whether anyone had done him harm. On hearing this, the son explained to him what had happened.

PURPORT

The father did not take the dead snake on his neck very seriously. He simply threw it away. Actually there was nothing seriously wrong in Mahārāja Parékñit's act, but the foolish son took it very seriously, and being influenced by Kali he cursed the King and thus ended a chapter of happy history.

TEXT 41

iNaXaMYa XaáMaTadh| NareNd]&
Sa b]aø<aae NaaTMaJaMa>YaNaNdTa()
Ahae bTaa&hae MahdÛ Tae k*-Ta,

MaLPaqYaiSa d]aeh oådRMaae Da*Ta")) 41))

niçamyā çaptam atat-arhaà narendraà

sa brähmaëo nätmajam abhyanandat

aho batäàho mahad adya te kâtam

alpéyasi droha urur damo dhâtaù

SYNONYMS

niçamyā—after hearing; *çaptam*—cursed; *atat-arham*—never to be condemned; *nara-indram*—unto the King, best of humankind; *saù*—that; *brahmanaù*—*brahmana-ãñi*; *na*—not; *ätma-jam*—his own son; *abhyanandat*—congratulated; *aho*—alas; *bata*—distressing; *aàhaù*—sins; *mahat*—great; *adya*—today; *te*—yourself; *kâtam*—performed; *alpéyasi*—insignificant; *drohe*—offense; *uruù*—very great; *damaù*—punishment; *dhâtaù*—awarded.

TRANSLATION

The father heard from his son that the King had been cursed, although he should never have been condemned, for he was the best amongst all human beings. The ãñi did not congratulate his son, but, on the contrary, began to repent, saying: Alas! What a great sinful act was performed by my son. He has awarded heavy punishment for an insignificant offense.

PURPORT

The king is the best of all human beings. He is the representative of God, and he is never to be condemned for any of his actions. In other words, the king can do no wrong. The king may order hanging of a culprit son of a *brahmana*, but he does not become sinful for killing a *brahmana*. Even if there is something wrong with the king, he is never to be condemned. A medical practitioner may kill a patient by mistaken treatment, but such a killer is never condemned to death. So what to speak of a good and pious

king like Mahārāja Parékñit? In the Vedic way of life, the king is trained to become a *rājarñi*, or a great saint, although he is ruling as king. It is the king only by whose good government the citizens can live peacefully and without any fear. The *rājarñis* would manage their kingdoms so nicely and piously that their subjects would respect them as if they were the Lord. That is the instruction of the *Vedas*. The king is called *narendra*, or the best amongst the human beings. How then could a king like Mahārāja Parékñit be condemned by an inexperienced, puffed-up son of a *brahmaëa*, even though he had attained the powers of a qualified *brahmana*?

Since Çaméka Rsi was an experienced, good *brahmana*, he did not approve of the actions of his condemned son. He began to lament for all that his son had done. The king was beyond the jurisdiction of curses as a general rule, and what to speak of a good king like Mahārāja Parékñit. The offense of the King was most insignificant, and his being condemned to death was certainly a very great sin for Çāṅgi. Therefore Rsi Çaméka regretted the whole incident.

TEXT 42

Na vE Na*i>aNaRrdev& Para:Ya&
SaMMaaTauMahRSYaivPaKvbuÖe)
YataeJaSaa duivRzhe<a Gauáa
ivNdiNTa >ad]a<Yaku-Taae>aYaa" Pa[Jaa")) 42))

na vai nābhir nara-devaà parākhyà

sammätum arhasy avipakva-buddhe

yat-tejasä durviñhaheëa guptä

vindanti bhadräëy akutobhayäù prajāù

SYNONYMS

na—never; *vai*—as a matter of fact; *nābhiù*—by any man; *nara-devam*—unto a man-god; *para-ākhyam*—who is transcendental; *sammätum*—place

on equal footing; *arhasi*—by the prowess; *avipakva*—unripe or immature; *buddhe*—intelligence; *yat*—of whom; *tejasä*—by the prowess; *durviñhaheëa*—unsurpassable; *guptäù*—protected; *vindanti*—enjoys; *bhadräëi*—all prosperity; *akutaù-bhayäù*—completely defended; *prajāù*—the subjects.

TRANSLATION

O my boy, your intelligence is immature, and therefore you have no knowledge that the king, who is the best amongst human beings, is as good as the Personality of Godhead. He is never to be placed on an equal footing with common men. The citizens of the state live in prosperity, being protected by his unsurpassable prowess.

TEXT 43

Al/+YaMaa<ae NardevNaaiMan
rQaa®Paa<aavYaMa® I/aek-")
Tada ih caErPa[curae ivNa&+Ya,
TYar+YaMaa<aae_ivvæQavTa(+a<aaTa()) 43))

alakñyamäëe nara-deva-nämni

rathäiga-päëäv ayam aiga lokaù

tadä hi caura-pracuro vinaikñyaty

arakñyamäëo 'vivarüthavat kñäëät

SYNONYMS

alakñyamäëe—being abolished; *nara-deva*—monarchical; *nämni*—of the name; *ratha-aiga-päëau*—the representative of the Lord; *ayam*—this; *aiga*—O my boy; *lokaù*—this world; *tadä hi*—at once; *caura*—thieves; *pracuraù*—too much; *vinaikñyati*—vanquishes; *arakñyamäëau*—being not protected; *avivarütha-vat*—like lambs; *kñäëät*—at once.

TRANSLATION

My dear boy, the Lord, who carries the wheel of a chariot, is represented by the monarchical regime, and when this regime is abolished the whole world becomes filled with thieves, who then at once vanquish the unprotected subjects like scattered lambs.

PURPORT

According to *Srimad-Bhagavatam* the monarchical regime represents the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead. The king is said to be the representative of the Absolute Personality of Godhead because he is trained to acquire the qualities of God to protect the living beings. The Battle of Kurukñetra was planned by the Lord to establish the real representative of the Lord, Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. An ideal king thoroughly trained by culture and devotional service with the martial spirit makes a perfect king. Such a personal monarchy is far better than the so-called democracy of no training and responsibility. The thieves and rogues of modern democracy seek election by misrepresentation of votes, and the successful rogues and thieves devour the mass of population. One trained monarch is far better than hundreds of useless ministerial rogues, and it is hinted herein that by abolition of a monarchical regime like that of Mahārāja Parékñit, the mass of people become open to many attacks of the age of Kali. They are never happy in an overly advertised form of democracy. The result of such a kingless administration is described in the following verses.

TEXT 44

**TadÔ Na" PaaPaMauPaETYaNaNvYa&
YaàíNaaQaSYa vSaaeivRlu/MPak-aTa()
ParSPar& ganiNTa XaPaiNTa v*ÅTae
PaéUNa(iñYaae_QaaRNA(PauådSYavae JaNaa")) 44))**

tad adya naù päpam upaity ananvayaà

yan nañöa-näthasya vasor vilumpakät

parasparaà ghnanti çapanti vâijate

paçün striyo 'rthän puru-dasyavo janäù

SYNONYMS

tat—for this reason; *adya*—from this day; *naù*—upon us; *päpam*—reaction of sin; *upaiti*—will overtake; *ananvayam*—disruption; *yat*—because; *nañöa*—abolished; *näthasya*—of the monarch; *vasoù*—of wealth; *vilumpakät*—being plundered; *parasparam*—between one another; *ghnanti*—will kill; *çapanti*—will do harm; *vâijate*—will steal; *paçün*—animals; *striyaù*—women; *arthän*—riches; *puru*—greatly; *dasyavaù*—thieves; *janäù*—the mass of people.

TRANSLATION

Due to the termination of the monarchical regimes and the plundering of the people's wealth by rogues and thieves, there will be great social disruptions. People will be killed and injured, and animals and women will be stolen. And for all these sins we shall be responsible.

PURPORT

The word *naù* (we) is very significant in this verse. The sage rightly takes the responsibility of the *brahmanas* as a community for killing monarchical government and thus giving an opportunity to the so-called democrats, who are generally plunderers of the wealth of the state subjects. The so-called democrats capture the administrative machine without assuming responsibility for the prosperous condition of the citizens. Everyone captures the post for personal gratification, and thus instead of one king, a number of irresponsible kings grow up to tax the citizens. It is foretold herein that in the absence of good monarchical government, everyone will be the cause of disturbance for others by plundering riches, animals, women, etc.

TEXT 45

TadaYaRDaMaR" Pa[ivl/IYaTae Na*<aa&
v<aaRé[MaacarYauTañYaQMaYa")
TaTaae_QaRk-aMaai>aiNaveiXaTaaTMaNaa&
éuNaa& k-PaqNaaiMav v<aRSa³r")) 45))

tadärya-dharmaù praviléyate nãëää

varëääçramäcära-yutas trayémayaù

tato 'rtha-kämäbhiniveçitätmanää

çunää kapénäm iva varëa-saìkaraù

SYNONYMS

tadä—at that time; *ärya*—progressive civilization; *dharmaù*—engagement; *praviléyate*—is systematically vanquished; *nãëäm*—of humankind; *varëa*—caste; *äçrama*—orders of society; *äcära-yutaù*—composed in a good manner; *trayé-mayaù*—in terms of the Vedic injunction; *tataù*—thereafter; *artha*—economic development; *käma-abhiniveçita*—fully absorbed in sense gratification; *ätmanäm*—of men; *çunäm*—like dogs; *kapénäm*—like monkeys; *iva*—thus; *varëa-saìkaraù*—unwanted population.

TRANSLATION

At that time the people in general will fall systematically from the path of a progressive civilization in respect to the qualitative engagements of the castes and the orders of society and the Vedic injunctions. Thus they will be more attracted to economic development for sense gratification, and as a result there will be an unwanted population on the level of dogs and monkeys.

PURPORT

It is foretold herein that in the absence of a monarchical regime, the general mass of people will be an unwanted population like dogs and monkeys. As the monkeys are too sexually inclined and dogs are shameless

in sexual intercourse, the general mass of population born of illegitimate connection will systematically go astray from the Vedic way of good manners and qualitative engagements in the castes and orders of life.

The Vedic way of life is the progressive march of the civilization of the Äryans. The Äryans are progressive in Vedic civilization. The Vedic civilization's destination is to go back to Godhead, back home, where there is no birth, no death, no old age and no disease. The *Vedas* direct everyone not to remain in the darkness of the material world but to go towards the light of the spiritual kingdom far beyond the material sky. The qualitative caste system and the orders of life are scientifically planned by the Lord and His representatives, the great *āñis*. The perfect way of life gives all sorts of instruction in things both material and spiritual. The Vedic way of life does not allow any man to be like the monkeys and dogs. A degraded civilization of sense gratification and economic development is the by-product of a godless or kingless government of the people, by the people, and for the people. The people should not, therefore, begrudge the poor administrations they themselves elect.

TEXT 46

DaMaRPaal/ae NarPaiTa" Sa Tau SaMa]a@(b*hC^\va")
Saa+aaNMaha>aaGavTaae raJaizRhRYaMaeDaYaa\$()
+auta*\$(é[MaYauTaae dqNaae NaEvaSMaC^aPaMahRiTā)) 46))

dharma-pālo nara-patīu

sa tu samrāò bāhac-chravāu

sākñān mahā-bhāgavato

rājarñir haya-medhayāo

kñut-tāo-çrama-yuto déno

naivāsmac chāpam arhati

SYNONYMS

dharma-pāla—the protector of religion; *nara-pati*—the King; *sa*—he; *tu*—but; *samrāṭ*—Emperor; *bāhat*—highly; *çravā*—celebrated; *sākñāt*—directly; *mahā-bhāgavata*—the first-class devotee of the Lord; *rāja-āñi*—saint amongst the royal order; *haya-medhayā*—great performer of horse sacrifices; *kñut*—hunger; *tā*—thirst; *çrama-yuta*—tired and fatigued; *dēna*—stricken; *na*—never; *eva*—thus; *asmat*—by us; *çāpam*—curse; *arhati*—deserves.

TRANSLATION

The Emperor Parékñit is a pious king. He is highly celebrated and is a first-class devotee of the Personality of Godhead. He is a saint amongst royalty, and he has performed many horse sacrifices. When such a king is tired and fatigued, being stricken with hunger and thirst, he does not at all deserve to be cursed.

PURPORT

After explaining the general codes relating to the royal position and asserting that the king can do no wrong and therefore is never to be condemned, the sage Çaméka wanted to say something about Emperor Parékñit specifically. The specific qualification of Mahārāja Parékñit is summarized herein. The King, even calculated as a king only, was most celebrated as a ruler who administered the religious principles of the royal order. In the *sastras* the duties of all castes and orders of society are prescribed. All the qualities of a *kñatriya* mentioned in the ***Bhagavad-gita*** (18.43) were present in the person of the Emperor. He was also a great devotee of the Lord and a self-realized soul. Cursing such a king, when he was tired and fatigued with hunger and thirst, was not at all proper. Çaméka Rsi thus admitted from all sides that Mahārāja Parékñit was cursed most unjustly. Although all the *brahmanas* were aloof from the incident, still for the childish action of a *brahmana* boy the whole world situation was changed. Thus Rsi Çaméka, a *brahmana*, took responsibility for all deterioration of the good orders of the world.

TEXT 47

APaaPaezu Sv>a*TYaezu bale/NaaPaKvbuiÖNaa)
PaaPa& k*-Ta& TaÜGavaNa(SavaRTMaa +aNTauMahRiTā)) 47))

apāpeñu sva-bhātyeñu

bālenāpakva-buddhinā

pāpaà kātāà tad bhagavān

sarvātmā kñantum arhati

SYNONYMS

apāpeñu—unto one who is completely free from all sins; *sva-bhātyeñu*—unto one who is subordinate and deserves to be protected; *bālena*—by a child; *apakva*—who is immature; *buddhinā*—by intelligence; *pāpam*—sinful act; *kātām*—has been done; *tad bhagavān*—therefore the Personality of Godhead; *sarva-ātmā*—who is all-pervading; *kñantum*—just to pardon; *arhati*—deserve.

TRANSLATION

Then the āñi prayed to the all-pervading Personality of Godhead to pardon his immature boy, who had no intelligence and who committed the great sin of cursing a person who was completely free from all sins, who was subordinate and who deserved to be protected.

PURPORT

Everyone is responsible for his own action, either pious or sinful. Rsi Çaméka could foresee that his son had committed a great sin by cursing Mahārāja Parékñit, who deserved to be protected by the *brahmanas*, for he was a pious ruler and completely free from all sins because of his being a first-class devotee of the Lord. When an offense is done unto the devotee of the Lord, it is very difficult to overcome the reaction. The *brahmanas*,

being at the head of the social orders, are meant to give protection to their subordinates and not to curse them. There are occasions when a *brahmana* may furiously curse a subordinate *kṇātriya* or *vaiçya*, etc., but in the case of Mahārāja Parékñit there were no grounds, as already explained. The foolish boy had done it out of sheer vanity in being a *brahmana*'s son, and thus he became liable to be punished by the law of God. The Lord never forgives a person who condemns His pure devotee. Therefore, by cursing a king the foolish Çàigi had committed not only a sin but also the greatest offense. Therefore the *āñi* could foresee that only the Supreme Personality of Godhead could save his boy from his sinful act. He therefore directly prayed for pardon from the Supreme Lord, who alone can undo a thing which is impossible to change. The appeal was made in the name of a foolish boy who had developed no intelligence at all.

A question may be raised herein that since it was the desire of the Lord that Parékñit Mahārāja be put into that awkward position so that he might be delivered from material existence, then why was a *brahmana*'s son made responsible for this offensive act? The answer is that the offensive act was performed by a child only so that he could be excused very easily, and thus the prayer of the father was accepted. But if the question is raised why the *brahmana* community as a whole was made responsible for allowing Kali into the world affairs, the answer is given in the *Varāha Purana* that the demons who acted inimically toward the Personality of Godhead but were not killed by the Lord were allowed to take birth in the families of *brahmanas* to take advantage of the age of Kali. The all-merciful Lord gave them a chance to have their births in the families of pious *brahmanas* so that they could progress toward salvation. But the demons, instead of utilizing the good opportunity, misused the brahminical culture due to being puffed up by vanity in becoming *brahmanas*. The typical example is the son of Çaméka Rsi, and all the foolish sons of *brahmanas* are warned hereby not to become as foolish as Çàigi and be always on guard against the demoniac qualities which they had in their previous births. The foolish boy was, of course, excused by the Lord, but others, who may not have a father like Çaméka Rsi, will be put into great difficulty if they misuse the advantages obtained by birth in a *brahmana* family.

TEXT 48

iTarSk*-Taa ivPa[l/BDaa" Xaáa" i+aáa hTaa AiPa)
NaaSYa TaTa(Pa[iTaku-vRiNTa TaÜÇ-a" Pa[>avae_iPa ih)) 48))

tiraskâtä vipralabdhäù

çaptäù kñiptä hatä api

näsya tat pratikurvanti

tad-bhaktäù prabhavo 'pi hi

SYNONYMS

tiraù-kâtäù—being defamed; *vipralabdhäù*—being cheated; *çaptäù*—being cursed; *kñiptäù*—disturbed by negligence; *hatäù*—or even being killed; *api*—also; *na*—never; *asya*—for all these acts; *tat*—them; *pratikurvanti*—counteract; *tat*—the Lord's; *bhaktäù*—devotees; *prabhavaù*—powerful; *api*—although; *hi*—certainly.

TRANSLATION

The devotees of the Lord are so forbearing that even though they are defamed, cheated, cursed, disturbed, neglected or even killed, they are never inclined to avenge themselves.

PURPORT

Rsi Çaméka also knew that the Lord does not forgive a person who has committed an offense at the feet of a devotee. The Lord can only give direction to take shelter of the devotee. He thought within himself that if Mahäräja Parékñit would countercurse the boy, he might be saved. But he knew also that a pure devotee is callous about worldly advantages or reverses. As such, the devotees are never inclined to counteract personal defamation, curses, negligence, etc. As far as such things are concerned, in personal affairs the devotees do not care for them. But in the case of their being performed against the Lord and His devotees, then the devotees take very strong action. It was a personal affair, and therefore Çaméka Rsi knew

that the King would not take counteraction. Thus there was no alternative than to place an appeal to the Lord for the immature boy.

It is not that only the *brahmanas* are powerful enough to award curses or blessings upon the subordinates; the devotee of the Lord, even though he may not be a *brahmana*, is more powerful than a *brahmana*. But a powerful devotee never misuses the power for personal benefit. Whatever power the devotee may have is always utilized in service towards the Lord and His devotees only.

TEXT 49

wiTa Pau}ak*-TaagaeNa Saae_NauTaáae MahaMauNa")
SvYa& ivPa[k*-Taae raja NaEvaga& TadicNTaYaTa()) 49))

iti putra-kâtāghena

so 'nutapto mahā-muniù

svayaà viprakāto rājīā

naivāghaà tad acintayat

SYNONYMS

iti—thus; *putra*—son; *kāta*—done by; *aghena*—by the sin; *saù*—he (the *muni*); *anutaptaù*—regretting; *mahā-muniù*—the sage; *svayam*—personally; *viprakātaù*—being so insulted; *rājīā*—by the King; *na*—not; *eva*—certainly; *agham*—the sin; *tat*—that; *acintayat*—thought of it.

TRANSLATION

The sage thus regretted the sin committed by his own son. He did not take the insult paid by the King very seriously.

PURPORT

The whole incident is now cleared up. Mahārāja Parékñit's garlanding the sage with a dead snake was not at all a very serious offense, but Çāṅgi's cursing the King was a serious offense. The serious offense was committed by a foolish child only; therefore he deserved to be pardoned by the Supreme Lord, although it was not possible to get free from the sinful reaction. Mahārāja Parékñit also did not mind the curse offered to him by a foolish *brahmana*. On the contrary, he took full advantage of the awkward situation, and by the great will of the Lord, Mahārāja Parékñit achieved the highest perfection of life through the grace of Srila Çukadeva Gosvami. Actually it was the desire of the Lord, and Mahārāja Parékñit, Rsi Çaméka and his son Çāṅgi were all instrumental in fulfilling the desire of the Lord. So none of them were put into difficulty because everything was done in relation with the Supreme Person.

TEXT 50

**Pa[aYaXa" SaaDavae I/aeke- ParEÜRNÜezu YaaeiJaTaa")
Na VYaQaiNTa Na ôZYaiNTa YaTa AaTMaa_Gau<aaé[Ya")) 50))**

prāyaçaù sādhave loka

parai dvandveṇu yojitāu

na vyathanti na hñyanti

yata ātmāguëāçrayaù

SYNONYMS

prāyaçaù—generally; *sādhave*—saints; *loka*—in this world; *parai*—by others; *dvandveṇu*—in duality; *yojitāu*—being engaged; *na*—never; *vyathanti*—distressed; *na*—nor; *hñyanti*—takes pleasure; *yata*—because; *ātmā*—self; *guëa-āçrayaù*—transcendental.

TRANSLATION

Generally the transcendentalists, even though engaged by others in the

dualities of the material world, are not distressed. Nor do they take pleasure [in worldly things], for they are transcendently engaged.

PURPORT

The transcendentalists are the empiric philosophers, the mystics and the devotees of the Lord. Empiric philosophers aim at the perfection of merging into the being of the Absolute, mystics aim at perceiving the all-pervading Supersoul, and the devotees of the Lord are engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Personality of Godhead. Since Brahman, Paramātmā and Bhagavān are different phases of the same Transcendence, all these transcendentalists are beyond the three modes of material nature. Material distresses and happinesses are products of the three modes, and therefore the causes of such material distress and happiness have nothing to do with the transcendentalists. The King was a devotee, and the *āñi* was a mystic. Therefore both of them were unattached to the accidental incident created by the supreme will. The playful child was an instrument in fulfilling the Lord's will.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Eighteenth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "Mahārāja Parékñit Cursed by a Brāhmaëa Boy."

Chapter Nineteen

The Appearance of Çukadeva Gosvami

TEXT 1

SaUTa ovac

**MahqPaiTaSTvQa TaTk-MaR Gaù|
ivicNTaYaàaTMak*-Ta& SauduMaRNaa")
Ahae MaYaa NaqcMaNaaYaRvTk*-Ta&
iNaraGaiSa b]øi<a GaU!TaeJaiSa)) 1))**

sūta uvāca

mahé-patis tv atha tat-karma garhyaà

vicintayann ätma-kåtaà sudurmanäù

aho mayä nécam anärya-vat kåtaà

nirägasi brahmaëi güðha-tejasi

SYNONYMS

sütaù uväca—Süta Gosvami said; *mahé-patiù*—the King; *tu*—but; *atha*—thus (while coming back home); *tat*—that; *karma*—act; *garhyam*—abominable; *vicintayan*—thus thinking; *ätma-kåtam*—done by himself; *sudurmanäù*—very much depressed; *aho*—alas; *mayä*—by me; *nécam*—heinous; *anärya*—uncivilized; *vat*—like; *kåtam*—done; *nirägasi*—unto one who is faultless; *brahmaëi*—unto a *brahmana*; *güðha*—grave; *tejasi*—unto the powerful.

TRANSLATION

Sri Süta Gosvami said: While returning home, the King [Mahäräja Parékñit] felt that the act he had committed against the faultless and powerful brahmana was heinous and uncivilized. Consequently he was distressed.

PURPORT

The pious King regretted his accidental improper treatment of the powerful *brahmana*, who was faultless. Such repentance is natural for a good man like the King, and such repentance delivers a devotee from all kinds of sins accidentally committed. The devotees are naturally faultless. Accidental sins committed by a devotee are sincerely regretted, and by the grace of the Lord all sins unwillingly committed by a devotee are burnt in the fire of repentance.

TEXT 2

Da]uv& TaTaae Mae k*-Tadevhel/Naad(
durTYaYa& VYaSaNa& NaaiTadqgaaRTa()
TadSTau k-aMa& ùgaiNaZk*-TaaYa Mae
YaQaa Na ku-Yaa| PauNarevMaÖa)) 2))

dhruvaà tato me kâta-deva-helanäd

duratyayaà vyasanaà näti-dérghät

tad astu kämaà hy agha-niñkâtäya me

yathä na kuryäà punar evam addhä

SYNONYMS

dhruvam—sure and certain; *tataù*—therefore; *me*—my; *kâta-deva-helanät*—because of disobeying the orders of the Lord; *duratyayam*—very difficult; *vyasanam*—calamity; *na*—not; *ati*—greatly; *dérghät*—far off; *tat*—that; *astu*—let it be; *kämam*—desire without reservations; *hi*—certainly; *agha*—sins; *niñkâtäya*—for getting free; *me*—my; *yathä*—so that; *na*—never; *kuryäm*—shall I do it; *punaù*—again; *evam*—as I have done; *addhä*—directly.

TRANSLATION

[King Parékñit thought:] Due to my neglecting the injunctions of the Supreme Lord I must certainly expect some difficulty to overcome me in the near future. I now desire without reservation that the calamity come now, for in this way I may be freed of the sinful action and not commit such an offense again.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord enjoins that *brahmanas* and cows must be given all protection. The Lord is Himself very much inclined to do good to *brahmanas* and cows (*go-brahmana-hitäya ca*). Mahäräja Parékñit knew all this, and thus he concluded that his insulting a powerful *brahmana* was

certainly to be punished by the laws of the Lord, and he was expecting something very difficult in the very near future. He therefore desired the imminent calamity to fall on him and not on his family members. A man's personal misconduct affects all his family members. Therefore Mahārāja Parékñit desired the calamity to fall on him alone. By suffering personally he would be restrained from future sins, and at the same time the sin which he had committed would be counteracted so that his descendants would not suffer. That is the way a responsible devotee thinks. The family members of a devotee also share the effects of a devotee's service unto the Lord. Mahārāja Prahlāda saved his demon father by his personal devotional service. A devotee son in the family is the greatest boon or blessing of the Lord.

TEXT 3

**AÛEv raJYa& bl/Ma*Ök-aeXa&
Pa[k-aeiPaTab]øku-l/aNal/ae Mae)
dhTv>ad]SYa PauNaNaR Mae_>aUTa(
PaaPaaYaSaa DaqiÛRJadevGaae>Ya")) 3))**

adyaiva rājyaà balam āddha-koṣaà

prakopita-brahma-kulānalo me

dahatv abhadrasya punar na me 'bhūt

pāpéyasé dhér dvija-deva-gobhyaù

SYNONYMS

adya—this day; *eva*—on the very; *rājyam*—kingdom; *balam āddha*—strength and riches; *koṣam*—treasury; *prakopita*—ignited by; *brahma-kula*—by the *brahmana* community; *analaù*—fire; *me dahatu*—let it burn me; *abhadrasya*—inauspiciousness; *punaù*—again; *na*—not; *me*—unto me; *abhūt*—may occur; *pāpéyasé*—sinful; *dhéù*—intelligence; *dvija*—*brahmanas*; *deva*—the Supreme Lord; *gobhyaù*—and the cows.

TRANSLATION

I am uncivilized and sinful due to my neglect of brahminical culture, God consciousness and cow protection. Therefore I wish that my kingdom, strength and riches burn up immediately by the fire of the brahmana's wrath so that in the future I may not be guided by such inauspicious attitudes.

PURPORT

Progressive human civilization is based on brahminical culture, God consciousness and protection of cows. All economic development of the state by trade, commerce, agriculture and industries must be fully utilized in relation to the above principles, otherwise all so-called economic development becomes a source of degradation. Cow protection means feeding the brahminical culture, which leads towards God consciousness, and thus perfection of human civilization is achieved. The age of Kali aims at killing the higher principles of life, and although Mahārāja Parékñit strongly resisted the domination of the personality of Kali within the world, the influence of the age of Kali came at an opportune moment, and even a strong king like Mahārāja Parékñit was induced to disregard the brahminical culture due to a slight provocation of hunger and thirst. Mahārāja Parékñit lamented the accidental incident, and he desired that all his kingdom, strength and accumulation of wealth would be burned up for not being engaged in brahminical culture, etc.

Where wealth and strength are not engaged in the advancement of brahminical culture, God consciousness and cow protection, the state and home are surely doomed by Providence. If we want peace and prosperity in the world, we should take lessons from this verse; every state and every home must endeavor to advance the cause of brahminical culture for self-purification, God consciousness for self-realization and cow protection for getting sufficient milk and the best food to continue a perfect civilization.

TEXT 4

Sa icNTaYaiàTQaMaQaaé*<aaed(YaQaa

**MauNae" SauTaaeċ-ae iNa%oRiTaSTa+ak-a:Ya")
Sa SaaDau MaeNae Naicre<a Ta+ak-a,
Nal&/ Pa[Saċ-SYa ivriċ-k-ar<aMa()) 4))**

sa cintayann ittham athāçåëod yathä

muneù sutokto nirâtis takñakäkhyau

sa sädhu mene na cireëa takñakä-

nalaà prasaktasya virakti-käraëam

SYNONYMS

saù—he, the King; *cintayan*—thinking; *ittham*—like this; *atha*—now; *açåëot*—heard; *yathä*—as; *muneù*—of the sage; *suta-uktaù*—uttered by the son; *nirâtiù*—death; *takñaka-äkhyau*—in relation with the snake-bird; *saù*—he (the King); *sädhu*—well and good; *mene*—accepted; *na*—not; *cireëa*—very long time; *takñaka*—snake-bird; *analam*—fire; *prasaktasya*—for one who is too attached; *virakti*—indifference; *käraëam*—cause.

TRANSLATION

While the King was thus repenting, he received news of his imminent death, which would be due to the bite of a snake-bird, occasioned by the curse spoken by the sage's son. The King accepted this as good news, for it would be the cause of his indifference toward worldly things.

PURPORT

Real happiness is achieved by spiritual existence or by cessation of the repetition of birth and death. One can stop the repetition of birth and death only by going back to Godhead. In the material world, even by attaining the topmost planet (Brahmaloka), one cannot get rid of the conditions of repeated birth and death, but still we do not accept the path of attaining perfection. The path of perfection frees one from all material attachments, and thus one becomes fit to enter into the spiritual kingdom.

Therefore, those who are materially poverty-stricken are better candidates than those who are materially prosperous. Mahārāja Parékñit was a great devotee of the Lord and a bona fide candidate for entering into the kingdom of God, but even though he was so, his material assets as the Emperor of the world were setbacks to perfect attainment of his rightful status as one of the associates of the Lord in the spiritual sky. As a devotee of the Lord, he could understand that the cursing of the *brahmana* boy, although unwise, was a blessing upon him, being the cause of detachment from worldly affairs, both political and social. Çaméka Muni also, after regretting the incident, conveyed the news to the King as a matter of duty so that the King would be able to prepare himself to go back to Godhead. Çaméka Muni sent news to the King that foolish Çàigi, his son, although a powerful *brahmana* boy, unfortunately had misused his spiritual power by cursing the King unwarrantedly. The incident of the King's garlanding the *muni* was not sufficient cause for being cursed to death, but since there was no way to retract the curse, the King was informed to prepare for death within a week. Both Çaméka Muni and the King were self-realized souls. Çaméka Muni was a mystic, and Mahārāja Parékñit was a devotee. Therefore there was no difference between them in self-realization. Neither of them was afraid of meeting death. Mahārāja Parékñit could have gone to the *muni* to beg his pardon, but the news of imminent death was conveyed to the King with so much regret by the *muni* that the King did not want to shame the *muni* further by his presence there. He decided to prepare himself for his imminent death and find out the way to go back to Godhead.

The life of a human being is a chance to prepare oneself to go back to Godhead, or to get rid of the material existence, the repetition of birth and death. Thus in the system of *varëäçrama-dharma* every man and woman is trained for this purpose. In other words, the system of *varëäçrama-dharma* is known also as *sanätana-dharma*, or the eternal occupation. The system of *varëäçrama-dharma* prepares a man for going back to Godhead, and thus a householder is ordered to go to the forest as *vänaprastha* to acquire complete knowledge and then to take *sannyäsa* prior to his inevitable death. Parékñit Mahārāja was fortunate to get a seven-day notice to meet his inevitable death. But for the common man there is no definite notice, although death is inevitable for all. Foolish men forget this sure fact of

death and neglect the duty of preparing themselves for going back to Godhead. They spoil their lives in animal propensities to eat, drink, be merry and enjoy. Such an irresponsible life is adopted by the people in the age of Kali because of a sinful desire to condemn brahminical culture, God consciousness and cow protection, for which the state is responsible. The state must employ revenue to advance these three items and thus educate the populace to prepare for death. The state which does so is the real welfare state. The state of India should better follow the examples of Mahārāja Parékñit, the ideal executive head, than to imitate other materialistic states which have no idea of the kingdom of Godhead, the ultimate goal of human life. Deterioration of the ideals of Indian civilization has brought about the deterioration of civic life, not only in India but also abroad.

TEXT 5

**AQaae ivhaYaeMaMaMau& c l/aek&-
ivMaiXaRTaaE heYaTaYaa PaurSTaaTa()
k*-Z<aax(iga)SaevaMaiDaMaNYaMaaNa
oPaaivXaTa(Pa[aYaMaMaTYaRNaŪaMa()) 5))**

atho vihäyemam amuà ca lokaà

vimarçitau heyatayä purastät

kãñëa-ighri-seväm adhimanyamäna

upäviçat präyam amartya-nadyäm

SYNONYMS

atho—thus; *vihäya*—giving up; *imam*—this; *amum*—and the next; *ca*—also; *lokam*—planets; *vimarçitau*—all of them being judged; *heyatayä*—because of inferiority; *purastät*—hereinbefore; *kãñëa-ighri*—the lotus feet of the Lord, Sri Kṛṣṇa; *seväm*—transcendental loving service; *adhimanyamäna*—one who thinks of the greatest of all achievements; *upäviçat*—sat down firmly; *präyam*—for fasting; *amartya-nadyäm*—on the bank of the

transcendental river (the Ganges or the Yamunä).

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Parékñit sat down firmly on the banks of the Ganges to concentrate his mind in Kṛṣṇa consciousness, rejecting all other practices of self-realization, because transcendental loving service to Kṛṣṇa is the greatest achievement, superseding all other methods.

PURPORT

For a devotee like Mahārāja Parékñit, none of the material planets, even the topmost Brahmaloka, is as desirable as Goloka Våndāvana, the abode of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the primeval Lord and original Personality of Godhead. This earth is one of the innumerable material planets within the universe, and there are innumerable universes also within the compass of the *mahat-tattva*. The devotees are told by the Lord and His representatives, the spiritual masters or *ācāryas*, that not one of the planets within all the innumerable universes is suitable for the residential purposes of a devotee. The devotee always desires to go back home, back to Godhead, just to become one of the associates of the Lord in the capacity of servitor, friend, parent or conjugal lover of the Lord, either in one of the innumerable Vaikuntha planets or in Goloka Våndāvana, the planet of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. All these planets are eternally situated in the spiritual sky, the *paravyoma*, which is on the other side of the Causal Ocean within the *mahat-tattva*. Mahārāja Parékñit was already aware of all this information due to his accumulated piety and birth in a high family of devotees, Vaiñēavas, and thus he was not at all interested in the material planets. Modern scientists are very eager to reach the moon by material arrangements, but they cannot conceive of the highest planet of this universe. But a devotee like Mahārāja Parékñit does not care a fig for the moon or, for that matter, any of the material planets. So when he was assured of his death on a fixed date, he became more determined in the transcendental loving service of Lord Kṛṣṇa by complete fasting on the bank of the transcendental River Yamunä, which flows down by the capital of Hastināpura (in the Delhi state). Both the Ganges and the Yamunä are *amartyä* (transcendental) rivers, and Yamunä is still more sanctified for the following reasons.

TEXT 6

Yaa vE l/SaC^\qTaul/SaqiviMaé[,
k*-Z<aax(iga]re<v>YaiDak-aMbuNae}aq)
PauNaaiTa l/aek-aNau>aYa}a SaeXaaNa(
k-STaa& Na SaeveTa MairZYaMaa<a")) 6))

yä vai lasac-chré-tulasé-vimiçra-

kãñëäïghri-reëv-abhyadhikāmbu-netré

punāti lokān ubhayatra seçān

kas tää na seveta mariñyamäëaù

SYNONYMS

yä—the river which; *vai*—always; *lasat*—floating with; *çré-tulasé*—*tulasé* leaves; *vimiçra*—mixed; *kãñëa-aïghri*—the lotus feet of the Lord, Sri Kṛṣṇa; *reëu*—dust; *abhyadhika*—auspicious; *ambu*—water; *netré*—that which is carrying; *punāti*—sanctifies; *lokān*—planets; *ubhayatra*—both the upper and lower or inside and outside; *sa-éçān*—along with Lord Siva; *kaù*—who else; *tām*—that river; *na*—does not; *seveta*—worship; *mariñyamäëaù*—one who is to die at any moment.

TRANSLATION

The river [Ganges, by which the King sat to fast] carries the most auspicious water, which is mixed with the dust of the lotus feet of the Lord and *tulasé* leaves. Therefore that water sanctifies the three worlds inside and outside and even sanctifies Lord Siva and other demigods. Consequently everyone who is destined to die must take shelter of this river.

PURPORT

Mahārāja Parékñit, just after receiving the news of his death within seven

days, at once retired from family life and shifted himself to the sacred bank of the Yamunā River. Generally it is said that the King took shelter on the bank of the Ganges, but according to Srila Jiva Gosvami, the King took shelter on the bank of the Yamunā. Srila Jiva Gosvami's statement appears to be more accurate because of the geographical situation. Mahārāja Parékñit resided in his capital Hastināpura, situated near present Delhi, and the River Yamunā flows down past the city. Naturally the King would take shelter of the River Yamunā because she was flowing past his palace door. And as far as sanctity is concerned, the River Yamunā is more directly connected with Lord Kṛṣṇa than the Ganges. The Lord sanctified the River Yamunā from the beginning of His transcendental pastimes in the world. While His father Vasudeva was crossing the Yamunā with the baby Lord Kṛṣṇa for a safe place at Gokula on the other bank of the river from Mathurā, the Lord fell down in the river, and by the dust of His lotus feet the river at once became sanctified. It is especially mentioned herein that Mahārāja Parékñit took shelter of that particular river which is beautifully flowing, carrying the dust of the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa, mixed with *tulasé* leaves. Lord Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet are always besmeared with the *tulasé* leaves, and thus as soon as His lotus feet contact the water of the Ganges and the Yamunā, the rivers become at once sanctified. The Lord, however, contacted the River Yamunā more than the Ganges. According to the *Varāha Purana*, as quoted by Srila Jiva Gosvami, there is no difference between the water of the Ganges and the Yamunā, *but when the water of the Ganges is sanctified one hundred times, it is called the Yamunā*. Similarly, it is said in the scriptures that one thousand names of Viṣṇu are equal to one name of Rāma, and three names of Lord Rāma are equal to one name of Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT 7

**wiTā VYaviC^Ū Sa Paa<@veYa"
Pa[aYaaEPAveXa& Pa[iTā ivZ<auPaŪaMa()
dDaaE Mauku-Ndax(iga]MaNaNYa>aavae
MauiNav]TaaE MauÇ-SaMaSTaSa®")) 7))**

iti vyavacchidya sa päëðaveyaù

prāyopaveṣṭhā prati viṣṇu-padyām

dadhau mukundāṅghrim ananya-bhāvo

muni-vrato mukta-samasta-saṅgaḥ

SYNONYMS

iti—thus; *vyavacchidyā*—having decided; *saḥ*—the King; *pāṇḍaveyaḥ*—worthy descendant of the Pāṇḍavas; *prāya-upaveṣṭam*—for fasting until death; *prati*—toward; *viṣṇu-padyām*—on the bank of the Ganges (emanating from the lotus feet of Lord Viṣṇu); *dadhau*—gave himself up; *mukunda-āṅghrim*—unto the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa; *ananya*—without deviation; *bhāvaḥ*—spirit; *muni-vrataḥ*—with the vows of a sage; *mukta*—liberated from; *samasta*—all kinds of; *saṅgaḥ*—association.

TRANSLATION

Thus the King, the worthy descendant of the Pāṇḍavas, decided once and for all and sat on the Ganges' bank to fast until death and give himself up to the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa, who alone is able to award liberation. So, freeing himself from all kinds of associations and attachments, he accepted the vows of a sage.

PURPORT

The water of the Ganges sanctifies all the three worlds, including the gods and the demigods, because it emanates from the lotus feet of the Personality of Godhead Viṣṇu. Lord Kṛṣṇa is the fountainhead of the principle of *viṣṇu-tattva*, and therefore shelter of His lotus feet can deliver one from all sins, including an offense committed by a king unto a *brahmana*. Mahārāja Parékṣit, therefore, decided to meditate upon the lotus feet of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, who is Mukunda, or the giver of liberations of all description. The banks of the Ganges or the Yamunā give one a chance to remember the Lord continuously. Mahārāja Parékṣit freed himself from all sorts of material association and meditated upon the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa, and that is the way of liberation. To be free from all material

association means to cease completely from committing any further sins. To meditate upon the lotus feet of the Lord means to become free from the effects of all previous sins. The conditions of the material world are so made that one has to commit sins willingly or unwillingly, and the best example is Mahārāja Parékṣit himself, who was a recognized sinless, pious king. But he also became a victim of an offense, even though he was ever unwilling to commit such a mistake. He was cursed also, but because he was a great devotee of the Lord, even such reverses of life became favorable. The principle is that one should not willingly commit any sin in his life and should constantly remember the lotus feet of the Lord without deviation. Only in such a mood will the Lord help the devotee make regular progress toward the path of liberation and thus attain the lotus feet of the Lord. Even if there are accidental sins committed by the devotee, the Lord saves the surrendered soul from all sins, as confirmed in all scriptures.

*sva-pāda-mūlāḥ bhajataṁ priyasya
tyaktāny abhāvasya hariṁ pareṣāṁ
vikarma yac cotpatitaḥ kathaṁcid
dhunoti sarvaḥ hṛdi sanniviṣṭaḥ*

(**Bhāg.** 11.5.42)

TEXT 8

**Ta}aaePaJaGMau>auRvNa& PauNaaNaa
MahaNau>aava MauNaYa" SaiXaZYaa")
Pa[aYae<a TaqQaaRi>aGaMaaPadeXaE"
SvYa& ih TaqQaaRiNa PauNaiNTa SaNTa")) 8))**

tatropajagmur bhuvanaḥ punānā

mahānubhāvā munayaṁ sa-çīṇyāṁ

prāyeṣā tērthābhigamāpadeṣaiṁ

svayaḥ hi tērthāni punanti santaṁ

SYNONYMS

tatra—there; *upajagmuù*—arrived; *bhuvanam*—the universe; *punänäù*—those who can sanctify; *mahä-anubhäväù*—great minds; *munayaù*—thinkers; *sa-çiñyäù*—along with their disciples; *präyeëa*—almost; *tértha*—place of pilgrimage; *abhigama*—journey; *apadeçaiù*—on the plea of; *svayam*—personally; *hi*—certainly; *térthäni*—all the places of pilgrimage; *punanti*—sanctify; *santaù*—sages.

TRANSLATION

At that time all the great minds and thinkers, accompanied by their disciples, and sages who could verily sanctify a place of pilgrimage just by their presence, arrived there on the plea of making a pilgrim's journey.

PURPORT

When Mahäräja Parékñit sat down on the bank of the Ganges, the news spread in all directions of the universe, and the great-minded sages, who could follow the importance of the occasion, all arrived there on the plea of pilgrimage. Actually they came to meet Mahäräja Parékñit and not to take a bath of pilgrimage because all of them were competent enough to sanctify the places of pilgrimage. Common men go to pilgrimage sites to get themselves purified of all sins. Thus the places of pilgrimage become overburdened with the sins of others. But when such sages visit overburdened places of pilgrimage, they sanctify the places by their presence. Therefore the sages who came to meet Mahäräja Parékñit were not very much interested in getting themselves purified like common men, but on the plea of taking a bath in that place they came to meet Mahäräja Parékñit because they could foresee that *Srimad-Bhagavatam* would be spoken by Çukadeva Gosvami. All of them wanted to take advantage of the great occasion.

TEXTS 9–10

**Ai}avRiSaïXCYavNa" XarÜa,
NairíNaeiMa>a*RGauri®raê)**

ParaXarae GaaiDaSauTaae_Qa raMa
oTaQYa wNd]Pa[MadeDMavahaE)) 9))
MaeDaaiTaiQadeRvI/ AaiíRze<aae
>aarÜaJaae GaaETaMa" iPaPPal/ad")
MaE}aeYa AaEvR" k-vz" ku-M>aYaaeiNa,
ÜŒPaaYaNaee >aGavaàardê)) 10))

atrir vasiñöhaç cyavanaù çaradvän

ariñöanemir bhågur aìgiräç ca

paräçaro gädhi-suto 'tha räma

utathya indrapramadedhmavähau

medhätithir devala ärñöiñeëo

bhäradväjo gautamaù pippalädaù

maitreya aurvaù kavañaù kumbhayonir

dvaipäyano bhagavän nāradaç ca

SYNONYMS

atri to *nārada*—all names of the different saintly personalities who arrived there from different parts of the universe.

TRANSLATION

From different parts of the universe there arrived great sages like Atri, Cyavana, Çaradvän, Ariñöanemi, Bhågu, Vasiñöha, Paräçara, Viçvämitra, Aìgirä, Paraçuräma, Utathya, Indrapramada, Idhmavähu, Medhätithi, Devala, Ärñöiñeëa, Bhäradväja, Gautama, Pippaläda, Maitreya, Aurva, Kavaña, Kumbhayoni, Dvaipäyana and the great personality Nārada.

PURPORT

Cyavana: A great sage and one of the sons of Bhāgu Muni. He was born prematurely when his pregnant mother was kidnapped. Cyavana is one of the six sons of his father.

Bhāgu: When Brahmājé was performing a great sacrifice on behalf of Varuëa, Maharñi Bhāgu was born from the sacrificial fire. He was a great sage, and his very dear wife was Pulomä. He could travel in space like Durväsä, Närada and others, and he used to visit all the planets of the universe. Before the Battle of Kurukñetra, he tried to stop the battle. Sometimes he instructed Bhāradväja Muni about astronomical evolution, and he is the author of the great *Bhāgu-saàhitä*, the great astrological calculation. He explained how air, fire, water and earth are generated from ether. He explained how the air in the stomach works and regulates the intestines. As a great philosopher, he logically established the eternity of the living entity (*Mahābhārata*). He was also a great anthropologist, and the theory of evolution was long ago explained by him. He was a scientific propounder of the four divisions and orders of human society known as the *varëäçrama* institution. He converted the *kñatriya* king Vétahavya into a *brahmana*.

Vasiñöha: See *Srimad-Bhagavatam* 1.9.6.

Paräçara: He is the grandson of Vasiñöha Muni and father of Vyäsadeva. He is the son of Maharñi Çakti, and his mother's name was Adäçyaté. He was in the womb of his mother when she was only twelve years old. And from within the womb of his mother he learned the *Vedas*. His father was killed by a demon, Kalmäñapäda, and to avenge this he wanted to annihilate the whole world. He was restrained, however, by his grandfather Vasiñöha. He then performed a Räkñasa-killing *yajña*, but Maharñi Pulastya restrained him. He begot Vyäsadeva, being attracted by Satyavati, who was to become the wife of Mahäräja Çäntanu. By the blessings of Paräçara, Satyavati became fragrant for miles. He was present also during the time of Bhéñma's death. He was spiritual master of Mahäräja Janaka and a great devotee of Lord Siva. He is the author of many Vedic scriptures and sociological directions.

Gädhi-suta, or Viçvämitra: A great sage of austerity and mystic power. He is

famous as Gädhi-suta because his father was Gädhi, a powerful king of the province of Kanyäkubja (part of Uttara Pradesh). Although he was a *kñatriya* by birth, he became a *brahmana* in the very same body by the power of his spiritual achievements. He picked a quarrel with Vasiñöha Muni when he was a *kñatriya* king and performed a great sacrifice in cooperation with Magaiga Muni and thus was able to vanquish the sons of Vasiñöha. He became a great *yogé*, and yet he failed to check his senses and thus was obliged to become the father of Çakuntalä, the beauty queen of world history. Once, when he was a *kñatriya* king, he visited the hermitage of Vasiñöha Muni, and he was given a royal reception. Viçvämitra wanted from Vasiñöha a cow named Nandiné, and the Muni refused to deliver it. Viçvämitra stole the cow, and thus there was a quarrel between the sage and the King. Viçvämitra was defeated by the spiritual strength of Vasiñöha, and thus the King decided to become a *brahmana*. Before becoming a *brahmana* he underwent severe austerity on the bank of the Kauçika. He was also one who tried to stop the Kurukñetra war.

Aìgirä: He is one of the six mental sons of Brahmä and the father of Bâhaspati, the great learned priest of the demigods in the heavenly planets. He was born of the semen of Brahmäjé given to a cinder of fire. Utathya and Saàvarta are his sons. It is said that he is still performing austerity and chanting the holy name of the Lord at a place known as Alokänanda on the banks of the Ganges.

Paraçuräma: See *Srimad-Bhagavatam* 1.9.6.

Utathya: One of the three sons of Maharñi Aìgirä. He was the spiritual master of Mahäräja Mandhätä. He married Bhadrä, the daughter of Soma (moon). Varuëa kidnapped his wife Bhadrä, and to retaliate the offense of the god of water, he drank all the water of the world.

Medhätithi: An old sage of yore. An assembly member of the heavenly King Indradeva. His son was Kaëva Muni, who brought up Çakuntalä in the forest. He was promoted to the heavenly planet by strictly following the principles of retired life (*vänaprastha*).

Devala: A great authority like Nārada Muni and Vyāsadeva. His good name

is on the list of authorities mentioned in the *Bhagavad-gita* when Arjuna acknowledged Lord Kṛṣṇa as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. He met Mahārāja Yudhiṣṭhira after the Battle of Kurukṣetra, and he was the elder brother of Dhaumya, the priest of the Pāṇḍava family. Like the *kṣatriyas*, he also allowed his daughter to select her own husband in a *svayaṃvara* meeting, and at that ceremony all the bachelor sons of the *āṇis* were invited. According to some, he is not Asita Devala.

Bhāradvāja: See *Srimad-Bhagavatam* 1.9.6.

Gautama: One of the seven great sages of the universe. Ṣaradvān Gautama was one of his sons. Persons in the Gautama-gotra (dynasty) today are either his family descendants or in his disciplic succession. The *brahmanas* who profess Gautama-gotra are generally family descendants, and the *kṣatriyas* and *vaishyas* who profess Gautama-gotra are all in the line of his disciplic succession. He was the husband of the famous Ahalyā who turned into stone when Indradeva, the King of the heaven, molested her. Ahalyā was delivered by Lord Rāmacandra. Gautama was the grandfather of Kāpācārya, one of the heroes of the Battle of Kurukṣetra.

Maitreya: A great *āṇi* of yore. He was spiritual master of Vidura and a great religious authority. He advised Dhātārāṣṭra to keep good relations with the Pāṇḍavas. Duryodhana disagreed and thus was cursed by him. He met Vyāsadeva and had religious discourses with him.

TEXT 11

ANYae c devizRb]øizRvYaaR
raJaizRvYaaR Aā<aadYaê)
NaaNaazeRYaPa[vraNa(SaMaeTaa,
Na>YaCYaR raJaa iXarSaa vvNde)) 11))

anye ca devarṇi-brahmarṇi-varyā

rājarṇi-varyā aruḍḍayaç ca

nānārṇeya-pravarān sametān

abhyarcya rājā çirasā vavande

SYNONYMS

anye—many others; *ca*—also; *devarñi*—saintly demigods; *brahmarñi*—saintly *brahmanas*; *varyäù*—topmost; *rājarñi-varyäù*—topmost saintly kings; *aruëa-ädayaù*—a special rank of *rājarñis*; *ca*—and; *nānā*—many others; *ärñeya-pravarän*—chief amongst the dynasties of the sages; *sametän*—assembled together; *abhyarcya*—by worshiping; *rājā*—the Emperor; *çirasā*—bowed his head to the ground; *vavande*—welcomed.

TRANSLATION

There were also many other saintly demigods, kings and special royal orders called aruëädayas [a special rank of rājarñis] from different dynasties of sages. When they all assembled together to meet the Emperor [Parékñit], he received them properly and bowed his head to the ground.

PURPORT

The system of bowing the head to the ground to show respect to superiors is an excellent etiquette which obliges the honored guest deep into the heart. Even the first-grade offender is excused simply by this process, and Mahārāja Parékñit, although honored by all the *āñis* and kings, welcomed all the big men in that humble etiquette in order to be excused from any offenses. Generally at the last stage of one's life this humble method is adopted by every sensible man in order to be excused before departure. In this way Mahārāja Parékñit implored everyone's good will for going back home, back to Godhead.

TEXT 12

Sau%aePaivíeZvQa Taezu >aUYa"
k*-TaPa[<aaMa" Svick-lizRTa& YaTa()
ivjaPaYaaMaaSa ivivç-ceTaa
oPaiSQaTaae_Ga]e_i>aGa*hqTaPaai<a")) 12))

sukhopaviñöeñv atha teñu bhüyaù

kåta-praëämaù sva-cikérñitaà yat

vijïäpayäm äsa vivikta-cetä

upasthito 'gre 'bhigåhéta-päëiù

SYNONYMS

sukha—happily; *upaviñöeñu*—all sitting down; *atha*—thereupon; *teñu*—unto them (the visitors); *bhüyaù*—again; *kåta-praëämaù*—having offered obeisances; *sva*—his own; *cikérñitam*—decision of fasting; *yat*—who; *vijïäpayäm äsa*—submitted; *vivikta-cetäù*—one whose mind is detached from worldly affairs; *upasthitaù*—being present; *agre*—before them; *abhigåhéta-päëiù*—humbly with folded hands.

TRANSLATION

After all the åñis and others had seated themselves comfortably, the King, humbly standing before them with folded hands, told them of his decision to fast until death.

PURPORT

Although the King had already decided to fast until death on the bank of the Ganges, he humbly expressed his decision to elicit the opinions of the great authorities present there. Any decision, however important, should be confirmed by some authority. That makes the matter perfect. This means that the monarchs who ruled the earth in those days were not irresponsible dictators. They scrupulously followed the authoritative decisions of the saints and sages in terms of Vedic injunction. Mahäräja Parékñit, as a perfect king, followed the principles by consulting the authorities, even up to the last days of his life.

TEXT 13

raJaaevac
Ahae vYa& DaNYaTaMaa Na*Paa<aa&
MahtaMaaNauGa]h<aqYaXaql/a")
raja& ku-l&/ b]aø<aPaadXaaEcad(
dUrad(ivSa*í& bTa GaùRk-MaR)) 13))

räjoväca

aho vayaà dhanyatamä nãpäëää

mahattamänugrahaëéya-çéläù

räjiää kulaà brahmana-päda-çaucäd

düräd visãñöaà bata garhya-karma

SYNONYMS

räjä uväca—the fortunate King said; *aho*—ah; *vayam*—we; *dhanya-tamäù*—most thankful; *nãpäëäm*—of all the kings; *mahat-tama*—of the great souls; *anugrahaëéya-çéläù*—trained to get favors; *räjiäm*—of the royal; *kulam*—orders; *brahmana-päda*—feet of the *brahmanas*; *çaucät*—refuse after cleaning; *dürät*—at a distance; *visãñöam*—always left out; *bata*—on account of; *garhya*—condemnable; *karma*—activities.

TRANSLATION

The fortunate King said: Indeed, we are the most grateful of all the kings who are trained to get favors from the great souls. Generally you [sages] consider royalty as refuse to be rejected and left in a distant place.

PURPORT

According to religious principles, stool, urine, wash water, etc., must be left at a long distance. Attached bathrooms, urinals, etc. may be very convenient amenities of modern civilization, but they are ordered to be situated at a distance from residential quarters. That very example is cited

herein in relation to the kingly order for those who are progressively marching back to Godhead. Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu said that to be in intimate touch with dollars-and-cents men, or the kingly order, is worse than suicide for one who desires to go back to Godhead. In other words, the transcendentalists do not generally associate with men who are too enamored by the external beauty of God’s creation. By advanced knowledge in spiritual realization, the transcendentalist knows that this beautiful material world is nothing but a shadowy reflection of the reality, the kingdom of God. They are not, therefore, very much captivated by royal opulence or anything like that. But in the case of Mahārāja Parékñit, the situation was different. Apparently the King was condemned to death by an inexperienced *brahmana* boy, but factually he was called by the Lord to return to Him. Other transcendentalists, the great sages and mystics who assembled together because of Mahārāja Parékñit’s fasting unto death, were quite anxious to see him, for he was going back to Godhead. Mahārāja Parékñit also could understand that the great sages who assembled there were all kind to his forefathers, the Pāñḍavas, because of their devotional service to the Lord. He therefore felt grateful to the sages for being present there at the last stage of his life, and he felt that it was all due to the greatness of his late forefathers or grandfathers. He felt proud, therefore, that he happened to be the descendant of such great devotees. Such pride for the devotees of the Lord is certainly not equal to the puffed-up sense of vanity for material prosperity. The first is reality, whereas the other is false and vain.

TEXT 14

TaSYaEv Mae_gaSYa ParavreXaae
 VYaaSaç-ictaSYa Ga*heZv>aq+<aMa()
 iNaveRdMaUI/ae iÜJaXaaPaaPaae
 Ya}a Pa[Saç-ae >aYaMaaéu Datae)) 14))

tasyaiva me 'ghasya parāvareṣo

vyāsakta-cittasya gāheñv abhékñēam

nirveda-mūlo dvija-ṣāpa-rūpo

yatra prasakto bhayam äçu dhatte

SYNONYMS

tasya—his; *eva*—certainly; *me*—mine; *aghasya*—of the sinful; *parä*—transcendental; *avara*—mundane; *éçaù*—controller, the Supreme Lord; *vyäsakta*—overly attached; *cittasya*—of the mind; *gâheñu*—to family affairs; *abhékñëam*—always; *nirveda-mûlaù*—the source of detachment; *dvija-çäpa*—cursing by the *brahmana*; *rûpaù*—form of; *yatra*—whereupon; *prasaktaù*—one who is affected; *bhayam*—fearfulness; *äçu*—very soon; *dhatte*—take place.

TRANSLATION

The Supreme Personality of Godhead, the controller of both the transcendental and mundane worlds, has graciously overtaken me in the form of a brahmana’s curse. Due to my being too much attached to family life, the Lord, in order to save me, has appeared before me in such a way that only out of fear I will detach myself from the world.

PURPORT

Mahārāja Parékñit, although born in a family of great devotees, the Pääòavas, and although securely trained in transcendental attachment for the association of the Lord, still found the allurement of mundane family life so strong that he had to be detached by a plan of the Lord. Such direct action is taken by the Lord in the case of a special devotee. Mahārāja Parékñit could understand this by the presence of the topmost transcendentalists in the universe. The Lord resides with His devotees, and therefore the presence of the great saints indicated the presence of the Lord. The King therefore welcomed the presence of the great *åñis* as a mark of favor of the Supreme Lord.

TEXT 15

**Ta& MaaePaYaaTa& Pa[iTaYaNTau ivPa[a
Ga®a c devq Da*TaictaMaqXae)**

iÜJaaePaSa*ï" ku-hk-STa+ak-ae va
dXaTvl&/ GaaYaTa ivZ<auGaaQaa")) 15))

taà mopayätaà pratiyantu viprä

gaigä ca devé dhâta-cittam éçe

dvijopasâññaù kuhakas takñako vä

daçatv alaà gäyata viṣṇu-gäthäù

SYNONYMS

tam—for that reason; *mä*—me; *upayätam*—taken shelter of; *pratiyantu*—just accept me; *vipräù*—O *brahmanas*; *gaigä*—mother Ganges; *ca*—also; *devé*—direct representative of the Lord; *dhâta*—taken into; *cittam*—heart; *éçe*—unto the Lord; *dvija-upasâññaù*—created by the *brahmana*; *kuhakaù*—something magical; *takñakaù*—the snakebird; *vä*—either; *daçatu*—let it bite; *alam*—without further delay; *gäyata*—please go on singing; *viṣṇu-gäthäù*—narration of the deeds of Viṣṇu.

TRANSLATION

O brahmanas, just accept me as a completely surrendered soul, and let mother Ganges, the representative of the Lord, also accept me in that way, for I have already taken the lotus feet of the Lord into my heart. Let the snake-bird—or whatever magical thing the brahmana created—bite me at once. I only desire that you all continue singing the deeds of Lord Viṣṇu.

PURPORT

As soon as one is given up completely unto the lotus feet of the Supreme Lord, he is not at all afraid of death. The atmosphere created by the presence of great devotees of the Lord on the bank of the Ganges and Mahārāja Parékñit's complete acceptance of the Lord's lotus feet were sufficient guarantee to the King for going back to Godhead. He thus became

absolutely free from all fear of death.

TEXT 16

PauNaê >aUYaaÜGavTYaNaNTae
riTa" Pa[Sa®ê Tadaé[Yaezu)
MahTSau Yaa& YaaMauPaYaaiMa Sa*ii&
MaE}YaSTau SavR}a NaMaae iÜJae>Ya")) 16))

punaç ca bhüyäd bhagavaty anante

ratiù prasaigaç ca tad-äçrayeñu

mahatsu yäà yäm upayämi sãñöià

maitry astu sarvatra namo dvijebhyaù

SYNONYMS

punaù—again; *ca*—and; *bhüyät*—let it be; *bhagavati*—unto Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; *anante*—who has unlimited potency; *ratiù*—attracting; *prasaigaù*—association; *ca*—also; *tad*—His; *äçrayeñu*—with those who are His devotees; *mahatsu*—within the material creation; *yäm yäm*—wherever; *upayämi*—I may take; *sãñöim*—my birth; *maitré*—friendly relation; *astu*—let it be; *sarvatra*—everywhere; *namaù*—my obeisances; *dvijebhyaù*—unto the *brahmanas*.

TRANSLATION

Again, offering obeisances unto all you brahmanas, I pray that if I should again take my birth in the material world I will have complete attachment to the unlimited Lord Kṛṣṇa, association with His devotees and friendly relations with all living beings.

PURPORT

That a devotee of the Lord is the only perfect living being is explained

herein by Mahārāja Parékñit. A devotee of the Lord is no one's enemy, although there may be many enemies of a devotee. A devotee of the Lord does not like to associate with nondevotees, although he has no enmity with them. He desires association with the devotees of the Lord. This is perfectly natural because birds of the same feather mix together. And the most important function of a devotee is to have complete attachment for Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the father of all living beings. As a good son of the father behaves in a friendly way with all his other brothers, so also the devotee of the Lord, being a good son of the supreme father, Lord Kṛṣṇa, sees all other living beings in relation with the supreme father. He tries to bring back the upstart sons of the father to a saner stage and to get them to accept the supreme fatherhood of God. Mahārāja Parékñit was certainly going back to Godhead, but even if he were not to go back, he prayed for a pattern of life which is the most perfect way in the material world. A pure devotee does not desire the company of a personality as great as Brahmā, but he prefers the association of a petty living being, provided he is a devotee of the Lord.

TEXT 17

wiTa SMa raJaaDYavSaaYaYauç-"
Pa[acqNaMaUle/zu ku-Xaezu Daqr")
odx(Mau%ae di+a<akU-I/ AaSTae
SaMaud]PaTNYaa" SvSauTaNYaSTa>aar")) 17))

iti sma rājādhyavasāya-yuktaù

prācéna-mūleñu kuṇeñu dhēraù

udai-mukho dakñiēa-kūla āste

samudra-patnyäù sva-suta-nyasta-bhāraù

SYNONYMS

iti—thus; *sma*—as in the past; *rājā*—the King; *adhyavasāya*—perseverance; *yuktaù*—being engaged; *prācéna*—eastern; *mūleñu*—with the root; *kuṇeñu*—on a seat made of *kuṇa* straw; *dhēraù*—self-controlled; *udai-*

mukhaù—facing the northern side; *dakñiëa*—on the southern; *küle*—bank; *äste*—situated; *samudra*—the sea; *patnyäù*—wife of (the Ganges); *sva*—own; *suta*—son; *nyasta*—given over; *bhäraù*—the charge of administration.

TRANSLATION

In perfect self-control, Mahārāja Parékñit sat down on a seat of straw, with straw-roots facing the east, placed on the southern bank of the Ganges, and he himself faced the north. Just previously he had given charge of his kingdom over to his son.

PURPORT

The River Ganges is celebrated as the wife of the sea. The seat of *kuça* straw is considered to be sanctified if the straw is taken out of the earth complete with root, and if the root is pointed toward the east it is considered to be auspicious. Facing the north is still more favorable for attaining spiritual success. Mahārāja Parékñit handed over the charge of administration to his son before leaving home. He was thus fully equipped for all favorable conditions.

TEXT 18

Wv& c TaiSMaàrdevdeve
Pa[aYaaePaivíe idiv devSa^a")
Pa[XaSYa >aUMaaE VYaik-rNa(Pa[SaUNaE,
MauRda MauhuduRNdu>aYaê Naedu")) 18))

evaà ca tasmin nara-deva-deve

präyopaviñöe divi deva-saighäù

praçasya bhümau vyakiran prasünair

mudä muhur dundubhayaç ca neduù

SYNONYMS

evam—thus; *ca*—and; *tasmin*—in that; *nara-deva-deve*—upon the King's; *prāya-upaviñõe*—being engaged in fasting to death; *divi*—in the sky; *deva*—demigods; *saighäù*—all of them; *praçasya*—having praised the action; *bhümau*—on the earth; *vyakiran*—scattered; *prasünaiù*—with flowers; *mudä*—in pleasure; *muhuù*—continually; *dundubhayaù*—celestial drums; *ca*—also; *neduù*—beaten.

TRANSLATION

Thus the King, Mahārāja Parékñit, sat to fast until death. All the demigods of the higher planets praised the King's actions and in pleasure continually scattered flowers over the earth and beat celestial drums.

PURPORT

Even up to the time of Mahārāja Parékñit there were interplanetary communications, and the news of Mahārāja Parékñit's fasting unto death to attain salvation reached the higher planets in the sky where the intelligent demigods live. The demigods are more luxurious than human beings, but all of them are obedient to the orders of the Supreme Lord. There is no one in the heavenly planets who is an atheist or nonbeliever. Thus any devotee of the Lord on the surface of the earth is always praised by them, and in the case of Mahārāja Parékñit they were greatly delighted and thus gave tokens of honor by scattering flowers over the earth and by beating celestial drums. A demigod takes pleasure in seeing someone go back to Godhead. He is always pleased with a devotee of the Lord, so much so that by his adhidaivic powers he may help the devotees in all respects. And by their actions, the Lord is pleased with them. There is an invisible chain of complete cooperation between the Lord, the demigods and the devotee of the Lord on earth.

TEXT 19

**MahzRYaae vE SaMauPaaGaTaa Yae
Pa[XaSYa SaaißTYaNauMaaedMaaNaa")
Ocu" Pa[JaaNauGa]hXaql/Saara
YadutaMaëaek-Gau<aai>aæPaMa()) 19))**

maharñayo vai samupägatä ye

praçasya sädhv ity anumodamänäu

ücuù prajänugraha-çéla-särä

yad uttama-çloka-guëäbhirüpan

SYNONYMS

maharñayaù—the great sages; *vai*—as a matter of course; *samupägatäù*—assembled there; *ye*—those who; *praçasya*—by praising; *sädhv*—quite all right; *iti*—thus; *anumodamänäu*—all approving; *ücuù*—said; *prajā-anugraha*—doing good to the living being; *çéla-säräù*—qualitatively powerful; *yat*—because; *uttama-çloka*—one who is praised by selected poems; *guëa-abhirüpan*—as beautiful as godly qualities.

TRANSLATION

All the great sages who were assembled there also praised the decision of Mahäräja Parékñit and they expressed their approval by saying, “Very good.” Naturally the sages are inclined to do good to common men, for they have all the qualitative powers of the Supreme Lord. Therefore they were very much pleased to see Mahäräja Parékñit, a devotee of the Lord, and they spoke as follows.

PURPORT

The natural beauty of a living being is enhanced by rising up to the platform of devotional service. Mahäräja Parékñit was absorbed in attachment for Lord Kṛṣṇa. Seeing this, the great sages assembled were very pleased, and they expressed their approval by saying, “Very good.” Such sages are naturally inclined to do good to the common man, and when they see a personality like Mahäräja Parékñit advance in devotional service, their pleasure knows no bounds, and they offer all blessings in their power. The devotional service of the Lord is so auspicious that all demigods and sages, up to the Lord Himself, became pleased with the devotee, and therefore

the devotee finds everything auspicious. All inauspicious matters are removed from the path of a progressive devotee. Meeting all the great sages at the time of death was certainly auspicious for Mahārāja Parékñit, and thus he was blessed by the so-called curse of a *brahmana*'s boy.

TEXT 20

Na va wd& raJaizRvYaR ic}a&
>avTSau k*-Z<a& SaMaNauv]Taezu)
Yae_DYaaSaNa& raJaik-rq\$=Jauí&
SaÛae Jahu>aRGavTPaaìRk-aMaa")) 20))

na vä idaà räjarñi-varya citraà

bhavatsu kãñëaà samanuvrateñu

ye 'dhyäsanaà räja-kiréöa-juñöaà

sadyo jahur bhagavat-pärçva-kämäù

SYNONYMS

na—neither; *vä*—like this; *idam*—this; *räjarñi*—saintly king; *varya*—the chief; *citram*—astonishing; *bhavatsu*—unto all of you; *kãñëam*—Lord Kṛṣṇa; *samanuvrateñu*—unto those who are strictly in the line of; *ye*—who; *adhyäsanam*—seated on the throne; *räja-kiréöa*—helmets of kings; *juñöam*—decorated; *sadyaù*—immediately; *jahuù*—gave up; *bhagavat*—the Personality of Godhead; *pärçva-kämäù*—desiring to achieve association.

TRANSLATION

[The sages said:] O chief of all the saintly kings of the Pääòu dynasty who are strictly in the line of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa! It is not at all astonishing that you give up your throne, which is decorated with the helmets of many kings, to achieve eternal association with the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

Foolish politicians who hold political administrative posts think that the temporary posts they occupy are the highest material gain of life, and therefore they stick to those posts even up to the last moment of life, without knowing that achievement of liberation as one of the associates of the Lord in His eternal abode is the highest gain of life. The human life is meant for achieving this end. The Lord has assured us in the *Bhagavad-gita* many times that going back to Godhead, His eternal abode, is the highest achievement. Prahlāda Mahārāja, while praying to Lord Nṛsiṃha, said, “O my Lord, I am very much afraid of the materialistic way of life, and I am not the least afraid of Your present ghastly ferocious feature as Nṛsiṃhadeva. This materialistic way of life is something like a grinding stone, and we are being crushed by it. We have fallen into this horrible whirlpool of the tossing waves of life, and thus, my Lord, I pray at Your lotus feet to call me back to Your eternal abode as one of Your servitors. This is the summit liberation of this materialistic way of life. I have very bitter experience of the materialistic way of life. In whichever species of life I have taken birth, compelled by the force of my own activities, I have very painfully experienced two things, namely separation from my beloved and meeting with what is not wanted. And to counteract them, the remedies which I undertook were more dangerous than the disease itself. So I drift from one point to another birth after birth, and I pray to You therefore to give me a shelter at Your lotus feet.”

The Pāṇḍava kings, who are more than many saints of the world, knew the bitter results of the materialistic way of life. They were never captivated by the glare of the imperial throne they occupied, and they sought always the opportunity of being called by the Lord to associate with Him eternally. Mahārāja Parékṣit was the worthy grandson of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira gave up the imperial throne to his grandson, and similarly Mahārāja Parékṣit, the grandson of Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira, gave up the imperial throne to his son Janamejaya. That is the way of all the kings in the dynasty because they are all strictly in the line of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Thus the devotees of the Lord are never enchanted by the glare of materialistic life, and they live impartially, unattached to the objects of the false, illusory materialistic way of life.

TEXT 21

SaveR vYa& TaavidhaSMahe_Qa
k-le/vr& YaavdSaaE ivhaYa)
I/aek&- Par& ivrJaSk&- ivXaaek&-
YaaSYaTYaYa& >aaGavTaPa[DaaNa")) 21))

sarve vayaà tävad ihämahe 'tha

kalevaraà yävad asau vihäya

lokaà paraà virajaskaà viçokaà

yäsyaty ayaà bhägavata-pradhänaù

SYNONYMS

sarve—all; *vayam*—of us; *tävat*—as long as; *iha*—at this place; *ämahe*—shall stay; *atha*—hereafter; *kalevaram*—the body; *yävat*—so long; *asau*—the King; *vihäya*—giving up; *loka*—the planet; *param*—the supreme; *virajaskam*—completely free from mundane contamination; *viçokam*—completely freed from all kinds of lamentation; *yäsyati*—returns; *ayam*—this; *bhägavata*—devotee; *pradhänaù*—the foremost.

TRANSLATION

We shall all wait here until the foremost devotee of the Lord, Mahārāja Parékñit, returns to the supreme planet, which is completely free from all mundane contamination and all kinds of lamentation.

PURPORT

Beyond the limitation of the material creation, which is compared to the cloud in the sky, there is the *paravyoma*, or the spiritual sky, full of planets called Vaikunthas. Such Vaikuntha planets are also differently known as the Puruñottamaloka, Acyutaloka, Trivikramaloka, Hñékeçaloka, Keçavaloka, Aniruddhaloka, Mädhavaloka, Pradyumnaloka, Sañkarṣṇaloka, Sridharaloka,

Väsudevaloka, Ayodhyäloka, Dvārakäloka and many other millions of spiritual *lokas* wherein the Personality of Godhead predominates; all the living entities there are liberated souls with spiritual bodies as good as that of the Lord. There is no material contamination; everything there is spiritual, and therefore there is nothing objectively lamentable. They are full of transcendental bliss, and are without birth, death, old age and disease. And amongst all the above-mentioned Vaikunthalokas, there is one supreme *loka* called Goloka Våndävana, which is the abode of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and His specific associates. Mahäräja Parékñit was destined to achieve this particular *loka*, and the great *åñis* assembled there could foresee this. All of them consulted among themselves about the great departure of the great King, and they wanted to see him up to the last moment because they would no more be able to see such a great devotee of the Lord. When a great devotee of the Lord passes away, there is nothing to be lamented because the devotee is destined to enter into the kingdom of God. But the sorry plight is that such great devotees leave our sight, and therefore there is every reason to be sorry. As the Lord is rarely to be seen by our present eyes, so also are the great devotees. The great *åñis*, therefore, correctly decided to remain on the spot till the last moment.

TEXT 22

Aaé[uTYa Tad*izGa<avc" Parqi+aTa(
 SaMa& MaDauCYaud(Gauå caVYal/Ik-Ma()
 Aa>aazTaENaaNai>aNaNÛ Yauç-aNa(
 éué[UzMaa<aêirTaaiNa ivZ<aae")) 22))

äçrutya tad åñi-gaëa-vacaù parékñit

samaà madhu-cyud guru cävyalékam

äbhäñatainän abhinandya yuktän

çuçrüñamäëaç caritäni viñëoù

SYNONYMS

äçrutya—just after hearing; *tat*—that; *ãñi-gaëa*—the sages assembled; *vacaù*—speaking; *parékñit*—Mahäräja Parékñit; *samam*—impartial; *madhu-cyut*—sweet to hear; *guru*—grave; *ca*—also; *avyalékam*—perfectly true; *äbhäñata*—said; *enän*—all of them; *abhinandya*—congratulated; *yuktän*—appropriately presented; *çuçrũñamäëaù*—being desirous to hear; *caritäni*—activities of; *viñëoù*—the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

All that was spoken by the great sages was very sweet to hear, full of meaning and appropriately presented as perfectly true. So after hearing them, Mahäräja Parékñit, desiring to hear of the activities of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, congratulated the great sages.

TEXT 23

SaMaaGaTaa" SavRTa Wv SaveR
veda YaQaa MaUiTaRDaraiñPa*ie)
NaehaQaNaaMau}a c k-êNaaQaR
%Tae ParaNauGa]hMaaTMaXaql/Ma()) 23))

samägatäù sarvata eva sarve

vedä yathä mürti-dharäs tri-pãñöhe

nehätha nämutra ca kaçcanärtha

äte paränugraham ätma-çélam

SYNONYMS

samägatäù—assembled; *sarvataù*—from all directions; *eva*—certainly; *sarve*—all of you; *vedäù*—supreme knowledge; *yathä*—as; *mürti-dharäù*—personified; *tri-pãñöhe*—on the planet of Brahmä (which is situated above the three planetary systems, namely the upper, intermediate and lower worlds); *na*—not; *iha*—in this world; *atha*—thereafter; *na*—nor; *amutra*—in the other world; *ca*—also; *kaçcana*—any other; *arthaù*—interest; *äte*—

save and except; *para*—others; *anugraham*—doing good to; *ātma-çélam*—own nature.

TRANSLATION

The King said: O great sages, you have all very kindly assembled here, having come from all parts of the universe. You are all as good as supreme knowledge personified, who resides in the planet above the three worlds [Satyaloka]. Consequently you are naturally inclined to do good to others, and but for this you have no interest, either in this life or in the next.

PURPORT

Six kinds of opulences, namely wealth, strength, fame, beauty, knowledge and renunciation, are all originally the different attributes pertaining to the Absolute Personality of Godhead. The living beings, who are part-and-parcel entities of the Supreme Being, have all these attributes partially, up to the full strength of seventy-eight percent. In the material world these attributes (up to seventy-eight percent of the Lord's attributes) are covered by the material energy, as the sun is covered by a cloud. The covered strength of the sun is very dim, compared to the original glare, and similarly the original color of the living beings with such attributes becomes almost extinct. There are three planetary systems, namely the lower worlds, the intermediate worlds and the upper worlds. The human beings on earth are situated at the beginning of the intermediate worlds, but living beings like Brahmā and his contemporaries live in the upper worlds, of which the topmost is Satyaloka. In Satyaloka the inhabitants are fully cognizant of Vedic wisdom, and thus the mystic cloud of material energy is cleared. Therefore they are known as the *Vedas* personified. Such persons, being fully aware of knowledge both mundane and transcendental, have no interest in either the mundane or transcendental worlds. They are practically desireless devotees. In the mundane world they have nothing to achieve, and in the transcendental world they are full in themselves. Then why do they come to the mundane world? They descend on different planets as messiahs by the order of the Lord to deliver the fallen souls. On the earth they come down and do good to the people of the world in different circumstances under different climatic influences. They have

nothing to do in this world save and except reclaim the fallen souls rotting in material existence, deluded by material energy.

TEXT 24

TaTaê v" Pa*C^yiMaMa& ivPa*C^e
ivé[>Ya ivPa[a wiTak*-TYaTaaYaaMa()
SavaRTMaNaa iMa]YaMaa<aEê k*-TYa&
éuÖ& c Ta}aaMa*XaTaai>aYauç-a")) 24))

tataç ca vaù p̣acchyaṁ imaà vip̣acche

viçrabhya viprā iti ḳātyatāyām

sarvātmanā mriyamäëaiç ca ḳātyaà

çuddhaà ca tatrāmāçatābhiyuktäù

SYNONYMS

tataù—as such; *ca*—and; *vaù*—unto you; *p̣acchyaṁ*—that which is to be asked; *ima*—this; *vip̣acche*—beg to ask you; *viçrabhya*—trustworthy; *viprāù*—*brahmanas*; *iti*—thus; *ḳātyatāyām*—out of all different duties; *sarva-ātmanā*—by everyone; *mriyamäëaiù*—especially those who are just about to die; *ca*—and; *ḳātyaṁ*—dutiful; *çuddham*—perfectly correct; *ca*—and; *tatra*—therein; *āmāçata*—by complete deliberation; *abhiyuktäù*—just befitting.

TRANSLATION

O trustworthy brahmanas, I now ask you about my immediate duty. Please, after proper deliberation, tell me of the unalloyed duty of everyone in all circumstances, and specifically of those who are just about to die.

PURPORT

In this verse the King has placed two questions before the learned sages. The first question is what is the duty of everyone in all circumstances, and the second question is what is the specific duty of one who is to die very shortly. Out of the two, the question relating to the dying man is most important because everyone is a dying man, either very shortly or after one hundred years. The duration of life is immaterial, but the duty of a dying man is very important. Mahārāja Parékñit placed these two questions before Çukadeva Gosvami also on his arrival, and practically the whole of the *Srimad-Bhagavatam*, beginning from the Second Canto up to the last Twelfth Canto, deals with these two questions. The conclusion arrived at thereof is that devotional service of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, as it is confirmed by the Lord Himself in the last phases of the *Bhagavad-gita*, is the last word in relation to everyone's permanent duty in life. Mahārāja Parékñit was already aware of this fact, but he wanted the great sages assembled there to unanimously give their verdict on his conviction so that he might be able to go on with his confirmed duty without controversy. He has especially mentioned the word *çuddha*, or perfectly correct. For transcendental realization or self-realization, many processes are recommended by various classes of philosophers. Some of them are first-class methods, and some of them are second- or third-class methods. The first-class method demands that one give up all other methods and surrender unto the lotus feet of the Lord and thus be saved from all sins and their reactions.

TEXT 25

Ta}aa>avÛGavaNa(VYaaSaPau}aae
Yad*C^Yaa GaaMa\$=MaaNaae_NaPae+a")
Al/+Yail/®ae iNaJal/a>aTauíae
v*Taê balE/rvDaUTavez")) 25))

tatrābhavad bhagavān vyāsa-putro

yadācchayā gām aōamāno 'napekñau

alakñya-liigo nija-lābha-tuñōo

vātaç ca bālair avadhūta-veñau

SYNONYMS

tatra—there; *abhavat*—appeared; *bhagavān*—powerful; *vyāsa-putra*—son of Vyāsadeva; *yadācchayā*—as one desires; *gām*—the earth; *aōamāna*—while traveling; *anapekñā*—disinterested; *alakñya*—unmanifested; *liiga*—symptoms; *nija-lābha*—self-realized; *tuñōa*—satisfied; *vāta*—surrounded; *ca*—and; *bālai*—by children; *avadhūta*—neglected by others; *veñā*—dressed.

TRANSLATION

At that moment there appeared the powerful son of Vyāsadeva, who traveled over the earth disinterested and satisfied with himself. He did not manifest any symptoms of belonging to any social order or status of life. He was surrounded with women and children, and he dressed as if others had neglected him.

PURPORT

The word *bhagavān* is sometimes used in relation with some of the great devotees of the Lord, like Çukadeva Gosvami. Such liberated souls are disinterested in the affairs of this material world because they are self-satisfied by the great achievements of devotional service. As explained before, Çukadeva Gosvami never accepted any formal spiritual master, nor did he undergo any formal reformatory performances. His father, Vyāsadeva, was his natural spiritual master because Çukadeva Gosvami heard *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from him. After this, he became completely self-satisfied. Thus he was not dependent on any formal process. The formal processes are necessary for those who are expected to reach the stage of complete liberation, but Sri Çukadeva Gosvami was already in that status by the grace of his father. As a young boy he was expected to be properly dressed, but he went about naked and was uninterested in social customs. He was neglected by the general populace, and inquisitive boys and women surrounded him as if he were a madman. He thus appears on the scene while traveling on the earth of his own accord. It appears that upon the inquiry of Mahārāja Parékñit, the great sages were not unanimous in their decision as to what was to be done. For spiritual salvation there were many

prescriptions according to the different modes of different persons. But the ultimate aim of life is to attain the highest perfectional stage of devotional service to the Lord. As doctors differ, so also sages differ in their different prescriptions. While such things were going on, the great and powerful son of Vyāsadeva appeared on the scene.

TEXT 26

**Ta& Üyívz| Sauku-MaarPaad,
k-raeåbaû&Sak-Paael/Gaa}aMa()
cavaRYaTaa+aaeàSaTauLYak-<aR,
Sau>...vaNaNa& k-MbuSauJaaTak-<#=Ma()) 26))**

taà dvyañña-varñaà su-kumära-päda-

karoru-bāhv-aàsa-kapola-gätram

cārv-äyatākñonnasa-tulya-karëa-

subhrv-ānanaà kambu-sujāta-kaëöham

SYNONYMS

tam—him; *dvi-añña*—sixteen; *varñam*—years; *su-kumära*—delicate; *päda*—legs; *kara*—hands; *üru*—thighs; *bāhu*—arms; *aàsa*—shoulders; *kapola*—forehead; *gätram*—body; *cāru*—beautiful; *äyata*—broad; *akñña*—eyes; *unnasa*—high nose; *tulya*—similar; *karëa*—ears; *subhru*—nice brows; *ānanam*—face; *kambu*—conchshell; *sujāta*—nicely built; *kaëöham*—neck.

TRANSLATION

This son of Vyāsadeva was only sixteen years old. His legs, hands, thighs, arms, shoulders, forehead and the other parts of his body were all delicately formed. His eyes were beautifully wide, and his nose and ears were highly raised. He had a very attractive face, and his neck was well formed and beautiful like a conchshell.

PURPORT

A respectable personality is described beginning with the legs, and this honored system is observed here with Çukadeva Gosvami. He was only sixteen years of age. A person is honored for his achievements and not for advanced age. A person can be older by experience and not by age. Sri Çukadeva Gosvami, who is described herein as the son of Vyāsadeva, was by his knowledge more experienced than all the sages present there, although he was only sixteen years old.

TEXT 27

iNaGaU!Ja}au& Pa*QauTau®v+aSa,
MaavTaRNAai>a& vil/vLGaUdr& c)
idGaMbr& v£-ivk-l<aRke-Xa&
Pa[l/Mbbahu& SvMaraetaMaa>aMa()) 27))

nigüòha-jatruà pāthu-tuìga-vakñasam

ävarta-nābhià vali-valgüdaraà ca

dig-ambaraà vaktra-vikérëa-keçaà

pralamba-bāhuà svamarottamābham

SYNONYMS

nigüòha—covered; *jatrum*—collarbone; *pāthu*—broad; *tuìga*—swollen; *vakñasam*—chest; *ävarta*—whirled; *nābhim*—navel; *vali-valgu*—striped; *udaram*—abdomen; *ca*—also; *dik-ambaram*—dressed by all directions (naked); *vaktra*—curled; *vikérëa*—scattered; *keçam*—hair; *pralamba*—elongated; *bāhum*—hands; *su-amara-uttama*—the best among the gods (Kṛṣṇa); *ābham*—hue.

TRANSLATION

His collarbone was fleshy, his chest broad and thick, his navel deep and

his abdomen beautifully striped. His arms were long, and curly hair was strewn over his beautiful face. He was naked, and the hue of his body reflected that of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

PURPORT

His bodily features indicate him to be different from common men. All the signs described in connection with the bodily features of Çukadeva Gosvami are uncommon symptoms, typical of great personalities, according to physiognomical calculations. His bodily hue resembled that of Lord Kṛṣṇa, who is the supreme among the gods, demigods and all living beings.

TEXT 28

XYaaMa& SadaPaqVYavYaae_®I/+MYaa
ñq<aa& MaNaaj& âicriSMaTaeNa)
Pa[TYauiTQaTaaSTae MauNaYa" SvaSaNaë>Ya,
STaç+a<aJa AiPa GaU!vcRSaMa()) 28))

çyāmaà sadāpévya-vayo-’iga-lakñmyä

stréëää mano-jiaà rucira-smitena

pratyutthitäs te munayaù sväsanebhyas

tal-lakñäëa-jjää api güòha-varcasam

SYNONYMS

çyāmam—blackish; *sadā*—always; *apévya*—excessively; *vayaù*—age; *aiga*—symptoms; *lakñmyä*—by the opulence of; *stréëäm*—of the fair sex; *manaù-jiam*—attractive; *rucira*—beautiful; *smitena*—smiling; *pratyutthitäù*—stood up; *te*—all of them; *munayaù*—the great sages; *sva*—own; *äsanebhyäù*—from the seats; *tat*—those; *lakñäëa-jjääù*—expert in the art of physiognomy; *api*—even; *güòha-varcasam*—covered glories.

TRANSLATION

He was blackish and very beautiful due to his youth. Because of the glamor of his body and his attractive smiles, he was pleasing to women. Though he tried to cover his natural glories, the great sages present there were all expert in the art of physiognomy, and so they honored him by rising from their seats.

TEXT 29

Sa ivZ<auraTaae_iTaQaYa AaGaTaaYa
TaSMaE SaPaYaa| iXarSaaJahar)
TaTaae iNav*taa ùbuDaa" iñYaae_>aRk-a
MahaSaNae SaaPaivveXa PaUiJaTa")) 29))

sa viṣṇu-rāto 'tithaya āgatāya

tasmai saparyāḥ çirasājahāra

tato nivāttā hy abudhāu striyo 'rbhakā

mahāsane sopaviveça pūjitaù

SYNONYMS

saù—he; *viṣṇu-rātaù*—Mahārāja Parékñit (who is always protected by Lord Viṣṇu); *atithaye*—to become a guest; *āgatāya*—one who arrived there; *tasmai*—unto him; *saparyām*—with the whole body; *çirasā*—with bowed head; *ājahāra*—offered obeisances; *tataù*—thereafter; *nivāttāù*—ceased; *hi*—certainly; *abudhāù*—less intelligent; *striyaù*—women; *arbhakāù*—boys; *mahā-āsane*—exalted seat; *sa*—he; *upaviveça*—sat down; *pūjitaù*—being respected.

TRANSLATION

Mahārāja Parékñit, who is also known as Viṣṇurāta [one who is always protected by Viṣṇu], bowed his head to receive the chief guest, Çukadeva Gosvami. At that time all the ignorant women and boys ceased following Srila Çukadeva. Receiving respect from all, Çukadeva Gosvami took his

exalted seat.

PURPORT

On Çukadeva Gosvami's arrival at the meeting, everyone, except Srila Vyāsadeva, Nārada and a few others, stood up, and Mahārāja Parékñit, who was glad to receive a great devotee of the Lord, bowed down before him with all the limbs of his body. Çukadeva Gosvami also exchanged the greetings and reception by embrace, shaking of hands, nodding and bowing down, especially before his father and Nārada Muni. Thus he was offered the presidential seat at the meeting. When he was so received by the king and sages, the street boys and less intelligent women who followed him were struck with wonder and fear. So they retired from their frivolous activities, and everything was full of gravity and calm.

TEXT 30

Sa Sa&v*TaSTa}a MahaNa(MahqYaSaa&
b]øizRraJaizRdevizRSa°E")
VYaraecTaal&/ >aGavaNa(YaQaeNdu,
Ga]Rh+aRTaaraiNak-rE" ParqTa")) 30))

sa saàvâtas tatra mahän mahéyasäà

brahmarñi-räjarñi-devarñi-saighaiù

vyarocatälaà bhagavän yathendur

graharkña-tärä-nikaraiù parétaù

SYNONYMS

saù—Sri Çukadeva Gosvami; *saàvâtaù*—surrounded by; *tatra*—there; *mahän*—great; *mahéyasäm*—of the greatest; *brahmarñi*—saint among the *brahmanas*; *räjarñi*—saint among the kings; *devarñi*—saint among the demigods; *saighaiù*—by the assembly of; *vyarocata*—well deserved; *alam*—able; *bhagavän*—powerful; *yathä*—as; *induù*—the moon; *graha*—

planets; *ākṣa*—heavenly bodies; *tārā*—stars; *nikaraiu*—by the assembly of; *parétau*—surrounded by.

TRANSLATION

Çukadeva Gosvami was then surrounded by saintly sages and demigods just as the moon is surrounded by stars, planets and other heavenly bodies. His presence was gorgeous, and he was respected by all.

PURPORT

In the great assembly of saintly personalities, there was Vyāsadeva the *brahmarṇi*, Nārada the *devarṇi*, Paraçurāma the great ruler of the *kṣatriya* kings, etc. Some of them were powerful incarnations of the Lord. Çukadeva Gosvami was not known as *brahmarṇi*, *rājarṇi* or *devarṇi*, nor was he an incarnation like Nārada, Vyāsa or Paraçurāma. And yet he excelled them in respects paid. This means that the devotee of the Lord is more honored in the world than the Lord Himself. One should therefore never minimize the importance of a devotee like Çukadeva Gosvami.

TEXT 31

Pa[XaaNTaMaaSaqNaMaku-<#=MaeDaSa&
MauINa& Na*Paae >aaGavTaae_>YauPaeTYa)
Pa[<aMYa MaUDNaaRvihTa" k*-TaaÅil/
NaRTva iGara SaUNa*TaYaaNvPa*C^Ta()) 31))

praçäntam äsénam akuëöha-medhasaà

munià nãpo bhägavato 'bhyupetya

praëamya mürdhnävahitaù kâtäijalir

natvä girä sünätayänvapâcchat

SYNONYMS

praçäntam—perfectly pacified; *äsénam*—sitting; *akuëöha*—without hesitation; *medhasam*—one who has sufficient intelligence; *munim*—unto the great sage; *näpaù*—the King (Mahäräja Parékñit); *bhägavataù*—the great devotee; *abhyupetya*—approaching him; *praëamyä*—bowing down; *mürdhnä*—his head; *avahitaù*—properly; *kâta-aïjaliù*—with folded hands; *natvä*—politely; *girä*—by words; *sünätayä*—in sweet voices; *anvapäcchat*—inquired.

TRANSLATION

The sage Sri Çukadeva Gosvami sat perfectly pacified, intelligent and ready to answer any question without hesitation. The great devotee, Mahäräja Parékñit, approached him, offered his respects by bowing before him, and politely inquired with sweet words and folded hands.

PURPORT

The gesture now adopted by Mahäräja Parékñit of questioning a master is quite befitting in terms of scriptural injunctions. The scriptural injunction is that one should humbly approach a spiritual master to understand the transcendental science. Mahäräja Parékñit was now prepared for meeting his death, and within the very short time of seven days he was to know the process of entering the kingdom of God. In such important cases, one is required to approach a spiritual master. There is no necessity of approaching a spiritual master unless one is in need of solving the problems of life. One who does not know how to put questions before the spiritual master has no business seeing him. And the qualification of the spiritual master is perfectly manifested in the person of Çukadeva Gosvami. Both the spiritual master and the disciple, namely Sri Çukadeva Gosvami and Mahäräja Parékñit, attained perfection through the medium of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Çukadeva Gosvami learned *Srimad-Bhagavatam* from his father, Vyäsadeva, but he had no chance to recite it. Before Mahäräja Parékñit he recited *Srimad-Bhagavatam* and answered the questions of Mahäräja Parékñit unhesitatingly, and thus both the master and the disciple got salvation.

TEXT 32

Parqi+aduvac
Ahae AÛ vYa& b]øNa(SaTSaeVYaa" +a}abNDav")
k*-PaYaiTaiQæPae<a >aviÛSTaqQaRk-a" k*-Taa")) 32))

parékñid uvāca

aho adya vayaà brahman

sat-sevyäù kñatra-bandhavaù

kāpayätithi-rüpeëa

bhavadbhis térthakäù kâtäù

SYNONYMS

parékñit uvāca—the fortunate Mahārāja Parékñit said; *aho*—ah; *adya*—today; *vayam*—we; *brahman*—O *brahmana*; *sat-sevyäù*—eligible to serve the devotee; *kñatra*—the ruling class; *bandhavaù*—friends; *kāpayä*—by your mercy; *atithi-rüpeëa*—in the manner of a guest; *bhavadbhiù*—by your good self; *térthakäù*—qualified for being places of pilgrimage; *kâtäù*—done by you.

TRANSLATION

The fortunate King Parékñit said: O brahmana, by your mercy only, you have sanctified us, making us like unto places of pilgrimage, all by your presence here as my guest. By your mercy, we, who are but unworthy royalty, become eligible to serve the devotee.

PURPORT

Saintly devotees like Çukadeva Gosvami generally do not approach worldly enjoyers, especially those in royal orders. Mahārāja Pratāparudra was a follower of Lord Caitanya, but when he wanted to see the Lord, the Lord refused to see him because he was a king. For a devotee who desires to go back to Godhead, two things are strictly prohibited: worldly enjoyers and

women. Therefore, devotees of the standard of Çukadeva Gosvami are never interested in seeing kings. Mahārāja Parékñit was, of course, a different case. He was a great devotee, although a king, and therefore Çukadeva Gosvami came to see him in his last stage of life. Mahārāja Parékñit, out of his devotional humility, felt himself an unworthy descendant of his great *kñatriya* forefathers, although he was as great as his predecessors. The unworthy sons of the royal orders are called *kñatra-bandhavas*, as the unworthy sons of the *brahmanas* are called *dvija-bandhus* or *brahma-bandhus*. Mahārāja Parékñit was greatly encouraged by the presence of Çukadeva Gosvami. He felt himself sanctified by the presence of the great saint whose presence turns any place into a place of pilgrimage.

TEXT 33

Yaeza& Sa&SMar<aaTa(Pau&Saa& SaÛ" éuÖyiNTa vE Ga*ha")
ik&- PauNadRXaRNaSPaXaRPaadXaaEcaSaNaaidi>a")) 33))

yeñää saàsmaraëät puàsää

sadyaù çuddhyanti vai gâhäu

kià punar darçana-sparça-

päda-çaucäsanädibhiù

SYNONYMS

yeñäm—of whom; *saàsmaraëät*—by remembrance; *puàsäm*—of a person; *sadyaù*—instantly; *çuddhyanti*—cleanses; *vai*—certainly; *gâhäu*—all houses; *kim*—what; *punaù*—then; *darçana*—meeting; *sparça*—touching; *päda*—the feet; *çauca*—washing; *äsana-ädibhiù*—by offering a seat, etc.

TRANSLATION

**Simply by our remembering you, our houses become instantly sanctified.
And what to speak of seeing you, touching you, washing your holy feet**

and offering you a seat in our home?

PURPORT

The importance of holy places of pilgrimage is due to the presence of great sages and saints. It is said that sinful persons go to the holy places and leave their sins there to accumulate. But the presence of the great saints disinfects the accumulated sins, and thus the holy places continue to remain sanctified by the grace of the devotees and saints present there. If such saints appear in the homes of worldly people, certainly the accumulated sins of such worldly enjoyers become neutralized. Therefore, the holy saints actually have no self-interest with the householders. The only aim of such saints is to sanctify the houses of the householders, and the householders therefore should feel grateful when such saints and sages appear at their doors. A householder who dishonors such holy orders is a great offender. It is enjoined, therefore, that a householder who does not bow down before a saint at once must undergo fasting for the day in order to neutralize the great offense.

TEXT 34

SaaiaDYaatae MahaYaaeiGaNPaTak-aiNa MahaNTYaiPa)
SaUae NaXYaiNTa vE Pau&Saa& ivZ<aaeirv SaureTara")) 34))

sānnidhyāt te mahā-yogin

pātakāni mahānti api

sadyo naçyanti vai puàsā

viñëor iva suretarāu

SYNONYMS

sānnidhyāt—on account of the presence; *te*—your; *mahā-yogin*—O great mystic; *pātakāni*—sins; *mahānti*—invulnerable; *api*—in spite of; *sadyaù*—immediately; *naçyanti*—vanquished; *vai*—certainly; *puàsām*—of a person;

viñëoù—like the presence of the Personality of Godhead; *iva*—like; *sura-itaräù*—other than the demigods.

TRANSLATION

Just as the atheist cannot remain in the presence of the Personality of Godhead, so also the invulnerable sins of a man are immediately vanquished in your presence, O saint! O great mystic!

PURPORT

There are two classes of human beings, namely the atheist and the devotee of the Lord. The devotee of the Lord, because of manifesting godly qualities, is called a demigod, whereas the atheist is called a demon. The demon cannot stand the presence of Viṣṇu, the Personality of Godhead. The demons are always busy in trying to vanquish the Personality of Godhead, but factually as soon as the Personality of Godhead appears, by either His transcendental name, form, attributes, pastimes, paraphernalia or variegatedness, the demon is at once vanquished. It is said that a ghost cannot remain as soon as the holy name of the Lord is chanted. The great saints and devotees of the Lord are in the list of His paraphernalia, and thus as soon as a saintly devotee is present, the ghostly sins are at once vanquished. That is the verdict of all Vedic literatures. One is recommended, therefore, to associate only with saintly devotees so that worldly demons and ghosts cannot exert their sinister influence.

TEXT 35

**AiPa Mae >aGavaNa(Pa[qTa" k*-Z<a" Paa<@uSauTaiPa[Ya")
PaETa*ZvSaeYaPa[qTYaQa| TaÓae}aSYaatabaNDav")) 35))**

api me bhagavān prētaù

kāñëaù päëòu-suta-priyaù

paitā-ñvaseya-prēty-arthāà

tad-gotrasyätta-bāndhavaù

SYNONYMS

api—definitely; *me*—unto me; *bhagavān*—the Personality of Godhead; *prētaù*—pleased; *kāñēaù*—the Lord; *päëòu-suta*—the sons of King Päëòu; *priyaù*—dear; *paitā*—in relation with the father; *svaseya*—the sons of the sister; *prēti*—satisfaction; *artham*—in the matter of; *tat*—their; *gotrasya*—of the descendant; *ätta*—accepted; *bāndhavaù*—as a friend.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, who is very dear to the sons of King Päëòu, has accepted me as one of those relatives just to please His great cousins and brothers.

PURPORT

A pure and exclusive devotee of the Lord serves his family interest more dexterously than others, who are attached to illusory family affairs. Generally people are attached to family matters, and the whole economic impetus of human society is moving under the influence of family affection. Such deluded persons have no information that one can render better service to the family by becoming a devotee of the Lord. The Lord gives special protection to the family members and descendants of a devotee, even though such members are themselves nondevotees! Mahārāja Prahlaḍa was a great devotee of the Lord, but his father, Hiraṇyakaśipu, was a great atheist and declared enemy of the Lord. But despite all this, Hiraṇyakaśipu was awarded salvation due to his being the father of Mahārāja Prahlaḍa. The Lord is so kind that he gives all protection to the family members of His devotee, and thus the devotee has no need to bother about his family members, even if one leaves such family members aside to discharge devotional service. Mahārāja Yudhiñöhira and his brothers were the sons of Kunté, the paternal aunt of Lord Kṛṣṇa, and Mahārāja Parékñit admits the patronage of Lord Kṛṣṇa because of his being the only grandson of the great Päëòavas.

TEXT 36

ANYaQaa Tae_VYaç-GaTaedRXaRNa& Na" k-Qa& Na*<aaMa()
iNaTara& iMa]YaMaa<aaNaa& Sa&iSaÖSYa vNaqYaSa")) 36))

anyathä te 'vyakta-gater

darçanaà naù kathaà nãëäm

nitaräà mriyamäëänäà

saàsiddhasya vanéyasaù

SYNONYMS

anyathä—otherwise; *te*—your; *avyakta-gateù*—of one whose movements are invisible; *darçanam*—meeting; *naù*—for us; *katham*—how; *nãëäm*—of the people; *nitaräm*—specifically; *mriyamäëänäm*—of those who are about to die; *saàsiddhasya*—of one who is all-perfect; *vanéyasaù*—voluntary appearance.

TRANSLATION

Otherwise [without being inspired by Lord Kṛṣṇa] how is it that you have voluntarily appeared here, though you are moving incognito to the common man and are not visible to us who are on the verge of death?

PURPORT

The great sage Çukadeva Gosvami was certainly inspired by Lord Kṛṣṇa to appear voluntarily before Mahārāja Parékñit, the great devotee of the Lord, just to give him the teachings of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. One can achieve the nucleus of the devotional service of the Lord by the mercy of the spiritual master and the Personality of Godhead. The spiritual master is the manifested representative of the Lord to help one achieve ultimate success. One who is not authorized by the Lord cannot become a spiritual master. Srila Çukadeva Gosvami is an authorized spiritual master, and thus he was

inspired by the Lord to appear before Mahārāja Parékñit and instruct him in the teachings of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. One can achieve the ultimate success of going back to Godhead if he is favored by the Lord's sending His true representative. As soon as a true representative of the Lord is met by a devotee of the Lord, the devotee is assured a guarantee for going back to Godhead just after leaving the present body. This, however, depends on the sincerity of the devotee himself. The Lord is seated in the heart of all living beings, and thus he knows very well the movements of all individual persons. As soon as the Lord finds that a particular soul is very eager to go back to Godhead, the Lord at once sends His bona fide representative. The sincere devotee is thus assured by the Lord of going back to Godhead. The conclusion is that to get the assistance and help of a bona fide spiritual master means *to receive the direct help of the Lord Himself*.

TEXT 37

**ATa" Pa*C^aiMa Sa&iSaiÖ& YaaeiGaNa& ParMa& GauåMa()
PauåSYaeh YaTk-aYa| iMa]YaMaa<aSYa SavRQaa)) 37))**

ataù pācchāmi saāsiddhiā

yogināā paramaā gurum

puruṣasyeha yat kāryaā

mriyamāēasya sarvathā

SYNONYMS

ataù—therefore; *pācchāmi*—beg to inquire; *saāsiddhim*—the way of perfection; *yoginām*—of the saints; *paramam*—the supreme; *gurum*—the spiritual master; *puruṣasya*—of a person; *iha*—in this life; *yat*—whatever; *kāryam*—duty; *mriyamāēasya*—of one who is going to die; *sarvathā*—in every way.

TRANSLATION

You are the spiritual master of great saints and devotees. I am therefore begging you to show the way of perfection for all persons, and especially for one who is about to die.

PURPORT

Unless one is perfectly anxious to inquire about the way of perfection, there is no necessity of approaching a spiritual master. A spiritual master is not a kind of decoration for a householder. Generally a fashionable materialist engages a so-called spiritual master without any profit. The pseudo spiritual master flatters the so-called disciple, and thereby both the master and his ward go to hell without a doubt. Mahārāja Parékñit is the right type of disciple because he puts forward questions vital to the interest of all men, particularly for the dying men. The question put forward by Mahārāja Parékñit is the basic principle of the complete thesis of *Srimad-Bhagavatam*. Now let us see how intelligently the great master replies.

TEXT 38

**Yac^{\ae}TaVYaMaQaae JaPYa& YaTk-TaRVYa& Na*i>a" Pa[>aae)
SMaTaRVYa& >aJaNaqYa& va b]Uih YaÜa ivPaYaRYaMa()) 38))**

yac chrotavyam atho japyà

yat kartavyà nâbhiù prabho

smartavyà bhajanéyà vâ

brühi yad vâ viparyayam

SYNONYMS

yat—whatever; *çrotavyam*—worth hearing; *atho*—thereof; *japyam*—chanted; *yat*—what also; *kartavyam*—executed; *nâbhiù*—by the people in general; *prabho*—O master; *smartavyam*—that which is remembered; *bhajanéyam*—worshipable; *vâ*—either; *brühi*—please explain; *yad vâ*—what it may be; *viparyayam*—against the principle.

TRANSLATION

Please let me know what a man should hear, chant, remember and worship, and also what he should not do. Please explain all this to me.

TEXT 39

NaUNa& >aGavTaae b]øNa(Ga*hezu Ga*hMaeiDaNaaMa()
Na I/+YaTae ùvSQaaNaMaiPa GaaedaehNa& KvicTa()) 39))

nünaà bhagavato brahman

gãheñu gãha-medhinäm

na lakñyate hy avasthänam

api go-dohanaà kvacit

SYNONYMS

nünam—because; *bhagavataù*—of you, who are powerful; *brahman*—O *brahmana*; *gãheñu*—in the houses; *gãha-medhinäm*—of the householders; *na*—not; *lakñyate*—are seen; *hi*—exactly; *avasthänam*—staying in; *api*—even; *go-dohanam*—milking the cow; *kvacit*—rarely.

TRANSLATION

O powerful brahmana, it is said that you hardly stay in the houses of men long enough to milk a cow.

PURPORT

Saints and sages in the renounced order of life go to the houses of the householders at the time they milk the cows, early in the morning, and ask some quantity of milk for subsistence. A pound of milk fresh from the milk bag of a cow is sufficient to feed an adult with all vitamin values, and therefore saints and sages live only on milk. Even the poorest of the

householders keep at least ten cows, each delivering twelve to twenty quarts of milk, and therefore no one hesitates to spare a few pounds of milk for the mendicants. It is the duty of householders to maintain the saints and sages, like the children. So a saint like Çukadeva Gosvami would hardly stay at the house of a householder for more than five minutes in the morning. In other words, such saints are very rarely seen in the houses of householders, and Mahārāja Parékñit therefore prayed to him to instruct him as soon as possible. The householders also should be intelligent enough to get some transcendental information from visiting sages. The householder should not foolishly ask a saint to deliver what is available in the market. That should be the reciprocal relation between the saints and the householders.

TEXT 40

SaUTa ovac

WvMaa>aaizTa" Pa*i" Sa raja ë+<aYaa iGara)
Pa[TYa>aazTa DaMaRjae >aGavaNa(badraYai<a")) 40))

sūta uvāca

evam ābhāñitaù pññaù

sa rājā çlakñēyā girā

pratyabhāñata dharma-jñō

bhagavān bādarāyaēiù

SYNONYMS

sūtaù uvāca—Sri Sūta Gosvami said; *evam*—thus; *ābhāñitaù*—being spoken; *pññaù*—and asked for; *saù*—he; *rājā*—by the King; *çlakñēyā*—by sweet; *girā*—language; *pratyabhāñata*—began to reply; *dharma-jñō*—one who knows the principles of religion; *bhagavān*—the powerful personality; *bādarāyaēiù*—son of Vyāsadeva.

TRANSLATION

Sri Sūta Gosvami said: The King thus spoke and questioned the sage, using sweet language. Then the great and powerful personality, the son of Vyāsadeva, who knew the principles of religion, began his reply.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Nineteenth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled “The Appearance of Çukadeva Gosvami.”

END OF THE FIRST CANTO

ⁱIn our *Teachings of Lord Caitanya* we have more elaborately explained all these philosophical intricacies. *Çrémad-Bhāgavatam* clarifies them all.

ⁱⁱThe complete text of the explanation given by the Lord will form a booklet itself, and therefore we have presented it in a chapter in our *Teachings of Lord Caitanya*.

ⁱⁱⁱThe International Society for Krishna Consciousness has been formed for this purpose.

^{iv}Summary of *Çrémad-Bhāgavatam*.

^v*Çrépāda Çaikarācārya*, the head of the Māyāvāda school, accepts this transcendental position of Lord Kāñēa in his commentation on *Bhagavad-gétā*.

^{vi}*dvā suparēā sayujā sakhāyā
samānā vākñā pariñasvajāte
tayoṛ anyau pippalā svādv atty
anaçnann anyo ’bhicākaçéti
(Muēðaka Upaēñad 3.1.1)*

^{vii}*nityo nityānā cetanaç cetanānām
eko bahünā yo vidadhāti kāmān
tam ātma-sthā ye ’nupaçyanti dhérās
teñā çāntiū çāçvaté netareñām
(Kaōha Upaniñad)*

^{viii}*cintāmaēi-prakara-sadmasu kalpa-vākñā-
lakñāvāteñu surabhér abhipālayantam*

*lakñmé-sahasra-çata-sambhrama-sevyamānaà
govindam ädi-puruññaà tam ahaà bhajāmi
(Bs. 5.29)*

*^{ix}yataù pravāttir bhütānāà
yena sarvam idaà tatam
sva-karmaēā tam abhyarcya
siddhià vindati mānavaù
(Bg. 18.46)*

*ataù pumbhir dvija-çreñöhä
varēäçrama-vibhāgaçaù
svanuñöhitasya dharmasya
saàsiddhir hari-toñaëam
(**Bhäg.** 1.2.13)*

**An akñauhiëé phalanx consists of 21,870 chariots, 21,870 elephants,
109,350 infantry-men and 65,610 horses.*